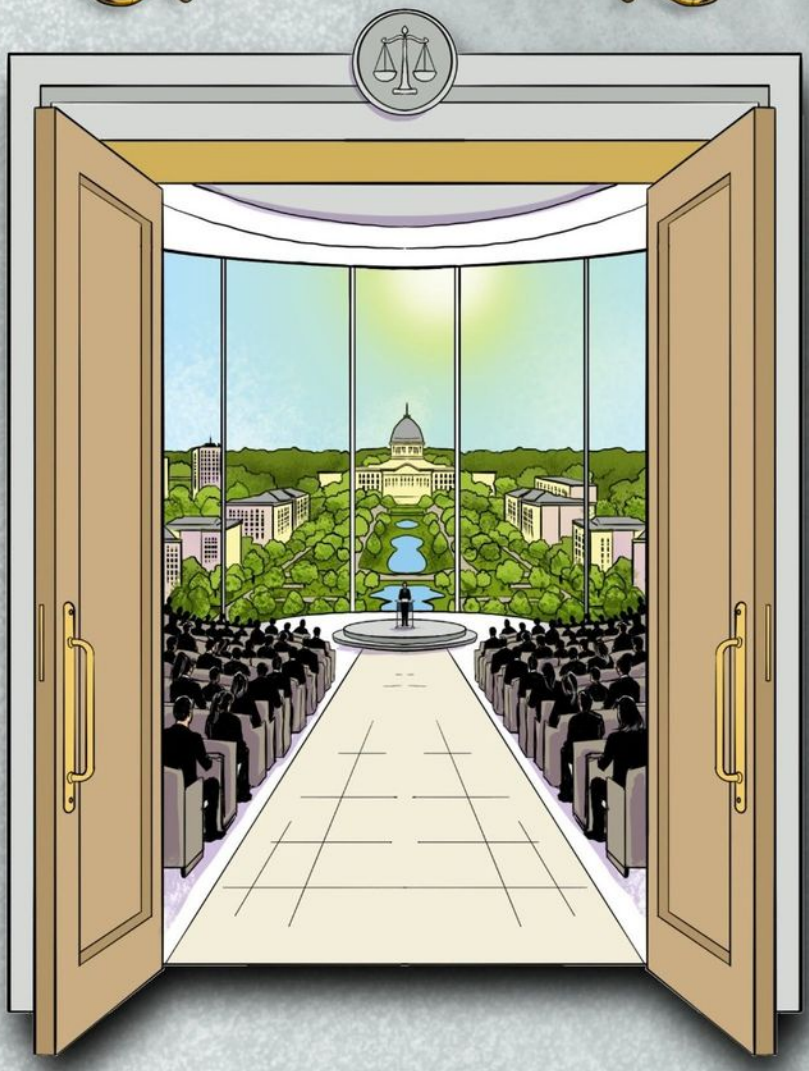
The City of Fairness



Stephen Takowsky

The City of Fairness

Reference Edition

Stephen Takowsky

Publishing Details

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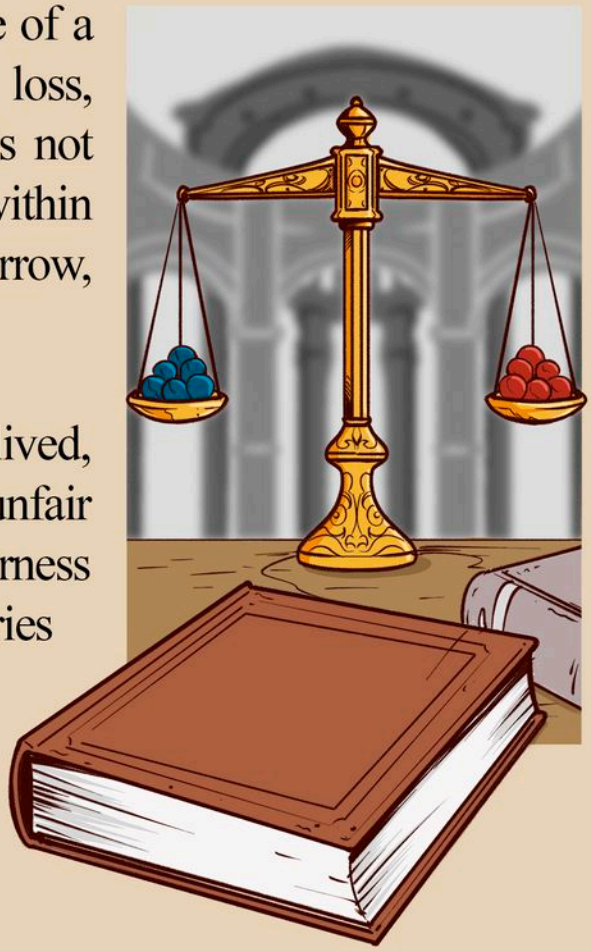
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Series Map

THE LAW OF FAIRNESS

A new way of seeing every life.

We judge fairness by the visible shape of a life: health and hardship, love and loss, opportunity and misfortune. Yet life is not lived from the outside. It is lived within consciousness, through joy and sorrow, pleasure and pain, peace and fear.



Could life be fair where it is actually lived, even when it appears profoundly unfair from the outside? The Law of Fairness proposes that every felt experience carries weight according to its intensity and duration. Across the completed conscious life, total positive and negative feeling exactly balance.

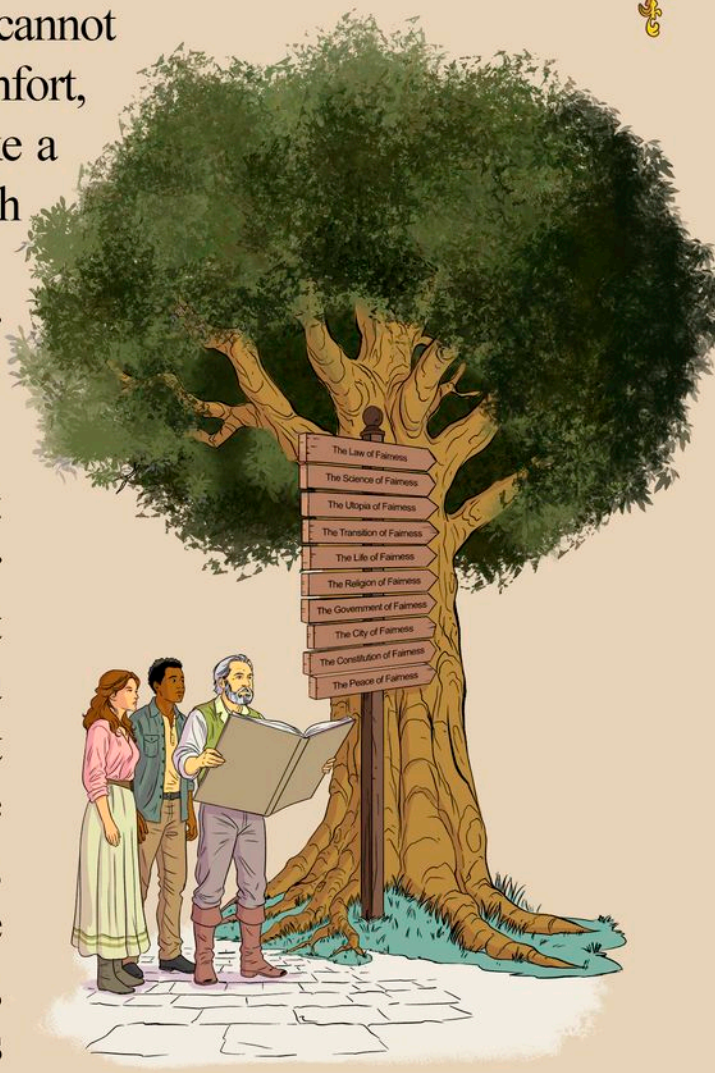
Picture a scale open for a lifetime. Joy and relief add weight to one side; pain and grief to the other. It may tip heavily for years, but when the conscious life is complete, the two sides balance. Each life carries its own scale. No life balances another.

Lives may differ enormously in length, choices, pleasures, wounds, and circumstances. The scale weighs neither wealth nor virtue, status nor faith. It weighs felt experience alone. Circumstances tell the visible story of a life, but feeling is how that story is lived. The Law asks us not to mistake the visible story for the whole.

WHAT IF THE LAW IS REAL?

A new meaning of utopia.

If the Law of Fairness is real, utopia cannot mean endless pleasure. More comfort, luxury, or consumption does not make a society ideal. If conscious lives end with no lasting surplus of positive feeling, utopia must mean something deeper and steadier than limitless happiness.



"There is no free happiness" does not mean joy is wrong, pain is payment, or suffering is holy. Pleasure alone cannot define a good life, nor appearances a good society. The goal is joy without excess. A fairer world would reduce needless suffering, poverty, disease, cruelty, corruption, and abuse while protecting love, beauty, rest, play, choice, and joy. Moderation restrains excess, work builds worthy goals, and stewardship preserves the world so future generations inherit something worth protecting.

If the Law is real, its deepest equality lies beneath wealth, status, power, culture, and belief. Lives may differ while reaching the same final balance of felt experience. These ten books follow that question from science into life, spirituality, government, cities, law, transition, and peace, exploring how humanity might build a lasting utopia.

THE TEN BOOKS OF FAIRNESS

A complete path from truth to practice.

THE LAW OF FAIRNESS



Explores the core question, defines key terms, and sets the ethical bounds of the series.

THE SCIENCE OF FAIRNESS



Evaluates the Law through evidence, measurement, rival models, protocols, and falsification.

THE UTOPIA OF FAIRNESS



Brings the series into a mature view of what a peaceful world could become.

THE TRANSITION OF FAIRNESS



Asks how a move toward utopia could unfold with care, step by step, under real limits.

THE LIFE OF FAIRNESS



Brings the Law into daily life and asks what it means for how we live.

THE RELIGION OF FAIRNESS



Explores faith, world religions, and the optional path of Fairness.

THE GOVERNMENT OF FAIRNESS



Examines civic structure and the public institutions that give it form in practice.

THE CITY OF FAIRNESS



Builds a civic space for learning, service, and peace with privacy kept safe.

THE CONSTITUTION OF FAIRNESS



Sets out the rights, rules, paths, and checks a lasting utopia would need.

THE PEACE OF FAIRNESS



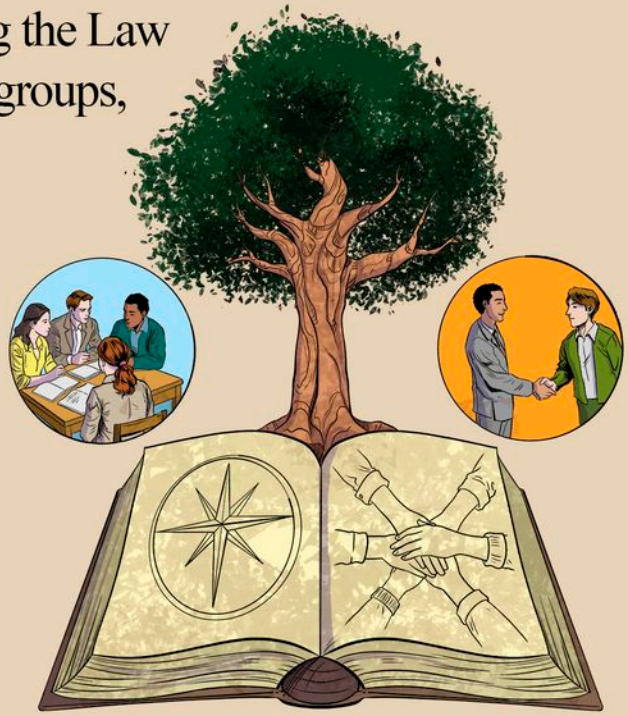
Builds the base for lasting peace and a fairer future for all humanity.

The series moves from the deepest question about reality to the structures that make a more peaceful world.

THE WORK AHEAD

A shared mission to build a better world.

Read the books, share them, and bring the Law of Fairness into classrooms, research groups, reading circles, and community conversations. Important ideas grow stronger when people examine them together, challenge assumptions, compare perspectives, and turn understanding into shared effort.



Scientists, researchers, clinicians, philosophers, and other experts can help test the Law, refine its measurements, improve its methods, and compare it with strong rivals. Serious criticism is essential. It exposes weaknesses, sharpens the questions, and helps reveal what should endure, what needs revision, and what should be rejected.

Beyond the hypothesis lies a practical challenge: building a world with less corruption and needless suffering, and more room for dignity, freedom, meaning, beauty, and opportunity. If this project speaks to you, bring your knowledge, experience, curiosity, and determination. Progress begins when people from different paths meet, share what they know, and build what survives scrutiny.

Help us make this generation
the one that brought peace to our world.

How to Read This Book

This Reference Edition explores the book's ideas in depth and develops the reasoning behind them. The companion Foundation Edition distills the essential ideas into a shorter, accessible introduction that stands on its own and requires no specialized background.

The City of Fairness asks a practical democratic question: could people learn how a future public official exercises judgment long before deciding whether to entrust that person with power?

The proposed City is a bounded civic setting for adults who voluntarily prepare for public responsibility under the Transparent Vow. The record concerns a declared active role and period, not the participant's entire personal life. Private life remains protected. Family members, visitors, staff, and clinicians retain their own rights and are not automatically made public because they know a participant. A person may remain outside the program. Participation grants neither office nor a higher rank of human worth. Independent correction matters.

Read Part I first for the City's purpose and limits. Parts II and III consider physical boundaries, protected spaces, rights, and the governed record. Parts IV and V address voluntary entry, material support, family life, and the ordinary conditions needed to make a public commitment possible. Parts VI and VII examine learning, deliberation, readiness, and the handoff to lawful public office. Part VIII develops independent governance and correction. Part IX looks at costs, pilots, evidence, and replication. Part X tests the strongest objections and draws the argument together. The order matters: the City's proposed benefits have to be understood alongside its privacy boundaries, appeal procedures, and alternatives. A visible record is useful only if people can interpret and contest it.

For a shorter route, begin with Chapter 1, then Chapter 2 on the bounded active record and Chapter 9 on rights. Follow the fictional Mara case from Section 1.1 to Section 29.3.4, where a disputed account moves through review, appeal, and verified correction. Chapter 30 explains why a sound decision must survive the technical systems that publish and preserve the record. Mara is a teaching case, not an observed City result.

Architects and accessibility specialists can begin with Chapters 5–8, then read Chapters 17–21 on daily life and recovery. Educators can follow Chapters 22–25 to see how disagreement becomes a test of judgment. Researchers can begin with Section 4.5 and continue to Chapters 32–34 on operational evidence, costs, and pilots. In each route, compare the City with less intrusive ways to prepare leaders. Ask what would count as improvement and what would stop a pilot. A coherent design is not yet evidence of a benefit. Keep a proposed design, a published finding, and an observed City outcome distinct. Read each source for the question it answers. Use the Glossary for terms, the References for cited work, and the Index to find a fuller argument. Privacy and care remain prior to evaluation: someone’s need for help must never become public spectacle.

This volume is self-contained. The Law of Fairness introduces the larger idea; The Science of Fairness develops the separate scientific inquiry. The Government of Fairness addresses administration, while The Constitution of Fairness treats legal authority and rights. Readers moving between Foundation and Reference Editions can follow subjects rather than chapter numbers. The next question should lead to a test people can understand and challenge.

Part I — City Type, Vow, and Power

Public responsibility can be designed before it is exercised. A housing rule changes a household's horizon; a budget delay becomes a missed appointment or an interrupted education. Public decisions reach people as lived consequences. The City begins further upstream, with the conditions in which those who may make such decisions learn to judge, receive advice, handle dependence, and respond to correction.

The Transparent City is a proposed civic institution for adults voluntarily preparing for substantial public power. It brings education, deliberation, record, care, and public encounter into one setting so that formation can be examined across time. Its case rests on what that combination makes possible. A campus has no special authority merely because its activities are visible or its architecture is beautiful.

The Law of Fairness supplies a question about where consequence is carried. Its formal candidate hypothesis, Per-Stream Terminal Valence Closure (PTVC), concerns whether the total positive and negative felt experience of each qualifying conscious stream balances at its true endpoint, which is not assumed to be biological death. Testing that hypothesis belongs to governed research. The civic inquiry here concerns the design of institutions and the people affected by them.

Part I establishes the proposal before the later Parts give it a physical and organizational form. Chapter 1 asks what existing democratic institutions leave unresolved and whether an integrated setting could improve the evidence available before authority is granted. Chapter 2 defines the Transparent Vow and the bounded active-role record. Chapter 3 tests the proposal against six forms it could wrongly assume. Chapter 4 sets out how a prototype could yield useful operational evidence and when that evidence should lead to revision or refusal.

The comparison with existing institutions is essential to this sequence. Elections, journalism, disclosure, party reform, professional education, public records, and oversight already perform different parts of the work. Their improvement may answer the problem with less intrusion. A City deserves further design only where a consequential gap remains and where its own demands on participants, workers, households, and hosts can be justified. Construction is only the beginning of that assessment; recurring maintenance, care, and host obligations determine whether the proposal remains viable after launch.

The reader can therefore approach this Part as an institutional specification under examination. It identifies a population, a purpose, a record obligation, and the authorities that remain outside the City. Later choices about residence, schedules, technology, staffing, and cost depend on these decisions. Establishing them first allows disagreement to be precise: a reader can reject the proposed burden, challenge a mechanism, or prefer an alternative without having to accept or dismiss the project as a whole.

Chapter 1 — A City for Public Responsibility

A future official’s public biography usually begins after much of the consequential formation has happened. Before a campaign introduces a candidate, other people have supplied opportunities, opened rooms, offered advice, rewarded caution, and made some ambitions affordable. Those relationships may have supported excellent public service. They may also have created dependencies that a polished account of the candidate cannot reveal.

This chapter asks what citizens need to know about that history. The inquiry is narrower than a demand to expose private life. Mentorship, friendship, family, association, and political experimentation remain legitimate. The relevant problem arises when an influence becomes materially consequential for public power while escaping proportionate review. Identifying that threshold is harder, and more useful, than treating every private relationship as suspicious.

Consider a procurement exercise in which advice from a sponsor-connected firm changes a recommendation. A contribution list reveals a relationship; a final statement reveals an outcome. A bounded decision sequence can also show the advice, the declared conflict, the reasons for accepting or rejecting it, and what changed after independent challenge. Section 29.3.4 follows such a case through appeal and verified implementation. The object of inquiry is the decision and its correction, not an attempt to reconstruct an entire person.

That example separates four possible contributions: education and material stability may support learning; a record may improve accountability; public presentation may improve understanding; and an institutional setting may improve coordination. These contributions need not rise or fall together. Distinguishing them makes it possible to ask which benefit

requires a City and which could be achieved by strengthening institutions already in place.

Formation also involves the use of knowledge under pressure. Drafting, revision, disagreement, staff relations, and responses to error can reveal capacities that instruction alone does not exercise. Democratic competence frameworks connect knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes (Council of Europe, 2018a). The proposed City would add continuity and public accountability to those foundations; it would still have to show that the resulting evidence is useful.

The chapter follows the problem from formative influence to campaign-time judgment, then compares schools, parties, media, training, and coordinated reforms. It examines what moving evidence earlier could change and who would carry the new costs. Self-selection, performance for observers, information overload, and institutional prestige may weaken the very evidence the proposal seeks to improve. The argument therefore has a conditional destination: identify the remaining gap, test the added contribution, and retain other routes to public service. A larger record is worthwhile only when it helps people understand a consequential pattern they could not otherwise assess.

1.1 — The Hidden Pipeline of Power

Recruitment for public office is shaped long before citizens can evaluate a finished candidate. Encouragement, credentials, introductions, and access to consequential networks are distributed unevenly, often before any formal campaign. The resulting selection affects future voters and institutions, even when each step looks ordinary in isolation (Norris and Lovenduski, 1995; Lawless and Fox, 2005; Hazan and Rahat, 2010; Carnes and Lupu, 2023). The proposed record stage makes defined public-power pathways visible while protecting private life and the freedom not to enter.

1.1.1 — Donor and Patronage Formation

Before voluntary City entry, ordinary life remains ordinary life. After entry, the City records active public-power formation and continuing dependencies without treating the whole past as public property. The review route is a public-consequence test: does a hidden relationship still shape role judgment, leverage, access, agenda, silence, or public burden?

Financial support can determine who has time to prepare, who makes introductions, which advisers are available, and whose preferences a future candidate learns to anticipate. The donor need not issue an order: dependence itself can shape decisions before bribery or an explicit bargain occurs.

International IDEA's political-finance work distinguishes private and public funding, spending, reporting, oversight, and sanctions because money in politics is not one problem with one remedy. The OECD Anti-Corruption and Integrity Outlook 2026 likewise separates the existence of political-finance rules from their implementation in practice (International IDEA, 2014; Wolfs, 2025; OECD, 2026c). Timely disclosure, effective oversight, enforceable sanctions, and public financing can

reduce some dependencies without requiring residential formation under record. Where such reforms are enforceable and sufficient, they are less burdensome than a City and should be preferred.

The record should distinguish a financial contribution's source, channel, purpose, conditions, refusal capacity, and later policy relevance. What could the participant no longer afford to ignore after receiving support?

1.1.2 — Prestige and Credential Channels

Prestige does not need to command in order to shape public power. Elite institutions can supply valuable knowledge, discipline, and opportunity while also teaching which voices sound serious and whose approval matters. Political recruitment research makes these social pathways relevant to the formation of public power (Norris and Lovenduski, 1995; Carnes and Lupu, 2023).

The City should test what a credential enables a participant to do. Can the participant explain expert knowledge clearly, recognize its limits, and revise after challenge from people outside the institutions that trained them? Staff observations, local testimony, policy exercises, and responses to disagreement can supply evidence of that conduct.

The City's own reputation must meet the same test: participation must never become a shortcut to credibility.

1.1.3 — Party, Consultant, and Media Shaping

Consider Mara, a composite role seeker created from recurring features of political recruitment rather than from one identifiable person. At twenty-four, she enters a policy fellowship after an excellent academic record and a mentor's recommendation. The fellowship leads to a donor-supported conference, a party research post, a consulting assignment, selective press access,

and eventually a campaign role. No single step is necessarily corrupt, and several give her valuable skill.

Across those steps, however, Mara learns which questions are rewarded, which forms of dissent remain employable, whose calls receive an immediate answer, and which public problems become visible only after they interest a gatekeeper. She also learns good things: how to read a budget, how to negotiate, how to revise a proposal, and how to work inside a coalition. Formation is powerful precisely because dependence, knowledge, generosity, compromise, and ambition can coexist.

When Mara later announces a candidacy, the public receives a résumé, a donor report, prepared biography, policy positions, and a few difficult interviews. Those materials may be accurate and still leave the formative sequence largely invisible. Voters are asked to judge the person produced by the pipeline without seeing enough of how influence was accepted, resisted, repaid, corrected, or carried forward.

A City-specific formation record would not publish Mara's private friendships, family history, or every conversation. It would make role-relevant pathways legible while they are active. Readers could see who funded the work, who shaped the task, what advice changed a public position, and which conflicts were declared. They could also see what correction followed challenge and where lawful office authority would begin and City authority would end (Norris and Lovenduski, 1995; Lawless and Fox, 2005; International IDEA, 2014; OECD, 2024b).

A future public figure may learn the party before learning the public. They may learn how to avoid a bad clip before learning how to explain a hard tradeoff. They may learn how to speak in phrases that survive television before they learn how to build

institutions that survive time. Formation through apparatus is not automatically corrupt, but it is rarely neutral.

The costs of this shaping can include flattened language, strategic ambiguity, controlled emotion, rehearsed sincerity, and policy that has already passed through the machinery of electability. People may think they are judging the person, when they are partly judging the apparatus that trained the person to appear before them.

The OECD Recommendation on Transparency and Integrity in Lobbying and Influence, revised in 2024, recognizes influence as a legitimate part of public decision making while requiring safeguards against opaque access, conflicts of interest, and revolving-door capture. The OECD Anti-Corruption and Integrity Outlook 2026 also reports that lobbying safeguards remain among the weaker elements of many integrity systems (OECD, 2024b; OECD, 2026c). The City's contribution, if needed, is earlier evidence of how advice was received, resisted, revised, or internalized, not a presumption that influence itself is corrupt.

A useful City record lets a reader reconstruct an influence claim rather than guess from a slogan. It connects the advice received to the evidence then available, the participant’s stated reason, and the revision that followed. A dated request from a patron and a matching change can establish a sequence worth examining; they do not by themselves settle why the participant acted. Reviewers should test the claimed connection against contrary evidence and the possibility that new information independently justified the change. The public account distinguishes the documented intervention, the participant’s explanation, and the reviewer’s supported inference. Private motives may remain unsettled while the practical question becomes answerable: was the recommendation justified, was the

relevant conflict handled, and did independent challenge change the work?

Recent candidate-emergence research reinforces the timing problem without proving that one formation path is universally superior. Experience inside a state legislature can materially change the probability of seeking higher office because institutions confer skills, networks, reputational signals, and practical knowledge. That finding supports a general proposition: political ambition is not merely an inner trait waiting to be revealed. Institutions help produce the confidence, opportunity, and credibility through which ambition becomes candidacy (McCrain and O’Connell, 2023).

Party gatekeeping is also capable of correction rather than only exclusion. A large conjoint study of party elites in Austria, Germany, and Switzerland found that information about women’s underrepresentation changed selectors’ preferences in patterned ways. The lesson for the City is not that parties fail. It is that selection environments respond to rules, cues, representation, ideology, and the composition of gatekeepers. A fair comparison must therefore treat party reform as a serious alternative and the City as one possible additional route (Gatto and Radojevic, 2025).

Digital political finance widens the formation map. Advertising purchases, data-driven outreach, third-party spending, influencers, platform services, and campaign technologies can route money and influence through channels that conventional reports miss. International IDEA's 2025 comparative work shows why disclosure must follow the real architecture of political spending as categories evolve. The City therefore treats campaign-stage disclosure as one interface in a longer accountability record, while finance regulation and enforcement remain with their lawful owners (Wolfs, 2025).

1.1.4 — Family Advantage and Social Inheritance

The City may examine how social inheritance affects public judgment without making family life a public exhibit. Relatives do not inherit a participant's Vow.

No one chooses the household into which they are born. Advantage may give language, safety, introductions, money, confidence, and the ability to take unpaid risks. Disadvantage may give urgency, knowledge of burden, improvisation, and suspicion of institutions. Neither inheritance is a moral verdict. Both are formative facts.

A parent's education, citizenship, neighborhood, reputation, and emotional steadiness can open public pathways through affection rather than patronage. Those routes of access remain relevant to analysis even where there was no corrupt intent (Carnes and Lupu, 2023).

Can a participant acknowledge inheritance without disguising it as pure merit, identify doors opened by birth, name unfamiliar burdens, hear resentment without defensiveness, and design public action that does not mistake inherited ease for universal possibility?

1.1.5 — Private Compromise Before Public Trust

Compromise before public trust can begin as survival. A person may owe someone a chance, a defense, a silence, a public posture, or a private loyalty before admitting their own ambition. By the time office becomes possible, the obligation may feel like friendship, gratitude, realism, or prudence. The public sees only the later caution or selective courage; the formative event has become habit.

Safely acknowledging a dependency may require time, mentors, opposition, material stabilization, and public-role

practice. Review should allow that development rather than demand instant confession.

Assess past compromise for present leverage, silencing of the participant on live issues, danger to others or institutions, and a repair path beyond reputation management. This does not authorize surveillance of every past mistake.

1.2 — Why Campaigns Arrive Too Late

Campaign scrutiny operates under an election calendar and public-pressure incentives. It can test current affiliations, responses, and promises, but often has little access to the long sequence of opportunities and dependencies that preceded candidacy. A pre-campaign record has value only if it supplies role-relevant context without becoming whole-life exposure (International IDEA, 2014; OECD, 2024b; OECD, 2026c). A useful comparison asks whether a voter can distinguish a documented early dependency from a late campaign claim.

1.2.1 — Persona After Formation

The OSCE Office for Democratic Institutions and Human Rights emphasizes plural competition, fundamental freedoms, equal conditions, and voters' capacity to make an informed choice in its campaign observation handbook (OSCE/ODIHR, 2021). Those are standards for public contest; the question here concerns the formative history behind a candidate's presentation.

A public persona offers an answer to "Who is this candidate now, under public contest?" Formation asks, "How did the candidate learn to handle influence, disagreement, and correction before that contest began?" Composure alone does not reveal the history of correction that produced it or the dependencies that made some answers safer than others.

Public life still needs narrative. An earlier record lets readers check a candidate's story of service or reform against documented patterns, including evidence that complicates the story.

1.2.2 — Managed Disclosure and Narrative Control

Narrative control can protect legitimate privacy, but it can also hide formative burden. A campaign may disclose financial

information while concealing financial dependence. It may disclose biography while concealing private obligations. It may disclose professional experience while concealing who shaped judgment. It may disclose mistakes while controlling their meaning so tightly that public correction becomes performance.

A role-specific record accumulated before campaign strategy begins can provide evidence that the campaign did not select or create.

A failure condition should be named early: if the City's own record site becomes a new campaign instrument, it has reproduced managed disclosure under institutional branding. The participant must not be able to select only flattering bundles, and the City must not be able to hide institutional failure behind polished summaries. The release process must be independent enough to resist participant influence, preserve context, and protect third parties.

1.2.3 — Scandal as Late Evidence

Scandal can force democratic judgment into emergency time. It may reveal donor dependence, staff cruelty, private compromise, evasive reasoning, or other conduct that institutions failed to surface earlier, but it often arrives under intense pressure and with limited context. The public must then assess the allegation quickly, when a slower formation record might have allowed correction before crisis.

A City record would let readers examine a scandal alongside earlier conduct. Did the event reflect a pattern? Was correction already present? Were staff concerns ignored? Did advisers warn? Did the person learn? Was the institution responsible?

Investigative journalism remains indispensable because no institution can safely investigate itself alone. UNESCO's fully updated second edition of Story-Based Inquiry presents

investigation as a disciplined, hypothesis-led process of evidence, verification, and publication rather than rumor or public appetite (Hunter, 2026). A City should make such work easier through provenance and access, while preserving newsroom independence and the possibility that journalists will find failures the City's own systems missed.

When a staff member has no safe route to name a hidden burden until a crisis erupts, the institution transfers risk to the most vulnerable witness. Earlier complaint and review channels give that witness a route before emergency disclosure becomes necessary.

1.2.4 — Voter Guesswork as Civic Burden

The burden of checking a candidate's public account falls unequally on voters with different time, access, education, institutional knowledge, and media literacy. A formation record must reduce that burden rather than merely supply more material to investigate.

Useful public evidence depends on its quality and usability, not simply its volume. In California insurance-reform elections, Lupia (1994) found that certain informational shortcuts helped less-informed voters emulate better-informed voters' choices. Lau and Redlawsk (2001) found that heuristic performance varied with political expertise and the choice situation. Todorov et al. (2005) linked competence judgments from faces to election outcomes, rather than establishing actual competence. Together these studies make a practical question worth testing: can concise, checkable City evidence improve factual understanding without asking readers to master an enormous archive?

Voter guesswork also affects public trust after the election. If citizens later learn that the person they trusted was formed by

hidden dependencies, they may conclude not only that one leader failed, but that the entire system is theater.

1.2.5 — Why Late Exposure Cannot Undo Earlier Harm

Late exposure can reveal misconduct and prompt genuine reform, but it cannot undo decisions already made or restore every opportunity already lost. The timing advantage claimed for the City is therefore preventive: relevant dependencies might be identified and corrected before a participant exercises public authority.

Campaigns and later investigations retain their own evidentiary value. A campaign tests prior formation under open political contest; an earlier record may help journalists and citizens interpret a later allegation or reversal. The two sources complement one another. Review should distinguish a warning that was reasonably available earlier from information that genuinely emerged later.

Inside the City, an identified dependency can lead to recusal, financial stabilization, adviser separation, further education, public explanation where warranted, delayed readiness, or exit. The intervention succeeds only if follow-up shows that the dependency weakened or conduct changed under comparable pressure. Completing a process, apologizing, or producing a larger record is insufficient. Repeated failure after support should narrow readiness claims rather than disappear into a narrative of growth. Before intervention, reviewers should record the observable change they expect and the evidence that would count against improvement, so later success cannot be defined retrospectively.

1.3 — Schools, Parties, and Platforms

Existing democratic institutions provide the baseline any City proposal must surpass. Schools, parties, platforms, leadership programs, professional networks, journalism, and civic associations each contribute something the City should respect and may never need to replace. The City becomes plausible only where their combined strengths still leave a formation burden that no less intrusive arrangement can carry adequately. That comparison should identify an actual unmet review need before proposing a new institutional demand.

1.3.1 — Schools Educate Without Whole Public-Power Formation

Formal schooling does not by itself establish how a person carries public responsibility. Examination results and theoretical fluency need to be considered alongside conduct when time is short, incentives conflict, or someone with less power bears the consequence.

Schools should not be required to adopt the City's exceptional record obligation to demonstrate educational quality. The relevant comparison is whether their teaching and practice already provide the evidence a public role needs.

Education should be assessed through uses of knowledge: how a participant treats a frustrated staff member, hears an affected person, revises a policy after embarrassment, resists an implied threat, or carries fatigue without cruelty. These are points at which knowledge becomes public conduct (Council of Europe, 2018a).

1.3.2 — Parties Select Without Role-Bound Record

Party selection helps determine which choices voters will encounter before the election itself (Hazan and Rahat, 2010).

Internal factions, donors, electoral calculations, and coalition needs can shape who becomes viable, while citizens may be asked to trust vetting they cannot inspect. The Guidelines on Political Party Regulation, Second Edition protect party freedom and recognize parties as essential democratic associations (OSCE/ODIHR and Venice Commission, 2020).

Parties also have incentives to hide flaws until they must manage them. They may protect a candidate because the alternative is worse for the party. They may frame concerns as attacks. They may delay disclosure, discipline whistleblowers, or select for message compliance. Even when a party acts responsibly, the public still receives a partial process through a strategic filter.

Parties remain free to interpret, support, refuse, and challenge City evidence without becoming subordinate to the City; the City likewise cannot make party selection its own authority.

This distinction also protects pluralism. Different parties may value different temperaments and policies. No institution should erase ideological difference by certifying one preferred kind of candidate.

Parties may legitimately consider electability, loyalty, fundraising capacity, coalition compatibility, message discipline, ideological fit, and personal reliability. Review should examine how those criteria are applied: whether they support a defensible political choice or instead favor donor interests, protect factions, reproduce inherited advantage, or exclude candidates merely because they pose unfamiliar risks.

1.3.3 — Platforms Amplify Without Stewardship

Platforms convert attention into political consequence without carrying full responsibility for formation. They can reveal ignored voices, expose hypocrisy, distribute evidence, and

mobilize public care. They can also reward speed, fury, simplification, persona, harassment, manipulation, and the kind of certainty that survives a screen better than a deliberative room.

Platform visibility reveals how quickly attention systems compress a person into clips, metrics, shares, sentiment, search results, and viral moments. The City needs a different institutional model: slow enough for context, governed enough for correction, and humane enough to resist exposure designed mainly for engagement. Formation becomes legible through provenance, role relevance, review, and care rather than through intensified attention capture (Marwick and boyd, 2011; UNESCO, 2018).

Stewardship requires slower release where delay protects accuracy, faster release where delay hides public risk, and a usable challenge route where interpretation may harm someone.

1.3.4 — Leadership Programs and the Evidence of Conduct

Training separated from visible consequence can improve skill while leaving dependency, staff conduct, household burden, and correction habits largely untouched. An OECD study of senior civil-service leadership identifies values-based leadership, open inclusion, organizational stewardship, and networked collaboration as core capabilities (Gerson, 2020). Candidate academies and civil-service schools can develop such capacities at far lower burden than a City and should be preferred where the actual gap is training or professional standards.

Such programs can teach constitutional literacy, budgeting, evidence use, media discipline, conflict management, public speaking, and ethical decision practice. Short programs can nevertheless be captured by prestige, party pipelines, donor networks, or credential inflation. Transparent selection, diverse

faculty, open curricula, independent evaluation, and no entitlement to office can make them a proportionate alternative in many settings.

Evidence that comparatively simple training can improve an important part of civic preparation deserves serious weight. In a randomized study embedded in an online behavioral-economics course for public officials in Latin America and the Caribbean, participants assigned a seven-item diagnostic after instruction performed better on average than those assessed before instruction. The reported difference was 0.87 standard deviations, with particularly strong results in applied reasoning (Márquez and Scartascini, 2026). The study examined course-related task performance; it did not establish later conduct in public office.

The finding strengthens the City's most demanding lower-burden comparator: effective education can improve reasoning without residential formation or an exceptional record obligation. The additional City question is whether sustained encounters with conflicting advice, staff rights, affected-person challenge, and independently verified correction add useful evidence of conduct beyond the educational improvement. The fair comparison keeps the training quality strong in both arrangements before attributing a difference to the City's integration.

1.3.5 — The City as Integrated Ecology

Integration has a specific task: preserve a consequential responsibility when work crosses between legitimate institutions. A warning may reach a teacher but not the decision owner; a corrected statement may leave the original public account unchanged; or a remedy may lose its owner when an

adviser departs. The question is which handoff fails and what additional arrangement would keep the duty intact.

A coordination agreement among existing institutions is a serious comparator. The City's proposed advantage is a setting in which the handoff can be practiced repeatedly and its consequences followed through ordinary work. A shared schedule may bring the right reviewers together; a case-specific reference may make a missing declaration discoverable; funded follow-up may keep a correction alive after staff change. These connections concern authorized decisions rather than a merged personal dossier. Physical proximity earns its place through better coordination, while distributed arrangements remain available where they achieve the same result with less burden.

Ethics, lobbying, conflict-of-interest, beneficial-ownership, and revolving-door rules address influence around public decision making. They can be highly effective when independent bodies possess investigative power, records are usable, sanctions are credible, and exemptions are narrow. They may make a City unnecessary for roles whose main risk is transactional influence rather than deeper formation.

Professional civil-service formation addresses administrative competence, stewardship, and public-service values. It is often the better institution for officials whose authority arises from expertise and lawful administration rather than electoral leadership. A City should complement, not duplicate, professional schools of government and merit systems (OECD, 2020b).

For investigative journalism and public records, the comparison turns on access, resources, source protection, the legal environment, record quality, and how early a concern becomes visible (UNESCO, 2025).

Citizens' assemblies and other representative deliberative processes improve public judgment on bounded questions. Learning, expert input, facilitation, minority views, evaluation, and public reporting can support considered recommendations. These bodies do not form office seekers, but they can reduce the demand for heroic leaders by strengthening the institutions around decision making (OECD, 2020a; OECD, 2025a; International IDEA, 2025).

Integrated review can expose attempts to use credentials to deflect questions about donor dependence, charisma to excuse staff mistreatment, party loyalty to conceal weak knowledge, or platform popularity to replace public reason. Strength in one area does not resolve a failure in another.

A revised seminar schedule may alter recovery time, staff coverage, and public access together. An integrated pilot can test those interactions and compare the result with coordination among existing institutions.

A campus can become a prestige ecology when fluency is mistaken for readiness. Publish what changed after an outside challenge so readers can assess whether criticism altered the institution's decisions. Reopen the comparison when a less intrusive institution can meet the same evidentiary need.

1.4 — How Visible Formation Changes the Timeline

A campaign asks voters to judge a candidate under deadline. This section asks a different question: what can voters responsibly know before a campaign begins, and what new privacy costs arise in obtaining it? The answer depends on timing, lawful authority, and the quality of the record (McAllister, 2007; Thompson, 2000; Jamieson, 1996). Earlier information is valuable only when its source and uncertainty remain legible to the people who will use it.

1.4.1 — Formation Before Election

Timing is a burden issue, but earlier visibility is not automatically fairer. Information demanded too early or too broadly can chill association, narrow experimentation, reward conformity, and turn formation into performance. The City's temporal claim therefore depends on a protected interval in which role-relevant conduct is recorded and reviewable without treating every private thought or relationship as public material.

A pilot must distinguish deterrence of concealed leverage from selection for people comfortable with observation. Caregiving, disability, trauma, minority affiliation, financial insecurity, and cultural expectations of privacy may discourage capable candidates for reasons unrelated to their public judgment. Entry and refusal data should be examined with those alternatives in view.

Moving formation before election does not mean moving authority before election. The City’s timing intervention is evidentiary and formative, not sovereign.

1.4.2 — Public Burden Before Public Authority

The relevant entry cost is answerability, not money, humiliation, sacrifice, or pain. A person who seeks high-consequence

authority may fairly be asked to carry role-specific record, explanation, correction, and review before others live under their decisions. That burden is not payment for trust and cannot purchase office. It creates evidence that voters and lawful institutions remain free to reject.

The person seeking authority and the institution preparing that person bear the burden of formation. Families, children, staff, and citizens must not be made to absorb it merely because they are close to the process.

1.4.3 — Longitudinal Evidence Over Campaign Fragments

Longitudinal evidence matters because hidden burden often appears in recurrence. One generous speech can coexist with repeated staff exploitation; one apology can coexist with resistance to correction; one promise to serve ordinary people can coexist with habitual distance from them. Yet recurrence must be interpreted carefully. A long record can magnify surveillance, produce false patterns, and reward those best able to perform consistency under observation.

Structure longitudinal evidence around correction, staff treatment, dependency, public reason, learning, care load, opposition, fatigue, and repeated choices under pressure.

1.4.4 — Readiness Before Persona

Readiness is not a universal score. It is role-specific, contextual, and contestable. A person may show readiness for one kind of office and not another. They may show promise but require delay. They may show integrity but lack administrative competence. They may show technical skill but lack public explanation. The City's record should make these distinctions visible.

Role-specific readiness asks what the office or pathway requires: legal literacy, financial judgment, executive discipline,

diplomatic restraint, conflict tolerance, administrative humility, media resistance, staff respect, emergency decision capacity, and willingness to be corrected. Any readiness conclusion should name the stated role, time and evidence threshold, remain open to public judgment, and respect lawful institutional authority.

1.4.5 — Democratic Choice With Deeper Context

Deeper context does not guarantee better choices. Citizens may still disagree, ignore evidence, distrust the City, prefer other values, or reject a participant's politics. That freedom matters.

The City contributes formation evidence within its own scope. Within the series, *The Constitution of Fairness* develops the model framework for eligibility, authority, rights, and review; *The Government of Fairness* develops public administration. Those divisions organize the books, while actual powers and duties come from applicable law and the institutions authorized under it. The City can prepare, document, and explain without conferring office or commanding government.

The OECD Guidelines for Citizen Participation Processes emphasize respect for public time, accountability, and coordination (OECD, 2022b). A City record must be usable within those constraints.

Test the release calendar against nomination windows, primary ballots, coalition commitments, appointment shortlists, and other lawful decision points. Disclosure after those windows close may explain what happened without restoring a lost choice. The City should record not only when material became public, but whether the public still had a meaningful opportunity to act on it (OSCE/ODIHR, 2021).

1.5 — City as Power Formation, Not Ordinary Citizenship

The City protects ordinary citizenship by limiting its exceptional burden to chosen public-power formation. Democratic competence and civic-participation frameworks properly address citizens broadly, while the City addresses a narrower role threshold for adults seeking consequential public power. Activists, volunteers, students, journalists, neighbors, donors, and private associations retain ordinary civic privacy and equal standing (Council of Europe, 2018a; Kahne and Bowyer, 2017). No one should have to surrender ordinary civic participation merely to avoid an exceptional record requirement.

1.5.1 — Public-Power Seekers as the Target

The category is an adult voluntarily seeking substantial public power. The role must be defined by its potential consequences for others, not by visibility, popularity, wealth, or ambition alone.

Plural pathways are essential. A union organizer, mayor, teacher, entrepreneur, judge, scientist, community advocate, civil servant, military officer, caregiver, journalist, or independent candidate may arrive at public service through different legitimate formations. These histories cannot be flattened into one preferred civic biography. The City offers a route with a defined burden; it does not define the only route by which public competence can be formed.

The review route should therefore begin with role definition. What power is being sought? Over whom? Through what lawful path? What burdens would the role impose? What evidence of formation is relevant? Which private domains remain outside scope? When does the active record begin and end?

1.5.2 — Ordinary Citizens Remain Private

Ordinary citizens remain private because ordinary life is not a public application. A person does not owe exposure in order to vote, complain, receive services, speak, refuse, worship, parent, work, rest, dissent, or live quietly.

The boundary can erode through imitation even without a formal rule. Schools, employers, parties, movements, donors, and audiences may begin treating visible life as evidence of civic worth. The City should monitor those effects and challenge claims that ordinary people must accept its exceptional record burden to demonstrate trustworthiness.

Ordinary-citizen privacy also covers people who encounter a participant incidentally, including family members, visitors, staff relatives, critics, neighbors, and children. Their presence cannot itself create a City record obligation; Section 2.4.5 sets out protection against incidental identification and exposure.

1.5.3 — Formation Is Not Government

Even when an officeholder works from inside a City environment, the lawful office, public duties, legal records, and government authority remain governed by the constitutional and administrative order outside the City.

An office-interface boundary should therefore be written as a five-question handoff before any City record, staff support, or facility crosses into official work. Which institution possesses lawful authority? Which record regime controls? Who supervises personnel and public money? Which secrecy, disclosure, and professional-duty rules apply? Where do complaint, review, and remedy lie? If any answer is simply “the City because the City prepared the officeholder,” the interface has failed. Formation may accompany an officeholder only through a documented arrangement that preserves the

independence of elections, Government, and constitutional review (Mashaw, 2006; Barak, 2012; Weber, 1978).

1.5.4 — Participation Is Not Moral Elevation

Entry is not evidence of virtue. A published record requires interpretation; it does not turn its subject into a superior kind of citizen.

A complete institution must also protect participants from the burden of moral elevation. Being treated as an example can become another form of captivity. Participants may feel pressure to symbolize courage, humility, transparency, or future civilization. That symbolic pressure can distort behavior and damage the person.

The remedy is status discipline. City labels should describe stage, role, record, readiness claim, pause, exit, correction, or decertification. They should not describe virtue. Public bundles should explain evidence, not rank persons.

1.5.5 — City Life Is Role Burden

Role burden distinguishes every adjacent person. Participants accept an active civic burden; staff carry professional duties under separate labor and privacy rules; families and visitors remain third parties whose rights do not transfer; officeholders remain governed by law. This map keeps proximity, employment, relationship, and later public authority from collapsing into one status.

Voluntary entry does not waive protection from harm. A participant may choose a demanding role without consenting to every burden an institution later imposes.

Seeing the City as role burden clarifies what each support system accomplishes. Housing reduces leverage and gives participants a stable place to recover. Health care protects the body under visible civic strain. Archive systems make formation

contestable. Staff support reveals and sustains the labor that carries the institution. Public interfaces let citizens examine power before trust is granted.

For each amenity, document its role in formation and the labor, maintenance, security, and service burden it creates. A feature that looks supportive from the participant's perspective may impose unjustified work elsewhere. Design review should compare the benefit with that operating burden before procurement.

Review should also examine post-exit monitoring, continuing access expectations, and informal authority. Permissions and support arrangements need stated expiry or review dates so that a completed role does not silently become a permanent claim on a person.

The no-advantage rule requires an annual independent audit. Participation must not create privileged ballot access, preferred appointment status, service priority, donor access, institutional immunity, or presumed credibility. The audit should examine informal credentialing, record migration, post-exit monitoring, and public claims that imply a superior civic class. Comparisons with similarly situated non-City candidates should distinguish judgments based on disclosed evidence from shortcuts based on membership. When status itself produces preferential treatment, the responsible institution must correct the practice and publish the remedy.

1.6 — Governing Question: Where Does the Burden Go?

Transparency and participation can move burden rather than reduce it when they are unusable, uncorrectable, inaccessible, or imposed on the wrong people. The chapter therefore turns the analysis back onto the City and asks what its own record, participation, and review demands cost participants, staff, families, host communities, and the public (Heald, 2006; Fung et al., 2007; Fox, 2007; Tyler, 2006). The answer requires identifying who gains a usable remedy and who bears each additional reporting obligation. A disclosure system that moves an unmanaged cost onto people outside the chosen role fails this test.

1.6.1 — Burden on Power

A comparative proportionality test keeps the burden inquiry from becoming a slogan. The City must pursue a legitimate and sufficiently serious aim: reducing hidden formation burden associated with substantial public power. General distrust of politics is not enough; the problem must be specified by role, jurisdiction, and evidence. The design must be suitable. Its mechanisms must plausibly address identified routes of influence, dependency, conduct, and correction. A campus, archive, Vow, or record is not suitable merely because it is visible; the proposal must explain how each mechanism changes the causal path that creates public burden.

A participant who later holds office acquires duties under the relevant public law. Chapter 26 defines the permitted City interface; the demand for answerability cannot override lawful official confidentiality.

When public value no longer justifies human cost, the City must be able to narrow record scope, improve support, delay

activation, allow pause, protect health, revise release rules, separate roles, or stop a pathway.

1.6.2 — Burden on Staff

Staff burden appears early because staff often see public power before the public does. They see entitlement, fatigue, generosity, contempt, learning, avoidance, dependence, manipulation, apology, and correction in ordinary operating life. If staff have no protected way to record or contest what they see, the institution turns them into hidden witnesses.

The staff charter must give workers a route to report role-relevant conduct without exposing their ordinary lives. Chapter 21 supplies the labor and role-separation design.

1.6.3 — Burden on Families and Children

Public-power formation can change household schedules, finances, public attention, security, emotional load, and future relationships. Family consultation must identify those effects before activation rather than treat support as an afterthought.

Collateral arrangements must distinguish consent, notice, shielding, complaint, correction, and remedy; a participant cannot waive another person’s rights.

Children require absolute protection. No child should become evidence of the City, proof of the future, a participant by proximity, a public image, a readiness signal, or emotional legitimacy for an adult’s public role. Family scenes may reveal relevant conduct, but they contain independent rights, histories, and vulnerabilities; public appetite for the household is not public interest.

A partner may consent to some shared arrangements, but that consent cannot erase dignity, privacy, professional counsel, health needs, or later refusal. A dependent may be affected by City life without becoming a public actor.

1.6.4 — Burden on Host Communities

Host-community burden includes symbolic burden. A town, region, or jurisdiction may become associated with the City in ways residents did not request. Supporters may celebrate the place. Critics may target it. Local politics may be altered. The City must not treat these effects as externalities outside its moral concern.

Host legitimacy does not require unanimous support. Serious public institutions often generate disagreement. But disagreement must have routes. Host complaint, review, reporting, mitigation, benefit sharing, and recourse should be part of the City's structure.

Host communities also possess a refusal interest. National enthusiasm, donor capital, or political prestige cannot substitute for lawful local process and material review. A host should be able to challenge cost estimates, land use, security arrangements, infrastructure claims, and public-benefit narratives. The City is not proportionate if its public mission depends on local acquiescence that would not be accepted from participants.

1.6.5 — Burden on Public Confusion

Ambiguity can serve supporters, critics, media, donors, and institutions in different ways. Vague inspiration attracts hope; caricature attracts attention; prestige ambiguity attracts money; flexible language postpones accountability. Ordinary citizens carry the cost when they cannot tell whether the City is a school, campaign gate, surveillance institution, private government, public archive, or civic rank. Clarity is therefore a distributive safeguard, not a branding preference.

Public artifacts need disclosures matched to their foreseeable misuse: a readiness label needs scope and status, while a record-site mockup needs a visible explanation of access and

correction. Place the relevant information where the misleading inference would arise. Fine print added after an image or slogan has travelled cannot repair its initial framing.

1.6.6 — Burden on Future Replication

Portability requires evidence that local law and institutional capacity can safeguard children, staff, nonparticipants, host communities, record stages, exit, protest, and authority boundaries through ordinary staffing changes, funding pressure, and local translation. Replication multiplies both promise and exposure, so scale raises the required proof of protection. Where that protection cannot travel intact, the responsible result is delay, redesign, or refusal.

Replication must carry the failure record as well as the design. Chapter 34 specifies how a later site can use that evidence, reject an unsuitable translation, or decline to build.

Chapter 2 — Transparent Vow: Bounded Active Record

The Transparent Vow turns the City's proposal into an obligation someone could actually accept. An adult entering an active public-power formation role agrees to a complete record of that role under defined conditions. In this book, "Total Record" is shorthand for that bounded completeness. It does not describe whole-person surveillance. The obligation must have an intelligible beginning, an accountable owner, and an end.

A record is not a single permission. Creating an object, storing it, allowing inspection, publishing a summary, interpreting its significance, and using it for research are different acts. Each can affect different people. Chapter 2 follows these decisions separately so that accepting one responsibility does not silently authorize the next. The distinction matters even when the same software or office performs several of the tasks.

The difficult question is who may act on a record once it exists. A participant, an affected stranger, a clinician, an archivist, an authorized inspector, a publisher, and a future voter can all have different claims on the same event. The Vow must allocate those claims before a dispute turns protected handling into apparent concealment or publicity into compelled exposure. Watch where each actor can object, who decides while a challenge is unresolved, and which protection remains effective when it inconveniences the City.

The chapter begins with the threshold: notice, understanding, independent advice, acceptance, and continuing review. It then defines the active period and the channels covered by the role obligation. The middle sections follow record stages and protected nonvisibility, including the difficult case in which consequential role business occurs near a protected relationship. The institution must identify the relevant transaction without treating proximity as permission to collect another person's life.

Interruptions make the design testable. A failed device, an emergency, a disputed classification, and a lawful restriction can all make material unavailable to a reader, but they do not mean the same thing. A continuity break concerns an expected record whose integrity failed; restricted access can concern an intact record. The difference determines what must be repaired, who may inspect it, and what the public can fairly infer.

Exit completes the account. Ending active status must change actual duties, permissions, schedules, and capture, while prior evidence remains subject to its continuing governance. A person cannot be required to remain merely because a dispute is unresolved. Section 2.3 gathers the stage-specific duties in an operating charter. A release request can then be checked against the particular permission sought. That charter gives later architectural, technical, and staffing chapters a common set of decision points. It is not a finished legal instrument: local law and specialist review must settle implementation. Its immediate purpose is to make the proposed obligation clear enough for an applicant to question and for an independent reviewer to hold the institution to its terms.

2.1 — The Transparent Vow as Civic Burden

The Transparent Vow is the City's threshold, not its decoration. It turns an abstract preference for answerable power into a role commitment that can be explained, reviewed, and refused. A person does not drift into the Vow by enthusiasm, donor invitation, public attention, family expectation, or institutional admiration. The entry point must be visible because the burden that follows is too serious to rest on atmosphere (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; O'Neill, 2002a; Faden and Beauchamp, 1986).

2.1.1 — Adult Role Commitment

A role commitment creates duties for the participant and duties for the institution. The participant agrees that active public-power formation will not proceed through authorized hidden channels. The institution agrees that the burden will be explained, bounded, supported, and contestable.

The Transparent Vow begins with adulthood because the burden is not appropriate for children or dependent youth. An active public-power formation role requires legal capacity, developmental maturity, practical understanding, and the ability to refuse social pressure. A minor may be affected by a participant's choice, but a minor cannot inherit the participant's Vow.

Active burden should begin only after a declared public-power pathway exists. The declaration need not promise a particular candidacy because readiness may change and jurisdictions differ. It should identify the kind of authority sought, the likely public consequences, and the reason ordinary preparation is insufficient. That declaration anchors the record to a public role rather than to personal identity, and it gives informed consent a defined object (Faden and Beauchamp, 1986; Beauchamp and Childress, 2019).

The adult role commitment should be witnessed by independent offices rather than by the same educators, donors, recruiters, or charismatic leaders who benefit from admission. A serious threshold needs counsel, capacity review, disability accommodations, language access, cooling-off time, family and dependent consultation where appropriate, and a record of questions asked before acceptance. The Vow is not voluntary merely because a person signs it. It is voluntary when refusal and understanding are real.

2.1.2 — Civic, Not Spiritual, Status

The Transparent Vow creates civic obligations; a participant's religious, secular, or mixed reasons for accepting them cannot become a membership test.

This boundary matters because severe visibility can become sacred theater if the institution is careless. People may be tempted to treat the Vow as confession, purification, initiation, sacrifice, or proof of a higher life. Those readings are not harmless metaphors inside a public-power formation system. They can make exit feel like betrayal, criticism feel like blasphemy, and ordinary privacy look morally inferior.

The record itself must carry the same boundary. Public bundles, status labels, archive descriptions, and ceremonies of entry should not use language of purity, election, holiness, spiritual rank, chosen persons, or sacred transparency. Even beautiful language can become coercive when attached to visibility.

A useful safeguard is translation. If the Vow can be translated into secular legal-administrative language without loss of authority, it is civic. If the Vow requires reverence to make sense, it has crossed into another domain. The City should be able to explain every duty through role, consequence, record,

rights, and remedy. Any optional spiritual interpretation belongs outside the civic obligation.

2.1.3 — Burden Before Trust

A role burden is defensible only when it is connected to a public consequence the participant is voluntarily preparing to carry. The relevant comparison is not between perfect privacy and perfect visibility. It is between alternative distributions of uncertainty. Without an active formation record, more uncertainty remains with voters, journalists, future staff, affected communities, and institutions that must evaluate the candidate later. An overbroad record can instead impose excessive exposure on the participant and nearby people without producing better evidence. The Vow is justified only in the narrower middle.

That middle requires a least-burdensome-means inquiry. Before a category is captured, designers should ask whether disclosure law, conflict rules, independent ethics review, confidential counseling, delayed release, aggregate reporting, or another less intrusive mechanism can address the same public risk. The proposed capture is justified only where the active formation purpose is clear, the category is necessary, and the burden cannot be placed more fairly elsewhere.

2.1.4 — Notice Before Acceptance

Good notice should be layered. The applicant needs a plain-language explanation, a detailed technical explanation, an independent rights consultation, a scenario review, and access to examples that show what the Vow means in daily life. A person who understands only the noble version has not yet understood the Vow.

Notice protects the choice that was actually explained. Nonwaivable dignity, third-party rights, future research consent,

model-training authority, and later review under changed circumstances remain separately governed. The City records notice as an accountability safeguard, with renewal and challenge routes, rather than as permanent armor against future claims.

Acceptance should fail when notice fails. If an applicant cannot describe the active burden, the protected categories, the exit route, the difference between capture and release, and the limits on research and Artificial Intelligence training, the fair answer is more review, not entry.

Notice should include the burdens carried by other people. Staff will support the participant, but staff are not servants of the participant's ambition. A person who accepts the Vow should understand that the institution counts collateral burden rather than hiding it behind their courage.

The notice record should be useful later. If a dispute arises, reviewers should be able to see what explanations were given, what questions were asked, which accommodations were offered, what uncertainties were disclosed, and whether the applicant had time to reconsider.

2.1.5 — Reviewability of Commitment

The Transparent Vow must remain contestable when conditions change, including illness, family burden, legal development, technology failure, or newly discovered risk. Review must be able to change the obligation rather than merely confirm the original signature.

The reviewing offices should be separated from the offices that benefit from keeping the participant active. Educators may want continuity, public-interface teams may want attention, donors may want visible success, and the City may want its first participants to appear durable. Ombuds, counsel, medical or

clinical review, privacy review, archival review, and external audit should have protected routes into the decision.

When review changes an active-role obligation, record the operational decision. Publish a status only where it is needed, lawful, and safe; neither protected content nor the existence of a clinical, legal, or other protected encounter must be disclosed merely to explain an absence.

Review must test comprehension, not merely renew a signature. Periodic review revisits categories, technologies, public uses, family effects, care needs, and continuing capacity to consent. Reaffirmation matters only when it can alter scope, pause participation, or trigger independent advice. The review record should show what changed and why continued commitment remains voluntary.

2.2 — Complete Active-Role Record

A complete active-role record is useful only when its scope is exact. In this book, Total Record is a defined term for the complete active-period record of the chosen public-power formation role, governed by purpose, access class, protection, correction, and exit. It never means a total record of the person or raw public access. Material obtained for another purpose cannot be presumed available for public release under the Total Record label.

2.2.1 — Active-Period Scope

The full active-role record begins only when an adult applicant is formally activated in a declared public-power formation pathway after notice, review, and acceptance. Birth, an early interest in politics, an application inquiry, a campus visit, an informal conversation, or public rumor cannot activate it. Record the start date to protect both public memory and the boundary of ordinary privacy.

Scope is not only temporal. It is functional. The record follows the active public-power formation role: study, deliberation, influence mapping, public interface, readiness preparation, relevant staff interaction, role-related travel, role-related correspondence, and consequential decision practice. It does not automatically claim unrelated inner life, family privacy, children’s experience, medical detail, intimacy, spiritual care, or every incidental human moment. When a mixed-purpose situation arises, classification must be explicit rather than opportunistic.

Active-period scope must also account for geography. The rule cannot end at the campus edge if the participant travels for role formation, public interface, lawful office activity, or transparent corridor work. But off-site continuity does not allow the City to

turn every location into a surveillance zone. Travel protocols, host agreements, portable capture rules, emergency exception labels, and nonparticipant masking must define how the active record follows the role without colonizing the surrounding world.

If no one can tell whether a moment was active, protected, paused, applicant-stage, post-exit, or ordinary private life, the institution gains discretion over where the burden begins and ends.

Before activation, applicants should be offered accessible examples of how the rule handles a policy seminar, a family meal, a clinical visit, a donor contact, and a post-exit speech. Their questions test the explanation, not their eligibility or loyalty. Where readers classify the same example differently, the institution clarifies the rule and provides another explanation before seeking informed agreement. Section 29.3.4 shows how a later boundary dispute can be decided without opening protected life to general inspection.

Log changes in role status when a participant activates, pauses, resumes, enters an authorized office interface, or exits. Movement between a residence and a classroom does not itself justify a personal movement log; the entry records the change in duty or permission.

2.2.2 — No Authorized Off-Record Role Formation

The central active rule is plain: consequential public-power formation may not move through an authorized off-record channel. The institution cannot announce transparency while preserving private rooms, private channels, private handlers, unlogged advice, donor corridors, consultant arrangements, or hidden influence routes where consequential formation occurs.

Off-record active life can appear in subtle forms. A mentor may give decisive advice in a protected setting without classification. A donor may communicate through a family member. A consultant may shape public persona through informal calls. A staff member may become a private handler. A platform may feed privileged information outside official channels. The City must treat these side routes as record-integrity problems, not as merely awkward social events.

Protected care, legal consultation, whistleblowing, and ordinary family life do not become record channels merely because the participant is active. If a role decision requires a minimal administrative entry, apply Section 2.3.1: record only the necessary, lawful, safe consequence without importing protected substance or revealing a protected encounter.

The institution must preserve role-relevant memory of admissions decisions, staff influence, security classifications, protected-nonvisibility rulings, record edits, release delays, and continuity breaks. Recording participants while leaving those institutional decisions unreviewable would create an asymmetric archive.

2.2.3 — Role-Burden Limitation

Role-bounded capture works through declared channels. Official formation meetings, assigned projects, role-related financial relations, supervised simulations, institutional communications, and approved external interfaces can carry clear provenance and review.

Public bundles, interfaces, staff instructions, contracts, retention schedules, and automated summaries should identify the record as role-bound and active-period rather than letting Total Record appear alone (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008).

Every classification must pass a role-relevance test. Name the concrete public-power pathway and ask whether less intrusive evidence could answer the question. Route sensitive substance to the appropriate protected reviewer and give affected people standing. State whether even a minimal status summary is necessary, then attach expiry, appeal, and a remedy for overclassification. Causal possibility alone is insufficient.

Both the institution and the participant must classify mixed-purpose encounters in good faith.

2.2.4 — Dignity Under Active Record

Dignity begins with the body. Sleep, health care, intimacy, and other ordinary private activity remain outside role capture where no separate lawful purpose justifies a record. An operational consequence, such as a changed workload, may need a minimal entry under Section 2.3.1; it does not authorize footage, clinical notes, intimate description, or a public explanation of protected care.

Dignity also protects the mind without claiming mind-reading authority. The City may record deliberation, stated reasoning, public explanation, revision, advice, and observable conduct. It should not pretend to possess inner truth. A participant's private fear, shame, grief, longing, or doubt may be humanly relevant, but the City must not build a doctrine of inward exposure. Public power needs accountable conduct and contextual evidence, not institutional possession of consciousness.

Dignity also belongs to accountability. A participant who has harmed staff, hidden influence, misused protected categories, or attempted off-record activity cannot invoke dignity as a shield against review. Dignity changes handling, not truth. The City may protect raw details while still disclosing the status,

consequence, correction, sanction, or unresolved question required for public understanding.

The remedy for dignity failure must include more than regret. Exposure of protected material, a mistaken classification, public humiliation, unnecessary raw release, or a fragment presented as the whole story should trigger correction of the public interface and notice to affected persons. Further access may need restriction, staff action may require review, and remedy must follow.

2.2.5 — Nonparticipant Separation

Nonparticipants retain their own privacy and standing. A participant's chosen burden does not cross by proximity, relationship, employment, or chance contact; each additional person and use requires its own lawful justification.

The record system must therefore identify third-party presence early. A conversation may include a participant and a nonparticipant. A household event may include role-relevant conduct and protected family material. A public corridor may include visitors. A clinical or legal encounter may include professionals bound by other duties. Capture design must recognize these people as rights-holders, not as background noise in the participant's record.

Nonparticipant separation has technical, legal, and narrative dimensions. Technical systems may need masking, segmentation, access controls, metadata boundaries, deletion review, and audit logs. Legal review must consider consent, privilege, child protection, labor rights, professional duties, and jurisdictional obligations. Narrative release must avoid making unnamed people legible through context, geography, timing, voice, or relational clues. Redaction that leaves a person identifiable by implication has not protected them.

Nonparticipant protection can create evidentiary tension. The public may need to know that a role-relevant event happened, that a participant received advice, that a conflict occurred, or that a protected category was invoked. The answer is not raw exposure. It is status-labeled summaries, affected-person review, independent oversight, delayed release, or restricted access where needed.

The most difficult nonparticipant cases will involve dual roles. A spouse may also be an advisor. A staff member may also be a political expert. A clinician may notice role-relevant risk. A journalist may become an affected person. Relationship labels alone are insufficient. The reviewer should classify the role played in the specific event and then protect the person according to both their public relevance and their independent rights.

Nonparticipant separation should be measurable by consequences, not merely by promises. Can a child attend family life without becoming a public character? Can a partner object? Can a staff member report harm without being swallowed into the participant's narrative? Can a visitor pass through the City without being indexed? If the answer is uncertain, the record design has not yet placed burden correctly.

2.3 — Capture Is Not Public Release

A record can exist without becoming public. Capture, custody, correction, access, release, and model-training permission are separate decisions requiring purpose-specific authority; authorization for one does not confer the others (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; International Council on Archives, 2012; W3C, 2013). Each stage needs its own error-correction duty and a record of who may authorize the next use. A public summary must be a reviewed output rather than an automatic copy of captured material.

2.3.1 — Capture Defined

Consider a hypothetical scheduling meeting outside the clinical consultation. A participant and an authorized coordinator discuss a change to an active-role work session. Only the necessary administrative facts enter the role record under declared notice and purpose; no clinical conversation, diagnosis, or family narrative is recorded.

Suppose an automated transcript of the scheduling meeting attributes one sentence to the wrong speaker. The record enters restricted review rather than the public site. The coordinator receives notice and standing to inspect the affected segment, the participant can contest the attribution, and an accountable human reviewer checks the authorized source record, corrects the attribution, and preserves an audit trail.

Only after purpose, attribution, protected-person review, context, and release authority are satisfied can a public summary be considered. The public may learn that an active-role schedule changed and why that mattered without receiving clinical or family information. If attribution remains unresolved, the object is labeled accordingly or remains unreleased (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; NIST, 2020b).

Capture is the creation, preservation, or intake of record material within the City's active public-power formation system. It may include documents, attendance, deliberation traces, influence contacts, work products, status labels, audit entries, security events, protected-category logs, technical continuity records, and other role-relevant evidence.

Capture can occur through several channels. Some material is produced by the participant's role work. Some is produced by staff, sensors, facilities systems, institutional logs, public-interface interactions, official correspondence, or external submissions. Some arrives from affected persons, whistleblowers, journalists, auditors, or host-community processes. Each channel needs provenance so later readers know where the record came from and what it can and cannot show.

A civic formation record does not automatically include clinical care, legal consultation, intimacy, or ordinary family contact. A separate lawful purpose may justify a narrowly held professional record, but not transfer its sensitive content into the City archive. Where an active-role consequence requires a status entry, such as a workload adjustment, that entry must be necessary, safe, and separately reviewed. Collection itself requires justification; restricted publication alone cannot repair unjustified capture.

Source evidence distinguishes observed conduct, stated explanations, documents, and accountable review findings from interpretation. A human reviewer's supported inference must be identified as such and remain contestable.

A stage-specific active-record charter should answer seven questions before any category is captured. What event or object enters the record? Who is responsible for capture? Which purpose authorizes it? What metadata establishes provenance? Which protected people or subjects appear within it? What is the

default access class? What review or appeal can change its treatment? If one of these questions has no answer, the system has produced data without governance (NIST, 2020b).

2.3.2 — Access Defined

Access is permission to inspect, handle, query, or use a record for a defined purpose. It is distinct from capture; public release is one form of making material accessible. Restricted access can authorize a reviewer to inspect more than the public may see, but only for the assigned task.

Access classes must be defined before activation. Public, participant, affected-person, oversight, staff-operational, legal, emergency, research, and Artificial Intelligence development access are not interchangeable. Each class needs a stated purpose, duration, logging rule, confidentiality condition, reviewer, and withdrawal route. A vague all-access culture would turn record integrity into internal surveillance (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; NIST, 2020b).

Affected-person access deserves special care. A staff member harmed by a participant, a nonparticipant misidentified in a record, a family member exposed by context, or a visitor whose image was captured may need access to correct, complain, or seek remedy. Yet granting access to one affected person may expose another. The City must treat affected-person access as a rights problem with review, not as a customer-service request.

Emergency access must be narrow and logged. Safety, medical crisis, imminent harm, legal duty, cybersecurity event, or continuity failure may require faster access than ordinary review. But emergency access should not become the back door through which curiosity, institutional embarrassment, or political pressure enters the archive. Every emergency access event should record who entered, why, what was viewed, what was

done, when review occurred, and what notice or correction followed.

If an authorized user misuses access to inspect material, export it, share fragments, train a tool, or pressure another person through knowledge gained from records, treat the conduct as record injury. The harmed party may be the participant, a staff member, a nonparticipant, or the public. Access abuse should have complaint, audit, sanction, and correction routes.

The person who maintains storage need not have authority to interpret content. The person who reviews a protected category need not have permission to export it. The person who investigates a complaint should see what is necessary for the complaint, not the participant's entire active history.

2.3.3 — Release Defined

A release decision should answer several questions before material leaves custody. What public burden does this release address? Which role-relevant fact is being made knowable? What protected categories are implicated? Which nonparticipants appear directly or by inference? What context is required to prevent misreading? What reply, correction, or appeal is available? What harms would raw release create that summary, delay, or restricted access could avoid?

Contextual bundles should be preferred to fragments. A single clip, line, image, or emotional moment can mislead even when authentic. Release design should preserve chronology, provenance, status, counterevidence, correction, and uncertainty so that public memory remains interpretable rather than merely abundant (International Council on Archives, 2012; W3C, 2013).

The final public-release cadence must be set through jurisdiction-specific legal and expert review before activation. It

must be timely enough to preserve a real opportunity for public judgment and restrained enough to protect dignity, safety, correction capacity, nonparticipants, and context. Where those aims conflict, the release decision needs a documented reason, accountable owner, review date, and route for challenge.

A decision may authorize a limited summary, restricted inspection, delay, or nonrelease. Public status is supplied only where needed and safe; it must not reveal a protected encounter or invite an inference of misconduct from lawful noncapture. The restricted decision record remains reviewable by the appropriate authority.

Monetized release should also be rejected. Release decisions cannot be driven by clicks, subscriptions, donor interest, campaign spectacle, or personality fandom. Public record access may require infrastructure funding, but the record itself should not become entertainment inventory.

Release is a public act, not an automatic technical state. It should identify the releasing authority, source bundle, applicable status label, protected omissions, date, version, correction route, and intended public meaning. A raw file placed online without those elements may be publicly reachable while remaining institutionally irresponsible.

2.3.4 — Interpretation Defined

The design must label each interpretive layer. Source records preserve what was captured; official status records a governed process; review findings state an accountable conclusion; participant replies and affected-person statements preserve contest and context; journalism offers independent interpretation; public opinion remains public judgment. Readiness bundles, correction notes, protected summaries, and

machine-generated summaries must identify which layer they represent.

Machine assistance must stay within the permitted source-linked tasks defined in Section 11.7.6. A label, source link, appeal route, or human approval cannot legitimize a prohibited profile of character, motive, readiness, or trust. Permitted outputs remain fallible and subject to the technical review in Chapter 30.

An accurate quotation may still mislead if it omits the question asked, the evidence available at the time, or a later revision.

Another obligation is to teach readers how not to overread. A pattern may suggest risk without proving motive. A correction may show learning without proving virtue. A protected label may show dignity handling without implying hidden misconduct. Interpretation guidance should not tell the public what to think. It should tell the public what kind of evidence they are seeing, which burden it can support, and which verdicts it cannot bear.

2.3.5 — Research Use Defined

Research or training use requires the separate authority, review and withdrawal rules in Section 11.6. Include nonparticipants and limits to deidentification in that review. Public availability does not establish permission for profiling or commercial reuse.

Every record receives an explicit research-use status and a named decision owner (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008).

2.3.6 — Artificial Intelligence Training Defined

The rule should be blunt: no City record becomes model-training material by default. A participant’s role-bound active-record burden does not authorize the institution, vendors, researchers, donors, public users, or future network partners to train models on the material.

Controlled retrieval can help users find approved records without training a general model on them. Summarization, transcription, translation, accessibility support, and provenance checking likewise need controls specific to their function. Vendor contracts and technical tests must establish whether a service retains inputs or uses them to alter a model; calling a product “search” does not settle that question (NIST, 2024b).

Before any training use, the City would need an authorized purpose, lawful basis, dataset provenance, model owner, retention rule, evaluation plan, bias and privacy assessment, human approver, opt-out or exclusion logic where applicable, and a credible route for correcting downstream outputs (NIST, 2023a; NIST, 2024b; UNESCO, 2021b).

Procurement review must reject tools that infer sincerity, loyalty, moral character, hidden motive, or future trustworthiness from the record. Such outputs would turn assistance into purported knowledge of the person, violating the City’s no-score boundary. Vendor documentation must make the distinction between permitted assistance and these inferences testable.

Stage transitions should carry an explicit effective date so later reviewers can reconstruct which authority governed a disputed use.

An unassigned charter decision is a development task: name the responsible team and require demonstration of the control in an ordinary operating scenario before activation.

2.4 — Nonvisibility Without Off-Record Formation

Protected nonvisibility lets the City combine answerability with dignity. It rejects indiscriminate exposure while also preventing sensitive categories from becoming undeclared channels of active public-power formation. The governing task is to define protection, delayed release, restricted access, affected-person standing, and review precisely enough that privacy remains real without reopening an off-record active zone (Lyon, 2007; Penney, 2025; NIST, 2020b). Protected nonvisibility includes noncapture where the City has no justified basis to record private life.

2.4.1 — Dignity Handling

Dignity handling should begin with category recognition. A record should identify whether the material involves health, counsel, intimacy, family, safety, child protection, professional privilege, or another protected domain. The classification should trigger rules for capture, custody, access, release, interpretation, retention, correction, and review. Protection cannot depend on staff improvising in the moment after sensitive material has already been exposed.

Dignity handling must be designed into architecture and workflow. Rooms, corridors, devices, signage, staff training, incident classification, private counsel windows, clinical spaces, and emergency protocols should make clear how protected domains are handled.

Staff need authority to prevent immediate injury when a procedure becomes unsafe. Review the operational action afterward, with access and documentation limited by the governing professional duties. The review must not convert protected care into a City record.

Institutional practice should protect against dignity inflation. Not every discomfort is a protected category. Public-power formation will involve criticism, disagreement, correction, embarrassment, and difficulty. Dignity handling protects vulnerability and rights, not reputation management. If every hard public fact becomes dignity-sensitive, the institution will hide the very burden it promised to reveal.

Dignity handling must account for chilling effects as an institutional outcome, not an individual weakness. People can begin to narrow lawful speech, experimentation, friendship, humor, dissent, and intellectual risk when observation is uncertain or socially punitive. The City should therefore measure where participants become performative, where staff avoid escalation, where protected people withdraw, and where public interpretation rewards conformity. Visibility that produces compliant silence can defeat formation while appearing orderly (Penney, 2025).

2.4.2 — Role-Record Delayed Release

Delay must be governed as a status. Every delayed record needs a classification, reason code, responsible office, review date, conditions for earlier release, conditions for extension, and a public-facing status label where silence would mislead and disclosure is safe and lawful. Content and, where necessary, the existence of a protected record may remain nonpublic; the delay decision remains independently auditable.

Delay can protect participants from performance pressure. If every difficult moment is released immediately, participants may start living as if each hour is campaign media. That would undermine the purpose of formation. The City needs enough time for reflection, correction, reply, and context before public interpretation hardens around fragments.

Delay can also protect nonparticipants and affected persons. A family member may need time to consent or object. A staff member may need protection from retaliation. A child may require absolute shielding. A legal process may require confidentiality. A security event may need containment. The public's interest in role formation is important, but it does not automatically defeat every competing duty.

The remedy for improper delay should include public correction where appropriate. If the City delayed material for an improper reason, extended delay without review, or used delay to shape public judgment unfairly, the record should disclose the delay history and the corrective action.

Delayed release should also include anti-surprise planning. Participants and affected persons should know when delayed material may become public, what review happens first, and how they can challenge classification or context. Surprise releases can replicate the cruelty of exposure even when technically lawful.

2.4.3 — Restricted Access

When a record is lawfully necessary, classification, restricted access, masking, delay, protected summary, or sealing can protect its sensitive content. A minimal status entry is used only where needed and safe. Protection remains reviewable without making the protected person or encounter a public exhibit.

The restricted-access class should be defined by role and purpose. Ombuds, external auditors, affected-person advocates, legal reviewers, clinicians, privacy officers, cybersecurity responders, child-protection reviewers, or designated public-interest panels may each need different access. No elite room should give powerful insiders unrestricted access to everything.

Restricted-access logs may themselves require protection. They must still record who inspected the material, under what authority, for what purpose, for how long, with what restrictions, and with what outcome. The existence of access should remain auditable.

Restricted access can improve a reviewer's understanding while also encouraging undue confidence in a privileged perspective. Where public explanation is necessary, lawful, and safe, state the reviewer's role, the finding's status, the available challenge route, and the reason the source remains restricted.

The next requirement is to define and review conflicts of interest. A reviewer with political ties, donor ties, family ties, professional dependence, vendor incentives, or institutional loyalty may not be appropriate for restricted material.

2.4.4 — Protected Summaries Before Release

A protected summary should answer the public question that justifies disclosure. Did a role-relevant event occur? Was a protected category invoked? Was there hidden active influence? Was an allegation reviewed? Was a record gap accidental, emergency-based, or misconduct? Was a remedy issued? The summary should not invite speculation about irrelevant private details. It should carry enough specificity to be meaningful and enough restraint to be humane.

A protected summary states the limits necessary for its purpose, such as unresolved attribution or restricted source access. Naming a clinical or legal category is not automatic: omit it where that fact would reveal a protected encounter or identify another person.

Protected summaries should be reviewable and correctable. Participants may challenge incompleteness, affected persons may challenge distortion, auditors may challenge institutional

self-protection, and public reviewers may challenge vagueness. Correction should not require exposing raw material. It may require amended status, stronger context, additional independent review, or a clearer statement of uncertainty.

Protected summaries should be written in a stable house language that avoids insinuation. Words such as incident, concern, protected review, resolved, unresolved, corrected, disputed, delayed, and restricted need definitions. Without definitions, summary language can become a way to imply guilt, minimize harm, or protect status. A glossary of summary terms may be more protective than dramatic prose.

A summary should also identify what decision it supports. Some summaries support public context, some support readiness review, some support affected-person remedy, and some support institutional audit. A summary that tries to serve every audience may reveal too much to some and too little to others. Purpose-specific summaries can preserve fairness if their differences are explained and traceable.

2.4.5 — Nonparticipant Masking in Active Records

Mask identifying third-party material before public release. If safe separation cannot be achieved or reidentification risk remains high, withhold the unsafe material from public release and use protected review. Provide a protected summary only where safe and authorized. Do not publish first and attempt repair afterward.

Nonparticipant masking includes redaction, pseudonymization, voice alteration, location generalization, timing suppression, relationship masking, metadata removal, and contextual shielding. It must address identification through combinations of details, not merely names.

Nonparticipant masking should include an objection route. A person may argue that they are identifiable, mischaracterized, exposed by context, or unfairly hidden where they need recognition for remedy. The City should allow affected-person review when safe, provide support, and update public materials when masking fails.

Masking is a continuing risk-management duty rather than a one-time edit. A person who is unidentifiable today may become identifiable after later public events, leaked fragments, social-media speculation, or archive expansion. High-risk records therefore receive scheduled and event-triggered review, with stronger masking or access controls when context changes.

The protection review should consider the full public environment, including search engines, social media, commercial datasets, and machine inference.

2.4.6 — Protected Domains Cannot Hide Role Formation

A protected setting must not become an authorized route for consequential role business to evade the active-record rules. The hard case is a mixed encounter: review must distinguish the role transaction from the protected relationship in which it occurred.

Where a role-relevant status entry is necessary and safe, an authorized reviewer may record that status without transferring protected substance into the City archive. Noncapture remains the rule where collection lacks justification. Neither the sensitivity of a setting nor the public's curiosity settles the classification; the decision must respect the professional and legal duties governing the encounter.

Professional interfaces need role-specific charters. Legal counsel protects due process and privilege-sensitive material while role-related political strategy remains traceable. Clinical care protects treatment and professional independence without

becoming hidden formation coaching. Spiritual care protects conscience without institutional command. Family consultation protects private relationships while public influence remains reviewable. The charter identifies purpose, confidentiality, escalation, record handling, and the point at which another role must take custody.

Hard classification cases require independent review. If the participant, staff, or institution alone decides whether a sensitive event is also role-relevant, incentives will distort the result. Privacy, legal, clinical, archival, and public-interest reviewers may need distinct roles, even when the public receives only a status label.

Before lawyers, clinicians, spiritual advisors, educators, and security staff enter the City, train them to preserve their professional duties while recording necessary role-relevant status safely.

2.5 — Continuity Breaks, Technical Failure, and Repair

Record integrity becomes credible when a failure has a name and a response. A missing expected record, an intact record withheld under law, and a documented emergency exception are different conditions. Review should classify the condition before inferring either misconduct or excuse (NIST, 2024a; NIST, 2025b; ISO/IEC, 2022; ISO, 2019). The repair record should state the interval affected, the persons notified, and the independent verification performed.

2.5.1 — Continuity Break Defined

A continuity break is an interruption in active record integrity during a period or event that falls within the role-bound active public-power record. It does not automatically mean misconduct. It means the expected chain of capture, custody, access logging, classification, or preservation was interrupted. Naming the break prevents the City from treating absence as either nothing or scandal by default.

Continuity breaks may result from device failure, misrouting, emergency interruption, cyberattack, or the absence of authorized capture infrastructure. Classification should identify which expected capture, custody, access-log, or preservation function actually failed. An intact record whose access or release is lawfully restricted or delayed is not, for that reason alone, a continuity break. Its access or release status should be labeled separately. Where an emergency both interrupts capture and restricts disclosure, record both conditions and assign each its own review and remedy.

A continuity break is not the same as lawful pause or exit. If the participant is formally paused or has left active status, the record obligation changes. If the participant remains active and

the record fails, the continuity break belongs inside the active record. This distinction prevents the institution from retroactively reclassifying active gaps as private time after embarrassment occurs.

Continuity breaks should be expected in design. Backup systems, redundant storage, manual logs, witness protocols, emergency review, audit trails, and protected-category workflows reduce the damage of failure.

Continuity breaks should be categorized by effect as well as cause. A short recording failure during an assigned workshop differs from a missing record during a donor contact, staff conflict, emergency, or readiness decision. The public significance of a gap depends on the question the missing evidence could answer. A period in which capture was neither required nor authorized is not a continuity break.

Partial evidence can be preserved, but only as labeled reconstruction. A gap may leave surrounding logs, witness statements, access records, backup fragments, status entries, or participant explanations. Those materials may support a limited account, yet the public must be able to distinguish original continuity from an account assembled after interruption.

2.5.2 — Technical Failure Classification

Technical failure classification assigns the right remedy to the right cause. Accident, system weakness, negligent design, vendor breach, user error, cybersecurity event, sabotage, and intentional evasion produce different responsibilities and public meanings. A battery failure calls for resilience and maintenance; chronic underinvestment calls for governance correction; a vendor exploit calls for security and contractual remedies; deliberate concealment calls for investigation and due process. Evidence, not institutional convenience, determines the category.

Technical failures require both engineering and governance review. Engineers may identify how a system failed, while archivists see custody implications, privacy reviewers see exposure, security reviewers see adversarial patterns, and ombuds see the burden on participants or affected persons. Classification should join technical diagnosis to rights, remedy, and public-risk analysis (ISO, 2019; ISO/IEC, 2022; NIST, 2024a; NIST, 2025b).

A technical failure should preserve chain-of-custody evidence where possible. Logs, hashes, timestamps, backup status, access attempts, system alerts, manual notes, staff reports, and vendor communications may help distinguish loss from tampering. The City should avoid overpromising technical certainty. It should state confidence levels, unresolved questions, and what cannot be reconstructed.

Vendor failures deserve special treatment. If core record systems depend on external vendors, the City has moved burden into contract architecture. Vendor telemetry, access, model tools, cloud storage, transcription systems, cybersecurity tools, and maintenance processes can become hidden power. Technical failure classification should therefore ask whether the vendor caused, worsened, concealed, or profited from the failure.

Classification should also consider cybersecurity deception. Deepfakes, altered logs, spoofed identities, malicious access, ransomware, insider threats, and adversarial deletion can make record failure appear like participant evasion or staff incompetence. The City should avoid immediate public conclusions until forensic review has enough basis. Precision protects both accountability and the innocent.

Failure classification should distinguish at least availability failure, capture failure, provenance failure, integrity failure, confidentiality failure, classification error, wrongful access,

wrongful release, interpretation failure, correction failure, and model-generated distortion. Each type creates a different public meaning and requires a different response. A system that labels every incident technical difficulty hides the difference between a broken camera, an altered file, a privacy breach, and a false public summary.

2.5.3 — Emergency Exception Logging

Emergency exception logging preserves later review when ordinary record procedure must bend. Fire, medical crisis, physical threat, cyberattack, evacuation, security incident, family emergency, legal compulsion, or sudden infrastructure failure may make ordinary capture, release, access, or classification temporarily impossible or unsafe.

An emergency exception should record the triggering condition, the active status of the participant, the nature of the deviation, who authorized it, who was notified, what material may have been lost or restricted, what protective steps were taken, and when ordinary review resumed. Keep the exception independently reviewable where public-power formation is implicated, while restricting details or the existence of a protected encounter when safety, dignity, or law requires it.

Emergency exceptions can be abused. A participant or institution may learn that invoking emergency language buys secrecy, delay, or narrative control. The City should therefore require independent after-action review, pattern monitoring, and escalation when emergency exceptions become frequent or poorly explained. A repeated emergency may reveal a design failure or a strategy of evasion.

Emergency labels must protect children, family, visitors, host residents, staff, and other affected people. A public notice may identify the exception without disclosing tactical security details,

medical information, locations, or vulnerabilities that could invite harm.

Emergency preparedness also requires rehearsal. Dry runs, tabletop exercises, staff drills, manual fallback forms, alternate power, protected transport, and communication protocols reduce the chance that crisis destroys record integrity.

2.5.4 — Record Gap Notice

A record-gap notice identifies an expected active-role record that is incomplete, of uncertain integrity, under reconstruction, or unrecoverable. Label any lawful access or release restriction separately, following Section 2.5.1. State what is known, what remains unknown, who is reviewing the gap, whether reconstruction is underway, and the next status-update date.

Gap notices need precision rather than euphemism. “Record unavailable,” without explanation, invites suspicion while shielding the institution; “serious hidden breach,” asserted before review, can unjustly implicate participants and staff.

Gap notice is especially important for public timing. If an event occurs near a readiness bundle, campaign transition, office interface, public controversy, staff complaint, or allegation of influence, missing record material can shape public judgment. The notice should prevent the gap from being exploited by supporters, opponents, media, or the institution itself.

Participants and affected persons should have a route to challenge a gap notice. The participant may argue that the notice implies suspicion unfairly. An affected person may argue that the notice understates harm or hides a protected category. Staff may argue that institutional management caused the gap. Correcting a notice should be part of record correction rather than a public-relations choice.

2.5.5 — Remedy and Correction

A continuity break, misclassification, improper release, hidden access, technical failure, false summary, inadequate masking, or delayed notice should not end with an internal acknowledgment. The City must ask who was burdened, what public understanding was distorted, what record must change, what harm requires repair, and what system must be altered to prevent recurrence.

Correction has several layers. Affected persons may need notification, apology, support, privacy repair, or legal remedy. Staff may need protection if they reported the problem.

Remedy should not depend on proof of bad intent. A public record can mislead without malice. Intent matters for discipline, but harm and correction matter for fairness.

A complete system must also repair institutional incentives. If staff were pressured to classify broadly, if vendors made audit difficult, if release deadlines encouraged shortcuts, if public attention rewarded sensational fragments, or if leadership suppressed bad news, individual correction is not enough.

Cosmetic correction cannot repair a public distortion that has already spread; a small edit buried in the archive is not enough. The City may need prominent correction, notification, machine-summary update, public-bundle versioning, search-result correction, and external audit.

Preserve the correction and resulting training, design, vendor, or policy changes in audit memory.

2.5.6 — Public Status Labels

Public status labels are the vocabulary by which the City tells the public what kind of record condition it is seeing. A label may identify active, paused, delayed, restricted, protected, under

review, corrected, disputed, sealed, deleted under schedule, or unrecoverable status.

A label should be precise without exposing what it protects. “Release delayed pending nonparticipant masking” may be safer than immediate public access. The label should carry enough information to locate the burden while refusing unnecessary exposure.

Public labels separate process status from moral meaning. Under review marks an unresolved process; restricted marks controlled access; protected marks a dignity boundary; corrected marks a change to the record; disputed marks an active challenge; sealed marks a lawful access condition. By displaying status, owner, date, and review path, the record slows the rush from procedural state to moral judgment.

Before public use, publish stable definitions, examples, update rules, appeal routes, and review or expiry dates. Place plain-language definitions beside the record so readers can distinguish statuses without legal training. Internal labels may be more detailed but must map to the same public categories.

City-controlled search, summaries, exports, and accessible versions must preserve applicable status and its effective date, dispute information, provenance, and correction information. External reuse may strip those labels; monitor consequential misuse and pursue correction where reachable without claiming control over every copy.

Across jurisdictions and translations, labels should preserve the distinctions among protected content, restricted access, and delayed release. Local handling may differ where law requires it, but each label must accurately describe the applicable condition.

2.6 — Exit Instead of Secret Exception

A severe civic Vow becomes fair only if the participant can leave by a lawful route. Exit is not the enemy of transparency. It is the alternative to secret exception, hidden active life, coerced endurance, and institutional self-protection. A City that cannot let people leave will eventually teach them to hide (Hirschman, 1970; Wertheimer, 1987; United Nations, 1966).

2.6.1 — Exit as Integrity Tool

Exit provides an explicit end to active status when the role can no longer be carried. Public labels describe the operational transition without requiring disclosure of health, family, or other private reasons. Alleged misconduct and any continuing remedy follow their separate processes; departure alone implies neither.

The institution also needs authority to release participants when its own conditions fail. Misused records, inadequate third-party protection, unsustainable staff systems, legal limits, technical breakdown, or spectacle pressure may make continued active burden unjustifiable. Independent review can order de-loading, pause, protected exit, or closure, with care and record repair following the person.

Departure does not cancel remedies owed for active-period conduct. The record remains governed under Section 2.6.5 while future active-role duties end.

Exit planning should begin at entry. The applicant should know how to request withdrawal, what happens to active-period records, what support continues temporarily, how family and dependents are handled, and what public status may appear. Exit explained only at collapse becomes coercive because the participant must decide under fear and exhaustion.

2.6.2 — Pause Versus Active Participation

A pause suspends City-sponsored role formation; its public status label does not disclose protected reasons.

Pause rules must specify which City-sponsored duties stop and which support continues. Basic support, care, necessary administration, and review may remain available. The City must not continue strategic coaching, donor access, policy assignments, public-interface preparation, or office-readiness work covertly while describing the participant as paused. This restriction governs the City's active-role program; it does not authorize surveillance of private thought, ordinary relationships, or lawful political activity outside that program. Any proposed return to active status requires a declared transition and review of role-relevant conflicts, not a claim over all conduct during the pause.

Pause should have entry criteria. Health overload, family emergency, technical failure, legal review, protected-category complexity, security threat, capacity concern, staff conflict, or participant request may justify it. The criteria should be broad enough to protect real life and narrow enough to prevent evasion. A pause granted for every inconvenience would dissolve the Vow. A pause denied until collapse would make the Vow cruel.

Pause should also have review dates and transition options. The outcome may be return to active participation, modified support, extended pause, withdrawal, suspension, removal, or institutional correction. The status should not drift indefinitely. Drift burdens the participant, staff, and public because no one knows whether active formation is continuing, suspended, or quietly abandoned.

Pause should be visible to internal systems as well as public materials. Staff schedules, access permissions, public-interface

calendars, role assignments, record capture rules, education requirements, advisor contacts, and support services should all reflect paused status. Status must change workflow, not merely narrative.

2.6.3 — Withdrawal Review

The review should begin from respect for the participant's stated reason without surrendering public accountability automatically. A person may need to leave for deeply private reasons. Withdrawal cannot require public confession. It should identify what level of public status is necessary to explain the active record, preserve remedies, and protect affected persons, while withholding raw protected material where dignity requires it.

Withdrawal review should also identify institutional obligations. Has the City provided promised support? Did notice accurately describe the burden? Were protected nonvisibility processes functioning? Did public release create unexpected harm? Did staff or donors exert pressure? Did technical systems expand beyond understood scope? If the institution changed the burden, it should not treat withdrawal as participant failure.

Withdrawal review records and implements the participant's decision to leave; it does not make voluntary departure conditional on institutional approval. The review may offer a pause, arrange support, modify conditions at the participant's request, open a complaint, initiate institutional correction, preserve the governed active-period record, or refer alleged misconduct to a separate process. Accountability and remedy can continue after departure, but they must not be used to require continued participation.

Affected persons may need a voice in withdrawal review when their rights or remedies are at stake. A participant should not be able to leave in a way that erases an unresolved staff complaint,

family exposure, nonparticipant harm, record breach, or public misrepresentation. At the same time, affected-person participation should not become retaliation or forced exposure. The review route must balance dignity, remedy, and public memory.

Withdrawal review should include the possibility of participant success. Sometimes leaving is the right civic decision because the participant recognizes misfit, competing duty, or changed ambition before harm occurs. The City should be able to say that withdrawal preserved fairness.

2.6.4 — No Shame in Leaving

If leaving marks a person as cowardly, impure, disloyal, failed, weak, or unworthy, the City will coerce continued participation through reputation.

Departure needs a civic vocabulary rather than a moral hierarchy. Not yet, no longer active, withdrawn, completed, redirected, suspended, removed, and reintegrating describe institutional status, not human worth. Even removal for misconduct should identify conduct and consequence without converting the person's entire life into an object of contempt.

No-shame language should appear in how other participants speak as well as in official labels. If the culture of the City treats leavers as weak even while the policy says exit is honorable, the real rule will be shame. Staff, mentors, educators, public-interface workers, and participants should be trained to speak of exit as a legitimate status change, not a moral fall.

2.6.5 — Post-Exit Boundary

The post-exit boundary restores future ordinary privacy while preserving the active-period record that public trust may need. A participant's active record may remain for accountability, correction, remedy, lawful retention, public memory, or

institutional learning. The City stops creating new active-role records when active status ends. Any later administrative, legal, safety, or correction records require a separate, defined purpose.

The boundary should be visible in the public record. Public materials should distinguish active-period evidence, post-exit updates about the old record, later public office records handled by government, ordinary public speech, private life, and unrelated future conduct. Without this distinction, the City's archive becomes a permanent identity system.

Labels must distinguish active, paused, withdrawn, suspended, completed, office-interface, and post-exit status, with the effective date of each transition.

Post-exit communication should be limited by purpose. The City may need to notify the public of withdrawal, preserve an active-period bundle, provide correction, handle appeals, support reintegration, or comply with law. Curiosity after exit is not public-power formation.

Exit does not grant new research or model-training permissions. Later use remains subject to the separate gates in Sections 2.3.5–2.3.6.

The boundary needs long-term review because records outlive the active role. Retention, sealing, deletion, bundle updates, correction, appeal, and posthumous dignity require explicit deadlines and review dates. A record kept forever without purpose becomes hidden cost.

Chapter 3 — The City’s Boundaries

An institution can retain its original name while changing its practical character. A gate installed for safety can impede departure. A community formed around study can make dissent costly. A public archive can become a market for exposure. The boundaries in this chapter concern those changes in power and dependence, including changes that occur without anyone deciding to abandon the original mission.

The inquiry begins by removing the institution’s preferred description. What remains are doors, permissions, records, money, support, obligations, and people with unequal ability to refuse. An applicant who needs housing, a worker who fears retaliation, or a former participant seeking an ordinary future may encounter a different institution from the one a visitor sees. Their ability to use a safeguard is stronger evidence than the confidence with which its designers describe it.

Six distinctions organize the chapter. The prison boundary concerns practical movement, care, and exit. The cult boundary concerns conscience, dissent, and authority that survives criticism. The spectacle boundary concerns how records are selected, presented, and financed. The government boundary concerns lawful powers and institutional custody. The virtue boundary concerns the conversion of participation into status. The scientific boundary concerns what operational evidence can establish. Each demands its own test; success on one cannot compensate for failure on another.

The tests matter most under pressure. A donor may seek access, a security incident may invite exceptional control, a charismatic participant may attract demands for authority, or an embarrassing record may threaten the City’s reputation. Review must ask what happens then, when honoring the boundary carries a visible institutional cost. It must also ask whether

temporary powers contract after the pressure passes or remain as convenient precedent.

Comparison should include the nearest legitimate alternative as well as the dangerous extreme. A residential school, training institution, archive, or public agency may share some of the City’s features without sharing its mission. Comparing actual powers, dependencies, and remedies prevents the proposal from inventing a private definition of safety. External critics need not adopt the project’s vocabulary before their evidence can count.

Chapter 2 supplied the record and exit rules; this chapter examines whether those rules withstand institutional incentives. The result should be a set of inspectable conditions rather than a series of reassuring denials. A critic must be able to identify a failure, reach an independent decision maker, and obtain a consequence that changes practice. That approach also gives supporters a more exact task: to defend what works, disclose what does not, and change the mechanism when its ordinary description no longer matches the institution they intended to build.

3.1 — Not a Prison

Practical voluntariness is the City's first legitimacy test. A place with a perimeter, routines, record systems, security gates, role obligations, and structured exit remains civic only when entry is informed, continued participation is genuinely revisable, and leaving is materially possible. Those conditions must be demonstrated in practice, not inferred from good intent (United Nations, 1966; United Nations, 2015; Goffman, 1961; Foucault, 1977; ILO, 2025). Exit must remain workable even when the institution disagrees with a participant's reasons for leaving.

3.1.1 — Voluntary Entry

Separate application, orientation, independent advice, commitment, and activation. A compressed or theatrical entry process lets institutional momentum substitute for deliberation. The entry safeguards in Section 2.1 must remain effective when an applicant is eager to belong.

The entry mechanism should also include an anti-recruitment safeguard. The City may publish eligibility, answer questions, and accept applications, but it should not target people made vulnerable by crisis, scandal, debt, public shame, or grief. Public-power seekers may be invited to consider burden, but they should not be emotionally cornered into it.

Practical voluntariness should be tested as a continuing condition rather than presumed from an application. The first question is whether the person had a real alternative before entry. The second is whether the material consequences of refusal were disclosed. The third is whether debt, immigration status, housing, medical need, employment, family dependence, or reputational pressure made refusal nominal. The fourth is whether independent advice was available before commitment (ILO, 2025).

The test continues after entry. Can the participant raise a complaint without retaliation? Can they decline a specific activity without being recast as disloyal? Can they pause without losing care or basic stability? Can they exit without forfeiting earned compensation, personal belongings, essential records, legal support, or the dignity of a public explanation? A voluntary institution is defined less by the ease of joining than by the reality of saying no after belonging has become costly.

Indicators developed in forced-labour prevention should not be transplanted as accusations, but they offer a useful adversarial checklist: abuse of vulnerability, deception, restriction of movement, isolation, intimidation, retention of identity documents, withholding of wages, debt bondage, abusive conditions, and excessive overtime. A City that begins to resemble these conditions cannot defend itself by pointing to an old consent form. It must treat the pattern as evidence that voluntariness has failed.

3.1.2 — Real Exit

Exit also needs independent witnesses. If the same office that benefits from a participant's continued presence controls the exit arrangements, the process lacks the independence needed to resolve that conflict. A fair design gives the participant access to an ombuds, counsel or independent advocate, medical review where relevant, and a public status label that says only what public-power accountability requires.

Review aggregate exit patterns only where the reporting group and detail protect individuals. Small cohorts may require pooled periods, broad categories, or restricted oversight instead of publication. The review should test whether people could leave and obtain promised support, not demand health or family

explanations as proof of voluntariness (Hirschman, 1970; Wertheimer, 1987).

3.1.3 — Rights Under Constraint

Rights under constraint should be readable in ordinary language. A participant should not need a specialist to understand which rights survive the Vow, how to complain, how to appeal, how to request shielding, how to challenge a release, and how to contact outside help. If rights are written only in internal legal form, the burden of comprehension has been shifted to the person under pressure.

The rights architecture should also include pattern review. A single complaint may be handled correctly while a pattern reveals intimidation, delay, access barriers, staff bias, or hidden retaliation. Periodic public summaries should show categories and reforms without exposing protected persons. Pattern review must begin before catastrophe reveals whether the rights system works in practice.

A mature rights floor should include emergency rights. The moment of crisis is when rights are easiest to treat as inconvenient. A participant in panic, illness, conflict, security alarm, or public controversy still needs status notice, de-escalation, care access, record logging, after-action review, and an appeal route where consequences follow.

Every constraint should be decomposed into purpose, duration, decision owner, review, appeal, and remedy. A secure-area access limit, an emergency safety separation, and a delayed-release rule serve different functions and therefore require different authorities. The record identifies what triggered the constraint, who approved it, how the affected person can challenge it, and when it expires.

3.1.4 — Non-Carceral Perimeter

A non-carceral perimeter starts with purpose-labeled gates. Some gates protect record systems. Some protect residential edges. Some manage visitor flows. Some preserve recovery zones. Some separate public interface from household life. Each gate should explain what burden it prevents from moving onto the wrong person.

Perimeter rules should separate entry control from exit control. A secure gate that carefully screens visitors is not the same as a gate that delays a participant's lawful departure. The City can protect residents from intrusion while making exit administratively simple and physically legible. A participant should know where to go, whom to notify, what happens to the record, and how to leave without negotiating with security as if seeking permission from custody.

The perimeter should also prevent crowds, media, activists, vendors, fans, or hostile observers from imposing traffic, surveillance, policing tension, or spectacle on surrounding neighborhoods.

The perimeter should communicate safety and relationship to children and dependents as clearly as it communicates access rules to experts. Family routes, visitor explanations, household edges, and contact procedures should show that the participant remains reachable and that institutional access does not depend on favor. Design language, staff practice, and physical form must make the boundary feel like governed civic infrastructure rather than custody or display.

Wayfinding should show exits, security staff should receive de-escalation and rights training, and visitor rules should be published. Searches, restraints, detention, and exclusion remain subject to applicable law and external authority.

3.1.5 — Care Before Control

Clinicians, mentors, disability specialists, participant advocates, and ombuds must be able to trigger review when record burden, schedule, public interface, security practice, or staff influence becomes unsafe. Care professionals should not be reduced to keeping participants functional for institutional output.

Care before control should have budget priority. It is easy to fund cameras, locks, incident systems, and security posts while treating sleep protection, trauma support, disability accommodations, family consultation, de-loading, and clinical independence as soft costs. If control receives durable funding and care depends on goodwill, the institution has already chosen the wrong moral sequence.

Care before control should include a burden-transfer review after every new restriction. If the City adds a gate, camera, escort rule, curfew-like limit, or public-interface constraint, it should ask whose burden has increased: participant, staff, family, visitor, host, or public. Security may be justified, but fairness requires the institution to count the cost of its own protective reflexes rather than naming them neutral.

Care before control changes the first institutional response to distress. When a participant misses obligations, withdraws, becomes disorganized, or appears overwhelmed, the initial question is what support, illness, conflict, exhaustion, or harm may be present. Security or disciplinary escalation may sometimes be necessary, but it should not become the default language through which vulnerability is translated into threat. Care teams need independence from performance evaluation so seeking help does not become self-incrimination.

3.2 — Not a Cult

Plural conscience and freely exercisable dissent are civic assets, not obstacles to formation. Coercive belonging can grow around politics, therapy, technology, philanthropy, education, leadership, science, nationalism, or reform, so a secular label offers no protection by itself. The operational test is whether interpretation, criticism, outside relationships, and exit remain free when the institution becomes admired (Lifton, 1961; Lalich, 2004; Tourish, 2013; Hirschman, 1970). A City organized around visible public-power formation will be especially vulnerable to group intensity.

3.2.1 — No Sacred Membership Requirement

This boundary must be visible in admissions. The application may ask whether a person understands the City's civic burden, record rules, rights, and limits. It should not ask whether the person believes the formal Law is true, finds the optional spiritual path explored in *The Religion of Fairness* meaningful, accepts a founder's interpretation, or treats transparency as sacred.

Daily life must also preserve plural conscience. Reflection spaces should not become mandatory religious spaces. Optional rituals should not become unofficial tests. Language about burden, repair, apology, grief, ambition, and service should be accessible to people who do not share the same metaphysical frame.

Admissions and public records should never mark belief status as readiness evidence. A participant may mention faith, doubt, or participation in the Religion of Fairness voluntarily where relevant to public-power formation, but the City should not collect belief as a performance metric.

Ceremony may mark responsibility, but it must not require an emotional display, reverence for the founder, or a metaphysical affirmation as evidence of commitment. Solemnity cannot become an informal admissions or advancement test.

3.2.2 — No Founder Sovereignty

Participants may live together, study together, face criticism together, recover together, and become symbols together. The public may project hope onto them. Donors may praise them. Critics may attack them. Shared pressure can create loyalty rituals even when no one writes a doctrine. The City must design against that social chemistry.

This boundary should be written into governance. Board authority, audit authority, ombuds authority, scientific deference, legal review, accreditation, public artifact review, and complaint systems should not depend on founder approval. A founder should be able to be criticized in the record, investigated by oversight, corrected by experts, and overruled by governance where the institution's safeguards require it.

No founder sovereignty also applies to language. Phrases such as founder vision, loyalty to the origin, true interpretation, inner circle, betrayal of the project, or enemies of the Law can create an atmosphere where personal identity and institutional truth merge. The City should prefer public reasons, written criteria, reviewable decisions, and distributed authority. A phrase that makes disagreement feel like disloyalty should be treated as design damage.

Origin history belongs in the record as context, not as a source of continuing sovereignty. The public archive can document founders, early choices, funding, conflicts, corrections, and dissent while organizing the institution around its lawful

mission, rights architecture, participants, staff, host community, critics, and independent review.

The institution also needs a succession plan independent of its founder. Even if a founder is wise, charismatic, or unusually careful, the City must not be organized around the founder's continuing presence. A lawful institution needs roles that can be refilled, standards that can be audited, archives that can preserve disagreement, and governance that can correct origin language. Mortality, scandal, illness, conflict, and change should not endanger the City's basic safeguards.

3.2.3 — Dissent and Freedom After Exit

Participants, staff, host communities, and external critics need formal routes to challenge the City’s practices and continued existence. Standing must not depend on agreement with its mission.

Protected reporting preserves the concern, relevant evidence, response, and review status with access appropriate to the case. Public reporting may describe the issue without identifying the critic. Freedom to dissent does not require every criticism to enter a public bundle.

Dissent routes should include protected internal dissent and lawful external reporting or public dissent. Internal dissent lets a participant or staff member raise concerns before harm spreads. Public dissent lets critics warn society when internal routes fail or when the concern belongs to citizens beyond the City. Protection must not depend on exhausting internal routes where law permits direct external reporting. Nor should a person lose protection because reasonable internal paths proved unsafe or ineffective.

The institution’s response to dissent should itself be logged and reviewed. Did the response change a rule, create a review,

disclose a failure, or explain a refusal? A dissent log that records complaints without institutional movement becomes another archive of unheard burden.

Prevent honors from creating post-exit dependency. Awards, alumni circles, donor dinners, public testimonials, and former-participant panels can keep a person symbolically attached even after formal exit. Exit without betrayal also means exit without permanent ceremonial usefulness.

The language surrounding exit is diagnostic. Terms such as deserter, apostate, failure, traitor, unready, unsafe, or ungrateful can create a social penalty more powerful than a locked gate. Alumni relations should be voluntary, and former participants should retain ordinary rights to criticize the institution publicly.

3.2.4 — Religion of Fairness and Civic Membership Boundary

Religious services, pastoral conversations, and Religion of Fairness events are optional and separate from civic assessment. Ordinary spiritual practice is outside the role record; participation or refusal must not create a readiness mark, formal or informal.

Boundary language around the Religion of Fairness should not become contempt for believers. Participants who find religious meaning in their burden should be protected too, provided they do not impose that meaning on others or convert civic record into spiritual rank. The City should permit conscience in many directions: belief, nonbelief, doubt, syncretism, rejection, silence, and change.

Review informal rewards as well as formal rules. Donor favor, public affection, and access to a spiritual community can pressure participation even when no written requirement exists.

Correct those advantages through disclosure, separation of decision roles, and independent review.

Pastoral and spiritual conversations remain outside the active civic record unless a participant requests a lawful, purpose-defined disclosure. Clergy, chaplains, advisers, and peer facilitators are not investigators or readiness assessors. Confidentiality and reporting limits must be clear before care begins.

The boundary also needs ordinary mechanics. Scheduling, facilities, staff authority, funding, honors, housing, support, and advancement may not favor the Religion of Fairness over another path. Participation, refusal, conversion, doubt, and departure carry no civic consequence.

3.3 — Not a Spectacle Park or Reality Show

A public record serves democracy when context defeats spectacle. Visibility can help citizens judge power, yet the same material can be clipped, monetized, aestheticized, or turned into an appetite for private exposure. The City's public interface must therefore make civic purpose, provenance, affected-person protection, correction, and contextual access stronger than humiliation, voyeurism, fame, or entertainment (Andrejevic, 2004; Debord, 1994; Marwick and boyd, 2011; UNESCO, 2018). The interface should disclose enough context to test a quotation without demanding that its critic accept the City's interpretation.

3.3.1 — Records Are Not Entertainment

Entertainment logic often hides as engagement. A platform may say it is making records accessible while ranking clips by outrage, intimacy, humiliation, or partisan utility. Views, shares, spectacle, and fan behavior are not measures of civic usefulness. Public usability matters, but usability is not virality.

The public record site should not have entertainment affordances. It should avoid infinite scrolling, autoplay feeds, reaction badges, popularity charts, character pages, dramatic thumbnails, countdowns, teaser language, and algorithmic recommendations based on emotional intensity.

A practical test is whether the record remains useful when stripped of drama. A release should help citizens understand role formation, influence, decision process, correction, or readiness limits even when presented plainly. If it matters only because it shocks, humiliates, or fascinates, it probably does not belong in that form. A record site designed for judgment will often be slower, plainer, and more contextual than a site designed for excitement.

3.3.2 — Anti-Humiliation Design

Pre-release review must distinguish the role fact from sensitive bodily, relational, clinical, familial, or spiritual material. The capture and release decisions remain separately justified under Section 2.3; a presumed need for continuity does not authorize collecting protected private life.

A fair record can be stern and, when the facts require it, devastating. Its force comes from accuracy, context, due process, and remedy rather than degradation added for memorability.

Humiliation can occur without insults. Camera angle, replay, thumbnail, headline, excerpt length, notification timing, audience reaction, searchable tagging, and juxtaposition can turn an accurate record into a degrading object. Anti-humiliation review should therefore examine presentation as well as content. The standard is not whether the participant feels comfortable. It is whether the institution is using exposure to reduce a person's status rather than to explain a public-role fact.

3.3.3 — Anti-Clipping Discipline

Imagine a journalist receives a cropped sentence from the record site: "the participant accepted a total active record." Detached from its surrounding rules, the phrase can be made to sound carceral, devotional, or televisual. A hostile-crop review treats that misreading as a design test rather than as proof of bad faith.

The object should identify the active public role and period beside the phrase "Total Record," with a clear route to the stage charter in Section 2.3. Add the particular limitation needed for the claim at hand. A concise object need not reproduce every safeguard, but it must not imply whole-person surveillance.

The test is passed only when a critic can quote the visible object without being forced to invent the missing boundary. The critic remains free to reject the institution, but the disagreement

concerns an accurately described civic design rather than an accidental invitation to voyeurism (UNESCO, 2018).

Visual discipline carries civic meaning before a reader reaches the explanatory text. Perimeter diagrams should communicate access and rights rather than confinement; record interfaces should foreground provenance and context rather than surveillance theater; archive imagery should present public memory rather than institutional worship. Intimate, medical, child, and household material remains outside public illustration. Strong visual design is vivid, humane, and difficult to crop into the opposite of its purpose.

Correction routes must exist before fragments are misused publicly. When material spreads with false status or missing context, the institution should be able to publish a corrective bundle, mark the relevant limits, protect affected persons, and avoid fueling further spectacle. Private people should not be forced to explain themselves because the City chose the record regime (Andrejevic, 2004; Marwick and boyd, 2011).

Clipping risk should be addressed at source. Each detachable excerpt should carry a record identifier, date, status, context, correction state, and a stable route to the fuller record. If a passage cannot survive detachment without material distortion, the interface should flag it and avoid packaging it for sharing. The City cannot prevent hostile editing, but it can refuse to facilitate it.

3.3.4 — No Monetized Exposure

Access design should avoid premium visibility. No donor, subscriber, journalist, influencer, academic, volunteer, or political actor should receive rawer exposure because they pay, praise, or amplify. Access classes may exist for oversight, affected-person rights, research review, legal process,

professional duties, or public bundles, but access should follow authority and purpose.

The ban on direct sales does not remove indirect incentives for exposure. A dramatic release could increase donations, prestige, volunteer growth, political access, or media partnerships. Review those incentives and give heightened scrutiny to a release that predictably benefits the institution by exposing a person.

The financing model is part of the boundary. Advertising, sponsored placement, subscription tiers for privileged record access, engagement bonuses, influencer partnerships, donor-branded releases, or sale of behavioral data would create structural pressure toward exposure. The public interface should be funded as accountable civic infrastructure, with disclosed budgets and procurement, so its survival does not depend on turning participants into content.

3.3.5 — Public Interface With Context

Navigation should distinguish public bundles from restricted inspection. Explain an unavailable object's status only to the extent needed and safe; some protected records or encounters must not be publicly acknowledged.

The interface must also prevent public overreach. Citizens may ask questions, submit evidence, contribute expertise, or review permitted bundles, but crowds cannot demand greater exposure. Curiosity creates no entitlement to intimacy; participation remains bounded by role relevance and dignity.

Accessibility is part of context preservation. Captions, transcripts, audio description, multilingual access, keyboard navigation, readable typography, cognitive-access versions, and plain-language summaries should carry the same provenance, status labels, and correction history as the primary record. An

inaccessible archive forces some readers to rely on secondary clips and summaries, which are often the forms most vulnerable to distortion.

Deliberate friction is warranted when virality would outrun judgment. Delayed reposting for sensitive material, visible correction overlays, limits on automated excerpt generation, and public-interest review for high-risk releases can slow the conversion of civic evidence into entertainment. The purpose is not to control criticism, but to keep evidence attached to the conditions that make it intelligible (Andrejevic, 2004; Marwick and boyd, 2011).

3.4 — Not Government Itself

The City is politically serious, but it is not government. It may form people who seek public authority, support those who lawfully hold office, preserve role-bound records, and create better evidence for democratic judgment. None of that gives it sovereign power (Weber, 1978; Mashaw, 2006; Barak, 2012; United Nations, 1966). Any official function requires a separate source of lawful authority and an accountable public owner.

3.4.1 — Government Remains Government

Preparation, candidacy, appointment, election, and office are distinct states. A transition requires authority from the applicable public process; publishing formation evidence does not change a person's legal status.

Every output needs an authority label. A readiness bundle is a public evidentiary claim, not a government credential. A participant's explanation is not law. A City audit is institutional oversight, not judicial decision. A lawful office suite is a workspace under external authority, not a separate branch of government (Mashaw, 2006; Barak, 2012).

Institutional practice should maintain a refusal procedure when public bodies ask too much of it. A government office may want the City to vet candidates, pre-clear appointments, manage public explanations, supply staff judgments, or absorb political accountability. The City should have authority to say no. A boundary that only restrains the City but not those who would use it remains incomplete.

3.4.2 — City Formation Is Pre-Authority

Distinguish advisor influence from agency instruction, and public interface from constituency service.

Formation evidence must remain distinct from campaign advantage. A formation record may later become useful in a campaign, but the City cannot run campaign strategy, message discipline, polling, voter targeting, opposition research, or partisan branding.

Pre-authority formation should clarify fit rather than inflate ambition. An admitted participant may prepare for a qualifying public-administration, local-board, or advisory role where the declared authority and consequences justify the City's exceptional burden. Journalism, advocacy, union activity, or general public influence alone do not establish that threshold. A participant who discovers a better fit in those ordinary civic pathways may be redirected or leave without stigma. The City offers a bounded route into substantial public-power formation, not a general institution for all influential people.

Formation exercises should limit real-world consequences and provide ways to reverse them where possible. Participants may draft policy, conduct hearings, negotiate, manage projects, or rehearse crisis decisions, but an exercise cannot itself compel outside compliance or bind a public institution. Its educational status must remain unmistakable. A simulation that can be mistaken for an official act has crossed the boundary it was meant to teach.

3.4.3 — Officeholding Requires Lawful Pathway

No City process can bypass external eligibility rules. Age, citizenship, residency, conflict rules, financial disclosures, professional qualifications, constitutional limits, term limits, confirmation standards, and statutory requirements do not disappear because a participant accepted a heavier record burden.

Lawful pathway also matters during office. If an active participant becomes an officeholder and law permits some City interface, that interface must remain subordinate to official duties, public law, confidentiality requirements, security obligations, records law, and constitutional boundaries. The City cannot make its own transparency rule override legal obligations by force of moral enthusiasm.

This rule also protects jurisdictions that choose not to recognize City evidence. A local community may prefer candidates formed through local service, indigenous governance, union leadership, professional experience, neighborhood trust, or ordinary political apprenticeship. Declining City formation cannot be treated as backwardness. Public legitimacy is contextual, and lawful communities retain the right to evaluate evidence in their own political language.

3.4.4 — Government Boundary

The government boundary protects public servants. Civil servants, agency staff, security officials, judges, clerks, regulators, contractors, and local administrators do not become City staff because a City participant holds office. Their rights, duties, confidentiality, records, and labor protections remain under the relevant law and institution. Surrounding government workers remain outside the City's visibility logic unless a separate lawful rule applies.

Shadow administration begins when City staff, archives, advisers, or public interfaces direct governmental action outside lawful channels; the City has then crossed into Government without authority. The appropriate response is correction, disclosure, role separation, legal review, and, if necessary, termination of the interface.

The office-interface boundary should include conflict logs. When a City participant holds office, there may be pressure from City educators, mentors, auditors, archive staff, volunteers, or donors. Those influences must not become hidden governmental advice. The City should log its own side of influence so the public can see when formation support risks becoming unofficial command.

Distinguish criticism of an officeholder's governmental decision, the City's support role, a participant's conduct, governing law, and the interface connecting them. Help the public identify where each problem belongs and which remedy applies.

3.4.5 — Constitutional Authority Boundary

Jurisdictional review is necessary because the City touches rights. A role-bound active record, protected nonvisibility, public bundles, exit, office interface, screening, and public approval can all raise legal questions. Those questions cannot be resolved by saying participants consented or public power is important. Consent has limits. Rights have structure. Law varies by jurisdiction. The City must treat legal validity as an Open Decision governed by expert review and lawful adoption, not by manuscript confidence.

Until competent authority has legally adopted a model rule, public materials should identify it as a proposal rather than an enforceable right or governmental order.

Buildings, ceremonies, and symbols should not imply constitutional authority the City does not possess. Mock courts, ceremonial oaths, symbolic chambers, official-looking seals, and grand legal language may make the campus feel more legitimate while confusing the public about authority.

Private agreements cannot manufacture public authority. A host contract, accreditation, land lease, philanthropic condition, participant covenant, or memorandum of understanding may define cooperation, but it cannot displace constitutional rights, courts, regulators, election bodies, public records law, or emergency authority. The City should publish an authority-and-custody map showing which institution owns each decision and record at every interface.

3.5 — Not a Virtue Certificate

Rich evidence can inform role-specific judgment without becoming a certificate of human worth. A participant's visible record may reveal relevant conduct under public-power burden, but it cannot establish honesty in every setting, civic superiority, moral rank, or greater human value than an ordinary private person. The City preserves that distinction through status labels, nonpreferential pathways, appeal, and a ban on using participation as a generalized trust score (Espeland and Stevens, 1998; O'Neil, 2016; Eubanks, 2018). A released summary must disclose the limits of its evidence wherever a status label might imply more.

3.5.1 — Participation Is Not Worth

Participation can also hide privilege. People with fewer dependents, more psychological resilience, safer legal status, stronger health, better education, fewer disability barriers, or more cultural trust may find entry easier. Treating participation as worth would punish people for constraints the City itself must recognize.

Refusal, delay, or redirection must carry its own applicant protection. The decision may reflect load, role fit, legal status, timing, family burden, safety, or a better pathway. It should not become a public mark of lesser worth.

The distinction between participation and worth also protects political opposition. A critic may oppose a City participant's policies, values, ideology, or temperament without being cast as anti-fairness. If City supporters treat opposition to a participant as opposition to human improvement, the City has created a moral shield around power. The public must remain free to disagree with the visible.

Children who observe participants require special care. They should never be taught that public visibility makes a person better than private people. Family programming, school materials, tours, and guide images should communicate that ordinary lives are complete. The participant carries extra burden because of chosen public-power ambition, not because visible life is morally superior.

3.5.2 — Record Is Not Soul

Interpretive restraint protects participants from total judgment. A recorded action can be relevant without becoming the person's whole identity; a mistake can require remedy without becoming a permanent name; a pattern can support concern while leaving room for response, change, and context. The record should state the proposition it supports, the conditions under which it was observed, and the limits of the inference.

The City and those acting on its behalf must distinguish observed conduct from a human reviewer’s contestable inference. Machine inference about character, motive, readiness, or trust is prohibited under Section 11.7.6 even when labeled uncertain. Independent journalists and readers remain free to draw and challenge their own conclusions; the City does not govern public interpretation (O’Neil, 2016; Eubanks, 2018).

The same restraint governs apology. A public apology can supply evidence of acknowledgment, responsibility, proposed repair, and later conduct. It cannot reveal an inner purification that the archive has no means to observe. Public judgment therefore follows words, actions, restitution, recurrence, and correction over time, while conscience remains with the person.

A record is a produced object shaped by categories, technology, access, omissions, context, and institutional judgment. It cannot exhaust motive, memory, consciousness,

identity, or moral character. This matters especially when the record is coherent and searchable, because coherence can create the illusion of completeness. The archive should preserve gaps, disputes, uncertainty, and the right to say that some features of a person are neither captured nor capturable by the institution.

3.5.3 — Role-Specific Readiness and Public Trust

Readiness bundles should identify the role, jurisdiction, burden type, evidence base, time period, limits, and dispute status they address. A role-specific bundle may speak to budgeting, constitutional reasoning, conflict handling, media literacy, staff management, record integrity, or public explanation.

Role-specific readiness protects both public judgment and the participant. The City should state which capacities were observed, which were simulated or externally reviewed, which remain unknown, and which deficits are role-critical. It should also make clear that strength in one domain is not universal competence and that “not yet” is a legitimate result rather than disgrace.

Trust should also remain revocable. New evidence, changed context, later conduct, office performance, legal findings, or public harm may alter judgment. A City record should not freeze a person into permanent trustworthiness.

3.5.4 — Research Constructs Are Not Civic Scores

Scientific validation, if ever achieved, would not authorize civic scoring. No index, ledger, composite, utility, contribution unit, hedonic measure, archive summary, public vote, or Artificial Intelligence output may measure worth, rank, loyalty, holiness, eligibility, or trustworthiness.

Score-shaped substitutes create the same danger under softer names. A dashboard that ranks integrity, resilience, transparency, burden carried, apology quality, readiness, or

approval converts contested evidence into status and invites people to treat quantified appearance as human truth. The prohibition reaches both the label and the institutional act of ranking (Espeland and Stevens, 1998; O'Neil, 2016; Eubanks, 2018).

The City may record role conduct and institutional load; it does not estimate phenomenal valence or terminal status. Scientific work requires separate protocols and authority, as explained in Section 3.6.

The prohibition on person scoring does not exclude operational measurement. The City may count time in role, public deliberations, correction response times, unresolved disputes, staff load, accessibility compliance, budget facts, or record uptime because those measures describe systems or discrete events. They must never be combined into a total person measure. Procurement rules should therefore prohibit person-ranking use and require purpose limitation, human review, appeal, and deletion where appropriate. System measures should remain auditable at the event or process level so useful operational learning does not drift into person scoring.

3.6 — Not Proof of the Law

The City applies the burden question within civic design. Operational findings can justify a specified institutional decision; they do not, by themselves, establish PTVC. The claim-status and comparison procedures are set out in Section 4.5 (Popper, 1959; Lakatos, 1970).

3.6.1 — Evaluating the Institution

Evaluate adverse findings alongside benefits: complaint and correction disputes, staff turnover, burnout, nonparticipant harm, host objections, archive errors, vendor failures and accessibility barriers. The comparison in Section 4.5 must include the cost and exposure created by evaluation itself.

3.6.2 — The Separate Scientific Question

PTVC concerns the cumulative balance of a qualifying stream's complete positive and negative phenomenal magnitudes at its independently defined true endpoint. It does not require the last conscious moment itself to be neutral. The research task is to identify observations that can distinguish that terminal-balance claim from rival explanations. *The Science of Fairness* develops the measurement and testing program. Institutional evaluation here asks whether the City delivers earlier, more useful evidence of public-power formation.

Scientific separation creates two constructive routes for collaboration. Researchers can study whether the City improves public understanding and institutional correction while PTVC investigators examine the stream-level hypothesis through an independently justified measurement bridge. Evidence from either route can sharpen the questions asked in the other without substituting for its tests. A result that changes a PTVC claim changes the City's reasoning only where it relied on that claim;

rights and care retain their independent grounds. The wider project can therefore learn from distinct fields without requiring them to begin with the same conclusion.

Adoption and scientific status require separate labels. Interest, funding, construction, operation, accreditation, suspension and decertification describe implementation. Neither a growing map of sites nor endorsement by a respected institution establishes the scientific hypothesis. Neither support nor opposition justifies accelerating construction to win a public argument.

Adoption maps should avoid moral geography. If future Cities exist in some countries or regions and not others, the map should not imply that participating places are morally higher. Country readiness, city interest, accreditation, and pilot status are implementation facts. Turning them into ranking would shift public burden onto entire populations and invite geopolitical vanity.

Livability findings can require the City to narrow or stop: a pilot that prevents sleep, recovery, dissent, safe work or exit fails its operating conditions. That finding concerns the institution, not a verdict on PTVC.

Chapter 4 — Prototype, Operational Evidence, and Ethics

The first City should make learning visible before prestige makes correction expensive. Built reality can reveal whether rights, records, staff systems, host relationships, care, and public interfaces work under pressure, but only if continuation is governed by declared questions and stop conditions. The ethical promise of a prototype is not that it will succeed. It is that people will not be asked to carry avoidable harm so the institution can preserve its image.

This chapter begins from a severe but liberating premise: a real City matters, but not because reality turns an idea into proof. Reality matters because burden changes when it leaves the page. A drawing can make transparency look orderly, a vow can sound clean, a record rule can appear exact, and an exit right can seem obvious. The built institution asks harsher questions. Who sleeps? Who repairs the devices? Who answers the complaint? Who is overexposed by accident? Who carries the host cost when the campus becomes real?

This chapter gives the City an ethics of beginning. A fair first version earns attention through explicit purpose, protected people, independent review, traceable decisions, and real authority to pause, narrow, redesign, or stop. Site selection, legal authorization, scientific status, funding, and transition sequence remain with their proper owners. The prototype standard is simple: the institution must be more correctable than its admirers expect and more protective than its momentum demands.

The central danger is monument drift. A promising institution can become emotionally expensive before it becomes operationally trustworthy. Donors may want a landmark. Supporters may want a victory. Designers may want their first concept protected. Critics may want a single failure to become total disproof. Media may want a frame simple enough to sell.

The City must be designed against all of these pressures because each of them shifts burden away from reality and into image.

Replication receives the final warning. The first City may succeed in one context while remaining unsafe to copy elsewhere. Rights may work because one staff culture is unusually strong. Archive integrity may depend on a technical team that cannot be replicated. Host trust may rest on local relationships that another place does not share. The first City may be real and still not be ready to multiply.

The intellectual standard comes from pilot and complex-intervention research: feasibility, process, implementation context, acceptability, fidelity, adverse effects, and continuation criteria are different questions. Combining them into a single success story hides the mechanism of failure. The chapter therefore treats each operational claim as scoped evidence with an owner, method, denominator, limitation, and decision consequence (Eldridge et al., 2016; Skivington et al., 2021). Review protocols should also record when a measure becomes unusable because the prototype itself changed, so evaluation can distinguish design learning from moving the goalposts.

4.1 — Why One Real City Matters

A pilot changes the kind of question one can answer. Plans describe what an institution intends to do; observed operations can reveal whether its safeguards survive the work required to make them real (Thabane et al., 2010; Eldridge et al., 2016). A real City also creates a common object of criticism. Without a built object, every disagreement can retreat into imagination: supporters imagine the best version, critics imagine the worst version, and both sides speak past the actual burden.

4.1.1 — Built Reality Tests Burden

Built reality narrows evasion. It lets a reviewer ask where the complaint office is, how records are sealed, where staff rest, how visitors are screened, what happens when a participant de-loads, and how the host community can object without begging for attention.

Built reality tests administrative friction. A rule that appears clear on the page may become ambiguous when an exhausted participant requests pause during a public-interface window, a record officer receives a release challenge during an outage, or a clinician recommends de-loading before a scheduled event. The prototype must expose these friction points because hidden friction returns burden to people under the cover of good design.

The pilot must test the smallest scale capable of coordinating residence, study, deliberation, records, recovery, staff work, public interface, and protected nonvisibility. A smaller or distributed arrangement may meet those needs; a larger campus may add costs without improving coordination. The test is whether the chosen scale supports those functions without creating burdens that a simpler arrangement could avoid.

Test whether participants understand their rights before capture begins, whether exit preserves continuity of housing and

care while protecting dignity and future privacy, and whether duty rosters provide the promised staff protection.

A built test also reveals sequence burdens. Paper design can list intake, consent, activation, capture, complaint, review, and exit as though they occur in clean order. In practice, a person may seek exit during a record dispute, staff may detect overload before the participant can name it, a host complaint may arrive during a media surge, or technical failure may occur inside a sensitive conversation. Systems become unfair when burden arrives before the protection intended to govern it.

A written permission becomes usable only when affected people have the time, support, protection from retaliation, and independent route needed to exercise it. Section 4.3.2 tests those conditions through participant, staff, nonparticipant, and host complaints.

Pre-opening exercises, access drills, protected nonvisibility tests, complaint walkthroughs, staff workload simulations, visitor pressure drills, record failure rehearsals, and host-community listening sessions all belong to the prototype ethic.

4.1.2 — Bodies Test Theory

Sleep loss, muscular tension, digestive disruption, panic, numbness, irritability, social withdrawal, sexual difficulty, sensory overload, and grief fatigue may signal strain that requires care and review. Such reports should prompt investigation of conditions rather than be treated as proof of either institutional failure or personal weakness.

Formation for public power will involve strain, so the prototype must distinguish demanding work from extractive conditions. Proportion, review, support, recovery, and reversibility determine whether the burden remains humane. A

participant who reaches overload triggers de-loading and design review rather than legend-making; a staff member who absorbs chronic excess triggers workload correction rather than praise for devotion. The institution learns by treating strain as information about fit and structure.

Bodies test time. A person may consent to record on the first day and discover by the thirtieth day that constant awareness changes appetite, movement, speech, and rest. A person may perform steadiness at the beginning and later show irritability, numbness, or strategic sincerity. A person may believe they can live under visible public-power formation and then find that the cumulative load requires de-loading, pause, accommodation, or exit. The City must learn from these bodily facts rather than moralize them.

Test care routing with illness, injury, grief, panic and overload: staff should be able to obtain appropriate help without waiting for a record classification. Apply Section 9.6.1 to the response.

Test routes, schedules and sensory conditions with people whose stamina, mobility, health and communication needs differ. Assess the building and support through Section 8.3.1 rather than treating an avoidable barrier as an applicant deficit.

Bodies test theory only within a care-first boundary. Participants must never be required to prove distress through endless measurement, and biometric curiosity cannot become another form of exposure. Care teams, consent boundaries, nonpublic health review, and independent clinical authority govern bodily evidence. The purpose is to detect avoidable load and protect people, not to convert exhaustion into public spectacle or a scientific shortcut.

Use the varied-cohort test in Section 4.3.1 to distinguish institutional accommodation from unusual participant resilience or comfort with observation.

4.1.3 — Staff Systems Test Morality

Staff-system health can be documented without making individual workers public material. Workload bands, staffing ratios, vacancy rates, turnover patterns, incident categories, complaint timelines, training completion, recovery rhythms, and anti-retaliation outcomes can reveal institutional strain at the appropriate level. The public does not need a worker's private life. It does need assurance that visible public power is not being purchased with hidden staff burden.

Staff systems also test complaint reality and learning speed. If staff see donor pressure, record misuse, participant mistreatment, security drift, public-interface abuse, or archive weakness, can they speak early, appeal safely, and trigger correction without waiting to resign? Protected staff testimony should be structured enough to guide change and independent enough to remain honest. Burnout, turnover, and silence are institutional evidence, not personal fragility.

The prototype must also test whether staff influence is visible without making staff full-life subjects. Material advice, access control, mentorship, scheduling, and record interpretation can shape public-power formation. That influence must be traceable. Staff accountability must be role-bound, not total.

4.1.4 — Host Communities Test Externalization

Externalization can be subtle because the City may bring benefits at the same time it creates strain. Local jobs, educational partnerships, cultural interest, infrastructure investment, and civic prestige may coexist with rents rising, traffic changing, emergency services adapting, protest routes shifting, and ordinary residents feeling watched by association. A fair prototype cannot count benefits in public and leave costs as private irritation.

A host-community review process should also distinguish immediate disruption from cumulative alteration. A short construction inconvenience differs from a permanent security pattern. A temporary media surge differs from a neighborhood becoming a symbolic battleground. A useful local complaint route should be able to see both. The City's ethics of beginning should include the patience to hear burdens that do not arrive in the vocabulary of the project.

Host-community standing is part of prototype legitimacy. Residents and local institutions need continuing routes to obtain information, raise cumulative-impact concerns, challenge mitigation failures, and seek remedy. Some objections will be answered by evidence; others will reveal burdens the project could not see from inside its mission. Ongoing review turns the host from scenery into a coequal source of operational knowledge.

4.1.5 — Public Interface Tests Trust

The public interface should be tested with people who do not already admire the project. Supporters may forgive complexity. Specialists may navigate labels. Critics may read adversarially but still possess high interpretive skill. Ordinary citizens may encounter one excerpt, one record bundle, one visual, one correction notice, or one hostile commentary before forming judgment. The interface must be designed for that unequal public field, where time, literacy, trust, disability, language, media habits, and prior political injury differ.

Test release and correction timing, including the conditions under which a public object should be withdrawn or revised.

A first implementation must learn how citizens, critics, journalists, scholars, affected persons, institutions, and ordinary voters actually encounter its records. Do status labels make

sense? Are corrections visible? Are protected summaries trusted? Can nonexperts distinguish draft from decision, simulation from office conduct, public release from protected source record, and operational evidence from proof? If public interface fails, the City may produce more confusion than trust.

Trust is tested when the interface disappoints both curiosity and defensiveness. The public may want more intimate access than fairness permits. Participants may want flattering summaries. Staff may want less scrutiny. Leaders may want simpler messages. Critics may want raw material that confirms their fear. The interface must answer to civic use rather than any one appetite. It should provide enough context for judgment while refusing humiliation, entertainment, doxxing, and artificial certainty.

A useful interface reports current findings, correction history, and unresolved concerns without treating certainty as a display requirement. Experiments on facts and numbers found that numerical uncertainty could be communicated with only small effects on trust in the studied settings (van der Bles et al., 2020). A later meta-analysis did not find an overall effect of uncertainty communication on trust in its source, while identifying methodological variation in the underlying studies (Dries et al., 2026). Neither an automatic loss of trust nor an automatic gain is a sound design premise.

The practical question is whether the explanation helps a reader use the evidence. State what is established, identify the unresolved issue, and explain what further observation or review could resolve it. Use a numerical range only when the method justifies one; otherwise describe the alternatives plainly. Link the next review point and any available action. The fictional-record protocol in Section 4.5.4 can compare truthful formats while keeping the underlying evidence fixed. Factual understanding

and access to correction are the objectives; greater confidence by itself is not success.

4.2 — Prototype Versus Monument

A prototype protects learning by keeping correction cheaper than image defense. Money spent, symbolic attention, donor identification, public hope, and institutional reputation can make revision feel like retreat, even when revision is the most responsible result. The first City therefore needs decision rules that prevent sunk cost, prestige, and legitimacy maintenance from determining continuation (Staw, 1976; Brockner, 1992; Suchman, 1995). Reversible construction and governance decisions make a failed test less likely to become an obligation to continue.

4.2.1 — Prototype Learns

A learning prototype must make disagreement useful. Internal dissent, outside criticism, participant complaint, staff warning, host-community objection, and technical audit should enter the institution through different channels, yet all should be capable of changing practice. If every route ends in the same leadership discretion, the City has not built learning. It has built a funnel.

Adverse findings are part of the prototype's yield. A failed practice, an unclear protected-nonvisibility category, a misunderstood public summary, or a misleading Artificial Intelligence flag identifies a mechanism that needs correction. Each result enters the learning record with an affected-person protection plan, accountable owner, provisional response, and reassessment date. Public reporting should present the lesson before reputation management can absorb it.

Early participants should be protected from symbolic burden. The first cohort already carries unusual visibility and uncertainty; it should not also be required to embody the City's success. Confidential reporting, independent support,

de-loading, and protected exit let experience become evidence for correction rather than performance for the institution.

Learning requires custody. The prototype must identify who receives evidence, who protects affected people, who decides a temporary response, who records dissent, who verifies correction, and who reports unresolved risk. A visible cycle moves from observation to classification, protection, review, decision, implementation, reassessment, and status-appropriate publication.

4.2.2 — Monument Protects Image

Monument logic often appears in the grammar of inevitability. People begin to say that the City must succeed because the world needs it, that critics should be careful because hope is fragile, that staff strain is temporary because the mission is historic, or that participants should remain patient because future generations are watching. Each sentence may sound generous. Together they become a machinery for shifting present burden onto those least able to refuse it.

A monument also tends to simplify its enemies. It treats the critic as hostile, the complainant as ungrateful, the cautious lawyer as timid, the staff whistleblower as disloyal, and the host resident as narrow. A prototype cannot afford that simplification. Its critics may be wrong, but the burden they identify may still be real. The City should preserve enough humility to learn even from people who misunderstand part of it.

Image protection appears when the institution begins to fear embarrassment more than burden. Staff overload becomes a messaging problem. A participant breakdown becomes an anomaly. A host complaint becomes local resistance. A technical failure becomes a minor bug. A rights problem becomes misunderstood policy. A public interface failure becomes a user

education issue. In each case, the City protects its image by shifting responsibility away from itself.

4.2.3 — Pilot Before Prestige

Pilot before prestige also shapes procurement and design. The first City should prefer inspectable systems over impressive but opaque systems, maintainable spaces over iconic forms that create hidden labor, reversible technical choices over permanent vendor dependence, and plain public labels over dramatic branding. A fair pilot is allowed to be beautiful. Its beauty should make burden easier to see and carry, not harder to question.

Pilot staffing should be built around competence, boundary discipline, care, resilience, auditability, and willingness to name failure. Reputation can support recruitment, but it cannot substitute for reviewable practice. Advisers and operators alike must accept conflict rules, correction, and removal. The most valuable staff member may be the person who notices drift early and protects the institution from its own prestige.

Pilot before prestige means that scale markers should be delayed. The first City should resist premature architectural grandeur, celebrity endorsement, triumphal donor language, international branding, and public countdowns that make stopping look like defeat.

The prestige question can be asked plainly: would the institution still make this decision if no one could admire it? If admiration changes the answer, require a justification grounded in the pilot’s public purpose.

4.2.4 — Inspection Before Celebration

Inspection should not wait for scandal. The first City should be inspected before opening, during operation, after incidents, at fixed intervals, and before any proposed replication. Different

inspectors should see different burdens: rights reviewers, record-integrity reviewers, clinical and occupational-health reviewers, accessibility reviewers, host-community reviewers, cybersecurity reviewers, staff representatives, public-interface testers, and outside critics.

Inspectors must be able to report adverse findings independently.

Recognition should attach to specific verified achievements: a complaint that changed practice, an overload corrected, or a host concern that altered the design. An inspection report does not certify permanent safety. It records what worked, what failed, what remains unresolved, and what must happen next.

4.2.5 — Stoppability Before Scale

Stoppability must be more than an emergency phrase. It requires legal authority, financial reserves, staff transition plans, participant care routes, archive preservation or sealing rules, host-community notification, vendor exit rights, public explanation templates, and review bodies that can act against leadership preference.

Scale without stoppability turns investment into pressure to continue and error into replication. Contracts, donors, public promises, technical entanglement, and network standards can make a system difficult to interrupt even when no person is physically trapped. The City should therefore prove modular stop authority before scale, so a flawed record process, weak child-protection rule, staff-load problem, or donor dependency can be contained before it becomes a network norm.

Leadership cannot hold sole stop authority when image, donors, or fear may capture it. Independent routes need triggers, emergency access, explanation duties, and protection for those who invoke them; no one should become a martyr to make the

institution listen. The route should identify a deputy or independent body with authority to act when ordinary leadership is unavailable, conflicted, or implicated. Every activation should create a timestamped record of the trigger, interim protections, and reviewing authority.

Every stop rehearsal should assign an owner for care continuity and records so interruption does not create a second failure while correcting the first. Before scaling, planners should price the minimum shutdown reserve and identify contracts, data dependencies, and essential services that could otherwise make a pause coercively expensive. Expansion should not proceed unless those dependencies have a workable interruption or transfer route.

Stoppability should be rehearsed like emergency response. Each rehearsal should end with a correction record naming the failed dependency, the office responsible for repairing it, and the deadline for retesting. The next rehearsal should verify the corrected route under realistic staffing, communication, and care-continuity conditions.

Before construction, a public prototype ledger records each major claim, evidence threshold, affected group, uncertainty, reviewer, appeal, and stop condition. United Kingdom guidance likewise places assumptions, testing, feedback, adaptation, and scale decisions within evaluation (UK Evaluation Task Force, 2026; HM Treasury, 2026b; HM Treasury, 2026c). Record who may invoke a stop. Resumption should require a documented finding that the triggering condition has been corrected or reduced to an explicitly accepted residual risk, with the corrective action, remaining uncertainty, reviewing authority, and repeat-pause condition recorded.

4.3 — What the First City Must Demonstrate

Operational seriousness begins with declared demonstration categories. A first City can test whether its role burden is livable, rights operate, records retain integrity, staff systems remain sustainable, nonparticipants are protected, host burdens are addressed, and capture pressures are resisted (Glasgow et al., 1999; Proctor et al., 2011). These demonstration categories are noncompensatory conditions rather than dimensions to be averaged into one success score. Serious failure in any one requires pause, narrowing, redesign, or stop.

4.3.1 — Livability Demonstration

Livability includes the architecture of the day. Morning reentry, work blocks, meals, public interface windows, evening decompression, sleep preparation, and recovery rhythms must function in practice. Livability cannot be inferred from inspiration or public testimony alone. It should gather operational evidence about load, exhaustion, participation, complaints, health referrals, exit requests, staff observations, and participant feedback.

The demonstration must include different bodies and circumstances. Livability for one unusually resilient participant does not demonstrate livability for the role. Disability, age, health conditions, neurodiversity, caregiving obligations, trauma histories, cultural differences, and varied social backgrounds may all reveal different burdens. Selection must not favor only people who make the system look easy.

A livability demonstration does not mean everyone thrives. It means the City can detect strain, respond to it, support recovery, adjust load, preserve dignity, allow exit, and identify when a pathway is not safe.

A livability finding may narrow proposed role pathways, release frequency, residential exposure, support arrangements, or public interactions.

Livability should be assessed across time and roles rather than through a launch survey. The review must distinguish acute burden, such as crisis, conflict, exposure, or technical failure, from cumulative burden, such as watchfulness, sensory load, repeated explanation, schedule pressure, isolation, and the slow narrowing of spontaneity. Participants, staff, families, protected visitors, and neighbors may experience the same design differently. A burden ledger should identify which groups absorbed unplanned work or delay during the pilot and whether that burden was reduced before continuation.

4.3.2 — Rights Demonstration

A rights demonstration should test friction, not only existence. How many steps does a participant need to complain? Can a staff member report retaliation without alerting the person who controls their schedule? Can a nonparticipant challenge wrongful exposure without becoming more exposed? Can a host resident complain without entering the City's ideological vocabulary? If the route requires too much confidence, legal literacy, time, money, or emotional reserve, the right may exist on paper while failing in life.

Track the personal costs of using rights (lost sleep, trust, relationships, professional standing, public dignity, or access to support) and include protection around the process in the remedy.

Before activation, test whether participants, staff, and nonparticipants can find and explain the rights routes relevant to them.

Institutional practice must demonstrate that rights work against the institution itself. A complaint that embarrasses the City should not be buried, and a staff report about donor pressure should not disappear into leadership discretion. When a complaint produces correction, the institution should preserve repair memory through protected case records and public category-level summaries where public risk remains, without exposing the claimant.

The participant who is exhausted, ashamed, frightened, or confused needs to know what can be paused, who can be contacted, what remains private, how fast review should occur, what retaliation is forbidden, and what happens if the first reviewer is implicated.

A rights demonstration must include the unpopular claimant. Rights are easiest when the harmed person is sympathetic, the complaint is simple, and the institution can fix the problem without embarrassment. The real test comes when the claimant is angry, politically inconvenient, socially disliked, or accusing a beloved part of the City.

Rights demonstration should include adversarial drills of its own. The City should test what happens when a complaint concerns a senior official, counsel is unavailable on a deadline, a staff grievance risks retaliation, a participant's pause request conflicts with public attention, a nonparticipant seeks emergency masking, or an appeal body misses its decision window. The test is whether rights alter power under pressure, not whether they read well in a handbook (Barak, 2012; Mashaw, 2006).

4.3.3 — Record Integrity Demonstration

Test whether public notices distinguish ordinary, protected, and public correction; integrity holds; release delays; access

breaches; provenance uncertainty; and retired summaries without exposing sensitive details.

Demonstrate reliable capture under the failure classes and gap rules in Section 2.5.

Demonstrate that classification decisions are consistent, reviewable, appealable, and audited.

The demonstration should separate capture integrity from release integrity. A captured record may be complete yet not publicly releasable. A public bundle may be lawful yet misleading if context is poor. A redaction may protect a collateral person yet create suspicion if the status label is unclear. A delayed release may be necessary yet dangerous if the review clock is invisible. The City must demonstrate the whole lifecycle because the public will encounter records as interpreted objects, not as raw storage.

The record integrity demonstration should also include hostile conditions: cyber intrusion attempts, deepfake claims, insider misuse, public clipping, media misinterpretation, and political pressure for selective release.

4.3.4 — Staff Sustainability Demonstration

Staff sustainability must be evaluated by more than retention. A worker may stay because the job matters, because alternatives are scarce, because loyalty is strong, because leaving would burden colleagues, or because the institution has made exit feel morally costly. Retention can hide strain. The first City should examine workload, recovery, sick leave, turnover reasons, near misses, grievance use, schedule volatility, emotional exhaustion, role conflict, and whether workers can say no without quiet penalty.

Test the role separations in Section 4.1.3 when staff face conflicting duties.

Stress-test archive schedules, public-interface load, security vigilance, clinical support expectations, maintenance demands, and complaint processing before crisis reveals that they are too heavy.

The design must assess the emotional cost of difficult duties and provide qualified review where moral injury is suspected. Staff may be asked to enforce boundaries against the public, deny inappropriate requests for access, classify sensitive records, respond to participants in distress, challenge leadership, or resist donors. These tasks require support and a route to challenge institutional decisions that conflict with professional duties or expose others to harm.

4.3.5 — Nonparticipant Protection Demonstration

Nonparticipant protection should be tested through ordinary spillover, not only rare catastrophe. A passerby may appear in footage. A family member may be mentioned in a recorded conversation. A local business may become part of a public story. A critic may be drawn into a participant's record. A child may be indirectly identifiable through schedule, school, or household context.

Test whether the system distinguishes participants, staff roles, visitors, bystanders, professional interfaces, household members, affected persons, and public contributors before assigning record treatment.

People must be able to challenge wrongful capture, mistaken release, misleading summaries, unmasked identity, platform spread, data misuse, or other public harm. The pilot should test complaint intake, correction, masking, compensation where appropriate, and public notice where needed.

Protection should not depend on the nonparticipant having power, sophistication, or legal endurance. Many affected people

will not know what happened, what record exists, whom to contact, or how to challenge exposure. A fair system carries part of that burden by creating accessible routes, plain notices, advocates where appropriate, and public explanations of categories without revealing protected persons.

4.3.6 — Anti-Capture Demonstration

The initial City should demonstrate conflict disclosure, gift refusal, vendor portability, procurement review, influence logs where appropriate, rotation of sensitive roles, independent complaint routes, newsroom independence where relevant, and public explanation when a relationship is terminated.

Funding cannot acquire admission, governance control, archive access, or favorable findings. Pilot auditors should test actual independence; Section 5.6 retains the fuller gift and indirect-leverage rules.

Because capture adapts, evidence is time-bounded. A pilot can show detection, boundary discipline, independent review, reporting, and practical refusal of money, vendors, politics, or prestige only under tested conditions. Continuing review asks whether those protections survive new tactics and dependencies.

Test attractive forms of capture: expansion funding before safeguards travel; vendor dependence or unauditable technology; special access or softer treatment for a celebrated participant; media reach tied to narrative control; and loyalty to founders, designers, or early staff that discourages challenge. Include supportive donors whose preferences redirect priorities.

4.4 — Failure Thresholds and the Ethics of Stopping

Stop authority converts institutional humility into a real protection. Failure, pause, and redesign thresholds must be fixed before the evidence arrives, because later incentives will favor reinterpretation, delay, minimization, or narrative rescue. A fair prototype therefore gives accountable reviewers the authority, information, and resources to pause, narrow, redesign, or close the City when continuation would shift avoidable burden onto people (Avery et al., 2017; CIOMS, 2016; HM Treasury, 2026c). The same decision must provide for people who remain dependent on City services while the continuation gate is closed.

4.4.1 — Stop Conditions

Imagine the first independent continuation hearing after several months of operation. The campus is beautiful, public interest is high, donors are ready to fund expansion, and many participants report that the education is valuable. The same review finds that staff recovery time, host-community complaint response, and bystander-record correction have not met the prospectively fixed thresholds.

Advocates argue that the deficiencies are temporary and that expansion money could solve them. Staff representatives answer that continued scale would increase the very burden under review. Host delegates point to unresolved service and access costs. The independent review body therefore pauses new admissions, protects current care, funds repair, and publishes the reasons without describing the pause as betrayal.

That decision is a successful use of the prototype, even though it interrupts momentum. The institution has learned which safeguards remain nominal under pressure and has prevented prestige from converting uncertainty into exposure. Continuation

may resume after independently verified repair, or the affected track may close if the threshold cannot be met.

A stop rule becomes credible when it has an owner, evidence source, review date, consequence, repair route, and protected appeal. “We will stop if necessary” is not a rule. The decision ledger below turns the promise into an inspectable control and preserves the possibility that the most honorable result of a pilot is a well-explained refusal to continue (Avery et al., 2017; HM Treasury, 2026c).

Stop conditions must exist at several levels because continuation can become unfair in different ways. Acute risk calls for a safety stop; unusable complaint or appeal routes call for a rights stop; compromised capture or release calls for a record stop; and unsustainable labor calls for a staff stop. Unmitigated local burden, repeated public-interface harm, or distorted review may require host, interface, or capture stops (Avery et al., 2017; CIOMS, 2016; HM Treasury, 2026c).

Certain failures should trigger immediate stop review. Child exposure, systemic nonparticipant harm, intimate-record misuse, inability to provide exit, severe staff exploitation, repeated record integrity failure, uncorrected donor capture, vendor sovereignty over public memory, unlawful operation, or inability to protect care before evidence cannot be treated as ordinary growing pains.

Match the extent of stoppage to the failure: suspend an affected release category or Artificial Intelligence tool, halt admissions, close a zone, pause public interface, or pursue decertification or shutdown where necessary. Closing the whole City is one response, not the default for every defect.

Stop conditions should protect against both dramatic and quiet harm. Dramatic harm is easier to recognize: serious exposure, abuse, breach, corruption, or crisis. Quiet harm may be repeated

sleep erosion, steady staff turnover, complaint delay, defensive culture, host fatigue, record confusion, or public-interface distortion. A fair prototype must learn to stop for patterns, not only for catastrophes.

Specify triggering powers for participants, staff, host representatives, rights reviewers, technical auditors, and external experts. Declare emergency suspension, ordinary review, appeal, evidence preservation, care continuity, compensation, and closeout responsibilities before a crisis.

4.4.2 — Pause Conditions

Pause conditions address failure that may not require ending a system permanently but does require temporary narrowing.

Publish a caretaker plan stating how the pause changes daily life, staff duties, affected-person protection, and host obligations, with a scoped public status.

Pause conditions should be specific enough to guide action. A participant pathway might pause because load has exceeded safe thresholds. A release system might pause because protected summaries are being misread. A public approval tool might pause because bot activity has distorted signal. Admissions might pause because staff ratios are insufficient. Travel corridors might pause because host protocols are not working.

Pause conditions should be available when the City does not yet know whether the failure is local, systemic, temporary, or disqualifying.

4.4.3 — Redesign Conditions

Redesign becomes necessary when the underlying form produces repeated burden rather than isolated error.

The record of redesign should include what was wrong, what burden it created, what is protected from disclosure, what

changed, what remains uncertain, and when the redesign will be reviewed again.

A corridor may invite side-channel access. A public bundle may confuse readers. A sleeping area may increase sensory load. A complaint route may be too complex. A staffing model may undercount emotional labor.

Redesign must alter the mechanism that placed burden wrongly. Workload changes require staffing, schedule, or authority changes; child protection requires corrected data flow and access control; misleading public bundles require revised provenance, context, and review; dignity language must be matched by enforceable practice. The successor design records what changed, how the new mechanism will be tested, and which signal would require another intervention.

The redesign process should include affected persons without making them carry the whole repair. Participants, staff, host residents, nonparticipants, critics, and experts may all hold knowledge the designers need. But the City should not require harmed people to become unpaid consultants or public symbols. Consultation should be compensated where appropriate, protected, accessible, and connected to actual decision-making.

4.4.4 — Public Explanation of Stopping

Public explanations should address each audience's practical questions. Participants need to know their immediate rights and support. Staff need to know work expectations and protections. Nonparticipants need to know whether exposure risk continues. Host communities need to know local effects. Critics need enough context to evaluate the institution. Supporters need enough truth not to convert stopping into persecution myth.

Public stop notices should state the failure category without exposing protected people or security-sensitive details.

The explanation should name responsibility where possible. Was the failure caused by participant misconduct, system design, operator error, vendor failure, donor pressure, technical attack, legal incompatibility, staffing shortage, host burden, or ambiguous interaction? Blurred responsibility protects institutions. Overconfident responsibility can scapegoat. The City must speak with enough precision to guide remedy and enough humility to avoid false closure.

A public stop notice should distinguish the finding, the decision, and unresolved questions. It should state what happened, which threshold was crossed, who decided, what evidence was considered, how affected people are protected, what repair follows, what records remain restricted, disputed, or incomplete, what appeal exists, when the decision will be reviewed, and whether redesign or requalification is possible.

Begin the notice with the scope of the stop, distinguishing a process or pathway from closure of the whole prototype.

4.4.5 — No Shame in Failure Memory

Preserve near-failures. A staff intervention that prevented wrongful release, a host complaint that caught externalization early, a participant pause that revealed overload, or a technical audit that found access risk before exposure should all become protected learning.

Failure memory should classify the failure carefully. Misfit, misconduct, exhaustion, design error, technical failure, legal incompatibility, staff overload, host burden, and donor pressure should not be collapsed. The lesson depends on the category. Shame thrives where categories are blurred because people begin to fear that every difficulty will be interpreted as personal failure.

No shame in failure memory does not excuse misconduct. Harm still requires remedy, consequence, and public notice where needed.

Failure memory should preserve negative findings and honorable refusals. A donor refused because conditions would distort governance, a vendor rejected because exit rights were weak, a replication request delayed because staff protections could not travel, and a public release withdrawn because context was unsafe all belong in the record. These are moments when burden was prevented before it became injury.

A continuation decision should be reconstructible after enthusiasm, disappointment, and institutional self-interest have entered the room. The following decision domains each require evidence, an accountable owner, and a predetermined response. If the same warning reappears later, the continuation file should link the new decision to the earlier unresolved signal.

Livability and care pass when burden, sleep, health, access, refusal, and recovery meet declared floors under independent care and rights review. If missed, pause admissions, provide care, reduce load, repair conditions, and reassess.

Rights operation passes when notice, privacy, complaint, appeal, nonretaliation, and exit work in practice under independent rights and external legal review. If missed, protect the person, suspend the implicated process, remedy harm, and verify correction.

Record integrity passes when capture, custody, access, release, correction, and status labels remain accurate, logged, and reviewable under independent records oversight. If missed, restrict release, preserve evidence, notify affected people, correct or retract, and audit.

Staff sustainability passes when workload, role clarity, compensation, recovery, complaint, and turnover stay within

declared limits under labor review. If missed, reduce scope, add capacity, pause expansion, repair conditions, or close the track.

Nonparticipant protection passes only when the pilot's declared third-party protection tests are met. For example, a public bundle that identifies a protected child triggers immediate suspension of that release route, restriction of the exposed object, safe notice to affected people, and independent incident review. The release function resumes only after an authorized reviewer verifies the correction and repeats the failed protection test. Applicable reporting and remedy duties continue separately.

Host-community commitments pass when services, access, environment, labor, housing, and public cost remain within agreed limits under host review with independent support. If missed, pause growth, compensate or repair, renegotiate, relocate, or close.

Anti-capture resilience passes when donors, vendors, leaders, parties, platforms, and prestige do not control continuation or interpretation under independent conflicts review. If missed, freeze the decision, disclose influence, recuse or remove actors, diversify support, or terminate funding.

Public usability passes when released records remain understandable, contextual, accessible, correctable, and useful under public-interface and accessibility review. If missed, redesign the interface, reduce release, restore context, correct artifacts, and delay broader use.

The prototype decision ledger is noncompensatory: a red threshold triggers its declared response even when other domains succeed. A domain may return to cleared status only when the accountable authority verifies that its own corrective condition has been met and retains the supporting evidence. Disputed thresholds remain visibly unresolved. The ledger

should also record whether two subthreshold warnings interact to create a stop condition that neither would trigger alone.

4.5 — Operational Evidence, Not Formal Proof

A useful pilot question specifies observable conduct, a credible comparison, and an outcome checked by someone other than its designers. Research from other settings can sharpen such a question, but the City must measure its own effects. There is empirical reason to examine whether credible review changes conduct before a final public judgment. In a randomized field experiment involving 608 Indonesian village road projects, raising the announced probability of government audit from about 4 percent to effectively 100 percent reduced missing expenditures by about eight percentage points. Missing expenditure was measured by the difference between reported costs and an independent engineering estimate, not by counting every form of corruption (Olken, 2007).

4.5.1 — Evidence of Feasibility

Feasibility evidence should include independent replication of process before replication of site. Can another reviewer understand the record lifecycle? Can another staff team follow the complaint route? Can another host community see what it would need to evaluate? Can another legal context identify what remains unresolved? If feasibility depends on tacit knowledge possessed only by founders or early staff, the City may function locally while remaining unready to travel.

Feasibility evaluation should distinguish delivering a process from achieving its purpose. Implementation research separates outcomes such as acceptability, adoption, feasibility, and fidelity from service or treatment outcomes (Proctor et al., 2011). Applied here, a review route might operate as specified yet remain difficult for affected people to use; a well-used route might still fail to correct decisions. Those are different findings and call for different changes.

A preregistered meta-analysis of six completed field experiments found no overall evidence that the tested nonpartisan performance-information campaigns changed vote choice or turnout (Dunning et al., 2019). The common intervention supplied information privately shortly before elections; it did not test the City's formation proposal. Its relevance here is to distinguish receipt of information from the effects attributed to it.

A City evaluation can follow a correction from notice through understanding, accessible action, a reasoned decision, and verified implementation. In fictional cases with warranted and unwarranted challenges, the reader identifies the current evidence and an available route; a simulated receiving office handles the request against the same source record. Assess justified resolution and effort on each side, including correct rejection of unsupported challenges, rather than more complaints or political agreement. If understanding improves but a warranted correction still cannot reach practice, the next test concerns the response system, not another longer explanation. Rights, care, privacy, and usable exit remain conditions of the comparison.

Feasibility evidence should also include cost honesty. A prototype may be technically possible while materially unfair if it depends on hidden donor control, underpaid labor, unpriced maintenance, host subsidy, fragile cybersecurity, or heroic staff overload.

An early mechanism test can separate two possible sources of continuity: making the evidence easier to retrieve and making responsibility for the next action explicit. In fictional cases, one design adds a direct link to the relevant declaration; another requires the receiving role to acknowledge an assigned correction task. Compare neither addition, either addition alone,

and both together. All conditions retain the same underlying permitted facts, task rules, and staff-time allowance. Independent simulation teams are assigned to conditions, and the analysis accounts for reused cases and repeated work by a team. No real claimant loses a safeguard for the experiment.

The primary question is whether a warranted correction reaches its designated destination within the declared interval. Secondary observations locate missing evidence, unresolved handoffs, and unnecessary rework. Before testing, specify how the two additions are expected to interact: on an additive scale, their combined improvement exceeds the sum of their separate improvements only when the joint effect goes beyond that prespecified benchmark. Estimate the interaction with uncertainty rather than inferring synergy from the best-looking condition. The result could favor a simple link, a responsibility receipt, their combination, or further redesign. This makes the integration claim testable before construction and gives existing institutions a method they can also use.

When random allocation is not appropriate or feasible, the comparison should still begin with a clear question: what would happen to eligible adults who start this defined City pathway rather than a specified alternative? State the strategies compared, outcomes, and analysis before examining results. Align eligibility, strategy assignment, and the start of follow-up at the same baseline. Define eligibility without using later completion; do not compare successful City completers with outsiders followed from an earlier and less selected starting point. The target-trial framework makes this alignment explicit (Hernán and Robins, 2016). It does not remove unmeasured differences by naming them. The City application should therefore report remaining selection limits and use only lawfully available,

purpose-appropriate information. Better design comes before a larger archive.

The theory of change should ask whether improvement travels between people. A learner may use a correction method taught to a teammate, so a comparison member can benefit without receiving the original lesson. A small difference between people directly offered the lesson and their peers would then be compatible with a useful shared effect. Hudgens and Halloran (2008) distinguish direct, indirect, and overall effects under specified allocation strategies; their framework makes the exposure of peers part of the question rather than unexplained noise.

One early study could use a supplemental learning aid in voluntary exercises with fictional decision files. Randomly assign sufficiently many groups to different proportions offered the aid, then randomly choose recipients within each group. Compare unoffered members across allocation strategies to examine spillover, and whole-group outcomes to examine the strategy’s overall contribution. Prespecify the assignment-based comparisons, follow-up, uncertainty analysis, and handling of nonuse and missing outcomes; an offer is not assumed to equal use. The design also requires a defensible account of contact between groups. Where shared instructors or exchange cross that boundary, change the grouping or narrow the causal claim; separate rooms alone cannot establish independence. Ordinary care and accessibility supports remain unchanged, the aid is available to everyone after the exercise, and no private social-network dossier is needed. This study can identify how learning spreads while leaving the wider feasibility, cost, and rights gates intact.

4.5.2 — Evidence of Livability

The City can borrow the research question rather than the effect size: does a credible prospect of review improve the handling of a consequential task before authority is granted? A local test would identify the conduct to be improved, the review arrangement, and an outcome checked independently of the institution's own report. The local evaluation also checks whether apparent improvement merely shifts the same burden into an adjacent task category. This precedent supports investigating accountable review in a different setting; it does not establish a benefit from residence or continuous recording.

Livability evaluation includes exit data with dignity. When people leave, the review examines any voluntary account of why they left, what support they received, which records remain protected, what the institution learned, and whether departure was treated as information rather than disgrace. An exit can show that safeguards worked. A prototype that counts only completion misunderstands the burden it is studying.

Qualitative accounts matter alongside operational measures because some harms first appear as hesitation, fatigue, silence, or ordinary dread. The City should listen to the texture of life as carefully as it counts visible outcomes.

Report livability findings as fit among person, role, support, institution, and burden, without treating struggle or endurance as a ranking of people.

Livability analysis brings testimony, confidential wellbeing review, operational load, complaints, exit experience, staff observation, and independent audit into a coordinated inquiry while preserving their distinct purposes and access rules. Each channel can reveal something the others miss. To examine the additional record regime, a lower-burden comparison pathway should receive comparable educational quality and material

support. Otherwise an advantage from better teaching or financial stability could be attributed to recording (Skivington et al., 2021).

Where genuine uncertainty, informed agreement, ethics review, and lawful authority permit comparison, random assignment among acceptable arrangements can strengthen causal inference. The protocol names the unit assigned and the effect being estimated. An offer of a pathway, actual participation in it, and completion of it are different objects of comparison. Necessary care and established protections remain available in every arrangement. Where random assignment is impractical, the study states what its comparison supports and examines plausible selection differences rather than treating statistical adjustment as a substitute for design.

The evaluation reports the flow from eligibility through application, entry, pause, and exit using privacy-protective counts. Voluntary reasons and separately authorized follow-up can help explain missing outcomes. Sensitivity analysis shows whether plausible outcomes among people no longer observed would change the conclusion. Repeated recordings from one person are repeated observations, not additional participants; shared instructors and cohort conditions also affect what can be inferred. The analysis should reflect the assignment and dependence structure rather than the number of files stored. Shared conditions can correlate outcomes, while shared instruction can also change what a comparison group receives; correcting uncertainty estimates alone does not resolve that second problem.

A first cohort can establish usable procedures, identify workload, and improve the next study. A comparative-effectiveness claim requires a sample and follow-up period justified for that question. Observation effects

can be examined through declared task and audience conditions without extending City monitoring into post-exit private life. Evaluation should compare behavior before, during, and after major publicity events where feasible, so attention effects are not mistaken for ordinary operation. This sequence turns early findings into a foundation for progressively stronger evidence.

4.5.3 — Evidence of Record Function

A stronger record system may initially reveal more errors because it discovers what the old system missed. To distinguish discovery from deterioration, evaluators should use a predeclared independent review of a probability sample of eligible, lawfully reviewable decisions, including decisions that received no complaint. Compare confirmed defects per decision examined and the share detected before release or consequential use. Freeze the pre-audit discovery status and its timestamps before review findings are communicated, so errors discovered by the evaluation are not credited as earlier routine detection. This recording step must not delay an urgent protective action or necessary correction. Apply the same ascertainment procedure to the comparator and use sampling probabilities when estimating rates and uncertainty. Reviewer disagreements receive a separate, documented adjudication; unresolved evidence is not counted as an error-free decision. Report its extent and show how plausible resolutions would affect the comparison. A rise in reports can then be interpreted alongside evidence that errors became less frequent or were caught earlier.

4.5.4 — Evidence of Public Usefulness

Evidence of public usefulness asks whether citizens, critics, journalists, institutions, and affected people can use the City’s records and interfaces for civic judgment under real conditions. The test belongs with nonexpert readers, concrete questions,

accessibility needs, and ordinary attention limits. A system usable only by specialists has limited democratic value, however accurate its internal architecture may be.

Public usefulness can be studied before a residential pilot. Researchers could prepare fictional decision files with a prospectively fixed factual record, then randomly assign readers to a well-designed conventional disclosure packet or a City-style presentation drawn from the same evidence. When format is the question, the available facts and reading time are matched. When additional evidence is the question, the added content is explicitly identified. A clearer layout and a richer evidence base then receive separate tests rather than credit for one undifferentiated effect.

The protocol selects a primary factual task before testing, such as correctly reporting whether a sponsor connection was declared before advice was adopted. Secondary tasks can examine whether readers distinguish allegation from finding, locate a correction, recognize uncertainty, and finish within the available time. The answer key fixes the fictional facts, not the policy preference or moral judgment readers ought to adopt. Confidence is compared with factual accuracy so greater certainty alone cannot count as better understanding.

Accessible versions and readers with varied prior knowledge belong in the design. A separately randomized comparison can change only the institutional label on otherwise identical evidence, distinguishing an informational benefit from confidence generated by the City’s name. The protocol specifies the smallest improvement worth pursuing, sample-size justification, exclusions, missing-data treatment, and planned comparisons before analysis. Assignment is at the reader level; analysis accounts for repeated answers by the same reader and reuse of the same case. A reader does not encounter the same

facts in both formats before the primary response, because the first exposure could teach the second answer. Case difficulty is balanced across conditions. Scoring should be blinded to presentation assignment where feasible. Secondary and exploratory findings retain their own status (Lakens, 2022).

The first shared output would be a reusable, nonidentifying case set with a versioned answer key and analysis plan. Development examples can be public, while an independently held set of new cases tests whether the method travels beyond familiar answers. Human readers and machine systems require separate evaluation reports; a machine benchmark does not stand in for citizen understanding. Public-administration and human-computer-interaction teams would have a concrete contribution to make: reduce the work of checking a decision while preserving freedom to disagree about it.

4.5.5 — Claim-Status Labels

Claim-status labels describe what a result supports, for whom, during which period, under which conditions, and for which decision. Feasible under tested conditions differs from proven good; livable for an early cohort differs from universally livable; record system functioning differs from truth access; public usefulness differs from democratic endorsement. The label keeps observation, interpretation, and authorization in their proper order.

City labels should align with *The Science of Fairness* without copying its verdict system. The City needs practical language for institutional evidence, while the science volume owns scientific adjudication. Terms such as validated, proven, confirmed, demonstrated true, or scientifically established therefore appear only when the relevant governed process has authorized them.

Before reporting begins, the evidence register should separate three fields: what occurred under declared conditions, what the finding may mean and which alternatives remain, and what action the evidence can justify. Useful labels may include design assumption, operational observation, provisional finding, demonstrated function, unresolved risk, adverse finding, redesign required, replication ineligible, and scientific non-claim.

The status label for a consequential public claim should open a compact record of its proposition, source version, support type, question it can answer, and review date. Label proposed mechanisms as proposals; identify an observation's population and method and an interpretation's supporting observation and reasoning. State when outcome data are absent rather than borrowing empirical status from nearby citations. The label should name the reviewer and distinguish support for another bounded test from replication.

The record also links material contrary evidence, unresolved disagreement, and any correction that changes the claim. For Mara's case in Section 29.3.4, the statement that a declaration preceded the adopted advice is tied to the dated declaration and task sequence. It does not establish the wisdom of the recommendation. A human reader or authorized machine can then inspect the same evidentiary boundary. These are claim-specific links, not a cross-architecture profile of the person.

For record-integrity findings, identify dependencies on a particular technical stack; for livability findings, include exit data and clinical boundaries.

A useful finding states how large a difference matters for the decision. Before comparison, define the smallest worthwhile improvement in the chosen civic outcome and report the

estimate with its uncertainty. Treat a worthwhile benefit as established only when the prespecified inferential rule supports a difference beyond that threshold, not merely when the point estimate exceeds it. When several outcomes or repeated examinations before the scheduled end could support a success claim, the protocol specifies how those opportunities enter the inferential rule before results are seen.

An imprecise comparison that does not establish a difference does not establish equivalence. Where equivalence is the question, use prospectively justified bounds and an appropriate test (Lakens, Scheel, and Isager, 2018). A difference can be statistically distinguishable from zero and still lie within those practical equivalence bounds. Report magnitude, direction, and equivalence separately rather than forcing them into mutually exclusive labels. A precisely estimated small benefit is not automatically a worthwhile benefit or an inconclusive result. Report a supported material disadvantage against its prospectively stated adverse bound as clearly as a benefit. Each conclusion applies only to its specified comparison and measured function. Rights and other noncompensatory requirements remain separate conditions, not costs that a favorable average can cancel.

The same status discipline must propagate through every public artifact. When a claim narrows, fails, expires, or is superseded, summaries, diagrams, donor materials, websites, speeches, and automated outputs should be corrected or withdrawn together. Technical governance frameworks likewise treat validity, monitoring, and lifecycle control as continuing obligations rather than one-time certification (NIST, 2024b).

4.6 — Why Replication Must Wait for Safeguards

Replication becomes responsible only when safeguards can travel. A useful first City may attract supporters, regions, donors, and public officials before rights, staff protections, archive integrity, host review, and decertification capacity have proved portable. Part IX later examines network discipline in detail; the ethical rule begins here: the institution may scale only as fast as its protections, evidence, and local legitimacy can scale with it (Greenhalgh et al., 2004; Milat et al., 2015; McLean and Gargani, 2019). Treat each replication request as a burden-transfer decision, documented against the portability tests that follow.

4.6.1 — Rights Must Travel

A copied charter does not show that protections work in another jurisdiction. A later site must demonstrate independently that complaints, refusals, protected records, and safe departures remain usable when laws, operators, and staff differ. Section 4.3 supplies the substantive safeguards; this Section tests portability.

Accreditation should require demonstrated safeguards before active participants enter.

If a right depends on the founding team's goodwill rather than trained staff, funded procedures, and independent authority, it has not become portable. Accreditation must test whether a replacement team can operate the same protection under pressure.

Rights must also translate across legal and cultural contexts without dilution. A host jurisdiction may have different labor law, privacy law, family law, public-record law, disability protection, or protest culture. The City cannot assume that a safeguard travels because the title travels. The invariant is dignity under reviewable burden. The legal shell may need

adaptation, and where adaptation cannot preserve the right, replication should wait.

Replication should require a portable rights packet rather than a promise to preserve values. The packet should include the operative covenant, protected categories, complaint and appeal routes, exit support, child and third-party protections, staff standing, emergency rules, independent review terms, translation and accessibility requirements, and public status labels. A new site should demonstrate these systems before it receives the City name.

4.6.2 — Staff Protections Must Travel

The staff-protection travel test should include whether a new site can recruit without desperation, train without haste, rotate sensitive roles, protect refusal, manage emotional load, prevent hero culture, and compensate workers fairly enough that mission does not become wage suppression.

Staff protection is an accreditation requirement established before opening. Role-bound records, off-duty privacy, complaint and appeal, anti-retaliation, staff stop authority, labor standards, workload monitoring, burnout response, rotation, recovery, staffing ratios, and whistleblower protection must have owners, budgets, and audit routes. A site demonstrates readiness only when it can sustain these protections through ordinary operations and crisis.

Cost archive work, clinical and legal support, mentoring, security, maintenance, accessibility, public-interface moderation, records, ombuds services, and host-community liaison. Outsourcing must not remove accountability, and staffing must not depend on heroic overwork. Accreditation should test local management practice, including whether supervisors reward overwork, punish whistleblowing, or normalize emergency pace.

4.6.3 — Archive Integrity Must Travel

A later City might copy storage software but not correction culture, provenance discipline, access review, contextual release, machine-output controls, or public comprehension testing.

The archive travel test should include breach response, vendor exit, human audit, protected-category handling, delayed release governance, correction routes, right of reply, public status labels, research-use separation, no cross-architecture dossier discipline, and machine-summary review. If any of these cannot travel, replication should not proceed in full.

Apply the record-integrity tests in Section 4.3.3 to the proposed site's own records, operators, and systems.

Archive integrity also requires vendor discipline. Replication may tempt sites to adopt cheaper systems, proprietary platforms, or simplified tools. Later Cities must preserve audit rights, portability, redundancy, public memory without private ownership, and Artificial Intelligence subordination.

Scale can make weak memory appear authoritative, especially when interfaces look consistent across locations.

4.6.4 — Host-Community Review Must Travel

The host travel test includes compensation and mitigation capacity. A later City must identify infrastructure costs, security burdens, price pressure, emergency-service demand, environmental effects, and public attention before authorization, then fund the agreed response. Replication earns legitimacy by paying its local burden and preserving local authority to challenge the arrangement.

Replication should report host benefits and burdens separately. Jobs, infrastructure investment, public learning, and local services may create value. Housing pressure, service demand, disruption, environmental effects, and security spillover may

impose costs on different people. Host review must identify who receives each benefit and who carries each burden; an aggregate gain cannot resolve a specific rights claim.

Host-community review cannot be copied by exporting a public-meeting format. Each place has its own land history, housing pressure, infrastructure capacity, local politics, indigenous or historic claims, environmental conditions, labor market, transport system, media ecology, and trust wounds. The review route must fit the host, not only the blueprint.

Host-community review must include the power to slow or alter plans. The host community may not own every institutional decision, but it should have meaningful routes to challenge siting, traffic, security, utilities, emergency coordination, environmental burden, local hiring promises, media management, and mitigation failures.

4.6.5 — Decertification Must Travel

A decertification system should specify who can trigger review, what evidence begins inquiry, and which emergency protections apply. It should also define the public status label, the treatment of participants and staff, archive preservation or sealing, host-community notice, and any route to requalification after repair.

Decertification must be governed carefully to avoid political weaponization. Decertification should be tied to nonnegotiable standards: adult voluntary entry, Transparent Vow integrity, ordinary privacy protection, staff dignity, record integrity, nonparticipant shielding, Artificial Intelligence subordination, rights, exit, host review, and failure memory.

Inviting spectacle or inflating operational evidence into proof should also be grounds for a later City to lose standing in a way the public understands.

Public status notices should distinguish unauthorized imitations from previously accredited sites that have lost standing. Both may borrow the language of the Transparent Vow while weakening its protections.

Obligations to records, participants, staff, and the host should survive loss of accreditation.

Part II — Ground, Form, and Spatial Charter

Every institution that hopes to change public life eventually reaches the ground. At that moment, aspiration becomes a neighbor, employer, utility customer, legal occupant, and physical presence. Land carries prior claims, infrastructure carries limits, and ordinary people already live around whatever parcel appears available. Part II begins where a civic idea becomes accountable to place: roads, water, housing, workers, weather, ecosystems, budgets, and the people who will carry the result.

Ground, form, and spatial charter come after the Vow because the built environment gives daily force to the City's ethical boundaries. A room can shelter dignity or intensify scrutiny. A gate can orient lawful access or create status by architecture. A public plaza can make answerability approachable or turn service into spectacle. Trust begins when those distributions are named, tested with the people who experience them, and revised when use reveals a burden the drawings missed.

The phrase spatial charter names the distribution of access, exposure, labor, quiet, danger, movement, repair, and maintenance across a place. It asks who may approach, who waits, who can leave, who is recorded, who is shielded, who carries equipment, who responds at night, and who bears the cost when systems fail. These choices shape daily rights and duties. *The Constitution of Fairness* develops the series' model legal architecture; applicable law governs any actual site.

Space begins deciding before a rule is read. Paths, edges, thresholds, landmarks, spatial syntax, and territorial cues influence who can orient, approach, withdraw, linger, or dominate. The City should use that body of design knowledge as a source of questions and tests, not as a substitute for law or a promise that conduct can be engineered (Lynch, 1960; Hillier and Hanson, 1984; Lefebvre, 1991).

Climate, utilities, and maintenance test whether the City can remain safe and repairable without consuming the host community's resilience margin. Part II therefore treats service continuity, adaptation, and maintenance as design constraints, not visual features (IPCC, 2023; UNDRR, 2022).

Civic seriousness does not require luxury, intimidation, monumental scale, or a visual language of destiny. Beauty can support orientation, calm, dignity, public memory, and delight, but it earns no exemption from host legitimacy, accessibility, maintenance, or cost discipline. The City's task is to define the spatial tests that any later lawful decision must survive, leaving macroeconomic capacity to *The Peace of Fairness*, legal validity to *The Constitution of Fairness*, and public administration to *The Government of Fairness*.

The movement ahead is deliberately concrete. It begins with parcels, leases, land histories, utility margins, commutes, permits, and host standing; moves through bands, doors, corridors, signs, light, sound, and refuge; then enters bedrooms, classrooms, dining rooms, libraries, clinics, archives, kitchens, gardens, loading routes, server rooms, lifts, alarms, and repair budgets. By the end of the Part, architecture should read as a public account of who moves, waits, works, rests, objects, repairs, and pays.

Chapter 5 — Site, Host, and Shared Responsibility

Site selection begins with relationships, capacities, and burdens rather than a preferred parcel. The decision asks which existing uses the City would join, what it could strengthen, and what it would have to prevent, fund, monitor, repair, or accept as reasons not to build.

Site selection becomes disciplined only when host standing, alternatives, lawful authority, rights, service capacity, climate exposure, lifecycle cost, and remedy remain visible together. The City is still a candidate institution, so lawful authorities, host processes, and later transition gates retain power to refuse, redirect, or stop a proposal. Evidence must be able to change the answer, not merely decorate a preferred parcel.

The chapter's strongest spatial proposition is that campus scale may be the minimum whole. That proposition earns attention because public-power formation may require residence, learning, deliberation, recovery, staff ecology, public interface, and record continuity to work as one system. It also carries a heavy burden of proof. Co-location must outperform distributed and leased alternatives on rights, host cost, accessibility, resilience, and total lifecycle burden rather than relying on imagery or prestige.

The host is not a single voice. A landowner may support a sale while tenants fear rent pressure. Businesses may expect customers while residents fear traffic and attention. Public officials may welcome revenue while emergency workers see capacity risk. People closest to the site may carry burdens that a jurisdiction-wide majority never experiences.

A legitimate host process separates representation from attendance. Its record should show who was invited, who could realistically participate, which interests were absent, what assistance made participation possible, what alternatives remained open, which objections changed the proposal, and what issues stayed unresolved. A crowded meeting can still be

unrepresentative; a smaller process can still be meaningful when barriers, dissent, and decision effects are visible.

Benefits and consent remain in separate columns throughout the chapter. Local jobs, procurement, infrastructure, public access, educational partnerships, or revenue may be valuable and should be evaluated honestly. They do not erase prior rights, justify displacement, or convert material need into agreement. A specific burden receives its own standing, response, and remedy even when the wider project has public benefits.

The chapter moves from form to authority, then from authority to the people who must live with the result. It tests whether co-location is functionally necessary, places each candidate form inside law and land history, builds a host-burden and remedy route, disciplines proximity, examines climate and utility dependence, and ends with whole-life cost and bounded replication. The destination is not a preferred rendering. It is a defensible sequence of reasons, evidence, challenge, correction, and retreat.

5.1 — Campus Scale May Be the Minimum Prototype

Campus scale is a rebuttable functional claim rather than an aesthetic entitlement. Minimum names the smallest integrated arrangement that can carry the complete institutional task, not the smallest parcel, the most impressive composition, or a permanent preference for construction. Each form must face the same functional test. Can it maintain active-period continuity without dragging ordinary households into the Vow?

5.1.1 — Residence Requires Continuity

Each form also faces the same burden test. Land use, displacement, transport, utilities, construction, operating cost, staff time, accessibility, security, media pressure, and host-service demand must be counted across the full lifecycle. A distributed design that looks inexpensive can externalize travel and coordination; a campus that looks efficient can concentrate risk and prestige. Total burden, not capital cost alone, governs the comparison.

Residence matters because public-power formation extends beyond scheduled instruction. Fatigue, repair, ordinary conflict, care, return, and the use of unstructured time can reveal whether a role burden is humane and whether the institution is exporting its cost. Yet continuity does not automatically require every participant to live inside one purpose-built boundary. It requires a governable relation among active status, place, record, rights, and nonparticipant protection.

A clustered leased model may provide continuity without permanent construction. Participants might live in several nearby buildings under common standards, with protected routes to formation spaces and clear boundaries for visitors, staff, and incidental neighbors. This form can lower capital and land burden, but it creates landlord dependence, mixed-use privacy

problems, transport demands, and the risk that ordinary tenants become collateral participants. Those risks require contractual and spatial safeguards before the form is credible.

An embedded model may use ordinary urban housing with tightly defined active periods and institutional facilities nearby. It can reduce enclave logic and keep participants in contact with ordinary civic life. It can also make the Vow leak into streets, shops, transit, and households, especially if devices or location systems are used to compensate for spatial ambiguity. An embedded form fails if continuity is purchased through pervasive tracking or if nonparticipants cannot remain outside the record.

A distributed model may be appropriate for participants whose care, disability, family, safety, or legal circumstances make relocation unfair. Continuity could be carried through defined work blocks, governed travel, remote participation, and explicit status changes. The burden then shifts from land to coordination, cybersecurity, records, time zones, home privacy, and staff availability. A fair comparison must count those burdens rather than treating distribution as costless flexibility.

Residence should therefore be specified by function. The institution needs reliable sleep conditions, private bodily dignity, care access, food, laundry, accessibility, ordinary recovery, visitor boundaries, emergency support, and a clear answer to when active role status begins and ends. It does not need monastic control, aesthetic uniformity, or constant public availability.

Continuity must remain compatible with pause and exit. A participant should be able to step out of active status, leave the site, receive care, attend to family need, or withdraw without being treated as a security breach. Housing arrangements should include transition periods, anti-retaliation rules, relocation

support where dependence was created, and protection against sudden homelessness.

Compare residential effects on neighbors under Section 5.3.2 and give affected residents an enforceable review route before selection.

5.1.2 — Formation Requires Multiple Spaces

Public-power formation cannot be reduced to one classroom or one digital platform. Learning, deliberation, drafting, opposition, simulation, reflection, care, and public explanation impose different demands on attention and dignity.

A distributed network can place functions where they are strongest. Existing universities may host instruction, civic buildings may host public deliberation, leased rooms may support drafting, and independent care providers may support recovery. This can reduce construction and diversify authority. It can also fragment records, increase travel, create inconsistent accessibility, and make responsibility unclear when harm occurs between sites.

An embedded model can use ordinary civic space rather than creating a separate world. Deliberation in a public building, study in a library, and community meetings in local venues may keep formation accountable to the society it hopes to serve. Yet borrowed spaces carry their own users, rules, labor, and privacy. The City cannot take over public facilities, displace ordinary programs, or treat community institutions as a free infrastructure layer.

Leased facilities can be relinquished, resized, or reconfigured to test which functions require proximity. Inspect building quality, lease security, landlord leverage, and retrofit costs before adapting them for study, deliberation, public interface, staff work, and recovery.

No room should exist merely because it looks civic. Each must answer what burden it contains, what risk it reduces, who works there, who may enter, what is recorded, what is protected, and how the space returns to ordinary use if the pilot stops.

Multiple sites can also reduce capture if authority is intentionally separated. Independent complaint, clinical care, legal counsel, and oversight may be safer outside the participant's primary formation environment. Not every function should be co-located. Some distance protects independence. The spatial model should distinguish integration from institutional monopoly.

A dedicated space should earn its place through a comparison of functions, not an assumption that openness creates collaboration. In two corporate before-and-after studies, Bernstein and Turban (2018) observed less face-to-face interaction and more electronic communication after transitions to open offices. These were not randomized City trials. Their relevance is the distinction between being physically near, being visually exposed, and being able to consult the right person: one does not establish the others.

A reversible City mockup could compare nearby rooms with clear privacy thresholds against a distributed arrangement using the same fictional tasks, staffing, and record rules. Test whether users reach the authorized adviser, transfer a correction accurately, and return to protected space without avoidable delay or exposure. Include different access needs and counterbalance layout order across comparable tasks so familiarity is not mistaken for better design. Speech-leakage checks use scripted fictional content, not private conversations. Report travel time, interruptions, mistaken crossings, and task completion separately. A shorter corridor earns no credit for exposing protected work. Where a leased or distributed arrangement

preserves the function with less total burden, it remains the preferred substitute; useful proximity may be achieved without constant visibility.

5.1.3 — Recovery Requires Place

Provide protected recovery time and a place close enough to use.

Co-located recovery can reduce travel and make support available before distress becomes crisis. It can also create role confusion if the same institution controls training, evaluation, housing, and care. Participants may fear that seeking help will affect readiness judgments. Staff may become both helpers and record sources. The design should preserve clinical, legal, and ethical independence even when care is nearby.

Distributed care can strengthen confidentiality and professional autonomy. It may allow participants to choose licensed providers outside institutional culture, while a campus may justify dedicated recovery capacity when immediate support, continuity, or safe de-loading truly requires proximity. The comparison should ask where recovery can be carried with the least combined burden. Transport, scheduling, continuity, emergency communication, jurisdiction, and incidental-record risks must be governed, and the City should not duplicate capable local care systems merely to appear complete.

Staff need break rooms, recovery time, confidential support, and routes away from public attention.

Recovery must not become disciplinary isolation. A person should not be removed from view because distress is embarrassing to the institution. De-loading needs clear status, consent, care, review, and return routes. When safety requires separation, the reason and duration should be governed without turning health information into public material.

Co-location also risks turning continuity into dependency. A participant may become reliant on one housing provider, one care network, one record system, one security structure, and one social world. Any campus proposal must therefore show how independent rights, outside relationships, lawful services, and realistic exit remain usable in practice.

Test recovery arrangements during a communications outage: can participants reach a safe resting place, clinicians act independently, staff step away from duty without losing pay, and emergency responders reach the site?

5.1.4 — Staff Ecology Requires Scale

The City cannot be sized only around participants. Staff make continuity possible through food, cleaning, maintenance, records, care, accessibility, transport, scheduling, security, facilitation, legal support, technology, and administration. A spatial form that appears efficient because staff travel farther, work in cramped back areas, remain on call, or disappear into subcontracting has not reduced burden.

A distributed model may allow staff to work nearer their homes or within existing professional institutions. It may also multiply travel, coordination, shift handoffs, security systems, and unpaid communication. Those burdens must be counted as part of the spatial form rather than treated as individual inconvenience.

Scale must also include accommodation. Disability access, pregnancy, caregiving, religious practice, language, heat exposure, shift fatigue, transport reliability, and safe return after late work all affect the staff footprint. Staff require accessible, dignified facilities.

Local hiring can create real value, but only when the jobs are safe, fairly compensated, trainable, durable, and connected to

advancement. Employment promises ring hollow when a contractor chain suppresses wages, reserves skilled roles for outsiders, or drains essential workers from local public services. The labor plan must show who is hired, under what terms, with what protections, and at what effect on the surrounding labor market.

5.1.5 — Public Interface Requires Boundary

Can it distinguish formation, recovery, care, public interface, and protected domains? Can staff work safely without hidden travel or unpaid coordination? Can records remain coherent without turning location tracking into whole-person surveillance? Can visitors, critics, and affected people reach the institution without exposing residents or neighbors? (Dober, 1992; Kenney et al., 2005; Inkelas et al., 2018)

A City devoted to public-power formation must be reachable. Citizens, host residents, critics, journalists, inspectors, experts, protesters, and affected persons need routes to information, observation, question, complaint, and challenge. Reachability does not require that the entire site become public space. It requires a boundary that explains what the public may reach, what remains protected, and how decisions about access are reviewed.

An embedded or distributed model may place public interfaces in ordinary civic buildings, libraries, or accessible urban locations. This can reduce the symbolic divide between the City and the public.

Public interface requires context. Visitors should know whether they are entering a public band, an oversight route, a media zone, a meeting space, or a protected area. Rules should be understandable before a person crosses the threshold. Access

decisions should produce reasons and appeal routes rather than unexplained exclusion.

The interface should be tested from the perspective of a person without status. Can a host resident find the complaint office? Can a disabled visitor reach a hearing? Can a critic attend without donor invitation? Can a person without digital access receive records help? Can a journalist challenge an access denial? If the route depends on insider knowledge, the boundary is not public.

The minimum-whole claim should be recorded as rebuttable, not permanent. Its evidence packet should separate functions that require co-location from those that can remain distributed, compare each arrangement’s burdens, identify evidence that would reopen the choice, and name who can contract or abandon the footprint.

5.2 — Host Jurisdiction and Legal Envelope

A credible City enters the legal order already governing the ground. Its charter, nonprofit status, public purpose, or government relationship creates no independent permission to build or operate. Land, planning, construction, labor, privacy, records, assembly, health, taxation, emergency authority, disability access, environmental protection, and remedy may belong to different bodies. The legal envelope maps those authorities and review routes without pretending design can create power.

5.2.1 — Legal Preconditions

The legal envelope must be assessed across every candidate form. A purpose-built campus may require acquisition, rezoning, environmental assessment, utilities agreements, building approvals, and long-term public-service arrangements. A leased cluster may require change-of-use approval, tenant and landlord protections, retrofit compliance, and contractual control over records and security. A distributed model may cross municipal, regional, or national boundaries and multiply legal responsibilities rather than reduce them.

Land history belongs inside the legal analysis. Formal title may not exhaust lawful or legitimate interests. Tenants, customary users, Indigenous peoples, communal owners, easement holders, nearby residents, cultural custodians, and people exposed to displacement may possess rights or claims that cannot be cleared by a simple purchase. International frameworks offer reference points, but applicable law and affected-rightsholder review control each case (UN-Habitat, 2015; United Nations, 2007).

Defensible land use may rest on ownership, lease, license, public grant, partnership, or another lawful arrangement, each

with different powers and dependencies. A lease preserves relocation options but creates landlord leverage. Ownership secures control while increasing capital, displacement, and symbolic burden. A public grant may transfer public value or create political dependence.

Title review must be joined to land-history review. The file should identify prior uses, current occupants, tenants, informal users, easements, contamination, heritage, sacred or cultural significance, communal interests, and unresolved claims. Where Indigenous peoples or customary communities may be affected, review must engage their representative institutions and applicable legal orders early enough to influence whether and how a proposal proceeds. Articles 10, 19, and 32 of the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples provide relevant reference points on relocation, consultation, land and resource decisions, and free, prior and informed consent in specified circumstances. They do not replace jurisdiction-specific law or settle which consent rule governs a particular site.

The second precondition is lawful planning and land use. Zoning, comprehensive plans, density, height, access, traffic, noise, mixed use, housing impacts, environmental review, and public-hearing requirements may apply differently to campus, leased, embedded, or distributed forms. Any land-use category must disclose the project's actual functions rather than hide them behind a broad label. Residence, education, public assembly, records infrastructure, clinical interfaces, food service, offices, security, and public visitation should be described honestly.

Environmental and social assessment becomes the third precondition because direct effects are only part of the site's burden. The review follows construction, operation, induced development, cumulative pressure, expansion, failure, and

closure, and it identifies who is affected at each stage. The World Bank Environmental and Social Framework offers one integrated reference across land acquisition, displacement, Indigenous Peoples and historically underserved traditional local communities, stakeholder engagement, disclosure, and grievance. Its contribution is disciplined lifecycle inquiry, not universal legal authority or legitimacy by checklist (World Bank, 2017a).

The fourth precondition is access to necessary infrastructure without unlawful preference. Water, wastewater, energy, roads, transit, communications, waste handling, emergency response, and public services may require agreements, permits, upgrades, or cost sharing. Civic purpose creates no presumption that public systems will absorb new demand. Any priority, subsidy, or dedicated capacity must be lawful, transparent, and justified against other public needs.

The fifth precondition is a complete building and life-safety route. Code compliance, fire and evacuation planning, structural review, accessibility, occupational safety, public-health requirements, food service, clinical licensing where applicable, and emergency coordination belong before occupancy. Temporary or pilot status does not justify inferior protection. A leased or modular form may require more careful review precisely because adaptation can hide compromises.

The sixth precondition is lawful institutional capacity. The entity that signs leases, employs staff, holds insurance, contracts with vendors, receives funds, manages records, and responds to claims must have clear authority and accountability. The City cannot operate through a maze of entities that distributes liability while concentrating control. Beneficial ownership, conflicts, delegated authority, and dissolution routes should be visible.

The seventh precondition is reviewability. Affected persons need access to courts, regulators, administrative review, ombuds processes, labor inspection, privacy authorities, and other lawful remedies. The project should not use arbitration, donor conditions, lease clauses, confidentiality terms, or private governance to remove disputes from public law where rights or public burdens are involved.

5.2.2 — Rights Compatibility

Participants accept a severe role burden, but consent does not waive bodily dignity, due process, labor rights, disability access, clinical and legal privilege, freedom of conscience, family protection, or lawful confidentiality. Nonparticipants accept nothing merely by living, working, traveling, or owning property nearby.

The first compatibility test concerns ordinary privacy. Site design, cameras, access controls, identity systems, visitor management, transport, and communications must not pull neighbors, workers, service users, or passersby into participant records. A campus that requires outward-facing surveillance to feel secure may be incompatible with the project's central direction. Security must be designed inward toward role-bound risk, not outward toward routine public life.

The second test concerns equality and accessibility. Physical routes, transportation, information, communication, emergency procedures, digital interfaces, housing, work areas, and public services must be usable by disabled people without exceptional permission, segregated routes, or humiliating workarounds. Article 9 of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, read with the Committee's General Comment No. 2, treats accessibility as an ex ante obligation and a condition for independent living and full participation, offering a strong

design reference for the site (Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, 2014b). Applicable disability, building, transport, employment, and digital-access law still controls the enforceable requirements.

The third test concerns labor. Staff and construction workers retain rights to safe work, fair pay under applicable law, association, representation, grievance, nonretaliation, accommodation, and privacy. ILO Convention No. 155 provides a useful baseline for prevention, defined responsibility, consultation, and worker participation in occupational safety and health, while national labor law controls the enforceable route. A transparency institution should not treat workers as if their employment makes their whole lives recordable, and role records must remain proportionate to public function and distinct from participant records.

The fourth test concerns community health and safety. Traffic, construction, air and noise pollution, security operations, crowd activity, emergency demand, and hazardous materials can impose risk beyond the property line. Neighbors deserve the same health and safety standard as participants. Safety planning should include affected communities and public authorities rather than remaining a private security document.

A candidate site fails if the institution can operate only by narrowing rights, relying on exceptional waivers, or making remedies practically inaccessible.

5.2.3 — Public-Records and Privacy Compatibility

The City’s record architecture must fit the host jurisdiction rather than hover above it. Public-records duties, privacy rights, data-protection rules, evidence law, archival obligations, labor records, clinical confidentiality, legal privilege, child protection, security restrictions, and cross-border data rules may pull in

different directions. Site selection should identify those tensions before infrastructure makes one answer expensive to change.

A purpose-built campus may create a dense technical environment with cameras, sensors, access logs, communications systems, archives, and public interfaces under one operator. That can strengthen provenance and continuity. It can also concentrate sensitive data, increase breach consequences, and tempt the institution to treat technical capture as lawful authority. Legal review must establish the applicable authority at each stage of record use.

A leased or embedded model may place record systems inside buildings controlled by landlords, shared vendors, public institutions, or other tenants. Network equipment, physical access, maintenance, incident response, and backup custody can become legally and technically complex. Contracts must not be allowed to decide questions that belong to rights, law, and public accountability.

Record compatibility begins with purpose limitation. The site should identify which systems support active participant records, staff operations, visitors, security, building management, care, public access, research, and ordinary administration. Those systems should not merge merely because a vendor can connect them. Location, access, utility, and security data can reveal intimate patterns even when no camera image is public.

Compatibility also requires protected handling of incidental people. Neighbors near an entrance, contractors repairing equipment, delivery workers, emergency responders, visitors, protesters, and family members may appear in records. The law and the design should support masking, restricted access, correction, challenge, and deletion or sealing where applicable without creating an off-record route for active public-power formation.

Public-record status cannot be presumed from the City's self-description. Depending on jurisdiction, funding, delegation, function, and contractual form, different bodies and record classes may carry different disclosure, privacy, retention, and review duties. Those classifications belong to competent legal authority. The spatial charter can require only that each record class, custodian, access route, protected category, correction process, and appeal path be declared before collection begins.

The candidate site is ineligible when lawful record separation cannot be maintained, essential custody remains vendor-controlled, third-party rights cannot be protected, or record continuity and legal compliance pull in opposite directions without a defensible resolution. The practical response may be redesign, a different jurisdiction, narrower operations, or no site.

5.2.4 — Labor and Building Law

Labor and building law bring the City's moral language into contact with work that can injure, exhaust, displace, or silence people. Construction is not a neutral interval before the institution begins. Design decisions determine lifting, exposure, working at height, heat, noise, traffic, hazardous materials, shift length, emergency access, and the ability of workers to refuse unsafe conditions. The ILO Safety and Health in Construction Convention and Recommendation provide an international reference for preventive duties across design, planning, execution, and worker protection (International Labour Organization, 1988).

The legal route must identify the employer, principal contractor, subcontractor, site controller, designer, owner, and safety duty holder under applicable law. The International Labour Organization's revised construction code offers a

nonbinding review reference for prevention, clear responsibility, worker participation, and continuous improvement (International Labour Organization, 2022b). Complex contract chains can make responsibility disappear precisely when risk is highest. Procurement is unacceptable when the cheapest layer carries the most danger while the institution preserves distance from employment obligations.

Worker voice should enter before final plans. Construction workers and their representatives can identify unsafe sequencing, inaccessible welfare facilities, unrealistic schedules, material hazards, and maintenance traps that drawings conceal. Operating staff should review service routes, storage, cleaning access, waste movement, equipment replacement, night work, and emergency procedures. Participation is a design input, not a courtesy after tender.

Worker accommodation, where needed, should be designed as ordinary dignified housing rather than a second invisible settlement. Safety, privacy, sanitation, transport, freedom of movement, tenancy or occupancy clarity, and accessible grievance routes belong inside the labor plan. Migrant and temporary workers need special protection against tied housing, passport retention, debt dependence, and retaliation.

Building law also protects the future. Structural integrity, fire safety, ventilation, sanitation, energy systems, material health, seismic or wind requirements, and safe egress must be appropriate to local hazards and uses. A modular or temporary building is not exempt from life safety. A beautiful adaptive reuse is not acceptable if hidden conditions make workers or occupants unsafe.

Scheduling can transfer burden to neighbors and workers. Night construction may reduce daytime traffic while harming sleep. Accelerated delivery may create overtime and shortcuts.

Phased work may prolong noise, dust, access disruption, and uncertainty. The construction plan should explain who benefits from the schedule and who carries its cost.

Grievance and nonretaliation routes must reach through the contract chain. Workers should be able to report safety, wage, harassment, discrimination, environmental, or integrity concerns without losing employment or immigration security. Complaints should be logged, reviewed, and capable of stopping work. A hotline controlled only by the contractor is not independent remedy.

5.2.5 — Constitutional Deferral

The legal envelope should be adversarially tested before site enthusiasm hardens. Independent counsel, planning and environmental review, labor and accessibility expertise, privacy and public-records analysis, host representation, and rights review should be able to identify a fatal defect.

Site contracts need an explicit authority boundary. A lease governs possession, not the scope of lawful public records. Donor agreements cannot control admissions or governance. Host agreements remain subject to individual rights, and community-benefit agreements remain distinct from planning law and affected-rightsholder consent where required. The contract register should show what each instrument can decide, what it cannot decide, who reviews it, and where challenge or remedy begins.

Constitutional deferral requires status labels in public communication. A proposed site, pilot agreement, model covenant, or access rule should be described as candidate architecture under review. The language should not imply that the project has authority to certify leaders, alter eligibility, bind

governments, or create a new civic class. The host public deserves to know what has and has not been authorized.

The site process should include a legal stop gate. If constitutional or rights review finds that the institution's core burden cannot be carried lawfully, the answer is not to search for a weaker jurisdiction. The design must change, narrow, or stop. Jurisdiction shopping for lower protection would be a form of burden evasion.

A legal-envelope matrix should identify authority separately for land tenure, planning, construction, labor, accessibility, data, public records, health, emergency action, inspection, complaint, closure, and asset transfer. For each lane it records the responsible public body, governing instrument, required permission, evidence threshold, review trigger, appeal route, emergency exception, expiry, and unresolved condition. The matrix prevents permission in one domain from being misrepresented as authority in another. Conflicting claims of authority should remain unresolved until the lawful forum identifies which rule controls.

Accompany the legal-envelope matrix with a jurisdictional boundary map showing where public authority and private agreements operate, where no City actor has authority, and the consequences of losing a permission.

5.3 — Host-Community Burden and Local Legitimacy

The host-burden register should begin before site selection and continue through construction, operation, expansion, pause, and closure. It should cover land history, displacement, housing, utilities, transport, schools, health and emergency services, environmental effects, cultural meaning, security externalities, visitor and media pressure, construction disruption, workforce demand, public finance, and long-term maintenance. The register is not a score. It is a map of duties, evidence, uncertainty, owners, review dates, and remedy routes (Arnstein, 1969; Fung, 2006; Tyler, 2006; De Barbieri, 2016).

5.3.1 — Local Residents as Burden Bearers

Refusal must retain legitimacy. A resident, worker, tenant, rightsholder, local official, or community organization may oppose the project without being called anti-fairness, anti-science, anti-progress, or hostile to the wider series.

Local residents become burden bearers before construction begins. Rumor, land speculation, political attention, donor interest, security planning, and media curiosity can change a place while the project remains only a proposal. The City should therefore begin local engagement before announcing a preferred site, not after the narrative has made refusal seem destructive.

Residents are not one category. People closest to the site may face noise and traffic. Tenants may face rent pressure without receiving property compensation. Small businesses may gain customers or lose access. Disabled residents may experience route changes differently. People with limited language access, digital access, time, or political confidence may be least visible in formal meetings. The process should be designed around those differences (Bullard, 1990; Schlosberg, 2007; Tyler, 2006).

Community standing should not depend on proving individualized financial harm. Noise, public attention, cultural change, pressure on services, and loss of ordinary privacy can be real even when they are difficult to monetize. Standing can be structured by proximity, affected interest, service responsibility, rightsholder status, work relation, or demonstrated burden rather than by property ownership alone.

Early information includes genuine alternatives rather than a sales case for the preferred plan. Residents receive comparable accounts of campus, leased, distributed, embedded, phased, multi-site, and no-build options, with the same assumptions for cost, traffic, utilities, housing, labor, and environmental effects. The process becomes meaningful when people can change the form, scale, location, conditions, or decision itself.

Residents should be able to condition a proposal. Conditions may concern routes, hours, housing mitigation, public-service capacity, environmental monitoring, visitor limits, construction schedules, workforce standards, security boundaries, public access, or review clocks. The project should not present mitigation as generosity. Conditions are part of the burden allocation that makes authorization intelligible.

Host participation also needs conflict disclosure. Landowners, officials, nonprofit partners, universities, contractors, donors, and community organizations may have financial or institutional interests in the outcome. Those interests do not disqualify a voice, but undisclosed alignment can distort local legitimacy as readily as concealed opposition funding. The decision file should state relevant interests, funding relationships, and representative roles so readers can distinguish participation from undisclosed influence.

5.3.2 — Housing and Traffic Effects

Participation has consequence when affected people can shape alternatives, conditions, monitoring, and remedy while change is still possible. That requires understandable materials, independent expertise, accessible and non-digital routes, conflict disclosures, time, continuing engagement, and a public account of what changed and why. UN-Habitat's planning guidance, the Habitat Professionals Forum's International Participatory Charter, and the World Bank's ESS10 provide useful reference points for inclusive participation, timely disclosure, responsive grievance, and lifecycle influence (UN-Habitat, 2015; Habitat Professionals Forum, 2024; World Bank, 2017b). None of them turns attendance, a survey, or a meeting into automatic legitimacy.

Housing effects can begin with expectation. Speculation may raise land prices before workers or participants arrive. Owners may convert long-term housing to short-term accommodation. Landlords may market proximity to the City as prestige. Staff demand may compete with local households. A site assessment should therefore establish a housing baseline and monitor change from announcement through operation.

Purpose-built participant housing may reduce ordinary-market competition but consume land and create an enclave. Leased housing may be easier to relinquish yet remove existing units. Staff housing supports late shifts while deepening employer dependence. Commuting protects housing supply but increases transport burden. Each option shifts cost, distance, security, and choice.

Displacement includes more than formal eviction. Rent increases, loss of informal use, redevelopment pressure, landlord harassment, conversion of local services, and changes in tax or insurance costs can force people out without one compulsory

acquisition. Human-rights guidance on adequate housing and involuntary resettlement offers relevant reference points for secure tenure, genuine consultation, notice, alternatives, and remedy (Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, 1991; World Bank, 2017a).

Where housing pressure remains, mitigation must be specific, funded, and reviewable. Depending on local law and evidence, tools may include workforce-housing support, preservation of affordable units, anti-displacement funds, transport benefits, restrictions on short-term conversion, or public investment selected through lawful local processes. No universal package fits every host. Project-created costs remain the project's responsibility and must not be transferred to households least able to absorb them.

Transport planning must follow actual daily chains rather than a ceremonial traffic count. Construction shifts, safe school routes, care visits, deliveries, emergency and disability access, public transit, cycling, walking, protest, media events, and late-night service work create different peaks and hazards. Event demand must not consume emergency space or make ordinary routes unsafe. When the project adds load, it should fund the capacity, safety, mitigation, and monitoring needed to carry that load rather than leaving the host to absorb it.

Monitoring should compare traffic models, parking plans, housing forecasts, and visitor assumptions with observed effects. Review clocks, public data, complaint records, and trigger thresholds should require correction when reality diverges. Temporary relief may be needed before long-term infrastructure is completed.

A transit investment may improve the area while also increasing property pressure. Record those effects separately in the host-burden register.

5.3.3 — Services and Infrastructure Load

The City will rely on systems that already serve other people. Water networks, wastewater treatment, electricity, communications, waste collection, roads, transit, hospitals, clinics, fire services, policing, emergency management, schools, and public administration may all absorb demand. The project should not count these systems as free background simply because taxes or fees are paid.

A service-load assessment should identify existing capacity, planned demand, peak conditions, failure points, deferred maintenance, staffing shortages, and competing public needs. Average capacity is not enough. A system may appear adequate until heat, drought, storm, fire, epidemic, protest, or a major event produces simultaneous demand.

Utility agreements should state who funds connection, upgrades, redundancy, repair, and decommissioning. Priority service that weakens ordinary users during scarcity is unacceptable. Dedicated capacity may be justified for continuity, but it should not create a private island or leave the host responsible for stranded infrastructure if the pilot stops.

Public-administration load also matters. Planning staff, inspectors, privacy authorities, labor inspectors, courts, record offices, environmental agencies, and local councils may spend substantial time reviewing and monitoring the site. Application fees may not cover complex oversight. The project should fund lawful review without purchasing favorable decisions or creating dependency.

Infrastructure benefits should be separated from project need. An upgraded water line, road, transit service, communications link, or clinic may serve the host and deserve support. It may also have been required primarily because the project created

demand. Public reporting should show who paid, who benefits, who controls the asset, and what happens after closure.

Service agreements should include performance and review. Consumption, outages, emergency calls, response times, waste, maintenance, and public costs can be monitored without turning residents into data subjects. Trigger thresholds should require mitigation, reduced activity, or pause when local systems become strained.

The host agreement must plan for withdrawal. If the pilot closes, does the host inherit expensive infrastructure, unused buildings, debt, contaminated land, or reduced staffing elsewhere? Decommissioning and asset-transfer terms belong in the original agreement.

5.3.4 — Cultural and Political Spillover

The City will change the meaning of its location even if its physical footprint is modest. A place may become known internationally as the host of a controversial institution. Residents may encounter visitors who assume support, opponents who assume complicity, and media stories that reduce a complex community to the project. Cultural and political spillover begins when the site becomes a symbol.

Symbolic meaning should be assessed before selection. A capital city, border region, conflict-affected area, sacred landscape, university district, economically distressed community, Indigenous territory, former industrial site, military area, or climate-vulnerable region will communicate different stories. The project should not choose a place for symbolism while asking residents to carry the consequences.

Indigenous and customary relationships to land require more than cultural acknowledgment. Territory, water, sacred sites, governance, livelihood, memory, and future generations may be

legally and morally implicated. Local tradition cannot be borrowed as an aesthetic resource or tied to fairness without invitation, authority, and rights-sensitive review.

Cultural pressure can also arrive through design. Architecture, naming, ceremonies, landscaping, public art, and language may make the City look like a civilizational center or sacred headquarters. A host community may reasonably resist being recast as the birthplace, capital, or proving ground of a global movement.

Cultural benefit should be defined by the host, not announced by the project. Public space, education, art, landscape repair, archives, or local programs may be valuable, but they should not be used to claim gratitude. Communities may want material mitigation rather than symbolic partnership, or may prefer no association at all.

Media attention and civic tourism can change local life even when no building expands. Visitors may seek photographs, proximity to participants, symbolic access, or participation in a public narrative; nearby businesses may gain customers while residents lose quiet, parking, privacy, or control over neighborhood meaning. The host review should therefore track attention as an operating burden and redesign routes, hours, visitor capacity, and public interfaces when the burden grows.

The host should retain the right to describe the project in its own terms. Local journalists, scholars, organizations, critics, and residents should not be pressured to use official language. The City's public materials should distinguish the institution from the host so that neither praise nor failure is assigned to everyone who lives nearby.

Political and cultural effects require continuing review because symbolism changes. A modest pilot may later become globally prominent. A donor event, controversy, public appointment,

security incident, or replication debate may transform attention quickly. Agreements should include review when scale or meaning changes, not only when buildings expand.

5.3.5 — Host Complaint and Review

A host complaint system should accept concerns from residents, tenants, workers, businesses, public agencies, visitors, community organizations, rightsholders, and others with a plausible affected interest. Standing begins with plausible exposure, including cumulative or indirect harm, rather than proof of completed injury. No applicant should have to disclose a worldview.

Complaints should receive a visible lifecycle. Acknowledgment, classification, immediate safety action, investigation, response, remedy, appeal, closure, and follow-up should have stated clocks. Complex matters may take time, but delay should produce explanation rather than silence. Ongoing harm may require interim relief while facts are reviewed.

Independence matters. Routine operational issues may be resolved locally, but complainants should have escalation to an ombuds function, host body, regulator, court, labor authority, privacy authority, or other independent route appropriate to the issue. The office that created the burden should not possess final authority over whether the burden exists.

The system should distinguish complaint from participation. A resident need not first attend consultations or accept benefits to preserve the right to remedy. Nor should a complaint be dismissed because the project was lawfully approved. Authorization permits activity under conditions; it does not erase later harm.

Record community benefits separately from complaint outcomes. A claimed offset for a rights violation or specific

injury must be a lawful remedy freely accepted by the affected person.

Review clocks prevent consultation from becoming a one-time performance. Housing, traffic, utilities, noise, security, local labor, procurement, complaints, environmental effects, and emergency capacity change over time. Each material condition needs a review date, responsible owner, affected-person access, escalation threshold, and consequence.

Complaint and review also require public memory. The record should show what was raised, how it was investigated, what remedy occurred, what deadlines were missed, and what remains contested. Public summaries should preserve privacy and legal limits while preventing recurring harm from being treated as a new surprise each time.

For siting and expansion decisions, host standing also requires early notice, a standing determination, access to relevant evidence, an opportunity to object or propose conditions, and a reasoned decision.

Objection has meaning only when it can change the decision. The response may revise the site boundary, reduce scale, add mitigation, fund independent monitoring, change visitor patterns, delay construction, narrow operations, reject expansion, or abandon the site (OECD, 2022b; World Bank, 2017b).

Remedy must match the burden. It may include restoration, compensation where lawful, service correction, protective conditions, labor repair, environmental remediation, access limits, operational pause, relocation, or closure. No community-benefit package may purchase silence.

Continuing standing survives approval, ownership transfer, leadership change, and public enthusiasm. The route remains open for cumulative effects, changed climate or utility

conditions, new evidence, recurring complaints, and expansion proposals.

5.4 — Proximity Without Overexposure

Reachability and protection form one design problem. Too much distance can shelter secrecy; too little can turn attention into siege. The site therefore distributes public approach, observation, protest, media, visitation, service, residence, and emergency access across distinct routes and time conditions. No single street, household, worker group, or protected zone should become the unpaid carrier of public curiosity.

5.4.1 — Near Enough for Accountability

Accountability requires practical nearness. A person harmed by the City should not need specialized transport, insider knowledge, expensive counsel, or a public campaign to reach the institution. Complaint, inspection, protest, visitor, media, and public-learning routes should be legible, affordable, accessible, and safe enough to use under ordinary pressure.

Accountability nearness also matters for emergency and legal systems. Courts, hospitals, emergency responders, inspectors, labor authorities, accessibility reviewers, and public administrators may need practical access.

Reachability must be tested for disability, language, cost, time, digital exclusion, and stress. An accessible route is not merely a compliant door. It includes transportation, signage, hearing and visual access, quiet support, human assistance, and a non-digital way to ask questions or challenge a decision.

Digital nearness also matters. The participant record site, public explanations, complaint systems, accessible formats, translation, and public reporting can reduce the need for constant physical access. But digital access must not replace all physical accountability. A civic institution that forms public power should be visible in both record and place.

The site should also support ordinary oversight visits. Inspectors, auditors, accessibility reviewers, labor reviewers, and emergency planners should be able to enter without elaborate performance.

5.4.2 — Far Enough From Harassment

Accountability does not make a participant permanently available. Staff need protected work and recovery, families and nonparticipants retain ordinary privacy, and neighbors should not live inside a permanent pressure zone. Harassment distance is therefore a positive design obligation: public concern receives clear routes, while ordinary people receive shielding, complaint channels, and rapid changes when attention becomes threatening.

Participants need protection from both enemies and admirers. Fan culture can be as distorting as hostility. A public-power seeker surrounded by constant praise may learn dependence on admiration. A participant surrounded by hostility may learn defensiveness or fear. The City's distance rules should protect formation from becoming reaction to the loudest external presence.

Protection should not be purchased through neighborhood securitization. The City should avoid outward-facing surveillance, routine identification of local residents, road closures without necessity, or police practices that make nearby people feel watched because the institution attracts controversy. Security externalities belong in host review and should narrow when the triggering risk passes.

Staff who operate systems, moderate platforms, maintain records, or provide care may become targets. Shield staff entrances, break areas, and service routes from personal pressure.

Distance from harassment should not become distance from critique. The distinction must be operationally clear. A protest with signs, chants, and harsh criticism may be lawful and important. A targeted campaign to expose a child, follow a clinician, or threaten staff is not critique. The site should help security make that distinction without overreaction.

Distance from harassment should be designed into routes, not improvised through force. Setback, landscape, arrival sequencing, protected entrances, protest spacing, media staging, visitor scheduling, lighting, and emergency access can lower threat without turning the City into a bunker.

5.4.3 — Media Distance Discipline

Overexposure also extends beyond participants. Staff entrances, family visits, delivery routes, nearby homes, schools, shops, clinics, protest areas, and local streets can become part of the City's public image. The project should carry the crowds, cameras, traffic, and security it attracts rather than using the neighborhood as an unmanaged buffer (Jacobs, 1961; Whyte, 1980; Lynch, 1960; Gehl, 2010).

Narrative pressure makes a governed media perimeter necessary. Independent journalism cannot depend on institutional self-narration, yet constant visual access, stakeouts, selective filming, or harassment can turn public formation and surrounding life into content. The site should remain reportable and inspectable while protecting participants, staff, families, visitors, and neighbors from a permanent set.

The media-access protocol separates governed public record from journalistic capture. The official record site supplies contextual, correctable material with status and provenance; independent media remain free to investigate, question, compare, criticize, and interpret it. Access is assigned by public

purpose rather than pressure, friendliness, audience size, or spectacle value.

Media activity should carry its own spatial and operational cost. Queues, satellite vehicles, lighting, temporary structures, interviews, and breaking-news crowds belong where they can be managed without occupying sidewalks, blocking businesses, illuminating homes, or converting local streets into a permanent broadcast set.

Media distance should include local-media respect. National or global outlets may dominate attention, but local journalists often understand host burden better. Access rules should not privilege prestige outlets in ways that make local accountability weaker. The host community's press is part of the City's public environment.

Official communications must distinguish documentation from dramatization. Photographs, diagrams, renderings, tours, and videos produced by the City can create the same spectacle risk as outside coverage. Public-communication review should ask what an image omits, whether it invites voyeurism or shrine logic, how it treats workers and neighbors, and what correction or withdrawal route applies when the image misleads.

Press zones, briefing rooms, background materials, credential routes, complaint channels, and protected no-filming boundaries should exist before controversy begins.

Access may be tiered by safety, capacity, protected-person rights, and lawful process. Publish and review those criteria symmetrically.

5.4.4 — Visitor Approach Design

Visitor approach design turns public access into a sequence rather than an accident. A visitor should know before arrival what kind of access is possible, what record status applies, what

identification or screening is required, where they may go, how to request accommodation, how to submit questions or complaints, and how protected areas are shielded.

The public edge communicates ordinary lawful access through legible paths, seating, signs, shelter, and staff assistance. It should neither recruit nor intimidate visitors, and it should avoid prestige choreography that makes understanding feel like admission to a special order.

Public interface spaces should be close enough to be meaningful and bounded enough to be safe. A visitor may attend a briefing, submit evidence, ask a public question, meet a designated role, observe a lawful public area, or use the public record site interface. They should not be able to convert the campus into a scavenger hunt for private material.

Test visitor design under peak demand from large events, controversial hearings, diplomatic visits, school groups, protests, and viral public interest. Timed entry, remote participation, overflow plans, and event limits should keep parking, transit, toilets, accessibility support, security, and staffing within capacity while preserving lawful protest, language support, emergency access, and ordinary local movement. Queues must not block roads, overload transit, spill into residential streets, or create intimidation.

First contact carries an emotional burden. Visitors may arrive skeptical, anxious, angry, curious, confused, or shaped by earlier encounters with government, surveillance, neglect, or public shame. A legible entrance, calm welcome, non-digital help, and clear route to question or leave reduce fear without demanding trust in advance.

5.4.5 — Residential Shielding

The design should prefer layered access over either openness or closure. Public interfaces can be generous, records can be usable, criticism can be visible, and oversight can enter without turning residential, care, staff, or protected domains into public space.

A proximity plan should be tested under ordinary days and intense attention. Elections, scandal, protest, celebrity visits, emergencies, hostile campaigns, and viral media may change demand quickly.

Residential shielding protects the human interior of the City and the ordinary life around it. Participants live under the Vow without becoming public displays. Staff and families may live or move nearby without becoming record subjects by proximity. Layered access, quiet approaches, visitor schedules, camera limits, protected windows, and emergency routes make residence possible while keeping active public-power conduct inside the governed record.

Shielding begins with sightlines, sound, access, and circulation. Residential quarters should not be exposed to casual public view. Windows, paths, planting, setbacks, walls, lighting, and visitor routes should reduce unwanted visibility without creating a fortress atmosphere. Constant public noise, media presence, protest, or visitor circulation can make residence feel unsafe.

Shielding can resemble secrecy when its purpose is obscure. The City therefore explains that residential shielding protects dignity, sleep, care, and nonparticipant boundaries while the active record still follows public-power conduct. Evaluating formation does not require raw visual access to bedrooms or recovery spaces.

An independent challenge route makes shielding enforceable. Anyone exposed by a camera, visitor path, media position, drone

rule, event schedule, or security practice can seek rapid review without proving bad faith.

Attention changes, so shielding is reviewed after controversy, campaigns, events, or route changes. A quiet edge can become a media edge.

Residential shielding extends beyond the fence. Nearby homes cannot become background footage, drone scenery, parking spillover, crowd overflow, rumor territory, or an informal security buffer without notice, consent where legally required, complaint, and remedy. The City's visibility stops before it enters ordinary windows or converts domestic life into collateral public material.

Audit ordinary disturbance as well as formal privacy: light spill, noise, crowd drift, drones, parking, deliveries, patrols, and press behavior. People can feel watched without being recorded, and that atmosphere is a real burden.

Post-occupancy perimeter review combines resident reports, incident records, route observation, noise and light measures, privacy breaches, complaint outcomes, and repairs. Its purpose is not to suppress lawful presence. It detects when the City shifts its visibility burden onto nearby homes, workers, or public space and requires redesign before the transfer becomes normal. For a major public event, the host liaison should walk the perimeter with residents who choose to participate and compare the planned crowd and media routes with what actually occurs. The review should identify who can move a queue, redirect a camera position, or close an unauthorized observation point immediately. A resident should be able to report a repeated intrusion without revealing the household members affected.

5.5 — Climate, Utilities, and Physical Resilience

A responsible site is designed around the conditions most likely to interrupt ordinary operation. Water, energy, communications, transport, heat, smoke, fire, flood, storm, drought, seismic risk, landslide, public health, and emergency access differ by place and interact across systems. The relevant profile is therefore local, multi-hazard, and service-based. A sustainability label matters less than evidence that people can remain safe, essential functions can narrow gracefully, and the host is not left with the project's displaced risk.

5.5.1 — Water and Energy Burden

Water burden includes source reliability, drought risk, local rights, treatment capacity, wastewater handling, stormwater, landscape needs, emergency supply, and host-community competition. Include demand from restorative landscapes, housing, kitchens, clinics, and public facilities. If the host region is water-stressed, the City must justify every demand and reduce use before asking the place to carry it.

Energy burden includes ordinary consumption, record systems, cooling, heating, communications, lighting, kitchens, medical interfaces, emergency systems, cybersecurity, and data infrastructure. Energy demand carries cost, emissions, grid stress, backup requirements, and failure consequences.

Redundancy matters, but redundancy can also be burden. Backup power, storage, microgrids, fuel, batteries, generators, and load management each have costs and risks. Continuity cannot be purchased by exporting pollution, noise, fire risk, or fuel vulnerability to neighbors.

Resource analysis should use a host-wide balance rather than a project-only efficiency claim. On-site generation, storage, recycling, or conservation may reduce demand, but the plan

should also identify embodied cost, maintenance, emergency draw, seasonal scarcity, and who receives priority during shortage. The City is not resource-resilient if its continuity requires another user to lose basic service.

Campus design should address orientation, shade, passive cooling, insulation, efficient systems, water reuse, low-water landscapes, maintenance access, metering, public reporting, and emergency planning.

Water and energy planning should also include repair. Efficient systems that require rare parts, specialized vendors, or expensive service may become future burdens. These systems must remain maintainable under ordinary budgets and local capacity.

The rationing plan must be ethically ordered before scarcity arrives. If heat, drought, grid stress, or supply interruption requires reduction, the order of protection should be predeclared around life, clinical care, emergency systems, record integrity, staff safety, and host impact. Scarcity should not be governed by improvisation or institutional self-preservation.

5.5.2 — Climate Risk Review

Risk review joins exposure, vulnerability, capacity, consequence, and interdependence in one decision record. The Sendai Framework contributes a governance and preparedness lens, while the UNDRR Principles for Resilient Infrastructure add socially engaged, environmentally integrated, protected-by-design, and system-wide resilience tests. Local hazard maps, codes, engineering standards, public-health authority, and host knowledge still control the practical decision. The central question is whether the City produces a net resilience gain for the systems it joins rather than merely fortifying itself (IPCC, 2022; UNDRR, 2015, 2022; ISO, 2019).

Review heat, flood, fire, smoke, storm, sea-level rise, drought, freezing, wind, disease-vector shifts, and infrastructure fragility against the region's projected conditions. Identify implications for participants, staff, records, host communities, and emergency systems.

Distinguish acute disruptions, such as a flood, from cumulative changes in heat exposure, water competition, insurance, and maintenance cost. A site that is affordable today may become unsustainable over decades.

Climate risk is also unequal. Vulnerable host communities may already carry environmental burdens. Building the City there could bring investment, but it could also intensify displacement, infrastructure strain, or emergency competition. Climate-vulnerable land is not a bargain when its price reflects political weakness, neglect, or existing environmental burden. The burden account must include environmental justice.

Compound events reveal whether the plan understands systems or only hazards in isolation. Heat may coincide with grid failure, smoke with evacuation limits, flood with wastewater failure, or a storm with communications loss. Adaptation can also move risk outward: a wall redirects water, cooling raises peak demand, hardening blocks access, or vegetation increases fire exposure. The site decision therefore traces secondary effects beyond the property line and rejects any safety strategy that depends on exporting danger to the host.

Resilience may sometimes let the City reduce host burden during crisis through communications, coordination, shelter, supplies, or accessible space where lawful and jointly planned. Such capacity cannot be improvised as heroic self-narration. The host must help define the function, activation rule, priority order, resource limit, liability, and condition under which the City withdraws rather than competes with public responders.

Report future climate uncertainty through stated assumptions, review intervals, trigger points, adaptation budgets, retreat conditions, and the authority that can require redesign.

Crossing a defined hazard, insurance, evacuation, or utility threshold should trigger redesign, narrower operations, seasonal limits, or rejection of the site.

Climate risk should also affect insurance, financing, construction phasing, and long-term affordability. A site that is technically buildable but financially fragile under foreseeable hazard costs may become a future abandonment problem.

5.5.3 — Communications Redundancy

Graceful degradation is a design requirement. Essential care, life safety, protected records, communications, access, water, sanitation, and exit should remain possible when one or more systems fail. Continuity does not mean that every program continues unchanged. It means that people remain protected, degraded status is explained, manual authority is named, and the institution can narrow or pause without hiding the loss of capacity.

Communications failure can prevent the City from explaining status, preserving record continuity and integrity, contacting families, coordinating staff, care, and emergency response, reporting breaches, maintaining public and affected-person access, or distinguishing emergency from concealment.

Redundancy should include multiple communication pathways, backup power for communications, secure internal networks, external reporting channels, emergency alerts, accessibility formats, translation support, staff communication, public status updates, and offline fallback protocols.

The archive gives communications redundancy special importance. Record capture may continue during a network

disruption while validation, remote backup, tamper alerts, public-site updates, and oversight notice are impaired. A communications plan should specify what continues locally, what pauses, which manual fallback applies, when status notices issue, and how later reconciliation identifies gaps without pretending uninterrupted service.

Communications redundancy must also protect privacy. Backup pathways can become weak pathways. Emergency channels may expose sensitive information. Redundant systems may create duplicate data, inconsistent logs, or vendor dependencies. Apply the role limits in Section 2.2 and the separate permissions in Section 2.3 to every backup pathway.

Host-community coordination belongs inside communications design. Local emergency responders, utilities, public officials, transportation providers, and affected neighbors may need status communication during disruption. Technical isolation is incompatible with physical reliance on the host. Redundancy should connect the City to lawful support systems without exposing protected information.

Redundancy should guard against informational inequality. If digital systems fail, participants, staff, visitors, host residents, families, emergency responders, and public users should not receive safety information according to status. The fallback system must be designed for the person least able to access the primary channel.

Communications planning should also include misinformation and impersonation. A City with high public attention will attract false alerts, fake records, deepfakes, spoofed messages, and rumor surges. Redundant channels must therefore include verification methods that are simple enough for the public to use under stress.

The plan must resolve conflicts between record continuity and urgent communication. During a crisis, safety and care messages to families, staff, visitors, host authorities, and the public may take priority over maintaining a complete public-facing data stream.

5.5.4 — Emergency Services Reach

Emergency services reach asks whether life can be protected before record formalities, public image, or institutional continuity. Medical response, fire response, evacuation, security incidents, weather emergencies, mental-health crises, family emergencies, infrastructure failures, and mass-casualty scenarios must be planned with the host systems that may respond.

Agreed emergency exception rules must allow responders to work without unnecessary privacy breach or procedural delay.

Emergency-services reach should be designed for varied bodies, senses, stamina, communication needs, medications, and mobility devices. Evacuation, alerts, shelter, transport, and clinical handoff need more than one sensory or movement pathway. A route is ready only when disabled users, support persons, and responders have tested it under time pressure and the resulting changes are recorded.

The host community should not be surprised by emergency demand. If the City may create unusual scenarios, such as media crowds, protests, cyber-physical incidents, participant overload, archive breaches, or security threats, host emergency systems should be prepared and supported.

Readiness itself has a public cost. Training, familiarization, equipment, mutual-aid planning, road access, drills, specialist response, and protected communication may require resources before any incident occurs. Capacity agreements should identify who pays, how frontline workers are consulted, and whether

preparedness for the City weakens ordinary obligations elsewhere.

Emergency services reach also requires practical familiarity before crisis. Responders should know the campus layout, protected nonvisibility zones, access bands, medical routes, family-contact procedures, hazardous systems, and record-sensitive areas without being absorbed into City ideology or public theater. This knowledge should be rehearsed, updated, and available across shifts so life protection does not depend on one relationship or one remembered tour.

Emergency routes should be rehearsed under realistic conditions. A sunny-day tour does not reveal whether a gate, corridor, elevator, bridge, security procedure, or records protocol will slow rescue in smoke, panic, flood, heat, or night confusion.

Emergency-service planning should include the public record consequences after the crisis, not during rescue. Once life is protected, the City should explain what happened, what failed, and what will change. Any disclosure that a record exists or is withheld must be safe and lawful.

5.5.5 — Resilience Before Beauty

Resilience must be assessed as a shared condition with the host. A private microgrid, water reserve, secure network, or protected route may strengthen continuity, but it may also consume scarce capacity, shift cost, or create priority during crisis. Resilience fails when the campus survives by weakening systems around it.

Resilience also includes the ability not to build. A site with unmanageable hazard, inadequate water, fragile emergency reach, severe host vulnerability, or adaptation costs that depend on future public subsidy may be unsuitable. The City should prefer a modest form in a safer setting to a dramatic form that turns foreseeable risk into someone else’s emergency.

Resilience before beauty is a governing rule for the first City. Beauty matters because human beings should not be formed in places that degrade the spirit. But beauty becomes false when it outruns water, energy, maintenance, climate risk, communications, emergency reach, accessibility, and staff sustainability.

Donor offers of iconic architecture, dramatic images, symbolic plazas, or named buildings remain subject to the gift and influence controls in Section 5.6.5.

Procurement, design review, fundraising, public presentations, and guided tours must all reveal this priority. Public-facing images should include maintenance work, staff routes, utilities, climate adaptation, accessibility, and host context so that effortless-city mythology cannot take hold.

Beauty can hide fragility, so resilience should be part of design review rather than a later correction. Glass, height, water features, grand atria, symbolic plazas, complex facades, and ceremonial approaches may increase heat load, maintenance cost, water demand, glare, security difficulty, accessibility burden, vendor dependence, or evacuation complexity. A proposal should lose standing when its visual impact depends on shifting these burdens to others.

The City can be beautiful through durability, clarity, shade, repairability, accessibility, proportion, material honesty, local fit, quiet, and the visible care of systems. Civic form is most convincing when it protects people after the weather turns, the power flickers, the crowd grows, and the first plan fails. Beauty that continues to serve is more demanding, and more humane, than spectacle that ages into obligation.

Rehearse compound failures identified in Section 5.5.2, including water interruption at high occupancy and a regional emergency that makes outside responders unavailable. The

exercise should identify the first endangered function, the people who cannot safely wait, the local systems on which the City depends, the resources it might draw away from the host, and the decision point for reducing occupancy or closing.

5.6 — Cost Discipline, Expandability, and Replicability

Cost discipline begins by replacing the opening budget with a whole-life account. Capital, labor, utilities, technology, security, care, host mitigation, accessibility, insurance, renewal, adaptation, decommissioning, and foregone alternatives all enter the decision. Maintenance and staff recovery are not optional future details, and closure is not free. The disciplined proposal shows when each cost appears, who carries it, which assumptions drive it, and how the institution changes course when those assumptions fail.

5.6.1 — Anti-Luxury Baseline

The anti-luxury baseline protects the City from confusing dignity with prestige. Participants, staff, visitors, and workers need safety, accessibility, quiet, light, thermal comfort, durable materials, decent food, humane rooms, and restorative landscape. They do not need opulence, scarcity theater, signature architecture, or materials chosen to signal civilizational importance.

Luxury is not defined only by price. A costly feature may be necessary for accessibility, resilience, climate performance, safety, or long-term maintenance. A cheap feature may impose discomfort, repair burden, energy waste, or staff labor for decades. The relevant question is whether the feature protects function and dignity or purchases image (Flyvbjerg, 2014; Kahneman, 2011).

Public areas should resist spectacle. Grand arrival sequences, monumental halls, donor walls, ceremonial staircases, and overdesigned record spaces can turn public access into awe. Architecture that induces reverence may weaken the equality the institution claims to serve.

Landscape should also remain functional. Shade, water management, biodiversity, walking, recovery, and noise control can justify investment. Decorative water use in a scarce region, imported planting that demands heavy maintenance, or large lawns that signal abundance may externalize environmental cost.

The baseline should be published as criteria rather than a universal aesthetic. Local materials, climate, culture, accessibility, maintenance skill, and existing buildings will shape different answers. A restrained building in one region may be expensive or inappropriate elsewhere.

Anti-luxury review should include lifecycle cost and replacement. A complex mechanical system may reduce energy while increasing dependence on proprietary maintenance. The City should prefer understandable, repairable, and locally supportable systems where performance allows.

The baseline also protects the host from symbolic comparison. Participant conditions that substantially exceed nearby schools, clinics, worker housing, or public spaces require a clear functional justification. Necessary differences should be explained, shared benefits should be pursued where feasible, and prestige should never be staged beside ordinary deprivation.

5.6.2 — Expandable Modules

Expandable modules allow the City to learn without pretending that its first plan is final. Housing, formation rooms, staff space, archive capacity, public interface, utilities, recovery, and service systems may need to change after real use.

Expansion is earned through a noncompensatory gate. Existing spaces must remain fit for purpose; staffing must remain sustainable; host conditions and utility margins must remain intact; and maintenance must be funded. Material failures of rights, accessibility, safety, labor protection, complaint handling,

or record continuity must be corrected and independently verified before expansion. Lesser defects may remain under a dated corrective plan only when reviewers show that they do not breach a prerequisite.

Modules should preserve independent functions at every phase. Participant growth cannot displace care space, staff rest, public access, emergency routes, accessibility, maintenance staging, or protected nonvisibility. Phasing is credible only when each occupied stage is complete enough to be humane and safe on its own, rather than relying on promises attached to a final build that may never arrive.

Host review must accompany expansion. More participants or facilities may change traffic, housing, utilities, security, media attention, and service demand even without new land. Material changes should trigger updated information, participation, conditions, and remedy routes.

Modularity should avoid vendor lock-in as carefully as it avoids construction excess. Proprietary building systems, access controls, communications, energy systems, or prefabricated units can make later change dependent on one company’s prices, permissions, or continued existence. Interoperability, repair documentation, spare parts, local skill, data portability, and credible vendor exit should therefore be assessed alongside speed, convenience, and initial cost.

Modularity can mean safe connections, adaptable dimensions, separable systems, demountable partitions, honest utility margins, and the ability to return space as needs change. It should preserve local materials, codes, skills, climate fit, and repair capacity rather than impose a branded kit.

5.6.3 — Maintenance Affordability

Maintenance is the long memory of design. Roofs, drainage, cooling, heating, water, lifts, doors, sensors, networks, kitchens, landscape, accessibility features, fire systems, roads, and archives all require inspection, repair, replacement, and skilled labor. A building is not affordable until those obligations are funded across realistic cycles.

Lifecycle costing should include routine operations, preventive maintenance, major renewal, emergency repair, energy and water, software and licenses, cybersecurity, insurance, compliance, cleaning, waste, landscape, staff training, spare parts, and decommissioning. It should also include host mitigation, public-service agreements, and the cost of remedy when the institution causes harm.

Maintenance affordability is inseparable from labor dignity. Understaffing, deferred repair, unsafe shortcuts, unpaid on-call work, and contractor churn can make operating budgets look balanced while workers absorb deterioration. The City should fund adequate staffing, training, equipment, rest, and worker voice before it funds optional enhancement.

Accessibility requires maintenance too. Lifts, ramps, automatic doors, hearing systems, signage, lighting, accessible paths, digital interfaces, and emergency devices must remain functional.

Climate adaptation should be budgeted as an ongoing duty. Heat, smoke, flood, drought, storm, erosion, and changing insurance or code requirements may alter maintenance needs. The project should not assume that the host or future donors will fund foreseeable adaptation.

Public reporting should distinguish capital gifts from recurring capacity. A donated building may create permanent operating obligations. A vendor may provide introductory pricing that later

rises. A host may contribute infrastructure that requires public upkeep.

Affordability review makes its assumptions visible and tests them together. Asset life, inflation, energy and water prices, insurance, climate exposure, staffing, occupancy, vendor terms, technology refresh, and reserve levels may move in the same unfavorable direction. Scenario analysis therefore asks what happens when costs rise, donations fall, a major system fails, or planned expansion never occurs. A lifecycle budget is a range of survivable futures with declared decision triggers, not one optimistic total.

Dependence on unpaid devotion, perpetual fundraising, political favor, monopoly vendors, or repeated deferral means the form exceeds honest capacity. A smaller, leased, distributed, or simpler arrangement should replace it before prestige turns excess into obligation.

5.6.4 — Replicable Standards

Expandability is capacity for learning, not a growth target. Modular form may let the first pilot correct mistakes, but each addition also changes duties to hosts, staff, utilities, records, and governing bodies. A proposed expansion should therefore compare construction, operation, adaptation, and closure across realistic forms. Environmental life-cycle studies can draw on ISO 14040 and ISO 14044, with critical review under ISO 14071:2024 where appropriate. Those environmental standards do not establish financial affordability, fair labor conditions, or host consent; each requires its own lawful and independently reviewable evidence. The added capacity earns approval through its demonstrated function, not anticipated prestige (Flyvbjerg, 2014; ISO, 2006a, 2006b, 2024; Thomashow, 2014).

Replicable standards should distinguish an invariant layer from an adaptable layer. The invariant layer concerns rights and burden: adult voluntary entry, ordinary-citizen privacy, nonparticipant shielding, protected nonvisibility, real exit, staff dignity, host standing, lawful records, accessibility, complaint, remedy, maintenance, and stoppability. The adaptable layer concerns form: campus, embedded, distributed, leased, phased, or multi-site arrangements; materials, density, landscape, transport, energy, public interface, housing, route geometry, technology, and visual language. Replication preserves the first layer while allowing the second to respond to local law, climate, culture, land, and host preference.

Replicable standards need an alternatives analysis. A later proposal must explain why its chosen form imposes less combined burden than feasible leased, embedded, distributed, phased, or multi-site arrangements. One successful campus cannot establish campus necessity elsewhere. Every new site returns to the beginning of the comparison rather than inheriting an architectural presumption.

Replication should also require local expertise, affected-person knowledge, and visible disagreement. Plans should be reviewed by local planners, rights experts, workers, disability organizations, emergency services, host residents, environmental specialists, and relevant Indigenous or customary rightsholders where applicable. Central approval cannot substitute for knowledge of place, and consultation cannot be treated as complete merely because a meeting occurred.

Interoperability should not become central control. Record standards, status labels, audit methods, and public interfaces may need compatibility, but local institutions should not feed a global dossier or submit to an unreviewable City authority. Network

learning must preserve record separation, jurisdiction, and local remedy.

Failure information must travel with success. Later sites should receive incident records, host complaints, labor problems, cost overruns, accessibility failures, design changes, donor conflicts, closure plans, and rejected alternatives.

5.6.5 — Donor-Prestige Controls

Donor-prestige controls protect the site from being purchased in the language of generosity. A donor may sincerely support the project and still seek naming, design influence, proximity, speed, access, symbolic ownership, preferred vendors, favored applicants, or association with future public power. The City should govern those pressures before a gift makes refusal difficult.

No donation should influence admissions, participant pathways, staff appointments, public access, archive access, complaint outcomes, site review, formal standing, or governance. The rule applies to written conditions and to softer expectations conveyed through relationships, events, advisers, naming opportunities, or future funding.

Design gifts deserve the same scrutiny as money. A donor may offer land, architecture, art, landscaping, technology, or a building at no purchase price. The gift may carry high maintenance, climate mismatch, inaccessible features, vendor dependence, symbolic burden, or conditions that narrow host choice. Some free assets are too expensive to accept.

Procurement should prevent donors from steering vendors, receiving indirect returns, or converting philanthropy into a private supply chain. Review should cover beneficial ownership, conflicts, pricing, data rights, labor practices, maintenance, subcontracting, performance history, and vendor exit. A

donor-connected company should gain no advantage from urgency, gratitude, personal access, or threatened withdrawal of funding.

The strongest control is the ability to refuse, return, or restructure a gift. Governance should include reserve planning, diversified funding, public conflict records, and decision rules that allow the project to delay construction rather than accept capture.

Refusal should be publicly explainable without becoming performance. The public can learn when gifts were declined, conditions changed, names removed, or designs simplified, while lawful confidentiality remains protected. That record distinguishes financial need from ownership and shows future sites what anti-capture costs in practice.

Donor review should continue after acceptance because influence can arise through renewal, rescue funding, social access, crisis support, media defense, or relationships with participants and officials. Periodic conflict review, access logs, governance disclosure, and external audit may remain necessary even when the original gift was clean.

Chapter 6 — The City’s Spatial Order

Architecture is often praised as though beauty makes it innocent. A civic institution formed around public responsibility cannot accept that innocence. A wall, corridor, threshold, stair, waiting area, or room allocates time, access, exposure, influence, and retreat. Built form decides who can approach, who waits, who is seen, who is protected, who can object, who can leave, and who carries the cost of everyone else's design choices (Lefebvre, 1991; Hillier and Hanson, 1984; Markus, 1993; Dovey, 1999; Sennett, 2018).

One continuous plane of exposure would be injury, not transparency. One continuous plane of concealment would restore hidden influence. The City therefore needs visibility gradients and access bands because roles, records, bodies, emergencies, and rights change across thresholds. The design challenge is to make those differences legible without turning them into caste.

Movement is one of the City's most revealing moral surfaces because influence often travels before it becomes a formal decision. Side entrances, unmarked waiting rooms, privileged shortcuts, service paths, informal pauses, and late-night exceptions can carry power precisely because their status is uncertain. Spatial order makes consequential movement interpretable through declared routes, access purposes, threshold memory, and review. It does so without turning ordinary walking, care, rest, or staff life into performance.

A coherent plan, distinctive landmarks, and consistent naming complement the multimodal wayfinding supports developed in Section 6.4 (Lynch, 1960; Arthur and Passini, 1992; Jamshidi et al., 2020).

Sensory atmosphere must be governed with the same seriousness. Light, sound, materials, scale, texture, temperature, glare, echo, crowding, and refuge shape the body before the

mind has time to argue. A building that is overlit may turn accountability into interrogation. A building that echoes may make deliberation feel like exposure. A building that resembles a detention facility may tell the nervous system that the Vow is captivity even when the law says it is voluntary.

The governing answer is a spatial charter. It does not choose exact dimensions, materials, vendors, jurisdiction, or professional drawings. Those remain for expert design, legal review, host negotiation, safety and accessibility review, budget discipline, and later pilot gates. The charter supplies the burden grammar any credible plan must satisfy: who carries visibility, who is protected from collateral exposure, how movement can be reconstructed, how staff labor is dignified, and how an affected person can understand and challenge the place.

The chapter advances through six linked design problems. Architecture first becomes practical constitutional meaning by assigning access, shielding, burden, recordability, and civic tone. Visibility gradients distinguish public, participant, staff, protected, emergency, and oversight bands without converting them into rank. Thresholds and corridors become anti-shadow infrastructure; wayfinding becomes civic clarity; light, sound, materials, and refuge become human-load architecture; and the final movement asks how gravity can be created through competence and care rather than fear, shrine logic, or luxury enclosure.

6.1 — Architecture as Constitutional Meaning

Architecture does not replace law. Its narrower power is practical: built form can make rights usable or exhausting, public access meaningful or theatrical, protected life secure or trapped, staff work visible or hidden, and emergency response possible or delayed. Constitutional and legal authority remain where law places them; the spatial question is whether the room, route, or threshold helps people exercise those rights in practice. If a protected room is poorly placed, it may become a hidden influence channel.

6.1.1 — Space Assigns Burden

A spatial decision register should record why a major spatial choice was made, which burdens it was expected to move, which groups were consulted, which alternatives were rejected, which risks remain, and when the choice will be reviewed.

A burden map should accompany every major spatial proposal. It should ask who walks farther, who waits longer, who is seen more, who can avoid being seen, who must pass through security, who receives help, who can complain, who cleans, who repairs, who absorbs noise, and who bears failure.

A governing distribution rule follows: burdens created by public-power formation should fall first on the institution and on adults who voluntarily carry the Transparent Vow, not by accident on ordinary citizens, children, families, staff, or host neighbors. Staff still carry real work and risk, but those burdens must be recognized, limited, compensated, resourced, and reviewable rather than hidden behind participant visibility.

The first burden is time. A distant complaint office, a long security queue, an elevator that routinely fails, or an inaccessible route converts minutes and uncertainty into unequal access. Spatial review should therefore count waiting, detours, repeated

explanations, and failed trips as institutional burdens rather than personal inconvenience.

The second burden is attention. People under active record already manage unusual visibility, while staff, visitors, families, critics, and affected people may need to navigate rules they did not design. A fair spatial order does not make each person continuously calculate whether a door, camera, hallway, or pause will be misread.

Require a burden map at schematic design, design development, construction documentation, post-occupancy review, and replication. Update the ethical review whenever the map changes. A corridor widened for visitor flow, a room relocated for efficiency, or a facade altered for beauty can all shift burden.

The burden analysis should identify decision owners and repair routes. When a queue, corridor, room assignment, checkpoint, or schedule produces recurring harm, the affected person needs more than a general complaint address. The City should name who can change the design, what evidence triggers review, how interim relief works, and when the correction is checked again.

This burden statement should be tested under ordinary days and stress days. A calm tour will not reveal what happens during protest, medical emergency, media pressure, staff shortage, power outage, or participant breakdown.

Anticipate how wear and changing use will alter the spatial burden: worn hinges, failed lifts, confusing signs, glare from new screens, and overloaded corridors all require review.

6.1.2 — Space Creates Access

The access map should distinguish role and purpose. A citizen seeking a public record bundle does not require the same route as

a clinician, an auditor, a family member, a staff operator, an emergency responder, or a participant returning from an external corridor.

Access also creates influence. The person who can reach a participant repeatedly may shape public-power formation. The donor who can enter through a side room may become a hidden actor. The volunteer who can bypass queue discipline may become informal staff. The architecture must treat repeated access as a source of power, not as a convenience.

Access must be differentiated without becoming exclusionary in spirit. Some rooms should be public, some participant-only, some staff-only, some professional, some protected, some emergency-only, and some oversight-accessible. The ethical question is whether each restriction has a reason that can be stated, logged, reviewed, and challenged where appropriate.

Access should be evaluated as a sequence rather than a door. Arrival, identification, waiting, explanation, movement, encounter, record, support, complaint, and exit form one continuous burden path. A person who can enter but cannot orient, communicate, rest, understand a status, or leave independently does not yet have meaningful access. User testing should follow the entire route and reverse design choices that fail it.

6.1.3 — Space Creates Shielding

Continue review after occupation: annual audits should test whether informal habits have changed the building’s access, shielding, or working conditions.

The strongest shielding rule is that protection cannot become a hidden channel for active public-power conduct. Legal counsel, clinical care, family contact, and protected recovery need real privacy. Strategy, donor influence, party direction, staff

manipulation, and consequential deliberation need the governed record. Declared purpose, access control, transition logs, independent review, and correction keep those functions separate without dissolving either privacy or answerability.

Legible shielding tells people why a space is protected, who may enter, and how its boundary can be challenged. A shielding audit records the purpose, protected class, access rule, necessary logging, responsible reviewer, and review date. Public explanation describes the category at a safe level; it does not expose the person, visit, or content being protected. Medical confidentiality, legal counsel, family life, staff privacy, and security restrictions retain their distinct rules.

Shielding must remain reviewable and correctable without becoming publicly penetrable. If a protected boundary is alleged to hide improper influence, the review route should already exist. An authorized reviewer can inspect access logs, purpose classifications, time windows, custodial decisions, and the basis for nonrelease without exposing the protected content itself.

6.1.4 — Space Creates Recordability

Poorly placed rooms and ambiguous thresholds can make record status intelligible only to insiders; cameras, sensors and logs alone cannot correct that. Design the record boundary into the space: deliberation halls should identify public-purpose roles and materials; drafting rooms protect rough revision; staff routes show consequential influence without exposing private life; and protected zones identify their category without revealing their contents.

Spatial recordability also helps prevent false accusation. When paths and rooms are legible, a participant is less likely to be accused of secret conduct because the environment can show

lawful protected handling, emergency status, staff access, or public-interface closure.

A deliberation room needs clear entry states, interpretable seating, stable audio, visible document surfaces, secure equipment, contextual labels, and defined privacy exceptions. A protected room needs equally clear purpose, access, transition, and oversight rules. The architecture should make the correct record state easier to follow than an improvised exception.

Poorly placed cameras, microphones, sensors, or logs can create noise, expose the wrong people, invite abuse, or make users perform for the apparatus. Assess capture by whether the relevant event can be reconstructed with integrity.

Recordability also requires human interpretability. A technically captured event may still be useless if the room context is unclear, if sight lines distort who was present, if microphones cannot separate voices, if access metadata is missing, or if later viewers cannot tell whether a silence was choice, intimidation, technical failure, or protected withholding.

6.1.5 — Spatial Accountability and Civic Tone

If a public edge is too porous, public access may become intimidation. If service routes are invisible, labor burden disappears. If the archive path is obscure, oversight becomes dependent on insiders. Space shapes not only movement, but trust (Lefebvre, 1991; Hillier and Hanson, 1984; Markus, 1993; Dovey, 1999).

Apply a spatial accountability test. No major room, route, threshold, or access band should be approved until its burden, access, shielding, recordability, and civic tone can be described in ordinary language, assigned to responsible owners, and tested after occupation.

Every institution teaches through atmosphere before it teaches through curriculum. A courthouse, school, hospital, airport, prison, shrine, luxury hotel, and civic plaza each instruct the body differently. The Transparent City must know what it teaches by scale, material, path, light, sound, waiting, entry, and public edge. The first lesson of the City should be seriousness without fear.

Materials, proportions, thresholds, and public edges should therefore avoid both intimidation and flattery. A calm entrance may do more civic work than a monumental gate. A modest deliberation hall may teach better public reason than a grand chamber. A warm staff area may reveal the City's ethics more deeply than a spectacular public facade.

A civic-tone review should involve participants, staff, disability reviewers, critics, host-community representatives, and ordinary visitors, not only architects and donors. Each group should be asked what the place teaches the body about power. If the answers include fear, reverence, elite comfort, confusion, or performance, the tone needs correction.

The tone review should continue after occupancy because buildings change through use. A room intended as calm may become intimidating when security gathers there. A public edge intended as welcoming may become fan culture during high attention.

The review asks designers, lawyers, operators, disability reviewers, civil-liberties reviewers, clinicians, archivists, security staff, and public representatives to read the same plan from different burden angles. A corridor is an access question for one expert, a record question for another, a security question for another, a fatigue question for another, and a dignity question for the person who must walk it under pressure.

Every design stage should include a user-burden walkthrough. Designers should walk the plan as a participant, staff member, disabled visitor, critic, journalist, family member, clinician, auditor, maintenance worker, emergency responder, host resident, and ordinary citizen.

A walkthrough is an early conflict detector, not an approval ritual. The shortest emergency route may disrupt protected dignity; the clearest public route may increase participant exposure; the warmest material may raise maintenance cost; and the most secure entrance may frighten ordinary visitors. Design improves when those conflicts are named, assigned, tested, and revised before construction hardens them into routine.

6.2 — Visibility Gradients and Access Bands

The visibility bands distinguish public explanation from participant work, staff function from whole-life exposure, protected care from off-record influence, emergency movement from permanent exception, and oversight access from prestige. Visibility bands are operational regimes, not labels pasted onto rooms. Before any permanent floor plan is approved, the access-band operating charter should identify each band's purpose; ordinary users, lawful visitors, and prohibited users; capture status and record expectations; access and escort rules; release rules; emergency override; retention and correction; and oversight, complaint, and timed review routes. Band changes should be rare, documented, and publicly explainable at the right level.

6.2.1 — Public Band

Public band-map legends should identify role, purpose, risk, and duty without presenting access as social rank.

The public band is the part of the City where citizens, visitors, critics, educators, journalists, and lawful public participants may approach the institution without entering active participant life. It should be visible, legible, accessible, and bounded.

A fair public band includes orientation spaces, public learning interfaces, record-site access points, complaint routes, visitor reception, exhibit-like explanations of rules, and places where citizens can ask questions without becoming surveillance subjects. It should teach people how to read the City's boundaries before they encounter participants, records, or protected zones.

A public-band audit should track how a first-time visitor learns the City's purpose, boundaries, complaint routes, public record interface, and nonparticipant protections. The audit should

include visitors who are skeptical, disabled, linguistically diverse, anxious, elderly, young adults, and unfamiliar with civic institutions.

Citizens should know what they may do there: learn, inspect, request records, attend public explanations, file complaints, observe designated proceedings, ask questions through lawful channels, protest in appropriate places, and leave without being enrolled in anything.

This band should be tested against four forms of capture: spectacle capture by crowds and media, security capture by overguarding, donor capture by prestige entrances, and insider capture by social codes only supporters understand.

6.2.2 — Participant Band

The participant band is where active public-power formation occurs. It includes learning, deliberation, drafting, daily rhythm, mentoring, public-interface preparation, and role-specific formation under the Transparent Vow. This band carries the strongest record burden because participants have voluntarily accepted the active role.

Separate the participant band's study and work routes from rest, private movement and recovery. Test whether room placement and sight lines create continuous staging or permit consequential role meetings to bypass declared record rules.

Access to the participant band should be role-bound. Educators, mentors, staff, clinicians, auditors, security, and authorized visitors may need entry for defined purposes. Donors, fans, partisan actors, curious visitors, and unbounded media should not receive access simply because participants are public-power seekers. The City must treat access to participants as influence, not hospitality.

6.2.3 — Staff Band

The staff band protects the people who make the City work. It includes operations, teaching preparation, moderation, food service, cleaning, maintenance, archive administration, security coordination, technical support, staff rest, and complaint channels.

Material influence, safety decisions, access control, records handling, and participant-facing advice may need traceability. Off-duty life, ordinary bodily needs, private relationships, and rest do not become public simply because a person works in the City.

Staff movement deserves the same design dignity as participant and public routes. Service corridors, break rooms, maintenance access, changing space, rest areas, and staff entrances should be safe, direct, legible, ventilated, accessible, and free of symbolic inferiority. When public-facing beauty depends on cramped back routes, concealed exhaustion, or humiliating entry, the architecture has shifted burden downward.

Staff complaint and appeal must not depend on the authority being challenged. Record misuse, overexposure, misconduct, donor pressure, security excess, or unsafe load can remain invisible when reporting requires permission from the problem's owner. Location, confidentiality, language access, and independent escalation determine whether a channel works.

Separation among staff roles matters. Clinicians, educators, security, archivists, operators, maintenance workers, and mentors should not all share the same informal channel into participant life. Role separation prevents one staff ecology from becoming a hidden government inside the City. Architecture can support that separation by giving roles distinct but connected zones.

A staff-band audit should be conducted with staff and examine workload, travel distance, exposure, rest, safety, role duties, privacy, influence risk, independent complaint, and the ability to refuse improper requests.

6.2.4 — Protected Nonvisibility Band

The protected nonvisibility band includes spaces for clinical care, legal counsel, crisis de-loading, intimacy and modesty, grief, optional worship or reflection, and sensitive third-party protection.

Limit entry to role, need and lawful purpose. Collect an identifiable access or category record only when separately necessary, lawful and safe; a protected room does not itself justify a visit log. Restrict any necessary metadata to the reviewer who needs it, and use safe aggregate assurance or no person-specific public entry when disclosure could expose an encounter. Apply the existence-protection rule in Section 2.1.5.

The band also protects nonparticipants who enter the City for limited reasons. A child, partner, family member, clinician, lawyer, clergy member, emergency responder, or affected person may need shielded movement. The architecture must prevent their path from becoming participant record exposure.

The protected band should also include appeal and challenge pathways. Participants and affected persons need a way to contest underprotection, overprotection, mistaken categorization, or delayed release decisions.

6.2.5 — Emergency Band

The emergency band exists because life, safety, and continuity sometimes require movement that ordinary bands cannot handle. Fire, medical crisis, security incident, family emergency, technical failure, weather event, threat, or evacuation may

require rapid crossing, temporary confidentiality, specialized access, and altered record handling.

Emergency access must be designed before emergency arrives. Routes should be clear, accessible, redundant, and legible to responders who may not know the City's internal culture. Protected nonvisibility rules, participant status, staff roles, public access, and archive protection all have to survive crisis.

Emergency routes cannot become permanent licenses for shadow conduct. Every exceptional path needs a declared trigger, a log, review, and a rule for returning to ordinary authority. Some details may require delayed disclosure, but later accountability should survive wherever law and safety permit.

Emergency design must include nonparticipants from the start. Medical responders, family members, visitors, neighbors, and others who never accepted the Vow need protected routes, minimal capture, clear status, and rapid correction when incidental recording occurs. Life-safety movement can be documented later at the level necessary for review without folding every person in the evacuation path into the participant record.

An emergency-band audit should simulate fire, medical crisis, security event, infrastructure failure, severe weather, and family emergency with participants, staff, visitors, disabled users, and outside responders.

Emergency-band planning should include degraded technology. Fire alarms, backup power, access-control failure, communications loss, elevator outage, network interruption, smoke, flooding, or hostile disruption can make normal systems unavailable. The City cannot rely on ideal digital permissions in the moment when bodies need help. Physical cues, mechanical overrides, trained staff, non-digital maps, accessible refuge, and after-action logging must be part of the emergency architecture.

6.2.6 — Oversight Band and Access-Band Audits

The band map should be readable at three levels: public explanation, operational detail, and protected oversight. The public level tells citizens why different zones exist. The operational level tells staff how access works. The protected oversight level allows reviewers to examine disputed boundaries without exposing protected content.

The oversight band allows independent inspection without public overexposure, but access follows each office's lawful function. Auditors, external inspectors, rights reviewers, technical specialists, and safety reviewers may need controlled routes to protected evidence under defined authorities. The informal ombuds needs confidential meeting space, safe contact routes, and access to voluntarily supplied information within its charter; the band itself does not grant that office a general investigative query power. Secure rooms and case-limited permissions make both forms of help possible without merging informal assistance with binding review.

Oversight must be spatially protected from both performance and capture. If reviewers are always escorted through curated public paths, inspection becomes theater. If they receive unbounded access without role discipline, oversight becomes voyeurism. The oversight band should let reviewers reach records, spaces, staff, participants, and systems according to defined powers, not according to charm or institutional favor.

The band should include workrooms, secure review stations, interview rooms, protected evidence access, complaint routes, and independent entry where appropriate. These spaces must be close enough to inspect the institution and separate enough to prevent the institution from controlling the reviewer's entire experience.

Independence in the oversight band is tested when a reviewer requests evidence. An auditor or inspector with authority to examine a protected item must be able to reach the permitted record without the office under review selecting the material or supervising its interpretation. A protected log records the request, authority, scope, any refusal, and the route for challenging obstruction. A fictional-case walkthrough should test both the formal inspection route and the informal ombuds route defined above, without exposing complainants or weakening lawful access restrictions.

The oversight band should allow participants, staff, visitors, host neighbors, and nonparticipants to speak with reviewers without leadership presence. Protected interview routes should therefore be available without requiring the reviewed office to arrange or witness the contact. Preserve identifiable scheduling metadata only when separately necessary, lawful, and safe under Section 2.1.5, with access limited to the authorized review function. Keep protected contact metadata and interview substance outside the reviewed office unless the governing process lawfully permits disclosure, and preserve the distinct confidentiality rules for informal ombuds contact.

Formal inspection access must be logged, limited, and reviewable. Conflict disclosures and access logs should make the reviewer's own use of privileged space visible to later audit. A reviewer who exceeds the declared purpose should face the same correction and access-restriction mechanisms that govern other privileged users.

Track routing delays across reviews so a pattern of obstruction cannot hide behind individually plausible scheduling decisions.

If a protected zone quietly expands, the City may be hiding influence. If a public zone quietly expands, the City may be exposing the wrong people. If a staff zone shrinks, labor may be

absorbing institutional growth. If an emergency route becomes routine, crisis logic may be normalizing itself.

Access bands should also be stress-tested against social power. Donors, famous visitors, former officials, founders, media figures, party leaders, relatives, experts, and charismatic participants may create pressure to bend the map. A fair band system works precisely when a socially powerful person wants an exception.

Band audits should include people who dislike the City. Friendly reviewers may accept explanations too quickly. Skeptics will ask whether protected bands hide favoritism, whether participant bands become punishment, whether staff bands conceal labor, and whether public bands perform openness. Their questions should be welcomed because band legitimacy depends on surviving suspicious reading.

6.3 — Thresholds, Corridors, Anti-Shadow Flow

A threshold marks a change in status. It may be a door, gate, vestibule, desk, access check, floor transition, lighting change, acoustic shift, sign, or digital confirmation. In the City, thresholds are civic instruments because they tell people when duties, recording conditions, access rights, or emergency rules change. Participants, staff, visitors, auditors, clinicians, journalists, and responders should encounter the same core clarity: what this boundary means, why it exists, and where to ask, refuse, appeal, or turn back.

6.3.1 — Threshold Clarity

Band transitions should include pause points where people can confirm consent, ask questions, adjust support, or refuse entry. A threshold crossed too quickly can cause accidental exposure. A threshold crossed under crowd pressure can become coerced movement. The City should use small spatial pauses to let people understand what changes before the change happens.

A clear threshold assigns each person a usable route. Participants receive advance notice before entering public-interface space; visitors encounter unmistakable cues before active formation zones; staff enter protected areas only through role-based access; and auditors reach review rooms without depending on social permission. Signs, lighting, acoustics, door form and controls, floor texture, digital prompts, reception sequence, orientation, and staffed assistance should make lawful action easy and status perceptible without making the threshold menacing.

Every threshold should also have a remedy logic. If someone crosses by mistake, what happens? If a sign is unclear, who can report it? If a threshold becomes a site of harassment or status display, how is it redesigned?

Test each threshold with people who have not read the manual. Ask them to identify the space beginning, applicable status, changed rights, record condition, and source of help. If ordinary users cannot infer these from cues, signs, and staff posture, change the design rather than require prior institutional fluency.

Thresholds need institutional memory at the level appropriate to their consequence. A material crossing can be classified as ordinary, protected, escorted, refused, appealed, corrected, emergency, or exceptional, with purpose, authority, duration, and review captured without exposing unrelated content.

6.3.2 — Corridor Traceability

Anti-shadow circulation does not require every movement to become public spectacle. It requires movement to be classed, justified, logged where appropriate, reviewable when consequential, and protected when disclosure would harm dignity or safety. The difference between a hidden route and a protected route is purpose, record, access control, review, and the possibility of challenge.

Circulation rules should remain comprehensible. If a route requires a manual too complicated for ordinary staff to remember, the building will be run by informal knowledge. If exceptions require excessive approval, people will route around them. The City needs enough structure to prevent shadows and enough simplicity that lawful movement remains usable under fatigue.

Corridors should also be designed against social possession. If a corridor becomes known as the route used by founders, donors, party figures, celebrity visitors, senior advisers, or favored participants, it will acquire unofficial meaning. Review should examine informal privileges attached to routes as well as the

published access rules. A corridor can become a privilege even when its access control is technically equal.

Corridor traceability is spatial metadata, not public footage. The City should be able to identify the corridor class, access authority, applicable record status, and any exception when movement through that threshold later becomes relevant to review.

A fair corridor system reduces side-contact risk. If a participant can be reached casually by people who should have used a formal interface, the corridor has become a political channel. If staff can shape decisions through repeated informal corridor contact without any record of material influence, the corridor has become governance. If media can position themselves at movement chokepoints, the corridor has become spectacle.

A corridor audit should classify each corridor by role: public, participant, staff, service, protected, emergency, oversight, or mixed-status. Mixed-status corridors require special design because they are where accidental contact, informal influence, and record ambiguity are most likely to appear.

Corridor design should also consider pause points. Benches, alcoves, waiting areas, and transitions can be humane, but they can also become informal meeting sites. The City should intentionally classify where people may pause so rest does not become hidden influence and traceability does not eliminate human interval.

Traceability should be proportionate. A staff member's trip to a rest area requires no personal movement record without a separate, necessary, lawful, and safe purpose. An emergency responder does not need the same preclearance as a recurring visitor. A journalist does not need the same access as an auditor. The City's circulation record should ask what consequence the

movement can have, then apply the least intrusive record sufficient to keep consequential access accountable.

Traceability should also include the negative record of denied movement. If an adviser, donor, visitor, media representative, staff member, or participant is refused access to a corridor or band, the refusal may matter as much as the entry. Denial records can reveal pressure, patterns, attempted side channels, or discriminatory gatekeeping.

6.3.3 — Anti-Side-Channel Design

A side channel is any path by which influence reaches public-power formation outside the intended structures. It may be a side door, private elevator, unmarked office, donor lounge, informal staff route, unsecured communication corner, or privileged visitor path.

Anti-side-channel design begins with path inventory. Every route to a participant, record space, office interface, protected zone, archive custody point, and staff influence site should be mapped. If a person can reach a public-power formation site without passing through a role-appropriate threshold, the design should be changed or the route should be formally classified.

An anti-side-channel review should test the building like an adversary. Ask how a donor could seek private access, how staff might influence a participant without a record, how a participant could bypass the Vow, or how a journalist might reach protected material. Critics, former public administrators, staff, security specialists, disabled users, civil-liberties reviewers, and people experienced in institutional manipulation should test these routes. Each discovered vulnerability receives a named design owner and a verified correction; findings are design inputs, not signs of disloyalty.

Repeated workarounds should trigger review of whether the formal route is impractical, a legitimate exception is needed, or an illicit route is becoming routine.

Temporary arrangements need the same side-channel discipline as permanent routes. Construction detours, event layouts, media days, emergency access, and delegations create improvised paths through which exceptions can become habits. Each temporary route needs an owner, purpose, duration, affected-person review, and closure date.

Participants need legitimate routes for office hours, counsel, mediation, support, expert advice, staff clarification, and personal repair. Each channel should be named, bounded, and reviewable, with any recording and disclosure limited by Section 2.3.1 and the protections applicable to care and counsel. These arrangements allow friendship, mentorship, counsel, disagreement, and care without letting privilege disguise itself as informality.

6.3.4 — Service Route Integrity

A circulation review needs seven maps: ordinary participant movement, staff and service movement, public visitors, protected professional movement, emergency movement, oversight movement, and likely misuse. The misuse map is essential because hidden power does not obey the official route. It looks for overlooked doors, social shortcuts, poorly supervised transition spaces, and plausible excuses.

Service routes are essential. Food, waste, supplies, repairs, cleaning, equipment, medical materials, archive hardware, emergency tools, and maintenance staff all need movement that does not disrupt participant life or public interface. The danger is that service routes become both invisible labor corridors and

unregulated influence paths. Service route integrity protects against both failures.

Operationally, service routes must be traceable enough to prevent misuse. Vendors, maintenance teams, deliveries, technical staff, and contractors may need access to sensitive locations. Without logs, supervision, and role limits, operational convenience can become a path into archive systems, participant spaces, or protected areas.

Conducted with service workers, a service-route audit should assess travel distance, safety, accessibility, ergonomic burden, lighting, privacy, access logs, vendor movement, and exposure to participant spaces.

Include service movement in the same design presentations as plazas, halls, and participant rooms, while protecting staff private life.

Classify each service-route threshold and the roles allowed to cross it. Section 8.2 separately governs the corridor's working conditions; those workplace rules must not disappear from either design or audit.

6.3.5 — Visitor Flow Control

The first requirement is role clarity. A visitor should know whether they are entering as a citizen learner, a critic, an expert reviewer, a journalist, an affected person, a family member, a vendor, or an emergency responder. These roles have different rights and limits.

Visitor routes should teach the institution without exploiting proximity. They can reveal public-purpose rooms, current status, complaint access, and the limits of observation while bypassing protected nonvisibility, staff operations, and participant movement that serves no public need. Timed entry, sightline control, acoustic separation, alternative routes, and host-facing

wayfinding reduce accidental contact and rumor without converting openness into concealment.

After departure, retain only the review records justified by the visitor's role. Keep complaints and corrections available, including a simple route to report unclear boundaries, signage, or record status. Repeated confusion should trigger design review.

Visitor-flow control should preserve the right to be unimpressed. A visitor should be able to approach the City as a critic, not only as a learner or admirer. The route should not choreograph emotional conversion. It should show enough to allow informed judgment, explain enough to prevent false inference, protect enough to prevent exposure, and leave enough room for disagreement that the public edge does not become recruitment by architecture.

The circulation-and-privacy control plan links six layers: role, zone, route, record status, exception, and review. For every consequential threshold, the plan states who may cross, for what purpose, what is captured, which people or information remain protected, what assistance is available, and who reviews an error.

Visitor flow control should prevent both exclusion and uncontrolled access. Arrival slots, queue management, escort rules, accessible routes, protest adjacency, media staging, storage, screening, and departure need enough structure to protect rights without turning every visitor into a suspect. Peak-period review should test whether the same route remains accessible and protective when queues, media attention, protest activity, and service traffic rise together.

The circulation system also needs an incident-to-redesign route. A missed turn, locked accessible door, repeated escort request, crowd pinch point, security misunderstanding, service collision, or protected-route breach should not disappear into anecdote. Each event should be classified by the burden it

created, reviewed with affected users and workers, assigned to a decision owner, and closed only after the physical or procedural repair has been tested. Closed incidents should remain linked to the redesign they produced so recurring failures can be recognized across seasons, events, and staffing changes.

6.4 — Wayfinding, Legibility, and Civic Clarity

A place can comply with rules and still be unreadable. Uncertainty about location, status, recording, help, complaint, or exit becomes an avoidable burden: participants fear accidental breach, visitors enter protected contexts, staff lose time, disabled people face exclusion, and responders lose minutes that matter. Legibility therefore joins spatial and institutional information. A person should be able to know where they are, what kind of authority operates there, and what practical choices remain.

6.4.1 — Public Signage

Name every major destination by function before brand: complaint route, record access, visitor help, emergency refuge, public learning, and protected boundary.

Legibility also requires restraint. Too many signs can become noise. Too many colors can become code. Too many warnings can make the campus feel dangerous. Too much brand language can make public power feel marketed. The City should use a disciplined visual vocabulary where each sign earns its place by reducing burden rather than decorating authority.

Public signage is the City’s first act of explanation. It tells citizens where they may go, what they may see, what they may not see, how to ask questions, how to file complaints, where record-site access begins, where protected domains are located as categories, and what behavior is expected.

The language should be plain without being simplistic. The City must explain terms like public band, participant band, protected nonvisibility, oversight access, record site, and complaint route in language a nonexpert can use.

Signage should avoid propaganda. Public signs should not praise the City, flatter participants, or create movement language. They should guide, protect, warn, explain, and route.

Public signage must also be accessible. Visual contrast, tactile cues, braille where appropriate, audio alternatives, multilingual support, icon discipline, plain-language maps, and low-stress layouts are part of fairness. A sign that works only for a calm, sighted, fluent, high-literacy visitor is not enough.

A protected-zone sign identifies dignity and lawful handling rather than secret privilege. A public-record sign explains provenance, status, context, and correction. A complaint sign makes relief and appeal visible before a person has to ask an insider.

A signage audit should test comprehension, not merely presence. Reviewers should ask first-time visitors to explain what a sign means, where it routes them, what behavior it expects, and what remedy it offers if they are harmed or confused.

The signage system should also be hostile-cropping aware. A single photographed sign may travel online without context. If the sign says only restricted area, critics may read secrecy. If it says total record, critics may read surveillance. If it says protected nonvisibility with no explanation, critics may read hidden privilege. Public signs should carry enough short context to survive being seen alone.

Public signage should distinguish access class, assistance, and record status. Labels such as public, protected, staff-only, participant-only, oversight-accessible, and emergency-access should correspond to actual rules, routes, custodians, and remedies. Signs may also identify non-digital assistance; a delayed-release label belongs to the relevant record, not the room.

6.4.2 — Participant Orientation

Participant orientation begins before the first active day and continues after activation. A participant must know not only what the rules say, but how the space carries those rules. Which doors change status? Which routes are public? Which rooms are protected? Which thresholds require log confirmation? Which spaces may include incidental visitors? Which paths are emergency-only? The participant should not have to learn by mistake.

Orientation should reduce shame. A person under the Vow will already carry public burden. If they are constantly afraid of accidental breach, the City has added avoidable load. Maps, walk-throughs, scenario rehearsals, plain-language spatial guides, mentor review, and repeated refreshers help the participant inhabit the City without excessive self-monitoring.

Participant orientation should include the dignity map. Participants need to know where care, counsel, protected nonvisibility, modesty handling, de-loading, complaint, and appeal are located.

A participant-orientation audit should test navigation in practice, not only knowledge of documents. The participant should cross thresholds, identify bands, practice emergency routes, locate protected spaces, find complaint and exit routes, and explain record-status changes in their own words.

Track navigation mistakes under ordinary fatigue, conflict, media pressure, illness, grief, family stress, or schedule compression. Repeated accidental breaches should prompt review of orientation and spatial cues before being attributed to a participant’s character.

6.4.3 — Staff Navigation

Staff routes should be clear by role. A clinician should know the protected path to care spaces. An archivist should know secure custody routes. Maintenance staff should know which paths protect operations without exposing them to participant or public pressure. Security should know how to move without making the City feel carceral. Educators should know how to reach participant zones without creating side channels.

Navigation tools for staff should include role maps, access-status dashboards, emergency route training, physical cues, and update procedures when spaces change. The City is likely to evolve. A changed route that is not communicated can create record gaps, safety risks, and staff frustration.

A staff-navigation audit should follow a full workday for each staff category. Educators, clinicians, security, archivists, food workers, maintenance workers, moderators, and operators should be asked where the building makes their work harder, less safe, less private, or more likely to create record confusion.

Staff navigation should be protected against constant public interruption. A staff member who must repeatedly act as impromptu guide, interpreter, security buffer, or emotional absorber is doing unrecorded public-interface labor. Good wayfinding reduces that hidden labor before it becomes burnout.

Navigation systems should also protect staff independence. If staff must pass through participant-heavy zones to reach supervisors, complaint offices, rest areas, or clinical support, the architecture may create pressure to appear loyal, calm, or available. Staff routes should allow service without surrendering boundaries.

6.4.4 — Accessibility Wayfinding

Wayfinding should be language-conscious without assuming one global solution. The first City may operate in a host jurisdiction with its own languages, legal signs, emergency conventions, disability requirements, and cultural expectations around public authority. Fairness has no single aesthetic accent; routes, rights, warnings, and help points must be translated into forms people in the host place can actually read.

Accessibility wayfinding serves people whose bodies, senses, cognition, language, trauma histories, stress levels, or temporary conditions make ordinary navigation difficult. It must be designed from the beginning, not added after the main path is complete.

Accessibility wayfinding must work as a chain. An accessible entrance is not enough when the route to reception, toilets, lifts, refuge, complaint, care, public records, and emergency exit breaks elsewhere. Review should follow complete journeys under ordinary and stressful conditions, including temporary closures and maintenance detours.

Accessibility uses the same dignified circulation whenever possible. Disabled people are not routed through service doors, hidden corridors, improvised lifts, or longer paths merely because the main route was designed around an ideal body. Where a distinct route is technically necessary, it remains direct, safe, equally legible, and equivalent in status and destination.

An accessibility-wayfinding audit should not be performed only by code compliance review. It should include disabled users, neurodivergent users, older adults, people under stress, people with low vision, deaf or hard-of-hearing users, wheelchair users, and people unfamiliar with the language of the institution.

When check-in systems, record kiosks, security gates, public interfaces, or mobile tools change, review them for new barriers and update wayfinding as needed, even when paths remain physically accessible.

Accessibility wayfinding should be maintained as conditions change. Temporary construction, event barriers, security adjustments, weather closures, broken elevators, altered lighting, crowd lines, media staging, and emergency drills can all make an accessible route inaccessible in practice.

6.4.5 — Wayfinding Tests and Crisis Routes

Legibility survives when basic movement and rights do not depend on a device. Phones, accounts, biometrics, apps, wearables, and digital maps may assist, but the built environment itself still communicates entrances, exits, emergency routes, complaint paths, help points, public-record access, and changes in status. This preserves access for people who refuse device-mediated participation and keeps the City readable when batteries die, networks fail, screens break, or stress narrows attention.

Test whether users can navigate through the available visual, tactile, and audio cues without routine staff explanation. Staff help should remain available; repeated dependence on it may reveal a design barrier.

Crisis wayfinding is the architecture of clarity when ordinary cognition is reduced. Fire, medical emergency, security threat, severe weather, cyber-physical incident, family crisis, protest escalation, or technical failure can turn a complex institution into a maze. The City must design for the moment when people have less attention, less time, and more fear.

A crisis route should be visible, redundant, accessible, and role-aware. Participants, staff, visitors, nonparticipants,

clinicians, security, emergency responders, and oversight personnel may need different paths or different information. A single evacuation map may not be enough in a City with protected records, dignity zones, archive custody, and active participant status.

Crisis-navigation drills must rehearse routes under stress with disabled users, participants, staff, public visitors, and outside responders. Test sign comprehension, safe movement, staff roles, protected-space exits, and access to refuge, medical care, shelter, assembly, and coordination without insider explanation. Include noise, time pressure, darkness, smoke, low visibility, crowding, staff absence, power loss, injury, language differences, device failure, and conflicting instructions. Directions must remain understandable when attention narrows, without dependence on complex diagrams, subtle symbolism, unfamiliar jargon, or conditional instructions.

When a door is locked, a route closes, or a protected area is shielded, people need a clear status message, a reliable information point, and a later explanation. Silence invites fear to invent motives, while timely communication preserves orientation without exposing protected details.

Crisis wayfinding drills exist to prevent confusion from becoming harm, not to keep the City in a permanent atmosphere of threat. After every drill or real incident, reviewers should ask who became lost, delayed, uninformed, dependent on informal help, or unable to use the designated route, and which privacy or protected-space boundaries were stressed by emergency movement.

Wayfinding should use a four-reader test. The first reader is an ordinary citizen arriving for the first time with skepticism. The second reader is a participant under stress who must avoid

accidental breach. The third reader is an emergency responder who must protect life without learning the theory.

The fourth reader tests accessibility: a person whose body, cognition, sensory processing, language, or technology access differs from the default imagined user. This reader should not be asked whether an alternate route exists only in theory. They should be asked whether the route feels equal, safe, timely, understandable, and dignified.

A change log should preserve wayfinding failures and repairs. When a room changes purpose, when a route is temporarily closed, when a sign is revised, when a new access device is introduced, or when a digital map changes, users should not be left to absorb the confusion.

6.5 — Light, Sound, Materials, and Sensory Burden

Glare can feel interrogative; echo can feel exposing; stone can feel dignified or cold; glass can feel open or merciless; silence can feel restful or disciplinary. The City counts these responses because participants, staff, visitors, critics, and nonparticipants encounter the institution through their nervous systems before they master its rules. Sensory design therefore becomes part of civic accuracy, not an aesthetic afterthought. Under active record, avoidable sensory strain may be misread as personal weakness. Reduce that strain without weakening public-power accountability.

6.5.1 — Light as Load

Review brightness, glare, visibility, shadow, reflection, and time of day in spaces used under active record.

Light also affects the archive. Poor lighting can distort records, obscure movement, create false impressions, or make later interpretation harder. Overly dramatic light can produce theater. Too little light can create suspicion. Lighting design should support record integrity without making every space feel like a set.

Daylight should be used with care. Natural light can support health, orientation, and dignity, but transparent surfaces can also create unwanted visibility. A glass wall may seem democratic and still expose people who need shielding. The rule should be daylight with boundaries, not exposure as aesthetic ideology.

A light audit separates orientation, safety, accurate record capture, privacy, sleep, circadian support, public interface, glare control, and protected dignity. Deliberation may require facial and document clarity while residence and recovery require shielding, adjustability, and darkness. Test across times of day,

seasons, screen use, storms, media events, energy-saving modes, and emergencies with users whose vision differs.

A room bright enough for record integrity may still need softened contrast. A public edge bright enough for safety may still need warmth.

Lighting review must monitor drift. Temporary security lights, media staging, donor events, repairs, seasonal changes, screen installations, and emergency equipment can slowly change the sensory contract of a place. Light should therefore be reviewed through maintenance logs, user complaints, staff reports, clinical feedback, and accessibility audits.

6.5.2 — Sound as Load

Echo, crowd noise, mechanical hum, alarms, footfall, corridor speech, doors, ventilation, and public-interface audio can make a place exhausting even when it appears calm. The City must treat sound as a civic design issue because judgment, care, sleep, staff work, and public interaction all depend on acoustic conditions.

Visible public-power formation can increase social vigilance. If every voice carries, participants may become guarded. If public questions bleed into recovery spaces, the City becomes siege. Noisy staff workspaces may increase mistakes. If protected spaces are acoustically weak, privacy fails.

The acoustic plan must distinguish zones. Public bands may carry low civic sound, orientation, and controlled interaction. Deliberation spaces need clarity without theatrical amplification. Protected nonvisibility spaces need sound shielding. Staff work areas need concentration. Recovery zones need quiet. Emergency systems need alarms that are unmistakable without creating avoidable panic.

Sound also affects accessibility. Some people process noise differently because of disability, trauma, age, cognitive load,

migraine, anxiety, hearing difference, or stress. A City that constantly stimulates hearing will exclude people long before it denies them entry. Quiet routes, sound-dampened waiting spaces, captioning, assistive listening systems, and low-noise alternatives are fairness tools.

The record may also be affected by sound. Poor acoustic design can misrecord speech, make deliberation unclear, produce false impressions of tone, or make public records harder to interpret.

A sound audit should measure more than decibels. It should review speech privacy, echo, cognitive load, staff fatigue, public-interface noise, sleep disturbance, alarm stress, and the ability to deliberate without shouting or retreating.

Combine acoustic measurements with user reports, accounting for person, task, duration, and sound source.

Sound should be mapped across adjacent uses. A deliberation hall beside a recovery space may transmit tension. A public queue beside a complaint route may expose distress. A kitchen corridor beside a protected professional room may create interruption. The acoustic map should ask not only whether spaces meet technical criteria, but whether one group’s ordinary function becomes another group’s hidden burden.

Sensory dignity extends to visitors, complainants, critics, and host residents. Public record rooms need calm acoustics and readable lighting; complaint rooms need privacy without isolation; reception must allow people to orient before making decisions; and protest-adjacent areas need sound and crowd management that respects both expression and neighboring life.

6.5.3 — Material Warmth

Materials teach the body what kind of institution it has entered. Steel, stone, glass, wood, fabric, concrete, ceramic, plants, water,

texture, color, and wear patterns all carry meaning. Material choices are not superficial. They signal whether the place is punitive, elite, fragile, durable, accessible, repairable, humane, or false.

Material warmth does not mean luxury. It means the City resists institutional coldness without becoming a retreat for the powerful. Warmth may come from repairable surfaces, humane texture, modest craft, natural materials where appropriate, visible maintenance, comfortable seating, and rooms that respect the body. It should not come from extravagance or donor display.

Materials that evoke punishment without functional need weaken the institution's civic meaning. Harsh grilles, punitive lighting cages, echoing concrete, excessive barriers, and conspicuous surveillance can make lawful boundaries feel like custody. Security may require durable separation, but its form should communicate purpose, proportionality, assistance, and review rather than punishment.

Material warmth should survive aging and ordinary repair. Replaceable parts, understandable joints, durable surfaces, and dignified maintenance access matter more than fragile first-day perfection. Materials must tolerate cleaning and security requirements without sacrificing access or maintainability.

Materials also carry class signals. Luxury finishes can imply elite retreat. Cheap institutional surfaces can imply punishment. Sacred materials can imply reverence. High-tech surfaces can imply surveillance. The material palette should therefore be reviewed for social meaning as well as performance.

Apply the cost test in Section 5.6.1 to material choices, including sensory load and the maintenance work a cheaper finish may create.

Procurement and maintenance can quietly reverse sensory intent. Designers may specify adjustable lighting, quiet equipment, non-glare surfaces, acoustic separation, and calm signage, only for substitutions or neglect to reintroduce load. Material, fixture, equipment, alarm, screen, and furnishing changes should therefore receive a sensory-impact review before the burden drifts through budget decisions no one calls ethical.

6.5.4 — Sensory Refuge

Sensory refuge lets a person reduce stimulation within a governed space. Each refuge space must identify its category, privacy, record status, and access rules.

Refuge spaces should be distributed, not rare. If relief is too far away, only people with time, status, or physical ease can use it. Small quiet rooms, low-stimulation routes, shaded benches, sound-dampened alcoves, accessible rest areas, and de-loading rooms can make the City livable without undermining record discipline.

The sensory system should include user control wherever control does not undermine record integrity, safety, or dignity. Adjustable light, quiet rooms, predictable alarms, choice of seating, non-glare screens, acoustically protected conversation areas, and the ability to step away can reduce burden without hiding power.

Refuge spaces should be included in public explanations without revealing users. The public can understand that the City provides low-stimulation and de-loading spaces because visible burden is heavy. Normalizing refuge helps prevent a culture in which only hidden collapse is treated as serious.

Separate recovery from oversight of the space. Use facility checks and safe aggregate assurance where they suffice. A person-specific access record requires a separate necessary,

lawful and safe purpose under Section 2.1.5; routine refuge use does not itself justify recording the visit or disclosing its existence. Staff must remain available for requested assistance and emergencies.

Refuge should have gradients too. Some people need brief low-stimulation pause. Others need clinical support, private recovery, protected family contact, quiet work, prayer or reflection where lawful and optional, or medical intervention. A single quiet room cannot carry all those burdens. The City should design refuge as a small ecology, with clear boundaries between ordinary decompression, professional care, emergency support, and protected nonvisibility.

Sensory reporting must be ordinary and dignified. People often hesitate to say that a place is too loud, bright, cold, crowded, harsh, or triggering because the complaint is treated as weakness. A report about glare or echo may identify a design failure with consequences for judgment, health, access, and staff retention.

6.5.5 — Integrated Sensory Review and Trauma-Aware Atmosphere

Light, sound, materials, sensory refuge, and trauma-aware atmosphere are conditions of dignity. The objective is not therapeutic softness in place of civic seriousness. It is a built environment where necessary public burden can be carried without avoidable bodily harm (World Health Organization, 2022c; CIE, 2018; Mostafa, 2014; Ulrich et al., 2008).

Sensory neglect is also a false economy. Poor sensory design can create costs through fatigue, mistakes, clinical overload, staff turnover, public hostility, maintenance failure, and participant collapse.

A sensory-load review should separate intensity, duration, predictability, personal control, and recovery. A bright room for ten minutes differs from the same room for eight hours under public record; a rare, explained alarm differs from continuous low-level noise; and a beautiful material may still be acoustically harsh. The review is a qualitative design memory, not a scientific score: it asks what stimulation occurs, for how long, for which body and role, and whether the person can leave, pause, adjust, shield, or recover.

Assess combined sensory and organizational load. Light, sound, record pressure, public interpretation, conflict, scheduling, alarms, visitor demands, and emotional-support work may be manageable separately yet overwhelming together. Review the total demand on participants and staff rather than evaluating each feature in isolation.

Sensory review should include staff, participants, visitors, disabled users, clinicians, security personnel, maintenance workers, and host-community interfaces. Staff may experience alarm fatigue. Participants may experience exposure fatigue. Visitors may experience confusion. Host neighbors may experience event noise. Maintenance workers may experience material off-gassing, heat, or repetitive strain.

A trauma-aware atmosphere recognizes that many people enter public institutions with histories of fear, humiliation, medical harm, policing, surveillance, poverty, violence, coercion, or institutional betrayal. The Transparent City must not assume that seriousness will be read as safety. It must design spaces that do not unnecessarily recreate carceral, clinical, authoritarian, or humiliating cues.

Trauma-aware design is a relationship between form and procedure rather than a palette of soothing finishes. Predictable sequences, visible exits, non-coercive waiting, control over

proximity, privacy during care, understandable security, and staff practices that do not translate distress into misconduct by default all matter. Choice is offered where safety and function permit it.

Security must be included in trauma-aware atmosphere. The City needs safety, but security posture should not dominate civic tone. Uniforms, weapons, barriers, cameras, and screening procedures should be reviewed for the burden they place on bodies.

Trauma-aware atmosphere does not mean assuming fragility in everyone. It means refusing preventable triggers that serve no civic purpose: domination cues, surprise confinement, harsh commands, narrow chokepoints, humiliating queues, excessive uniformed presence, unpredictable alarms, involuntary exposure, and spaces that mimic courts, prisons, hospitals, or interrogation rooms without necessity.

This standard should be reviewed by people with clinical, disability, veteran, survivor, and lived-experience knowledge.

Explain what will happen, who may enter, where exits are, how long a process lasts, what is recorded, how to request pause, and who can help.

6.6 — Seriousness Without Fear

The City needs gravity because it prepares people for consequential public power, preserves an unusual civic record, asks staff to support difficult work, and asks a host community to live beside an institution with public meaning. Gravity, however, can be communicated through competence, clarity, proportion, repair, and calm rather than intimidation. An overly casual atmosphere can trivialize the work; monumental design can overstate the institution. The desired tone is serious enough to focus attention and human enough to remain recognizably ordinary.

6.6.1 — Non-Carceral Gravity

Public interpretation begins with the built message. A perimeter that resembles custody, a screening point that resembles suspicion, or a corridor that resembles control will be read accordingly, and that response is evidence rather than hostility. Non-carceral gravity therefore uses proportionate security, visible purpose, ordinary materials, humane waiting, and clear exit. The design should communicate a civic boundary that protects people, not a prison that prose later has to explain away.

Non-carceral gravity also protects staff and participants from role distortion. Security rooms should support coordination without teaching warden behavior; operations centers should distribute authority rather than invite command theater; and participant routes should require understanding rather than obedience.

A non-carceral audit should review perimeter, screening, room proportions, security posture, doors, windows, furniture, lighting, sound, uniforms, and response protocols. It must examine windowless rooms, confusing checkpoints, controlled

silence, and humiliating searches, including whether lawful entry and exit are physically intelligible.

Security review should include a dignity test. The City can use controlled access, trained personnel, emergency protocols, and protective infrastructure without making the first experience of the place a command. Reviewers should ask whether security staff are positioned as guides as well as guardians, whether barriers are proportionate, whether searches are lawful and respectful, and whether people can distinguish safety from dominance.

6.6.2 — No Sacred Monumentality

Seriousness without fear must survive public representation as well as construction. Renderings and published explanations can mislead as powerfully as a building. Glass towers, guarded plazas, monumental halls, luxury residences, sacred light, or crowds gazing at participants may reasonably suggest surveillance, spectacle, elite retreat, or cult architecture. Public images should instead make the institution's bounded, adult, voluntary, role-based, reviewable, and ordinary-life-protective character visible, including the workers and maintenance systems that sustain it.

Monumental axes, grand entrances, ceremonial paths, founder-centered spaces, symbolic chambers, and excessive symmetry can turn a civic institution into an object of devotion.

The City cannot use sacred atmosphere to pressure civic belonging; the Religion of Fairness remains optional and separate under Section 3.2.4.

Light, proportion, gardens, durable materials, public art, and rituals of orientation can express human responsibility without inviting institutional worship.

Avoid sacred-origin narratives that make replication seem like imitation of holiness rather than transfer of safeguards.

A monumentality audit should ask whether the building or its use makes criticism feel inappropriate. Look for discouraged questions, staff reluctance to challenge founders, or room names that treat the institution's historical importance as already settled.

Sacred monumentality would also distort the wider project. The built form cannot present the Law as proved, participants as a chosen class, or the City as the beginning of an inevitable future. It remains a corrigible institution under objection. Its architecture should preserve failure memory, revision, criticism, decommissioning, and the visible possibility that the proposal may need to contract or end.

6.6.3 — No Luxury Enclosure

Luxury enclosure can appear through access. If only insiders, donors, experts, or political allies feel comfortable entering, the City becomes socially enclosed even if its gates are open. Furniture, language, food, dress expectations, visitor protocols, and public edges can all signal who belongs. The City must be legible to ordinary citizens, not only to elite visitors.

Comparison reveals whether participant support has become enclosure. Participant spaces must be judged beside staff spaces, public edges, host-community effects, maintenance routes, and local conditions. If visible-service residents live comfortably while workers strain, hosts absorb cost, or public areas feel inferior, the building has reproduced hierarchy.

6.6.4 — Calm Public Edges

Entrances, visitor reception, protest-adjacent areas, public-record access, learning interfaces, exterior paths, and host boundaries tell people whether the institution expects approach or

obedience. The edge should neither seduce nor repel. It should make public responsibility understandable, reachable, and safe.

Neither the loudest public force nor institutional fear may capture the boundary. A workable edge protects approach, criticism, assembly, observation, and departure while preventing one energy from dominating access for everyone else. That balance requires proportionate rules and review beyond immediate institutional command.

The tone of a public edge changes through use. Sign clutter, security creep, crowd-control equipment, media staging, vendor kiosks, temporary fencing, or repeated protest barriers can make an originally calm boundary feel hostile. Review after major events should restore orientation, access, and dignity instead of allowing emergency furniture to become permanent architecture.

Waiting is part of public access. Shade, seating, restrooms, water, accessible queues, clear time estimates, multilingual explanation where needed, non-digital assistance, and complaint routes determine whether approach is dignified or punitive.

6.6.5 — Human-Scale Authority

The final spatial tone should pass a public-courage test. Does the place make ordinary citizens more willing to ask questions, inspect records, challenge claims, and demand repair, or does it make them feel small before an institution that seems morally grand? The City fails if its architecture silences criticism through awe. Public power becomes answerable when the public can approach it without reverence.

It should also pass a participant-humility test. Does the place remind participants that public service is burden-bearing, learning, correction, and lawful answerability, or does it make them feel selected by history? Spaces that flatter future power are dangerous even when they use the vocabulary of sacrifice.

Finally, it should pass a staff-truth test. Does the place allow staff to tell the truth about overload, breach, misuse, fear, or unfair expectation without having to challenge an architectural myth? If staff feel they are damaging a beautiful mission when they name a practical problem, beauty has become coercive. Seriousness without fear means the building helps people tell the truth about the building itself.

Size workstations, rest areas, maintenance paths, kitchens, archive rooms, and staff meeting spaces for actual bodies and fatigue.

Human-scale authority becomes visible in small decisions about desk height, room size, chair spacing, and the ability to sit while waiting. It also appears in clear help points, warm and repairable materials, proportionate halls, staff placement, and the ease with which a person can object without shouting upward at the institution.

The final approval question should be asked from the ground, not the aerial rendering. Can people with different bodies, access needs, and levels of familiarity understand where to go and what the institution is asking of them, even when worried, impatient, or skeptical? Can they leave? Can they complain? Can they find help? Can they see power without being swallowed by the place built to reveal it? If the answer is no, the design is not yet human-scale authority.

Chapter 7 — Zones, Commons, and Service Ecology

The City is an inhabited ecology before it is a diagram. People sleep, study, deliberate, eat, walk, recover, work, meet strangers, maintain systems, and return to private selves within the same institutional day. Chapter 7 tests whether those ordinary arrangements deepen public responsibility while preserving friendship, rest, staff dignity, and unmeasured life. The quality of the City appears not only in its formal rooms, but in the transitions that let people remain human between them.

Daily zones reveal where burden is hidden. A participant room can protect dignity or quietly punish the person who lives there. A dining hall can support shared life or reproduce hierarchy. A classroom can cultivate public reason or reward performance. A service ecology becomes fair when each zone names its users, workers, dependencies, access states, conflicts, and correction route rather than relying on an atmosphere of benevolence.

Deliberative halls and drafting rooms make the formation of judgment visible. Public power drafts, listens, revises, resists, tests, fails, and tries again before it speaks with authority. The spatial design therefore supports source access, minority reports, revision history, burden analysis, and reasons that can be reconstructed later. At the same time, unfinished thought is not treated as final character. Inspectability attaches to the work of reasoning without converting every hesitation into performance theater.

Commons, dining, libraries, and walking grounds allow relationships to develop through shared meals, reading, humor, disagreement, and quiet. People remain responsible for their treatment of others, but an ordinary meal or walk does not become readiness evidence merely because a participant is present. These intervals give friendship and rest their own place in daily life, without asking anyone to perform authenticity for observers.

An inhabited City is necessarily interdisciplinary because burden does not remain inside professional boundaries. Residence depends on privacy law and family protection. Classrooms require educational judgment and public-risk control. Deliberation requires record status and resistance to performance theater. Commons depend on service labor, recovery depends on clinical independence, archive interfaces depend on public-memory governance, and landscape depends on ecology and host review. The zones become credible only when those responsibilities meet in the lived place rather than remaining separate promises on paper. A joint review of a single route from residence to work can reveal whether those responsibilities connect at each doorway and handoff.

The chapter follows a braided ordinary day rather than a collection of amenities. A participant wakes near a protected household edge, moves through study and deliberation, eats food carried by visible labor, uses commons without performing sociability, reaches care without spectacle, encounters the public record site, and walks an exterior whose water and maintenance costs are not hidden. Each movement tests whether the City’s values survive routine. Walking that route with operating staff brings the timing of meals, cleaning, maintenance, and assistance into the design before occupancy.

7.1 — Residential Quarters and Household Edges

Residential design must prevent consequential role meetings from bypassing declared record rules. Classify role-relevant advice, financial influence and strategic work under Section 2.2.3 while keeping ordinary domestic activity outside routine capture. Room placement, entry arrangements and accommodation are specified below. The residential design should name the record status of the zone, the dignity protections inside it, the status of staff entry, emergency entry and visitor adjacency, and the route by which a participant can challenge a residential rule that has become humiliating or unsafe.

7.1.1 — Participant Rooms

The room supports sleep, bodily care, ordinary possessions, accessibility, emotional decompression, and clear control over protected functions.

Record continuity is satisfied through declared status changes, narrowly necessary environmental or safety data, and separate handling of any role-relevant interaction, not through audio or video observation of bodily life. The spatial charter therefore distinguishes noncapture, protected status, restricted handling, public release, and interpretation.

Residence review should include participants, staff, family members, ordinary citizens, disability reviewers, and privacy critics. A resident should be able to locate the person responsible for a broken lock, a noise dispute, or an inaccessible shared facility without navigating the entire institution.

The participant room also needs a threshold script for moments of entry. Staff entry, emergency entry, maintenance entry, clinical entry, and visitor-adjacent entry cannot all mean the same thing. A person living under record should know why a

door opened, what status applied, who was present, and whether the event created a record category requiring later explanation.

Durable furniture, controllable light, acoustic protection, simple storage, modest personal effects, accessible controls, and clear emergency signaling can lower daily burden without creating luxury.

7.1.2 — Household Boundary Rules

The Vow is not inherited by household members or visitors.

Boundary rules should define who may enter residential areas, when, under what notice, under what record condition, and with what shielding. They should distinguish routine household contact from active formation conduct, crisis contact from ordinary visitation, and protected family communication from hidden public-power strategy. These categories should be understandable to participants and nonparticipants before the first contact occurs.

Families also need complaint routes that do not require public exposure. A partner who feels pressured, a dependent whose care is disrupted, or a household member who believes the City is misplacing burden must be able to speak without becoming material for public interpretation.

Household support should remain private relationship rather than public virtue display. A supportive spouse, patient child, or caregiving family member is not evidence of the participant's goodness and should not be recruited into an institutional narrative. Household dignity includes the freedom to help, disagree, limit contact, seek support, or leave without becoming a public symbol.

The City may need to know who is a partner, dependent, caregiver, emergency contact, legal representative, or protected minor for purposes of safety, consent, scheduling, and shielding.

Household information should be purpose-limited, role-labeled, access-limited, and subject to correction.

A participant may want to prove transparency by bringing family life into view, or a supporter may want access in the name of loyalty. The City should resist both impulses: the affected person may be unable to refuse exposure without injuring the relationship.

7.1.3 — Modesty Design

Apply the participant-room noncapture rule to dressing, hygiene, sleep, and intimacy. Any separately authorized safety or care record must remain within its own lawful purpose; access restrictions cannot justify collecting bodily material for the civic archive. Route consequential role business through an appropriate channel without recording unrelated bodily content.

The design must serve varied bodies, disabilities, religious practices, gender realities, medical needs, trauma histories, and cultural expectations without allowing any one framework to dominate the City. Modesty should not become a tool for shame, purity culture, gender policing, or exclusion. It should be a plural dignity architecture under law and expert review.

Modesty design should be tested in ordinary failure conditions as well as ideal conditions. What happens when a device breaks, a staff member enters at the wrong time, a medical emergency occurs, a door fails, a visitor wanders, or a release queue mislabels a protected category?

The modesty plan should specify sightlines, device placement, room layout, any necessary entry logs, staff training, and independent review. Include reproductive health, grief, distress, and disability support in that review.

Test whether modesty protections withstand institutional embarrassment, urgency, criticism, and pressure to prove that

nothing is hidden. A panic response to criticism must not turn protected bodily material into a public sacrifice.

7.1.4 — Nonparticipant Access Limits

Nonparticipant access limits protect both directions of the threshold. They prevent nonparticipants from being exposed by proximity, and they prevent outside persons from entering active residential spaces in ways that create hidden influence, pressure, or record confusion.

Access rules should preserve real relational life. Participants need family, friendship, care, ordinary conversation, and contact with people who do not belong to the institution. Outside relationships are not capture risks merely because they cross a residential edge. The design task is to distinguish ordinary human support from active public-power influence and to route each through the appropriate privacy or record state.

Children require stronger shielding than adult visitors. Professional confidentiality, staff role protection, household privacy, and media rules govern other visitors according to their role.

A visitor or family member who enters a City boundary should know how to leave, decline future visits or contact, challenge exposure, and ask what record category applied.

Access rules should define approach routes, waiting areas, contact windows, escort duties, recording notices, incidental-capture responses, child restrictions, family-consultation procedures, and emergency exceptions.

Access limits should also protect household visitors against attempts to obtain stories, images, impressions, or emotional leverage through their proximity to a participant. No visitor should discover after leaving that their face, voice, grief,

presence, or refusal has become public evidence about the participant.

7.1.5 — Recovery Adjacency

Recovery adjacency means that rest, de-loading, sleep support, and basic care must be near the places where participants actually live. Physical distance, stigma, and administrative barriers can delay access to help.

Recovery adjacency should not create constant emergency demand on clinicians, mentors, or residential support staff without staffing ratios, triage rules, and protected downtime.

Recovery adjacency should be measured not only in distance, but in social ease. If a participant must cross a humiliating public path, ask permission from the wrong authority, or risk visible stigma to recover, the recovery space is functionally farther away than the floor plan suggests.

Set recovery-access triggers for fatigue, sleep loss, panic, sensory overload, illness, grief, conflict, and cognitive strain. Permit self-request, mentor observation, clinical referral, staff concern, and scheduled review, with privacy and record categories defined in advance. Access must not require public breakdown.

7.2 — Educational and Study Precincts

Public-power seekers encounter law, economics, administration, history, science, media, ethics, diplomacy, systems, and the lived consequences of institutional choice. The educational precinct earns its place when knowledge appears in better questions, revised drafts, calibrated uncertainty, listening, service, and the ability to explain burden to people outside the room. Learning spaces help or hinder study through their actual physical and social conditions. Research on classroom design and spatial transitions provides reasons to examine room layout, sensory conditions, ease of movement, and the relationship between space and teaching practice (Barrett et al., 2015; Cleveland and Fisher, 2014; Byers et al., 2018).

7.2.1 — Classrooms for Public Reason

These classrooms teach participants to justify decisions in terms that can be examined by people who do not share their private loyalties. Public reason is not the erasure of conviction. It is the discipline of making power explain itself to those who must live under it.

The classroom can turn public reason into a testable administrative skill. Give a participant a fictional service rule and ask for a one-page burden map naming the lawful decision maker, the person who must wait, the documents needed, the staff work involved, the appeal deadline, and the route for correcting a mistaken outcome. Change one fact (such as a translation delay or an unavailable supporting document) and ask which reasons, deadlines, and remedies must change. Review factual accuracy against the case file and assess reasoned treatment of value conflicts without demanding agreement with the instructor. Chapter 22 develops more complex exercises from the same burden-tracing discipline.

Seating, speaking rules, facilitation, source access, and participation norms should prevent the most fluent person from appearing most ready by default.

Teach listening as an assessable civic practice. Ask participants to restate rival arguments, identify missing affected persons, and explain what would change their mind.

The classroom record should distinguish attendance, learning, testing, assigned sources, questions raised, corrected errors, adopted or rejected conclusions, unresolved disagreements, and formal readiness. A future public record should not flatten those categories into a single image of virtue or ignorance.

7.2.2 — Study Rooms

Study also requires quiet. A public-power seeker must have time to read difficult material without immediately turning it into public statement. Study rooms protect the discipline of not speaking too soon.

Study rooms support reading, note-making, comprehension, language work, legal review, policy comparison, and personal intellectual struggle.

Different kinds of study require different arrangements. Some rooms may support solitary reading. Others may support paired source review, assisted learning, translation, accessibility support, or supervised archive education. Intellectual work does not fit one body, one language, one neurotype, or one academic style.

Study rooms also protect staff time. If participants have no proper place to struggle independently, they may overuse mentors, faculty, or staff for work that should be self-directed. Conversely, if study rooms are isolating and unsupported, participants may quietly fail. The correct design creates both independence and reachable assistance.

Study provision should also include assistive technology, large print, movement breaks, and reduced visual stimulation.

Study-room device rules, meeting permissions, source access, visitor restrictions, and staff support should prevent off-record direction. Protect concentration through clear purposes, limited access, logged exceptions, and reviewable use categories rather than constant interruption.

7.2.3 — Research-Literacy Spaces

Research literacy teaches participants to evaluate studies, dashboards, audits, expert summaries, statistics, model outputs, public comments, and technical reports before using them in public decisions.

Participants should be able to distinguish a proposed scientific measurement from an observation about how the City operates. When PTVC is discussed, its measurement and endpoint questions remain in the scientific program developed by *The Science of Fairness*.

These spaces should include access to methodological instruction: sampling, causal inference, measurement error, observational limits, qualitative evidence, administrative data, replication, statistical uncertainty, and ethical review.

Artificial Intelligence literacy belongs here too. A summary generated by a system may help navigate records, but it can distort salience, omit context, reproduce bias, or sound more certain than the underlying record allows. Participants should learn to challenge machine output, request provenance, and ask what data, prompt, and classification system shaped the result.

Ask of every graph, study, model, dashboard, expert memo, poll, audit, or AI-generated summary: What was measured? What was excluded? Who was missing? What is the error range?

What competing explanation still stands? What use would overstate the evidence?

7.2.4 — Faculty and Mentor Zones

The City's distinct requirements (plural sources, traceable role assignments, protected intellectual struggle, accessible disagreement, and independence from donor or mentor prestige) are proposed civic safeguards. Their value must be examined through observed learning and decision tasks, not inferred from research on classroom architecture.

Faculty and mentor zones support guidance while making material influence on public-power formation reviewable.

Mentor zones also need safeguards against dependency. A participant who relies too heavily on one mentor may begin to borrow judgment instead of forming it. A mentor who enjoys influence may begin to shape the participant as an extension of themselves. The City should diversify guidance, rotate review, and make intellectual dependency visible without shaming legitimate learning.

Protect mentor time, emotional capacity, privacy, and professional boundaries.

Conflict-of-influence review should examine whether a mentor's vocabulary, ideology, professional network, or approval is dominating a participant's reasoning.

Mentor-zone records identify role, purpose, frequency and influence category without exposing protected care content. Review repeated private access by founders, donors, celebrity experts and officials as well as faculty; apply the role boundaries in Section 18.3.

7.2.5 — Public Learning Interfaces

A public learning interface presents curriculum purposes, standards, reading paths, public lectures, diagrams and structured outputs. It does not offer raw access to every classroom moment.

Public learning materials should be readable, translated where needed, disability-accessible, and clear about limits. Simplification must preserve safeguards.

Citizens can learn from anonymized examples, structured demonstrations, faculty explanation, participant-authorized material, and contextualized record bundles.

The interface must work for skeptical readers as well as sympathetic ones. Curriculum boundaries, evidence labels, public-risk limits, correction histories, complaint routes, and unresolved questions should be easy to locate without passing through decorative optimism.

Sample exercises, annotated cases, aggregate themes, and later reflections can extend the public learning materials. Private disability support, grief-shaped difficulty, household interruption, and raw confusion remain protected.

A learning-space evidence packet should accompany each major room type. It records the room’s public task, accessibility assumptions, recording status, protected discussion boundary, staff load, equipment dependencies, reset procedure, and the conditions under which the room may not be used. A seminar room that excludes a wheelchair, a simulation room that cannot de-load a distressed participant, or a public-learning interface that requires specialist dialect is not merely inconvenient. It is producing a distorted formation environment and should be corrected before the distortion is interpreted as individual performance.

Learning spaces also need a periodic room-ecology review. Reviewers should examine who routinely gains the floor, who is interrupted, which bodies can remain comfortable for a full session, whether remote and translated participation is genuinely equivalent, what staff labor makes the room function, and whether the technology privileges polished speed over careful thought. The review should connect pedagogy to space without treating architecture as a cure for educational failure. When the same people repeatedly disappear from discussion, the room, timetable, facilitation, and record process all become subjects of inquiry.

7.3 — Deliberative Halls and Drafting Rooms

Deliberation is the point at which knowledge becomes shared judgment under disagreement. A participant may understand law, administration, science, and history yet still fail to listen, revise, state uncertainty, or account for people outside the room. The City therefore creates spaces where reasoning can be observed before office through sources, alternatives, minority positions, burden notes, draft histories, and correction. Reasoning must become traceable without becoming performance.

7.3.1 — Deliberation Halls

Deliberative halls are arranged around relationships among people, sources, proposals, and affected interests rather than a heroic speaker. Sightlines, acoustics, shared displays, accessible seating, translation, note access, and visible drafting help participants hear one another and examine evidence. The room also keeps absent people conceptually present through burden maps, testimony, data, and stated uncertainties.

The hall’s record should capture reasoning pathways, not merely quotable statements. It should identify who introduced a claim, what evidence supported it, what objection was raised, what alternative was considered, which affected persons were named, what changed after challenge, and what remained unresolved.

Deliberation halls must protect minority positions. A dissenting participant should not be treated as disruptive merely because they slow consensus. The City should make space for minority reports, unresolved concerns, and structured objection.

The hall must also resist public applause culture. If public-facing deliberations become occasions for spectators to reward speakers, participants may begin to deliberate for

reaction rather than truth. Public access should be carefully governed, often delayed, contextual, and protected from crowd capture.

Audit whether summaries represent speakers' arguments accurately.

Deliberation also carries the burden of silence. Some participants contribute by listening, annotating, requesting sources, using interpretation or assistive support, or identifying uncertainty after reflection rather than speaking immediately. The hall should not convert talkativeness, speed, or comfort under interruption into readiness, nor should it mistake quiet processing for civic weakness. Turn-taking, written contribution, pause, and later amendment should remain legitimate forms of public reasoning.

7.3.2 — Drafting Rooms

Participants may begin speaking for the archive rather than the problem, staging apology, or treating dissent as brand management. Deliberative rooms should therefore preserve drafts as drafts, simulations as simulations, structured opposition, source routes, revision history, and after-action learning without converting intellectual risk into public humiliation (Habermas, 1984; Mansbridge et al., 2012; Fishkin, 2018; Gastil, 2008).

These spaces also create a library of public reasoning for future study inside the City, though not research by default. Participants can learn from earlier deliberations when privacy, status, and consent rules permit. They can see how past cohorts mishandled evidence, corrected language, misread opposition, or improved through after-action review. Formation becomes cumulative without turning earlier participants into permanent exhibits.

The design of these rooms should also anticipate the most subtle burden shifts of intellectual power. Who controls the agenda? Who decides which policy draft is live? Who has access to experts? Who is interrupted without consequence? Who is asked to represent a whole affected group? Who bears the emotional cost of opposition? Who records the objection that was inconvenient but correct?

Drafting rooms turn public reasoning into policies, statements, rules, budget notes, explanations, and recommendations.

The way a sentence is written can shift responsibility, hide uncertainty, soften harm, imply certainty, erase affected persons, or turn a cost into an abstraction. A drafting room should train participants to ask what every phrase does to the people who must later live under it.

Teach readers to distinguish rough drafts, provisional options, and later-rejected arguments from settled commitments. Release timing and status labels must preserve these distinctions.

Drafting-room practice should include a burden footnote habit. Major drafts should ask, in some visible form, whose time, money, privacy, safety, labor, and appeal rights the proposed language touches. This does not need to become formulaic, but the discipline should be present before public office.

Track why a clause exists, who proposed it, what problem it addresses, what burden it shifts, what alternative was rejected, and what review is still needed.

The room should also expose the difference between writing and laundering. A participant may receive expert help, legal drafting assistance, data analysis, translation, or administrative modeling. That help can be legitimate, even necessary. But the public should later be able to see whether a participant understood the draft, whether advice became hidden authorship, whether donor or factional language entered the text, and

whether affected-person concerns were removed for convenience.

7.3.3 — Simulation Chambers

Simulation chambers let participants practice consequential decisions under bounded pressure without exercising governmental authority. Public power often requires judgment under incomplete information, time pressure, competing goods, fear, uncertainty, and public consequence. A participant who reasons well in calm seminars may behave differently when a crisis compresses time.

Simulation rooms must support the scenario boundaries, stop authority, clinical access and debrief arrangements in Chapter 24. Design observation and circulation for the declared learning task.

Scenario design should be explicit about what is being tested. Is the exercise about evacuation, public explanation, budget triage, misinformation, diplomatic confidentiality, emergency care, staff conflict, or legal constraint?

Label the exercise as simulation. Public release should include context, limits, debrief, and correction, without presenting simulated pressure as a public ranking of courage.

Simulation records should separate performance, stress response, correction, and readiness signals. A participant who freezes once in a difficult scenario may need training, not shame. A participant who repeatedly hides evidence, blames staff, humiliates opponents, refuses correction, or sacrifices protected persons under pressure may reveal a more serious readiness concern. Reviewers should use these records as one evidence family within a broader formation assessment, with context, independent review, and an opportunity to learn.

7.3.4 — Opposition Rooms

Opposition rooms are the City's refusal to form public power only among friends.

The opposition room should support adversarial dignity. Critics need enough independence, preparation, and protection to challenge assumptions, incentives, evidence, and power without becoming props. Participants should face strong arguments and real consequences, while abuse, harassment, and theatrical humiliation remain outside the exercise.

Record handling must protect opponents as well as participants. A critic entering the room should not become a public target. Their argument may be recorded, summarized, or referenced under agreed terms, but their private life is not part of the participant's formation record.

Opposition rooms should be protected from ideological tokenism. Bringing in one critic from a group, class, tradition, or political tendency cannot stand for the whole position. The City should treat opposition as an ongoing discipline of serious rival modeling, not a symbolic encounter staged for institutional credibility.

Opposition should be evaluated less by who appears to win than by how a participant receives, tests, and answers challenge. Does the person listen, restate the objection fairly, ask better questions, retaliate, collapse into performance, or revise a position? The record should distinguish disagreement with a critic from refusal to engage the critic's evidence or affected-person account.

Define the critic's role, consent, record status, compensation if appropriate, exit right, privacy protections, and complaint path.

Opposition rooms should welcome different forms of challenge: legal, scientific, material, historical, religious,

ordinary-life, disability, labor, host-community, administrative, and ideological.

7.3.5 — After-Action Spaces

After-action space should make classification possible without turning the room itself into a tribunal. It needs enough time, privacy, source access, and facilitation to separate what happened, what kind of error occurred, what burden followed, and what correction belongs next.

After-action spaces should also include care. Pressure exercises, opposition sessions, public interface failures, and household conflicts can leave real residue. Immediate self-analysis should not be demanded from a body still under threat. Care before interpretation remains a rule here.

Public summaries may be appropriate, but raw after-action material should not become spectacle. The public needs to know that correction occurred, what general pattern was identified, and what safeguards changed. It does not always need every vulnerable detail.

After-action review should also ask what the City learned about itself. A participant’s error may reveal bad instructions, unclear thresholds, poor simulation design, staff overload, or a flawed record interface.

A trustworthy record identifies the problem, relevant context, corrective action, affected people, remaining uncertainty, follow-up owner, and date of review so repair can be tested after the emotional moment has ended.

A room-level revision record can identify the question considered, source materials supplied, significant exclusions, declared conflicts, unresolved dissent, changes made after critique, the reason for any accountable refusal, and the person

responsible for follow-up. It does not record private thought or reward ideological movement.

Displays, clocks, document screens, annotation surfaces, translation channels, and accessible seating should support that trace without turning faces, hesitations, or private reactions into evidence. When the record is released, a person outside the room should be able to distinguish proposal from decision, dissent from obstruction, correction from retreat, and silence from consent.

7.4 — Commons, Dining, Libraries, and Walking Grounds

Seriousness cannot occupy every hour in the same register. Commons, dining spaces, libraries, and walking grounds create intervals in which a person stops performing the roles of candidate, student, participant, or future official and encounters others through meals, reading, humor, quiet, and ordinary reciprocity. Those intervals allow civic discipline to coexist with friendship, difference, fatigue, and unmeasured life (Ostrom, 1990; Whyte, 1980; Gehl, 2010; Klinenberg, 2018). Commons governance must address unscheduled access, informal influence, service burdens, and table hierarchy without turning ordinary use into performance.

7.4.1 — Commons as Civic Interval

A participant remains bound by the Vow's rules in the commons, including the duty not to hide consequential role business. That continuing obligation does not make quiet presence, friendship, or ordinary conversation automatically recordable. Role records require a declared role purpose; separately authorized safety or other records remain governed by their own limited purposes and protections. The commons provide human intervals in which people need not produce evidence of authenticity for future public release.

Design should prevent hierarchy. If some corners become informal VIP zones, if staff occupy inferior edges, if participants perform for visitors, or if influential mentors dominate the center, the commons will reproduce the hidden status systems the City opposes. Furniture, sightlines, access rules, and norms should support ordinary equality.

The commons should include space for quiet presence as well as conversation. A person should not be forced into constant

sociability to prove openness. Introverted, neurodivergent, grieving, tired, disabled, or overloaded participants may need to be near others without performing interaction.

Informal influence needs rules lighter than formal deliberation and stronger than social guesswork. Friendship, admiration, irritation, and trust will grow in shared space. The concern is repeated asymmetry that affects role decisions or legitimate access: the same participants included, the same critic isolated, the same mentor hovering, or donor-adjacent access becoming ordinary. Commons design should make room for human relation while allowing such patterns to be examined as possible capture, rather than treating friendship itself as suspicious.

Staff should be visibly respected without becoming surveillance instruments. Complaint routes, pattern review, ordinary civility, and limits on retaliatory interpretation belong to commons ecology.

7.4.2 — Dining as Shared Life

Meals should be nutritious, culturally respectful, accessible, and humane without resembling an elite retreat.

Food systems must accommodate health, disability, allergies, sensory needs, culture, religion, and ethical dietary commitments without turning difference into spectacle. Accommodation should be planned with affected people and food workers rather than improvised at the last moment. The review must include menu design, ingredient information, cross-contact risk, fasting or observance needs, budget, staffing, and the burden created by special processes.

Review table hierarchy, service labor, dietary accommodation, food waste, complaint handling, and staff interaction without ranking personalities. The relevant evidence is operational:

recurring delays, unmet needs, worker overload, exclusion, waste, and whether correction follows.

Dining arrangements must also include eating-disorder safeguards and enough time to eat.

The service-ecology and food/culture bias review begins with the daily chain rather than the finished plate: procurement, delivery, storage, preparation, accommodation, service, cleaning, waste, staffing, cost, and recovery. Each step identifies who decides, who works, who may be excluded, what failure looks like, and how a complaint changes the system.

Review seating, quiet usable for prayer or secular reflection, and whether accommodations require repeated personal pleading, alongside the food and service conditions above.

Workers need equal standing in this review. A menu cannot be called inclusive if it produces unsafe shifts, impossible preparation, harassment, unpaid interpretation, chronic understaffing, or pressure to conceal shortages. Worker voice, workload data, safety rights, procurement transparency, and anti-retaliation routes are part of the food system's public integrity (International Labour Organization, 1981, 2019b).

When complaint patterns, waste, exclusion, staff strain, supply fragility, or cultural bias recur, the City changes the menu, schedule, staffing, contract, space, or service rule rather than asking individuals to absorb the mismatch.

7.4.3 — Libraries as Quiet Burden Relief

The library should give readers time to sit with sources, compare views, follow footnotes, ask what they do not know, and resist premature certainty (Klinenberg, 2018; Aabø and Audunson, 2012). Clearly distinguish public materials, participant study materials, and staff references. Restricted source records remain under the separate regimes specified below.

The library can extend public learning through annotated guides, reading lists, accessible summaries, lectures, and reference support without turning participant study into a visitor attraction. Public interfaces remain distinct from quiet work areas, and materials can show how sources, disagreements, and corrections developed without displaying a learner in a difficult moment.

The library should give participants access to law, history, administration, public finance, comparative politics, ethics, science literacy, biographies of institutional failure, local host-community materials, and records of rival reforms. It should preserve different forms of access: physical books, digital materials, screen-reader compatibility, large print, translation pathways, assisted research, and staff who can help without becoming hidden authorities.

The library also needs a memory boundary. It is a learning environment, not the archive and not a shortcut around record controls. Public bundles, historical cases, anonymized teaching files, published critiques, and lawfully released material can support study; protected raw records, staff complaints, intimate material, and research data remain in their proper regimes. Context should become easier to reach without making restricted source material easier to take.

7.4.4 — Walking Grounds

Walking grounds provide an alternative to keeping every important activity indoors, seated, and verbal.

The path system should support several kinds of walking: solitary regulation, mentor conversation, participant pair discussion, staff recovery, accessible movement, and public-edge orientation. Not every path should carry the same

record status. Some may be public. Some participant-only. Some staff-protected. Some designed for quiet recovery.

Walking loops should not assume a single body or pace. Mobility devices, rest points, shade, lighting, winter conditions, heat, sensory load, seating, wayfinding, and emergency access are part of the design.

Seasonal review should also test drainage and air quality under adverse weather.

The arrangement of a junction can matter as much as the length of a path. Picture two walking loops that meet at a sheltered place to sit. People moving at different speeds can separate for a time and rejoin without anyone having to leave the shared outing altogether. A shorter route can offer its own satisfying circuit rather than feel like the unfinished portion of the longer one. The design gives a person choices about distance and company at the point where those choices become useful. Testing the junction with people who use different mobility aids can reveal whether the meeting place works in practice. In this way, the grounds support a common life through several ways of moving through it.

7.4.5 — Nonperformance Norms

A participant under record may begin to curate kindness, humility, fatigue, reading, apology, friendship, or silence. Nonperformance norms should therefore address incentives to stage ordinary life, not authorize judgments about whether a person is authentic.

Release must serve a defined role purpose rather than narrate ordinary moments. If the public record site rewards small moments too easily, it may encourage participants to stage them for the site. Delayed release, contextual bundles, and

anti-clipping rules help preserve ordinary life from immediate audience capture.

Record role-relevant treatment of staff without making them props for authenticity or evidence objects in public stories. How public-power seekers treat staff may reveal character, but staff are not instruments of moral display.

Daily checks can identify schedule overruns, lost recovery, and audience pressure; a material concern should trigger the bounded review described in Section 17.7.5. Remedies may include longer release delays, less public exposure, lower load, or revised evaluation practices. Review must not become daily scrutiny of sincerity.

Public-facing editors and record-site staff must not turn ordinary shared life into institutional public relations. This includes the City's own publicity. Selecting only moving, charming, or morally pleasing moments trains the City toward sentimental self-display. Audit release curation for emotional manipulation, privacy, and accuracy.

7.5 — Recovery, Health, Quiet, and Reflection Zones

Care spaces also protect the legitimacy of the record. A record of a person in preventable overload is not strong evidence of public-power readiness. It may be evidence of institutional failure. The City must learn to distinguish conduct under ordinary burden from conduct under excessive burden the City itself created. Recovery zones help make that distinction visible (Ulrich, 1984; Hartig et al., 2014; SAMHSA, 2014; WHO, 2018b).

7.5.1 — Sleep Protection Areas

Recovery policy must not reward participants for appearing to need less rest or support.

Sleep protection areas treat sleep as civic infrastructure. Their design should support the rest needed for demanding study, deliberation, correction, and public interaction.

Sleep spaces should reduce light intrusion, sound disturbance, alert pressure, unnecessary monitoring anxiety, schedule instability, and late-night social expectation (WHO, 2018a; Basner et al., 2014).

Sleep remains outside routine audio or video capture in the City role-record system. The institution may maintain necessary environmental, scheduling, emergency, or safety records under declared purposes, but it does not create footage of sleeping bodies to demonstrate continuity or readiness. Any exceptional clinical recording belongs to a separately authorized care process with professional confidentiality and applicable consent requirements. The public record can explain how sleep is protected without exposing the person at rest.

Staff also need sleep-respectful operations. Night staff, security, clinicians, maintenance workers, and emergency responders may carry the cost of participant rest. The City must

design rotations, staffing, and emergency protocols so sleep protection for one group does not become hidden exhaustion for another.

Necessary environmental, alert, and emergency information must not become a nightly behavioral dataset for readiness interpretation.

The City should define sleep windows, emergency exceptions, lighting standards, noise limits, device interruptions, recovery after night events, and protected handling of sleep-related records.

7.5.2 — Clinical Interface Areas

Clinical interface areas protect independent care inside a record-heavy institution.

The clinical interface must distinguish care record, safety signal, operational adjustment, and public release. Some information may be necessary for de-loading or safety. Much should remain protected. Clinical disclosure is not ordinary public-power evidence.

Clinician independence is essential. A clinician cannot simultaneously serve as therapist, admissions officer, disciplinarian, public-relations adviser, political-readiness evaluator, or archive narrator without corrupting care. Safety information may need lawful routing, but the clinical role remains centered on the patient, governed by professional duties, and protected from institutional appetite for evidence.

Staff must also have clinical access.

Clinical interface policy should be written before the first crisis, not negotiated during one. Participants and staff should know the thresholds for confidential care, safety notification, de-loading recommendation, public status, and appeal.

Clinical interface areas must be physically and institutionally distinct from formation authority. The rooms need independent governance, confidentiality categories, emergency exceptions, record boundaries, complaint routes, and medical and legal review.

7.5.3 — Quiet Rooms

The recovery ecology should also produce institutional data in careful aggregate form. If quiet rooms are always full, if sleep protections are constantly breached, if clinical de-loading increases after certain public interfaces, or if staff use crisis spaces more than expected, the City should treat that as evidence about the institution's design.

Quiet rooms provide an intermediate zone between ordinary activity and clinical care, where a person can reduce stimulation without requiring crisis status.

Quiet rooms are for restoration. Use purpose labels, facility checks, and periodic review to prevent secret meetings, donor contact, political strategy, or unlogged influence while keeping the experience calm. Any person-specific access log requires the separate purpose and safeguards in Section 6.5.4.

Report system-level load and recovery capacity without turning individual quiet-room use into a public character signal.

Quiet rooms should be easy to find, accessible, nonpunitive, and available to participants, staff, visitors, and protected contributors before distress becomes acute.

Check whether quiet-room operation shifts unmanaged conflict onto staff, feels like banishment, deters use through exposure, or leaves access status unclear.

7.5.4 — Reflection Spaces

Reflection spaces allow participants and staff to return to meaning without requiring a particular creed. A person under the Transparent Vow may need silence, grief, apology, prayer, meditation, secular reflection, ethical reconsideration, or a place to sit with shame without performing confession. The City must protect this need without becoming a religious institution.

Use remains voluntary; the space should not imply spiritual rank, moral purity, or institutional doctrine.

Reflection spaces can support apology, but they should not stage apology. A participant may need to prepare for repair, grieve harm, face guilt, or consider a correction. That preparation is not the same as public apology. Public apology belongs in its proper record context, with affected persons, remedy, and accountability. Reflection is not a shortcut to absolution.

Reflection rooms should be calm, plural, modest, and accessible.

Entering a reflection space creates no expectation of public disclosure, visible piety, therapeutic narrative, or agreement with a spiritual interpretation. The room is equally protected from donor access, charismatic mentorship, private political negotiation, and religious pressure.

7.5.5 — Crisis De-Loading Rooms

Crisis de-loading rooms provide immediate space for panic, grief, threat, family emergency, public humiliation, conflict, medical distress, or accumulated record strain.

Protected handling is essential because crisis material can be highly vulnerable and easily misused. Raw crisis footage, intimate distress, medical details, or family emergencies should not become public content. Public records may later include

status, summary, remedies, and institutional learning where appropriate, but raw exposure is rarely justified.

The crisis room should be connected to family and nonparticipant rules. Some crises involve loved ones, dependents, intimate partners, or outside harms. The City must be able to contact and protect relevant people without making them public, and to keep the participant's crisis from becoming a gateway into household exposure.

Operate crisis de-loading rooms under Section 9.6's care-before-classification rule. The immediate questions are safety, medical need, psychological support, trusted contact, removal of triggering load, and protection of others. Only after care is secure should the City determine what the event means for record, participation, pause, training, review, exit, or public explanation.

The de-loading room should also have aftercare for the people around the crisis. Staff, peers, visitors, household members, clinicians, and witnesses may carry fear, confusion, resentment, guilt, or secondary trauma. A crisis does not end when the participant becomes calmer. The City should provide debrief, correction, support, and protected channels for those affected.

7.6 — Archive, Public Record Site, and Logistics

Memory and operations require places whose boundaries can be inspected. The archive preserves custody and context; the public record site provides governed access; the operations core coordinates service under review; logistics routes move food, equipment, waste, care, and repairs; maintenance spaces keep the visible institution working. Link the governed public interface to its source archive without merging their access permissions. Raw source material remains under lawful custody; public bundles need enough provenance for civic review. Spatial and operational design must support both integrity and accessibility (ISO, 2016a, 2017; CCSDS, 2012; PREMIS Editorial Committee, 2015; W3C, 2013).

7.6.1 — Archive Location

Placement must support lawful custody, independent inspection, reliable work, and continuity through failure. Source records need controlled access, environmental protection, provenance, backup, emergency procedures, and separation from visitor traffic. The public should understand the archive's purpose and oversight route without receiving access to protected content.

Archivists, technicians, redaction specialists, correction staff, and reviewers need humane workspaces and sufficient staffing.

Site and building review should test fire, flood, heat, power loss, unauthorized access, and other locally relevant hazards.

7.6.2 — Public Record Site Interface

Make interface complexity navigable without moral scores, readiness halos, or sensational clips.

Affected-person routes must be visible. If someone believes they were wrongfully exposed, mischaracterized, omitted, or

harmed by a record bundle, the site should show how to seek correction or remedy.

The public record site interface should be designed as a translation layer. It receives record material that has been governed, labeled, contextualized, protected, delayed, summarized, corrected, or released through lawful rules. It is not a window into raw life. Citizens should be able to understand conduct, reasoning, influence, correction, and readiness without being invited to consume intimate material, medical detail, household spillover, or every unfinished human moment. The interface exists because public trust requires access to meaning, not because curiosity deserves access to everything.

Status labels, provenance notes, version history, correction history, dispute markers, context statements, uncertainty labels, and access limits should be readable to nonexperts.

Built-in sharing should attach the context needed to understand a fragment's status. A search result may need a dispute label, correction history, or access warning; a summary may need the source record and date beside it.

7.6.3 — Operations Core

The operations core coordinates the City's ordinary day. It schedules rooms, routes staff, manages access, tracks maintenance, supports public interface, handles emergencies, coordinates records, and monitors institutional load. That coordination is indispensable, and it concentrates practical power precisely because so many other functions depend on it.

Management decisions shape participant life. A schedule can create fatigue. A room assignment can privilege one person. A public interface slot can amplify another. A staff rotation can hide burnout. A maintenance delay can create dignity failure.

Role assignments, escalation paths, access controls, decision traces, complaint routes, and after-action review should be clear enough to reconstruct consequential choices. Operators need authority to keep the City functioning, while affected people need a path to question how that authority was used.

The operations core should be near enough to hear lived conditions, protected enough for staff to work, and modest enough to avoid command theater.

Conflict disclosures and periodic audits should supplement consequential decision traces.

Operational review should include participants, staff, clinicians, visitors, host communities, maintenance workers, and public users, so schedules, workload, care boundaries, access, local spillover, repairs, and interfaces can be challenged by those affected.

7.6.4 — Logistics Routes

Operations and logistics require a public explanation proportionate to their power. Procurement, deliveries, waste, access credentials, contractor routes, equipment custody, incident response, and maintenance schedules shape what the visible institution can actually do. Transparency here means accountable roles and reviewable processes, not live publication of security-sensitive detail.

Staff safety and ergonomics are part of route design. Heavy loads, long distances, poor lighting, insecure corridors, noise, heat, and inadequate rest points can turn logistics into bodily injury.

Log supply movement, protected-area access, and vendor contact only to the extent required by the role; avoid unnecessary personal tracking.

Apply declared access permissions, logs, privacy limits, and staff pressure-reporting routes to deliveries, contractor visits, and operational handoffs.

7.6.5 — Maintenance Visibility

Public reporting should show whether records, accessibility, safety, utilities, public interfaces, and protected zones remain functional.

Maintenance visibility joins budgets, schedules, backlogs, worker burden, safety incidents, accessibility failures, environmental cost, design defects, and restoration dates in one reviewable account. The record protects worker privacy while preventing the public-facing City from appearing whole as its support systems deteriorate.

Backlog review should rank unresolved work by safety, accessibility, continuity, and worker burden as well as by financial cost.

An ordinary-day chain test should follow several events at once: a citizen requests a public bundle, a participant seeks correction, a protected item enters escrow, a delivery reaches the service edge, a broken component needs repair, and an auditor asks for provenance. The test asks whether people, goods, records, and authority can move through their proper routes without colliding, exposing protected material, or depending on personal favors. Chain tests should rotate operators so continuity is demonstrated by the system rather than by one person’s memory.

The same exercise needs a stop route. If the chain of custody is uncertain, a public bundle is misleading, a service path breaches protected space, a vendor blocks access, or a maintenance failure threatens preservation, the affected release or operation pauses under a named human authority. The pause receives a status

label, correction owner, review clock, and public explanation appropriate to the risk. Restart approval should identify the condition that changed and the person who verified that the affected route can safely resume.

7.7 — Landscape, Water, and the Restorative Exterior

The exterior is part of the City's working institution. Horizon, weather, movement, shade, water, vegetation, silence, and public edges let bodies recover from rooms, screens, records, and continuous interpretation. Landscape also carries drainage, cooling, biodiversity, circulation, emergency access, host connection, and maintenance. A restorative landscape must not be purchased through ecological damage or exclusive use. Design should begin with existing habitat, water, soil, heat, species, public access, cultural meaning, maintenance labor, and climate projections.

7.7.1 — Restorative Landscape

Restorative landscape gives the City a way to reduce load without medicalizing every form of recovery. Trees, shade, gardens, soil, birdsong, textured paths, seasonal change, and open view can help the body regulate after record pressure, deliberation, public interface, or conflict.

Provide restorative outdoor access for participants, staff, visitors, and, where appropriate, the public under the relevant zone rules (Hartig et al., 2014; Nguyen et al., 2021).

Outdoor access bands, route status, and recording categories should be clear before a person enters a conversation or recovery area.

Plant selection, water use, soil health, biodiversity, maintenance practices, and local species should respond to place. Imported luxury landscapes can externalize burden through water, labor, chemicals, heat, or replacement.

Restorative spaces should offer varied combinations of open sky, shade, movement, stillness, sound, quiet, company, and solitude. A setting that seems calm to its designer may feel exposed, inaccessible, hot, noisy, or culturally alien to a user.

7.7.2 — Water Systems

A fountain, pool, garden, cooling feature, or reflective basin may appear restorative while drawing from a stressed watershed or burdening local infrastructure. The water review asks who pays, who loses access or capacity, who maintains the system, what ecological assumptions are being made, and what happens during drought, flood, contamination, or failure.

Water design should prioritize resilience and need before display. Potable systems, greywater reuse, stormwater capture, drainage, flood protection, fire suppression, cooling, and sanitation belong ahead of ornamental effect. Exterior water features should be justified by ecological function, cooling, recovery, or public-edge dignity, not by donor spectacle.

Review water features for safety, disease risks, accessibility, climate failure, maintenance workload, and lifecycle cost.

Report water source, reuse, stormwater capture, drought plans, and ecological limits in terms the public can understand.

7.7.3 — Walking Loops

Walking loops should provide predictable circuits without a new routing decision at every junction. Offer different distances and grades, and test each complete route for accessibility in ordinary and adverse conditions. Assign every loop an access class and current record status under Section 7.4.4.

Apply purpose, role, consent, logging-threshold, privacy, and review rules when a walking conversation becomes consequential role activity. A role meeting does not become exempt from access or record rules because it occurs on an unscheduled walk.

Changes in walking habits may offer an occasion to ask whether the City's demands need adjustment. They do not, by themselves, establish anxiety, avoidance, or performance. Any

care response should begin with the person's account and relevant context, use only information collected for a declared and authorized purpose, and remain separate from admission or moral ranking. Walking should remain an available support, not a behavioral test.

Walking loops should include staff recovery access, with scheduling and boundaries where needed.

7.7.4 — Public Edges

Exterior public edges may include paths, visitor approaches, public gardens, interpretive displays, protest-adjacent spaces, host-community transitions, and visual openings.

Provide lawful protest visibility, safety boundaries, complaint access, and routes for criticism that protect against harassment, doxxing, and intrusion into protected domains.

Host-community use may be possible in some exterior spaces, but only with boundary clarity. Shared gardens, educational walks, public events, or civic displays can build local connection. They can also blur access and create pressure. Public-edge programming should be carefully scoped, accessible, and reviewed for burden on residents and staff.

Test signage, seating, shelter, lighting, transport, accessibility, security posture, translation, and staff scripts after dark, in crowds, in bad weather, under media pressure, and during emergencies. Check these conditions against school travel, care work, deliveries, worship, commerce, sleep, and neighborhood movement.

7.7.5 — Climate Adaptation

Climate adaptation begins with local knowledge as well as technical analysis. Host residents, workers, utilities, emergency responders, Indigenous and customary communities, and long-term land users may understand heat, water, wind, flood,

soil, traffic, and seasonal failure patterns that external teams cannot see from a model. Their knowledge enters design, review, drills, and post-occupancy evaluation alongside engineering and climate evidence.

Climate burdens are unequal. Disabled participants, elders, pregnant people, people with respiratory conditions, clinicians, security staff, maintenance workers, kitchen staff, visitors, and nearby residents may experience the same event very differently. The plan must identify those differences before crisis.

After significant climate events, update the public learning record to show what failed, who carried the burden, what changed, and what remains uncertain. Shade failure, drainage failure, weak air filtration, excessive water demand, or dependence on fragile systems should trigger named correction rather than concealment.

The final exterior review should be a performance walk rather than a beauty tour. Reviewers test the site at dawn, midday heat, darkness, rain, safely simulated smoke conditions, a crowded event, and an ordinary quiet day. They follow a wheelchair route, a maintenance route, a family visit, an emergency approach, a host-neighborhood edge, and water after a storm. The record tests shade, rest, drainage, lighting, noise, surveillance exposure, ecological strain, worker access, and the dignity of leaving.

Chapter 8 — Infrastructure and Resilience

Infrastructure reveals whether the City can keep its principles under load. A power cut can interrupt record systems; a temporary repair can erase an accessible route; a service corridor can become a hidden influence path; an emergency response can protect life while changing ordinary record continuity. Chapter 8 treats each event as institutional evidence. Systems are judged by the services they preserve, the burdens they redistribute, the people they protect, and the corrections they make possible after failure.

Active-record infrastructure comes first because trust cannot rest on a mysterious capture stack. Capture remains a technical service under law and human authority, never a machine judgment about the person recorded.

Accessibility is treated as an integrity condition before opening. Mobility, sensory, cognitive, communication, and emergency access are not one checklist and cannot be delegated to a late compliance review. Complete journeys, real tasks, temporary closures, crowded conditions, fatigue, communication differences, and interaction with digital systems all matter.

Construction brings the institution's first labor and environmental record into being. Material extraction, contractor chains, site safety, heat, dust, carbon, waste, transport, procurement, substitutions, repairability, and future maintenance reveal whether burden honesty begins before participants arrive.

Technical vocabulary must not become a shadow language for hidden power. A server contract, security checkpoint, material specification, evacuation route, procurement choice, or maintenance deferral is a burden decision. Experts need sufficient detail to evaluate performance and risk, while affected people need a plain-language account of the system's effects and what to do when it fails.

Every critical system carries a service statement, accountable owner, dependency map, maintenance schedule, failure log, manual fallback, vendor-exit plan, recovery objective, correction route, and retirement condition. Standards provide disciplined vocabulary and tested practices, while local evidence shows whether the system actually serves its users. An affected person should be able to learn what failed, who owned restoration, which service returned, what remained unavailable, and what changed afterward (ISO, 2019; UNDRR, 2022; NIST, 2020c, 2024a).

Architects, engineers, archivists, cybersecurity reviewers, accessibility experts, emergency planners, public administrators, labor scholars, clinicians, construction professionals, disability advocates, procurement specialists, and civil-liberties readers will test different parts of the chapter. One asks whether the system works; another whether it exposes too much; another who maintains it; another what happens when it fails. The design must let those questions meet in the same record.

That expert depth still has to remain human. The reader should be able to follow a failed lift, an inaccessible detour, a dropped record stream, a worker refusing unsafe work, an evacuation under smoke, a family emergency, or a repair budget cut and see the chain of decisions that produced the burden. Technical seriousness is the ability to explain consequence, not the accumulation of jargon.

8.1 — Capture Infrastructure and Continuity Systems

The capture stack begins with a dependency map rather than a device catalogue. Power, networks, clock synchronization, mounting, environmental conditions, permissions, firmware, staff procedure, storage, and repair capacity determine whether each device can perform its stated role. Mapping those links reveals single points of failure and prevents a technical gap from being misread as personal evasion. It also lets the City decide which dependencies need redundancy, manual fallback, independent verification, or retirement.

8.1.1 — Record Hardware

Test the stack under ordinary use, altered access conditions, and failures, including power loss, network failure, public-interface overload, emergency movement, protected nonvisibility, device replacement, insider misuse, cyberattack, and legal hold.

The City needs sensors, microphones, access logs, environmental monitors, time sources, secure edge devices, and human verification stations only where they serve the active public-power record. Each component requires a lawful basis and protection for incidental persons.

A hardware registry should therefore be treated as a civic artifact. Each device should have a stated purpose, physical location, activation state, responsible custodian, maintenance schedule, calibration history, access class, privacy impact, protected-zone limitation, and failure procedure. This registry need not expose security-sensitive details to the public, but it must be available to the relevant oversight bodies.

The hardware plan should also include a hardware-status taxonomy. A device can be active, degraded, disabled, under repair, in emergency fallback, or retired. Each status should carry a record consequence. If a device is degraded, public

interpretation must not treat its output as ordinary capture. If it is disabled, the reason and substitute procedure must be known. If it is retired, the archive should preserve when and why that occurred.

Hardware must align with each zone's purpose and access band. A public deliberation hall, clinical interface, residential threshold, service route, and emergency exit require different capture arrangements. A protected nonvisibility area cannot use the same capture logic as a public record room.

The hardware plan should preserve vendor independence. Hardware should not trap the City inside one company's formats, firmware, licensing, access controls, analytics, or maintenance pipeline. If record hardware cannot be audited, replaced, migrated, or operated under public-interest governance, it has become a hidden authority.

Maintainability requires funded cleaning, calibration, replacement, access review, security updates, and physical inspection, including attention to degrading microphones, failed readers, depleted batteries, shifted mounts, and aging wiring.

8.1.2 — Redundant Storage

Redundancy should protect civic memory without multiplying exposure. A copy is not harmless because it is a backup. Every replicated record creates another location where breach, misuse, corruption, subpoena, vendor failure, or administrative drift can occur. The storage design should therefore distinguish hot operational copies, cold preservation copies, encrypted escrow, local continuity caches, and disaster recovery repositories. Each copy should have a purpose, retention rule, access class, deletion path, and incident owner.

A storage design should be tested against four losses: loss of source, loss of status, loss of context, and loss of control. Losing

the source destroys memory. Losing status makes protected material appear ordinary. Losing context makes fragments look more certain than they are. Losing control turns preservation into exposure. Redundant storage must protect all four, not merely keep files alive.

The storage-migration plan must exist before migration becomes urgent. Storage systems age, formats change, vendors disappear, encryption standards evolve, and public access tools are replaced. Migration should preserve provenance, correction history, status labels, sealing decisions, access limits, and public bundle relationships.

Apply encryption, provenance, and lawful sealing to backups; copying a record creates no permission to sell it or reuse it for model training.

Keep operational storage, protected escrow, archival preservation, recovery copies, public bundles, and oversight repositories functionally separate.

Redundancy also requires independent recoverability. If restoration depends on one vendor, cloud region, proprietary format, administrator group, or undocumented procedure, the record remains fragile even when copies exist. Recovery tests should prove that lawful records, status labels, audit trails, protections, and correction histories can be restored.

Geographic distribution may protect records from fire, flood, sabotage, and system failure, but it introduces jurisdictional risk. A record stored across borders may face different laws, access demands, surveillance exposure, vendor rules, or emergency powers. Legal architecture and expert review must shape where records may reside.

Recovery drills should also distinguish restored records from altered or partial ones.

Redundant storage must also protect nonparticipants. A masked face, protected summary, delayed-release category, or third-party shield should not be undone because raw backup exists somewhere else.

8.1.3 — Integrity Monitoring

Logs, checksums, anomaly alerts, access histories, and chain-of-custody reports are useful only when they are themselves governed. The City should know who can configure alerts, who can silence them, who can reinterpret them, who receives escalation, and how false positives are corrected.

The monitoring design should separate technical anomaly from moral conclusion. A missing segment, unusual access pattern, sensor drift, corrupted timestamp, or device restart may indicate accident, maintenance, cyberattack, misuse, environmental stress, or emergency improvisation. The alert should not become accusation. It should trigger classification, preservation, notice, and review.

The monitoring system should also track its own burden on staff. Constant alerts can create alarm fatigue, and alarm fatigue can become hidden failure. The City should review alert volume, false-positive rates, staff response time, escalation clarity, and whether monitoring produces anxiety without useful protection.

Monitor records for disappearance, alteration, truncation, mislabeling, incorrect dates, selective synchronization, and loss of context.

Monitoring should produce a bounded statement of system condition, uncertainty, affected material, accountable owner, and required response.

Log and audit monitoring itself. Provide interpretable summaries for reviewers, technical-claim challenges for affected

people, and appropriate aggregate public reporting without exposing attack-sensitive details.

Review false negatives as well as false positives, and preserve appeal and correction routes.

Integrity monitoring must cover restricted, sealed, and delayed-release material; protection from public view does not remove integrity obligations. In some cases, protected records need stronger monitoring because fewer people can inspect them.

Record completeness and trustworthiness are distinct. Completeness asks whether the records required for a defined active-role purpose are present; trustworthiness asks whether they can be authenticated, contextualized, challenged, repaired, and lawfully used. Completeness alone does not establish reliability, and a partial record can remain useful when its limits are explicit and its defects are addressed (ISO, 2016a, 2017; CCSDS, 2012; NDSA, 2019; NIST, 2024a).

8.1.4 — Failure Logging

Capture governance should also distinguish technical time, institutional time, and human time. Technical time asks whether devices synchronized. Institutional time asks when a decision, incident, repair, or notice occurred. Human time asks when an affected person could reasonably understand what happened and respond. A fair continuity system does not collapse these clocks into one machine timestamp.

A failure log records uncertainty explicitly, including unknown causes and unresolved effects. Public notices should translate its status without exposing protected technical or personal information.

Use stable status language for minor interruption, material gap, protected emergency interruption, suspected tamper event,

confirmed integrity breach, inaccessible record, delayed reconstruction, and unrecoverable loss. Record lawful noncapture as a separate authorized state, not as a failure. These labels should not be improvised each time embarrassment appears.

The failure log should record category, time, duration, who detected the problem, affected systems and records, known facts, unknowns, likely cause, uncertainty level, participant or nonparticipant impact, interim measures, corrective action, responsible review body, the condition requiring independent review, and public status where needed. Access to technical and protected-person details remains restricted as appropriate.

Logs should identify system causes, not only human names.

Classify severity and identify the required combination of internal correction, affected-person notice, public status, and shutdown review.

Trend repeated incidents so drift cannot be hidden by classifying each event as an isolated anomaly.

8.1.5 — Emergency Capture Protocols

During an emergency, ordinary capture may need to change to protect life, dignity, or response. The City may route people through unusual paths, suspend public feeds, switch to restricted capture, rely on manual logs, or preserve a protected summary until the scene is safe. Each deviation is a temporary integrity measure with a recorded reason, status, authority, and later review, not permission for secret active life.

The protocol identifies the threshold at which care, evacuation, or immediate safety outranks ordinary recording procedure. As soon as conditions permit, document the change with a minimal status record and the responsible authority, protect affected people, and arrange later reconstruction. Emergency may make

perfect documentation impossible; it does not erase the fact that normal controls were suspended.

The emergency protocol should have a rehearsed break-glass structure. Break-glass access means a narrow, logged, time-limited departure from ordinary access or capture procedure for immediate life, safety, or system-continuity reasons. It should require identity, reason, scope, duration, later review, and affected-person assessment. It should never become a standing convenience for senior officials, security teams, technical administrators, or public-relations pressure.

Emergency capture must also account for emotional and cognitive aftermath. A person who has just survived a medical event, threat, fire, evacuation, or family emergency may not be able to understand record-status notices immediately. The City should provide delayed explanation, advocate support where appropriate, and an appeal route after stabilization.

Emergency capture must protect incidental responders and other nonparticipants while preserving the event's lawful public-power record.

Audit emergency-use patterns by person, route, device, room, and category, including possible misclassification, expanded security exceptions, or concealed vendor outages.

The protocol should be rehearsed with the people who will use it, not merely written by those who govern it. Clinicians, security staff, archive staff, disabled users, maintenance workers, public interface workers, and outside responders should test whether the rule can be carried under pressure.

A failover drill should end with a restoration test, not merely confirmation that backup systems activated. The City should identify records created under emergency rules, permissions that changed, data delayed or lost, people affected, notices issued, and reconciliations still open.

8.2 — Service Routes and Maintenance Labor

Service-route review should use worker observation, task trials, ergonomic assessment, rest-access checks, and complaint evidence. Protect service workers from being used as intermediaries for unlogged messages, favors, or privileged participant access. A staff-burden register should run beside the participant record without exposing staff private life. It can track staffing ratios, recurring overload, unsafe routes, maintenance backlog, emotional labor, injury patterns, complaint categories, turnover, and unresolved hidden-cost warnings (International Labour Organization, 1981, 1988; NIOSH, 1997).

8.2.1 — Service Route Dignity

A service-route map must remain visible to governance even where it is not public. This map should identify the paths by which food, waste, cleaning, maintenance, supplies, devices, records media, medical support, and emergency equipment move. It should also identify which routes intersect with participant spaces, protected domains, public spaces, and staff-only domains.

Service routes should communicate purpose, safety, emergency exits, protected boundaries, and escalation options without reliance on informal lore or unsafe shortcuts.

Service route design should include adequate width, clear signage, safe surfaces, ergonomic movement, climate control, lighting, rest access, emergency egress, and separation from public spectacle.

Service route dignity should be audited. Workers should have complaint routes, anonymous reporting where needed, and participation in route review.

8.2.2 — Maintenance Staffing

Maintenance staffing is civic capacity that has to exist before opening. Record hardware, lifts, water systems, accessibility devices, emergency equipment, kitchens, landscape, communications, lighting, security tools, and archive environments all depend on skilled people, workable shifts, training time, spare capacity, and safe callout. The staffing plan records skill mix, coverage, on-call limits, recovery, succession risk, contractor dependence, and trigger points for narrowing service. Deferred hiring becomes visible as a continuity and safety decision rather than an invisible economy.

Calculate staffing from actual systems and their recurring tasks: record-device calibration; door adjustment; secure-room inspection; public-interface uptime; monitoring of heating, cooling, water, air quality, and electrical systems; accessibility maintenance; emergency drills; and landscape and drainage care.

Watch for skipped inspections, postponed repairs, overtime, unsafe shortcuts, and compounding minor failures as signs of insufficient staffing.

Staffing should be tied to system complexity. A simple, maintainable design may require fewer specialized staff. A highly technical design may require more staff, more vendors, more training, more cybersecurity, and more redundancy. If the City chooses complexity, it must fund the labor complexity creates.

Maintenance staffing also requires role clarity. Workers need authority to take systems offline when safety requires it, report deferred maintenance, challenge symbolic spending that crowds out repair, and escalate risk without retaliation.

Train maintenance workers in role-record boundaries, privacy, nonparticipant protection, cybersecurity, and dignity protocols

before they work in protected zones or on record, emergency, public-interface, or accessibility systems.

Staffing sufficiency belongs in pilot review, continued-operation review, and public maintenance reporting. When upkeep cannot keep pace, growth pauses before the workload is transferred to workers or users.

Preserve maintenance knowledge through documentation, training, respectful retention, and succession, including why systems were designed as they were.

8.2.3 — Safety and Ergonomics

Ergonomic review should cover lifting, reaching, kneeling, repetitive inspection, night repair, confined-space work, heat exposure, chemical handling, ladder use, electrical work, alarm response, and eye strain at monitoring stations.

Ergonomic review should include the actual tasks of the City, not generic office posture. A record technician may need safe access to ceiling devices. A custodian may need service rooms close enough to avoid exhausting routes. A clinician may need unobstructed emergency movement. A landscape worker may need shade, water, and equipment storage. A security staffer may need a station that permits calm observation rather than constant vigilance strain.

Assess cumulative repetition and awkward posture, not only a single task or dramatic hazard. Repeated lifts and reaches can create occupational risk even when each movement appears manageable.

Use rotation, supervision, rest, and escalation for complaint intake, moderation, security screening, archive correction, public interface, and emergency response. Include ergonomic assessment in early design, with carts, lifts, adjustable stations,

anti-fatigue surfaces, proper lighting, hearing protection, ventilation, tool access, and safe storage.

Protect service and maintenance workers from harassment, retaliation, public exposure, and role confusion during tense or sensitive assignments.

Safety data must remain a protection tool rather than a surveillance file. Injury reports, near misses, equipment faults, overload indicators, and hazard observations should be collected to improve work, staffing, training, and design. They should not become punitive productivity measures, public reputation signals, or evidence of a worker's character. Purpose limits, access controls, anti-retaliation rules, retention schedules, and worker review are part of the safety system itself.

Ergonomics interacts with record design. If a device requires constant manual correction, someone carries that burden. If a public record site has repeated technical glitches, staff absorb frustration. If a door system misclassifies access, security and maintenance workers carry conflict. The City must evaluate systems by the labor they require when they fail, not only by how they function in demonstration.

Apply the stop-work and escalation authority in Section 8.2.2 when a task risks injury, record breach, nonparticipant exposure, or unsafe public access.

8.2.4 — Operational Transparency

Public operations reporting can show staffing levels and categories, maintenance schedules, backlog classes, dependencies, service-route principles, vendor roles, outages and major failures, response times, safety review and incidents, significant repairs and deferrals, and budget pressure. The object is the support system, not the worker's private day.

Different audiences require different operational views. The public needs intelligible status and consequence. Oversight needs fuller logs and supporting records. Staff need work-order detail and safe internal communication. Protected people need notice when their spaces or records are affected. Security-sensitive information may require lawful shielding.

Operational dashboards can create false precision or expose staff to blame. Report at a level useful for governance, meaningful to the public, and protective of workers.

Use distinct status labels for planned maintenance, emergency repairs, accessibility outages, record-device downtime, service-route closures, and vendor incidents.

Operational transparency works through role-bounded explanation. A repair report identifies the affected service, status, delay, owner, interim protection, and next review without publishing a worker's identity by default, exposing a security-sensitive route, or revealing a protected zone.

8.2.5 — Staff Privacy Boundaries

Staffing and cost calculations should include workers' exposure to records and access to sensitive areas.

Staff privacy boundaries require more than a statement that staff are not participants. Service workers may appear incidentally in participant records, emergency logs, access systems, complaint files, maintenance tickets, and public-record explanations. The City should define when staff identity is necessary, when a role label is sufficient, when masking is required, and how workers can object to unnecessary exposure.

Apply staff privacy boundaries to contractors and temporary workers through contract terms, badges, orientation, access logs, and incident procedures.

Configure staff-role capture under Section 21.2.1 for material access, advice, work, safety, complaints, interventions and conflicts. Exclude off-duty, medical and unrelated domestic material under Section 21.2.2.

Excessive exposure can narrow recruitment to workers unusually tolerant of it. Role limits should allow skilled workers to serve without surrendering ordinary private life.

Staff consent should be meaningful and role-specific. Employment terms must clearly state what role records exist, what is logged, what can be reviewed, what is public, what is protected, and how staff may challenge misuse. That notice should be renewed whenever technology or job design materially changes what the institution can observe. Renewal should identify any new sensor, access log, or review authority before the change takes effect.

The boundary should be revisited when roles change. A worker promoted into a sensitive archive role, a maintenance contractor given recurring protected-zone access, or a moderator assigned to public interface review may need a different role record. Changing duty should change record status through notice and consent, not through invisible expansion. A short transition record should identify the new duty, changed visibility, review date, and route to challenge the change. If the worker refuses the changed burden, reassignment or exit should remain available without retaliation.

8.3 — Accessibility, Disability, and Sensory Inclusion

Accessibility supports movement, communication, comprehension, and independent use across varied bodies, senses, cognition, language, stamina, and technology access. Ordinary participation should not depend on avoidable detours, unnecessary disclosure, or staff availability when independent access is feasible; requested assistance must remain available. Disability expertise must shape the building before design decisions are fixed. Mobility, sensory, cognitive, communication, psychiatric, chronic illness, fatigue, pain, neurodivergence, aging, temporary injury, pregnancy, and trauma-related needs all affect how a person carries the City.

8.3.1 — Universal Design Baseline

The baseline needs authority to stop an opening, delay an event, revise a route, change signage, add quiet capacity, repair an assistive system, or require independent review when access fails.

Accessibility belongs inside ordinary operations. A meeting is not fully scheduled until its access conditions are known. A route is not complete until varied movement, communication, cognition, and sensory needs have been considered. A public record bundle is not ready until comprehension and assistive-technology use have been tested.

Use-case testing turns the universal-design baseline into lived evidence. Reviewers should follow a wheelchair user through a safely simulated fire evacuation, a blind visitor through the public record site, a neurodivergent participant from public interface to sensory refuge, a person with low literacy through consent, and a staff member with chronic pain along a full service route.

No design anticipates every body or context. The baseline therefore includes feedback and accessibility complaint routes, expert audit, participant and staff review, and public usability testing.

8.3.2 — Mobility Access

Mobility access must survive temporary conditions. Construction hoarding, repairs, deliveries, crowds, security incidents, weather, wet surfaces, broken lifts, and event furniture can defeat routes that appear accessible on drawings. Every temporary change needs an accessible alternative, clear notice, and a person responsible for restoring the route.

Test whether people can reach residence, learning, dining, deliberation, public interface, care, evacuation, reflection, archive access, complaints, visitors, and emergency assistance without segregation, avoidable delay, exhaustion, or exceptional permission.

The City should review distance, slope, weather exposure, resting points, door hardware, elevator redundancy, tactile surfaces, seating, signage, emergency refuge, and the social meaning of the path.

Plan alternate accessible routes, maintenance priority, evacuation arrangements, rest points, seating intervals, and clear outage notices for lift failure, blocked ramps, flooded paths, or unavailable accessible vehicles.

Vertical-access redundancy must remain usable during evacuation and maintenance outages, not only during ordinary operation; emergency plans should be tested with the bodies and assistance needs the City actually serves.

Mobility access also affects record boundaries. If an accessible route forces a person through a more visible area than others use, the City has created unequal exposure. If the only accessible

route passes through staff zones or protected areas, it creates role confusion. If mobility assistance requires excessive staff involvement, it may create privacy loss. Access routes must preserve dignity and record status.

Outdoor mobility deserves attention. Walking grounds, restorative exterior, public edges, paths to protest areas, host-community interface, and emergency assembly points must be usable across weather, terrain, light, and fatigue conditions.

Maintenance determines whether mobility access remains real. Slopes settle, doors become heavy, surfaces crack, automatic openers fail, tactile guides wear, and snow, heat, rain, or debris can make a route unusable. These failures need inspection, reporting, and prompt repair as governance matters.

Include media presence and simultaneous public events in those mobility-access tests.

8.3.3 — Cognitive Access

Users should be able to understand where they are, what rules apply, where to get help, how to leave, and how to contest a problem.

The cognitive-access plan should use redundant cues for comprehension: plain-language signs, icons where useful, maps that do not disclose protected routes, staff wayfinding points, orientation rehearsals, digital supports, quiet waiting places, and crisis instructions that can be understood under pressure. Cognitive access also requires restraint. Too many alerts, screens, warnings, options, and labels can become their own form of exclusion.

Use precise plain language for the distinction relevant to each task: for example, capture versus release on a record notice, or fact versus allegation in a public bundle. Put the explanation at the decision point.

Design confirmations, summaries, repeated cues, and review steps for users affected by memory, attention, stress, trauma, language difference, or neurodivergence.

Cognitive access protects agency. Consent terms must be understandable before agreement; status labels must let public readers distinguish fact, allegation, correction, and uncertainty; and appeal routes must remain usable by a person under stress. Readability testing, alternative formats, supported decision-making, translation, teach-back, and independent assistance prevent complexity from becoming a gatekeeper.

Ask users to explain in ordinary language what the relevant service requires of them and how they can seek help or challenge a decision.

8.3.4 — Sensory Access

Apply Section 6.5's sensory-load review to routine operations, including light flicker, glare, echo, alarms, mechanical hum, crowd density, scent, temperature, screen brightness, visible capture equipment, and abrupt transitions. Integrate user-adjustable features and low-stimulation alternatives where function permits.

Make recording equipment's purpose, active status, shielding, and available relief understandable without an aggressive visual presence. Adjust seating arrangements, lighting, waiting times, and noise at public interfaces.

Sensory refuge is an accessibility route. The practical test is whether a person can identify, reach, use, and leave a lower-stimulation space without stigma, delay, or loss of the service they came to receive.

Alarms and emergency systems require particular care. They must be noticeable, accessible, and effective across hearing, vision, cognition, and mobility differences, but they should not

produce avoidable panic or sensory injury. Redundant signals, visual alerts, tactile cues, plain instructions, and staff support can protect safety without relying on one overwhelming stimulus.

Public record interfaces should avoid dense labels, flashing alerts, auto-playing media, and complex navigation that obstruct review or dramatize the record.

Assess staff sensory exposure over the full shift, including noise, lighting, screens, and repeated alerts in service, moderation, archive, security, clinical, and maintenance work.

8.3.5 — Accessibility Audit

Accessibility also protects public interpretation. If only certain bodies can move easily through the City, the public receives a distorted picture of who appears calm, articulate, punctual, steady, or resilient. Exclusion can masquerade as character evidence. Access failure therefore risks converting design bias into public-power judgment (United Nations, 2006; ISO, 2021a; Steinfeld and Maisel, 2012; Hamraie, 2017; World Health Organization, 2022c; W3C, 2023).

The accessibility program needs both individual accommodation and shared-system redesign. Accommodation addresses a person’s access needs; redesign changes the environment so fewer people need a separate adjustment. Use both, favoring redesign where it can remove predictable barriers.

An accessibility audit needs authority before opening and throughout operation. Disabled reviewers and users, accessibility professionals, emergency planners, staff representatives, and clinicians where relevant should test the institution under ordinary and stressed conditions.

Testing should combine walk-throughs with real tasks: entering a building, reaching care, using the record interface, understanding consent, submitting a complaint, and evacuating.

Reviewers should test crowding, lift or screen failure, noise, fatigue, distress, and conflicting demands.

Each material finding needs an accountable office, funded remedy, deadline, interim protection, retest, and appeal route. Immediate hazards pause or close the affected function. Significant barriers may remain under a dated repair plan only while interim accommodation preserves safe, dignified access; otherwise the function pauses until independent retesting confirms repair. A failed retest preserves the pause. Recurring failures require redesign or governance review, and less urgent defects remain on a dated schedule. Public summaries report progress without exposing personal information (Steinfeld and Maisel, 2012; Hamraie, 2017).

Accessibility complaints may reveal disability, medical condition, cognitive profile, trauma history, or family need. Protect individual requests and accommodation records; use aggregate reporting to expose recurring barriers. Check for missing voices: silence may indicate an inaccessible reporting route rather than an absence of need.

Repeat accessibility review after construction, occupancy, public-interface launch, major technology changes, emergency drills, renovation, and before operating-status renewal. Disabled users and workers should be able to challenge the official account. Compare promised access with actual task completion across conditions and user groups, assigning each finding to a named owner.

8.4 — Construction and Materials

Construction extends the City's public record before any participant arrives. Land disturbance, procurement, worker conditions, material extraction, transport, energy, carbon, waste, biodiversity, and host disruption all belong to the project's civic account. Whole-life assessment follows those burdens through manufacture, construction, use, maintenance, adaptation, disassembly, and reuse. A beautiful campus is worthy of its purpose only when its making can withstand labor, environmental, cost, and community scrutiny (ISO, 2006a, 2006b; RICS, 2023; UNEP and GlobalABC, 2026).

8.4.1 — Material Source Burden

Source review covers stone, timber, steel, concrete, glass, electronics, batteries, wiring, insulation, finishes, furniture, and sensor components, including extraction abuse, forced-labor risk, toxic exposure, and ecological harm.

Review provenance, labor conditions, ecological impact, climate suitability, durability, repairability, replacement availability, transport, local effects, and dependence on unstable or coercive suppliers. Record the choice, reasons, alternatives, and accepted burdens.

Distinguish functional materials from prestige choices. Test whether rare finishes, dramatic glass, imported timber, or fashionable components justify their burden compared with durable, repairable, locally maintainable alternatives.

Define refusal criteria for exploitative, fragile, energy-intensive, unrepairable, or excessively extravagant materials, including when donor preferences would otherwise override them.

Review replacement horizons, including rare parts, proprietary contracts, long shipping routes, and hazardous disposal.

8.4.2 — Labor in Construction

The build record should remain available after opening so safety incidents, accessibility changes, vendor dependencies, and budget revisions do not disappear from later evaluation (International Labour Organization, 1988).

Before any participant carries a Transparent Vow, workers carry heat, height, dust, deadlines, injury risk, commute burden, wage pressure, subcontracting complexity, and project uncertainty. The public should not be asked to admire a building produced through rushed work, unpaid time, unsafe sequencing, weak grievance routes, or retaliation against workers who slow the schedule for safety (International Labour Organization, 2022b).

Construction transparency should include worker voice. Public summaries need not expose individual workers, but they should show safety performance, wage compliance, subcontractor accountability, change-order pressure, injury response, rest conditions, language access, training, accommodation, and complaint outcomes.

The construction plan must address costs imposed on the host through mitigation and remedy. Local workers may benefit from jobs, but they may also carry rent pressure, traffic, noise, displacement, or public-service strain. Apprenticeship, local procurement, fair bidding, traffic planning, worker transport, community notice, and complaint routes should be treated as construction ethics.

Require safety planning, training, protective equipment, hazard reporting, stop-work authority, accident review, and fair scheduling, including protection against unsafe acceleration.

Construction labor intersects with immigration status, local employment, union conditions, apprenticeships, housing, transport, and regional labor demand. The project should

disclose recruitment, employment entities, wage and hour rules, accommodation, safety representation, complaint routes, and the effect of its hiring on essential local services.

Protected worker channels should cover safety, contractor standards, wages, incidents, corrective actions, and labor complaints, with safeguards against retaliation, loss of work, or threats concerning immigration status.

8.4.3 — Carbon and Energy Load

Carbon and energy review should make the City's construction burden as visible as its operating burden; efficiency after opening cannot erase the emissions embedded in what was built (UNEP and GlobalABC, 2026).

Resilience changes energy ethics. Backup power, distributed generation, storage, passive survivability, load shedding, cooling, and critical-system priorities all carry costs and external effects. The review should identify which functions must persist, for whom, for how long, with what fuel or storage, and under whose authority, rather than treating maximum continuity as an unquestioned good.

The energy-continuity plan must address failure in layers: brief interruption, extended outage, extreme heat or cold, cyber-linked utility failure, fuel or grid disruption, and regional disaster. Each layer should state what continues, what narrows, what pauses, what is protected, and what public status applies.

Distinguish operational energy (heating, cooling, lighting, computing, ventilation, storage, water, transport, security, and daily use) from embodied energy associated with materials, manufacturing, transport, construction, and replacement. Assess the greenhouse-gas emissions associated with each separately; energy use and carbon emissions are related but are not interchangeable quantities. An efficient building may still have

high embodied emissions, while an initially low-carbon material may create additional burden if it fails early.

Test renewable generation, storage, microgrids, passive design, efficient systems, thermal resilience, and demand management under heat, storms, fire, cyberattack, and maintenance constraints.

Count power and hardware for archive storage, redundancy, search, security monitoring, Artificial Intelligence assistance, rendering, public access, backups, and cybersecurity.

Public energy reporting should cover usage categories, resilience status, emergency capacity, efficiency improvements, maintenance problems, and carbon-reduction efforts while protecting security-sensitive detail.

8.4.4 — Waste and Lifecycle Review

Waste review should begin at design, not demolition. Systems chosen for ease of launch may become future burdens when replacement parts are proprietary, batteries are hard to recycle, sensors become obsolete, finishes fail early, or renovation creates hazardous waste. Lifecycle review should ask how components are repaired, repurposed, disassembled, recycled, safely disposed of, or avoided altogether.

Avoid novelty waste from custom fixtures, experimental surfaces, branded interiors, one-off interfaces, and display technologies that are difficult to maintain. Favor components that can be understood, repaired, sourced, upgraded, and retired.

A finish that looks pristine but requires toxic cleaning will shift burden to staff and environment.

A materials-and-systems passport should accompany every major component. Such a passport can record source, installation date, expected service life, replacement route, repair instructions,

warranty, recycling or disposal path, known risks, and responsible custodian.

Construction also generates waste. Offcuts, packaging, demolition debris, soil movement, broken materials, temporary structures, and procurement errors can create large early burdens. The City should design for waste reduction, reuse, recycling, safe disposal, and transparency.

Lifecycle review also protects host communities from delayed burden. Waste does not vanish because it leaves the campus. Disposal routes, demolition plans, electronic waste, and hazardous materials may affect other places and workers. The City's burden review should follow waste far enough to avoid exporting harm under the name of cleanliness.

8.4.5 — Materials and Construction Transparency

Construction discipline aims at traceable compromise rather than purity. No major building can be made without supply chains, permits, cost pressure, delays, and imperfect information. The ethical task is to identify burdens, reduce what can be reduced, justify what remains, protect workers, avoid prestige waste, and preserve repair and replacement routes.

Construction transparency governs decisions without turning workers into content. Public reporting can show contractor selection logic, beneficial ownership, major change orders, cost escalation, material substitutions, land and utility effects, safety performance, delay causes, community impacts, grievance status, and remedy. Individual workers retain privacy and freedom from harassment, and cameras are not used to create a civic spectacle out of labor.

Protect vulnerabilities, worker private details, security layouts, and sensitive technical schematics in the construction record;

public status reporting should allow review of the decision without disclosing those details.

Disclose design changes driven by donor preference, naming ambitions, prestige pressure, or symbolic extravagance, linking funding decisions to design choices.

Host communities need specific construction transparency. They should know expected disruption, traffic, noise, utility changes, public service load, safety measures, complaint routes, mitigation commitments, and schedule changes.

Report material departures from plan, their reasons, and the burdens created or reduced, including changes caused by planning failures, vendor pressure, budgets, labor risk, or environmental problems.

Later builders should be able to learn what cost too much, what failed early, what overburdened workers, what materials performed well, what procurement rules mattered, and what host-community effects were underestimated.

8.5 — Emergency Systems and Continuity of Care

Emergency planning begins with the endangered person. Who is trapped, overloaded, unable to hear an alarm, unable to use stairs, dependent on medication, separated from a child or caregiver, carrying protected material, or uncertain where to go? Those questions organize routes, refuge, staffing, communication, transport, clinical handoff, accessible alerts, and family contact. Record rules then support later accountability without delaying rescue, care, evacuation, or stabilization.

8.5.1 — Medical Emergency Routes

Medical routes should be planned with clinical time in mind. A person in respiratory distress, cardiac crisis, seizure, severe allergic reaction, psychiatric emergency, pregnancy complication, injury, or acute overload cannot wait for the institution to reconcile record formalities. Routes must be direct, known, accessible, clear of spectacle, coordinated with local emergency services, and able to shift into protected handling immediately.

During medical transport, preserve only necessary integrity, review, and continuity facts while shielding clinical details, bystanders, families, and responders unless lawful review requires more. Documentation must not delay care.

Specify who calls, who escorts, where responders enter, what information is shared or shielded, how incidental persons are protected, and how record status changes during care. Rehearse the route with staff and responders.

Medical records created during emergency should remain governed by health privacy, consent where possible, clinical independence, and later record-status review. The fact that an emergency happens inside the City does not make intimate health information automatically public-power evidence. Some

facts may matter to the City's safety and continuity review; many details belong in protected care records or restricted summaries.

Clinical handoff requires clear role boundaries. Emergency responders, clinicians, security, operators, archive staff, and participant-support staff may all become involved. Each role should know what information is necessary for care, what is protected, what must be logged, what may be delayed, and who reviews the emergency record afterward.

Medical routes should include accessibility and communication needs. A person may be Deaf, blind, mobility-impaired, cognitively overloaded, nonverbal, in panic, medicated, injured, or unable to explain history. The City should prepare emergency communication tools, accessible evacuation aids, medication information handling, and support persons where lawful.

After medical emergencies, the City should review timing, route function, dignity protection, staff coordination, record impact, nonparticipant exposure, and recovery support.

Privacy duties continue after the event. Restrict staff disclosure of protected medical information and use a minimal truthful status notice when needed to address an observed emergency without exposing clinical details.

8.5.2 — Fire and Evacuation Systems

Emergency systems separate immediate command from lasting authority. Record exceptional direction, access changes and protective nonrelease under Section 26.5.2, then complete the return protocol in Section 26.5.5 (UNDRR, 2015; ISO, 2018c, 2019; FEMA, 2021; WHO, 2019b).

Fire and evacuation design should account for the City's unusual population and record conditions. Participants, visitors,

disabled persons, staff, contractors, children or dependents in shielded zones, public-interface users, archive workers, and emergency responders may all move differently during alarm. The City needs drills, refuge areas, redundant alarms, tactile and visual signals, smoke control, clear assembly rules, protected-person procedures, and routes that do not reveal private household or care spaces unnecessarily.

Safely simulate combined evacuation failures at night as well as during the day: unavailable lifts, blocked preferred routes, noisy communications, malfunctioning doors, crowds outside, unsafe assembly weather, and loss of record-system power.

Evacuation drills must remain distinct from spectacle. Drills should be serious, scheduled and unscheduled within reason, trauma-aware, and publicly reviewable at the status level. They should not be used to humiliate participants, test panic for entertainment, expose protected persons, or create dramatic footage for public trust.

Use zone-specific, comprehensible procedures for public halls, residential wings, clinical interfaces, archives, service routes, protected nonvisibility areas, and record hardware rooms.

Do not delay evacuation for record formalities. Where practicable, log shutdowns, capture changes, opened protected zones, rerouted exits, and sealed data rooms; reconstruct missing status information afterward.

Plan return after evacuation: reunification, medication access, communication, accessible shelter, record status, and emotional stabilization.

8.5.3 — Security Incident Response

Security response covers threats, intrusion, harassment, sabotage, doxxing, violence, insider misuse, and cyber-physical attack. Bound action by declared roles, review, de-escalation,

evidence preservation, nonparticipant protection, and later explanation.

Distinguish a confused visitor, angry critic, harassment group, armed intruder, compromised vendor credential, falsified media asset, insider data misuse, and environmental hazard. Use classification, proportionate response, protected recording, outside review, and remedy for harm caused by the response itself.

Investigate infrastructure contributors: gate failure, sensory overload, poor wayfinding, vendor weakness, understaffing, or unclear authority may cause or worsen an incident.

Incident response should include a rights-after-action review. After the immediate risk is contained, reviewers should ask whether anyone was wrongly excluded, over-searched, over-recorded, exposed, silenced, injured, threatened, misclassified, or denied a complaint route.

Distinguish lawful criticism, protest, and ordinary conflict from threats. Train staff to apply declared assessment criteria, human judgment, de-escalation, accessibility, review, and clear escalation routes without humiliation or unnecessary force.

Record handling during security incidents requires careful design. Some material may need delayed release to prevent copycat harm, protect victims, preserve investigation, or shield security vulnerabilities. Yet delayed release must be logged, reviewed, and time-bound where lawful.

Cyber-physical incidents require coordination across technical and human systems. A door system may fail because of cyberattack. A record device may be disabled during intrusion. A public interface may be flooded by bots during a protest. Security response must include operations, cybersecurity, archive integrity, public communication, and care.

After containment, verify restoration of normal record status and the adequacy of public explanation alongside the rights review.

8.5.4 — Family Emergency Protocols

A participant may be responsible for a child, partner, elder, disabled dependent, relative in crisis, or household matter that cannot be postponed because the active record is inconvenient. The City should define how family emergencies are noticed, shielded, verified, supported, transported, and reviewed without turning dependent life into public material.

Do not penalize lawful care for dependents, emergency response, or requests to pause. Record role-continuity decisions without making the private crisis public.

Allow departure, pause, communication, support, and urgent care under clear status. Apply Section 2.5.1 to interruptions of required records, distinguishing failure from lawful pause or noncapture. The emergency does not authorize concealed active-role business.

Train staff to route care, protect privacy, support travel, manage record status, and prevent media intrusion during family emergencies involving grief, panic, legal or medical uncertainty, and public attention.

8.5.5 — Continuity After Crisis

Crisis communication should explain what is happening, what remains protected or unknown, the required action, changed services, and how to seek help. Use accessible, multilingual, non-digital, and role-specific channels as facts develop.

Emergency design remains incomplete until recovery is planned. The City should identify who was harmed, which records or services failed, what support and explanation are

owed, which repairs must precede reopening, and what system changes follow.

Fire, breach, injury, outage, flood, death, illness, or attack may require changed schedules, record rules, counseling, accessibility review, staff recovery, host repair, or independent investigation. Resumption must follow evidence that safe conditions have been restored.

The recovery protocol should define operational states such as fully active, partially active, paused, restricted, externally supervised, under repair, under inquiry, or closed to new participants. Each state must have concrete consequences for records, rights, staff workload, public interface, host burden, and the next review.

Use tiered access for after-action review. Clinicians, security reviewers, legal authorities, affected persons, technical auditors, and the public may need different records. Some material can be released promptly, some after investigation or delay, and some remains protected because disclosure would expose a person without public-power relevance. A public summary still states what happened, what failed, what service changed, who reviews it, and which repair or remedy follows.

After-crisis review must account for burdens that did not exist before the event. A breach may produce lasting fear; an evacuation may expose accessibility failures; a public incident may trigger harassment; a medical event may create family vulnerability. Some crises change the burden map and require continuing support, shielding, or redesign.

The first task is recovery. Before ordinary operations resume, the City should check immediate care needs, accessible accommodation, staff rest, family shielding, and continuing risks. Record gaps, trauma, public confusion, and technical or

accessibility failures need named owners, deadlines, remedies, and independent review.

The second task is record reconstruction. What happened? What was captured? What was interrupted? What status labels apply? What remains protected? What requires delayed release? What must be corrected? Who needs access? Who needs notice? What should never be public?

The third task is responsibility classification. Was the crisis caused by participant conduct, system failure, staff error, vendor failure, design weakness, external attack, unforeseeable event, or some combination?

The fourth task is public communication. Explain crises affecting trust, active-record status, readiness, nonparticipant harm, safety, or operations, stating category, status, corrective action, and disclosure limits.

Review which crisis messages clarified, confused, disclosed too much, or protected institutional image at affected people’s expense.

8.6 — Maintenance as Institutional Honesty

Buildings age, software loses support, climate conditions change, skilled workers leave, and budgets tighten. Maintenance must preserve safety, accessibility, record integrity, care, and dignity through ordinary years. Maintenance is continued authorization in daily form. A City may pass an opening review and still degrade through neglected access equipment, outdated cybersecurity, underfunded staff, leaking roofs, deferred climate adaptation, or inaccessible public interfaces. Core functions remain authorized only while their service, safety, rights, record, and care conditions continue to hold (ISO, 2019; Vanier, 2001; Wireman, 2004).

8.6.1 — Repair Over Image

Distinguish repair, renewal, replacement, upgrade, and redesign. Repair restores function; renewal extends life; replacement substitutes a component; upgrade changes capacity; redesign changes the underlying arrangement. Use the category that describes the work rather than concealing redesign as routine repair or presenting an image upgrade as essential maintenance.

Repair over image requires visible imperfection. Scaffolding, temporary routes, closed rooms, maintenance notices, patched surfaces, and equipment replacement should not be hidden merely because they disturb the public image.

The danger is not only cosmetic. Image protection can delay safety work, accessibility fixes, cybersecurity upgrades, archive environment repairs, staff station improvements, and utility replacement. The City should treat any decision to postpone functional repair for ceremonial, donor, media, or visual reasons as a governance event.

This discipline also corrects leadership incentives. Openings, expansions, ceremonies, and new programs produce visible

credit; repairs usually prevent events that never become news. Budgets and governance review should therefore make renewal, backlog reduction, accessibility repair, incident learning, and maintenance leadership visible.

This priority must govern budgets, donors, operating review, and public reporting. Visible additions wait while critical accessibility, safety, record, utility, care, or emergency defects remain unresolved. New programs may proceed only when they do not consume resources needed to restore essential systems.

Explain the burden reduced and obligation served when repair interrupts a visible event.

When a repair changes a mistaken design assumption, record the reason, affected people, cost, and result as a redesign.

8.6.2 — Public Maintenance Reporting

A maintenance report should show functioning systems, rights-affecting failures, work in progress, accountable owners, temporary controls, and defects requiring restriction, pause, or independent review. Use clear status labels for good standing, repair, conditional approval, pause and external review, with appropriate limits for security-sensitive details and protected people.

Show outage trends, delays in access repair versus public-interface repair, staff complaints, recurring vendor failures and emergency-drill performance. Distinguish scheduled minor work from emergency-system failure, temporary access workarounds from persistent exclusion, and planned device maintenance from unexplained capture failures.

Credible maintenance reporting needs time status. Each material issue should be classified as immediate repair, scheduled repair, monitored condition, redesign, vendor dispute,

funding decision, external review, or operating-status concern, with a named next date.

Report whether temporary workarounds add staff time, exclude users, reduce privacy, or increase confusion; include those effects in the burden review.

8.6.3 — Deferred Maintenance Risk

Deferral carries a public clock. When a repair is postponed, the record states the reason, decision owner, accepted risk, affected services and people, interim protection, next review, and trigger that converts delay into a mandatory pause or violation. Waiting may sometimes be proportionate, but the institution must keep the carrier and consequence of that wait visible (ISO, 2019; NIST, 2020c; Vanier, 2001).

Assess known weaknesses before failure: server end of life, recurring lift faults, seasonal ramp icing, inadequate cooling reserve, roof defects, contractor backlogs, and delayed access repairs.

Critical deferral may require slower admissions, a narrower public interface, restricted record operations, closure of affected spaces, outside supervision, or halted expansion, with public explanation.

8.6.4 — Budget Protection for Maintenance

Budget reports, condition assessments, worker testimony, outage logs, and user complaints should meet in one reviewable maintenance picture.

Expansion, ceremonies, media systems, and new programs can compete with less visible maintenance needs. Protect a maintenance reserve against those competing priorities.

The budget should treat depreciation, replacement, and retirement as ordinary stewardship. Some systems can be repaired; others should be withdrawn before failure.

Size reserves for uneven repair demands, including storms, cyber incidents, device recalls, building defects, and accessibility redesign.

Report whether funding matches system complexity, which backlogs grow, whether reserves cover critical failures, and whether workarounds are becoming permanent. Protect worker privacy and sensitive security details. Withhold replication claims until the condition of systems proposed for copying can be explained.

Compare maintenance funding and condition across ramps, lifts, staff routes, service spaces, assistive systems, and public-facing areas to detect unequal neglect.

The reserve must survive leadership change. A new administration, donor cycle, controversy, or expansion plan should not be able to drain repair funding without a recorded justification, affected-system review, and independent challenge.

8.6.5 — Maintenance Review Gate

Maintenance should be classified by duty: safety maintenance, accessibility maintenance, record-integrity maintenance, dignity maintenance, staff-workflow maintenance, public-interface maintenance, environmental maintenance, and aesthetic maintenance. Aesthetic maintenance matters, but it should not outrank the duties that protect life, rights, staff, nonparticipants, and record integrity.

The maintenance review gate should be difficult to evade. Leadership should not be able to route around it by calling a failure temporary, cosmetic, donor-funded, politically inconvenient, or not yet public. If infrastructure failure touches record integrity, safety, accessibility, worker health, emergency response, host burden, or protected-person rights, the gate should have authority to require correction before expansion continues.

The gate should review record infrastructure, emergency readiness, accessibility systems, service routes, staff workload, public interface stability, protected nonvisibility systems, archive integrity, vendor support, cybersecurity maintenance, water and energy resilience, and host-community spillover. A single defect may require repair; a pattern across categories may require narrowing, pause, or decertification.

Use scheduled reviews and trigger reviews. Trigger conditions include repeated outages, access failures, safety incidents, staff injury clusters, unresolved complaints, vendor nonperformance, cyber warnings, failed emergency drills, and host-community concerns.

The maintenance gate must accept protected input from workers and affected users rather than depend only on leadership reports.

The maintenance gate needs graduated consequences. Depending on severity, it may require a repair plan, deadline, budget correction, outside audit, vendor replacement, public status label, admissions pause, narrowed public interface, temporary closure, leadership review, suspension of an affected function, or loss of formal standing.

Apply Section 8.6.1’s repair priority to ceremonies, tours, donor events, expansion announcements, public releases, and replication claims. None may conceal a critical failure or consume resources needed for essential repair.

Report gate outcomes using the maintenance-status categories and disclosure limits in Section 8.6.2, including any restriction or suspension imposed under this gate.

The service, maintenance, and continuity register brings the chapter’s obligations into one operational record. For each critical system it identifies the accountable human owner, external dependencies, minimum service level, maintenance

interval, known vulnerabilities, manual fallback, affected groups, unresolved backlog, restoration priority, and next review date.

A register entry distinguishes ordinary degradation from a continuity event. It records what continues, what narrows, what pauses, who must be notified, which protected rights remain nonnegotiable, and what evidence is needed before normal operation resumes.

Keep cyber and physical dependencies distinct within a shared view. Server outages may block record access; power failures may stop lifts; water loss may close care or food systems; staff shortages may disable intact systems. Recovery plans need technical redundancy and human capacity (ISO, 2019; NIST, 2024a; WHO, 2019b). Test backup systems in recovery exercises with their usual operators unavailable.

Workers and affected users must be able to submit additions or corrections to the register, including maintenance staff, disabled users, clinicians, archive custodians, responders, participants, and host representatives. Protect reporting from retaliation and give every submission a visible disposition; retain rejected reports so later outages can be compared with earlier decisions.

Restart approval should identify each affected system’s remaining temporary workarounds and replacement obligations.

Part III — Rights, Records, and Openness

The first two Parts have given the City a civic type and a physical form. Part III gives those commitments a memory system. The institution now has to show how rights, custody, access, correction, time, and public interpretation can make visible responsibility usable without turning ordinary human vulnerability into public property. This is the movement from architecture to answerability: the City becomes more open by becoming more exact about what may be known, by whom, for which purpose, and under whose continuing review.

Rights come before records, not as a limit added after openness but as the condition that makes openness legitimate. A powerful archive earns trust only when participants and nearby people can invoke due process, counsel, care, complaint, appeal, remedy, privacy, and exit against the institution itself. Record power becomes civic value when it remains subordinate to human standing and review (Nissenbaum, 2010; International Council on Archives, 2011; European Union, 2016).

Follow the same record across these chapters and ask a different question at each stage: who may challenge it, what the archive must preserve, what the public site may show, and how time changes that justification.

With that rights floor in place, the Part turns to two different institutions of memory. The official archive preserves governed source records with custody, provenance, access rules, status, and correction. The public record site publishes structured civic objects that ordinary readers can inspect and contest. Journalism, machine assistance, and public discussion then interpret those objects without becoming the archive’s owner.

The record lifecycle is the Part's central technical grammar. Capture, custody, access, release, interpretation, research, Artificial Intelligence training, reuse, retention, sealing, deletion, and correction are separate decisions rather than one expanding

permission. Each transition needs a stated purpose, authority, affected-person route, review clock, destination, and remedy. Making those gates visible allows the City to preserve useful memory while preventing an initially lawful record from silently becoming every later kind of institutional resource.

Time gives record governance its discipline. Some evidence remains durable because it protects public memory, affected persons, and institutional learning; other exposure should narrow, seal, expire, or return for review as public relevance changes. Retention, delayed release, escrow, deletion, sealing, periodic review, and posthumous handling therefore answer one question at different stages: what continuing purpose justifies carrying this material now, and who can challenge that answer?

The perimeter gives these distinctions a physical and social form. Citizens, critics, experts, journalists, protesters, vendors, relatives, and emergency responders can approach through routes designed for their purposes, while households, staff spaces, archives, care rooms, and nonparticipants remain protected. Openness here means legible access, reasons, challenge, and correction. The edge succeeds when a newcomer can tell what is public, what is protected, who owns the decision, and how that decision can be reviewed.

Chapter 9 — Rights, Privacy, and Protected Life

A participant enters a protected consultation room carrying a printed extract from the public record site. The extract is authentic, yet it is wrong in the way that matters most: an interim classification has been cropped away from its status label, a clinical pause has been mistaken for misconduct, and a family member has been drawn into the public story without consent. The first institutional question cannot be how to defend the archive. It must be how to stop the harm, preserve the source, hear the affected people, and place the burden of repair on the institution that created the exposure. Rights begin at precisely this point, when a record is real enough to injure and incomplete enough to deceive.

Rights keep visible burden attached to the role that accepted it instead of letting the institution push costs toward people with less power to refuse. They govern capture, access, shielding, release, challenge, remedy, and exit from the beginning. A right becomes usable only when the holder, duty bearer, triggering event, response clock, review body, interim protection, and remedy are identifiable. Anything less may express a value, but it does not yet give a harmed person a route through the institution.

A usable rights system can be followed from standing and notice through immediate protection, lawful evidence access, independent assistance, reasons, review, remedy, implementation, and verification. Jurisdiction-specific law remains controlling, so the City does not create enforceable doctrine by description. Its design contribution is to expose the whole route clearly enough that participants, families, staff, professionals, reviewers, and the public can identify the next responsible actor at every stage (Tyler, 2006; OHCHR, 2024).

Collateral protection begins before release. It shapes room layout, camera range, appointment metadata, visitor badges,

captions, staff logs, machine search, public tours, donor materials, emergency notices, and later historical interpretation. A blurred face may remain identifiable through school, timing, voice, or association; an unnamed partner may still be exposed by context. The City therefore treats inference control as part of architecture and workflow, not as a final redaction task.

Professional interfaces let the City receive care, counsel, review, conscience support, and emergency help while preserving the relationship that makes each service trustworthy. Medical, legal, clinical, pastoral, and emergency roles carry different duties, records, authorities, and complaint routes. Purpose limits, separate custody, credential verification, restricted release, professional independence, and a logged return to active-role handling protect both competent service and the City's anti-shadow purpose.

Care before evidence establishes the order of response when a person is unsafe, ill, exposed, overwhelmed, or threatened. Relief, stabilization, shelter, counsel, and protection begin immediately while source material is preserved in ways compatible with those needs. Classification, investigation, and public explanation then proceed under their own clocks. This order makes the City more reliable, not less evidentiary, because it prevents avoidable harm from becoming the price of institutional certainty.

9.1 — Participant Rights Under Visible Burden

A rights regime becomes credible when a person can find the rule, understand the allegation or decision, obtain independent assistance, answer the record, receive reasons, seek review, and obtain an effective remedy. Those elements recur across fair-hearing, administrative-justice, and procedural-justice traditions, although their legal force varies by jurisdiction. In the City they must become operational pathways: timely notice, counsel outside institutional command, complaint intake that does not require public exposure, and an appeal body able to change the result. Voice, neutrality, respectful treatment, and trustworthy motives affect perceived legitimacy, but perception cannot replace authority, evidence, or remedy (United Nations, 1966; UN Human Rights Committee, 2007; Tyler, 2006).

9.1.1 — Due Process

Due process protects against public acceleration: a decision that began inside an administrative file can become a public label, a released bundle, a search result, or a lasting interpretive frame. The Transparent City must slow that movement where visibility would otherwise make a first judgment travel faster than fairness (United Nations, 1966; UN Human Rights Committee, 2007; Tyler, 2006).

The Transparent City will face many decisions that can harm a participant: status changes, record labels, sanctions, pauses, restrictions, release decisions, role pathway changes, public explanations, removal, and post-exit classifications. None of these should be made through informal mood, reputation management, staff resentment, public pressure, donor concern, media pressure, or algorithmic flagging. The participant must know what is being alleged or decided, what evidence is being used, what standard applies, and how to respond.

Due process also protects the interpretation of the archive. An accurate recording can document an unfair procedure; procedural unfairness does not automatically make the recording false. But a punishment recorded without the charge, response, or appeal can mislead the public about what the evidence establishes. An uncontestable label can likewise turn an institutional interpretation into apparent fact. Record integrity therefore requires accurate source material, visible procedural context, and a route to challenge the conclusions attached to it.

Institutional legitimacy requires the City to distinguish emergency action from final determination. In an urgent safety situation, temporary restriction may be necessary before full review. But emergency status must be labeled, limited, logged, and assigned a reviewer, an expiry or review deadline, and a return path. Review follows as soon as danger permits. Later public descriptions must identify the action's temporary status and outcome; they must not imply a final finding unless one is reached through due process.

Provide plain-language notice, translation, accessible formats, counsel or advocacy, readable standards, non-digital routes, and sufficient response time. Test comprehension with tired, frightened, disabled, time-pressed, and institutionally unfamiliar users, using supportive conditions rather than deliberately inducing distress.

For public-facing status changes, release delays, restrictions, and explanations, make an auditable view of the decision route available with protected details withheld. Include the authority, evidence class, reviewer, appeal, interim safeguards, and bearer of error risk.

A second due-process safeguard is role separation. The person who initiates a sanction should not be the sole interpreter of the evidence, the sole custodian of the record, the sole

communicator to the public, and the sole reviewer of the participant’s objection.

A rights-invocation card should accompany every consequential participant decision. It identifies the action under review, the claimed authority, the information relied upon, temporary protections, the deadline for reasons, the counsel route, complaint and appeal bodies, remedies each body can order, and the person responsible for implementation. The card is neither verdict nor waiver. It is a portable route from notice to action, written for the moment when stress makes institutional vocabulary hardest to use (Tyler, 2006; Mashaw, 2006; European Union, 2016).

9.1.2 — Counsel Access

Make the rights route visible, usable, and explainable in ordinary language before activation.

Normalize independent legal advice before activation, during disputes, around release challenges, and at exit; seeking counsel is not evidence of guilt or hostility.

Counsel access protects the participant from the institution's interpretive advantage. The City may record that a protected legal interface occurred only when separately necessary, lawful, and safe, but that fact does not create access to privileged content. Confidential consultation lets a person ask questions, preserve rights, and challenge the City's own account without converting every legal concern into formation material. The occurrence record, content boundary, access rule, and review route should therefore remain distinct.

A legal-consultation label does not by itself authorize concealed nonlegal public-power activity. Apply lawful role-status and occurrence-log rules, privilege protection, and

independent review of disputed boundaries; the City's classification must not override legal privilege.

Partners, families, staff, visitors, and wrongfully exposed people also need access to independent advice concerning City records and remedies.

Before activation, arrange independent funding, language and disability access, urgent consultation, and counsel-choice rules so legal help is financially and practically reachable.

9.1.3 — Complaint Rights

The operational standard is a rights, complaint, appeal, and remedy route attached to every active participant and available, where relevant, to affected persons. The route names the right holder, triggering event, responsible authority, interim protection, response clock, counsel channel, complaint intake, appeal body, remedy options, public-notice rule, anti-retaliation protection, and independent reviewer. It also records accessible format, translation, disability accommodation, emergency pause, exit consequence, and effect on record status. Present it as a navigable map of institutional duties that keeps protection usable under stress (European Union, 2016; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021; World Medical Association, 2024).

Explicitly protect complaints made against a celebrated project: institutional admiration must not require participants, staff, families, visitors, or affected people to shield it from criticism.

The City will create many kinds of possible injury: overexposure, misclassification, staff misconduct, participant misconduct, technical failure, retaliation, unsafe conditions, disability exclusion, discriminatory treatment, intimate-record mishandling, family burden, public-interface abuse, and institutional pressure to continue when pause is needed. A

participant must have a route to name harm without needing to make it public first.

Keep complaint status separate from character judgment unless fair process establishes specific relevance. Protect complainants against exposure, punishment, and informal exclusion while their claims are assessed.

Complaint systems must include independent review. The operator whose conduct is challenged cannot control the outcome. A formal reviewer hears the complaint, and a separately assigned appellate authority reviews a contested decision; neither role is held by the implicated management line. The ombuds offers confidential, informal assistance within its charter. Evaluation examines whether people can reach a reviewer, receive reasons, and obtain the remedy due. Complaint counts are read alongside access, delay, substantiation, and follow-through: an increase may reflect easier reporting, more harm, or both. Institutional embarrassment is not a quality target, and low complaint volume is not proof that the underlying conditions are sound.

Complaint rights may require representative complaint. A child, dependent adult, medically fragile person, intimidated partner, or wrongfully exposed bystander may not be able to complain directly. The City should allow lawful representatives, advocates, or protected intermediaries where appropriate so the most vulnerable people are not excluded from recourse by the vulnerability that requires protection.

Use aggregated complaint patterns to detect architectural, staffing, technical, and cultural failures. Do not rank complainants; use the findings for governance, audit, and repair.

Offer low-intensity, confidential, urgent, formal, and external routes for early concerns as well as fully formed allegations: for

example, repeated access denial, an unexplained label, staff conflict, or suspicious treatment of protected categories.

Complaint rights also require protection against informal retaliation. Retaliation is not only dismissal or punishment. It can appear as colder staff treatment, slowed support, social exclusion, unfavorable interpretation, subtle pressure, leaked tone, or narrative framing that marks the complainant as unstable. Record and review these forms of retaliation as institutional risks.

9.1.4 — Humane Care

Rights do not preclude investigation and proportionate consequences for misconduct, concealment, role violation, harm, breach, or manipulation.

Fund and staff clinicians, sleep protections, accessible spaces, referrals, de-loading authority, and emergency protocols so the care right is practically available.

Provide immediate care, safety, medical attention, clinical response, de-loading, sleep protection, and crisis support before readiness classification. Later investigation and proportionate consequences remain possible.

Use protected care context when interpreting conduct affected by distress, pain, sleep deprivation, panic, or medical instability. Clinical independence, protected summaries, and context labels should distinguish conduct, condition, response, and institutional burden.

Humane care must avoid two opposite failures. The first is neglect disguised as rigor, where the institution treats visible public-power formation as a license to ignore suffering. The second is care disguised as control, where health language is used to manage dissent, suppress complaint, or delay exit. Humane care must remain independent enough to protect the

person and transparent enough in status to prevent hidden domination.

9.1.5 — Exit Rights

Departure alone does not establish failed readiness. The City should help the public distinguish voluntary exit, pause, removal, exhaustion, changed circumstance, misconduct, and ordinary redirection. Clear exit categories protect the participant, the City, and the public record (Mashaw, 2006; Bovens, 2007).

Departure does not automatically erase lawful active-period records; retention, release, sealing, time review, and public-power relevance remain governed. Future ordinary life is not subject to continuing active recording by default.

Exit is voluntary only when continuity survives departure. If participation has changed housing, health care, debt relief, dependent support, employment, security exposure, or public reputation, the City owes a planned transition. Bounded severance, care continuity, practical assistance, and clear record handling complete obligations created by the institution without owning the former participant.

The exit packet's dignity statement identifies which interpretations lack support and which judgments the City has never made.

Exit patterns should be audited for coercion without becoming a scoreboard. Rare departure despite visible distress may indicate that leaving is too costly; clustering after complaints may expose retaliation or a failed pathway; fear of future public interpretation may reveal weak post-exit boundaries. The institution should review timing, support requests, unresolved complaints, and post-exit harms with small-number privacy. Such evidence cannot rank participants, but it can reveal whether the door is real or merely announced.

A credible exit right should be rehearsed before it is needed. Orientation can include a private exit simulation in which a participant asks what happens to housing, care, dependent support, security exposure, public labels, unfinished complaints, and future access to records. It reveals whether staff give consistent answers, whether forms are intelligible, whether independent advice is available, and whether a person can leave without first persuading the institution that leaving is wise.

Portability matters after departure. The participant should receive a plain-language exit packet identifying continuing services, record status, unresolved proceedings, correction and reply routes, emergency contacts, data restrictions, and the date of the next time review. The City should also monitor whether former participants face blacklisting, retaliatory disclosure, or informal pressure to remain publicly loyal after ordinary participation has ended (European Union, 2016; OHCHR, 2024).

9.2 — Protected Nonvisibility Categories

Contextual integrity offers the clearest account of protected nonvisibility. Information may be appropriate for a clinician, lawyer, emergency responder, or trusted care provider while remaining inappropriate for a public record bundle, newsroom, search tool, or training dataset. A sound design therefore specifies the actors, purposes, information types, transmission principles, retention period, and review route for each protected category. Data-protection principles such as purpose limitation, minimization, accuracy, storage limitation, and security offer useful design analogues, while professional confidentiality supplies stronger domain-specific duties. The result is not an off-record life for active public-power conduct; it is a disciplined refusal to make dignity-bearing contexts interchangeable (Nissenbaum, 2010; European Union, 2016; World Medical Association, 2022).

9.2.1 — Health and Clinical Care

Health protection includes the ordinary, unheroic work of keeping a body livable. Medication refills, disability accommodation, menstrual health, chronic pain, allergy management, mobility support, nutrition, and sleep conditions may never become dramatic public events, yet they determine whether visible service can continue without needless harm. Everyday care needs the same protected handling as crisis care (Nissenbaum, 2010; European Union, 2016).

Health information may have limited relevance to participation, load, safety, role pathways, or office duties. Before attaching public meaning, use protected summaries, clinical independence, category review, and the participant’s response. A diagnosis alone does not determine capacity.

Clinical professionals need enough independence to treat honestly and enough accountability to operate inside a public-power formation institution. Their primary duty is care, not archive production, and they should not become unreviewable gatekeepers over participation. Law, professional ethics, consent, and City protocol should specify the limited safety or status information that may leave the clinical interface, who receives it, and how the person can challenge misuse.

Health information moves only as far as its purpose requires. A public status board may need to show a pause without giving its health-related reason; a load review may need functional limits without receiving the narrative of treatment. The governing questions precede every transfer: what decision requires this fact, which recipient needs it, how long does that need last, and what narrower form would suffice?

Return-to-participation decisions should be framed as capacity and support judgments, not moral rehabilitation. A participant returning from illness, crisis, or clinical care should not be asked to perform gratitude, courage, or redemption for the record. The relevant question is whether the burden can now be carried safely under lawful supports.

Apply clinical protection to staff and collateral persons as well as participants, including care after moderation overload, exposure, or a City-related injury.

Health shielding should include metadata discipline. Even a protected clinical conversation can reveal too much if appointment timing, location, specialist category, medication logistics, crisis frequency, or staff routing becomes publicly inferable. The City should design health nonvisibility against inference as well as direct release.

9.2.2 — Legal Counsel

The legal counsel category should be especially clear at the boundary between personal legal advice and official legal duty. A participant moving toward office may interact with personal counsel, campaign counsel, public-office counsel, ethics counsel, and institutional counsel. These roles are not interchangeable. The City must prevent confusion over whom counsel represents, what is privileged, what belongs to public office, and what remains a personal rights interface.

Nonparticipants' legal consultations retain their own confidentiality and applicable privilege; a participant's Vow does not extend to their counsel relationship. Seeking a remedy must not require additional public exposure.

Do not assume that a legal label alone establishes privilege or that public-power relevance defeats it. Use lawful occurrence logging, counsel-identity handling, category limits, and independent privilege review to assess disputed claims of concealment.

Legal counsel protection begins with jurisdictional humility. The City can require protected access to counsel, respect privilege and confidentiality where law provides them, log occurrence status only when separately necessary, lawful, and safe, and preserve an independent complaint route. It cannot manufacture one privilege rule for every legal order. Local counsel and competent authority determine the legal details, while the City preserves the institutional design principle that advice must remain usable against the institution itself.

Independent privilege review should precede any disputed release, summary, or access event.

Protect preliminary inquiries about representation, conflicts, or separate counsel for family members, subject to applicable law, as well as established counsel relationships.

9.2.3 — Intimacy and Modesty

Protected nonvisibility requires distinct handling options. Material may be fully shielded, available only to restricted reviewers, represented by protected summary, delayed before release, or included in an ordinary public bundle after legal, ethical, and affected-person review. Teach and rehearse these options before disputes arise.

Intimacy protection resists moralized interpretation. Conventional relationships do not establish stability, unconventional relationships do not establish danger, and sexual history is not a proxy for public fitness. Modesty rules protect the body from humiliation while preserving lawful review of coercion, dependency, leverage, conflicts of interest, and misconduct when those matters bear directly on public-power formation.

Protected handling may include restricted review, delayed release, shielded access, access logs, summary substitution, third-party masking, partner consent review, and expert review. The public may need to know that a power imbalance was reviewed, that a relationship created dependency, that a complaint was made, or that a conflict was resolved.

For possible coercion, exploitation, secret leverage, partner pressure, or misconduct, use expert review, protected evidence, affected-person rights, coercion screening, and a limited public summary where warranted. Modesty protection must not prevent lawful investigation of abuse.

A nonparticipant partner or collateral person retains independent control over body, image, data, intimate history, and public identity. Review of a participant's conduct does not transfer the Vow to anyone nearby. Consent for a limited use must be specific, renewable where circumstances change, and revocable where law and safety permit; refusal should not reduce

the person's standing or access to care. The record design should make the third party's route visible without requiring further exposure.

A clear relevance threshold governs intimate material. Before viewing, summarizing, retaining for public meaning, or releasing any intimate content, reviewers identify the precise public-power question it answers, the authority for review, the people placed at risk, and the least exposing form that can carry the necessary meaning. Curiosity, moralism, embarrassment, and audience appetite do not satisfy that threshold. Material that cannot meet it remains protected.

Preserve the intimate-relevance threshold in every downstream artifact, summary, tour, clip, and search interface; presentation must not expand the authorized disclosure.

The modesty category should be designed for bodily realities that institutions often mishandle: bathing, dressing, medical devices, menstruation, pregnancy, lactation, disability assistance, toileting, sexual health, gendered vulnerability, age-related change, and recovery from trauma. These realities may occur in the active period, but they are not civic evidence by default.

9.2.4 — Grief and Worship

If protected material also contains role-relevant evidence, preserve any lawfully held source, restrict raw access, and use the narrowest accurate status or protected summary sufficient for accountability. Protection does not authorize concealed active public-power conduct.

A participant may grieve a death, loss, betrayal, family crisis, public harm, personal failure, or moral injury. A participant may pray, meditate, sit in silence, speak with clergy, practice within another religion, reject religion, or use optional practices associated with the Religion of Fairness only where they remain

separate from required civic formation. These moments may occur under active record conditions, but they require protected handling.

Grief is care material before it is record material. Tears do not establish virtue, silence does not establish depth, and a public apology does not require raw footage of mourning. Where accountability needs a status, sequence, or protected summary, the record can carry that limited function without consuming the vulnerable state itself.

Protect faith, secular commitment, mixed-belief life, doubt, silence, and nonparticipation. Religion of Fairness participation, prayer, ritual, and sacred language remain optional and are not evidence of readiness, loyalty, or moral depth.

Grief or pastoral protection must not be repurposed for concealed donor contact or political strategy. Define category scope, lawful occurrence logging, protected content, and independent review of disputed use.

Clergy or pastoral support should be optional and plural. The City should not assume one tradition, one language of meaning, or one response to suffering. Professional or recognized support may include clergy, chaplains, spiritual caregivers, secular grief counselors, or other qualified helpers depending on law and context.

9.2.5 — Crisis and Safety

Use declared categories, independent review, emergency rules, expiry or renewal, audit, and an affected-person challenge to excessive or insufficient shielding. Disclosure beneficiaries must not control protection as a discretionary favor.

Activate protected crisis handling without delaying life-saving action, de-escalation, medical care, or immediate safety.

Emergency records and later review follow the Chapter 8 protocol.

Safety categories must be protected because public exposure can worsen danger. Stalking risk, domestic violence risk, targeted harassment, location exposure, emergency movement, and threat response may require delayed release or restricted access.

A crisis protection decision specifies trigger, owner, scope, time limit, oversight notice, renewal standard, after-action disclosure, and challenge route. Review as soon as danger permits, maintaining care and protection.

Threat-model risks to families, former partners, clinicians, staff, and witnesses when City visibility exposes them to enemies, obsessive supporters, media attention, or political targeting. The City must address dangers its operations increase.

Keep crisis records separate. Clinical records carry symptoms, treatment, medication, and professional judgment; safety logs carry immediate threats, locations, protective actions, and operational consequences. Public notices may need only to report paused participation and pending review. Separate custody, access, correction, and retention rules must meet each audience's needs while protecting medical privacy (World Medical Association, 2024; European Union, 2016).

Reentry begins with restored agency, not with the institution's calendar. After an acute event, independent review considers the person's wishes, the contribution of City load, changed conditions, required support, protected record status, and the narrow public explanation actually owed. Return, redirection, extended pause, and exit remain legitimate outcomes.

9.3 — Children, Dependents, and Families

Children and dependents cannot be treated as extensions of a participant's consent. Their developmental position, reliance on adults, changing capacities, and limited ability to leave household exposure create a distinct protection problem. The child-noninheritance rule must therefore operate across capture, metadata, release, search, media, visitor access, and machine processing, not merely at publication. International child-rights and privacy frameworks do not supply a ready-made City code, but they make the burden clear: best interests, evolving capacities, participation rights, family integrity, and protection from exploitative data practices require independent representation (United Nations, 1989; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021; United Nations, 1966).

9.3.1 — Child Noninheritance Rule

Indirect exposure belongs inside the child-noninheritance rule. A child may be identifiable without being named when a record reveals school, schedule, neighborhood, health details, family conflict, belongings, or repeated contextual clues. Shielding therefore requires inference review, not merely name removal. The standard is whether peers, media, commercial actors, or hostile observers could reasonably reconstruct the child's identity or circumstances (United Nations, 1989; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021).

The child noninheritance rule is a bright operational rule: no child becomes a participant because an adult lives, works, visits, receives support, or seeks public power through the City. The adult's chosen record burden stops at the child. Every system that touches family life should implement the same result through capture exclusions, access limits, masking, delayed release,

complaint, correction, and artifact review rather than relying on a general promise of privacy.

Operational practice should prohibit using children as proof. A child's image, voice, routine, school context, distress, affection, or relationship with a participant should not be displayed to establish that the City is humane, intergenerational, successful, or safe. Any exceptional handling requires a separate lawful and child-centered process, a compelling purpose, minimal exposure, independent review, and a clear withdrawal or expiry route. Shielding remains the default.

The rule also protects children from symbolic labor inside the institution. A child should not be asked to perform pride, forgiveness, support, sacrifice, normalcy, or loyalty for a participant or for the City. Their behavior cannot be interpreted as a readiness signal or moral verdict on the adult.

Public artifacts require the same child shield as the archive. Brochures, tours, documentaries, dashboards, social clips, fundraising pages, architectural renderings, and case studies can create permanent exposure even when the source record is protected. Artifact review should test identifiability, inference, future search, emotional pressure, and promotional use before release.

Apply stricter time review, masking, and nonrelease to child-related material, considering how apparently harmless disclosure may affect later adolescence and adulthood.

Child noninheritance should appear in procurement, tour design, media agreements, donor materials, record-site prototypes, training, and incident review, not only in privacy policy. Vendors and partners should be contractually unable to reuse child-related material, build profiles, or retain incidental capture outside the authorized purpose. Audits should verify actual absence, masking, deletion, and correction.

9.3.2 — Dependent Protection

Dependent burden must be counted without turning dependents into record subjects. Care obligations can affect entry, pause, residence, travel, office service, and the practical ability to remain under the Vow. The dependent's diagnosis, school, routine, legal status, or family history does not therefore become public material. Minimum necessary information, protected summaries, restricted access, and independent review support care without public disclosure.

Dependent protection spans financial, logistical, medical, relational, and emotional realities. When participation creates care gaps, transport burdens, housing instability, disrupted treatment, or caregiver strain, those effects belong inside the City’s decision rather than being dismissed as private inconvenience. The response may be added support, a lighter schedule, delayed activation, a different pathway, or refusal of entry when the burden cannot be carried safely.

Review whether family members, caregivers, funders, or the City use dependent support to control a participant or use a dependent to manipulate public image.

Dependent persons should have access to the representative complaint routes in Section 9.1.3, with guardianship-sensitive protocols, professional review, and protection against public exposure where appropriate.

Dependent support must not be conditioned in ways that deter a participant from complaining, pausing, or exiting.

Immigration vulnerability, language dependence, and trauma can also trigger dependent shielding.

9.3.3 — Partner Rights

Awareness and exposure are different institutional acts. The City may need to know that a child exists, that a dependent requires

support, that a partner needs an appeal route, or that a household faces a safety risk. None of those facts belongs in public view by default. A protected status stub, private support plan, family-law referral, safety flag, or affected-person route can carry the operational need while leaving the underlying life private.

Partner rights recognize that spouses, partners, and intimate household companions may be deeply affected by the participant's Vow without accepting the same role. A partner may share space, care duties, finances, emotional history, parenting, public attention, and security risk.

The first partner right is consent boundary. A partner's relationship with the participant does not automatically consent to public record release, intimate exposure, relational interpretation, or public use of household context. A partner may choose certain forms of participation, support, consultation, or public statement, but those choices must be specific, revocable where possible, and protected from coercion.

The second partner right is complaint. A partner may be harmed by the participant, by the City, by public attention, by record misuse, by staff conduct, by security failures, or by family burden. The partner needs a route to name harm without being forced into public exposure.

The third partner right is dignity in interpretation. Audiences may pressure a partner to appear loyal, forgiving, supportive, patriotic, spiritual, or proud. A partner may instead choose silence, distance, complaint, or private support. Disagreement, separation, reconciliation, or emotional moments must not automatically become public evidence of character or readiness. Any proposed use requires careful, lawful, narrow review.

The fourth partner right is safety. If there is coercion, abuse, stalking, domination, retaliation, or unsafe household dynamics, the City must put safety before reconciliation and before image.

Partner rights are not only privacy rights. They include protection from harm and access to qualified support. The City must not use family unity language to pressure a person into unsafe repair.

Partner rights should include independent counsel or advocacy where the partner's interests diverge from the participant's interests. Partners may need privacy, safety planning, family-law advice, intimacy shielding, employment protection, or a route to object to release.

9.3.4 — Household Complaint Route

Public accountability should address the institution's handling of household burden, support, complaints, safeguards, remedies, and role-relevant conduct while protecting identifying details. A family scene enters public memory only through a separate lawful and person-centered process, never because it makes the project easier to admire, attack, or market.

Accept household concerns in the speaker's own language. A household member may not speak in terms of record burden, nonvisibility, or public-power formation. They may simply say the schedule is breaking care, the media attention is frightening a child, or the participant has changed under pressure. Intake must translate lived harm into institutional categories without dismissing ordinary language as imprecision.

The route must serve partners, children, elders, relatives, chosen family, roommates, caregivers, dependents, and separated co-parents. Provide confidential intake, protected advocacy, translation, and disability access according to need, with safeguards for people who fear retaliation from the participant or the institution.

A household complaint begins as a route to relief, not as a new public object. Intake protects the reporting person, classifies the

concern, provides immediate assistance where needed, and reviews any role-relevant implications through the proper authority. Public explanation appears only when public trust genuinely requires it and in the least exposing form.

The route must distinguish discomfort from harm, and harm from public-power relevance. Some household disruptions may be expected and manageable. Some may require support. Some may show that participation should pause. Some may reveal misconduct. Some may belong to family-law or domestic-violence systems beyond the City's competence.

The household complaint route should include remedies. Possible remedies include schedule adjustment, shielding, support services, temporary pause, referral, legal review, care planning, public correction, compensation where appropriate, and participant-status review.

Include safety screening, emergency shielding, and independent review.

The route should also allow household members to ask for clarification before harm becomes acute. A partner may need to know what will be recorded. A dependent may need to know where to go during a crisis. A caregiver may need to object to schedule design. A child advocate may need to raise a shielding concern.

9.3.5 — Family-Law Boundary

The family-law boundary protects against the City being used as reputational leverage. A participant should not be able to say that City status proves parental fitness, nor should an opponent be able to say that active burden proves family unfitness. Family-law systems must judge family matters through lawful standards. City records may inform only where properly

requested, protected, contextualized, and legally relevant (United Nations, 1966; European Court of Human Rights, 2026).

The City is not a family court, child-welfare system, custody authority, domestic-violence court, medical decision-maker, or general household regulator. Defer decisions in those domains to competent authorities.

Route domestic violence, coercive control, stalking, abuse, or danger to qualified safety services. Do not pressure mediation, apology, or household reconciliation while safety is at risk.

Medical and reproductive issues intersect with family law as well. Pregnancy, reproductive health, medical decision-making, disability support, dependent care, guardianship, and parentage may require legal and clinical expertise. The City must defer to qualified review while preserving its own nonexposure and record-stage disciplines.

When a family-law matter affects participation, give only the necessary status explanation; do not publicly adjudicate custody, domestic conflict, reproductive health, or family vulnerability.

Private disputes create a predictable misuse route. A participant, partner, former partner, relative, employer, or critic may try to convert City material into leverage in custody, divorce, inheritance, immigration, employment, or reputation conflict. Family-law boundaries should require lawful process, relevance, minimum necessary transfer, notice where permitted, protective review, and a later disposition rule. A request log should preserve the question actually asked so a later reviewer can identify when a narrow inquiry expanded into an unrelated search.

When a family-law dispute creates a preservation question, obtain prompt direction from qualified counsel or a competent authority. Any legal hold should preserve relevant lawfully held material, restrict discretionary dissemination, identify the lawful

custodian, and remain subject to controlling disclosure, preservation, and deletion duties. Record its reason, scope, review date, affected-person notice where lawful, and disposition when proceedings end or jurisdictions conflict. Preservation does not itself authorize inspection or grant either private party a strategic right of access.

The family-law interface should use minimum necessary exchange. A court, guardian, child-protection authority, clinician, or counsel may need a specific record for a specific purpose, but that need does not justify exporting an entire participant archive or household history. The request, legal basis, selected material, redactions, objections, transfer method, recipient duties, and later disposition should be recorded. This keeps the City from becoming an informal discovery warehouse and protects children and dependents whose lives would otherwise travel into disputes they did not choose (United Nations, 1989; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021). Recording the recipient's acknowledgment completes the handoff and gives affected people a named destination for any later correction.

9.4 — Third-Party Rights and Incidental Contact

Incidental contact creates institutional duties rather than implied consent. A visitor, neighbor, delivery worker, protester, clinician, cleaner, journalist, or passerby may enter the City's sensory or digital field for a limited reason. Camera range, microphone range, access logs, biometric tools, captions, searchable metadata, and reuse should therefore be purpose-mapped before collection. Minimization, rapid masking, notice where feasible, an affected-person challenge route, correction, and remedy must travel together because harm can arise through aggregation, secondary use, distorted context, or exclusion from the decision even when no single datum appears intimate (Solove, 2008; Nissenbaum, 2010; European Union, 2016).

9.4.1 — Visitor Protection

Third-party protection requires affected-person standing. A person wrongfully captured, mislabeled, exposed, summarized, quoted, indexed, or associated with a participant must have a route to be heard without first becoming more public. Standing should not depend on fame, litigation capacity, media attention, or personal access to City leadership.

The collateral-person matrix asks five questions: what purpose and conditions govern entry; what lawful basis permits capture, including consent where required; what separately authorizes release; what protected role or vulnerability applies; and what remedy exists if those conditions were misunderstood?

The record system must therefore distinguish several categories: visitor, bystander, professional, staff, vendor, emergency responder, protester, journalist, family member, affected person, and ordinary public contact. These categories

may overlap. Classify by purpose, role, lawful authority, applicable consent, and public-power relevance.

Visitor protection begins with role-limited entry. A visitor enters the City for a defined purpose: meeting, tour, inspection, expert review, media access, family contact, public interface, service delivery, or event participation. That defined purpose should determine the record conditions that apply. A visitor should know before entering what may be captured, what may be released, what will be masked, and what remedy exists for error.

Visitors are not participants. They may be recorded for security, access, context, or public-power relevance, but their ordinary life is not under the Vow. The City should avoid treating visitor appearance as implied consent to public use. Notice must be clear, but notice alone is not enough. The design should minimize unnecessary visitor capture and restrict release unless public-power relevance is strong and lawful.

Visitor categories may differ. A family visitor requires stronger shielding. A public tour visitor may accept limited visibility. An inspector may enter under oversight rules. A journalist may document under media protocols. A vendor may enter under operational logs.

Unequal power changes what visitor consent means. A student, intern, low-wage worker, local resident, translator, contractor, critic, or participant's guest may sign while feeling unable to refuse. The design therefore pairs notice with a real alternative, a human contact, nonretaliation, and a route to withdraw or challenge.

9.4.2 — Bystander Protection

Bystander protection must anticipate modern search and inference. A partial face, gait, vehicle, location pattern,

workplace uniform, school emblem, voice, or combination of small clues may identify someone after obvious details are masked. Review therefore tests contextual inference, not merely direct identifiers, before release. Protection also follows derivatives so a masked source is not defeated by an unmasked thumbnail, transcript, caption, or search result.

Bystanders appear without intending to enter the City's record. A bystander may be near the perimeter, on a public street, in a host community, at a protest, in a service area, at an emergency scene, in a public interface, or incidentally present during travel. Their appearance may be captured, but capture should not become public release without strong justification.

Bystander protection should assume that a person may discover capture only after release or inference. The City therefore needs visible notices where feasible, retrospective lookup and challenge routes, rapid protective action, and non-digital assistance for people who cannot navigate the record site.

Masking should be the default where bystander identity is not public-power relevant. Face blurring, voice alteration, metadata reduction, delayed review, protected summaries, and context control may be needed.

Some public disturbances, protests, emergencies, harm events, or interactions may require contextual records. Retain or disclose bystander detail only to the extent justified by the specific lawful purpose.

Bystander remedy must be practical. A person who discovers wrongful exposure should be able to contact the City, identify the record, request masking or correction, receive a response, and obtain remedy where harm occurred. The City should not require expensive legal action before correcting obvious bystander exposure.

Bystander review should also consider group exposure. A street, school, clinic, protest line, religious gathering, workplace, or host-community event can be exposed even when individual names are masked. The City should therefore review background, location, timing, local uniqueness, and social inference before treating bystander protection as complete.

9.4.3 — Professional Protection

Professional protection shields people who enter the City under a professional duty: doctors, lawyers, clinicians, clergy, pastoral caregivers, disability specialists, interpreters, emergency responders, auditors, inspectors, technical experts, social workers, and others whose role requires trust or expertise.

Professional occurrence logs, role status, conflict checks, access records, and public process explanations must remain separate from protected service content.

Verify professional scope and credentials or role where appropriate, record entry only when separately necessary, lawful, and safe, and independently review allegations that the interface is being repurposed for favoritism or concealed nonprofessional conduct, subject to applicable confidentiality and privilege.

Professionals facing misrepresentation, wrongful release, participant pressure, targeting, or harmful public interpretation need correction, masking, security assistance where appropriate, and complaint access.

Professional independence should be evaluated as a service-quality condition: visibility pressure that changes care, counsel, interpretation, or emergency judgment degrades the professional function itself.

9.4.4 — Staff Protection

State role-record boundaries in recruitment, job descriptions, scheduling, support, complaints, and exit terms before employment creates dependency.

Staff remain third parties to the participant's Vow. This chapter therefore limits incidental staff capture to role-relevant conduct and protected remedy; Chapter 21 supplies the fuller staff-record architecture.

Preserve staff consent rights where applicable, notice, complaint, labor protections, nonretaliation, and data limits, including access, retention, correction, and remedy.

For distressing material and conflict work, provide rotation, adequate staffing ratios, debriefing, clinical support, protected refusal, safety review, and a route to report hidden costs.

Scrutiny of staff conduct must remain tied to the act, authority, evidence, and remedy. Protect workers against doxxing, scapegoating, family exposure, and unmanaged public blame after complaints, outages, corrections, gate decisions, or care and security failures.

Collective voice is essential when individual complaint is too risky. A worker may fear naming unsafe load, record misuse, retaliation, or role-boundary drift alone. Protected committees, union routes where lawful, ombuds access, and collective pattern reporting can reveal conditions that isolated cases conceal.

9.4.5 — Remedy for Wrongful Exposure

Wrongful exposure remedy should include an anti-blame rule for the harmed person. A person whose information is released should not be told they should have avoided the City, avoided complaint, avoided visiting, avoided a relationship, or anticipated the institution's error. The burden of repair belongs to

the system that exposed them (European Union, 2016; Ohm, 2010).

Prepare for mistaken release, improper access, faulty masking, metadata leakage, misclassification, public clipping, machine-summary error, staff overdisclosure, vendor breach, and inferential exposure.

Notify affected people promptly and through safe contact routes when a significant exposure occurs. Where avoidable, they should not first learn of the harm through public circulation. Explain what happened, identify the record or release involved, name the immediate protective steps, and provide a route for response. Notice must be clear and accessible, and must not delay urgent protection.

Correction or shielding may require masking identity, removing improper material where possible, correcting public labels, replacing raw release with a protected summary, sealing material, adding context, restricting access, challenging platform circulation, or issuing a public correction. Digital spread cannot always be undone, but difficulty is not an excuse for inaction.

Accountability requires the City to identify whether wrongful exposure resulted from human error, system failure, vendor breach, policy weakness, malicious action, unclear category rules, or insufficient review. Examine system causes as well as individual conduct.

Concrete relief may include compensation, support, security assistance, legal assistance, clinical support, or other measures matched to the harm. Exposure can produce reputational injury, safety risk, emotional distress, financial harm, professional harm, family harm, and platform harassment.

Remedy should include downstream correction where possible. If a wrongful release has been copied into a civic platform, media interpretation, machine summary, or public

discussion forum connected to the City, the correction should travel as far as the City can lawfully carry it.

A serious record system budgets for repair before harm occurs. Wrongful exposure may require legal help, temporary relocation, counseling, digital-security support, employment repair, family protection, or emergency care. An exposure-injury reserve should have transparent funding, independent authorization, rapid access, audit, and anti-retaliation controls.

Wrongful-exposure remedy should include speed because exposure multiplies with time. Search indexing, reposting, machine summarization, harassment, employment effects, and family consequences may begin before formal findings conclude. Temporary shielding, status notices, takedown efforts, emergency assistance, and protected explanation may be needed while the full review proceeds.

The remedy route should distinguish the kind and reach of exposure. A private internal misrouting, a restricted reviewer mistake, a public bundle error, a media amplification, a machine-summary hallucination, and a viral screenshot do not create the same burden. Each requires a response matched to its urgency, technical demands, legal questions, support needs, and public consequences.

9.5 — Professional Interfaces

Professional interfaces are not generic private rooms; they are relationships governed by specialized duties. The City should therefore maintain interface-specific protocols, credential checks, separate records, purpose limits, and independent complaint routes. The professional remains accountable to law and ethics, but is not deputized into the City's publicity system (United Nations, 1990a; World Medical Association, 2022; World Medical Association, 2024). Give each interface a narrow charter identifying authorized entry, protected material, permitted status information, misuse reporting, and the return to ordinary record handling.

9.5.1 — Medical Interface

Disability and chronic illness belong inside ordinary medical design rather than at the edge of an imagined ideal participant. Ongoing treatment, fluctuating capacity, fatigue, pain, sensory need, mobility support, or medication can coexist with serious public-role formation when accommodation is real and role fit is honest. The medical interface should distinguish supportable variation from unsafe load instead of treating complexity as either disqualification or irrelevance (United Nations, 2006; World Medical Association, 2022).

Operators should not medicalize dissent, exhaustion, or criticism to conceal poor design, and clinicians should not be pressured to justify participation decisions already made elsewhere. The clinician owns treatment judgment within professional and legal limits; the City owns workload, environment, safety, and program decisions. A visible referral, complaint, and conflict route keeps those responsibilities from being quietly exchanged.

The same medical boundary protects people who never accepted the Vow. Family members, visitors, staff, contractors, and bystanders may require care on site. Their treatment belongs in the relevant clinical or incident system, not in the participant archive, except for the minimum information needed for lawful safety review.

Medical interface policy should also include ordinary accessibility. A participant may need sign language interpretation, mobility assistance, neurodivergent accommodations, trauma-informed care, translation, medication management, or assistive technology during care. These supports should not create extra public traces simply because they are visible in logistics.

9.5.2 — Legal Interface

Independent experts should review category use, access breadth, retention, misuse of professional labels, and alleged concealment while preserving legally protected service content.

Public process labels may state that release is under legal review, appeal is pending, a privilege question is resolved, or an injunction governs access, without exposing protected advice.

The legal interface organizes counsel, privilege review, dispute handling, and lawful challenge inside the institution. Its design should answer where consultation occurs, whether and how any necessary, lawful, and safe occurrence log is kept, what content remains protected, who may see a status label, and who reviews a contested boundary. Assign an owner to each operational decision.

Use clear notices and separate custody for protected legal consultation, ordinary administration, and recorded public-power work; disputed privilege follows the review in Section 9.2.2.

Frequent consultation or lawful procedural delay is not by itself proof of misuse; review credible allegations of concealed nonlegal conduct under Section 9.2.2.

Protect participants, staff, and affected people from retaliation or adverse character inference when legal challenges concern release, support, admission, role conditions, sanctions, or record injury.

9.5.3 — Clinical Interface

Clinical support also protects against therapeutic coercion. The City does not require confession, vulnerability performance, emotional disclosure, or psychological framing as proof of formation.

Provide protected therapy, mental health care, trauma support, psychological assessment where appropriate, crisis stabilization, and emotional recovery.

Clinical care should be usable without stigma and separate from moral ranking. Seeking therapy may show responsible self-care, while acute instability, coercion, severe overload, or safety risk can still affect participation under a distinct role-assessment process. The City should separate treatment records from status decisions, require the minimum necessary bridge information, give the participant notice and review rights, and make clear which professional owns each judgment.

The interface should include consent boundaries, protected notes, category labels, crisis exceptions, independent referral options, and review rules for mandatory reporting where law requires it. Participants should know what is protected, what may be shared for safety, what may affect status, and what will not become public.

The clinical interface should include clear separation between therapy, capacity review, risk assessment, mentorship, and

public evaluation. These roles may all involve psychological language, but they are not the same. Therapy serves care. Capacity review serves informed participation. Risk assessment serves safety. Mentorship serves formation. Public evaluation serves civic review. If the City merges them, participants will not know when they are being helped and when they are being assessed.

Prevent therapeutic dependence on the institution through independent referral, outside consultation, exit continuity, and protected choice.

9.5.4 — Clergy or Pastoral Interface

Pastoral support remains optional within a civic institution. Participants may seek religious counsel, secular chaplaincy, grief support, moral conversation, or conscience guidance.

Protect pastoral content involving grief, guilt, confession, doubt, family pain, fear, shame, and hope; disclose only lawfully justified occurrence, status, or operational consequence.

Use plural provision, nonrecruitment, minimal status logging, protected content, and independent misuse review to prevent pastoral facilities becoming channels for faction building, recruiting, or concealed political work.

Apply qualified safeguarding and legal review to abuse, coercion, imminent danger, child risk, or institutional manipulation involving pastoral care. Follow applicable confidentiality, privilege, and reporting duties; spiritual claims do not remove lawful safeguarding obligations.

9.5.5 — Emergency Interface

Emergency dignity continues after immediate danger has passed. A person carried out by paramedics, evacuated during panic, protected from threat, or involved in a family emergency does not become a permanent symbol of fragility. After-action status

separates what the public needs to know from what belongs to care, safety, and protected recovery. Status records should document institutional conduct without unsupported judgments about the person needing help (World Medical Association, 2024; O'Neill, 2002a).

Emergency interfaces authorize urgent access across protected thresholds when ordinary procedures cannot safely operate.

Authority should be legible before the alarm sounds. The protocol identifies who may enter, who may override an ordinary threshold, what can be captured, what is delayed, who receives notice, how family and accessibility needs are handled, and who classifies the event afterward.

Handle paramedics, firefighters, police, crisis clinicians, security specialists, officials, and family emergency contacts under their urgent roles, with necessary safety/accountability documentation and protection against unnecessary public exposure.

Review repeated emergency access for system failures or misuse without presuming either. Apply triggers, time limits, oversight notice, after-action review, and pattern audit.

Log emergency actors, authority, protected material accessed, required repair, and permission expiry as soon as conditions permit. Temporary access must not persist after its authorization ends.

Rehearse role cards, access classes, privacy flags, translation, family contact, disability accommodation, and debriefing with care, security, record operations, legal review, and public communication. Test permission delays, lost protections, information bottlenecks, and care priority. Assign failures to named owners with dated corrective actions, then replay with a different team and different communication conditions.

9.6 — Care Before Evidence, Complaint, Appeal, Remedy

Begin safety, clinical stabilization, shelter, legal access, and protection from retaliation while preserving evidence compatibly with those needs. Provide assisted intake, accessible and non-digital reporting, interim relief, independent investigation, reasons, appeal, and enforceable remedy. Limit public explanation to what is justified by public accountability or third-party safety (World Medical Association, 2024; United Nations, 1966; UN Human Rights Committee, 2004). The remedy architecture begins with a no-wrong-door principle.

9.6.1 — Relief Before Classification

A harmed person need not decide whether the event is a privacy violation, care failure, technical breach, professional-boundary issue, child-shielding failure, or public-summary error before relief begins. The first contact receives the person, opens immediate protection, preserves relevant evidence, and routes the category to the proper authority.

Frontline authority must permit immediate protective action. Staff should not wait for senior approval before shielding a child, pausing a harmful release, summoning care, or protecting a complainant from retaliation. Provisional powers can be narrow, time-limited, logged, and audited afterward. Fast protection and later review are compatible when the authority is designed in advance (World Medical Association, 2024; National Commission, 1979).

Relief can take many forms: medical care, de-loading, temporary shielding, emergency masking, safe housing, security support, protected status, access suspension, public-release hold, counseling referral, child protection, technical containment, staff

reassignment, or pause. Relief should be proportionate and time-limited where appropriate.

Record protective action separately from adjudication. De-loading, shielding, delayed release, and emergency pause are provisional status events, not findings of misconduct, weakness, concealment, or guilt. Stabilizing a person does not prove a complaint; providing shelter does not decide liability; temporary masking does not decide permanent nonrelease. Where public notice is justified, labels should state what is known, what remains under review, and what protection is active.

9.6.2 — Participant Complaint Intake

Intake must be easy to find, accessible, safe, confidential where needed, and capable of triage. Do not require proof of the whole case before accepting a report.

Listen without premature defense or cross-examination. Gather enough information to protect and route the complaint; investigation follows through the proper process.

Safety screening is the next duty. Some complaints require immediate action: danger, retaliation risk, child exposure, intimate-record harm, medical emergency, staff threat, doxxing, public harassment, or technical breach. Intake should identify urgent cases and trigger relief before ordinary review.

Classify the complainant’s role to identify appropriate protections and remedies, without rejecting people whose categories overlap or remain unclear.

Complaint intake should preserve narrative dignity. A harmed person should not have to retell the same event to multiple offices, perform distress to be believed, provide unnecessary intimate detail, or accept a public label before help begins. Intake should gather what is needed, protect what is vulnerable, and allow further details to be added later.

Allow anonymous or protected preliminary reports where lawful, including questions about reportability, personal risk, and exposure of others. An untested allegation is not a finding, and early protection need not depend on formal public identification.

Complaint intake needs a visible clock. The record distinguishes immediate protection, evidence preservation, acknowledgment, initial classification, independent assignment, interim reasons, expected decision date, and any extension. Missed deadlines escalate automatically rather than forcing the complainant to begin again. Where delay itself creates danger, a charter-authorized rights officer or independent reviewer can order temporary protection, restore access, pause publication, preserve housing or care, or separate parties while the merits remain open. Timeliness changes outcomes: a remedy arriving after exposure, retaliation, or forced exit may be legally available and humanly useless (Bovens, 2007; OHCHR, 2024; European Union, 2016).

9.6.3 — Participant Appeal Pathway

Keep appeals manageable in time, cost, technical and legal demands, and emotional effort, with assistance proportionate to the person’s needs.

Appeal should reach an independent review body outside the office responsible for the disputed operational, archive, or staff-management decision.

The appeal pathway should be accessible and understandable. A person should know the deadline, required information, available assistance, interim protections, standard of review, possible outcomes, and whether public status changes during appeal.

Appeal should preserve interim protection where needed. If a release is challenged, release may need to pause. If retaliation is alleged, the complainant may need protection. If a child or nonparticipant is at risk, shielding should remain while review occurs.

Record the appeal date, applicable status, changed decision, and reasons, with protected details withheld and public corrections where warranted.

Appeals should provide reasons, record access where lawful, protected advocacy, escalation, and review of recurring problems across cases.

Appeal outcomes should become institutional learning without becoming public rank. Aggregate reversals, delayed decisions, repeated categories, and differential access can reveal where the City is failing. The learning should be public enough to show accountability and protected enough to avoid exposing participants or complainants.

9.6.4 — Remedy Types

The rights, complaint, appeal, and remedy route should be written as a living sequence, not a poster. Intake receives the harm without requiring perfect classification. Triage protects the person and preserves evidence. Category review assigns the proper legal, clinical, privacy, employment, family, or record process. Appeal reaches a body capable of changing the first decision. Remedy moves burden back toward the source of harm through correction, shielding, restoration, compensation where lawful, service repair, discipline, or public notice. At each step, the City names who acts, by when, what interim protection applies, what happens after silence, and how retaliation is detected.

Remedy should repair the person's burden and the system that made it possible. Individual relief may require shielding, correction, compensation, care, legal support, pause, restored access, or a protected apology; structural relief may require policy change, staff action, vendor replacement, workflow redesign, training, audit, prevention orders, decertification review, or public reporting. Every remedy decision should name both tracks and verify implementation.

Correction addresses false or misleading records, including inaccurate summaries, missing context, improper inference, wrong identity, outdated release, and mislabeled material. It should be visible enough to repair public memory and should not hide the fact that an error occurred when the public has already relied on it.

Compensation may be necessary where wrongful exposure, data injury, lost work, relocation, medical cost, security risk, or reputational harm creates material burden. Compensation should not be treated as hush money. It should be bounded, documented, audited, and paired with structural repair where the harm reveals system failure.

Shielding may require masking, redaction, sealing, delayed release, protected summaries, search restrictions, access limits, and takedown requests where appropriate. Reduce future exposure without promising to erase all past circulation.

Remedy should include restoration of agency. A person harmed by the City may need more than correction of a record. They may need a voice in how the correction is phrased, whether their name appears, whether a summary is used, how future access is limited, and what support is offered.

Some remedies will need expert review before implementation. A public clarification may affect litigation. A compensation plan may affect employment. A shielding order

may affect child safety. A record correction may affect public trust.

Where harm involves vendor conduct, child safety, or a legal duty, the remedy must include the appropriate specialist response rather than rely on a general apology or training measure.

9.6.5 — Public Explanation Where Needed

Make the route available to staff, families, children through lawful representatives or advocates, partners, visitors, professionals, bystanders, host-community members, and other affected people as well as participants.

Public explanation should be tested for hostile reuse. A statement meant to preserve trust can accidentally expose a person by implication, confirm rumors, invite harassment, or create a searchable label that outlives the event. Before release, the City should ask how the explanation may be clipped, misunderstood, indexed, or weaponized. Explanation is a public artifact and must be governed as one (UN Human Rights Committee, 2004; Bovens, 2007).

Consider public explanation when a record or participant status changes, release was wrongful, systemic failure occurred, safety is affected, or the public needs to understand institutional action. Withhold protected details unless their disclosure is lawful and necessary.

A useful public explanation names the event category, immediate protections, record status, review owner, remedy or correction, and structural change where one follows. Protected people remain unidentified unless identification is lawful and necessary. Precise language replaces euphemism, and the explanation links to the correction route and next review.

Public explanation cannot be managed as reputation defense. It distinguishes preliminary status from final finding, states uncertainty that remains, protects affected-person privacy, and gives the next review date where possible.

Public explanations are themselves governed records. When early information changes, the City updates the statement, preserves version history, links the correction log, and enables reply where appropriate. The earlier error is not silently overwritten.

Audit recurring explanation categories for possible system failures, formulaic reporting, and patterns of protecting leadership while blaming lower staff.

Ask affected people whether the explanation protects dignity, avoids unnecessary identifiers, preserves correction, names institutional responsibility, and reduces harmful speculation.

Chapter 10 — Archive and Public Record Site

A member of the public opens a participant record bundle and sees three different accounts of the same event: the source recording, the participant's contextual statement, and a later finding that changed the official classification. Beside them sits a machine summary that omits the correction because its index was stale. Nothing here can be solved by saying that the archive is complete. The question is whether each layer declares what it is, whether provenance remains visible, whether disputes travel with the record, and whether the interface makes correction easier to find than the original error.

Public memory changes who carries uncertainty. In ordinary political life, citizens guess, journalists reconstruct what was never designed to be knowable, whistleblowers risk retaliation, opponents exploit thin official records, and families become collateral material when private conduct bursts into public conflict. The City moves part of that burden upstream by creating a governed record. It succeeds only if the new archive does not transfer uncertainty and exposure onto participants, nonparticipants, staff, or hosts least able to contest it.

Integrity joins technical controls to institutional responsibility. Authenticity requires provenance, custody logs, tamper detection, durable identifiers, and independent verification. Trust also requires separation of duties, incident response, public status, correction, and recovery when integrity cannot be established. A forged clip, silent edit, stale machine index, broken timestamp, or vendor migration becomes governable only when the system records both the failure and the route back to reliable public memory.

The chapter makes this architecture inspectable by requiring each record state to identify its public purpose, source and custody evidence, visible status, affected-person route, release or interpretation owner, correction duty, and review clock. A

complete archive is never a complete person. The point is to keep public claims traceable to governed source memory and to carry corrections through every official derivative (International Council on Archives, 2012; ISO, 2016a; W3C, 2013).

Journalism performs a different public function. It investigates, interprets, questions, synthesizes, criticizes, and sometimes discovers what official memory missed. The record site supplies auditable, status-labeled source material; the newsroom remains free to challenge its selection, framing, and omissions.

Machine assistance can improve navigation, translation, retrieval, comparison, and access to correction history, but it remains one interpretive tool among several. Every official machine summary needs visible source links, status propagation, uncertainty, human review, challenge, versioning, and withdrawal. It may help a reader find governed material; it cannot assign readiness, trust, character, virtue, or worth, and it cannot collapse contradictory records into an official personality narrative (Council of Europe, 2024; NIST, 2023a; European Union, 2024).

The chapter establishes a plural architecture of public memory for the procedures that follow. The archive preserves governed sources; the record site presents versioned civic objects; journalists and independent reviewers interpret; lawful authorities compel or restrain; affected people contest; auditors inspect; citizens judge. Each role gains value because none owns the whole chain. By separating custody, publication, interpretation, correction, and authority, the City can make formation answerable without converting evidence into fate or one institution into a memory sovereign.

10.1 — Archive as Lawful Public Memory

An archive earns public trust by preserving evidence of decisions and actions without claiming possession of the people represented in them. Records-management standards emphasize authenticity, reliability, integrity, usability, provenance, and controlled disposition; archival ethics adds access, accountability, and respect for rights (International Council on Archives, 2011; ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017). The archive is the City's governed source memory. It preserves active public-power formation under declared custody, provenance, category, context, access, and review rules so later storytelling cannot replace the underlying record.

10.1.1 — Source Record Function

The source archive remains distinct from the public record site, newsroom, platform feed, research dataset, and Artificial Intelligence training reservoir. Those later uses may receive authorized derivatives, but they do not inherit the archive's full contents or authority merely because the source exists.

Lawful public memory describes the archive’s public-power purpose and duties, not universal release. Source records may remain restricted, summarized, delayed, or sealed while the public record site presents only authorized material.

Every source record should carry enough basic information to make future interpretation possible: time, place, role, access band, record origin, participant status, nonparticipant presence, protection category where applicable, and the authority under which the record was captured.

The source record function also supports correction. If the public record site releases a bundle, and that bundle is later challenged, the archive must allow the City to return to source

records, classify the issue, restore context, and correct the public layer.

Source memory should also be designed for lawful humility after the participant leaves. A public-power formation record may remain relevant, but the person is no longer under active formation burden. The source layer must preserve what public accountability requires while allowing post-exit privacy and time review to have real meaning.

A source record also needs a release lineage. When a later public bundle, protected summary, research extract, or correction notice draws from the archive, the public-facing item should be traceable back to the source layer without exposing protected contents.

10.1.2 — Conduct, Not Soul

Conduct can matter greatly. How a participant treats staff, responds to criticism, handles delay, manages a conflict, asks for help, hides a pressure, credits an adviser, or revises a position may be public-power relevant. The archive preserves such conduct because public authority is shaped by repeated patterns. But conduct is not consciousness. It does not give the City direct access to motive, destiny, worth, or inner life.

This distinction protects participants from record totalism. A participant may be angry on a given day without anger becoming identity. A draft may be immature without proving incapacity. A silence may be meaningful, or it may be fatigue, grief, fear, or misunderstanding. The archive can preserve the event. Interpretation must remain humble.

Public education materials attached to the record site should explain the limits of both the archive and machine assistance.

A credible record system should therefore avoid language that turns the archive into moral essence. Terms such as true self,

revealed nature, or proof of character should be treated as public-risk language. The safer vocabulary is conduct, pattern, context, correction, limitation, and public-power relevance.

The conduct boundary should also shape search. A public interface that lets users search for humiliation, private language, medical vulnerability, intimate detail, or emotional collapse teaches the public to treat a person as extractable material. Search should be oriented around public-power questions: decisions, roles, reasons, influence, correction, readiness, office relevance, and institutional response.

Avoid character thumbnails such as calm, unstable, loyal, deceptive, or virtuous. Display role-relevant records, patterns, corrections and disputes.

10.1.3 — Lawful Custody

Lawful custody begins with a custody map. The City must know which office may create a record, which office may preserve it, which office may classify it, which office may correct it, which office may authorize public release, and which office may hear an appeal when custody is challenged.

Custody also requires separation of functions. The same person or office should not control capture, classification, public release, correction, and audit.

A lawful archive must report custody failures. Unauthorized access, orphaned copies, missing logs, broken permissions, unreviewed exports, and unexplained gaps should become status events. Contain the failure, notify affected people safely, correct any resulting distortion in the public layer, and investigate why custody failed. Coordinate these responses according to urgency rather than waiting for one to finish before starting the next. A founder, donor, platform, vendor, staff office, political faction,

or public crowd must not override the archive's lawful custody and review rules.

Custody rules also specify access logging, handoff procedures, incident response, vendor exit, and independent review, covering inspection, correction, release, sealing, summarization, transfer, and retirement.

Lawful public memory requires the City to treat custody as layered. Operational staff may manage systems. Archivists may preserve memory. Oversight bodies may audit access and classification. Affected persons may have correction pathways. Legal authorities may control categories requiring privilege or protection. Technical vendors may host or support infrastructure only under strict audit and exit rights.

Lawful custody also means jurisdictional humility. Privacy law, public-records law, evidentiary rules, labor law, disability law, professional confidentiality, child protection, family law, and constitutional standards all shape what custody may mean in a real place. The City can define the moral need for custody, but legal enforceability belongs to lawful institutions and expert review.

Custody should produce visible accountability without exposing protected contents. Public reports can show access counts, correction categories, breach incidents, delayed-release categories, audit findings, and unresolved issues without revealing vulnerable material.

Custody should include emergency rules before emergency arrives. A breach, court order, public crisis, death, transfer, decertification, or shutdown can create pressure to improvise. The custodian should know in advance who can freeze access, who can authorize urgent review, who can notify affected persons, and who can speak publicly.

Custody must also include rules for transfer and closure. If a City is suspended, decertified, merged, dissolved, or moved, the archive cannot be abandoned to convenience. A lawful transfer plan should preserve rights, correction, access, protection categories, and public memory continuity.

The custodian should be answerable to affected persons as well as public reviewers. Participants and nonparticipants need to know how to ask who accessed their records, what status a record carries, and what remedy exists for misuse.

For a custody breach, identify the people needing protection and name the independent investigation owner.

Name a transfer authority in advance for staff changes, vendor failure, and institutional reorganization.

Custody must be legible to participants before the Vow becomes active. A person cannot meaningfully accept record burden without knowing who holds the record, which bodies can see it, which categories are protected, what happens after exit, and where to challenge misuse.

10.1.4 — Public-Power Relevance

Public-power relevance is the archive's limiting principle. Records are preserved because active formation for consequential public roles affects people beyond the participant, not because every human trace is interesting. Each retained or released item therefore names the role connection it serves. Where relevance is weak and exposure risk high, the archive narrows, summarizes, shields, delays, or declines release.

Public-power relevance includes conduct that bears on office readiness, staff dignity, influence, dependency, correction capacity, record continuity, public reasoning, crisis conduct, conflict response, or use of support. It may include sensitive material only when power relevance is strong and protection

standards are met. It does not include ordinary private detail merely because the participant is under the Vow.

The relevance test protects nonparticipants. A visitor's incidental appearance may be relevant to record integrity but not to public release. A family detail may matter for support planning but not for civic display. A professional interaction may require logging without publicizing the professional.

Apply relevance symmetrically to praise, criticism, scandal, rehabilitation, and silence. Do not display favorable material eagerly while delaying unfavorable material for institutional advantage.

Fame does not strengthen a weak relevance claim. Later public attention may increase curiosity, commercial value, or political pressure, but it does not by itself increase civic need. The archive applies the same role-based threshold when the participant is obscure and when the world is watching.

A practical memory-burden test can discipline relevance review. The reviewer should ask what public-power question the record answers, what lawful authority supports preservation or release, what status label belongs to it, what context is necessary, who may be burdened by exposure, what challenge route exists, and what narrower form can carry the civic meaning. A record unsuitable for public release may remain in protected custody only when preservation has its own lawful basis and continuing purpose.

A fact may be relevant during active formation, less relevant after role change, relevant again during an office campaign, and then eligible only for historical review. Restored context may reduce its apparent importance; a later protected summary may become appropriate where raw release was not. Time review protects accountability and dignity through reasoned changes to

retention, access, and release, with the decision itself documented.

10.1.5 — Anti-Myth Function

Public power is constantly compressed into story, and the archive must resist both heroic and hostile simplification. A participant can be cast as reformer, manipulator, martyr, prodigy, failure, or proof of a new politics long before the underlying sequence is read. Campaigns, critics, donors, media, volunteers, and supporters all contribute because memorable characters travel faster than governed context (ISO, 2017; International Council on Archives, 2012).

Sequence is the first defense. Drafts, warnings, advice, hesitation, correction, later learning, and changed conditions show formation as a process rather than a single revealing scene. A speech looks different when the reader can see the options that preceded it and the repair that followed it.

Flattering myth can be as confining as scandal. Public praise may pressure a participant to remain transparent, tireless, wounded, brilliant, or unusually fair even when that persona no longer fits reality or safe capacity. Role-relevant records of uncertainty, error, and modest work make it harder for admiration to become a role the person is forced to perform.

Scandal myth works in the opposite direction. One fragment can define a person, erase a correction, or turn an unresolved dispute into final character. The archive cannot prevent every misuse, but structured context, visible status, and a usable correction route give the public something sturdier than the fragment.

Make the archive’s own claims open to provenance checks, uncertainty labels, challenge, and correction, including reasons to distrust an item it preserves.

Institutional legend belongs under the same discipline. The City may be tempted to remember itself as the first institution that solved hidden power. Staff warnings, host objections, failed designs, abandoned practices, correction costs, and public misunderstandings should remain searchable enough to interrupt that self-portrait.

The opposite legend, that difficulty proves only cruelty or failure, is also incomplete. A serious record can show when the institution narrowed, paused, repaired, or relinquished authority. Learning should remain visible after both praise and outrage have moved on.

Contradiction should not be edited away. A participant may show courage and vanity, patience and evasion, growth and relapse, sound judgment and fatigue. Mixed evidence is not a defect in memory. It is one reason history is more trustworthy than legend.

An anti-myth audit can sample featured material, search defaults, recommendation logic, headlines, public bundles, and omissions. The question is not whether positive and negative items appear in equal numbers. It is whether selection rules let routine burden, unresolved complaint, institutional failure, and later correction remain findable beside the dramatic scene.

10.2 — Participant Record Site as Public Interface

The public record site should be designed as an interface for inspection rather than a stream of exposure. Users need layered context, stable definitions, accessible navigation, provenance cues, visible disputes, correction histories, and plain explanations of role status. Accessibility is not an optional visual treatment: keyboard operation, semantic structure, readable contrast, captions, text alternatives, and cognitive clarity determine who can inspect power. Public access also requires restraint. Search, bulk download, automated scraping, and decontextualized clipping can transform legitimate transparency into targeting or spectacle. The interface should therefore support meaningful access while governing high-risk extraction and preserving the distinction between official source, interpretation, and machine assistance (International Council on Archives, 2012; UN Human Rights Committee, 2011; W3C, 2023).

10.2.1 — Record Bundle Purpose

A record bundle gathers related material around a specified civic purpose for public review (UN Human Rights Committee, 2011; W3C, 2023).

A bundle protects citizens from fragment overload by showing why the material matters, what is disputed, and what should not be inferred.

A strong bundle also includes limits. It should tell readers when a record is partial, when context is missing, when a dispute remains unresolved, when legal review is pending, when sensitive content has been summarized, and when material should not be treated as final.

Bundle purpose also supports audit. An auditor can ask whether a bundle's contents match its stated purpose, whether

protected material was unnecessarily included, whether damaging context was omitted, and whether a reader would understand the limits.

Link the bundle to its supporting source categories and applicable access protections.

Good bundle design also makes absence visible without making absence suspicious. Where acknowledgment is safe and lawful, the bundle should identify delayed, sealed, redacted, or summarized material through appropriate labels. The underlying decision remains independently auditable when acknowledgment itself must stay protected.

Bundles should also disclose their assembly logic. A citizen should know whether a bundle is chronological, role-based, event-based, correction-based, readiness-based, or institutional-failure based. Assembly logic matters because order creates meaning. The same records can produce a different public burden if they are arranged as a scandal trail, a redemption arc, or an administrative record.

10.2.2 — Context Layers

Context layers are the record site's defense against fragment-based judgment. Every public item should carry enough surrounding information to prevent the reader from treating a draft as a decision, a simulation as office conduct, a delay as concealment, a protected summary as raw evidence, or a disputed item as settled.

The first layer is status. Readers need to know whether material is source-derived, summarized, corrected, disputed, delayed, sealed, protected, time-reviewed, provisional, or final within a defined category. Status does not decide interpretation, but it gives interpretation a floor.

The second layer is temporal context. A comment made at the beginning of formation may mean something different after months of correction. A decision revised after opposition carries a different meaning from a decision never challenged. A record without sequence can make growth look like contradiction or make stubbornness look like consistency.

The third layer is role context. Public-power relevance depends on what role is being formed, what pathway the participant is in, what duties were at stake, and what kind of burden the record addresses. A behavior relevant to executive crisis readiness may not have the same relevance for a local deliberative role.

Context layers should also protect against false equivalence. Not every record in a bundle has equal weight. A final decision, a rejected draft, a simulation response, a staff warning, and a participant reflection may all belong in the same sequence, but they should not appear as identical evidence. The site must help readers understand weight without dictating conclusion.

Context layers should be designed for machine readability as well as human readability. If summaries, search tools, accessibility tools, and translation systems rely on the site, they must receive status and context metadata so that assistance does not strip away the very safeguards the public needs.

Keep participant replies, affected-person notes, and institutional interpretations visible alongside record status, chronology, role, legal status, protection, and correction context. One layer must not erase another.

Include relevant staff concerns in the context supplied with an excerpt.

The strongest context layers should be portable. If a record is quoted by the record site, referenced by a newsroom, summarized by a machine, or linked from a civic platform, the

core status and correction context should travel with it where possible.

10.2.3 — Role Pathway Display

The public record site should identify the role pathway because readiness is never abstract. Local office, legislative work, executive responsibility, diplomacy, administrative leadership, adjudicative roles, and technical public service impose different burdens and call for different evidence. The interface should show the pathway without pretending that the pathway authorizes office.

A useful pathway card can name the prospective role family, its public duties, relevant formation domains, evidence categories, protected absences, unresolved questions, review date, and limits on transfer. Budget literacy does not demonstrate diplomatic judgment. Crisis simulation in one domain does not become universal leadership evidence.

Pathways can change without becoming moral narratives. Redirection may reflect better fit, delay may protect health or family, narrowing may show honest judgment, and departure may be prudent. The interface should record the administrative change and any reason category that can lawfully and safely be disclosed without turning it into a story of ascent or failure.

Administrative labels need precise definitions. Accepted, active, paused, delayed, redirected, withdrawn, completed, returned, and under review describe process states attached to a role pathway. They are not reputational grades and should not be ordered visually from lower to higher human value.

External authorities remain external. Voters, law, election administrators, parties, legislatures, appointing bodies, professional regulators, and courts retain their own responsibilities. A pathway page should reveal those handoffs so

the City record cannot be mistaken for a parallel credentialing state.

Visual grammar matters. Branching routes, parallel domains, review points, and exits communicate role specificity better than a staircase, pyramid, badge sequence, or rising score. The diagram should show obligations and limits, not a journey from ordinary life toward superior civic virtue.

Institutional failure must appear on the same page as participant evidence. A missing record may result from denied opportunity, inaccessible design, technical loss, staff shortage, protected status, unresolved complaint, or role irrelevance. The interface should not silently assign every absence to the person under review.

Different pathways produce different densities of evidence. A crisis-oriented track may contain repeated simulations; a legislative track may contain extensive drafting and coalition work; a technical track may emphasize systems analysis.

Transfer across roles should therefore be rebuttable rather than automatic. Evidence may remain relevant after a pathway change, but the public interface should state why, under what limit, and which new questions remain unanswered. The volume of archived material must never create an aura of universal readiness.

10.2.4 — Dispute and Correction Visibility

Dispute and correction status must be visible beside the affected public record.

The same visibility applies to corrections sought by nonparticipants.

Do not bury a correction at the bottom of a page while the original error remains prominent.

Dispute visibility needs proportion. A challenge should be findable without converting every disagreement into spectacle. Protected categories, nonparticipant rights, legal review, or safety may justify delayed or summarized explanation. The public entitlement is to know that the record is contestable, what status applies, who owns review, and whether the result changed the operative object.

Show what is challenged, the response, and the current review status without inferring motive from the fact of a challenge.

Public correction design should be simple enough to be found under stress. A harmed person should not need to navigate a maze of archive offices, legal categories, and technical forms to seek repair.

A deliberation clip may appear to show evasion until a later correction explains that a protected legal consultation constrained what could be said. Preserve the lawfully held source and attach the correction to authorized continued uses of the clip. Restrict or withdraw the public object if its continued release is no longer justified.

Correction visibility should be designed for proportional attention. Some disputes require a small label, some require a prominent correction, some require withdrawal of a public object, and some require a public institutional explanation. Too little correction hides harm; too much correction can create new harm.

10.2.5 — Accessibility for Nonexperts

The interface should also anticipate unequal public attention. Some participants will draw fascination; others may be ignored. Some issues will become symbolic; others will be technically important but publicly quiet. The site must organize memory by civic relevance, not by popularity or drama.

Offer chronological, issue-based, office-readiness, and correction paths, with a plain-language overview for readers who need orientation before approaching source-linked material. Multiple routes help readers with different needs understand the record (International Council on Archives, 2012; Bertot et al., 2010).

Accessibility includes protection from manipulative design. The record site should not use autoplay, trending lists, dramatic thumbnails, outrage prompts, emotional ranking, or endless scroll to hold attention. A civic record site should help readers stop, compare, verify, and leave with a bounded judgment.

Nonexpert access also includes civic intermediary access. Journalists, teachers, advocacy groups, researchers, and local forums may need structured public materials to explain City records to wider audiences. Public materials should keep the same status labels, correction notices, release notes, and protection limits wherever they travel.

Plain-language explanations matter. Terms such as archive, protected summary, delayed release, disputed status, chain of custody, role pathway, nonparticipant masking, and Artificial Intelligence summary should be defined where they appear.

Offer summaries, context labels, source-linked records, correction logs, provenance views, and expert notes at successive depths.

The public interface should explain what it is before asking the reader to trust it. A short charter can identify the official source of record status, the distinction between source and interpretation, the correction and reply routes, the accessibility options, and the current version. Orientation is not promotional copy.

Search should reveal status before relevance ranking can hide it. A disputed, corrected, protected, obsolete, or delayed item

should carry that condition into search results, exports, and machine-assisted retrieval.

Emotional accessibility matters too. Severe tone, dense legal language, moral drama, and constant warnings can make the primary record harder to use. Calm layering, dignified pacing, and routes to deeper detail sustain attention without mistaking simplicity for truth.

The usability report should show whether readers across literacy levels, languages, disabilities, devices, and time constraints can find status, sources, disputes, corrections, versions, protected summaries, and appeals without undue effort or steering. A useful retrieval exercise presents a corrected decision beside a superseded account and asks first-time readers to identify which statement currently governs. Test the same task through accessible text, screen-reader navigation, and a translated explanation rather than treating one successful format as sufficient. Record where readers stopped, which link misled them, and whether the revised presentation fixes the confusion on a new case.

10.3 — Provenance, Custody, and Tamper Resistance

Provenance makes evidentiary trust inspectable. A record should carry its source, capture time, role context, custody events, transformations, redactions, releases, corrections, responsible authority, and known limits. Tamper-evident logs, cryptographic checks, write controls, independent replication, and anomaly review help only when human investigators can understand what the system recorded and what it missed. Content credentials can document origin and modification, but an authentic asset may still be incomplete or misleading; technical verification therefore belongs beside context review, affected-person challenge, and correction (W3C, 2013; ISO/IEC, 2012; C2PA, 2026).

10.3.1 — Provenance Metadata

Provenance metadata must preserve a record's origin, governance, and history. Origin fields include the source system or device where lawful, capture method and authority, creation and capture times and their time source, and authorized role context. Governance fields include the access band, nonparticipant presence, protected-category flags, and classification history. History fields cover processing and transformations, custody and access events, release decision and authority, correction lineage, and known limitations. Every record must remain internally auditable even when some fields cannot be public. A later reviewer can then test whether the record retains the authority and limits under which it was preserved (W3C, 2013; ISO/IEC, 2012).

Some provenance metadata will itself be protected. Exact locations, device identifiers, security routes, medical context, family identifiers, witness names, and staff identifiers can expose people if released casually. The public interface should disclose enough provenance to support trust while preserving

details whose exposure would create new harm. Metadata is not automatically public simply because it proves authenticity.

Record sensor failures, late human notes, translations, protected-category changes to release form, and timestamps reconstructed from secondary logs, including the uncertainty each introduces.

Provenance must also distinguish record types. A raw capture, a protected summary, an official release note, a correction log, a dispute label, a public bundle, a newsroom interpretation, and an Artificial Intelligence summary should never appear as the same kind of item. Each has different authority. Metadata must carry that difference.

Provenance metadata can become invasive if overcollected. The City should capture what is needed for authenticity, status, context, and review, not every possible trace because storage is cheap.

Provenance metadata should include human-readable forms as well as technical forms. Auditors may need detailed logs, but citizens need basic confidence: official source, status, date, category, and release authority.

A further requirement is to guard against provenance laundering. A document can be given official-looking metadata after weak capture, poor custody, or questionable classification. Metadata is only as trustworthy as the process that creates it. Provenance systems themselves need audit, not reverence.

Provenance metadata should be resilient against vendor change. A record system that preserves source information only inside a proprietary platform can lose intelligibility when a vendor fails, contracts end, or formats change. The City should require exportable, documented, durable metadata.

Provenance needs a visible gap protocol. Device-clock drift, lost metadata, altered vendor exports, invalid signatures, and

uncertain origin are not silently normalized into certainty. Each gap receives a status, bounded explanation, investigator, preservation action, and rule for whether the item may support public release. Later restoration preserves the history of uncertainty rather than overwriting it (W3C, 2013; ISO, 2017; NARA, 2023).

10.3.2 — Chain-of-Custody Logs

Chain-of-custody logs record who handled a record, what changed, what authority allowed the action, and what status resulted.

A custody log should track capture, transfer, classification, access, redaction, summary, release, correction, sealing, export, audit, and breach response. Identify the responsible actor and authorized role while protecting private staff life.

Preserve prior classification and correction history, record the reason for each change, and attach a review clock to delayed release.

Any defensible record system has to protect custody logs themselves. They may contain sensitive staff actions, nonparticipant references, security details, legal review, and protected categories. Public summaries of custody may be appropriate where raw custody data is not.

A chain-of-custody log should make improper access visible. If someone browses records outside their role, retrieves sensitive material without purpose, or exports data beyond authority, the log should create evidence of that misuse.

The custody system should include access reason codes. It is not enough to know that someone opened a record; the system should identify the purpose category where feasible. Oversight review can then detect browsing disguised as work or repeated access patterns without public purpose.

Chain of custody should also cover public exports. Once a public bundle is downloaded, cited, or shared, the City cannot control every use, but it can provide stable identifiers, release notes, and version checks that let responsible users verify currency.

Provide plain-language summaries of capture authority, unexplained gaps, authorized access, reviewed transformations, and release or withholding reasons.

Sampling audits and meaningful sanctions should make quiet over-access by insiders harder to normalize.

10.3.3 — Tamper Alerts

Tamper alerts are the City's early warning system for manipulated memory. They should detect or flag unexpected edits, missing files, altered metadata, unauthorized access, hash mismatch, suspicious export, inconsistent timestamps, abnormal query patterns, or attempts to bypass classification.

Treat a tamper alert as a request for human review, not a finding of misconduct. Classify, investigate, and label status where needed.

Public communication around tamper alerts requires care. Some alerts may not need public notice. Others may affect released material, participant rights, nonparticipant protection, or public trust. The City should define categories: internal technical review, oversight notice, affected-person notice, public status alert, and breach communication. Silence cannot be the default where public memory is compromised.

Configure alerts around role boundaries so insider misuse can be detected without obstructing ordinary authorized work.

Provide appeal and bias review for people affected by alert handling.

Detection is useful only if response has been rehearsed. Staff need a practiced sequence for freezing affected objects, preserving evidence, notifying oversight and affected persons, publishing a bounded status notice, restoring service, and reviewing the failure. Assign an accountable responder to each alert.

Tamper alert governance should include remedies for people harmed by suspected manipulation. If a false or compromised record becomes public, affected persons may need temporary status notes, context restoration, public warning, and later correction even before the full investigation ends.

10.3.4 — Deepfake Resistance

Plan for attacks on the record: deletion, forgery, leaks, unauthorized access, clipping, mislabeling, metadata manipulation, selective release, deepfake media, unverifiable summaries, and confusion about which version is official.

Attacks on memory will often be political, technical, moral, and emotional at once. A fabricated record can injure a participant; a successful attack on a genuine record can deprive the public of evidence; a breach can expose nonparticipants who never chose visibility. Integrity response must account for all three harms rather than protecting only institutional continuity.

Deepfake review should proceed in stages. A suspect item should be quarantined from official reuse, matched against source records, checked against custody logs, compared with independent technical indicators, routed to human review, and given a public status label when public harm is likely. The City should not promise instant truth.

No detector should become the judge. Machine detection, cryptographic signatures, watermark checks, metadata comparison, witness review, and source record reconciliation

each answer different questions. A detector can miss a strong forgery or suspect a real recording. The City should combine technical evidence with custody evidence and human accountability, then explain the confidence level without turning confidence into a final verdict about the person.

Deepfake resistance protects both people and public judgment. Fabricated audio, video, images, or text can injure participants, nonparticipants, elections, and institutional legitimacy; false denials can also discredit authentic records. Prepare capture security, rapid challenge, and correction routes alongside the verification methods above before the first convincing attack (C2PA, 2026; NIST, 2024c).

Public users should be able to distinguish official record-site material from external clips, commentary, reposts, altered media, and unofficial compilations.

Teach users that machine-generated transcripts can be wrong, authentic excerpts can mislead, and official confirmation may take time.

The public record site should avoid training citizens to rely on visual realism. It should teach verification habits: official source, status, provenance, version, release note, and correction log.

During verification, state what remains unresolved about whether an item is false, altered, authentic, or stripped of context.

Synthetic attacks may target emotion before technical scrutiny catches up. Fabricated intimacy, invented insults, false staff abuse, or simulated crisis behavior can feel more revealing than ordinary evidence.

Deepfake resistance cannot rely on one vendor. The combined methods should also include manifest review where available and adversarial testing.

10.3.5 — Independent Audit

Integrity systems should also be legible during calm periods, not only after breach. If the public learns provenance and custody rules only during scandal, those rules may feel defensive. The record site should normalize integrity education before trust is tested.

The archive must be open to independent external inspection under rules that protect sensitive material while testing authenticity, classification, correction, and lawful release (C2PA, 2026; Chesney and Citron, 2019).

An independent audit should examine provenance systems, custody logs, tamper alerts, access patterns, classification decisions, protected summaries, release notes, correction handling, vendor dependence, Artificial Intelligence assistance, and breach response. Test these procedures under stress.

Public audit summaries are necessary, but they must be carefully designed. The public needs to know categories of findings, severity, remedies, unresolved concerns, and repeated failures. The public does not need protected raw records, vulnerable names, security details that increase risk, or intimate material.

Independent audit should include adversarial testing. Red teams can attempt to manipulate records, abuse search, infer protected facts, exploit metadata, pressure release categories, or test public-interface confusion.

Include the public-interface task tests in Section 10.2.5 in the independent audit, covering status labels, protected summaries, and version histories.

Independent audit should be scheduled and triggered. Regular audits create baseline accountability; incident-triggered audits respond to breach, controversy, unusual access, public confusion, or repeated correction.

Include participant and nonparticipant experience in testing whether harmed people can reach correction routes.

Auditors should be able to test sampling integrity and the treatment of unfavorable institutional records.

A mature audit program uses blind test records and controlled canary events. Auditors can introduce a harmless synthetic record with known provenance, correction, access, and expiry properties, then test whether every system preserves them. They can also verify that unauthorized browsing, delayed correction, broken version links, or vendor-side copying produces a detectable signal. These tests do not guarantee every real record is safe; they show whether controls detect the failures they claim to govern (ISO, 2016a; NIST, 2020a).

Findings need remediation clocks. A critical custody failure may require immediate suspension of release. A recurrent labeling defect may require a temporary warning across every affected bundle. A vendor weakness may require access reduction, migration, or termination. The audit record should identify owner, deadline, interim protection, verification method, and consequence for nonclosure. Repeated findings should escalate rather than restart as if they were new.

Include cloud storage, transcription, translation, provenance credentials, search, backups and security services in the dependency-chain audit under Section 29.4.4. Verify contractual audit reach through subcontractors.

10.4 — Public Bundles, Status Labels, and Versioning

A public bundle should be a governed publication object, not a raw data dump. Each bundle needs a declared purpose, inclusion rule, protected-category review, status labels, version identifier, release date, change log, and expiration or review condition. Labels such as allegation, participant statement, verified event, disputed classification, interim restriction, final decision, correction, and withdrawn item must remain distinct. Version history should allow a reader to see what changed without preserving every harmful error in perpetually prominent form. Records standards and public-sector version practices support this layered approach, but the City should test official excerpts and export views against misleading crops, keep status beside the content, and provide durable links to the current record. External copying may still remove that context (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; International Council on Archives, 2012).

10.4.1 — Public Bundle Categories

A decision bundle may gather drafts, briefings, objections, revisions, final explanation, and later correction; a correction bundle may show error, response, remedy, and updated status; a role-pathway bundle may show relevant education, deliberation, staff treatment, public interface, and limits. Each category should answer a defined public question with declared sources, status, omissions, and expiry, and should keep unrelated material separate (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017).

Each category must specify excluded material and the governing protections.

Use stable bundle categories for comparison across participants by human readers, with explained exceptions for unusual cases.

A bundle category should also indicate the intended reader. Some bundles may be for general citizens, some for affected persons, some for institutional reviewers, and some for oversight summaries.

Public bundle categories should be listed in a glossary or public guide so users can learn the record site's grammar.

Bundle categories should be reviewed after major public misunderstandings. The City may need to rename, restructure, or split the category so its purpose becomes clearer.

Bundles for event context, incident response, office interface, support-and-load summaries, and institutional failure also require different source rules and audiences.

Bundle categories should be defined before political pressure arises. Categories invented during controversy can appear defensive and may be selected strategically.

Bundle categories should remain revisable through public and expert review. As the City learns, new release forms may be needed, and old categories may create hidden bias. Revision should happen through logged governance, not quiet interface redesign.

10.4.2 — Status Labels

A status label earns its place only when it changes handling. A disputed record must route readers to the challenge; a corrected record must reveal the correction; a delayed record must name the authority and review date; a protected or sealed record must explain its category only where acknowledgment is safe and lawful, without disclosing the protected content.

Use a finite vocabulary with distinct handling rules for current, disputed, corrected, superseded, delayed, sealed, protected, summarized, draft, simulation, unverified, under review, subject to appeal, and released with limitations.

A corrected label should link to what changed, when, and whether public meaning changed. The earlier version may remain preserved for audit under appropriate access controls.

For publicly disclosable protection categories, explain delayed, sealed, and protected states at the level needed for review but not reconstruction. Identify the applicable child, legal, clinical, intimate, nonparticipant, security, family-law, or appeal protection without disclosing underlying content.

A status label should work for an ordinary reader and for an auditor. Each label needs a plain definition, responsible authority, start time, review path, expiry or transition rule, and consequence for misuse. Technical precision without usability hides the route from the affected person; friendly wording without testable criteria hides it from oversight.

Place labels beside excerpts, summaries, downloads, transcripts, media packets, educational items, and other official derivatives. Supply copy-stable identifiers and context for sharing.

Audit the thresholds for consequential labels so routine warnings do not bury important states.

Accessibility cannot depend on color alone. Text, symbols, contrast, screen-reader order, plain language, and cognitive load all shape whether a label is usable. The interface should be tested with people who rely on different sensory, linguistic, and cognitive pathways.

Record status transitions with their date, authority, reason, and review trail.

Label governance must resist pressure from every direction. A powerful participant may seek rapid removal of a “disputed” label; critics may want a damaging status retained after review; the institution may prefer ambiguity that protects itself.

Independent criteria, conflict rules, and appeal help keep the vocabulary from becoming a tool of influence.

Status grammar protects evidence from moral theater. Corrected names a record action, not exoneration; disputed names an active challenge, not falsity; sealed names access, not scandal; protected names handling, not guilt. Apply these distinctions consistently in City wording, symbols, placement, release notes, and machine summaries, and make them clear to journalists and other readers so procedural states do not harden into character verdicts.

Use explicit historical, expired, and scheduled-for-review states where time changes how an item may be used.

Present a short status, a concise explanation, and a route to authority, history, and review.

10.4.3 — Version History

A version history should show meaningful changes: added context, correction, redaction, protected-summary replacement, dispute resolution, release after delay, sealing, unsealing, category reclassification, and altered status labels.

The system should distinguish minor technical changes from meaning-changing changes. Formatting fixes, accessibility improvements, typographical corrections, and file migrations that leave meaning intact should not overwhelm the public log; edits that change meaning must be visible regardless of their technical form. Define thresholds for public notice so version history is neither empty nor unusable.

Version history must not expose protected material through the back door. If a redaction is corrected, the log should not reveal what the redaction protects. If a nonparticipant name is removed, the log can state that a nonparticipant protection correction occurred without naming the person.

Version history must protect readers who encounter official material outside the record site. Every public object should carry a stable identifier, current-version check, status date, and visible route back to the authoritative source. When a meaning-changing update occurs, the City should notify known syndication partners and affected people where appropriate. The objective is not perfect control of circulation, which is impossible, but a public path by which reliance can be corrected.

Institutional learning becomes visible when the log connects a corrected object to the process change that followed. A misleading label may lead to a new review trigger; a masking failure may change capture zones; a stale machine index may create a propagation check. The version history should distinguish repair of the individual object from repair of the system so the public can see whether the same burden is likely to recur.

A meaning-changing version entry states the prior state, new state, date, authorizing role, reason, effect on public interpretation, downstream artifacts, and next review. Keep technical corrections in a compact maintenance layer available for authorized review.

Version history should preserve stable citations. Scholars, journalists, courts, oversight bodies, affected persons, and citizens may need to cite the exact state they reviewed. Version-specific reference must remain possible without creating confusing duplication or allowing an obsolete state to masquerade as current.

Version history should include machine-generated outputs where they affect public interpretation. If a summary, translation, transcript, caption, search result, or recommendation changes, the public-facing meaning may change even if the

source record does not. Versioning must follow the public object, not only the source file.

10.4.4 — Protected Public-Bundle Summaries

A protected summary is a governed public object. It should identify the public question answered, protection category where naming it is safe and lawful under Section 11.3.1, release authority, level of generality, creation date, version, correction owner, and review date. It should remain linked to source custody without exposing protected content. If source material can be released safely with context, institutional convenience is not a reason to substitute a summary.

Different domains require different forms. Clinical care may permit a functional statement without diagnosis; legal counsel, a process statement without privileged advice; family or child protection, a status statement without identity; and security, a bounded risk statement without operational detail. Category experts should help determine the least revealing form that still communicates the role-relevant fact. The summary must distinguish what it establishes from what remains unavailable and must not invite readers to infer hidden wrongdoing or certainty.

Writers should be trained in these limits and reviewed independently of public-relations incentives. Review must work in both directions: an affected person may challenge excessive disclosure or mischaracterization, while authorized public oversight may challenge concealment of role-relevant conduct or flattering ambiguity. The answer is a reviewable decision, not automatic raw disclosure.

Available remedies include correction, narrowing, replacement, withdrawal, and a stronger release note. A changed summary should retain a version history where this can be done

safely. Scheduled review, new information, legal resolution, or material public misunderstanding should prompt reconsideration.

10.4.5 — Release Notes

Release notes explain why material appears, why it appears in a particular form, and why other material may be withheld, delayed, summarized, sealed, or corrected (International Council on Archives, 2012; NARA, 2023).

A release note should identify the bundle category, public-power relevance, source authority, status labels, protection categories where applicable, dispute status, version relation, and correction route. It should also state major limits: what the release does not show, what should not be inferred, and whether further review is pending.

Use neutral language for favorable and adverse releases.

Link classification challenges, wrongful-exposure reports, and context-restoration requests to their review routes and correction log.

In high-risk releases, the note may need to name public harm protections. If material could be clipped, sexualized, used to identify a child, trigger harassment, or expose a nonparticipant, the release note should indicate safeguards and public-use limits.

Release notes can help build institutional memory for future reform. When release decisions are logged consistently, auditors can detect patterns: overrelease in scandal, underrelease near favored participants, recurring delays in certain categories, or confusion around nonparticipant protection. Over time, those patterns can show whether policy, staffing, or interface design needs correction rather than leaving each release decision isolated.

10.5 — Correction, Right of Reply, and Context Integrity

Correction is not a hidden administrative repair. When an official public interface has carried an error, the corrected record should identify what changed, when, why, and under whose authority, while avoiding unnecessary repetition of the original harm. Participants and nonparticipants require different access routes but equal seriousness. A right of reply can preserve contested interpretation without forcing the archive to declare all claims equally supported. Context restoration may require linking a clipped item to the longer sequence, restoring omitted documents, or explaining a later reversal. Data-protection law, records practice, and journalistic ethics converge on a practical insight: accuracy is a continuing duty rather than a one-time publication event (European Union, 2016; ISO, 2016a; Society of Professional Journalists, 2014).

10.5.1 — Participant Correction

A participant correction begins with a specific object and alleged defect. The request identifies factual error, missing source, status mistake, misclassification, incomplete sequence, wrongful release, or material omission. General dissatisfaction with public judgment is not enough, but the route should help a person translate harm into a reviewable claim (European Union, 2016; ISO, 2016a).

The intake body acknowledges the request, preserves the challenged version, applies any necessary interim label, and assigns a clock. Urgent exposure, safety, or identity errors may require provisional shielding before full review. The visible status should say that review is active without treating the complaint as proof.

Access to the relevant source or a protected review pathway is essential. A person cannot challenge an object they are forbidden to understand. Where third-party rights limit disclosure, counsel or an independent reviewer can examine the protected material and explain the basis sufficiently for contest.

The decision should distinguish source error from interpretation. A wrong date, attribution, status, or category may require correction. An accurate but incomplete item may require context restoration. A contested conclusion may require a reply or dispute label. Different defects need different remedies.

Publish the correction's defect category and effect on earlier interpretation without repeating protected content or humiliating the participant.

Using the route should never count against the participant as noncooperation, evasiveness, or poor transparency. A lawful challenge is part of governed record, not a breach of the Vow. Anti-retaliation review should examine later admissions, support, status, staff treatment, and public communication for adverse inference.

Use a dated addendum, linked reply, restored sequence, or corrected status when context repair is more truthful than changing the source.

Correction access must not depend on confidence, legal literacy, money, or public influence. Plain-language help, translation, disability access, representative assistance, and funded independent advice can prevent the process from becoming a privilege of the articulate.

The decision record should name the defect category, evidence reviewed, authority, reasons, remedy, propagation duties, appeal route, and implementation owner. That structure lets later auditors see whether similar harms receive similar treatment and

whether correction changes practice rather than merely adding a note.

Offer confidential intake, representation, and time-limited interim protection when illness, exhaustion, legal constraints, political attack, or fear of further exposure obstruct a correction request.

Repair must follow every governed derivative. Public bundles, exports, machine summaries, newsroom feeds, cached pages, accessibility versions, translations, research extracts, and graphics should receive a tracked update or an unresolved-status notice. Some copies cannot be recalled, but replacement identifiers, redirects, notices to known recipients, and a propagation log show whether public memory was actually repaired (European Union, 2016; International Council on Archives, 2012; C2PA, 2026).

10.5.2 — Nonparticipant Correction

Because they never accepted the Vow, nonparticipants have independent standing to seek correction without the participant's permission or further public exposure. The route covers visitors, bystanders, family members, staff, professionals, protesters, host-community residents, and incidental contacts.

A usable nonparticipant pathway should cover wrongful exposure, identity error, masking, removal where appropriate, protected-summary revision, context correction, and remedy for harm. Intake must be understandable without knowledge of City bureaucracy and available through accessible, trauma-aware, privacy-preserving channels. Urgent cases require interim protection before the merits are finally decided.

The complaint itself needs protection. A person asking to be removed from wrongful exposure should not become more visible because they objected, and staff should not treat the

request as evidence of guilt or hostility. Complaint data require separate custody, limited access, anti-retaliation safeguards, and a clear destruction or retention rule.

High-risk exposure requires an emergency route. A wrongly exposed child, clinician, partner, victim, protester, or bystander may need immediate masking, temporary takedown, search suppression, safety support, or platform notice before ordinary review is complete. Interim action should be logged, narrowly scoped, and capable of being revised as facts change.

Repeated collateral harms should trigger redesign rather than an endless sequence of individual cases. If the same camera angle, release template, bundle category, or machine summary repeatedly exposes nonparticipants, the pattern belongs in an institutional failure review. Correction data should therefore feed architecture, training, vendor, and policy changes.

Notice is necessary where it is feasible and safe. People cannot challenge exposure they do not know exists, yet notice itself may reveal sensitive circumstances or create danger. The City should define when affected persons are notified before release, immediately after release, or through a protected intermediary. The decision and its reason should be reviewable.

Use the remedies in Sections 9.4.5 and 9.6.4, including restored access and future masking where appropriate; removing a file alone may not repair reputation, safety, or trust.

The burden of using the correction system should itself be measured. Time, cost, number of steps, need for counsel, emotional load, repeat disclosure, and delay before public repair all reveal whether the route is practically available.

Assign a single accountable case owner to coordinate assistance and correction.

Representation must be available when direct participation is unsafe or impossible. Children, dependents, incapacitated

people, elders, patients, clients, and people under threat may need a guardian, counsel, independent advocate, or trusted intermediary to act. The representative's authority and limits should be recorded, and the affected person's own voice should be preserved where possible.

10.5.3 — Record-Site Right of Reply

A right of reply is bounded by relevance, privacy, nonharassment, and the same protection rules that govern the record. A participant may explain context, remorse, disagreement, or changed understanding, but may not use the reply to threaten, harass, retaliate against, or expose protected details about witnesses, staff, professionals, nonparticipants, or critics.

Recognize staff and nonparticipant replies when a public bundle misdescribes a visit, staff action, or household consent.

The route lets a participant or affected person add a contextual response to public memory. It does not overwrite source records, certify the response as true, or annul a lawful finding.

A visible label should identify the reply as contextual response rather than source record or official verification. It should name the speaker's role, the record addressed, date, review status, and any live dispute. That grammar protects the speaker from having the response misrepresented as an admission, and it protects the public from mistaking assertion for adjudication.

The route should not force every response into a repentance story. A reply may apologize, correct a fact, dispute interpretation, describe harm, explain later learning, or simply preserve disagreement. The institution should resist the dramatic convenience of treating accountability as a single arc from offense to redemption.

Official language can be accurate and still fail to express the lived consequence of a decision. A person harmed by a record may need to state what a formal correction cannot capture, provided the response remains relevant and protective of others. The route should permit human language without converting injury into spectacle.

Popularity cannot determine access to reply. A disliked participant, an unpopular protester, a low-status staff member, or a nonparticipant without a public platform retains the same route. The interface should therefore insulate reply decisions from audience approval and institutional prestige.

Not every response should carry the same visibility as the original record. A public reply may be appropriate in one case; a protected response, affected-person note, or summary-level correction may be safer in another. The speaker should receive a reasoned choice among formats where law and protection permit. Keep status and audience clear across formats.

Limits or rejection of a reply must be reviewable. Keep an accepted reply attached to the relevant record across versions and official derivatives, subject to its approved access limits.

Review replies for defamation, relevance, collateral safety, and protected content without selecting acceptable viewpoints. Discomfort alone does not justify rejection.

Attach assistance and a deadline to the disputed object so access to reply does not depend on money, endurance, or a media contest.

10.5.4 — Context Restoration

Context restoration repairs an official public object when status, sequence, provenance, correction, or protected meaning has been stripped away. It does not give the City ownership of every outside interpretation. The institution may restore what its own

governed record can establish, while criticism and independent judgment remain free.

A simulation clip presented as ordinary conduct, a draft presented as final, an old version circulated without its correction, or a protected summary described as proof of concealment can all produce false public meaning. The response should reconnect the fragment to its status, sequence, provenance, and later record. Restoration succeeds when a reader can verify the missing context rather than merely trust an institutional denial. The repaired path should be as easy to find as the fragment.

Speed matters when distortion is spreading. Clips, headlines, platform posts, and machine summaries can establish a durable frame within hours, while a slow correction arrives after the audience has moved on. High-risk cases therefore need a rapid, provisional context notice that can later be confirmed, revised, or withdrawn. Urgency does not justify certainty; it justifies a visible review state.

Connect the disputed object to the relevant public bundle, release note, correction log, and reply.

Provide an accessible restoration object with a stable identifier, plain-language current status, and a short explanation that intermediaries can reuse safely.

Repeated distortion is evidence about release design. If the same kind of bundle is routinely misread, the problem may lie in sequencing, labels, headlines, excerpts, or missing context rather than in public carelessness. Restoration data should feed future templates and training.

Scale context requirements to the reach and compression of the official artifact.

The duty remains tied to public-power relevance. The City is not responsible for correcting every rumor about personality or

private life, and it should not enlarge its record simply to answer gossip. Restoration applies when an official record, official release, or public-power claim is materially misframed in a way the governed interface can responsibly clarify.

A practical trigger is material risk of misleading interpretation caused by missing record, status, sequence, provenance, or correction. The institution need not prove that every reader was deceived, but it should identify the public object, the omitted context, the likely consequence, and the authority for intervention. The trigger and decision should be logged so restoration cannot become discretionary reputation management.

Repair may require adding sequence, linking a later correction, changing a headline, revising a machine summary, attaching a role-pathway note, masking a collateral person, or elevating an affected-person response. The chosen action should address the public object that created the misunderstanding. Telling readers to be more careful is not a substitute for repairing a misleading official interface.

Correction remains reachable after release. Old records can reappear years later after original labels fall away. The City cannot control every recirculation, but it can keep the official version current, preserve correction history, issue durable clarifications, and notify known derivatives when renewed use creates foreseeable harm. Time review governs context as well as retention.

10.5.5 — Public Correction Log

A public correction log makes repair visible as part of record integrity. It records material corrections, resolved disputes, status changes, bundle revisions, protected-summary updates, and context restorations that alter public meaning (Society of Professional Journalists, 2014; Kovach and Rosenstiel, 2021).

Searchability needs protective limits. Readers should be able to see what changed without using the log to reconstruct protected content, identify collateral persons, or browse vulnerability. Category-level search, controlled detail, and affected-person review can support oversight without creating a new exposure index.

Correction categories should distinguish institutional error, participant or nonparticipant request, legal update, technical fix, version migration, and context restoration. Record both the defect and its effect: a typographical error may be minor or may expose a person, while a disputed interpretation does not by itself establish false provenance. The category shapes public meaning, remedy, and later audit.

Where public harm occurred, the log should show remedy status in proportionate terms. It may record protection, reclassification, withdrawal of a compromised bundle, or redesign of a safeguard without exposing protected detail. A corrected record can still leave the injured person without repair.

The log is an institutional memory tool, not a shame archive. Entries stay plain and specific, organized around consequence and repair rather than humiliation or scandal ranking.

Correction patterns can become network-level failure memory. Repeated problems with labels, masking, release notes, protected summaries, or machine outputs should be shared only after de-identification and separation of local facts from general design lessons.

Timeliness belongs in the audit because an accurate correction can arrive after harm has completed its public life. The log records detection, protection, decision, propagation, and completion, and repeated delay escalates. Machine-readable correction links should travel with superseded official objects so later systems can discover that the earlier version changed.

The log should distinguish derivatives that confirmed correction from destinations that remain unreachable, keeping incomplete repair visible.

10.6 — Record Site, Newsroom, AI-Assisted Summary

The archive, record site, newsroom, civic platform, and machine summary perform distinct epistemic jobs. The archive preserves governed source material; the record site publishes official bundles and status; journalism investigates and interprets; the platform hosts interaction; machine systems assist search, translation, summarization, and anomaly review. None is sovereign memory. Each layer needs visible provenance, an accountable human owner, error reporting, challenge, and a route back to source. Risk frameworks can organize governance, mapping, measurement, and management, but they cannot make an opaque output authoritative by attaching a human approval label (NIST, 2023a; UNESCO, 2021b; C2PA, 2026).

10.6.1 — Record Site Is Official Interface

The official interface should state the limits of its authority explicitly. It can state what governed City records show, how the material was produced, which status applies, and what correction or dispute remains. Competent legal authorities determine legal consequences; newsrooms exercise independent editorial judgment; scientific claims remain open to independent research and criticism; election authorities administer elections; citizens reach political conclusions. The interface supports interpretation by making evidence legible; it does not own the verdict.

The site should also disclose its governance. Readers should know who operates the interface, who audits it, what correction route exists, what vendor dependencies exist in category terms, and how Artificial Intelligence assistance is labeled.

The official interface should also be designed to survive leadership change. If new operators, new politics, or new controversies arrive, the site should not become an instrument of

the current leadership's tone. Governance, style, correction, and audit rules should outlast personalities.

10.6.2 — Newsroom Is Interpretation

Independent journalism can see institutional self-protection, participant myth, staff burden, donor influence, public confusion, and record-site weakness that the City may normalize.

Journalism may draw on records, interviews, leaks, context, expert opinion, public reaction, and editorial judgment. Keep its interpretations distinct from official source memory; the official record site does not replace independent investigation (Society of Professional Journalists, 2014).

Supply journalists with release notes, status labels, provenance, correction logs, and public bundles under the applicable nonparticipant, intimate-record, child, and legal protections.

A further requirement is to protect the public from confusing journalism with official classification. A headline may call a participant ready, corrupt, redeemed, fragile, or unfit. The record site should not convert such character labels into official status. It may report specific findings about conduct or a defined procedural decision, with its evidence, authority, and challenge route.

The record site's relationship to journalism should include correction, not control. If a newsroom misstates official status, the City may provide correction. It should not use correction pathways to intimidate reporting or chill critical interpretation.

Journalistic interpretation may also reveal flaws in the record site itself. If reporters repeatedly misunderstand a label, find an undisclosed gap, or expose overrelease, the City should treat that

as feedback. The newsroom can become an external sensor of public-memory design.

Journalists also need protection from becoming accidental record subjects. Entering the public interface to ask questions does not place a reporter under the Vow or authorize a profile of sources, movements, contacts, or private life. Media accountability and media privacy require separate rules, especially when hostile audiences target the press.

Media access must not depend on friendliness to the institution; standards should protect independent scrutiny, including unfavorable interpretation.

Influential newsrooms receive no privileged raw access. Specify access classes, public-interest standards, delays, and affected-person safeguards before controversy.

10.6.3 — AI Summary Is Assistance

Artificial Intelligence may assist retrieval and comprehension, but it cannot become the first institution of memory. A tool can locate records, compare status labels, summarize chronology, identify open disputes, or translate technical language into plainer form. It may not rank persons, infer moral worth, decide readiness, or convert a complex record state into a civic verdict. The Council of Europe convention, the European Union's AI law, and NIST's voluntary risk framework offer relevant governance comparators; none substitutes for the City's lawful authority, human review, or affected-person remedies (Council of Europe, 2024; NIST, 2023a; European Union, 2024).

Every generated summary should preserve source anchors and uncertainty. The interface should show which records were used, any exclusions or protections that can safely and lawfully be acknowledged, whether the output is current, what disputes

affect it, and when a human last reviewed the system or the item. Fluency is not provenance.

Summary use and model training are separate decisions. A tool may be authorized to summarize public bundles without permission to train on protected source records, export embeddings, build profiles, or reuse material elsewhere. Misleading output should enter both the public correction route, where public harm occurred, and an internal failure process, where system repair is required. The secondary-use register must show which authority governs each purpose.

Evaluate the inferences invited by confident prose, ranking, and recommendation features, not merely sentence accuracy.

People affected by machine output need an appeal route. Misstated records, omitted disputes, protected inference, mistranslation, exaggerated readiness, or misuse of a protected summary can all cause real public injury. Interim labels and temporary withdrawal may be necessary while review proceeds. The institution should be able to correct both the output and the system behavior that produced it.

Refusal is a necessary capability. The tool should decline requests for protected inference, ranking or comparing people, motive attribution, or answers that the available record cannot support. It should also abstain when a source is under integrity review or when a dispute makes compression materially misleading.

Adversarial testing should include leading prompts, attempts to reconstruct protected categories, requests for rankings, deceptive source combinations, and efforts to override status labels. The system should refuse unsafe inference, preserve the attempt where appropriate for security review, and direct the user back to governed records.

Certain disputes and breaches should narrow or disable summary functions. When provenance is uncertain, a record is under integrity review, or a correction has not propagated, continued generation can spread uncertainty as if it were knowledge. Temporary restraint should be status-labeled and reviewed, not hidden. Public access to source records and human explanation must continue where lawful.

The system needs downgrade and exit paths. Poor performance, unsafe inference, vendor failure, overreliance, or inability to read status correctly should trigger restriction, replacement, or removal without breaking access to the archive.

Auditability requires a record of model version, instruction or prompt class where appropriate, source scope, exclusions, known limitations, review state, and correction history. Logs should be proportionate and protected so they do not create a new surveillance layer. The purpose is to reconstruct consequential output and repair failure, not to retain every user's curiosity forever.

Artificial Intelligence must never become the sole practical interpreter of public memory. Human-readable source pages, plain-language explanation, accessible formats, expert assistance, translation, and non-digital access should remain available beside machine summaries.

10.6.4 — Civic Platform Is Interaction

Citizens may ask questions, submit burden reports, discuss public bundles, flag confusion, request accessibility support, contribute expertise, or participate in bounded civic input where ratified. This interaction can make public memory more democratic, but it can also become noisy, abusive, manipulative, or mistaken for evidence (UNESCO, 2023; European Union, 2016).

Civic interaction may reveal concern, attention, misunderstanding, lived burden, or manipulation. It should feed review channels rather than become a tribunal.

Moderation is therefore part of memory governance. The platform should prevent doxxing, harassment, sexualized commentary, child exposure, nonparticipant identification, bot manipulation, brigade behavior, false claims of official status, and attacks on staff or families. Moderation rules should be public enough to inspect and flexible enough to protect people.

The platform should also protect moderation staff. Moderators may see abuse, threats, intimate speculation, false claims, and coordinated campaigns. The City must not hide this labor. Platform integrity includes workload, rotation, support, appeal, and anti-retaliation protections for those who maintain the interface.

The civic platform should distinguish affected-person reports from general comment. A person harmed by a record needs a protected route, not a public thread. A citizen with expertise needs a verified submission path. General discussion should not swallow higher-duty channels.

The platform should also prevent participation metrics from becoming participant metrics. The number of comments, likes, questions, or approvals around a participant should not be treated as readiness evidence.

The platform should preserve evidence of manipulation without exposing ordinary users unnecessarily. Bot patterns, brigade behavior, and harassment campaigns should be auditable, but the system should avoid turning civic participation into public surveillance of citizens.

Separate questions, evidence submissions, complaints, expertise, interpretation, public sentiment, and abuse reports.

A civic platform should include proportionate friction against impulsive harm. Context prompts, pauses before high-risk posting, anti-doxxing warnings, and direct routes to official bundles can slow the conversion of public discussion into punishment. Friction must remain viewpoint-neutral and subject to appeal rather than becoming covert moderation of criticism.

The civic platform should also protect silence. Citizens may be affected by City records and still choose not to comment, vote, testify, or enter public debate. Public interaction is a right and a contribution channel, not a demand that every burdened person become visibly engaged with the system that touched them.

10.6.5 — No Single Memory Sovereign

Concentration should be audited like financial or vendor capture. A single platform, newsroom, search engine, archive office, machine assistant, donor, or public-interface team can become the place where meaning is effectively settled even without formal authority. Convenience is often the route by which this power accumulates. Dependence, reach, correction control, and switching cost should therefore be visible governance questions.

A social or civic platform may control attention without controlling the official file, yet viral framing can become the memory most people encounter. The response is not to suppress discussion but to maintain routes back to source, status, correction, and context. Attention should never silently acquire the authority of evidence.

Plural memory still needs structure. Official custody, common identifiers, status standards, correction propagation, and retention rules prevent disagreement from becoming a pile of incompatible fragments. The aim is disciplined tension, not relativism. Public meaning can remain contested while the provenance and state of the underlying objects stay clear.

Every new dashboard, summary layer, record-status indicator, search feature, research portal, or ranking of records should face a concentration test. If it merges functions, creates vendor dependence, or turns convenience into the default verdict, redesign should occur before authority becomes habitual.

The decisive test is whether a person harmed by public memory can reach an authority other than the one that caused the harm. If every route returns to one office, plurality is fictional. Appeal must cross an actual boundary.

Conflicts among memory actors require a protocol. Source custody, disputed classification, independent interpretation, shielding, and oversight access may collide. The City should identify which authority controls each decision, preserve claim status, and show how appeal, correction, and lawful restraint move through the disagreement.

When one actor absorbs several functions, concentration itself should trigger audit rather than waiting for obvious abuse. Periodic role-accumulation review should flag when temporary combinations of custody, release, interpretation, or correction authority begin to look routine.

Closure of a City review does not end lawful public scrutiny. Structured releases must remain open to investigation, scholarly analysis, legal challenge, affected-person response, and public criticism.

A public disagreement register can preserve conflict without grading speakers. It should record what is contested, which source or status is affected, what review is underway, what remains public or shielded, and the next decision date. Unresolved dispute should not disappear into official certainty. Closed disputes should retain the reason for closure and links to superseded public interpretations so later readers can reconstruct how the official account changed.

Chapter 11 — Record Lifecycle and Access

One recording can live several institutional lives. At capture it may be a security event. During access it may be restricted to a small response team. At release it may become part of an official bundle, then be interpreted in journalism or become research data. Machine training may turn it into a statistical influence that cannot easily be withdrawn. Treating those stages as one permission is how a transparent institution becomes a dossier system. This chapter follows the record through each transformation and asks what authority, purpose, protection, review, and remedy must be renewed along the way.

The record lifecycle is a grammar of permission. It asks what the object is allowed to become, who owns the decision, which evidence supports the transition, who carries new burden, which label must travel, when the permission expires, and how misuse is challenged. The chapter concentrates on permission creep because many serious record harms occur after lawful capture, when a later use is treated as a harmless technical continuation. A missing answer stops the proposed transition until the gap is resolved.

Digital convenience is not a lawful bridge between stages. A debugging export can become a dataset; an internal review corpus can become research material; a public bundle can be scraped into a model; a correction log can become a reputation feature; a search tool can become a person-ranking device. Lifecycle controls make those conversions visible before scale and automation make them difficult to reverse.

Lifecycle discipline protects the people who operate the system. Staff need clear duties, least-privilege access, separation of roles, protected refusal, supervision, incident support, and complaint routes when asked to browse, export, release, summarize, or repurpose material improperly. A record architecture that relies on workers silently absorbing ethical

conflict is already moving burden away from accountable leadership.

The No Cross-Architecture Dossier rule carries that separation across the series. City records remain distinct from Religion of Fairness participation, Workgame contribution, PTVC research, public voting, donor histories, government files, platform traces, and machine inference. Where a narrow status handshake is genuinely necessary, the interface transmits the minimum fact, purpose, authority, expiry, and appeal route without exposing the underlying record system.

The formal shorthand “Total Record” can invite incompatible interpretations: raw files for the public, a unique longitudinal dataset, opposition research, donor intelligence, or a permanent machine-readable profile. Public-facing materials should therefore lead with complete active-role record and reserve “Total Record” for defined legal or technical contexts. The lifecycle then replaces those projections with governed states by showing which material exists, which audience may receive which form, what remains protected, how disputes and corrections travel, and where later purposes require new authority.

Enacted law, jurisdiction-specific retention duties, public-record obligations, professional privilege, labor rights, and data-protection requirements remain for competent legal drafting and review.

11.1 — Capture, Access, Release, Interpretation, Research

The record lifecycle should be modeled as a sequence of distinct authorizations. Capture asks whether information may be acquired. Access asks who may inspect it and for what purpose. Release asks what may leave the controlled system. Interpretation governs official and commissioned accounts and the conditions of protected access, while leaving independent commentary free.

11.1.1 — Capture Stage

Institutional practice should also maintain a data map that is understandable by governance, not only by engineers. The map should identify record classes, sensitive categories, nonparticipant risk, authorized repositories, public-interface outputs, research pathways, model-training prohibitions, vendor touchpoints, access logs, retention clocks, and deletion or sealing constraints.

This stage discipline should apply to metadata as well as content. A timestamp, location, access log, role label, incident tag, search query, route history, or release note can expose as much as a visible recording. Metadata can reveal relationships, routines, clinical interfaces, staff patterns, crisis episodes, family presence, or political pressure.

Capture creates the record. In the Transparent City, its proposed purpose is to make active public-power formation under the Transparent Vow accountable. The Vow establishes a role commitment; it does not by itself supply legal authority for every capture channel. Necessity, lawful basis, declared scope, and protected categories must still be established (ISO, 2016a; European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b).

The active-period record may be comprehensive within its declared scope, while its purpose remains bounded: preserving the formation of public power for lawful accountability, review, correction, and later public context. Breadth of capture does not itself authorize later uses.

Every capture system should therefore carry a capture statement. The statement should identify the participant's active status, the spatial and temporal scope, the recording systems involved, the categories of protected handling, the nonparticipant safeguards, and the failure logging rules.

Document the necessity of each capture channel before activation; storage cost, vendor defaults and administrative convenience supply no authority.

Capture must also distinguish sensor fact from civic fact. A camera, microphone, keycard reader, document system, deliberation transcript, calendar entry, visitor log, repair ticket, and staff note may all produce material, but they do not carry the same interpretive weight. The City should keep a capture-source class for every record type so later readers know whether they are looking at direct recording, administrative metadata, human annotation, derived summary, or correction history.

Capture audit should also test blind spots. A system can be unfair by missing relevant public-power conduct just as easily as by collecting too much. If donor contact, staff influence, back-channel advice, professional dependency, repair work, or technical failure falls outside capture, the public receives a clean record of the wrong thing. Capture review must therefore compare the formal capture map with the actual ways power moves through the City.

Every governed record should carry a record-stage passport. The passport states the original purpose, source class, rights holder, nonparticipant risk, current custodian, permitted stage,

authorized roles, release status, retention rule, correction route, research status, training status, last review, next review, and any unresolved incident. It moves with copies and derivatives, but it does not make protected contents public. Its function is to prevent a record from crossing from capture to access, release, interpretation, research, training, or reuse without leaving an intelligible authorization trail. Where the passport is missing or inconsistent, the default is pause and reconstruction, not silent permission (NARA, 2023; ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017).

11.1.2 — Access Stage

Access is permissioned viewing. A record may exist in the archive while remaining unavailable to most people, available only to a limited reviewer, available to an affected person, or available to oversight under special controls.

The access stage asks who may look, for what purpose, with what training, through what interface, for how long, under what logging, and with what prohibition on copying, leaking, summarizing, or using the material beyond the permission granted.

Separate public, affected-person, staff, oversight, emergency, research, and expert-review access, each with its own scope and audit trail. Section 11.4 develops the principal access routes.

Access should follow function and protection rather than rank. A senior participant receives no automatic breadth, while a technician, clinician, archivist, or investigator may receive narrowly necessary material for a defined duty. Ordinary access uses least privilege; emergency access uses a fast break-glass route with reason, time limit, logging, notification, and later review. The governing question is what this role must see to perform a duty, protect a right, preserve continuity, or repair a failure, and no more.

Every access event should leave its own trace. The access log should record who entered, what class of material was seen, under what purpose, for how long, by what authorization, and whether any export, note, summary, or secondary action followed.

Access design also needs a refusal route for staff. A worker may be asked to view material outside their role, pressured to help a superior, or told that speed matters more than permission. The system should let staff refuse improper access requests without retaliation, and it should record the refusal as institutional integrity rather than obstruction.

11.1.3 — Release Stage

At release, apply the public-power relevance test in Section 10.1.4 before deciding whether to publish, in which form, with what delay, redactions, context and summaries, and through which dispute route. Preserve Chapter 10's version history, release notes, right of reply and correction links; lawful capture alone does not authorize publication.

A participant may be the public-power subject, but a released record can include family members, staff, visitors, bystanders, professionals, or host-community members. Nonparticipant masking, protected summaries, category review, and affected-person challenge rights must occur before release.

Release design should meet the nonexpert-access requirements in Section 10.2.5.

11.1.4 — Interpretation Stage

Interpretation begins when a record is described, summarized, explained, judged, compared, clipped, taught, reported, or used to support a conclusion. The City must make its own interpretations visible enough to challenge and disclose the

conditions governing any commissioned account or protected-source access.

Context integrity is the core safeguard. Interpretation should carry source status, date, role relevance, dispute labels, protected-category limits, known gaps, correction history, and uncertainty where needed.

Keep judgments about motive, sequence, pressure, contradiction, omission, and institutional meaning distinct from the source record. Label the City's official explanations and outside analysis accordingly.

High-stakes interpretation needs visible routes that let competing interpretations disclose their sources, limits, interests, and corrections, including any oversight statement.

11.1.5 — Research Stage

Research is formal inquiry under independent governance. The City may produce records that researchers one day find valuable, but operational value is not research permission.

Scientific claim status remains with *The Science of Fairness*. Research use follows the separate permissions in Section 11.6.

Research review should ask whether the City itself is the right source of data. Some questions may be answered with synthetic test environments, published public bundles, voluntary interviews, simulations, external public-administration data, or ordinary research cohorts. The existence of City records does not make them the least burdensome source.

11.1.6 — Artificial Intelligence Training Stage

Artificial Intelligence training is not research by another name and not technical housekeeping. It is a distinct use stage because training can produce future systems that infer, summarize, classify, imitate, retrieve, or act on patterns far beyond the original record context.

The training stage asks whether a record may be used to develop or change an Artificial Intelligence model through training or fine-tuning. Evaluation, safety testing, benchmarking, and operational monitoring may use a model without changing its learned parameters; these are distinct uses and still require their own purpose, authority, data boundary, and risk review. Any proposal must also state whether the system will operate inside the City, outside it, in public interfaces, in research, or in unrelated contexts.

Training can create effects that outlive the source record and reach people outside the City; the consent pathway in Section 11.6.3 governs these downstream burdens.

Model training requires separate consent and authority; it is not authorized by the Vow, staff role exposure, nonparticipant presence, affected-person access, or public release. Even public material may be restricted from training where dignity, law, status labels, or purpose limits require it.

Refusal remains the default. Before a record enters training, reviewers must explain its necessity, specify the planned public explanation, and apply the authorization and derivative controls in Section 11.6. If those conditions cannot be stated plainly and enforced, the records do not enter the model.

Model evaluation should also include refusal performance. A system exposed to City materials should be tested on whether it declines to infer worth, loyalty, hidden intent, holiness, psychological fitness, public eligibility, or trust.

11.1.7 — Reuse Stage

The City therefore needs a cumulative record-use rule: a proposed use is not authorized unless purpose, authority, scope, affected-person protection, contestability, time limit, and review

are all present. If any element is missing, the use pauses until the gap is supplied or the proposal is rejected.

Review also needs an independence check: does the reviewing office benefit from the proposed use?

Reuse is any secondary use beyond the purpose, stage, and authority originally granted. It is the stage where record systems often drift over time (International Council on Archives, 2012; NARA, 2023).

Before reuse, test the new purpose against the original role burden and changes to public meaning. Reuse that fails this review should pause.

Operational record practice should classify reuse requests by risk. Low-risk internal correction may be allowed under controlled conditions. Public education may require context and redaction. Research requires scientific governance. Artificial Intelligence training requires separate authority. Media use requires release discipline. Cross-system use is presumptively prohibited unless explicitly authorized by the correct domain and lawful review.

A reuse ledger identifies the original and proposed purposes, consent or legal authority, scope, affected persons, exclusions, protections, approval path, the review body that can refuse, challenge route, time limit, status label that travels with the material, and public notice where needed.

Secondary use inherits every correction, right of reply, status change, redaction revision, and oversight finding.

Every proposed reuse begins with a notice and compact impact assessment. It states access changes, outputs, retention, reviewer, and whether less data, a protected summary, synthetic material, or no reuse can meet the objective.

Secondary use expires unless affirmatively renewed. Sunset review tests continuing necessity, changed risks, and copy

migration; closure revokes access, disposes of derived files, propagates corrections, and updates public status. A shielded object should remain unavailable for downstream reuse until its release or access status is lawfully changed.

Research asks whether systematic inquiry is authorized. Training asks whether machine learning is permitted. Reuse asks whether a new purpose is compatible with the original authority. A single consent box or broad institutional mission cannot answer all of these questions. Records and privacy governance become most reliable when each stage has its own owner, legal or ethical basis, metadata, review clock, audit trail, and closure condition (ISO, 2016a; European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b). A record-stage passport is an internal governance object, not a public score or visible badge. It identifies permitted and prohibited next stages, gate ownership, and the applicable appeal route. Section 11.1.1 specifies the operational fields and the pause rule.

11.2 — Delayed Release, Escrow, and Lawful Shielding

Delayed release and escrow are justified only when a specific, reviewable harm cannot be managed by a less restrictive measure. Delay may protect an active investigation, emergency response, third party, legal privilege, clinical care, or immediate safety; it does not serve embarrassment control. The escrow record identifies custodian, access conditions, release trigger, maximum interval, review body, notice rule, and audit trail. Every shield has a clock, every clock a responsible reviewer, and every extension reasons that can later be inspected (International Council on Archives, 2012; European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b).

11.2.1 — Delay Purpose

Delay purpose identifies the harm or lawful duty that prevents immediate release, including a need to correct context (International Council on Archives, 2012; European Union, 2016).

A delay should name the harm it prevents. Safety delay, child-protection delay, legal-process delay, medical-stabilization delay, security delay, professional-confidentiality delay, family-law delay, and operational-continuity delay are not interchangeable. Each has a different reviewer, clock, notification rule, and release trigger.

Delay carries a least-restrictive-safeguard duty. The decision file should explain why narrow redaction, protected summary, affected-person notice, staged release, or partial access cannot manage the risk. Full delay is justified only when faster or narrower protection cannot meet the governing legal duty or the stated protection standard.

11.2.2 — Escrow Function

Escrow preserves accountability without immediate exposure. A record in escrow remains under lawful custody, protected from deletion, tampering, selective editing, informal access, or institutional disappearance. It is not public yet, but it is not free from review.

Escrow also protects against selective pressure. Participants cannot hide merely unflattering material, and critics cannot force release that would harm a child or compromise care. Donors, officials, platforms, and journalists do not decide escrow status. Authority, criteria, and appeal are fixed before pressure arrives.

Escrow should have institutional custody outside the interested office. The custodian should have defined independence, security duties, access logs, audit obligations, and authority to resist improper pressure.

People outside the institution may not see the escrowed content immediately, but the public should be able to see the existence of the escrow event when lawful and safe. A stub can state that material exists, identify the category of protection, name the reviewing body, state the clock, and identify the public consequence of future release or continued shielding.

Escrow should include technical integrity as well as legal custody. The escrowed record needs checksum, provenance, chain of custody, access controls, migration plan, tamper alerts, and recovery procedures.

11.2.3 — Shielding Review Clock

Escrow should also have an adversarial possibility. A participant, affected person, oversight office, or lawful authority may need to challenge the delay, not merely wait for the institution to review itself. The challenge route should not expose protected content by default, but it should allow an

independent reviewer to ask whether the delay is serving dignity, safety, law, or nonparticipant shielding, or whether it is serving reputation management.

A review clock prevents delay from becoming permanent by inertia. Every delayed or escrowed record should carry a time marker: when the delay began, when it must be reviewed, who reviews it, what evidence the review considers, and what outcomes are possible.

The length of the review clock should depend on the category. A medical matter may require one timeline. A legal proceeding may require another. A security issue may require short and repeated review. A child-protection matter may require long shielding with periodic reconsideration. A pending correction may require rapid review.

The practical question is who carries the cost of waiting. The public may carry uncertainty. An affected person may carry unresolved harm. A participant may carry suspicion. A nonparticipant may carry safety risk if release is too fast. Staff may carry review burden. The clock should be set with these burdens in view, not only administrative convenience.

A review clock should also trigger status communication. Where lawful and safe, a public status note can say that review remains pending without exposing the protected content. Affected persons may need more detailed notice. Oversight may need deeper access.

A review clock can become calendar theater. An institution may set review dates and then rubber-stamp delay. The review must therefore be substantive. It should ask whether the original purpose remains, whether harms have changed, whether a summary can be released, whether redaction is sufficient, whether continued shielding is lawful, and whether delay is now protecting the institution rather than the people at risk.

A review clock should also have consequences when missed. If a clock expires without review, the record should not simply remain hidden by inertia. The missed clock should trigger escalation, public status update where lawful, oversight notice, and review of why the deadline failed.

11.2.4 — Release Trigger

A delayed record should never be invisible to authorized governance. Oversight should be able to establish its existence, delay category, authorizing office, review date, and possible release or summary conditions. Public notice should disclose these facts only at a level that is lawful and safe: even a record's existence or timing can expose a protected person. Where an individual notice would do so, aggregated reporting and independent assurance should make the withholding accountable without revealing the protected connection.

A release trigger defines the conditions under which delayed material may become public, partially public, available to affected persons, available to oversight, or converted into a protected summary.

Triggers may be temporal, legal, safety-based, clinical, technical, or contextual. A case may conclude. A threat may pass. A nonparticipant may be masked. A child may remain protected but a summary may be released. A technical validation may be completed. A right of reply may be added. A dispute label may be finalized. Each trigger should match the reason for delay.

A release trigger should survive pressure from scandal, media campaigns, political opponents, donors, participants, and online crowds. Intensity is not authority. The decision turns on the predeclared condition, lawful purpose, burden analysis, and review route, not on who can generate the loudest demand.

There is also a danger in trigger avoidance. The institution may keep adding conditions so that release never occurs. Oversight must be able to ask whether trigger criteria are being manipulated. Public summaries should disclose enough of the trigger logic to make abuse harder. Affected persons should have challenge routes where delay harms them.

Release triggers should be legible before the crisis arrives. Additional possible triggers include affected-person consent, a legally relevant age threshold accompanied by fresh rights and disclosure review, a security downgrade, independent review, or expiration of a defined harm period.

A release trigger should never be written so broadly that the institution can avoid it by redefining the facts. Terms such as safe, resolved, stable, or no longer sensitive require decision standards. Who decides that safety exists? What evidence is required? Who can challenge the decision?

11.2.5 — Abuse Prevention

Every protection can be abused. Delay can protect a child, or it can protect a powerful adult. Escrow can preserve legal process, or it can bury institutional misconduct. Shielding can preserve dignity, or it can conceal public-power conduct (NIST, 2020b; ISO, 2016a).

Distinguish protected facts from concealed exercises of power. A medical fact may be shielded while a decision made under a false medical pretext requires review. Legal advice remains protected according to law; alleged political activity behind a legal label requires independent privilege review. Intimacy may be shielded while possible coercion requires qualified investigation. A suspected misuse of a category does not itself authorize disclosure of its protected content.

Abuse prevention must also protect against over-release. Not every suspicion of concealment justifies public exposure.

If a delay was abused, correct the record, notify affected people safely, repair the failed process, and apply proportionate consequences where misconduct is established. If shielding was wrongly denied, repair the resulting harm.

Abuse prevention should look for patterns, not only individual excuses. If one category is repeatedly delayed, comparable participants receive inconsistent shielding, one staff unit invokes security unusually often, or public controversy produces sudden protection language, the system should trigger a pattern review. A useful comparison examines similar requests handled by different units, making a recurring institutional practice easier to distinguish from a genuinely unusual case.

Abuse prevention should educate without exposing protected content. Public explanations, aggregate statistics, reversal rates, elapsed-time data, and sample reason codes can show how shielding is governed. Reports should explain the denominator and reporting period, so a count of reversals can be interpreted alongside the number of decisions reviewed.

Public delay and escrow reports should identify missed review deadlines. A correction in the reporting method should remain visible across successive releases, allowing readers to distinguish improved practice from a changed way of counting.

11.3 — Redaction, Protected Summaries, Category Checks

Redaction manages residual identification and meaning risk; it does not create guaranteed safety. Place, time, role, voice, relationship, and unusual events may reidentify a person after direct identifiers are removed, while a compressed summary may protect identity yet distort the institutional act that matters. A strong process defines audience and threat model, tests linkage and inference, documents each removal, preserves the governed source, and reviews repeated categories. The accurate claim is risk reduced under stated assumptions, not anonymity assured (Garfinkel, 2015; Ohm, 2010; Narayanan and Shmatikov, 2008).

11.3.1 — Redaction Standards

Redaction standards govern when protected information is removed before broader access or release. The standard is specific enough to guide staff and constrained enough to prevent institutional hiding. It names the protected category, exact scope, reason, authority, reviewer, public status, and appeal route, then records what meaning may have changed through removal (Garfinkel, 2015; Ohm, 2010).

Lifecycle governance should redact only what must be protected. Redaction should not remove public-power relevance merely because it is uncomfortable. It should not erase staff influence, donor contact, participant misconduct, institutional failure, or decision pathways under the language of privacy.

The City should require second review for high-impact redactions and sampling audit for ordinary redactions. Affected persons should have correction routes if redaction fails to protect them or if redaction misrepresents their role.

Every redaction should have a reason and a challenge route, but the internal reason need not be the public label. A category

such as medical care, child information, or legal privilege can itself disclose something protected when attached to an identifiable person. The authorized reviewer receives the specific basis needed to test necessity; the public receives the least revealing explanation that still permits scrutiny of the relevant decision. Where even naming the category would expose a person, use a general protected-information label and a safe route to independent review. Affected people receive the information their standing and a meaningful challenge require, subject to protection of others.

Test mosaic risk across the entire bundle, combining dates, locations, role titles, family references, rare medical facts, language patterns, and unique events in the review.

11.3.2 — Summary Standards

A protected-summary standard defines what the summary may do: identify public-power relevance, explain why raw material is protected, describe timeframe or decision consequence, preserve an oversight finding, and maintain affected-person dignity. It does not editorialize beyond the record, shelter the institution through vague language, or turn withheld detail into insinuation.

A useful summary explains the civic event without volunteering its private cause. When only a schedule change needs explanation, for example, the public account can state the revised date, who authorized the change, and whether any public deadline is affected. It need not announce a medical or family-law category. Nor should it claim that no misconduct was found unless an appropriate review actually made that finding. Where a public-power issue does require more explanation, the summary identifies that issue and its evidentiary status in the least exposing sufficient form. Independent review preserves

access to the necessary protected basis without turning every public notice into an invitation to infer private life.

Summary sufficiency can be tested before a real person is exposed. For fictional cases, prepare a status notice, a protected explanation, and a more detailed permitted account. Give separate reader groups the same factual task: identify the decision, distinguish a finding from an allegation, and locate the current correction or challenge route. Also test whether the wording invites an unsupported inference about a collateral person. Select the least revealing form that meets prospectively declared comprehension requirements, rather than the longest or most reassuring account. Confirm the chosen form with new cases and readers not used to select or tune it. Report citizen and machine evaluations separately; success by a model does not establish public comprehension. This is a proposed usability test, not a permission to publish whatever readers understand. Lawful authority, necessity, and affected-person protection remain separate requirements. In actual use, the public summary states its scope and limits without automatically listing every sensitive category omitted; the authorized review file preserves the fuller explanation needed to check it.

Summaries should be reviewable by more than the office whose conduct is summarized. The publication controls in Section 10.4.4 apply.

11.3.3 — Category Review

Category review flags sensitive material before release decisions are made. It asks whether a record involves children, health, clinical care, legal counsel, intimacy, reproductive health, pregnancy, custody, security, cybersecurity, professional interfaces, nonparticipant exposure, or other high-risk domains.

Category review should occur at capture or first review where possible and again before access or release. Early tagging does not decide final release; category labels and their provenance tell later reviewers why material needs special handling.

Avoid category inflation: discomfort alone does not make a record high-risk, and a sensitive label must not become an automatic bar to accountable explanation. Apply the specific protection required while preserving the role-relevant fact in a lawful form.

Some records carry multiple categories. A crisis event may involve medical care, security, staff conduct, nonparticipant exposure, and participant decision-making. Multi-category records should not be pushed through the simplest path. They require layered handling. One part may be redacted, another summarized, another released to oversight, another held in escrow.

Category review also determines expert need. Staff should not improvise child protection, trauma interpretation, legal privilege, reproductive health handling, family-law status, cybersecurity risk, or intimate-record release without specialized review.

The categories should be conservative at first and precise over time. Overinclusive flags can slow access unnecessarily; underinclusive flags can expose people. The City should therefore allow provisional tagging, specialist review, correction, and audit.

Category review should be revisited when context changes. A security category may expire; a child-protection category may change when a person reaches adulthood; a legal category may shift after proceedings end; a medical category may remain sensitive long after public interest fades.

11.3.4 — Expert Review Need

Expert review is purpose-bound. Reviewers receive the minimum material needed for the question, a logged role, confidentiality and conflict rules, a reuse limit, and a visible review trail. Their conclusion remains contestable and cannot silently govern unrelated matters.

Expert review can test both unnecessary secrecy and unsafe release. An independent specialist may find that a summary is sufficient where an internal team proposed full withholding, or identify risks the team missed before release. The purpose is a better justified handling decision, not a presumption that expertise always requires withholding.

Expert capture remains possible. Experts may be selected because they agree with the City, depend on City access, serve donors, favor a profession's norms, or misunderstand the City's unique burden. Expert panels should therefore be rotated, conflict-reviewed, and sometimes adversarial. Expert review should remain accountable to the record's purpose and to affected persons.

Expert review should follow the type of harm and decision. Clinicians assess health and treatment burden; lawyers address legal authority and privilege; child-safeguarding specialists examine child risk; accessibility reviewers examine usable access; security experts assess technical and physical threats; records professionals examine custody and lifecycle. A review map can require joint judgment where domains intersect, while preventing any single profession from becoming a general authority over the person.

Specialists contribute reasons, evidence, and professional judgment without inheriting the institution's responsibility. The City should record the question asked, information supplied, conflicts, opinion, dissent, decision owner, and action taken.

That trail protects experts from scapegoating and prevents operators from hiding behind professional prestige. Accountability remains with the actor authorized to decide and with the institution that designed the route.

11.3.5 — Audit of Redaction

Audit of redaction tests whether protected handling remained accurate, narrow, justified, consistent, and documented. It examines residual identifiability, the quality of protected summaries, category assignment, decision authority, access logs, correction, and whether protection language concealed institutional failure. Review should include samples of material that was released, withheld, and later reclassified so the audit can detect both exposure and overshielding (Narayanan and Shmatikov, 2008; ICO, 2025).

Review redaction patterns across time, including repeated protection of staff influence, donor contacts, participant errors, or institutional failures, and repeated under-redaction of nonparticipants.

Publish aggregate audit findings where lawful without exposing the material under review.

Redaction audits should produce reform. If staff misunderstand a category, training changes. If a rule is overbroad, it narrows. If repeated access logs show curiosity browsing, controls change.

The audit should also include the experience of affected persons. A redaction may look technically correct while still exposing a pattern, relationship, location, health condition, or family fact through context. Affected-person feedback does not decide every case, but it helps the City see burdens that technical reviewers may miss.

Redaction audit should include public usability. If citizens repeatedly misunderstand redacted bundles, if journalists cannot distinguish protected absence from missing evidence, or if affected persons find summaries misleading, the redaction system may be technically correct and civically weak. Audit should test whether protected records still tell the public what it has a right to know. A calibration exercise should give independent reviewers paired fictional files: one in which a withheld detail is unnecessary to explain a decision and one in which a similar omission hides an actual conflict of authority. Reviewers record what the public can safely learn, which restricted evidence supports that account, and who can contest it. Differences in judgment become a reason to refine the category rule and retest it on unfamiliar material, not to expose the original claimant.

11.4 — Public, Affected-Person, and Oversight Access

Access should follow standing, purpose, and proportionality rather than a single public-private switch. The general public may need official bundles and accountability records. An affected person may need fuller access to understand and contest harm. Oversight bodies may need protected source access. Emergency personnel may need temporary, logged access to save life or prevent imminent harm.

11.4.1 — Public Access

Researchers and journalists may require governed pathways rather than privileged browsing. Differentiated access is not secrecy when categories, reasons, review, and audit remain visible. It becomes secrecy when the institution can move inconvenient material into an unreviewable class or deny an affected person the information necessary for remedy (UN Human Rights Committee, 2011; International Council on Archives, 2012; European Union, 2016). Public access is the City's democratic-facing access layer. It gives citizens structured material for evaluating public-power formation. It should make the record more useful than campaign persona without turning the archive into a spectacle machine. Public access must be broad enough to matter and bounded enough to protect dignity (UN Human Rights Committee, 2011; International Council on Archives, 2012).

Apply the public-power relevance test in Section 10.1.4 and the public-interface standards in Sections 10.2.1–10.2.5. Public access uses governed bundles; raw archive browsing should not be the default.

Use rate limits and other safeguards where needed to deter mass scraping, stalking, intimidation, automated clipping, and harassment.

11.4.2 — Affected-Person Access

Affected-person access protects people who are named, shown, implicated, harmed, misrepresented, or otherwise burdened by a record. An affected person may be a participant, staff member, family member, visitor, bystander, professional, complainant, host-community member, or someone whose rights or reputation may be impacted by the record.

Affected persons may need access to correct memory, challenge release, request redaction, understand harm, support a complaint, seek remedy, or respond to public interpretation. That access may be deeper than public access, but it should be limited to the affected purpose.

Affected-person access must protect other affected persons too. A complaint record may involve multiple people. A family record may include children. A staff record may include protected employment details. Giving one person access should not wrongly expose another. The City must sometimes use summaries, supervised review, redacted views, counsel-mediated access, or oversight routing.

Where lawful and safe, notify affected persons of planned release, disputed interpretation, or harmful exposure using Section 10.5.2's notice procedure. Oversight records and reviews any safety-based withholding of notice.

This access should be trauma-informed and supported. Some records may be painful to view, especially where harm, humiliation, conflict, illness, or family exposure is involved. Affected-person access should include notice, explanation, support options, viewing controls, copy limits where lawful, appeal paths, and an ability to request correction or contextual reply.

11.4.3 — Record Oversight Access

Oversight access enables deeper review than public access. Oversight bodies may need source records, protected material, redaction originals, access logs, classification decisions, escrow records, breach histories, complaint files, and internal audit material.

Oversight access must be broad enough to test the institution and narrow enough to prevent oversight from becoming another sovereign. The reviewer's purpose, authority, scope, confidentiality, conflict status, logging, reporting duty, and limits on reuse should all be defined.

Oversight access should produce public summaries where possible. The public may not receive raw protected material, but it should know whether oversight found the shielding justified, the breach repaired, the access abuse disciplined, or the redaction overbroad.

Oversight bodies can become dependent on access, prestige, funding, or institutional relationships. Oversight therefore requires rotation, conflict review, independent audit of auditors, routes to complain about oversight conduct, and external red teams.

Oversight bodies should also publish their own limits. Who appointed them, who funds them, what conflicts they hold, what data they can see, what they cannot see, what methods they use, and how they are audited all matter.

Oversight access should include technical reproducibility. If an oversight body reviews a search result, timeline, transcript, model summary, or public bundle, it should be able to reconstruct how that output was produced.

Oversight access should produce an access-decision record separate from the substantive material reviewed. That record identifies the request, purpose, scope, approving authority,

conflicts, conditions, start and expiry time, queries or exports performed, findings category, downstream disclosure, and destruction or return of working copies. It should be available to an independent auditor and, in protected form, to the affected person where lawful. The point is not to expose oversight deliberation; it is to prevent privileged inspection from becoming an invisible second archive with no accountability of its own (European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020a; International Council on Archives, 2012).

11.4.4 — Emergency Access

Emergency access protects life and continuity when ordinary access procedures would be too slow.

Emergency access should be tightly defined. It should state who can invoke it, what circumstances qualify, what records may be accessed, how the access is logged, how long it lasts, who reviews it afterward, and how misuse is corrected. Emergency cannot be a general password for bypassing the lifecycle.

The relevant test is what burden delay would create. If waiting for ordinary review would endanger a person, damage continuity, worsen a crisis, or prevent urgent care, emergency access may be justified. But the same lens asks what burden emergency access creates. It may expose protected material, create staff power, or become a secrecy habit. Both burdens must be counted.

Emergency access should trigger after-action review. The review should ask whether the emergency was real, whether the access was necessary, whether the scope was limited, whether protected persons were harmed, whether notice is required, whether records need correction, and whether the protocol should change.

Emergency logic must remain exceptional. Staff shortage, convenience, reputation risk, political pressure, or recurring operational difficulty should not be relabeled as emergency simply because the label accelerates access. A genuine exception protects life, safety, or essential continuity, carries a clock, and returns to ordinary review as soon as the danger permits.

The emergency pathway should include human discretion because not every crisis fits a code. But discretion should be bounded by duty, training, and post-event review. The City should honor the person who acts quickly to protect life, and it should still ask whether the action was necessary, proportionate, and repairable.

Emergency review should include care outcomes as well as rule compliance. Did the access help? Did it reduce harm? Did it create new injury? Were affected persons notified when appropriate? Were staff supported after the event?

11.4.5 — Abuse and Browsing Controls

Abuse and browsing controls prevent authorized access from becoming curiosity, gossip, harassment, informal power, or hidden interpretation (European Union, 2016; Bovens, 2007).

Browsing controls include purpose prompts, role-limited views, access logs, unusual access alerts, sampling audits, peer review, separation of duties, training, sanctions, and affected-person notice where appropriate. These controls should not make legitimate work impossible, but they should make purposeless access difficult and visible.

Abuse can occur through accumulation. A staff member may assemble a private profile from individually permitted views; an analyst may combine searches to infer protected facts; a reviewer may range beyond an assigned case; a moderator may

clip material for private sharing. Controls must detect these patterns as well as individual violations.

Controls must also protect against overcontrol. If staff fear every legitimate access will be treated as suspicion, they may avoid necessary work. The City needs a culture of accountable use, not fear. Training should explain why access exists, why limits matter, how to ask for broader access lawfully, and how to report misuse.

Browsing control should include social controls as well as software controls. Staff culture, peer expectations, supervisor review, sanctions, whistleblower protection, and training may matter as much as access architecture. A technically restricted system can still be abused through screenshots, gossip, informal summaries, private devices, or hallway interpretation.

End each role's access when the authorized duty ends. Periodic access recertification can require each role to justify the categories it still needs rather than carrying yesterday's permissions forward by inertia.

Subject executives and founders to the same access limits. Higher roles should make their access purpose clearer; independent sampling can test whether informal exceptions are accumulating around status.

Browsing controls should detect patterns without turning staff into subjects of indiscriminate surveillance. Access analytics can flag unusual volume, repeated searches for prominent people, access outside role hours, attempts to open unrelated protected categories, or downloads preceding departure. A human reviewer should then examine context, because an emergency responder, auditor, or records specialist may have a legitimate explanation. The control must protect records while preserving notice, proportionality, appeal, and due process for the worker whose access is questioned (NIST, 2020a; European Union,

2016). Pattern thresholds should be documented and periodically recalibrated so routine operational changes do not become permanent false alarms.

Canary records and decoy identifiers can test privileged-access misuse, but their governance must be explicit. They must not turn ordinary error into an accusation or substitute a trigger for evidence. Their purpose is to reveal possible unauthorized browsing or extraction under controlled conditions. Authorization, scope, review criteria, evidence handling, employee rights, and retirement are recorded. Test records should be removed when their purpose ends, and their use should appear in the same audit trail as other privileged-access controls.

11.5 — Retention, Deletion, Sealing, and Time Review

Retention should be justified record class by record class. Some materials may require durable preservation because they evidence public-power formation, institutional decision, complaint, remedy, or systemic failure. Other materials should expire because continued storage adds little accountability while increasing exposure, security, or chilling risk. Deletion, sealing, and posthumous review must therefore be governed by declared criteria, holds, appeals, provenance, and periodic reconsideration. A deletion rule that can erase institutional wrongdoing is corrupt; an eternal-retention rule that preserves every intimate or incidental trace is also corrupt. The fair design makes both preservation and forgetting answerable (ISO, 2016a; International Council on Archives, 2012; European Union, 2016).

11.5.1 — Retention Purpose

Retention purpose states why a record is kept. The archive should not retain material merely because it can. It should retain records that support public-power memory, accountability, correction, failure learning, rights protection, dispute resolution, institutional audit, or lawful historical review (ISO, 2016a; NARA, 2023).

Other records may require retention in protected form. Medical, legal, intimate, child, family-law, security, or nonparticipant materials may need to be preserved for accountability or remedy while shielded from public or ordinary access. Retention and exposure are separate decisions.

Retention purpose should be reviewed against changing risk. A record that was needed for an active dispute may later be needed only as an audit stub. A raw recording may later be replaced for public purposes by a verified summary while the raw material

remains sealed. A public bundle may require continued public access because it documents a pattern of power.

Count storage, encryption, migration, search, audit, breach response, staff training, vendor exit, and format preservation in retention decisions. Future staff and fragile systems must not absorb unacknowledged costs.

11.5.2 — Sealing Criteria

Sealing criteria define when a record remains preserved but is removed from ordinary access or public release. The City may seal records to protect children, medical privacy, legal counsel, intimate dignity, family-law matters, security, nonparticipant safety, or other high-risk categories.

Sealing should require a stated category, authority, review clock where appropriate, access conditions, affected-person notice where lawful, and a public status label if public absence would otherwise mislead.

Sealing criteria should identify both what the restriction protects and whom it burdens. A seal may protect a child, a participant's dignity, or an active legal process; it may also limit public understanding, affected-person access, or oversight. The decision should state those competing interests, the authority relied upon, the least restrictive alternative considered, and the review date.

Sealing should be harder to use for material involving public-power conduct than for material involving collateral vulnerability. If a record directly concerns misuse of power, staff influence, donor capture, misconduct, or institutional failure, sealing should require stronger justification and oversight. The City should protect vulnerable details without sealing the public-power fact itself where possible.

Sealed material may be opened only through a lawful, recorded route. Informal request, senior preference, political pressure, donor curiosity, newsroom pressure, or institutional embarrassment cannot supply authority. The route should identify who can petition, who may oppose, what standard applies, what notice is given, which safeguards remain active, and what public status label follows.

Where lawful and safe, a public stub can show that a sealed record exists, its class, custodian, governing clock or standard, and challenge route. When even acknowledgment would expose protected information, accountability must proceed through authorized oversight.

Sealing criteria should avoid class prejudice. Some lives include more medical records, legal contact, immigration issues, disability support, family complexity, poverty bureaucracy, or safety risk. If sealing is handled poorly, people with heavier life burdens will either be exposed more or hidden in ways that make their records look suspicious. The City must not let unequal background burden distort public meaning.

11.5.3 — Deletion Limits

Deletion limits prevent convenient erasure. A City built to make public-power formation answerable cannot allow participants, staff, donors, vendors, or operators to erase records simply because the records are uncomfortable. Deletion is the most final form of record handling and should be narrow, justified, and auditable.

Some records may need deletion because they were wrongly captured, unlawfully obtained, duplicative beyond necessity, technically corrupted, dangerously overinclusive, or harmful in a way that cannot be solved by sealing or redaction. Deletion may also be required by law in some circumstances.

The next inquiry is who benefits from deletion. If deletion benefits a powerful actor while burdening the public, oversight, affected persons, or future accountability, it should be treated with suspicion. If deletion protects a nonparticipant who never consented and preserves public meaning through summary, it may be fair. The beneficiary and burden-bearer must be named.

Deletion decisions should preserve a deletion receipt where lawful. The receipt can identify the class of record, reason, authority, date, reviewer, and whether a protected summary or status note remains. The receipt should not reveal the deleted protected content.

Deletion can create false completeness. A public record may look whole even after material has been removed. Status labels should prevent this where public interpretation requires it. A citizen should not be deceived by a smooth timeline if lawful deletion has affected public meaning.

11.5.4 — Time Review

Time review should be scheduled before controversy arrives. If the City waits until a participant is famous, disgraced, deceased, or politically contested, the review will be pulled by public mood. A fair retention system sets review clocks early, names categories, identifies reviewers, and states what questions will be asked when the clock matures.

Time review reassesses whether continuing exposure, retention form, access class, sealing status, summary form, or public label remains fair as years pass. Time does not erase accountability, but it can change the balance between public memory and human dignity.

High-impact record classes and sensitive cases require scheduled time review. Readiness bundles, public corrections, disciplinary matters, protected summaries, intimate categories,

child-adjacent records, nonparticipant exposure, and post-exit records may all change in relevance or harm.

Time review asks whether continued access still serves the declared public purpose. Raw detail may no longer be necessary; a protected person may be carrying growing harm; the participant may have returned to ordinary life; office relevance may have changed; historical value may have increased; or new platform practices may make old release assumptions unsafe.

Time review is not quiet revisionism. Powerful participants cannot bury old records because they are inconvenient, and the institution cannot erase failure memory to protect its image. Public-power relevance may last for decades. Review therefore balances dignity and continuing accountability through stated criteria rather than using dignity as a disguise for reputation management.

Time review may produce several outcomes: continued public access, summary substitution, sealing, renewed release with context, correction, deletion where lawful, restricted access, posthumous review, or further review date. The outcome should be logged. Affected persons should have routes to request review or challenge the result where appropriate.

A time review should include technical aging. Formats decay, encryption weakens, metadata standards change, search tools improve, and models become more capable of inference.

Time review should include a public-interest decay question. Public curiosity often survives long after public need has faded. A record may remain searchable because people still click, not because accountability requires it. The City should ask whether continued prominence, indexing, and discoverability still serve public-power memory or merely feed retrospective appetite.

11.5.5 — Posthumous Review

Public memory needs a clock. The City cannot treat a record's future as an afterthought because the future is where many records do their greatest harm. Search improves. Context fades. Families change. Offices end. Technologies infer more. Public appetite returns during scandal. A record held safely today may become dangerous tomorrow, and a record deleted today may erase accountability that future citizens need (International Council on Archives, 2012; ISO, 2016a; NARA, 2023).

Posthumous review separates continuing public relevance from the appetite to treat death as unrestricted access. A participant's death may leave public-power records that still matter, protected material whose purpose has ended, and family or third-party interests that remain vivid. The review should name the authority, record category, historical value, legal constraint, family-notice route, expiry, and appeal before access changes. These proposed duties should be distinguished from the legal rules that apply: the GDPR does not itself apply to deceased persons' data, although Member States may regulate their processing, and records may still contain protected data about living people. Public memory can preserve accountable conduct while refusing to turn the dead into ownerless material (European Union, 2016, recital 27; International Council on Archives, 2012).

Family dignity matters because families can be harmed by posthumous exposure, especially when records involve intimacy, health, children, grief, household conflict, or private dependency. But family preference cannot automatically erase public-power memory. The City must distinguish family dignity from family control over public accountability.

Posthumous review must identify the living people and institutions that continue to carry the record's effects. Public

history, family protection, nonparticipant privacy, staff accountability, institutional self-interest, and lawful research may pull in different directions after the person can no longer answer. The process should not assume that death resolves those conflicts. It should provide a lawful forum, representation where appropriate, and time-based reconsideration.

Historical use should be governed. Scholars, journalists, civic educators, and future reviewers may need access, but not every posthumous record should become public entertainment. Historical access can include delays, conditions, redactions, summaries, ethical review, and limits on reproduction.

Unfinished remedies follow Section 31.7.1; the process must not pretend that the deceased can participate.

Posthumous review should occur on a declared schedule rather than only when controversy erupts. The first review may follow death after a humane interval, with later reviews tied to public-role relevance, legal change, newly affected persons, historical value, or emerging privacy risks. A panel should include records expertise, legal authority, affected-person representation, and independent review. Its task is not to create a final biography. It is to decide what remains necessary, what can be summarized, what should be sealed, and what unresolved corrections still require action.

Memorialization and accountability must remain separate. Families, colleagues, institutions, and the public may want remembrance, tribute, criticism, or historical interpretation. Those activities can coexist with the archive, but they should not rewrite source status or suppress adverse material. Distinguish a memorial page from an official record bundle so tribute does not acquire record authority and grief is protected from institutional use. Continuing prominence should be reviewed separately from

lawful retention so historical value does not become perpetual amplification.

Apply the derivative-correction and notification duties in Section 10.5.1 to posthumous sealing and correction decisions, including known syndicated media, cached pages, downloaded bundles, research extracts, and machine-generated summaries. Keep proof of notices and attempted propagation; worldwide erasure cannot be guaranteed. Affected third parties retain a route to correction even when memorial preferences point elsewhere.

11.6 — Research Use and Model Training

Operational participation does not imply research consent, and research consent does not imply permission for artificial-intelligence training. Those uses alter purpose, audience, risk, and future control. Research governance requires a defined question, minimization, independent review, meaningful consent or another valid authority, data security, withdrawal terms, and a plan for reporting harms and negative results. Machine-training pathways add model memorization, inference, bias, opacity, downstream reuse, and withdrawal difficulties. The City should therefore prohibit silent dataset conversion and require a separate training authorization that identifies the model class, data scope, retention, evaluation, human owner, release boundary, and deletion feasibility (National Commission, 1979; World Medical Association, 2024; NIST, 2023a; UNESCO, 2021b).

11.6.1 — Operational Record Is Not Research Consent

A separate secondary-use register should make every approved research or model-training project traceable without exposing protected source records. It should identify record class, purpose, authority, consent basis, nonparticipant exclusions, oversight body, permitted claims, retention period, publication limits, vendor restrictions, withdrawal constraints, and complaint route. The separate research consent pathway is in Section 11.6.2; an operational entry creates no permission to study or train on it.

People who merely appear in operational records have not thereby granted research permission. Section 11.6.4 defines the nonparticipant exclusion controls.

The Science of Fairness must retain its own ethics, rival-model discipline, and consent rules for research questions.

Written operational consent should explain in plain language before activation that public-power record, research participation, model training, public bundles, and other reuse pathways remain distinct.

11.6.2 — Research Consent Pathway

Research governance should also include an estimand discipline. A proposal should say what question the data can actually answer, what it cannot answer, what population it represents, what biases enter through City selection, what claims would be forbidden, and what negative result would matter. Without that discipline, City records could produce impressive-looking findings that are really only artifacts of who entered, who stayed, who was protected, and what the City happened to measure.

A research consent pathway defines how City records may be used for formal inquiry when such use is lawful, ethical, independently reviewed, and limited. It should state who may be asked, what records are requested, what questions are being studied, what risks exist, what alternatives exist, how withdrawal works, and how claims will be labeled.

The pathway should include independent review, not only City approval. The City has institutional interest in showing value. Researchers may have interest in publication. Funders may have interest in results. Independent review helps protect participants, staff, nonparticipants, and public interpretation from these pressures.

Research consent is specific and renewable where possible. It names purpose, scope, data categories, duration, recontact rules, withdrawal conditions, protections, and publication limits rather than granting all-records permission for unspecified future studies. Broad future research requires stronger governance,

narrower access, independent review, and stricter exclusion of nonparticipant material.

Research claims drawn from City records must remain within the design that produced them. Use Section 4.5.5 claim labels for operational evaluation and Section 3.6 for the separate scientific boundary.

The pathway must handle vulnerability. A participant may feel pressure to consent because refusal might appear uncooperative. Staff may feel pressure from employment. Former participants may fear public interpretation. Consent must therefore include refusal without penalty, separation from readiness evaluation, and clear statements that research refusal is not evidence of moral deficiency.

The pathway should also address withdrawal and derived data. A participant may agree to one study, then discover that variables, coded features, quotations, deidentified extracts, or models derived from the data continue to travel. The consent form should explain what can be withdrawn, what cannot practically be withdrawn, what will be destroyed, what will remain, and what public reporting duties survive.

Research collaboration can begin with agreement on the question before agreement on the answer. A City team and an independent team could record their competing predictions, define which observations would distinguish them, and settle the main analysis before viewing outcomes. Where a suitable journal offers Registered Reports, the protocol can seek peer review and in-principle acceptance before results are known; publication remains conditional on the journal's methodological and reporting requirements, not on a favorable result (Chambers and Tzavella, 2022).

Studies using fictional cases can share one versioned case family instead of generating disconnected demonstrations. A

common factual record can support separate tasks in disclosure, correction transfer, protected summarization, and human–AI review. Each task keeps its own answer key and outcome; success on one does not establish success on the others. An independent team prepares unseen cases after the development rules are fixed. Release the public development materials with a data dictionary and scoring instructions, while protecting the held-out keys until testing ends. This makes a contribution reusable without turning the case family into a universal readiness test.

Unexpected findings can open a new line of inquiry. Record when the question emerged and which observations informed it, then report the exploratory result alongside the planned analyses. A promising explanation becomes a new prediction to test on observations not used to develop or tune it. Preserve amendments with their reasons and what was known when each was made. Preregistration distinguishes discovery from planned confirmation; it need not prevent either (Nosek et al., 2018). Exploration remains within the study's authorized data and consent boundaries.

A collaboration agreement should give investigators access to the authorized study materials and freedom to report all prespecified outcomes. Time-limited review for confidentiality or legal obligations cannot become a funder's veto over findings. The shared product is a question, method, and result that another group can examine. Section 4.5.5 governs how those findings are labeled, while the consent and withdrawal terms remain those agreed for the particular study.

11.6.3 — Artificial Intelligence Training Consent Pathway

Model-use review should identify the actual technical function before any data is supplied: retrieval, accessibility support,

summarization, translation, integrity monitoring, anomaly detection, retrieval benchmarking, synthetic-data generation, operational assistance, classifier training, embedding generation, evaluation, fine-tuning, or another proposed function. These uses are not interchangeable and do not all involve training. A person may accept one form of assistance and reject another because the future burden differs. Apply the use-specific authority and risk review in Section 11.1.6.

Any approved model-training pathway must separately govern purpose, provenance, included data, affected persons, exclusion rights where applicable, evaluation, downstream correction, and model retirement.

The pathway must identify the data form (raw records, redacted records, protected summaries, metadata, access logs, public bundles, or synthetic transformations) and test any anonymization claim under Section 11.3's residual-identification standard.

Before training, assess whether the model could infer trust, reproduce protected patterns, reveal nonparticipants, rank participants, generate misleading summaries, become indispensable to staff judgment, enable vendor reuse, or acquire authority over the archive's meaning.

Model-training consent includes refusal without penalty, no effect on readiness, nonparticipant exclusion, model-use limits, audit rights, deletion or non-use conditions where feasible, bias and error review, human oversight, and a ban on hidden scoring. Training pauses when those conditions cannot be enforced. Consent does not authorize civic ranking.

The relevant architecture should also require model-use boundaries after training. A model trained or evaluated with City material should not later support candidate ranking, trust scoring, public eligibility, donor targeting, personnel discipline,

religious profiling, emotional inference, or public voting persuasion. The training pathway must govern downstream use, not merely data ingestion.

Training consent should address model memory after withdrawal. If technical deletion cannot fully remove learned effects, the participant should know that before consent. If unlearning is possible only within limits, those limits should be stated.

Model-training permission requires a derivative inventory and an exit plan before training begins. The City should identify source records, transformations, labels, embeddings, checkpoints, evaluation sets, generated examples, vendors, downstream systems, retention periods, and stop conditions. If authority expires, consent is withdrawn where applicable, a protected category is discovered, or prohibited inference appears, the institution must know what can be deleted, what requires retraining or retirement, which outputs need correction, and which residual risks require notice. One authorized run does not create indefinite permission for every derivative (Council of Europe, 2024; European Union, 2024; NIST, 2023a).

11.6.4 — Nonparticipant Data Exclusion

Nonparticipant data exclusion is a core condition for any research or model-training use. Nonparticipants include children, family members, partners, staff outside role scope, visitors, bystanders, professionals, host-community members, protesters, journalists, contractors, and incidental contacts.

Nonparticipant protection is designed before extraction. Research and training proposals identify incidental-person risks, exclusion methods, masking, summary substitution, metadata stripping, access limits, derivative controls, and verification

procedures before data move. A proposal that cannot protect people who never joined the study does not receive the records.

Exclusion must include inference review of family roles, locations, dates, events, and professional relations; removing names is insufficient if the remaining context identifies the person.

Exclusion receives independent audit rather than self-certification by the research or model team. Sampling, adversarial re-identification testing, affected-person review where appropriate, expert review, access logs, and breach response form the pathway. Discovery of nonparticipant material pauses use, triggers containment, and opens correction and remedy.

When exclusion is impossible because nonparticipant material is woven into the relevant public-power event, the default should be heightened protection, protected summary, affected-person notice where lawful, and independent review. These measures do not themselves authorize research or model-training use.

Test exclusions for indirect disclosures in participant-centered records: spouse routines, child schedules, lawyer strategy, therapist context, doctor identity, staff relationships, journalist sources, and neighborhood patterns.

11.6.5 — No Silent Dataset Conversion

The rule against silent dataset conversion also applies to the City's handling of material after public release. Publication for democratic review does not itself authorize official conversion into a training corpus, scraped benchmark, commercial analytics asset, campaign classifier, or donor intelligence layer. The City cannot control every outside reuse, but it can state applicable permissions, withhold unapproved cooperation, design against

scraping where lawful, and address misuse in its public-risk planning.

No silent dataset conversion means that records cannot quietly change status from operational archive to research corpus, model-training data, vendor dataset, internal analytics pool, or public benchmark. Conversion must be named, authorized, reviewed, logged, and contestable (NIST, 2023a; UNESCO, 2021b).

Update the record-stage passport (Section 11.1.1) for every change of purpose, audience, system, or derivative, with notice, source, owner, expiry, and remedy proportionate to the new burden.

Before data cross a system boundary, the dataset route should also record vendor restrictions, research approval where applicable, default prohibition on model training, export logging, public status, and the alert or review triggered by the transfer.

Discovery of an unauthorized conversion should trigger pause, containment, identification of affected persons, deletion or quarantine where possible, notice to oversight, correction of downstream use, and a review of the pathway that enabled the conversion.

Dataset conversion should require public artifact review if any output may travel. A chart, dashboard, benchmark, model card, research table, or public visualization can compress sensitive decisions into a misleading image. Before a dataset becomes an artifact, the City should ask what the artifact hides, who can be misread through it, and what status label must travel with it.

A governed dataset should receive a birth record before the first export. That record names the fields, provenance, inclusion and exclusion rules, lawful or consent basis, nonparticipant treatment, transformation history, intended users, access environment, retention, deletion, and prohibited inferences. It

should identify whether the dataset contains direct records, protected summaries, labels, embeddings, or derived features.

Export controls should follow the data rather than ending at the City boundary. Approved recipients need purpose limits, security duties, re-identification prohibitions, correction propagation, incident notice, audit rights, subcontractor rules, and a termination plan. High-dimensional or linked data require special scrutiny because names can disappear while identity remains inferable. De-identification is a risk-reduction method, not a promise that persons have vanished from the data (Narayanan and Shmatikov, 2008; Ohm, 2010).

Dataset closure needs evidence covering primary files, backups, derived tables, model checkpoints, shared workspaces, and vendor copies. Where complete destruction is impossible, the City should record the residual risk, restriction, and next review.

Before secondary use begins, a cross-system map should show how a source record could become an export, coded variable, research table, embedding, model checkpoint, vendor copy, public graphic, or decision aid. The map names every custodian, permission, transformation, retention rule, correction duty, and closure route. When the institution cannot trace that route or cannot withdraw an unauthorized derivative, the proposed use has not earned permission. Before authorizing a new research export, conduct a withdrawal rehearsal with fabricated records across the proposed recipient systems. Remove one permission after a derivative has been queued, then test whether the export, backup restoration, cached output, and scheduled model-training job respect the new status. The receiving custodian should acknowledge both the correction and any destinations beyond its control. If a necessary downstream owner cannot be identified, authorization waits for the missing boundary to be repaired.

11.7 — No Cross-Architecture Dossier

The no-dossier rule prevents the City's record from becoming the backbone of a general system of person classification. Cross-linking civic formation with religion, employment, voting, donation, affect research, public controversy, or inferred trust can produce an informational identity more powerful than any individual record. Surveillance studies describe this as an assemblage: fragments gathered for different purposes become a new object of governance. The danger is not only privacy loss. It is function creep, behavioral chilling, unequal error correction, and the conversion of participation into eligibility. Architectural separation, independent keys, purpose barriers, query controls, and prohibition of inferred trust profiles are therefore constitutive safeguards, not optional cybersecurity features (Haggerty and Ericson, 2000; Lyon, 2007; Nissenbaum, 2010).

11.7.1 — No City + Religion of Fairness Profile

Civic formation records and Religion of Fairness participation records require a hard separation. Religious practice, Fair Life Records, Religion of Fairness community involvement, spiritual commitments, service, or Clean-Slate City materials cannot be assembled into a joint profile of belief, virtue, loyalty, or civic suitability. Carefully governed interfaces may exist for a specific lawful purpose, but the default is nonconnection. Optional spiritual life cannot become an input to public-role judgment (Haggerty and Ericson, 2000; Lyon, 2007).

A joint profile would also pressure people who do not participate in the Religion of Fairness to perform religious alignment for public trust.

Admission does not depend on Religion of Fairness participation. Protect lawful religious or secular practice and any

needed schedule or space accommodations; religious status must not enter City evaluation or public readiness material.

The Religion of Fairness boundary requires separate identifiers, custodians, permissions, access groups, retention rules, and public statements. City admission or readiness records may not contain religious participation, House involvement, covenant status, or inferred spiritual seriousness. Technical systems and staff training should make nonconnection the default, with any narrow lawful interface logged and independently reviewable.

This separation also protects the Religion of Fairness. A voluntary religion becomes unsafe if its communities can quietly import civic records to assess believers or leaders. The City record should not follow a person into prayer, ritual, pastoral care, household life, or sacred belonging.

11.7.2 — No City + Workgame Profile

Workgame contribution data must remain outside the City participant profile. Project tasks, coordination history, team status, completion records, and contribution metrics answer questions about collaborative work, not civic worth or readiness for public power.

This separation also protects workers. If Workgame records can affect City evaluation, participants may feel pressured to overwork, perform loyalty, or accept unpaid burden for future public status. Staff and contributors may become trapped in hidden ambition channels. The City must not recreate prestige pipelines through project contribution.

Implementation should keep Workgame and City identifiers, databases, access roles, scoring systems, and public displays separate. Contribution points or histories cannot enter admission, readiness, or public ranking. Relevant expertise may be

evaluated through the ordinary role-fit process with the same evidence rules available to people who never joined the project.

The boundary should include reverse separation. City participation should not inflate Workgame status, unlock project authority, privilege proposals, or make criticism harder. A person under the Transparent Vow is not automatically a better builder, and a strong builder is not automatically a better public-power bearer.

The Workgame boundary should also prevent gamification drift inside the City. Participants should not begin to act as if visible life earns points, badges, levels, or project credibility. The City must not borrow the motivational grammar of contribution scoring.

11.7.3 — No City + PTVC Research Profile

Candidate phenomenal-valence estimates, affective measurements, experimental indicators, and other scientific outputs cannot enter a City readiness profile. Those objects belong to research protocols with declared instruments, uncertainty, reference classes, and verdict limits. They are not trust scores, public-worth measures, or evidence of political fitness. The City may protect research participants and route lawful interfaces without importing a research estimator into civic judgment.

A merger could lead staff and public audiences to treat uncertain estimates as stable traits while pressuring researchers to produce socially useful classifications. Research data would then govern civic evaluation, and civic incentives would distort research.

Scientific expertise may improve record-burden assessment, accessibility, sleep protection, survey design, and operational evaluation.

Public summaries should not describe visible stress, grief, exhaustion, joy, or calm as measurements of a participant's phenomenal life.

11.7.4 — No City + Public Voting Profile

Public voting, approval signals, platform reactions, polls, endorsements, and crowd sentiment cannot become a unified participant profile. Public input may matter in a lawful decision process, but popularity does not measure worth, readiness, or truth. The system should preserve the event and its stated purpose without converting fluctuating attention into a durable trait.

Crowd error has identifiable victims. Minorities can be punished, unpopular truth-tellers discouraged, participants misranked, and audiences trained to treat approval as moral evidence. Platforms and bots can also manufacture apparent civic meaning. Public-input systems therefore need purpose limits, manipulation review, and a prohibition on exporting their signals into a person file.

Where a lawful process uses bounded public input, keep its records separate from the participant archive and state the question, population, manipulation controls, decision weight, expiry, and appeal route. The signal ends with that purpose.

The voter or contributor also needs protection. Votes, comments, objections, questions, and credibility judgments should not be linked to a participant profile in ways that expose citizens, map political relationships, or enable retaliation. Public contribution can inform a bounded process without creating a reusable social graph between critics, supporters, and candidates.

11.7.5 — No City + Donor Profile

Donor and funding records require audit for capture risk, but they should not become a general participant profile. Gift history, sponsor contact, philanthropic access, financial networks, and institutional influence answer questions about money and leverage, not human worth or civic identity. The relevant disclosure should attach to the transaction, decision, or conflict, with access proportionate to that purpose.

Linking donor relationships to City records without strict purpose limits can give funders a map of candidate influence and vulnerability and encourage preferential treatment for funder-linked participants.

The City should record donor limits, funding transparency, conflict checks, no admission influence, no archive access, no naming sovereignty, and no priority governance.

Donor information belongs in anti-capture review, procurement oversight, conflict files, and funding transparency, not in participant ranking. Funders receive no privileged archive access, private readiness analytics, sponsor fields in public bundles, or donor-linked opportunity maps. The separation should extend to vendors whose technical access could reveal influence, vulnerability, or future political utility.

11.7.6 — Composite Dossier Controls and AI-Inferred Trust Profiles

Dossier prevention must also reach outside actors. A party, newsroom, donor network, advocacy group, vendor, university, foreign intelligence service, platform, or private model builder may try to merge released City material with other public or private data. The City cannot guarantee that no hostile actor will attempt it, but it can refuse to assist, limit machine-readable exposure where lawful, watermark or label public materials,

monitor abuse patterns, challenge unlawful extraction, and explain to citizens why merged profiles are an attack on the City's purpose.

An Artificial Intelligence inferred trust profile must not be created. A machine system may not combine City records or public interactions into a hidden score of trust, worth, readiness, seriousness, risk, or fairness. The prohibition extends to access logs, staff observations, speech patterns, correction history, sentiment, biometric traces, and research estimates. Workgame data, Religion of Fairness data, donor data, and voting signals are likewise excluded from such scoring (Nissenbaum, 2010; Eubanks, 2018).

A hidden trust score may arrive under another name: recommendation, risk flag, priority queue, anomaly signal, support tool, fit assessment, confidence label, readiness aid, or embeddings used as traits. Function governs the prohibition. If an output quietly orders people, shapes access, or pressures a consequential decision, renaming it does not make the profile acceptable.

Artificial Intelligence may assist search, accessibility, translation, alerting, integrity review, and workflow when each function has named inputs, limits, logging, human challenge, and a shutdown route. It cannot compare persons, decide trust, infer inner life, rank readiness, combine record architectures, or create a shadow dossier. Human review after profiling is insufficient if an undisclosed model has already shaped access, attention, or opportunity. The design must prevent prohibited inference before it becomes an invisible decision path.

The technical control set should include a complete model inventory, declared allowed functions, prohibited features and linkages, inference testing, explanation and appeal, human audit, vendor obligations, public reporting, and a mandatory shutdown

route when a tool begins functioning as readiness or worth classification.

Procurement and audit should test whether a tool changes access, attention, or opportunity through proxies even when no explicit score is displayed. A system that produces unexplained ordering effects should be suspended until the decision path is understood and made contestable.

The No Cross-Architecture Dossier rule does not forbid every lawful interface. Sometimes systems must communicate narrow status information: a participant has exited, a protection category applies, a research refusal must be honored, a public bundle has been corrected, a donor has no access rights, or an emergency contact route is active. The rule forbids merger into a total profile.

The safest interface is purpose-bound, minimal, logged, capable of being narrowed or revoked where lawful, and readable by the person affected. It transfers only the status needed for a defined function and not the underlying record. A research office may need to know that no consent exists; it does not need the participant's City archive. A government interface may need an active-status label; it does not need Religion of Fairness participation or donor proximity. A public platform may need a correction notice; it does not need staff notes or access logs.

Every technical specification must preserve the distinction between narrow interoperability and composite person judgment.

The plus signs in the subsection titles mark the prohibited act: fusion. Each neighboring architecture may maintain a legitimate record for its own purpose, but the records cannot be assembled into a master profile that judges the person across roles.

Chapter 12 — Perimeter, Visitors, and Media

Four claims arrive at one gate: a relative needs to reach a participant in crisis, a journalist seeks a deliberative session, protesters ask to be seen from the main approach, and an ambulance needs immediate passage. A fair perimeter cannot answer them with one badge or suspicion. It distinguishes purpose, protects households, and remains intelligible when time is short.

Security enters as a bounded public service. The City must plan for harassment, stalking, sabotage, unauthorized access, crowd pressure, cyber-physical incidents, emergencies, and ordinary conflict. It therefore needs trained people, proportionate screening, de-escalation, incident command, and review. Security remains subordinate to civic purpose through visible authority, narrow powers, staff support, accessible complaint, after-action review, and expiry of exceptional measures.

Protest and dissent are routes by which public burden returns to view. People who reject the City's premises or effects must be able to be seen, heard, documented, protected, and answered. Protest design therefore considers proximity, accessibility, sight and sound, traffic, media, counterprotest, de-escalation, arrest risk, staff burden, and complaint. Safety limits address conduct rather than viewpoint and protect protesters, participants, staff, families, visitors, hosts, and nonparticipants together.

Independent media prevent the City from becoming the sole author of its public meaning. Reporting, documentary access, public-record review, interviews, and investigation can reveal patterns that official bundles miss. The same practices can create spectacle, performance pressure, misleading fragments, or collateral exposure. Purpose rules, context, masking, role boundaries, correction, and right of reply let scrutiny remain independent while placing the burden of protection on the institution that grants access.

The chapter can be read as an access charter. Every opening identifies who may enter, for which purpose, into which zone, under what record state, for how long, with which protection, and with what remedy. Every closure identifies the public interest it protects, the less restrictive alternatives considered, the decision owner, the review clock, and the route of appeal. This structure makes both access and refusal answerable.

The public often meets the City first through a gate, route map, visitor page, protest line, media rule, denied entrance, or emergency closure. Those objects can communicate the institution’s civic character more forcefully than a formal statement. The edge should therefore be among the City’s clearest public surfaces: accessible, calm, specific, multilingual where needed, correction-ready, and honest about both invitation and limit.

The rules also identify deletion requirements and preserve the distinct legal authority of the host jurisdiction (United Nations, 1966; UN Human Rights Committee, 2011; UN Human Rights Committee, 2020).

Peak-event testing should compare burdens on nearby residents, staff, visitors, and protected occupants rather than optimizing access for only the most visible group.

Routes that repeatedly shift screening, protest, media, or waiting pressure onto the same neighbors or workers should trigger redesign before that burden becomes normalized.

The edge should be tested under ordinary, protest, media, emergency, and high-attention conditions rather than only through a curated visit.

12.1 — Why the Perimeter Exists

The perimeter preserves distinctions that openness alone cannot hold: participant from visitor, household from public route, source archive from public interface, care space from media space, protest from intrusion, and emergency access from ordinary access. Its rules are legible, reviewable, and proportionate, telling people when recording begins, which route applies, where assistance is available, and how to leave. Physical and digital boundaries correspond; a room is not private if microphones, remote viewers, access logs, or later search make it public. The design goal is intelligible jurisdiction over attention, capture, and access rather than enclosure for its own sake (Nissenbaum, 2010; W3C, 2023).

12.1.1 — Transparent Vow Protection

The Law of Fairness question is decisive: who is protected by the boundary, and who is burdened by it? A perimeter becomes unjust when it protects status against accountability. It becomes necessary when it protects the Vow from hidden access, the archive from sabotage, households from exposure, staff from harassment, and nonparticipants from record spillover. The City must therefore justify every barrier by burden placement, not by institutional comfort.

The perimeter protects the Transparent Vow by preventing hidden access from returning through casual entry. A participant under the Vow cannot use unlogged role-relevant meetings, unauthorized influence, or side-channel arrangements to conduct public-power business outside the governed record. If anyone can enter without role, notice, and status, the active record becomes porous at the very point it claims continuity (Nissenbaum, 2010).

The City should maintain an access-intent register at the edge of active participant space, limited to the operational facts needed to preserve the Vow: role, purpose, sponsoring office or invitation, time window, access band, record status, and the human authority responsible for denial, approval, or later review.

12.1.2 — Archive Protection

Archive protection includes physical, digital, procedural, and human boundaries. A server room may need restricted entry. A records office may need access protocols. Staff who handle classification may need protection from harassment. Public visitors may need to know that curiosity does not grant raw access.

Archive protection must not become archive secrecy. The public has a legitimate interest in how records are captured, protected, corrected, and released. The perimeter must therefore support tours, oversight windows, public explanations, audit displays, and record-site access where appropriate.

A perimeter also protects against informal archive authority. Not every person who works near records should be able to browse them. Not every expert visitor should be treated as a reviewer. The boundary must be internal as well as external, marking who may touch memory and under what authority.

Physical entry, system access, classification, correction, and public-interface permissions remain separate under the lifecycle rules in Chapter 11.

Archive protection should also separate emergency preservation from emergency publication. A breach, fire, cyberattack, or protest event may require rapid safeguarding of records, but urgency should not become permission to release or interpret material without the proper stage controls.

Archive protection should be designed around three separate risks: physical disruption, informational corruption, and interpretive capture. A locked room can protect devices and still fail if access logs are weak, if staff are pressured informally, or if public bundles are released without context. The perimeter therefore protects the archive only when physical security, credentialing, provenance, staff support, and public explanation are treated as one integrity system rather than as separate technical chores.

12.1.3 — Household Protection

Residential and care routes use the least revealing access and record needed for safety and service; the independent household rights in Section 9.3 apply.

Household edges, participant residence, visitor approach, family consultation rooms, protected nonvisibility areas, and public-interface zones need distinct spatial grammar. A visitor should not drift into family space, and a participant should not turn household contact into an off-record extension of active public life.

Household protection is incomplete without remedy. Family members and dependents need a direct route to report overexposure, harassment, unsafe access, coercion, or misuse of household material, together with interim protection and independent review.

The perimeter also prevents resentment from accumulating inside families. If the participant’s public burden repeatedly spills into dinner, rest, school calls, medical appointments, or ordinary affection, family members may begin to carry the cost of a Vow they never made. A fair City measures its perimeter not by how close the public can get to the participant, but by whether the participant’s private circle can remain real.

12.1.4 — Staff Safety

Shield staff entrances and work routes from stalking, harassment, doxxing, and pressure for unauthorized access.

Staff safety includes physical safety, psychological safety, role clarity, and authority limits. Boundary enforcement fails when staff face retaliation for applying declared rules or use their authority arbitrarily. Train and protect staff so enforcement remains calm, reviewable, consistent, and dignified.

The staff-safety rule should also be read as a staffing-budget rule. If the City cannot provide enough trained people to keep boundaries calm, accessible, and reviewable, it should not compensate by asking fewer workers to absorb more conflict. Understaffing is a boundary failure disguised as thrift.

Staff-safety design should include a conflict-load ledger for the boundary itself. This ledger should not score staff temperament or punish workers for distress. It should identify where the perimeter is producing repeated anger, confusion, harassment, overtime, emergency calls, or moral injury, so the institution repairs the design rather than asking workers to absorb preventable strain.

Visitors need a complaint route to challenge wrongful denial, while staff need backing to enforce declared rules.

12.1.5 — Public Legibility

Apply Section 6.6’s civic-tone requirements to perimeter materials, signs, sight lines, staff conduct, and entry sequence so people can understand protection, public access, review, and limits.

Public legibility begins before entry. A person approaching the City should be able to understand basic zones, roles, access limits, recording rules, protest routes, complaint options, accessibility services, and protected domains without insider

vocabulary. Too little explanation breeds rumor; too much technical language produces a different form of exclusion (W3C, 2023; Steinfeld and Maisel, 2012).

Access is not authority. Citizens may approach, observe public materials, protest, submit reports, ask questions, and use lawful interface routes. Those permissions do not include raw-record demand, entry into protected zones, exposure of nonparticipants, harassment of workers, or command over response timing.

Public legibility should be tested with people who do not already admire the City. A host-community resident, a skeptical journalist, a disability advocate, a protest organizer, a visitor with limited language access, and a person who simply got lost should all be able to understand the first layer of boundary logic.

Every gate, screening rule, visitor path, media boundary, protest route, and protected domain must trace its authority to a stated perimeter purpose. If a rule protects none of those purposes, it may be institutional convenience rather than fairness (United Nations, 1966; UN Human Rights Committee, 2020).

12.2 — Security Without Carcerality

Security without carcerality begins by separating unfamiliarity from threat. Risk assessment, screening, de-escalation, emergency response, and force are distinct functions with different thresholds and review. Staff receive role-specific training, supervision, fatigue controls, complaint review, and narrow limits on search, restraint, exclusion, and information gathering. The least intrusive effective response governs ordinary situations; imminent danger may justify stronger action under law, documentation, and later review. Humiliation, collective punishment, detention aesthetics, and fear-based design contradict the City's formative purpose (United Nations, 1990b; United Nations, 2015; OHCHR, 2024).

12.2.1 — Non-Prison Design

Apply the non-carceral spatial requirements in Section 6.6.1 to entries, screening spaces, visitor routes, public edges, and protected thresholds (United Nations, 1990b; United Nations, 2015).

Non-carceral security should be tested at the moments where authority is felt: screening, waiting, denial, escort, search, emergency separation, and exit. Each should use the least restrictive lawful method, state its purpose, preserve a review route, and avoid turning uncertainty into intimidation.

Design review includes people who have experienced carceral, institutional, psychiatric, immigration, military, or highly securitized environments. A designer may not notice fear grammar that a visitor's body recognizes immediately.

Revisit the design after security incidents so added barriers, devices, and changes in staff posture receive review together.

Specify the spatial design requirements before the first security contract is signed.

Include barrier height, bench placement, and the route from denial to exit in that design review.

12.2.2 — Proportionate Screening

A bag check, identity question, device restriction, metal detector, pat-down alternative, escort rule, waiting line, denied pass, or secondary review can protect people, but it can also humiliate, delay, exclude, or mark some visitors as suspect before they have done anything wrong. The City must treat screening as a civic act requiring justification, not as a ritual of institutional power.

The fairest screening system uses the least intrusive method that can reasonably meet the specific risk. A routine public tour does not require the same rule as a high-risk archive inspection, a medical emergency, a contentious protest, a visit by a targeted participant, or a vendor repair in a protected systems room.

The screening question should be stated plainly: what risk is being addressed, what information is necessary, who sees it, how long it is kept, what happens if something is flagged, and how can a person appeal or correct an error?

Proportionality also limits data collection. The City must not collect more identity, device, biometric, behavioral, or background information than necessary for the specific access class.

The dignity of screening matters. People may arrive anxious, disabled, elderly, grieving, angry, confused, or unfamiliar with the City. Screening should avoid unnecessary exposure, physical humiliation, public embarrassment, ableist assumptions, and class-coded suspicion.

The City must audit whether screening actually reduces the specified risk; reassurance, inconvenience, and a hard appearance do not establish effectiveness.

A proportionate system can still refuse entry. It can delay, redirect, escalate, or require oversight. But every escalation should be explainable, logged where material, and reviewable.

Document why each access class requires identification, orientation, escort, or ordinary visitor notice.

The written screening standard should address trauma accommodation as well as disability access and remedies for misuse.

Provide an appeal route for patterns of harsher screening by body, language, clothing, disability, protest affiliation, religious markers, or political view. Review individual humiliating searches as well as recurring reports.

12.2.3 — De-Escalation Norms

De-escalation norms require staff to distinguish confusion from threat, dissent from violence, agitation from danger, and rule violation from malicious intent. The first response should often be explanation, redirection, translation, cooling space, supervisor review, or access clarification.

Protest settings make de-escalation essential. A protester may shout, accuse, insult, or gather with others. The City must not treat criticism as threat. It should intervene where harassment, stalking, doxxing, violence, protected-zone breach, obstruction of emergency or essential accessible routes, or nonparticipant exposure occurs. Ordinary expressive disruption is assessed under Section 12.5.4 rather than treated as a threat by default.

Staff need training, backup, and recovery to de-escalate well. The City must count the emotional cost of asking staff to absorb conflict. Rotation, supervision, complaint routes, and after-incident care are part of the standard. De-escalation should also have a record category. Not every exchange needs public

release, but incidents involving force, removal, denial, or repeated conflict should be reviewable.

De-escalation should be tested across difference. It must work with anger, disability, language difference, grief, and mistrust without turning difference into threat.

De-escalation begins in the built and procedural environment. Visible help points, wide waiting areas, quiet rooms, clear signs, shade, water, interpreters, non-digital options, and realistic time buffers reduce the number of conflicts that security must solve. The most humane intervention may occur before anyone raises a voice.

The City needs thresholds for support, rotation, supervisor intervention, refusal, and repair.

12.2.4 — Perimeter Security Review

Security burden should be audited by asking who is made to feel like a threat. A system that purchases safety through participant fear, staff hypervigilance, humiliating screening, protest suppression, or intimidation of ordinary visitors has moved burden onto the people it claims to protect. Risk management remains necessary, but it must be proportionate, explainable, and contestable rather than expressed through a generalized profile of suspicion.

Security review examines whether each practice remains necessary, proportionate, lawful, humane, and aligned with the City's purpose. It should examine searches, visitor denials, protest responses, use of force, device rules, incident classifications, emergency exceptions, retention of screening data, staff complaints, and patterns of unequal treatment.

Review must include external inspection. Internal security teams may normalize their own growth. An outside reviewer can identify fear drift, racial or class bias, disability mismatch,

overcollection, protest suppression, staff burnout, and technology creep. Reviewers' rewards must not depend on favorable findings.

Security review also includes affected-person complaint routes. A visitor wrongly denied entry, a protester wrongly treated as threat, a staff member pressured to overenforce, a participant overprotected into isolation, or a family member exposed by a security choice must have somewhere to go.

Public reporting should summarize security without exposing vulnerabilities or private persons unnecessarily. Categories of incidents, corrective changes, complaints, review findings, and rights concerns can be reported with care.

This review includes false-positive and false-negative analysis. The City must ask whom security wrongly treated as threat and whom security wrongly allowed to create harm.

Review includes civil-liberties knowledge, disability review, labor review, protest-rights experience, privacy expertise, and participant representation where appropriate.

Security review has access to uncomfortable evidence. Body-worn records where lawful, incident logs, visitor complaints, protest reports, disability-access complaints, staff debriefs, denial patterns, and media disputes should be reviewable without allowing casual browsing. The review body must see enough to judge power and be bound enough not to become another source of exposure.

12.2.5 — Safety Without Fear

Safety without fear is experienced through ordinary interactions: signage that explains rather than threatens, staff who begin with assistance, screening that preserves dignity, accessible alternatives, calm waiting spaces, visible complaint routes, and predictable escalation. The atmosphere should let a lawful visitor

understand what is happening without feeling accused and let staff enforce a boundary without performing dominance.

Safety must not be purchased through wealth and exclusion. A quiet enclave can appear calm because ordinary people, protest, disability access, translation needs, civic education, and everyday confusion have been designed out. That is luxury insulation, not a public standard. Humane security should remain compatible with scrutiny, accessibility, and the imperfect presence of the public.

Any defensible access system has to treat fear as data without making fear sovereign. Participants, staff, visitors, critics, and neighbors may all report whether the perimeter feels intimidating, confusing, or unsafe. Those reports should inform design review, not function as a popularity vote over necessary protection.

Watch for reluctance to question guards, avoidance of complaint routes, reports of feeling watched during ordinary movement, or a perimeter experienced as warning rather than orientation.

Routine experience reviews should test whether security practices changed willingness to enter, ask for help, or complain.

Repeated fear reports should trigger operational and design review, with retraining or changes where the findings warrant them, rather than be dismissed as a communication problem.

12.3 — Access Classes, Gates, and Screening

Access classes describe temporary permissions rather than human rank. Participant, staff, visitor, vendor, journalist, expert, critic, emergency responder, and family routes each carry a defined purpose, zone, time, record state, expiry, and review. Digital access follows the same logic through least privilege, separation of duties, and logged exceptional entry. Denial receives reasons and a review path whenever rights or public participation are affected (NIST, 2020a; ISO/IEC, 2022; UN Human Rights Committee, 2011).

12.3.1 — Participant Access

Gates then turn access classes into lived practice. A gate can be physical, digital, procedural, or temporal. It may be a doorway, check-in process, credential verification, visitor orientation, vendor log, media agreement, emergency route, or public interface window.

Participant access is governed by active status under the Transparent Vow. Movement may carry record status, protected nonvisibility boundaries, public interface rules, staff interaction limits, and access restrictions tied to role pathway (NIST, 2020a; ISO/IEC, 2022).

Use the participant-orientation walks in Section 6.4.2 to test whether access and record-status changes are understood.

Participant access is role-limited like every other access class. A participant receives the material needed to understand and challenge their own record and to perform defined duties, but not unrelated raw archives, staff-private space, protected third-party material, or service routes as informal privilege. Access rules should identify purpose, area or dataset, time, supervision, logging, and remedy.

Internal gates should log material changes to access or record status without tracking every ordinary step. Entry into a deliberation hall, a crisis room, or a protected nonvisibility area may change the applicable rules; walking to meals or the grounds does not itself justify a movement profile.

Update access when an applicant becomes a participant, a participant enters an office interface, a paused participant reenters, or someone exits. Outdated permissions must not continue.

Participant access should be integrated with de-loading and health review. A participant may have permission to enter a public interface but lack the present capacity to carry it safely. Access rules should not force performance after distress, exhaustion, threat, grief, medical need, or overload.

12.3.2 — Staff Access

Staff permissions must specify the relevant teaching, cleaning, repair, security, archive, operations, translation, moderation, care, or logistics duty. Access belongs to that role, not private curiosity or informal power.

Apply the role-bound access logging and worker protections in Sections 11.1.2 and 11.4.5.

Staff access should include appeal and correction. A staff member wrongly denied access may be unable to do their job. A staff member given excessive access may be placed at risk or tempted into misuse. Supervisors should not use access control as retaliation.

This rule connects to labor review. If staff need broader access to make an understaffed system function, consider staffing remedies; do not expand access beyond what their roles can safely carry.

Participants should know which staff roles may enter which spaces and why, without receiving private staff information.

12.3.3 — Visitor Access

Visitor access should be understandable before arrival. Public information should describe available routes, hours, accessibility accommodations, recording conditions, protected zones, prohibited conduct, identification needs where lawful, expected wait, non-digital assistance, complaint, and appeal.

Receive visitors without requiring confidence or familiarity with institutional language.

Visitor access also protects those who seek information without seeking visibility. Attendance at a tour, public session, complaint meeting, protest, family visit, or record-site appointment should not become an endorsement label or participant trace. Capture and release rules should distinguish operational security from public identification, provide masking or opt-out routes where feasible, and delete visitor data when its purpose expires.

The visitor path should avoid protected domains. It should not pass casually by intimate, clinical, household, staff-private, child-sensitive, or archive-custody zones.

The visitor path should include an exit ethic. A visitor should know how to leave, how their data is handled, how to ask for correction, and how to avoid becoming public material.

Explain the City’s recording, access restrictions, searchability, and planned uses before the visit. Notice must be layered, because one sign at the gate is not sufficient for people under stress, with disabilities, using translation, accompanying children, or entering during a public event. Give visitors a route to clarify the conditions before proceeding.

12.3.4 — Expert and Media Access

Auditors and other public users also need purpose-specific access; a simple inside/outside split cannot govern their exposure status and boundaries.

Unclear access classes can turn a vendor into an unlogged adviser, an expert into a hidden decision-maker, or a volunteer into a worker without labor protection. They can also permit unbounded media recording, wrongful visitor capture, or a participant's misuse of public openness as private access. Define each role before those permissions blur.

Experts and media both shape public understanding, but they do so through different powers. Experts may inspect systems, advise, test, diagnose, or critique; journalists observe, question, investigate, interpret, and reach people who will never visit. Neither role is an enhanced visitor category. Each requires its own purpose, independence protections, access boundaries, and remedy for misuse.

Expert access should follow the dedicated purpose, competence, conflict, access, and influence-trace controls in Section 12.4; this subsection focuses on how that route differs from media access.

Media access must also begin with purpose. Public-interest reporting is not the same as entertainment, promotional imagery, humiliation, or personality content. A journalist may need to see, ask, investigate, and challenge. That does not mean raw intimacy, child exposure, staff vulnerability, or protected nonvisibility material becomes available.

Their review trails should therefore differ. Expert influence may alter design, safety, rights, technical systems, or policy, while media output shapes public knowledge outside the City's control. The institution may record conditions of access, protected categories, conflicts, and correction routes without

approving conclusions. Documentation should reveal influence and boundary, not create editorial control.

Both roles require conflict awareness. An expert may have donor ties, vendor ties, ideological commitments, professional incentives, or prior public positions. A media organization may have sensational incentives, political commitments, or business pressures. The City must not exclude every conflict automatically, but it must make relevant conflicts known and manage access accordingly.

Post-access review should examine consequences rather than reward favorable output. Did the expert relationship create hidden authority, did the report expose protected people, did the coverage omit decisive context, or did the access produce public understanding that the previous design could not? Future access rules should learn from those outcomes.

Duration changes the risk. Extended presence creates familiarity, relationships, informal access, altered participant behavior, and possible dependence on future invitation. Longer engagements therefore need clearer renewal, conflict, rotation, data handling, and post-access rules.

Each access event should carry a purpose memo stating why entry is justified, what may be seen or recorded, which categories remain protected, what may be quoted, how influence is logged, who can challenge misuse, and what status travels with resulting artifacts. The memo should be public in proportionate form and reviewable after the event.

Use ordinary, published access terms, conflict disclosure, rotation, and prohibitions on private favors or unlogged bargaining to protect expert and media independence.

12.3.5 — Emergency and Vendor Access

Emergency access must be fast enough to save life and controlled enough to preserve lawful record and dignity. Medical responders, firefighters, crisis teams, public safety officials, technical responders, and urgent repair crews may need to cross boundaries that ordinary visitors cannot cross. The City must prepare those routes before crisis, not improvise them during panic (UN Human Rights Committee, 2011; W3C, 2023).

Vendor access presents different risks. Vendors may repair capture systems, maintain archive infrastructure, service security devices, support accessibility tools, provide food systems, repair utilities, or update software. Vendor entry can become technical dependency, data access, or hidden influence if not governed tightly.

Vendor access should be minimal, escorted or supervised where needed, logged when material, and governed by contract. A vendor should not gain archive access because they maintain the building. A software vendor should not browse records because they support search. A maintenance vendor should not become a private observer of active formation.

Emergency and vendor access should be tested in dry runs. A protocol that looks safe on paper may fail when an ambulance arrives, a server breaks, a fire alarm sounds, or a vendor needs urgent repair.

Vendor contracts should include least-access rules, escorted zones where appropriate, logging, a ban on data use outside the authorized contract purpose, incident reporting, exit rights, and a ban on turning access into leverage.

Every accelerated entry should generate an emergency access receipt after the immediate danger has passed. The receipt records who entered, under what trigger, which zones or systems were reached, what notice was bypassed, what information was

exposed, what actions were taken, and who will review the event. It should be available to affected people and oversight in forms that do not reveal security vulnerabilities. The receipt converts urgency from an invisible exception into a reviewable episode and gives the City a basis for correcting routes that failed under pressure.

Vendor exit is designed before vendor entry. Contracts specify credential revocation, return or destruction of data, transfer of documentation, continuity assistance, vulnerability disclosure, migration or escrow of critical configurations, and post-termination audit. The City tests whether capture, access, correction, safety, and public memory continue if a vendor fails, is acquired, raises prices, or refuses cooperation.

12.4 — Experts, Critics, and Temporary Contributors

Experts, critics, and temporary contributors add the most value when invitation cannot be converted into dependence. Purpose, access, compensation, conflicts, deliverables, publication rights, data handling, and end date are declared before entry. Critics receive protection from retaliatory exclusion, selective editing, and compelled endorsement, while the review trail preserves recommendations, institutional responses, and unresolved disagreement. Legitimacy comes from qualified outsiders being able to inspect difficult claims and publish reasoned dissent, not from displaying eminent names (UN Human Rights Committee, 2011; Bovens, 2007; O'Neill, 2002a).

12.4.1 — Expert Purpose Statement

Every expert entry should begin with a purpose statement. The City must know what problem the expert is being asked to examine, what competence they bring, what materials they need, what protected categories remain outside scope, and what kind of output will follow (UN Human Rights Committee, 2011; O'Neill, 2002a).

The statement should identify conflicts where relevant. A vendor-connected expert, donor-connected expert, political ally, former critic, activist, academic researcher, journalist, or professional consultant may still contribute, but the City should not hide the context of their influence. Conflict disclosure is not automatic disqualification.

The purpose statement also determines access depth. Some experts can work with public materials. Others may need restricted records, staff interviews, facility walkthroughs, technical logs, anonymized bundles, or protected summaries. Access must follow need. It should not follow status.

The purpose statement should also distinguish advisory access from evidentiary access. An expert may advise design without seeing individual records, or examine system categories without seeing raw identities. The City must not use expertise as a shortcut around minimization.

Publish a plain-language purpose statement without exposing protected details.

The expert purpose statement should include what the expert is not judging. A cybersecurity reviewer is not certifying the City's moral legitimacy. A clinician is not approving political formation. A journalist is not validating the Law of Fairness. A disability reviewer is not endorsing the entire institution. Stating the boundary of expertise prevents the City from borrowing authority beyond the expert's actual task.

12.4.2 — Temporary Role Boundary

Temporary contributors enter for a defined purpose and leave when that purpose ends. Watch for drift: a consultant becomes indispensable; a reviewer becomes a regular informal adviser; a critic becomes a gatekeeper; a vendor expert becomes the only person who understands a system. Temporary roles must not become shadow offices.

The perimeter duty requires the institution to define the beginning, scope, duration, permitted contact, access depth, record duty, confidentiality limits, and exit conditions for temporary contributors. A person invited to review a public interface should not gain informal access to participants. A technical specialist should not become a policy adviser unless a new role is created and reviewed.

Do not advertise a temporary contributor's presence as approval unless the contributor gave that approval under clear terms.

Temporary roles should also carry communication limits. A contributor with temporary access should not privately brief participants, donors, media, or public officials about protected observations unless the role explicitly permits that communication.

The temporary boundary should also protect the contributor. A temporary expert should not be blamed for decisions outside their scope, used as cover for choices they did not approve, or kept publicly tied to a system after their role ended.

Temporary role boundaries should be visible to insiders as well as outsiders, including who supervises, decision rights, how conflicts are logged, publication freedom, and what continuing obligations survive exit.

After the role ends, a temporary contributor may remain bound not to disclose protected information, but should not be gagged from reporting wrongdoing, misuse, coercion, unlawful exposure, retaliation, or institutional failure through proper channels.

12.4.3 — Critic Protection

Critics are necessary because admiration misses burden. A critic may notice surveillance drift, legal overclaim, staff exploitation, child exposure, intimate-record danger, host-community resentment, disability exclusion, or public artifact misuse before supporters do. The City must treat criticism as part of its safety system, not merely as public-relations risk.

Adversarial review deserves a legitimate and safe route. A critic should not lose access merely for being unfriendly, be labeled malicious for asking difficult questions, or be placed in a crowd setting that makes careful inspection impossible. Anti-retaliation, viewpoint-neutral criteria, privacy, security, correction access, and protection from doxxing or fan

harassment let criticism test the City rather than test the critic's tolerance for abuse.

Critics remain subject to the category-specific access limits in Section 12.4.4.

Public openness depends on the City’s ability to create channels for protected criticism. Some concerns may need confidential submission before public release, especially when they involve safety, breach, staff retaliation, nonparticipant exposure, or technical vulnerability. A critic should be able to warn the City without immediately exposing the very harm they are trying to prevent.

Public response routes protect both critic and institution. The City must have a method for acknowledging, classifying, answering, correcting, or rejecting criticism. A reviewable response helps the public see whether criticism changed the City or why it did not.

The City must publicly reject harassment done in its name, including attacks by supporters who treat criticism as betrayal.

Assess a critic’s evidence separately from their motives. A critic may dislike the City and still accurately identify a burden.

12.4.4 — Access Limits

A good reason to enter the City does not become a good reason to see everything. Experts and critics should receive the narrowest access sufficient for their purpose, with escalation only when justified, logged, and reviewed.

Limits should be category-specific. Child-related material, intimate records, health and clinical material, legal counsel material, household material, staff private records, archive custody systems, security vulnerabilities, and nonparticipant identities require separate handling. The City must not use broad

nondisclosure agreements as a substitute for actual access design.

Keep the review scope within the expert's competence; amend the purpose if broader access is needed.

Boundary legitimacy requires the City to include affected-person protections in expert and critic access. If a reviewer must see sensitive material, the handling should include masking, summaries, restricted rooms, access logs, and remedy for misuse.

Explain access limits publicly by reference to protected domains, safety, scope, law, or public purpose.

Access limits should also be reviewable and adjustable. A critic or expert who demonstrates a legitimate need for deeper access should have an escalation path. Access that creates unanticipated harm or authority drift should be narrowed.

Access limits should be paired with substitute evidence where possible. When raw access is denied, the City should ask whether a summary, aggregate, protected demonstration, or independent inspector can give the critic enough basis to evaluate the claim.

The substitute must arrive promptly, provide enough information to test the claim, permit independent checking, and protect vulnerable people while disclosing no more protected information than the authorized review requires.

12.4.5 — Review Trail

A review trail shows how outside input entered the institution and whether it changed anything. It may include a public summary where appropriate (Bovens, 2007; Fung, 2006).

Two abuses become easier when influence is unrecorded. Hidden dependence lets an adviser shape policy without public knowledge; false endorsement lets the institution borrow a

person's name while concealing the narrowness or disagreement of the role.

Proportionality keeps the trail from becoming bureaucratic capture. A passing visitor comment, a journalist's question, a legal memorandum, and a disability audit that redesigns access do not require the same public object. Material influence, consequential access, and changed practice are the triggers, not every conversation.

Later failure gives the trail another use. Reviewers can ask whether a risk was identified, whether access limits prevented necessary knowledge, whether a warning was ignored, and whether the institution implemented only the flattering parts of advice.

The public layer may be narrower than the oversight layer. Where lawful and safe, an acknowledgment can give the review category, date, owner, and disposition without exposing identities or sensitive records.

Disagreement deserves preservation. A rejected warning, unresolved objection, minority report, or staff dissent may become important after later harm. Recording only accepted advice would turn the trail into a celebration ledger rather than evidence of judgment under uncertainty.

Future stewards also need the reasons behind access decisions. Leadership change should not erase why a reviewer was admitted, what limits were imposed, which conflicts were known, or why a recommendation was rejected.

A common schema helps expose selective quotation. Favorable experts, skeptical critics, local residents, staff reviewers, and temporary technical contributors enter the same basic fields. The institution cannot feature praise while burying adverse findings simply because the latter are inconvenient.

The stable schema is contributor and role, purpose, access, materials, conflicts, questions, findings, dissent, institutional response, implementation owner, expiry, and later reassessment. A common schema does not imply equal evidentiary weight.

Temporary authority expires automatically. Credentials, editing rights, and advisory access should carry an end date; continued access requires a new decision. Public descriptions should identify the dates of the role so former contributors are not mistaken for current advisers. Confidentiality and other protective duties survive the role for as long as applicable law and the relevant agreement require. Recurring contributors should receive a fresh conflict and access review rather than inherit privileges from earlier work.

Independence also requires disclosure of payment, travel support, access arrangements, publication timing, and confidentiality without treating compensation as automatic disqualification. The City cannot purchase favorable silence, delay adverse findings, or reward compliant reviewers with privileged access. The trail records both the support that made review possible and the safeguards that kept support from becoming ownership. Closeout should verify that credentials, shared folders, distribution lists, and informal access actually ended when the appointment did.

12.5 — Protest, Dissent, and Adversarial Presence

Peaceful protest gives the City an external view of its own burdens. A credible route preserves sight, sound, accessible participation, media observation, and proximity sufficient for expression without forcing entry into residential, clinical, child-protected, archive, or emergency domains. Restrictions require lawful purpose, necessity, proportionality, nondiscrimination, de-escalation, and review. The institution should also answer organized criticism through records, meetings, corrections, or policy decisions so protest produces a public response rather than mere containment (UN Human Rights Committee, 2020; OHCHR, 2024).

12.5.1 — Protest Zone Design

Protest zone design is not the art of moving criticism out of sight. Distance, sightline, sound, weather protection, accessibility, safety, public interface, and media visibility should keep objection visible, audible, and answerable without letting crowd pressure control the City. A zone that is technically available but practically invisible is suppression by design (UN Human Rights Committee, 2020).

Protesters carry risks of their own. A critic approaching a highly visible institution may face counter-harassment, hostile surveillance, doxxing, crowd confusion, or misclassification by security. Dissent is not protected if the institution merely permits it while leaving dissenters exposed to foreseeable harm. Route design, anti-retaliation rules, privacy options, and a complaint channel should protect the person without weakening the protest's public visibility.

Closeness must be balanced with the protected-domain and essential-route safeguards in Section 12.5.4.

The protest zone should be accessible. People with disabilities, elders, people using transit, people with language barriers, and ordinary citizens without elite resources should be able to dissent.

The protest zone should also be evaluated by actual use. Empty design assumptions often fail when crowds, weather, counterprotest, disability access, media presence, and emotion arrive together. Protest design must be corrected after real events rather than defended because it looked balanced on a plan.

Protest zones should provide water, shade, accessible facilities, toilets, safe approach routes, emergency assistance, and clear communication so people can participate safely and with dignity.

Rules should be content-neutral, published in advance, and reviewable after each major event. Entry logs, camera systems, and incident records may not be repurposed into a protester dossier or a future access penalty merely because a person opposed the City (UN Human Rights Committee, 2020; OHCHR, 2024).

12.5.2 — Dissent Is Not Threat

Security systems can blur dissent and threat because both may be loud, inconvenient, and emotionally charged. The City must resist that blur. Threat involves conduct that endangers people, records, essential access, protected domains, emergency function, or personal safety. Dissent involves disagreement, protest, accusation, argument, satire, refusal, and public challenge.

Staff need the same distinction. A gate worker, moderator, security officer, public interface operator, or participant support staff member may feel pressure to remove critics quickly. Training should help staff respond to discomfort without overclassification. Supervisory review should catch patterns

where certain groups, viewpoints, or forms of expression are misclassified as threat.

Protected dissent and prohibited conduct should be stated in plain language before conflict. People need to know that criticism, leafleting, observation, counter-speech, and peaceful assembly are not threats, while violence, targeted harassment, doxxing, and coercive obstruction cross different boundaries.

This rule must be protected from viewpoint bias. The City must not become more tolerant of dissent that sounds polite, elite, or familiar while treating angry, local, religious, labor, youth, or marginalized dissent as inherently unsafe. Tone may affect management, but it must not replace threat assessment.

The dissent-is-not-threat rule should survive high emotion. The most revealing protests may happen when participants fail, records expose harm, staff speak out, or host communities object.

12.5.3 — Adversarial Review

Adversarial review creates structured channels for critics to test claims, records, access rules, security practices, public artifacts, and institutional drift. It complements protest and centers on challenging the City's assumptions rather than supplying only specialist advice. Experts may participate in this adversarial role as well as in ordinary expert review.

An adversarial review should identify the question, available evidence, access limits, response record, and remedy or correction route while leaving critics free to challenge the review's premises.

Adversarial review must also protect against performative opposition. A token critic who cannot access meaningful information becomes legitimacy theater. A friendly critic presented as hostile misleads the public. A televised

confrontation designed for drama may create spectacle rather than review. The City must distinguish real adversarial testing from public artifact management.

Adversarial review includes a right to publish conclusions within lawful limits. If the City invites critics only to absorb their insight privately, criticism becomes institutional resource extraction. Public criticism may be uncomfortable, but the City must not convert opponents into unpaid internal consultants without public voice.

Maintain channels for adversarial review before crisis makes coordination harder: opposition briefings, red-team visits, public questions, independent reports, protest memoranda, external legal analysis, and staff-protected dissent. These channels do not replace protest.

Repeated criticism from protesters, experts, staff, host residents, and journalists should trigger review of underlying burdens and possible design changes; explanation alone is insufficient.

Participant training should discourage manipulating sympathy or counterattacking through institutional channels when challenged.

12.5.4 — Safety Boundaries

The same rule needs a limiting condition: protest can harm. It can become harassment, doxxing, stalking, intimidation, blocked emergency or essential accessible routes, family exposure, staff targeting, or violence. It can be manipulated by bots, media incentives, partisan campaigns, or personal grievance. The City must protect dissent without letting dissent become a tool for destroying the very people and protected domains the City is obligated to shield.

The first safety boundary protects protected domains. Protest may not enter or target child spaces, household edges, clinical interfaces, legal counsel spaces, intimacy-related protections, archive custody rooms, or staff-private areas. The public can criticize these protections. It cannot violate them as a method of criticism.

The second boundary protects persons from targeted harm. Doxxing, stalking, threats, harassment, private-address exposure, family targeting, and coordinated intimidation are not civic dissent. The City must respond firmly without treating all criticism as part of the same category.

The third boundary protects emergency and accessible service routes. Protest arrangements must preserve prompt medical, fire, and emergency access and a safe, accessible way to obtain essential services. Disruption of ordinary visitor or staff movement should be assessed separately: inconvenience alone does not make an assembly violent or justify dispersal. Restrictions should follow applicable law, address a specific risk, remain necessary and proportionate, and use communication, alternative routes, and de-escalation where these can protect both access and peaceful dissent.

The fourth boundary protects protesters from overreach. Security must not use safety language to move protest out of sight, collect excessive data on dissenters, retaliate against critics, or create chilling fear. Protester complaint routes should exist because security power is itself a source of possible harm.

Safety boundaries should be written in verbs, not identities. A person becomes restricted because they threaten, stalk, dox, dangerously obstruct essential access, breach protected domains, or wrongfully expose others, not because they belong to a disfavored group or hold a hostile view.

Safety boundaries should also distinguish individual conduct from group blame. A harmful act by one protester should not automatically narrow the rights of all protesters. Collective restriction requires its own justification.

Safety boundaries around dissent should be content-neutral to the greatest lawful extent. A protest that praises the City should not receive easier access than a protest that condemns it. A friendly crowd can still endanger families, staff, visitors, and records. A hostile crowd can still be peaceful.

Boundary enforcement should be documented carefully because protest conflict creates high-risk public memory. If people are moved, denied, restrained, dispersed, protected, or separated, the public will need later explanation. That explanation should include the specific conduct risk, the least burdensome intervention considered, and any remedy for wrongful restriction.

12.5.5 — Public Response Route

The City does not need to answer every slogan, rumor, or insult in real time. But it should have a public response route for substantive criticism, especially where critics allege surveillance drift, rights failure, child exposure, staff exploitation, host burden, or record misuse (OHCHR, 2024; United Nations, 1990b).

At intake, classify criticism by topic, urgency, evidence, affected persons, and potential remedy. Route it to immediate safety review, public explanation, external audit, correction, or reasoned rejection as appropriate.

The response should avoid defensive triumph. The better response states what was alleged, what can be confirmed, what is still under review, what protections apply, what cannot be released, and what correction or explanation will follow.

The route should also protect sensitive persons. A criticism involving a child, intimate material, staff complaint, or nonparticipant exposure may require public acknowledgment without detail. The City must not answer public pressure by releasing the very material that should be protected.

The City must respond to reasons, evidence, affected-person accounts, and design failures; the volume of criticism alone cannot determine the response.

The response route should include a visible unresolved category. Some criticisms cannot be answered immediately, and some should not be smoothed away by public-relations prose. Naming an objection as received, under review, disputed, partially accepted, or unresolved is more honest than pretending every public challenge can be resolved by the institution that receives it.

The public response route should publish service standards. Safety allegations may require immediate acknowledgment and protection; rights complaints need a named owner and review clock; complex policy objections may require staged response, sources, and hearing. Different categories need different timelines, but silence should never be the default. If a case moves between offices, the receiving office should inherit the original receipt date and deadline, and the critic should receive a protected transfer notice identifying the new owner and the next expected response without exposing confidential testimony.

An unresolved-objections register should preserve challenges that survive the first answer. Each entry can show the issue, affected group, status, institutional response, dissenting view, next review, and interim safeguard. Submissions about the same failure may be linked, but consolidation must preserve distinct affected-person accounts and must not restart the response clock.

Written, in-person, remote, and accessible routes should reach the same owner, status system, appeal route, and correction history. Equivalent consequence matters more than identical channels for people who cannot travel, speak quickly, use a platform, or risk identification. A periodic case walkthrough should follow one criticism from first receipt to the office permitted to answer it, then to any independent appeal or public correction. It should verify that a change of staff or category does not erase the earlier deadline. The critic receives a usable status even where protected reasons cannot be made public.

12.6 — Media, Documentation, and Narrative Pressure

Media access can deepen accountability when public-role formation is documented without turning private vulnerability into entertainment. Accreditation may organize capacity and safety, but its criteria remain viewpoint-neutral, published, appealable, and no broader than operational need. Context packages carry source, time, status, correction, protected-person handling, and known limits; masking occurs before distribution; reply operates within the same information cycle. Content credentials can trace origin and edits, but provenance alone does not establish truth or fair framing, so verification, proportionality, and correction remain journalistic duties (UN Human Rights Committee, 2011; UNESCO, 2018; Society of Professional Journalists, 2014; C2PA, 2026).

12.6.1 — Media Purpose Rules

Documentation changes the scene it records. Participants may perform, staff may become guarded, visitors may hunt for clips, and protesters may escalate for visibility. Media plans should therefore define camera windows, routine no-performance periods, protected routes, remote access, rotation, pooling where appropriate, and review of behavioral effects. The aim is sustained public understanding of formation over time, not a constant demand that ordinary work become theater.

Media access begins from public interest, not institutional comfort. Reporting on record governance, access denials, protest, failure, staff burden, host-community effects, or public-power formation may be damaging to the City's reputation and still be legitimate. A rule becomes suspect when it shields embarrassment rather than people. Protection must be tied to wrongful exposure, safety, privilege, and other defined

harms (UNESCO, 2018; Society of Professional Journalists, 2014).

The rule also distinguishes gathering from publishing. A journalist may observe a space, interview an authorized person, inspect a public bundle, or request access under a purpose statement without gaining permission to release protected raw material, expose nonparticipants, misstate record status, or turn a restricted encounter into public spectacle.

Media governance must distinguish education, investigation, public accountability, public-interest documentary work, routine reporting, emergency reporting, and promotional material. Each creates different risks. Investigative access is necessary, but it still operates within protected-domain limits.

Favorable coverage can never be the price of entry. The institution may enforce child protection, masking, lawful privilege, safety, and role boundaries, but it may not condition access on promotional tone or suppress criticism through future invitation. A critical account may be legitimate; wrongful exposure remains wrongful even when packaged as criticism.

The same rules apply to City-produced media. Official videos, photographs, diagrams, tours, captions, public summaries, and social posts can expose nonparticipants, romanticize breakdown, erase staff labor, or present disputed material as settled. An internal communications team should not receive permissions denied to an independent newsroom. Institutional authorship increases, rather than reduces, the duty to correct.

The rules should be written before high-profile controversy. Predrafted purpose rules give journalists, participants, staff, and the public a known framework for access, limits, correction, and refusal, reducing the temptation to negotiate dignity under pressure.

Media access should be organized through a purpose-and-format packet rather than prestige or favorable coverage. The packet states the reporting purpose, requested spaces and records, recording methods, protected categories, masking duties, interview consent, pool arrangements where capacity is limited, correction contact, publication timetable where volunteered, emergency limits, and remedy for misuse. Independent, local, nonprofit, freelance, international, and critical journalists should face the same functional rules. Access can be narrower for a camera crew than for a document review without making either outlet more legitimate (UN Human Rights Committee, 2020; UNESCO, 2023; Society of Professional Journalists, 2014).

12.6.2 — Anti-Spectacle Limits

Spectacle begins when the public is invited to watch the difficulty of others for emotional stimulation rather than civic understanding. It can appear as humiliation, intimacy, breakdown, conflict, dramatic crying, romantic tension, family exposure, staff confrontation, or public shaming framed as transparency.

Apply anti-spectacle limits equally to favorable and hostile portrayals, using the anti-myth tests in Section 10.1.5.

Certain categories require presumptive limits and explicit review triggers: children, intimacy, clinical care, crisis, breakdown, family conflict, staff vulnerability, protected nonvisibility, and nonparticipant exposure. The rules should specify when documentation is prohibited, when masking or delay is required, and who may authorize an exception.

Before release, ask whether the same relevance standard would apply to someone who was not charismatic, infamous, attractive, vulnerable, disliked, or politically useful. Then test whether each

dramatic or intimate element supplies necessary evidence of the public-power issue, or whether a less exposing form preserves its meaning. Material selected chiefly for shock, humiliation, intimacy, or audience appetite fails the civic-relevance test.

Add non-filmed alternatives and refusal paths to the camera zones, time limits, and context briefings used to reduce performance pressure.

Anti-spectacle limits should apply to internal audiences too. Participants, staff, donors, visitors, and supporters can turn the City into a drama even without television cameras. Public tours, conference panels, social posts, recruitment materials, and ceremonial events should avoid making visible burden look glamorous, holy, punitive, heroic, or entertaining.

12.6.3 — Context Requirements

Context requirements protect public judgment from fragments that look self-explanatory. A clip of anger, hesitation, apology, refusal, security presence, protected-room entry, or protest interaction may carry very different meaning depending on role, sequence, simulation status, record status, prior event, and later correction. The released artifact should supply the minimum context needed to prevent the most foreseeable false inference without becoming an official command about what the audience must conclude.

Use the applicable labels for access class, record status, release status, protected summary, staged simulation, public interface window, protest setting, emergency exception, delayed release, disputed record, correction history, and nonparticipant masking. Acknowledge protected categories only where lawful and safe under Section 11.3.1.

No defensible implementation can guarantee that every outside actor will preserve context. It can control its own releases, access

agreements, record-site labels, correction logs, and public education. It can also call out context-stripping when it creates harm.

For City-controlled reposts, attach a durable short status and date, full explanation, authoritative source link, context caption or transcript, and correction and response route. Watermarked status notes may help where appropriate, but must not be the only safeguard when an excerpt circulates.

Uncertainty labels should also identify pending legal review or an affected person's reply that has not yet arrived.

12.6.4 — Nonparticipant Masking in Media

Nonparticipant masking protects people who appear near the City without accepting its burden. A visitor in a hallway, a child near a family boundary, a staff member off duty, a protester in a crowd, a professional helper, a local resident, or an incidental bystander may be captured by media or institutional documentation.

Masking may involve blurring faces, removing names, masking identifying details, limiting location data, delaying release, using protected summaries, excluding audio, or restricting publication. The method should match the risk. A child requires stronger protection than an adult visitor who agreed to be interviewed. A clinician requires different protection from a public official at a scheduled interface.

Nonparticipant masking must be built into capture protocols, not added only after harm occurs. Camera angles, visitor routes, media zones, signage, consent notices, and release review should all reduce accidental exposure.

Masking also protects critics. A person visiting to oppose the City should not automatically become public material. Public dissent may be visible, but individual identification should be

handled with care, especially where exposure could lead to harassment, job loss, family harm, or doxxing. The City must not use media access to intimidate critics.

Masking is honest only when it protects collateral people without concealing relevant public-power conduct. Privacy language cannot hide staff misconduct, institutional failure, or official action that the public has a lawful reason to understand. Review separates the identity and intimate detail of the nonparticipant from the conduct, authority, and consequence that make the event publicly relevant.

Inference review should also test badge shapes, vehicle plates, hallway sequences, school references, and local landmarks that can make a masked person identifiable.

Nonparticipant masking must assume that identifiability changes over time. A blurred face, altered voice, removed name, or cropped background may be enough today and insufficient tomorrow when combined with location clues, social media, school schedules, protest footage, or public comments. Masking should be risk-reviewed rather than treated as a single technical operation.

If a partner, child, staff member, protester, or bystander is identified despite masking, apply the wrongful-exposure remedies in Section 9.4.5 and review the release practice that failed. The releasing institution carries the initial duty to respond.

12.6.5 — Media Right of Reply

Narrative pressure is unavoidable because supporters, opponents, journalists, political actors, donors, staff, participants, former participants, hosts, and online communities will describe the City from different positions. The institution should not seek control over those accounts. It should govern the

parts it actually owns: access terms, documentation rules, status and context packages, nonparticipant masking, correction, right of reply, and equal treatment of favorable and adverse reporting.

Media and public artifacts can injure long before correction catches up. Participants, staff, nonparticipants, critics, and host-community residents therefore need a route to answer materially false, misleading, incomplete, or context-stripped material. The route should attach to the object, preserve evidence of the claim, and distinguish correction from disagreement. Public reach increases the urgency of repair (C2PA, 2026; Kovach and Rosenstiel, 2021).

Reply does not confer a power to suppress criticism. It adds relevant contestation to the public record when identity, role, fact, exposure, or context is disputed. A participant may challenge interpretation, a nonparticipant may correct exposure, a staff member may clarify responsibility, and a critic may answer institutional description. The audience remains free to judge the record and the response.

The reply process should distinguish factual correction, contextual statement, affected-person objection, participant response, staff response, and institutional response. Not all replies have equal status. A factual error should be corrected. A contested interpretation may be labeled. A protected matter may require summary rather than raw reply.

Official artifacts must be subject to the same reply route. If a City video, diagram, bundle, tour narrative, or public summary misstates a person's role or exposure, correction cannot depend on the goodwill of the communications team that created it. The institution should record the request, decide under a clock, and propagate the result across every official derivative.

People with the least leverage may need reply most. Staff, visitors, protesters, household members, affected professionals,

host-community residents, and other nonparticipants may lack the platform available to a public participant. A plain-language, time-bounded route should offer a protected contact method, translation, disability access, representative assistance, and anti-retaliation safeguards. A named office should carry the administrative burden; a lawyer, publicist, or insider connection should not be a condition of use.

Where continued display is lawful and safe, the public record should hold both the original claim and the reply, with their relationship clear.

Apply the source-update, correction-history, syndication-notice, and stable-notice duties in Section 10.4.3 to corrected City-issued bundles, captions, clips, transcripts, and machine summaries. The City cannot compel independent outlets to revise lawful reporting. Correction records should name which derivatives were checked and which could not be reached, so propagation limits remain visible.

Machine-generated clips and summaries require the same context discipline as human reporting. A transcription tool may omit uncertainty, a search system may surface an obsolete version, or an automated excerpt may detach a sentence from its status label. The reply route should accept challenges to automated presentation, identify the source and system involved, preserve the original output for audit, and correct both the public artifact and the process that generated it (C2PA, 2026; NIST, 2023a). Distinguish isolated output errors from recurring system conditions; for recurring errors, review the prompt, retrieval and source-selection rules, model configuration, workflow, and vendor governance.

12.7 — Openness Without Boundary Collapse

Small exceptions can combine into an ungoverned regime even when no single entry looks like a major breach. A permissions ledger should record the purpose, beneficiary, burden carrier, expiry, and review of each opening, and test their cumulative effects.

12.7.1 — Everyday Access and Protected Spaces

The burden-report path must accept reports of traffic, noise, prestige effects, policing spillover, media congestion, staff treatment, disability barriers, host-community resentment, and public confusion.

Apply the anti-conversion safeguards in Sections 9.2 and 11.2 when official activity enters protected spaces: interface charters, lawful occurrence records, anomaly review, affected-person complaint, and a return to ordinary role-record handling. This does not require recording private encounters or disclosing their existence.

The underlying rights to bodily and family dignity do not expire when a review clock matures. Particular shielding, access, and release decisions follow the category-specific time review in Section 11.5.4; a review date does not itself authorize disclosure.

Badges, passes, routes, escort rules, and digital credentials must communicate the authorized purpose and access limit without visual hierarchies of importance.

For controlled access, the operational test should identify the authorized role, purpose, zone, time, record conditions, and reviewer, together with the person's identity where that is necessary for the permission. Missing authority should trigger narrowing, escalation, or refusal proportionate to the risk. Ordinary public access should not require unnecessary identification. Emergency assistance should proceed promptly

under the emergency protocol, with the minimum necessary record completed or reconstructed afterward.

12.7.2 — Public Communication in Practice

When public-interest material requires urgent release, name urgency as a release condition and retain masking, context, reply, and harm review.

Rehearsals using clips, photographs, visitor accounts, protests, or leaks expose missing labels, unclear authority, weak masking, slow replies, and artifact vulnerabilities before real people carry the cost.

12.7.3 — Learning from Boundary Review

Review access denials, visitor complaints, protest incidents, media disputes, nonparticipant exposure, staff safety, security escalation, expert and vendor entry, emergency pathways, release decisions and protected-domain classifications. Record which access class or operating practice changes in response.

Review includes those affected by the boundary. Staff, participants, visitors, critics, media representatives, host-community members, disability reviewers, child-safety experts, privacy reviewers, and security reviewers may see different burdens.

Public summaries should show that boundary review occurs and what categories of correction follow, without exposing protected persons or security vulnerabilities. The public needs enough information to judge whether the City is using its boundary to protect people or to avoid scrutiny.

Include a public-facing burden map for the review period, using the categories above and identifying staff load, visitor confusion, household spillover, and access conflicts.

Part IV — Entry, Vow, and Anti-Capture

The doorway is the City's first civic institution. Before there is a resident, role pathway, covenant, public record, or office interface, there is a person deciding whether to approach. That person is not institutional proof or public material. They remain a private human being whose freedom, circumstances, and ordinary dignity set the standard for everything that follows.

Applicants make an imagined institution feel real, which is exactly why the doorway attracts pressure. Donors may want momentum, journalists may want the first recognizable name, parties may want affiliation, and supporters may want a story that proves history has begun. The harder question is who carries the cost when an applicant becomes useful to others before the applicant is safe inside the process. Public-integrity systems repeatedly reveal a gap between rules on paper and implementation in practice; the threshold therefore needs monitoring, verification, and a protected route for exposing failure before institutional enthusiasm can bury it (OECD, 2003; OECD, 2026c).

Screening translates a human choice into a bounded institutional decision. It addresses support, safety, lawful eligibility, humane fit, and capture risk rather than searching for superior people. The gate asks whether an adult applicant can enter a defined pathway under stated conditions, what the City owes before entry, and which later decisions remain with law, voters, appointing bodies, or operating institutions.

Covenant and stabilization give consent a material foundation. Debt pressure, housing insecurity, health-care precarity, dependent-care fear, gifts, sponsorship, donor access, and private rescue can steer visible service from outside the record. Support becomes anti-corruption infrastructure when it enlarges refusal capacity while remaining independent of loyalty, silence, testimony, political allegiance, or continued participation.

Pause, reconsideration, refusal, and return keep consent alive after the first signature. Health, family duties, security conditions, finances, comprehension, and institutional readiness can all change. A fair threshold can answer not yet, not this way, not under this load, or not at all, while preserving privacy, continuity, and an ordinary life beyond the application.

This sequence keeps entry subject to choice rather than treating applicants as a recruitment pipeline. *The Life of Fairness* protects ordinary private life as complete life. *The Constitution of Fairness* owns model legal architecture for lawful visibility and remedy. *The Government of Fairness* owns operating public administration. *The City of Fairness* owns only the bounded threshold for voluntary adult public-power formation, so it cannot stretch backward into childhood, family pressure, party grooming, donor expectation, movement belonging, or public curiosity.

Part IV supplies the institutional grammar that any later admissions design must make concrete. Purpose limitation, separate decision lanes, observable evidence, accommodation, qualified human judgment, explanation, appeal, expiry, refusal, and remedy define the minimum architecture. Jurisdiction-specific law, clinical practice, security procedure, public-input design, and office eligibility remain with their lawful and professional owners. This Part gives those specialists a coherent threshold to test rather than pretending to replace their authority.

Chapter 13 — Who Applies and Why

The first hypothetical applicant is enthusiastic. She has spent years organizing local heat-response work and wants deeper preparation for consequential public responsibility, but she also supports an aging parent and cannot move on a heroic timetable. A fair process can receive her ambition without treating caregiving as a defect or enthusiasm as consent to every later burden.

The second applicant is skeptical. He wants to inspect the Vow, the privacy rules, the support terms, and the exit route before revealing a public biography. His hesitation is not evidence of disloyalty. It is a test of whether the institution can answer hard questions without converting inquiry into suspicion or publicity.

The third applicant decides not to proceed. Her work schedule, childcare, and housing make the present burden impractical, even though her interest in public service is serious. A threshold that leaves her with privacy, dignity, and future opportunity has succeeded; a threshold that turns refusal into failure has begun to own the person it claims to invite.

The fourth applicant is redirected. He wants public consequence, but repeated review shows that a local technical, legal, or community role fits his present capacities better than the pathway he first imagined. Redirection is not a lower civic rank. It is the institution admitting that service and office are not identical and that role matching should protect both the applicant and the public (Perry and Wise, 1990; Fox and Lawless, 2014).

The four outcomes reveal one governing question: where does an applicant's desire send burden when it meets reality? Ambition can become durable public capacity or recruit staff, citizens, and records into an image project. Wound can sharpen attention or narrow judgment. Calling can sustain difficult work

or become a private claim of destiny. The threshold follows each motive into conduct, correction, and consequence.

This chapter establishes the threshold's operating logic before specialists translate it into instruments and lawful procedure. Legal eligibility, clinical review, security methods, role-specific assessment, and any public-input mechanism require qualified design and jurisdictional authority. Here the City defines what those processes owe the person: bounded purpose, separate questions, human explanation, contestable evidence, support, privacy, expiry, and a route back to ordinary life. Review authority remains answerable rather than sovereign.

Reading these cases requires two kinds of attention. The applicant offers an account of why public work matters; the reviewer must identify what the available conduct supports, what remains uncertain, and what other explanation could fit. Later sections follow ambition, service, wound, calling, prestige, escape, and fear into correction, staff relationships, and changes of direction. They ask how motives bear on a role without turning a persuasive biography (or an awkward first meeting) into a verdict on the whole person.

The invitation can also shape the behavior being assessed. A process that rewards heroic sacrifice may discourage the applicant with dependents; one that rewards a polished story may train everyone to speak its preferred language. This Chapter therefore follows the threshold from initial interest to voluntary entry and protected refusal, examining the pressures the City itself creates. Chapter 14 supplies the assessment and recruitment procedures needed to test these judgments responsibly, including intended-use validation and fairness review (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; SIOP, 2018).

13.1 — Ambition Under Visibility

The ordinary public sphere often trains ambition under opacity. A future leader learns to manage rooms, please gatekeepers, cultivate donors, survive platforms, polish biography, hide uncertainty, speak in marketable conviction, and avoid correction until correction becomes scandal. By the time formal candidacy begins, ambition has already been shaped by private rewards. The City intervenes earlier by asking ambition to bear visibility before it asks the public to bear trust.

13.1.1 — Ambition as Energy

Ambition is the energy that moves a person toward difficult public work: study, boredom, criticism, decision, and sustained responsibility. Naming ambition openly prevents institutions from disguising status selection as leadership, excellence, or vision and makes its route available for evidence and review.

Ambition as energy should also be separated from extroversion, wealth, credential polish, rhetorical smoothness, and social ease. Some applicants will be quiet, awkward, locally rooted, technically minded, disabled, trauma-shaped, or cautious. They may still carry powerful public ambition. The City should look for direction of energy, capacity for burden, and willingness to be corrected rather than the familiar signals of elite performance.

Ambition is best read along two axes: intensity and object. A seven-decade study of 717 high-ability individuals linked ambition with educational attainment, occupational prestige, and income; those findings do not establish whether a particular ambition is democratically useful or ethically safe, or whether the associations generalize beyond that sample (Judge and Kammeyer-Mueller, 2012). The threshold therefore asks what

the ambition notices, what it is prepared to sacrifice, and whose burden rises when progress stalls.

Public work also tests whether ambition can change form without abandoning purpose. Goals become impossible, unlawful, obsolete, or less important than a newly visible burden. Research on goal adjustment distinguishes rigid persistence from the capacity to disengage from an unattainable aim and reengage with another meaningful one (Wrosch et al., 2003). A mature applicant can release a plan, preserve the record of why it ended, redirect effort, and continue serving people whose needs outlast any single proposal.

Separate evidence of energy from evidence of direction in the applicant file. Work history, civic repair, study discipline, peer reliability, and response to unglamorous tasks may show energy without ranking the person.

13.1.2 — Ambition Under Burden

The applicant’s response to burden reveals more than their declared ideals. Some people become more careful when watched because they understand that the record protects others. Some become theatrical because they feel watched. Some become resentful because they expected the City to confirm their exceptionalism. Some become humble in public but cruel with staff. The City must read changes in pattern rather than trust the first explanation.

Ambition under burden also protects the applicant. It can reveal that the role imagined by the applicant does not match the cost they can carry. That discovery should not be treated as failure. It is better to learn before activation, before campaign reliance, before family rupture, before health collapse, and before public trust is built around a person who cannot live inside the burden.

Accordingly, a fair threshold should offer burden previews before activation and before any irreversible public disclosure. Shadow days, record simulations, deliberation exposure, visitor-pressure scenarios, correction exercises, family consultation, care review, and quiet periods can help applicants understand the demands. Previews should be disclosed, proportionate, protected, and open to refusal or withdrawal. They inform the applicant and identify support needs; a brief exercise should not be treated as proof of future character or capacity.

13.1.3 — Status Hunger

Visibility may reduce opportunities for concealed influence, but beneficial filtering is a hypothesis. The same conditions may reward performance or select for tolerance of exposure. Privacy needs, care duties and communication conditions can also affect who applies or declines; reluctance is not evidence of a wish for private exemption. Test these competing explanations through the comparison and observation procedures in Sections 4.5 and 17.7.1.

Status hunger is not the same as ambition. Ambition seeks to do, build, learn, decide, or serve. Status hunger seeks to be seen as the kind of person who deserves those things. It is a hunger for placement in the eyes of others. Under ordinary politics, status hunger can become nearly invisible because many political systems reward it while pretending to reward service.

Status hunger matters because visibility can discipline it or feed it. An applicant who is comfortable under attention may be carrying burden, or may be using staff, citizens, critics, and the archive as supporting material for a personal mythology. The threshold therefore examines whether scrutiny produces repair and ordinary work or turns correction into martyrdom, humility

into performance, and service into image defense. Confidence is not condemned, but status reward is removed from the gate.

Applicant-facing practice should look for status hunger in small forms, not only grandiose speech. Does the applicant exaggerate sacrifice? Do they name powerful acquaintances unnecessarily? Do they handle ordinary corrections as personal injury? Do they neglect work that is not visible? Do they treat low-status staff with impatience? Do they narrate every difficulty as evidence of exceptional depth?

Status will form even inside an institution that rejects status worship. Research treats status desire as a recurrent human motive distinct from money, power, and belonging (Anderson et al., 2015). Admission, difficult assignments, mentor proximity, archive presence, public attention, and visible sacrifice can all become currencies. Institutional candor therefore requires watching how the City itself distributes admiration and deference instead of assuming that transparency has purified the social field.

Applicants should sometimes perform low-visibility work, share credit, explain dependence on staff, and continue when the audience disappears. Reviewers should observe how they respond when recognition is scarce, without using humiliation or claiming to diagnose character.

Application materials, diagrams, portraits, interviews, and donor briefings must not portray applicants as chosen, elite, sacred, or historically elevated. Such presentation turns admission into the status reward the threshold is supposed to resist. The acceptance standard should remain ordinary, bounded, and role-specific.

13.1.4 — Public-Service Ambition

Visibility imposes a real cost even on honest ambition. An applicant may feel exposed, clumsy, misunderstood, slow, or bereft of familiar control over strategy and reputation. Those reactions are not automatic evidence of unfitness. The useful question is whether the cost produces greater candor, patience, repair, and respect for other people's standing, or whether it produces evasion, blame, and demands for exemption. The City studies the direction of adaptation rather than glorifying discomfort for its own sake.

Public-service ambition is ambition that wants to reduce hidden burden through lawful public consequence. It does not mean the applicant has no ego, no longing, no fear, and no need for recognition. It means the desire for public action remains tethered to the people who will bear the results. The center of gravity is not the applicant’s self-image but the public burden at stake.

This kind of ambition is recognizable by its patience with complexity. A public-service applicant does not need every problem to flatter their preferred solution. They can hold tradeoffs without pretending that one paragraph solves them. They are willing to ask who loses time, who waits in a queue, who carries cost, who is exposed, who is shielded, who can appeal, who is forgotten, and who will repair the damage if the decision fails (McClelland and Burnham, 1976; Hogan and Kaiser, 2005).

Public-service ambition can recognize a useful idea without treating it as a threat to personal significance. It can be ambitious for a public outcome more than for personal authorship.

Public-service ambition becomes safer when it can tolerate limits. The applicant must be able to hear no from the people they hope to help, accept rights and procedure as part of service,

and notice when urgency is being paid for by staff, family, or the body. Service that cannot rest, consult, or be corrected does not reduce burden; it merely hides the people carrying its speed.

13.1.5 — Ambition After Correction

Correction should be logged across five separate fields: what was corrected, how the correction was delivered, how the applicant responded, what repair followed, and whether the pattern recurred. The separation matters because polite reception can coexist with no behavioral change, while an awkward first reaction can be followed by serious repair. Reviewers should judge the observable learning sequence rather than reward emotional smoothness.

Correction capacity depends on an environment in which early truth is possible. Applicants will not seek difficult feedback when uncertainty becomes a permanent stain, staff fear retaliation, or revision is treated as proof of unfitness. Psychological safety research helps explain why learning behavior depends on whether interpersonal risk can be taken without humiliation or punishment (Edmondson, 1999).

13.2 — Service, Wound, Calling, Prestige, Escape, Fear

Applicants rarely arrive with one motive. They arrive carrying histories, hopes, wounds, stories, pressures, and partial self-knowledge. The City would be unsafe if it demanded a single clean reason, and equally unsafe if it treated all reasons as interchangeable. Motive is not a verdict, but motive is a burden signal (Perry, 2000; Kim et al., 2013). The City should help applicants see themselves more truthfully before the public sees them more fully. Biography may explain attention, but it cannot become credential, diagnosis, public entertainment, or substitute for present conduct.

13.2.1 — Service Motive

At the threshold, a declared wish to serve is assessed through conduct: respect for consent and limits, willingness to do ordinary work without expecting gratitude, and recognition of the independent agency of those the applicant hopes to help.

Service, however, is not automatically safe. A person may serve because they need gratitude, because being needed stabilizes identity, because rescue gives them control, or because service lets them avoid their own private difficulty. The motive can be generous and still mixed. The City should not shame that mixture. It should make it visible enough for governance.

13.2.2 — Wound Motive

A wound motive appears when an applicant’s desire for public power is shaped by injury. They may have been betrayed by government, harmed by institutions, ignored by elites, trapped in poverty, humiliated by bureaucracy, failed by healthcare, targeted by violence, or marked by family history. Wound can

become a source of attention because pain often notices burdens that comfort misses.

Institutional injury can also narrow judgment, harden a demand for repayment, or make authority feel like the only available repair. Wound therefore enters the threshold as knowledge, vulnerability, and unfinished possibility at once. The relevant questions are whether the applicant can hear unlike histories, whether public reasoning extends beyond biography, and whether care, support, or time is needed before authority amplifies what remains unresolved.

The wound motive requires clinical and ethical humility. The City is not a therapy substitute, and application is not treatment. An applicant may need care, legal support, community repair, time, or ordinary privacy rather than visible formation. To welcome a wounded person too quickly can exploit their pain. To exclude them automatically can compound the injury. The threshold must be careful enough to hold both risks.

Wound also interacts with narrative pressure. Media, donors, movements, and supporters may prefer wounded applicants because their stories are compelling. The City must refuse to use biography as recruitment material. Applicant privacy protects wounded persons from being turned into proof that the City is humane, revolutionary, or emotionally powerful (Mackenzie and Stoljar, 2000; Manson and O’Neill, 2007).

The fairest handling of wound is neither exposure nor concealment. The City should create protected review settings where history can be named as much as needed for support and fit, kept private where possible, and never converted into public credential unless lawful, voluntary, and relevant after acceptance.

Adversity has no single honorable trajectory. Some people experience durable distress, some recover gradually, some show

resilient functioning, and some report growth that coexists with pain. Reviews of resilience and posttraumatic growth caution against treating one pattern as universal or morally superior (Bonanno, 2004; Tedeschi and Calhoun, 2004). The threshold neither presumes instability nor demands a redemptive story. It asks what present support and boundary allow the person to choose freely now.

Wound-informed expertise becomes strongest when biography is joined to comparison. A person harmed by a housing system may notice administrative cruelty others overlook, but their experience cannot by itself establish the best housing policy, represent every affected group, or predict the consequences of a remedy. The City should help applicants move from singular experience to triangulated public understanding through data, law, comparative cases, affected-person testimony, frontline knowledge, and contrary evidence. This process honors the wound without turning it into a monopoly on truth. It also protects the applicant from being trapped forever in the role of survivor, witness, or symbolic representative when their civic capacities are wider than the event that first awakened them.

Motive review should not require applicants to narrate the same painful history repeatedly.

13.2.3 — Calling Motive

A calling motive appears when an applicant experiences public service as vocation. They may feel drawn by conscience, faith, civic responsibility, historical moment, personal gift, community need, or a sense that their life has prepared them for a task. The City should make room for serious vocation because some burdens require more than career planning. They require durable commitment.

Calling becomes dangerous when it resists correction. A person who believes they are destined for a role may hear review as obstruction, criticism as persecution, delay as betrayal, and refusal as proof that others lack vision. The City must distinguish vocation that can kneel before evidence from destiny language that creates private sovereignty.

The entry process must also protect applicants from communities that impose calling on them. Families, religious leaders, political groups, donors, or activists may tell a person they have a destiny. That pressure can feel holy, necessary, or historic while still being coercive. Freedom from coercion includes freedom from being assigned significance by those who want the applicant to carry their hopes.

Calling should be translated into public terms before it can guide a role path. The applicant may privately use sacred, historical, or vocational language, but the City must ask what lawful burden the calling would carry, what limits it accepts, what evidence could redirect it, and what refusal would mean. Untranslated calling becomes unreviewable authority.

A calling can sustain work that ordinary incentives cannot. It can give coherence to sacrifice, perseverance, and service across long periods of uncertainty. Yet research on deeply meaningful work also shows the double edge: workers who experience a calling may accept lower pay, longer hours, greater discomfort, and stronger moral obligation while holding the institution to demanding standards (Bunderson and Thompson, 2009). The City should treat this pattern as both resource and vulnerability. A person who calls the work sacred, destined, or inseparable from identity may be unusually persistent, but also unusually easy to exploit and unusually reluctant to leave when the institution becomes harmful.

For that reason, the threshold should ask whether the calling can survive plural expression. Can the applicant serve the same public purpose outside the City, in another role, after delay, or without recognition? Can they distinguish devotion to a burden from loyalty to one institution? Can they rest without interpreting rest as betrayal? A calling that has only one authorized vessel gives that vessel excessive power. The City should widen the applicant's map of meaningful contribution before asking for a Vow. The aim is not to extinguish vocation. It is to prevent vocation from becoming the lever by which a person consents to conditions they would reject if the work mattered less.

13.2.4 — Prestige Motive

Prestige motive appears when an applicant wants the honor, distinction, influence, admiration, access, or symbolic elevation associated with the City. This motive is dangerous when hidden, but it is not unusual. Most public systems carry prestige. To pretend otherwise makes prestige more powerful because it moves underground.

Prestige is not disqualifying merely because recognition matters to the applicant.

Use the low-visibility work and shared-credit observations in Section 13.1.3, including learning settings where the applicant is not the most impressive person.

Scarcity can turn admission itself into a prestige signal. The answer is not to deny that effect but to design against it through dignified explanations, reviewable outcomes, restrained recognition, and equal respect for delay, redirection, and refusal. Acceptance begins a burden; it does not certify virtue or superiority.

A good operational audit would ask which parts of the application process generate unnecessary prestige: special invitations, public lists, elite references, dramatic ceremonies, rare access, donor attention, or media interest. Each prestige source should be justified by public purpose or removed.

13.2.5 — Escape Motive

Escape motive appears when an applicant seeks the City as a way out of another life. They may want to escape debt, family pressure, career failure, public disgrace, loneliness, unsafe conditions, ideological disillusionment, stalled ambition, or ordinary confusion. The City must handle this motive with special care because severe institutions often attract people who need shelter.

Escape is not always illegitimate. A person may honestly need a new path. They may be trapped in a profession that deforms them, a network that pressures them, a private economy that captures their choices, or a local environment where service has become impossible. Public formation can be a real calling after escape from a corrupt or exhausted setting.

The entry process first asks what the applicant needs, then whether civic formation is the right response. Housing, legal aid, debt counseling, clinical care, domestic safety planning, employment help, community repair, and private-life support often belong in ordinary service systems rather than an admissions pathway. Meeting urgent need before assessing entry protects the applicant from mistaking crisis relief for consent.

Escape motive also raises donor and party risks. A person trying to leave one dependency may be vulnerable to another. If entry offers material stabilization, public attention, housing, healthcare, or status, the applicant may feel unable to refuse. The stabilization architecture is meant to prevent support from

becoming ownership, but the vulnerability must be recognized before any support relationship begins.

A healthy escape motive can become public service when the applicant has enough ground beneath them to choose rather than flee. The City should slow the process, test alternatives, protect privacy, and ask whether the applicant would still want the role if another safe path were available. That question reveals whether the City is destination or emergency exit.

13.2.6 — Fear Motive

Fear motive appears when an applicant seeks the City because the world feels dangerous, unstable, corrupt, or impossible to trust. They may fear institutional collapse, violence, climate harm, authoritarianism, humiliation, poverty, technological domination, public disorder, or personal vulnerability. Fear can awaken responsibility, but it can also make power feel like the only shelter.

Fear becomes dangerous when it seeks control as relief. A fearful applicant may want authority to reduce uncertainty, silence opposition, force order, punish perceived threats, or build a world where they never feel helpless again. The City must distinguish courage under fear from power-seeking as anxiety management.

Fear can also make coercion harder to detect. A family, party, movement, religious group, donor, or online community may tell the applicant that entry is necessary because catastrophe is near. Crisis rhetoric can compress choice. The applicant may feel that refusal would betray history, community, or future generations. The City must protect consent from emergency imagination.

Fear also affects the body. Hypervigilance, sleep loss, threat scanning, and emotional exhaustion can distort judgment. The City should not pathologize fear, but it must ask whether fear has

become the applicant's main decision engine. Clinical and support review belongs later, but motive literacy begins here. Review should distinguish persistent threat arousal from a temporary response to conditions that can be changed by rest, safety, or reliable information.

Fear should be examined for proportionality and pluralism. Can the applicant distinguish danger from disagreement, urgency from permission, and public order from personal relief? The concern is not that fear exists, but that it may become an interpretive monopoly in which every obstacle appears as threat and every critic as saboteur. Scenario work can test whether the applicant can revise a threat judgment after credible contrary evidence arrives.

Ask whether fear eases when information, care, and procedural clarity arrive. If it remains the governing engine, slow or redirect. Fear need not disqualify a person, but it cannot author the role. A later return to the pathway should document what changed rather than treat delay itself as a defect.

13.3 — Desired and Dangerous Traits, Mixed Motives

Self-description alone cannot govern the threshold. Applicants may misunderstand themselves, and polished candidates may know which motives sound acceptable. What the City needs is conduct-and-burden literacy: a disciplined ability to compare stated purpose with observable action across contexts, without converting patterns into worth scores or personality destiny (Fleeson and Jayawickreme, 2015; Mischel and Shoda, 1995). Public-risk language should be attached to observable conduct and a declared decision.

13.3.1 — Correction Capacity

Serious conclusions require more than one context. An applicant who receives correction gracefully in a formal interview but retaliates during ordinary work has not shown stable correction capacity. Context is evidence, not noise.

Correction capacity is the ability to consider criticism or redirection, distinguish valid correction from error or abuse, and make a proportionate repair when warranted. It is not meekness or passive agreement. Distress, an awkward first response, or a needed pause does not by itself establish incapacity. Assessment should follow the person's conduct over a fair period, with appropriate support, rather than reward a polished display of calm.

Correction must be tested across power differences. It is easier to accept correction from prestigious experts than from a junior staff member, local resident, service worker, critic, or peer. Correction capacity matters most when the correcting person does not increase the applicant’s status. Staff dignity and correction capacity often reveal each other.

Correction capacity should be examined through comparable opportunities to revise, not a memorable apology. In a declared

fictional task, reviewers can record the objection received, the relevant evidence, the participant's response, and whether a warranted change survives a later task. They distinguish an unsupported refusal from a reasoned challenge to faulty criticism. Independent reviewers first record their own assessments, then explain disagreement by reference to the task rather than the participant's demeanor. These observations support a bounded learning judgment; the following validity review determines whether that use is justified.

Correction capacity is a City design construct, not a validated personality trait. Its rubric should distinguish factual, moral, procedural, interpersonal, and public correction, then test each category through multiple observations and opportunities for explanation. A person may handle one form well and another poorly, so no single interview moment can justify a global label. Before the rubric is used for consequential decisions, its intended use, reliability, validity, subgroup effects, and error costs require independent review (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; SIOP, 2018).

Correction capacity includes seeking feedback before failure, not only responding once it arrives. Feedback-seeking research examines informational value, ego, image and effort costs, and the social conditions that make asking possible (Anseel et al., 2015). The City's rubric should record whether an applicant asks what evidence would change a view, invites staff to identify foreseeable burden, checks affected people's understanding, requests review before public commitments harden, names who can interrupt them, and returns to people whose earlier warning proved accurate. These are concrete civic acts, not personality labels.

A warranted challenge may produce contrary evidence, protect a third party, or appeal an unfair process. Assess whether

disagreement remains reasoned, documented, proportionate, and open to revision.

Correction capacity also needs accessibility awareness. Neurodivergence, trauma, language difference, culture, disability, and class experience may shape how correction is received and expressed. The fair question is not whether the applicant performs the culturally preferred response, but whether they can use correction to reduce future burden.

13.3.2 — Staff Dignity Signal

The rubric also records what the institution contributed. Confusing instructions, inaccessible settings, biased review, unreasonable schedules, public humiliation, or inconsistent support can produce the behavior later attributed to the applicant. Fair review asks what changed after the City repaired its own conditions before concluding what the person could not carry.

The staff dignity signal asks how the applicant treats people who support, clean, schedule, protect, counsel, record, transport, maintain, review, and administer the institution. Public power often reveals itself in downward behavior. A person may speak beautifully to the public and treat staff as invisible burden carriers. The City must not miss that signal.

Staff have their own rights, limits, fatigue, privacy, and dignity; the assessment must not turn their work into a prop for an applicant.

Staff dignity can be tested through ordinary friction. Does the applicant respect schedules? Do they demand exceptions through charm? Do they become impatient when a process protects someone else? Do they ask who will do the labor their idea requires? Do they clean up after themselves, answer messages responsibly, accept waiting, and notice invisible work?

Compare the applicant’s conduct toward senior reviewers and influential visitors with their treatment of service and support staff. Treat deference upward paired with domination downward as a serious warning.

Staff treatment is not a minor etiquette proxy. Research with public-sector employees has linked workplace incivility to reduced satisfaction and psychological well-being, and it shows how low-intensity disrespect can become pervasive while remaining easy for powerful people to dismiss (Cortina et al., 2001). The City's interest is therefore practical. An applicant who interrupts, belittles, bypasses, pressures, or appropriates credit may be creating hidden workload and fear before formal authority begins. Repeated conduct toward coordinators, cleaners, drivers, translators, technical workers, assistants, and care staff can reveal whether the applicant experiences other people as collaborators, obstacles, servants, or scenery.

The signal must still be governed by fair process. One tense interaction should not become a secret character verdict, and staff should not be turned into informal surveillance agents. Reports need protected channels, behavioral specificity, context, opportunity for response, attention to hierarchy, and review for bias. The applicant should know the standard in advance. The value of the signal comes from patterns and repair: whether burdens recur across roles, whether the applicant changes after feedback, whether lower-status workers can speak without retaliation, and whether the City itself created unreasonable conditions.

Behavioral specificity protects staff and applicant, but it does not eliminate interpretive bias. Directness, eye contact, emotional restraint, speed, deference, humor, and comfort with hierarchy vary across culture, disability, neurotype, trauma, class, and language. Reviewers should separate

burden-producing conduct from unfamiliar style, offer the applicant a chance to explain context, and ask whether the institution created the friction. The standard is whether staff were burdened, pressured, bypassed, or denied repair, not whether the applicant performed a preferred etiquette (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; EEOC, 2007).

13.3.3 — Status-Centered Drift

Status-centered drift names a pattern in which the applicant's relationship to the City bends increasingly toward self-display, specialness, admiration, grievance, or narrative control. It is called drift because it may develop gradually. An applicant may begin with sincere service and slowly learn to use visibility as proof of exceptional importance.

The term must be used carefully. The City should not diagnose applicants casually, and it should not use psychological language as a weapon. Status-centered drift is not a public insult. It is a review category for patterns that shift burden from public purpose to personal image. Expert input and due process are necessary whenever clinical or psychological interpretation becomes relevant.

Track whether the status-seeking behaviors described in Section 13.1.3 increase over time or begin to govern assignments, credit, correction, and narrative control. No single observation establishes unfitness.

A fair response to early drift is not immediate condemnation. It may be coaching, de-loading, altered role path, private warning, reflection, or delay. Review should ask whether the applicant changes the pattern after support or continues to reject the role's duties. The City should support correction while responding firmly to persistent refusal of those duties.

The archive must not feed status-centered drift. Metrics, summaries, follower counts, media clips, praise bundles, and reputation dashboards should not become status nutrition. Feedback belongs to burden, correction, and public consequence, not personal fascination. This follows from evidence that external rewards can displace more autonomous reasons for service (Anderson et al., 2015; Deci and Ryan, 2000).

13.3.4 — Manipulation Risk

Manipulation risk arises when an applicant performs the signals the City rewards while evading the duties those signals are meant to indicate. A City built around transparency, correction, service, humility, and burden awareness will attract applicants who can speak that language fluently. The question is whether their conduct bears it out.

Manipulation risk is not the same as intelligence, persuasion, political skill, or social strategy. Public service requires communication. The risk appears when communication becomes concealment, when self-disclosure is staged to win trust, when correction is performed to end scrutiny, or when the applicant studies safeguards mainly to evade them.

Manipulation risk also includes outside coaching. Parties, donors, families, consultants, social movements, or online communities may prepare applicants to pass the City's threshold for strategic reasons. The applicant may become a carrier of hidden agendas without understanding the full capture risk. The City must ask who has shaped the application before the applicant arrived.

Making immediate rewards modest and duties real can be one useful filter against applicants seeking only rank, fame, or comfort, but it cannot carry the selection burden by itself. A

skilled performer may endure heavy duties for later influence, while a capable applicant may decline because of privacy, care, disability, or family costs.

Manipulation, retaliation, rule evasion, deception, image defense, concealed obligation, or misuse of access can justify review when evidence and consequence are specified. Casual diagnostic labels add heat without improving judgment. Reviewers should instead record response to criticism, treatment of staff, truth under incentive, consistency across audiences, relationship to rules, use of special access, and willingness to let records correct self-narration.

13.3.5 — Mixed-Motive Interpretation

The operative object is an observable-burden application rubric. It contains eight fields: the burden claimed; the conduct observed; the people affected; the burden shifted; the context and institutional contribution; support or accommodation tried; prohibited inference and remaining uncertainty; and the review, expiry, correction, and appeal route.

Each entry distinguishes observation from inference. 'Interrupted a staff member four times after being asked to stop' is an observation. 'Lacks empathy' is a broad interpretation that exceeds the evidence unless a qualified, role-relevant process supports it. The same discipline applies to flattering labels such as natural leader or unusually resilient (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; Gilliland, 1993).

No column is summed into a total. The output is a reasoned, pathway-specific narrative, not a portable reputation number or secret trust index.

The rubric can support delay, a different pathway, more support, a narrower burden, or refusal for a stated reason. It cannot identify the applicant in total, determine who deserves

dignity, confer eligibility, predict officeholding, or decide how citizens should vote. Its authority ends with the bounded formation decision it was created to inform.

Applicants may seek service and prestige, repair and authority, belonging and sacrifice, vocation and escape. The file can identify a motive, how it intensified under a defined pressure, or how a boundary reduced its risk; an early conversation cannot establish the person's final truth.

Protected reflection may ask what attracts the applicant, what they hope the City will give them, what image of themselves is involved, what they fear losing, and which burdens they may try to avoid. The applicant's answer is evidence about stated meaning at that moment, not a confession of hidden essence. The purpose is clearer consent and safer formation, not emotional extraction or a performance of moral purity.

Reviewers should distinguish motive from capacity. A person may have an imperfect motive and strong correction capacity. Another may have a noble motive and poor load tolerance. Another may be safe for local public-service formation but not for high executive burden. Mixed-motive interpretation supports role pathway matching rather than binary acceptance.

Apply the observable-burden rubric in Section 13.3 to each relevant motive, including the support or boundary that could change its effect and the evidence that would revise the interpretation (Gilliland, 1993; Colquitt et al., 2001).

Consider an applicant who interrupts a service worker, apologizes, changes turn-taking, and invites renewed correction. Reviewers may see entitlement, stress, or repair. The record preserves conduct, conditions, interpretation, and correction; its conclusion concerns the pathway, not identity.

Interpretations expire unless later evidence renews them. An interview, simulation, or stressful week cannot establish a

permanent trait. Record review dates, contrary evidence, and any institutional contribution.

13.4 — Why Perfect Motives Are Not Required

Perfect motives cannot be an admissions requirement. Human complexity is the condition under which public institutions operate (Fleeson and Jayawickreme, 2015; Mischel and Shoda, 1995). Because motives cannot be verified directly, a purity test risks rewarding class fluency, emotional style, ideological fit, or reviewer preference. The relevant admissions test is whether someone can explain decisions, accept challenge, and repair a mistake despite mixed motives.

13.4.1 — Purity Theater Risk

Purity theater is the performance of a morally acceptable self in which fluency in service, humility, burden, community, care, and sacrifice is mistaken for formation.

Purity theater shifts burden onto honest applicants. A person who admits vanity, fear, status desire, unresolved wound, family pressure, or uncertainty may appear less ready than a person who conceals the same things behind polished service language. The process then punishes truth and rewards image management. That is a direct violation of the City's own purpose.

Reviewers also need training against purity preference. Many people are drawn to applicants who resemble their moral ideal. They may prefer the calm voice, the elite service resume, the trauma story told with restraint, the spiritual vocation, or the self-effacing reformer. The City must ask whether those preferences are evidence-based or merely aesthetic.

13.4.2 — Human Complexity

Complexity does not mean anything goes. It means evaluation must be precise enough to ask which complexity matters for which burden. A fear that can be supported may not block entry. A status desire that can be acknowledged may be manageable. A

wound that needs care may require delay. A manipulative pattern may require refusal. Complexity increases the need for disciplined review rather than eliminating judgment.

Human complexity includes unequal starting positions. Financial reserves, disability, family responsibilities, language, education, and legal circumstances can change what an applicant can undertake. Concern about a livelihood is not evidence of indifference to public service. In a randomized recruitment study for public-sector positions in Mexico, higher advertised wages attracted applicants with higher measured ability, without evidence of worse measured public-service motivation (Dal Bó, Finan, and Rossi, 2013). That result concerns recruitment in the studied setting; it does not make an ability test a City admissions rule or establish that higher pay produces integrity.

For the City, the constructive question is whether declared support lets capable people consider participation without requiring unusual private reserves. Evaluate the accessibility of the offered pathway and the applicant's task-relevant evidence, rather than treating willingness to sacrifice essentials as a credential. Keep changes in who applies distinct from learning after entry. A fair threshold can welcome public commitment and ordinary material needs together while retaining clear role standards and independent support.

13.4.3 — Formation Over First Impression

Formation over first impression means judging how a person learns under defined responsibilities, not simply how they appear at the doorway. First impressions can favor polish, social confidence, class familiarity, and emotional control. Public responsibility requires the ability to revise judgment and practice in light of evidence.

Threshold governance must design actual formative intervals, not merely claim to value them. There should be protected learning windows, reflection tasks, role exposure, moderated contact, support review, and chances to revise.

The principle has limits. Some risks cannot be postponed into formation. Clear coercion, serious deception, hostile capture, active danger, or inability to consent may require refusal or delay before any formative process. Formation is not an excuse to expose staff or participants to avoidable harm.

The design implication is to prefer evidence that resembles the actual burden. Structured interviews, work samples, simulations, and realistic previews can be tied to defined requirements more clearly than free-form impression, but even these methods require validation, accessibility, and attention to adverse impact (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; EEOC, 2007; SIOP, 2018). For the City, a formation task should not ask which applicant looks most statesmanlike. It should ask how the person handles a conflict of evidence, a staff correction, an accessibility constraint, a privacy boundary, an unpopular maintenance choice, or an affected person's refusal. The task becomes informative because its relation to the civic burden is visible.

Formation evidence must also remain role-bounded. A person may learn quickly in deliberation and slowly in public communication, or show strong technical judgment while needing more relational support. The City should resist converting uneven performance into a global rank. Instead, it can ask what pathway, pace, supervision, and support make responsible growth possible. It also makes the institution's own teaching accountable. When many applicants fail the same task, the question is not only who lacks capacity. It is whether the instruction, environment, or criterion is poorly designed.

13.4.4 — Correction Over Flawlessness

Correction over flawlessness requires the City to keep records of correction carefully. Internal correction notes should support formation, not become gossip, stigma, or public entertainment. The record should distinguish allegation, finding, response, remedy, appeal, and unresolved dispute. Otherwise correction data can become its own unfair burden.

Before the first participant is identified, public communications should explain that visible formation will include mistakes and show how correction is assessed. Otherwise, an expectation of flawless records may punish participants for the visibility the City requires. The stated standard should be willingness and ability to correct errors.

13.4.5 — No Moral Sorting

No moral sorting means that each admissions decision remains a bounded judgment about role fit, public-risk burden, consent, supportability, and present readiness. Acceptance creates an opportunity for formation, not superior status. Delay protects time for repair or institutional readiness; redirection recognizes a different route; refusal protects a boundary that cannot presently be carried. None of these outcomes measures the value of a life, the worth of citizenship, or the depth of a person's possible contribution elsewhere.

Admissions letters, forms, summaries, public explanations, internal dashboards, and donor reports should not present decisions as moral rankings. Language such as top applicants, highest-value candidates, civic excellence rank, or trust tier would convert a bounded decision into a verdict on the person. The City should describe role fit, readiness, support, risk, and review status, using only constructs tied to a declared decision

purpose and supported for that use (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; SIOP, 2018; Colquitt et al., 2001).

Applicants need a route to challenge language that feels stigmatizing. An admissions decision can be substantively justified and still written in a way that harms dignity. Correction and right of reply begin before public record because institutional language itself can carry burden.

Periodic audit should compare the City’s stated neutrality with the narratives applicants feel pressured to perform. If applications conceal mixed motives, examine what the institution rewards.

13.5 — Voluntary Entry as Civic Threshold

Legitimate entry requires adult status, informed and uncoerced consent, a reviewable decision, and a real right to refuse (Council of Europe, 1997; CIOMS, 2016). The threshold is civic because it concerns public power. It is not ordinary lifestyle choice, self-help practice, religious vow, entertainment participation, elite school admission, or employment contract alone. It is a decision to enter a formation environment designed around possible public authority. That gives the institution stronger duties than ordinary recruitment would carry.

13.5.1 — Adult Status

Adult status is nonnegotiable for entry into the Transparent City. Minors do not enter the Vow, and dependents do not inherit it through proximity.

This rule protects children and adolescents from adult ambition. Families, communities, parties, movements, media, and donors may be tempted to identify gifted young people early and narrate their future public role. The City must refuse that romance. Childhood is not a preparation dossier for later transparency. *The Life of Fairness* establishes the stronger claim: a child's privacy and development are not raw material for an adult institution.

Adult status remains a lawful threshold rather than an institutional invention. Host-jurisdiction rules governing age and capacity provide the starting point, with constitutional and safeguarding review where ambiguity exists. The City adapts its pathway to those standards instead of redefining adulthood to fit institutional demand.

Young adults may be legally eligible yet still subject to family pressure, economic dependence, educational leverage, political grooming, or online fame. Adult status is the floor, not the whole

consent analysis. Freedom from coercion and reviewable consent remain necessary.

The City may educate the public about public-power formation, but education is not recruitment. Youth-facing civic education, if ever created, must remain outside the Vow and should be governed by child privacy, non-performance, and ordinary-life protection.

13.5.2 — Informed Consent

Informed consent requires understanding, not merely disclosure. A document can list risks while leaving the applicant unable to imagine them. The City must therefore explain the Vow, record stages, access classes, protected nonvisibility, pause, refusal, possible office interfaces, staff roles, public exposure, family effects, and unresolved design questions in language the applicant can actually use.

Informed consent should be staged over time. First inquiry should receive a plain-language orientation. A formal application should receive deeper explanation. Pre-activation review should require renewed understanding after simulations, support review, household consultation, and role matching. A person may consent differently after the burden becomes concrete (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; Manson and O'Neill, 2007).

Orientation materials should explain the choice rather than sell it. They should not promise transformation, historic significance, moral elevation, career access, spiritual meaning, or public admiration. They should state burdens, limits, protections, alternatives, uncertainties, and refusal rights clearly.

Applicants may summarize what they understand, ask questions, receive corrections, and repeat later. Language access, disability accommodation, literacy support, non-digital access,

legal consultation, and independent counsel where needed are part of the consent burden carried by the City.

Shared decision-making models are useful here because they distinguish awareness that a choice exists, exploration of options, and a decision that reflects the person's circumstances and preferences (Elwyn et al., 2012; Elwyn et al., 2017). The City can adapt that architecture without medicalizing entry. It should first make clear that application, delay, redirection, refusal, and ordinary nonparticipation are legitimate options. It should then compare burdens and supports. Only after that comparison should it ask for a decision at the current stage.

Comprehension checks evaluate the quality of the City's explanation as much as the applicant's understanding. Teach-back can reveal that language, format, translation, timing, or accommodation needs improvement. When misunderstanding concerns record release, family exposure, support terms, or pause rights, the institution should revise the explanation and record what made the terms clear. This makes consent quality a City performance obligation and prevents literacy, disability, language background, anxiety, or unfamiliarity with institutional vocabulary from being misread as lack of civic seriousness.

The entry process should also test consent under quiet conditions. A person who says yes in a ceremonial room, with supporters watching, may not be as free as a person answering privately after rest and independent consultation. Consent should be heard away from applause.

13.5.3 — Freedom From Coercion

Freedom from coercion means the applicant’s entry is not produced by threat, dependency, manipulation, emergency, debt pressure, family pressure, political pressure, religious pressure, employer pressure, donor pressure, public shame, or crisis

compression. The City must look for coercion even when the applicant says yes.

Coercion can be obvious, such as threats, blackmail, or conditional support. Pressure can also be indirect. A party tells the applicant this is their only path to relevance. A family says sacrifice is expected. A donor promises relief if the person applies. A movement says history needs them. A community treats refusal as betrayal. A person in crisis sees entry as the only way to be safe.

The first gate identifies urgent support needs and makes nonentry materially possible before asking for civic commitment. Chapter 15 develops the stabilization arrangements.

Coercion review must be private and careful. Applicants may not know they are pressured. They may love the people pressuring them. They may fear consequences if they name the pressure. The City needs confidential consultation routes, independent support, and time away from interested parties before major consent stages.

Belonging to a family, party, religion, movement, profession, or community does not by itself establish coercion. Social embeddedness is normal. The question is whether the person can refuse without losing essential support, safety, belonging, or dignity. That question must be asked concretely.

13.5.4 — Refusal Right

The refusal right is the applicant's right not to enter. It requires protection against retaliation, exposure, threats, and the withdrawal of essential support as punishment for refusal. Declining may still mean losing the opportunity offered by this pathway. That ordinary consequence must be disclosed and distinguished from an institutional penalty designed to make

refusal unsafe. Protect refusal throughout inquiry, application, orientation, simulation, support review, role matching and the period before activation (Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, 2014a; WHO, 2021a).

Forms, meetings, orientation materials, and staff scripts should tell applicants exactly how to pause or withdraw, what happens to their data, what support remains available, and whether they can return later.

Refusal should also be protected from narrative capture by supporters. If a public supporter says the applicant abandoned the mission, the City should not amplify that frame. Its own language should protect nonentry dignity even when others want drama.

13.5.5 — Reviewable Consent

The City does not own the complete legal architecture of consent. Its narrower responsibility is to make entry free enough to matter through plain information, independent advice, time, support, alternatives, refusal, and correction, while returning legal form to *The Constitution of Fairness*, public administration to *The Government of Fairness*, and rollout gates to *The Transition of Fairness*.

Reviewable consent means consent remains open to examination over time. The City cannot take one early yes and treat it as permanent authorization for every later burden. Consent must be checked when burden changes, when role pathway changes, when health changes, when household conditions change, when record conditions change, and before activation begins.

Reviewable consent also requires independent routes for concern. Staff, clinicians, legal advisers, family consultants, ombuds, and the applicant themself should have ways to flag

coercion, overload, misunderstanding, or changed circumstances. Consent review should not depend entirely on the applicant's ability to speak forcefully at the right time.

Protection against coercion cannot become paternalism. Adults retain the right to make difficult choices. The institutional duty is to verify that the person understands the burden, has practicable alternatives, can seek independent advice, and can refuse without material or reputational punishment. Respect for agency and scrutiny of coercive conditions belong together.

Consent records should document stage, explanation, questions, support offered, rights, refusal routes, and unresolved issues. Apply the applicant-data controls in Section 13.6.5.

Reviewable consent also requires time. If each stage rushes into the next, review becomes ceremonial. The City should build intervals for sleep, consultation, legal advice, clinical support if needed, family conversation, and private reconsideration (Elwyn et al., 2012; Elwyn et al., 2017).

A final voluntariness audit should test the process rather than grade the applicant. In protected aggregate form, reviewers should examine uninterrupted decision time, whether questions changed proposed terms, whether pause and refusal were used without retaliation, whether support remained available after a no, whether return routes were usable, and whether applicants reported pressure from family, donors, employers, parties, media, or staff. These are measures of institutional freedom, not applicant quality. Repeated pressure at one stage requires redesign even when every consent form is complete.

A former applicant must be able to obtain their file, correct an error, confirm deletion or sealing, learn who accessed it, and challenge an improper disclosure without re-entering the application process, subject to narrow lawful limits. Data transfer to another institution follows Section 13.6.4.

13.6 — Applicant Privacy Before Acceptance

Applicant privacy before acceptance protects the person who has not yet entered the City. This is essential because the City's public intensity will make curiosity powerful. People will want to know who is considering entry, who was approached, who refused, who was delayed, who was redirected, and who failed a review. Without strong limits, application itself becomes exposure (European Union, 2016; Nissenbaum, 2010).

13.6.1 — Inquiry Without Exposure

Inquiry is the earliest and most fragile stage. A person may ask a question, request materials, attend an information session, consult privately, or wonder aloud whether the City is right for them. That act should not begin public exposure. Curiosity is not consent.

This safeguard also prevents recruitment theater. Inquiries must not be displayed, celebrated, leaked, or used in donor materials as signals of momentum. Minimised aggregate counts may be used privately to audit access and barriers, with safeguards against identification; they must not become proof of public desire, moral legitimacy, or historical inevitability.

Some inquiry channels may require identity checks for safety or integrity, especially if they lead to site visits, protected information, or role-specific consultation. Even then, the data should remain purpose-bound. The person should know what is collected, why, who sees it, how long it is retained, and how to withdraw where lawful.

Inquiry systems should be designed with non-digital floors. Some people cannot safely or easily use online forms, searchable accounts, cloud profiles, or platform-linked identities. A fair City should allow protected human contact, written materials, and low-data routes where lawful and practical.

13.6.2 — Delayed Application Status

The City still needs some internal records. It must prevent fraud, coercion, duplicate applications, conflicts, capture, safety risks, and process abuse. It may need enough data for audit, appeal, legal compliance, and applicant support. But internal need does not equal public release, broad access, model training, donor visibility, media briefing, or permanent dossier formation.

Delayed application status occurs when a person has moved beyond inquiry but is not yet accepted, rejected, redirected, or activated. Delay may arise because the applicant needs more time, the City needs more review, documentation is incomplete, support needs are unresolved, role pathway is uncertain, coercion concerns exist, or unresolved design questions affect the process.

Keep pending applications sufficiently private to prevent uncertainty from becoming public suspense. Supporters, critics, media, donors, and parties should not be invited to campaign around an unresolved applicant. Status communication, when necessary, stays minimal and prevents the institution from shifting the social cost of its own timetable onto the person waiting.

Every delayed application needs a clear internal reason and review deadline. Explain the delay to the applicant, provide check-ins, status updates, and appropriate support, and keep pause or withdrawal available. Provide a route to question the delay and, where appropriate, appeal it (Solove, 2006; NIST, 2020b).

Time does not enlarge the file. Information collected during a pending period remains tied to the unresolved decision, and each additional request needs a named use, retention rule, and explanation to the applicant. Irrelevant material should be

deleted, sealed, or never collected (European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b).

Powerful outsiders can use delay strategically. Donors, parties, factions, or media cycles may prefer an application to remain pending for narrative reasons. Delay should be governed by applicant safety and process integrity, not by public choreography.

13.6.3 — Refusal Privacy

Applicant privacy also protects public legitimacy. If application becomes public too early, outside actors can pressure the applicant, attack them, flatter them, fund them, threaten them, or narrate their motives before the City can protect the process. Premature exposure shifts burden from the institution to the applicant and their household.

Refusal privacy protects the person who does not enter. The refusal may come from the applicant, from the City, or from mutual recognition that the threshold is not right. In every case, nonentry should not automatically become public material. The applicant remains a private person.

City-initiated refusal must also be handled with dignity. There may be serious reasons: coercion, deception, unsupported load, role mismatch, security concern, safety risk, inability to consent, or unresolved legal issues. Even then, the decision is not a public condemnation of the person. Internal records may exist for process integrity, but public labeling should be avoided unless lawful necessity requires some limited statement.

The public may have legitimate questions if a prominent figure's application was publicly known through other channels. Even then, the City should use minimal, dignity-preserving language. It can say process has ended or no active status exists without disclosing motives, health, family considerations,

review details, or internal concerns unless law or safety demands more.

Refusal privacy coexists with specific safety and legal duties. Misconduct that independently requires reporting, protective warning, or lawful action follows the relevant process, with scope, review, and reasons recorded. That narrow exception does not convert ordinary nonentry into public exposure.

Refusal privacy should include breach response. If an applicant's refusal leaks, the City should have a route for correction, takedown requests where lawful, public noncomment discipline, support to the applicant, and internal review of how the exposure occurred.

13.6.4 — Redirection Privacy

Redirection occurs when the City determines that another path may better fit the person's gifts, burdens, timing, or consent. The applicant might be directed toward ordinary public service, education, local government, technical work, community leadership, civic project work, private life, clinical support, legal help, or later reconsideration.

Redirection privacy matters because alternative paths can reveal sensitive information. A recommendation for delay, clinical support, debt stabilization, family consultation, role change, or non-City service may expose private burdens if mishandled. The applicant should not have to carry a public explanation for why the City suggested another route. Purpose limitation, minimization, and role-based access should govern the redirection record as strictly as the original application (OECD, 2013; European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b).

Redirection should be useful, not dismissive. If the City suggests another path, it should provide enough information to make the path real where appropriate: who to contact, what

supports exist, what records are transferred if any, what consent is required, what data stays behind, and whether return is possible.

Data transfer during redirection requires strict consent and purpose. The City should not send applicant files to another institution, movement, employer, religious body, political actor, or service path without lawful basis and clear permission.

Redirection should be recorded as a pathway decision rather than as a deficiency label. The file should say what burden or fit issue made another path better, what options were offered, what the applicant chose to share, and what data may travel.

13.6.5 — Applicant Data Limits

Early applicant handling is therefore divided into inquiry, delayed status, refusal, redirection, and data limits. Each stage has its own purpose, owner, access class, retention rule, correction route, and exit condition. Private dignity remains the default until lawful acceptance and later activation create a different record status.

Apply Section 11.7 separation before acceptance: applicant records remain distinct from public record sites, donor databases, research files, religious records, voting systems, media lists, vendor analytics, model-training corpora and future government files.

Minimization still permits records needed to audit decisions, correct error, investigate misconduct, protect applicants, and answer lawful review.

Data limits also protect application workers. Staff need access permissions, audit logs, conflict rules, breach routes, and authority to refuse improper requests from donors, parties, officials, researchers, vendors, or public-relations teams. Privacy cannot depend on a junior worker absorbing pressure alone.

Independent data audit belongs with people who are not rewarded for institutional growth. Privacy reviewers, civil-liberties advisers, security specialists, accessibility experts, and applicant advocates should be able to ask why a field exists and whether it can be deleted, sealed, summarized, or never collected (Council of Europe, 1997; CIOMS, 2016).

Purpose limitation should be visible at field level through a data card readable by both applicant and auditor. Each item should name the field, purpose, stage, owner, lawful or voluntary basis, permitted access, decision use, prohibited uses, retention, derivative systems, correction or challenge route, and deletion proof (European Union, 2016; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Retention discipline is designed before the first application. Verification may need a short audit window, complaints a longer lawful period, and exploratory material rapid deletion or sealing. Access is logged without a public trace, identity stays separate from aggregate analysis, and records cannot migrate silently into later selection or prediction systems. Fields that never influence a lawful decision or remedy should become candidates for removal at the next scheduled review.

The City can publish applicant-data categories, purposes, access roles, retention windows, breach duties and aggregate deletion performance without exposing individual files. This lets applicants challenge systemic overcollection without disclosing why they applied or how their cases ended (European Union, 2016; Nissenbaum, 2010). Deletion verification should cover backups and authorized downstream copies. Aggregate reports should identify categories removed or narrowed, showing whether minimization changes collection practices.

Chapter 14 — Application, Support, and Role Pathways

A hypothetical applicant enters the review room expecting to be judged as a whole person. Instead, the first page names the pathway, burden, support, evidence, decision owner, review date, and inferences that are forbidden.

The threshold is a bundle of distinct decisions, not one judgment on a person. Identity verification, lawful eligibility, consent, support, functional capacity, accommodation, security, manipulation risk, pathway matching, local legitimacy, and any ratified public input answer different questions. Each needs its own construct, owner, evidence limit, uncertainty statement, review clock, and appeal. Collapsing the lanes lets an impression in one domain become a verdict in every other domain (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; SIOP, 2018).

Assessment and recruitment standards contribute disciplined process without supplying a universal City code. The Standards for Educational and Psychological Testing, SIOP validation principles, ISO 10667:2020, and ISO 30405:2023 emphasize declared purpose, competent administration, intended-use evidence, candidate experience, responsible stakeholders, review, and learning. Fair-recruitment guidance adds transparency, non-discrimination, freedom from coercion, and protection against applicant-paid access costs. The City adopts those habits while keeping admission distinct from employment, licensure, diagnosis, or election (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; SIOP, 2018; ISO, 2020a; ISO, 2023b; ILO, 2019a).

Jurisdiction therefore matters. Local law may govern equality, privacy, data protection, disability accommodation, labor status, background review, medical information, political participation, and appeal in very different ways. The architecture here is a candidate design, not enacted law. Qualified legal, psychological, security, disability, and public-administration review must translate it before any real threshold opens.

Broad discovery and local legitimacy must be held together rather than traded against each other. The City should search beyond elite schools, donor circles, dominant languages, and established parties. Global reach still cannot erase host law, democratic authority, regional knowledge, language access, or the accountable relation required for a particular public role. Discovery expands possibility; it does not appoint outsiders over a place. Public input enters only as a bounded candidate mechanism where lawfully ratified. It may surface local knowledge, conflict, or practical concern that a closed panel missed. It may also become a popularity contest, harassment channel, or portable reputation score. Any future mechanism must therefore answer precise questions about authority, scope, access, moderation, review, and remedy while leaving authorization and weighting open. A public-input pilot should therefore publish its decision rule before receiving responses, so participants know what the input can actually change.

Artificial Intelligence may assist forms, scheduling, translation, document routing, accessibility, and audit logs inside a disclosed human workflow. Personality, emotion, credibility, mental state, pathway, and refusal decisions remain outside machine authority. Under the current consolidated EU AI Act, many employment and selection systems are high risk, while workplace emotion inference is generally prohibited outside medical or safety purposes; the exact legal classification of any City tool would still depend on jurisdiction and use. The City adopts a stricter institutional rule: named people disclose the tool and data, explain the evidence, receive challenges, correct errors, and remain responsible for the outcome (European Union, 2024; NIST, 2023a; SIOP, 2023; EEOC, 2023). Every automated aid should have a named fallback process that remains usable when the tool is unavailable, challenged, or withdrawn.

14.1 — Identity Verification and Eligibility

Verification gives the threshold an accountable administrative foundation. The City needs sufficient confidence that an adult is applying under a real identity, for a legally possible pathway, without material deception. Purpose limitation prevents that foundation from expanding into a total biography. Each fact answers a specific eligibility or integrity question, and reviewers use a less burdensome reliable route whenever one is available (ISO, 2020a; SIOP, 2018).

14.1.1 — Adult Identity

Evidence must be proportionate to the consequence and accessible to people whose lives do not fit a single documentary norm. Official records may be appropriate for some facts, while sworn explanations, corroborating evidence, protected attestations, or qualified legal review may be needed when documents are missing, inconsistent, unsafe to obtain, or shaped by migration, adoption, displacement, disability, family change, or state error. Administrative difficulty is not the same as deception.

The construct here is narrow: legal adulthood and identity continuity for this application. Allowed evidence may include reliable identity documents, protected attestations, or accessible alternatives when ordinary documentation is unavailable or unsafe, but it may not be used to infer citizenship worth, social conformity, family legitimacy, or ideological belonging. A trained human verifier must record uncertainty, distinguish mismatch from deception, and explain any adverse conclusion. The process needs accommodation, secure correction, independent appeal, and an audit of whether documentation rules impose unequal burdens. Software may flag a missing field; it may not decide that a complicated identity is suspicious.

The reviewer should separate adult identity from public identity. The City needs to know that the person who signs the application is legally able to make an adult role commitment; it does not need to make the applicant's documentary history a public exhibit. When proof documents contain adoption history, migration history, name-change history, family conflict, gender history, or other protected facts, the verification file should preserve the decision basis under restricted custody while the public-facing record later states only the role-relevant status and any unresolved dispute.

A clean adult-identity gate also protects the applicant against impersonation and pressure. If another person, party apparatus, family member, employer, patron, or online following is effectively driving the application, identity review should stop long enough to verify direct agency. The remedy is not humiliation; it is private confirmation, independent contact, and a chance to withdraw without public trace.

14.1.2 — Jurisdictional Fit

The verification record should separate identity, jurisdictional fit, background integrity, data minimization, and correction. Identity asks who is applying. Jurisdictional fit asks whether the proposed pathway has a lawful setting. Background integrity asks whether relevant representations are materially candid. Data minimization asks what may be collected and retained. Appeal asks how institutional error is repaired. A concern in one category cannot silently become an adverse conclusion in another.

Jurisdictional review produces a pathway note, not a prestige label. The note identifies the relevant public body, constituency, office type, law, language, eligibility rule, and unresolved legal question. It then distinguishes an existing lawful route from a

possible future route or a speculative one. When a path depends on reform, public authorization, or transition work, the record says so plainly and prevents the City from selling an opportunity it cannot yet lawfully honor.

Jurisdictional fit concerns the legal relationship between the proposed pathway and the relevant public setting, not whether the applicant belongs socially or culturally. Permitted evidence includes current legal requirements, residency or qualification rules where applicable, professional obligations, conflicts of law, and qualified counsel's analysis. Nationality, accent, migration history, party belief, or unfamiliarity may not be treated as proxies for incompatibility. The legal reviewer must disclose uncertainty and conflicts, identify another lawful pathway where one exists, and provide a reasoned appeal route. Because law changes, a negative decision needs a review date rather than a permanent mark.

Cross-border service may remain possible through diplomatic, technical, advisory, or humanitarian pathways where the applicable requirements allow it.

The fair outcome of a jurisdictional mismatch may be delay, another jurisdictional track, language preparation, legal advice, or redirection to a different civic pathway.

The record should distinguish eligibility to enter the City from eligibility to pursue a particular office track.

14.1.3 — Background Integrity

Background integrity is not a search for an unblemished past. It is a test of material candor about facts that bear directly on consent, lawful eligibility, security, conflicts, access, or the proposed pathway. The City should begin with a written relevance rule so reviewers cannot turn curiosity, moral

disapproval, or political disagreement into a moving target after an application arrives.

Allowed evidence should be linked to a stated question and evaluated for reliability, recency, context, and opportunity to respond. A discrepancy may reflect memory, translation, record error, name change, informal work, family instability, legal complexity, or fear of exposure rather than intent to deceive. Reviewers need training in source quality and must distinguish an unresolved fact from a proven falsehood.

Consistency of administration matters as much as the written rule. Similar discrepancies should trigger similar inquiry, and departures should be documented rather than improvised around a familiar or favored applicant. Periodic case review can compare how reviewers treated equivalent facts, how often additional inquiry changed the outcome, and whether some applicants were required to explain more of their lives than others.

Materiality must be explained. A fact is material when accurate disclosure could reasonably change a defined pathway, support plan, conflict control, access boundary, or lawful eligibility decision. Embarrassment, unconventionality, or reputational risk to the City is not enough. The applicant should know the issue, the evidence, the relevance claimed, and the possible consequences before an adverse conclusion is finalized.

Error risk runs in both directions. A loose process may admit someone who concealed a serious conflict or coercive obligation. An overbroad process may exclude capable people whose records reflect poverty, discrimination, migration, protest, or unequal policing rather than pathway risk. Periodic audit should examine which sources generate reversals, which groups bear documentation burdens, and whether a less intrusive method would answer the same question.

The application process should treat correction as evidence of integrity when the correction is timely, candid, and proportionate. An applicant who repairs an inaccurate statement, discloses a forgotten conflict, or names uncertainty should not be punished more harshly than an applicant who is merely better at presenting a polished file. Material concealment after fair notice is the decisive breach, not an honest correction made through the route provided. The remedy route is staged: clarification first, then restricted review, then delay or refusal only where the relevance and risk can be explained without turning the past into a permanent stigma.

14.1.4 — Minimal Necessary Data

The assessment architecture should prefer verified status over retained proof artifacts whenever the status is enough. A protected notation that adulthood or a qualification has been confirmed may serve better than retaining a full identity document, family record, address history, or professional file. Provenance and auditability matter, but they do not require indefinite possession of every artifact used to reach a conclusion.

Sensitive information should be separated by function. Identity evidence, accommodation information, clinical material, security information, legal advice, and public-facing status do not belong in one admissions dossier. Access should follow role and purpose, with no convenience search across categories. Separation reduces both misuse and the tendency to interpret unrelated facts as one story about the person (European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b).

The applicant-data limits in Section 13.6.5 govern verification records. A new purpose does not override prohibited uses or authorize reuse of the underlying file merely because a verification result becomes public.

Collection creates unequal burdens. Some applicants can produce documents quickly, while others face cost, travel, language barriers, inaccessible systems, unsafe family contact, or records destroyed by conflict and displacement. The City should measure time, expense, refusal points, and dropout across the verification process.

14.1.5 — Appeal of Verification

Applicants must be able to challenge identity mismatches, document authenticity, legal-fit conclusions, materiality judgments, and deception claims without public exposure. Notice should state the issue, usable evidence, decision owner, deadline, and review route in accessible language.

The appeal body must be independent enough to correct rather than repeat the original process. It needs authority to obtain source records, seek qualified review, accept alternative proof, order correction, limit retention, reverse findings, and define safe interim status. Recusal rules cover prior involvement, personal connection, donor pressure, and institutional embarrassment.

A usable appeal does not depend on wealth, legal sophistication, repeated travel, perfect fluency, or public advocacy. Accessible formats, interpretation, disability accommodation, reasonable extensions, and a named human contact lower the practical cost of correction.

The correction record should separate the original claim, applicant response, new evidence, reviewing reasons, and result. Corrections must propagate to every system and reviewer that received the error. The applicant should receive confirmation and notice of any lawful residual retention. A propagation receipt should identify each destination that accepted the correction and any system that still requires manual repair.

Set separate response targets for ordinary verification appeals and cases where delay would defeat the remedy. Emergency correction, assisted submission, and enforceable time limits should prevent a correctable error from costing the applicant the application window (Hausknecht et al., 2004; Colquitt et al., 2001).

Meaningful appeal also requires the usable basis of the decision. Security, third-party privacy, or lawful confidentiality may justify narrow withholding, but the restriction must be specific, logged, independently reviewable, and no broader than necessary. The system should audit resolution time, correction patterns, accommodation use, abandoned appeals, and propagation failures; recurrent burdens on particular documentation or access conditions require redesign of the gate, not repeated case-by-case repair. Consistency review should test whether equivalent alternative evidence is accepted across applicants rather than only after escalation. Rehearse a correction shortly before an application deadline: trace dependent decisions, assign reopening authority, and confirm the corrected status in time. If timely repair is impossible, an independently authorized interim route should preserve the applicant’s opportunity without presuming success.

14.2 — Capacity, Psychosocial Support, and Load Review

Capacity review begins with the pathway's real demands and the institution's design choices. A burden may be essential, modifiable, distributable, schedulable, or produced by an unnecessarily rigid environment. Reviewers identify the support that makes participation feasible, the risk that remains after support, and whether the present mismatch belongs to the role, the timing, the applicant's circumstances, or the City's own capacity. Fit is therefore relational and revisable rather than a search for an ideal participant.

14.2.1 — Capacity Review

Every consequential conclusion carries a screening-separation record. It states the question presented, allowed data fields, source, owner, uncertainty, support considered, prohibited inference, retention period, applicant access, correction route, expiry, and appeal. Any emergency or lawful transfer across lanes receives a reason, minimum dataset, recipient, time limit, and independent review instead of disappearing into a general file.

Make support and safety findings functional, conditional and time-bounded under Sections 14.2.2 and 14.2.4. Respect will, preferences and equal recognition while assessing environmental barriers (Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, 2014a; World Health Organization, 2022c).

Graduated exposure can answer some capacity questions more fairly than a final prediction. A person may be ready for education, limited orientation, supported trial, health stabilization, household consultation, or a slower track without being ready for activation. Review repeats when illness, grief,

family change, disability flare, public attack, financial shock, or security threat changes the burden.

The construct is role-relevant functional capacity under stated conditions and accommodations, not general competence or personal strength. Evidence may include informed self-report, structured simulations, task samples, orientation, support history, and qualified professional input where necessary. Diagnosis, appearance, prestige, or effortless performance alone is insufficient. The conclusion states essential demands, temporary and enduring limits, support tried, uncertainty, alternatives, appeal, and reassessment.

Some risks require pause, delay, redirection, or refusal: inability to understand the Vow, compromised consent, inability to distinguish active record from ordinary privacy, no practicable exit, intolerable record burden even with support, or immediate unmanaged danger. The protected record states the operational conclusion, support needs, uncertainty, expert trigger, and appeal.

The review should name the specific active-period demands: continuous role-bound record, intense learning, public interface, criticism, household adjustment, time discipline, correction, and possible delay. The question is whether the City can support the person without shifting hidden burden onto staff, family, or the applicant's body (Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, 2014a; WHO, 2021a).

The review should maintain a difference between present capacity, supported capacity, and pathway capacity. Present capacity asks what the applicant can carry now. Supported capacity asks what becomes possible with accommodation and stabilization. Pathway capacity asks whether the chosen public-power route requires a different pace, smaller load, or alternate track.

The applicant must know which lane is active. Identity review verifies person and process. Legal review addresses eligibility. Functional assessment tests defined pathway demands. Accommodation review changes the environment. Clinical care protects health and consent. Security review addresses conduct and access risk. The decision panel integrates only the permitted outputs. No lane silently consumes another, and each uses separate personnel, records, permissions, and appeal.

The firewall itself requires audit. Reviewers should sample whether clinical detail leaked into general files, whether decision panels received only functional conclusions, whether accommodation was tried before exclusion, whether emergency transfers expired, whether applicants understood the lane, and whether appeals changed the process.

14.2.2 — Psychological Support and Safety Review

An escalation rule handles immediate danger without dissolving the firewall. A clinician may disclose the minimum necessary information to a named safety authority when a genuine emergency requires it, while ordinary treatment detail remains protected. The transfer is logged, time-limited, and reviewable. Clinical disclosures are excluded from comparative pathway scoring; a separately documented functional safety conclusion may justify a proportionate pause or restriction, with support and appeal. Emergency disclosure cannot become a permanent bridge from care into selection.

Psychological review begins with support and safety, not a diagnostic hunt. The relevant questions are whether the applicant understands the burden, whether participation could foreseeably destabilize health or safety, which supports are needed, and whether an acute condition makes consent or immediate entry

unreliable. The review does not search for a preferred personality or psychological image of leadership.

Qualified professionals define the method, limits, and relationship to admissions. Competent assessment requires appropriate tools, multiple sources, context, privacy, and cautious interpretation. A treating clinician should not automatically become the admissions evaluator, and an admissions evaluator should not control treatment. Separation protects candor and keeps care from becoming an intelligence-gathering route.

Allowed evidence may include a consent-focused interview, functional information voluntarily and lawfully provided, observed response to structured burden, and validated measures used only for their supported purpose. Prohibited inferences include virtue, honesty, loyalty, ideology, courage, general office performance, or moral danger. Raw clinical notes, intimate history, and treatment records stay outside the general admissions file.

Predictive language must be disciplined by base rates and incremental value. A measure may add little once structured observation, role-specific work, accommodation response, and support history are known; low-base-rate predictions of severe failure can produce many false positives. The assessor should identify the comparison population, explain the method's added information, distinguish false-positive and false-negative harms, and show why a less intrusive source is insufficient. Culture, trauma, neurodivergence, disability, medication, language, and distrust can alter presentation without revealing civic capacity (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; Schmidt and Hunter, 1998; SIOP, 2018).

The purpose, scope, and consequences of review must be explained, including what information will travel, which

decision it can influence, and what happens under uncertainty. Where law and safety permit, the applicant receives the conclusion, can correct factual error, may offer another qualified opinion, and can appeal without making private history public.

A responsible conclusion uses bounded language: support available, further review needed, temporary delay advised, defined condition required, or no adequate assessment. It does not pronounce the applicant healthy enough for power, psychologically unfit for citizenship, or destined to fail.

Clinical information travels in the narrowest functional form. A clinician or disability specialist may describe constraints, supports, crisis arrangements, or load limits without exposing diagnosis, therapy detail, trauma narrative, medication, intimate history, or family secrets unless a higher lawful review establishes necessity.

Consider a hypothetical applicant who experiences panic during a high-stimulation simulation. The treating clinician recommends a quieter recovery setting and shorter sessions; the pathway assessor reviews performance after accommodation; the decision panel receives only a functional conclusion; and the applicant can challenge any claim that one episode establishes general unfitness.

14.2.3 — Relational Review

Before admission, use Section 16.4.2 to identify which household members would absorb additional care work and whether support can meet it.

Relational review asks about collateral load, coercion, support, and the practical effect of participation on people near the applicant. It does not require family approval, authorize surveillance of a household, or treat an unconventional relationship as risk. Evidence should be applicant-led and

purpose-limited, with separate consent for any third party and protected routes when consultation could increase danger. Reviewers need competence in coercive control, care burden, confidentiality, and cultural variation. The likely errors run in both directions: ignoring household harm and granting others a veto over the applicant. Support, safety planning, redirection, and appeal must remain available without creating a family dossier.

Where coercive control, stalking, domestic abuse, or custody conflict may be present, ordinary family consultation can create danger. The City needs a protected route that allows the applicant or collateral person to seek advice without automatic joint meetings, notice to the other party, or disclosure through the general file. Safety planning may require separate counsel, clinical support, secure communication, and postponement of admissions questions.

An adult may choose public-power formation despite uncertainty or opposition, but childcare disruption, dependent care, partner exposure, housing change, financial dependency, safety, professional duties, and collateral record risk still require attention. The review also looks for pressure in both directions: status-seeking relatives, controlling partners, parties using family as leverage, donors rescuing a spouse, or a household presenting the City as the only escape.

Relational review can reveal needed accommodations: scheduled family contact, dependent support, travel limitation, housing design, privacy safeguards, safety planning, or activation delay. These prevent the participant’s chosen burden from being displaced onto others.

Household members' standing should include notice, shielding, consultation where appropriate, and complaint routes if the participant's role burden begins to fall on them.

14.2.4 — Disability-Aware Accommodation Review

Disability-aware fit begins with the human-rights model of disability: barriers arise from the interaction between a person and an environment, not from impairment alone. The Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, especially its equality, accessibility, and work provisions, provides a strong orientation even where it is not directly controlling law. The first question is therefore what the City has designed badly or failed to provide.

Accommodation should be developed through an accessible, confidential, and collaborative process. Possible changes include schedule, pacing, communication format, sensory environment, assistive technology, staffing, transportation, remote participation for defined tasks, recovery time, or a different sequence of training. The applicant should not have to disclose more diagnosis than is necessary to establish the functional need.

Some limits will remain real. An accommodation may not eliminate a specific safety risk or may fundamentally alter an essential function. Even then, the conclusion must identify the function, evidence, alternatives considered, uncertainty, and whether the limit belongs to the present pathway, the timing, or the City's current capacity. General statements that the environment is demanding are not enough.

Disparate burden should be reviewed with disabled people and relevant experts, not only measured after exclusion occurs. The City should examine completion rates, delays, accommodation requests, assessor disagreement, appeal outcomes, and reasons for withdrawal. Denial of accommodation, inaccessible forms, or excessive proof demands can create exclusion even when no reviewer intends discrimination.

The accommodation record should remain private, practical, and revisable. It names support needs, responsible offices,

review intervals, emergency arrangements, and any burden that cannot be removed without compromising rights or an essential function. Failure occurs when it publicly discloses the applicant's private circumstances, denies necessary support without reasons and appeal, or shifts the cost invisibly to staff and family.

14.2.5 — Load Accommodation

A serious load plan needs review dates and failure signs. Sleep, family stress, public attention, study load, medical need, sensory burden, and shame exposure may change after entry. The plan should identify which fatigue, withdrawal, agitation, shutdown, sleep loss, family strain, performance drift, or health deterioration triggers adjustment or pause before strain becomes collapse.

Load accommodation must protect clinicians, mentors, security, accessibility staff, translators, and residential workers from hidden overload. Schedule, recovery time, staff ratios, public-interface windows, care, and pathway pacing must be staffed, funded, and reviewable.

Load fit concerns cumulative feasibility across schedule, sensory exposure, care duties, health, travel, public contact, recovery, and record demands. Schedule simulation, supported trial, applicant preference, household impact, and professional advice may inform the decision without becoming continuous monitoring. The human review team must name what can change, what cannot, and what remains uncertain; graduated activation, reduced load, pause, alternatives, and reassessment should precede total exclusion where possible.

The record should identify the process adjustment (a shorter interface window, a de-loaded simulation, delayed release, or another protected condition) without disclosing the private

diagnosis. The applicant should be able to check that the agreed adjustment appears correctly in the schedule actually issued.

Load decisions must remain conditional. One person may begin lightly and increase burden; another may need pause. The file should use current support plan, current pathway, review date, contraindications, and load ceiling rather than permanent labels such as fragile, high risk, elite track, or not leader material. When a plan changes, the file should identify which earlier limit was superseded rather than accumulate conflicting instructions. A schedule rehearsal should then simulate the unexpected absence of a trained support worker and ask whether the agreed accommodation remains available without transferring unsafe overtime to a colleague. The receiving team should verify the replacement in the actual calendar, not merely acknowledge the support plan. The applicant receives a private notice of any material change and retains the normal review route.

14.3 — Role Pathways and Office-Track Matching

The City does not form one generic leader. Public roles differ in the kind of consequence they carry, the time available for judgment, the forms of law and evidence they use, the people they burden, and the kinds of pressure they attract. Role pathways translate those differences into preparation rather than forcing every applicant through the same prestige model (Campion et al., 2011; Levashina et al., 2014). Each pathway should begin with role analysis.

14.3.1 — Local Office Pathway

Local-pathway assessment concerns proximity, service navigation, municipal law, public meetings, neighborhood conflict, constituency contact, and the practical consequences of small-scale authority. It should test learnable contextual competence through structured exercises and local engagement, not require inherited networks, a preferred accent, or social familiarity. Reviewers should include relevant municipal and community knowledge while disclosing conflicts and avoiding a local popularity contest. Language access, disability accommodation, and supervised trial can reveal capacity more fairly than résumé prestige.

Evidence for local preparation can be concrete. Applicants might analyze a service queue, explain a land-use dispute to people with competing interests, trace a maintenance failure through departments, or design a public meeting that includes residents with limited time and access. The exercise should be evaluated for factual care, respect, feasible follow-through, and recognition of who carries delay.

Local office is neither a beginner tier nor a consolation path. National eloquence cannot substitute for understanding how a local backlog reaches an ordinary household.

The City should prepare applicants to hear local complaints without contempt, defensiveness, or theatrical empathy. Record bundles for local readiness should show practical responsiveness: service-delivery understanding, local conflict handling, staff treatment, capacity to explain constraints, respect for local law, and ability to choose between imperfect options.

Local matching should also guard against imported glamour. The City may attract applicants who see local office as a small stage on the way to higher office. That ambition is not automatically wrong, but the pathway should test whether the applicant can treat local burdens as real rather than as training scenery. A local pathway record should show contact with local institutions, host-community understanding, and attention to the particular costs that residents already carry.

14.3.2 — Legislative Pathway

Legislative exercises should include evidence that challenges the applicant's own political commitments.

The legislative construct is disciplined deliberation under disagreement: reading proposals, hearing evidence, drafting and amending language, explaining reasons, negotiating without hidden ownership, and revising after criticism. Structured writing, amendment exercises, hearing simulations, and relevant prior conduct can supply evidence. Ideological agreement, rhetorical polish, party loyalty, or resemblance to current legislators may not substitute for the construct. A diverse, trained panel should monitor scoring consistency and accommodation, preserve minority viewpoints, and identify uncertainty. The applicant may challenge factual error or biased interpretation.

A useful legislative work sample should preserve disagreement rather than stage a debate with an obvious winner.

The applicant may be asked to revise a proposal after testimony, draft an amendment that protects a minority concern, identify an implementation burden, and explain which compromise was rejected and why. Reviewers should examine the reasoning trail, use of staff, treatment of evidence, and capacity to acknowledge loss (Kristof-Brown et al., 2005).

Legislative exercises should test resistance to donor and party pressure. Record evidence should include draft histories, source notes, committee simulations, minority-report engagement, lobbying boundary logs, coalition exercises, public hearing conduct, and correction after error.

Refusal belongs where the applicant cannot bear democratic contest, hides dependencies, threatens protected persons, or treats lawmaking as private revenge.

14.3.3 — Executive Pathway

The City should identify essential tasks, consequence routes, knowledge demands, public interfaces, confidentiality boundaries, recovery needs, and likely failure modes before choosing any assessment. Work samples, deliberative exercises, writing, supervised trials, and review of relevant conduct are stronger when they resemble the burden to be learned rather than the style of current elites.

Executive matching needs a delegation test: can the applicant use staff without hiding behind them, accept briefing without surrendering judgment, and decide without making subordinates blame shields? The record should show how authority travels through meetings, memos, orders, advice, dissent, and after-action review.

Executive matching should examine whether an applicant seeks command mainly in crises, when urgency can make consultation and scrutiny seem dispensable. Assess whether the

applicant can return to ordinary administration, maintenance, consultation, and repair after the emergency passes.

Executive matching concerns administration, delegation, priority setting, crisis judgment, staff treatment, conflict disclosure, and the ability to explain consequential choices. Evidence may include simulations, work samples, documented conduct, and supervised exercises, but charisma, dominance, speed, or confidence are not reliable proxies. Reviewers must test how the applicant uses expertise, corrects error, handles dissent, and recognizes limits, while accounting for team design and accommodation. Overprediction can place others at risk; underprediction can exclude unconventional but capable leaders. Trial, reassessment, appeal, and pathway change are therefore more credible than a single final personality verdict.

Executive scenarios should test sequence and delegation. A credible exercise might combine an urgent service failure, staffing constraints, fiscal scarcity, incomplete evidence, conflicting legal advice, staff dissent, media pressure, and a vulnerable population that cannot wait for perfect certainty. The applicant should identify immediate care, lawful authority, delegated tasks, decision checkpoints, public explanation, and conditions for reversal. The quality of the response lies partly in knowing what not to centralize in the executive.

An executive pathway should train the burden of administration rather than vision alone: budget execution, appointments, procurement, service delivery, staffing ethics, emergency delegation, data limits, interagency coordination, public explanation, maintenance, and correction under pressure. Screening should also test resistance to retaliation and respect for legal review, legislative authorization, professional expertise, and public consultation.

14.3.4 — Judicial or Quasi-Judicial Pathway

No pathway confers candidacy, appointment, election, professional licensure, security clearance, judicial qualification, or public authority. Those decisions belong to lawful institutions and democratic processes outside the City. The City may offer formation and a reviewable account of participation.

Judicial or quasi-judicial formation must make reasons, conflicts, recusal, ethics, and institutional integrity reviewable while preserving lawful independence and protecting parties' private information.

Applicable legal doctrine and professional standards remain controlling, and public visibility must not become a channel for popular pressure on a decision.

The relevant construct is disciplined adjudicative formation: evidence handling, legal reasoning, impartial procedure, recusal, protected deliberation, reason giving, and awareness of jurisdictional limits. Where law requires qualifications, those requirements control; the City cannot invent substitutes. Written problems, conflict analysis, and structured reasoning may be reviewed by qualified legal experts, but political belief cannot be equated with bias and a calm manner cannot be equated with impartiality. Confidentiality, disability access, cultural caution, and appeal remain necessary.

Simulations can test hearing conduct, recusal analysis, evidence handling, reasons, and treatment of unrepresented parties without demanding disclosure of actual confidential matters or private judicial thought. Reviewers should distinguish independence from isolation and restraint from indifference. A person who produces the preferred outcome for the City is not thereby a better adjudicator.

Quasi-judicial pathways include regulatory boards, administrative judges, licensing panels, ethics bodies, school

discipline panels, immigration or benefits review, and other roles in which public power decides cases. Formation can strengthen case sensitivity, humility, procedural fairness, language access, disability access, appeal awareness, conflict-recusal practice, explanation of legal limits, response to pressure, and visible correction. Readiness evidence stays narrow and role-bound; it never becomes a popularity contest over whether an applicant appears harsh, lenient, or pleasing to an audience.

This pathway should also protect against public-record distortion. A person preparing for adjudicative work may have to discuss hypothetical cases, legal philosophy, bias, error, and uncertainty. Public bundles should not turn these exercises into campaign clips that imply prejudgment of real disputes. The screening record should require controlled context, expert legal review where needed, and a clear handoff to *The Constitution of Fairness* and applicable law for actual validity questions.

14.3.5 — Diplomatic and Technical Pathways

Matching remains provisional because both people and pathways change. An applicant may discover a better route, reviewers may identify a support need, or experience may show that the City's original model was wrong. Trial periods and reassessment reduce the cost of early error. Redirection is legitimate only when it preserves dignity, gives reasons, and does not create a hierarchy in which one public function is treated as a lesser human destination.

Diplomatic and technical pathways require different skills but share a risk: specialized language can conceal public power. Diplomacy carries negotiation, representation, confidentiality, cultural interpretation, and the danger of speaking for people who are not present. Technical public work carries model

choice, procurement, infrastructure, data, maintenance, and the danger of presenting value judgments as neutral expertise.

The pathways should therefore use different evidence. Diplomatic formation may include negotiation exercises, treaty or agreement analysis, language work, conflict scenarios, protocol judgment, and public explanation after protected deliberation. Technical formation may include system design, failure analysis, accessibility review, data-limit statements, vendor evaluation, lifecycle cost, and explanation to non-specialists.

Contextual competence is essential in both. A diplomat cannot treat culture as a technique for persuasion, and a technical specialist cannot assume that expertise cancels democratic accountability. Reviewers should examine whether the applicant can identify affected people, disclose uncertainty, distinguish evidence from preference, and explain who carries the cost when a recommendation is wrong.

Artificial Intelligence may assist technical analysis, translation, simulation, or document review within lawful limits and a disclosed human workflow. It does not select specialists, author advice invisibly, or turn model output into public judgment. The applicant and later reviewer must be able to identify what the system did, which data it used, where uncertainty remains, and who owns the recommendation.

Expert review must be paired with translation duties, conflict disclosure, and a route by which affected communities and non-specialists can challenge the recommendation.

14.4 — Security, Manipulation, and Capture Risk

Security review should answer a narrow question: is there specific, supportable evidence of conduct, access, deception, coercion, sabotage, material conflict, credible threat, or dependency that could compromise the declared role pathway? Review should not become personality screening or speculative loyalty testing. The decision record should identify the alleged risk, the protected interest, the evidence source, source reliability, access involved, alternative explanations, uncertainty, and available mitigation. The reviewer must also state the cost of being wrong in both directions. Missing a real threat can endanger people and records; treating dissent or difference as threat can corrupt the threshold itself.

14.4.1 — Infiltration Risk

Security information often arrives through confidential channels, which increases the need for independent scrutiny. Confidentiality cannot convert rumor into fact or make an adverse conclusion permanently unanswerable. Where disclosure would create a specific lawful danger, the City should provide the usable substance, log what is withheld, permit independent review, and revisit the restriction on a defined clock.

Infiltration risk concerns deceptive entry for unauthorized access, sabotage, intelligence gathering, manipulation, or concealed control. It does not mean that every organized applicant, critic, foreign national, dissenter, or person with unusual associations is suspect. The construct is conduct directed toward an improper purpose, joined to a relevant access route or material deception.

Allowed evidence may include corroborated identity falsehoods, concealed organizational instructions, unauthorized

access attempts, relevant funding or communication records, credible threat information, or coordinated conduct that cannot be explained by ordinary advocacy. Protected belief, religion, nationality, political opinion, race, class, disability, or lawful association may not be used as proxies. Reviewers should distinguish whistleblowing, protest, curiosity, error, and criticism from hostile entry.

Source quality is decisive. Anonymous reporting may initiate inquiry but should not ordinarily sustain an adverse conclusion without corroboration. Reviewers should examine motive, access to knowledge, consistency, independent support, and whether the source benefits from exclusion. Classified or protected information, where lawfully used, needs a separate reviewer capable of testing reliability without unnecessary disclosure.

Security review must also account for the base-rate problem. When genuinely hostile entry is rare, broad indicators can generate more innocent flags than accurate detections, especially if political dissent, foreign ties, unusual travel, or protected association are allowed to stand in for conduct. Reviewers should state the threat model, consider both missed threats and false accusations, and test whether a narrower access control can manage uncertainty.

Uncertain security concerns call for the least restrictive effective control. Supervised trial access, narrower permissions, protected-device rules, delayed archive access, or independent monitoring may resolve a defined exposure more fairly than immediate refusal. Each control needs a reason, owner, review date, and removal condition so that suspicion does not harden into permanent status.

Whenever safety permits, the usable basis of concern must be disclosed and the applicant given a meaningful chance to

answer. Public accusation is a separate and much higher threshold because a false infiltration label can destroy reputation and chill legitimate dissent. Even a justified refusal should disclose no more than the lawful operational reason required, with protected appeal and correction if later evidence changes the conclusion.

Independent audit should review both missed threats and patterns of overclassification, political selectivity, or security claims used to shield insiders.

14.4.2 — Donor Leverage

Donor leverage is practical power created through money, rescue, access, employment, housing, legal support, media promotion, family benefit, or promised opportunity. It can exist without an explicit bargain. The relevant question is whether a private actor has made refusal materially dangerous or gratitude politically binding.

The review should map the dependency rather than moralize the relationship. Who supplied what, under which terms, through which intermediaries, and what would happen if the applicant later said no? Indirect support through relatives, businesses, nonprofits, scholarships, litigation, consulting, or reputation management can matter when it creates control over speech, access, or future conduct.

Allowed evidence should be limited to relevant financial and relational facts, disclosed terms, communications, conflicts, and the consequences of refusal. Wealth is not corruption and poverty is not vulnerability by definition. A reviewer should not demand a total account of every gift or friendship. The inquiry must remain tied to a plausible route by which private support could steer public-power formation (UNODC, 2009; World Bank, 2020).

Beneficial ownership and intermediary structures may matter when support travels through companies, trusts, charities, consultancies, or family arrangements. The review should trace control only as far as necessary to understand the relevant dependency, using qualified financial and legal expertise where needed. It should not convert complexity into guilt.

Dependency audit must not mistake visible scarcity for greater capture. Applicants with fewer resources may have transparent needs, while affluent applicants can carry subtler leverage through family firms, professional networks, philanthropy, social standing, future employment, or access to reputational rescue. The review should ask whose dependencies are scrutinized and whose are normalized as respectable connection (OECD, 2003; OECD, 2026c).

A donor-leverage finding should end with a concrete dependency plan. It should state what private power exists, what has been disclosed, what remedy is required, and how future contact will be reviewed.

Where leverage exists, the response may be disclosure, debt restructuring, independent support, divestment, recusal, cooling-off periods, or refusal if the dependency cannot be made answerable.

14.4.3 — Party Capture

Party affiliation and political organization are ordinary parts of democratic life. Party capture begins when an organization can secretly direct entry, pathway choice, speech, voting commitments, staffing, access, or later conduct through obligations the applicant cannot openly explain or refuse. The construct is concealed control, not partisan identity.

Evidence may include undisclosed instructions, contractual or financial dependence, coordinated deception, promises of future

office, demands to bypass review, controlled messaging, or retaliation for independent judgment. Membership, ideology, volunteer history, lawful campaigning, or strong belief cannot substitute for those facts. A plural City should expect political conviction rather than screen it out.

Reviewers must disclose their own political conflicts and recuse where affiliation, rivalry, or personal history could distort judgment. A cross-partisan or otherwise plural panel may be useful, but diversity of affiliation does not cure unclear constructs. The decision still needs evidence, relevance, uncertainty, and an applicant response.

Mitigation may include disclosure of obligations, ending an operational role, conflict rules, recusal from certain activities, transparent communication boundaries, or a delay while the applicant establishes independent support. The City should not demand political isolation. It should require that no external organization holds an undisclosed veto over formation or future public judgment.

Use explicit logs when an outside organization shapes arguments or strategy, alongside any role separation and communication boundaries required under the mitigation plan.

14.4.4 — Fame Manipulation

Fame can widen public communication and expose an applicant to perspectives the City would otherwise miss. It can also distort motives, feedback, privacy, security, and reviewer judgment. Fame manipulation concerns the use of attention, audience pressure, platform incentives, or reputation management to control the process, not the mere fact that an applicant is known.

Observable conduct, not prestige proxies, belongs in the review. Relevant facts may include undisclosed promotional arrangements, coordinated fan pressure, purchased

amplification, pressure on staff, attempts to bypass ordinary procedure, concealment of commercial interests, or dependence on constant public approval. Follower counts, charisma, appearance, media fluency, and controversy are not validated constructs for this purpose and should neither advantage nor condemn an applicant. Any consequential indicator requires a defined use, evidence of validity, error analysis, and review for subgroup effects (AERA, APA, and NCME, 2014; SIOP, 2018; Levashina et al., 2014).

Social-media scraping and sentiment analysis introduce additional sources of error. Context collapse, bots, coordinated attacks, platform demographics, language difference, and selective visibility make popularity data poor evidence of role fit. The City should not build personality or risk profiles from online traces, nor ask applicants to surrender unrelated accounts as proof of seriousness.

Support may be needed because public attention creates real load. Security planning, communication boundaries, reduced exposure, independent mental-health care, staff protection, and family shielding can make participation possible without rewarding spectacle. Seeking that support is not evidence that the applicant cannot serve.

The admissions record should also protect the applicant from being recruited by their own audience. If entry is driven by public pressure, humiliation, monetized controversy, fan expectation, or fear of losing relevance, the City should pause rather than exploit the moment. A famous applicant may need a cooling period, communications plan, anti-harassment protections, and rules against turning the City into a live stage.

14.4.5 — Coercion Signals

Coercion signals indicate that an applicant's choice may be controlled by threat, dependency, intimidation, exploitation, domestic abuse, blackmail, trafficking, organizational command, or fear of losing essential support. Coercion may push a person toward entry, away from entry, or toward concealment. The primary purpose of review is safety and restored agency, not fault finding.

Possible signals include inconsistent instructions from another person, inability to speak privately, monitored communications, unexplained urgency, threats tied to family or livelihood, sudden control of travel or documents, and fear of consequences for refusal. No single signal proves coercion. Reviewers need trauma-informed training, cultural caution, and a protected route to ask about safety without escalating danger.

Disclosure procedures must be designed so that seeking help does not automatically expose the applicant to the coercive actor. Separate communication channels, safe timing, independent advocates, and limited information sharing may be necessary. The City should not demand confrontation, police reporting, family notification, or public explanation as the price of support unless applicable law and immediate safety require a specific action.

The application process should prearrange relationships with independent services rather than improvising after a disclosure. Emergency housing, legal advice, domestic-violence expertise, trafficking support, secure transportation, clinical care, and digital-safety assistance may be needed in different cases. Availability will vary by jurisdiction, and referral must not be portrayed as guaranteed rescue. The institution's duty is to know its limits, maintain safe routes, and avoid leaving a person more exposed because they answered honestly.

Apply the role and record separation in Section 14.2, including the minimum-data controls for emergency transfers.

Additional signals include scripted answers, fear of disappointing a patron, unusual financial promises, ideological discipline, immigration vulnerability, employment dependence, and public shaming. Fair-recruitment evidence shows how fees, intermediaries, dependency, and vulnerability can make nominal choice materially coercive, even though the City threshold is not ordinary employment recruitment. Reviewers should therefore ask who benefits from the entry, who controls the applicant's alternatives, and whether refusal remains practically safe (ILO, 2019a; ILO, 2024).

When coercion is suspected, use a protective pause. The applicant may need independent counsel, safety planning, separate contact from controlling persons, delayed status, or referral to outside support. A refusal may protect the applicant from being used. A delay may protect dependents from fallout. The record should never convert coercion into weakness or shame. After a coercive contact is removed, reviewers should test whether refusal and alternative pathways are genuinely usable without that person's permission.

14.5 — Global Discovery and Local Legitimacy

Global discovery matters because public capacity is not distributed according to prestige. Capable people may stand outside dominant parties, universities, professions, cities, languages, donor networks, and media circuits. Search must widen without forgetting that recruitment itself can extract time, money, hope, data, care labor, and family sacrifice from applicants (Fox and Lawless, 2014; Kim et al., 2013). The ILO's fair-recruitment principles offer a useful comparative reference. Transparency, freedom from coercion, non-discrimination, due diligence, accessible information, and the rule that workers should not bear recruitment fees translate into a City obligation: applicants should not buy access, hire insiders, or assume hidden debt to become visible (ILO, 2019a).

14.5.1 — Broad Talent Discovery

Broad talent discovery means building multiple lawful routes into awareness of the City. Public notices, community organizations, professional associations, disability networks, labor groups, educational institutions, local civic bodies, diaspora organizations, and ordinary referral may all play a role. No single recruiter, donor, party, or platform should control who becomes visible to the threshold.

The invitation must disclose the burdens and limits set out in Section 13.5.2 before requesting an application. It must not imply that entry provides a shortcut to office.

Before release, the invitation and inquiry process should be tested with people from different regions, languages, disability communities, educational histories, work schedules, digital-access conditions, and levels of institutional familiarity. Reviewers should record where readers misunderstand the burden, abandon the process, or infer prestige and office access

that the City does not promise. Correction belongs upstream: rewrite the notice, change the channel, add interpretation or accommodation, and reduce unnecessary proof before blaming applicants for failing to navigate a gate designed around insiders (EEOC, 2007; ILO, 2019a; ISO, 2023b).

Financial and practical barriers must be counted. Application fees, travel, document procurement, unpaid preparation, inaccessible interviews, language services, digital access, child care, time away from work, public exposure, and relocation assumptions can turn formal openness into class selection. Where support is offered, it should follow public rules and create no debt of loyalty to a recruiter, sponsor, or institution.

Recruiters need conflict rules and training. They should not promise admission, imply office access, coach favored candidates around the process, collect private dossiers, or use vulnerable communities as evidence of diversity. Their task is to make the pathway understandable and reachable, then withdraw from the decision unless a transparent role has been assigned.

Include evidence of responsibility from caregiving, rural service, disaster response, youth mentorship, and community conflict work, alongside formal employment and education.

Publish aggregate information about discovery burdens and reduce them through assistance, including remote inquiry, protected preliminary review, translation, appropriate stipends, and refusal privacy.

14.5.2 — Local Democratic Fit

Revisit local fit as formation deepens: weak initial knowledge may improve through study, service, language, consultation, and repair, while established local identity does not guarantee accountability. Include locally informed reviewers and listening structures able to recognize informal knowledge, historical

memory, service patterns, and trust wounds without making local prejudice authoritative.

Local democratic fit concerns the applicant's ability to understand, learn, and respond to the lawful setting of a proposed public role. Relevant evidence may include local law, institutions, public-service realities, language access, field exercises, listening, and demonstrated correction. Birthplace, inherited network, accent, wealth, or public popularity cannot substitute for competence. Reviewers with local knowledge must disclose conflicts and resist gatekeeping by familiarity. Training and supervised experience may cure a gap, while appeal can address biased interpretation. The City's conclusion remains about a formation pathway and never replaces voters, appointing bodies, or lawful eligibility rules (OECD, 2020a; OECD, 2022b).

Local democratic fit also protects against parachute ambition. A person may use the City to gain legitimacy in a jurisdiction where they have little accountability, or be imported by a party, donor, or movement for its own strategy. Review must ask who would carry that externally shaped candidacy.

The learning plan should identify the constituency, institutions, language, history, and public burdens the applicant must understand, together with how that understanding can be demonstrated over time.

14.5.3 — Language and Cultural Fit

A valid review system should treat translation as public infrastructure, not as courtesy. If the relevant public cannot understand the applicant's record, the public carries the burden of interpretation. If the applicant cannot hear criticism in the public's language or cultural idiom, the public carries the burden of being misunderstood.

This construct is role-relevant communication and interpretive competence, not assimilation to a preferred manner. Evidence may include accessible language tasks, use of interpretation, cultural scenario analysis, and the ability to recognize uncertainty or seek help. Accent, code-switching, disability-related communication, neurodivergent style, religious practice, or unfamiliar social style may not be treated as incompetence. Qualified language and cultural reviewers should distinguish essential communication from aesthetic preference and offer training or accommodation where feasible. Applicants must be able to challenge biased assessment. Audit should examine whether the process rewards dominant-class fluency rather than public understanding.

Language fit is not a demand for monolingual purity. It asks what languages are needed for the pathway, what translation support is required, how public record bundles will be accessible, how hearings or interfaces will function, and whether the applicant can communicate with relevant publics without relying entirely on curated intermediaries. Translation can help, but it also introduces interpretive power. Cultural fit does not mean conformity to local prejudice or tradition without critique. It means understanding public meaning, historical burden, institutions, symbols, trust patterns, religious and secular contexts, conflict memories, family structures, and ways people experience authority. A participant who misunderstands these may impose burden unknowingly even while intending reform.

Language and cultural review should create support plans where possible: translation, cultural advisors, local mentors, public-interface design, reading lists, hearings, immersion, and explanation practices. Where the necessary competence cannot yet be supported, the review should identify the remaining gap and consider delay or redirection.

The review should name the context in which language or cultural competence matters. A multilingual technical regulator, a local council member, a diplomat, and an emergency executive may need different capacities. The fair measure is whether communication can carry public consequence with dignity and correction.

14.5.4 — Host Legitimacy

Host review should consider symbolic and practical burdens from tourists, protests, security changes, reputational association, housing pressure, traffic, labor demand, and political conflict. It should include staff and service workers as well as officials.

Host legitimacy concerns the institution’s lawful and social relationship with the place that carries its burden, not a popularity vote on each applicant. Evidence includes authorized host processes, community concerns, service load, language practice, recruitment effects, and the standing of affected groups. Applicants should not become proxies for unresolved disputes about the City, nor should local opposition be reframed as hostility to fairness. Independent host review, grievance, monitoring, and remedy may condition institutional practice without producing a personal stigma file. The City must distinguish a problem with its own presence from a claim about the person seeking entry.

Host legitimacy also asks whether the City is recruiting in a way that benefits or burdens the local community. Does the City offer local hiring, accessible public learning, complaint routes, infrastructure support, and meaningful recourse? Or does it import prestige, extract attention, strain services, and leave local residents with the cost? Admissions scale is part of this question.

The host should not have a veto over every applicant, because that could become local prejudice, political capture, or fear of controversy. But host review should inform admissions capacity, cohort timing, public interface design, security planning, media handling, and community burden mitigation. A fair host-legitimacy process should publish aggregate burdens and safeguards without exposing applicants prematurely. It should include complaint channels, public meetings where appropriate, local service review, traffic and housing assessment, and routes for correcting unexpected impacts.

14.5.5 — Anti-Elite Access

In selection review, flag reliance on famous universities, senior employers, political families, donor networks, polished speech, or prior media access as possible opportunity proxies. Absence from them is not evidence of incapacity.

Access support must follow independent, rule-based arrangements, without creating debt or personal obligations as the price of being considered; the assistance and cost controls in Section 14.5.1 apply here (ILO, 2019a; ISO, 2023b).

A recruitment-cost ledger should follow the applicant from first inquiry to final outcome. Although the ILO's evidence concerns labor recruitment, its second global study across 110 countries shows why formal fee prohibitions do not exhaust the problem: travel, documents, tests, intermediaries, and other related costs can still decide who is able to enter (ILO, 2024). The City should therefore count fees, travel, unpaid preparation, interpretation, technology, child care, relocation, lost work, and repeated disclosure. Keep personal assistance details private.

Anti-elite access should follow the full attrition funnel, not only the final cohort. Using privacy-protecting aggregate measures, the City should estimate invitation reach and track

inquiries, application starts, reported barriers caused by document costs or time, withdrawals after repeated disclosure, accommodation, redirection, and appeals. Demographic patterns require careful interpretation rather than automatic quotas, but unexplained loss at one stage is evidence about the gate itself (Fox and Lawless, 2014; Hausknecht et al., 2004).

Anti-elite access does not mean rejecting expertise or experience. Some pathways require technical qualifications, lawful credentials, deep knowledge, or years of practice. The rule is that requirements must be tied to the burden and open to equivalent evidence where law permits. Expertise should enter as capacity to be tested, not inherited authority to be trusted.

Application examples should show equivalent forms of evidence before launch so unfamiliar presentation is not mistaken for weaker capacity (Gilliland, 1993; Hausknecht et al., 2004).

Lack of elite credentials is not automatically wisdom, and elite training is not automatically capture. Review the same role-relevant evidence in both cases.

14.6 — Public Input as a Bounded Open Decision

Public approval remains an Open Decision, subject to the authorization and pilot conditions in Section 14.6.5. Public input must be disaggregated by function. Evidence of conflict, testimony about relevant conduct, local knowledge, reasoned objection, and general approval are not interchangeable. Each requires different verification, response, and weight. A single popularity number would erase those distinctions and make the least informative output the most powerful.

14.6.1 — Public-Input Scope

Public approval scope must be written before public attention is invited. The authorizing rule should identify the pathway, the decision stage, the precise question, eligible participants, information available, response period, and possible institutional effect. A vague invitation to support or oppose a person creates emotion without a lawful object.

The public record should make clear what is known and what remains contested. Status labels, source provenance, applicant response, and correction should accompany any material used. The City should not ask citizens to judge an opaque dossier or reward the loudest allegation.

Timing matters. Input requested too early can expose an applicant before basic eligibility is established. Input requested too late can become ceremonial. A candidate architecture would need to specify a limited window, notice, accessible participation, protection against repeated targeting, and a rule for new information that appears after closure.

If lawfully ratified, input might trigger review, require a reasoned response, add a condition, or contribute one defined source of evidence. It must not silently acquire more weight because participation is high or media attention is intense.

The relevant public must also be named. Host residents, affected jurisdictions, potential constituents, professional communities, staff, and a broad online audience bear different burdens and possess different knowledge. A loud global crowd may lack standing; a deeply burdened local group may still lack authority to discriminate.

14.6.2 — No Applicant Worth Ranking

No worth ranking means that public input cannot produce a civic score, trust badge, leaderboard, moral grade, popularity tier, or portable reputation. The result belongs only to the stated decision and expires with that use. It cannot follow the applicant into employment, campaigns, ordinary social life, research, or another City process.

Minority and unpopular applicants need particular protection. A person may challenge local power, represent a stigmatized group, or refuse familiar political performance while still offering serious public capacity. The process should preserve reasoned minority support, distinguish coordinated hostility, and prevent majoritarian dislike from becoming an eligibility fact (Fishkin, 2018; Landemore, 2020).

Reviewers must resist reputational halo inside the institution. A highly approved applicant should not receive softer evidence standards, privileged access, favorable pathway assumptions, or reduced scrutiny. A controversial applicant should not receive the opposite.

Interface review should test approval percentages, badges, stars, heat maps, ladders, and comparable lists for implied rankings of applicants.

14.6.3 — Anti-Mob Filters

Accessibility, language support, non-digital routes, protected reporting, anti-retaliation, and moderation are prerequisites. Participation cannot require public exposure.

Anti-mob design begins by separating participation from punishment. Criticism, evidence, protest, and organized disagreement are legitimate. Threats, doxxing, sexualized abuse, impersonation, coordinated falsehood, repeated targeting, and pressure on family or staff are not forms of democratic input merely because they occur in public.

Applicant and collateral-person privacy must be built into the interface. Public materials should exclude protected addresses, family information, medical or disability details, intimate history, security-sensitive information, and unrelated personal data. Moderators need authority to remove unlawful or irrelevant exposure while preserving a visible reason log and route for challenge.

Deceptive media and impersonation add a distinct risk. A fabricated recording, altered document, impersonated account, or clipped statement can spread before ordinary verification is possible. The public interface should preserve provenance, accept rapid challenge, mark unverified material clearly, and prevent viral circulation inside the official process from counting as corroboration. The response is not a promise to settle every disputed image; it is a commitment not to let speed become evidence.

Moderation itself is power. Rules should be published, applied consistently, and subject to audit and appeal. Staff should receive support and rotation because exposure to threats and abuse can distort judgment. The City should report aggregate moderation patterns so anti-harassment controls do not become a hidden way to suppress substantive criticism.

The institution cannot control the entire internet. It can reduce foreseeable amplification, preserve authentic records, issue rapid corrections, support affected people, coordinate with platforms or authorities where lawful, and avoid turning abuse into official evidence. A security plan should address escalation without promising universal removal of harmful content.

Where justified, use authentication proportionate to risk, rate limits, protected channels for vulnerable groups, and independent review of unusually volatile public response.

Moderation must distinguish angry but substantive criticism from abusive exposure. Route serious complaints into review, reply, and remedy without requiring contributors to reveal protected facts.

14.6.4 — Public-Input Appeal and Audit

Applicants must be able to see the categories of public input used, the verified facts, the institutional interpretation, and the decision effect. Where privacy or safety requires withholding, an independent reviewer should test the restriction and provide the usable substance. Appeal is directed at the process and evidence, not at winning a second popularity contest.

The appeal body should be separate from daily moderation and original admissions review. It needs authority to correct false information, exclude irrelevant material, order a new evaluation, reduce or remove the effect of a tainted signal, and protect the applicant during review. Timelines should reflect the speed with which public harm can spread (Mansbridge et al., 2012; Fung, 2006).

Citizens also need correction rights. A person whose submission was misquoted, misclassified, exposed, or removed should have a route to contest the record without becoming a party to the applicant's private file. The institution should

preserve provenance and version history so correction does not erase the fact that an error influenced the process.

Evaluation should also ask whether the mechanism adds information beyond ordinary expert review. If public input mostly repeats media visibility, partisan organization, or demographic advantage, its democratic appearance may conceal little independent value. The audit should compare verified contributions, unique concerns, correction rates, participation gaps, and decision changes against the costs of exposure and administration.

Audit must examine participation and consequence, not only technical uptime. Relevant questions include who could participate, whose contributions were verified, which groups faced harassment, what concerns triggered action, which allegations were reversed, and whether public input changed outcomes differently across protected or marginalized groups. Numerical screening rules, where used under local law, are only warning signals and not a complete account of fairness.

Repeated harassment, unequal participation, or unreliable evidence requires redesign, suspension, or abandonment of the mechanism.

Audit should also test moderation consistency and media-driven timing, and whether approval tracks wealth, charisma, party backing, or platform size rather than role-fit evidence.

14.6.5 — Open Decision Label

The narrowest plausible function is advisory: public input may surface information or concern that a qualified human panel must examine and answer. It cannot automatically admit, refuse, rank, or certify an applicant. Whether even that limited function is justified remains open.

The Open Decision label marks a real boundary of authority. Public approval touches democratic authority, privacy, harassment, technology, records, and admissions at once. The City may analyze the possibility, but it may not announce an electorate, platform, threshold, weighting rule, release design, or legal effect without later lawful authorization and transition governance.

Some boundaries are already settled. Public input cannot measure human worth, confer office, prove readiness, override nonwaivable rights, expose collateral persons, authorize research, or create a portable score. It must remain optional to the City architecture unless and until a competent authority ratifies a specific design.

Any future pilot would require a legal basis, privacy and security review, accessibility testing, moderation capacity, applicant support, independent audit, stop conditions, and public explanation of the limited purpose. Testing should begin with the least consequential function capable of answering whether the mechanism adds reliable knowledge. A pilot result would assess the mechanism, not the applicant population or the formal Law.

Absence of public approval should carry no hidden meaning. If a jurisdiction declines to ratify the mechanism, the City may use other lawful review routes. An applicant should not be treated as less legitimate because a public signal was unavailable, and a City should not be treated as incomplete because it refuses a mechanism whose burdens exceed its value.

Until ratification, operational drafts, tests, diagrams, and public excerpts must display an Open Decision label linked to the current authorization record. That record names the deciding body and the unresolved scope, evidence, appeal, anti-mob, accessibility, and privacy questions. Favorable pilot results or public enthusiasm do not change the authorization status.

Before renewal, the public-input process should also face an adversarial review. A red team can test coordinated campaigns, identity fraud, inaccessible interfaces, selective disclosure, platform amplification, doxxing, intimidation, and attempts to infer protected facts from participation patterns. The response cannot be an ever-expanding surveillance layer. It should prioritize scope limits, authentication proportionate to risk, human moderation, rapid correction, protected evidence handling, and the ability to stop the mechanism when its democratic cost exceeds its informational value.

Data minimization is part of the adversarial test. The City should be able to explain why each identifier, comment field, verification step, moderation log, and retained contribution is necessary to the bounded public-input purpose. Participation data must not become a political-interest map, supporter list, dissent index, or source for later applicant ranking. Where aggregate reporting is sufficient, individual traces should be deleted or separated.

14.7 — Acceptance, Delay, Redirection, or Refusal

The threshold ends in a decision, but each decision remains local to an applicant, pathway, time, evidence set, and support environment. Outcome language should therefore carry the same boundedness as the review itself. It must explain what has been decided without creating a portable identity, permanent suspicion, or prestige halo that unrelated institutions can reuse (Gilliland, 1993; Hausknecht et al., 2004). The institution must explain which future review can reopen a disputed finding without converting the applicant into a permanent risk category.

14.7.1 — Acceptance Conditions

The scoped decision record is the chapter's final operating object. It identifies the pathway, outcome, reasons, evidence considered, accommodation offered, unresolved uncertainty, review date, privacy category, appeal route, and conditions for reconsideration. A companion limits field states that the record is not a human-worth judgment, general prediction of public trust, office-eligibility finding, or reusable dossier. The applicant receives an accessible notice identifying the records created, who may access them, and how correction changes the recorded outcome.

Apply the decision-record requirements in Section 14.7 to the named pathway and support plan, including activation conditions, protected boundaries, review dates, unresolved expert issues, and exit routes. Specify triggers for pause or reconsideration: new capture evidence, support failure, consent concern, health deterioration, nonparticipant exposure, or legal mismatch.

Acceptance means readiness to enter this pathway now under stated conditions, supports, and review. The applicant must be able to inspect and correct the operational record before

activation. Private screening material must not become part of a public celebratory profile.

Acceptance into one pathway should not be treated as readiness for every future public role. Acceptance also requires institutional readiness. If the City lacks staff, accessibility support, clinical independence, language capacity, record infrastructure, protected nonvisibility handling, or host capacity, the applicant may be suitable but entry may still be premature. Confirm the required household, shielding, mentor, security, staff, and communication arrangements before activation. Before recruitment, publish the authorized allocation rule for funded places among equally eligible applicants, including waiting-list timing and procedural review. Treat the choice of rule as an Open Decision under Section 29.1.5.

The acceptance notice identifies the counsel, complaint, pause, withdrawal, support-review, and nonparticipant-protection routes in Section 9.1 and Section 9.3, alongside appeal and activation timing.

14.7.2 — Delay Conditions

A delayed applicant should know what information will be retained or sealed and whether support remains available. When the City causes the delay, the notice should identify its unfinished support plan, pathway development, legal review, accommodation, or host-burden work.

Delay is justified only by a defined, potentially remediable condition or by the City’s present inability to support the pathway. The notice should state what is missing, who is responsible for the next action, what help is offered, when review returns, and how indefinite limbo is prevented. It must distinguish applicant need from institutional unreadiness and avoid language of suspicion where none exists. The applicant

may appeal factual or procedural error, decline support, or reapply later without a public mark. Audit should identify delays that function as hidden refusals, especially for disability, poverty, language, care, or documentation burdens.

14.7.3 — Redirection Options

Redirection proposes another pathway or form of service because the evidence indicates a better fit, not because the applicant has been assigned a lower civic value. The City should explain the role analysis, offer genuine choice, protect privacy, and avoid steering difficult or marginalized applicants into less prestigious work by habit. The applicant may refuse the redirection, appeal the basis, seek further information, or pursue public life outside the City altogether. Trial and later movement should remain possible where appropriate.

Maintain appropriate referral partnerships under the purpose, consent, and data-transfer controls in Section 13.6.4.

Outcome audits must not disguise exclusion by recording a refusal as redirection or moving difficult applicants into invisible roles.

14.7.4 — Refusal Conditions

Before a refusal, reviewers should test whether accommodation, delay, support, safety planning, a narrower burden, or redirection can resolve the actual problem. Refusal becomes appropriate when identity cannot be established, no lawful pathway exists, consent remains compromised, material deception is unresolved, coercion or security exposure cannot be bounded, or the City lacks the capacity to carry the burden without shifting harm.

Refusal from the City is not a verdict on citizenship, employment, political participation, or lawful fitness for office (SIOP, 2018; ISO, 2020a).

If refusal review reveals coercion, abuse, exploitation, a security threat, or imminent harm, the admissions process must not simply close the file. Route the concern toward qualified help, legal review, safety planning, or appropriate authorities where lawful. Refusal privacy and necessary reporting follow Section 13.6.3.

14.7.5 — Appeal and Review

The outcome system should audit accuracy and consequence together. It must examine reversals, delays, accommodations, withdrawals, demographic patterns, assessor disagreement, and whether similarly situated applicants receive materially different treatment. Automated tools, where used for clerical support, must also be tested for barriers and adverse impact rather than assumed neutral (EEOC, 2023; ISO, 2023b; U.S. Department of Justice, 2022).

The applicant should be able to challenge factual error, unsupported inference, inconsistent criteria, inaccessible process, denied accommodation, conflict of interest, improper data use, security overreach, or a remedy that does not match the stated reason. The route should be clear at the moment of decision.

The reviewing body needs sufficient independence, expertise, and authority. It should not be limited to asking whether the original reviewer followed internal procedure. It must be able to test the construct, evidence, relevance, source quality, accommodation analysis, decision proportionality, and records handling, and then affirm, modify, reverse, or order a new process.

Use the accessible appeal arrangements in Section 14.1.5 without requiring repeated disclosure of intimate history. Interim protection may be necessary where delay itself causes harm,

such as expiring legal eligibility, unsafe exposure, loss of housing, or continuing false information.

Periodic validation should examine whether the entire screening architecture still serves its intended uses. Pathways, support capacity, social conditions, technology, law, and evidence will change. Instruments and rules should have review dates, retirement criteria, and a record of material revisions. An assessment method should not continue merely because it has become familiar or because replacing it would expose that earlier decisions rested on weaker evidence.

Apply the correction-propagation and receipt requirements in Section 14.1.5 to appeal outcomes. Repeated reversals on the same criterion should trigger criterion-level review rather than leaving each applicant to rediscover the same defect.

Review must examine findings of overcollection, ableist assumptions, class-coded evidence, cultural misunderstanding, unequal legal access, public-input abuse, and security overreach across cases. Track which rules change because review found the original gate unreliable, alongside case closures.

Chapter 15 — Covenant and Stabilization

On a stabilization desk sit ordinary objects with political force: a loan statement, a lease renewal, an insurance card, a child-care schedule, a mobility device repair estimate, and an offer from a wealthy supporter. None is merely private when it can steer whether a future public servant is free to disagree. The chapter asks how support can remove these levers without replacing them with dependence on the City.

The governing material question is where burden goes when support is provided, withheld, conditioned, delayed, or withdrawn.

The Transparency Covenant is the chapter's first instrument because stabilization must be reciprocal rather than benevolent. The participant accepts a role-bound active-period burden: record, correction, review, status honesty, respect for staff, and willingness to be known in relation to public-power formation. The City accepts duties in return: lawful notice, support terms, complaint routes, appeal, audit, care continuity, nonparticipant shielding, donor separation, and exit protection. A covenant that names only the participant's burden becomes extraction. Support that names only the City's generosity becomes patronage. The chapter keeps both sides visible.

This chapter's material boundary is precise. The City secures only the supports needed to keep its own threshold voluntary, role-bound, and free from private ownership. It does not redesign national housing, health care, debt, labor, or social insurance. Those wider systems return to *The Peace of Fairness* and lawful public authority, while ordinary private life remains protected by *The Life of Fairness*.

Private need remains private. The City may know enough to reduce leverage, but public relevance is not public exposure. A support file distinguishes what the support office may know, what an independent reviewer may inspect, what the participant

may correct, what an affected person may challenge, what an auditor may verify, and what the public may receive only as protected summary. Debt, health, disability, family strain, and emergency conditions are not content for institutional storytelling.

The field pressures are demanding and distinct. Anti-corruption scholarship looks for donor separation, gift rules, conflict review, and influence controls. Labor and public-administration practice looks for staff workload, consistent eligibility, appeal, and audit. Social policy asks whether support is predictable, dignified, nondiscriminatory, and adequate for its purpose. Disability advocacy asks whether accessibility support is foundational rather than discretionary. Family-support expertise asks whether dependents and partners are protected from being turned into instruments of an applicant's ambition. A credible City must answer all of those questions without pretending to enact law.

The sequence now becomes materially complete. Motives have been treated as mixed, screening has been separated from worth, and support must be stabilized before the Vow can begin without hidden ownership. Review, pause, return, and changed-circumstance controls follow next. Together the Chapters make the threshold slow enough to protect the person and exact enough to reveal where leverage still remains.

15.1 — The Transparency Covenant in Place

The covenant is an operating instrument, not a poetic promise. It identifies active role status, authorized support offices, the rights notice, appeal, audit ownership, protected categories, and the conditions under which support may be corrected, paused, or continued after exit. Its function is to assign burden through named duties and routes so that participant obligation and City responsibility remain visible together (OECD, 2003; United Nations, 2004). The covenant should also include a support map.

15.1.1 — Covenant Function

A support map names the material pressures known at entry, the support tools available, the person responsible for each tool, the protected information category, and the review date. It keeps the City from solving a housing crisis in one office, a health crisis in another, and a debt crisis in a third while no one sees the combined leverage burden.

A useful covenant function test is whether the document would still make sense during a dispute. If a participant alleges retaliation, if staff allege noncooperation, if a donor tries to claim influence, or if a family member seeks protection, the covenant should identify the route without improvisation. It should tell each person where the burden belongs and which office must respond.

Write the reciprocal duties in a form a skeptical reader can test: identify the participant's obligations in Section 15.1.2, the City's duties in Section 15.1.3, and how each duty can be reviewed.

Covenant administration should review the covenant periodically rather than treat it as settled at signing. Burdens change as the participant moves from application to activation,

from active formation to possible office track, and from support to exit.

Before financial support begins, the Covenant includes a dependency map. Each obligation has an owner, purpose, source, duration, review date, appeal route, amendment authority, notice rule, and exit consequence. The map distinguishes what the participant owes the public role, what the City owes the participant, what staff may enforce, what donors may never influence, and which duties expire at pause or exit. It also assigns responsibility when promised support fails, because unowned gaps become leverage fastest under stress.

A dependency map should be tested by a reviewer who represents the person's freedom rather than the City's recruitment goals. That reviewer asks whether any term can be accelerated, withdrawn, publicized, or renegotiated when the participant criticizes the institution; whether a donor or vendor can identify the recipient; whether family members become guarantors; and whether support decisions affect later pathway judgments. Hidden cross-defaults, informal promises, and discretionary exceptions are more dangerous than an openly limited benefit because they cannot be challenged until leverage is already active.

15.1.2 — Participant Burden

The covenant is distinct from the Transparent Vow. The Vow is the participant's commitment to full active-period record for public-power formation. The covenant assigns the City's corresponding duties to that participant and to the public that depends on the record.

Participant burden must be named without theatrical severity. The active participant accepts role-bound record, truthful status, cooperation with review, respect for staff, correction after harm,

and the loss of certain hidden advantages available in ordinary private formation. They do not accept humiliation, spiritual ownership, medical exposure, family exposure, sexual spectacle, or public use of every intimate detail.

Active public-power formation follows the governed role-record rules in Section 2.4; this duty does not make every captured element public (Tyler, 2006; O'Neill, 2002a).

Participants must avoid shifting record costs onto workers, families, visitors, clinicians, critics, or host-community members who did not choose the Vow.

The participant also carries a duty of status honesty. If they need pause, de-loading, review, exit, or changed-circumstance reassessment, the honest path is to use those pathways rather than create hidden exceptions.

A practical burden schedule can help: what begins at activation, what is continuous, what is periodic, what is triggered by office pathway, what survives exit, and what ends.

15.1.3 — City Duty

City duty should be as specific as participant burden. The institution owes rights notice, care routes, support integrity, staff competence, donor separation, record-stage discipline, nonparticipant shielding, complaint intake, appeal, audit, and safe exit.

Staff need procedures for requests such as medication continuity, dependent coverage, gift rulings, housing repairs, and support appeals. Each procedure identifies intake and review owners, the record created, shielded information, the decision's expiry, and the route for challenge.

Provide accessible covenant and support terms for independent advice before activation. Complex terms require independent

review before agreement; the participant must be able to understand the obligations, protections, and exit consequences.

The most important City duty may be the duty to stop. If stabilization cannot be provided without ownership, if rights cannot be guaranteed, if support becomes coercive, if funding becomes capture, or if nonparticipant shielding fails, the City must pause or refuse activation.

Duties need response deadlines, escalation paths, remedy categories, and temporary relief, with enforceable practice wherever possible.

For a denied support request, give the participant reasons, available alternatives, an appeal path, and risk analysis where safe.

The Covenant also needs a breach-and-repair route. If the City changes a material term, exposes protected information, fails to provide promised support, or allows a donor or operator to create leverage, the participant should receive notice, interim protection, independent review, correction, and a choice among continuation, renegotiation, pause, or exit. A repair decision should state which reciprocal duty is suspended or narrowed while the breach remains unresolved.

15.1.4 — Rights Embedded in Covenant

Voluntary entry does not erase due process, counsel, health care, disability accommodation, family shielding, complaint, appeal, or protection from retaliation.

Complaint rights must cover both participant harm and collateral harm. A partner, dependent, staff member, host-community member, visitor, or professional helper may be burdened by support structures. The covenant should not make the participant the only person who can report harm. If the City

creates burden around the participant, affected people need routes to seek review.

Rights also need anti-waiver discipline. The City should be cautious about any form that asks a participant to waive complaint, future claims, protected categories, counsel access, or appeal in exchange for support. Such waivers can turn stabilization into bargaining with vulnerability, which is exactly what the chapter seeks to prevent.

15.1.5 — Non-Spiritual Framing

The covenant governs role behavior, support duties, record boundaries, and public-power formation. It cannot ask for inward belief; apply the civic and spiritual independence rule in Section 3.2.4. The soul is not the City's jurisdiction.

Participants may challenge support terms, complain about treatment, refuse donor events, leave the City, follow another faith, or reject religion altogether without being framed as faithless.

Use plain civic language in orientation, application materials, support agreements, public explanations, and staff training. Describe rights, duties, notice, support, records, appeal, care, nonparticipant protection, donor limits, audit, and exit. Avoid purity, surrender, consecration, higher life, spiritual rank, or sacred obedience.

15.2 — Debt Relief and Financial Stabilization

Financial stabilization must be handled with enough independence that relief cannot be converted into personal loyalty. A credible design separates eligibility review, payment authorization, donor firewall, public aggregate reporting, and appeal. It distinguishes unsecured debt, predatory obligations, family loans, business liabilities, campaign-linked expenses, and ordinary personal preference. The point is not to erase every past burden. It is to identify which debts create current leverage over the role-bound public-power pathway and to remove or buffer only what the City can justify (Mullainathan and Shafir, 2013; Mani et al., 2013).

15.2.1 — Debt as Leverage

Debt as leverage is not limited to obvious bribery. It can appear as a creditor who can threaten a lawsuit, a family lender who expects obedience, a business partner who holds a guarantee, a donor who offers private refinancing, or a platform patron who covers legal bills. The City should examine whether a debt affects role independence, not whether the applicant has lived a financially perfect life.

Leverage also depends on timing. A debt may be manageable in ordinary life but corrupting at the threshold of public-power formation. Once the participant enters the City, their options, reputation, income, household arrangement, and future prospects may change. If debt becomes harder to service under the Vow, the pressure may rise precisely when the participant is meant to become more answerable.

Debt can also create hidden public narrative risk. A participant may hide debt out of shame, exaggerate financial virtue, seek donor rescue, accept private help, or perform gratitude to people who relieved pressure. These behaviors may appear as

personality issues, but they can be structural responses to debt leverage. The City must read the financial condition before judging the person.

The debt review should distinguish exposure risk from leverage risk. A debt may be embarrassing but not leverage-bearing; another debt may be small but controlled by a person with influence. The City should not collect debt details for curiosity. It should collect what is necessary to understand whether debt can bend public-power formation.

The operational record should also identify what happens if the participant refuses an interested party. If refusal would trigger collection, reputational harm, family retaliation, professional loss, or withdrawal of a guarantor, the debt is not merely financial.

15.2.2 — Relief Without Loyalty

Relief without loyalty combines procedural clarity with human warmth. Assistance arrives as a rule-governed public-interest decision rather than a personal favor seeking intimacy, praise, access, or future advantage. The no-obedience clause in Section 15.5.1 applies, and the record identifies the support category and rule used rather than a sentimental story of rescue.

Studies associate burdensome debt with poorer health, supporting concern about material vulnerability (Sweet et al., 2013; Turunen and Hiilamo, 2014). Gratitude capture is a separate institutional risk the City should anticipate. Participants may protect the City’s reputation because it relieved their distress, even without an explicit demand. Staff, donors, and audiences can reinforce that expectation. Relief without loyalty requires design against these pressures, not merely rules against formal quid pro quo.

Support descriptions should avoid redemption, family, sacred-care, or institutional-generosity language.

15.2.3 — Transparent Terms

For practical use, financial stabilization should be staged. First comes emergency containment, so immediate threats do not govern consent. Second comes verification and prioritization, so the City does not reward deception or overreach. Third comes relief or restructuring under transparent terms. Fourth comes monitoring for new leverage. Fifth comes exit planning. This sequence matters because rapid relief without review can become favoritism, while endless review can leave the participant governed by the very creditor pressure the City claims to remove.

Transparent terms do not mean public exposure of every financial detail. They mean that the participant, oversight body, and appropriate public summaries can distinguish grant, loan, escrow, guarantee, service payment, emergency reserve, and post-exit bridge support. Terms should state duration, conditions, appeal, repayment if any, exit implications, privacy category, and donor firewall.

Add the funding-source category, amount or range, purpose, decision maker, applicable rule, review date, and a protected explanation where facts cannot be made public.

The support terms sheet should also distinguish stipends, debt settlements, dependent-care funds, emergency assistance, and accessibility support. It should name change authority.

Provide a support-change process for newly discovered debt, changed housing costs, dependent care, or medical needs. Adjustments should follow that review pathway without requiring private pleading for essential support.

Transparent terms include a conflict-of-interest statement from everyone who shapes support decisions. Donor, family, political, vendor, staff, and personal ties should be disclosed and reviewable.

15.2.4 — Exit Implications

Exit implications are where support either proves its fairness or reveals its chain. If a participant leaving the City faces sudden debt revival, repayment threat, housing loss, medical interruption, sponsor pressure, or public humiliation, the support has become a soft prison. The City should define fair transition periods, repayment limits if any, hardship review, sealed hardship protections, and no-retaliation rules before active participation begins. A person should not have to stay visible because leaving would make their private life collapse (Haushofer and Fehr, 2014).

The support agreement should distinguish ordinary exit, early exit, pause, suspension, removal for misconduct, removal for misfit, institutional shutdown, and emergency withdrawal. Each may have different financial implications. A single punitive repayment rule for all exits would be crude and dangerous.

Debt relief is especially sensitive. If the City pays a debt in full and then demands repayment upon exit, the participant may become more trapped than before. If the City pays without any conditions, abuse may become possible and public trust may weaken. The better question is what conditions preserve refusal capacity while protecting the public purpose. The answer will likely depend on reason for exit, duration, support type, and review findings.

Exit implications should also protect dependents. A child, elder, disabled family member, partner, or household member should not suffer sudden harm because the participant leaves.

The City's support cannot become a weapon against collateral persons. Transitional care, housing bridge, medical continuity, and dependent protection may be necessary even when the participant's active formation ends.

15.2.5 — Public-Purpose Justification

A useful operational test can be stated plainly: leverage risk rises when need severity, dependency concentration, exit cost, and term opacity rise together. This is not a formal equation of the Law. It is a practical City test. If a participant has high need, few alternatives, high penalty for leaving, and unclear terms, the support arrangement is dangerous even when it appears generous.

The public-purpose standard ties support to the fairness of this formation threshold. Assistance is justified when a specific material condition creates leverage, blocks practical refusal, excludes people for reasons unrelated to the pathway, or threatens continuity of care and dependent responsibility. The standard does not promise to absorb every debt or equalize every private circumstance. It requires a reasoned fit among need, formation integrity, equity of access, bounded cost, alternative support, review, and exit.

A public-purpose memo should accompany major support categories. It should state the burden being reduced, the leverage risk, the support form, the rights attached, the exit terms, the donor separation, the audit mechanism, and the reason the support is necessary for City integrity. This memo should be available to oversight and summarized publicly where appropriate.

Public-purpose justification should include a sunset review. A support category justified at one stage may become unnecessary, excessive, or captured later. Periodic review asks whether the

support still reduces leverage or has begun to create dependency, inequality, or public mistrust (OECD, 2003; United Nations, 2004).

The debt relief stress test should include criticism of the City, refusal of activation, pause for family care, loss of a pathway recommendation, and earlier-than-expected exit. Repeat the test after major changes.

The debt plan should also include a quiet exit simulation. Reviewers walk through the week after refusal, the month after pause, and the first months after withdrawal: which payments continue, which obligations return, who receives notice, what information remains protected, and which adviser can contest an error. The simulation should include a participant with limited savings, one supporting dependents, one with a disability-related expense, and one whose creditor is connected to an employer or political network. If any scenario makes honest departure impossible, stabilization is incomplete.

Creditor independence is practical when debt-relief administration sits outside admissions, pathway assignment, donor relations, and public communications. Published criteria, protected records, independent appeal, and disclosure of creditor negotiations keep relief from becoming character judgment or informal leverage. Creditors receive no privileged access to the participant's public record, and unresolved debt remains a financial condition rather than a moral label.

15.3 — Housing, Healthcare, and Dependent Support

Household stability is public-integrity infrastructure, but the household is not public property. The City needs enough information to keep housing, treatment, food, accessibility, and care obligations from governing the participant, while shielding partners, children, dependents, clinicians, landlords, and family members from spectator use. The two-sided question is what must be stabilized for refusal to remain possible and what must remain private so nonparticipants are not drafted into the Vow (Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, 1991; Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, 2000). Housing, medical care, food, accessibility, and dependent care must work together. Financial assistance cannot compensate for exposing a household through publicity or humiliating people who request daily support.

15.3.1 — Housing Stability

Housing support should identify the provider and define occupancy terms, privacy boundaries, household protections, safety rules, accessibility modifications, complaint and appeal routes, continuity during pause, exit and removal, an exit bridge, and protection against retaliatory relocation.

Housing stability should be defined by adequacy, not display. The City should provide or secure housing that is safe, private where privacy is required, accessible, durable, and compatible with household needs, without turning residence into luxury branding.

Participants need lawful tenancy or equivalent rights.

Housing support should include pre-entry review of current risk. Is the participant dependent on a landlord with political interests? Is a family member controlling shelter? Is housing tied to an employer, donor, campaign network, religious group, or

party? Will entering the City destabilize a household? Will dependents lose shelter if the participant enters, pauses, or exits? These questions locate hidden power before activation.

Housing stability also protects staff and host communities. If participant housing is poorly planned, burden may move into local rents, traffic, utilities, emergency services, or staff housing needs. Housing support belongs inside the host-burden ledger.

15.3.2 — Healthcare Continuity

Healthcare continuity must be designed around treatment, not image. Participants may need medication, therapy, disability care, reproductive care, chronic-disease management, emergency care, or independent clinical judgment. The support system should preserve clinical independence and protected nonvisibility while preventing healthcare dependence from becoming leverage.

Apply the clinical firewall in Section 14.2, including separation of treatment from evaluation and disclosure only of necessary functional support information.

Continuity means care should not be interrupted by entry, pause, de-loading, exit, removal, or institutional failure.

Healthcare planning must also protect dependents and households: entry may disrupt someone else's treatment, alter a partner's insurance, or interrupt a child's care. Count these burdens without exposing the people affected.

Support continuity plans must identify workload limits, backup staffing, safe refusal, handoffs and the replacement route when a contractor fails. Apply the usable-capacity calculation in Section 21.6.1.

15.3.3 — Dependent Support

Before activation, the support system should rehearse a continuity interruption. What happens to housing, medication, clinical care, food access, dependent care, accessibility support, communication, transportation, and legal advice if the participant pauses, the pilot is suspended, a vendor fails, or the City closes? The rehearsal must name backup providers, decision owners, privacy limits, bridge periods, and appeal. Continuity is not a promise that every service lasts forever. The rehearsal should test whether a workable plan can prevent institutional failure from being transferred overnight to the people who trusted the threshold.

Dependent support is ethically delicate because it touches people outside the Vow. The City may support child care, elder care, disability care, transportation, scheduling, or emergency cover because care obligations are real constraints on public-power formation. The support system should protect the dependent's life first and the participant's pathway second.

The support plan identifies care duties, leverage channels, shielded information, available consent or representation, continuity during pause or exit, and remedy if a dependent is exposed, neglected, or used as pressure.

Support does not change the independent rights of dependents under Section 9.3 or authorize their use in publicity, research, model training, recruitment, testimony, or political promotion.

Dependent support should ask what burdens entry creates. Does the participant's schedule reduce care availability? Does relocation affect school, treatment, family support, language access, community ties, or disability support? Does the participant's record status create risk for dependents? Does support create resentment, dependency, or pressure inside the

household? These questions must be asked before activation, not after harm.

Support forms may include care coordination, financial support, protected transportation, schedule design, housing adaptations, respite support, communication access, and post-exit transition. Each form must be bounded. The City should not replace family life or professional care systems with informal institutional control.

The protected dependent-support ledger records changes in household time, money, emergency calls, transport, interpretation and lost rest. Provide remedy for excessive burden shifted by the City, using the review in Section 19.3.4.

15.3.4 — Food and Daily Needs

Food and daily needs are easy to trivialize until they become instruments of control. Meal access, basic supplies, transportation, communication, clothing, hygiene, and ordinary incidentals can all decide whether a participant feels dependent on informal generosity. The City should make daily-needs support predictable and modest, with enough privacy to avoid shame and enough accountability to prevent favoritism.

Daily-needs support can be undermined by the work required to obtain it. Administrative-burden research distinguishes the cost of learning a rule, the psychological cost of seeking help, and the effort of complying with the process (Moynihan, Herd, and Harvey, 2015). Apply that distinction to a routine support request: can the person find the applicable support rule, use an accessible route, supply only necessary evidence, and receive a timely decision without retelling a private history to several offices? A predictable allowance or reusable authorization may reduce repeated processing where lawful and suitable. Compare

that design with reimbursement on actual time, access, error, and staff effort rather than assuming either form is always better.

Information and usable assistance need separate attention. In a randomized study of older adults likely eligible for SNAP, Finkelstein and Notowidigdo (2019) found that information increased enrollment and that information plus application assistance increased it further. Those induced to enroll were less disadvantaged on observed measures than people enrolling without the outreach, so a higher total did not settle who was being reached. The City can use that lesson to test access to an already authorized support: does a clearer notice suffice, or does a person need help completing the route? Examine completion time and who remains unable to obtain support, not just the number of requests. This is a service-access question, not a target for increasing City enrollment. An informed decision to decline participation remains a valid outcome.

Food systems have their own burden ledger. Who cooks? Who cleans? Who sources food? What labor standards apply? How are dietary needs handled? Are cultural and medical needs respected? Does the dining system create class hierarchy? Are staff overburdened? Are local supply chains affected?

15.3.5 — Accessibility Support

Use the verified-status approach in Section 14.1.4 for housing, medication, dependent care, and accessibility support, with purpose-bound access and expiry when the relevant burden ends.

Fund mobility, sensory, cognitive, communication, medical and scheduling accommodations before activation, and review them as needs change. Do not require public gratitude or disclosure of disability to obtain support. Implementation may include assistive technologies, quiet spaces, captioning,

interpretation, flexible routines, ergonomic design, and trained staff.

Accessible design protects staff and visitors as well. The City's public interface, complaint routes, record site, wayfinding, emergency systems, and digital tools must be usable by people with varied bodies and capacities.

Use the private, revisable accommodation record in Section 14.2.4 for accessibility support, including change requests, denial reasons, and appeal.

Accessibility support should be predesigned and responsive. Some needs can be anticipated through universal design. Others require individual adjustment. The City should not force all access into preapproved categories, because human bodies and cognitive patterns do not always match institutional menus (United Nations, 2006).

15.4 — Gifts, Sponsorship, and Anti-Leverage Rules

Gift and sponsorship rules test whether the City can accept help without becoming owned by it. Lawful, audited support may fund the institution, but it cannot attach to a participant's room, debt package, healthcare, family support, mentor, public event, research path, or future office track. Separation must be visible enough to build trust and monitored strongly enough to expose informal access. Integrity frameworks repeatedly show that rules without implementation and verification can become window dressing (United Nations, 2004; OECD, 2003; OECD, 2026c).

15.4.1 — Personal Sponsorship Ban

The personal sponsorship ban covers direct payments, earmarked funds, named support packages, proxy benefits, family assistance tied to one participant, mentor privileges, travel gifts, media opportunities, and support routed through friendly institutions.

The ban should apply before, during, and after activation where the relationship could affect formation or public interpretation. Pooled support, independent grant mechanisms, public budgets, blind contribution structures, and audited institutional funds are safer than named benefactors.

A donor can contribute to a general audited fund where they have no control over admissions, support decisions, participant identity, archive access, governance, or public narrative.

Family sponsorship requires special handling. Family members may have legitimate relationships and obligations, but family rescue can also become pressure. The City should not treat all family help as banned in the same way as donor sponsorship, but it must review whether family support creates coercion, shame, silence, or hidden control. Family leverage review belongs beside the sponsorship ban.

The sponsorship ban should cover public story sponsorship as well as money. A media figure, influencer, donor, party, or organization may try to become the discoverer or champion of a participant. That narrative can become ownership even without direct financial support.

Enforcement should include side-channel review for patterns of preferential help, including introductions and advisory access.

15.4.2 — Gift Limits

The anti-leverage system needs a gift-triage route usable under pressure. A participant or staff member can ask whether an item, payment, service, invitation, housing offer, legal help, medical payment, travel support, family transfer, or public tribute is permitted, prohibited, returned, redirected to a pooled fund, logged publicly, logged under shield, or escalated.

Gift limits should be plain enough to enforce and humane enough to live with. The rule should cover value thresholds, source categories, timing, secrecy, repetition, role relevance, return procedures, donation alternatives, emergency exceptions, and public or sealed logging. A small gift with a clear expectation can create more leverage than a larger audited benefit, while ordinary tokens should not be treated as corruption. When in doubt, the participant should have a simple route to ask before accepting.

Assess gifts by symbolic influence, repetition, the giver’s power, and the recipient’s vulnerability as well as price (OECD, 2005; UNODC, 2009).

Gift limits should apply to participants, closely connected support channels, and relevant staff roles. Staff can also be targeted. A donor or interest group may not need to influence a participant directly if it can influence a staff member, mentor, scheduler, moderator, archivist, or operator.

Gift rules should provide a safe redirection path. People may want to help the City. The institution should make it easy to redirect gifts into general audited funds, public support programs, host-community benefits, or no-gift notices. Refusal should not require personal confrontation each time.

Certain gift categories should be presumptively prohibited. These include offers tied to admission or screening and gifts from vendors seeking contracts or donors seeking access. They also include gifts from parties or campaigns linked to future office, intimate gifts from people seeking influence, and gifts that create a public narrative around a participant's hardship.

15.4.3 — Donor Access Limits

Donor access limits should separate institutional support from personal influence. Donors may help fund the City under lawful, audited, noncontrolling rules. They should not receive private meetings with participants, early access to records, influence over admissions, support decisions, housing, staff assignments, educational tracks, public-facing events, or future office pathways.

The City should not invite donors into intimate formation spaces, private hardship stories, staff personnel channels, admissions discussions, or participant social life.

The same prohibition covers special donor contact with auditors and governance bodies.

Donors may need public reports, aggregate financial disclosures, audited impact summaries, lawful recognition within limits, and ways to understand how funds are used. Reports and briefings must not provide privileged access to participant records, internal complaints, support files, or readiness material.

A donor may be thanked in a general way where lawful and appropriate, but should not control the name, central spaces, archive, Vow, covenant, admissions program, participant cohort, record site, or public meaning of the City. Naming rights can create symbolic control even when formal governance remains independent.

Funding a response to debt, healthcare, construction, cyberattack, staff expansion, or host-community mitigation must not give donors emergency authority or influence.

The donor access rules should be public. Exceptions for public events or lawful ceremonial contact should be structured, logged, and nonpreferential.

15.4.4 — Family Leverage Review

Family leverage review must be careful not to criminalize ordinary family life. Families may love, worry, disagree, help, or need help. The review concerns coercive dependence, financial control, reputation pressure, inheritance threats, care threats, political pressure, and expectations that distort public formation. The remedy may be support, mediation, shielding, counsel, delay, or exit, not automatic suspicion.

Review family leverage through the protected relational-review routes in Section 14.2.3, including safe consultation and shielding of household information.

When family leverage is found, the City may need stabilization measures: independent housing, dependent support, legal advice, mediation boundaries, private financial replacement, protected communication, or delayed activation. In severe cases, entry may need to be delayed or refused because the participant cannot freely accept the Vow under current conditions.

Family leverage review should be repeated after entry where needed. A household that seemed supportive before activation may respond differently once public attention, schedule changes, or support terms become real.

Support review must avoid cultural flattening. Some family structures are more interdependent than others, and interdependence is not automatically coercion. The review tests whether the participant's agency, dependents' safety, and household dignity are protected, not whether the household matches one cultural model of independence.

15.4.5 — Sponsorship and Gift Reporting

Public reporting should make the support system legible without making supported people legible as private cases. It should disclose funding categories, aggregate support amounts, donor separation rules, gift and sponsorship controls, appeal counts, audit findings, corrective actions, and safe cost bands. Those disclosures allow the public to examine whether support is fair, whether wealth creates hidden advantage, whether donors are kept away from individual decisions, and whether assistance creates dependency. Personal debt, health facts, family pressure, dependent needs, disability detail, and household crisis remain protected unless a lawful, narrow release route applies.

Where public trust requires disclosure that a participant received material stabilization, use category-level reporting where possible and preserve the personal-information limits above.

Public reporting should include exceptions and disputes. If a support decision is contested, if a donor rule is violated, if a gift is returned, if a support appeal succeeds, or if an audit finds uneven treatment, the public may need summary notice.

Disclosure becomes more useful when the record shows what changed because the conflict was known. In an advice experiment, Cain, Loewenstein, and Moore (2005) found that disclosure did not reliably neutralize biased advice and could encourage further exaggeration. The lesson is not to abandon disclosure, but to connect it to a response. For a sponsor-connected adviser, record whether an independent check, recusal, alternative source, or bounded continued role is appropriate, and who made that decision. Retaining useful expertise can be justified, but a declaration alone is not the justification. Later review asks whether the chosen response protected independent judgment while preserving valuable advice. The public account can show that chain without exposing unrelated donor or household information.

System reporting should also reveal burdens shifted beyond participants. If stabilization increases host housing pressure, staff workload, vendor concentration, administrative complexity, or local service demand, aggregate reporting should name those effects and the remedy without exposing personal files.

An incident drill should test the anti-leverage firewall. A donor, sponsor, vendor, political ally, or admirer offers a benefit to a participant or family member. Staff must know how to receive the report, protect the person from retaliation, preserve only necessary evidence, return or quarantine the benefit, review any related decision, notify independent oversight, and publish an aggregate lesson without creating scandal theatre. Drills should include ambiguous benefits conveyed through intermediaries.

The donor firewall should be governed by people who can say no to both fundraising and program leadership. It needs authority to investigate indirect benefits, family gifts, vendor discounts, sponsored travel, naming opportunities, employment offers, and

pressure conveyed through intermediaries. Findings should trigger correction of affected decisions, not merely repayment of the item. Where a relationship creates continuing leverage, separation may require recusal, a changed provider, a different funding source, or withdrawal from the proposed benefit. Oversight should revisit continuing relationships after the immediate gift is resolved.

15.5 — Reviewable Support, Not Ownership

Before substantial support begins, a summary of the support-and-exit independence plan should fit on one operational page, with references to the complete terms. It identifies each support, its source, purpose, owner, review date, what continues during complaint or pause, the bridge after refusal or exit, any lawful end condition, the appeal route, and protected information. It prohibits retaliatory clawbacks and states any narrowly defined, disclosed, and independently reviewable repayment obligation. It names the offices barred from using support as leverage and the information withheld from donors, parties, employers, and future selectors. The no-obedience clause in Section 15.5.1 governs every support.

15.5.1 — Support Is Not Obedience

Freedom from obedience must be practiced in training, contracts, donor communication, and daily administration. Staff should expect supported participants to disagree, complain, refuse, leave, and criticize; donors should understand that funding buys neither access nor praise. Participants receive this assurance before support begins, together with usable refusal and complaint routes.

The support file should therefore contain a no-obedience clause. The participant does not owe praise, ideological agreement, silence, continued participation, favored interpretation, emotional availability, private friendship, future endorsement, political alignment, religious participation, research participation, Artificial Intelligence training permission, testimony, votes, or public loyalty because support was provided. Staff should be trained to treat criticism from supported participants as ordinary civic evidence, not ingratitude.

Participants must comply with lawful safety rules, record rules, role duties, staff boundaries, and support terms. Those obligations must serve the covenant's purpose rather than the institution's desire for deference.

Give participants a refusal script covering donor events, public testimonials, promotional use of their support story, pressure to praise the City, informal requests outside role, and attempts to condition support on loyalty.

Obedience risk should be audited through participant surveys, complaint patterns, support-change logs, staff training records, donor contact reports, and exit interviews. The City should ask whether participants feel free to criticize the institution that houses, treats, or financially stabilizes them.

Staff need training to recognize compliance theater. A participant who is materially dependent may perform agreement to protect stability. Staff should watch for excessive agreeableness, fear of complaint, scripted gratitude, and reluctance to refuse. These may signal support pressure, not readiness (Council of Europe, 1997; CIOMS, 2016).

15.5.2 — Support Is Not Silence

Participants may report support failures or misconduct while continuing to receive the health, safety, and exit support legitimately owed.

Complaint routes must address fear of losing support, being called unstable, facing exposure, disappointing staff, or being treated as ungrateful for reporting harm.

Separate complaint channels from the office controlling the contested benefit wherever feasible. Provide independent intake, emergency protection, anti-retaliation authority, and continued support during review.

Whistleblowing protection may be necessary for participants as well as staff. A participant may observe donor pressure, staff misconduct, record manipulation, access abuse, gift violations, family leverage mishandling, or support inequity.

A support complaint must not be used as a proxy for clinical instability or pathway unfitness.

Audit should compare complaint patterns among supported and unsupported participants facing similar conditions. Low complaint rates can mean satisfaction, but they can also mean fear.

15.5.3 — Support Is Not Permanence

Support terms may change when needs or roles change, exit occurs, or review finds error. Change must not become punishment for criticism, refusal, disability, family complexity, or loss of usefulness to the institution. Transition planning matters because abrupt withdrawal can recreate the leverage support was meant to remove.

Support terms should include defined durations, review points, extension criteria, post-exit bridges, and independence planning.

Indefinite support for everyone who once carried the Vow could create a privileged class and make replication unaffordable. Support should preserve dignity and refusal capacity under justified terms, without becoming a permanent reward for visible service.

Former participants should not become a symbolic alumni class by default. Continuing support or visibility requires a specific role, lawful duty, or care need rather than institutional nostalgia.

15.5.4 — Support Has Appeal

The support plan must estimate and address the immediate burdens of leaving: housing transition, care continuity, debt terms, dependent needs, legal advice, records, and employment reentry. Its purpose is to prevent City-created costs from trapping the participant, without promising that departure will be costless.

A support appeal should identify the decision, evidence, authority, deadline, privacy category, interim protection, and independent reviewer. It should allow correction without forcing public exposure, with evidence submission, counsel or adviser access where appropriate, confidentiality, and protection from retaliation (OECD, 2003; Tyler, 2006).

Appeal should be accessible without requiring legal sophistication. A participant should know how to challenge denial, reduction, delay, overcollection, public exposure, repayment demand, donor-contact risk, family-leverage finding, or exit-support decision. The appeal body should have independence, time limits, emergency authority, and the ability to order correction.

Appeal should also be available to affected nonparticipants in defined ways. A partner, dependent, caregiver, or household member may be harmed by a support decision. Staff may be burdened by support misdesign. Host-community members may face spillover. The City must design appeal routes carefully so they do not expose private life, but the affected should not be powerless.

Review whether the decision served the public-purpose standard in Section 15.2.5 and met the covenant’s reciprocal duties.

Provide an emergency appeal and immediate temporary relief for housing loss, medical interruption, dependent danger,

inaccessible support, food insecurity or retaliatory support changes. Use Section 9.6.1 for provisional relief while full review proceeds.

Track appeal outcomes in aggregate. Repeated reversals require review of the support office's criteria, evidence, and procedures, including whether decisions were too restrictive. Higher appeal rates among particular groups may indicate inequity; unusually low rates should prompt inquiry into possible fear of retaliation.

15.5.5 — Support Has Audit

Audit reveals patterns that individual appeals cannot. It examines distribution, denial, reduction, emergency and exit support, donor and vendor relations, housing and clinical interfaces, accessibility, staff discretion, workload, and the effect of support on surrounding people. The important questions are who receives help, who is denied, whose decisions are reversed, where private wealth creates unlogged advantage, and where dignity for participants is being purchased through hidden labor. Monitoring and verification belong to the support rule because institutional burden often appears first as a pattern no single decision maker intended (OECD, 2026c).

Audit must review support's effect on staff. It should examine workload, emotional labor, staffing ratios, burnout, and support decision complexity across case management, clinical care, housing coordination, accessibility, and finance.

Donor audit tests both formal and cultural influence. It asks whether funders shape support categories, priorities, recognition, narratives, emergency decisions, or the institution's willingness to disclose failure. Influence may appear as hesitation, gratitude, agenda alignment, or fear of losing funds rather than a direct

command. The audit must therefore compare policy with actual access and decision patterns (OECD, 2003; OECD, 2026c).

Support audit should use a qualitative integrity checklist rather than a formula or rank. The object is disciplined questioning, not a support score.

The City should audit the language of support as well as its finances. Review should ask whether communications cast recipients as grateful, needy, inspirational, burdensome, heroic, or risky, and whether those portrayals pressure them to remain or stay silent. This is a proposed institutional safeguard against leverage through public language.

Support audit should also examine omissions. What needs are not being requested because participants believe they will be judged? What harms are not being reported? What categories never appear because the intake form did not ask? Hidden need is one of the hardest support failures to detect. Test intake forms with hypothetical needs outside the listed categories and test access with eligible people unfamiliar with the City's administrative vocabulary. Verify that unlisted needs can be routed accurately and that people can find assistance and reach a decision without repeated disclosure. Aggregate reporting should distinguish an unused service from one that was difficult to find; protected individual responses remain outside public performance records.

15.6 — Material Stability as Corruption Safeguard

Material stabilization can be modeled as a sequence of responsibility: identify a leverage channel, choose a bounded intervention, name the owner, protect sensitive information, test whether refusal capacity increased, review side effects, and stop or redesign support that created new dependence. The sequence produces evidence about the institution's integrity without claiming that stability purifies the person. Public diagrams should show how support interrupts leverage, rather than present it as a gift. Public explanations of stabilization should use the bounded support justification in Section 15.2.5 and the reporting rules in Section 15.4.5.

15.6.1 — Stabilization Before Formation

Stabilization before formation should be a start condition, not an optional improvement. If debt, housing, health, food, accessibility, dependent care, or safety is already a foreseeable leverage channel, the City should reduce that pressure before active public record begins. This does not require a perfect life; it requires enough stability that consent, public reasoning, correction, refusal, and exit remain real rather than being built on private panic.

The sequence matters. Screening identifies role fit and risk. Stabilization removes private leverage. Pre-activation review confirms consent. Activation begins the active record. If this sequence is reversed, the City may record a person under pressure and later call that pressure character. The institution must not confuse unmanaged material fear with public-power evidence.

The stabilization plan needs threshold categories: immediate barrier, leverage risk, equity adjustment, accessibility requirement, dependent protection, emergency stabilization, and

post-exit risk. These categories help distinguish support required for activation from support better handled through other pathways.

The stabilization process should also avoid forcing rapid disclosure. Some applicants may need time to understand their own leverage conditions, especially around family, debt, health, or dependency. Speed can favor those who already have organized lives and penalize those carrying complex burden.

15.6.2 — Reserve as Refusal Capacity

Independent auditors must be able to test any claimed improvement in trust against the leverage, refusal-capacity, and side-effect evidence described above.

Reserve is the material ability to say no. It may include money, housing continuity, healthcare continuity, dependent-care continuity, legal advice, transportation, communication access, emergency support, and time. A person with no reserve may appear free but be practically governed by whoever can threaten collapse. The City must treat reserve as a condition of honest refusal (ILO, 2021).

Apply the non-scoring leverage review in Section 15.2, adding the provider's discretion and the strength of independent review.

Reserve also has a temporal dimension. A participant may be able to refuse pressure today while being unable to refuse it next month if support expires, an appeal is delayed, a dependent crisis appears, or a medical renewal fails. Refusal capacity should therefore be reviewed across time, not declared at entry and forgotten.

Reserve design should include protections against both excess and insufficiency. Too little reserve creates fear. Too much reserve may create elite separation, public resentment, or dependence on the City. The right amount is role-specific,

need-sensitive, audited, and tied to the public purpose of anti-corruption. It should be enough to prevent private ownership, not enough to create a privileged life insulated from accountability.

Reserve should include time. A person with money but no time to think, recover, seek counsel, or consult family may still lack refusal capacity. The City should treat time pressure as a material burden because haste is one of the ways consent becomes thin.

15.6.3 — Equity of Access

Participants may need different supports to carry the same public burden. Equal dignity does not require identical support packages.

Equity of access should also include the hidden advantage of already-stabilized lives. A wealthy applicant may enter with legal counsel, housing reserves, medical access, child care, private networks, and reputational protection already in place. A poorer applicant may need the City to provide what wealth previously provided in private. The fairness question is not whether support gives some applicants an advantage. It is whether unequal private reserves are already giving other applicants an invisible advantage that the City has chosen not to name (World Bank, 2020; OECD, 2017a).

Equity does not mean lowering safeguards. A person should not enter active record merely because they have been disadvantaged. Role fit, consent, capacity, and public-risk review still matter. Equity means that material barriers irrelevant to public-power formation should not exclude people or distort the record.

Support should also avoid creating a separate stigma track. If some participants are known publicly as supported participants

and others as self-sufficient participants, the City may create class interpretation inside the record. Support categories should be handled in ways that make anti-leverage design ordinary rather than shameful.

15.6.4 — Stabilization and Material-Burden Boundary

Scope discipline prevents stabilization from becoming a claim to solve every material injustice. The City may learn from debt, care, housing, healthcare, disability, labor, and food burdens, but it owns only support necessary for role-bound public-power formation under the Vow. Public summaries should say plainly that this is not a welfare state, housing ministry, healthcare system, debt jubilee, or macroeconomic program. Broader material justice returns to *The Peace of Fairness* and lawful governments; narrow scope is a condition of honesty, not an excuse for neglect.

This boundary should not prevent evidence from traveling responsibly. Patterns discovered by the City may illuminate wider material burdens: debt structures that narrow political courage, housing systems that create patronage, medical dependence that silences dissent, family care pressures that exclude public service, or accessibility gaps that disguise institutional failure as personal incapacity. Such lessons should travel only through privacy-protected, claim-status-labeled, non-ranking channels. The City may contribute evidence to broader thought without expanding its own authority.

Any service that cannot identify its owner outside the City's role should remain unpromised until ownership is resolved.

Budget review should pair each promised support with the reserve, entitlement, or independent provider that keeps it usable during pause and exit.

Public materials should distinguish guaranteed support, conditional support, and services that depend on external law or provider capacity.

The independence file should flag a support whose continuation depends on the same office judging readiness as a concentrated leverage risk.

The combined-dependency review names concentrated discretion, synchronized expiry dates, hidden intermediaries, and transition gaps before they can govern consent. Its remedy is structural: diversify owners, separate decisions, extend bridges, fund independent advice, or delay activation until saying no remains materially possible. The final activation review should test at least one simultaneous-loss scenario so apparently independent supports are not assumed to fail separately.

Chapter 16 — Review, Pause, and Return

A hypothetical applicant reaches the end of review and asks for three more weeks. A household member has raised a concern, a clinician has recommended a lower load, and the applicant wants independent legal advice before the active record begins. A fair institution does not interpret this pause as disloyalty; it treats time, advice, and reconsideration as part of consent itself.

A useful pre-activation standard is the burden-ready sequence: rest, plain-language comprehension, independent advice, household and dependent review, professional consultation, changed-circumstance check, support-continuity check, record-start explanation, rights explanation, pause route, refusal route, and appeal route. The sequence is not meant to become bureaucratic theater. It exists so that the City cannot call a threshold fair while leaving one of the carriers of burden unnamed.

Consent is not the same as momentum. It is not a signature placed beneath long terms. It is not a ceremony, a public promise, a donor expectation, an internal approval, a family hope, or a psychological desire to be done with uncertainty. Consent inside the Transparent City is treated as an active condition that can be reviewed, paused, advised, withdrawn, and reassessed. A City that mistakes one dramatic yes for continuing consent will eventually ask a person to carry visible burden under conditions they no longer understand or can no longer bear.

Clear status is also a public-trust safeguard. The City must be able to distinguish applicant, paused applicant, accepted applicant awaiting activation, active participant, early exit, and returned applicant. Ambiguity can generate rumor, staff confusion, false archive continuity, and manipulation. Status labels matter precisely where rights, records, duties, and public meaning change.

Two cases show what a functioning threshold can achieve. One applicant pauses during a family health crisis, receives bridge support, returns after conditions stabilize, and reconfirms under updated terms. Another concludes after independent advice that the Vow conflicts with duties to a dependent and leaves without adverse inference, public explanation, or loss of dignity. The institution succeeds in both cases because it protects judgment rather than maximizing entry.

Activation is a two-sided change of state. Before it, the person remains an applicant under protected inquiry; after it, defined capture begins, public status changes, rights and duties attach, review clocks start, and records acquire a new purpose. The applicant may be ready while the City is not, because staffing, accommodation, household support, security, appeal, or record systems remain incomplete. The transition file therefore records the exact time, authority, notice, consent version, unresolved conditions, protected consultations, institutional readiness, and rollback consequences. The threshold opens only when both sides can carry their assigned duties, and any delay is attributed to the responsible side rather than converted into an applicant defect.

16.1 — Pre-Activation Review and Informed Consent

Pre-activation review searches for expectation mismatch. Does the applicant think activation guarantees office? Does the applicant think protected nonvisibility authorizes consequential role activity off record? Do they think capture means instant public release? Do they think support is a reward or a debt? Each mismatch is a future harm unless it is named before activation.

16.1.1 — Cooling-Off Period

Cooling-off begins only after complete plain-language terms are delivered and before active obligations start. Allow a defined minimum interval for reconsideration and explain what can still be reviewed, withdrawn, paused, or challenged. The applicant should neither be rushed toward activation nor left waiting without usable information.

A fair cooling-off design accounts for sleep, consultation time, translation, disability access, clinical appointments, family and dependent care schedules, and the simple fact that a frightened person may need repeated explanation.

For implementation rules, the cooling-off period is treated as a gate with a purpose, duration range, review date, and protected communication rules. The City must be able to state when cooling-off begins, who may contact the applicant, what information may still be provided, what pressure is forbidden, and how the applicant may request more time without creating negative inference.

16.1.2 — Plain-Language Terms

Test plain-language terms with people who are skeptical, tired, disabled, grieving, financially stressed, unfamiliar with the City, or less fluent in the language used in the terms.

The plain-language packet distinguishes five terms that are easy to collapse: capture, access, release, interpretation, and research use. An applicant may understand that the City records active participation while still misunderstanding who may see the record, when public release can occur, how interpretation is labeled, and whether research or model training is permitted. Those distinctions must be visible before activation.

The plain-language packet works in layers: a one-page threshold statement, a practical scenario guide, and a fuller terms document. Each uses the same defined concepts and leads honestly to the next level. Teach-back checks whether the applicant can explain capture, access, release, protected nonvisibility, support, pause, refusal, and exit in their own words. Misunderstanding triggers better explanation, translation, format, timing, or accommodation rather than a score against the person (Manson and O'Neill, 2007; Elwyn et al., 2012).

The terms include examples because abstract rights can sound more secure than they are. The applicant must see sample scenarios: a technical failure, an emergency, a family illness, a partner objection, a clinical appointment, a record dispute, a public release delay, an Artificial Intelligence summary error, an early exit, and a refusal.

Plain-language terms must state both the protections offered and the realities no institution can control. The City can promise defined procedures, named rights, review, remedy, correction duties, support contacts, and honest status boundaries. It cannot guarantee kind public interpretation, effortless life under record, the absence of misunderstanding, future office, trust, readiness, or proof of virtue.

Reject any term that makes the City appear safer than it is or obscures how difficult cases are handled and what consequences may follow.

16.1.3 — Counsel and Advice

The activation file must therefore show when terms were delivered, which independent-advice opportunities were offered, what accommodations were supplied, which questions were answered, what material changes occurred, when the offer expired, when reconfirmation occurred, and which human decision owner approved the transition.

Independent advice is accessible without becoming another privilege of wealth. If only affluent applicants can secure meaningful counsel, the threshold will become more legible for the already protected. The City may fund or facilitate advice, but the adviser's judgment must remain independent of the City's desire to activate.

Independent advice loses value when the adviser is another source of leverage. Family members, donors, political sponsors, party officials, employers, mentors, or movement leaders may push a choice that serves their own interests while presenting it as care. The City does not police every relationship. It names common conflicts, protects confidential access to independent counsel, and makes clear that the applicant may seek advice beyond the people invested in entry.

Advisers must not be paid to produce activation.

16.1.4 — Household Consultation

Household consultation asks whether activation will alter privacy, care, security, housing, health routines, children's stability, household labor, or the ability of nonparticipants to remain ordinary.

Record household consultation through the protected handling rules in Section 16.4.5, including unresolved conditions and required protective adjustments.

A household consultation protocol must distinguish information, burden, and consent. Information tells the household what activation may change. Burden review identifies who may be affected. Consent identifies which household interactions or disclosures are allowed. These are not interchangeable. A family member may need information and burden review without consenting to become part of a record story. The City should provide separate channels where affected adults can describe burden without surrendering privacy or acquiring veto power over the applicant.

16.1.5 — Activation Readiness

Expiry prevents an old decision from silently governing a new life. If activation does not occur within the authorized period, or if a material condition changes, consent lapses for activation purposes. The City must present the current terms again rather than treating delay as proof that the earlier signature remains sufficient.

A pressure event triggers review of whether consent still tracks the decision being made. Donor intervention, a media leak, a family threat, health change, new debt, public controversy, a role retitle, or an altered record rule requires a new cooling-off interval when it materially changes voluntariness, terms, or burden. The reviewer must record that judgment and the applicant's opportunity to respond.

Activation readiness begins with a negative test: what would make activation unfair today even if it looked appropriate last month? Unresolved illness, a dependent crisis, psychological overload, a new threat, an unclear term, a legal issue, financial leverage, accommodation failure, or staff unreadiness requires review. Activation pauses when a material unresolved risk prevents safe, informed participation or a required safeguard is

missing. A stable condition with workable support does not by itself bar activation. Readiness is a documented threshold verified with both the applicant and the City.

Activation requires both the applicant's informed, voluntary reconfirmation and the City's operational readiness under Section 16.6. Every required element must be present; enthusiasm cannot substitute for a missing safeguard (Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, 2014a; WHO, 2021a).

After cooling-off, hold the final pre-activation meeting immediately before activation and deliberately without ceremony. The applicant receives the current terms for the named pathway, unresolved uncertainties, support plan, household and professional consultation status, protected-record boundaries, pause and withdrawal routes, activation consequences, and first review date. They are asked to explain the commitment in their own words and to name what would make them stop. Reconfirmation is valid only when questions can still change the outcome and when declining to proceed leaves the person materially and reputationally safe. Silence, continued presence, receipt of support, or institutional preparation cannot substitute for reconfirmation.

Teach-back should be paired with a reversible non-activation test. The applicant should be invited to choose pause, request another adviser, decline a support term, ask for a narrower record explanation, or leave the meeting without activation. The system then observes whether that choice is honored without persuasion, delay penalty, reputational harm, or loss of legitimate support. Consent is most credible when the institution demonstrates that a no can still change the outcome (Elwyn et al., 2017; Manson and O'Neill, 2007).

An independent consent witness authorized by the activation protocol should be able to record whether the process was understandable, whether pressure appeared, which questions remained unresolved, and whether the applicant used any right without penalty. The witness does not certify inner freedom or replace the applicant’s judgment. The role is procedural: to create a protected route for concern, ensure that the institution answers material questions, and stop activation when the conditions for meaningful choice are not present.

16.2 — Lawful Pause and De-Loading Before Activation

Pause is a defined, non-active status governed by the rights, record, support, and review requirements below (Council of Europe, 1997; CIOMS, 2016). Pre-activation review must account for overload created by screening, support negotiations, family consultation, public attention and repeated institutional explanation. Route it through the pause and support procedures below. De-loading includes informational load.

16.2.1 — Pause Purpose

Pause protects the applicant from having to abandon the path entirely while readiness remains unresolved.

Pause serves many legitimate purposes: health review, family burden, legal clarification, support dispute, financial change, safety concern, disability accommodation, psychological load, spiritual or ethical reflection, or ordinary uncertainty. The route should not force every need into crisis language.

Pause preserves privacy as well as time. When public status already exists, the public may need a minimal notice that the process has paused, but private reasons remain protected unless the applicant chooses lawful disclosure or a defined public-risk duty requires more. Communication states status, rights, and next review without turning the person's circumstances into a narrative event.

A recurring pause pattern must be treated as a City-level finding. If applicants repeatedly pause after plain-language review, the terms may be alarming or unclear. If they pause after household consultation, collateral burden may be undercounted. If they pause after support review, material terms may feel coercive.

16.2.2 — De-Loading Pathway

A de-loading pathway needs concrete options: slower meeting cadence, reduced public-interface preparation, temporary relief from nonessential tasks, clinical check-in, legal review time, family-support coordination, financial-stress review, sleep recovery, sensory relief, and administrative simplification.

De-loading serves truthful decision rather than retention. Care becomes coercive when it quietly keeps a person in the pipeline at any cost.

De-loading needs a light version and a serious version. A light version may reduce meetings, allow rest, or simplify documents. A serious version may involve clinician review, security change, household intervention, support redesign, or legal delay. Without levels, the City may either overreact to ordinary fatigue or underreact to genuine threshold danger.

During de-loading, avoid urgency, disappointment, destiny claims, and appeals to institutional need. Keep the routes to more time, redirection, or exit clear.

16.2.3 — Pause Status Labels

Pause needs a visible owner, not informal permission. The applicant knows who can authorize de-loading, stop public-facing pressure, protect consultation space, continue support, set the review date, and resolve a prolonged status. Staff know the same routes and limits.

The threshold must distinguish inquiry, application, pre-activation review, paused pre-activation, de-loading, redirection, refusal, withdrawal before activation, acceptance without activation, active participation, early exit, and return as an applicant. Each status needs defined rights, record rules, support, staff responsibilities, review dates, and a separately

justified level of public visibility. Clear status prevents preparation from being mistaken for active participation.

Public status labels protect both the applicant and the credibility of the threshold. 'Active,' 'paused,' 'under review,' 'withdrawn,' and 'closed' should correspond to defined facts, named owners, and reviewable timestamps. Prestige cannot justify calling a person active, nor can institutional self-protection justify relabeling an unresolved review as withdrawal.

Repeated pause extensions require reasons; a review date obliges the City to reassess status, not the applicant to activate.

Status labels must be designed with future screenshots, archives, summaries, and public artifacts in mind. A label that seems harmless internally may become harmful when repeated by media, opponents, or supporters. The City must choose words that are precise, calm, nonstigmatizing, and resistant to misuse (Elwyn et al., 2017; WHO, 2021a).

16.2.4 — No Secret Active Status

An applicant may be overwhelmed by documents, status language, family questions, future public interpretation, technology explanations, financial concerns, or rumors as much as by appointments. The City must sequence and stage information to protect understanding rather than bury the person under warnings.

The no-secret-active-status rule prevents the City from receiving the symbolic benefit of participation before the person has entered the Vow. A person who is still reviewing terms must not be used as evidence of launch, seriousness, diversity, momentum, or public trust. Before formal activation, preparation must not impose active-style disclosure, daily capture, public interpretation, or enforcement by implication.

The activation process must treat any secret-active drift as a serious procedural failure. If it occurs, the remedy includes record correction, public status clarification where needed, applicant review, staff guidance, and possibly a pause.

16.2.5 — Reentry Review

Reentry review after pause must not punish the fact of pause. It asks why the pause occurred, what changed or stabilized, what remains unresolved, which consultations occurred, whether support terms and public status remain accurate, and whether the applicant still understands and freely chooses activation.

Returning applicants should not be required to apologize, disclose more, or prove exceptional commitment because they paused. Collect additional data only to answer new operational questions.

Reentry review should record any institutional defect exposed by the pause and assign it to a responsible owner before the applicant proceeds toward activation. An applicant should not return into the same confusing term, support gap, timeline pressure, or household failure that helped produce the pause.

The applicant must leave reentry review with clear status: continue pre-activation, pause further, redirect, withdraw, revise support, seek further consultation, or proceed toward activation readiness.

Reentry review must ask whether the wish to return arises from guilt or embarrassment about having paused; the City must not exploit a desire to prove seriousness after delay.

16.3 — Reversible Participation and Real Refusal

A program may advertise withdrawal while making withdrawal materially ruinous, socially humiliating, professionally damaging, or permanently searchable. The City must design refusal from the perspective of the person who has the least reserve (Council of Europe, 1997; Beauchamp and Childress, 2019). Review refusal patterns with the category-level method in Section 16.2.1, without retaining unnecessary private reasons. Refusal must be tested after a participant has formed actual dependencies, not only at the first consent meeting.

16.3.1 — Refusal Without Stigma

Use the non-stigmatizing outcome language in Section 13.4.5 in applicant materials, staff training, public notices, and donor communications.

Stigma can be formal or informal. Formal stigma appears in public labels, adverse records, unjustified exclusion from future paths, or punitive loss of support. Informal stigma appears in staff disappointment, peer gossip, movement narratives, family pressure, donor frustration, or public speculation. The City must design against both.

Close the refusal process under the record limits in Section 16.3.5; the City may retain the applicable procedural status and any lawful protective obligation.

Audit future opportunities, support decisions, internal notes, and staff discussion for penalties or derogatory treatment after refusal.

16.3.2 — Withdrawal Before Activation

Withdrawal before activation must be simple enough that the applicant does not need to perform distress to be believed. A person may withdraw because of health, family, faith, doubt,

changed ambition, legal concern, fear, ordinary preference, or a judgment that the burden is wrong. The reason may matter for support and review, but the right to stop must not depend on having an institutionally approved reason.

Withdrawal before activation is procedurally distinct from early exit: neither the Total Record Rule nor the active Vow has begun. The City may hold limited application, support, and review records.

Withdrawal includes status closure. The applicant must know what happens to application data, support obligations, public status, staff contact, future eligibility, consultation records, and any existing public explanation.

Apply the category-level learning process in Section 16.2.1 to withdrawals, including reports of stigma encountered during the process.

Withdrawal needs a closeout conference only if the applicant wants it or if a defined operational issue requires it. The City must not demand a confessional exit interview as the price of leaving. A person may owe status clarity and limited administrative closure.

16.3.3 — Early Exit Rules

Rules for early exit after activation must be written before anyone needs them. Rules invented under public pressure will tend to serve image management. The City must know in advance what happens to record, support, rights, status, public explanation, household protections, staff duties, and future eligibility when a person exits early.

The first rule is that early exit remains possible. A participant must not be trapped because the record has started. The City may require status closure, public explanation where needed, record handling, support transition, and review of any unresolved

public-power implications. It may not make exit practically impossible through debt, housing collapse, medical interruption, humiliation, or retaliatory release.

Early exit rules must distinguish reasons without ranking dignity. Exit may follow misfit, health load, family burden, security change, ethical reconsideration, support dispute, misconduct, institutional failure, or simple recognition that the role is wrong. Some reasons require public explanation. Some require private handling. Some trigger remedy. Some trigger future eligibility questions.

The record of early exit must show status without turning the participant into an example. Public-power-relevant material may need to remain. Protected domains remain protected. Nonparticipant shielding remains active. The fact of exit must not license a public hunt for private reasons.

Early exit includes care and debrief. A participant leaving active record may need help with sleep, housing, medical continuity, work transition, family repair, public pressure, and emotional decompression.

The rule must also distinguish exit from removal. Voluntary early exit, care-based exit, mismatch exit, misconduct removal, and institutional-failure exit must not be blurred. Each carries different public meaning, record handling, support obligation, and future eligibility (Deci and Ryan, 2000; Manson and O’Neill, 2007).

16.3.4 — Support After Refusal

Apply the transition protections in Sections 15.2.4 and 15.3 when refusal affects housing, healthcare, debt arrangements, legal support, dependent care, or disability accommodations. The bridge must address reliance created or intensified by entry

planning and end through bounded, reviewable transition terms rather than abrupt withdrawal.

Aggregate audit should examine whether entry planning created avoidable needs for transition support and whether the support actually provided after refusal was sufficient to preserve voluntariness.

16.3.5 — Record of Refusal Limits

A refusal record must be narrow, protected, and time-governed. The City may need an internal record that a person considered entry, withdrew, and received appropriate support or closure. It does not need a permanent public dossier explaining fear, family conflict, disability, finances, clinical concern, spiritual hesitation, or private disagreement.

Purpose limitation is the strongest record rule. Refusal information may be used to close the file, protect the applicant, prevent duplicate pressure, honor a no-contact preference, support appeal, or improve institutional design in aggregated form. It may not be used to shame, blacklist, rank, gossip, train models, solicit donors, or decorate the institution's origin story.

Internal records may capture dates, status, process, support, data handling, future eligibility, and safety or legal duties.

These limits include retention rules: how long application and refusal records remain, which materials may be sealed or deleted, and what a lawful audit, complaint, funding, or protective purpose genuinely requires. Jurisdiction-specific law and expert review will shape the details.

Apply Sections 11.6–11.7 to any proposed secondary use of refusal records.

A refusal record held internally today may later become searchable through new tools or merged systems. Anticipate that

risk by limiting collection, classifying retained data, restricting access, and excluding cross-architecture use.

16.4 — Household, Dependents, Professional Consultation

Consultation is a burden map, not a ceremony of approval. The applicant remains an adult who may choose a public path. But the City must know whether that choice will move burden into a child's privacy, a partner's safety, a dependent's care, a clinician's duty, a lawyer's confidentiality, or a household's ordinary room (Elwyn et al., 2012; Elwyn et al., 2017). Consultation must also protect the right not to consult a person who would increase danger or coercion.

16.4.1 — Partner Consultation

An applicant may have a partner, family member, employer, patron, religious authority, party sponsor, or public ally whose involvement would distort consent. The City must count collateral burden without forcing the applicant into the hands of someone who controls or threatens them.

A reviewable threshold distinguishes affected, consulted, and protected people. Direct consultation is appropriate when a person can speak to a burden and participation is safe; professional or guardian routes protect people who cannot speak for themselves; deliberate noninvolvement protects those whom contact would expose or coerce. The objective is not maximum contact but accurate burden recognition with the least collateral exposure.

Consultation must also account for unequal ability to speak. A partner may fear conflict. A dependent may be unable to express burden. A clinician may be constrained by privacy duties. A lawyer may see risk that the applicant does not want to hear. The City must not treat absence of objection as absence of burden.

Partner consultation begins without an assumption of harmony. A partner may welcome entry, fear it, oppose it,

benefit from it, carry new burden, or exert pressure. The review attends to safety, dependency, care, privacy, coercion, and ordinary life while treating agreement as information rather than proof and disagreement as information rather than obstruction.

Use the protected route in Section 14.2.3 whenever ordinary partner consultation could increase coercion or danger.

A spouse, partner, or intimate household member may carry real burden from activation: schedule change, public attention, household record boundaries, security concerns, relocation, emotional strain, dependent care, public speculation, and altered privacy.

The consultation must clarify what the partner is and is not consenting to. A partner may consent to particular discussions, support arrangements, or household planning. That does not mean consenting to exposure, public interpretation, relationship records, or inherited participation.

Partner consultation is recorded narrowly: that consultation occurred, what protective conditions are required, and whether unresolved threshold issues remain. Emotions, fears, intimate details, and private history stay outside the public formation record. The partner retains standing as an affected person.

16.4.2 — Dependent Impact Review

The consultation framework must therefore use multiple routes rather than one conversation. Written information, private questions, confidential complaint channels, professional review, dependent-care assessment, and later check-ins may each reveal different burdens.

Dependent-impact review begins from protection and noninheritance. A child, elder, disabled dependent, patient, or other vulnerable person may affect the timing and conditions of activation through care, housing, security, travel, or schedule

needs, but does not inherit the applicant's Vow or become public proof of the applicant's character. The City counts the impact while shielding the dependent from exposure.

Dependent review asks practical questions: who provides care, what changes under activation, what backup exists, which travel or security burdens appear, what record exposure is possible, which school or health routines could be affected, and what happens under pause or exit.

Children receive the strongest protection because they did not choose the threshold. Their image, school, peers, location, health, emotions, and family history remain outside any attempt to demonstrate that an applicant is loving, stable, or serious. When activation attracts attention toward a child, the City treats that attention as a concrete burden requiring shielding, support, and review.

Dependent-impact review also looks for indirect coercion. An applicant may believe entry is the only way to support a dependent, or may feel forced to refuse because care would otherwise collapse. Family members, donors, or sponsors may try to use a dependent's needs as leverage. Detecting those pressures before activation preserves both the applicant's choice and the dependent's welfare.

16.4.3 — Clinician Consultation

Clinical consultation addresses foreseeable health, mental-health, medication, sleep, trauma, disability, sensory, and care-continuity concerns before activation.

Where a clinical threshold finding about support, safety, or load is needed, use independent clinicians under Section 14.2.2 and keep consultation content protected.

At the same time, clinician consultation must be taken seriously when it identifies danger. Severe overload, acute crisis,

untreated instability, unsafe sleep conditions, coercive pressure, or inability to sustain the threshold may require delay, de-loading, redesign, or refusal.

Record clinical consultation through the protected stub in Section 16.4.5, including functional threshold concerns, accommodations, support requirements, and review date.

Clinical review includes a threshold-specific load map. The map must identify expected stressors, protective factors, warning signs, accommodation needs, emergency contacts, and conditions that trigger pause.

16.4.4 — Legal Consultation

The legal consultation record must protect both proof of process and confidentiality. The City may document that access to legal review was offered, that major categories were reviewed, and that unresolved legal issues were routed. It must not collect privileged advice or use consultation content as future evidence against the applicant.

The consultation must cover the difference between City commitments and enforceable law. The City may describe duties, rights, support, archive rules, and status labels. Jurisdiction-specific enforceability, legal remedies, confidentiality, family law, employment effects, public-record requirements, privacy obligations, professional duties, and future campaign or office implications require proper legal analysis.

Legal consultation must also identify collateral legal issues: custody, dependent care, immigration status, employment contracts, debt obligations, housing, disability rights, safety orders, professional licenses, or obligations to public institutions. These may affect activation readiness without becoming public narrative. An unresolved legal issue that prevents lawful, informed activation must pause the threshold until resolved.

16.4.5 — Confidential Consultation Handling

Where a consultation record is necessary, consent governance must use a protected, minimal summary rather than the full content where possible. This protected stub can show that consultation occurred, that a category was reviewed, that a recommendation or unresolved issue exists, and that a next step was assigned. It must not expose the substance unless lawful review, safety, or rights require it.

Confidential handling includes breach response. If protected consultation content is wrongly accessed, summarized, hinted at, or used in role review, the City needs correction, sealing, reviewer replacement, staff discipline where appropriate, notice where safe, and audit of the failure path.

A consultation-handling matrix must identify who may know the existence of a consultation, who may know the category, who may know operational implications, and who may know content (European Union, 2016; CIOMS, 2016). Access should contract again when the consultation's operational purpose ends, rather than persisting because a staff member once had a reason to know.

The matrix must be tested with hard cases: a partner safety concern, a clinician warning, legal uncertainty, dependent risk, and an applicant's fear of public exposure. If the City cannot route each case without either hiding needed status or spreading private detail, the consultation system is not ready for activation.

16.5 — Capacity Reassessment as Conditions Change

Capacity is not a fixed character trait. A person may be capable of understanding the Vow under one set of conditions and temporarily unable to carry it under another. Illness, exhaustion, grief, panic, coercion, medication change, pregnancy, caregiving crisis, debt shock, legal threat, public harassment, or security risk can alter the fairness of activation (Appelbaum, 2007; Grisso and Appelbaum, 1998). Changed-circumstance review needs a low threshold for opening and a careful threshold for action.

16.5.1 — Health Change

Health change includes visible and invisible conditions. Surgery, chronic illness flare, pregnancy, miscarriage, medication change, disability shift, sleep collapse, pain escalation, infection, cognitive change, addiction relapse, trauma response, or new diagnosis may all change readiness.

Apply the consultation-record limits in Section 16.4.3 to health-change review, recording only functional implications, support requirements, risk, and the effect on activation.

Some health changes require an immediate pause: acute distress, unsafe loss of sleep, inability to understand the terms, inability to consult privately, or a medical condition that makes activation hazardous.

After any immediate safety or consent concern is secured, review whether schedule, sensory design, medical continuity, sleep protection, mobility access, device limits, or protected nonvisibility adjustments can support safe activation. Delay may still be necessary; accommodation must be considered before exclusion. Even a well-supported applicant may choose pause or refusal, and the availability of a modification cannot be converted into pressure to proceed.

16.5.2 — Family Change

A person must be able to request review without proving collapse, but the response must be proportionate. Some changes require explanation, some require support adjustment, some require pause, some require legal review, and some require refusal or redirection.

Family change can alter consent without changing the applicant's ambition. A parent becomes ill, a child needs care, a partner loses work, a custody issue appears, a household becomes unsafe, a dependent's support fails, a funeral occurs, or a family conflict escalates.

Family change is disaggregated by effect on consent, availability, household safety, child protection, dependent care, privacy, legal status, and public exposure. Custody may require legal review, school disruption may require shielding, partner conflict may require safety planning, and death may require grief support and delay.

Use the protected consultation records in Section 16.4.5 to record the family change's operational effect without publishing household details.

Grief can change the fairness of activation even when formal capacity remains. Death, illness, separation, crisis, or conflict may make entry technically possible and humanly unwise. A dignified threshold gives the person room to pause and return without making public-purpose language compete with mourning.

16.5.3 — Security Change

Reassessment distinguishes changed fact from changed understanding. External conditions may remain stable while the applicant comes to understand the Vow, public exposure, or household cost differently. That deeper comprehension matters.

A person may truthfully say, 'I now understand this burden in a way I did not when I signed.'

Reassess changed threats under the conduct-based, proportionate review rules in Section 14.4, with time limits, appeal, and a defined return path.

Security change can transform activation conditions. Public attention, stalking, targeted harassment, threats, doxxing, organized opposition, domestic danger, political hostility, cybersecurity risk, travel risk, or family vulnerability may appear before activation.

Security reassessment distinguishes threat to applicant, household, staff, records, nonparticipants, public interface, and institutional continuity. Distinguish intrusion or stalking from lawful protest; hostile coverage alone does not establish a specific threat. Each risk needs its own evidence, authority, mitigation, privacy, review, and expiry.

Security change may require delaying activation, altering public status, strengthening nonparticipant shielding, adjusting visitor plans, changing communication channels, updating device protocols, or engaging lawful authorities. The City must not improvise quietly. Security steps must be logged and reviewed while protecting sensitive details from public misuse.

Security burden rarely stays on the named target. A threat to the applicant may endanger a child, partner, clinician, receptionist, security worker, neighbor, or service worker. The review maps where risk travels and prevents the institution from protecting the visible person by transferring exposure downward.

16.5.4 — Financial Change

Financial change matters because it can reopen leverage. A debt call, lost job, medical bill, family emergency, housing cost,

creditor threat, legal expense, immigration cost, transport loss, or emergency need can make a person suddenly vulnerable to donors, private rescuers, employers, family patrons, or institutional pressure.

Financial reassessment asks whether refusal has become unaffordable, pause unsafe, or activation materially pressured. If so, the leverage must be repaired or the threshold delayed.

Update the dated debt and dependency records in Sections 15.1.1 and 15.2.1 with new offers, obligations, guarantees, due dates and informal expectations; apply the independent support-and-exit test in Section 15.5 to changed conditions. Under Section 15.4.5 disclose only support categories, aggregate costs, conflicts and safeguards as justified. Private hardship does not become public moral evidence.

16.5.5 — Psychological Load Change

Reassessment also recognizes improvement. A family burden may resolve, treatment may stabilize, legal ambiguity may clear, financial leverage may be removed, or psychological load may decrease after rest. Review is not only a route to delay; it is how activation proceeds cleanly when conditions become fairer.

Psychological load change must be treated without shame and without amateur diagnosis. Anxiety, depression, trauma activation, grief, panic, obsession, exhaustion, public dread, insomnia, moral injury, humiliation, or identity strain may change how a person hears the threshold. The City must route such changes to qualified support rather than turning them into moral or political labels.

Psychological-load review asks whether the applicant can still understand terms, choose without overwhelming pressure, use support, ask questions, refuse, pause, and plan for record burden.

If those capacities are materially compromised, de-loading or delay is the fairer route.

The review describes changed load rather than attaching a permanent label. Sleep, comprehension, consultation, decision pressure, hidden distress, public attention, archive anxiety, and the ability to maintain boundaries all matter. The file should show which condition changed, what support or reduced public-interface pressure was offered, what remains uncertain, and when the conclusion expires.

Use the de-loading levels in Section 16.2.2, with independent counseling or peer support where appropriate. Reduce demands rather than add institutional material for an overloaded applicant to manage.

Reassessment must distinguish recovery from continued endurance and record which support changes actually reduced the load. Use the compliance-pressure observations in Section 15.5.1 when apparent agreement may reflect a wish to end pressure.

16.6 — Activation as Public-Power Threshold

Activation is the documented transition between protected applicant status and active participation under the Transparent Vow. At one declared threshold, notice is issued, active-period capture begins, the full participant-rights bundle becomes operational, limited public status may begin, staff and support duties deepen, and the first review clock opens. These acts should remain separately identifiable and reconstructible, and none may be shifted retroactively or treated as ceremonial. Activation is fixed prospectively and cannot be rewritten after the fact. Record start cannot reach backward into applicant life, move forward to excuse early breakdown, lag behind imposed burdens, or follow a premature public announcement.

16.6.1 — Activation Notice

Activation notice must reach the participant, oversight, and the operations, archive, care, rights, ombuds, security, access-control, mentor, and support teams responsible for the new status, plus any protected interfaces that need status information. Notice must not broadcast unnecessary application history, household details, health facts, legal concerns, or reasons for prior delay.

A good notice must be short, clear, and role-specific. It must identify the activation time, status, rights start, record start, support contact, complaint route, pause and exit route, and review clock. It must not carry celebratory language that makes later pause feel like failure.

Issue public notice only when required or appropriate, using the limited status fields and protections in Section 16.6.4.

Preserve the notice’s threshold statement in the record, including the role pathway and the limits on its meaning specified in Section 16.6.4.

The notice must also be versioned. If an error is corrected, if public status changes, if security limits alter disclosure, or if the role pathway is adjusted, the record must show the version history.

16.6.2 — Record Start

The record-start marker must be technically and publicly auditable without exposing protected material. A timestamp, responsible custodian, system-status check, backup confirmation, and rights notice can make the beginning legible. The City must not accept active burden when capture infrastructure is uncertain, degraded, or unreviewed.

Technical failure at or near record start must be treated as a status event. The City needs contingency rules for delayed activation, reattempt, emergency capture, or rescheduling. It must not pretend the start occurred cleanly if it did not.

Record start must be tested by a dry-run procedure before any real activation. The City must simulate activation, capture, protected nonvisibility, technical failure, staff notification, correction, and public status before a human life is placed under the system.

The first active record should carry a reader-orientation note. It identifies the role-bound purpose of the record and distinguishes capture from public release, operational records from inner life, and participation from separate research or Artificial Intelligence training authority. Beginning with those distinctions helps later readers interpret the archive without treating access as permission to infer everything about the person.

16.6.3 — Rights Start

“Rights start” means that the additional safeguards required by active participation are fully operational when its burdens begin. Existing rights and pre-activation protections continue. Tested

routes for notice, counsel, complaint, appeal, care, protected nonvisibility, correction, anti-retaliation, support review, staff dignity, and exit must already be ready to use when the active record starts.

Staff receive named duties, response clocks, escalation routes, and interim-relief authority.

The active-role safeguards also protect nonparticipants without displacing their existing rights. Household members, partners, children, visitors, professional helpers, staff, bystanders, and affected persons may have remedy routes because active participation can affect them.

The first review period includes a rights-start test (European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b). Did the participant know the routes? Did staff respond correctly? Were protected domains actually protected? Was any complaint chilled by confusion or fear?

16.6.4 — Public Status

Public status releases only the facts needed to make active burden intelligible: participation has begun, the role pathway, activation date, applicable rules, rights summary, status limits, and review clock. Doubt, family consultation, clinical advice, financial repair, and prior pause remain within their protected records. The page supports accountability while expressly withholding moral rank, office entitlement, generalized trust, and scientific meaning.

Where security, privacy, or protected circumstances require delayed or limited status disclosure, the City must handle that through lawful labels, not silent confusion. A limited public status can still be honest if its limits are classified, reviewed, and explained without exposing protected facts.

Apply the quotation and screenshot review in Section 16.2.3 to the public-status page so its concise fields remain accurate when shared.

16.6.5 — Activation Review Clock

Early, periodic, and triggered review examine load, support, rights, record integrity, household and dependent burden, health, staff interactions, public-interface pressure, and the threshold's own performance. Each review has an owner, evidence lanes, protected handling, possible outcomes, and authority to adjust the course.

Check participants' understanding, status handling, and how activation language affects later applicants' willingness to pause or refuse.

Use participant reports, staff observations, archive performance, and ombuds and complaint data. Clinical input, public-interface effects, and household or dependent-burden evidence may also matter; protect personal information.

Oversight should be able to see that early review occurs, which categories it covers, when it is due, and what aggregate patterns emerge. Individual medical, household, and protected details remain shielded (OECD, 2022a; World Bank, 2020).

Findings about overload, nonparticipant burden, staff strain, record breakdown, or public-interface harm should trigger adjustment, pause, narrowing, remedy, or exit.

Part V — Living Under the Vow

A civic institution proves its humanity in the ordinary hours when people wake tired, wait for help, miss a meal, carry family worry, absorb criticism, or finish work after everyone else has gone home. A careful charter, protected rights, a bounded record, a beautiful campus, and an honorable purpose matter because they should make those hours more livable, not merely make the institution look serious. Part V tests the City at that level. The Transparent Vow earns credibility when it becomes a humane morning, a recoverable evening, protected sleep, dignified household boundaries, and work that does not consume the people who sustain it.

Visibility can discipline conduct and deform it at the same time. A participant may begin to wake for the archive, phrase intention for future readers, stage humility, or convert fatigue into evidence of sacrifice. Searching for a supposedly pure self would only create another performance. The better response is institutional: bounded release, protected ordinary intervals, context before interpretation, multiple forms of evidence, and review of whether observation pressure is distorting conduct. Sociological work on presentation and organizational research on transparency explain why this double effect belongs inside the design rather than outside it (Goffman, 1959; Bernstein, 2012).

The body is a further test, because active-role observation adds work to activities that already have physiological limits. Hyperarousal, sleep disruption, sensory strain, social vigilance, and cumulative load are risks to examine, not established outcomes of an untested City. They should inform lighting, device use, quiet periods, weekly rhythm, clinical access, accommodation, and the authority to pause. Treating these possibilities as design constraints supports prevention without

turning health into public evidence or assuming that every participant will experience the same strain.

Households reveal a major route by which civic burden can move beyond the person who chose it. Spouses, partners, former partners, children, elders, dependent adults, caregivers, roommates, and friends retain independent standing even when schedules, housing, travel, public attention, care work, custody, pregnancy, conflict, or exit affect them. The City's duty is to recognize and resource the burden it creates, then provide complaint and remedy without converting family life into a subsidiary record. Household members are rights-holders in their own lives, not evidence surrounding a civic subject.

Intimacy and bodily dignity require a distinct discipline because public appetite often borrows the language of civic interest.

Staff make the Part's promise possible. They cook, clean, repair, schedule, moderate, archive, teach, mentor, treat, translate, secure, audit, and absorb emotional strain that can disappear from the public story. Their influence remains traceable where it shapes public-power formation, while employment never converts them into scenery or subjects of the participant's active-role formation record. Privacy, professional independence, representation, workload limits, complaint routes, and stop authority belong to the workers themselves. Labor and workplace-health guidance makes the design test concrete: noble purpose never cancels psychosocial risk, unsafe workload, or the right to a healthy working environment (International Labour Organization, 2023; ISO, 2021b; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

Chapter 17 — The Architecture of a Day

An ordinary schedule must remain usable when the day changes. A health concern, a difficult public encounter, or a delayed task can alter what a participant and the staff can reasonably carry next. An overrun calls for decisions about what to defer, who needs notice, and whose protected time the delay could displace. Chapter 17 follows that full rhythm and asks whether visible formation can make responsibility more answerable while preserving the body, unperformed friendship, quiet, and the right to recover. Morning plans, adjustments during the day, and evening review must belong to one coherent process.

The chapter moves through morning checks, work blocks, meals and movement, public interface, and evening recovery. It then asks what routine can reveal and how observation can distort it. These stages form a temporal charter: a design of time that shows where burden enters, who carries it, and when adjustment or relief is due.

The Day Reconstruction Method studies recalled daily experience as a sequence of episodes; recovery research distinguishes restoration from the mere absence of assigned work. Status, load, and available support can become legible; consciousness cannot be requisitioned as public evidence (Kahneman et al., 2004; Sonnentag and Fritz, 2007; Nissenbaum, 2010).

A schedule distributes more than appointments. It allocates cognitive intensity, interruption rights, public access, physical recovery, staff load, and the quiet in which someone can notice that something is going wrong. Occupational-health research shows that demand must be interpreted together with control, resources, recovery, and social support. The City therefore makes pace, break integrity, interface load, and accumulated small duties contestable before strain hardens into error or harm

(Karasek, 1979; Bakker and Demerouti, 2007; Sonnentag and Fritz, 2015).

Daily design accommodates disability, caregiving, illness, religious or secular observance, travel, crisis, and different forms of concentration. Equality does not require identical hours. It requires role- and need-based reasons, support that follows burden, and accommodations that do not become a quieter route to exclusion. The result is a day flexible enough to remain human and structured enough to remain answerable (United Nations, 2006; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

Recoverability is the daily-life argument's final standard. A difficult day does not become a failing identity, and a strong day does not become a permanent expectation. Schedules, reviews, and public summaries carry clocks that permit revision. The City learns from patterns without trapping a person inside yesterday's pattern, allowing routine to inform public responsibility without becoming destiny (Schlossberg, 1981; Sonnentag and Fritz, 2015).

17.1 — Morning: Reentry Into Public Time

Morning design marks the resumption of scheduled role work without dramatizing it. The wake transition tells the participant which record conditions apply, what protected handling remains intact, and what support is available. It does not create a ritual of awakening for public consumption. Public understanding comes from the clarity of the burden and its safeguards, not from watching a person wake (Goffman, 1959; Bernstein, 2012; Nissenbaum, 2010).

17.1.1 — Wake Transition

Resuming scheduled role work does not reactivate the Vow. Participant status and rights continue during protected rest; ordinary sleep and bodily life remain outside routine capture under Section 7.1 and Section 18.2.5.

Before scheduled role work begins, confirm with the participant that arrangements for the role record are ready and that continuing protected handling is correctly labeled (Bowker and Star, 1999; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Staff should not have to improvise this threshold. The daily protocol should state who verifies status, what systems confirm continuity, what happens if the participant wakes distressed, what counts as an irregular start, and how the record notes the difference between normal reentry and exception.

The operational standard should be simple enough that the participant can understand it while tired. A three-part signal can carry most of the burden: scheduled role work is resuming, any exception from the night has been labeled, and first obligations are now governed by the day schedule.

A useful wake transition should also create a small audit trail for later disputes. If a technical system failed overnight, if a clinician extended protected handling, if an emergency

interrupted sleep, or if a delayed start was authorized, the morning transition should point to the relevant status label.

17.1.2 — Health Check-In

Sleep quality, pain, illness, medication, disability, distress, fatigue, and sensory strain all change the burden of public-power formation.

Health check-in is nonpunitive triage of what the day can safely carry. It must not supply a readiness score or psychological profile (Nissenbaum, 2010; Bernstein, 2012).

The record treatment of health check-ins must be carefully bounded. Some information may be operationally necessary. Some belongs in protected clinical handling. Some may require only a status label such as load reduced, delayed start, or care route activated. The City should collect the minimum necessary for schedule, safety, and fairness, while refusing to convert health data into public curiosity.

Route only the operational health information each role needs so mentors, educators, security, clinicians, and operations staff do not misclassify fatigue, anxiety, or overload as misconduct.

Routine check-in does not replace clinical judgment. Available responses are ordinary schedule, reduced load, clinical review, delayed start, de-loading, emergency care, or no change.

The daily health protocol should distinguish self-report, observed concern, clinical route, schedule adjustment, and emergency escalation.

Regular accommodation, medication timing, mobility support, sensory protection, and clinical review belong in the daily schedule.

17.1.3 — Day Intent Record

The day intent record names the main burdens, tasks, duties, and expected interfaces of the day without requiring an inspirational statement for the archive.

The record helps distinguish intention, plan, adjustment, and outcome. A participant may intend serious study but be interrupted by a health issue. They may plan deliberation and discover they were unprepared. They may intend public contact and need closure because crowd pressure becomes unsafe. The day intent record gives later review a baseline without pretending that the baseline proves motive.

The day intent record should be brief enough to be usable and concrete enough to be reviewable. An ideal entry names task, burden, expected public interface, and likely support need. For example, a participant might record that the day centers on reviewing citizen housing reports, drafting an explanation, and protecting recovery after a difficult opposition session.

Entries should be plain enough to compare directly with the evening review.

The day intent record should remain amendable. A midmorning emergency, public input, health change, or staff issue may alter the day. Amendments should not be treated as failure. They show whether the participant and the City can update duty without hiding the fact that the morning plan changed.

17.1.4 — Private Feeling Versus Public Role

The distinction between private feeling and public role is essential because record systems tempt interpretation. If a participant looks tired, a viewer may infer dishonesty. If they are quiet, someone may infer guilt. If they smile, someone may infer manipulation. The City should teach readers and reviewers that

conduct can be observed, context can be noted, and role response can be evaluated, but inner life cannot be claimed by the archive (Goffman, 1959; Bernstein, 2012; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Private feeling may still matter operationally. If a feeling becomes severe distress, overload, anger affecting staff, panic affecting deliberation, or grief requiring support, the City should route care and adjust burden. But the route is care and role management, not public extraction. The record may state that a support pathway was activated without exposing what does not need to be exposed.

Where demeanor, fluency, calm, fatigue, facial expression, or social style is relevant, the record site can identify the observed conduct, source, setting, uncertainty, correction history, and decision relevance. Do not convert those observations into claims about inner truth or general character.

17.1.5 — Morning Nonperformance Norm

The morning nonperformance norm prevents staged awakening. A participant should not be rewarded for looking ready, humble, disciplined, serene, grateful, or courageous at the first public edge of the day.

Apply the ordinary-life capture limits in Section 7.1 and the sleep rules in Section 18.2.5. Any separately justified role record from the morning requires a public-purpose release decision and a less exposing alternative where sufficient.

That protection also governs media and public-artifact rules. Promotional materials should not use waking, dressing, exhaustion, tears, or early vulnerability as proof of civic seriousness.

The norm should extend to internal culture as well as public release. Staff should not circulate favorite morning moments,

compare participants by early discipline, or build informal mythology around those who appear serene.

17.2 — Work Blocks: Study, Deliberation, Visible Labor

The schedule must distinguish kinds of work rather than compressing all serious activity into productivity. Each work block answers a different burden question. Study asks how the participant receives knowledge before speaking. Drafting asks how thoughts become public form.

17.2.1 — Study Block

The study block protects learning time before declaration. Public-power seekers often live under pressure to respond, position, explain, and persuade before they have understood enough. The City must create spaces where the participant is expected to receive complexity before producing an answer.

A study block should make sources visible without turning reading into a performance of intelligence.

Study tests the ability to answer a strong objection. In a declared teaching exercise, the participant receives one sound criticism and one plausible but faulty criticism of a fictional policy brief. The task is to identify the relevant evidence, revise the brief where warranted, and explain why an unsupported objection does not justify change. Reviewers use a prepared factual key while leaving genuinely contested value judgments open. Learning is visible in the quality of the response, not the speed of agreement with a teacher.

Staff and mentors can guide sources, explain context, and correct misunderstanding without becoming hidden authors of the participant's mind. Material influence is traceable where it shapes reasoning or public work, while authorship and judgment remain with the participant. The record should make assistance visible at the level needed for accountability rather than converting education into concealed political control.

A strong study block should include source-status discipline. Some material is law, some administrative practice, some testimony, some journalism, some scientific uncertainty, some partisan claim, some lived burden, and some expert disagreement. Participants should learn to label the kind of source before using it.

Ask which burdens a source notices and which it misses, even when the source is prestigious or ideologically familiar.

The study block should also include notes on what remains unknown. Public-power education is distorted when participants learn only to gather support for action. A disciplined study record should include unresolved facts, contested evidence, missing voices, and domains that require expert review.

Study should sometimes include the strongest arguments against the City itself.

17.2.2 — Drafting Block

Drafting under record distinguishes origin, revision, source influence, staff contribution, and final status. A first draft is not a final view; revision is not necessarily inconsistency; deletion can show learning; staff input can be legitimate influence; and source notes prevent false originality. The process becomes useful when each stage is labeled clearly enough for readers to reconstruct how the document changed (ISO, 2017; W3C, 2013).

The danger is that drafting becomes performance. If the participant writes every sentence imagining future readers, the draft becomes image management. If staff polish too heavily, the record may show a voice that is not the participant's. If rough work is publicly clipped, the City will punish thinking before it matures. The drafting block must protect process without hiding material influence.

Protect quiet time for ordinary drafting; reserve speed-focused assessment for bounded exercises.

The drafting block benefits from a standard traceability pattern: issue, affected persons, evidence used, uncertainty, proposed response, implementation burden, staff burden, public explanation, and correction path. This is not a legal form. It is a fairness template that reminds the participant that language moves burden through systems.

Drafts should contain limits early rather than as defensive afterthoughts. A participant who states what a claim does not decide, which authority it lacks, and what must be reviewed elsewhere is learning to narrow power before power expands.

Polish can conceal vague authority, missing cost, false certainty, or rhetorical compassion without repair. Draft review should therefore ask what a sentence authorizes, which burden it lowers or shifts, and whether its beauty is doing work that reasons have not yet done.

17.2.3 — Deliberation Block

The deliberation block structures shared judgment. Deliberation under record lets the City observe how the participant listens, challenges, changes, resists, credits, and handles unresolved disagreement.

Deliberation uses more than verbal combat. Debate has a place, but public judgment also requires inquiry, synthesis, clarification, minority reports, scenario comparison, and patient disagreement. The block varies form according to purpose so participants learn to understand and improve a decision, not only to win the room (Mansbridge, 1980; Fishkin, 2009; Fung, 2006).

Preserve the provisional status and surrounding context of exploratory discussion, as for drafts under Section 17.2.2.

Review interruptions, attribution, treatment of quieter speakers, deference to prestige, and use of complexity to dominate.

Facilitators preserve dissent, prevent domination, surface unanswered burdens, and keep the reasoning trace legible.

The deliberation block should include visible roles: presenter, critic, affected-person advocate, implementation reviewer, staff burden reviewer, rights reviewer, and summary steward. Rotating these roles prevents one style of intelligence from ruling every room.

Preserve minority concerns, unresolved objections, and the reasons any were not adopted. Keep material unresolved concerns open for review so later reviewers can recover warnings and assess the decision in context.

Fluency can masquerade as clarity and end deliberation before uncertainty has been resolved. Review should ask whose doubts disappeared, who stopped speaking, and whether the change came from persuasion, fatigue, hierarchy, or fear.

The deliberation block should occasionally include silent review before speech. Fast speakers often dominate public rooms, while careful thinkers may need time to form objections.

17.2.4 — Administrative Block

Administrative work includes forms, schedules, replies, routing, compliance, follow-up, and the service consequences of those tasks.

Administrative review uses the small-duty records in Section 17.6.2 to assess timeliness, accuracy, responsiveness, delegation, staff coordination, and error repair.

The administrative block can include simple service-reality exercises: follow an appeal from filing to decision, trace a procurement delay, review an accessibility complaint, or map

how one missed record update becomes burden for an ordinary person.

Participants should also be required to encounter administrative error from the citizen side. A future public-power holder should know what it feels like when a form is unclear, a portal fails, a call is not returned, or a status label disappears.

Administrative blocks should teach the participant to respect handoff. In public systems, one person's decision becomes another person's paperwork, another person's phone call, another person's delay, and another person's error risk. The City should make participants trace at least some decisions through the people who must carry them.

17.2.5 — Break Integrity

Deliberation asks how judgment changes in the presence of others. Administration asks how promises move through practical systems. Break integrity asks whether the City can protect the conditions of judgment instead of worshiping output.

A break under the Vow is a bounded interval for rest, regulation, food, movement, silence, or transition. It is neither a secret active zone nor a demand for intimate disclosure. A status label may be necessary, but detailed content usually is not. Active status continues while the purpose of the interval shifts from public output to recovery (Nissenbaum, 2010; Sonnentag and Fritz, 2015).

Break integrity protects the whole labor ecology. When the participant never stops, educators, mentors, operators, security personnel, clinicians, food workers, archivists, moderators, and maintenance staff are pulled into the same pace. Protected breaks therefore carry staffing, handoff, coverage, and escalation rules, not merely permission for an individual to pause.

Breaks can become evasive if badly governed. A participant may use them to avoid correction, postpone difficult deliberation, hide informal influence, or leave a scheduled public interface without updating its status. This is why break integrity requires both protection and review.

Break integrity should include a protection against covert work. A participant should not be praised for answering messages during every break, holding informal influence conversations, or turning rest into unofficial strategy.

A practical break protocol should specify duration, status, protected spaces, interruption rules, emergency override, and post-break reentry, including who may interrupt recovery and for what reason.

The schedule audit should show whether breaks actually occur, whether people can take them without guilt, and whether staff receive equivalent protection.

When an interruption is authorized, the protocol should state how lost recovery time is restored. Repeated interruptions should trigger workload review for participants and staff.

Work-block design tracks cancellation patterns only as needed to govern work. Monthly review can show lost protected intervals by role, unit, event type, or public demand while keeping private health and household reasons outside the public bundle. Repeated cancellation reveals a design defect even when no single incident looks dramatic (Perlow, 2012; Sonnentag and Fritz, 2007).

Participants and staff must be able to decline nonurgent interruptions without being labeled uncommitted. Supervisors should record operational consequences, not speculate about attitude, while independent review checks patterns of pressure, retaliation, or unequal access to rest. Remedies may include

more staffing, narrower public windows, different deadlines, or removal of recurring demands.

One practical drill should introduce a plausible urgent request during a protected recovery block. The supervisor must identify qualified coverage, state whether an emergency exception actually applies, and show where any displaced rest will be restored. Independent review checks the subsequent calendar rather than accepting a promise of later recovery. The exercise uses fictional demand, not a manufactured personal crisis.

Working-time research cautions against reading endurance as competence. Long hours and poorly designed schedules can degrade health, judgment, family life, and work quality, while psychological-safety research shows that learning depends on the ability to ask questions, surface error, and revise without humiliation. A serious work block has a defined purpose, a finish condition, protected interruption, and a route for acknowledging that attention has failed (International Labour Organization, 2023; Pega et al., 2021; Edmondson, 1999).

17.3 — Meals, Movement, and Human Interval

Meals, movement, and unstructured intervals should preserve ordinary social contact without becoming covert evaluation blocks. Their design value is recovery, relationship, and observation of institutional burden, not extraction of more participant evidence. Research on recovery and energy management suggests that brief detachment, movement, ordinary conversation, and control over pauses can restore attention and reduce the spillover of strain. Care theory adds a further correction: meals and service encounters reveal who is expected to anticipate, soothe, clean, carry, and disappear. The design question is therefore not simply whether participants receive breaks, but whether the entire social field of the break preserves dignity for those eating, serving, cleaning, and returning to work (Fritz et al., 2011; Sonnentag and Fritz, 2007; Tronto, 1993).

17.3.1 — Meals as Ordinary Life

The dining system should protect ordinary rhythm. Food access should be reliable, culturally respectful where possible, nutritionally adequate, allergy-aware, disability-aware, and respectful of staff (Tronto, 1993; United Nations, 2006).

Recognize kitchen, service, cleaning, procurement, and waste labor without turning food workers into public characters in the participant's record.

Shared meals can expose problems in how the institution distributes waiting, service, cleaning, special access, and accommodation. Review those arrangements with staff under Section 17.6.3 and handle reports of mistreatment through the applicable protected complaint route. Do not turn ordinary conversation or displays of gratitude into covert assessment of diners.

A role-relevant meeting held over a meal remains subject to declared record rules, but that does not authorize routine recording of ordinary eating. Document and release only what the accountability purpose requires, using a less exposing summary where it is sufficient.

Meals should also resist hierarchy by design. Separate elite tables, informal privilege, quiet staff resentment, and special access through dining rooms can all recreate old power. Shared life does not require forced intimacy, but it does require that the meal not become a status theater where public-power seekers learn soft entitlement.

Do not require participants or visitors to display gratitude, humility, cultural openness, frugality, or community spirit during meals.

The meal schedule should also account for public-interface intensity. A difficult citizen session, opposition block, or crisis simulation may change appetite, digestion, social capacity, and need for quiet.

17.3.2 — Movement as Regulation

Movement spaces should support regulation as well as exercise. A participant living under active record may carry bodily tension and need ways to recover before returning to work. Walking, stretching, accessible movement, breathing, posture changes, outdoor loops, and quiet movement spaces belong in humane daily design.

Provide opportunities for accessible movement after conflict or long study and before public contact.

The record handling of movement should be modest. Movement may be logged as part of daily rhythm or care plan, but it should not become body surveillance. The City should not create hidden fitness scores, productivity metrics, biometric

rankings, or readiness inferences from ordinary bodily regulation.

Movement spaces protect regulation without turning participants into exhibits. Walking grounds, corridors, and accessible routes reduce unnecessary visitor observation, and staff are not asked to manage spectacle around ordinary movement.

Offer walking, stretching, quiet sitting, and assistive equipment according to disability and fluctuating capacity, without treating one form of regulation as the civic ideal.

Movement pathways should be built near work, recovery, and public-interface zones so regulation does not require a dramatic exit.

17.3.3 — Informal Conversation

Informal conversation can reveal how power is used, but casual speech is also easy to misread. Relevant conduct includes whom people include or dismiss, whether they listen, whether humor becomes cruel, how they treat staff, how they acknowledge uncertainty, and whether their conduct changes when formality drops.

If every informal remark is treated as a final public position, participants will stop speaking naturally and begin performing caution. Where role-relevant conversation must be recorded, distinguish joking from decision, frustration from policy, brainstorming from commitment, and ordinary warmth from strategic influence. Preserve enough surrounding information to explain the fragment without treating casual speech as complete doctrine (International Labour Organization, 2023; Deci and Ryan, 2000).

Informal conversation should be interpreted as pattern rather than isolated quote, unless a single statement causes serious

harm or reveals material misconduct. A person should be answerable for repeated contempt, coercion, manipulation, or disregard. A clipped sentence should be assessed with its setting, record status, the speaker's condition, possible irony, and subsequent correction in view.

Informal conversation with peers also forms public power. Participants learn whether disagreement can survive friendship, whether humor becomes exclusion, whether group belonging suppresses dissent, and whether private frustration becomes contempt for citizens. These patterns matter because future office will contain informal rooms where power often moves.

The public record site should not place casual clips beside official statements as if they carried the same interpretive weight.

Informal speech should also be a place where participants learn repair. A careless joke, dismissive tone, or casual exaggeration may not require public crisis, but it may require apology, clarification, or changed habit.

17.3.4 — Noninstrumental Time

Noninstrumental time is time not immediately justified by output. It may include quiet, walking, music, reading without assignment, simple rest, unstructured thought, harmless play, silence, looking at trees, or doing nothing visible.

The temptation will be to make every interval useful. If a participant rests, the City may call it recovery. If they walk, regulation. If they read, study. If they talk, social evidence. These categories have value, but they can also devour life. Some time should remain unforced by purpose even while active status continues (Fritz et al., 2011; Sonnentag and Fritz, 2007).

The commons capture rule in Section 7.4.1 continues to govern: ordinary presence is not automatically recordable, while

consequential role business cannot be hidden in an informal interval.

Noninstrumental time should be protected especially for participants whose identities have been shaped by achievement. Some people enter public-power formation already trained to convert every minute into usefulness. For them, the City's refusal to instrumentalize every interval may be an important correction. Public power should not be formed only by people who can no longer rest.

Noninstrumental time should have design protection against public scheduling creep. If every open interval becomes available for donor visits, mentor check-ins, media observations, or extra tasks, the City has not preserved human time.

17.3.5 — Staff Interaction Boundaries

Staff interaction boundaries govern the daily encounters through which participants can exert pressure on the people who support them.

Boundaries also prevent favoritism and dependency. A participant may become overly attached to a mentor, reliant on an operator, indulgent toward a friendly staff member, or hostile toward a critic in a support role. Staff may also overidentify with participants. Role clarity, advice logs, complaint routes, and rotation can prevent informal dependence from becoming hidden power.

Staff boundary training should include examples of hidden pressure: asking for off-record reassurance, requesting special favors, making staff choose between kindness and policy, using emotional intensity to bend a rule, or treating friendly staff as personal allies.

The daily schedule should include moments when staff can step out of participant presence.

Informal time can become coercive when staff are expected to provide warmth, companionship, or political reassurance beyond their role. A shared meal may be ordinary for a participant and emotional labor for the person serving, moderating, interpreting, or cleaning around it. The boundary should make friendliness possible without making intimacy a job requirement. Staff can participate as people while retaining the right to finish a shift, decline personal disclosure, and avoid becoming part of a participant's public story (Hochschild, 1983; Star and Strauss, 1999).

The boundary distinguishes service, collegial, mentoring, friendship, and private relationships. Categories can change, but changes are acknowledged because authority, scheduling, housing, evaluation, and record access may follow the role. Participants must not pressure staff socially, and staff must not use operational access to create dependency or influence.

A practical boundary includes a no-record default for incidental conversation, a complaint route for repeated pressure, and a conflict review when personal relationships intersect with supervision or access. The City needs to record the decision that changes authority, duty, access, or risk (Nissenbaum, 2010; Gray and Suri, 2019).

The test is what happens when a staff member says no. If refusal is followed by adverse changes to shifts, evaluation, proximity, or future opportunity, the institution must investigate whether those changes were retaliatory and restore any unfairly lost option.

17.4 — Public Interface Windows

A public interface window is a bounded period in which the participant encounters public questions, citizen burden, critique, expertise, and lived reports through structured channels. The boundary protects both sides. Citizens receive a real route into formation. Participants receive a schedule that allows preparation, accessibility, attention, and closure. Staff receive a manageable system rather than endless crisis (Fung, 2006; Fishkin, 2009).

17.4.1 — Scheduled Public Contact

Public contact works best as a plural system rather than a single open microphone. Deliberative-democracy research distinguishes information, consultation, dialogue, collaboration, and decision, each with different promises and risks. Every interface window therefore states what the public can change, what will be recorded, how minority and accessibility needs enter, and when the window closes. A crowd may reveal urgency, but volume alone cannot replace reasons, affected-person standing, or lawful authority (Fung, 2006; Fishkin, 2009; Nabatchi and Leighninger, 2015).

Schedule public contact with notice, preparation time, accessibility, moderation, security, and staff support, applying the access protections in Section 17.4.3 (Fung, 2006; Fishkin, 2009).

Label each scheduled window by its purpose (questions, burden reports, listening, correction, explanation, deliberative response, or expert input) so people know what the encounter can change.

A scheduled public contact window should have intake rules and output rules. Intake rules define who can speak, how questions are selected, how protected reports enter, and how

accessibility is handled. Output rules define what the participant owes afterward: answer, referral, correction, public explanation, or acknowledgment of uncertainty.

Sometimes the fairest answer is: I have heard the burden, and I do not yet know what can be done.

Dramatic public contact can crowd out study, administration, maintenance, and quiet correction. The schedule should preserve those less visible duties.

Public-interface governance varies the scale of public contact. A small listening session, written-question window, expert panel, affected-person interview, local host meeting, and broad public forum each reveal different burdens.

17.4.2 — Citizen Input Windows

Public interface also protects the people who use it. A person who submits a report, asks a question, attends a session, or offers expertise remains an ordinary citizen rather than a full-record subject. The City receives public input through purpose-limited channels, protects identity and bystander information, and gives people a route to withdraw, correct, or challenge their material without exposure by proximity.

Citizen input windows create a route for lived burden to enter the participant's formation. Citizens may know things that experts, parties, staff, and formal institutions miss. They may see a service failure, a housing burden, a disability barrier, a procurement consequence, a language issue, a safety risk, or an ordinary indignity that public systems have normalized.

Public-interface governance treats citizen input as information, not as command. A single report may be true, false, partial, urgent, biased, mistaken, or revelatory. The participant should learn to receive input with respect and verification. Public pain should not be dismissed because it is anecdotal. It also should

not be converted into policy without review (Nabatchi and Leighninger, 2015; Mansbridge, 1980).

Citizen input should also be visible enough in aggregate to prevent institutional filtering. If staff silently decide which public burdens reach participants, staff become hidden public meaning authorities. Queue rules, sampling, escalation criteria, protected reporting, and public summaries can reduce the risk of invisible filtering.

Citizen input should be treated as a civic stream with routing, verification, and care. Some input should go to public deliberation, some to protected complaint, some to technical review, some to host-community review, and some to no action with explanation.

Public-interface governance publishes aggregate information about input without exposing private people. What kinds of burdens are being reported? Which groups are underrepresented? Which reports led to correction? Which remain unresolved?

Sample, categorize, and escalate input so that moving, flattering, or ideologically convenient stories do not displace other burdens.

The participant should be taught to recognize the difference between public input that asks for response and public input that asks for witness. Some citizens need a remedy, some need a question answered, and some need a burden to be recognized. Confusing these modes can create false promises or cold administration.

17.4.3 — Accessibility During Interface

Include disabled people, non-native speakers, people without digital access, caregivers, people under threat, and people unable to attend the usual hours in interface design and testing.

Public-interface governance treats accessibility as design, not accommodation after complaint. Translation, captioning, sign language, plain-language materials, screen-reader compatibility, mobility access, cognitive accessibility, sensory-safe participation, remote options, and protected reporting pathways should be considered before the interface opens (Tyler, 2006; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Time is an accessibility issue. A window offered only during work hours may exclude workers. A window offered only online may exclude people without stable technology. A window that requires long attention may exclude people under fatigue or disability. The City should vary formats so that public burden is not heard only from those with surplus capacity.

The record should note access conditions where relevant. If a participant only hears from certain groups because the interface is inaccessible to others, the formation record is biased. The City should be able to state who could participate, who could not, and how access failures were corrected.

Public-interface governance considers access fatigue. A process can be technically accessible and still exhausting to use. Long forms, repeated identity checks, jargon, unclear status updates, and sensory-heavy meetings can exclude people without appearing to. Accessibility audits should include burden of use, not only formal availability.

Accessibility should also protect people from compulsory disclosure of disability or vulnerability. A person should not have to expose private diagnosis, literacy difficulty, trauma, poverty, or immigration status in order to use the interface.

17.4.4 — Anti-Crowd-Capture Rules

Anti-crowd-capture rules keep public contact answerable to evidence and affected-person standing rather than intensity

alone. Crowd capture can occur through admiration as well as anger. A participant surrounded by praise may become dependent on approval. Volunteers and supporters may defend the participant against criticism. Public applause may feel like evidence of readiness. The City must treat positive crowd energy with the same caution as hostile crowd pressure (Fung, 2006; Fishkin, 2009).

Digital integrity controls protect genuine participation from bots, brigades, and manufactured consensus. Integrity screening remains transparent, appealable, and narrow enough to protect legitimate dissent.

Anti-crowd rules should include queue discipline, rate limits, identity-protective verification where appropriate, moderation standards, harassment response, doxxing protections, source labeling, and manipulation audit. These tools should be public enough to inspect and flexible enough to protect the interface from evolving tactics.

A useful safeguard is a public manipulation audit summary. The City can report that certain quantities of input were identified as automated, duplicated, brigaded, threatening, or unverifiable without exposing ordinary participants in public interface.

Anti-crowd rules should protect minority burdens from being drowned by majority attention. A repeated problem affecting a smaller group may matter more than a viral complaint affecting many people's mood. The City must distinguish intensity, volume, severity, and representativeness.

Remain open to angry public contributions about burdens officials may have ignored; distinguish substantive concerns from manipulation and harassment.

17.4.5 — Interface Closure

Closure should include a status marker, a summary of what occurred where appropriate, routing of unresolved items, care or debriefing for participants and staff, and a clear statement of what happens next. Some inputs may require complaint handling, separate research review, staff review, policy drafting, archival custody, or a reasoned no-action disposition. Research use still requires the separate authority in Section 11.6 (Nabatchi and Leighninger, 2015; Mansbridge, 1980).

A closure protocol protects citizens from wondering whether they were heard. The City may not respond to every person individually, but it should provide public and protected routes for acknowledgment, escalation, and correction.

Give every submission a traceable disposition. Use participant and staff debriefs to identify changes in judgment and unresolved public pain requiring repair.

17.5 — Evening: Decompression and Reassembly

Evening should close the active day without reopening it as a second work shift. Review, repair, and necessary record clarification should finish early enough that decompression and sleep remain real protected functions. Evening is also where the day may reveal hidden damage. A participant who performed stability during public interface may collapse afterward.

17.5.1 — End-of-Day Review

A household member may carry burden that did not appear in the day's formal record. Staff may have absorbed conflict. A citizen input may have raised unresolved harm. The end of the day should provide routes for these realities before they become tomorrow's distortion.

End-of-day review gathers the day without turning it into a public confession. It asks what happened, what was learned, what burden moved, what was avoided, what needs correction, what requires follow-up, and what must be protected.

Comparing plan, interruption, adjustment, outcome, and remaining burden connects the morning intent record to the day’s actual work (Sonnentag and Fritz, 2015; Perlow, 2012).

A good end-of-day review distinguishes categories. A missed task may be avoidance, overload, changed priority, staff failure, health issue, or public emergency. A conflict may be misconduct, misunderstanding, needed opposition, or unresolved burden.

The review should include staff and mentor input where appropriate, but not let staff become hidden judges. Participants should have a voice in explaining context. Affected persons may need routes when the day produced harm. The archive should preserve enough process to make later interpretation fair.

The review should also identify tomorrow's burden. An unresolved apology, delayed citizen response, unfinished draft, staff complaint, health issue, or public-interface consequence should not vanish overnight.

Assign City failures (such as an unrealistic schedule, understaffing, inaccessible public contact, or confusing record systems) to the responsible office rather than to the participant.

Record changes in conduct, knowledge, schedule, support, or remedy.

The end-of-day review separates a brief protected care-routing portion from a civic portion devoted to role-relevant learning. Everyone involved knows which conversation is occurring, which record applies, and who has authority to act.

17.5.2 — Decompression Time

Decompression is part of the schedule rather than a reward for demonstrated exhaustion. Active record and visible formation create load, so recovery is designed before breakdown rather than granted after it (Sonnentag and Fritz, 2015; Perlow, 2012).

Remaining under the Vow does not make decompression routinely recordable. Apply the commons and sleep capture limits in Sections 7.4.1 and 18.2.5; any necessary care record follows its separate clinical authority. Operational status can show that recovery was protected without exposing its content.

Decompression can include silence, walking, music, quiet rooms, light reduction, low-stimulation environments, private journaling under protected rules, clinical check-in, or simple rest. The City should offer varied pathways because bodies regulate differently.

Care language can be used as a form of compliance management. Decompression remains legitimate only when it responds to the participant's actual load, protects choice, and

cannot be manipulated to make the person easier for the institution to operate.

The decompression pathway should include the option of no interpretation. Not every heavy day needs immediate meaning. Sometimes the fairest response is food, quiet, movement, clinical support, or sleep. The City should not force the participant to explain pain before the body has had time to lower it.

17.5.3 — Relationship Repair Window

The relationship repair window protects the people around the participant from the residue of the day. Public-power formation can create missed calls, stress, impatience, worry, conflict, delayed care, or household misunderstanding. Repair should not be postponed until damage becomes crisis.

Protect every nonparticipant’s independent privacy under Section 9.3 during apology, clarification, support, and household planning (Hobfoll, 1989; Lazarus and Folkman, 1984).

Repair should be voluntary and safety-aware. The City must never force reconciliation, demand emotional access, or pressure a harmed person to accept an apology for the sake of the participant's record. Where harm is serious, professional or legal pathways may be needed.

Record handling should use summary, status, or protected routing where appropriate. The public does not need intimate details of repair. It may need to know that household burden exists, that support is in place, or that a role-related pattern is being addressed.

The repair window should not assume a conventional household. Partners, spouses, friends, chosen family, co-parents, elders, dependents, roommates, and people outside the City may each relate differently to the participant's day. The repair

structure should be flexible enough to count real burden without forcing people into one domestic model.

The repair window should include the right not to repair that night. Some conflicts need space. Some harms need safety planning. Some household members may not want contact.

When relationship repair involves a nonparticipant, the City should ask what the nonparticipant needs from the institution, not only what the participant needs for formation.

17.5.4 — Sleep Preparation

Evening design is a test of whether the institution understands cognitive residue. Recovery research describes psychological detachment as a distinct process, not an automatic consequence of leaving a desk, and studies of constant connectivity show how alerts and expectations can keep work active long after formal duty ends. A closing routine should therefore resolve status, identify unresolved matters, return responsibility to the correct holder, and protect the transition toward relationship, rest, and sleep (Sonnentag and Fritz, 2015; Perlow, 2012; Watson et al., 2015).

Sleep preparation should include environmental quiet, light discipline, device limits, alert boundaries, schedule closure, and clear emergency exceptions. A participant should know when the day is over, what remains pending, what can wait, and what will wake them (Sonnentag and Fritz, 2015; Perlow, 2012).

Sleep protection includes the workers who make nighttime continuity possible. Security, clinical support, operations, archive systems, maintenance, and emergency response need rotations, reserve capacity, quiet workflows, and recovery periods that identify who remains awake so others can sleep. Apply the noncapture and separate-authority rules in Section

18.2.5; bedtime imagery must not become public evidence of civic seriousness.

Route late comments, alerts, staff messages, citizen reports, and platform reactions to morning review unless they meet the defined emergency criteria.

Defer nonurgent late-night posts, summaries, apologies, and release decisions to rested review.

17.5.5 — Record Boundary Clarification

Record boundary clarification is the administrative close of the day. It states what has been captured, what remains protected, what is delayed, what needs correction, what was interrupted, and what status carries into the next day.

This clarification protects participants from rumor and staff from improvisation. A technical issue, emergency interruption, protected conversation, clinical contact, or unresolved public input should not be left in a vague state (Bowker and Star, 1999; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Boundary clarification also protects nonparticipants. If a family member, visitor, staff member, citizen contributor, or professional interface appeared in the day, the record should confirm appropriate masking, shielding, delay, or access limitation.

The process should be proportionate. Standard status categories, automated prompts with human review, and clear exception paths can keep the process usable.

The end of a day does not trigger publication. Capture, boundary clarification, review, correction, and release are separate stages with separate authorities. Evening review may prepare material for a later decision, but the City keeps protected content protected until a lawful public-purpose test,

affected-person review, and the least-exposing-sufficient rule are satisfied.

Some labels may be provisional until morning review.

17.6 — Routine as Public-Power Evidence

Routine is the slow archive of power. Repeated conduct may reveal discrepancies that a single prepared hearing, speech, or apology misses. That possible advantage must be tested against the observation and performance effects examined in Section 17.7. This does not mean routine is morally transparent.

17.6.1 — Pattern Over Performance

Construct routine patterns from comparable observations across contexts under the rubric in Section 13.3; avoid isolated aesthetic impressions (Bernstein, 2012; Edmondson, 1999).

Public office requires explaining, appearing, speaking, and responding. Interpret that performance as one data type within a longer pattern.

Automated assistance may retrieve declared operational records or flag data-quality issues within the permitted workflow in Section 11.7.6; it must not infer traits, score trust, or generate readiness profiles. Named human reviewers assess role-relevant evidence with context, appeal, correction, and bias review. A repeated pattern can reflect the participant, the schedule, the staff ecology, the environment, disability mismatch, public pressure, or bad institutional design.

Public release of pattern should be careful. Citizens may benefit from summaries such as repeated correction accepted, repeated staff complaints, repeated missed follow-up, or repeated public-interface overload. But raw compilations can humiliate or mislead.

If many participants show the same distortion, examine schedule, design, staff culture, release pressure, and public interface before attributing it to individual weakness.

Pattern summaries should include uncertainty. A record may show repeated behavior but not fully explain it. The City should

state where interpretation is strong, where context is incomplete, and where rival explanations remain plausible.

A public story can lock around a participant and absorb later evidence. Once someone is known as disciplined, evasive, warm, cold, humble, or ambitious, every new fact may be bent toward that label. Pattern review must remain revisable so the record never becomes destiny.

Pattern review should be scheduled far enough apart to avoid constant surveillance anxiety. Daily capture does not require daily judgment. Some patterns need weeks or months to become visible. The City should distinguish record density from interpretation frequency, or it will overread ordinary variation.

17.6.2 — Small Duties Matter

A record of routine can be misread. A participant may be depressed, ill, grieving, overloaded, culturally misunderstood, disabled without proper support, or affected by hidden staff failure. Routine evidence requires context, category, and humility.

Repeated small duties, staff treatment, and responses to correction may be relevant to public-role judgment, but the record must not treat them as deterministic predictors of later office behavior. Routine review should look for patterns, context, and correction while avoiding two opposite errors: dismissing ordinary conduct because it is undramatic and overreading ordinary conduct because it was recorded.

Small duties matter because public power often fails in small ways first. A missed reply, ignored note, delayed correction, careless scheduling choice, neglected accessibility request, unreviewed staff burden, or forgotten follow-up can seem minor. Over time, such duties show whether a participant treats implementation as moral work or as background labor.

Routine evidence becomes useful only when review remains proportionate. One forgotten task is not a public indictment, and ordinary imperfection is not misconduct. The relevant question is whether small obligations are noticed, repaired, delegated honestly, or dismissed because they lack prestige (Tyler, 2006; Goffman, 1959).

The record of small duties should be categorized, not flooded into public view. Internally, the City may track completion, delay, delegation, reason for delay, harm, and repair. Publicly, the useful evidence is usually pattern and correction, not every minor item.

Small-duty records should include the burden of delegation. Delegation is not failure; public power often requires it. But the participant should know what they are delegating, to whom, with what follow-up, and with what staff burden.

17.6.3 — Staff Treatment as Evidence

Gather evidence of staff treatment through role records, complaint systems, patterns and protected summaries; do not make workers public witnesses by default (McCambridge et al., 2014; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Examine conduct and working conditions together. Understaffing, poor training, inaccessible procedures, or overload may contribute to conflict and must be documented alongside the participant's actions.

Use the protected staff-evidence channels and fair-process rules in Section 13.3.2, accounting for the participant's symbolic power and staff exposure to retaliation.

Independent ombuds review should help staff experience matter without turning staff into collateral participants.

Audit scheduling, workload, consent, boundaries, credit, compensation, and repair alongside verbal gratitude.

Remedy harmful staff treatment through changes to scheduling, communication, delegation, access, or role expectations.

17.6.4 — Correction Habits

Compare responses to logistical, factual, staff, citizen, mentor, opposition, and public corrections across time (Bernstein, 2012; Edmondson, 1999).

Apply the correction standard in Section 13.3.1, including the right to contest faulty criticism. Follow warranted correction through repair and later recurrence.

Routine-evidence review also protects the dignity of the corrector. Staff, citizens, peers, and critics who offer correction must not be punished, mocked, or turned into props for the participant's growth narrative.

Correction habits should include correction of overreach by supporters. A participant may receive praise that misstates their readiness, excuses their conduct, or attacks critics. How the participant handles flattering falsehood is part of correction.

Correction can be proportionate and quiet. Public harm may require public repair; private or role-bound harm may require a protected response. The City teaches people to match the visibility of the correction to the visibility and burden of the error, avoiding both concealment and spectacle.

17.6.5 — Evidence, Not Worth

Routine evidence may inform readiness, support, delay, redirection, or public record; it may not be converted into a measure of human value.

This rule governs internal dashboards as much as public materials. A hidden dashboard that ranks participants by daily seriousness can distort opportunities before any public claim is made and is prohibited. Permitted operational measures must

remain contestable and tied to a declared purpose, with governed access. Any exception to ordinary access controls must name its approver and expiry; it cannot authorize prohibited scoring or ranking.

Visibility fluency can create a caste: polished participants may be trusted faster while honest struggle is penalized. Reviewers should check whether coaching, media experience, or familiarity with institutional norms explains apparent fluency before treating it as role evidence.

Where the distinction between durable conduct and learned presentation remains uncertain, narrow the evidence claim. Recognition should remain reversible when later evidence changes the pattern.

17.7 — Anti-Performance Drift

Performance drift is the gradual conversion of visible life into staged life. A participant notices which gestures receive praise, which apologies travel well, and which forms of calm earn admiration. Uncertainty becomes tidier, fatigue more heroic, meals more self-conscious, and casual speech more scripted. The record then begins to shape the person it was meant to observe, which is why the institution audits its own incentives before assigning meaning to the behavior.

17.7.1 — Camera-Conscious Distortion

Authenticity cannot be produced by command. The City instead reduces the incentives that make a participant live for the imagined viewer: it limits audience pressure, delays release where justified, protects ordinary intervals, supports private correction, and gives mentors a bounded route to flag performance drift. The response changes the environment before it turns a predictable observation effect into a moral diagnosis (Goffman, 1959; McCambridge et al., 2014).

Classic work on self-presentation and later reviews of research-participation effects show that people alter conduct when they know they are being seen, even without conscious deception (Goffman, 1959; McCambridge et al., 2014; Bernstein, 2012).

A participant may anticipate scrutiny even when no camera is visible, imagining future reviewers, critics, supporters, journalists, voters, staff, family members, or opponents.

Observation can change behavior, and that change can be useful as well as distorting (Goffman, 1959; McCambridge et al., 2014). A participant who begins documenting advice because the record requires it may create a genuinely more answerable decision. Respecting a worker’s right to refuse an improper

request is a real improvement even when reputation supplied part of the incentive. The City distinguishes improved conduct from misleading presentation by examining consequences, consistency, and correction; it need not resolve the participant’s private motive before recognizing a real improvement.

Signs of distortion may include overexplaining ordinary actions, performing humility, exaggerating diligence, avoiding necessary conflict, staging kindness, speaking in public-ready phrases during private work, or choosing conduct for anticipated release rather than role responsibility. None of these signs proves insincerity alone. They are prompts for review.

Audit praise for quotable language, moving moments, and selected daily scenes. These choices may teach participants which recorded persona earns admiration.

Durability is tested through later, unfamiliar tasks under declared conditions. After a participant corrects a flawed procurement explanation, a new exercise can ask whether the same reasoning survives a different vendor relationship or an inconvenient counterargument. Review preserves the support and access conditions under which the work occurred. Improvement that transfers across such tasks is stronger evidence of learning than repetition of a rehearsed answer. No hidden recording, withdrawn care, or invented personal crisis is needed to ask that question.

Keeping some assessment internal until context is ready may reduce pressure to perform for an immediate audience. The pilot should test whether delayed, governed release improves the quality of role-related evidence while also checking for concealment, continuing archive anxiety, and loss of public trust.

Camera-conscious distortion may also affect the public. Citizens who know they may appear in a record may alter how they describe pain or express anger, expertise, or loyalty. The

City should examine these effects in public interface, staff contact, and visitor behavior as well as participant conduct.

Presenting context, categories, correction, and status instead of dramatic clips may reduce the incentive to stage material for release.

17.7.2 — Archive Anxiety

Archive anxiety is the fear of future interpretation. A participant may worry that an ordinary sentence, tired expression, draft mistake, missed task, awkward silence, or unresolved conflict will later be used against them. This fear can produce excessive caution, defensive speech, avoidance, insomnia, and loss of ordinary relation.

Archive anxiety is a foreseeable response to durable public meaning. Political opponents, journalists, researchers, future historians, citizens, and malicious actors may all revisit a record, so the institution answers anxiety with predictable access classes, delayed release, correction, contextual reply, security, and expiry rather than dismissal (Bernstein, 2012; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Mentors and clinicians should distinguish archive anxiety from misconduct avoidance. A participant may fear public misinterpretation even when acting responsibly. Another may invoke anxiety to avoid legitimate accountability. Careful review is needed. The City should route distress to care while preserving record integrity.

Archive anxiety can also affect staff, family members, and nonparticipants. They may fear appearing in records, being named in summaries, or being drawn into future interpretation. The City's nonparticipant masking and staff role-record rules should reduce this burden.

Anticipatory self-censorship produces an orderly but impoverished record. People who live only to avoid future misuse will stop taking intellectual risks, naming uncertainty, or making correctable mistakes. Honest imperfection must be survivable if the archive is to remain informative.

Track whether archive anxiety rises after release events, public controversies, or particular media practices.

17.7.3 — Mentor Intervention

Mentors identify observable distortions, ask questions, and help restore attention to role duties; they do not certify authenticity (Edmondson, 1999; Schein, 2010).

A good intervention is specific. Instead of saying, “You are performing,” a mentor can name a pattern: “Your public-interface answers are more polished but less responsive. You apologize faster but repair less. You treat staff more formally when cameras are active and avoid drafts that show uncertainty. You seem to be choosing words for release rather than clarity.”

Mentor intervention is traceable without becoming another performance. Material guidance that shapes public-power formation enters the appropriate role record, while the participant's vulnerability in receiving that guidance remains protected. The record captures the intervention, decision, and follow-up, not an intimate transcript of the conversation.

Mentors also need oversight. A mentor can create performance drift by rewarding a preferred style of calm, passion, brevity, or visible humility, imposing their own ideals, encouraging strategic presentation, or becoming too important to the participant's self-understanding. Mentor influence should be reviewable, and participants should have complaint routes when mentorship becomes pressure.

Mentor intervention should include a right to second interpretation. A participant may feel that a mentor has misread culture, disability, grief, personality, or ordinary caution as performance. The City should allow review without undermining the mentor role.

Mentors should be trained to distinguish performative polish from adaptive professionalism: clear speech, restraint, and public explanation can serve role duties rather than image.

Mentor intervention should be documented as formation support, not as hidden diagnosis. The mentor can identify patterns and suggest adjustments, but clinical claims belong to clinicians and readiness claims belong to proper review.

17.7.4 — Public Release Delay

A governed release delay must satisfy the performance-drift test in Section 17.7.1 and the category-specific access, release, correction and review rules in Chapter 11; delayed access is not permission to conceal a consequential record.

Release delay must not become concealment. Review clocks, release triggers, oversight access, public status labels, and appeal pathways are needed.

Delay also gives harmed or affected persons time to respond. If a record involves a citizen report, staff concern, household issue, professional interface, or public misunderstanding, immediate release may deny affected people any meaningful chance to correct or protect themselves.

17.7.5 — Daily Anti-Performance Review

The Daily Anti-Performance Review audits conditions and decisions, not sincerity. It examines whether schedules, cameras, prompts, release practices, mentor incentives, metrics, and audience pressure are predictably distorting conduct; it may not

certify an inner self or compare one participant’s authenticity with another’s.

Review triggers are observable, contestable, and non-scoring. Repeated public-window overruns, canceled breaks, abrupt changes after praise or scandal, avoidance of rough drafts, unusual concern with future release, staff reports of image management, mentor concern, or the participant's own account of archive anxiety may open inquiry. Each trigger begins review rather than producing a finding, and none becomes a readiness rank (Bernstein, 2012; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Standing is distributed so the review cannot be monopolized by leadership. A participant may request it; affected staff may trigger it without supervisor permission; a mentor may submit a bounded formation concern; a clinician may impose a care-based limit within professional authority; and an independent reviewer may pause release, alter capture, close a public window, or require rest. Every pathway identifies who can act, what record is created, and who may appeal.

Alternative explanations must be considered before intervention. Disability, language, culture, grief, trauma, fatigue, medication, unfamiliar communication style, or ordinary caution can be misread as staging or disengagement. The participant receives the evidence packet, may add context, and may obtain a second interpretation (Tyler, 2006; United Nations, 2006).

A typical case is an ordinary Tuesday rather than a dramatic scandal. A public interface runs long, a drafting block starts late, lunch disappears, and two staff members stay after hours to repair the record and reschedule a citizen meeting. Nothing looks catastrophic in isolation. Together, the events show a timetable rewarding visible completion while exporting food, recovery, and cleanup into less visible time.

The review reconstructs that burden chain. Who extended the interface, who had authority to close it, which public promise made refusal difficult, which work became overtime, whose household or health absorbed the delay, and what alternative schedule was available? The participant, staff representative, schedule owner, and independent reviewer contribute facts without diagnosing one another. Job-design evidence supports examining demands, control, resources, and recovery as one system (Karasek, 1979; Bakker and Demerouti, 2007; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

Correction changes the next week rather than the person's status. The public window receives a hard closure, the meal period is protected, cleanup is budgeted inside paid work, the citizen meeting receives a reasoned reschedule, and the staffing plan gains backup capacity. A later review tests whether the burden reappeared or merely moved elsewhere.

The review panel must include participant and staff representation, privacy competence, and an independent chair who does not control admissions, public communications, or promotion. A representative who is a party to the matter or materially implicated in it contributes evidence and can use an advocate, but does not decide that case; a qualified substitute preserves the representative perspective. The record states the trigger, mechanism, evidence sources, affected people, alternative explanations, uncertainty, intervention, responsible owner, review date, and retention rule.

Public accountability should describe the structural correction. The City may report that release timing changed, a camera practice was suspended, an interface window was shortened, staffing was increased, or mentoring guidance was revised. It

should not publish anxiety, motive, health information, cultural interpretation, or an alleged degree of sincerity.

Appeal protects both the participant and affected workers. A participant can challenge a trigger, causal account, intervention, retention period, or public summary; staff can challenge a correction that leaves their burden intact. The appeal body may affirm, narrow, reverse, or replace the intervention and must explain its reasoning. A successful appeal corrects the record.

Retention follows the life of the mechanism under review. When a schedule defect is corrected and its review clock closes, the concern expires unless a new event independently justifies reopening it. The design lesson may remain in institutional memory, while suspicion of the person does not migrate into admissions, readiness, personnel, public-profile, or model-training systems.

Equity and error auditing examine trigger rates, evidence types, interventions, appeals, reversals, retention, and public summaries for disparate burden across disability, culture, language, gender, race, religion, class, communication style, and popularity. The review remains structural and aggregated where possible.

Retirement remains a legitimate result. If the review repeatedly produces style proxies, unappealable interpretations, reidentification, staff coercion, or pressure toward public performance, the City narrows or ends the mechanism. The retirement record preserves the failure mode, affected groups, attempted repairs, and successor protections so that another site cannot repeat the same harm under a new label.

Review should compare high-attention and ordinary periods to see whether corrective habits persist after publicity fades.

Chapter 18 — Health, Recovery, and Care Load

Visible public-power formation has a body. It may be described in constitutional, civic, architectural, and archival terms, but it is carried through breath, sleep, attention, muscle tension, fatigue, appetite, fear, trust, and recovery. A City that forgets this will treat the Transparent Vow as a moral abstraction and will eventually ask flesh to pay for an institutional ideal.

The purpose of this chapter is to make bodily and psychological sustainability a political requirement inside the Transparent City. The active participant is not merely a candidate in training, not merely a record subject, and not merely a public-power seeker. The participant is a human being living under an unusual burden: full active-period record, public meaning delayed but possible, role-specific formation, staff interaction, public interface, and the knowledge that ordinary conduct may later be interpreted by others.

A humane care system holds accountability and care together. It recognizes sleep, overload, medication, disability, distress, and de-loading as operating facts, then routes them through independent clinical judgment, protected records, support, schedule change, and stop authority. At the same time, active public conduct remains answerable through the proper civic record. The result is neither heroic hardness nor an unreviewed private zone, but a care architecture that protects dignity while keeping roles and evidence clear (McEwen and Stellar, 1993; World Health Organization, 2022a; Maslach and Leiter, 2016).

Scientific restraint governs the chapter. It does not diagnose participants, create clinical protocols, settle medical standards, or convert operational support records into research data. *The Science of Fairness* governs scientific claim status, and actual care belongs to qualified professionals under proper legal and ethical boundaries. The chapter's task is to design the City so that health and recovery are not treated as afterthoughts.

The chapter therefore moves through six domains. It begins with the biophysical cost of visible life, then turns to sleep and sensory safeguards, then separates Artificial Intelligence, mentors, and clinicians, then builds load limits and weekly rhythms, then protects reflection and ritual without religious coercion, and finally creates humane pathways for breakdown, de-loading, return, and exit.

Care inside the City is an operating system, not a service attached after strain appears. Sleep protection, sensory regulation, clinical access, workload review, confidential help, and de-loading authority must be designed into the institution before the first participant begins. The relevant standard is not whether support exists somewhere in policy. It is whether a tired, frightened, ill, disabled, or overwhelmed person can reach it without first becoming a public case, a disciplinary problem, or an evidentiary opportunity (World Health Organization, 2022a; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

Clinical independence is the hard edge of this care architecture. A clinician must be able to recommend rest, treatment, privacy, leave, reduced visibility, or withdrawal even when the recommendation inconveniences the City or weakens a public narrative. Urgent care cannot wait for archive classification, committee permission, or reputational review. Later accountability may examine how the institution responded, but the care decision remains governed by professional duty and the affected person's rights, not by the City's desire for continuity (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; World Health Organization, 2022a).

18.1 — The Biophysical Cost of Visible Life

Visible-life demands may create physiological, cognitive, sensory, and relational load. The City must examine whether anticipated future viewing sustains vigilance and whether public attention affects sleep, concentration, appetite, movement, or social ease. Chapter 18 therefore treats these possibilities as design risks: identify where load enters, who can reduce it, and which protected care route is available before endurance is mistaken for readiness (McEwen and Stellar, 1993; McEwen, 1998). Longitudinal load is governed before it becomes a clinical crisis.

18.1.1 — Hyperarousal

Allostatic-load research explains how repeated adaptation can accumulate wear, and occupational guidance locates psychosocial risk in job design, schedules, relationships, control, and organizational culture. The City therefore reviews not only whether a participant can finish a difficult week, but whether demand, recovery, staff support, family burden, and sensory exposure remain sustainable across seasons (McEwen and Stellar, 1993; McEwen, 1998; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

Hyperarousal describes heightened alertness or reactivity that persists beyond an immediate demand. In the Transparent City, persistent vigilance is a design risk: participants may anticipate that a gesture, pause, sentence, facial expression, or tired moment will later be interpreted as evidence of public-power formation. This possibility calls for qualified assessment, not an assumption that visibility produces a clinical disorder.

Possible hyperarousal belongs in the assessment of institutional burden rather than being dismissed as vanity or fragility. A person under the Vow lives in a condition where

conduct may acquire future public meaning, and the body may respond before the mind can explain why. Changes in pulse, tension, irritability, vigilance, and difficulty settling may therefore belong to the operating burden (McEwen and Stellar, 1993; McEwen, 1998).

The operational question is whether the City can design cues that tell the body when burden is active, when burden is reduced, and when care overrides record interpretation. Clear schedules, predictable release windows, quiet thresholds, protected clinical interfaces, and delayed public release may reduce the sense that every second is immediate exposure. Persistent ambiguity can prolong vigilance.

Hyperarousal also affects interpretation. A participant under persistent alert may sound sharper, colder, more defensive, more compliant, or more performative than they would under ordinary conditions. The record must therefore be read with load context.

Repeated reports of watchfulness, startle, inability to settle, or fear of future interpretation must trigger a review of timing, public release patterns, alert design, spatial cues, and mentor expectations.

This material also requires careful public language. The public must not be invited to diagnose a participant as anxious, unstable, weak, or unfit because hyperarousal appears in the record. The public may need to know whether the City is creating excessive arousal.

A useful City protocol should distinguish ordinary arousal from escalating strain and persistent difficulty recovering. Rising strain may appear as narrowing attention, hardened interpretation, or reduced capacity to receive correction, but these observations are prompts for support and qualified assessment, not diagnoses. Persistent or recurrent difficulty recovering should trigger review of workload and care needs.

When heightened arousal coincides with staff harm, reassurance demands, or avoidance, document the conduct and support needs separately. Do not infer cruelty, motive, or readiness from an arousal symptom or outward composure.

18.1.2 — Sleep Disruption

Protecting sleep is part of protecting public judgment. The adult-sleep consensus associates regularly insufficient sleep with poorer performance and more errors (Watson et al., 2015). Sleep disruption from the City’s record and public-interface demands remains a risk to assess, not an established result.

Sleep enters the institutional analysis in an unusual way: not as raw material for exposure, but as a condition of the participant's capacity to carry burden. Sleep quantity, sleep opportunity, disturbance patterns, late alerts, noise, light, public-interface timing, crisis interruptions, and record anxiety all shape the day that follows. Sleep becomes an institutional responsibility without becoming public property (Lazarus and Folkman, 1984; Hobfoll, 1989).

A participant who sleeps poorly for one night may simply be human. Repeated sleep disruption becomes a governance issue. The City must distinguish occasional insomnia, acute stress, design-induced disturbance, clinical concern, security interruption, relationship burden, device pressure, and schedule overload.

Extend the nighttime staffing protections in Section 17.5.4 to maintenance, security, clinicians, mentors, record operators, food workers, and moderators.

Anticipatory sleep loss is another risk. A participant may lose rest not because anything happens at night, but because tomorrow's record, public interface, interpretation, or possible release has already entered the mind. The City must therefore

treat sleep protection as an evening and daytime practice, not merely a bedroom rule.

18.1.3 — Identity Strain

Identity strain begins when a person can no longer easily distinguish being known from being used, being recorded from being understood, or being seen from being reduced. The participant under the Transparent Vow may start to ask which self is appearing in the record and which self the public will later believe. That question can become heavy long before any record is released.

Apply the archive-anxiety controls in Section 17.7.2 and the context and correction rules in Chapter 11.

Identity strain also matters after exit. A former participant may fear that the active record will remain the public's dominant account of who they are. The City must prepare for post-exit future privacy and ordinary-life reintegration from the beginning.

Identity strain must be reviewed through language as well as behavior. If the participant begins describing themselves mainly as a record, a symbol, a future officeholder, a case study, or an institutional proof, the City must offer protected support and review the pressures behind that language.

Mentors must help participants practice role separation in ordinary language. The participant can learn to say, in effect, that this conduct belongs to the record, this feeling belongs to protected interior life, this relationship belongs to a shielded category, this clinical matter belongs to care, and this public explanation belongs to the role.

Identity strain must be assessed across time, not through one confession or public narrative. A participant may feel differently about exposure across successive seasons; those changes do not

by themselves establish failure or growth. Review whether the experience is tolerable and recoverable or is causing harm. Perceived learning does not override care or consent.

The participant must also have access to language for ordinary dislike of the role burden. A person may be committed to public service and still hate a day of exposure, resent a correction, feel ugly under record, or wish temporarily to be unseen. Those feelings do not automatically discredit the Vow.

18.1.4 — Social Vigilance

Social vigilance is the constant attention to how one is being perceived, how others may interpret a conversation, and how a future reader may reconstruct the meaning of a relationship. Under ordinary life, this can be tiring. Under full active-period record, it can become a structural burden. The participant may begin to feel that every relationship is partly public in advance.

Social ease should inform design review without becoming a personality test. Participants should be able to speak casually, disagree imperfectly, repair awkwardly, eat without strategy, ask for help, and receive affection without translating every moment for an audience. When those ordinary capacities shrink, the City examines release rules, schedule pressure, public attention, mentoring, and protected space because formation becomes less truthful when human relation becomes a stage (McEwen and Stellar, 1993; McEwen, 1998).

Social vigilance also affects other people. Staff may alter their speech around participants. Friends may withdraw. Families may become cautious. Visitors may perform. Mentors may overdocument. Ordinary relational texture can become brittle.

Use the spatial status and capture boundaries in Chapters 6–7 to make the expectations of each setting legible.

Unequal vigilance also matters. People with less social power may be more cautious because they have more to lose from misinterpretation. Staff, nonparticipants, people with prior trauma, people from marginalized communities, and people with less institutional fluency may carry additional relational load.

Status literacy must not become a new class system. Participants may learn the codes of visible life more quickly than visitors, families, service workers, critics, or temporary contributors. If that happens, the participant gains insider fluency while others carry the risk of awkwardness. The rules of a room must therefore be visible enough that people do not need elite training to avoid accidental exposure or misinterpretation.

A social-vigilance audit must ask whether people still tell the participant unwelcome truth. If staff become too careful, mentors too flattering, visitors too deferential, or peers too strategic, the participant may be surrounded by record-managed politeness rather than honest relation. The result can be a new form of hidden power: no one lies in the record, but everyone edits themselves before speaking.

18.1.5 — Longitudinal Load

Longitudinal load is the cost that becomes clearer through repetition. A day may reveal immediate demand; a week may reveal inadequate recovery; and a season may show whether adjustments restore capacity. The long view asks whether participants retain attention, agency, relationships, and the ability to recover while developing public judgment. These are conditions the institution can protect and review.

Longitudinal review resists the habit of evaluating only acute crisis. Breakdown is visible; cumulative strain may be harder to recognize. Sleep debt, small irritability, social narrowing, performance drift, staff dependence, avoidance of public

interface, and quiet resentment may build beneath the threshold of emergency. Longitudinal review exists to catch the slow movement of burden before collapse (Lazarus and Folkman, 1984; Hobfoll, 1989).

A longitudinal load review register can be useful if it remains non-diagnostic. It must track patterns such as recovery opportunity, sleep integrity, public-interface intensity, sensory exposure, de-loading requests, complaint frequency, mentor notes, clinical recommendations, and staff-burden spillover. It must not become a personal score, readiness rank, or hidden human-worth measure.

Longitudinal load must also be compared across participants and roles carefully. A local-office pathway, executive pathway, technical pathway, family situation, disability context, and public-interface load may differ significantly. Fairness may require different rhythm, accommodation, support, and recovery structure while preserving the same core Vow.

Longitudinal load requires periodic review dates that cannot be skipped for convenience. Monthly, seasonal, and annual reviews must ask different questions. The monthly review can catch strain. The seasonal review can assess rhythm. The annual review can ask whether the City is forming capacity or normalizing adaptation to harm.

A complete load review also compares participant load with staff load and host load. If participant wellness improves only because staff absorb more invisible work, the longitudinal picture is false. If public interface becomes smoother only because public questions are filtered too aggressively, the burden has shifted rather than disappeared.

A serious longitudinal review must include institutional variables as well as personal variables. The City must ask whether one building wing produces more fatigue, whether one

mentor team generates more de-loading requests, whether public-interface days predict sleep disruption, whether seasonal simulations create delayed strain, and whether staff shortages appear as participant instability.

Longitudinal review must not become a search for the perfectly sustainable candidate. No serious public burden is cost-free. The question is whether the cost remains lawful, reviewable, proportionate, reparable, and compatible with care. Some strain may be instructive because future office will also contain strain. The City fails when it hides the strain, romanticizes it, shifts it onto others, or refuses to change when the pattern becomes injurious. Review should also record recovery time after peak-load periods, because similar acute strain can produce very different long-term burden depending on how quickly normal function returns.

When cohort review shows that a sequence repeatedly produces sleep debt, mentor dependence, social withdrawal, or staff overload, publish category-level lessons and revise the design before later cohorts encounter the same defect. For each revision, including changes to interface density, night alerts, mentor staffing, or quiet spaces, the public lesson should name the responsible owner and a verification date to test whether the change reduced the predicted load. Attribute the lesson to the City; a narrower public account of an individual requires its own fairness justification.

18.2 — Sleep Protection and Sensory Safeguards

Sleep protection requires environmental, temporal, and informational control. Consensus guidance for healthy adults identifies regular sufficient sleep as foundational, while research on evening light and environmental noise shows that ordinary design choices can delay circadian timing, reduce sleepiness, fragment rest, and impair next-day alertness. The City should treat quiet hours, lighting, alerts, emergency exceptions, and sleep-related record handling as one system (Watson et al., 2015; Chang et al., 2015; Basner et al., 2014; World Health Organization, 2018a). Quiet hours must govern recording demands and scheduling as well as walls and lighting.

18.2.1 — Sleep as Civic Infrastructure

Administratively, sleep must be protected by default rather than rescued after failure. Schedules must contain sleep opportunity, quiet buffers, device cutoff rules, and review of late obligations. Exceptions must be logged because repeated exceptions reveal the real institution more clearly than written norms.

Sleep protection must also be part of readiness interpretation. A participant who demonstrates better judgment after sleep protections are added has not been artificially helped in a disqualifying way. The City has removed an avoidable burden that distorted the record.

Sleep protection must include non-digital floors. If a participant’s room, schedule, or recovery plan depends entirely on devices, apps, biometric prompts, or automated alerts, the protection can fail when systems fail or when the participant needs less stimulation. Paper schedules, human check-ins, analog quiet signals, and low-technology night protocols provide fallbacks.

Provide a buffer between sleep and public interface, using the wake-transition and no-waking-performance rules in Section 17.1.

18.2.2 — Quiet Standards

Quiet standards should cover alerts, footsteps, doors, devices, public voices, and mechanical systems.

Quiet standards begin with zones. Residential areas, recovery rooms, clinical interfaces, reflective spaces, libraries, and sleep corridors receive stronger protection than public edges, deliberative halls, service routes, or emergency bands. Because one acoustic norm cannot serve the whole City, each zone is matched to the kind of burden carried there (Basner et al., 2014; World Health Organization, 2018a).

Sound design must account for more than decibel level. Intermittent noise, unpredictable alerts, echo, public voices near private thresholds, mechanical vibration, late-night movement, and constant low-level signal can all keep the body alert. The issue is not only volume. It is predictability, meaning, timing, and whether the person can trust the environment to let the body settle.

Quiet standards must include measurable and qualitative review. The City may track interruption frequency, complaints, after-hours movement, alarm events, and acoustic failures, but it must also listen to how spaces feel. A technically compliant room can still keep people tense if its sound pattern signals exposure or danger.

Staff must be able to challenge quiet policy from their own perspective. If quiet zones force longer service routes, unsafe night work, or hidden labor, the standard must be redesigned.

Preserve relevant acoustic context when interpreting voice, patience, memory, conflict, or attention in the record.

Provide participants and staff a protected route to report noise that prevents recovery, including the work required to maintain quiet.

Quiet is also an equity issue. Some people can function amid noise because their histories, sensory systems, age, health, or cultural expectations permit it. Others cannot. A fair City does not design only for those most comfortable with noise. Quiet protects disability dignity, trauma recovery, concentration, prayer, grief, study, and ordinary bodily regulation.

18.2.3 — Light Discipline

Recordability never requires architectural harshness. Bedrooms, recovery areas, clinical interfaces, and corridors can support necessary continuity without feeling like interrogation spaces (Cajochen et al., 2011; Perlow, 2012).

Daylight matters because the body uses light as time information. Study, work, commons, walking routes, and public-interface spaces must support orientation to the day where possible. Artificial light must be adjustable by zone and purpose. A deliberative hall, sleep corridor, public record interface, and crisis room must not share one lighting logic.

Night discipline is especially important. Late light, device glow, emergency brightness, public-interface spillover, and security illumination can all undermine sleep. When emergency light is needed, the event must be classified and reviewed, not normalized as ordinary nightly disturbance.

Light also affects dignity. Modesty protocols, protected nonvisibility, intimate handling, clinical care, and de-loading rooms require lighting that protects the person from feeling displayed. Not every protected space must be dim, and not every bright space is humiliating. The issue is whether light serves

care, orientation, and safety, or whether it intensifies the sense of being examined.

Light discipline must be coordinated with accessibility and sensory inclusion. Some people need brighter wayfinding; others need reduced glare or lower stimulation. Disability, age, migraine risk, trauma history, low vision, circadian disruption, and night work all affect what light does to the body. Maintenance must check failed fixtures, harsh replacements, flicker, drifting sensors and security-light spill that alter those conditions after opening.

Public artifacts should show beauty without romanticizing sensory cost. Images of luminous halls, transparent rooms, night windows, and glowing archive walls need captions and framing that preserve human rhythms.

Light discipline must be tested in occupied buildings, not merely promised in drawings. Screens multiply, night work expands, emergency lighting reaches rest areas, and public-facing architecture pressures people to remain visible. Review lived conditions with people who use the spaces and correct failures rather than treating design approval as permanent performance.

Light policy must include the record rooms and not only bedrooms. Archive review spaces, public-interface rooms, deliberative halls, clinical corridors, and staff stations all shape endurance.

18.2.4 — Device and Alert Limits

A City under record will be tempted to solve uncertainty through alerts. Alerts for schedule, capture status, access request, public question, mentor note, security condition, clinical check, archive flag, message, release, or review can all seem useful. Too many alerts can make participants feel constantly on call.

Device limits protect attention. A participant must not be forced into constant responsiveness simply because public-power formation is important (Watson et al., 2015; Chang et al., 2015).

Alert limits also protect against performance drift. If every public reaction, archive comment, citizen question, staff note, and mentor flag reaches the participant immediately, the participant may begin living in response to the system.

Not all alerts are equal. Emergency alerts may override normal limits. Clinical alerts may require care. Security alerts may protect life. Public-interface alerts may wait. Archive notes may be batched. Routine reminders may be quiet. The City must classify alerts by urgency, source, burden, and recovery cost. Reputation management or anxiety alone does not make a message an emergency; route tasks that do not require participant attention to the responsible staff.

Device use must also include staff and nonparticipants. Staff can be overburdened by constant channels. Families can be pulled into City rhythms through participant devices. Clinicians can be pressured by institutional messaging. Vendors can shape alert design in ways that maximize engagement rather than fairness.

Devices can help with accessibility, translation, schedule clarity, emergency response, and record integrity.

Device and alert policy must include an interruption budget. The City must ask how many times in a day a participant, mentor, clinician, operator, or staff member can be interrupted before the work itself becomes fragmented.

Alert design must be transparent enough to audit. Who created the alert category, who receives it, who can silence it, what happens if it is ignored, and whether it creates a record must all be known.

Sleep governance is especially careful with wearable devices. A wearable may help safety or accessibility, but it can also make the body feel continuously governed. Device use must remain purpose-bound, contestable, and removable where safe.

Sleep governance also protects participants from compulsive record checking. A person under visible burden may begin searching for public reaction, archive status, comment summaries, correction requests, or machine interpretations.

18.2.5 — Sleep-Related Record Handling

Protected sleep is a declared noncapture period: the sleeping body is not recorded as formation evidence. The City records only the narrowly necessary status, environmental or safety data, and incidents permitted by this section; continuity does not authorize audio or video observation of sleep.

The first distinction is between operational record and public release. The City may need to know that sleep opportunity was protected, that interruptions occurred, that emergency access happened, or that a health condition required care. Protected summaries may serve public meaning without public harm (Basner et al., 2014; World Health Organization, 2018a).

Sleep-related records must be governed by status categories. Ordinary sleep, sleep interruption, emergency entry, clinical intervention, security issue, technical failure, and participant request must not be collapsed.

Sleep-related record handling includes usable challenge and remedy. Participants can contest classification, seek review of repeated interruption, report dignity violations, and correct misleading summaries.

Before the first participant enters, the sleep-related record policy must specify the permitted status, environmental or safety data, incident logs, access roles, retention limits, and challenge

route. Emergency entries must be classified by purpose and necessity. Neither ordinary sleep nor vulnerability during waking creates permission to record the body as formation evidence.

Sleep governance also protects against inference. Repeated public notes about disruption may reveal medical, family, emotional, or intimate information even without images. Aggregate reports and protected summaries must therefore be assessed for what they allow others to infer.

Public reporting should use the least exposing form that establishes whether sleep protection worked. Unauthorized intimate capture is a breach to contain and remedy, not material to retain merely because later viewers might find it useful.

Any recording independently required for clinical care remains governed by clinical confidentiality, applicable consent requirements, and lawful emergency rules. It does not enter the City's formation record merely because the patient is a participant. A separately established role-relevant event can be reviewed without treating sleep itself as public evidence.

Sleep-related records must be reviewed by people trained to understand vulnerability, not by general archive staff alone. The reviewer needs privacy judgment, clinical sensitivity, record-law discipline, technical competence, and public-interest restraint.

Sleep governance also keeps sleep-related review separate from sensational public dispute. If opponents claim that a participant slept poorly, behaved strangely after waking, or used medication, the institution must not answer by releasing vulnerable material.

Audit sleep-related access. Logs must show whether release occurred, who looked, why, under what authority, and whether access was necessary. A fictional overnight support entry can test whether ordinary search or public scheduling reveals its

existence, timestamp or access history. Authorized reviewers should remain able to investigate improper access under their own permissions. Public explanations must describe the control without hinting who used clinical support.

18.3 — AI, Mentor, and Clinician Boundaries

Technical assistance, formation interpretation, and clinical care remain distinct authorities. Human owners retain consequential decisions and challenge routes; mentors guide interpretation without owning conscience; clinicians direct care under professional duties rather than archive demand. The governance frameworks cited here inform the responsibility cards below without themselves authorizing a City service (NIST, 2023a; European Union, 2024; Council of Europe, 2024). Each support role therefore receives a responsibility card.

18.3.1 — AI Assistance Limit

The role-bound scope card identifies the human owner, purpose, authority, permitted inputs, permitted outputs, confidentiality rule, prohibited inference, override power, appeal route, review date, and retirement condition. It also names who may stop the role when care, privacy, or safety is threatened. The card travels with the service and any derivative output so responsibility cannot disappear inside a handoff or technical interface.

The map is tested through cross-role scenarios rather than organizational charts alone. If a machine flag suggests a schedule-limit breach, a mentor notices avoidance, and a clinician recommends rest, the City must know which fact can move to which role, what remains protected, who decides the schedule change, and what the public may be told. The safest answer is usually a narrow operational status plus accountable human action, not a merged support dossier.

For Artificial Intelligence, the shared responsibility card expands into a technical control sheet. It records the system and vendor, version and configuration, exact task, authorized data, forbidden data and inferences, output status, human decision owner, monitoring interval, challenge route, fallback, emergency

suspension, and retirement or vendor-exit condition. This machine-specific layer makes dependencies inspectable before an output can influence a schedule, care route, public summary, or formation decision.

Permitted functions are narrow and operational: retrieval from already authorized records; schedule comparison; accessibility support; translation with human verification; missing-context prompts; checks of declared schedule limits, records integrity, and data quality; and preparation of labeled summaries for review. The system's scope must remain limited by purpose, proportionality, and named human responsibility (NIST, 2023a; European Union, 2024; Council of Europe, 2024).

Prohibited functions are equally explicit. A system may not decide readiness, sincerity, dignity, clinical condition, spiritual meaning, dangerousness, moral worth, public trust, or the significance of a life pattern. It may not become therapist, conscience, mentor, adjudicator, or eligibility authority.

Label every output by its evidential role: search result, provisional summary, risk flag, forecast, or classification proposal. None establishes a diagnosis, an independent finding, or a final decision. Include source records, model version, uncertainty where meaningful, the responsible human reviewer, and the correction route. Review summaries for omissions and framing as well as factual accuracy.

Data boundaries are part of the assistance limit. Clinical notes, intimate records, child-related material, protected nonvisibility categories, nonparticipant information, staff private data, and raw reflection records are excluded unless a separately authorized purpose and lawful pathway require the minimum necessary input. Operational capture is not model-training consent (NIST, 2020b; Council of Europe, 2018b).

A false-positive scenario shows why this separation matters. A model flags repeated late-night logins in authorized operational records, shortened recovery intervals, and irregular message timing as a possible breach of the agreed recovery schedule. The pattern appears serious, but the late logins came from an accessibility synchronization process and the message timing reflected a temporary caregiving schedule. A machine-centered workflow would turn accommodation and care into suspicion.

Human review changes the outcome. The participant receives notice, an accessibility specialist checks the synchronization logs, the schedule owner verifies the temporary arrangement, and a clinician is not consulted unless the participant seeks care or a genuine clinical question arises. The alert is withdrawn, the record is corrected, the model rule is tested for similar errors, and no readiness consequence survives.

Contestability must be practical. Participants and affected staff need access to the input categories, output, responsible owner, decision use, correction path, and deadline for review without having to reverse-engineer a proprietary model. A challenge pauses any adverse operational consequence unless an independently justified safety rule requires immediate action. The human reviewer must be able to disagree without seeking permission from the system that produced the flag.

A kill switch is necessary but not sufficient. The City also needs authority to suspend one feature, isolate a data source, revert to a manual process, preserve evidence, notify affected people, and prevent a vendor from silently restoring functionality. Stop conditions include unexplained error, discriminatory burden, unauthorized data use, security compromise, role expansion, appeal failure, or repeated disagreement between output and qualified human review.

Version and provenance records make later correction possible. Each consequential output should identify the model or service version, configuration, prompt or rule family where relevant, input provenance, human reviewer, and downstream use. Changes in vendor, model, threshold, or data source require a new review rather than inheriting old approval. The City must be able to reconstruct why an output existed at the time it affected a decision.

Emotional dependence presents a different risk. A participant may prefer a tool that responds instantly, never tires, and appears nonjudgmental, especially when human support is scarce. The City must not solve understaffing by letting a machine become a hidden confessor, strategist, or substitute companion. Use patterns that displace mentorship, clinical care, friendship, sleep, or independent judgment trigger a support review, not a moral judgment about the user.

Clinical boundaries remain firm. A tool may help schedule an appointment, retrieve an authorized resource, or present a participant's own tracked information, but it may not diagnose, prescribe, determine capacity, or disclose clinical material to formation reviewers. Clinicians retain professional independence and decide what can be shared under consent and law.

Fairness testing must include accessibility and differential error. A system can burden disabled participants, unfamiliar language users, people with irregular care schedules, cultural minorities, or less standardized communication even without using protected labels directly. Review therefore examines who is flagged, who is missed, who must appeal, how long correction takes, and whether the tool shifts work onto staff or participants (UNESCO, 2021b; United Nations, 2006). Apply the public machine-output disclosure and correction rules in Section 10.6.3,

including a visible generated-output label and access to the governed source record.

Procurement must preserve exit. Contracts require data portability, deletion or return duties, audit access, incident notice, model-change notice, subcontractor disclosure, continuity plans, and the ability to operate essential functions without the vendor. Include vendor dependence in the care-risk register.

Periodic review asks whether the tool still earns its place. Reviewers compare error, appeal, labor, privacy, accessibility, dependency, and outcome evidence against a manual or less intrusive alternative. A tool may be narrowed or retired even if it performs accurately when its surrounding burdens are too high.

18.3.2 — Human Mentor Role

Mentors help participants interpret formation, prepare for difficult public contact, and act on warranted correction. Their influence remains subject to the supervision and intervention controls in Section 17.7.3.

A mentor must not function as confessor, therapist, campaign strategist, disciplinary judge, public-relations handler, or private political adviser. Some conversations may touch emotional, political, or practical material, but role boundaries must remain clear (UNESCO, 2021b; World Health Organization, 2021a).

Mentors need protection too. They must not be expected to absorb unlimited emotional labor, become emergency clinicians, or serve as invisible stabilizers for institutional design failures. Mentor workload, complaint routes, role records, and supervision matter.

Mentor assignment is reviewable from both sides. Participants can report dependency, pressure, bias, romanticization, humiliation, ideological shaping, or boundary confusion, while

mentors can report overload, manipulation, or institutional pressure to push someone forward.

Apply the purpose-limited mentor-note rule in Section 17.7.3; notes must distinguish observed role conduct, agreed action, and uncertainty.

Because mentors encounter patterns before formal review, material interventions need a second-look route. The mentor identifies the observation, source, uncertainty, plausible alternatives, and requested next step; the participant can respond; and a supervisor or peer reviewer can test boundary and bias when the stakes are high.

Mentors must also be rotated carefully without destroying trust. Permanent dependence can make the mentor a hidden center of power; constant replacement can make formation shallow and unsafe. A fair model uses continuity, second looks, supervision, and review.

18.3.3 — Clinician Independence

A participant must be able to seek help for exhaustion, anxiety, grief, sleep disruption, trauma response, health concern, or overload without assuming that every disclosure becomes a public-power record category.

Clinical independence therefore designs clinician access outside ordinary mentor, operator, and archive authority. Scheduling, notes, alerts, and disclosures must follow professional boundaries. Any necessary communication to the City must use minimum necessary information, role-specific status, and clear protection. The clinician must be able to recommend de-loading, pause, accommodation, or urgent care without becoming a public narrator.

Clinical independence also protects against overmedicalization: conflict or strong emotion need not be a

disorder. Clinicians must be free of pressure both to minimize care and to medicalize ordinary burden.

Care records, safety summaries, duty-to-warn pathways, and public explanations must be separated with legal and ethical precision.

Clinical input may establish load limits, care needs, pause conditions, crisis plans, or safe-return conditions. It cannot certify virtue, endorse candidacy, or turn therapy into public narrative; apply the confidentiality and functional-assessment limits in Section 14.2.2.

Clinical independence must be written into procurement, employment, and reporting structures. A clinician paid, evaluated, or pressured by the same office that wants a participant declared ready may face a conflict even without bad intent. The City must use independent clinical governance, confidential consultation channels, and protected refusal rights.

A public-facing statement can confirm independent clinical review, a status change, load adjustment, or pending return review without exposing therapy, diagnosis, medication, trauma, family history, or private notes.

Clinicians must also have the right to criticize the institution's design. If clinical patterns show that a schedule, space, record practice, or public-interface demand is harming participants, the clinician must not be limited to treating individuals one by one. They must be able to trigger institutional review through protected channels.

18.3.4 — Override Rules

A psychosocial-risk register translates that separation into work design. It records the hazard, exposed role, likely pathway, existing control, worker or participant report, decision owner, review clock, and stop threshold. Repeated alerting, public

hostility, ambiguous authority, intimate-record exposure, night interruption, moral distress, and impossible caseloads are treated as design hazards rather than character flaws. The register remains role-focused and cannot become a score of resilience or fitness (ISO, 2021b; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

A schedule may be too intense, a mentor intervention poorly timed, an Artificial Intelligence flag misleading, a public-interface demand excessive, a clinical concern urgent, or a record release premature. The City must know who can stop what, on what basis, and how the stop is reviewed.

The strongest override protects life and immediate safety. If clinical or emergency conditions require interruption of ordinary record, schedule, public interface, or formation activity, care comes first. The action is logged and reviewed later, but procedural purity cannot delay urgent care (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; World Health Organization, 2022a).

Use the tool suspension, challenge, and correction controls in Section 18.3.1 when an Artificial Intelligence output creates burden.

Participant and staff override routes also matter. A participant must be able to request de-loading, challenge overload, seek care, contest a public-interface demand, or object to support-record misuse. Staff must be able to stop unsafe procedures, report impossible workload, and trigger review when institutional expectations threaten dignity.

Use the exception record in Section 26.5.2 for safety, clinical, legal, technical and emergency overrides. Preserve each domain’s lawful initiator and access class; review repeated overrides for evasion, concealed misconduct or emergency powers becoming routine.

Override governance reviews override frequency. Rare overrides may indicate a healthy safety valve. Constant overrides may indicate a broken schedule, unclear rules, weak staffing, bad technology, or a culture that hides problems until emergencies.

Override rules must be tested in drills. A protocol that looks clear on paper may fail when a participant is ashamed, a journalist is waiting, a public event is scheduled, an Artificial Intelligence system keeps prompting completion, and staff disagree about risk. Drills reveal who freezes, who has authority, and which record status applies.

Override authority must be protected from retaliation. A staff member who stops a public event, a clinician who refuses a release, a mentor who slows a schedule, or a participant who contests a tool may embarrass the institution in the short term.

18.3.5 — Support-Record Boundaries

Support records are some of the most sensitive records in the City because they sit between care, formation, operation, and public meaning. A mentor note, clinical status signal, de-loading request, Artificial Intelligence alert, staff observation, or recovery plan may be important for the participant's safety and the City's integrity. It may also be easily misused.

The first boundary is purpose. Support records exist to support care, load management, formation integrity, safety, and institutional learning. They do not exist to feed public spectacle, generate readiness narratives, train machines, embarrass participants, evaluate spiritual worth, or create hidden scores (UNESCO, 2021b; World Health Organization, 2021a).

The second boundary is access. Not everyone who can see formation records must see support records. Clinical material, mentor notes, Artificial Intelligence alerts, and staff observations may require different access categories. Oversight may need

audit trails without raw disclosure. Public record sites may need protected summaries or no release at all.

The third boundary is interpretation. A support record identifies a need, response, and relevant conditions; it does not certify weakness, integrity, dishonesty, or readiness. Clinical recommendations may concern institutional overload as well as individual needs. Any role decision must use the proper functional review and its contextual evidence.

The fourth boundary is reuse. Support records must not be silently converted into research data, Artificial Intelligence training material, public interface content, campaign material, donor reassurance, or staff evaluation. Any otherwise permitted secondary use requires separate authority, review, and protection.

Support records must be classified at creation. The person creating the record must know whether it is clinical, mentor, operational, safety, accessibility, load review, or public-interface support. Later reclassification must require review.

Participants must receive plain-language notice about support records before they need support. The City must tell participants in advance what is recorded, who can see it, how it may be used, what is protected, and how to challenge misuse.

Support-record policy must also protect staff. Staff observations may be necessary for safety, but staff must not be pressured to provide psychological speculation. Their role is to report role-relevant facts and burden concerns, not to diagnose or narrate the participant.

Support workers need the same boundary discipline that protects participants. Mentors, clinicians, care coordinators, disability-support staff, and Artificial Intelligence reviewers should be credited when their work materially shapes a decision and protected when their labor becomes strained. Traceable

influence does not require disclosure of confidential care or substitution of helper identity for participant accountability.

Participants and staff receive the responsibility map before use. Material changes trigger review. A departure from declared practice suspends the affected use of data or authority until responsibility is restored; urgent care and essential support continue through the appropriate independent route.

Escalation follows the problem: schedules to operations, formation to mentors, health to clinicians, danger to emergency care, and rights complaints to independent review. The lanes remain separate, but they must connect when a single problem crosses them. A participant facing exhaustion, for example, may need a temporary schedule change, clinical assessment, mentor de-loading, and a protected complaint route without being forced to retell the same private history to each office.

18.4 — Load Limits and Weekly Rhythms

Load limits should be attached to demands and resources rather than to a generalized ideal of resilience. The job-demands-resources tradition explains why high demands become more hazardous when autonomy, staffing, support, recovery, and role clarity are weak. Global working-time evidence likewise shows that hours and schedule organization affect health and work-life balance. A City load board should therefore review the system that produces strain, not merely the person who reports it, and should have authority to remove work before care becomes a test of loyalty (Demerouti et al., 2001; Bakker and Demerouti, 2007; International Labour Organization, 2023).

18.4.1 — Daily Load Ceiling

A day can become too demanding even when each study, deliberation, public-interface, mentoring, or record-review task is justified in isolation (Demerouti et al., 2001; Bakker and Demerouti, 2007).

The daily ceiling must include both scheduled and unscheduled burden. A participant may have a moderate official schedule but face unexpected citizen input, family stress, technical alert, staff conflict, sleep disruption, or public controversy.

Set ceilings for the pathway and the person’s actual support needs, using Section 18.4.4 for role-specific load and Section 14.2.4 for accommodation.

Before adding a task, the scheduler checks the remaining protected recovery interval and the applicable load limit. Work that would exceed the limit is deferred, reduced, or reassigned to qualified capacity with its own workload protected. A change to the limit follows the existing review route; operational

convenience and a participant's wish to continue do not override an independent clinical restriction. The revised schedule records where the displaced work and recovery time went.

A practical daily-load register must track visible-record pressure, decision and deliberation demand, sensory burden, relational pressure, public-interface intensity, and the recovery that has actually occurred. These factors must not be collapsed into a single score, public dashboard, clinical diagnosis, or readiness grade. Their purpose is to help qualified humans see when several burdens are accumulating at once, document uncertainty, and adjust the day before strain distorts care, judgment, or the record.

Daily ceilings must be conservative at first because the cumulative effects of visible life may emerge slowly. A participant may appear capable on day one, strained on day four, and less able to recover after a month. The City must therefore treat early endurance as weak evidence. The better question is whether the participant remains able to sleep, receive correction, treat staff well, think clearly, ask for care, and stop when the ceiling is reached.

The ceiling must be recalibrated after incidents, not defended as a fixed rule. A day that looked acceptable before a breakdown may look too heavy afterward. Recalibration can change the length of public-interface windows, the number of record-review tasks, the density of deliberative sessions, or the ratio of recovery to exposure.

18.4.2 — Weekly Recovery Pattern

A weekly recovery pattern must include low-interface periods, protected sleep opportunity, reduced alert exposure, ordinary movement, unpressured meals, clinical access where needed, mentor light days, and time not immediately framed as

productivity (International Labour Organization, 2023; Pega et al., 2021).

The week must also include review without obsession. Participants need to understand patterns, but not be forced into constant self-analysis. A weekly load review can ask what drained, what restored, what distorted, what clarified, what staff burden appeared, what nonparticipant burden surfaced, and what must change.

Provide predictable rest and rotation for clinicians, mentors, security, operations, archive staff, and moderators within the weekly pattern.

Include lower-load days, outdoor time, and family or household boundary time where appropriate.

Weekly review compares the recovery time promised with the recovery time actually available. A cancelled interval records the operational reason, who authorized the change, when equivalent time was restored, and whether the replacement displaced another person’s rest. The review uses scheduling evidence rather than private accounts of how someone spent the interval. Repeated differences between promise and delivery lead to a revised workload or staffing plan.

During public controversy, do not cancel recovery to extend sessions, answer more questions, or release more summaries. Keep legitimate public responses within the governed weekly rhythm.

A weekly pattern must include the public's burden too. Citizens, critics, visitors, and affected persons must know when the participant is available, when the record is being reviewed, when public response is scheduled, and when recovery is protected.

18.4.3 — Seasonal Intensity Variation

Seasonal intensity variation recognizes that not every period of formation can carry the same load. Some seasons may involve study, others deliberation, others simulation, public interface, office preparation, crisis rehearsal, recovery, or review.

Seasonal design must make high-intensity periods visible in advance. Participants, staff, households, clinicians, public-interface teams, and host systems need warning when load will rise. Sudden intensity may be unavoidable in emergencies, but ordinary formation must not operate by surprise (Karasek, 1979; Siegrist, 1996).

Low-intensity seasons are not failures. They may be the periods when integration happens. A participant may process prior correction, rebuild sleep, repair relationships, deepen study, recover from public interface, or test ordinary rhythm.

Seasonal intensity must be tied to review. If a high-intensity season produces repeated breakdown, sleep failure, staff burnout, complaints, or nonparticipant spillover, the next season must change. If low-intensity seasons become avoidance or institutional drift, they also require correction.

Load governance includes seasonal exit and pause points. A participant who can only leave after a major sequence ends may become trapped by the narrative of completion. Seasonal review must ask whether continuing is fair, not only whether progress has been made.

Different climates and cultural calendars may matter. Heat, winter darkness, holidays, religious seasons, school schedules, host-community events, and election cycles can all alter load. Seasonal intensity must be locally intelligent rather than imported from one original City as if human rhythm were universal.

Seasonal design must also include renewal of consent. A person may consent to a general Vow and later discover that a particular season affects the body or household differently than expected. Periodic review can ask whether the participant still understands the burden, whether support remains adequate, whether dependents are shielded, and whether continuation remains free of hidden coercion.

Seasonal variation can be used for education in restraint. A participant must learn how to move from intense public interface to quiet study without feeling useless, from crisis simulation to ordinary care without seeking adrenaline, and from opposition to rest without carrying the opponent into sleep.

18.4.4 — Role-Specific Load

Match formation load to the public role being prepared for without creating a prestige ladder; use the pathway-specific demands in Section 14.3 as the starting point.

When a participant struggles, review pathway fit and support design before concluding that public service is not possible.

Load governance maintains a pathway map that explains why certain load elements belong to certain roles. Participants and the public must know why one pathway requires more simulation, another more legal humility, another more administrative work, and another more public-interface training.

A role-specific approach also protects against hidden exclusion. If every pathway is designed around extroversion, long hours, high sensory tolerance, elite language, and constant public response, many capable people will be filtered out by design rather than by true public unreadiness.

Where needed, adjust role load for sensory modification, sleep timing, mobility, communication, medication schedules, clinical

privacy, and public-interface density, applying the accommodation review in Section 14.2.4 without stigma.

Public summaries must not equate visible hours with seriousness; explain the role-specific burden and whether support reduced or displaced it.

Role-specific load must be revisited when the participant's path changes. A person accepted for one pathway may discover aptitude or burden mismatch that suggests another.

18.4.5 — Load Review Board

A Load Review Board makes overload institutionally visible across people, roles, schedules, spaces, staff, records, and public interface.

The board reviews unfair, unsafe, distorted, or hidden load; it does not judge strength, worth, or fitness for office. It examines daily ceilings, weekly rhythms, seasonal intensity, sleep reports, de-loading requests, staff burden, complaints, and continuity events without turning those signals into public rank.

The board must include role separation. Operators know schedules. Clinicians understand care but must preserve independence. Mentors understand formation but can have bias. Staff representatives know hidden labor. Participant voice reveals lived load. External reviewers may see normalization drift. No single role may control the interpretation of overload. Composition also includes occupational health, disability expertise, and records governance.

The board must use status categories rather than moral labels. A load condition may be normal, elevated, concerning, unsafe, under review, requiring de-loading, requiring clinical assessment, requiring schedule redesign, or requiring pause. Public reporting may occur in aggregate or protected form where necessary.

The board must have authority to change actual conditions. It must be able to recommend or require schedule reduction, staffing increase, interface limits, technology pause, public-release delay, clinical review, pathway adjustment, architectural modification, device-policy revision, mentor retraining, or temporary halt.

Publish protected aggregate findings on repeated ceiling breaches, staff burnout, and public-interface harm.

The board itself must be audited. A review body can become too cautious, too permissive, too captured by clinicians, too dominated by operators, or too protective of public image.

Public board output uses operational categories and protected summaries under Section 18.3.5. It may identify a changed schedule, support route, interface ceiling, or failed institutional practice without exposing the underlying care record.

A two-axis map can compare load severity with recovery adequacy: high load may be seasonal with strong recovery, while moderate load can be dangerous when recovery is poor. The map guides inquiry rather than verdict and helps reviewers ask what must change.

Minutes must be auditable without exposing intimate detail. They should record reasons, evidence categories, dissent, decisions, review clocks, appeals, and institutional correction.

Load review separates immediate care, temporary adjustment, recurring workload, and structural redesign. Clinicians control urgency; operations change schedules; staff and accessibility specialists raise labor and accommodation effects; participants contest evidence and response. No aggregate index may collapse these lanes into a tolerance score.

Board materials show hours, intensity, interruptions, recovery loss, public-interface demand, travel, voluntarily disclosed caregiving constraints, and unresolved complaints only to the

degree needed for the decision. Missing information and alternative explanations remain visible. A quiet week may reflect recovery, exclusion, illness, or concealed overload, just as high activity may reflect pressure rather than commitment.

Each decision receives a clock and, where possible, a reversible first step: reduced load, protected recovery, schedule change, staffing, or reassignment. The board reviews results with the affected person and staff; if the intervention fails, the board revises the load plan rather than assigning blame (Bakker and Demerouti, 2007; World Health Organization, 2022a).

Appeal must reach authority outside the unit that created the demand. The appellant may challenge the evidence, proportionality, confidentiality, or unequal burden. Remedies can restore time, pay, access, opportunity, privacy, or support.

18.5 — Reflection and Ritual

Visible public-power formation cannot be only schedule, record, and load management. Human beings need ways to return to themselves, process error, grieve consequence, prepare apology, and recover meaning after being corrected. The City must make room for reflection. It must also prevent reflection from becoming coerced confession, spiritual pressure, or public performance.

18.5.1 — Secular Reflection

Reflection can help people work through responsibility, but it becomes coercive when one authorized emotional style is treated as evidence of maturity. Research on contemplative practice finds modest average benefits for some forms and populations, while psychology of religion emphasizes the diversity of spiritual coping, including struggle, doubt, and nonreligious meaning. The City should therefore offer quiet, ritual, conversation, grief, and secular reflection as voluntary resources. No participant owes the institution a confession, conversion, catharsis, or publicly legible inner transformation (Goyal et al., 2014; Pargament, 1997; Koenig et al., 2012).

Secular reflection must be fully protected, including for participants who are doubtful, spiritually wounded, or uninterested in religious language.

Secular reflection gives the participant a way to return to themselves without making that return a ritual of belief. It may involve quiet, writing, walking, ethical review, apology preparation, breathing, reading, conversation, or simply unstructured thought. The City must protect spaces and times where meaning can be gathered without being publicly performed (Goyal et al., 2014; Pargament, 1997).

Apply Section 18.5.5 when reflection creates a role-relevant output; private reflection does not itself authorize an institutional record or release.

Reflection governance provides reflection prompts that remain civic rather than spiritual by default. Examples may ask what burden was moved, who was unseen, what correction was resisted, what staff work was relied on, and what public consequence followed.

A reflective interval need not produce an insight, quotation, report, or improvement metric.

18.5.2 — Optional Ritual

Optional rituals may mark return, grief, apology or a new beginning. Neither attendance nor refusal may become a readiness or loyalty signal; apply Section 3.2.4 to their scheduling and institutional use.

Ritual can be civic, secular, religious, or personal depending on context and consent. A moment of silence after harm, a nonreligious review practice, a voluntary prayer, a grief observance, an apology setting, or a shared closing practice may help some participants carry burden (Koenig et al., 2012; Deci and Ryan, 2000).

Distinguish a declared public ceremony from personal practice, clinical care, secular reflection, and protected grief. Ordinary private practice remains outside routine capture under Section 7.1; any role-relevant output follows Section 18.5.5.

Optional reflection and ritual require a socially real opt-out. Participation is never announced, counted, rewarded, or treated as a sign of seriousness, and alternative secular spaces receive equal time and dignity. Staff protect confidentiality and watch for informal status effects so that conscience remains free in daily practice.

Ritual policy must also address plural provision. If one optional form receives space, schedule, staff support, or record handling, other lawful and appropriate forms must receive fair consideration.

Participants may try a practice and leave it later without penalty or a public explanation; apply the conscience-record boundary in Section 18.5.3.

Optional ritual spaces must be acoustically, visually, and administratively modest. If they become the most beautiful rooms, the most honored rooms, or the rooms most often shown in public materials, optionality may weaken.

18.5.3 — Religion of Fairness and Optional Ritual Boundary

The boundary protects people who do not participate in the Religion of Fairness through ordinary operating rules. Required schedules, readiness reviews, mentor notes, housing, support, promotion, and public summaries may not depend on belief in the Religion of Fairness, its vocabulary, ritual, or affiliation. A secular participant and a participant from another tradition must be able to complete every civic requirement without translating conscience into the terms of the Religion of Fairness. The Vow is civic, and that distinction must be visible in records as well as policy (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; World Health Organization, 2021b).

Reflection spaces therefore need neutral access design. Booking categories, room names, staff scripts, calendars, symbols, and funding should permit secular quiet, multiple religious practices, personal reflection, and no practice at all without creating a default sacred identity. Optional Religion of Fairness uses can exist, but they remain separable from required formation and protected as conscience information.

Staff training should use concrete prohibited inferences. Refusal of a Religion of Fairness practice is not resistance to correction; absence from ritual is not disengagement; secular language is not shallowness; another tradition is not a competing loyalty; and private devotion is not evidence of readiness. Mentors may ask what form of reflection supports the participant, but they may not prescribe a metaphysical frame. Supervision and complaint review should test whether informal culture violates those limits.

Public artifacts need the same discipline. Tours, photographs, illustrations, captions, record-site summaries, ceremonies, donor materials, and media access must not present the Religion of Fairness as the City's hidden creed or emotional center. Where a participant voluntarily describes the Religion of Fairness as personally meaningful, the record should identify the statement as personal meaning rather than institutional doctrine. Plural and secular routes deserve equal narrative dignity, not merely a disclaimer in small print.

The ownership line is simple enough to teach. *The Religion of Fairness* owns its doctrine, ritual development, pastoral practice, doubt, exit, and religion-side anti-capture. The City owns bounded public-power formation and may accommodate lawful conscience as part of humane daily life. Neither volume authorizes the other to convert spiritual participation into civic standing.

Readiness review may examine whether a participant protects freedom of conscience, resists coercion, respects nonparticipation, and can explain public reasons across plural disagreement. It may not ask whether the participant began participating in the Religion of Fairness, prayed correctly, joined a house, used a sacred calendar, or interpreted suffering through

categories specific to the Religion of Fairness. Those questions would measure affiliation rather than public-role capacity.

External legibility makes optionality verifiable. Schedules mark required and optional activities; spaces disclose their governance; public materials name the City's civic purpose; and complaint channels let people report religious pressure without entering a theological dispute.

Funding and sponsorship cannot weaken that boundary. A donor, founder, religious organization, or Religion of Fairness community facility may not purchase privileged ritual time, symbolic placement, staff influence, admissions access, or public-artifact prominence. Restricted gifts require the same anti-leverage review used elsewhere in the City.

Records treat the Religion of Fairness like any other protected religious or philosophical practice. Personal devotion is relevant only when role conduct, coercion, discrimination, funding, conflict, public explanation, or institutional authority creates a narrow civic purpose. Absence of devotion is never a deficiency, and no raw reflection record enters a readiness file.

18.5.4 — Grief and Apology Spaces

Grief and apology spaces exist because public-power formation will involve harm, loss, error, and repair. A participant may grieve what they have done, what was done to them, what public systems have harmed, or what cannot be restored. Apology may be needed to staff, peers, affected persons, families, host communities, or the public. These moments require space that is serious without being theatrical.

Grief enters the City first as a need for care. Participants, staff members, and family members remain grieving people rather than exhibits of depth, symbols of institutional nobility, or sources of emotional leverage. Later public explanation may

sometimes be appropriate, but most grief belongs in protected human space with consent, support, and time (Goyal et al., 2014; Pargament, 1997).

Safety before reconciliation governs apology spaces: no apology process should pressure an affected person, become a condition of care, or begin before the harmed person is safe.

An apology space is judged by what it repairs. It supports truth, responsibility, affected-person agency, refusal of forced forgiveness, concrete remedy, and follow-through while keeping emotion voluntary. Tears, eloquence, confession, silence, and private grief are not readiness measures. The record therefore follows commitments, corrections, and consequences rather than staging remorse for an audience.

Grief and apology may require professional support. Clinicians, mediators, legal counsel, ombuds, spiritual care providers, or trained facilitators may be needed depending on context. Household conflict, trauma, workplace harm, and public injury require different safeguards.

Remedy may require compensation, schedule change, record correction, staff discipline, nonparticipant shielding, public notice, or policy revision.

Respect a harmed person’s request for distance, boundaries, privacy, remedy, or silence in place of contact or an emotionally satisfying apology.

A grief space must also allow anger to be named and examined without public spectacle or moral labeling. Respond to threats or harmful conduct through the appropriate safety and accountability route; anger alone does not establish danger.

18.5.5 — Reflection Without Public Confession

The City may need to see conduct, reasoning, repair, decisions, and role-relevant patterns. It does not need forced confessions of

private feeling as proof of sincerity. Public confession can feel honest while becoming manipulative or coercive. A participant may learn to speak vulnerability in ways that please the archive. Staff may reward emotional disclosure. The public may demand more pain as proof. Media may turn confession into narrative. Supporters may treat vulnerability as moral authority (Koenig et al., 2012; Deci and Ryan, 2000).

This does not mean participants never speak personally. Public explanation may sometimes require acknowledgement of motive, regret, uncertainty, fear, or responsibility. The distinction lies in purpose and consent. A public explanation serves accountability for public-power formation. A coerced confession serves appetite, control, or institutional theater.

Participants must also be protected from institutional prompts that become confession scripts. A daily review can ask about burden and correction without requiring emotional self-revelation. The difference between accountable reflection and forced vulnerability must be built into forms, mentor practice, and release policy.

A role-relevant reflection may inform a mentor discussion, clinical care, an operational note, or a justified public explanation under that lane's authority. These are separate routes, not automatic stages of disclosure; apply Section 11.7 to prevent cross-architecture reuse.

The public must be taught this distinction from the beginning. If the City markets itself through confession clips, tearful moments, dramatic apologies, or exposed breakthroughs, it will create the appetite it later claims to resist. Editorial review of public materials should test whether emotional exposure is being used as a substitute for evidence of repair.

When reflection has no public-power consequence, make the option of no institutional output explicit. Audit for indirect

pressure to produce disclosures, testimonials, or institutional meaning.

18.6 — Breakdown, De-Loading, and Humane Failure

The humane-failure pathway gives the City a graduated route from early strain to safe pause, recovery, return, or exit. Breakdown signals help the institution see overload before collapse. De-loading reduces burden while options remain. Care before classification prevents immediate moral labeling. Nonpunitive review distinguishes correction from shame, and return or exit review asks what the next safe step must be (Maslach and Leiter, 2016; World Health Organization, 2022a).

18.6.1 — Breakdown Signals

Possible early concerns include changes in sleep, irritability, withdrawal, perfectionism, emotional flatness, conflict avoidance, sudden compliance, excessive self-explanation, staff tension, sensory tolerance, or recovery after public contact. These observations can prompt a supportive check-in; none establishes overload or a diagnosis by itself.

Possible explanations include personal grief, institutional overload, a poorly designed schedule, clinical need, public attack, family burden, staff conflict, or genuine misconduct pressure. Assess these alternatives through contextual review, with qualified care where needed (Maslach and Leiter, 2016; World Health Organization, 2022a).

The humane-failure pathway collects signals from multiple sources without building a gossip system. Participants may self-report. Mentors may notice. Clinicians may recommend limits. Staff may report burden. Load Review Boards may see patterns. Artificial Intelligence may flag schedule anomalies or alert intensity, but machine flags remain subordinate. The signal pathway must protect privacy and prevent overreach.

Breakdown signals also require nonparticipant awareness. A household member, dependent, staff member, or partner may

experience the participant's overload before the City sees it. Complaint routes must be safe for these people.

Route early concerns through the care-first triage in Section 18.6.3, including review of the institution’s contribution to burden.

Train staff, mentors, clinicians, operators, and participants to report early signals before crisis, and reward early naming rather than silent endurance.

Signal systems also protect against strategic misuse. Concern language cannot become a weapon for rivals, resentful staff, manipulative mentors, or public actors. Context, independent review, corroboration where appropriate, and safeguards against labeling keep the system responsive without making vulnerability politically usable.

Compare signal clusters after interface changes and technology rollouts through the institutional-variables review in Section 18.1.5.

Changes across sleep, social contact, study, public monitoring, and recovery may warrant review, using voluntarily disclosed information and authorized role observations. A single urgent safety concern still requires prompt qualified assessment; reviewers must not wait for a cluster.

Treat volunteering for every burden, refusing rest, welcoming every public challenge, and constant duty talk as possible overload signals, even when these behaviors attract praise.

18.6.2 — De-Loading Pathways

Humane failure requires an organizational route before it requires a label. Burnout research locates exhaustion, cynicism, and reduced efficacy in chronic workplace conditions, and current mental-health-at-work guidance emphasizes organizational prevention, accommodation, and supported return

rather than individual blame. The City should treat de-loading, leave, role change, treatment, and exit as ordinary safety mechanisms (Maslach and Leiter, 2016; World Health Organization, 2022a; National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine, 2019).

De-loading is a governed reduction of burden to preserve safety, dignity, and truthful formation when current load is too high; it is neither a penalty nor a secret retreat from the Vow.

A de-loading pathway may reduce public-interface windows, postpone simulation, lower alert exposure, increase sleep protection, pause certain educational blocks, shift to protected summaries, schedule clinical review, reassign staff support, or mark a temporary status label. The point is to reduce load without pretending the participant remains in ordinary full-intensity formation (National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine, 2019; Bonanno, 2004).

De-loading needs an intelligible status rather than an ambiguous retreat from active life. The internal record identifies its review clock, access rules, public explanation where needed, and conditions for reentry.

Include added clinical work, scheduling, coordination, public communication, and record handling in every de-loading decision, and repair any burden shifted to staff.

Every de-loading pathway ends in a scheduled review. The review chooses among return, continued reduced load, pause, pathway redirection, or exit and records the reasons, support needs, and next clock.

A care-first de-loading case begins after three nights of disrupted sleep, escalating alerts, and an unusually dense sequence of public-facing work. The participant becomes tearful during a drafting block, loses track of a familiar task, and asks to continue because a public session is scheduled. The first

response is not a readiness finding. The schedule owner stops the public work, a protected coordinator secures a quiet route, and care begins before the institution asks for an explanation.

The tools and professionals remain inside their lanes. An Artificial Intelligence scheduling tool may flag the concentration of late alerts and missed recovery blocks, but it cannot infer diagnosis, motive, or fitness. A mentor may report observed role strain but cannot demand clinical disclosure. An independent clinician determines care and what, if anything, may be shared. The public record receives only the operational status needed to explain postponement, while health information remains under professional control (NIST, 2023a; World Health Organization, 2022a).

The immediate de-load removes public interface, suspends nonessential recording, protects sleep opportunity, assigns one contact person, and audits whether staff are now carrying the displaced work. A public status label identifies a protected care process and review date without naming symptoms, treatment, family facts, or a speculative cause. The participant does not have to repeat private facts across offices, and no donor, campaign, research team, or model-training system receives the care record.

After care has stabilized, an independent return-or-exit review asks whether the workload can be repaired. The options include a lighter role, altered hours, reduced public windows, additional support, delayed return, or voluntary exit. The reviewer examines the City's contribution to the overload, including scheduling, alert design, staffing, public promises, and archive pressure. Recovery is not treated as proof that the original design was sound, and continued difficulty is not treated as proof of personal failure (World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022; Bakker and Demerouti, 2007).

The record retains the decision, authority, and review outcome while excluding intimate detail. If the same pathway repeatedly produces crisis, the institution must change or stop the pathway rather than normalize de-loading as the price of participation.

18.6.3 — Care Before Classification

A person in acute distress first needs safety, treatment, shelter from spectacle, and a qualified route for deciding what record handling is necessary. Classification can follow when the person is protected and the facts can be handled without turning pain into public material.

The first hour can be governed through five questions: who may be unsafe, what demand stops now, what care is needed, what protected status applies, and which qualified person owns the next decision? Those questions prevent a distressed participant from being routed first through publicity, discipline, or readiness classification. They also create enough structure for staff to act without improvising authority during crisis (World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022; Hobfoll, 1989).

Classification still matters. The City must eventually distinguish misfit, misconduct, exhaustion, clinical concern, technical failure, institutional design problem, and ordinary human difficulty. But premature classification can injure. It can turn a treatable load problem into a moral label, a medical need into a reputation issue, or a design failure into personal blame.

Care before classification must apply to staff and nonparticipants as well. A staff member harmed by overload, a visitor injured by exposure, a family member in crisis, or a bystander affected by record misuse needs relief before institutional debate.

During acute distress, public communication must be limited to necessary status, safety, process, and next review point; it must not speculate about motive, diagnosis, readiness, guilt, or moral meaning.

Classification must include an institutional-failure category. If the City has no category for its own contribution, it will quietly place every crisis inside the participant. A fair review can find mixed causes: personal conduct, clinical burden, staff shortage, technology failure, public harassment, design mistake, or governance neglect.

18.6.4 — Nonpunitive Failure

Nonpunitive failure does not mean consequence-free failure. The City does not treat overload, mismatch, mistake, pause, de-loading, exit, or difficulty carrying the Vow at a given intensity as a judgment of human worth.

Use the cause categories in Section 18.6.3 to select the response: misfit may require redirection, misconduct may require consequences, exhaustion may require care, and institutional failure may require correction.

Nonpunitive failure is not the same as automatic return. A person may fail in a way that requires exit, role redirection, longer treatment, apology, restitution, or permanent ineligibility for a pathway. The City must also examine whether its own design helped create the failure before drawing a pathway-specific conclusion.

Public language after failure is spare, accurate, and non-theatrical. A status label, process explanation, correction route, and protected summary may be enough.

Failure language must also guard against inspirational abuse. It is tempting to turn every collapse into a lesson about resilience. Some failures do not need to be inspirational. Some need rest,

repair, apology, redesign, or ending. The City must not force meaning onto suffering in order to protect its image. Care before theory applies here as sharply as anywhere in the series.

18.6.5 — Return or Exit Review

Return or exit review determines the next safe step after overload, pause, breakdown, major de-loading, changed circumstances, or significant failure. Return and exit must both remain honorable possibilities.

Return review must ask whether sleep has stabilized, care is adequate, staff burden is manageable, household effects are addressed, record status is clear, and the participant understands what changed. It must also ask whether the City itself has changed enough (National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine, 2019; Bonanno, 2004).

Exit review must ask whether continued participation would become coercive, unsafe, misleading, or unfair. A participant may need to leave because of health, family, role mismatch, public risk, loss of consent, changed circumstances, or recognition that the City is not the right path. Exit must preserve dignity, support, and future ordinary privacy where applicable.

A fair return review includes the voices needed for the decision without becoming crowd judgment. Participant voice is primary; clinician, mentor, staff-burden, household, legal, ombuds, and public-explanation inputs enter only where relevant. No party may own the person’s future through the review process.

Return review tests readiness against shame, expectations, threatened stability, and fear that exit means failure. Allow enough private space to consider alternatives before confirming renewed participation; a reconfirmation interval can help separate choice from sunk-cost or public pressure. Changed

conditions and available supports should be documented before reentry.

Use the exit safeguards in Section 16.3.3, preserving reintegration, support, family protections, appeal, record clarity, and future privacy. Before closure, identify owners of unresolved care, complaint, and record-correction duties, available reintegration contacts, and transitional support's named owner and reviewable end date.

Final review names excessive intensity, insufficient support, changed fit, and needed repair without unnecessary exposure. Return can injure, exit can abandon, and prolonged retention can become ownership. The review states what remains safe and repairable. If no safe configuration remains, the review should say so plainly and route closure without requiring another cycle of failed endurance. A clear final status helps future reviewers distinguish completed exit from unresolved institutional duty. Unresolved duties should remain traceable without extending active control over the former participant.

Chapter 19 — Family, Children, and Dependents

The Transparent Vow is chosen by one adult, but its consequences can cross a household threshold before anyone names the crossing. A participant may enter the City to carry public-power formation under record; the people near that participant do not enter by implication. This chapter begins at that edge, where public accountability can become private exposure if the City lacks exact discipline.

The first discipline is noninheritance: no spouse, partner, child, dependent adult, elder, caregiver, roommate, co-parent, chosen-family member, or former household member acquires the Vow through affection, proximity, reliance, residence, or public curiosity. The participant's choice remains the participant's choice, and every other person retains a separate life, consent status, and claim to protection (European Court of Human Rights, 2026; United Nations, 1989; United Nations, 2006).

Children are the brightest boundary. A child cannot become evidence that the City is humane, hopeful, intergenerational, or safe. Children are persons, not proof of the future.

Dependents and elders reveal another hidden burden register. Public life often appears individual because someone else holds the ordinary world together. The City must be mature enough to see care labor without consuming the people who receive care. Disability support, elder care, medication coordination, transportation, language access, guardianship, supported decision-making, and respite are not sentimental margins. They are part of whether public-power formation is honest.

Pregnancy, custody, parentage, reproductive health, and dependency law are high-review domains. The City must not improvise there. These contexts involve bodily dignity, medical privacy, family-law consequences, gendered burden, coercion risk, jurisdiction-specific rights, child welfare, disability rights,

and sometimes danger. A serious City routes them to qualified review and protected handling instead of pretending that civic vocabulary can solve what law, medicine, and family life must guard.

Conflict and repair require equal restraint. A household may disagree with a participant, oppose the City, request privacy, name harm, seek distance, or refuse reconciliation. The City must offer complaint, mediation, safety planning, remedy, and appeal without making private pain into formation theater. Apology matters, but apology is not a public performance prize (United Nations, 1989; European Court of Human Rights, 2026).

The chapter's final movement is return. Some records of active public-power formation may remain lawful public memory, but the active burden should release its hold on the family. Former participants, partners, children, dependents, and future households need a credible path back to ordinary time rather than permanent conscription into the City's meaning.

Household forms vary across culture and law. Marriage, cohabitation, co-parenting, chosen family, multigenerational care, shared housing, guardianship, foster relationships, and distributed caregiving create different authority and dependency patterns. The City should not force them into one domestic template. It needs a functional account of who relies on whom, who can consent, who can refuse, what support is portable, and which questions belong to courts, clinicians, schools, or other lawful authorities (Minuchin, 1974; Walsh, 2016).

19.1 — Partners, Spouses, and Household Forms

Family systems make visible why individual consent cannot absorb household consequences. A role change reorganizes time, attention, money, visibility, caregiving, and conflict across a network of relationships, while contextual privacy depends on whether information flows remain appropriate to the relationship in which they arose. The City should therefore examine household burden without claiming the household. Support can be offered, records can be bounded, and complaints can be heard while partners and relatives remain independent persons rather than extensions of the participant (Minuchin, 1974; Walsh, 2016; Nissenbaum, 2010).

19.1.1 — Household Diversity

Build household rules around the actual arrangements below rather than one assumed cultural, legal, class, or domestic-stability model.

A married participant may face different legal, financial, and social conditions from an unmarried partner. A co-parenting participant may need child-related scheduling and custody sensitivity without exposing the child. A participant living with extended family may carry elder care, sibling support, disability support, or family business obligations. A participant living alone may carry different risks of isolation, public performance, and lack of support (Minuchin, 1974; Walsh, 2016).

Chosen family often carries real care, dependency, and belonging outside formal legal categories. The City should recognize those burdens and apply the same purpose-limited influence, access, and support review used for other households.

Households vary in closeness, safety, dependence, and willingness to participate. Some families support; some pressure; some are absent; some require strict no-contact and location

protection. The City begins with the actual relationship rather than an idealized family model, then uses safe consultation, privacy, independent support, and lawful boundaries suited to that household.

Maintain a protected household-status map using the functional questions and fields below. Keep it minimal, reviewable, and purpose-limited.

A serious household map therefore begins with function before form. The review asks who shares space, who shares money, who depends on whom, who performs care, who has lawful authority, who may be endangered by publicity, and who may be pressured by the participant’s public ambition. Legal labels matter, but they do not reveal the full burden. A sibling who manages daily care, a friend who provides transport, or a former partner whose custody arrangement could be destabilized by publicity may carry substantial City-related burdens without a current marital tie.

A participant can identify a legal spouse, co-parent, partner, caregiver, dependent adult, person unsafe to contact, chosen-family support person, and other household member without ranking every bond through one hierarchy of legitimacy. Structured fields provide operational clarity, while protected explanation preserves complexity when the form would otherwise hide burden.

19.1.2 — Partner Consent Boundaries

Household governance distinguishes involvement from consent. A partner may be involved in household consultation, safety planning, care coordination, or exit preparation because those processes affect domestic life. That involvement does not grant the City general access to the partner's life. It also does not give the partner ownership over the participant's adult decision to

enter or leave, unless specific legal or safety conditions apply (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008).

Consent is ongoing and category-specific: permission for one contact, visit, or emergency notice does not authorize continuing involvement. A partner may agree to private burden review, decline public summary, provide information for safety assessment, refuse recording, or end involvement later. The record distinguishes consultation, capture, access, release, research, and reuse so that one agreement never expands by implication. Silence, dependency, housing pressure, and fear trigger additional review rather than assumed consent.

A partner’s uncertainty, criticism, privacy, absence, separation, or refusal to appear publicly does not by itself establish misconduct or unfitness and must not become a reason to demand visible support.

Partner consent boundaries also protect against coercion by the participant. A participant may want a partner to appear supportive, disclose private details, relocate, remain silent, or accept burdens in the name of public service. The City must provide private complaint routes and protected consultation so that a partner can name pressure without becoming public material.

A partner must receive plain notice of what the participant's active status may mean for household schedules, security friction, visitor controls, public attention, delayed release, support routing, and complaint access. Notice is not recruitment. It must not praise the partner for sacrifice, shame the partner for concern, or imply that love requires accepting exposure. The City may ask what burden might move onto the partner; it may not treat the partner's private answer as material for public persuasion.

The confidential partner-consent file records permissions, refusals, safety concerns, protected contact rules, and appeal routes. Apply the minimization and category controls in Section 19.1.3.

19.1.3 — Household Record Limits

Household records document bounded duties and decisions, not ordinary domestic life. Apply the nonparticipant rights in Section 9.3 and the controls below.

Household record limits must begin with minimization. The City must collect only what is necessary to understand role burden, protect nonparticipants, prevent coercion, preserve lawful process, and support participation or exit. Curiosity, future usefulness, institutional convenience, or public-interest speculation cannot justify broader collection (European Union, 2016; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Purpose travels with information. Support-planning material stays in the support lane, safety information does not become public interpretation, household complaints do not become campaign material, and legal-review records do not become training data. Any otherwise permitted secondary use requires a new authority, notice, affected-person route, and refusal or remedy rather than borrowing permission from the original purpose.

Public release requires stricter limits: household information ordinarily remains private. When public-power relevance requires some public explanation, summary must be favored over raw detail. The public may need to know that a participant has a care burden, a conflict boundary, a protected household arrangement, or a nonparticipant complaint status. The public usually does not need the private facts that make those labels meaningful to the household.

Record limits must include access logs and challenge rights. Household members must have a route to know when protected household information has been accessed beyond ordinary operational use, where lawful and safe. They must have a route to challenge misclassification, overcollection, wrongful exposure, or misleading summary.

Household governance distinguishes at least four levels of material: participant public-power conduct, affected-person notice and consent records, protected collateral context, and excluded private life. Assign different access classes, retention rules, release presumptions, review clocks, and correction routes to each.

Audio, video, access logs, visitor records, emergency notes, and support files must be taggable at ingestion for protected handling. Build masking, escrow, delayed review, restricted access, and contextual summaries into that design.

The household boundary does not require a public notice every time protected material is withheld. Where a public explanation is necessary, a minimal status statement can show that the relevant institutional decision received review. Where even that statement would invite identification or speculation without serving accountability, no person-specific public entry is made.

19.1.4 — Domestic Burden Review

Domestic burden review tracks costs shifted by participation to partners, caregivers, children, elders, and other household members.

Household review must examine time, money, care, housing, transportation, security, emotional load, public attention, scheduling, legal obligations, opportunity loss, and recovery or exit effects. A participant's entry may require relocation, changed routines, new childcare arrangements, protected visits,

secure communication, travel adjustments, or family explanation. These burdens must be identified before they become resentment or harm (Minuchin, 1974; Walsh, 2016).

Domestic labor enters the burden register as real work. Cooking, cleaning, childcare, elder care, disability support, appointment coordination, emotional support, household administration, and public explanation can all expand around a visible participant. The City identifies which demands it created, funds or reduces them where appropriate, and gives household members a private complaint route instead of celebrating civic courage built on invisible care.

Check whether City support, fear for the participant's public standing, or appeals to the project's importance prevent household members from refusing or complaining.

Domestic burden review stays protected so household members can speak without fearing public exposure. Their accounts inform support, revised participation conditions, safety review, or remedy within a narrow lawful purpose. They are not mined for public narrative or used as raw material for interpreting the participant.

Review before activation, after major role changes, during known crises, after household complaints, and before transition into office. Compare the actual time, care, access, security, and work effects with the agreed support plan.

A household change notice keeps the review alive without turning the household into a reporting unit. A partner, caregiver, co-parent, dependent person, advocate, or participant may signal that a material condition has changed. The notice identifies the burden category, immediate protection needed, responsible office, response clock, accessibility needs, and whether the participant may safely be informed. It does not require a domestic narrative.

When City participation shifts domestic burden, the remedy follows the burden. Schedule repair, respite, transportation, confidential counseling referral, household privacy redesign, temporary pause, added staff support, or lawful exit may be required.

Domestic Burden Review must also ask who would disappear if the institution used only the participant's self-report. The person most burdened may be the one least likely to complain because they fear harming the participant's path, losing access, triggering conflict, or becoming visible. A fair review therefore uses multiple protected routes and does not assume that silence means no burden.

19.1.5 — Relationship Complaint Route

Household members must have a private, accessible complaint route that protects against retaliation, can produce action, and does not pass entirely through the participant.

Complaints may concern overexposure, pressure to appear supportive, scheduling harm, household labor burdens, unsafe contact, coercive use of City support, misuse of private information, record boundary violations, or institutional failure to provide agreed support. The complaint system must not treat these as domestic inconveniences outside City concern when the City's own burden created or intensified them (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008).

Route each concern to adjustment, safe mediation, protection, legal referral, or participant-status review according to its type and risk.

Confidentiality must be strong but not absolute in ways that hide danger. Household members must understand what can remain private, what may trigger safety action, what may require legal or expert referral, and what may affect participant status.

The complaint route must also protect against retaliation by the participant, staff, supporters, volunteers, or public interpreters. Retaliation can be emotional, financial, reputational, procedural, or public.

Extend the route to co-parents, dependents, and other affected persons, including concerns about security friction, harassment, mistaken records, or household instability. No complainant must prove loyalty to the project, sympathy for the participant, or ideological agreement.

The route must offer at least three paths: confidential consultation, formal protected complaint, and urgent safety escalation. Consultation lets a person ask whether something is permitted without opening a public file. Formal complaint creates a protected record, response clock, reviewer assignment, and remedy path. Urgent safety escalation bypasses ordinary mediation when violence, coercion, stalking, self-harm risk, child danger, or serious intimidation appears.

A participant who punishes a household member for using a complaint route has created public-power evidence about coercion, but the complainant still does not become public evidence. The City may evaluate the participant's conduct under the Vow while masking, summarizing, delaying, or sealing the household member's material.

A household complaint route must be able to hold mixed and contested accounts. Reviewers separate immediate safety, factual disagreement, relationship conflict, City-created burden, and matters outside institutional authority; they preserve evidence, give affected people independent standing, and choose a remedy proportionate to what the City caused or can change.

Offer plain-language human help and digital routes designed to minimize dangerous traces on shared devices, with clear

notice of remaining exposure risks. Translate reports of unsafe, humiliating, exhausting, or unfair conditions into safe routing.

A household member's refusal may require changes to housing, scheduling, capture, transport, security, or public-interface design; the City adapts the arrangement rather than pressuring the person to accept exposure.

Dependent adults, disabled family members, and elders also require usable alternatives, not nominal consent. A person who relies on the participant for housing, mobility, money, communication, or daily care may face pressure even when no threat is spoken. The City must fund independent advocacy, accessible communication, respite, replacement care, and complaint routes where needed. The person's rights and support do not depend on continued participation or household harmony (United Nations, 2006; National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine, 2016). Support plans should name a backup provider before crisis so access to care does not depend on the participant remaining available.

Suppose a participant's travel to a high-profile public event would expose a child's location and leave an elder without reliable care. The City must change the event, provide independent care, protect location data, or accept nonattendance. Temporary household accommodations should have an end date and a private review route to prevent dependency. Use household-support trends to improve scheduling and housing without turning family conflict into a participant score.

Noninheritance survives exit and conflict. Apply Section 19.6 and confirm that complaint, correction, and remedy routes remain reachable after separation without routine City monitoring. Check account permissions and emergency contacts directly with the affected household member so a former participant cannot retain access by administrative default.

19.2 — Children and Absolute Protection Boundaries

Child protection is not a softer version of adult consent. The Convention on the Rights of the Child centers best interests, privacy, development, protection, and the child's evolving capacity to be heard; its digital-environment guidance addresses profiling, data practices, exposure, and the persistence of online material. Those principles support an absolute City rule: no adult Vow can manufacture a child's participation. Images, school information, peer relationships, health data, and family conflict require shielding by default and review by child-centered experts, not publicity staff (United Nations, 1989; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021; UNICEF, 2017).

19.2.1 — Child Nonparticipation Rule

The child nonparticipation rule is categorical. Proximity, residence, relationship, public appearance, family status, or symbolic association never makes a child a participant in the Transparent City. The child carries no Vow, enters no full active-period record, and serves as no part of an adult participant's public evidence.

A child’s assent or a parent’s approval cannot authorize participation in the adult Vow or waive the child protections below (United Nations, 1989; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021).

Apply the shielding and ingestion controls in Section 19.2.3 to every child-related record; incidental capture never becomes an ordinary participant record.

The nonparticipation rule must also govern physical space. Children must not be routed through public record halls, visitor demonstrations, donor tours, media rooms, archive exhibits, or ceremonial thresholds merely because they accompany an adult. The built City must have child-protective paths, waiting areas,

and family interfaces that keep children away from symbolic performance.

19.2.2 — No Child as Evidence

The no-child-as-evidence rule adds a separate protection to nonparticipation. It blocks the use of child life as evidence that a participant is trustworthy, that the City is humane, that the future is safe, that a household is stable, or that public-power formation has moral depth.

Apply the no-child-as-evidence rule to every persuasive format: photographs, speeches, public tours, fundraising and donor presentations, ceremonies, future-oriented narratives, documentaries, social excerpts, Artificial Intelligence-generated images, archive highlights, campaign-like artifacts, and informal staff stories (UNICEF, 2017; Nissenbaum, 2010).

The rule also prevents reverse use. A child's distress, reluctance, absence, conflict, disability, school difficulty, or ordinary childhood complexity must not become evidence against the participant by default.

Child-related questions involving safety, legal status, custody, dependent care, or household burden belong in protected expert and legal channels. Public explanation, when necessary, should describe the City's action, the adult's choice, the protection required, and the available remedy without making the child the evidentiary object or revealing identifying detail.

Child advocates examine safety, privacy, school life, peer effects, family burden, and the child’s own age-appropriate views, then route correction and remedy through protected channels.

19.2.3 — Child Image and Data Shielding

Child image and data shielding must be designed before the City opens. It cannot be improvised after a child's face appears in a record, a location is revealed, or a public artifact travels beyond context. Image and data protection must cover photographs, video, audio, metadata, location, school information, peer contact, medical references, family routines, and indirect identifiers that allow reconstruction.

Child privacy assumes that public materials will be copied, cropped, searched, summarized, miscaptioned, and circulated beyond their original setting. A child's image can become permanent in ways adults cannot control. Data shielding must therefore be stronger than ordinary internal caution. It must be built around foreseeable misuse, not only intended use (United Nations, 1989; World Health Organization, 2021b).

Default masking applies to incidental child capture. A child's appearance triggers protected handling through exclusion, masking, protected summary, delayed review, deletion where lawful, or restricted access according to the actual need. Child data stays outside Artificial Intelligence training and public demonstration. Research or interface testing requires separate lawful authority and child-protection review and must not override the prohibitions in this subsection.

Masking a face is insufficient when time, location, school routes, household patterns, or family relationships still identify a child. Test what journalists, fans, critics, stalkers, political opponents, platform users, or machine systems could reconstruct by combining those traces.

Child data handling must include expert review, access logs, breach notification, and remedy. If child information is wrongfully exposed, the City must not treat the harm as merely technical. The injury may affect school life, peer relationships,

safety, family privacy, and long-term dignity. Remedy may require removal efforts, public correction, support, legal review, and compensation where appropriate.

Child material is nonrelease material unless a separate legal duty requires otherwise. Any required release must be narrow, protective, and reviewed by child-safety and privacy experts. Internal systems must tag child-related material at capture, restrict model access, and log every authorized exposure.

Also prohibit the use of child-related data for synthetic reenactment, emotional storytelling, and automated profile building.

Image and data shielding also prohibits child likeness in synthetic or illustrative form when the likeness is traceable to a real child. A blurred photograph, stylized drawing, generated image, composite, voice clone, or anecdote can still burden a child if people close to the child recognize the reference. Public education must use fictionalized, nonidentifying, expert-reviewed examples that do not borrow a child's actual life.

19.2.4 — School and Peer Protection

A child's exposure does not end at the edge of the City. It travels to school, peers, sports, online spaces, friendships, neighborhood life, and future relationships. A child may be teased, questioned, admired, targeted, isolated, or pressured because an adult has entered the City. The City must count these external effects, even though they occur outside its perimeter.

School protection begins with minimization. The City must avoid making a child's school, schedule, route, activities, friendships, or peer environment identifiable. When coordination with schools or child-serving institutions is necessary, it must be confidential, purpose-limited, and guided by qualified review

(United Nations, 1989; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021).

School and peer protection may require practical supports: communication guidance, privacy support, security review, counseling referral, schedule adjustments, transportation planning, and protected complaint routes for caregivers. The City must not over-own the school domain, but it must take responsibility for foreseeable burdens generated by its own institution.

School and peer protection uses a narrow coordination route. Contact with schools, teachers, coaches, or peer families is limited to needs such as safety, privacy, transport, harassment response, or media boundaries. It must use lawful, child-protective channels with the authorization required for that contact. The school receives only the information needed to protect the child and is never recruited into the City's narrative.

Peer protection must include digital spillover. Children of participants may be tagged, searched, mocked, impersonated, doxxed, or pressured online. The City needs a child digital-safety route that can respond without public spectacle: rapid reporting, platform contact, evidence preservation, protective guidance, and support for the family.

School and peer protection must be revisited over time because children grow into new social worlds. A plan that protects a preschool child may fail for an adolescent with social media, dating, sports, college applications, or a changing sense of identity.

19.2.5 — Child-Safety Review

Child-safety reviewers must be independent enough to refuse, delay, mask, reroute, correct, or escalate disclosures, school

contacts, public explanations, and record bundles when direct or predictable exposure threatens a child.

Child-safety review requires independent specialists in child development, privacy, digital safety, family law, education, trauma, disability, medical confidentiality, and abuse prevention (UNICEF, 2017; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Conduct child-safety review before opening, before admission involving child-related household duties, before family-related public artifacts or protected summaries, after incidents, and during periodic audit.

Child-safety review must address both direct and indirect harms. Direct harm may include exposure, coercion, unsafe contact, or data breach. Indirect harm may include school pressure, parentification, public symbolism, social isolation, family stress, or altered household routines.

Child-safety review must also be able to disagree with participants and families. Parents or guardians may consent to things the City must still refuse. A participant may believe a child is comfortable. A family may want to support the civic mission publicly. The City must not treat adult consent as enough when the public meaning attached to a child is too heavy.

Its decision record must preserve the reasoning while protecting child-specific detail. Public accountability can describe safeguards, categories of review, incident counts where safe, and reforms without exposing children.

Child protection also includes freedom from ideological inheritance. A participant's child is not presented as naturally belonging to the Law of Fairness project, the Religion of Fairness, future public service, or any later civic track. The child remains free to grow into any life without the adult project prewriting that identity.

A child-safety incident must trigger more than removal of content. It must trigger root-cause review. Was the exposure caused by staff training, architecture, media access, metadata, public artifact design, participant behavior, platform circulation, or unclear status labels?

Public communication also avoids indirect recruitment through family imagery. Public materials can make ordinary families feel that participation is expected, admired, or morally superior. Even without naming children, a pattern of family-centered messaging can create social pressure. The City must teach that ordinary family privacy is not a lesser form of civic life.

The child-protection standard must therefore be fail-closed. When uncertainty exists, the City must choose nonpublication, masking, delay, or expert review rather than exposure. The burden of justification must fall on the adult institution that wants to use or retain material, not on the child or household to prove why the material is dangerous.

Digital exposure requires an incident route as specific as the prevention rule. A child, parent, guardian, advocate, school, staff member, or platform liaison may trigger rapid review. The route preserves evidence without republishing it, suspends City-controlled distribution, recalls derivative summaries and captions, corrects metadata, issues lawful removal requests, protects location and school information, and records what cannot be retrieved. The child or later adult retains an independent correction and shielding route; the participant cannot waive it (Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021; European Union, 2016).

A practical Child-Safety Review begins when a City event image reveals a participant’s child, school emblem, and location metadata, then spreads into a summary and volunteer post. The independent advocate freezes City distribution, preserves

evidence without republication, and opens protected routes for the child, guardian, school, and relevant professionals.

The advocate hears the child in a developmentally appropriate manner when that can be done safely and meaningfully, while refusing to make the child responsible for solving the exposure. Review remains limited to the incident, the affected relationships, and the systems that allowed it. The City's authority does not expand into a general inspection of family life. Best-interests analysis, evolving capacities, privacy, and digital-environment rights guide the response (United Nations, 1989; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021).

After immediate containment, remedy shifts to the system that failed. The City notifies affected parties through a safe channel and reviews camera position, tour design, staff scripts, volunteer permissions, upload defaults, and release checks so that the child does not carry the burden of an institutional failure. The incident log should distinguish actions the City controls from copies held elsewhere, so remedy is specific rather than falsely complete.

Public accountability remains possible without publishing the child's story. The record site can state that a child-protection incident occurred, identify the failed control, name the authority that ordered the freeze, report the categories of remedy, and state whether the release process changed. The child and later adult retain correction, shielding, access, and complaint routes independent of the participant's wishes (European Union, 2016; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021).

Close review by checking City-controlled removal, continuing school or peer harm, staff understanding of revised rules, and recurrence of the metadata or framing defect. Apply the same separation between support and public evidence to the dependent-care arrangements in Section 19.3.

19.3 — Dependents, Elders, Disability, and Care Burden

Caregiving neither disqualifies an applicant by default nor certifies moral depth. Review the actual demand and support needed. Care burdens differ in form but share a common risk: the person needing support can disappear behind the schedule of the person providing it. Disability rights protect autonomy, privacy, family life, accessibility, and inclusion, while caregiving research documents physical, psychological, and economic strain on families.

19.3.1 — Dependent Adults

Dependent adults may include people with significant illness, disability, cognitive impairment, financial dependence, immigration dependence, language dependence, or other support needs. They may be elders, partners, siblings, adult children, parents, chosen family, or household members.

Apply the independent privacy and record rights in Section 9.3 and Section 19.1.3 to dependent adults, including their health, finances, location, capacity, immigration status, and care arrangements.

If participation disrupts care, the City must identify that before activation. Who provides daily support? What happens during crisis? What if the participant pauses, exits, travels, or enters office? What support cannot be moved? What would burden the dependent adult? These questions belong to entry review and ongoing burden review.

A dependent adult may be used to pressure the participant, or the participant may use support control to pressure the dependent person. Financial control, housing control, medical access, documentation, transportation, and emotional dependency can

all become leverage. The City must provide protected complaint and expert referral pathways.

Dependent adults remain agents within relationships of support. Disability, illness, age, cognitive change, trauma, poverty, immigration status, language barriers, or temporary crisis may alter how consultation occurs, but they do not erase privacy, sexuality, preference, refusal, or the right to supported decision-making. The City uses accessible consultation and independent advocacy while keeping the person outside any public story of burden or compassion.

For dependent adults, supported decision-making must be preferred wherever it is lawful and appropriate. The City must not rush to speak through guardians, carers, or family members when the person can express preferences with communication support, time, translation, assistive technology, or trusted accompaniment. The participant must not be the sole interpreter of the dependent adult's interests; use lawful representation and independent coercion review where needed.

19.3.2 — Elder Care Burden

Support must be portable and least exposing, with the dependent person's preferences, communication access, and rights treated as primary information rather than background facts. Caregiver relief matters, but it cannot be purchased by publicizing the life of the person receiving care (United Nations, 2006; World Health Organization, 2022c; Pinquart and Sörensen, 2003; National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine, 2016).

Elder care may involve medical coordination, transportation, financial management, housing decisions, memory loss, grief, cultural duty, family conflict, inheritance pressure, loneliness, and the slow rearrangement of time. A participant who cares for

an elder brings these burdens to the threshold of the City, even when the elder never appears in public.

If City schedules, location, record burden, security rules, or public interfaces complicate elder care, review that added burden and mitigate it where possible (Pinquart and Sörensen, 2003; Schulz and Sherwood, 2008).

Elder privacy requires particular care. Older adults may be more vulnerable to public attention, scams, family pressure, medical exposure, memory-related misunderstanding, or reputational harm. The City must shield elder identity, health information, location, care arrangements, financial information, and family disputes from public interpretation except where lawful process requires narrow handling.

Cultural variation matters. In some families, elder care is understood as central obligation. In others, support is distant, strained, or legally mediated. The City must not impose one cultural model of filial duty. It must ask what obligations actually exist, who carries them, what harm could follow from participation, and what supports or boundaries are needed.

Elder care can also create public-power risks. An elder's assets, household, medical decisions, or family network may create financial leverage, inheritance pressure, or conflicts of interest. The City must review these risks carefully without treating the elder as suspect.

Dependent-care governance maintains an elder-care accommodation path comparable in seriousness to medical and disability accommodations. It must include confidential documentation, flexible scheduling, protected emergency absences, role-specific adjustments, support coordination, and review of shifted burden onto other household members.

Elder-care accommodation should allow for anticipatory grief without requiring either concealment or public disclosure; use the protected grief supports in Section 18.5.4.

19.3.3 — Disability Support

An accommodation packet should reveal function without exposing diagnosis. It states the barrier, requested adjustment, responsible office, implementation date, continuity plan, review clock, and appeal route. It also asks whether the City itself created the barrier through schedule, architecture, transport, communication, security, or record design. The protected clinical or personal basis remains with the appropriate professional or affected person; public explanation is limited to the operational change (United Nations, 2006; World Health Organization, 2022c).

Disability support must be approached without ableism and without romanticism. Disabled participants, disabled household members, disabled partners, disabled dependents, and disabled caregivers may all be present near the City. Respect disabled people’s expertise about their own needs.

Provide physical, sensory, cognitive, communication, and transport access, scheduling flexibility, and clear support-person boundaries.

Dependent-care governance understands disability through environment as well as impairment. A record system, entrance protocol, visitor rule, schedule, sound environment, digital portal, or security procedure can disable a person if it is built around the convenience of the institution. Household shielding therefore includes making City interactions accessible to nonparticipants who must occasionally interface with the system, without forcing those people into the system's public record.

Diagnosis, medication, care schedules, assistive and access devices, communication needs, support-worker and caregiver arrangements, and fluctuating capacity require a protected handling class with minimum necessary access, correction rights, and expert review. Accommodation, safety, or support need does not authorize broad release or model training. Treat these as public-power evidence only where a narrow, lawful, role-relevant reason requires it.

Disability support must include fluctuating conditions. Some needs change by day, season, medication, pain, sensory load, stress, or disease course. The City must not demand repeated proof as if fluctuation were suspicion. It must design accommodation review that can respond to change.

19.3.4 — Caregiver Load

Caregiver load is counted as work even when it is given in love. Schedule changes, transport, medication coordination, food, supervision, emotional labor, accessibility support, and crisis response can move public-role costs into a partner, adult child, sibling, friend, or paid aide. The City therefore maps the demand, funds respite or assistance where appropriate, and keeps refusal safe from guilt, dependence, and public judgment.

Test whether City support actually reduces caregiver work or creates additional coordination, then adjust participation terms accordingly.

Caregiver privacy matters. A caregiver may need to speak candidly about overload without becoming public evidence. A paid caregiver may need labor protections. An informal caregiver may need support without being recruited into the City's mission. A family caregiver may need relief without being treated as disloyal. The City must provide protected routes for these distinctions.

Include dependence on a single caregiver in the leverage review in Section 19.3.1, including pressure, guilt, and influence over decisions.

Caregiver load must be reviewed in time, attention, money, emotional vigilance, employment loss, sleep, privacy, social isolation, and future opportunity. It must also be reviewed across gender, class, disability, immigration status, race, age, and household power because care burdens are rarely distributed randomly.

Review aggregate reports of transport strain, scheduling conflict, child-care spillover, elder-care disruption, and emotional vigilance to identify and repair recurring institutional causes without exposing households.

19.3.5 — Support Without Exposure

Support arrangements must reduce care burden without making the recipient public or requiring loyalty to the institution.

Support terms must be transparent to the affected people where appropriate and protected from public display. Household members must know what support is offered, what obligations it creates or does not create, what happens if participation pauses or ends, and how complaints can be raised. Support should arrive through protected channels, including confidential reimbursement where appropriate. The public may need aggregate information about support systems, not identifying detail.

The dependency plan identifies who controls housing, care, transport, or financial assistance; what continues during complaint, pause, or exit; which benefits cannot be clawed back; and where an affected household member can appeal.

Support without exposure must include support for refusal. A dependent person, caregiver, or household member may refuse

certain City supports if those supports feel intrusive or unsafe. Refusal must not be treated as irrational resistance to the project.

Apply the scheduled and change-triggered household review in Section 19.1.4 to caregiving arrangements.

Dependent-care governance also distinguishes support from substitution. It may support household care through funds, coordination, respite, or access planning. It must not automatically take over care relationships in ways that displace family agency, professional standards, or the preferences of dependent persons.

A care-burden review must ask what would happen on the worst ordinary day, not only the best planned day. What happens if the participant is sick, called into public interface, under review, traveling, suspended, or exiting? What happens if the caregiver becomes ill? What happens if transportation fails or a dependent person's care changes?

Base support eligibility on reviewed burden, not on an emotionally compelling story, donor preference, or willingness to appear publicly. As vulnerability increases, reduce demands to appear in public explanation.

Support records remain separate from participant evaluation. A defined safety or role-conduct issue uses only the necessary protected information and the proper review route under Sections 11.7 and 19.1.3.

Auditors can review aggregate patterns, adequacy, delay, denial rates, appeal outcomes, and burden shifts without revealing protected people.

Donors receive no dependent’s story, name, image, gratitude, medical facts, or household circumstances in exchange for assistance. Funding may be acknowledged at the institutional level.

19.4 — Pregnancy, Custody, and Reproductive Health

Pregnancy, reproductive health, parentage, and custody combine bodily autonomy with legal and relational complexity. Health and human-rights frameworks emphasize confidentiality, informed consent, non-discrimination, and the patient's authority over medical decisions; family-law consequences vary by jurisdiction and cannot be solved by an institutional norm. The City should therefore use narrow status information for scheduling and safety, protect clinical detail, obtain specialist review, and avoid any inference that pregnancy or reproductive choice reveals civic readiness (UNFPA, 2021; American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists, 2021). Necessary care and family rights cannot become concessions exchanged for credibility in a public role.

19.4.1 — Pregnancy Dignity

A pregnant participant or partner retains bodily dignity and medical privacy; pregnancy cannot serve as civic evidence or a readiness credential.

Pregnancy review recognizes that pregnancy can create public-power formation questions involving health, scheduling, care support, household burden, security, dependency planning, and post-birth child protection. Those questions travel through protected support and qualified review rather than public interpretation (UNFPA, 2021; American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists, 2021).

Pregnancy status must not be publicly disclosed by default. If some public explanation is necessary because participation status changes, the explanation must be minimal, protected, and framed around role status, care, or pause rather than bodily detail.

Pregnancy can also reveal gendered expectations. The City must not punish pregnant participants through assumptions of

unfitness, nor pressure them to demonstrate resilience by carrying more than is safe. Load review, care planning, clinical independence, and exit or pause options must respond to the actual person and situation.

19.4.2 — Custody Sensitivity

Custody, visitation, guardianship, relocation, and related family-law questions belong to qualified jurisdictional review under applicable orders and law. The City adjusts its own operations within those boundaries.

A participant's entry into the City may affect custody arrangements. Location, schedule, public attention, security, housing, record systems, and travel may all matter. These implications should be identified before activation where possible, through jurisdiction-aware legal and family review. A parent must not be pressured to enter before the effects on children, co-parents, and protected family life are understood (European Court of Human Rights, 2026; United Nations, 1989).

City staff may document role-relevant facts, protect records, adjust participation, and obtain qualified advice, but they do not reward a participant's version of a dispute, pressure another parent, certify parental virtue, or feed supporters and critics with family-law material.

Custody sensitivity also includes safety. Where there are abuse allegations, coercive control concerns, stalking risks, unsafe contact, or protective orders, the City must defer to qualified legal and safety review. Reconciliation or public explanation must never be prioritized over child or caregiver safety.

The custody problem is also a record problem. A public archive can become a weapon in family conflict. A former partner may seek records to gain leverage. A participant may fear that honest disclosure will be misused. A child may be

exposed through adult litigation. The City must anticipate this and build lawful shielding, access review, subpoena response protocols, court-interface procedures, child-masking rules, and notice rights where applicable.

19.4.3 — Reproductive Health Privacy

Reproductive-health information requires especially careful handling because one fact can expose bodily autonomy, clinical history, legal risk, intimate relationships, and household safety at once. The protected domain includes fertility care, contraception, pregnancy, pregnancy loss, abortion care, birth, postpartum care, reproductive surgery, sexual health, genetic information, menstrual health, and related mental-health support. The City treats these as care and dignity records before asking whether any operational consequence exists.

Three record layers must remain separate. A clinician may hold the detailed health record; a scheduler may receive only the accommodation or availability signal needed to organize participation; and the public record ordinarily receives nothing beyond a narrow status statement, if even that. Consent to one layer does not authorize another, and a partner's coordination consent does not place the partner inside the participant's record (International Labour Organization, 2000; United Nations, 2006).

Consent must be granular, current, and free from material pressure. A participant may authorize clinical care, coordination with a named person, a limited accommodation signal, or a specific legal disclosure while refusing public release and secondary use. The provider's professional duties and the nonparticipant's independent rights remain intact.

Jurisdictional variation increases the duty of restraint. Rights, reporting rules, confidentiality, access, and legal exposure differ

across places and may change over time. Qualified legal and clinical review should determine the applicable pathway before the City creates a label, summary, or cross-border transfer. Where uncertainty could endanger a person, the default is stronger protection rather than speculative disclosure.

Reproductive-health records do not enter ordinary public release, staff storytelling, donor reassurance, or readiness narratives. Any proposal for an otherwise permitted research or model-training use must pass Section 11.6 and the applicable clinical, legal, consent, and least-exposing review. No approval overrides the prohibited uses in Section 11.7 or child-data protections in Section 19.2.3. Protected metadata receives the same necessity and exposure review as protected content.

Unauthorized disclosure requires a response distinct from ordinary correction. The City must contain access, preserve evidence, notify affected people where safe, suspend downstream use, withdraw or correct derivative summaries, and provide security, clinical, legal, or family support as the harm requires. A breach cannot be closed merely by relabeling the original record as protected; copied inferences and secondary circulation must also be traced (European Union, 2016; Citron, 2014).

Public-label design uses privacy language that does not force disclosure by implication. Even saying that a record concerns reproductive health can sometimes reveal too much in a small household or public timeline. Labels must be useful to reviewers but carefully designed for public summaries. The public may need to know that a protected health matter required accommodation. It does not need the reproductive category unless a lawful reason truly requires it.

19.4.4 — Parentage and Dependency Implications

Qualified, jurisdiction-aware review maps legal and practical obligations only as far as needed to protect people and prevent hidden burden. The review identifies care and financial duties, people affected by relocation or schedule, applicable legal orders, needed support, and information that remains protected (European Court of Human Rights, 2026; UNFPA, 2021).

Parentage has no automatic readiness meaning. Parents and nonparents can both carry public responsibility; family complexity, conventional appearance, fertility history, or household form neither certifies nor disqualifies. The City addresses only defined role burdens, conflicts, care needs, and rights, using the least exposing information sufficient for that purpose.

Use the protected public-label rules in Sections 19.1.3 and 19.4.3 when a parentage or dependency issue changes role status.

Parentage and dependency implications reach into law, finance, inheritance, housing, citizenship, custody, medical authority, schooling, disability support, and family identity. The City may encounter situations involving nonmarital parentage, adoption, guardianship, step-parenting, surrogacy, donor conception, foster care, informal kinship care, or disputed responsibility.

Parentage complexity must also keep the City humble about time. A legal parentage question can unfold over months or years. A dependency arrangement can change after illness, death, migration, separation, reconciliation, or court order. The City must maintain review clocks and allow protected correction when family status changes.

19.4.5 — Expert Review Flag

Expert review must be multidisciplinary. Legal experts, clinicians, child-safety specialists, disability experts, privacy professionals, trauma specialists, and family-support practitioners may all be needed depending on the issue. The problem is routed by type, authority, and affected person rather than handed to one generalized committee (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; European Court of Human Rights, 2026; United Nations, 2006).

Review must occur before public release, before status decisions that affect families, before pilot policies involving child or reproductive domains, after incidents, and during periodic audit. Uncertainty about classification triggers a pause for qualified review.

Expert review is independent enough to disappoint the City. Reviewers can require masking, delay, exclusion, referral, modification, public correction, or suspension of a practice. Their recommendations, the institution's response, and any unresolved disagreement are tracked and summarized publicly only where doing so is safe.

Expert review also protects against moral bias. Pregnancy, custody, reproductive health, disability, and family structure are domains where cultural judgment can masquerade as civic concern. Expert review cannot eliminate bias, but it can force the City to justify decisions through law, care, evidence, dignity, and role relevance rather than public discomfort.

Where a public explanation is necessary, state only the protected review status and the limit on further disclosure, using Section 19.4.3 to avoid revealing the category by implication.

Privacy around reproductive and custody domains must be designed for future change. A record that seems harmless today may become dangerous after a legal change, political campaign,

family conflict, public controversy, or data breach. Time review must ask whether continued retention, access, or summary remains justified.

The channel must also include conflict-of-interest review. A clinician, attorney, family adviser, donor, participant, partner, or staff member may have interests that shape how a sensitive issue is described. The City must avoid relying on one interested voice when decisions affect public status, safety, or legal handling.

High-review material must be marked in the record system with handling restrictions that travel. A protected reproductive-health or custody-related label must not be lost when a file moves between archive, public record site, legal review, expert review, or future time review.

Expert routing is mandatory when pregnancy, custody, reproductive health, parentage, dependency, domestic safety, child privacy, or disability support creates a material question. The record names the trigger, qualified discipline, conflict check, protected access, decision owner, and review date. Ordinary staff pause and refer rather than improvising legal, clinical, safeguarding, or disability judgments.

19.5 — Conflict, Mediation, Apology, Household Repair

The household-repair route is a protected process whose first duty is safety. Research on intimate partner violence identifies coercive control, surveillance, isolation, economic dependence, threats, and sexual coercion as patterns that can make ordinary mediation dangerous (Stark, 2007; Herman, 1992). The City should therefore distinguish disagreement from abuse, apology from access, reconciliation from pressure, and family privacy from impunity. The first question in a household conflict is not how to preserve the participant's story. It is whether every affected person can refuse contact, obtain independent support, and seek remedy without retaliation (World Health Organization, 2025a).

19.5.1 — Conflict Under Record

Review how recording affects speech, withholding, explanation, escalation, memory, and staff classification during household conflict.

Not every household conflict is public-power relevant. People argue because they are tired, afraid, grieving, disappointed, incompatible, or human. The City must not turn ordinary disagreement into public record spectacle. At the same time, conflict may reveal coercion, intimidation, hidden dependency, retaliation, unsafe conduct, or burdens created by the City. The distinction requires careful classification (Stark, 2007; Herman, 1992).

Apply the household record categories in Section 19.1.3 to safety, complaint, mediation, remedy, status review, and legal referral. A conflict creates no general permission to record or release ordinary household life.

The household-repair route guards against strategic conflict use. A participant may try to frame a household member as unstable. A household member may try to weaponize the participant's public status. A supporter may pressure silence. A critic may exploit family disagreement. The City must treat conflict claims seriously without making any party's story automatically sovereign.

Interpret conflict with context for fatigue, stress, history, safety, disability, grief, and power imbalance, without excusing harm.

19.5.2 — Mediation Boundaries

Mediation is one optional repair path, not a universal answer. It is available only when safety, agency, informed willingness, and sufficient balance permit structured conversation. Coercion, abuse, intimidation, legal orders, serious power imbalance, or credible fear route the matter to protective, legal, or clinical channels instead. The City measures success by safety and remedy, not by producing reconciliation.

Mediation boundaries must be established before any conversation begins. Who participates? What is confidential? What may be recorded? What may be summarized? What happens if someone withdraws? What safety supports exist? What role does the mediator have? What legal or clinical review is needed? (World Health Organization, 2021c; Council of Europe, 2011).

The mediator must not be the participant's evaluator, public-relations adviser, staff supervisor, admissions reviewer, release decision-maker, or donor-relations officer. Mediation needs independence appropriate to the risk level. It may require external professionals rather than City staff, especially in family, custody, trauma, or safety contexts.

Mediation dialogue remains within its separately declared confidentiality and record terms; it is not formation content or a public readiness narrative.

Before mediation, there must be screening for violence, intimidation, stalking, coercive control, threats, severe power imbalance, child danger, dependency leverage, immigration pressure, financial domination, and mental-health crisis. Screening must be done by trained people, with private access for nonparticipants, not by asking both parties together whether they feel safe. If safety is uncertain, the City must route to protection, legal support, or separate consultation rather than joint conversation.

19.5.3 — Household Apology Standards

Use the remedy-centered apology standard in Section 18.5.4: acknowledge warranted responsibility, specify change, and leave the harmed person free to refuse contact or forgiveness.

Nonparticipants do not owe apology for the participant's formation needs. Partners, children, dependents, elders, and household members are not drawn into public rituals of remorse or reconciliation. Private repair remains their choice, and refusal is not framed as obstruction of the City.

Keep any necessary apology record within the household complaint and remedy purpose under Section 19.1.3; the harmed person’s emotional response is not evidence of the participant’s readiness.

Timing and follow-through distinguish repair from performance. Some harms require immediate acknowledgment; others require space before contact. The City may review whether obligations were met and conduct changed, using a protected summary that records completion or unresolved concerns without exposing the harmed person.

19.5.4 — Safety Before Reconciliation

Before any repair process, apply the coercion screen in Section 19.5.2 and establish whether every affected person can decline without retaliation. Include spiritual pressure and misuse of the participant's public status.

Affected people may refuse contact, mediation, apology, or reconciliation without being characterized as bitter, disloyal, immature, or obstructive. Protective orders, separate routes, confidential support, and independent advocacy take priority when danger or coercion remains (Stark, 2007; Herman, 1992).

Safety review covers the channels through which harm can continue: physical access, housing, money, devices, location data, medical care, immigration or legal status, school and child routines, transportation, employment, and public narrative. Reviewers ask who controls each channel and what retaliation could follow a refusal. A calm meeting or polished apology cannot answer those questions.

Safety before reconciliation also protects participants. A participant may be harmed by family members, partners, public critics, or private networks. The City must not assume the participant is always the source of household power. The same careful routing applies.

Child safety overrides adult repair narratives. Adults may want reconciliation, public explanation, or closure. If child safety is involved, expert review and protective handling govern. The City must not use children as messengers, mediators, symbols, or emotional bridges.

When an existing record or proposed release creates danger, use the protected handling and urgent intervention routes in Chapters 9–11. The affected person need not become publicly visible to obtain protection.

The safety hierarchy must be visible in staff training and not merely in policy. Staff must know that a request for joint conversation, family meeting, apology session, or mediated return is not automatically benign. They must know how to pause, separate parties, check for coercion, involve qualified help, protect records, and document safety decisions without exposing the person seeking protection.

19.5.5 — Household Remedy

Remedy types may include correction of records, masking or removal where lawful, protected public clarification, support adjustment, schedule change, safety planning, mediation where safe, legal referral, counseling referral, financial compensation where appropriate, participant status review, staff review, or policy reform (World Health Organization, 2021c; Council of Europe, 2011).

Household remedy also needs the power to find institutional fault. Schedule, record rules, support terms, public interface, or staff decisions may have created the pressure. A credible route can implicate the City itself rather than treating every harm as private family complexity.

Remedy must be tracked for patterns. Repeated household complaints may reveal a structural problem in admissions, support, release rules, staff training, public interface, or record handling.

Household remedy protects future autonomy. Support, correction, compensation, safety measures, or other relief never bind a person to continue supporting the City or the participant, remain in contact, or stay silent.

Remedies may also require changed conduct. Remedy should be judged against the burden that triggered it, with follow-up

showing whether exposure, cost, pressure, access, or care conditions actually changed.

Each remedy has notice, a reviewer, a response clock, appeal, and follow-up. Unsafe contact, retaliation, or imminent exposure may require immediate protection before the full case is resolved; ordinary record correction can follow its declared review timetable.

Give partners, child guardians, dependent adults, elder representatives, caregivers, and household members standing to challenge City action even when the participant disagrees. Where lawful and appropriate, they should be able to communicate with reviewers and receive dispositions directly.

Finally, remedy records must be protected. The fact that the City repaired a household harm must not make the household publicly legible. Aggregate reporting may show how often household remedies occur, how quickly they are resolved, and what categories of burden recur. Individual household stories must remain guarded unless a lawful and carefully reviewed reason requires otherwise. Audit fields should record the category, timing, responsible office, and completion status of the remedy without carrying the private narrative into the reporting layer.

19.6 — Return to Ordinary Life After Visible Service

Post-service reintegration knows how to let people go. A participant may exit before office, complete formation, pause indefinitely, enter public role, return from office, retire, be removed, or simply become no longer active. Household life must then be allowed to move toward ordinary time (Schlossberg, 1981; Ebaugh, 1988). Leaving a visible role is not a return to an earlier self.

19.6.1 — Former Participant Family Life

Former participant family life must not remain under active City logic by default. Once active Vow status ends, the household must not continue to be interpreted as if every future event belongs to public-power formation. New relationships, family changes, care needs, grief, separation, marriage, parenting, illness, and ordinary domestic life require restored privacy unless a separate lawful public role creates a narrow reason otherwise.

At exit, identify retained active-period records, protected categories, voluntary future contact, data limits, and any separately authorized pathway for a later return to public role.

Support may still be needed. Exit from active burden can disrupt housing, finances, care arrangements, relationships, security, public attention, and identity. Post-exit support must be bounded and reviewable, but real.

Post-service privacy includes hiring, schooling, housing, relationships, local belonging, and ordinary social life. Family members and former household members do not remain permanently relevant because an adult once lived under the Vow. The City cannot control every outside memory, but it can stop feeding continuing exposure through its record site, search

tools, alumni practices, donor communications, and public artifacts.

19.6.2 — Household Reentry

Transition research and role-exit scholarship describe the work of disengaging from identities, expectations, routines, networks, and public narratives that have organized daily life. A fair exit therefore includes practical reentry, family renegotiation, record boundaries, and permission to become unremarkable (Schlossberg, 1981; Ebaugh, 1988; Hirschman, 1970).

Household reentry is the practical process of moving from active visible burden back toward ordinary domestic rhythm. A household may need to readjust schedules, privacy expectations, communication patterns, public attention, finances, care duties, conflict routines, and emotional roles (Hirschman, 1970; Walsh, 2016).

Reentry support must be optional, private, and nonpossessive. The City may offer counseling referral, legal referral, financial transition planning, privacy guidance, safety planning, family support, or public-status clarification. It must not monitor reentry as a continuing formation test unless a separate role requires narrow review.

The household may also decide that return does not mean restoration of the old arrangement. Some relationships may end. Some households may restructure. Some family members may need distance. Some may repair. The City must not treat household continuity as proof that visible service was healthy, or household change as proof that it failed.

Reentry includes digital and public-record hygiene. Status labels, correction requests, nonparticipant masking, search-result guidance, takedown routes where available, and restrained public explanations help families recover ordinary life after

visibility. The institution states the limits of its control honestly and keeps responsibility for its own records, derivatives, vendors, and communications.

Reentry support must account for habits formed under observation, including vigilance, defensive explanation, and record-minded speech. The household may choose external care, new routines, distance, or no formal service. A final status notice should clarify that active obligations have ended and distinguish retained records from future private life; accepting help must never restart monitoring.

19.6.3 — Children After Exit

Children after exit remain protected. The end of active participation does not authorize retrospective child storytelling. A child's earlier proximity to the City must not become memoir material, campaign content, institutional proof, or public curiosity after the adult leaves.

Post-exit child protection must account for delayed public attention. A child may become more identifiable later if a former participant seeks office, writes publicly, becomes controversial, or is targeted by critics. Records that seemed safely obscure during active participation may become more sensitive later. The City must provide long-term review where child-related risk changes (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008).

Children may also need ordinary explanation. Depending on age and context, they may need help understanding what the adult's participation meant, why certain information was protected, why public attention occurred, or why family routines changed. The City must not script the child's meaning. It must support caregivers with private, age-appropriate, expert-informed resources where needed.

Apply the no-child-as-evidence rule in Section 19.2.2 to later histories, exhibits, machine retrospectives, education products, and donor materials. Historical importance creates no new permission.

When children become adults, they may speak, challenge, correct, seek limited access to relevant records, request distance, or remain private. Adulthood does not retroactively authorize exposure of childhood; protection still covers the period when consent could not carry adult public meaning.

Children after exit may also need help with the absence of the City, not only its presence. A household that has lived around security protocols, public attention, or institutional support may feel disoriented when those structures vanish. The child must receive continuity in ordinary life, not a dramatic farewell from the institution.

19.6.4 — Relationship Repair After Service

After City service, relationship repair may address shifted labor, exposure, feeling used, misunderstanding and other cumulative harms. Use the household repair and safety routes in Section 19.5 and the changed-arrangement review in Section 19.6.2. Repair can be private, slow or incomplete; separation may be a fair outcome, and no one owes reconciliation.

Close active record obligations, correct City records, provide agreed transition support, and resolve nonparticipant complaints. Aggregate burden review may improve future practice; studying a family's repair requires the separate research authority in Section 11.6 and cannot become a public narrative by default.

Preparation for return should address what household members actually need: time, rest, repayment, childcare, silence, apology, changed habits, or separation. Public accountability creates no entitlement to private absolution.

19.6.5 — Ordinary Life Is Complete

Ordinary life is complete. The City is a bounded institution for adult public-power formation, not a higher human destination. When active obligations end, the person and household must be free to become unremarkable again.

Review whether previously released family-related material still serves a legitimate role purpose as circumstances and exposure risks change; mask, summarize, update, or time-review it where warranted.

Post-exit labels describe the actual participation or record status under Chapter 11; they must not conflate a person's status with the access status of a file.

After visible service, *The Life of Fairness* addresses ordinary life; *The Constitution of Fairness* addresses model legal architecture; *The Science of Fairness* addresses scientific use and interpretation; and *The Transition of Fairness* addresses transition timing. The City must not keep jurisdiction over a family merely because it once formed a participant.

Post-exit review must include a no-new-burden test. Does a proposed public update, historical account, documentary, research project, campaign use, or archive feature create new burden for family members who no longer have any live role in the City? If so, the City must justify, narrow, delay, mask, or refuse it.

Images, captions, summaries, donor language, recruitment materials, and social excerpts must never imply that visible life is a higher life. The City's success is measured partly by whether people can refuse it, leave it, or live beside it without being diminished.

Reintegration requires a plan before exit, not a farewell. Housing, healthcare, education, employment, caregiving, security, digital safety, and record correction may need

continuity. The plan identifies which supports end or remain portable, who funds transition, and how former participants seek remedy without renewed visibility. For each agreed transfer of support, the receiving provider should confirm continuity privately, using only the information needed for that service and the household’s chosen contact route.

Record sunset is part of family reintegration. Lawful public materials may remain, but household access, alerts, location protections, permissions, and search priorities require review. Children and collateral persons retain independent correction and shielding rights.

Formal exit does not by itself restore ordinary social life. Friends, schools, employers, neighbors, and media may keep reading the household through the former role. The City may offer security, referrals, counseling, and correction support while assistance recedes as autonomy grows (Ebaugh, 1988; Schlossberg, 1981).

Chapter 20 — Intimacy and Bodily Dignity

The Transparent Vow places unusual visibility on adults who voluntarily seek substantial public power. It does not convert the body into a civic exhibit, the bedroom into a committee room, the clinic into an archive annex, or a partner into evidence by association. The record must reveal public-power burden without possessing the person. Intimacy is therefore where the institution must prove that dignity belongs inside accountability rather than outside it.

The fairness question is therefore not whether the public is curious, whether an excerpt would be clarifying, or whether a participant once accepted a visible role. The question is who will carry the burden of exposure, whether the public-power issue can be understood in a less exposing form, which affected person has standing, what law or professional boundary controls, and what remedy exists if the institution gets the line wrong.

A humane City must remain a place where people can love, recover, receive care, grieve, and protect one another without performing those experiences for public trust. Intimate protection is more than scandal avoidance. Private affection and bodily safety sustain judgment, courage, creativity, and recovery from public strain. An institution that consumes those sources of steadiness weakens the people it claims to prepare for power.

Intimate life follows schedule, health, recovery, family, children, and dependents because it is entangled with housing, care, money, disability, pregnancy, parentage, custody, grief, treatment, security, and return to ordinary life. Those connections can create real public-power questions. They also require strict limits on what is captured, who may see it, what may be summarized, and what remains outside public release.

The central institutional danger is category expansion. Once a relationship record exists, ordinary disagreement, attraction, private messages, medical facts, or changes in intimacy may be

treated as potentially relevant simply because they are available. That drift must be stopped before public release, and preferably before collection. A mature relevance test identifies the burden route, the affected people, the legitimate purpose, the less intrusive alternatives, and the remedy if the institution is wrong.

Bodily dignity requires a vocabulary more precise than public or private. Some material must not be captured. Some may be captured only because an unavoidable active-period event, emergency, or continuity failure occurred, then held under strict restriction. Other material may be reviewed by a qualified professional, converted into a protected summary, delayed, sealed, or excluded from public release. These are candidate design categories, not enacted law, but the distinctions must be visible now so Total Record cannot be mistaken for total bodily exposure.

The risk of misuse is not evenly distributed. Sexual history, pregnancy, reproductive choices, disability, gender expression, orientation, family form, and trauma have often been used to shame, exclude, control, or discredit people. A formally equal release rule can therefore create unequal harm. The care interface must examine not only what a record says, but how social power, platform incentives, prejudice, and institutional authority may weaponize it.

The City owns the design of its participant record, access classes, public interface, complaint route, and operational safeguards. It does not own ordinary intimacy, clinical judgment, family-law authority, constitutional validity, or the private lives of nonparticipants. Those boundaries are not evasions. They are the conditions under which the City's own domain can become coherent and trustworthy. Any interface with clinical or family-law authority should record the handoff owner so City staff cannot fill jurisdictional gaps by improvisation.

20.1 — Relationship Records Under the Vow

A relationship record is justified, if at all, by the route through which intimate association affects public-power formation. A gift may create dependency. A partner may control access, information, money, housing, or contact with decision makers. A former partner may possess evidence of coercion or abuse of role. None of those possibilities makes the whole relationship public.

20.1.1 — Relationship Relevance

The operational test is civic necessity, not emotional vividness. Reviewers must be able to write one sentence naming the public-power question the relationship fact helps answer, one sentence naming the affected person whose burden is being protected, and one sentence explaining why a less intimate substitute is insufficient. If those sentences cannot be written, relevance has not been established.

Relevance is also role-specific. A fact irrelevant to one pathway may matter to another because of confidentiality, family-law exposure, procurement, foreign influence, staff authority, or a defined public-trust risk. The record therefore connects each handling decision to the actual public-power pathway rather than treating every relationship as equally meaningful (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008).

Relationship relevance must be documented through a protected relevance note. The note should state what role concern is at issue, what material is being handled, who may be affected, what access class and handling category apply, consent status, review authority, and the least exposing sufficient record form.

A useful relevance decision must identify both the public-power fact and the intimate material that remains outside

the decision. For example, a reviewer may need to establish that a participant's partner owns a vendor seeking access, that a former partner holds an unresolved threat, or that a household dependency creates leverage. The review does not thereby acquire a license to disclose the couple's sexual history, private arguments, fertility information, or affectionate correspondence.

20.1.2 — Partner Status

Partner status determines handling, not worth. Spouse, partner, former partner, co-parent, caregiver, dependent adult, and nonparticipant witness are relationship categories; active participant, former participant, visitor, and nonparticipant describe a person’s relation to the City. Together they guide lawful access, consent, notice, support, and remedy. Neither category measures legitimacy, loyalty, stability, or readiness, and a relationship with a participant does not transfer the Vow.

Even when both partners carry City roles, their records remain separate. Each person retains individual consent, role pathway, support needs, protected domains, and challenge rights; the public interface never treats a couple as one civic object. A nonparticipant partner receives stronger shielding because schedule, visibility, security, stress, and public record may affect them without creating consent to exposure. The record system marks that independent status before any relationship material is handled (Stark, 2007; Council of Europe, 2011).

Reassess former-partner material only for a defined role concern, using the relevance test in Section 20.1.1. Update status when a relationship begins, ends, changes legal form, becomes co-parenting, or becomes unsafe; do not narrate the change publicly without a justified purpose.

Partner status travels with the record. When material is summarized, queried, exported for review, or later reconsidered,

authorized reviewers can see the partner's status at capture and at release.

Former partners may face greater safety risk than current partners, and unrecognized households may carry greater dependence than formal marriages. Describe the relevant function and protected interest.

20.1.3 — Power Imbalance Review

Power imbalance review asks whether a relationship creates pressure that could distort consent, public-power formation, or later office. Money, age, status, immigration dependence, employment, housing, caregiving, family or spiritual authority, addiction history, institutional access, legal threat, emotional domination, public reputation, and control over sensitive information may each create leverage. Affectionate appearance does not settle whether a person can freely refuse, and the record must not reduce imbalance to one obvious form.

Test whether refusal carries material consequences: loss of housing, care, income, legal or immigration support, child contact, safety, or public standing. Use the private coercion-screening route in Section 20.3.3; dependency alone does not establish abuse or role unfitness (European Union, 2016; Westin, 1967).

Reputational pressure is governed by the partner nonperformance protection in Section 20.1.5. Trained personnel must conduct power-imbalance review, with legal and clinical consultation where needed; mentors must not be the sole reviewers because they may be invested in the participant’s formation.

Reviewers should document both what is known and what remains unknown. Power imbalance is often inferred from fragments, and overconfidence can injure everyone involved. A

careful review can say that risk factors are present, that coercion is not established, that more support is needed, or that no public release may occur until affected persons are protected.

Reviewers must not treat quietness as fear or confidence as safety. The question is whether one person can impose a material consequence on another and whether the City's process would increase that leverage.

20.1.4 — Relationship Record Boundaries

The care interface must distinguish existence notes, relevance summaries, restricted context memoranda, protected legal or clinical records, and material excluded from public-power handling.

Apply independent nonparticipant protection and the access/challenge controls in Sections 9.3 and 20.5.3 to third-party facts within relationship records.

The boundary must be written into search design as well as release policy. A public user must not be able to assemble a private relationship file through clever queries, timelines, tags, or linked records.

The boundary must also travel across devices and locations. A personal phone, home network, wearable, private message service, clinic portal, or partner's device does not become City property merely because a participant uses it. Where role-relevant communication occurs through a personal channel, the institution should seek the narrow transaction or fact needed for review and avoid copying the surrounding private life. Technical convenience is not a lawful basis for domestic search.

20.1.5 — No Romantic Performance

Participants must not be required to display affection, forgiveness, grief, desire, loyalty, or domestic stability for public trust. Supportive partners, reconciliations, apologies, reunions,

and displays of emotional depth are not substitutes for readiness evidence.

Protect a partner's refusal to appear, praise the participant, accept public framing, forgive on cue, or display household harmony; refusal is not suspicious. Prohibit promotional use of intimate material in campaign-style relationship packages, readiness montages, proof-of-devotion displays, curated romance, or family-stability branding. Any public explanation must remain sober, limited, and role-relevant (Stark, 2007; Council of Europe, 2011).

The no-performance rule does not make ordinary affection suspicious; participants remain free to love, reconcile, celebrate, grieve, and change.

Audit public events, profiles, documentaries, donor materials, and participant pages for incentives that reward displays of loyalty, reconciliation, sacrifice, or suffering and penalize privacy, separation, anger, uncertainty, or absence.

20.1.6 — Influence and Dependency Mapping

The financial map identifies who funds housing, travel, medical or legal care, childcare, communications, security, or debt; who could withdraw that support; and who would be affected by exit. For emotional or reputational dependency, identify a specific mechanism of pressure or role influence rather than inferring leverage from affection or reliance (European Union, 2016; Westin, 1967).

Influence mapping includes access and information dependency. A partner may provide advice, introduce contacts, filter criticism, manage communications, hold damaging information, or control routes to private networks. Those functions may matter to public-power formation even when intimate detail does not. The map also records release-related

safety risks such as retaliation, harassment, doxxing, custody conflict, employment loss, or public humiliation, because the risks of disclosure are part of any fair interpretation.

The map may conclude that no further action is needed.

A dependency map must be updated by triggers, not by continuous domestic monitoring. A new gift, financial arrangement, access role, custody event, threat, conflict, or material change may justify review. Ordinary affection, disagreement, care, or private routine does not. The map should lead to recusal, support, conflict management, separation of access, safety planning, or legal review, and then close or narrow when the relevant burden has been addressed. A closure note should identify the resolved dependency and any remaining review date, so temporary protection does not become an indefinite inquiry.

20.2 — Intimacy, Modesty, and Non-Spectacle

Modesty is an architectural and procedural principle, not a moral test. It concerns camera placement, sensor scope, protected zones, emergency handling, review qualifications, display choices, summaries, metadata, and the prevention of reidentification. Different bodies, disabilities, cultures, faiths, trauma histories, and gender expressions will require different accommodations. No single standard of comfort or exposure can be imposed as civic virtue (Citron, 2014; McGlynn et al., 2017).

20.2.1 — Intimacy Is Not Entertainment

Non-spectacle requires more than blurring names. Research on image-based sexual abuse and technology-facilitated violence shows how intimate material can be copied, recontextualized, searched, mocked, and used for coercion long after an initial release. The City should therefore prohibit public intimate imagery, erotic detail, humiliating summaries, and any release whose civic purpose depends on audience appetite (Citron, 2014; McGlynn et al., 2017; Henry and Powell, 2018).

Search design, metadata, headings, thumbnails, excerpts, recommendation systems, and machine summaries are configured to prevent the interface from promoting intimate material as an object of fascination. Necessary oversight remains findable through purpose, status, and context rather than through sensational presentation.

Do not use intimate material to increase engagement. Prohibit thumbnails, teasers, excerpted fragments, curiosity labels, sensational timing, platform-friendly packaging, live streams, reaction prompts, searchable sexual categories, dramatic crops, autoplay, promotional clips, and fundraising or recruitment reuse. Even publicly relevant material remains subject to this restriction (Citron, 2014; McGlynn et al., 2017).

Apply the purpose-bound access controls in Section 11.4 and the reviewer protections in Sections 20.2.3 and 20.5.

Official language also needs an entertainment-drift test: if a headline, label, summary, or example attracts attention after the public-power issue is removed, it may carry appetite rather than civic meaning.

Before release, reviewers must record the public question, need for exposure, forbidden uses, and stop authority.

20.2.2 — Modesty Protocols

Use the varied accommodations described in Section 20.2 without treating modesty as a moral or cultural test. The protocols below govern bodily exposure and its handling.

Classify bodily and care contexts before handling them, using the noncapture rule below. Separately justified incident or professional records require a defined access and output route; record continuity alone does not justify acquiring bodily material (Henry and Powell, 2018; Council of Europe, 2011).

Modesty protection extends independently to partners, clinicians, caregivers, aides, family members, visitors, and other collateral people. Noncapture, masking, cropping, delayed handling, restricted review, and protected summaries are considered before access expands. A fast private complaint route can halt imminent release, correct a record, secure support, and begin remedy because exposure in this domain may cause immediate and lasting harm.

A modesty protocol is a limit inside the role-bound Total Record Rule, not a denial of it. Dressing, bathing, toileting, sleep, sexual activity, medication, and ordinary bodily care are noncapture zones by default. Any exception must arise from a specific lawful safety or role-relevance need, use the least intrusive form, receive independent approval and review, and

never permit raw public release. Protected bodily life cannot be used as a hidden channel for public-power formation.

Modesty protocols must be rehearsed before crisis. Staff must know how to handle bathing, medical care, emergency assistance, disability support, pregnancy, clothing failure, and protected rooms without improvising.

Modesty protocols should cover space, technology, personnel, and emergency. Candidate measures include camera-free care zones, rapid recording suspension for accidental bodily exposure, teams authorized only for the stated purpose, screens or garments, voice-only or text substitution, restricted reconstruction after an incident, and a clear route for a participant or collateral person to signal distress. The exact design remains open, but the principle is not: bodily exposure must never be the default price of record continuity.

20.2.3 — Restricted Review

Restricted review is the controlled path for intimate material that may bear on public power but cannot be responsibly opened to ordinary public viewing. Each review must identify its purpose, eligible reviewer, source material, permitted output, access log, and disposal rule; reviewers must be trained, independent, conflict-screened, and sanctionable for misuse. The resulting status note, relevance decision, safety referral, or protected summary remains separate from the raw intimate record, so technical access never becomes general interpretive authority (Suler, 2004; European Court of Human Rights, 2026).

Restricted review includes independent standing for partners, bystanders, clinicians, and other collateral people. Where lawful and safe, they can object or provide input because the participant's burden never erases their dignity. The same architecture guards against institutional concealment: sensitivity

cannot become a reason to bury the City's own error or politically inconvenient conduct. Independent audit and appeal keep protection from turning into self-protection.

It applies only when raw release would create disproportionate harm, lawful or professional review is required, nonparticipant exposure is likely, or a protected summary can carry the civic meaning. Notes, screenshots, transcripts, reviewer comments, and temporary files inherit the source’s sensitivity until an authorized decision changes their status; the plan must also provide disposal, access audit, dual authorization where warranted, and wellness support for reviewers handling intimate material.

20.2.4 — Public Summary Limits

A public summary carries the minimum civic conclusion that can be understood without raw intimate exposure. It states the public-power question, protected categories, reviewer and authorization, status, provenance, affected-person input where safe, dispute, correction route, review date, and why a less exposing form was chosen. It may report that a protected relationship-power review occurred, that no public-power relevance was found, that a coercion concern remains under review, or that material was excluded (Citron, 2014; McGlynn et al., 2017).

Writers must avoid insinuation, moralized language, unnecessary chronology, and terms that invite readers to infer diagnosis, sexual conduct, fertility, relationship quality, purity, or character. The summary answers the civic question and then stops; public dissatisfaction with that restraint is not evidence of concealment.

Affected persons may challenge misleading, overexposing, incomplete, or suggestive language. A corrected summary

preserves the narrow conclusion, identifies what remains disputed, and routes readers to the authorized review process without turning omission into a puzzle.

20.2.5 — Anti-Humiliation Rule

The anti-humiliation rule requires review of unnecessary bodily or intimate exposure, including tone, timing, audience, interface, staff conduct, and downstream risk. An affected person's report of humiliation triggers review of the handling and its justification; it is not dismissed as a private feeling.

Truth alone does not justify release: a true intimate detail may be irrelevant, disproportionate, unsafe, culturally weaponized, platform-amplified, or harmful to nonparticipants. Anti-humiliation review must examine titles, thumbnails, excerpts, timing, emphasis, algorithmic promotion, summary framing, and proximity to other material (Henry and Powell, 2018; Council of Europe, 2011).

Humiliation can also be institutional, not just public. Staff jokes, casual discussion, unnecessary internal access, repeated retelling, training examples, or informal curiosity can violate dignity. The record system should train staff that sensitive records are never internal entertainment or moral gossip. The anti-humiliation rule must include remedies. Wrongful humiliation may require takedown where possible, correction, apology, compensation, access review, staff discipline, public clarification, or release-process redesign. Incident review should distinguish individual misuse from recurring permission, supervision, or workflow defects and amend the relevant rules or processes when the same exposure recurs.

Before release, test clips, screenshots, search results, and short excerpts for humiliation, identification of children or partners, and voyeurism. If the civic meaning cannot survive compression

with dignity, use a safer form, including a summary where sufficient.

20.3 — Consent, Bystanders, Collateral Persons

Safety complicates ordinary notice. A survivor, whistleblower, former partner, clinician, or person facing coercive control may be endangered if the participant or another person is informed too early. A candidate design therefore needs protected intake, independent advice, safe non-notification where law permits, later notice where appropriate, and an auditable reason for departing from ordinary consent practice. Safety does not authorize secret institutional convenience.

20.3.1 — Ongoing Consent

Ongoing consent requires a calendar and a trigger list. Consent must be revisited when relationships change, safety risks arise, legal processes begin, health circumstances shift, a public summary is contemplated, a participant nears office, or a new form of access is proposed.

The minimal consent record states what was requested, accepted, refused, open to change, subject to review, and connected to which complaint route.

A safety or public-power concern may require protected review despite refusal only under exceptional authority, documented necessity, expert review, and the least exposing route.

People can narrow, suspend, or challenge consent through private filing, supported explanation, interpretation or disability accommodation, and an urgent pause when release is near, without first exposing the facts that made the permission sensitive.

Consent status is explicit by use, person, and time. Permission for a protected clinical note does not authorize a public summary, one interview does not authorize later reuse, and crisis-era agreement may require later confirmation. Revocation

may leave some lawful records in place, but it stops new discretionary uses and triggers review of existing access. These limits belong in the original explanation rather than appearing only after conflict.

20.3.2 — Nonparticipant Refusal

People outside the Vow may decline voluntary contact, recording, interviews, public-facing relationship material, intimate summaries, or staged support. Apply the anti-retaliation and independent complaint protections in Section 19.1.5.

Refusal requires no public explanation of trauma, health, disability, faith, employment, immigration status, or family danger. Honor protected notice and no-contact preferences through the independent route below (Stark, 2007; World Health Organization, 2021c).

Refusal also governs visual and digital material. A nonparticipant is excluded or masked from clips, photographs, transcripts, searchable metadata, machine summaries, and public bundles by default. Rare lawful concerns may require protected review, but protected review is not public release; refusal continues to shape the least exposing handling path.

Record the refusal boundary and necessary operational consequence without adverse inference. Reports of pressure, retaliation, misdescription, or accidental exposure use Section 20.3.5.

Refusal needs an independent, accessible channel with representation, pseudonymous inquiry, or a safe address where needed. Seek alternative evidence; refusal counts against no participant absent a separate role-relevant fact.

20.3.3 — Coercion Screening

Screen for coercion before requesting intimate disclosure. Use private explanation, independent support, pressure screening, a limited request, and only then a handling decision. Apply the leverage analysis in Section 20.1.3.

In private, trained reviewers ask whether the affected person understands the request, can refuse, has independent advice, faces participant or third-party leverage, and would face greater risk after exposure. The participant must not control that consultation (Council of Europe, 2011; Nissenbaum, 2010).

The screening must include institutional coercion. The City itself may pressure people by implying that cooperation is needed for fairness, public trust, the participant's readiness, or the project's success. The care interface should train personnel to invite consent without moralizing it. A coercion signal should change handling status. It may require delay, shielded review, clinical or legal referral, nonparticipant protection, release challenge, or removal of public summary. The presence of coercion does not automatically determine the public meaning, but it must determine the protection pathway.

Coercion screening separates the protected account from the participant's access. Notes, pressure indicators, and safety signals reach only the roles that need them, so the person under review cannot use the file to discipline, persuade, or punish the affected person. The complaint route is tested from the weaker person's position: it does not depend on an allied staff member, a monitored device, a controlled schedule, or disclosure made while housing, care, money, custody stability, or emotional safety is at risk.

Coercion screening should focus on conduct and consequence, not stereotypes about victims or relationships. Threats, stalking, surveillance, financial control, sexual coercion, custody

leverage, immigration leverage, isolation, retaliation, and forced disclosure may require a protected route. A person's affect, delay, inconsistency, continued contact, or reluctance to accuse does not establish credibility or lack of credibility. Qualified safety assessment must remain separate from public narrative.

20.3.4 — Third-Party Masking

Third-party masking protects people who appear in intimate or relationship records without being the public-power subject. Masking may include removing names, faces, voices, locations, metadata, identifying context, relational clues, or search terms.

Apply masking before protected details enter internal copies, review notes, machine summaries, indexes or access logs. Use the inference-risk test in Section 11.3.1 at capture, classification, review, export and release (Nissenbaum, 2010; European Union, 2016; European Court of Human Rights, 2026).

Apply the child and dependent protections in Sections 19.2–19.3 to every masking decision.

Before release, reviewers test the entire public bundle for identification through timing, location, voice, family role, distinctive events, and linked records. Affected persons can challenge clues that staff miss through protected notification, surrogate filing, or technical review. Any reidentification key remains sealed for authorized use. If identification risk cannot be reduced sufficiently, the City changes the form to a less detailed summary, delay, restricted access, or nonrelease rather than treating failed masking as permission to expose.

20.3.5 — Complaint and Remedy

Complaint and remedy must work for people who distrust the City as well as those who trust it. Independent intake, anti-retaliation protection, trauma-aware timing, translation, disability access, and clear outcome authority make the route

credible. Affected people can challenge coercive consent, exposure, masking, summary language, access, platform spread, humiliation, staff misconduct, participant pressure, or failed protection without becoming public figures. The process needs private and emergency paths, rapid release holds where harm is imminent, and a rule that complaint itself creates no new exposure.

Use the remedies in Section 19.5.5 and the release-challenge route in Section 20.5.4, with urgency matched to the harm. Independent appeal must reach an authority other than the office that approved the disputed handling (Stark, 2007; World Health Organization, 2021c).

The affected-person file records the route, status, relief sought, protection level, and outcome, not a new intimate archive. Audit whether affected people can find the route, use it privately, obtain accessible support, receive a timely answer, and appeal.

A collateral person must be able to complain without the participant's permission. The route should accept confidential contact, provide independent advice, and preserve evidence without widening access. Challenges may also concern capture, classification, release timing, retention, or the accuracy of the institutional record.

Interim protection begins before final decision when exposure could become irreversible. A disputed release can be paused, search results suppressed, credentials suspended, a summary marked under review, or an identifier masked. The institution records the action without publishing the intimate reason. Delay is justified by preventing irreversible harm, not by assuming the complaint is true.

Apply Section 30.3.5 correction propagation to the harmful version and its derivatives, including recipient notice and withdrawal where warranted (European Union, 2016; European

Court of Human Rights, 2026). Repeated complaints about the same format, vendor, reviewer, or rule become institutional evidence. They can change the system without forcing affected people into public advocacy.

20.4 — Sexual and Reproductive Health, Pregnancy

Route treatment, accommodation, leave, emergency response, and safety through independent clinical care before addressing any narrow public-power conflict or record question; intimate clinical content is not civic material by default. Sexual health, reproductive health, pregnancy, and custody-related questions require separate care, consent, privacy, and legal routes even when one event touches more than one domain. Current World Health Organization guidance on sexual and reproductive health and rights emphasizes dignity, bodily autonomy, confidentiality, informed consent, and non-discrimination. WHO's 2025 training materials on clinical management of rape and intimate partner violence in humanitarian emergencies emphasize survivor-centered care, first-line support, safety planning, and practice within professional scope (World Health Organization, 2025a).

20.4.1 — Sexual Health Handling

A sexual-health fact becomes public-power relevant only through a specific route such as coercion, abuse, legal duty, deception with public consequence, risk to others, misuse of authority, or hidden leverage that affects the role. Even then, relevance does not automatically justify raw release. Clinical review, legal review, recusal, and protected summary come first. A participant must not avoid care because treatment may become a readiness file, and a clinician does not become an investigator merely by providing care (World Health Organization, 2006; Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; UNFPA, 2021).

Sexual and reproductive health records carry an explicit no-inference rule. Public readers, staff, reviewers, and machine tools may not translate protected health categories into character,

readiness, reliability, morality, or civic seriousness. When a fact affects schedule, safety, leave, care, or continuity, the institution records only that bounded consequence and routes clinical detail through protected professional channels.

Sexual health includes more than a single diagnosis. It may involve infection testing or treatment, sexual function, pain, assault care, medication effects, disability, orientation-related care, gender-related care, counseling, or a partner's health. None of this becomes public by default. Where a role-relevant accommodation or safety fact exists, the public record must use the least clinical detail capable of explaining the institutional decision.

20.4.2 — Reproductive Health and Pregnancy

Apply Section 19.4.3 to reproductive-health handling. Record only the necessary administrative consequence, such as accommodation, pause, safety action, or conflict status.

Reproductive health often implicates others. Partners, donors, surrogates, children, clinicians, families, and legal systems may be involved. The participant's consent cannot waive every other person's rights or dignities. The institution should assume collateral sensitivity unless expert review says otherwise (UNFPA, 2021; European Court of Human Rights, 2026).

Artificial Intelligence may not infer readiness, trust, stability, moral risk, or ideological meaning from reproductive-health facts. Any otherwise permissible training use follows the separate authorization in Section 11.6; consent or expert review cannot authorize the prohibited inferences in Section 11.7.6.

Menstrual and menopausal care receive the same protection; the City must not collect a reproductive history as a condition of participation.

Apply the pregnancy dignity and accommodation rules in Section 19.4.1. Explain any necessary participation change through limited role-status information.

Pregnancy loss, medical complexity, grief, emergency care, or changed family circumstances may require revised support. Avoid public statements that force later updates on private medical facts; reassess workload and environment through the protected accommodation route.

Pregnancy handling also protects postpartum recovery and a pause in active status. Disclosure timing belongs to the participant except where a narrow safety or operational duty lawfully requires otherwise.

20.4.3 — Custody Interaction

Apply Section 19.4.2 to custody-related handling, obeying controlling orders and limiting City action to its own operational duties.

Treat custody-related record handling as high-risk even when the public-power issue is minor. Review effects on child exposure, litigation, co-parent pressure, identifiable addresses or schools, searchability, and perceptions of family fitness. Co-parents and guardians retain privacy, refusal, and complaint rights (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008; United Nations, 1989).

Custody-sensitive records should default to child-protection review before public relevance review. The public may have an interest in a participant's conduct, but a child's safety, school privacy, location, medical information, and family-law process must be protected before any adult reputation question is considered.

20.4.4 — Expert-Review Requirement

The cited sources orient the chapter but do not settle local law or clinical protocol. Implementation remains dependent on qualified professionals and jurisdiction-specific review. Expert review must be triggered by defined categories before public pressure arrives. The expert route remains independent of admissions, readiness, communications, and donor pressure. The reviewer should receive only the material necessary for the question and must not acquire wider authority over readiness, morality, or public meaning. A category gate is credible only when it can pause handling, require a less exposing form, record dissent, and send the matter to lawful authority.

Use the discipline-specific routing and conflict checks in Section 19.4.5 and the authority map in Section 20.7 when an intimate-record question crosses domains.

Expert findings follow the separate restricted-review and public-summary routes in Sections 20.2.3–20.2.4, including the option of no public release.

Repeated risk flags, excessive delay, confusing summaries, weak affected-person notice, or recurring platform abuse trigger changes to policy, staffing, technology, and record scope. Qualified capacity is budgeted before sensitive capture begins; when the institution cannot provide timely, independent review, it narrows the practice rather than collecting material it cannot govern.

20.5 — Delay, Shielding, Summary, and Restricted Access

Sensitive material sometimes exists even when the institution has acted with restraint. An emergency may be recorded, a continuity failure may capture protected content, a conflict may require evidence, or a qualified reviewer may need access. Once material exists, protection needs a defined lifecycle rather than informal discretion. Delay, shielding, summary, and restricted access are not synonyms.

20.5.1 — Intimate-Record Delayed Release

The least-exposing-sufficient protocol begins before anyone opens the material. First, name the exact civic question. Second, test whether the question can be resolved without creating a record or handling existing material further. Third, identify every affected person and any immediate safety or care duty. Fourth, choose the lowest-exposure state that can answer the question: no public record, an existence note, a protected status label, a verified fact, a protected summary, a restricted excerpt, a qualified opinion, or raw review under exceptional authority. Fifth, assign the human owner, review clock, challenge route, derivative controls, and next lawful state. The protocol ends when the authorized question is answered.

Every change of form receives a fresh decision. A protected summary does not become a searchable transcript, an internal excerpt does not enter a public bundle, and human review does not authorize research or model training by implication. Known derivatives receive corrections and withdrawals; expiry leads to sealing, deletion, or renewed lawful justification.

Reviewers of intimate material need training, supervision, rotation and support under the restricted-review protocol in

Section 20.2.3. Before widening access, apply the ordered alternatives above.

Delay notices should state what is delayed and what is not. Where appropriate and safe, a public notice may identify the review, burden category, reason for delay, and next review date without exposing the intimate material. Delay may be needed for medical review, legal process, child protection, coercion screening, nonparticipant objection, security risk, trauma review, or summary preparation.

Delayed release must never mean delayed care. The person affected by intimate material may need immediate support, masking, legal advice, clinical help, or safety planning while public release remains under review.

Delay must never become indefinite limbo. The decision needs a start event, public-purpose reason, protected custodian, review date, conditions for extension, and a route for affected persons to seek earlier release or continued protection. Once the reason changes, the institution must reconsider the form rather than allowing sensitive material to remain forgotten in a queue. Review may conclude that permanent sealing, a protected summary, or nonrelease is required; a delay creates no presumption of later bodily exposure.

20.5.2 — Summary Substitution

Summary substitution conveys the necessary civic meaning to the public or oversight in place of raw intimate material where that form is sufficient.

Apply the public-summary limits in Section 20.2.4 to relationship-power issues, coercion reviews, conflicts, and protected-domain decisions. Public summaries omit sexual detail and raw clinical material; a necessary legal disclosure follows its

qualified restricted route and creates no publicity permission (Nissenbaum, 2010; OECD, 2013).

A protected link connects each summary to its source. The source-control note records comparison with the source, disagreement, intentional omission, and why omitted material was unnecessary. Oversight can verify it. Public prose preserves uncertainty, review boundaries, and contest status without inviting sexual inference, relationship gossip, pregnancy speculation, or humiliation.

Include the material role-relevant facts and uncertainty supported by the authorized evidence. The summary must not sanitize abuse, hide a conflict, or erase an affected person's account to protect the institution. Affected persons retain a safe route to challenge omission or distortion. The public text carries its scope, date, review status, and correction route.

20.5.3 — Protection Categories and Access Logs

Delay postpones a decision or release for a defined reason. Shielding limits who may see raw material. Summary substitutes the civic meaning for unnecessary detail. Restricted access permits purpose-bound review while logging each use. Sealing and deletion, where lawful, answer different questions again (European Union, 2016; Council of Europe, 2018b).

The NIST Privacy Framework offers a useful nonbinding orientation by treating privacy risk as problems people may experience across the data lifecycle. That lifecycle perspective helps locate burden in collection, access, use, retention, and disposal rather than mistaking compliance for the whole question. The framework does not supply City law (NIST, 2020b).

Access logs identify who accessed sensitive material, when, under which role and authority, for what purpose, and with what

downstream action. They also preserve anomaly flags for review. A click trace alone cannot show whether access was justified. Public reporting uses protected aggregate findings rather than exposing the log itself.

Logs are available to authorized oversight and affected-person challenge where lawful and safe. Use purpose classes that distinguish legal, clinical, technical, summary, emergency, oversight, and breach-response access (European Union, 2016; Council of Europe, 2018b).

Review access logs for excessive access by particular roles, unnecessary vendor access, staff browsing outside purpose, or spikes before public controversy. Suspicious patterns trigger staff inquiry, possible access suspension, notification where safe, and audit. Log machine access where possible, including Artificial Intelligence indexing, search, summary, and classification, even when no person opens the file.

Access logs receive their own protection class because they can reveal the existence of sensitive material, legal or clinical review, affected-person identities, or private timing. Access to the logs is itself logged.

20.5.4 — Release Challenge

Release challenge begins early enough to matter. Where lawful and safe, affected persons can object before release; emergency pause is available when necessary; and post-release repair remains open when harm appears later. The route is accessible, protected, and independent, so a person need not confront the participant, expose private facts publicly, or navigate a complex process without support.

Post-release challenge remains open when failed masking, newly identifying context, or changed legal and platform risks emerge. Review continued release under the same relevance,

rights, and proportionality standard as the original decision (European Court of Human Rights, 2026; Solove, 2006).

Release challenge must be available for machine-generated material as well as human-written material. A summary, label, search result, transcript, or recommendation produced with technical assistance can mislead or expose.

A release challenge has three linked rules. The pause rule contains irreversible harm while the objection is heard. The decision rule distinguishes dignity protection from reputation management. The correction rule explains how overexposure, misleading summary, wrongful omission, or failed notice will be repaired. A successful challenge can move material downward from raw access to restricted access, summary, status label, or no public mention; prior exposure creates no presumption that greater exposure should continue.

The challenge route needs an independent reviewer, a temporary hold standard, access to the proposed material or summary, representation, expedited handling for imminent harm, and authority to alter the result. Emergency release without prior notice may sometimes be lawful, but it must remain exceptional and reviewable afterward. The burden of defending intimate exposure belongs to the City, not to the person racing to stop it.

Consider a participant whose undisclosed financial dependency on a partner creates a credible influence concern in a public-role exercise. The civic question is whether the dependency affected judgment, disclosure, or vulnerability to pressure. The City does not begin by opening messages, therapy notes, sexual history, health information, or the partner's unrelated finances. An independent reviewer first tests whether verified status information and a bounded account of the relevant transaction can answer the public question.

The least-exposing-sufficient decision uses a protected review of the narrow evidence, then releases a summary that states the relevant dependency, the public-power risk, the participant's response, and the resulting safeguard without reproducing intimate communications or identifying collateral persons unnecessarily. The participant and affected partner may challenge relevance, inference, wording, masking, and timing before release where law and safety permit. Every access is logged by purpose (Nissenbaum, 2010; European Union, 2016; Council of Europe, 2018b; European Court of Human Rights, 2026).

Restricted material carries review and expiry dates, and emergency or legally compelled access creates no later publicity right. The record cannot migrate into donor, campaign, unrelated research, or model-training systems. When the narrow file cannot answer the civic question, reviewers seek another lawful source or report uncertainty. A release rehearsal should also test the moment between approval and dispatch. If new evidence or a protected objection changes the permitted version while an item is queued, the authorization check must stop the obsolete item before publication. The independent reviewer verifies the corrected version and the person with lawful release authority.

20.6 — Public Appetite Is Not Public Interest

Intimate material changes when it enters a public environment. A lawful, accurate, proportionate record can be clipped, reframed, sexualized, monetized, translated, or attached to a false narrative. Search systems may preserve the most vivid fragment long after correction. Public-interest review must therefore consider the life of the material after release, not only the decision made inside the City.

20.6.1 — Relevance and Readiness

Online disinhibition, context collapse, and engagement-driven circulation can transform a relevant fact into harassment, sexualization, or permanent reputational punishment. Review should establish whether the affected person can correct or challenge the framing before distribution (Suler, 2004; Citron, 2014; Marwick and boyd, 2011).

Public explanations can use the relevance test in Section 20.1.1 to show which civic question a protected fact answers and why a less exposing form was chosen (Suler, 2004; Citron, 2014).

Media, platforms, opponents, supporters, and donors may use public-interest framing to seek attention. A viral demand does not establish lawful relevance.

Institutional training uses abstracted or composite cases whenever vivid intimate detail is unnecessary. Staff learn the rule, burden route, and remedy without educating themselves through avoidable exposure.

The consent and protection process should prevent readiness bundles from including sexual detail as a character signal. A readiness bundle must not imply that a participant is more fit because they have a conventional relationship, less fit because they have an unconventional one, more trustworthy because intimate life appears orderly, or less trustworthy because

intimate life appears complex (Marwick and boyd, 2011; boyd, 2014).

Number of partners, relationship form, orientation, private practice, fertility, celibacy, infidelity allegation, or willingness to discuss sex may carry social meaning but no automatic readiness meaning.

20.6.2 — Click Value Is Not Civic Value

Apply the presentation controls in Section 20.2.1. Assess their civic usefulness through the measures below, rather than treating attention as evidence of value (McGlynn et al., 2017; Henry and Powell, 2018).

Give media and platform partners release conditions where lawful: context requirements, nonparticipant masking, anti-clipping notices, right of reply, and public harm warnings. These cannot prevent every abuse.

The record system should define success metrics that do not reward attention. Public comprehension, correction speed, reduced harm, audit completion, affected-person remedy, and successful masking are better measures than views, shares, mentions, or dramatic engagement.

The authorized context package travels with every official public bundle. Detached clips or quotations are not equivalent official releases; the City must not manufacture fragments that omit their governing status.

20.6.3 — Public Harm Review

NIST's 2024 report Reducing Risks Posed by Synthetic Content provides an orientation for provenance, detection, labeling, authentication, incident response, and the limits of technical controls. C2PA Specification 2.4 provides a versioned specification for recording content origin and edits. Neither source creates truth, prevents all impersonation, or guarantees

removal. Human review, affected-person contact, correction, security support, and lawful platform coordination remain necessary.

Public harm review follows a release beyond the controlled record site. It examines foreseeable identification, harassment, doxxing, deepfake abuse, custody or litigation effects, chilling of care, physical danger, and barriers to future correction. The review includes risks to participants, partners, children, dependents, staff, clinicians, family members, and host communities, and it tests whether delay, masking, summary substitution, restricted access, or nonrelease can preserve the civic function with less harm.

Disparate-harm review considers how the same intimate fact may be weaponized differently against women, LGBTQ people, religious minorities, disabled persons, divorced or unmarried persons, pregnant people, or people from cultures with different norms. Its output is a reviewable handling decision: release, delay, shielded review, summary substitution, additional masking, expert review, a public-status label, or nonrelease. Where release proceeds despite material risk, the justification must be unusually strong.

Document less exposing alternatives, affected-person input where safe, mitigation, and post-release monitoring in every public-harm review.

Use Section 20.7.3 for pre-release threat modeling and post-misuse response. Record what the City can control and what remains beyond its reach.

20.7 — Expert Review and Legal Boundary

Intimate-record handling sits at the intersection of several expert domains, and no single profession can resolve every question. Privacy law may govern collection and disclosure. Family law may govern custody, parentage, safety, and court orders. Clinical ethics may govern confidentiality and care. Trauma expertise may govern contact and release. Platform and cybersecurity expertise may govern foreseeable misuse.

20.7.1 — Intimate-Record Law

The City therefore needs an authority map rather than a vague instruction to seek advice. Each high-risk decision must identify the operational owner, the professional reviewer, the legal dependency, the affected person's route, the decision clock, and the condition for pause. Expert advice must be documented without exposing the intimate material it protects. Disagreement among experts must remain visible to the authorized decision maker rather than being collapsed into false certainty (European Union, 2016; European Court of Human Rights, 2026).

Intimate-record legal review covers consent, medical confidentiality, privacy and data protection, evidence, public records, workplace law, family law, image-abuse law, and constitutional rights.

Complete jurisdiction-specific intimate-record review before the first active participant enters. The resulting handling matrix must distinguish capture, access, summary, sealing, consent requirements, and prohibited actions, including independent nonparticipant rights (European Union, 2016; European Court of Human Rights, 2026).

Legal review covers the whole record ecosystem, including search, metadata, machine summaries, public bundles, and

exports. It also establishes the lawful notification and remedy routes used in Section 20.3.5.

Review cross-jurisdiction conflicts because material collected lawfully in one place may create new risk when transferred, searched, accessed, or summarized elsewhere. Treat intimate records as jurisdictionally fragile until qualified review confirms portability.

The authority map identifies when counsel, a court or statutory duty, independent advice, or rights-conflict escalation is required. Unresolved legal authority remains an explicit handling status.

Legal review must identify the jurisdiction, the record holder, the data subject, the legal basis, the privilege or confidentiality interest, the applicable public-record or data-protection rule, and the remedy forum. These rules may point in different directions. A United States site, for example, would require current federal and state analysis rather than a generic invocation of medical privacy. The law may change between design and operation, so review must be renewed.

20.7.2 — Trauma Review

Assess potential injury from release even when the record is accurate and the original event was not misconduct, including fear, shame, grief, bodily vulnerability, coercion memories, or relationship harm.

Assess effects on everyone required to encounter the material, including staff and reviewers. Protect refusal as an exercise of agency; it is not itself evidence of fragility (Herman, 1992; Roberts, 2019).

Plan for debriefing, care, explanation, security, or complaint support that affected persons may need after material is examined, summarized, challenged, or disclosed.

Trauma review must include the timing and manner of contact with affected persons. A lawful notice can still be harmful if delivered abruptly, without support, in unsafe surroundings, or through a channel visible to others.

Clinicians advise on likely harm, timing, phrasing, support, and uncertainty; the lawful decision authority determines record status. Clinical uncertainty must remain visible to that authority.

Trauma-informed review gives people control over pace, setting, support, and unnecessary repetition. It avoids treating fragmented memory, delayed disclosure, flat affect, anger, continued contact, or reluctance as automatic proof or disproof. Interviews must be conducted only when necessary and by qualified people, with clear separation between care, safety, fact-finding, and public communication.

20.7.3 — Platform Abuse Review

Platform-abuse review includes monetization, misleading translation, decontextualization, harassment, impersonation, fan pressure, and rumor. Use provenance labels, rapid correction, lawful removal requests, and watermarking where appropriate.

The release process must also account for moderation burden. Sensitive releases may produce harassment against participants, partners, children, staff, reviewers, or journalists. Moderators need staffing, tools, rotation, and mental-health support. The review must also address machine ingestion, altered summaries, false intimate content, and cross-record inference; model training remains prohibited by default unless a separate lawful pathway exists.

Platform-abuse review assumes adversarial use and brings technical, legal, and communications expertise into the release decision. Before release, the team tests screenshots, reposting, sexualized or synthetic editing, doxxing, reidentification, search

indexing, blackmail, employer or custody pressure, partisan attack, automated scraping, machine inference, provenance, and takedown options. The review may change format, metadata, timing, access, response staffing, or public wording; where downstream harm cannot be limited with reasonable confidence, use the least exposing effective format, including text over image, summary over excerpt, restricted access, or no release.

Prepare trained staff, rapid affected-person contact, legal escalation, security support, correction language, preserved provenance, and a clear statement of what the institution knows and does not know.

20.7.4 — Family-Law Review

Family-law review begins by separating the City's bounded duties from legal adjudication. The City may need to adjust schedule, housing, travel, support, record access, or participation status when custody, parentage, guardianship, adoption, support, domestic safety, or dependent care is implicated. Adjudication remains with the legally competent authority through proper process.

The review record must state what the City knows, what it does not know, and what it is forbidden to decide. Uncertainty about effects on school stability, household safety, immigration status, support duties, or co-parenting trust is preserved through restricted detail, specialized counsel, lawful-order review, and a narrowly framed operational summary. Child and dependent safety remain the first practical question while jurisdiction remains elsewhere.

Apply the custody-record and court-interface safeguards in Section 19.4.2 to prevent strategic use of the City archive in family proceedings.

20.7.5 — Constitutional Limits on Intimate Records

Handling requirements vary by jurisdiction across privacy, medical, family, employment, records, speech, equality, and constitutional law. This chapter supplies candidate institutional architecture, not enacted doctrine. Where lawful authority is absent or uncertain, the institution must narrow its action rather than improvise power.

The constitutional boundary keeps the City honest about the powers it lacks. Intimate-record architecture therefore requires jurisdiction-specific legal validity beyond moral design, including review of privacy, speech, association, religion, bodily integrity, equality, family life, data protection, counsel, third-party effects, future use, material pressure, and the real conditions of consent. The word voluntary cannot cure a distorted choice.

Bodily dignity and public-power accountability must be reconciled under lawful authority. When they cannot be reconciled in a particular handling path, the City narrows, pauses, redesigns, or refuses that path. The Vow does not outrank rights, and institutional confidence cannot substitute for review, standing, reasons, and remedy.

Train staff, participants, reviewers, volunteers, media partners, and technical teams in the expert and legal boundary. A protected audit register should track decision categories, review times, expert involvement, appeals, complaints, breaches, and reforms without exposing the intimate material or making affected people public examples.

The final constitutional inquiry asks whether the entire mechanism is proportionate to the public-power purpose. New technology touching intimate records should pass a fresh proportionality review before procurement or expanded use.

Chapter 21 — Staff and Hidden Labor

The City cannot be fair if it makes only one class of people visible. A participant under the Transparent Vow may carry the most obvious burden, but that burden becomes possible only because other people keep the institution alive. Someone prepares food, cleans rooms, repairs doors, guards boundaries, moderates public channels, preserves records, teaches difficult material, offers care, schedules meetings, maintains devices, responds to crisis, translates public contact, and absorbs the emotional weather of a place built around public-power formation. If those people disappear into the background, the City has not solved hidden burden. It has simply moved it downward.

This chapter distinguishes staff role records from the participant's active-role record, then specifies the access, professional and employment boundaries needed when staff influence formation.

Invisible labor is not labor that lacks consequence. Organizational and sociological research shows that maintenance, emotional regulation, classification, cleanup, coordination, and moderation can leave little visible trace when performed successfully (Hochschild, 1983; Star and Strauss, 1999; Roberts, 2019; Gray and Suri, 2019). The City should make roles, staffing, hazards, and decision influence legible without exposing workers' private lives. When a record credits preventive work, it should identify the action and risk addressed; the absence of an incident alone does not establish what was prevented.

Staff roles also require clear boundaries. Educators, clinicians, mentors, security staff, archivists, operators, moderators, maintenance workers, food workers, and administrators do not carry the same authority. Role collapse creates hidden sovereignty. A mentor who becomes a clinician, a clinician who

becomes a readiness judge, a security worker who becomes a disciplinarian, or an operator who silently controls access can shift power into places the public cannot see.

The final section turns to staffing ratios, workload, burnout, and hidden cost. A City can fail through understaffing as surely as through bad doctrine. If there are too few clinicians, educators, moderators, archivists, security workers, cooks, cleaners, operators, translators, accessibility staff, or complaint reviewers, then every safeguard becomes a promise assigned to exhaustion. The City must count capacity as part of fairness.

For that reason, staff councils, worker representation, complaint independence, workload evidence, compensation review, contractor protections, whistleblower routes, and anti-retaliation follow-up belong inside the City's moral architecture. These are not managerial conveniences. They are structural protections against the oldest institutional lie: that the visible mission is noble enough to excuse the private depletion of the people who make it run.

21.1 — Staff Are Not Background

Staff are human beings first, role-holders second, record subjects only within defined professional scope. Institutional transparency becomes less credible when the people maintaining it receive weaker protections than its visible participants. Work conditions should be reviewed for exhaustion, coercion, and undocumented discretion. Professional accountability must remain bounded by a practical route to challenge an inaccurate record.

21.1.1 — Staff as Burden Carriers

Staff carry burden because every City promise must become work. The promise of dignity becomes room design, cleaning schedules, secure transport, meal planning, complaint intake, and clinical boundaries. The promise of record integrity becomes capture checks, storage verification, access logs, status labels, correction review, and breach response.

Staff also carry interpretive work: they may notice possible performance drift, hostile public contact, unsafe record classification, boundary testing, or unequal strain in a routine. Their observations can inform burden review, with inference distinguished from what was directly observed (Hochschild, 1983; Star and Strauss, 1999).

Staff also carry timing burden. Participants may enter a room at a scheduled moment, but staff prepare before and repair after. A public interface lasts an hour for the participant, yet it may require days of screening, translation, accessibility testing, moderation planning, risk review, and follow-up.

Review staff burden routinely as well as after crises. A monthly or quarterly staff-burden summary can identify whether one role is absorbing repeated overload, whether a public-interface routine is creating avoidable emotional strain, or

whether a record practice depends on unacknowledged discretion.

A staff-burden register therefore must name work before it names virtue. The register must ask which promise the worker is carrying, what time and skill the promise requires, what emotional or safety exposure appears, what support is available, what record is created, and who reviews the load when the pattern becomes excessive.

The staff-burden register separates load from blame. A heavy day does not prove supervisory wrongdoing, and a difficult record does not define a weak worker. Its purpose is to reveal cumulative strain before it becomes injury, silence, resentment, or hidden rationing, then ask whether the burden is necessary, fairly distributed, relieved, and supported by realistic reserves.

21.1.2 — Service Labor Visibility

Service labor includes food, cleaning, laundry, waste handling, logistics, transportation, room preparation, maintenance, supply, and repair. Staff-dignity governance requires them to be visible in budgets, schedules, representation, and remedy before failure makes the labor undeniable.

Food systems reveal this clearly. A dining room may appear to foster ordinary shared life, but the kitchen behind it carries labor, heat, timing, procurement, allergies, nutrition, cultural respect, waste, cleaning, and staff scheduling (Roberts, 2019; Gray and Suri, 2019).

Cleaning and maintenance sustain rooms where people sleep, argue, grieve, recover, receive care, and live under record. Workers entering intimate or protected spaces need clear access rules, safe conditions, and record boundaries that protect them as carefully as the participants they serve.

Logistics and supply chains also matter. A City may speak about public burden while its food, equipment, uniforms, software, cleaning materials, furniture, and repair parts arrive through hidden exploitation or unreviewed vendors. Service labor visibility therefore extends beyond the campus. It asks how the City’s ordinary operations depend on labor elsewhere.

Facility planning gives service spaces the same dignity applied to public halls. Loading docks, kitchens, repair rooms, storage areas, staff rest spaces, cleaning routes, and accessibility infrastructure are designed as workplaces rather than hidden backsides of civic beauty.

Service labor must also have feedback power over design. The person who cleans the room may know where privacy fails. The person who runs the kitchen may know where schedule rhetoric ignores bodies. The person who maintains equipment may know where resilience plans fail under operating conditions.

21.1.3 — Emotional Labor

Emotional labor includes managing one's feelings and outward expression to meet a role's demands, such as remaining reassuring during a difficult intake or calm during hostile public contact (Hochschild, 1983). The City must also count related emotional demands: hearing distress, de-escalating conflict, carrying confidentiality, and repeated exposure to harmful material. These burdens overlap, but they may require different protections, supervision, and recovery.

Training, rotation, supervision, recovery, and adequate staffing must support emotional work; resilience language cannot substitute for those resources.

Use the staff-dependency review in Section 21.5.2 when emotional support concentrates influence in one relationship.

This labor must be counted without turning private staff experience into public content. Staff may need internal debrief, peer support, clinical support, rotation, and workload relief. They do not owe the public a record of their emotional reactions to the people they support.

Use role-level indicators of emotional demands to decide when rotation or relief is needed: incident intensity, hostile-contact frequency, crisis contact, confidentiality burden, and concentration of support work. These indicators do not measure a worker's private emotional experience.

Emotional labor must be included in training without making workers responsible for everyone else's feelings. Staff can learn de-escalation, boundary language, referral pathways, and self-protection, but the institution must not turn skill into limitless obligation. The fairest emotional-labor system teaches staff how to help, when to hand off, when to refuse, when to report, and when the City itself must reduce the demand.

21.1.4 — Archive and Moderation Burden

Archivists and moderators will encounter conflict, vulnerability, falsehood, protected material, public anger, intimate boundaries, correction disputes, harassment attempts, and records that may shape public trust.

Archive duties in Section 21.3.5 can have serious consequences when classification, redaction, or correction fails; staffing must account for that responsibility (Hochschild, 1983; Star and Strauss, 1999).

Moderation staff carry a different strain. Public channels may receive evidence, complaint, testimony, bad-faith manipulation, bot activity, doxxing attempts, sexualized comments, threats, ideological attacks, and fan behavior. Moderators protect the public interface from becoming mob pressure, but they often do

so by being exposed to the very material everyone else is protected from.

Artificial Intelligence tools may assist in authorized search, content triage, integrity checks, or moderation support under Section 11.7.6, but they cannot remove the burden. Machine assistance can reduce some exposure and create new risks at the same time. Human review, appeal, bias review, and staff workload review must remain active.

Archive and moderation roles must have special escalation rules for child-related material, intimate material, nonparticipant exposure, credible threats, coordinated harassment, and suspected manipulation. The person who first sees the harm must not be forced to carry the whole institutional response alone.

Staff-dignity governance also recognizes secondary exposure as an occupational risk. Staff who repeatedly handle threats, intimate records, child-protection material, medical crises, public ridicule, or violent rhetoric may carry the burden long after the file is closed. The response must include rotation, trauma-aware supervision, access minimization, peer support, clinical referral when needed, and permission to step away without stigma.

Access tiers, content warnings, and machine assistance under human control help limit high-strain digital exposure.

21.1.5 — Staff Dignity Principle

Staff dignity requires rights, role clarity, safety, pay, recourse, recovery, privacy, training, representation, and power to identify hidden burden. The following rules make those duties operational.

Name the responsible role rather than using an undifferentiated label such as support; distinct duties need distinct staffing and accountability (Roberts, 2019; Gray and Suri, 2019).

Staff who work in the City are not morally superior, disciples, servants of a sacred cause, or invisible movement members. They are workers and professionals in a serious civic institution. Their dignity does not depend on self-sacrifice.

Staff dignity appears in the budget. Pay, staffing levels, training, recovery, protective equipment, security support, representation, turnover, and reserve capacity are costed before the City promises a safeguard.

Include the staff-treatment standard in Section 13.3.2 in participant training.

The principle also gives staff language for refusal. A worker must be able to say that a request violates role dignity, staff privacy, safety, or workload limits without needing to translate that refusal into personal distress.

Contract renewals should carry workload evidence so outsourced strain cannot disappear from the institutional account.

21.2 — Staff Records and Active-Role Boundaries

Staff records follow the defined role, material influence, and protected-data boundaries below; employment does not transfer the participant's Vow. An employee may answer for professional decisions without consenting to an open-ended record of private life. The record must identify the function, the decision boundary, and the lawful reviewer. Protected complaints and personnel information need a controlled process rather than default public posting.

21.2.1 — Role Record Definition

A role record documents what a staff member does within a defined City role that materially affects formation, rights, records, care, access, safety, interpretation, or public interface. It may include assigned duties, decisions made in role, advice with material influence, access to protected records, complaint handling, escalation actions, and conflicts of interest.

Each role entry answers what the worker did that affected formation or another person's rights. Apply Section 21.2.2 to private life and any exceptional off-duty review (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008).

Role records must be proportional. A senior archivist who controls release categories may need more detailed role documentation than a temporary maintenance worker fixing a door. A clinician's role record may show appointment status, safety escalation, or capacity adjustment without exposing clinical content. A food worker's record may show schedule, safety, and workplace issue without turning meals into surveillance of the worker.

Define categories before work begins, with a purpose, retention rule, and challenge route for each. Use the materiality threshold in the role-record definition.

Oversight may need to see how staff power shapes participants, but that visibility should usually take the form of summaries, audit categories, and role-based disclosure rather than raw worker exposure.

The role record must include an audit trail of why a category was used.

Role record definitions must be reviewed after real use. Early rules may miss influence paths that only daily operation reveals. The City must update categories through governance review, staff consultation, and rights review rather than through quiet administrative expansion.

The role record must also identify what is not being recorded.

Role record design must be testable in a concrete case. A reviewer must be able to take a mentoring meeting, clinical boundary warning, access decision, record correction, security intervention, public-interface preparation, or archive classification and identify the role, the authority used, the person affected, the record created, the privacy boundary, and the appeal route.

Label the evidential status of each role record so an access log, mentor note, incident report, or clinical boundary notice cannot be inflated into a whole-person or readiness judgment.

21.2.2 — Off-Duty Privacy

Off-duty privacy is the rule that staff private life remains private by default. A staff member does not surrender ordinary life because they work near visible participants. Their home, family, religion, friendships, political views, health, sexuality, private time, and ordinary conduct do not become City records merely because their work supports the City.

Off-duty privacy also affects recruitment and retention. Broad private-life exposure may deter qualified applicants or favor

people willing to accept unusual intrusion. The City should examine declined offers, departures, and confidential worker feedback to test that risk, without inferring desperation, ideological capture, or poor judgment from a person's willingness to work there.

There may be rare cases where off-duty conduct affects role fitness. A security worker’s off-duty threat conduct, an archivist’s unauthorized disclosure, a clinician’s professional misconduct, or a staff member’s conflict of interest may require review. The answer is not full-life monitoring. The answer is lawful, narrow, evidence-based, role-relevant review with due process and appeal.

Off-duty privacy must also include protection from public harassment tied to City employment. Staff may become targets because they work near participants or archives. The City must not treat such risks as private inconveniences. It must have reporting, support, and anti-doxxing measures where staff are threatened because of their role.

Off-duty privacy must continue after employment ends. A former staff member must not remain bound to the City’s record ecology except for lawful role records, confidentiality duties, and reviewable obligations tied to their actual work.

Off-duty privacy must survive public controversy. When the City is criticized, it may be tempted to prove staff virtue by exposing private dedication, family sacrifice, personal politics, religious life, health history, or after-hours conduct. That would turn staff into evidence for institutional defense. The City must answer criticism with role records, audit findings, staffing data, and remedies, not with the private lives of its workers.

21.2.3 — Professional Boundary

Each profession has a defined authority, duty, record obligation, and limit. The six role specifications in Section 21.3 assign those boundaries.

Staff-record governance makes role boundaries legible. Staff and participants can see who may decide, recommend, escalate, recuse, or refuse a task.

The boundary must be reviewable. It is not enough to write role descriptions. The City must audit whether roles drift in practice. It must ask which staff roles become indispensable, which are asked to carry emotional overflow, which accumulate decision power, and which receive blame without authority.

Professional roles can cooperate without dissolving into one another. When clinicians, mentors, educators, and operators discuss a participant, the purpose, scope, record, decision owner, and limits of the exchange should be explicit.

Professional boundary also requires physical and digital cues. Meeting types, record labels, room design, access permissions, and platform roles must tell participants and staff what kind of interaction is occurring.

Staff-record governance asks after each major incident whether any role was asked to do the work of another role. Many failures will first appear as helpful improvisation. Helpful improvisation can be necessary in emergency, but if repeated, it becomes evidence that the institution is understaffed or badly designed.

Teach the responsibility and referral map at onboarding, including prohibited improvisation and emergency exceptions.

Boundary rules must include what staff may decline. A clinician may decline a request to disclose therapeutic content for reputational management. An educator may decline pressure to grade ideological agreement as competence. A mentor may

decline to become a participant's handler. A security worker may decline an unlawful humiliation order.

Professional boundary also protects participants from dependence on personality. If the City functions only because a beloved clinician, teacher, mentor, operator, or security worker quietly works around rules to keep services running, the system is weaker than it looks. Boundaries require roles to be teachable, reviewable, and replaceable without erasing the dignity of the person who performs them.

21.2.4 — Staff Consent

Staff consent begins with truthful notice. A person considering work in the City must know what role records exist, what kinds of information are recorded, who may access them, how long they are retained, how they may be corrected, and what rights staff have to complain, appeal, or refuse overreach. Consent cannot be buried in employment paperwork that no one understands.

Separate agreement to employment from the lawful basis for each data use. Required role records need jurisdiction-specific authority, necessity, notice, and challenge rights; an employment signature cannot substitute for that basis. Where processing relies on consent, workers must have a genuine choice without detriment. Keep optional research and public release distinct from required accountability (European Union, 2016; Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008).

Staff must also have refusal and accommodation routes. A staff member may object to a new data practice, a public-facing role change, unsafe moderation exposure, expanded access logging, or a boundary collapse. The City must not treat every refusal as disloyalty.

A refusal of optional use cannot be treated as refusal of job accountability.

A staff member who agreed to a human-reviewed role record did not necessarily agree to automated pattern analysis, biometric access tracking beyond necessity, or expanded search across personnel records.

Material role expansion triggers notice, training, review, and feasible refusal or accommodation options before new duties begin.

After a material role or system change, the worker receives a concise change receipt identifying the new duties, information uses, access rules, training, and available challenge route. It distinguishes what changed from what remains protected and states the applicable retention and contact arrangements after employment ends. The receipt supplements the original notice rather than asking the worker to rediscover changed conditions inside a complete policy manual.

21.2.5 — Staff Data Limits

Give workers a data map showing the fields, purposes, users, retention, correction routes, and prohibited uses established below.

Staff data limits prevent the City from building staff dossiers. A staff dossier is a file that expands beyond role accountability into generalized person assessment: productivity reputation, loyalty inference, private beliefs, emotional style, interpersonal rumors, health speculation, family details, political signals, or machine-generated trust impressions.

Every staff data field begins with a defined operational, safety, labor, audit, access, complaint, rights, or role-accountability purpose. The record names who may use it, for how long, under

what authority, and with what correction and deletion route. A field without a current purpose does not enter the system.

Minimization follows purpose. Aggregate workload data is used when it can reveal understaffing without collecting personal distress narratives; access logs are used when they can establish archive handling without speculating about intent. More intrusive information requires a specific question, qualified authority, proportionality, and a review date.

The third data limit is separation. Staff data must not be merged with donor systems, public voting signals, Religion of Fairness participation, Workgame-like contribution records, participant records, PTVC research estimates, or Artificial Intelligence-inferred trust profiles.

The fourth data limit is retention. Staff role records must have retention periods matched to purpose. Some access logs may need longer preservation. Some complaint records may require legal retention. Some training data may expire. Retention must not default to forever.

The final data limit is contestability. Staff must have ways to inspect, correct, challenge, or contextualize role records where appropriate. A record system that can shape employment, credibility, or complaint outcomes without staff recourse is hidden power.

Specify who may search staff records, permitted purposes, logs, and penalties for unauthorized or curiosity-driven access. Proper collection does not justify improper searches.

Workers must be able to see when a record was deleted, sealed, retained or scheduled for review.

Staff telemetry and role records must not be used to infer health, loyalty, politics, relationships, or psychological condition. A justified safety or role-function concern follows the appropriate lawful, qualified review using necessary evidence; it

does not authorize the automated profiles prohibited by Section 11.7.6.

Procurement carries the same record boundary. Scheduling, access control, moderation, analytics, storage, and staffing vendors operate under purpose limits, access logs, deletion, portability, breach notice, audit rights, subcontractor controls, and a prohibition on model training or unrelated reuse absent separate lawful authority. Outsourcing never transfers the City’s duty to protect workers and participants.

Enforce this separation through access controls, database boundaries, query logs, retention, and deletion or sealing paths. Apply the No Cross-Architecture Dossier rule in Section 11.7 to workers as well as participants.

21.3 — Educators, Clinicians, Mentors, and Security

Role-separation architecture names six central role categories: educator, clinician, mentor, security, archive, and operator. These are not the only staff roles, but they represent the core authority risks. Public records preserve role separation. They identify which role taught, cared, logged, protected, operated, or decided rather than attributing every action to an undifferentiated City.

21.3.1 — Educator Role

The educator role is to teach public-power knowledge, reasoning, history, law literacy, administrative reality, material burden, institutional craft, media interpretation, and other formation subjects within scope. Educators help participants learn how public decisions move through systems and into felt life. They do not own the participant's worth, readiness, or future office path.

An educator may challenge weak reasoning, demand evidence, require revision, and expose a participant to difficult material. They may not humiliate, impose ideology as loyalty, punish dissent, or turn the classroom into a hidden admissions filter beyond defined evaluation (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; Schein, 2010).

Class participation, assignments, reasoning, revision, and feedback may be part of formation records where relevant. But the educator's private impression of the participant must not become secret readiness authority. Evaluation must be documented, role-bound, contestable where appropriate, and separated from care or discipline.

Educators must also handle their own influence honestly. A powerful teacher can shape worldview, language, assumptions, and public reasoning. That influence must not be hidden under

the myth of neutral instruction. Source attribution, curriculum transparency, minority perspectives, and serious rival frameworks help prevent intellectual capture.

Educators respond to distress through a clear care route rather than diagnosis. They may pause the learning activity, protect immediate safety, contact the independent clinical channel, and document only the educational or operational consequence. Political disagreement, difficulty, and emotion remain distinct from illness, which protects both the participant and the educator.

Protect educators from pressure by City leaders, admissions staff, or donors to produce favorable participants or withhold honest evaluation.

Educational authority must also be transparent about its criteria. If a participant fails a public-reason exercise, the record must show whether the issue was factual error, poor reasoning, disregard of affected persons, inability to explain tradeoffs, evasion of evidence, or disrespect for lawful limits. The educator's role is to make learning legible, not to make taste, charisma, or institutional preference look like readiness.

Teach the City's domain and authority limits through the series map and the book's opening definitions. Disagreement with the institution is not itself evidence of unreadiness.

21.3.2 — Clinician Role

Clinicians provide care, assessment, crisis support, referral, and accommodation advice within independent professional authority. Apply the clinical boundaries in Sections 14.2.2 and 18.3.3.

Clinical independence also protects staff. Staff may need support after moderation exposure, security incidents, participant crisis, public harassment, or burnout. A staff member must be

able to seek care without fearing that every disclosure becomes a labor record or performance evaluation.

Clinical independence includes protection from disciplinary use. Distress, criticism, disagreement, or resistance to institutional pressure is not treated as illness by default. Clinicians control care records and advise on safety, accommodation, functional capacity, timing, and de-loading within professional bounds. Civic, employment, disciplinary, and role-readiness decisions remain with separate accountable review processes and cannot demand a diagnosis as justification.

Emergency exceptions are narrow, logged, and reviewable. Clinicians may communicate what immediate safety requires, while broader clinical disclosure remains protected. The affected participant or staff member receives an explanation when safe, and the distinction between emergency action and ordinary care survives the crisis.

The clinical boundary must be tested in dry runs before the City opens. Crisis scenarios, de-loading requests, capacity concerns, and safety escalations must be rehearsed so care does not become confused under pressure.

Clinical records remain in protected care architecture with narrow bridges to safety and capacity review. Any bridge records its reason, authority, minimum information, recipient, and challenge route.

21.3.3 — Mentor Role

Mentors help participants integrate feedback and prepare for public responsibilities within the support boundaries in Sections 17.7.3 and 18.3.2.

A mentor guides without owning the participant’s future. They may advise, question, challenge, and support. They may not become the private source of permission, the hidden interpreter

of all feedback, the person who determines readiness, or the emotional center around which the participant organizes compliance (Lipsky, 1980; Edmondson, 1999).

Log material mentor influence under Section 21.5.1, preserving the distinction between consequential advice and ordinary support.

Mentorship is separated from clinical care, education, and operations. Mentors may notice distress and route support, help participants interpret feedback, and clarify choices, but they do not diagnose, treat trauma, control grading, schedule access, or become substitute therapists.

Provide supervision for role boundaries, dependency, recurring intervention patterns, and the mentor's own investment in outcomes.

Mentorship must remain available when the participant's best judgment is to challenge, pause, or refuse the City itself.

Use the mentor-note limits in Sections 17.7.3 and 18.3.2; record material interventions without converting private trust into a detailed emotional file.

Apply Section 21.5.2 when a mentor becomes the sole trusted route for advice, support, or interpretation.

Mentors must be trained in the difference between support and steering. Support helps a participant see options, burdens, consequences, and limits. Steering quietly narrows the participant's future toward the mentor's preference, faction, worldview, or institutional convenience.

21.3.4 — Security Role

The security role is to protect life, boundaries, records, staff, participants, visitors, nonparticipants, and the public interface without turning the City into a prison atmosphere. Security is necessary because the City will attract attention, conflict, protest,

harassment, intrusion, cyber-physical risk, and emergency events.

Apply the threat and protest distinctions in Section 12.5.4: confusion, dissent, protest, and distress are not threats by default.

Security work is proportionate, de-escalatory, documented, and reviewable. Screening, escort, perimeter response, emergency protection, exclusion, search, delay, and any use of force have defined authority, records, complaint routes, and after-action review.

Provide security workers with role-appropriate training, rotation, debriefing, support, and protected recourse under Sections 21.4 and 21.6.

Security records document material incidents, access decisions, escalation, exceptions, and authority use under the role-record limits in Section 21.2.1.

Security design and incident review must include staff, participant, visitor, protester, disability, family, journalist, and host-community perspectives, including those protected and those burdened by protection. A system that feels safe to leadership may feel threatening to others.

A non-carceral security posture can still expose workers to anger, threat, manipulation, protest pressure, online targeting, and the burden of using restraint while being judged from every side. The City must train security in de-escalation, rights, trauma awareness, protest respect, child and family shielding, and staff self-protection. It must also give security staff complaint and review routes when they are pressured to become either passive decoration or coercive shortcut.

A security file can protect the City from later amnesia, but it can also stigmatize a participant, visitor, protester, family member, or staff person if written carelessly. Reports must separate observation from inference, threat from discomfort,

ordinary disruption from a specific safety threat, and safety action from punishment.

21.3.5 — Archive Role

Archivists, record officers, classification reviewers, correction handlers, and public-record staff preserve accurate, contextual, protected institutional memory.

Archive staff must preserve provenance, chain of custody, status labels, correction pathways, access logs, protected categories, public bundles, and record integrity. Each permission remains separately authorized under Section 2.3 (UNESCO, 2021b; World Health Organization, 2021a).

Archive staff determine record status within their authority, not participant readiness or worth.

Archive staff need protection from pressure. Participants may want favorable classification. Leaders may want public relations. Donors may want access. Journalists may want release. Critics may want raw exposure. Vendors may want system control. The archive role requires independence enough to resist these pressures and accountability enough to prevent internal hiding.

Archive training must include requests that disguise public appetite as civic relevance, using the relevance test in Section 20.1.1.

Use the correction and challenge mechanisms in Chapters 10–11 when classification, redaction, summaries, or labels are wrong.

Archive staff must have a protected route to challenge pressure from participants, leadership, donors, media, researchers, and public campaigns.

21.3.6 — Operator Role

Operators coordinate schedules, logistics, access, facilities, platforms, vendors, rosters, maintenance, visitor flow, and administrative continuity. Operational choices affect who gets access, when a meeting occurs, how urgent a complaint appears, whether a repair happens, which staff are overloaded, which public input is routed, which vendor is called, which rooms are available, and how exceptions are processed (Lipsky, 1980; Edmondson, 1999).

Discretion, escalation, conflicts, logs, complaint routes, and anti-retaliation are visible enough to audit, while friendly access cannot purchase hidden privilege.

At the governance level, operator load should be auditable as a control risk. Chronic understaffing, exception queues, delayed corrections, and informal workarounds should trigger scope reduction or staffing correction before they become hidden operator discretion.

Vendor coordination is a major operator risk. Operators may manage platforms, security tools, archive systems, maintenance contracts, food services, accessibility systems, and communication vendors. If operations become dependent on a vendor, the City may lose independence by convenience. Operator training must include anti-vendor-capture discipline.

Operators must be included in design review because they know where written rules become difficult to carry. A policy may look elegant until an operator must schedule it, staff it, route it, document it, and repair it under pressure.

The operator coordinates the service ecology but does not absorb the authority of every profession. It may not overrule clinical judgment, rewrite an archivist’s lawful custody decision, suppress a security stop, direct an educator’s substantive

assessment for reputational reasons, or decide a staff complaint in which operations is implicated.

A responsibility matrix should identify routine authority, consultation, concurrence, emergency stop, and review for each recurring decision. When two roles conflict, the immediate safety or rights rule controls first, and the unresolved institutional question moves to independent review rather than informal bargaining.

Operator performance should be judged by continuity with boundaries, not by the absence of visible friction. Complaints, pauses, professional refusals, and changed plans may show that the system is working. An operator who hides disagreement to produce a smooth public surface is creating shadow governance. The record should preserve the decision route and correction (Suchman, 1995; Edmondson, 1999).

Rotation and conflict safeguards matter because operational knowledge becomes power. Long tenure can create indispensable expertise, but it can also produce gatekeeping, vendor dependence, and informal control over who receives help. Succession, cross-training, leave coverage, documented procedures, and audit reduce that dependency without treating experienced staff as disposable.

21.4 — Staff Complaint, Appeal, and Anti-Retaliation

Staff complaints provide an early route for identifying institutional drift, including conduct by the City itself. Every worker must be able to choose representation before a consequential interview, access the evidence relied upon, use paid work time, communicate through a protected channel, and escalate outside the management line implicated by the complaint. Temporary measures may change schedule, supervision, contact, housing, access, or assignment without presuming the final outcome. Representation belongs to employees, contractors, temporary workers, interns, fellows, and volunteers whose labor is governed by the City.

21.4.1 — Staff Complaint Intake

Staff complaints may concern participant conduct, supervisor misconduct, role boundary collapse, safety risks, overexposure, harassment, discrimination, workload, archive misuse, record-classification pressure, donor influence, vendor issues, retaliation, public-interface harm, or the City itself. Intake must not be so narrow that staff must distort their complaint to fit a category (Morrison, 2014; Miceli et al., 2008).

Intake must allow multiple routes. A worker may not trust a direct supervisor. A clinician may need confidential professional escalation. A moderator may need urgent harm reporting. A maintenance worker may need a non-digital route. An accessibility staff member may need protected documentation.

Apply care-first triage under Section 18.6.3 to urgent staff harm before final complaint classification.

Complaint intake helps staff preserve relevant evidence without turning them into investigators. Schedules, messages, access records, incident notes, witness accounts, and system logs are secured by a qualified intake function, which also addresses

immediate safety, representation, confidentiality, and anti-retaliation. The harmed worker does not carry the entire proof burden alone.

A good intake system leaves the staff member knowing what happens next: who receives the complaint, what timeline applies, what immediate protection is available, what information is confidential, what retaliation protections exist, and how to appeal if the response fails.

Accept reports whose category is uncertain; intake helps classify the concern.

The staff recourse system also measures whether staff use the intake system. Very low use may signal trust, but it may also signal fear, confusion, or futility. Intake data must be interpreted with staff consultation, not administrative pride.

Provide language, disability, time, and non-digital access to intake.

The intake route must also protect consultation before formal accusation. Staff may need to ask whether a concern is reportable, whether they are safe, whether a boundary was crossed, whether a pattern exists, or whether an informal step would expose them to retaliation.

Complaint intake must accept both event reports and pattern reports. A single incident may be easy to name, but unfair labor burden often appears as repetition: the same participant tests boundaries, the same supervisor dismisses fatigue, the same donor creates urgency, the same vendor hides defects, the same schedule harms night staff.

21.4.2 — Staff Appeal Pathway

Appeal can challenge classification, delay, routing, conflicts, findings, or inadequate and retaliatory remedies.

Use an independent labor, professional, rights, audit, or governance route suited to the grounds of appeal (International Labour Organization, 2019b; International Labour Organization, 2022c).

Extend the representation and access guarantees in Section 21.4 to every appellant, including temporary and contracted workers.

Appeal timelines must distinguish urgent action, careful investigation, and interim protection. State when immediate measures are available; delay can become retaliation while a worker remains in the harmful environment.

Appeal records are protected and auditable. Oversight receives enough information to detect patterns, delay, bias, or retaliation, while complainants and affected persons are shielded from unnecessary public exposure. Category summaries usually serve public accountability better than raw personnel files.

An appeal can strengthen a decision by affirming it as well as by changing it. The test is whether an independent reviewer addresses the grounds raised and explains why the evidence warrants affirmation, narrowing, reversal, or further fact-finding. The City should examine access, elapsed time, reasons, and implementation together. Sampling unappealed decisions can reveal errors that people lacked the resources to challenge; a target reversal rate would instead reward the appearance of correction.

Appeal must include the right to challenge remedies that solve the institution’s problem but not the staff member’s burden. Moving a worker away from harm may help, but if it damages their role, pay, dignity, or future opportunities while leaving the harmful structure intact, the remedy is incomplete.

The appeal pathway must also detect patterns across cases. A single appeal may appear minor; several similar appeals may

reveal a role, supervisor, vendor, participant, or policy that repeatedly creates burden.

Prevent procedural exhaustion: reuse protected evidence where appropriate so workers need not repeatedly recount traumatic facts or chase an opaque file. Apply the representation, access, and timing requirements already stated.

Appeal must not be controlled by the same person, team, donor, vendor, or participant relationship that produced the problem. Independence does not always require an external tribunal, but it requires distance, disclosure of conflicts, and a path beyond the local hierarchy. Staff must know who reviews the appeal, what authority that reviewer has, what remedy is available, and how protected information will be handled during the appeal.

21.4.3 — Anti-Retaliation Rule

The anti-retaliation rule says staff may not be punished, threatened, marginalized, reassigned harmfully, denied opportunities, overloaded, publicly smeared, privately isolated, or informally disciplined because they reported harm, supported a complaint, refused an unsafe role, or disclosed institutional drift through protected channels.

Retaliation can be disguised as ordinary management. It may appear as schedule changes, social exclusion, removal from important work, negative performance notes, sudden scrutiny, denial of advancement, loss of access, changed duties, public insinuation, or quiet reputation damage. The City must define retaliation broadly enough to catch the forms institutions actually use (Detert and Burris, 2007; Near and Miceli, 1985).

Anti-retaliation protection must cover complainants, witnesses, and supporters. Staff who corroborate a complaint, help another worker file, document events, preserve evidence,

translate a concern, or refuse retaliation or a cover-up can become targets.

Continue anti-retaliation monitoring after formal resolution.

Retaliation penalties must be real enough to change leadership behavior.

Include denied training, immigration or contractor pressure, bad references, mockery, moral accusation, and mission-shaming in retaliation review.

Anti-retaliation review must therefore include a look-back and look-forward window. Reviewers must examine what happened before the complaint, what changed after it, who gained from the silence, who controlled assignments, and whether apparently neutral changes created burden. The aim is not to freeze all management decisions. It is to ensure that management cannot punish truth under the language of performance, fit, culture, budget, or reorganization.

21.4.4 — Labor Standards

Complaint systems fail when formal voice exists but practical retaliation remains. Research on employee voice and whistleblowing shows that workers weigh the likelihood of futility, isolation, career harm, and managerial reprisal before speaking. International labor standards likewise treat violence, harassment, and retaliation as organizational responsibilities rather than private resilience tests. The City should therefore provide multiple intake routes, temporary protections, independent review, reasoned outcomes, remedy, and evidence that the complaint changed practice when substantiated (Morrison, 2014; Miceli et al., 2008; International Labour Organization, 2019b; International Labour Organization, 2022c).

Labor standards begin with anti-avoidance. Core protections attach to work performed for the City, not merely to a payroll

category. Direct employees, agency workers, contractors, subcontractors, temporary staff, and platform-mediated workers must receive role-appropriate pay, safety, scheduling, complaint, representation, and remedy protections.

The City needs worker representation that staff choose rather than leadership appoints. Depending on jurisdiction, that may include unions, works councils, elected staff committees, or other independent bodies. Freedom of association, protection against anti-union discrimination, and collective bargaining are baseline labor rights, not optional signs of institutional maturity (International Labour Organization, 1948; International Labour Organization, 1949; ILO, 1971). A management-created staff council may supplement those rights, but it cannot displace independent representation.

Compensation follows actual burden rather than symbolic proximity to participants. Trauma exposure, harassment, night work, physical strain, emergency response, high-conflict interface, intimate-record review, and professional liability receive pay, rotation, recovery, training, and support proportionate to the load. Hidden and contracted labor is included so the prestige structure cannot obscure who sustains the institution.

Make labor protections enforceable through policy, contract, budget, staffing, and procurement. Cover pay, hours, rest, safety, training, accommodation, representation, grievance, professional scope, and recovery (International Labour Organization, 1948; International Labour Organization, 1949).

Procurement must carry labor standards through the full delivery chain. Bids and contracts should disclose subcontracting, applicable wage and safety rules, worker-representation channels, grievance access, audit rights, remediation duties, and termination triggers for unresolved

harm. Worker interviews and complaint outcomes matter alongside vendor certifications (International Labour Organization, 2023).

Audit labor protections against each role’s specific exposure and competence requirements under Section 21.6.

The staff recourse system avoids the language of heroic availability. Staff must not be expected to be endlessly reachable because the mission is historic. On-call systems, emergency coverage, after-hours contact, and crisis response must be designed so that urgency is carried by the institution, not by informal devotion.

Applicants and participants should receive a plain-language labor summary before activation. It should identify who performs essential work, which protections and representation routes apply, how concerns reach independent review, and where aggregate labor conditions are publicly reported. The purpose is not to turn staff into instructional material. It is to make clear that formation will not rest on invisible exploitation and that participants share a duty not to demand it.

Professional development and exit dignity protect staff futures. Workers need paid training, transferable credentials where lawful, access to records of service, notice of role change, fair severance or transition support where applicable, and a route to preserve professional reputation after departure.

Workers need both clear information about their rights and support in exercising them. Staff receive accessible notices, translated and disability-accessible formats, named complaint and appeal routes, and protected time to consult a union, chosen representative, lawyer, or other adviser. Plain language complements representation; it does not replace it.

Contractor parity requires verification and remedy, not only contract language. The City should sample payroll and

scheduling evidence where lawful, review safety and grievance outcomes, consult workers without management present, track remediation deadlines, and suspend or terminate relationships that preserve essential service by exporting prohibited burden. Aggregate findings should enter public assurance without exposing individual workers.

Provide safe work routes and a protected process for refusing unsafe work.

21.4.5 — Whistleblower Protection

Whistleblower protection covers drift before scandal: quiet overlogging, donor pressure, coercive mentoring, degraded archive controls, unsafe staffing, discriminatory scheduling, retaliation disguised as culture fit, and normalized unpaid labor. Reporting early institutional change is part of public protection, not merely a workplace complaint.

A credible route provides an outside recipient, preserved evidence, anti-retaliation follow-up, lawful confidentiality, status updates, and remedy. It also protects workers who describe confusion, overwork, fear, unfairness, unsafe practice, or pressure without using the word whistleblower.

Workers may use a lawful independent or external reporting route without first exhausting an implicated management chain; the City must explain any jurisdiction-specific duties and protect against retaliation.

Investigate alleged false or malicious reports on evidence; good-faith error or an unsubstantiated report is not itself malicious disclosure. Protection must not depend on institutional loyalty.

Where safe, public summaries report whistleblower categories, status, and correction without exposing people. Protection also

covers refusal to falsify records, soften findings, hide staff overload, or approve unsafe releases.

When a warning becomes public, do not reveal the worker's identity or frame reporting as sabotage.

Whistleblower channels must be tested before crisis through drills or tabletop reviews for record breach, intimidation, donor pressure, clinical-boundary complaints, and staffing-ratio failure. Tests verify that staff know the route, reviewers are independent, retaliation controls work, and public explanation can occur without exposing protected people.

Escalation follows a clock. Immediate threats to health, safety, confidentiality, or legal duty trigger protection at once. Other complaints receive acknowledgment, interim measures, investigation, decision, appeal, and a completion date. Silence is not a decision; delay is justified and reviewable. The worker may escalate when the responder misses the clock, has a conflict, or controls the challenged condition.

Stop authority is role-specific. Clinicians may stop clinical-duty violations; security staff unsafe access; archivists unauthorized release; maintenance staff dangerous equipment; moderators harmful interfaces; and staff representatives credible immediate risk. Later review determines the broader remedy, but no worker must continue dangerous work to preserve continuity.

Apply the monitoring and retaliation tests in Section 21.4.3, including nonrenewal and immigration pressure. Where law permits, require the responsible decision-maker to explain adverse changes after a protected report (International Labour Organization, 2019b; International Labour Organization, 2022c).

If overload complaints produce only wellness advice, the City has individualized a structural problem. Remedy may require staffing, fewer public windows, rotation, protected breaks, reduced capture, vendor change, discipline, or shutdown.

Evidence on the health risks of long working hours reinforces the need to reduce excessive demands (Pega et al., 2021; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

21.5 — Staff Influence, Advice Logs, and Source Integrity

Formation depends on contributions from staff and public sources. This section specifies how material influence is logged and credited without exposing private support. Hidden staff influence can be mistaken for independent character. A participant may appear disciplined because staff remove difficulty.

21.5.1 — Advice Logging

Participants may appear brilliant because staff supply reasoning. They may appear humble because mentors teach the performance of humility. They may appear steady because operators shield them from overload. If the public sees only the participant, public meaning is distorted (Bowker and Star, 1999; Suchman, 1995).

Advice logging records material staff influence on participant formation. Material influence includes advice that substantially shapes a public statement, policy draft, apology, public-interface response, role-pathway decision, readiness claim, crisis handling, or record interpretation. It does not include every encouraging word, ordinary reminder, or human kindness.

Advice logs preserve the source of material reasoning or intervention so the public record does not imply unaided authorship (Bowker and Star, 1999; Suchman, 1995).

Advice logs must be concise, structured, and role-focused. They might record who gave material advice, the role in which advice was given, the topic, the category of influence, whether the participant accepted, revised, or rejected it, and whether the advice affected a public record. The log must not become a transcript of every conversation.

Advice logging must also protect sensitive domains. Clinical advice, legal counsel, protected family matters, and safety-related discussions may require special handling, protected summaries, or exclusion from public release. The City must not force sensitive professional interfaces into raw public logs.

Staff must be trained to understand the threshold for logging. If the threshold is vague, staff may overlog to protect themselves or underlog to avoid work. Clear examples help: a reminder to attend class is not material advice; rewriting a public response is. A brief encouragement is not material advice; directing a participant to conceal a weakness would be.

Disclose the relevant role and contribution under Section 21.5.4, using protected attribution where needed.

Advice logs must also distinguish suggestion, instruction, pressure, and correction. A participant who receives a suggestion remains differently situated from one who is pressured by a staff member with control over access, support, or readiness.

Advice logging must never be used to punish staff for helping. If staff fear that every material contribution will expose them to blame, they may withdraw from useful formation.

Naming staff influence does not transfer responsibility for the participant’s choice to accept, reject, or explain advice within role.

Review advice logs for repeated influence outside a staff member’s role. A single suggestion may be harmless, while a pattern can reveal a hidden curriculum, faction, dependency, or gate.

21.5.2 — Staff-Participant Dependency

Staff-participant dependency arises when access to advice, support, interpretation, or decisions becomes concentrated in one

relationship. Review the resulting leverage without presuming misconduct.

Advice and source governance distinguishes healthy reliance from dangerous dependency. Healthy reliance allows a participant to receive help, learn, recover, and make better decisions. Dangerous dependency narrows agency, creates hidden loyalty, distorts public conduct, or gives one staff member private influence beyond role. The difference may become visible only over time (Lipsky, 1980; Edmondson, 1999).

Dependency mapping must ask practical questions. Does the participant repeatedly seek one staff member before making decisions? Does a staff member control access to emotional support, public explanation, archive interpretation, or schedule relief? Does the participant fear disappointing a staff member more than facing public burden? Does the staff member shape conduct outside their role? Does the dependency affect readiness evidence?

Staff can also become dependent on participants. A staff member may identify with a participant’s success, fear a participant’s disapproval, rely on a participant for meaning, become protective beyond role, or join a participant’s public narrative. This reverse dependency can create hidden bias.

Participants should have multiple routes for advice, care, complaint, and correction so no single relationship becomes indispensable or coercive.

Material dependency triggers a proportionate response: disclosure, supervision, rotation, role separation, added support, protected consultation, or temporary reassignment. Review distinguishes healthy reliance, ordinary trust, conflict of interest, coercion, and hidden authority. Where safe, diversify support gradually rather than severing a trusted relationship abruptly.

Dependency review must include the material environment. A participant may depend on one staff member because the City has too few mentors, unclear complaint routes, inconsistent scheduling, inaccessible systems, or weak peer support.

Dependency review must be especially careful when a participant approaches office or campaign release. As stakes rise, a trusted staff relationship can become a hidden channel for shaping public conduct at the precise moment public interpretation matters most.

Dependency review must also protect staff from being emotionally drafted into a participant's future. A participant under strain may ask a mentor, clinician, educator, security worker, or operator to become rescuer, advocate, confidant, scheduler, interpreter, and witness at once. The City must not let care turn into unlimited personal obligation.

21.5.3 — Informal Power Review

Informal power is authority without title. In the City, informal power may appear through charisma, trust, longevity, technical knowledge, access to leadership, control of scheduling, familiarity with record systems, emotional influence, institutional memory, or proximity to participants.

Informal power review asks who must be pleased for the City to function, who can delay a complaint, soften a record, shape a public bundle, influence a participant, route a visitor, approve a repair, or define a crisis, and where people go when formal routes fail.

Informal power review may use staff surveys, participant feedback, complaint patterns, access logs, schedule analysis, advice-log review, staff interviews, and external audit. It must look for concentration, dependency, role creep, retaliation risk, and hidden veto points.

Language review also matters. Phrases such as 'that is how we do things here' or 'leadership will not like that' can reveal informal governance.

Avoidance mapping asks whom people avoid. A role that staff or participants fear crossing may hold more authority than the formal chart admits.

Systemic accountability also protects staff from scapegoating for informal influence that leadership tolerated. If a mentor, operator, scheduler, or security lead becomes a hidden gatekeeper, responsibility belongs not only to the individual but also to the system that lacked rotation, oversight, documentation, and challenge.

The person who can call the director at night, bypass ordinary queues, secure exceptions, or quietly frame a participant to reviewers may become a gatekeeper even without title. The City must require disclosure of repeated exception channels.

Advice and source governance reviews informal power after successes as well as failures. A beloved workflow, charismatic mentor, efficient operator, or trusted security lead can become hidden power precisely because everyone is grateful.

21.5.4 — Source Attribution

Participants learn from educators, mentors, staff, experts, critics, community reports, archival material, public submissions, legal counsel, scientific review, and lived testimony. When those sources materially shape a public output, the record must not imply solitary authorship.

Attribution must be proportional and safe. Some sources may require protected handling. Legal counsel may be privileged. Clinical care is protected. Public contributors may need anonymity. Staff may be named by role rather than personal identity.

Source attribution distributes accountability without transferring authority. Naming an expert or staff contribution shows who influenced the work, yet the expert does not decide and the helper does not own the participant's judgment.

Apply the same materiality standard to citizen reports, staff corrections, affected-person testimony, and formal expertise; non-elite contributions must not disappear from attribution.

Source attribution must include the dignity of affected persons. A policy correction shaped by a harmed person’s testimony must not be absorbed into the participant’s growth story without acknowledging the burden that testimony carried.

Source attribution protects contributors as well as intellectual honesty. Public authorship, internal contribution, protected staff note, anonymous safety warning, and institutional synthesis receive different labels and exposure rules. Staff can be credited where appropriate without being forced into fame, harassment, or a public identity they did not choose.

Source attribution must also protect against intellectual capture by outside networks. Staff may bring ideas from universities, nonprofits, agencies, firms, unions, movements, religious communities, or technical communities. That is healthy when disclosed and interpreted. It becomes capture when outside frameworks quietly determine City practice without attribution, review, or contestability.

21.5.5 — Overlogging Limit

The overlogging limit protects the City from drowning staff in documentation. A City terrified of hidden influence may try to log every conversation, reminder, glance, suggestion, and mood.

Excess minor entries can bury material influence, encourage defensive logging, and waste audit attention; test whether the

record improves understanding rather than merely increasing detail (Lipsky, 1980; Edmondson, 1999).

There must be a way to audit underlogging without mandating overlogging. Pattern review, targeted sampling, complaint-triggered review, access logs, and external audit can detect hidden influence.

The overlogging limit must be itself audited. If staff report that logs are consuming care time, teaching time, maintenance time, or recovery time, the City must revise the logging practice.

Overlogging can also become a security risk. Vast unnecessary logs create more material to breach, misuse, misread, or weaponize.

Teach the materiality boundary through the examples in Section 21.5.1 and contested cases. Compare inconsistent classifications and revise guidance when the same boundary repeatedly causes confusion.

21.6 — Staffing Ratios, Workload, Burnout, Hidden Cost

Staffing is an ethical parameter because chronic overload changes what an institution can notice, prevent, and repair. The job-demands-resources model, burnout research, and studies of staffing-sensitive outcomes show that workload interacts with control, support, recovery, skill mix, and organizational culture. A hidden-cost audit should therefore include overtime, turnover, errors, moral distress, moderation exposure, emotional labor, delayed maintenance, family spillover, and the work transferred to contractors (Demerouti et al., 2001; Maslach and Leiter, 2016; National Research Council, 2004; Pega et al., 2021). Coverage plans should show whether protected breaks and supervision remain available during periods of peak demand.

21.6.1 — Staffing Ratios

Staffing ratios are the practical answer to the question: how many human beings does a safeguard require? The City may need participant-to-clinician ratios, participant-to-mentor ratios, moderator-to-public-interface ratios, archivist-to-record-volume ratios, maintenance-to-space ratios, security-to-perimeter and event ratios, accessibility-support ratios, and complaint-handler ratios. Each ratio must be tied to actual burden.

A ratio must not be copied from ordinary institutions without caution. The Transparent City carries unusual record, public-interface, care, and nonparticipant-protection burdens. A standard residential staffing model may undercount archive work. A standard educational staffing model may undercount emotional labor. A standard security model may overemphasize control and underemphasize de-escalation. The City needs ratios built from its own burden register.

Staffing ratios must include reserve capacity for illness, turnover, emergencies, family leave, training, audit, public controversy, and crisis.

Ratios must also be reviewed across roles. Understaffing one domain often shifts burden into another. If archive staff are too few, operators may pressure them to rush. If clinicians are too few, mentors may become informal therapists. If moderators are too few, security may face more public anger.

Workers can challenge staffing assumptions through the workload review in Section 21.6.2.

Expansion must pause when the proposed participant numbers cannot be supported within the required staffing ratios and qualified capacity for clinical care, moderation, archiving, maintenance, complaint handling, or the public interface.

Define baseline and surge ratios, protected minimums, maximum caseloads, and stop rules for demand changes or lost capacity.

Staffing ratios are linked to stop authority. Unsafe archive coverage slows release; inadequate clinical coverage pauses high-strain programming; collapsed moderation capacity narrows public interfaces; and security shortages require revised visitor access so that force or intimidation does not substitute for adequate staffing.

Staffing ratios include competence, language, timing, supervision, and professional boundaries as well as headcount. A larger number of untrained workers cannot replace qualified clinical, archival, accessibility, security, or de-escalation capacity. The ratio therefore states which skills must be available at which times and what operations narrow when the required mix is missing.

The staffed-capacity denominator prevents misleading ratios. Public reports must distinguish authorized positions, filled

positions, qualified and available workers, contractors, trainees, people on leave, and hours protected for training, debrief, representation, and recovery. A nominal headcount cannot be treated as usable capacity. Expansion gates rely on the qualified capacity actually available for the work, not the number printed in an organizational chart.

21.6.2 — Workload Monitoring

Workload monitoring is privacy-aware. Aggregate measures, role-level patterns, time-use review, incident categories, de-identified trends where appropriate, and worker-controlled narrative channels are preferred over constant individual surveillance. Evidence collection is justified when it reduces psychosocial risk and produces remedy, not when it merely gives management more ways to watch tired people (ISO, 2021b; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

A credible workload register records not only completed work but work deliberately deferred to protect capacity. Cancelled public-interface hours, delayed archive release, postponed visitor access, narrowed programming, and paused operations may look inefficient from outside; they may also show that the City refused to purchase a public benefit with an unfair staff cost (Maslach and Leiter, 2016; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

Workload monitoring tracks whether the City is placing more burden on staff than the official design admits. It must include hours, intensity, emotional exposure, record sensitivity, public-interface volume, complaint load, crisis events, overtime, on-call frequency, recovery time, and the amount of hidden coordination required to make formal systems work.

Workload governance distinguishes routine load from high-strain load. Reviewing a public schedule is different from reviewing intimate material. Moderating ordinary questions is different from moderating harassment after a public controversy. Cleaning an ordinary room is different from cleaning after a crisis. Workload monitoring must include category weights so intensity is not flattened.

Workers can challenge a dashboard that describes an unsafe role as sustainable. Quantitative signals are read with staff accounts, complaint data, turnover, sick leave, errors, and external audit, so no single measure becomes sovereign over lived workload.

Threshold breaches require an owned response: add qualified capacity, reduce demand, defer discretionary activity, or narrow or pause operations.

Monitoring must also track work displaced to unofficial channels. If after-hours messages, informal favors, or work on personal devices keep systems moving but are omitted from the account, the official record understates workload.

The monitoring system must also include positive capacity indicators. Time for training, repair, reflection, peer consultation, and careful review shows whether staff are merely surviving the City or actually able to carry it well.

Backlog is burden stored in time, and its measurement needs a consistent boundary. For a stable process with finite long-run averages, the average caseload equals the arrival rate multiplied by mean time from receipt to recorded exit (Little, 1961). In an invented example, twelve cases arrive each week and sixty are present on average, including both queued and active work. The implied mean time in the system is five weeks. This long-run average is not a deadline guarantee, an estimate of the longest

waits, or a forecast obtained by dividing today's queue by nominal staffing.

Use the same case boundary for all three quantities. An internal transfer is not a new arrival, and withdrawal is a distinct exit outcome, not completed remedy. Finite reporting windows must account for cases already present at the start and still present at the end. Report case age and urgent-response performance alongside the averages. When delay is excessive, test additional qualified coverage, less rework, or reduced discretionary activity; do not improve the display by refusing complaints or closing unresolved work. The measure makes the cost of waiting inspectable without making throughput the purpose of review.

A department cannot be the only judge of whether its workload is safe, especially when leadership pressure, budget limits, and public deadlines are present. Independent review may be internal or external depending on the issue, but it must be able to recommend slowing or stopping work without being treated as disloyal.

21.6.3 — Burnout Response

Burnout response begins with the admission that burnout is not simply personal weakness. In the City, it may result from intense public-interface work, constant record responsibility, emotional support, hostile moderation, crisis care, role ambiguity, inadequate staffing, moral pressure, or the weight of protecting a project others treat as historic. The cause is often structural, which means the first response must examine work design, control, support, staffing, recovery, and psychosocial risk rather than merely coaching the exhausted worker (Maslach and Leiter, 2016; ISO, 2021b; World Health Organization, 2019a; World

Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

Workload governance should respond early to reported exhaustion, withdrawal from work, reduced effectiveness, and sustained overload. WHO treats burnout as an occupational phenomenon associated with unmanaged chronic workplace stress, not a medical diagnosis (World Health Organization, 2019a). Irritability, sleep difficulty, errors, or departure can have many causes; they should prompt a confidential offer of support and review of workload, staffing, control, and recovery, not a managerial diagnosis or a readiness inference.

Burnout response must include immediate relief where needed. A moderator exposed to repeated harassment may need rotation. An archivist handling sensitive child or intimate material may need debrief and reduced load. A security worker after a serious incident may need care and time. A clinician carrying too many crises may need case reduction. Relief must not be framed as failure.

Recurring burnout or overload in a role triggers investigation of work design and competing explanations. Examine whether controversy protocols, staffing, or new technology changed exposure or recovery; a cluster warrants review, not an automatic causal finding.

Use the independent staff-care and minimum-information bridges in Section 21.3.2; seek support without creating a general performance or health profile.

Burnout response must not wait for individual disclosure alone. Some staff will hide exhaustion out of pride, fear, or loyalty. The City must detect structural signals before asking depleted people to self-diagnose publicly or privately. When the pattern is structural, individual leave is insufficient. Use the

workload and hidden-cost review to change the demand, staffing, workflow, or practice that produces it.

21.6.4 — Rotation and Recovery

Rotation prevents competence from becoming a sentence. High-strain work often accumulates around the people most able to carry it, until reliability is rewarded with uninterrupted exposure. Each role therefore needs a declared load unit, exposure ceiling, backup role, and review clock before the worker reaches crisis. The institution must plan to release capable people from difficult work rather than discover too late that no one else was prepared.

Role-specific rotation cannot follow one universal schedule. Operators may need relief after event pressure; maintenance workers after an emergency call. Across roles, the relevant demand, recovery interval, competence requirement, and continuity risk differ. Job-demand and resource evidence supports designing those limits prospectively (Demerouti et al., 2001; Bakker and Demerouti, 2007).

Recovery includes more than absence from the shift. It may require debrief, peer or clinical support, reduced exposure, schedule repair, training reset, protected sleep, time with family, and a return pathway that does not convert treatment into identity. A worker should not have to prove collapse before receiving it. Recovery is a routine operating cost.

Cross-training supports rotation only when competence and refusal remain intact. Backup staff need supervised preparation, defined authority, access limits, and a route to decline work outside qualification. Thin staffing cannot turn moderators into clinicians, operators into archivists, or security workers into counselors.

A protected handoff carries the information needed for continuity without transferring private health details or informal gossip. The handoff states the open task, risk, decision owner, next review time, affected-person needs, and any restricted context available to the authorized successor. Overlap time is paid and scheduled. The person taking recovery is not required to remain unofficially on call for the replacement.

Public accountability belongs at category level. The City can report that recovery is funded, rotation occurred, overtime was corrected, backup coverage exists, and a high-strain practice changed without revealing an individual's diagnosis, treatment, family burden, or complaint.

Expertise should remain available without keeping the expert inside the exposure. Debrief records, peer teaching, advisory periods, documented decision rationales, and limited consultation can preserve learning after rotation. The default is that the successor owns the active role. Consultation cannot become a permanent shadow shift that prevents the former role-holder from recovering.

Culture is tested through consequences. Reviewers examine whether workers who use recovery lose desirable assignments, promotion, income, professional trust, housing, schedule control, or access to leadership. They also examine which forms of endurance receive praise.

Recovery time is protected from mission creep by an enforceable contact rule. Only a narrowly defined emergency authority may interrupt it, and every interruption is logged, compensated, reviewed, and counted against the recovery plan. Routine messages, monitoring, advice to replacements, and informal checking are prohibited.

Return is role-focused and nonpunitive. The worker receives a clear assignment, workload, supervision plan, and opportunity to

challenge conditions without being treated as fragile, suspect, or less committed. Recovery history may not become an informal eligibility score.

A handoff is complete when the receiving role can use the transferred responsibility. In a prospective before-and-after study at nine hospitals, Starmer et al. (2014) found that a structured handoff program was associated with fewer medical errors and preventable adverse events. The intervention combined standardized communication with training and implementation support; the study does not isolate one phrase or establish an effect for the City. It offers a concrete reason to test the quality of a handoff rather than count messages sent.

In a fictional City exercise, the receiving archivist should explain the pending correction in their own words, identify the authoritative version, and state the next action and the condition requiring escalation. The sender checks this account before transferring the task. The receiver must also have the permission, skill, and time to act; an acknowledgment without those conditions does not establish continuity. Test later completion and mistaken interpretation against a concise written-handoff comparator, holding staffing and case difficulty comparable. Use scheduled, paid overlap and task-relevant information only. The transfer releases the outgoing worker from routine responsibility; repeated interruptions of recovery require more capacity or less activity, not continued unpaid availability.

Rotation respects expertise, relational continuity, disability, worker preference, and the different risks of each role while preventing indefinite exposure.

21.6.5 — Hidden-Cost Audit

Worker representation co-owns the hidden-cost audit. Staff can challenge categories, add burden routes, contest findings, and

request re-audit when official measures miss lived conditions. The audit includes contractors, temporary workers, vendors, interns, fellows, volunteers, and remote workers. Hidden cost often migrates to the least protected edge of an institution. If permanent staff appear healthy because risk has been shifted into contract moderation, gig transport, outsourced cleaning, unpaid translation, volunteer crisis support, or vendor technical teams, the City has externalized rather than solved the burden problem (ISO, 2021b; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

In a fictional case, a two-hour public forum required more than twenty staff-hours across moderation, translation, security, accessibility, recording, redaction, transport, and cleanup. Several workers missed breaks, one moderator reviewed abusive material late into the night, and the official event report counted only the public duration. A staff representative files a protected burden report and asks the City to pause expansion of the forum schedule.

The pause triggers anti-retaliation protection and an audit co-owned by worker representatives. Reviewers reconstruct the whole burden chain from schedules, paid time, incident logs, staffing plans, vendor work, protected narratives, and deferred tasks. They do not solve invisibility by imposing constant surveillance on individual workers. The question is which design choices created load, which roles lacked control or recovery, and where silence may reflect fear rather than success (International Labour Organization, 2019b; ISO, 2021b).

The audit finds the forum underpriced in time and labor. Vendor terms omit moderation recovery, schedules assume unpaid handoff, and release deadlines erase meal and rest protections. Correction changes staffing ratios, paid preparation and recovery, rotation, vendor duties, public-window frequency,

and the authority to close an interface when capacity is exhausted (Pega et al., 2021; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

The public summary names the event, underestimated burden, responsible offices, corrective budget, timetable, and re-audit date without exposing health or complaint details. Workers receive pay correction, protected recovery, representation, and a route to challenge the remedy. The forum resumes only when its labor can be carried without hidden depletion.

Replication packets disclose preparation, service, moderation, translation, accessibility, security, recording, redaction, cleanup, recovery, vendor work, complaints, and risk. Attendance is not success; safeguards travel only with staffing, pay, recovery, representation, and stop authority.

Compare promised staffing with actual paid hours, recovery, and displaced work. Re-audit the changed schedule and costs against the conditions that produced the finding, rather than confirming only that a new policy exists. The audit must be able to stop a favored practice.

Every remedy has an owner, budget, deadline, appeal route, and recheck date. Closure requires changed burdens, not a report. Distinguish temporary surges from recurring baseline understaffing so chronic depletion is not reported as a sequence of exceptions.

If the burden reappears under another vendor, role label, or workflow, retain the prior finding as a recurrence rather than resetting it as a new problem.

Part VI — Formation and Public Readiness

Public readiness begins when the City turns rooms, records, routines, and rights into a disciplined practice of judgment. Part VI asks what those structures can teach before a person seeks authority over the public. Its practical test is whether formation can deepen knowledge, expose burden, welcome opposition, record correction, and preserve uncertainty without reducing readiness to appearance.

Through the book's fairness question, education is measured by the burdens it prevents or reveals. A future officeholder's missing knowledge is eventually paid for in time, rights, safety, public money, staff exhaustion, or delayed remedy. Prestige, polished speech, flattering rooms, easy simulations, and campaign persona can conceal those costs until authority has already been granted. Formation earns its place by making consequential gaps visible while they can still be repaired.

Part VI gives civic formation a clear scope. The City may teach adults to locate authority, trace administrative consequence, recognize material burden, reason across conflict, and govern data or artificial intelligence responsibly. Within the series, *The Constitution of Fairness* develops model legal architecture; *The Government of Fairness* examines administration; *The Peace of Fairness* develops material systems; *The Transition of Fairness* addresses sequencing; and *The Science of Fairness* develops scientific testing and interpretation. Applicable law and lawful institutions govern actual authority. Scientific conclusions depend on the relevant evidence and methods, not on the title of a volume. The City prepares people to consult the right discipline and records where advice changed a decision or left a question unresolved (OECD, 2019b).

Education, deliberation, opposition, simulation, readiness, and campaigns form one continuous learning arc. Curriculum meets

adversaries so it does not become fragile, and deliberative records preserve revision so they do not become propaganda. Simulations govern stress so intensity does not become harm. Readiness claims stay scoped so they do not become caste. Campaigns carry formation history forward so the City does not become a prestige machine. The Part shows how these functions can strengthen one another before office begins.

An anti-monopoly rule runs through the educational arc. Universities, civil-service systems, parties, professions, local service, journalism, community organizing, diplomatic and military colleges, public administration, and lived experience all remain legitimate sources of formation. The City offers one bounded route whose unusual contribution is an inspectable history of learning under the Vow.

Campaigns form the final movement because they are where formation evidence enters democratic contest. Moving evidence upstream can reduce the impossible burden placed on a short campaign season, yet it leaves elections and public judgment fully alive. Voters, journalists, parties, institutions, opponents, and lawful officials remain free to interpret, challenge, discount, or reject the record. The City offers a deeper object of interpretation and no commanded verdict.

Chapter 22 — Education for Office

Public office concentrates consequence. A short directive can alter a benefits queue, policing priority, procurement market, school rule, border practice, public-health message, or appeal route. Education for office begins by tracing how knowledge travels into those outcomes. Its value appears when a participant can see the burden path before a decision hardens into law, administration, cost, or harm.

The City's educational layer works beside universities, professional licensing bodies, party schools, military and diplomatic colleges, civil-service academies, and workplace formation. Each retains the standing it lawfully controls. The City's narrower contribution is preparation for visible public-power formation under the Vow. Its record follows how knowledge, burden tracing, judgment, opposition, and correction develop across time.

Transfer is the hardest educational claim. A participant may reason well in a seminar and fail under institutional pressure. They may understand a procurement rule and still favor a familiar vendor. They may explain data uncertainty and later repeat a convenient headline. The City must therefore seek evidence across time and context, while acknowledging that no curriculum can guarantee future conduct in office.

The chapter proceeds through six distinct domains. It begins with the institutional design of learning beyond credentialism, then turns to law and public reason, economics and administration, diplomacy and conflict, systems and ethical craft, and finally media, data, Artificial Intelligence, and public interpretation. Each Section names what must be learned, how learning may occur, who must teach, how assessment remains limited, and what the City must defer.

The chapter's governing object is a public-task learning portfolio, not a grade, personality profile, or civic seal. Each

entry links the task and lawful authority; sources, assumptions, and alternatives; people, access conditions, and burden routes; the decision, implementation chain, and remedies; and criticism, revisions, disputes, limits, and expiry. A benefits redesign, for example, follows a statutory entitlement through form design, data fields, staff queues, vendor dependencies, notices, appeals, and lived consequence. Professional standards may inform competency design, but the City cannot accredit, license, or certify a person for office (NASPAA, 2024; OECD, 2019b; Burtscher et al., 2024).

Review remains plural because no observer sees the whole task. Domain experts identify technical error; front-line workers expose implementation burden; affected people identify omitted consequences; accessibility reviewers test barriers; peers test explanation and dissent; and the participant may answer, contextualize, or appeal. Those views remain separately attributed so disagreement is not hidden behind numerical authority (Edmondson, 1999; Bovens, 2007; Bowker and Star, 1999).

Curriculum governance is itself a public-task lesson. Every module needs a named owner, version date, source status, jurisdictional scope, accessibility review, expert-review route, and retirement condition. Outside teachers and critics should be able to challenge a module without being absorbed into the City’s identity. When law, technology, evidence, or public practice changes, the curriculum should show what changed and why (OECD, 2023; ISO, 2016a; Gerson, 2020).

22.1 — Office Needs Formation Beyond Credentialism

A serious City needs an admissions-to-learning architecture rather than a prestige filter. It must identify what prior knowledge is necessary, what can be learned inside the City, what requires outside licensure, what evidence may be accepted as equivalent, and what support allows people from different educational histories to participate. The standard must be demanding because public consequence is demanding, not because elite culture must be preserved. Equivalency decisions should be specific enough for a rejected applicant to identify a capability that remains unproven.

22.1.1 — Credentials Are Insufficient

Credentials are useful when their meaning is kept exact. A professional license can establish that a person met a jurisdiction's requirements for a regulated practice. A degree can show sustained exposure to a discipline. A certification can show that a defined body has assessed a defined competency. Trouble begins when these limited facts are enlarged into assumptions about judgment, integrity, courage, empathy, or fitness for public authority (NASPAA, 2024; OECD, 2019b; Gerson, 2020).

Every pathway requires a credential-purpose map. The map would identify which credentials are legally required, which are useful background, which can be satisfied through equivalent evidence, and which must carry no weight. It must also record who decided the requirement, what public burden the requirement addresses, and when the requirement will be reviewed.

Equivalent evidence matters because formal opportunity is uneven. A participant may have deep municipal experience without an elite degree, extensive community mediation without

a diplomatic title, or strong budget practice without having worked in a prestigious ministry. Structured work samples, documented practice, supervised trials, prior public records, and oral defense may reveal role-relevant knowledge that institutional pedigree misses. Equivalence does not mean vagueness; it means stating the function and testing it directly.

One useful exercise is a partially blinded portfolio review. Reviewers first examine selected work without school, employer, family, donor, or political-network identifiers, then review the full context after making provisional judgments. The comparison can reveal where prestige changed interpretation. It will not remove bias by itself, but it makes the institution’s own shortcuts more visible.

Credential evidence also ages. A qualification earned years earlier may remain legally valid while the field, technology, law, or public burden has changed. The City must therefore distinguish enduring foundations from knowledge that requires refresh, and it must ask for current practice where the role makes currency important. Review must never become a demand for endless expensive certification, but neither must an old badge shield a participant from demonstrating present competence.

The institution’s own name can become a laundering device for prestige. Ceremonial language, exclusive symbols, selective alumni stories, and vague claims of completion could quickly turn a curriculum record into a social seal. Public materials therefore describe what was studied, which evidence was produced, what remained unresolved, and where the record’s authority ends. Completion means a documented course of formation, not civic certification.

Apply the disparate-burden review in Section 14.5.5 to credentials: test necessity, less exclusionary routes, and support that preserves essential role demands.

Validity evidence must follow the use rather than the prestige of the issuer. A credential that predicts success in one profession may say little about public reasoning, coalition work, administrative judgment, or response to correction. The City must periodically compare credential requirements with later educational performance and remove requirements that add exclusion without adding useful information. This is not a promise that every pathway can be entered through experience alone.

22.1.2 — Elite Fluency Risk

Elite fluency is the ability to move comfortably through the language, pace, manners, references, and emotional conventions of powerful institutions. It can be learned through education, family background, professional exposure, or repeated access to high-status rooms. It may help a person communicate in office. It may also cause reviewers to mistake familiarity for competence and discomfort for incapacity (Gerson, 2020; Schön, 1983).

Language is one route of distortion. Accent, dialect, vocabulary, grammatical convention, and speed can change how authority is perceived even when the underlying reasoning is equally strong. The City must distinguish the communication requirements of the role from preferences inherited from elite schooling. Where public explanation requires a widely used language, the curriculum can support learning without treating first-language difference as a deficit of mind.

Demeanor creates a second route. Quick answers, steady eye contact, restrained emotion, confident posture, and ease with adversarial questioning are often rewarded. Yet these traits can reflect rehearsal, culture, disability, trauma history, or comfort with institutions rather than public judgment. Some roles require

rapid communication under pressure, but the task must be designed to measure that function directly rather than rewarding a generalized performance of command.

Course design must offer multiple forms of participation while preserving shared standards. Participants may demonstrate understanding through written analysis, oral explanation, visual mapping, supported presentation, collaborative problem solving, or staged practice when the chosen form does not alter the public function being assessed. Accessibility and reasonable accommodation are rights and validity conditions, not favors added after a task fails (CAST, 2024; United Nations, 2006). Disability expertise and individual consultation remain necessary because no general framework can predict every learner's access needs or every role's essential functions.

Assessment must separate substance, communication, and support. A reviewer may conclude that the reasoning is strong, the public explanation needs development, and a language or accessibility support plan is appropriate. Structured criteria, independent review, and the participant’s access to reasons make the distinction more durable.

Faculty composition matters because institutions normalize the fluency they already possess. Instructors and assessors must include varied regional, linguistic, professional, class, disability, and educational experience. Aggregate review must examine who is praised as articulate, who receives repeated communication remediation, whose ideas are adopted without credit, and whose appeals reveal that style was mistaken for deficiency.

Apply Section 14.2.4 when assessment conditions need accommodation; document how the format preserves the essential task without requiring public disclosure of protected information.

22.1.3 — Public Consequence Requires Formation

Field-based learning connects coursework to service delivery. Participants must observe service pathways, speak with front-line staff, examine complaint and appeal files in protected form, study implementation failures, and trace how law becomes routine. They must encounter waiting, paperwork, translation gaps, inaccessible interfaces, staffing shortages, vendor constraints, and the emotional labor of public contact.

A public-consequence map can make the exercise precise. The participant identifies the formal decision, implementing bodies, staff tasks, resource assumptions, affected groups, likely delays, data dependencies, complaint routes, and foreseeable spillovers. The map must include people who are usually treated as background, such as caregivers, interpreters, contractors, maintenance workers, and family members. It must also identify where the participant lacks evidence (Kolb, 1984; Bransford et al., 2000).

A field-contact agreement should specify the task, what may be observed, who may decline, how contributors are compensated where appropriate, and which records remain protected. Before the participant's account enters the portfolio, contributors receive a safe route to correct misrepresentation without having to endorse the proposed policy. The agreement ends with a disposition of notes and a contact for later correction.

Affected-person feedback reveals burden; it is not a popularity grade. One service user may expose a barrier the participant missed, while another may disagree with the policy itself. The educational record preserves the substance of the correction, the participant’s response, and any resulting revision. Community testimony remains human evidence rather than a portable empathy score.

Evidence of transfer appears when a participant carries the lesson into a different problem. Someone who learned that digital consolidation created access barriers must later ask similar questions about automated eligibility, remote hearings, or online-only consultation. Transfer must be tested through new contexts rather than by asking the participant to repeat the original lesson. Even then, the conclusion remains provisional because office pressure can change behavior.

Community-led teaching must include the right to define the problem differently from the City. A neighborhood may reject the institution's preferred categories, a labor group may identify hidden work, and a disability organization may show that the proposed solution creates a new access burden. Participants must learn to preserve those disagreements rather than translating them into the language the curriculum already knows.

22.1.4 — Longitudinal Learning

The central artifact must be a structured learning portfolio. It may contain selected drafts, source notes, feedback, revisions, oral-defense summaries, field observations, simulations, team records, and the participant's account of what changed. The portfolio must be curated by defined rules rather than assembled to flatter. Reviewers need access to enough earlier work to understand development without exposing every classroom fragment.

Apply the warranted-correction standard in Section 13.3.1 to revision history: understand and test criticism, explain agreement or refusal, and change the work when the evidence warrants it.

Longitudinal assessment must control for changes in the assessors as well as changes in the learner. Use stable task criteria disclosed to participants in advance, multiple qualified

readers, periodic calibration, disclosed conflicts, and occasional blinded comparisons where feasible. Review whether similar work receives different interpretations across groups or over time. Preserve relevant context, such as support or changed role demands, in protected form, and give participants reasons and a route to challenge consequential judgments.

Remediation belongs in the record with careful status. Additional study, coaching, tutoring, accessibility support, supervised practice, a changed role pathway, or a reduced load may be evidence of responsible formation rather than failure. The record must identify the specific need and response without publishing sensitive support details. Delay must have review dates and a path out; otherwise remediation can become quiet exclusion.

Transfer can be taught as well as tested. Laboratory problem-solving research found that comparing two analogous examples could help learners form a reusable schema (Gick and Holyoak, 1983). A City lesson could pair a fictional procurement decision with a fictional service-allocation decision. Their subject matter differs, but both require the learner to connect a relevant interest, a disclosure, an independent check, and a reasoned decision. Learners explain which relationships carry across the cases and where the analogy stops.

Then vary a decisive fact: in one case an adviser can select the beneficiary; in the other the adviser has no such power. Learners must explain why the same response may no longer fit. A later unfamiliar exercise tests whether they can identify the controlling relationship without repeating the first solution. These are proposed instructional tasks, not evidence of an established City effect. The record can show what transferred under the tested conditions while leaving conduct in a future office to its own evidence.

Public-facing portfolios should summarize longitudinal evidence rather than expose a person’s entire learning record. A readiness bundle can show representative work, major revisions, areas of strength, unresolved limits, and responses to serious criticism. Status labels, challenge rights, and protected exclusions travel with the summary.

Preparation also appears in how a learner uses knowledge that becomes available later. In ninth-grade statistics studies, Schwartz and Martin (2004) found that an invention-based preparation condition showed an advantage over tell-and-practice on a transfer assessment containing a learning resource, while the assessment without that resource did not reveal the same advantage. Their embedded experiment distinguishes applying what one already knows from being prepared to learn something new.

A proposed City exercise gives every learner a new fictional service problem and the same accessible worked example or expert explanation. The example addresses the governing relationship without supplying the target answer. Learners explain which part of the resource applies, revise their account, and later address a different case in which one condition changes. Review asks whether the learner used the source correctly and recognized the limit of the analogy, rather than rewarding copied vocabulary. Necessary supports remain available throughout; the exercise is declared and bounded. A comparative study would allocate preparatory instruction prospectively and use common resources, assessment times, and independently scored cases, with analysis respecting group assignment. The learning claim concerns demonstrated use of new knowledge. Neither seeking qualified help nor needing an accessible resource is treated as evidence of unfitness.

22.1.5 — Curriculum as Burden Preparation

The curriculum therefore requires a public learning map. The map must not list prestige subjects; it must name the burden each subject prepares a participant to see. Constitutional literacy prepares recognition of limits. Administrative literacy prepares recognition of implementation cost. Budget literacy prepares recognition of tradeoffs. Media and data literacy prepare recognition of borrowed certainty. Artificial Intelligence literacy prepares recognition of machine limits (NASPAA, 2024; OECD, 2019b; Gerson, 2020).

The core curriculum prepares participants for the consequences of decisions they may later make. Depth will vary by field; each module must teach enough to recognize significance, ask competent questions, and seek specialized authority when required.

A three-layer design helps preserve proportion. The common core gives every participant a shared language of burden, record, rights, uncertainty, and correction. Role pathways deepen the domains relevant to likely office or function. Electives and advanced modules allow additional study without turning breadth into a status contest. Movement among layers must be possible when learning or intended service changes.

Curriculum governance must be independent enough to revise founder assumptions. A multidisciplinary body can set learning objectives, approve instructors, review sources, examine assessment patterns, hear complaints, and publish revision reasons. Membership must include field experts, educators, disability and access specialists, former participants, affected-community voices, and serious critics. No single donor, party, institution, or founding figure may control the syllabus.

Modules must distinguish primary law, official data, peer-reviewed research, professional standards, lived testimony,

investigative reporting, historical records, and contested commentary. Participants must learn what each source can establish and where it is vulnerable. Rival schools must be represented by their strongest arguments, not by summaries designed to make the preferred view win.

The curriculum register shows why a topic is present, whose expertise shaped it, what burden it addresses, and what evidence would justify changing or removing it. Address neglected schools of thought identified by external critics in the revision reasons.

Instructor authority carries its own record. Relevant expertise, material conflicts, prior advocacy, assessment role, and recusal are visible to reviewers. Academic freedom protects criticism of the City and project while duties of accuracy, non-retaliation, accessibility, and fair assessment remain active. Students receive a complaint route that does not require confronting the instructor alone.

Fund the learner supports established in Section 22.1.2 and monitor whether receiving them delays progress, limits instructor access, or stigmatizes participants.

At each module review, publish changed and retired sources, dated reasons for revision, and any contextual notice required for earlier participant records. Keep retired modules traceable to their withdrawal reasons.

22.2 — Law, Constitution, and Public Reason

Public office operates through authority, whether the officeholder acknowledges it or not. A minister signs under delegated power. A mayor acts within a charter. A regulator interprets a statute. A school board follows procedural duties.

22.2.1 — Constitutional Literacy

An emergency official may exercise temporary powers subject to review. Legal literacy helps a future officeholder distinguish moral desire, political support, administrative convenience, and lawful authority (Rawls, 1993; Habermas, 1996; Gutmann and Thompson, 1996). Use clearly labeled jurisdictional examples and require local legal translation before applying a lesson to real authority. The comparative work in Section 22.2.1 makes variation in constitutional and rights systems explicit.

Constitutional literacy begins with institutional location. Participants must be able to identify where authority comes from, which body holds it, how it is limited, what procedures activate it, and which remedies exist when it is misused (Rawls, 1993; Habermas, 1996; Gutmann and Thompson, 1996).

Comparative study helps reveal that familiar arrangements are not universal. Participants can examine how different systems allocate legislative, executive, judicial, subnational, administrative, electoral, and emergency authority. The comparison must not become a ranking of civilizations. It must show how similar public problems are managed through different histories, legal traditions, and institutional compromises.

Primary sources must carry special weight. Constitutions, statutes, regulations, judgments, official rules, treaty texts, and authoritative guidance must be read before commentary whenever feasible. Participants also need to understand

hierarchy and status: a political speech, legal article, agency manual, court decision, and constitutional provision do not carry the same authority.

A useful exercise is an authority map. Given a proposed action, the participant identifies the legal basis, decision owner, required procedure, protected rights, oversight bodies, appeal routes, and points of uncertainty. The map must include what the official cannot decide alone. It must also identify where customary law, Indigenous authority, local autonomy, international obligations, or professional regulation may alter the answer.

Participants also need to distinguish constitutional principle from institutional habit. A practice may be longstanding without being lawful, and a written guarantee may be formally strong while weakly enforced. Comparative cases therefore must examine text, interpretation, implementation, and remedy together. The participant must ask who can invoke the rule, what evidence is needed, whether delay defeats the protection, and what happens when the institution responsible for enforcement is itself implicated.

Instructors must include comparative constitutional scholars, public lawyers, administrative practitioners, and local experts who can show how law works beyond famous cases. Serious critics must test whether the curriculum treats one constitutional tradition as the default. Participants must encounter disputes over interpretation, judicial review, legislative supremacy, executive discretion, federalism, emergency power, and the relation between written law and institutional practice.

Assessment must emphasize issue recognition and disciplined routing rather than doctrinal performance. A participant may be asked to explain what legal questions arise, what sources matter, who must be consulted, and what can be said publicly while

review is pending. The reviewer must distinguish a wrong conclusion reached through careful method from a confident answer that ignores the structure entirely.

Constitutional literacy does not authorize the City to define a constitution. *The Constitution of Fairness* owns the project's model legal architecture, and real jurisdictions retain their own lawful authority. The City's practical task is to teach participants to recognize lawful limits when good intentions or public support make overreach tempting.

Interpretive disagreement must be taught through real methods rather than partisan labels. Text, structure, history, precedent, purpose, principle, institutional competence, comparative practice, and democratic legitimacy may carry different weight across traditions. Participants must be able to explain how an interpretation was reached and what rival interpretation remains serious. The City must not resolve these disputes by declaring one method synonymous with fairness. It must form people capable of recognizing when method changes the rights and burdens in a case.

22.2.2 — Rights and Limits

Rights education must begin where institutional impatience begins. Rights are often most inconvenient when officials believe the goal is urgent, humane, popular, or technically obvious. The curriculum must therefore train participants to recognize that a desirable objective does not erase notice, hearing, privacy, equality, counsel, dissent, family protection, bodily dignity, labor rights, or other lawful constraints (Gutmann and Thompson, 1996; Tyler, 2006).

The curriculum distinguishes absolute protections, qualified rights, procedural rights, statutory entitlements, policy commitments, and ethical interests. Jurisdictions classify them

differently, so City prose cannot universalize one legal taxonomy. A common discipline nevertheless remains: identify whose protected interest is at stake, what authority permits interference, which less intrusive route exists, and who can review the decision.

Rights-impact exercises must include politically unpopular or institutionally weak groups. Test the action using the method below, including notice, appeal, correction, and any sunset.

Hard cases must include emergency health measures, protest restrictions, public-record release, automated eligibility, policing, school discipline, migration decisions, security screening, and conflicts between privacy and accountability. The purpose is not to lead participants toward one predetermined answer. It is to make the structure of the conflict visible and to require reasons that can be challenged.

Proportionality must be taught as disciplined reasoning rather than a word that ends debate. Participants can identify the legitimate aim, the connection between measure and aim, less restrictive alternatives, unequal effects, duration, review, and remedy. They must also learn that some rights and protections cannot be traded away merely because a policy is popular or efficient. Equality analysis must include indirect burden, since a formally identical rule can exclude people differently. The exercise is not to discover a mathematical balance, but to make the official justify why this burden, on these people, through this measure, is lawful and necessary.

Disability and language access belong inside rights analysis rather than in a separate kindness module. A formally equal procedure may still exclude people who cannot access the notice, attend the hearing, understand the language, use the digital system, or endure the sensory environment. Participants must

learn to distinguish a genuine essential requirement from an institution's unexamined habit.

Assessment must preserve the participant's revisions after rights criticism. A proposal may become narrower, slower, more accessible, more reviewable, or less data-intensive. That change is educational evidence.

Proportionality and less-restrictive-alternative analysis must be taught where the jurisdiction uses them and clearly labeled where it does not. Even outside a formal doctrinal test, the discipline remains educationally useful. Qualified local counsel must control the legal translation.

22.2.3 — Public Reason Practice

Public reason is the craft of explaining coercive or allocative decisions to people who remain free to disagree. It does not require officials to abandon moral conviction or personal history. It requires them to distinguish private motivation from public justification and to offer reasons that can be examined without demanding prior loyalty to the speaker.

Bad explanation exports interpretive labor to everyone else. Citizens then decode jargon, infer hidden criteria, search for missing evidence, and guess which authority made the choice; staff invent reasons after the fact; journalists and courts reconstruct a path from fragments. Formation teaches participants to carry that burden before release. A clear explanation names decision, authority, reasons, evidence, uncertainty, affected people, review, and remedy.

A plural-audience exercise can test this skill. The participant explains one decision to affected residents, implementing staff, an oversight body, a skeptical journalist, a political opponent, and a person who rejects the participant's worldview. The

explanation may change in form, but not in factual content, uncertainty, rights, or responsibility.

Public reason must include alternatives and tradeoffs. A statement that presents one path as inevitable hides judgment. Participants must name the options considered, the evidence used, the burdens shifted, the people consulted, and the reasons for rejecting alternatives. Where information is protected, the explanation must state the category, authority, review route, and what can be disclosed without defeating the protection.

Oral defense should test responsiveness rather than debating style. Reviewers present the strongest objection, ask what evidence would change the conclusion, and examine whether the participant can separate criticism of a decision from an attack on the self. The Council of Europe's democratic-culture framework offers one useful orientation across knowledge, critical understanding, skills, values, and attitudes (Council of Europe, 2018a). It does not justify a checklist of approved dispositions or permit reviewers to confuse political conformity with public reason.

Written work must include revision after challenge. Participants may submit a public explanation, receive objections from people with different expertise or experience, and produce a revised explanation with a change log. The educational record must show what changed and why. Refusal to change can be legitimate when it is reasoned and evidence-based; unresponsive repetition is not. When the earlier explanation misled, identify the burden it shifted, the people owed notice, and any remedy (Lind and Tyler, 1988; Thompson, 1987).

Minority reasons deserve protection even when the final decision follows the majority. A participant must be able to preserve the strongest dissent, identify what evidence would reopen the issue, and explain why the dissent did not prevail

without caricature. The record must show that decision authority ended the process for action, not the legitimacy of continued criticism.

22.2.4 — Legal Humility

Legal humility is the ability to recognize the edge of one's authority and competence before others pay for the mistake. Public culture often rewards immediate answers, especially during crisis. The City must teach that pause, referral, narrow action, and documented uncertainty can be stronger forms of leadership than improvised certainty (Bovens, 2007; Roberts, 2006).

Participants need an authority-escalation map. The map identifies questions that can be handled through ordinary administrative judgment, questions requiring qualified counsel, questions belonging to a court or legislature, questions involving professional privilege, and questions that cannot be resolved inside the City. The exercise must include time pressure so that humility is practiced when delay feels politically costly.

Legal humility also means distinguishing moral objection from legal conclusion. An action may be lawful and still deserve political opposition. It may be ethically attractive and still lack authority. It may be urgent and still require procedure. Participants must learn to state these distinctions clearly.

A properly designed simulation can present incomplete facts, conflicting advice, and a strong incentive to act. The participant must preserve evidence, protect immediate safety where lawful, identify the decision owner, request review, and explain what remains unknown. Reviewers must value the quality of the route, not whether the participant guessed the final legal answer.

Participants must practice short status statements that separate confirmed authority, disputed interpretation, protected advice,

operational necessity, and matters awaiting review. Legal humility is the ability to act at the fastest lawful speed without converting uncertainty into hidden permission.

Assessment asks whether legal deference is selective. A participant may seek review when an answer is inconvenient and bypass it when allies support the goal.

Identify what may be done now within lawful bounds, the safeguards it requires, and the review that follows while other questions remain unresolved.

Consulting counsel is not a transfer of political responsibility. Lawyers may identify authority, risk, procedure, privilege, and plausible interpretations, but the authorized official still owns the lawful decision within their role. Legal humility means respecting professional judgment while keeping public responsibility attached to the named decision maker.

22.2.5 — Law Under Record

Law under record means that the participant's use of authority, sources, rights, and professional advice can later be reconstructed without exposing privileged content. The educational challenge is to preserve enough of the judgment path for review while respecting legal confidentiality and the distinct role of counsel (Rawls, 1993; Habermas, 1996; Gutmann and Thompson, 1996).

A bounded legal-reasoning note can separate facts, authority, legal questions, rights, procedural duties, public explanation, and unresolved issues. It must identify which portions are the participant's analysis, which reflect qualified advice, and which remain protected.

Apply the source distinctions in Section 22.2.1: cite controlling authority, jurisdiction, and whether an interpretation

is settled, contested, provisional, or dependent on facts not yet established.

Privilege and confidentiality require designed boundaries. Attorney-client communications, protected deliberation, sensitive litigation strategy, personal legal advice, and certain investigative materials may require restricted handling. The City must record that consultation occurred, who held decision authority, and what public explanation is possible without publishing the protected substance.

The public may also need to know when review will occur. The record must show where law constrained the choice and where accountable judgment remained.

If a participant misstates authority, omits a right, or relies on an outdated source, preserve the timing, reason, affected people, and repair. Propagate the correction to later summaries and readiness materials so revision cannot create an appearance of continuous correctness.

A lawful educational bundle might include a redacted reasoning note, rights-review revision and proper deferral, each labeled by status.

22.3 — Economics, Administration, and Material Order

Public decisions become real through budgets, staffing, files, contracts, buildings, schedules, and front-line discretion. A policy can be morally compelling and legally sound while remaining impossible to administer. It can also be administratively efficient while shifting hidden cost onto households, workers, disabled people, local communities, or future budgets. Education for office must therefore connect political intention with the machinery that carries it (Musgrave, 1959; Stiglitz and Rosengard, 2015; Schick, 1998).

22.3.1 — Budget Literacy

Budget literacy begins with the difference between a political promise and a funded commitment. Participants must understand revenue, expenditure, baselines, one-time and recurring costs, capital and operating budgets, reserves, debt service, contingent liabilities, fiscal risk, and the time horizon over which a decision creates obligations (Musgrave, 1959; Stiglitz and Rosengard, 2015; Schick, 1998).

The IMF Fiscal Transparency Code offers a comparative orientation toward fiscal reporting, forecasting and budgeting, fiscal risk analysis, and resource-revenue management (International Monetary Fund, 2019). It is neither a universal City curriculum nor a substitute for applicable public-finance law. Participants use it to ask why assumptions, off-budget activity, forecasts, contingent liabilities, and risk disclosures matter, then examine how the relevant jurisdiction defines, reports, and reviews them.

A practical exercise can begin with a proposal that appears popular and affordable. Participants reconstruct the baseline, identify implementation capacity, test optimistic assumptions,

map distributional effects, and produce high, middle, and low scenarios. They must include staffing, accessibility, technology, maintenance, appeals, communications, and evaluation rather than treating program cost as the headline appropriation alone.

Consider a proposed saving that closes a neighborhood office and moves applications online. The visible line may fall, while the public pays through longer bus trips, data costs, missed work, inaccessible interfaces, delayed documents, overloaded call centers, and more appeals. Staff absorb recovery work and local charities become informal service desks. A complete fiscal claim returns those displaced costs to the analysis and identifies whose money, time, risk, and administrative effort changed.

Budget assessment must combine numerical work with explanation. A participant may present a short fiscal note, defend assumptions orally, and revise after critique from finance professionals, service staff, and affected-community reviewers. The evaluator must distinguish arithmetic error, uncertainty, policy disagreement, and failure to identify a burden carrier. Those are different educational problems and require different responses.

Public explanation must resist both false precision and fiscal fog. Participants must be able to say what is known, what is estimated, what remains outside the model, who bears risk, and what evidence would trigger revision. They must not use large numbers to intimidate the public or use moral language to avoid cost.

Fiscal incidence deserves explicit attention. The person who pays a tax, receives a subsidy, loses a service, gains an asset, or bears inflation may differ from the person named in the budget line. Participants must examine direct and indirect effects, geographic distribution, intergenerational burden, and the

difference between average impact and impact on people near a material threshold.

22.3.2 — Administrative Competence

Administrative competence is the ability to understand how a decision moves through an organization. Participants must learn about mandates, delegation, staffing, workflow, records, discretion, coordination, frontline judgment, service standards, complaints, appeals, and the difference between announcing a policy and operating it (Schick, 1998; Wilson, 1989).

The OECD Recommendation on Public Service Leadership and Capability offers a comparative framework for values-driven leadership, a skilled and effective public service, and systems that support performance, learning, and adaptability (OECD, 2019b). It is guidance rather than a universal administrative constitution. The curriculum must still account for local law, labor systems, resources, institutional history, and the practical knowledge of public servants who carry implementation.

Process mapping is a central method. Participants trace one public task from entry to resolution, identifying decision points, handoffs, data requirements, staff roles, delays, discretion, failure states, and remedies. They must pay particular attention to moments when the citizen must supply information the institution already holds, repeat a story, travel unnecessarily, wait without status, or navigate conflicting instructions (Schön, 1983; Lipsky, 1980; UN DESA, 2018).

Front-line public servants must teach part of the curriculum. Use the field-contact agreement in Section 22.1.3 to compensate their contribution, protect confidential cases, and prevent retaliation or pressure to endorse the institution.

Frontline discretion deserves explicit study because rules rarely administer themselves. Staff interpret incomplete

evidence, manage queues, respond to distress, and decide when a case fits an exception. Discretion can humanize a rigid system, but it can also create inconsistency, bias, favoritism, and fear. Participants must learn how training, supervision, reason-giving, escalation, sampling, complaint review, and worker voice shape that discretion. They must also recognize when a policy is so under-resourced that frontline workers are being asked to ration rights through personal judgment.

A useful exercise is an implementation memorandum. The participant identifies authority, responsible units, staffing, training, technology, communications, accessibility, records, procurement, funding, timeline, risks, complaints, and review. The memorandum must include a stop or redesign trigger.

Assessment must test coordination and listening, not only individual analysis. Team exercises can reveal whether a participant notices missing expertise, shares credit, creates impossible deadlines, or treats staff as interchangeable capacity. Reviewers must preserve evidence of how the participant responds when implementers explain that the preferred design cannot work as written.

A useful discretion exercise follows the same incomplete application through two plausible front-line decisions. Participants identify which difference reflects lawful judgment, which reflects inconsistent guidance, and which arises from workload or missing information. They then propose supervision, reasons, escalation, and appeal that improve consistency without removing every humane exception. Responsibility remains shared between the worker's choice and the system that shaped it.

22.3.3 — Procurement Awareness

Learning must move repeatedly between numbers and lived systems. Participants may examine a budget and then trace the service it funds. They may study procurement rules and then follow a contract change that alters staffing or access. They may read performance indicators and then speak with the workers and residents whose experience is compressed into those measures.

Procurement instruction must include an influence map before it includes a contract form. Participants must identify who wrote specifications, who framed urgency, who defined technical requirements, who can answer vendor questions, who benefits from incumbency, who may appeal, and who will operate the purchased system after the announcement fades (Lipsky, 1980; Mashaw, 1983).

Procurement is where public purpose meets private capability, market structure, contract language, and long-term dependency. It is also a common route for favoritism, vendor lock-in, hidden change, weak oversight, and the transfer of public responsibility to systems the public cannot inspect.

The procurement lifecycle begins before a tender. Needs assessment, market research, specification, budgeting, choice of procedure, competition, evaluation, award, contract management, modification, delivery, payment, performance review, complaint, and exit all shape burden.

The OECD Recommendation on Public Procurement and the UNCITRAL Model Law on Public Procurement provide comparative principles for integrity, access, competition, objectivity, professional capacity, risk management, accountability, and challenge routes (OECD, 2015; United Nations Commission on International Trade Law, 2011). They do not settle local law or remove legitimate policy choices. Their educational value is to reveal the questions a lawful procurement

system must answer and why procurement expertise, contract management, vendor exit, and remedy deserve attention before an award is announced.

A contract-path exercise can reveal capture. Participants ask who defined the need and wrote the specification, then which vendors could realistically compete. They test what data or intellectual property the supplier retains, how performance is measured, and what change orders permit. They also examine renewal, termination, transition, supplier failure, and whether the public can exit without losing essential capability. The exercise must include labor conditions and subcontracting because low price can hide burden in another workforce.

Conflicts of interest require more than disclosure. Participants must distinguish personal, financial, political, advisory, familial, and post-employment interests; identify recusal and review; and consider whether the procurement design itself favors an incumbent. They must also understand that accusations of corruption require evidence.

Assessment should include a procurement briefing followed by an adversarial challenge. The participant states the public need, legal procedure, evaluation criteria, conflicts, risk allocation, contract-management plan, vendor-exit route, and complaint process. Another team answers from the position of a losing bidder, affected worker, privacy advocate, service user, or front-line implementer. The exercise tests whether the design remains defensible once people outside the award can inspect its burdens and remedies (OECD, 2015; United Nations Commission on International Trade Law, 2011).

The educational record must show whether a participant can resist two seductions: the promise that a vendor will solve institutional weakness and the belief that public ownership automatically guarantees competence. Procurement awareness is

the discipline of keeping public responsibility attached to the decision even when implementation is contracted out.

Digital and Artificial Intelligence procurement must be treated as institutional design, not as an ordinary software purchase. Evaluation must include data rights, security testing, accessibility, model change, audit access, human override, incident response, portability, and the cost of leaving the vendor. Participants must ask whether the public body retains enough knowledge to govern the system after procurement.

22.3.4 — Service Delivery Reality

The educational record must show whether participants can distinguish appropriation from capacity, output from outcome, formal access from usable access, and short-term savings from transferred cost. It must also show whether they know when specialized advice is required.

Service delivery is where the governed meet the state as a form, queue, portal, office, inspection, payment, teacher, clinic, or call. A participant who understands policy but not service delivery may underestimate the burden of delay, repetition, humiliation, inaccessible design, and unexplained discretion (OECD, 2015; Thai, 2001).

The curriculum must use service journeys with care. Participants can trace how a person seeks housing support, registers a business, appeals a benefit decision, accesses a clinic, reports a hazard, or obtains an identity document. The exercise must include non-digital access, language, disability, transportation, documentation, caregiving, work schedules, safety, and the possibility that the applicant is already exhausted.

Use the field-contact safeguards in Section 22.1.3 for service observation. Consider simulated cases, anonymized files,

community-led teaching, or voluntary observation when these meet the learning goal with less intrusion.

Participants must learn to distinguish formal entitlement from usable access. A service may exist in law while remaining unreachable because the office is distant, the portal fails, the language is unclear, the deadline is short, the queue is hidden, or the appeal is too burdensome. Usable access requires status information, reasons, human help, accessible channels, and a path when the ordinary route breaks.

Test the service as a user, a caregiver, a frontline worker, and a person whose application is wrongly rejected, including people who cannot use the preferred channel. The test must demonstrate a reachable route back after error.

Metrics must be read alongside experience. Processing time, completion rate, cost per case, error rate, and user satisfaction can reveal patterns, but each measure has limits and incentives. Faster processing may conceal rushed denial. High satisfaction may exclude people who gave up. Low cost may reflect understaffing. Participants must ask what behavior the metric rewards and who disappears from the denominator.

A service-redesign exercise can require the participant to improve one pathway while preserving rights and staff dignity. The proposal must identify workload, training, data, accessibility, technology, complaint, implementation, and evaluation. Front-line reviewers must be able to reject assumptions that create impossible work.

Service recovery is a distinct public skill. When an agency loses an application, gives contradictory instructions, misses a deadline, or exposes data, apology alone does not restore access. Participants must design immediate relief, error correction, deadline protection, escalation, compensation or remedy where lawful, and changes that prevent recurrence. The affected person

must not have to restart the entire process in order to prove that the institution failed.

22.3.5 — Curriculum and Material-Burden Boundary

The curriculum does not attempt to turn participants into economists, accountants, procurement lawyers, civil servants, engineers, or service designers. It gives them enough operating literacy to ask better questions, read warnings, understand implementation burdens, and recognize when a claim of efficiency depends on invisible labor or deferred cost. *The Government of Fairness* and *The Peace of Fairness* retain their own domains.

Economics in the City curriculum must illuminate material consequence without pretending to settle the economic architecture of society. Participants need literacy in distribution, labor, housing, infrastructure, debt, inflation, growth, inequality, taxation, climate risk, migration, and public finance. They also need to know that each field contains deep disagreement, different models, and jurisdiction-specific institutions (Moynihan, 2008; Musgrave, 1959; Stiglitz and Rosengard, 2015).

The burden boundary begins with scale. A local office may influence permits, transport, schools, land use, procurement, and service access. A national office may influence macroeconomic policy, currency, taxation, welfare, defense, migration, and infrastructure. The curriculum must match depth to plausible authority and avoid rewarding participants for making confident claims about systems beyond their role.

Models simplify, and the omissions matter. Economic analysis may leave out unpaid care, informal work, ecological loss, administrative burden, household distribution, or effects beyond the forecast window. That limitation does not invalidate

modeling. It makes assumptions, sensitivity, omitted burdens, and alternative models part of responsible public explanation.

A material-boundary brief must distinguish questions requiring economic, fiscal, labor, climate, housing, or infrastructure expertise from those belonging to political judgment after advice. The brief must name the affected groups, time horizon, uncertainty, and institutional authority.

The Peace of Fairness develops the series' full material-burden architecture. City coursework prepares participants to engage that work without treating a few modules as a complete economic doctrine.

Assessment must reward honest scope. A participant who identifies a macroeconomic uncertainty and consults qualified expertise must not be marked down for lacking an immediate answer. A participant who uses a simple calculation to conceal contested assumptions must be challenged.

Macroeconomic uncertainty must be taught as a field of competing models, lagged effects, feedback, and political choice. Forecasts depend on assumptions about behavior, institutions, external conditions, and measurement. Participants must compare scenarios and sensitivity rather than searching for one authoritative number that ends debate. They must also recognize when material policy requires democratic distributional choices that cannot be delegated to a model, economist, or central technical office.

22.4 — Diplomacy, Conflict, and Peace Architecture

Public authority does not operate only among cooperative institutions and shared facts. It encounters rival interests, historical grievance, strategic deception, fear, armed force, sanctions, displacement, secrecy, and the possibility that every available option carries harm. Education for office must prepare participants for this reality without making aggression, access to secrets, or crisis performance into prestige (Jervis, 1976; Fisher et al., 2011; Lederach, 1997). The City can teach conflict analysis, negotiation, lawful confidentiality, security tradeoffs, and the material burden of peace and war. It cannot reproduce diplomatic service, intelligence work, military command, humanitarian operations, or the knowledge of communities living inside conflict.

22.4.1 — Conflict Literacy

Assessment in this Section follows judgment paths rather than displays of toughness or calm. Participants identify actors, interests, grievances, power asymmetries, legal constraints, civilian burden, information gaps, escalation risks, secrecy needs, and off-ramps. They also name what remains unknown and whose expertise or authority must enter before action.

Conflict literacy begins by distinguishing disagreement from conflict and conflict from threat. Political opposition, labor dispute, communal grievance, misinformation campaign, criminal violence, insurgency, interstate coercion, and armed conflict involve different actors, laws, histories, and remedies. Treating all opposition as danger produces repression; treating all danger as dialogue can abandon people who need protection (Jervis, 1976; Fisher et al., 2011; Lederach, 1997).

Participants must learn conflict mapping as a provisional method. The map identifies parties, constituencies, stated

positions, underlying interests, resources, grievances, narratives, power asymmetries, spoilers, vulnerable groups, legal frameworks, and possible escalation or de-escalation routes. It must also identify who is absent from the table and why absence may be strategic, coerced, or structurally produced.

Historical depth matters because conflict rarely begins at the moment an official notices it. Land, discrimination, colonial rule, corruption, impunity, economic exclusion, displacement, language, religion, and institutional memory can shape present behavior. The curriculum must use historians and local experts to prevent participants from treating inherited grievance as irrational resistance to a contemporary plan.

A serious practicum can present a conflict through conflicting source packets. Participants receive official statements, community testimony, media reports, incomplete data, legal documents, and deliberately misleading claims. They must evaluate reliability, state uncertainty, identify immediate protection needs, and propose questions rather than rushing toward a solution. The exercise must reward discovery of missing knowledge.

Conflict work also requires attention to trauma, translation, and unequal risk. A meeting that appears open may be unsafe for a person who faces retaliation after speaking. Literal translation may miss historical or sacred meaning. A neutral venue may belong symbolically to one side. Participants must learn to ask who can enter, who can leave, who controls the record, and what protection follows participation. Local mediators, cultural experts, survivor advocates, and security professionals may disagree about the safest route. That disagreement must be recorded rather than resolved by the participant’s confidence.

Protocol and symbolism also carry substance. Seating, titles, flags, translation order, security arrangements, and the sequence

of meetings may communicate recognition, hierarchy, or exclusion before formal negotiation begins. Participants must learn to ask local and diplomatic experts what these choices mean rather than dismissing them as ceremony. A careless symbolic act can shift burden onto negotiators or communities who must later repair an avoidable insult.

Conflict literacy also includes the behavior of the officeholder. Participants must examine how language, status, security posture, meeting design, public timing, and private access can escalate or reduce harm. They must study whether an official listens differently to allies and opponents, confuses criticism with sabotage, or rewards those who perform civility while ignoring people whose anger reflects real injury.

Assessment must include after-action review. The participant reconstructs what they believed, which sources they trusted, what changed, whose burden remained invisible, and what they would do differently. Reviewers must distinguish a reasonable decision under uncertainty from a decision that ignored available warning.

Public presentation must avoid combat branding. Photographs of confrontational exercises, command rooms, or adversarial debate can make the City appear to manufacture toughness. The public-facing record must emphasize analysis, civilian protection, lawful authority, consultation, de-escalation, and correction.

Conflict sensitivity asks how an intervention changes the relationships around it. Funding one group, recognizing one representative, choosing a venue, publishing a map, or imposing a timetable can alter power even when the program is described as neutral. Participants must examine who gains access, who becomes exposed, and whether the intervention rewards

escalation or exclusion. The curriculum must make the institution's own footprint part of the conflict map.

22.4.2 — Diplomatic Confidentiality

Diplomatic confidentiality protects processes and people who may be harmed by premature exposure. Negotiation positions, private assurances, humanitarian channels, prisoner matters, asylum concerns, threat warnings, and sensitive intermediaries may require restricted access. A doctrine of immediate total disclosure could destroy trust, endanger participants, or make agreement impossible.

Confidentiality remains a governed category with authority, purpose, scope, and review. Participants distinguish public, restricted, privileged, lawfully classified, delayed, summarized, and non-recordable information when another person's rights control. The City does not invent legal classifications. It teaches the questions a lawful classification must answer and the review clock that prevents convenience from becoming permanent secrecy.

A classification exercise can present mixed material from a negotiation. Participants identify what can be disclosed now, what can be described through a protected summary, what requires restricted handling, who may access it, and when the decision must be reviewed. They must also state the public explanation that can be offered without revealing the protected substance.

The burden of secrecy travels in two directions. Disclosure can endanger a dissident, mediator, community, family, source, or future negotiation. Secrecy can conceal abuse, misrepresentation, private commitment, or unequal access. The participant must count both burdens and explain why the chosen restriction is no broader or longer than necessary.

Participants must practice need-to-know access, secure note handling, conflict disclosure, authorized summaries, and later review for release or continued shielding. They must also learn that a promise of secrecy cannot authorize illegality or silence a person who has an independent right to report harm.

Confidentiality also creates temptations of self-interest. An official may disclose protected material to appear transparent, courageous, or vindicated. Another may invoke diplomacy to hide embarrassment or avoid scrutiny. The curriculum must use scenarios in which the participant's reputation would benefit from improper disclosure, since that is when the duty to others becomes most visible.

Assess whether the participant can give the bounded explanation specified above, including recognizing when they lack authority even to confirm that a protected process exists.

22.4.3 — Peace Burden

The United Nations Guidance for Effective Mediation offers a useful orientation through preparedness, consent, impartiality, inclusivity, national ownership, international law, coordination, and agreement quality (United Nations, 2012). These are not steps that guarantee peace. They help participants see why process legitimacy, affected-party agency, coherent implementation, and the durability of consent matter when a settlement is more than a photograph.

Peace has material and human architecture. Ceasefires, sanctions relief, reconstruction, demobilization, migration policy, humanitarian access, defense posture, policing, debt, and institutional reform distribute cost across civilians, workers, families, public budgets, ecosystems, and future generations. Education must prevent participants from using peace as a moral

image detached from the people who must carry it (Schelling, 1960; Galtung, 1969).

Every option carries cost, including inaction. Military response may create civilian harm and long memory; failure to protect may permit ongoing violence; sanctions may burden households; a ceasefire may save lives while freezing injustice; reconstruction may restore infrastructure while empowering corrupt intermediaries. Formation makes those tensions visible without treating complexity as paralysis.

A peace-burden brief can identify immediate protection, long-term material effects, legal authority, financing, displaced populations, care systems, infrastructure, trauma, local ownership, and review. Participants must distinguish what is known, estimated, contested, and omitted. They must also identify who is being asked to wait for safety while others debate strategic advantage.

Affected communities must appear as political and moral agents, not only as victims. Local organizations, women's groups, displaced people, minority communities, veterans, workers, religious leaders, youth, and people with disabilities may hold knowledge that formal negotiators miss. Inclusion must not become token consultation. The exercise must ask how their positions affect the agreement and what protection exists when participation creates risk.

Assessment must include public explanation under moral pressure. The participant explains a decision that contains unavoidable harm, names uncertainty, acknowledges who bears the cost, and identifies review or repair. The evaluation must reject triumphal language.

Agreement quality depends on implementation architecture. Participants must examine verification, financing, sequencing, dispute resolution, local administration, security guarantees,

return or resettlement, transitional justice, and the capacity of institutions expected to perform the agreement. A text may be elegant and still fail because obligations are unfunded or authority is unclear.

22.4.4 — Security Tradeoffs

Security education begins with a refusal of false binaries. Openness and safety are not always opposites, and secrecy and safety are not always allies. Public authorities must often balance immediate protection, civil liberties, intelligence uncertainty, operational secrecy, public trust, and the risk that exceptional powers become ordinary. The curriculum must teach participants to identify the tradeoff rather than hide it behind the word security (Sagan, 1993; Boin et al., 2017).

Threat assessment must be conduct- and evidence-based. Participants must distinguish capability, intent, opportunity, vulnerability, consequence, and confidence. They must learn how bias can turn identity, religion, nationality, dissent, disability, neighborhood, or political belief into a substitute for evidence.

A scenario may require participants to respond to a credible but incomplete threat. They must identify lawful authority, immediate protective action, information needs, affected rights, communication, oversight, review, and the conditions for ending exceptional measures. A red team must test whether the plan creates new vulnerabilities, targets the wrong group, or relies on a system that cannot be audited.

Security measures carry operational burden. Screening requires staff, technology, training, appeals, maintenance, false-positive handling, and support for people wrongly flagged. Surveillance may generate data that must be protected and reviewed. Restrictions may displace risk into informal spaces.

Participants must include these costs rather than treating security as a switch that can simply be turned on.

Error rates matter because security systems act on imperfect information. A screening rule may miss a real threat while falsely burdening many innocent people. Surveillance may generate more signals than staff can responsibly interpret. Emergency restrictions may persist because no one is assigned to end them. Participants must examine false positives, false negatives, differential impact, oversight access, appeal, sunset, and rollback before approving a measure. The burden of proof must rise with intrusiveness and duration, while the public explanation must remain honest about what the measure can and cannot prevent.

Civil-liberties and affected-community review must occur before crisis wherever possible. The institution must identify stop authorities, complaint routes, protected dissent, data limits, and return-to-normal rules in advance.

Assessment must examine whether the participant updates as evidence changes. Overreaction and underreaction can both be failures. A good record identifies the initial confidence, actions taken, new information, revised judgment, and repair for people burdened by error.

Security simulations must not cultivate dominance, emotional suppression, or fascination with command. Toughness theater rewards the appearance of control and may disadvantage participants with different stress responses. The educational question is whether the participant protects people, respects authority, consults expertise, communicates uncertainty, and ends exceptional measures when the justification expires.

Oversight must have access, expertise, independence, time, and remedial authority. Participants compare judicial, legislative, inspector, professional, internal, and public forms because each

sees different risks. The curriculum also asks what happens when oversight fails and how affected people obtain correction without exposing legitimate security information.

22.4.5 — Transition Boundary

Participants seeking office need to understand that institutional change occurs through sequence, authority, capacity, and consent. They must be able to distinguish a proposal, prototype, pilot, ratification, lawful implementation, scaling decision, and final program. They also need to recognize that dates do not authorize advancement and public enthusiasm does not replace readiness (Jervis, 1976; Fisher et al., 2011; Lederach, 1997).

The Transition of Fairness owns the project's full sequence, Workgame, gates, rollout, country readiness, political timing, pause, rollback, decertification, relay, and failure memory. The City must teach enough transition literacy to prevent participants from treating the City as destiny or assuming that educational completion authorizes implementation. It must not design the transition inside a curriculum chapter.

A gate exercise can ask participants to review a proposed public initiative. They identify prerequisites, legal authority, staffing, funding, technology, safeguards, affected communities, evaluation, pause conditions, rollback, and who can say no. They must distinguish a planning horizon from a promise and a readiness indicator from a political mandate.

The exercise must include sunk-cost pressure. Buildings may have been purchased, donors may be enthusiastic, staff may be hired, and public attention may be high. Participants must decide whether evidence supports continuation, redesign, pause, or stop.

In a transition exercise, respond to praise that invites premature replication, jurisdiction rankings, or endorsement of a

political vehicle. Identify the missing evidence and proper authorization before answering.

Participants must explain uncertainty without making the initiative sound pointless, and explain ambition without presenting it as inevitable. They must state what has been authorized, what remains candidate, what evidence is needed, and what failure would mean.

Pilot evidence must be interpreted against preregistered or otherwise predeclared criteria where feasible. An initiative can appear successful because leaders redefine the objective after observing the result, highlight favorable sites, or discount burdens that emerge slowly. Participants must practice distinguishing learning from justification after the fact.

Transition literacy should culminate in a written authority-and-evidence gate. The exercise should include a public summary and a private decision log so reviewers can compare explanation with underlying reasoning.

22.5 — Systems Design, Ethics, and Institutional Craft

Public institutions are systems of people, rules, resources, technologies, habits, incentives, and memory. Their failures can spread beyond one bad decision. A delay can produce a backlog, a backlog can produce rushed judgment, rushed judgment can produce error, error can produce appeals, and appeals can deepen the delay. Education for office must help participants recognize these loops before they become ordinary suffering (Meadows, 2008; Simon, 1969; Ostrom, 1990).

22.5.1 — Systems as Burden Routes

Systems thinking is useful only when it remains connected to human experience. Diagrams can reveal feedback, bottlenecks, dependency, and unintended consequence. They can also flatten people into nodes and present contested assumptions as objective structure. The City must teach participants to build maps that remain open to correction by workers, affected people, and evidence.

A system map must begin with the public purpose and the people affected, not with the organization chart. Participants identify inputs, decisions, handoffs, delays, feedback, incentives, constraints, outputs, and outcomes. They also name who performs the work, who waits, who absorbs error, and who has power to change the route (Meadows, 2008; Simon, 1969; Ostrom, 1990).

Stocks and flows help explain why institutions behave unexpectedly. Applications accumulate while staff capacity changes slowly. Maintenance debt grows when visible expansion is rewarded. Trust can decline faster than formal reform can restore it. Participants must learn these concepts through concrete public systems rather than abstract notation

alone, since the value lies in seeing why apparently small choices compound.

Reinforcing feedback amplifies change; balancing feedback tends to counter deviations from a target or limit (Meadows, 2008). A complaint system may reveal failure and improve service, or it may burden staff without changing authority. A performance target may focus effort, or it may encourage gaming. A security measure may reduce one risk while driving activity into less visible channels. Participants must be asked to identify the behavior a rule is likely to reward, not only the behavior it officially requests.

System boundaries require argument. A hospital queue is connected to housing, transport, staffing, public health, and family care. A school policy is connected to disability support, policing, nutrition, migration, and household time. Participants must state what they included, what they excluded, and why.

Causal links inside a system map carry graded confidence. Some are directly observed, some supported by research, some drawn from practitioner experience, and others remain hypotheses. Participants mark those differences, identify proxy variables, test rival explanations, and seek cases the map fails to explain. The diagram organizes inquiry and directs measurement.

A mapping practicum can use two teams. One designs the system from the perspective of authority and implementation; the other reconstructs it from the perspective of users, workers, and people who fail to enter. The teams then compare missing actors, conflicting definitions of success, and points where responsibility disappears. Differences between the maps guide investigation of omitted actors and contested assumptions.

Assessment must examine whether the participant tests the map against new evidence and affected-person testimony,

revising boundaries, causal claims, or interventions when warranted. Record major revisions and explain why contested assumptions were retained.

22.5.2 — Institutional Maintenance

Maintenance is public ethics expressed through repetition. The learning task is to sustain a system for its users after launch, when deterioration competes with visible new projects for attention (Ostrom, 1990; Leveson, 2011).

The curriculum must distinguish preventive, corrective, adaptive, and restorative maintenance. Preventive work reduces foreseeable failure. Corrective work responds when something breaks. Adaptive work changes the system when needs or conditions change. Restorative work repairs harm and trust after failure. Each requires budget, staff, authority, records, and public explanation.

A maintenance audit can examine one public service or technical system. Participants identify critical assets, replacement cycles, vendor dependencies, skills, accessibility needs, backups, data migration, security patches, contingency plans, operation during outage, and failure ownership. They must include the labor that keeps the institution usable, especially cleaners, technicians, clerks, drivers, facilities staff, and people who preserve local knowledge.

Apply the fiscal-note method in Section 22.3.1 to deferred maintenance. Prioritize repairs on evidence and examine whether each asset still serves its purpose; future costs do not justify an unlimited maintenance budget.

Ask participants to inherit a system several years after launch, with turnover, budget pressure, obsolete tools, and unresolved complaints. They must use the maintenance audit to assign

resources and ownership, protecting ordinary function before adding another feature.

Assessment must include a repair decision under scarcity. The participant must prioritize among visible expansion, hidden maintenance, staff recovery, accessibility, and resilience. Reviewers must examine who bears the risk of deferral and whether the participant explains that risk honestly.

The public record must make maintenance competence visible without glamorizing crisis response. A participant who funds routine inspection, listens to technicians, preserves documentation, and replaces a failing system before collapse may look less dramatic than one who manages an emergency.

Include maintenance workers in design review before purchase or construction, applying the practitioner-participation terms in Section 22.3.2.

22.5.3 — Ethics Under Constraint

Ethics under constraint begins when every available option leaves some burden. Officials may face limited resources, conflicting rights, incomplete evidence, legal duties, urgent need, and unequal power. The curriculum must not offer a single moral shortcut that converts these conflicts into clean answers. It must teach participants to identify duties, consequences, affected persons, uncertainty, alternatives, and the moral remainder after a decision (Reason, 1997; Perrow, 1984).

Participants must encounter multiple ethical traditions and methods. Rights-based reasoning, consequential analysis, duties of office, care ethics, virtue traditions, public reason, professional ethics, and historical experience can illuminate different features of a case. The goal is not to synthesize them into one City doctrine. It is to prevent a participant’s preferred

language from becoming the only moral lens permitted in the room.

Case work must use genuine tradeoffs. A health allocation decision, emergency evacuation, public-record release, environmental permit, labor dispute, or school closure can force competing obligations into view. Participants must state which burdens are unavoidable, which are shifted, which people lack voice, and what repair remains due after the decision.

Power asymmetry must shape the analysis. Consent from a dependent person may not carry the same freedom as consent from an equal. A small procedural burden may be decisive for someone with little time, money, mobility, or institutional trust. Participants must learn to ask whether the decision relies on the endurance of people least able to refuse.

Assessment must examine the integrity of the reasoning and the openness to challenge. Reviewers can ask whether the participant named conflicting values, considered less burdensome alternatives, sought affected-person knowledge, and preserved remedy. They must not assign a virtue score or demand one approved moral conclusion.

Use reflective writing to identify difficulties, assumptions, and unresolved reasoning under the boundaries in Section 18.5.5. Summarize only what is relevant to the public task in the readiness record.

Some decisions require institutional ethics review rather than individual reflection alone. Repeated conflicts can reveal that incentives, law, staffing, or governance create a burden no conscientious official can solve case by case. Participants must learn when to escalate from personal judgment to policy redesign, independent review, or democratic decision.

22.5.4 — Anti-Capture Design

Apply the capture analysis to the curriculum itself. Use the governance in Section 22.1.5, including rotating faculty, source diversity, external criticism, participant appeals, and staff complaint channels (Russell and Vinsel, 2018; Carpenter and Moss, 2014).

Capture redirects an institution's formal purpose through control of money, information, appointments, access, technology, expertise, or reputation. Trace the mechanism without presuming every relationship corrupt.

The OECD Recommendation on Public Integrity organizes one comparative approach around coherent integrity systems, cultures of integrity, and accountability (OECD, 2017a). The City may use that guidance to sharpen questions about conflicts, incentives, enforcement, transparency, and organizational practice.

An influence map can identify formal authority, informal access, financial dependency, appointment power, information control, post-employment opportunity, and reputational leverage. Participants must note which relationships are legitimate, which need disclosure, which require recusal, and which create unacceptable dependency. The map must include the City itself, since educational institutions can capture participants through praise, networks, or future opportunity.

Design responses must be matched to the route. Disclosure may expose a conflict but not cure it. Recusal may work for a discrete decision but fail when the relationship is structural. Rotation can reduce dependency but lose expertise. Independent review can add accountability but also create delay. Procurement, funding, staffing, and advisory systems need different combinations of controls.

Alumni may expect access, and political allies may seek a pipeline of approved candidates.

A practicum can present a project supported by a generous donor, an experienced vendor, and a politically connected advisor. The participant must identify conditions, information rights, procurement rules, conflicts, decision ownership, exit, and public explanation.

Assessment must include the participant's own dependencies. The record must not expose private relationships without cause, but formation must help the participant recognize where gratitude or loyalty could affect public judgment. Self-knowledge becomes useful only when joined to institutional controls.

Data and platform control create newer capture routes. A supplier may control identity infrastructure, communication reach, analytics, search visibility, or the technical expertise needed to understand a public system. Participants must map these dependencies alongside money and appointments, then ask what interoperability, public capability, audit, and exit are required to keep authority from migrating invisibly.

22.5.5 — Public Explanation Craft

Institutional craft includes the ability to notice its own failure. Learning artifacts identify signals, decision owners, feedback routes, stop conditions, repair capacity, and public explanation.

This module applies the public-reason method in Section 22.2.3 to explanations people can use to contest a decision and obtain review (Thompson, 1987; Meadows, 2008; Simon, 1969).

Plain language matters, but simplification can become distortion. Participants must practice explaining technical or legal material without removing contested assumptions,

uncertainty, or minority effects. Translations must be reviewed for meaning rather than treated as mechanical duplication.

Accessibility requires multiple channels. Non-digital routes remain important where connectivity, literacy, disability, safety, or trust make online publication insufficient. The curriculum must treat access as part of explanation, not a later distribution task.

The strongest evidence of craft is often the willingness to correct a favorable misunderstanding that would have benefited the speaker.

A hostile-question exercise can test whether the participant remains truthful under pressure. The participant must answer directly, correct false premises without contempt, and state when they do not know.

Can an affected person understand the decision, find the source, challenge an error, request accommodation, appeal, or identify the responsible office?

Uncertainty must be explained in a form that supports action. Participants must learn to distinguish confidence in facts, confidence in forecasts, confidence in causal explanation, and confidence in the chosen action. This allows the public to see where disagreement belongs and what new evidence would justify revision. Usability testing should ask whether an affected reader can identify the decision, remaining uncertainty, and next available action.

The explanation record should also show what changed after publication. Participants should practice issuing dated addenda, visible corrections, and replacement notices that preserve the original record without letting obsolete language continue to govern. It is finished only when the public can locate the current account, understand the change, and reach the institution that remains responsible. A replacement notice should link directly

from the obsolete explanation so correction does not depend on finding a separate page. Test whether the correction reaches the original audiences with comparable visibility.

22.6 — Media, Data, AI, and Interpretive Literacy

Public authority now speaks inside an information environment that can magnify error before an institution has understood what happened. A headline can separate a decision from its evidence. A dashboard can make uncertainty look like precision. A generative model can produce fluent language that readers mistake for verified judgment, and synthetic media can travel faster than correction. Education for office must therefore treat source reconstruction, model limits, provenance, and public interpretation as core civic capacities rather than optional technical literacy (Entman, 1993; Wardle and Derakhshan, 2017; UNESCO, 2021a; NIST, 2024b).

22.6.1 — Media Framing

Framing is unavoidable because no report can include every fact, voice, image, and historical cause. Examine how the frame was chosen, what it emphasizes, what it excludes, which interests shape it, and how readers can discover the limits. Participants must learn to see framing without treating every disagreement as manipulation (UNESCO, 2021a; Entman, 1993; Druckman, 2001).

Agenda setting begins before wording. Editors, officials, parties, platforms, advocates, and audiences influence which events become public problems and which remain ordinary background. A small but vivid incident may dominate attention while a slow administrative failure remains unseen. Participants must examine how novelty, conflict, proximity, status, imagery, and platform incentives change what becomes legible.

A comparative-coverage exercise can use several accounts of the same event. Participants identify source selection, headline structure, image choice, chronology, missing context, quoted authorities, affected voices, uncertainty, and correction history.

They must then reconstruct the strongest responsible account that each source could have produced from the information available at the time.

Independent journalism must remain independent. The City must teach participants how newsrooms verify, protect sources, investigate institutions, correct error, and separate reporting from commentary, while also examining commercial pressure, political pressure, ownership concentration, access journalism, and platform distribution. The curriculum must never train future officials to treat critical media as enemies whose legitimacy depends on favorable coverage.

Participants must work with journalists and media scholars to distinguish legitimate scrutiny from harassment and reporting from institutional publicity. Practice answering hard questions without threatening access, flooding the record with distraction, or reserving candor for friendly outlets.

Source relationships require boundaries. An official may provide background, documents, interviews, or technical explanation. They may also attempt to shape access through timing, exclusivity, intimidation, strategic leaking, or reward. Participants must practice giving accurate information without using public resources to cultivate a loyal press class. The record must distinguish explanation from influence.

Assessment can combine a framing memorandum, source log, and public interview. The participant explains what is known, what remains disputed, which evidence is primary, how the issue is being framed, and what correction would be issued if a claim changes. Reviewers must value accuracy and accessibility over the appearance of media mastery.

Public artifacts must resist propaganda aesthetics. Heroic portraits, victory montages, selective testimonials, hostile caricatures, and decontextualized before-and-after images can

turn education into image production. A credible City record shows sources, dates, disputes, revisions, and affected-person perspectives.

Platform distribution changes the media ecology after publication. Ranking systems, recommendation feeds, search, monetization, and coordinated sharing can amplify a frame the original newsroom did not intend. Participants must understand these dynamics without treating platforms as a single conspiratorial actor. The relevant questions concern incentives, access, moderation, provenance, correction reach, and whether public communication depends on private systems whose rules can change without democratic notice.

22.6.2 — Data Limits

Data are produced through definitions, instruments, collection rules, classifications, incentives, exclusions, and maintenance. A number may be accurate within its method and still fail to answer the public question attached to it. Participants need to understand that data are neither mere opinion nor unmediated reality. They are evidence with a construction history, and that history determines what the number can legitimately support (Bowker and Star, 1999; D'Ignazio and Klein, 2020).

Definitions come first. Unemployment, homelessness, crime, waiting time, service completion, poverty, school attendance, migration, health outcome, and public satisfaction can each be measured in multiple legitimate ways. Participants must ask who defined the category, which cases enter, which cases disappear, what period is used, and whether the definition changed. Comparisons become misleading when definitions travel without their conditions.

Sampling, missingness, measurement error, and nonresponse must be treated as public facts. A dataset may overrepresent

people who can be reached, documented, or safely counted. Administrative data may reflect enforcement patterns rather than underlying behavior. Survey responses may be shaped by fear, language, mode, and trust. Participants must learn to ask whether absence means zero, unknown, unrecorded, or excluded.

A dashboard audit can make these issues concrete. The participant reconstructs each indicator’s source, denominator, update cycle, uncertainty, disaggregation, access restrictions, and decision use. They identify where the visual design implies ranking, causation, completeness, or real-time precision that the data cannot support. They must then redesign the dashboard or recommend that a metric not be displayed.

A percentage without a base can mislead; an average can hide unequal distribution; a proxy can encode discrimination; a model can fit historical data while failing under changed conditions. Participants must distinguish description, prediction, and causal inference. The most important number may be the one the institution cannot yet estimate honestly.

Causal claims require a separate discipline. Correlation, temporal sequence, regression adjustment, natural experiment, randomized design, qualitative process evidence, and expert judgment do not carry the same inferential force. Participants do not need to become statisticians, but they must know when a graph cannot establish that a policy caused an outcome and when qualified analysis is required.

Data protection belongs inside data literacy. Small groups can become identifiable through combinations of location, time, condition, and rare characteristics even when names are removed. Public release may expose communities to stigma, enforcement, commercial targeting, or political attack. Participants must consider minimization, aggregation, access

controls, disclosure risk, affected-person rights, and whether the public benefit justifies release.

Assessment must require both analysis and translation. A participant may reproduce a simple calculation, identify methodological limits, consult a qualified statistician, and explain the result to a public audience without erasing uncertainty. The record must never turn data fluency into a score of intelligence or treat a model's output as more serious than testimony merely because it is numerical.

Fairness analysis in data begins with context rather than one detached statistical test. Error rates, base rates, sample sizes, measurement practices, and decision consequences can point in different directions. Participants ask which harm matters in the actual use, whether groups were defined responsibly, and whether a less data-intensive process could serve the purpose. No technical parity rescues a decision that should not be automated or scored.

22.6.3 — AI Output Limits

Media, data, and Artificial Intelligence literacy are related but not interchangeable. Media literacy examines selection, framing, incentives, sourcing, and narrative form. Data literacy examines definitions, sampling, measurement, uncertainty, missingness, comparison, and causal claims. Artificial Intelligence literacy examines model behavior, training and input conditions, system limits, security, procurement, human oversight, and the difference between generated output and accountable knowledge.

Four source families anchor this literacy program, and each performs a different task. UNESCO supplies media and information literacy, then connects Artificial Intelligence and digital transformation to civil-service capacity and public

responsibility (UNESCO, 2021a; UNESCO and Broadband Commission, 2022). The United Nations Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics supply standards for professional independence, impartiality, scientific methods, transparency, confidentiality, and equal access (United Nations General Assembly, 2014). NIST supplies a risk-governance vocabulary for mapping, measuring, and managing Artificial Intelligence systems (NIST, 2023a; NIST, 2024b). The Council of Europe connects lifecycle governance to human rights, democracy, and the rule of law (Council of Europe, 2024). None of these sources certifies a system or participant. A public-task exercise must name which instrument applies, its legal status and jurisdiction, the accountable human owner, the evidence gap, and the review route.

Artificial Intelligence literacy also requires refusal practice. Participants must be asked to reject fluent outputs that lack source traceability, overstate confidence, infer protected traits, erase affected persons, hallucinate authority, or turn uncertainty into an official-sounding conclusion. A tool that cannot show its source, limit, and human owner must not be allowed to carry public consequence (NIST, 2023a; NIST, 2024b).

Artificial Intelligence systems can classify, predict, retrieve, rank, summarize, generate, translate, detect, and recommend. Those functions can be useful. They can also produce confident error, reproduce bias, expose sensitive information, conceal dependence on vendors, and encourage humans to treat a generated answer as if responsibility had moved into the machine.

Participants must understand the basic conditions of model behavior. Training data, objectives, model architecture, retrieval sources, prompts, system instructions, fine-tuning, filters, tools, and deployment context all influence output. The same system

may behave differently across languages, populations, time, and task.

Generative systems require particular skepticism. They may fabricate sources, merge distinct events, produce plausible but false explanations, and respond differently to small changes in prompt or context. Even when an answer is accurate, the system may not provide a reliable account of how it reached it. Participants must learn to verify claims against primary sources and to separate useful drafting assistance from factual or legal reliance.

Apply the risk and rights frameworks introduced in Section 22.6 to a specific proposed AI use. Add UNESCO's ethics recommendation and, where applicable, the European Commission's 2026 Article 50 guidance on transparency for certain AI interactions and generated or manipulated content (UNESCO, 2021b; European Commission, 2026). Identify the instrument's legal status, the duty it informs, and the evidence needed to assess compliance.

Use the technical-control sheet in Section 18.3.1 and the procurement method in Section 22.3.3 for the proposed task. Red-team exercises should probe fabricated citations, discriminatory outputs, privacy leakage, prompt injection, synthetic impersonation, overreliance, and confident error. Reviewers need time, information, competence, and authority to disagree; an approval checkbox cannot supply those conditions. Responsibility for the public act remains with accountable people (NIST, 2024b; Council of Europe, 2024; UNESCO and Broadband Commission, 2022).

A verification practicum can require a participant to use an Artificial Intelligence system for a bounded task, preserve the prompt and output where lawful, identify factual claims, check sources, examine omissions, test alternative prompts, and

document human revision. Another exercise can compare human and machine summaries of a contested record. The participant must explain why a final statement is theirs, not the system's.

Extend the procurement exercise in Section 22.3.3 through a vendor update and an exit: test whether records, audit access, and service continuity survive migration (Burtscher et al., 2024; OECD, 2026d).

Automation bias must be made visible. Humans may defer to a system because it appears quantitative, consistent, fast, or technically complex. Reviewers may sign a recommendation they did not independently understand.

Under Section 11.7.6, Artificial Intelligence tutors, analytics, and assessment tools must not profile or rank learners for readiness, character, ideology, or worth, or determine advancement. Bounded translation, accessibility, scheduling, retrieval, practice, and source-linked task feedback may be permitted under defined controls. Qualified people remain responsible for educational judgments and reasons that participants can challenge.

Include an incident-response exercise after deployment, using the controls in Section 18.3.1. Identify who can suspend the system, notify affected people, preserve evidence, correct the record, and decide whether to remove the tool.

Evaluation must continue after deployment and must include people who experience the system's errors. Benchmark performance may not reveal language gaps, rare cases, adversarial use, accessibility barriers, or harm created by integration into a real workflow. Participants must design monitoring that can detect drift and unequal burden without creating a permanent surveillance layer. A system that cannot be observed safely may be unsuitable for consequential use.

22.6.4 — Public Misinterpretation

Public misinterpretation is not always irrational. Institutions often release fragments, delay context, use unexplained terms, or correct quietly after promoting loudly. The curriculum must begin by asking what burden the institution created through its own communication (UNESCO, 2021a; Gebru et al., 2021).

Context collapse occurs when material created for one purpose travels into another. A classroom draft becomes a campaign attack. A protected summary becomes a moral verdict. A statistical association becomes a claim about an individual. A simulation becomes evidence of real-world failure. Participants must learn to predict these shifts before release and to attach status, date, purpose, and limits to high-risk material.

Hostile cropping deserves direct practice. A participant's sentence may be shortened, reordered, captioned, or paired with unrelated imagery. A graph may lose its denominator. A correction may be omitted. The City must train participants to write crop-safe sentences where feasible, but it must not reduce serious reasoning to slogans. The larger response is to maintain accessible source context that can be found quickly.

Use the synthetic-media response in Section 20.7.3 for an impersonation exercise, testing verification and publication of accurate context under platform constraints.

Before release, diverse readers can review whether a notice, chart, summary, or clip creates predictable ambiguity, inaccessible language, cultural confusion, or a false impression of certainty. Testing must include people likely to be affected, not only communications professionals. When interpretation fails, the institution must distinguish hostile manipulation from reasonable misunderstanding and from its own design error.

Correction systems need proportionality. Not every false claim deserves institutional amplification. Some require a quiet update;

others require a prominent correction, affected-person notice, platform contact, or emergency security response. Participants must learn to assess reach, harm, persistence, vulnerability, and the risk that correction itself repeats the damaging content.

A misinterpretation exercise can present a lawful public artifact and several hostile readings. Using the distinctions above, participants classify the readings and prepare a response that corrects errors without humiliating the public or treating criticism as disinformation merely because it is inconvenient.

Apply the communication-harm remedies in Section 20.3.5 when assessing the institution's own release. The record must show repair rather than merely a defense of the original statement.

Crisis communication requires a preassigned response structure. Technical verification, legal review, affected-person contact, security support, public explanation, translation, and media coordination may need to occur at once. Participants must know who leads, who can publish, how uncertainty is labeled, and how an erroneous first response will be corrected.

22.6.5 — Context Stewardship

Context stewardship treats meaning as something institutions must maintain over time. A document can remain factually unchanged while its interpretation shifts because law, evidence, terminology, technology, or public circumstances have changed. The City must preserve enough provenance and version history for readers to understand what a record meant when it was created and how later correction altered it (Mitchell et al., 2019; Selbst et al., 2019; D'Ignazio and Klein, 2020).

Use the bundle, release-note, and reply controls in Sections 10.4–10.5. Keep the context proportionate: enough to understand the record without burying responsibility in unnecessary volume.

Provenance checks can establish aspects of origin or change, not the truth or lawful release of content; use the technical distinctions in Section 20.6.

Use the correction and version-linking method in Section 22.5.5. Decisions about preserving or restricting an earlier version also require lawful review of public interest and affected-person rights.

Context has a maintenance cost that must be assigned. Version histories, dispute labels, translations, accessibility, broken links, format migration, correction prominence, and the relationship between summary and source require continuing work. A record site that preserves accusation while allowing correction to decay produces a new asymmetry. Participants must learn to budget for stewardship and to decide when an obsolete artifact must be archived, redirected, restricted, or retired under lawful review. Plan for vendor failure and search results that continue to surface obsolete material.

Test navigation, translation, captions, assistive-technology compatibility, and low-bandwidth access with intended users, including their ability to reach the underlying source.

The final exercise asks participants to prepare a context bundle for a contested decision and defend each inclusion, omission, label, and access choice before journalists, archivists, data and accessibility specialists, affected people, and public readers. The exercise should preserve the reasons for excluding material as well as the reasons for releasing it, so both decisions remain open to challenge.

Context stewardship includes retirement: artifacts may remain historical, restricted, superseded, or lawfully deleted. Cheap storage cannot justify preserving every harmful or obsolete object; review balances memory, affected-person rights, law, research, security, and permanent searchability. A retirement

decision should identify any remaining public explanation and the office responsible for responding to a later correction request.

A reader should be able to follow one public task from its first proposal through criticism and revision to its present limits, with each version clearly identified.

Chapter 23 — Deliberation Across Record Boundaries

Public power becomes answerable when citizens can inspect how consequential reasoning formed. A decree, vote, budget, appointment, sanction, or emergency instruction may arrive as a clean public act, yet beneath it may sit excluded testimony, untested assumptions, hidden advisers, inherited ideology, suppressed doubt, and alternatives that were never fairly examined. Chapter 23 builds a record of that pathway without claiming ownership of the private mind.

The City records public-relevant reasoning, not interior life. Confusion, prayer, grief, hesitation, private feeling, mental association, and unsaid fear remain outside civic ownership. When an active participant forms a judgment that may shape law, administration, budgets, coercion, appointments, public explanation, crisis response, or institutional trust, the record should show how evidence entered, how disagreement was handled, who materially influenced the result, what drafts changed, where error was admitted, and what limits remained.

The practical fairness question is where the burden of reasoning goes. In ordinary public life, citizens often carry that burden after the fact, guessing whether a leader understood affected people, whether dissent mattered, whether evidence was selected conveniently, whether a reversal reflected learning or expedience, and whether an expert advised responsibly or governed from the side. The City moves part of that work upstream by preserving a reviewable pathway before the public is asked to carry the risk of trust.

Traceable reasoning gives the public more to judge than a participant’s persona. It can show sources, dependencies, dissent, revision, and correction, while a weak conclusion remains weak and a strong process remains open to challenge. It does not convert procedure into truth.

Deliberation design must also resist performance. A visible seminar can become a stage, a debate can reward speed and dominance, a working group can hide hierarchy behind consensus language, and a draft trail can punish honest learning. Source notes can become citation decoration and minority reports can become tokens. The City therefore designs visibility to discipline power while protecting inquiry, revision, dissent, and the time needed to think.

Six practices create the chapter's deliberation revision history: visible public reasoning; seminars, debates, and working groups; governed drafts and decision logs; error, apology, and repair; adviser and dependency mapping; and disciplined claim-status limits. Their purpose is not administrative abundance. Together they preserve inquiry, dissent, influence, change, and public explanation at the scale needed to reconstruct consequential judgment.

The protocol links a decision's revision history to the people and sources that shaped it. Each artifact records stage, purpose, owner, and source; adviser, dependency, and dissent disclosures; access, release, and retention status; and correction, expiry, or supersession routes. Exploratory discussion can remain protected so unfinished formulations do not harden into permanent identity. Public recommendations require reasons, dissents, declared dependencies, affected-person context, and a route back to the source record (ISO, 2016a; W3C, 2013; OECD, 2022b).

23.1 — Why Reasoning Must Become Visible

The reasoning record makes the pathway in Section 23.1.1 reviewable without becoming a diary. Its fields connect a public question to evidence, influence, decisions, and subsequent correction. People reason differently: some discover a view while speaking, while others need time to form a draft before sharing it. The record should preserve the public decision pathway without treating those differences in expression as differences in integrity or readiness.

23.1.1 — Judgment Pathway

A judgment pathway is the traceable route by which a public-relevant conclusion forms. It begins with a question before the conclusion has hardened. The City must record the problem as first stated, the role context in which the question arose, the affected persons whose burdens are implicated, the authority that might later be sought, and the first set of assumptions brought into the room (Mercier and Sperber, 2017; Tetlock, 2005; Kahneman, 2011).

The pathway must include burden mapping. The participant should identify who would carry the cost if the conclusion were wrong, delayed, overbroad, underinclusive, symbolic, administratively impossible, or legally infirm. That map does not settle the question.

Timing matters. A conclusion formed after three hours of pressure has a different public meaning from one formed after months of study. A view that changed after testimony carries different evidentiary weight from one that changed after donor pressure, party signaling, or fear of public embarrassment. The judgment pathway must show when evidence entered, when dissent appeared, when alternatives were rejected, and when the participant declared a provisional or final position.

The pathway should also record decision horizon. Some questions require immediate action because life, safety, or continuity is at risk. Others require deliberate delay. Still others require staged action that leaves correction open.

Review routes must attach to the pathway. If a participant omits an affected group, misstates evidence, refuses relevant dissent, or hides an advisor, there must be a protected route for correction, right of reply, status-label change, or oversight review.

The final pathway field preserves uncertainty, unresolved dependencies, and conditions that would require revisiting the conclusion.

One practical tool is a pathway index keyed to events rather than character. The index can identify first framing, burden map, evidence threshold, dissent entry, advisor entry, draft shift, decision point, and later review. Those labels guide readers without pretending that a single number could measure judgment.

Cross-jurisdictional issues require added care. A participant may reason about a policy that affects people outside the City, outside the host jurisdiction, or outside the electorate that will later decide. The pathway should name the limits of local knowledge and identify where outside consultation is required before confidence grows.

Finally, the pathway has to survive transfer into public bundles. Citizens should not receive a maze of internal files. They need a readable sequence with links to deeper records, status labels, and correction notes.

The pathway must be durable enough for future office conditions. If a participant later seeks office, the public should be able to compare campaign claims with formation records. The City does not give the campaign a script; it gives citizens a way

to see whether the campaign has simplified, distorted, or honored the earlier pathway.

23.1.2 — Evidence Use

Evidence use is a discipline of relevance, weight, uncertainty, source integrity, affected-person burden, and interpretive limit (Kahneman, 2011; Tversky and Kahneman, 1974).

Evidence types must remain distinguishable. Lived testimony, administrative data, peer-reviewed research, legal authority, historical analogy, budget modeling, operational records, local knowledge, security intelligence, and expert judgment do not carry the same kind of weight. A fair record identifies what kind of evidence was used and what it could not establish.

Evidence should be connected to decision weight. A source that appears in the record but changes nothing should not be made to look decisive. Testimony from a vulnerable person that altered a safeguard should not be buried beneath abstractions. A dataset that carries large uncertainty should not be translated into public certainty for rhetorical advantage.

The relevant fairness test is who carries the cost when evidence is overread or underread. A budget model that ignores care labor moves burden into households. A policing dataset shaped by prior enforcement can reproduce hidden injury. A public-opinion sample can conceal minority risk. A vivid story can overgeneralize from one life. Evidence use becomes more responsible when the possible displaced burden is named, the missing population is visible, and the decision owner explains why the evidence is sufficient for this use and no more.

Use the field-contact safeguards in Section 22.1.3 when learning from harmed people. Protected summaries, advocate testimony, synthesis, anonymized reports, or delayed review can avoid unnecessary retelling.

Evidence records need status labels. A source may be current, disputed, provisional, protected, withdrawn, corrected, superseded, incomplete, or outside the City's competence to judge.

Use the pathway's protected correction route for misquotation, omitted context, category errors, or false claims of consensus. Link the correction to the affected source note.

A disciplined evidence record can include a relevance note for each major source. The note states the claim supported, the burden affected, the uncertainty carried, and any limits on relying on the source alone.

Test academic, practical, and local knowledge according to the claim each can support; familiarity with citation conventions does not itself establish evidential strength.

Record each source's authorized capture, access, release, and reuse status under Chapters 10–11; use in deliberation creates no additional permission.

The public record should make uncertainty usable rather than decorative. A note saying evidence is uncertain is too vague. A better note says whether the uncertainty concerns sample, method, jurisdiction, age, legal status, affected population, implementation, or interpretation.

23.1.3 — Disagreement Behavior

Disagreement behavior reveals how a participant treats public burden when it pushes back. Agreement is easy to perform in a friendly room. The harder test is whether the participant can hear an objection without humiliating the objector, caricaturing the claim, hiding behind status, or reducing all opposition to bad faith (Longino, 1990; OECD, 2020a). Reconstruction should be recorded before rejection. A participant who rejects an objection

should first be able to state it in a form a serious opponent would recognize.

Test whether objections from people with less institutional standing can alter the work, rather than giving serious consideration only to prestigious critics.

Disagreement may be factual, moral, legal, administrative, experiential, procedural, or interpretive. The participant's response should fit the kind of challenge being made. A factual dispute may need source review. A moral objection may require burden reframing. A legal objection may require counsel. An administrative objection may reveal implementation impossibility.

Mere calm must not be rewarded. A participant can speak softly while ignoring every challenge. Another can show urgency because the issue is grave. The record should evaluate uptake, accuracy, curiosity, boundary setting, and later correction rather than treating tone as the whole of democratic maturity.

Apply the reviewable safety boundaries in Section 12.5.4 to threats, doxxing, protected-detail exposure, and targeted harassment. Ordinary dissent or disruption does not by itself establish a threat or justify silencing an objection.

Disagreement becomes useful when it leaves a trace in the conclusion, the limits, the safeguards, or the explanation. A participant may remain persuaded of the same policy while adding a complaint route, narrowing a power, delaying release, naming uncertainty, or changing implementation. The record should show whether dissent had any path to consequence.

Facilitators and reviewers should watch for indirect punishment. A participant may not openly attack a critic, but may later exclude them, ignore their future comments, ridicule their category of concern, or route staff away from them.

Disagreement records need enough continuity to detect retaliation disguised as preference.

Room effects belong in the record. After a participant responds to dissent, do other people speak more freely or less freely? Are staff more willing to flag risk? Can the critic see that the objection was considered without being expected to endorse the result?

Release a disagreement with its claim, evidence, response, later correction, and remaining dispute so an excerpt does not become the whole argument.

Match the response to severity: use educational support, procedural repair, or disciplinary review under the applicable complaint and role rules.

Disagreement behavior also includes the participant's use of institutional tools. A participant may ask for extra time, additional sources, protected consultation, or expert review. Those requests can show seriousness when they are tied to burden, but they can also become delay tactics. The record should preserve the reason and later outcome.

23.1.4 — Revision Capacity

Some participants need silence before response. Some reason through diagrams, drafts, numbers, stories, legal frameworks, spiritual language, or practical examples. Visible reasoning cannot privilege quick verbal dominance as the mark of seriousness. It must capture process through multiple modes while keeping standards of evidence, relevance, respect, and responsibility intact.

Revision capacity means changing a claim when warranted while remaining responsible for its earlier effects. Apply the correction standard in Section 13.3.1 through the records below (Tyler, 2006; Ostrom, 1990).

A revision entry should name its cause. New evidence, affected-person testimony, legal constraint, administrative reality, expert correction, ethical reflection, security information, or a better burden map each changes the work for a different reason. Donor pressure, party instruction, public panic, private leverage, and reputational fear belong in a separate influence field. The distinction lets readers see whether judgment responded to reason, authority, consequence, or pressure without presuming that every influence is improper.

Revision should be connected to drafts. If a policy paragraph changes, the record should state why. Was a group added because it was previously missed? Was a term removed because it created stigma? Was a promise narrowed because implementation was impossible?

A good revision record includes the cost of not revising. What burden would have remained if the earlier version had stood? It also allows apology, remedy, or affected-person response where the earlier view caused harm.

Public readers also need to see when revision was offered but refused. If an expert, staff member, minority report, or affected person proposed a change that the participant rejected, the reason for rejection may be as important as revisions accepted.

Review the declared influences when revision affects prior public claims, donor or party interests, staff criticism, or protected groups. Do not infer motive from the change alone.

Revision also involves public explanation of continuity. A participant who changes one claim may still preserve a deeper principle. The record should help readers see whether the participant abandoned a value, refined a method, narrowed a remedy, or corrected a factual premise.

Revision capacity cannot become a demand for endless pliability. Some burdens require a participant to resist pressure

after careful review. The record should preserve when a participant held position because evidence, law, affected-person protection, or rights discipline required firmness.

23.1.5 — Public Trust Need

Use Section 23.3.5's context labels and publish which reasoning materials and protected summaries will be available, when and under what limits. The public retains judgment.

The public trust need also includes memory over time. Reasoning records should allow later readers to see whether a participant's stated limits were honored, whether corrections changed future behavior, and whether repeated patterns emerged. Trust is longitudinal, not a single release event.

23.2 — Seminar, Debate, and Working-Group Forms

Deliberative forms should let inquiry, contest, drafting, dissent, and facilitation serve public-power formation while keeping participation connected to institutional accountability (OECD, 2020a; OECD, 2022b; OECD, 2025a; Gastil, 2008). Seminars, debates, and working groups do different work. A seminar slows inquiry so participants can understand a problem before choosing a side. A debate tests competing claims and exposes weak assumptions.

23.2.1 — Seminar Structure

A seminar is a protected inquiry form. Its purpose is not to win, impress, or announce a final position. It gives participants space to encounter concepts, testimony, evidence, legal limits, field knowledge, and disagreement before public stance hardens. The seminar should be recorded as learning under formation, not as a finished platform (OECD, 2020a; OECD, 2022b; Gastil, 2008).

The seminar requires a question protocol. Each session begins with the problem, affected burdens, core sources, protected categories, and expected uncertainty. Participants must know whether the session concerns law, administration, economics, ethics, data, history, local knowledge, security, or direct lived experience.

Apply the facilitation and access rules in Section 23.2.5, including written and asynchronous responses when needed.

The seminar record should include question evolution. Did the participant ask better questions by the end? Did they identify a burden they had missed? Did they confuse a legal constraint with a moral preference? Did they recognize a source limitation?

Seminar records should label provisional thought as provisional. Misunderstandings, exploratory questions, and

abandoned positions can remain evidence of learning without being released or summarized as final ideology.

Seminar access rules should be clear. Some seminars may be public-facing, some participant-only, some expert-led, some protected because of sensitive examples, and some delayed until affected-person review is complete.

The seminar also needs a source packet with status labels. Participants should know which materials are foundational, contested, illustrative, legally sensitive, outdated, confidential, or included for criticism.

Keep concept maps, revised questions, source annotations, and burden maps alongside transcripts when they show learning. Apply the seminar's provisional-status and access rules to release.

The remedy for seminar failure may include re-facilitation, additional source review, mentor intervention, accessibility redesign, or public correction if the seminar was already bundled.

23.2.2 — Debate Discipline

Debate tests claims under opposition. It is valuable because power often becomes dangerous when it never encounters a serious adversary before acting. But debate is also dangerous because it can reward speed, aggression, rhetorical elegance, and audience approval over accuracy, restraint, and burden awareness (Gastil, 2008; Gutmann and Thompson, 1996).

The City's debate discipline begins with issue framing. Participants should know the proposition, burden categories, evidence limits, protected persons, and standards of relevance before the exchange begins. A debate about emergency secrecy, for example, cannot be judged by the same public-release expectations as a debate about routine budgeting.

Assess evidence, legal accuracy, treatment of affected people, uptake of dissent, and later revision under Section 23.1.3; fluency or hesitation alone is not the result.

Debate design should limit the influence of audience reaction. Applause, virality, laughter, outrage, or immediate polling can distort deliberation. The City may record the presence of public pressure, but it should not allow crowd response to become an unofficial verdict on reasoning.

Debate also needs recovery. Adversarial testing can intensify stress, shame, defensiveness, and identity threat. Participants and critics should have post-debate debrief, correction routes, protected clarification, and status labels for claims shown to be inaccurate.

Debate design should separate preparation from live exchange. Preparation records show sources, burdens, and anticipated objections; the exchange shows pressure behavior; post-debate records show reflection.

The City can use rotating burdens in debate. A participant may be required to defend a position they do not prefer, identify the strongest objection to their preferred view, or describe the affected group most likely to be harmed by their conclusion. The record shows how the participant handles an opposing argument without requiring them to adopt it.

Apply Section 23.2.5 to debate pacing and access, with written supplements, pauses, clarification windows, and later correction.

A debate record should also mark claims that were conceded, refined, deferred, or left unresolved.

Debate topics should be selected for formation value rather than spectacle value. The most useful question may be technical, local, or administratively dull.

23.2.3 — Working Groups

Each form must have a record boundary. A seminar record may emphasize questions, sources, uncertainty, and conceptual change. A debate record may emphasize objections, burden tests, and responses. A working-group record may emphasize drafts, decision logs, assignment of reasons, and unresolved dependencies. The same release rules should not govern every form because the risks differ.

Working groups are where deliberation becomes institutional craft. A working group must produce a decision-ready chain: draft rule, implementation map, budget assumptions, service route, staffing and maintenance needs, record and release protocol, oversight, and remedy. The output should identify unresolved dependencies and the public authority that would still need to act (Bächtiger et al., 2018; Curato et al., 2017).

The working group record must show membership, purpose, authority, assignments, sources, affected-person input, unresolved questions, and decision rules. Label the resulting advice as binding, advisory, contested, protected or referred elsewhere under Section 21.3, without implying that deliberation grants governmental decision power.

A working group should also record abandoned alternatives. Citizens learn something important when they see that a faster rule was abandoned because it harmed disabled users, that a cheaper option was rejected because it hid staff labor, or that a dramatic release plan was narrowed because it exposed nonparticipants.

Working groups also require membership review. If every group is staffed by people with the same training, ideology, class position, or institutional loyalty, the draft may look rigorous while missing the decisive burden. Diversity here means relevant knowledge and affected stakes, not ornamental inclusion.

Record the office, budget, timeline, staff capacity, and appeal route for each safeguard, including who carries the operational duty and what happens if it is not met.

Working-group products should include sunset or review conditions where appropriate. If a proposal depends on uncertain data, untested technology, or unfamiliar host conditions, the draft should state when it must return for review.

Working groups should include cost-to-maintain analysis, identifying recurring training, translation, technical support, and audit capacity alongside staffing costs.

A working-group handoff note should identify questions beyond this volume’s scope. Within the series, *The Constitution of Fairness* examines rights, legal validity, and enforceability; *The Peace of Fairness* examines macroeconomic capacity, infrastructure, and material distribution; *The Government of Fairness* examines public administration; and *The Transition of Fairness* examines sequencing and authorization requirements.

A working group can be tested with a fictional case in which useful information is distributed across roles. One member knows the legal constraint, another the staffing limit, and another a fact that changes an apparently attractive option. Each initially records a view before discussion. The review then asks whether the group surfaced and used the distinct information, not merely whether members spoke equally or reached agreement. Research on unshared information shows why a group’s available knowledge and the knowledge actually discussed are different objects (Stasser and Titus, 1985).

The case key identifies the supplied facts and procedural requirements while leaving genuine value tradeoffs open. A later task changes which role holds the decisive information. The exercise tests a transferable habit: seek the missing perspective

before agreement hardens. No confidential fact from a real household or worker is needed.

23.2.4 — Minority Reports

A working group converts reasoning into practical language, budgets, rules, timelines, and safeguards. Minority reports preserve serious dissent when a claim of consensus would be misleading. Facilitation rules protect the room from domination, exclusion, and performance incentives.

A minority report preserves material dissent that apparent consensus would otherwise erase (Stasser and Titus, 1985; Edmondson, 1999).

Minority reports should be protected as normal deliberative artifacts. A participant, staff member, expert, affected-person representative, or working group subset should be able to record a principled objection without being treated as disloyal. The report should state the claim, the burden at issue, the evidence or value being disputed, and the remedy or alternative proposed.

Minority reports need thresholds. Not every stray disagreement requires a formal report, and not every formal report carries equal weight. The City can distinguish material dissent, protected-person dissent, expert dissent, implementation dissent, rights dissent, and interpretive dissent.

A minority report should travel with the public bundle where its issue remains relevant. If a final decision relies on a contested assumption, citizens should be able to see that the assumption was contested. If an objection was later answered, the answer should travel with it. If the objection remains unresolved, that status must remain visible.

The report must not become a weapon for endless veto. The City can preserve dissent without requiring that dissent always stop action. Some decisions must move under uncertainty. The

fair question is whether dissent was heard, represented accurately, answered where possible, and kept available for future review.

A minority report should have a protected submission path independent of the hierarchy that produced the majority view.

Majority response also belongs in the record. The final decision should state whether the report changed the draft, was rejected, was deferred, triggered expert review, or remains attached as unresolved dissent.

Minority reports can help the majority learn from error. If a decision later proves wrong, reviewers can examine whether the report contained a relevant warning and how it was handled. The report's existence alone does not establish that its alternative was correct or that the majority acted unreasonably.

23.2.5 — Facilitation Rules

Facilitation prevents speed, status, fluency, aggression, seniority, charisma, or fear from capturing deliberation. Unmanaged rooms often shift burden to quieter, junior, disabled, non-native, staff, local, or socially exposed voices (OECD, 2020a; OECD, 2022b; Gastil, 2008).

Rules should govern speaking order, clarification, time balance, evidence, protected details, accessibility, translation, written input, interruption, and recourse when someone dominates.

Facilitator authority must remain reviewable. Logs should record material interventions, redirection, exclusion, and complaint routes because facilitation can protect fairness or quietly steer the room.

Anti-performance facilitation keeps the room from rewarding staged listening or theatrical attack. Attention stays on burden, evidence, relevance, and remedy.

Review after the session tracks interruption, lost attribution, deferred objections, unequal clarification, and who leaves more exposed.

Facilitation training includes power literacy: class, disability, race, gender, language, credentials, fame, staff dependency, and trauma can shape who speaks and who is believed.

Confidential interventions stay protected. A facilitator may pause for overload, a protected category, or nonparticipant exposure; public notes record the procedural reason, not sensitive detail.

Use retraining, role separation, external observation, revised protocols, accessibility redesign, or participant feedback to remedy facilitation failures.

Participants and nonparticipants may pause or leave for health, safety, religion, disability, trauma, or care without losing their right to contribute. The record marks procedure without exposing the private reason.

When discussion crosses into protected health, family, legal, intimate, or child-related material, pause or redirect the exchange and apply the relevant capture and access rules before continuing. A change of release label cannot authorize prohibited capture.

23.3 — Drafting, Notes, Traceability, Revision History

A public position usually has a paper trail before it has a podium. Drafts, notes, outlines, comments, source files, meeting summaries, decision logs, version histories, and release notes often show more about judgment than the final speech or policy sentence. The City must therefore treat intellectual artifacts as public-power formation, but only under careful status control (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; W3C, 2013). Drafts and notes become governed artifacts.

23.3.1 — Draft Origin

Draft origin matters because authorship is a form of power. A position written by the participant, staff, an expert, a consultant, a party-aligned advisor, an affected-person group, or a donor-connected office carries different interpretive implications. The City must know who began the text and why (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; W3C, 2013).

The origin record should identify initial drafter, role, source materials, mandate, time pressure, and known constraints. A participant may still own a text they did not first write, but the public should not be asked to believe that every polished sentence arose from independent judgment.

Some drafts begin from templates. Template use may be efficient, but it can smuggle ideology, institutional defaults, legal assumptions, or hidden interests into formation. The record should identify template source, prior use, adaptation, and known limitations.

Collaborative drafts need role clarity. A staff member may supply operational detail, a lawyer may supply legal constraints, a community representative may supply burden descriptions, and the participant may set public direction. The record should

separate these contributions so credit and accountability do not collapse.

Credit staff and other contributors under Section 21.5.4 when their work becomes participant-authored text.

Apply protected source attribution under Section 23.5.5 when sensitive material shaped a draft.

Draft origin can also reveal institutional dependence. If the first drafts of a participant's positions consistently come from one office, one advisor, one ideological network, or one private channel, the pattern may matter more than any single text.

If origin is disputed, the record should carry a dispute label and review route.

Draft-origin records should preserve affected-person language when it materially shapes the final text and attribution is safe. The record may name the contributor, identify a protected contributor category, or preserve sealed provenance with a public summary.

23.3.2 — Revision Trail

A revision trail records material changes and unresolved disagreements in a public-relevant text (W3C, 2013; Bowker and Star, 1999).

Apply Section 10.4.3's version policy to collaborative drafts. Tag meaning-changing revisions by affected burden, source, reason, reviewer and status, while linking material dispute and protected redactions.

A revision trail should preserve objections that changed the text. If a minority report added a disability accommodation, that link should remain. If a legal review removed an unlawful power, that link should remain. If a staff complaint changed workload assumptions, that link should remain.

The trail must also show when a change increased risk. Not every revision is improvement. A participant may remove a safeguard to satisfy a political constituency, weaken a complaint route to preserve image, or obscure a cost to protect support. The revision record should flag contested changes rather than assuming later versions are always better.

Provide material-change summaries and links to appropriately accessible deeper versions.

Deletion pressure requires active monitoring. A participant, staff member, donor, advisor, or institution may want a damaging early version removed. Deletion, sealing, or restricted access may sometimes be justified, but convenience, embarrassment, and image protection are not enough.

Revision trails also help identify burden migration. A draft may remove one visible burden by creating another hidden burden elsewhere: adding a rights procedure that overloads staff, protecting privacy in a way that obscures accountability, or accelerating public release in a way that harms nonparticipants.

The revision trail can include public-risk notes. A change may be made because a phrase is true but too easily cropped, because a protected group might be misidentified, or because a release would invite harassment.

Revision review should include regression checks. A later version may fix one defect while reintroducing an old one. The City should track whether revisions revive surveillance drift, proof drift, public-appetite language, staff invisibility, or authority beyond the City's domain after earlier revisions addressed those risks.

23.3.3 — Source Notes

Source notes implement the evidence-use rules in Section 23.1.2 by linking each material source to its introducer, relevance,

limits, and effect on the work (Duranti, 1998; Nissenbaum, 2010). Use protected attribution under Section 23.5.5 when a source's identity or contents cannot be released.

Source notes should also record missing sources. If current data was unavailable, legal review pending, field testimony deferred, local consultation incomplete, or science unsettled, absence becomes part of public interpretation.

Source notes should connect to reading responsibility. A participant cannot cite a report they have not understood as if the citation itself were competence. The record may distinguish direct reading, staff synthesis, expert briefing, and secondhand reliance.

The City can also mark source freshness. Some legal, scientific, technological, demographic, or security sources become outdated quickly. A record should not treat an old source as current simply because it remains rhetorically useful.

Source notes should preserve contested translations. When materials cross language, culture, technical vocabulary, or legal systems, translation can shape meaning. The record should identify translator role, interpretation limits, and unresolved ambiguity when translation affects public-power reasoning.

Source notes also support future correction. When a source is later retracted, superseded, legally changed, or shown to be misused, the City can trace the recorded reasoning paths that cite it.

A source note should identify whether the source came from a documented search strategy, a participant's existing network, staff curation, a donor, an advocacy group, a critic, or a public comment. Origin does not decide validity, but it helps readers understand possible selection pressure.

23.3.4 — Decision Logs

A decision log connects deliberation to an action, recommendation, or deliberate non-action through the fields below (Roberts, 2006; European Union, 2016).

The log should distinguish decisions, recommendations, drafts, provisional positions, procedural rulings, release decisions, referrals, and deferrals. A public reader should not mistake a working recommendation for an authorized policy or a procedural pause for a secret rejection.

Decision logs need reasons and a time-specific evidence trail. Alongside the decision date, record when a relevant event occurred and when its evidence became available to the decision maker. Later additions retain their own receipt dates. A declaration may have existed before a recommendation yet been missing from a reviewer's export; the log should make both facts reconstructible rather than retrospectively giving that reviewer knowledge they did not have.

The reasons still identify decisive burdens, rights concerns, operational and legal limits, dissent, and unresolved dependencies. A correction distinguishes a newly supplied fact from a changed interpretation of evidence already available. This allows reviewers to examine the original judgment fairly while also asking whether an avoidable search or handoff failure deprived it of necessary information. The trail records responsibility without requiring unrestricted access to the protected source. Availability does not establish that the decision maker read or understood the item. A contemporaneous citation or authorized consultation record may show use; otherwise that question remains open.

The log must include non-decisions. Choosing not to act, not to release, not to adopt a proposal, not to continue a line of

inquiry, or not to accept an advisor recommendation can be as significant as affirmative action.

Attach the protected correction route in Section 23.1.1 to decision-log entries, including omitted dissent, misstated reasons, and exposure errors.

Logs must remain readable. Technical fields may exist, but public bundles should translate status, reason, burden, and correction routes into plain language without sacrificing precision.

The log must show whether unresolved dissent traveled to the final explanation.

Consider an illustrative working group that recommends publishing an emergency summary. Its log states that the group may recommend release but cannot authorize it; the designated release officer must first obtain the required rights and safety review. The entry links the sources, dissent, decision, and review date. If harm later emerges, reviewers can test the failed assumption and responsible decision rather than reconstructing authority from recollection.

23.3.5 — Context Labels

Status, relevance, protected categories, and interpretation need determine whether an artifact is retained, summarized, delayed, restricted, or released. The record should make development intelligible without making every exploratory sentence permanent public property.

Context labels prevent fragments from pretending to be whole. A sentence from a seminar, a phrase in a draft, a note to a mentor, a rejected option, a minority report, or an early error can mislead badly when separated from its status (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; W3C, 2013).

The record needs status labels such as draft, abandoned draft, superseded, disputed, corrected, protected, delayed, sealed, preliminary, expert-contested, minority report attached, affected-person reply pending, legal review pending, operational review pending, and public summary only. The labels must be simple enough for public use and exact enough for expert review.

Labels should travel with excerpts. If a public bundle includes a paragraph from an early draft, the status must remain attached wherever the paragraph appears in official City materials. A record-site interface that allows copying without labels invites hostile cropping and public confusion.

Labels require governance. Someone must decide them, challenge them, update them, and audit them. The labeling office must be separated from the participant's image interest, donor pressure, and public-relations appetite.

Artificial Intelligence may help people navigate a large record, but it does not control status labels. A system can propose candidate categories, locate related material, or surface possible inconsistencies for human review. Final labels remain governed, appealable, versioned, and attributable to named human decision owners.

Provide an accessible public glossary for context labels, with examples showing a superseded draft and a delayed release.

Context labels also need time review. A protected category may remain protected, a delayed release may become releasable, a disputed item may be resolved, or a correction may supersede earlier language.

Mislabeling requires remedy. If a draft is released as final, a protected summary treated as raw evidence, or a disputed claim presented as settled, the correction should be visible to prior readers where possible.

Labels require bias review. A majority position may receive neutral labels while dissent receives alarming labels. A participant-favorable record may sound procedural while a critic-favorable record sounds accusatory. Labeling language must be audited for asymmetry.

23.4 — Error, Apology, and Public Learning

Public learning is the goal. The City should create records that help citizens understand how reasoning failed and how institutions corrected it, without turning the harmed into props or the participant into a public exhibit of shame. A useful correction record states what was known when a decision was made and what changed after challenge. It also identifies a remedy when an apology alone does not repair the harm.

23.4.1 — Error Recognition

Begin error recognition by identifying what was wrong, who was affected, what evidence or burden was missed, and whether harm continues (Tavris and Aronson, 2007; Lazare, 2004; Lewicki et al., 2016).

Recognition must distinguish error type. Factual error, legal error, interpretive error, process error, burden omission, protected-detail exposure, source misattribution, staff-credit failure, and public-release mistake require different responses. Record whether the error emerged through self-correction, staff intervention, expert or affected-person challenge, adversarial criticism, audit or public discovery. Discovery route matters: an institution that corrects only after public harm needs a different remedy from one that catches the failure before release.

Speed matters, but speed is not the only measure. Some errors should be corrected immediately. Others require legal review, clinical protection, affected-person consultation, or technical verification. The record should show why timing was chosen.

Apply the protected-attribution and disclosure limits in Section 23.5.5 to error explanations so correction does not widen the original exposure.

Error recognition should trigger a local burden review. What burden did the error shift, hide, intensify, or misclassify? A

wrong citation may be minor in one context and grave in another if it justified a decision affecting housing, health, liberty, or safety. Error severity follows burden, not embarrassment.

External recognition deserves protection. Critics, staff, journalists, affected persons, and experts who identify error should not be treated as threats to the City.

If overload contributed to error, use the care-first and de-loading routes in Sections 18.6.2–18.6.3 alongside correction.

Near misses also belong in the record. A harmful release stopped before publication, a misleading claim caught in review, or an omitted group restored before final decision may not require public scandal, but it can reveal whether safeguards are working.

Error recognition must include institutional errors. Not every mistake belongs primarily to the participant. A form may be badly designed, a facilitator poorly trained, a source packet incomplete, or a record interface misleading.

23.4.2 — Public Error Apology Standards

Apology standards prevent public regret from becoming reputation management. An apology should identify the act or omission, the burden created, the people affected where lawful to name, the correction being made, the remedy available, and the future practice changed (Lewicki et al., 2016; Coombs, 2007).

Apply the reflection-without-confession boundary in Section 18.5.5: assess correction and repair, not emotional display.

Ask affected people what response they need, including no contact. Apply the remedy route without allowing a participant's wish to apologize to override safety or refusal.

Label the stage of apology and explain timing using the verification and protection requirements in Section 23.4.1.

An apology does not close outstanding legal, complaint, care, correction, or remedy processes.

Apology cannot become loyalty extraction. Staff, dependents, partners, critics, or affected persons should not be pressured to forgive publicly, endorse the participant's growth, or reassure the record site.

The apology may need multiple audiences. Staff, affected persons, the public, a professional body, a working group, or a protected nonparticipant may require different forms of communication. A single public statement may be insufficient or unsafe.

Apology records should include commitments that can be checked later. If the participant promises to change a review practice, cite sources more accurately, consult affected persons earlier, or limit a claim, the record should return to that promise in later review.

Depending on the burden, remedy may also require personnel change.

Apology standards should include nonverbal repair. Sometimes the most meaningful apology is changed schedule, restored access, corrected record, paid cost, protected silence, or reduced burden.

23.4.3 — Revision After Error

After a serious error, connect the finding to a concrete change and test whether the change addresses its cause (Benoit, 1995; Hearit, 2006).

The revision must match the error. A factual correction needs corrected evidence. A burden omission may need affected-person consultation. A process error may need facilitation change. A protected-detail exposure may need shielding, notification, remedy, and technical review.

Rejected remedies should be preserved too. If an affected person requested a remedy the City denied, the record should state the reason within lawful limits. If a proposed correction was found insufficient, that history matters.

Repeated error requires escalation. If the same kind of reasoning failure appears across settings, the remedy may shift from local correction to pathway review, mentoring change, pause, role reassessment, release limitation, or readiness caution.

Revision after error should identify whether the earlier error reached public release. An internal draft error may require one route; a public bundle error may require notification, corrected release notes, and a visible update trail.

Cosmetic revision requires separate scrutiny. A participant may change wording while leaving the underlying burden untouched. Reviewers need to ask whether the revision alters decision criteria, affected-person protection, staff load, release status, or remedy routes.

Seek qualified independent review when the correction exceeds the City's competence.

Revision should be checked against affected-person experience after implementation. A corrected draft may still fail in practice. The City should return to those who carried the original burden, when safe and lawful, to ask whether the repair actually reduced harm.

A serious revision record also names what cannot be repaired. In those cases the City should not pretend that correction restores the prior condition. It can still provide remedy, prevention, and public memory of the injury.

23.4.4 — Public Explanation After Error

Use the public-explanation craft in Section 22.5.5 to report the error, repair, protected limits, and next review (Dekker, 2012;

Edmondson, 1999). The explanation should avoid defensive inflation. The City should not bury a correction under institutional praise, participant biography, general values language, or long reminders that the City is difficult. If an error occurred, the explanation should name it directly within lawful and dignity-preserving limits.

A good explanation includes status. Is the correction final, provisional, disputed, under appeal, awaiting expert review, or subject to later time review?

Give harmed people a protected remedy and appeal route distinct from the public explanation.

Journalistic use must be anticipated. A public explanation may become a headline, excerpt, or clip. The City should write explanations so the core status travels even when quoted briefly: what happened, what it means, what it does not mean, and where correction stands.

The level of public detail should follow burden, protected status, and public relevance.

Communications staff may improve clarity; the authority responsible for correction and remedy must control the substance.

Public explanations should identify responsibility directly. Saying that an error occurred may hide who had authority, which system failed, and where remedy lies. Clarity does not require cruelty, but it does require a subject, an action, and an accountable route.

Explanation records should be coordinated with archives. If the public explanation differs from the underlying correction log, citizens will encounter contradictory memory. The archive, record site, right-of-reply system, and public statement must carry the same status architecture.

23.4.5 — No Humiliation Rule

The no-humiliation rule governs how error is presented: the record serves repair and public understanding, not degradation (Tyler, 2006; Tavris and Aronson, 2007; Lazare, 2004).

Apply the rule to everyone implicated in an error, including harmed people, critics, and opponents.

This rule does not erase accountability. Serious harm, repeated misconduct, bad-faith deception, retaliation, or protected-detail exposure may require strong public notice. The difference is purpose. Accountability names burden and remedy; humiliation extracts pleasure or status from another person's exposure.

Use the release test below to set context, summary, delay, moderation, anti-doxxing, and appeal defaults.

A pre-release humiliation review should ask four questions: whether the detail is necessary for civic interpretation; whether a less exposing summary would carry the same public value; whether vulnerable or collateral people would be identifiable; and whether timing, framing, or interface design turns correction into spectacle. The outcome and reviewer should be recorded. A qualitative judgment remains contestable.

The no-humiliation rule should shape public excerpts. A chapter, guide page, caption, diagram, or social post should not use a person's error as a dramatic hook if the same lesson can be taught through structure.

Humiliation review should also include cumulative exposure. One release may be justified, while repeated references, excerpts, summaries, and commentary turn the same event into permanent punishment. Time review helps prevent accountability from becoming endless display.

23.5 — Advisors, Influence, and Intellectual Dependency

Material influence must be legible, credited, bounded, and reviewable. This section maps the advice and dependencies behind consequential judgment (Hardwig, 1985; Collins and Evans, 2007; Jasanoff, 2003). A declaration of independence has little value if advisors quietly determine the available alternatives. The influence record should disclose the scope of advice and explain the participant's response to it.

23.5.1 — Advisor Mapping

Advisor mapping identifies the people, institutions, and systems that materially shaped a public-relevant judgment. It does not require listing every conversation or private friendship. It focuses on influence that changed evidence, framing, burden recognition, legal understanding, policy design, public explanation, or decision timing (Hardwig, 1985; Collins and Evans, 2007; Jasanoff, 2003).

A useful map includes advisor role, domain, relationship to the participant, potential conflicts, authority level, contribution, affected sections of the record, and release status. A lawyer who identifies a rights limit, an engineer who reveals feasibility constraints, and a resident who names a lived burden each belong on the map in different ways.

The map should distinguish formal and informal influence. Formal advisors may appear in schedules and official records. Informal influence may arrive through texts, private networks, party channels, social media, family expectations, donor communities, or ideological groups.

Apply protected attribution under Section 23.5.5 to sensitive advisory relationships.

The map should also identify consequential rejections of advice.

Advisor maps need correction, reply, and appeal routes. An advisor may dispute characterization, a participant may omit material influence, a staff member may identify side-channel pressure, or an affected person may show that a community source was misused. The review should preserve the contested entry, identify the decision owner, protect confidential sources, and record the outcome without forcing disclosure of privileged, clinical, pastoral, security-sensitive, or protected personal material.

Use the materiality threshold in Section 21.5.1; ordinary private contact does not become an advisor entry merely because it occurred.

Conflict fields are also necessary. Advisors may have financial, political, institutional, professional, ideological, familial, vendor, platform, employment, or reputational interests. The map should distinguish a disclosed interest, an unmanaged conflict, a prohibited relationship, and an allegation under review. Conflicts do not automatically disqualify advice, but undisclosed or unbounded conflicts distort interpretation.

Protect advisors against harassment and retaliation, using role or contribution attribution when identification is unsafe. Keep a confidential route for them to correct the entry.

Advisor mapping can also reveal imbalance. If a participant repeatedly draws on elite experts while affected communities appear only as examples, the pattern should trigger formation review.

23.5.2 — Expert Dependence

Public judgment necessarily relies on expertise beyond any one participant’s knowledge. The task is to make that reliance

examined and accountable (Jasanoff, 2003; Longino, 1990). Expert literacy begins with asking the right questions. What does this field know with confidence? What remains uncertain? Which assumptions drive the recommendation? Who may be harmed if the expert frame is too narrow? What alternative expert views exist? What is outside the expert's competence? What evidence would change the advice?

Expert dependence must not become expert sovereignty. An expert can inform the public-power seeker, but cannot silently govern through them. The participant remains responsible for how expertise is translated into authority, especially where values, rights, tradeoffs, local knowledge, or affected-person burdens exceed the expert's technical domain.

The protocol should trigger qualified review when the subject exceeds ordinary deliberative competence, before public release or consequential action. The record names the review lane, scope, unresolved disagreement, and decision owner.

Expert disagreement is most useful when the point that would change the recommendation is visible. Ask each adviser to distinguish a disputed fact from a forecast and from a value choice, then state what evidence or changed condition would alter the advice. Two experts may agree about likely cost yet differ about whose risk should receive priority; another pair may share the same objective but disagree about a causal assumption. The participant's account should preserve that distinction, identify any agreed ground, and explain which reason controls the decision. A short jointly checked statement of agreement and disagreement can make reliance inspectable without forcing consensus. Where uncertainty remains, record which reversible step could learn more and who is responsible for reassessment.

Expert dependence may create unequal access. Wealthy, well-connected, institutionally fluent participants may already

have networks of high-status advice. The City must provide access to qualified expertise without allowing private advisor networks to become hidden advantage.

When a conclusion depends heavily on specialized judgment, an expert-dependence note makes that reliance visible. It identifies the domain contribution, what the participant understood, where uncertainty remained, and which value choices stayed outside technical expertise. The note also names recusal, conflict, and review where relevant.

Expert shopping requires explicit review. A participant may seek experts until one supports a preferred view, choose a prestigious name over a relevant specialist, or ignore a qualified dissenting analysis. The record should show the selection rationale, the material rival perspectives considered, the limits of available expertise, and whether the participant sought authority for comfort rather than knowledge.

Credit and bound staff work translating expert advice under Section 21.5.4; leadership remains responsible for overclaims it adopts.

Expert dependence also creates a translation burden. An expert may speak in terms the public cannot use. The participant must translate without simplifying away uncertainty, converting a jurisdiction-specific opinion into universal law, or turning expert caution into political certainty. The record should preserve the source statement, the participant's translation, material edits, and a route for the expert to challenge misrepresentation.

23.5.3 — Ideological Dependency

Ideological dependency occurs when a participant borrows a frame so deeply that it does the thinking before public burden is examined. Every person has traditions, loyalties, theories, histories, and moral vocabularies. The City need not demand

neutrality. It must ask whether the participant can see when a frame hides burden (Kitcher, 2001; Kuran, 1995).

Ideological-dependency review looks for a frame that answers every problem before the evidence arrives. Market failure, state overreach, cultural decline, individual responsibility, historical oppression, technological inefficiency, spiritual failure, national interest, security, or administrative competence may each reveal something important. Any of them can become a blinder when rival causes and affected-person accounts are forced into the same story. The record should show where an alternative frame changed the problem definition or remained excluded without adequate reason.

Ideological dependency is not proved by consistency. A participant may hold stable convictions after serious inquiry. The concern appears when the frame cannot be challenged, when evidence is forced to fit, when dissent is dismissed by category, or when affected persons become examples rather than interlocutors.

The City can test ideological dependency through counter-frame exercises. Participants should explain a problem from rival serious perspectives, identify what each frame sees and misses, and state what burden their own preferred frame is most likely to hide.

Limit ideological review to reasoning on the public task; use protected attribution under Section 23.5.5 when a contribution cannot safely be named.

Ideological dependency also appears through communities. A party, movement, religion, profession, university, media ecosystem, or online network may reward certain conclusions before evidence enters. The record should show whether the participant can maintain respect for a community without outsourcing judgment to it.

The City can use frame audits in high-stakes deliberation. A frame audit identifies the dominant vocabulary of the participant's reasoning, the burdens that vocabulary tends to see, and the burdens it tends to miss.

Use the counter-frame exercise, relevant consultation, or mentoring to reopen inadequately examined reasoning; pause consequential release where necessary. The purpose is better examination, not ideological conversion.

Ideological review can include self-authored limit statements. Participants can name the arguments their own tradition finds hardest to hear, the people it tends to undercount, and the evidence that would force reconsideration.

Protect lawful convictions and affiliations; assess role-relevant reasoning rather than conformity to an institutional ideology.

23.5.4 — Hidden Influence Review

Hidden influence review searches for side channels that shape judgment without appearing in the formal record. It is one of the City's core anti-capture tasks because public-power formation often moves through private meetings, informal messages, favors, emotional leverage, social belonging, future career promises, and donor or party expectations (Carpenter and Moss, 2014; Bovens, 2007).

Influence review looks for timing anomalies, unexplained draft changes, repeated alignment with unlogged actors, sudden shifts after private contact, staff reports, visitor records, gift or sponsorship traces, data-access logs, and communications requiring lawful review. Findings remain contestable and proportionate to the evidence.

Use lawful, independently reviewed inquiry tied to specific role-relevant indicators. The material-influence threshold in

Section 21.5.1 does not authorize general surveillance of private life.

Apply the independent, confidential reporting and anti-retaliation protections in Section 21.4.5 to reports of side-channel pressure.

Findings require status discipline. Confirmed hidden influence, unresolved concern, false alarm, protected review, and no finding have different public meanings. The City must not allow suspicion to become accusation or secrecy to become exoneration.

Hidden influence review should include vendor and platform influence where relevant. Search tools, recommendation systems, analytics dashboards, model summaries, and proprietary data interfaces can shape what a participant sees before they know they are being guided.

Review documented or disclosed pressure from personal and institutional relationships when it materially affects the public task. Do not infer hidden feelings or improper influence from affiliation alone.

Independent auditors need enough access to test the pattern without becoming a new center of uncontrolled exposure. Audit protocols should define scope, protected categories, documentation, and public status of findings before review begins.

If a hidden influence concern is investigated and not supported, record the finding and its limits so unresolved suspicion does not become an unsupported accusation.

Examine authorized role-access records for repeated unscheduled consultation, early drafts, or interpretive privileges. Such patterns may warrant inquiry; they do not alone establish improper influence.

23.5.5 — Credit and Accountability

Credit and accountability must travel together. A participant should not absorb the insight of staff, experts, affected persons, translators, critics, or community groups as if it were solitary genius (Hardwig, 1985; Collins and Evans, 2007; Jasanoff, 2003).

Attribute material contributions in public bundles through the contribution notes below, using protected provenance when safe naming is not possible.

Accountability remains with the participant when they adopt a conclusion. A participant cannot say that an expert made them do it, a staff member wrote it, a community demanded it, or data forced it. The record may show influence, but the participant must explain why that influence was accepted and what burden the acceptance carries.

Attribution can itself create harm. Naming a survivor, patient, child, protected source, security reviewer, or vulnerable critic may expose the person whose contribution improved the work. The protocol therefore permits categorical, delayed, anonymized, sealed, or summarized credit, with a protected provenance record where appropriate.

A contribution note can state that a safeguard originated from staff review, community testimony, or expert challenge, while the participant's final explanation states why it was adopted. Contribution notes should preserve enough provenance to distinguish original input from the participant's later adoption or revision.

Refused credit also belongs in the influence record. Some contributors may not want public association, especially in polarized or sensitive matters. Respecting refusal can be part of fair credit, so long as the record still avoids presenting the participant as solitary source of the insight. Protected

provenance can preserve the existence of outside contribution without forcing a contributor into public identification.

23.6 — Deliberation as Operational Evidence, Not Proof

Deliberation supplies operational evidence of how a defined task was handled. The following distinctions limit what may be claimed from that evidence (Bovens, 2007; OECD, 2020a). Official summaries and extracts must identify the source artifact, stage, dispute status, and limits relevant to their particular claim. Link to the governing interpretation guidance rather than reproducing the full warning in every artifact.

23.6.1 — Evidence of Process

The evidence is operational because it concerns the functioning of the City's formation system. Did the seminar structure work? Did minority reports travel? Did advisors get mapped? Did source notes remain accurate? Did correction routes function? Did protected categories remain shielded? These are institutional questions, not metaphysical conclusions.

Describe process evidence in qualitative, role-specific terms under the no-ranking and no-profiling rules in Section 11.7.6.

Include failures relevant to the public task, with the same scope, evidence, and challenge rights as favorable observations.

Process evidence should be office-specific. Deliberation about municipal zoning, national security, judicial appointment, public health, and procurement each has different burdens. The same record pattern may mean different things depending on the office pathway.

Process evidence is temporal. A deliberative habit can improve, degrade, or change under office pressure, so every public claim should identify the observation period and review date. Older evidence may remain historically useful without functioning as a current readiness statement.

Process evidence should be compared to the City's own obligations. A good participant record means little if the City failed to provide accessible rooms, fair facilitation, qualified sources, staff support, or complaint routes.

Incomplete process evidence should be labeled rather than repaired by inference. Missing transcripts, protected summaries, technical failures, late corrections, or sealed material may narrow what the public can conclude. State the missing interval, reason, likely consequence, and whether reconstruction is possible in the authorized review record; disclose those details publicly only where safe and lawful.

23.6.2 — Not Proof of Virtue

Visible reasoning is not proof of virtue. A person can deliberate publicly for strategic reasons, learn the language of humility, credit advisors performatively, apologize well while repeating harm, or revise when reputation requires it (OECD, 2020a; ISO, 2016a).

Public language should describe the observed process without creating a halo. It may state that a participant repeatedly corrected work in a defined domain or handled dissent carefully during a declared period. It should not claim that the City has discovered goodness, loyalty, superior humanity, or future virtue.

Apply Section 11.7.6 to AI navigation and summaries: source-linked assistance must not become personal virtue, trust, or motive inference.

Remove praise terms such as noble, pure, elevated, enlightened, exemplary, or morally proven from official reasoning bundles.

These official-language rules apply to recruitment materials and public artifacts.

23.6.3 — Not Proof of Truth

A good process can still reach an untrue conclusion. Evidence may be incomplete, experts may be wrong, testimony may be partial, administrative data may be biased, legal interpretation may shift, and moral judgment may remain contested. Deliberation records do not convert uncertainty into truth (Tetlock, 2005; Longino, 1990).

Use the context labels in Section 23.3.5 to distinguish the conclusion's evidential and dispute status.

Policy simulations require special care. A simulation can reveal assumptions, tradeoffs, stress points, or scenario behavior. It cannot prove that the real world will behave the same way. Participants must learn to say what a simulation tested and what remains unknown.

Evaluate legal validity, scientific and historical claims, administrative feasibility, moral justification, and local testimony by their appropriate standards. A deliberation record cannot supply one interchangeable test of correctness.

For crisis decisions, apply the time-specific evidence trail in Section 23.3.4 so later review can distinguish knowledge, estimates, protected information, and subsequent discoveries.

The distinction between process and truth helps preserve pluralism. Two participants may reason carefully from different values and still disagree. The City should not force all good process toward one answer merely to reassure the public that visibility works.

23.6.4 — Not Proof of Law

Deliberation records provide operational evidence about the City. Scientific interpretation remains subject to Section 3.6; research reuse requires the separate permissions in Section 11.6.

When deliberation touches the formal Law, the record should preserve the established claim-status labels: formal explanation, established background, conditional analysis, or practical reflection. Scientific rules for measurement, rivals, endpoints, falsification, and verdicts remain with the science domain.

Public artifacts must carry the same status discipline: captions and diagrams must not visually imply that City evidence proves the Law.

The boundary runs in both directions: City success does not validate the Law, and City failure does not falsify it.

23.6.5 — Public Interpretation Limits

A reasoning bundle supports public judgment; it does not direct approval, rejection, nomination, or voting (Bovens, 2007; OECD, 2020a).

Public interpretation guides should make distinctions easier to preserve than to collapse. A reader needs to recognize draft and final, source and conclusion, dissent and disloyalty, error and disgrace, revision and opportunism, advice and capture, and process evidence and truth. Each guide should link to the source artifact, dispute status, correction history, and limits on use.

Apply the accessibility and source-navigation tests in Section 22.6.5 to interpretation guides while preserving status, uncertainty, and protected boundaries.

Apply the separate roles for the source record, journalism, civic discussion, and machine assistance in Section 10.6 when presenting deliberation.

Make the protected correction route in Section 23.1.1 available for misleading bundles, omitted context, and exposure errors.

Public bundles need a deliberate reading order. A reader first sees purpose, status, protected limits, and correction routes, then summary, then deeper record.

Public interpretation should remain plural. A labor advocate, journalist, constitutional lawyer, local resident, party official, scientist, and ordinary voter may draw different conclusions from the same record. The City does not need to force convergence to serve democracy.

The visible-deliberation standard must survive deliberate pressure, where opposition, incomplete information, ambiguity, and stress reveal whether visible reasoning can remain steady without becoming performance. Summaries should preserve unresolved disagreement when it remains material rather than smoothing conflict into institutional consensus.

Chapter 24 — Opposition, Simulation, and Stress

Formation reaches a new level when participants meet serious opposition under governed conditions. A person may read carefully, deliberate gracefully, and write persuasive drafts, yet still become dangerous when challenged by someone who rejects their premises or exposes a burden their allies did not see. Chapter 24 gives opposition an educational role without turning hostility into a civic virtue.

Opposition, simulation, and stress belong inside the City's formation ecology because public power will meet conflict, ambiguity, incomplete information, and time pressure. The chapter's contribution is a governed way to practice under those conditions before real lives depend on the response. Rights, accessibility, professional independence, and distributed stop authority remain part of rigor rather than external restraints on it.

The governing question is where burden goes when pressure arrives. Protective insulation can leave citizens to bear the consequences of untested judgment; humiliating challenge can injure the participant's body and dignity; spectacle can expose participants and critics for audience attention; and overclaim can turn a limited exercise into unwarranted confidence in readiness.

Opposition is educational when it reveals assumptions, burden routes, missing evidence, and weak explanations that friendly formation did not expose. It loses that value when it becomes identity attack, ritual humiliation, partisan capture, or a test of endurance unrelated to the contemplated role. The design question is always which public capacity the challenge is meant to develop and how reviewers will know whether learning occurred.

Simulation adds a different form of learning. It makes timing, authority, information gaps, staff coordination, communication, rights, records, and recovery visible inside a controlled scenario. Fidelity should match the capacity under examination, not the

designer's appetite for drama. A low-tech tabletop exercise may reveal more than an immersive event when the public task is reasoning, coordination, or lawful escalation.

Stress data require context. A response under fatigue, noise, ambiguity, time pressure, role confusion, or sensory overload is evidence about conduct under those conditions, not a pure measure of character. The record should identify the condition, support available, accommodation, authority, observer role, and limits of inference before any readiness claim uses the event.

The chapter also protects role-players, staff, interpreters, clinicians, observers, and affected reviewers. Their labor and exposure can be essential to the exercise, but the participant is not the only rights-bearing person in the room. Everyone should know the scenario boundary, record status, complaint route, stop authority, debrief route, and rules governing later use of their contribution.

The chapter's controlling object is a simulation charter with trauma safeguards joined to an after-action and care protocol. The charter treats design, facilitation, debriefing, evaluation, and improvement as one governed cycle (FEMA, 2020b; INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2021; INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2025a; World Health Organization, 2025b).

24.1 — Why Opposition Is Educational

Opposition can reveal information that supportive discussion has missed. Allies may share vocabulary, political assumptions, institutional loyalties, or emotional investment in a participant's progress, and those bonds can soften challenge or hide failure. Serious opponents introduce different premises, burden memories, and standards of proof before public power makes the disagreement costly (Nemeth, 2018; Janis, 1982; Sunstein, 2002). The educational task is to answer the strongest relevant criticism with evidence rather than simply to endure an adversarial performance.

24.1.1 — Opponents Reveal Blind Spots

Five local tests distinguish legitimate opposition from cruelty or theater. The challenge must expose a public-power burden that comfort might hide, preserve the dignity of the person challenged, give the participant a fair chance to answer, produce a record that can be interpreted in context, and leave a route for correction after the exchange (Nemeth, 2018; Janis, 1982; Sunstein, 2002).

A blind spot is not always a moral failure. Often it is a place where experience, language, class, profession, ideology, comfort, habit, or institutional training has made a burden less visible. A participant may sincerely want fairness while missing who waits, who pays, who is exposed, who is silenced, or who lacks the fluency to object in the official language of the room.

An independent critic may question assumed trust in an agency, missing moderator labor, or a security rule that treats protest as threat. Opposition is useful when it identifies a burden the initial account omitted.

A blind-spot entry should record what happened after the omission was named. Did the participant seek missing expertise,

revise the affected-person map, request better evidence, narrow the proposed authority, or treat the objection as an annoyance? The record also identifies whether the curriculum or scenario created the omission. Opposition becomes educational only when the new information changes the formation path or produces a reasoned, contestable rejection.

Compare omissions across tasks and time. Repeated neglect of the same affected group warrants inquiry into the participant's reasoning and the curriculum, with competing explanations and a reply preserved.

Include critics with operational and lived-system knowledge, using the practitioner-participation terms in Section 22.3.2.

Blind-spot review treats silence as evidence that needs interpretation, not as proof that no burden exists.

Opposition should be rotated across role, status, and affected-person position. If the same kind of critic always enters, the same blind spots may remain. A City that hears only elite opposition may miss administrative burden. A City that hears only friendly critics may miss structural danger. A City that hears only adversaries may lose the trust required for learning.

24.1.2 — Allies Hide Some Failures

Allies supply trust and encouragement, but closeness or shared assumptions can limit what their feedback reveals (Sunstein, 2002; Mutz, 2006).

Allies may also hide failures by sharing the same blind spot. A group may be highly intelligent and still miss the same burden because everyone was trained by the same institutions, speaks the same professional language, belongs to the same class, or shares the same political story. In that case, the problem is not favoritism. It is formation inside a closed interpretive circle.

Ally review belongs in opposition design. After friendly feedback, participants should be asked what friendly reviewers may be least likely to see. Which affected groups were not represented? Which assumptions were shared? Which objections did supporters dismiss too quickly? Which staff warnings were softened?

Supportive testimony needs a scope record. A mentor, community member, expert, or staff worker should not be displayed as proof of readiness without stating what that person observed, which period and domain they reviewed, what limits they named, and whether they depend on the participant or City.

Major formation exercises should include an ally-limit statement. Supportive reviewers can be asked what they may be too close to see, what they want to protect, and where their relationship to the participant may soften critique.

An ally review should state whether material concerns remain unresolved and identify the evidence for each. A mentor might affirm a participant's improvement while noting that staff warnings still receive late responses. The public record can preserve both findings and the next review date.

24.1.3 — Civility Without Softness

Civility permits hard, evidenced criticism of public conduct and proposals. It does not require shielding participants from discomfort (Mill, 1859; Asch, 1956).

Civility means that disagreement remains oriented toward truth, burden, and repair rather than domination. It forbids dehumanization, humiliation, threats, targeted exposure, identity degradation, sexualized insult, disability contempt, racialized or religious targeting, and the conversion of pain into entertainment.

Without softness means the City must allow hard claims. An opponent may say that a participant's proposal would harm people, hide labor, excuse violence, violate rights, or protect elites. They may say that the participant is overconfident, evasive, or captured by a frame. Such claims should not be excluded merely because they are difficult. The question is whether they are made within rules that protect dignity and public relevance.

Apply the disagreement standard in Section 23.1.3: tone alone cannot establish respectful engagement or excuse evasion.

Use the reviewable intervention and access rules in Section 23.2.5 to stop cruelty, protect critics, and prevent civility objections from displacing substantive scrutiny.

24.1.4 — Opposition Under Record

Keep the exchange, subsequent correction, and remaining dispute linked under the revision-history rules in Section 23.3, so a response during learning is not presented as a settled position (Stasser and Titus, 1985; Edmondson, 1999).

For opposition, apply Section 23.1.3’s dispute-record fields while preserving the contested burden, the participant’s response and any protected material withheld. Do not let a heated exchange stand in for the whole argument or a settled judgment of character.

Apply the contributor protections in Section 23.5.5 to critics; participation in an exercise does not waive safety, attribution, or refusal rights.

Apply the continuing anti-retaliation review in Section 23.1.3 after an opposition exchange, including changes in access or staff treatment. Use the argument-history release form in Section 23.1.3, centered on the issue and later revision. Select material for educational value rather than dramatic confrontation.

Major exchanges need an opposition-status label. Labels might identify structured critique, affected-person testimony, adversarial review, ideological opposition, expert challenge, staff warning, or public complaint.

Opposition under record should also include a response clock. If a serious objection requires further review, the record should say when and how the answer will return.

Check whether an objection changed the work or received a reasoned answer. Merely displaying a range of critics does not demonstrate that their input was examined.

24.1.5 — Learning From Discomfort

Learning from discomfort requires evidence of transfer. Reviewers should not treat an uncomfortable exchange as successful merely because the participant endured it. The evidence appears later, when the participant changes a question, repairs a harm, credits an opponent, adjusts a draft, protects an affected person, or recognizes that a prior certainty was carrying someone else's burden too cheaply (Nemeth, 2018; Janis, 1982; Sunstein, 2002).

Review the exercise design under Section 24.4.5.

Offer supported reflection on the participant's own pressure signals and pausing habits. Observers assess conduct and task conditions; clinical interpretation remains with qualified professionals under Section 24.5.2.

Use the no-manufactured-trauma rule in Section 24.5.1 to distinguish role-relevant challenge from avoidable injury.

Debrief should separate discomfort categories. There is cognitive discomfort when a claim no longer fits evidence, moral discomfort when a burden has been ignored, relational discomfort when a critic is hard to face, bodily discomfort under

stress, and status discomfort when the participant's image is threatened.

Discomfort should also be compared with the discomfort imposed by the participant's proposed action. A participant may feel uncomfortable being criticized, but the policy under discussion may impose fear, delay, exposure, or loss on others. Reviewers should not let the participant's immediate discomfort eclipse the public burden under review.

Observers should record not only the participant's reaction but also the conditions the institution created. Who framed the challenge, who held stop authority, what status differences shaped the room, whether the critic was protected, and whether the public summary rewarded drama all affect what the episode can teach. A defensible record can conclude that the exercise was badly designed, that the critic was treated unfairly, or that staff intervention prevented harm.

24.2 — Cross-Ideological Formation, Mutual Legibility

Public power rarely acts in a world of shared premises. A participant may later govern people who reject their vocabulary, distrust their institutions, interpret fairness differently, and remember public harm through different histories. Cross-ideological formation must therefore prepare participants to work across those differences without pretending that deep conflict can be solved by politeness (Rawls, 1993; Habermas, 1996; Dryzek, 2000). Some institutions use dialogue to pressure dissenters into civility while leaving power unchanged. The Transparent City should not use cross-ideological work to flatten conflict or demand emotional reconciliation.

24.2.1 — Serious Opponent Models

Ask which burdens each frame brings into view and which it may miss, using the counter-frame method in Section 23.5.3.

A serious opponent model is a representation of a rival view strong enough that a fair adherent of that view could recognize it. It is not the easiest version to dismiss, the loudest online caricature, or the most extreme representative. Participants should answer the strongest serious version.

A serious opponent model should identify the rival value, the feared harm, the institutional memory, the evidence base, the limits of the view, and the internal debates within the opposing tradition. No ideology is one voice. A serious model recognizes disagreement inside the opposing camp, rather than using the most convenient representative as the whole.

Serious-opponent work should require participants to state what the opponent gets right. A rival may name a burden, caution, right, implementation risk, historical wound, or

unintended consequence that the participant's own frame underweights.

Opponent models should be corrigible. When a critic says that a claim misstates their position, the participant should revise the model or explain why the objection is not accepted, using sources and a fair account of the dispute. The record then shows the initial model, correction request, revised version, remaining disagreement, and reviewer assessment.

Preserve repeated misrepresentation of a rival view and the corrections offered. Review the evidence and learning needs without inferring ideological capture or motive from one failed model.

Major exercises should produce a mutual-legibility note. That note can state the rival burden, the participant’s own frame, the strongest unresolved objection, and the boundary that prevented agreement.

The record should identify when rival views were unavailable or unsafe to include directly. Some contexts may require expert summaries, historical documents, affected-person testimony, or written models rather than live confrontation. Mutual legibility can be pursued without forcing vulnerable people into adversarial rooms.

24.2.2 — Mutual Translation

Mutual translation is the practice of carrying a claim from one moral or political vocabulary into another without erasing its burden. A participant may need to explain a rights concern to a security-oriented audience, a material-burden concern to a procedural audience, or a dignity concern to a budget audience (Dryzek, 2000; Mutz, 2006).

Mutual translation can improve through inquiry as well as imagination. In the final experiment reported by Eyal, Steffel,

and Epley (2018), asking a romantic partner about specified opinions improved prediction of those discussed opinions; imagining the partner's perspective did not supply the same information. The useful City question is whether a participant can discover and represent a concern that an initial brief left unclear. The finding motivates listening before persuasion, not a claim that every conversation reveals another person's mind.

A declared fictional planning exercise can make that skill visible. A role-player receives a fixed brief containing an access requirement absent from the participant's account. The participant records an initial interpretation, asks bounded clarifying questions, and offers a paraphrase for correction. Review distinguishes discovering the requirement, stating it accurately, and explaining how it affects the proposal. Recognition of a concern is not agreement with a policy or verification of every factual allegation; disputed facts still require evidence. The role-player need not endorse the final decision. In real consultation, contributors retain the existing voluntary-contact and protection rules, including the right not to explain private experience. A successful exchange leaves the disagreement more accurate, not necessarily smaller.

A mutual translation record should remain context-labeled. It should not be used to accuse a participant of secretly holding the view they translated.

Apply Section 22.2.3's plural-audience exercise to allies, serious opponents, and affected people outside the institutional vocabulary. Compare whether each version preserves the claim's factual limits and substantive criticism, even when that criticism makes the audience uncomfortable.

Some residue will remain untranslatable. A value, grief, sacred commitment, historical memory, or fear may lose meaning when forced into another vocabulary. The record should identify that

residue rather than pretend that communication has solved the conflict.

Compare words whose meanings differ across the communities in the exercise, and mark where translation reaches an unresolved value or evidential disagreement.

24.2.3 — Pluralism Under Burden

Pluralism under burden concerns the lawful exercise of authority while deep disagreement persists (Mansbridge et al., 2012; Landemore, 2020).

The participant must know how pluralism changes procedure, explanation, access, remedy, and restraint. People who disagree retain their rights, complaint routes, protection from retaliation, and access to understandable public explanations.

Pluralism becomes concrete through burden cases. A participant may face competing rights, cultural practices, safety concerns, religious objections, public-health needs, privacy demands, and equality claims. Reviewers are not looking for one universal answer to every case. They are looking for the ability to slow down, name the burdens, seek proper authority, protect dignity, and refuse to cast one side as moral waste.

The record should show when pluralism requires limits. Not every practice can be accommodated. Not every claim is lawful. Not every objection should block action. But when limits are imposed, the participant should explain the authority, the burden, the rejected alternatives, and the remedy or appeal available.

Pluralism under burden should include protected-majority and protected-minority cases. A public-power seeker should learn that dignity applies even when a group has political power, and protection applies even when a group lacks it. The relevant question is not whether a group is liked by the participant's peers, but what law, rights, burden, and remedy require.

Pluralism should also be tested when the participant's own community is angry. It is easier to protect opponents in abstract exercises than when allies demand punishment, speed, silence, or symbolic victory. A participant's relation to their supporters under plural strain may reveal whether they can lead a public, not merely please a base.

24.2.4 — Ideological Capture Review

Ideological capture review also examines institutional incentives inside the City. If the curriculum, mentors, donors, staff culture, public platform, or archive rewards one style of answer as the only serious style, participants may learn to imitate that style even while the chapter praises pluralism. Capture can happen through prestige and tone as much as through explicit doctrine (Bandura, 1999; Haslam, 2004).

Apply the frame audit in Section 23.5.3 to different tasks so a burden recognized in one domain can be tested in another.

The review includes language audit. Words such as liberty, safety, dignity, merit, efficiency, family, tradition, justice, innovation, responsibility, care, transparency, and fairness can carry preloaded conclusions. Reviewers should ask when such words clarify and when they stop thought.

Apply the conviction protections in Section 23.5.3; review assumptions and evidence without imposing an institutional ideology.

Ideological-capture review therefore asks whether a favored vocabulary preselects the evidence, narrows the affected people considered, or makes one remedy seem inevitable before alternatives are tested. Where a lawful limit is necessary, the pluralism standard in Section 24.2.3 supplies the authority, proportionality, and appeal requirements; this review tests whether the participant’s frame distorted their application.

Frame rotation offers a disciplined review method for cross-ideological formation. Participants examine the same public problem through rights, material burden, security, administrative capacity, ordinary privacy, staff labor, public trust, and long-term repair. The frames are not treated as equally persuasive in every case. Their value lies in revealing what each one brings into view and what it leaves outside the picture.

Ideological capture review includes capture by anti-capture rhetoric. A participant may become so focused on donors, elites, parties, or vendors that they overlook other burdens such as implementation failure, ordinary citizen privacy, or staff exhaustion. Suspicion can become its own ideology. Reviewers should examine what even its protective language may miss.

Pair findings with a formation plan that tests the identified narrowing, using the corrective methods in Section 23.5.3.

24.2.5 — Disagreement Without Dehumanization

The exercise must identify dehumanizing language and conduct that can license exclusion or punishment through public power (Kuran, 1995; Rawls, 1993; Habermas, 1996).

Dehumanization may appear in obvious forms: contempt, slurs, ridicule, threats, fantasies of removal, or treating opponents as vermin, disease, traitors, enemies of humanity, or obstacles to progress. It may also appear in refined forms: describing whole communities as irrational, backward, unserious, primitive, disposable, incapable of responsibility, or unworthy of explanation. Reviewers should watch both registers.

Use the field-contact protections in Section 22.1.3 and scenario safeguards in Section 24.5.1 when involving people targeted by dehumanization. Do not expose them to avoidable harm for another person’s training.

When dehumanizing language appears, the record should follow repair rather than performance. The participant identifies the harm, reconstructs the burden, revises the frame, and shows how later conduct changed. Repetition after correction may indicate serious role risk; a repaired failure may show learning. The distinction requires longitudinal evidence and affected-person review, not a single ceremonial apology.

Formation must distinguish disqualification from dehumanization. Some conduct disqualifies a person from a role. Some claims cannot be accommodated under law. Some movements may require firm resistance. None of that requires treating the people involved as less than human. Public power must sometimes constrain without degrading.

Dehumanization review includes humor and metaphor. People often hide contempt in jokes, memes, animal comparisons, disease metaphors, cleanliness language, or casual references to stupidity and backwardness. Cross-ideological formation should not over-police expression into sterility, but it should notice repeated metaphors that license contempt.

Where safe and appropriate, involve the affected community in reviewing repair; an apology to the institution alone may not answer the harm.

24.3 — Crisis Labs and Scenario Simulation

A crisis lab gives participants a bounded place to practice public responsibility under constrained conditions before real lives depend on their habits. Office often requires action before certainty, coordination across incomplete information, and communication while consequences are still moving. Simulation makes those demands visible, provided the exercise states what it tests, what it omits, who may stop it, and how learning will be reviewed (FEMA, 2020b; INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2021; INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2025a; Issenberg et al., 2005; McGaghie et al., 2010). A simulation is a model of selected demands, not a replica of office.

24.3.1 — Scenario Design

A crisis lab also tests the institution. If staff are overloaded, instructions are unclear, protected categories are mishandled, Artificial Intelligence tools overstate certainty, or clinicians are excluded until too late, the exercise may reveal City failure rather than participant failure. Simulation should always be read as evidence about the participant and the design that surrounded them.

The design brief must justify the method against a specific capacity and state what the scenario does not reproduce. Surprise, speed, and spectacle are not measures of rigor (INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2025a; Issenberg et al., 2005; McGaghie et al., 2010).

Scenario design begins with a public-power question: what kind of decision pattern needs observation? Rights under fear, staff dependence, public explanation, resource scarcity, confidentiality, conflicting expertise, or pressure from allies may each require a different design.

A responsible scenario should identify the triggering event, authority context, available options, unavailable information, affected persons, legal boundaries, protected categories, time horizon, staff roles, communication needs, and review pathway. The safeguards map assigns legal and clinical review, accessibility, staff protection, and stop authority.

The scenario should include plausible institutional constraints. Budgets, staff shortages, language access, disability needs, public records, legal limits, emergency services, media distortion, and technical failure all affect decisions.

The design should include a public meaning plan before the exercise begins. What can be released? What will remain protected? What is simulated and what is real? What does failure mean? How will affected role-players be protected?

A scenario design brief should include a non-goal statement. For example, a disaster simulation may test public explanation and staff coordination, not emotional invulnerability. A security scenario may test proportionality, not suspicion.

Scenario design should use graded intensity. Early simulations can test basic role clarity and burden mapping. Later exercises can add time pressure, public interface, conflicting advice, or partial information. A City that stages intensity should justify each increase.

The design brief should sit apart from the participant record and from the public summary.

Track staff and role-player exposure and recovery using the capacity and care rules in Sections 21.6 and 24.5; include that load in the exercise review.

Good simulation design includes ordinary breakdown points. A printer fails, a translator is unavailable, a staff member gives partial information, a local resident cannot access the form, a record label is unclear.

Scenario design should be red-teamed before participants enter the room. A legal reviewer can identify unlawful assumptions, a clinician can identify avoidable trauma risks, a disability reviewer can identify access failure, a public-administration reviewer can identify unrealistic command paths, and a civil-liberties reviewer can identify rights shortcuts.

24.3.2 — Role Assignment

Assign a defined public role and authority before the exercise; role differences must serve the learning objective rather than merely increase pressure (McGaghie et al., 2010; Rudolph et al., 2006).

Create a role matrix using the fields specified below, and use it to observe how participants request, use, credit, and challenge support and specialist advice.

Apply Section 24.5.1 when representing vulnerable people. Trained actors, protected materials, summaries, and qualified review can provide the required information without extracting personal pain for realism.

Role assignment should test handoff discipline. A participant should know when to make a decision and when to route a matter to law, clinicians, technical review, public administration, host-community review, or scientific claim-status authorities.

Include the assigned role and authority from the matrix in public summaries.

The role matrix should state what authority each participant, staff member, adviser, role-player, and reviewer carried; what each person could decide; what had to be referred; and what information each role lawfully received.

24.3.3 — Time Pressure

A crisis lab can reveal how a participant asks questions, assigns responsibility, protects rights, uses staff, communicates uncertainty, and carries fear under specified conditions. It cannot reproduce the full legal, moral, informational, bodily, institutional, or historical complexity of real authority.

Time pressure reveals patterns that generous deliberation may hide. A participant with enough time can consult, revise, and polish. Under time pressure, they may rely on habit, ideology, trusted staff, fear, or the first available frame. This does not make time-pressure behavior truer than ordinary behavior. It makes it useful in a different way.

Time pressure should be proportional to the learning objective. A public statement needed within minutes is different from a budget decision due by morning or a legal response due next week. If every exercise becomes a race, the City trains haste. If no exercise requires urgency, the City misses a major feature of public power.

Time-pressure records should distinguish immediate decisions from those that can wait. Reviewers examine whether the participant protects rights under urgency, communicates uncertainty, delegates lawfully, requests missing expertise, and preserves an affected-person route instead of erasing consultation. The exercise should also record whether the clock was realistic or artificially constructed to manufacture failure.

Include the downstream staff time and capacity required by urgent decisions in the burden review under Section 24.3.5.

A time-decision matrix can structure simulation review. It asks what must be decided immediately, what can be delayed safely, what must be delegated, what requires lawful authority, and what should be communicated as provisional.

Time pressure should include communication sequencing. A participant may need an immediate holding statement, a later detailed explanation, and a final corrected account. The exercise should test whether the participant can communicate in stages without overclaiming.

Reviewers should watch for time pressure used as moral cover. A participant may say there was no time to consult affected persons, protect accessibility, or check staff load when a narrower, temporary, or conditional action was available. The record should ask whether urgency was real, exaggerated, or created by prior neglect.

A timing log should show which deadlines were realistic, which were compressed for formation, which decisions were reversible, and which safeguards remained active despite speed.

24.3.4 — Incomplete Information

Build an exercise with consequential information gaps, conflicting sources, and a defined update path, rather than treating incomplete information as an incidental obstacle (Reason, 1997; Leveson, 2011).

Participants should be evaluated on uncertainty language. Do they say what is known, what is suspected, what is unknown, and what will be reviewed? Do they overstate to appear strong? Do they delay everything to avoid responsibility? Do they hide uncertainty from the public while acting on it privately?

Require reasons for inferences about affected groups when facts are missing. Examine evidence and alternatives rather than treating a quick inference as proof of hidden bias.

The exercise should include pathways for updating. Public power rarely decides once. It issues temporary guidance, gathers more information, revises, apologizes, compensates, or narrows.

Use the consequence and reversibility analysis in Section 24.3.5 when missing information could conceal serious or irreversible harm.

Apply the source distinctions in Section 23.1.2 under the scenario's time constraints, stating why evidence is sufficient for a provisional action or why confirmation is required.

The withholding register should distinguish realistic uncertainty from manipulative concealment. It identifies what was known, what was unknown, what was unavailable by design, what could have been discovered through better questions, and what no responsible official could have known in time.

24.3.5 — Public Consequence Modeling

Public consequence modeling should include delayed consequences, not only immediate outcomes. A decision that looks humane in the first hour may create a privacy burden, budget burden, staff burden, precedent burden, or credibility burden weeks later (INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2025a; Issenberg et al., 2005; McGaghie et al., 2010).

Identify who would experience the consequences of the simulated choice, using the burden ledger fields that follow.

Simulation design can use a practical burden ledger: affected persons, type of burden, intensity, duration, reversibility, consent status, remedy route, and uncertainty level. This is not a formal scientific formula.

Modeling must include secondary burden. A participant may protect one group while overloading staff, preserve public trust while exposing a bystander, gain speed while undermining accessibility, or protect security while chilling lawful protest. The exercise must therefore look beyond the first intended beneficiary and trace where cost moves next, who can contest

that movement, and what remedy remains if the design was wrong.

Public consequence modeling should also include communication effects. A decision may be materially sound but publicly explained so poorly that fear spreads, protected persons are identified, or affected people cannot understand what to do. Public explanation is part of consequence. The exercise should test whether participants think about interpretation before release, not after harm begins.

Label consequences as modeled possibilities and record assumptions, uncertainty, and data gaps. Use the model to compare choices, not to claim that it predicts the actual outcome.

Distinguish reversible steps from irreversible exposure or injury. Where uncertainty is high, compare narrower reversible options and the harms of delay.

Attach a responsible remedy route to each consequential option in the ledger before selecting it.

A burden fan can show how an action distributes burdens. The proposed action sits at the center; affected people, staff, third parties, legal institutions, interpreters, future officeholders, and the participant's body and family form the spokes. The exercise asks where weight travels and which safeguards prevent breakage.

Final review identifies who may challenge interpretation. Affected people, staff, lawyers, clinicians, civil-liberties reviewers, and public-administration reviewers may trace different consequences; material disagreement remains visible. Review also records how fear, fatigue, authority, and narrowed attention shaped the exercise, including whether the simulation itself taught the wrong lesson.

24.4 — Fear, Ambiguity, and Decision Under Pressure

Use the condition map in Section 24.4.5 when interpreting pressure evidence (Arnsten, 2009; Lupien et al., 2009; Starcke and Brand, 2012). Public power still requires pressure evidence because office will not always wait for calm. The participant must practice how to ask for facts, preserve rights, communicate uncertainty, use authority, and protect staff under strain. Reviewers should observe development, not only reaction.

24.4.1 — Fear Response

The decision analysis asks what the participant protected, what they missed, how they used authority, whose burden moved, and whether the scenario itself distorted the response. Emotional containment is not the same as public judgment. A visibly calm participant may choose badly, while a distressed participant may still preserve rights, seek help, and correct course. Review must therefore separate demeanor from decision quality and design effects from participant effects (Arnsten, 2009; Lupien et al., 2009; Starcke and Brand, 2012).

Participants can recognize and seek support for fear without treating the feeling itself as failure. The exercise assesses the decisions and conduct that follow.

A useful record asks what the participant does with fear. Do they seek more information? Do they narrow the decision? Do they scapegoat? Do they overtrust security? Do they become punitive? Do they defer necessary action without explaining the reason? Do they communicate uncertainty honestly?

Apply the accommodation and interpretation rules in Sections 24.5.5 and 24.4.5 to fear responses.

Observe role conduct toward staff and security under pressure, including demands for impossible certainty or tasks. Record the

action, its effects, and any repair without diagnosing the participant's inner state.

Participants should learn to distinguish a public explanation of risk from a disclosure of private fear. A public official may need to say, "The situation involves uncertainty, potential harm, and limited information," without saying, "I am terrified." The exact language depends on the role. Protected reflection can examine how fear affects a decision, while public communication explains the relevant risks and uncertainty.

Reviewers can ask participants to create a personal fear protocol before high-stakes simulation. The protocol is not a confession. It identifies the signs that the participant is rushing, freezing, overcontrolling, appeasing, or seeking certainty too quickly. It also identifies whom they should consult when those signs appear.

Fear response should be compared to public communication. A participant may manage fear internally but communicate in ways that spread fear to the public. They may overstate danger, understate uncertainty, or use emergency language to gather support. The curriculum should train participants to keep fear from becoming public manipulation.

Include role-relevant after-action conduct such as blame, credit, apology, or retaliation. The ordinary-life and private-recovery boundaries remain in force.

24.4.2 — Ambiguity Tolerance

Ambiguity tolerance is the ability to remain responsible when the answer is not yet clean. Public power often acts amid unresolved evidence, competing harms, and incomplete authority. A participant who cannot tolerate ambiguity may grab certainty too early. Another may refuse action until the public

has already paid for delay. The exercise must test both risks (Starcke and Brand, 2012; Kahneman, 2011).

Ambiguity is different from confusion. Confusion means the participant may not understand the problem, role, evidence, or authority. Ambiguity means the problem itself remains partly unsettled even after responsible inquiry. Pressure review should help participants separate what they need to learn from what no one can fully know yet.

An uncertainty register should separate open facts, contested values, legal ambiguity, implementation risk, public-interpretation risk, and protected-domain uncertainty. Each type has its own responsible response: further evidence, explicit value choice, counsel, staged implementation, limited release, clinical care, or claim-status restraint. The participant is evaluated on whether the uncertainty is named and routed, not on performing certainty where none exists.

Examine whether the participant can acknowledge affected people’s concerns while keeping claims proportionate to unresolved evidence.

Practice the provisional choices in Section 24.3.3, with a review trigger and the cost of waiting made explicit.

Uncertainty can be practiced through forecasts whose meaning is fixed before the outcome arrives. Mellers and colleagues reported better geopolitical-forecast accuracy with probability training and team discussion (Mellers et al., 2014). A later exploratory reanalysis obtained materially different effects on modeled forecasting ability after accounting for question selection and response timing (Hauenstein et al., 2025). Together these studies sharpen the educational question: did a working process deliver better forecasts, or did reasoning improve on comparable questions with comparable information? These are related achievements, not interchangeable claims.

A proposed City exercise uses fictional public-project cases with a declared event, resolution rule, and evidence schedule. Learners record a probability and reason before the next information is released, then explain which evidence justified an update. For a test of training under equal conditions, randomly assign the lesson or a time-matched comparison, use common cases at fixed forecast horizons, and retain unanswered items in the report. Across enough independently prepared cases, examine accuracy, calibration (whether events assigned similar probabilities occur at corresponding frequencies) and discrimination between more and less likely outcomes. Repeated updates to one case are not independent cases. Test later transfer on unused cases, with accessibility support held available. A separate exercise may allow free information gathering to evaluate the whole workflow. A better forecast earns a task-specific finding; it neither chooses the policy nor licenses a person for office.

The participant's tolerance should not become institutional delay. Sometimes ambiguity is used to avoid hard decisions, especially when the burdened people lack power. Reviewers should ask who pays for waiting. If delay protects the participant from criticism while others suffer, ambiguity tolerance has become avoidance.

24.4.3 — Conflict Under Load

The exercise should examine how a participant handles disagreement while tired, rushed, criticized, or responsible for competing burdens. Compare the response with ordinary seminar work, applying the interpretation limits in Section 24.4.5 and the safety rules in Section 24.5.

The first question is whether the participant preserves the personhood of others. Under load, do they snap at staff, dismiss

critics, trivialize affected persons, or treat a role-player as an obstacle? Do they still use names, roles, and evidence carefully? Do they ask for clarification, or do they assign motive too quickly?

The second question is whether the participant preserves process. Load can tempt a person to bypass counsel, skip accessibility, ignore minority reports, silence dissent, or claim emergency authority prematurely. Reviewers should observe whether the participant knows which procedures are essential under pressure and which can be modified lawfully.

Use the whole conflict-to-repair sequence below, including recurrence, when interpreting an initial mistake.

Conflict load must not be designed by stacking preventable burdens until anyone would fail. Realism is not the same as overload. The exercise should match the role and purpose. If the load is beyond plausible office conditions or ignores accommodations, the result may reveal bad design more than participant risk.

Trace the consequences of conflict conduct through the burden ledger in Section 24.3.5.

Review aggression carried out by allies, volunteers, staff, or platforms where it relates to the public task. Establish what the participant encouraged or authorized, what they knew, and what reasonable steps were available to them. Benefit alone does not establish responsibility for another person’s attack.

Conflict under load should be tested after recovery as well. A participant may respond poorly in the moment but return with a specific repair that addresses the resulting burden. Another may appear calm and later rationalize the harm. Pressure review should read the whole arc: conflict, immediate response, recovery, repair, and pattern.

24.4.4 — Authority Use Under Pressure

Authority use under pressure includes restraint under invitation. Some simulations will tempt participants to seize power because the room appears to reward decisive control. Reviewers should watch whether a participant asks who has lawful authority, who must be consulted, who can object, and whether emergency speed is being used to bypass ordinary protections. Restraint can be as public-power relevant as command (Weick and Sutcliffe, 2007; Boin et al., 2017).

A participant may underuse authority by refusing responsibility, hiding behind process, or asking staff to decide without naming the decision. They may overuse authority by bypassing law, silencing dissent, expanding security, demanding loyalty, or treating uncertainty as permission for force. Readiness requires neither softness nor domination. It requires proportionate authority under lawful limit.

The record should show authority basis. Did the participant know what authority they had in the scenario? Did they ask whether a decision belonged to them? Did they consult legal or operational roles? Did they distinguish recommendation from order, preference from duty, and urgency from power?

Evaluate authority use through the burden ledger in Section 24.3.5, including effects on staff, affected people, and available remedy.

Scenario design should include refusal tests. Sometimes authority is offered in the simulation by a role-player who asks the participant to exceed scope, conceal a fact, punish a critic, or release protected material for public reassurance. A participant who refuses improper authority may show more readiness than one who accepts expanded control.

Pressure review can use an authority ledger during after-action review: claimed authority, lawful authority, delegated authority,

emergency authority, refused authority, and review authority. A participant should know not only what they did, but why they believed they were allowed to do it.

Require a public explanation of both the action taken and powers declined, using Section 22.5.5.

When a participant expands control, require a task-relevant reason and evidence. Examine whether the action addressed the public problem rather than inferring anxiety from its decisiveness.

Authority should remain interruptible by law, evidence, staff warning, and affected-person burden.

24.4.5 — Interpretation Caution

Stress evidence requires a longitudinal interpretation ceiling. One strong moment does not establish readiness, and one poor moment does not establish general unfitness. Reviewers compare behavior across scenarios, load conditions, support levels, later debrief, correction, and ordinary work. A finding should name the conditions under which it was observed and the role-specific claim it can support, leaving the rest of the person outside the verdict (Arnsten, 2009; Lupien et al., 2009; Starcke and Brand, 2012).

Apply the accommodation rules in Section 24.5.5 and assess the public function rather than a preferred style of calm, speed, eye contact, or speech.

Another caution concerns scenario design. If instructions were unclear, roles conflicted, time pressure was unrealistic, expert channels were absent, or protected categories were mishandled, the participant's failure may be partly institutional. The record should include design critique before public interpretation.

Use the summary and archive rules in Section 24.6 for pressure events; keep role, conditions, and contested interpretation attached to excerpts.

Reviewers should also consider whether apparent strength reflects familiarity, support, style, or scenario fit.

Participants may contest interpretation, supply missing context, identify design flaws, and accept part of a finding while disputing another. Reply does not erase evidence; it completes the record. Public readers should see contested meaning.

Difficult pressure evidence should not be hidden. Structured interpretation states what was tested, observed, left untested, plausibly explained, repeated, repaired, and publicly claimable. For a calibration exercise, two reviewers can first examine the same fictional pressure response with different, explicitly incomplete context. They then receive the same missing facts and record which interpretations changed and why. The exercise distinguishes improved evidence from persuasion by authority or dramatic presentation. An unchanged conclusion can be justified when the added facts are irrelevant; a revised one remains attached to the particular task, not the participant’s identity.

24.5 — Trauma-Safe Limits and Clinician Review

The simulation charter uses the protections below to make challenge interpretable and safe enough to justify its educational purpose (SAMHSA, 2014; Hobfoll et al., 2007; Beauchamp and Childress, 2019). Participants need a predictable route to pause an exercise without forfeiting their role. Clinical review should define exposure limits when a scenario risks reactivating serious harm. An exercise that cannot be stopped safely cannot fairly test judgment.

24.5.1 — No Manufactured Trauma

No manufactured trauma means the City may not design exercises whose purpose is to overwhelm, degrade, terrify, humiliate, coerce, or break participants. The City may simulate hard public conditions. It may not create harm as a credential. This boundary protects the participant, the staff, the role-players, and the public from confusing pain with formation.

Difficult public events can be taught through bounded scenarios, expert briefings, protected summaries, trained role-play, and debrief care.

Manufactured trauma can hide behind phrases such as stress inoculation, toughness, realism, leadership pressure, or elite formation. Reviewers should examine such language carefully. If the exercise depends on shock, humiliation, forced disclosure, sleep deprivation, sensory assault, or personal targeting, it likely exceeds the formation purpose.

Known vulnerabilities must never be weaponized. Consent and independent clinical review may guide accommodation and proportionate challenge; they do not authorize manufactured trauma or personal targeting. A person's trauma history, family history, intimate life, disability, grief, religious identity,

immigration history, or medical condition must not become a surprise tool.

Apply the voluntary-contact protections in Section 22.1.3 to lived-experience contributions. Review purpose, alternatives, support, and consent without asking critics or role-players to manufacture distress for realism.

No manufactured trauma also means no audience incentives for suffering. If observers, public summaries, staff culture, or participant status rewards visible endurance, trauma production may occur without explicit design. Exercise governance should audit reward structures.

The rule should allow refusal without stigma. A participant who declines a harmful or improperly designed simulation should not be treated as unready by default. The refusal may reveal a safety concern in the exercise. Reviewers should distinguish unwillingness to face challenge from refusal to submit to unsafe design.

Every exercise requires a pre-brief clear enough for a participant without technical expertise. The pre-brief should not reveal scenario secrets that defeat the exercise, but it should explain rights, safety pathways, protected categories, stop rules, record handling, and debrief expectations.

Safety review includes nonparticipants represented or implicated by the scenario. A simulation about children, families, medical crisis, sexual harm, disability, policing, migration, or war can reproduce public stereotypes if carelessly written. Expert and affected-person review can protect the dignity of those represented.

Record near misses, including impending protected-domain breaches or unsafe escalation, and route them to the institutional after-action review.

24.5.2 — Clinical Oversight

Independent clinical oversight applies the care boundaries in Sections 14.2.2 and 18.3.3 to simulation safety, accommodation, and de-loading (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; WHO, 2022a).

Clinicians must be independent of operator, donor, publicity, and completion pressure. They may require modification or a stop under the authority specified below.

Use the minimum functional-information bridge in Section 14.2.2 for safety instructions; clinical records remain within their separate care authority.

The clinician's role is not to eliminate all discomfort. Formation will involve challenge. Clinical oversight distinguishes challenge from harm, temporary stress from dangerous overload, and role difficulty from injury. That distinction requires expertise, context, and trust. It cannot be replaced by operator intuition or participant bravado.

Extend the independent care pathway to staff and role-players, coordinating clinical and labor review of exercise exposure.

Clinical oversight includes pre-brief review, live monitoring where appropriate, and post-exercise debrief. A clinician may not need to be present in every room, but the care pathway should be designed before the exercise begins.

A clinical stop immediately ends the exercise for the affected person and triggers care. Operators may not reverse it for schedule, donor, publicity, or completion reasons. Any clinical disagreement follows independent professional review; the protective stop remains in force pending a safe decision.

Clinical advice may identify functional limits and safety or support needs under Section 14.2.2. It does not decide civic readiness; confidential care records remain excluded from selection, scoring, publicity, and campaigning.

The clinical-oversight protocol should also name who may consult the clinician, how minimum safety instructions are communicated, and how disagreements with operators are recorded and appealed.

24.5.3 — Stop Rules

Stop authority must also protect people who are not the participant being tested. A role-player, staff member, interpreter, clinician, observer, or affected reviewer may be the first person to recognize that the exercise has crossed a boundary. The formal subject of the simulation cannot be the only person allowed to halt harm. Distributed stop authority, rehearsed before the exercise and protected from retaliation, prevents the simulation from reproducing the power imbalance it claims to examine (INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2025a; SAMHSA, 2014).

A stop should not automatically imply failure. It may indicate participant overload, scenario defect, protected-domain breach, role confusion, staff risk, technical failure, or emerging harm to a third party. The stop record should classify the reason without humiliating the person who invoked it.

The stop protocol must distinguish pause, modification, termination, and removal. A pause allows care and clarification. A modification changes the scenario. Termination ends the exercise. Removal may protect a person from a role or setting.

Stop rules should also govern public release. A stopped exercise may be vulnerable to false interpretation. The public summary should explain the category of stop where needed, protect sensitive persons, and avoid making the stop a spectacle.

The behavior of senior staff, mentors, and admired participants can reinforce or undermine stop rules. Treating a stop as weakness may discourage its use even when written policy

protects it. Public-power formation should honor well-called stops as part of integrity.

Stop rules should be practiced as a three-level signal system rather than stored only as policy. A yellow pause slows the exercise when confusion, fatigue, access failure, or escalating distress may distort the test. An orange stop ends a module when a protected domain is approached or safe continuation is doubtful. A red stop ends the exercise and triggers clinical and oversight review, including possible correction of the City rather than the participant. The rules should state who may invoke each level, protect users from stigma, and require review after every invocation. Post-invocation review asks whether the rule worked, the person felt safe using it, others respected it, and future design should change.

24.5.4 — Debrief Care

Apply care-first stabilization under Section 18.6.3 before evaluative debrief; allow the time and support needed for meaningful participation.

The second stage of debrief can reconstruct what happened. What did the participant think was happening? What did staff see? What information was missing? Which burdens were noticed or missed? Which decisions were role-appropriate? Which reactions came from scenario design? Reconstruction should be calm enough that the participant can learn rather than defend an image. Advocacy with inquiry gives reviewers a disciplined way to challenge conduct while preserving the participant's opportunity to explain before interpretation hardens (Fanning and Gaba, 2007; Rudolph et al., 2006; Eppich and Cheng, 2015; INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2025b).

Invite protected feedback from affected roles where appropriate, using the contributor protections in Section 22.1.3.

Record the next care, learning, repair, or pathway step and its responsible owner. Discussion alone does not close a debrief.

The institution itself also requires debrief. Did the exercise meet its purpose? Did it create avoidable harm? Did public release plans remain responsible? Did staff carry hidden load? Did stop rules function? Did clinician independence hold?

Follow-up debrief checks for delayed stress effects, staff burden, or public release concerns. A single conversation may be insufficient for serious scenarios.

Debrief must include repair for role-players and staff. A simulation may ask someone to carry hostility, grief, confrontation, moderation, or emergency pressure. Those people should not disappear when participant learning begins. Their care, feedback, and boundaries belong in the after-action process.

Keep private care separate from the public operational-learning summary under Section 24.5.2.

24.5.5 — Vulnerability Accommodation

Vulnerability accommodation begins from the fact that participants enter simulation with different bodies, histories, risks, languages, disabilities, family burdens, medications, and sensory thresholds. One undifferentiated model of stress performance would confuse conformity with readiness. The design question is which support permits role-relevant testing without unnecessary injury and when the pathway must change because support cannot make the exercise fair (United Nations, 2006; SAMHSA, 2014; Beauchamp and Childress, 2019).

Extend accommodation to witnesses, staff, and role-players, including alternative contribution formats, rotation, and debrief support where needed.

Accommodation notices should disclose function without exposing private history. Where relevant, the public record may state that an exercise used approved supports or modified conditions and explain whether the assessed public function changed. Medical, disability, trauma, family, and clinical details remain protected unless a lawful and necessary route requires more. The participant may correct the notice, and the accommodation itself must never be framed as a defect in character.

Use the functional review in Section 14.2.4 to distinguish essential role demands from conditions that teams, tools, timing, or procedures can accommodate.

Accommodation must remain dynamic. A reviewable adjustment plan should separate protected medical, disability, trauma, and family information from public role conditions; identify access needs and supports; state whether the assessed public function changed; and set review points for health, grief, medication, sleep, role, or cumulative exposure. It should also define when a scenario must be redesigned rather than forcing a person through it.

Clinicians must also track cumulative exposure across repeated scenarios.

24.6 — After-Action Review and Visible Correction

After-action review turns simulation into accountable learning. It reconstructs what happened, classifies errors, identifies burden movement, records commitments, revises the exercise, and determines what the public may responsibly see (Reason, 1997; Dekker, 2012; Woods et al., 2010). Reviewers must distinguish a participant's mistake under uncertainty from an error created by defective exercise design. The next exercise should test whether the proposed repair has changed performance.

24.6.1 — Decision Reconstruction

Reconstruct the exercise using the time-specific decision method in Section 23.3.4 before assigning success or failure.

The reconstruction should distinguish event timeline from interpretation. First, what happened in order? Then, what did it mean? Under stress, people often merge sequence with explanation. A participant may say they acted because a risk was obvious, while the timeline shows the risk was not communicated until later.

Classify missing information using the withholding register in Section 24.3.4, including omissions caused by the scenario itself.

Map material influence during the exercise under Section 23.5.1, including authorized technical inputs.

End reconstruction with unresolved questions, required expertise, and what would warrant retesting or a changed interpretation.

After-action review can use a reconstruction map with five columns: event, information available, authority assumed, burden considered, and later correction. This map helps reviewers see whether the participant's reasoning matched the conditions.

Record the exercise’s institutional conditions under Section 24.4.5 without diagnosing the participant’s inner state.

A reconstruction should preserve alternative paths. What else could the participant have done? Which alternatives were unavailable, unlawful, too slow, too harmful, or simply missed?

Decision reconstruction should first evaluate the choice using the information and duties available at the time, then examine the outcome and the response it requires. Baron and Hershey (1988) found that knowledge of favorable or unfavorable outcomes changed evaluations of otherwise matched decisions in their studied scenarios. The lesson is not to ignore consequences. It is to distinguish the quality of the original reasoning from luck and from obligations that arise after the result.

A fictional infrastructure exercise can make the distinction concrete. Reviewers first assess a repair decision from its available inspection evidence, alternatives, and known risks. Different reviewer groups then receive different plausible outcomes of that same decision. They identify whether any revised judgment rests on genuinely new evidence about the earlier process or only on whether the result was fortunate. A second question asks what action is now owed to affected people and what the result should change in future risk estimates. An unexpected failure can require urgent remedy without proving that the original choice was careless; a fortunate result cannot excuse a neglected duty. This produces a review that can learn from outcomes without rewriting the evidence available before them.

In the after-action review, document authority confusion, staff training gaps, overstated Artificial Intelligence alerts, accessibility failures, and whether simulated public input added noise.

The review preserves disagreement about interpretation where serious disagreement remains. A participant, staff member, clinician, critic, or external reviewer may see the same event differently. A clean institutional summary can be misleading when the record is contested.

24.6.2 — Error Classification

Classify errors by the change needed and the authority able to make it (Woods et al., 2010; Fanning and Gaba, 2007).

A participant may make an evidence error, authority error, communication error, procedural error, dignity error, staff-use error, public-burden error, protected-category error, or recovery error.

Distinguish error, rule breach, and a finding of misconduct. A mistaken act can breach a rule without settling intent or culpability; error and misconduct can also coexist. Establish the applicable duty, evidence, responsibility, and review standard. Correct ongoing harm without prejudging the disciplinary outcome.

Error classification should include harm severity and reversibility. A poor phrase that is corrected before release differs from a wrongful public exposure. A delayed decision differs from an irreversible injury. A missed staff warning differs from retaliation against the staff member. The response should match burden intensity, duration, and repair possibilities.

Use classifications for task-specific learning, care, and accountable review; do not convert them into participant scores or risk rankings. The no-profiling rule in Section 11.7.6 remains in force.

Mark whether a finding is established, provisional, disputed, or awaiting qualified review.

Include omissions of a relevant duty or inquiry even when no overtly harmful act occurred. Explain why the missing step mattered to the task.

Where they change the remedy, the matrix should also distinguish reasoning, value-conflict, legal-boundary, role-confusion, time-pressure, technology, and institutional-design errors.

The matrix should include shared-causation fields. A participant may have erred, and the scenario may have been poorly designed. Staff may have failed to clarify a role, and the participant may have failed to ask. A legal boundary may have been marked, and the pressure of time may have made it easy to cross. Shared causation does not dissolve accountability. It locates it.

24.6.3 — Learning Commitments

A learning commitment names the practice that will change and the evidence by which it can be evaluated (Eppich and Cheng, 2015; Argyris and Schön, 1978; INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2025b).

Specify when each commitment should be fulfilled: before the next simulation, a public release, a readiness bundle, or an office interface, as appropriate. Timing makes learning accountable without pretending every issue can be fixed instantly.

Assign commitments to the City's staff and designers as well as participants where the after-action review identified institutional defects.

Learning commitments should include review triggers. What evidence would show improvement? Who will review it? What happens if the same pattern recurs? Does recurrence require pause, role redirection, additional support, or removal from a pathway?

Learning commitments should include a burden owner. If the participant commits to earlier legal consultation, who ensures counsel is available? If the City commits to better staff ratios, who budgets for it? If a public summary process changes, who audits the next release?

The record should show when a commitment is fulfilled, revised, or retired. Some commitments become unnecessary because the pathway changes. Some prove inadequate. Some succeed and should become standard practice.

24.6.4 — Public Summary

Write the public summary around the simulated task, observed conduct, correction, and limits, using the explanation method in Section 22.5.5 (ISO, 2016a; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Public summaries should preserve context before drama. A tense quote, visible hesitation, or strong disagreement may be meaningless without role, scenario, timing, information limits, and protected boundaries.

Apply the protected-record boundaries in Chapters 10–11 and Section 24.5.2; involvement in an exercise does not make protected content releasable.

The summary should include dispute labels where interpretation remains contested. The participant may disagree with a classification. Staff may identify system error. Clinicians may warn against overreading. Opponents may think the response was inadequate.

Test the summary with nonexpert readers and apply the accessibility requirements used in Section 22.6.5, including current digital accessibility standards (W3C, 2023).

State the exercise-specific finding, unresolved dispute, and next review in plain language. Link to the interpretation limits in

Section 24.4.5 rather than repeating a general no-proof warning in every summary.

Test foreseeable excerpts for loss of the scenario, role, and finding status; revise official wording and display where a short extract would predictably mislead.

Include material institutional changes from the after-action review, not only participant commitments.

24.6.5 — Simulation Archive Limits

Keep simulation source records under lawful custody and purpose-specific access, with public release governed by the rules below (Reason, 1997; Dekker, 2012; Woods et al., 2010).

Separate raw simulation footage, protected summaries, public summaries, clinician notes, staff feedback, participant reflections, role-player records, and technical logs. Each requires its own access, retention, correction, and release rules.

Apply staff and role-player protection under Section 24.5.5 to archive access and release; necessary contribution to an exercise does not itself authorize public identification.

A simulation record supports claims about conduct under the designed conditions, subject to Section 24.4.5. It does not establish future office performance.

Enforce purpose-specific access under Chapter 11; authority to review, summarize, or redesign training does not automatically authorize another use.

Prohibit dramatic compilations, including public education or fundraising reels of failure, courage, panic, apology or confrontation; consent alone cannot override this restriction.

Retain enough source records for oversight, appeal, pattern review, and institutional learning, recording the reason for retention, sealing, summary, delay, or deletion.

Make stopped or redesigned exercises as legible as completed ones, including the reason for change, under the public-summary rules in Section 24.6.4.

Check whether dramatic scenarios displace routine exercises exposing quieter operational weaknesses (FEMA, 2020b; SAMHSA, 2014; INACSL Standards Committee et al., 2021, 2025a, 2025b; World Health Organization, 2025b).

The next exercise record should identify which assumptions changed because of the prior after-action review.

Chapter 25 — Readiness and Campaigns

Readiness is a consequential public claim because it can shape campaigns, party support, institutional review, media attention, donor behavior, and voter expectations. Chapter 25 therefore treats readiness as a scoped release problem rather than a crown. The City can assemble relevant formation evidence, but the claim remains bounded by role, jurisdiction, time, exclusions, dissent, uncertainty, correction, and expiry.

The archive gives this chapter its raw material. Education, deliberation, opposition, simulation, staff treatment, correction, and public explanation leave records that can deepen democratic interpretation. Raw volume is not yet a usable public object, however. The City must organize evidence so source records, summaries, disputes, protected omissions, and correction history remain visible without pretending that the archive contains the whole person.

The chapter asks how a record can travel into democratic contest without becoming a more sophisticated instrument of mythology.

Not yet provides a constructive civic option between premature endorsement and permanent condemnation. A participant may need additional formation, a narrower role, more field experience, a different season, or a different form of service. Delay can protect the public while preserving dignity, learning, and future possibility.

Campaign continuity is the final test. The participant should not receive a persona reset that erases revision, staff treatment, disputes, or limits, yet neither should the archive become an opposition-research warehouse or a permanent claim on private life. The City's task is to preserve role-relevant continuity while returning campaign law, party decisions, media judgment, and voter choice to their lawful owners.

The underlying release bundle should separate record categories. Public-task work, revision history, opposition and simulation summaries, staff-treatment findings, source and advisor disclosures, unresolved disputes, and accessibility context should not be flattened into one narrative. Each category needs provenance, status, scope, and an explanation of why it is relevant to the contemplated role. Context is part of accuracy because the same event can carry different meaning when detached from task, time, or jurisdiction (Nissenbaum, 2010; W3C, 2013).

Public interpretation remains plural. A voter, party, appointing body, journalist, civil-society group, critic, and affected person may read the same bundle differently. The City's responsibility is not to force convergence but to make the record understandable, contestable, accessible, and correctable. Democratic disagreement remains a feature of the handoff rather than a defect to be engineered away. Accessibility testing should ask whether readers can find dissent and exclusions as easily as favorable findings.

The City also remains answerable for how its claim travels. Misleading summaries, missing dispute labels, inaccessible formats, unlawful exposure, partisan exclusivity, stale bundles, machine-generated distortion, and campaign misuse require correction, notice, review, or withdrawal. Release is not the end of responsibility; it begins a new public-duty clock. A withdrawal notice should remain linked to obsolete copies so downstream users can locate the current status.

25.1 — The Archive as Democratic Object

The archive becomes a democratic object when people can inspect and challenge the source records behind a public claim (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; W3C, 2013).

25.1.1 — Questions a Record Can Answer

A public record should help voters ask concrete questions. What burdens did the participant notice quickly? Which burdens did they miss until challenged? How did they handle dissent? Did correction change later conduct? Did staff influence become visible? Did public explanation improve? These questions are more useful than asking whether a candidate seems authentic in a debate or moving in a campaign video.

A dated, correctable source can help readers check rumors and competing accounts. Its value depends on record integrity, not on an assumption that official publication is inherently trustworthy.

Archive tools must enforce Section 11.7.6: source-linked navigation and summaries are permitted only within that rule; personal trait, trust, motive and readiness profiles remain prohibited.

25.1.2 — Reading Evidence in Context

When a record describes conduct, voters should be told whether the source is observed behavior, participant explanation, staff testimony, correction record, simulation output, or institutional interpretation.

A contextual record should also separate original material, institutional summary, machine-assisted summary, journalist excerpt, campaign quotation, and public comment. Those categories are not interchangeable. A voter reading a summary should know whether they are seeing a primary record, an

interpreted bundle, a disputed excerpt, or a later explanation produced for public access (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008).

Context also requires proportional reading. A ten-second failure, a two-hour debate, a season of staff complaints, a corrected draft, a disputed advisor note, and a year of ordinary conduct should not be presented as equivalent evidence. Help readers weigh duration, recurrence, source, response, and consequence alongside the content itself.

Test for both hostile clipping and favorable omission: the selected context must preserve material evidence that challenges the proposed interpretation.

Apply the protected-exclusion and attribution rules in Sections 25.5.5 and 23.5.5 when another person’s contribution is necessary for context.

25.1.3 — Finding and Challenging the Source

The record site should explain why each bundle exists for a particular pathway. A role-specific landing page identifies the office burden, jurisdiction, evidence categories, observation period, missing or protected material, current disputes, correction route, expiry, and claims the City refuses to make. Responsible reading should require fewer clicks than sensational reading.

Route challenges to factual error, missing context, misleading summary, protected-content failure or overclaiming through Section 29.3.3. Preserve the earlier version alongside the corrected object.

25.2 — Building a Record Instead of a Persona

Preserve the evidence that tests a campaign's story through the five categories below (Goffman, 1959; Thorndike, 1920; Scammell, 2015). A campaign biography can conceal the decisions behind a persuasive label. Voters need evidence of relevant choices and responses to criticism in context. The record makes a claim checkable without making the City the final judge of a person's character.

25.2.1 — Persona Risk

A heroic image can spare a candidate from explaining decisions; a villainous one can make later correction invisible. Both leave voters with a simplified character in place of evidence.

The Transparent City creates a new persona risk because visibility itself can become a brand. A participant who lived under record may be marketed as more honest, more tested, more courageous, or more trustworthy than ordinary candidates. Release design must anticipate that overreading even when the City explicitly rejects it.

The record should show how the persona was formed, who benefited from it, what it omitted, and which pieces of evidence resist the image.

Place the source and current status beside a quoted persona claim, using the scoped label in Section 25.3.5, so readers can test what the campaign selected or omitted.

25.2.2 — Longitudinal Conduct

Longitudinal evidence tests whether a public portrayal fits conduct across declared tasks and observation periods. Preserve sequence, recurrence, change, and follow-through (Scammell, 2015; Tetlock, 2005).

Compare conduct across relevant task conditions, including routine work, delays, disagreement, and reliance on staff.

Show improvement, recurrence, and differences between domains without smoothing them into one trajectory.

The record site can support longitudinal reading through timelines, pattern summaries, correction sequences, staff interaction categories, public explanation history, and status labels. These tools should never produce a score. They should help citizens see continuity without requiring them to search the entire archive manually.

25.2.3 — Correction History

Use correction history to examine how the participant responded to errors in the recorded tasks. Its relevance to a proposed role must be explained; it is not, by itself, a validated predictor of future office performance (ISO, 2016a; Bovens, 2007).

Use the error-and-repair records in Section 23.4 to link acknowledgment, remedy, subsequent conduct, and affected burdens.

Keep error types and their remedies distinct under Section 23.4.1; successful correction in one task does not establish competence in another.

Preserve how the error was discovered and what prompted correction under Section 23.4.1. Do not infer private motivation from that route alone.

Reviewers should also check whether the same pattern reappeared under another name.

25.2.4 — Staff Treatment

Include role-relevant staff-treatment evidence under the standards in Sections 13.3.2 and 21.4 (Star and Strauss, 1999; Edmondson, 1999).

Use the staff protections in Chapter 21 when selecting or releasing this evidence; a readiness review does not authorize private-life exposure.

Examine warnings, credit, schedules, boundaries, and responses to criticism using the material role record. Politeness alone is insufficient.

Include any material dependency findings from Section 21.5.2 with their evidence, status, and response.

Include lawful, protected accounts of staff complaint routes and outcomes, showing whether staff could complain safely.

25.2.5 — Public Explanation Record

A message is designed to land. A public explanation is designed to be examined. Link the public explanations produced under Section 22.5.5 to their source decisions, objections, later outcomes, corrections, and admitted limits (Goffman, 1959; Thorndike, 1920; Scammell, 2015).

Public explanation must not become endless self-defense. Readiness review should value clarity, proportion, and answerability over volume.

A useful explanation also keeps the decision's original horizon in view. In a fictional exercise, a participant recommends opening a temporary service point while a permanent facility is repaired. The explanation identifies the expected repair interval and the information used to estimate it. A later delay gives the participant something precise to revisit: which assumption changed, what that changes for the temporary service, and what users should now expect. The first explanation remains readable beside the update. Readers can distinguish a reasonable decision made with earlier information from an estimate that was already unsupported when announced. The resulting record shows how the participant carries a public promise through changing

circumstances, rather than judging every earlier sentence solely by what eventually happened.

25.3 — Readiness Varies by Office and Jurisdiction

Readiness becomes informative only when it stays role-specific and jurisdiction-specific. A person may be prepared for one public function and unprepared for another, strong in one competence domain and weak in a domain the contemplated office requires. A universal label would collapse burden, context, and uncertainty into status (OECD, 2019b; NASPAA, 2024; Gerson, 2020). Role specificity also protects democratic pluralism.

25.3.1 — Office-Specific Burden

Complete an office-specific burden map before releasing readiness material. Identify the role's powers, recurring decisions, pressures, resources, financial exposure, affected people, confidentiality requirements and secrecy exceptions, staff responsibilities and working relationships, legal constraints and risks, and most dangerous failure modes. Give particular attention to vulnerable people who would carry the cost of failed judgment. The readiness bundle should then explain how the participant's record relates to that map (OECD, 2019b; NASPAA, 2024; Gerson, 2020).

Use the pathway-specific duties in Section 14.3; an office title alone does not determine the evidence required.

Local office may require deep responsiveness to ordinary complaints, public meeting conduct, local service delivery, zoning, housing, schools, roads, policing, utilities, and neighbor conflict. Executive office may require crisis authority, appointment power, procurement, security decisions, personnel management, and high-scale public explanation. Legislative office may require coalition, drafting, amendment, negotiation, and public reasoning under party pressure. These are not interchangeable tests.

Every release should name what has not been tested.

25.3.2 — Jurisdictional Context

Jurisdictional context includes law, language, political memory, corruption patterns, media environment, party system, administrative capacity, fiscal conditions, legal remedies, cultural expectations, and the local history of public harm (Gerson, 2020; Wilson, 1989).

The process must leave room for local readers to identify circumstances the City has missed.

Verify the proposed office's actual legal powers rather than relying on its title; seek local legal review when authority remains unsettled. Test language and cultural interpretation under Section 14.5.3, and evidence transfer under Section 14.5.2, against the receiving jurisdiction's conditions. Preserve core rights and safeguards while documenting local authority, legal limits and different community challenges.

25.3.3 — Scale of Consequence

Scale of consequence should be recorded through a burden matrix rather than an adjective. The matrix identifies the number and kind of affected people, depth and duration of impact, reversibility, time to harm, rights at stake, geographic reach, and dependency on other systems. A small administrative change and a decision involving war, emergency power, public health, finance, mass data, policing, children, infrastructure, or fundamental rights therefore receive different scrutiny. Review intensity rises with consequence, while the matrix remains a decision aid rather than a score of the participant (Moore, 1995; Carpenter and Krause, 2012).

Scale is not only population count or political prestige. A local housing board can profoundly affect families' security, while a

technical administrator may control a system few citizens understand.

Scale of consequence also helps interpret weakness. A minor weakness in public explanation may be tolerable in one role if strong staff and review structures exist. The same weakness may be intolerable in a role where crisis communication can affect public safety. Readiness should not be moralized when the real question is whether a weakness can be safely carried under the proposed burden.

25.3.4 — Competence Domain

Different jurisdictions may value different forms of service, legal competence, language ability, local legitimacy, cultural understanding, administrative craft, public interface, or conflict management. Role-specific review should not impose one elite pattern of readiness across every political setting. Core safeguards travel. Role interpretation remains contextual.

A competence-domain map prevents readiness from becoming one generalized capacity. Domains may include constitutional literacy, administration, budget and procurement, service delivery, staff leadership, public explanation, conflict tolerance, opposition behavior, crisis judgment, data and Artificial Intelligence literacy, record discipline, legal deference, disability awareness, diplomacy, and material-burden understanding. Evidence, uncertainty, reviewer disagreement, and expiry remain visible within each domain; strength in one area does not silently compensate for a role-critical deficit in another, and no domain becomes a measure of intelligence or worth (Thorndike, 1920; Rosenzweig, 2007).

Competence domains should be tied to role requirements. A technical regulatory role may require deep domain knowledge and strong conflict-of-interest discipline. A public-facing

mayoral role may require public explanation, staff management, crisis response, and local service literacy. A legislative role may require drafting, coalition, amendment, and committee discipline. The record should be organized accordingly.

Where the evidence supports a different role, use the redirection process in Section 25.4.2.

The bridge from formation to public service becomes more informative when evaluation separates entry into office from performance after entry. If a pathway changes who is elected or appointed, comparing only the officeholders from each pathway no longer compares the same starting population. Office performance for someone who never held that office is undefined, not zero performance or an ordinary missing observation. Principal stratification provides one language for such post-entry selection: an effect among people who would enter under either pathway is distinct from an effect on entering at all (Frangakis and Rubin, 2002). Membership in that hypothetical group is not directly observed; a causal estimate needs stated identifying assumptions or bounds, not a label applied to observed officeholders.

A useful report therefore separates the entry process, shared role-task evidence collected at declared times, and any later office-specific findings. A common assessment can evaluate a defined learning outcome without claiming to measure performance in an office never held. Later comparisons must name the jurisdiction and observation window as well as their lawful evidence source. No new monitoring after exit follows from this research question. Nonentry can be a responsible choice, while a bounded positive result remains valuable without being promoted into a claim about every graduate.

25.3.5 — Readiness Label Limits

Use readiness statuses such as ready, partially ready, not yet, redirected, or complete for a pathway only under the following limits (OECD, 2019b; NASPAA, 2024; Gerson, 2020).

Attach each label to its role, jurisdiction, source bundle, evidence period, and assessed scope. Use the claim wording in Section 25.8.1 rather than a general endorsement.

Use nonhierarchical, role-specific status labels; no medal, tier, or excellence category may turn them into participant rankings.

The label should also include expiration or review triggers where appropriate. Health, law, office context, public facts, record disputes, staff evidence, campaign conduct, or new harms may require reassessment. Expiration should be visible wherever the label is displayed so stale status cannot travel as current evidence. Public interfaces should display the review date beside the status rather than behind a secondary link.

Explain material status changes without exposing protected detail. Link derivative copies to the current record and retain historical dates on archived versions.

A public-facing label should survive a quotation test. Give independent readers a short excerpt, a screenshot, and a version stripped of surrounding explanation; ask whether each still conveys the assessed task, jurisdiction, evidence period, dispute status, and absence of endorsement. When a detachable form repeatedly invites a claim of general superiority, redesign the label or withhold that form. A longer disclaimer elsewhere cannot repair a misleading first view. Test the revision with new readers before publication.

25.4 — The Virtue of Not Yet

Not yet is a defined disposition with a route to more formation, redirection, or another choice of service (Schön, 1983; Mezirow, 1991; Edmondson, 1999). The option of not yet needs institutional protection. Campaigns want momentum, parties want usable candidates, and media want a story. Supporters want proof that the City works; participants may want their effort to lead to visible public service. Those pressures must not turn further formation or a decision against candidacy into a personal failure.

25.4.1 — Delay as Protection

Delay a readiness claim when the evidence lacks the strength, stability, scope, or context needed for the proposed role (Schön, 1983; Mezirow, 1991; Edmondson, 1999).

Using the support and review plan in Section 25.4.4, classify the evidence or condition that must change and set a review date and responsible owner. A review clock prevents open-ended deferral from becoming soft exclusion.

Use a bounded public status explanation under Section 25.4.5; retain any necessary protected detail only in the authorized review record.

25.4.2 — Redirection as Wisdom

Redirection proposes a different form of service or formation when the record better supports it (Edmondson, 1999; Tyler, 2006).

Evaluate alternative pathways on fit without treating their visibility or prestige as a hierarchy of human worth.

Redirection may occur because the participant’s strongest evidence supports a different role. Someone may consistently respect staff, administer carefully, and follow through without

having the conflict tolerance required for campaign life. Another may excel at public explanation but lack the technical competence needed for a proposed office.

Public explanation of redirection should name better fit without turning role limits into reputational punishment. Where lawful and consented, the City may state the alternative pathway or continued form of public service the record supports and the role-specific limits that make candidacy unwise, while withholding protected vulnerabilities.

25.4.3 — Non-Candidacy Without Shame

Choosing not to seek office is a complete outcome. The active formation Vow creates no obligation to become a candidate (Lind and Tyler, 1988; SAMHSA, 2014).

Public explanation should be minimal where non-candidacy is personal, protected, or not public-power relevant. If the participant chooses to state more, that is a separate decision under care, counsel, and release discipline. The formation process should not force self-disclosure to satisfy public curiosity about why a visible formation path did not become a campaign.

Close the public status without insinuation under Section 25.4.5 and maintain the post-exit record protections in Chapter 19.

25.4.4 — Continued Formation

A continued-formation plan names the office or claim deferred, evidence gap, required support or instruction, revised load, reviewer, protected information, next review window and conditions for withdrawal. The participant may continue, redirect, pause or leave (Goffman, 1959; Bovens, 2007).

Change the conditions that obstructed learning, using the support and load plan rather than merely adding more tasks.

Specify the concrete learning task, such as administrative practice or conflict tolerance, so continued formation does not become an undefined waiting period.

The next task should be chosen for the particular gap. A participant who can describe a service clearly but cannot arrange its delivery needs a different exercise from one who can organize the work but cannot explain it to a first-time user. For the first learner, an educator might supply two workable staffing arrangements and ask which one can support an extended opening hour. For the second, the educator might hold the operating plan fixed and ask for a revised public notice. Feedback can then identify the specific decision that improved. The learner gets a manageable next step, and the reviewer gets evidence connected to the reason further preparation was requested. Progress becomes a change in what the participant can do with the problem.

25.4.5 — Public Explanation of Not Yet

Explain the public meaning of not yet using the bounded status below, preserving protected information (Schön, 1983; Mezirow, 1991; Edmondson, 1999).

The explanation may state that a role-specific readiness claim is not being made at this time, that further formation or review is needed, that the participant has been redirected toward another pathway, or that candidacy is not recommended for the proposed role. It should not become a public diagnosis.

Public explanation must be contestable where it affects reputation. Participants should have a route to challenge inaccurate labels, missing context, or unfair summary. Affected persons may also need correction routes if the explanation hides their burden or exposes them. The City’s status language should never become an unappealable verdict.

Test whether readers understand the practical status without needing insider terminology.

A standard explanation template can protect consistency while still allowing the individual to decline unnecessary personal detail.

25.5 — Readiness Bundles and Record-Site Releases

A readiness bundle is the versioned public view of relevant evidence, governed by the integrity test below (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; W3C, 2013). Downstream use must be anticipated at design time. The bundle needs durable provenance, embedded status labels, export integrity, a canonical source within the record site, correction and withdrawal signals, and a rule that no machine-generated summary becomes the authoritative version. Make limits as visible as strengths and disputes as legible as accomplishments in the bundle's headings, labels, ordering, and visual emphasis.

25.5.1 — Bundle Purpose

A readiness bundle should pass an explicit integrity test before release. It identifies the contemplated role and jurisdiction, evidence window, included and missing task categories, provenance, reviewers, dissent and disputes, protected exclusions, public status, named human approver, release owner, correction and appeal routes, expiry, and withdrawal trigger. The bundle carries no institutional endorsement of candidacy (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; W3C, 2013).

A fictional entry makes the distinction tangible. In Mara's supervised procurement exercise in Section 29.3.4, the public task file links the recommendation to the authorized advice, her timely conflict declaration, and the final appeal disposition. The appeal repaired the omission of the declaration's link from the review packet and removed an unnecessarily identifying reference from an unreleased draft. The resulting account supports the narrow finding that the connection was declared before the advice was adopted; it leaves the quality of the recommendation open to examination on its stated reasons.

Protected collateral material is excluded, and the case establishes no readiness claim for an actual office or another jurisdiction.

The entry identifies the review service as decision owner and the public-interface manager as release owner. It directs corrections through formal intake and links to a privacy-preserving account of the correction, not to the withheld identifying draft. It remains current only for the stated task and evidence period. A later role claim requires its own dated review. In a live bundle, the responsible people, contact route, dates, and authorized destinations must be populated before release.

Provide layered access: a short status page, a fuller contextual bundle, lawful source access, and correction routes.

Identify the specific public decision or question the bundle serves; use the channel rules in Section 25.6 for each recipient.

Public release does not authorize the City to expand processing, disclose protected records, or supply data for research or model training without the applicable lawful basis and permissions. These controls do not override lawful quotation, criticism, or independent reporting; downstream rights and duties depend on applicable law.

25.5.2 — Record Categories

Keep each evidence domain separate under the competence map in Section 25.3.4, with its own sources, limitations, and review status (W3C, 2013; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Present limitation evidence alongside positive findings, including uncertainty, nontransferability, or a role mismatch.

Within each record category, distinguish the frequency of confirmed errors from the completion of required repairs. Measure errors against eligible decisions examined under a declared review method. For repairs, set the requirement, clock

origin, and assessment horizon in advance. Include every required correction in that cohort, even if it remains open at the horizon, and report verified completion, pending work, and unavailable follow-up separately. Do not calculate success only among finished cases or count an error-free task as a missed opportunity to correct. Neither rate ranks readiness. Also report severity, self-initiated and prompted repair, recurrence, and the mix of defects discovered. A larger share of difficult defects can lower a completion rate without indicating worse repair. A causal comparison requires a common, declared evaluation target and justified assumptions; adjusting for differences in which cases arose after entry does not automatically make the comparison valid.

Protected material, unavailable evidence, tasks not attempted, and findings of no relevant event remain distinct statuses. None is silently converted into success or failure. The public receives only the denominator and context justified for that release; a small count that would identify a protected person stays within the appropriate review channel.

25.5.3 — Dispute Labels

Use the context labels in Section 23.3.5 with the dispute categories below, making their practical meaning clear to readers (Solove, 2008; European Union, 2016).

A dispute label must not punish a participant merely because a dispute exists. Some disputes remain unresolved because protected material cannot be exposed. The label should identify a bounded, answerable review route.

Place the dispute label beside the material it qualifies, with a direct route to the current disposition.

Dispute labels must distinguish factual, interpretive, contextual, and protection disputes. A factual dispute asks

whether the record is accurate. An interpretive dispute asks what the record means. A context dispute asks whether material has been framed fairly. A protection dispute asks whether release itself causes harm. Each type requires a different review path.

Use defined intake thresholds, review, and appeal for dispute labels. Investigate alleged bad-faith use on evidence; rejection of a challenge does not itself establish abuse.

25.5.4 — Release Timing

Release timing should follow a decision clock tied to the proposed public role and, where applicable, the lawful campaign timeline. The record identifies the public decision date, minimum interpretation period, protected-person review, correction and reply window, lawful filing duties, delayed-content rule, and trigger for updated release. Material published too early can punish unfinished formation or expose collateral people; material published too late can deprive voters of meaningful interpretation. Timing should not serve campaign advantage (Roberts, 2006; Bovens, 2007). For a delayed release, record its reason, accountable owner and next review trigger.

Apply the visible version and derivative-copy update rules in Section 25.3.5 whenever a release changes.

25.5.5 — Protected Content Exclusion

Protected content exclusion is the rule that some material does not enter public readiness bundles in raw or derivable form even when the participant seeks office. Children, intimacy, health, clinical care, legal counsel, family burden, nonparticipant identity, safety-sensitive details, and certain crisis contexts require shielding. Exclusion covers cropped excerpts, metadata, machine summaries, model-training reuse, and combinations that can reconstruct the protected fact (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2008; European Union, 2016).

Where authorized and safe, a protected summary may convey a bounded finding or institutional decision. Apply the no-identifying-status test in Section 19.1.3 before disclosing even the category of review.

Protected exclusions should be audited. The same institution that benefits from a favorable bundle should not alone decide what disappears. Category review, independent oversight, affected-person routes, and correction logs should make exclusion accountable without exposing the excluded material.

25.6 — Public, Institutional, and Party Release

Release channels matter because audiences exercise different powers. Citizens read for democratic judgment, lawful bodies review eligibility or appointment conditions, parties decide support, and newsrooms prepare independent coverage. Purpose-specific rules, parity, logging, protected exclusions, and correction propagation reduce the risk that one channel will turn the same record into a hidden advantage (Przeworski et al., 1999; Fearon, 1999; Besley, 2006). Use the parity and purpose controls in Sections 25.6.2–25.6.4; donors receive no special release. Log and justify any lawful difference in access.

25.6.1 — Public Release

Use the bundle to answer the public's role-specific questions under Section 25.1, with its source and limits available for challenge (Przeworski et al., 1999; Fearon, 1999; Besley, 2006).

Publish a machine-readable provenance record, downloadable summaries, and a plain-language explanation. Keep status, version, dispute markers, source links, and correction routes attached to exports wherever technically possible, recognizing that detached fragments will still circulate.

Use one governed source record with purpose-specific authorized views. Differences in lawful access may change supplied detail, but must not change evidential status or selectively shape the account to persuade a recipient.

25.6.2 — Institutional Release

Institutional release should use a purpose-bound request packet. The packet identifies the requesting body, lawful authority, decision at issue, fields supplied, protected exclusions, access duration, retention or deletion rule, review owner, and appeal or correction route. Eligibility, ethics, conflict, appointment, or

records bodies may have duties the public does not have, but the City remains a source of formation evidence rather than the lawful authority itself (Besley, 2006; Ashworth, 2012).

Institutional access should be logged, and additional detail supplied only where authority, purpose, and safeguards justify it. Protected content requires a lawful pathway with specific controls.

Notify participants of the institutional release and provide the applicable error-challenge route; any lawful limit on notice must itself be justified and reviewable.

25.6.3 — Party Release

A party receives the authorized public bundle under parity rules. Any separate legally authorized review must use Section 25.6.2 and cannot arise merely from party status. Parties may not direct the record, demand protected access, delay correction, obtain exclusivity, or condition support on a favorable City statement. Log contacts and exceptional requests (OECD, 2020a; Scammell, 2015).

If a party receives a readiness bundle, the public should know the existence and category of that release unless law or safety requires otherwise.

Prohibit harassment, doxxing, and pressure on critics in City-supported campaign interfaces. Route independent third-party abuse through the lawful protection and correction mechanisms; publication does not give the City control over an entire party network.

25.6.4 — Media Release

For media releases, use Section 25.5.1’s provenance package with source date and version, correction history, quotation context, and a verification contact. Check for synthetic voice, machine summaries, translation error, platform compression,

search snippets, and adversarial cropping so distortions can be identified and corrected (Entman, 1993; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Independent reporting remains necessary; journalists are not obliged to adopt the City's interpretation.

Distinguish the official source from newsroom interpretation, machine summaries, and circulating excerpts using the categories in Section 25.1.

Media misuse requires a visible correction pathway. If a story misstates a status, strips context, exposes a nonparticipant, or treats a readiness claim as a certificate, the record site should provide a public correction log and official clarification.

25.6.5 — Owner-Book Boundary

Owner-domain boundary prevents this chapter from becoming campaign law, political strategy, party design, or transition architecture. The City may describe readiness bundles, record continuity, release channels, and campaign transition risks. It does not settle election law, party law, public finance, ballot access, political vehicle timing, or national rollout sequence (Przeworski et al., 1999; Fearon, 1999; Besley, 2006).

The legal architecture domain owns constitutional and election-law enforceability. The operating-government domain owns government interfaces and administrative systems. The transition domain owns sequencing, political vehicles, gates, and rollout timing. The material-systems domain owns broader public finance and resource burden. Release governance should hand off those subjects rather than absorb them.

International election-observation practice reinforces the value of keeping campaign assessment tied to declared legal and democratic criteria rather than to an institution's preferred candidate. The City may help readers understand provenance, correction, access, and protected limits, but it should not import

the authority of election observers or claim that its formation record settles campaign fairness. The campaign environment remains independently governed and publicly contestable (OSCE/ODIHR, 2021).

Attach the campaign-use notice in Section 25.7.4 where a City release is intended for campaign use. It identifies the source, the City's limited purpose, and the independent authorities responsible for unresolved legal or political questions.

25.7 — Campaign as Continuation, Not Reinvention

Campaigns reward compression, loyalty, speed, repetition, emotional clarity, and image. The City's contribution is continuity: formation evidence should remain available through democratic contest without allowing the archive to dominate the campaign or replace voter judgment (Scammell, 2015; Lupia, 1994; Lau and Redlawsk, 2001). The transition needs a declared handoff from the formation record to campaign-facing summaries. Corrections and restricted materials must retain consistent handling rules as public attention rises.

25.7.1 — Record-Carrying Campaign

A record-carrying campaign links its formation claims to the governed evidence and current status (Scammell, 2015; Lupia, 1994; Lau and Redlawsk, 2001).

The campaign may summarize, link to official record-site materials, respond to questions, and explain role relevance. Summaries must not detach from official labels or turn limited claims into broad trust messages.

Campaign staff need orientation to the record's rules. They should understand protected content, nonparticipant shielding, dispute labels, public artifact discipline, opposition research boundaries, media correction routes, and Artificial Intelligence summary limits.

A voter explainer translates the scoped claim in Section 25.8.1 and links readers to evidence and correction routes (Zaller, 1992; Lodge and Taber, 2013).

Apply the accessibility tests in Section 22.6.5 to voter explainers and provide usable alternatives to long records, consistent with current web-accessibility standards (W3C, 2023).

Answer questions about exclusions through the notice rules in Section 25.7.3 without expanding protected disclosure.

25.7.2 — No Persona Reset

Use a public change log to connect material campaign claims with earlier reasoning and later revision. Genuine changes can be explained; omitting the prior record cannot substitute for that explanation (Lau and Redlawsk, 2001; Druckman, 2001).

A campaign may highlight resilience while omitting harm to others, praise public explanation while ignoring staff complaints, or leave not yet findings unmentioned. These omissions should remain contestable through the campaign-continuity protocol.

No persona reset also forbids campaign-facing copies from becoming substitute archives. Campaign sites may quote or link to governed City records, but static mirrors should not outlive corrections, dispute labels, or withdrawal notices; every campaign excerpt should resolve to the current authoritative version.

25.7.3 — Opposition Research Boundary

Where a public exclusion notice is safe, identify its protection category, basis, reviewer, review date, and any available summary. If even that notice would identify a protected person or fact, use a less identifying aggregate or protected review route. Challenges follow the logged correction process (Nissenbaum, 2010; Roberts, 2006).

Opposition research may scrutinize public claims; it gains no City-authorized access to the protected content excluded by Section 25.5.5.

Opponents may challenge the candidate’s interpretation, question relevance to the proposed role, and criticize the City’s process using lawful public evidence.

When record material is misused, preserve evidence of what traveled, which label was lost, who was harmed, what correction was issued, and whether the release design needs repair. Use rapid incident response and notify platforms or publishers where appropriate.

25.7.4 — Campaign Law Boundary

Election-law questions require jurisdiction-specific legal authority rather than institutional improvisation. Ballot access, campaign finance, advertising disclaimers, nomination mechanics, party recognition, reporting obligations, defamation, equal-time rules, and election administration belong to existing law and to the legal and governmental domains that interpret and administer it. The campaign-continuity protocol can explain record-use conditions, identify when counsel is required, and refuse misrepresentation of City materials. It cannot legalize campaign behavior by moral confidence or convert an ethics notice into compliance advice (OSCE/ODIHR, 2021).

The campaign law boundary also protects the City from becoming a political machine. If the City begins designing tactics, targeting voters, optimizing messages, coordinating party strategy, or deciding how a participant should win, the institution has crossed from formation into political vehicle.

The European Union political-advertising regime provides one jurisdiction-specific illustration of why campaign use of City materials may require applicable legal review beyond an internal ethics rule. Regulation (EU) 2024/900 and its implementation measures govern matters the City neither writes nor enforces (European Parliament and Council, 2024; European Commission, 2025a; European Commission, 2025b).

If a campaign violates record-use conditions, the City can suspend City-facing claims within its own authority. Any

suspension should identify the violated condition and the route for correction or appeal.

Provide a campaign-use notice with City-originated campaign releases: canonical source, version, expiry, current status, correction route, and no endorsement or certification of campaign-law compliance. Keep protected exclusions safe under Section 25.7.3. Correct the City's own source and known derivative defects within its lawful authority, preserving earlier versions and current status.

25.8 — Readiness Is a Public Claim, Not a Halo

The release leaves three distinct responsibilities: voters judge candidates, lawful institutions assess matters within their authority, and the City remains answerable for its evidence and presentation. A status label can circulate farther than the evidence that justified it. Each release should explain the scope and limits of the City's review. The participant remains answerable to lawful challenge after departing the City.

25.8.1 — Claim, Not Certificate

Write readiness claims in ordinary public language. Avoid seals, medals, honorific grades, heroic labels, stars, progress bars, leaderboards, halo colors or simplified readiness icons that imply civic virtue or rank. Use role context, limits, dispute status and interpretation notes instead (Thorndike, 1920; Rosenzweig, 2007; Bovens, 2007; O'Neil, 2016; European Union, 2024).

A useful release states: "For this office and jurisdiction, the identified record supports the following formation claim during this evidence window. These disputes, exclusions, and uncertainties remain. Review is due on the stated date; voters and lawful institutions still decide." The release should link directly to the evidence, correction route, and current version.

If campaigns or supporters turn the statement into an endorsement, the City should correct the claim and its presentation. Contestability depends on those practical controls, not on calling the document a claim rather than a certificate.

25.8.2 — Voters Still Decide

Citizens remain free to value the City's record, distrust it, prefer another candidate, weigh policy differently, or judge that the stated readiness does not answer the burden they consider decisive. Policy positions, party platforms, local knowledge,

later conduct, legal qualifications, and competing records also matter (Achen and Bartels, 2016; Healy and Malhotra, 2013).

In its official voter guides, the City may explain participant records, correct misuse, and provide source materials. It may not rank candidates by City formation or advise citizens how to vote.

Candidates remain responsible for answering citizens' substantive questions; a readiness claim cannot replace an explanation of policy or local consequences.

25.8.3 — Institutions Still Review

Eligibility bodies, ethics offices, courts, election administrators, parties, appointment authorities, agencies, and oversight bodies may agree, require more evidence, impose remedies, or reject the claim within their lawful roles. The City supplies only purpose-bound material each body is entitled and needs to review (Bovens, 2007).

25.8.4 — City Still Answerable

City answerability should continue after election season and include correction of foreseeable misunderstandings created by its own presentation (Thorndike, 1920; Rosenzweig, 2007; Bovens, 2007).

Promptly correct inaccurate records, revise misleading summaries, add missing dispute labels, and remove or restrict wrongly exposed protected material where law and remedy require. Notify affected people and all known downstream recipients of the defective release. Publish a durable correction at the source and seek updates where defective copies are known to persist.

City answerability protects participants: when overclaiming, unclear limits, or release timing causes harm, the City must correct its claim, materials, or timing rather than leave individuals carrying its design failures.

Part VII — Office and Public Interface

Public office is where formation begins to carry direct public consequence. Before office, a participant studies, deliberates, receives criticism, practices explanation, and lives under a role-bound record. After election or appointment, decisions can move budgets, agencies, appointments, emergency resources, public language, and institutional attention. The threshold therefore enlarges the duty to explain because decisions now carry official authority across a wider field of consequence.

Part VII carries that burden across the office threshold while leaving sovereignty where law placed it. The City may support continuity between visible formation and official service through attributable reasoning, separated records, usable public contact, governed exceptions, and reviewable travel practice. It neither creates nor enlarges public authority. Its value lies in making the path of lawful power easier to understand and correct.

The case for an office interface is practical. Modern government is shaped not only by the person named on a ballot or appointment paper, but by calendars, staff, briefings, counsel, contractors, devices, visitors, security systems, public questions, and emergencies. Those pathways can carry decisive influence without leaving a usable public memory. A well-designed interface makes the ecology more legible while preserving the distinct rights and duties of everyone who enters it (Bovens, 2007; Mashaw, 2006; U.S. GAO, 2025).

Public contact is where the office interface can most visibly improve democratic life. People need practical routes to ask questions, submit evidence, report burden, contest an explanation, and receive a reasoned response. Those routes should be accessible without fandom, permanent profiling, unpaid investigative labor, or exposure to platform conflict. The aim is reachable public power with the costs of visibility kept

away from ordinary citizens (OECD, 2022b; W3C, 2023; UNESCO, 2023).

Travel and diplomacy test whether answerability can move without pretending that every room belongs to the City. Officials may enter foreign jurisdictions, classified facilities, hospitals, disaster zones, lawfully private meetings, or negotiations involving people who never accepted the Vow. An expected record may fail; another activity may be outside authorized capture or subject to lawful restriction. Classify those conditions separately, protect those affected, and restore the permitted practice when an exception ends. One question organizes the Part: where does the burden of official action go? It may reach residents waiting for service, workers implementing a decision, staff absorbing pressure, communities receiving risk, or citizens trying to understand an unexplained act. The interface cannot erase those burdens. It can reveal their route, reason, record, exception, reviewer, and correction owner well enough for affected people to challenge what happened.

Plural democratic life remains larger than the City. Voters, legislatures, courts, agencies, public servants, parties, journalists, civic organizations, unions, professions, and ordinary politics retain their own authority and value. The City offers one bounded way to carry visible formation into office support. Participation creates neither a preferred caste nor a privileged route to public service.

The three Chapters move outward in a deliberate sequence. Chapter 26 follows lawful office through staff, rooms, records, crises, and the boundary against shadow government. Chapter 27 opens structured routes for citizens, volunteers, experts, critics, and platform users. Chapter 28 carries the interface into travel, diplomacy, reciprocal hosting, and government environments where the City must sometimes narrow or stop its own practice.

Chapter 26 — Public Office and the City Interface

Chapter 26 narrows the office threshold to one operating question: how can lawful office use City-supported space, records, and staff without allowing City proximity to become governmental authority? The answer depends on a visible chain of command, separated record regimes, bounded staff roles, secure operations, and a clear return to ordinary public institutions.

The default is that active governmental offices remain outside City premises and systems. A City-hosted exception requires independent legal authorization, public justification, time limitation, separate funding and staff, technical and record segregation, and evidence that the interface adds value unavailable through an external connection. If command, custody, money, employment, secrecy, or remedy cannot remain unmistakably under lawful government, the office must operate elsewhere.

The positive case is that public power need not shed its memory to become practical. A decision can remain connected to the briefing that shaped it, the dissent that challenged it, the conflict that surrounded it, the revision that improved it, and the explanation offered afterward. Preserving that trace can make disagreement more informed without pretending that additional record automatically produces better judgment.

Staff dignity is equally central. Government workers who enter or use City facilities remain employees or officers under their own lawful regimes; proximity does not place them under the participant's Vow or full record. Organizing rights, labor protections, security duties, whistleblowing routes, professional privileges, disability accommodation, family life, and ordinary privacy remain intact. Accountability follows role-relevant influence rather than consuming the worker.

The fairness question clarifies the interface's purpose without changing the status of its claims. Official action shifts burdens through time, access, money, safety, attention, and institutional consequence. Making those routes easier to review could help affected people challenge decisions. Evidence from that practice would help assess the office-interface design.

By the end of this chapter, the reader should be able to draw two maps. One shows who may decide, command, spend, classify, appoint, review, and remedy. The other shows who creates, owns, stores, accesses, releases, corrects, retains, and lawfully produces each record class. No City mechanism is credible until both maps are clear and their points of contact are governed.

A worked hypothetical makes the boundary concrete. A City participant who has become mayor receives a credible report of a cyberattack affecting the municipal water system. The mayor may work from a City-supported suite only if the emergency command chain, public employer, budget, official record custodian, security classification, incident-response lead, oversight route, and later public explanation remain under municipal law. The City may preserve an authorized interface log and provide continuity support, but it cannot issue the emergency order, own the official file, direct government staff, or decide the remedy (U.S. GAO, 2025; FEMA, 2024; NIST, 2025b).

26.1 — Election Deepens the Ongoing Covenant

Entry into office connects three stages without merging their authority: the pre-office record documents formation, correction, limits, and public claims; a lawful election or appointment confers authority in a particular jurisdiction; and subsequent conduct exercises that authority in institutions the City does not own. Continuity means preserving the links among these stages without giving the City control of the office. Entry into public office gives City status no force within government. The earlier formation record remains subject to its own lawful release rules; it does not migrate automatically into official systems. Any continuing City facility or service arrangement requires separate authorization, with official duties, personnel, money, records, and remedies controlled by the lawful institution.

26.1.1 — Campaign-to-Office Continuity

Where a continuing interface is separately authorized, link relevant public promises to the official briefings and constraints that changed their implementation. Preserve whether new evidence, staff filtering, legal limits, or a protected exception affected the account, using the lawful custodian's record.

At the legal threshold, the interface should execute an official-record reset rather than a wholesale record transfer. The reset names the new authority owner, custodian, source system, privilege and classification rules, access classes, retention schedule, correction route, and public-release duty. Formation material may remain linked by provenance when relevant and lawful, but it does not migrate into the official file by default; protected or private City material stays outside unless a separate legal basis and affected-person safeguards authorize use. The result is continuity of meaning without continuity of custody (NARA, 2023; ISO, 2016a; U.S. GAO, 2025).

Match official explanation and review to the reach of a decision, within lawful limits. Make material staff influence reviewable and apply the confidentiality controls in Section 26.5 when information cannot be released.

Make explanation of consequential official action a continuing duty, implemented through the source-linked account in Section 26.4.1.

Use the public-explanation accessibility tests in Section 22.6.5 for office accounts, preserving lawful disclosure limits.

Use the time-specific evidence method in Section 23.3.4 so explanations distinguish what was available for the original decision from later information.

26.1.2 — No Victory Exception

Election does not erase the formation record or remove the officeholder's public duties of answerability. Continuing City services and recording still require the separate authority specified in Section 26.1.3.

Plan for office pressures using the emergency, confidentiality, and staff protocols below; classify each claimed exception rather than letting workload make it routine.

Use the protected-category and exception rules in Sections 26.2.3 and 26.5. Election does not convert convenience into legal necessity.

26.1.3 — Lawful Office Conditions

Lawful office conditions begin with source and capacity. The interface must identify the legal instrument that creates the office, the powers actually attached to it, the person or body empowered to supervise those powers, and the conditions under which authority pauses, transfers, or ends. A City agreement cannot enlarge that capacity, cure an unlawful act, or create a parallel mandate.

The Transparent Vow also changes status at this threshold. It remains a voluntary City commitment and may support separately authorized office practices, but it does not become a universal employment term for government staff or a private amendment to public law. Where a lawful office cannot use a proposed City mechanism, the honest result is redesign, limitation, or nonuse rather than quiet evasion.

Before a City practice touches an official act, identify what the applicable law permits, requires, forbids, delays, protects, or assigns to another authority.

Refer unresolved constitutional and government questions to the competent owners identified in Section 26.7 (U.S. GAO, 2025; OECD, 2020b).

Demonstrate lawful authorization through the legal preflight in Section 26.7.2 and the office authority and custody matrix in Section 26.7 before the relevant function begins.

When disclosure is restricted, use authorized oversight and the protected-status review in Section 26.5 rather than treating law as a blanket reason to abandon explanation.

26.2 — The Office Suite as Constitutional Environment

The office suite should make decision space, staff access, protected rooms, public contact, and crisis capability legible without changing the lawful owners of authority, privilege, custody, or remedy (U.S. GAO, 2025; NIST, 2024a; Nissenbaum, 2010). A credible suite begins with separation. Official government systems, City systems, public-interface systems, personal devices, campaign systems, security systems, and vendor tools cannot be treated as one convenient network. Identity, access, logging, storage, incident response, procurement, maintenance, and decommissioning need named owners so that convenience does not silently merge institutions.

26.2.1 — Decision Space

At the point of action, users must be able to identify which institution owns the room, which system owns the record, which role can direct work, which exception protects information, and which remedy applies when the boundary is crossed. No badge, doorway, device, or seating arrangement may create powers that law has not conferred (U.S. GAO, 2025; NIST, 2024a; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Every decision space needs a visible authority legend. It should identify who chairs the official process, who may present information, who may advise, who records the event, who controls the official file, and who has no decisional role. A City host may manage the room while remaining outside the chain of command.

The 2025 GAO Green Book offers a useful comparative orientation by distinguishing authority, responsibility, information, communication, control activities, and monitoring. A City-supported suite can translate those distinctions into

spatial and procedural cues without pretending that an office layout is an internal-control system or source of law. No one should be able to convert operational convenience into undeclared authority because they control the screen, schedule, microphone, archive terminal, or access list (U.S. GAO, 2025).

Use the trace methods in Section 26.4 to preserve decision inputs and changes. Keep authorized deliberative capture separate from public release, with a named custodian and a review clock for any delay. Apply a separate release decision so working discussion cannot be presented as a settled official act.

Provide the source, burden, and revision tools in Section 26.4 at the point of decision, so officials can use them while the work is underway.

26.2.2 — Staff Access Map

Physical circulation carries the same burden. Visitors, government staff, City staff, media, members of the public, contractors, foreign representatives, counsel, clinicians, and security personnel require different access routes and purposes. A door or credential should reveal the authority behind access, not merely the confidence of the host.

The access map must include digital reach as well as physical presence. Calendar permissions, shared drives, messaging channels, briefing portals, device administration, remote support, transcription systems, and emergency credentials can shape access even when no one crosses a door. Every privilege requires a purpose, owner, expiration condition, and audit route.

Vendor and foreign access require separate treatment. Maintenance personnel, cloud providers, interpreters, external security specialists, diplomatic visitors, and technology vendors may need limited access, but they do not enter through an informal invitation. Procurement terms, security review,

data-location rules, escort requirements, conflict disclosure, incident duties, and removal capability must be defined by the lawful owner of the system.

A staff access map should show more than organizational hierarchy. It should identify who can reach the official, who can shape the calendar, who can filter public contact, who can introduce experts, who can summarize risk, who can enter protected rooms, and who can trigger emergency protocols.

Update the access map when material roles or privileges change, including temporary crisis access. Keep staff privacy and public explanation proportional to the effect on official judgment.

Distinguish formal title from actual administrative, advisory, legal, emergency, political, technical, or public-facing access (NIST, 2020a; Carpenter and Moss, 2014).

Apply staff role privacy under Section 26.3.2 to the access map; document access to authority without publishing a worker's private life.

Refer material relationship-based access concerns to the conflict review in Section 26.3.3.

26.2.3 — Counsel and Protected Rooms

Protected rooms must also identify the record boundary at the door. Privileged legal material, classified information, clinical information, whistleblower communications, and ordinary restricted administrative work are not one category. Different authorities govern who may enter, what may be captured, whether a stub is created, who holds the protected record, and whether any later disclosure is possible.

No City record system may retain a hidden duplicate merely because a conversation occurred on its premises. Where law assigns custody to government counsel, a court, a security

authority, a clinician, or another professional custodian, the City record should contain only the lawful interface information needed to account for use of the space. Protected substance remains with the authorized custodian.

Set the protected room's purpose, authorized roles, time bounds, capture and access status, oversight, and post-use review before use.

Protected rooms become dangerous when privilege or safety labels shelter unrelated influence. A counsel room can drift into political strategy, a security room into unreviewed decision making, and a restricted room into donor access. An abuse-response route also belongs to the room's design before its first use (Pozen, 2010; Thompson, 1999).

Use only the lawful interface status permitted by the custodian; it may identify a protected process without its substance where even that notice is safe.

Counsel access must be real. Normalize lawful advice without stigmatizing its use, and review misuse of counsel space separately.

26.2.4 — Public Interface Edge

A thousand messages may reveal public fear without settling law or policy; a single affected-person report may reveal a burden that broad popularity missed. Preserve source, context, queue status, accessibility, urgency, and response path. The interface should help power hear better, not simply hear more.

Apply queue discipline, accessibility, protected reporting, topic routing, and abuse controls without privileging volume or organized pressure (Nissenbaum, 2010; W3C, 2023).

The public-interface edge protects ordinary citizens from record inheritance. A person who asks a question, files a complaint, or offers a comment does not thereby enter the

official's role-bound record. The edge receives public burden while minimizing identity, limiting reuse, preserving correction and deletion routes, and preventing doxxing, profiling, or unrelated model training.

Questions receive trackable status where appropriate, burden reports are routed to an owner, recurring concerns are aggregated without erasing individual harm, and dissent remains part of answerability.

26.2.5 — Crisis Room Rules

Communications, devices, storage, acoustic protection, power, identity management, visitor procedures, supply chain, and incident response must satisfy the lawful authority using the room. Where those controls are absent, the function belongs in an authorized facility.

Use NIST Special Publications 800-53 and 800-161 as comparative references for access control, audit, system integrity, contingency planning, and supply-chain risk. Every security-critical capability needs a qualified, accountable owner; every external dependency needs a reviewable purpose and exit path (NIST, 2020a; NIST, 2022).

Crisis-room operation uses the separately authorized record regime in Section 26.1.3, including lawful restricted access and temporary nonpublication.

Entry rules make the room governable: who may activate it, who may enter, what qualifies, which records are captured or delayed, and who reviews the exception. Without those answers, a crisis room can become the most powerful unreviewed space in the City (FEMA, 2024; NIST, 2025b; ISO, 2019).

A return-to-record protocol begins with activation. It names who decides that immediate risk has receded, what can be disclosed, what remains protected, which oversight has reviewed

the choice, what explanation is due, and how affected people are notified where needed. A tabletop handoff should test whether that chain still works when the activating official is unavailable or the crisis spans a shift change.

Post-event access review should identify any physical or sensory feature that impeded disabled users during the response.

After each crisis-room activation, record which staff roles gained temporary gatekeeping power and when that authority ended. Verify closure or lawful reassignment through the reconciliation in Section 26.5.5.

26.3 — Staff as Part of the Visible Governing Process

Attribute material staff influence through the role and conversion records below, while preserving the public employer's authority and workers' rights. Visibility must be role-bound. Government staff remain subject to their employing institution, applicable labor and ethics rules, clearance obligations, professional duties, and lawful chains of command. City staff remain subject to City governance.

26.3.1 — Staff Influence Logs

Identify the institution and active role behind each material contribution; apply government and City duties separately rather than using an undifferentiated adviser label.

Role conversion needs its own event. When a former mentor becomes a paid adviser, a City operator becomes a government contractor, or an archivist is asked to brief the official, the change should be authorized and disclosed before substantive influence occurs. Compensation, conflict, confidentiality, record duty, recusal, and termination conditions belong in that conversion record.

Apply the materiality threshold in Section 21.5.1 to authorized office influence logs, subject to the public employer's law and record duties.

Record contributions that changed language, evidence, alternatives, interpretation, public response, or access, identifying the contributor's active role (OECD, 2024b; Bovens, 2007).

Preserve material staff dissent and the official's response using the minority-report method in Section 23.2.4 where compatible with the official record regime.

Link a correction to the relevant influence entries so reviewers can locate an input, filtering, or decision failure.

Staff must be able to correct influence logs that exaggerate, omit, or misattribute influence.

26.3.2 — Staff Role Privacy

Public-service rights do not shrink because work occurs near a visible officeholder. Applicable employment law, collective bargaining, organizing rights, workplace safety, disability accommodation, leave, professional standards, and anti-discrimination protections remain in force. ILO Convention No. 151 offers a comparative international reference for freedom of association and labor relations in public service, while local law determines the actual rights and procedures (ILO, 1978; ILO, 2019b).

Security obligations also remain role-specific. A staff member may hold a clearance, professional license, statutory confidentiality duty, or whistleblowing obligation that the participant does not share. City record practices must never pressure the worker to breach those duties or disclose private information merely to demonstrate institutional transparency.

Consider a records analyst whose work becomes controversial after an official decision. The public may need to know what the analyst prepared, which instructions governed the work, whether a conflict existed, and how the record was corrected; it does not need the analyst’s home address, family routines, medical history, or unrelated beliefs. The interface should preserve the role record, seal collateral personal data, offer correction and anti-retaliation routes, and treat targeted exposure as an institutional incident rather than the private cost of public service (ILO, 1978; ILO, 2019b).

Role privacy draws the boundary around staff records. Official duties, material advice, access role, conflicts, work-related conduct, complaint status, and participation in specific office

processes may be recorded when relevant. Off-duty life, unrelated family matters, personal grief, ordinary relationships, health details, and private beliefs remain outside the record unless a lawful, narrowly tailored role need brings them in (ILO, 1978; ILO, 2019b).

Provide notice and protected correction, complaint, and anti-retaliation routes for staff role records through Section 26.3.5.

26.3.3 — Advisor Conflicts

Contractors and advisers require their own scopes. No category inherits another category's burden merely by sharing a building.

Conflict review should include influence actors beyond formal advisers. Donors, vendors, former employers, party officials, family businesses, foreign principals, advocacy organizations, think tanks, and platform operators may shape access or information. The revised 2024 OECD Recommendation on Transparency and Integrity in Lobbying and Influence provides useful comparative questions about gifts, hospitality, fair representation, evidence quality, and pre- or post-office conflicts (OECD, 2024b).

The aim is not to stigmatize association. Public officials need expertise, political relationships, and contact with organized interests. The fairness question is whether a material tie changes access, framing, or benefit without being visible to those who review the decision. Disclosure, recusal, countervailing input, and reasoned treatment are stronger controls than moral suspicion.

Connect each material adviser conflict to the decision it could affect and the control selected (Carpenter and Moss, 2014; OECD, 2024b). Assign the lawful owner to choose and

document disclosure, recusal, role limits, exclusion, or independent review according to the conflict.

26.3.4 — Informal Staff Power

Identify informal staff power by whether a role can materially alter access, evidence, framing, or timing, regardless of formal rank.

Informal authority should trigger a role-conversion test when repeated conduct begins to resemble a stable public function. If a scheduler routinely decides access, an adviser repeatedly resolves disputes, or a security coordinator effectively determines whose evidence reaches the official, the office should name the function, define its limits, document material influence, provide review, and protect the worker through an accurate role description. Formalization is not automatic promotion; it is a way to prevent durable power from surviving as personal favor, invisible labor, or deniable control.

Apply the dependency review in Section 21.5.2 when one relationship becomes indispensable to material access or decisions, within the public employer's authority.

Compare actual presence and absence with the formal access map. Review who can interrupt, refuse, change drafts without attribution, interpret between the official and others, or become an unofficial source of permission (Lipsky, 1980; Mashaw, 2006).

Dependency review should assess whether indispensability prevents a staff member from resting, disagreeing, complaining, or leaving.

26.3.5 — Staff Complaint Routes

A staff complaint connected to public office must have a route outside the immediate office hierarchy. Allegations involving unlawful direction, retaliation, records manipulation, security

bypass, harassment, donor pressure, or misuse of City systems cannot be routed only to the people implicated. Independent ombuds, inspector, ethics, labor, professional, judicial, or statutory channels may be necessary depending on jurisdiction (UNODC, 2025; Edmondson, 1999).

Protected reporting should preserve confidentiality where lawful, separate investigation material from ordinary personnel files, and identify the competent owner. Where the issue belongs to government, employment, criminal, regulatory, judicial, or professional authority, the City routes rather than absorbs the case.

Office-interface intake begins with protective triage: immediate safety, retaliation risk, evidence preservation, conflicts of interest, interim work arrangements, and jurisdiction. The worker receives acknowledgment and status without becoming a public figure (UNODC, 2025; ILO, 2019b). Where public explanation is necessary, the staff member should be consulted about foreseeable exposure risks before identifying detail is released.

Classification then directs the matter to the correct remedy. Participant misconduct, official misconduct, record error, security risk, donor pressure, workload, and governance failure may share a doorway but not an owner or standard.

The office should publish aggregate route and delay patterns where lawful, preserve anti-retaliation and appeal, and trigger governance review when complaints reveal recurring pressure.

26.4 — Public Explanation and Record Continuity

Public explanation relies on records, but continuity begins by refusing record fusion: the official government record remains authoritative for government action, while City records document only City functions and the bounded interface. The National Archives and Records Administration's Universal Electronic Records Management Requirements offer one useful comparative discipline by separating lifecycle requirements, metadata, access, disposition, and system responsibilities. The 2025 GAO Green Book likewise emphasizes operations, reporting, compliance, documentation, and control. Neither instrument supplies universal law for the City (NARA, 2023; U.S. GAO, 2025).

26.4.1 — Decision Explanation

Every explanation begins with the authoritative source of the decision. A City summary may help the public navigate, but the order, vote, directive, judgment, regulation, or other government instrument remains the act with legal effect. Readers should be able to move from explanation to source, identify who had authority, and see where review or remedy belongs.

Where the City publishes a companion account, the status label should be unmistakable: City interface explanation, not official legal text. Corrections to the companion account belong to the City. Corrections to the official act belong to the lawful government process. The two may cross-reference each other without becoming interchangeable.

An official public account, however brief, should preserve a minimum explanation schema: authoritative act, decision owner, affected groups, evidence classes, material alternatives, unresolved uncertainty, implementation owner, review date, and remedy route. Any notice about protected material must be

lawful and safe; authorized reviewers can inspect the restriction without exposing the underlying content. Keep the account current so reviewers can compare it with implementation, corrections, and after-action findings (Bovens, 2007; Heald, 2006; U.S. GAO, 2025).

Proportionality follows burden and consequence. A minor scheduling matter does not require a treatise, while a decision affecting housing, safety, health, public money, rights, staffing, emergency response, or public trust may require a fuller account. The practical test asks how much burden moved and how much confusion, vulnerability, or lost recourse would remain without explanation.

Maintain a dated, source-linked revision history under Section 26.4.3 and the continuity-label rules in Section 26.4.5.

26.4.2 — Briefing Trace

Briefing materials also need custody labels. A government memorandum, City educational note, contractor analysis, classified annex, public submission, and personal annotation may enter the same meeting while remaining different records. The trace should preserve provenance and material influence without copying protected substance into the wrong system.

Trace which material sources reached the official, which were filtered or excluded, and how they affected the decision.

Where lawful, the trace may identify a protected item’s existence, source, status, and role without copying its substance (NARA, 2023; ISO, 2016a).

Preserve whether the official saw original record material, a staff summary, an expert report, a dissenting memo, a public submission, or an emergency update. Review omitted input: was an affected community left out, a minority view filtered, a critic

ignored, an expert warning softened, or a channel blocked by staff?

A briefing trace must remain usable for correction. If an official lacked a crucial fact, the trace can help reviewers determine whether the omission was unavoidable, negligent, strategic, or produced by the system, and whether it contributed to the decision's failure.

26.4.3 — Revision Trace

Preserve what changed, the evidence or constraint that drove it, material contributors, affected burdens, and unresolved dissent.

A revision trace preserves stages instead of flattening them. First draft, working draft, counsel-reviewed version, staff revision, public explanation, and corrected version each carry a distinct status. Clear labels protect unfinished thought from being mistaken for final action while preserving accountability for how the decision changed.

A trace should follow the practical offer as well as the words. Consider a fictional proposal to keep a public study room open later. The promise in the announcement may remain unchanged while the staffing plan is revised from one late shift to two overlapping shifts. That operational revision can determine whether the promised opening hour is actually dependable. Conversely, a notice may be rewritten in plainer language while the service itself stays the same. Keeping those two kinds of change distinguishable helps readers see whether a revision altered the offer, improved its explanation, or did both. It also gives the next decision maker a useful starting point: the public commitment and the arrangement that currently supports it.

26.4.4 — Public Questions on Official Decisions

Route public questions through the office interface as potential information about errors, access failures, or overlooked consequences.

The question system should distinguish general curiosity, affected-person questions, expert challenges, misinformation correction, legal inquiries, emergency concerns, and harassment. Each class requires a different response path.

Within the intake classes above, identify the substantive owner for factual, rights, harm, staff, records, legal, or emergency questions (OECD, 2022b; W3C, 2023).

Publish patterns of questions where lawful and use recurring confusion to repair the office's explanations. When a pattern reveals hidden burden, address it beyond individual response tickets.

26.4.5 — Record Continuity Labels

A continuity label should be accompanied by a record-family statement. City interface records describe City access, facilities, support, and public explanation. Official records describe government action under law. Campaign records concern electoral activity. Personal records remain private unless law provides otherwise. Security and classified records follow authorized security systems. Staff and counterparty records remain governed by their own employment, contractual, professional, or legal regimes.

Each record family needs a named system of record, custodian, authority, classification, permitted users, release basis, retention authority, correction route, and response to lawful process. Cross-system references may use links, identifiers, hashes, certified extracts, or other lawful pointers where duplication would create confusion or risk. A copy's legal status depends on

the applicable authority and certification, not on visual identity alone.

Apply the NARA lifecycle disciplines without implying that a City summary holds an absent or protected official source (NARA, 2023; ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017).

Route lawful process to the correct custodian. The City can preserve its own interface records, maintain chain of custody, route requests, respond within its authority, and explain those limits.

A continuity label tells readers whether a record is current, provisional, delayed, protected, disputed, corrected, or unavailable after a continuity break. For example, “Delayed: security review pending; next review 15 October” explains an absence without disclosing the protected substance. The date is illustrative, not a proposed universal deadline.

Each label needs a responsible authority, defined scope, challenge route, and review date or condition. Reviewers should test both misuse directions: an unexplained gap that invites rumor and an overbroad protection label that conceals relevant conduct. Public wording should remain brief enough for nonexperts to use (NARA, 2023; W3C, 2013).

Keep event, review, release, and revision dates distinct. Link superseded labels directly to the current authoritative status.

26.5 — Crisis Governance and Return to Record

Crisis compresses time, widens consequence, and increases legitimate reasons for confidentiality. It can also concentrate authority in the channels least visible to ordinary review. A serious interface prepares before the emergency, when command, secure systems, protected logs, oversight access, continuity, and restoration can still be designed without panic. The result is speed with a return path.

26.5.1 — Emergency Need

FEMA's 2024 Federal Continuity Directive links essential functions, continuity personnel, communications, facilities, information systems, and records within a managed continuity program. NIST Special Publication 800-61 Revision 3 places preparation, detection, response, recovery, and improvement inside a continuing cybersecurity-risk system. These are jurisdiction-specific comparative sources, but they reinforce a broader institutional lesson: crisis work needs authority, protected records, recovery, and learning rather than improvised secrecy (FEMA, 2024; NIST, 2025b).

Emergency need must name the lawful decision maker and the power being exercised. A threat assessment, continuity activation, classified briefing, evacuation, emergency procurement, public-health action, or temporary relocation may each have a different authority. The City may host or support the response only within that authority, and it must remain possible to distinguish a government command from a City operational action.

Need must be defined before crisis. Emergency categories should identify threats to life, bodily safety, critical infrastructure, legal privilege, protected persons, active security response, and time-sensitive public harm.

Choose the narrow protected scope needed for the emergency and make it reviewable. Restrictions that continue after the emergency require their own lawful basis (Boin et al., 2017; FEMA, 2024).

Emergency need should include review of alternatives. Could a protected summary be issued? Could oversight receive notice? Could non-sensitive elements be released? Could public explanation be delayed rather than denied? City governance should ask what is the least opaque lawful path that protects life, rights, and public trust.

A closeout clock should begin with the exception itself, not only when staff later decide that the crisis has passed. The review trigger should be visible to staff before the protected channel is opened.

26.5.2 — Logged Exception

An emergency log belongs in an approved system with access controls, integrity protection, reliable time sources, responsible custodians, and an incident process. A private drawer or ungoverned City database cannot carry emergency accountability. Even when substance is restricted, the log's existence, location, owner, and review trigger should remain known to the competent authority.

An exception log should preserve the minimum protected trail needed to reconstruct the trigger and time, lawful authorization, authorized roles, decision category, scope and duration, affected systems or record classes, protection reason, recovery, expected review point, oversight route where lawful, and return to ordinary rules. Sensitive operational details need not appear publicly. If the record may have been compromised, that uncertainty must remain visible until resolved (Pozen, 2010; NIST, 2025b).

Logging makes an exception reviewable; it does not itself establish that the restriction is lawful. Oversight must be able to test the stated authority, scope, and reason without unnecessary protected disclosure.

Review repeated exceptions for planning failures, misuse, and incompatibility between office duties and the proposed interface. Preserve alternative explanations and route findings to redesign or appropriate oversight.

Use the log to investigate record gaps without presuming whether they arose from lawful restriction, failure, or misconduct.

Test each log for specific scope, necessity, proportionality, and current review; a vague entry cannot justify a whole period of restricted activity.

26.5.3 — Delayed Disclosure

Delayed disclosure requires a specific protective purpose, a responsible authority, and a review date or condition. It may protect life, lawful privilege, an emergency response, a counterparty, a security operation, or a vulnerable person. Embarrassment, partisan convenience, donor pressure, and dislike of scrutiny do not justify it.

Where release depends on an uncertain event, such as an investigation ending, the file should name both that event and a periodic review interval. Review may retain the restriction when law or safety requires it, but renewal must record a current reason. This prevents a conditional trigger from becoming indefinite concealment.

Delayed disclosure may use layers. A public notice may state that an emergency exception occurred. Oversight may receive more detail. Affected persons may receive protected information. The public may later receive a summary, then a

fuller explanation after risk passes. Layering allows accountability to begin before full release is safe (Roberts, 2006; Thompson, 1999).

Use the decision and revision traces in Section 26.4 for later disclosure, preserving the emergency sequence and unresolved restrictions.

Include errors in the original emergency judgment, scope, or duration in the correction and remedy record.

26.5.4 — Emergency Oversight Access

An emergency reviewer may need clearance, professional competence, conflict independence, secure facilities, access to the lawful custodian, and power to require correction or remedy. A reviewer without jurisdiction or access cannot supply the required oversight.

Match oversight access to the review purpose; authority to inspect an exception does not give every reviewer access to every protected fact.

Crisis oversight needs access logs, conflict checks, confidentiality duties, appeal or meta-review, and a lawful public summary.

Emergency opacity needs review outside the immediate circle of decision. Oversight may vary by jurisdiction, legal context, and office type (Boin et al., 2017; Thompson, 1999; U.S. GAO, 2025).

The review should ask whether the emergency trigger was valid, whether the scope was narrow, whether disclosure was delayed properly, whether affected persons were protected, and whether return-to-record occurred.

Publish a lawful oversight summary identifying the category, disposition, and resulting reforms where these can be disclosed safely.

26.5.5 — Return-to-Record Protocol

Restoration reconciles every emergency record, access grant, and temporary role with the ordinary regime. It closes temporary accounts and devices, revokes emergency credentials, transfers protected records to the proper custodian, labels continuity gaps, checks affected systems, and schedules public explanations. Assign a named owner and a new review date to each unresolved restriction or delayed disclosure. Skipping reconciliation leaves the crisis channel alive.

Use the after-action method in Section 24.6 for institutional learning within the official custodian's authority, keeping lawfully restricted substance protected.

Close the emergency basis explicitly and assign any remaining restriction or remedy to its own lawful review route.

The protocol must name the owner and date for resuming normal recording, access, explanation, release review, and public-question routes.

Specify the return owner, evidence, records, and oversight sign-off at activation, using Section 26.2.5 (Boin et al., 2017; ISO, 2019).

Reconciliation classifies missing data, delayed logs, restricted communications, emergency movement, and incomplete capture as technical, legal, security, human, or misconduct-related where possible. Clear classification reduces rumor and directs repair.

Human recovery belongs beside archival order. Debriefing, rest, clinical or peer support where needed, and complaint routes help prevent staff and officials from carrying unresolved crisis burdens after the event. A closure review should record whether any staff member still carries emergency duties, access, or recovery obligations after formal deactivation.

In a later drill, verify that emergency credentials and restricted channels reactivate only on a fresh lawful trigger.

26.6 — How Governing From the City Changes Power

The interface's benefits remain contingent. Records can chill thought, invite performance, or be misread. Staff visibility can become blame. Public contact can become pressure. The interface must therefore be judged by whether it improves traceability and correction without creating greater burdens of theater, exposure, delay, or private dependency.

26.6.1 — Power Under Memory

Accountability may change who is hired to carry public decisions, not merely how a leader explains them afterward. León and Santos (2026) use Brazilian municipalities exposed to randomly assigned anti-corruption audits to study subsequent public-sector recruitment. They estimate a 4.4 percent increase in the number of workers meeting the formal educational requirements of their occupations, with a larger 8.8 percent increase for frontline health and education posts. Their result concerns the match between qualifications and positions; it does not by itself establish better services or measure a City-trained official. Related evidence is consistent with increased recruitment effort and reduced patronage, without independently identifying the causal contribution of every proposed mechanism.

The City can turn that external finding into a precise educational and public-office question. During formation, participants can practice justifying appointment criteria, identifying conflicts before recommendations are adopted, hearing staff objections, and correcting decisions against an independently documented standard. After lawful entry into office, only the receiving government or agency controls appointments and official personnel records. An independent evaluation could ask whether this preparation improves

role-relevant recruitment decisions beyond an adequately resourced merit system, and then separately measure any change in service outcomes.

Use the office record families in Section 26.4.5 to preserve consequential decision paths without merging custody or extending public access.

Test whether anticipated review improves task performance or instead increases defensive behavior and presentation work. The office interface's behavioral effects remain empirical questions.

Use the lawful relevance, retention, and review controls in Section 26.4.5 to prevent minor records from becoming indefinite public ammunition.

26.6.2 — Staff Influence and Public Contact

Attribute material inputs through Section 26.3.1 while leaving the official responsible for the decision they adopt.

Evaluate whether reviewable influence logs improve attribution and warning uptake without increasing workload, retaliation, or exposure. Include workers' experience in that assessment.

Evaluate the public-contact system against the queue and response controls in Section 26.2.4: can people reach the correct owner and obtain a usable status?

Test whether structured contact changes explanations or decisions when it identifies a material omission; volume of messages alone does not demonstrate learning.

26.6.3 — Mistakes Become Learnable

Apply the error, breach, and misconduct distinctions in Section 24.6.2 through the competent official process. Different findings require different remedies.

Link each finding to the responsible repair and follow-up, using Section 24.6.3 within the lawful office regime.

An evaluation should examine warning uptake, correction reach, recurrence, and discovery before public harm. Do not infer improved trust or reduced concealment merely from the existence of a record.

26.6.4 — Government Boundary Preserved

The officeholder does not need City permission to exercise lawful authority, and the City cannot use housing, archive access, technology, security, reputation, or support services as leverage over public action. If the City believes its own rules have been breached, it may use its lawful internal processes, suspend its own support, preserve records, or refer a matter to the proper authority. It may not issue a private command to government.

Donor, founder, and operator access must be especially constrained at this boundary. Financial support for the City creates no audience with an officeholder, no policy channel, no priority in public questions, no archive privilege, and no influence over continued City support.

Use the authority-specific vocabulary in Section 26.7.5 for every office-interface description (Mashaw, 2006; Roberts, 2006).

Apply the separate record families in Section 26.4.5 and the transfer limits in Section 11.7 to office interfaces.

Any information shared with the City requires separate authority and a purpose-limited receipt.

26.7 — Government and Constitutional Boundary

Define the office authority and custody arrangements before any supported arrangement begins. The allocation diagnoses boundaries; it supplies no authority of its own (U.S. GAO, 2025; NARA, 2023; OECD, 2020b). For each real office and supported function, identify the lawful owner, record custodian, reviewer, remedy, and stop point. The arrangement is not ready while any of these fields remains uncertain (Mashaw, 2006; Roberts, 2006; U.S. GAO, 2025).

26.7.1 — Government Operations Authority

Budget separation is indispensable. Public funds, City funds, campaign funds, donor funds, and personal funds cannot be pooled through convenience. Every facility, employee, contractor, device, trip, security service, and record service must have a lawful payer, procurement route, conflict review, and audit trail. An off-budget benefit can become hidden influence even when no one calls it a payment.

For an official decision or order, the competent public authorities own the decision, official record, disclosure, oversight, complaint, and remedy. The City may host an interface but cannot exercise those powers.

For government staff, an authorized public supervisor directs staff; personnel and operational records remain with the public employer and its labor, safety, and grievance systems. The City may log authorized access but may not supervise staff or convert them into City participants.

For a briefing, advice, or recusal, the official office and its authorized advisers, ethics officers, or counsel own the briefing or recusal record and protected categories. The City may preserve lawful interface provenance but may not keep a shadow copy of privileged or classified substance.

For public money or a contract, the lawful finance, procurement, or contracting authority owns public funds, vendor selection, audit trails, protests, and remedies. Hosting creates no public-account, payment, or procurement power for the City.

For a protected matter, the designated lawful custodian controls access, retention, release, destruction, and oversight for privileged, classified, clinical, or other protected matter. The City may keep only a lawful interface stub or room-use fact and must stop capture when required.

For an AI or vendor function, the lawful purchaser or system owner controls procurement, security, audit, appeal, correction, and retirement. The City may provide bounded infrastructure but cannot become the hidden controller or permanent data custodian.

For an emergency exception, the official emergency authority owns the trigger, scope, protected record, expiry, oversight, after-action review, and lawful disclosure. The City may support continuity but cannot invent emergency power or extend the exception.

For public explanation, the official office owns public explanation under applicable information, accessibility, language, reply, correction, and appeal duties. The City may host the interface but cannot substitute its narrative for the official record or remedy.

For a complaint or remedy, the competent ombuds, inspector, court, legislature, agency, employer, regulator, or other lawful body owns the complaint and remedy file. The City may route complaints about its interface or conduct but may not decide an external government dispute without authority.

For exit or termination, government, employer, host, and City exercise only powers granted by law or contract. Closeout must revoke access, reconcile records and vendors, preserve

unresolved incidents and remedies, and end City support without a continuing claim over the office or institution.

For each supported function, add the public funding source, employment status, official system of record, and termination condition to Section 26.7 (U.S. GAO, 2025; NARA, 2023).

If a City protocol conflicts with lawful government procedure, legal review must govern the relationship.

26.7.2 — Legal Validity Authority

City records may support legal review, but cannot cure a legally defective act.

A legal-validity preflight should precede every office interface. It identifies the jurisdiction, office class, enabling authority, appointment or electoral basis, delegation limits, applicable privilege, public-record duties, employment rules, data and security law, review body, and available remedy. The preflight records unresolved questions and the person authorized to answer them; City approval is never one of the validity fields (Mashaw, 2006; Roberts, 2006).

The Constitution of Fairness develops the model's treatment of enforceability, office legality, rights, privilege, government records, and election interfaces. Actual jurisdiction-specific questions belong to competent legal authorities. The City may identify operational needs and risks but cannot settle legal validity.

Changes in jurisdiction, office class, delegation, records regime, privilege, vendor, Artificial Intelligence system, security arrangements, emergency authority, employment relationship, or governing law should reopen the legal preflight. Such changes do not automatically invalidate an arrangement; the competent legal authority must determine whether existing authorization still covers it. Until that question is resolved, any affected

function should be limited or paused where continued use would exceed the known authority.

26.7.3 — City Built-Interface Authority

Built-interface authority is narrow but meaningful. The City can govern its own premises, safety rules, access systems, employment relationships, contracts, archives, public interfaces, and participant agreements within law. It can decide whether its facilities are available, whether its own standards are met, and whether City support should pause. Those decisions affect the City, not the legal validity of government action.

The interface may also produce City-authored explanations, access maps, continuity labels, or audit findings. Each must carry a status label and a route to correction. None becomes an official government order, legal finding, intelligence assessment, or personnel judgment merely because an officeholder worked nearby.

Diagrams and public summaries may show the City's connections with office, staff, counsel, public questions, crisis rooms, and archives, but must not place it above government or imply command authority.

Complete Section 26.7 and test the interface's access, security, accessibility, maintenance, incident, and suspension arrangements before use. An unaccepted room or platform remains a proposal (U.S. GAO, 2025; NARA, 2023; NIST, 2024a).

Use the spatial and digital safeguards in Section 26.2 within the City's authorized premises and systems.

The City owns defects in its interface and the duty to repair them within its authority. Limited jurisdiction identifies responsibility; it does not excuse failures the City caused.

26.7.4 — No Shadow Government

A shadow government can arise without formal declarations. It appears when a private body controls access, information, money, staffing, technology, records, or reputation strongly enough to direct public action while avoiding public authority and review. The City's prohibition must therefore reach functional control, not only official titles.

The test has several questions. Can a City actor issue or block an order, condition support on policy, alter an official record, control a government employee, grant donor access, direct classified work, determine appointments, or deny a legal remedy? Can the officeholder act only by satisfying an internal City preference that the public cannot review? Any affirmative answer requires lawful authorization, redesign, or withdrawal of the interface.

A dual-loyalty conflict can emerge without an explicit command. Imagine that a former City educator becomes an official’s senior adviser while continuing private consultations with a City founder, using a City platform to test official messages, and seeking City donor support for policy work. The risk is not the adviser’s history; it is the unrecorded overlap among formative loyalty, official duty, institutional access, and private leverage.

When City and official roles collide, separation is the first remedy. The adviser’s continuing City role should be disclosed and ended or narrowly authorized; City-system access should be suspended where it touches official work; and official counsel or ethics authorities should own the conflict review. Relevant communications enter the correct official record, while recusal, reassignment, or withdrawal follows applicable law. The City may preserve its boundary-event record but may not adjudicate

the officeholder's legal obligations (Carpenter and Moss, 2014; Pozen, 2010; OECD, 2024b).

The public explanation should identify the conflict category, the lawful reviewing authority, the temporary safeguards, the final disposition, and any correction to the City's own practices without publishing protected advice or private details. No retaliation should follow merely because a staff member, official, or affected person disclosed the overlap.

26.7.5 — Cross-Reference Discipline

Cross-reference discipline begins with verbs. The City may host, support, document, label, audit, refer, suspend its own services, and govern its own premises within law. It may not authorize government, establish constitutional validity, command agencies, certify scientific truth, approve political succession, or confer public legitimacy. Precise verbs keep institutional ambition inside its actual authority.

The Government of Fairness owns the deeper design of public administration, ministries, agencies, services, procurement, official records, public-sector Artificial Intelligence, secrecy, emergency operations, and operating answerability. This chapter may describe an interface with those systems, but it does not decide how they are legally organized or administered.

For the distinct model of legal authority, see *The Constitution of Fairness*; the City's contribution here is an office-interface question, not a legal validity decision.

The Transition of Fairness addresses authorization, readiness gates, pause, rollback, decertification, and adoption. This candidate interface implies neither government approval nor an inevitable next phase.

The Science of Fairness addresses validation, measurement governance, protocols, rivals, negative results, and verdicts.

Office-interface evidence may improve or discredit City design; it cannot validate PTVC.

Cross-references may point to government records without custody, cite authority without settling every jurisdiction, and mark protected gaps without reconstructing content. Reference is a bridge, not absorption.

A handoff can preserve a citation while silently changing who makes a consequential choice. When a City-generated case summary is used in an official government process, the receiving authority should identify which source was transferred, which version and access limits apply, which interpretation is contested, who can revise the official decision, and how an affected person reaches a lawful remedy. The receiving agency controls its own statutory record; the City does not inherit authority over the agency's action.

A published study of the U.S. Census Bureau's adoption of differential privacy illustrates why technical changes should also be analyzed as changes in institutional responsibility. Abdu and colleagues (2024) examine how a new technical method rearranged expert roles and public participation, and why documentation alone could not replace trusted interpretation across communities. The City's proposed handoff file should therefore record the public value at issue and test whether the receiving staff and affected users can use the explanation.

Each cross-reference should name both the exporting City owner and the lawful authority that receives the matter.

Treat broken external references that prevent users from finding the responsible authority as accountability defects. During repair, their public entries should preserve the destination's identity and provide a verified alternative contact, without silent redirection.

Chapter 27 — Public Interaction and Volunteers

Public interaction is one of the City's strongest contributions. Formation for consequential power should include direct contact with the people who carry the results of public decisions. Citizens need usable routes for evidence, complaint, questions, correction, expertise, and lived knowledge. Otherwise visible formation would leave the governed outside the gate with the familiar burdens of guesswork and unequal access.

Opening public channels also creates risks. An unbounded interface can expose participants, staff, families, critics, volunteers, and ordinary users to harassment, misinformation, and surveillance. Overly technical systems or ones driven by emotional reactions can exclude people with limited time, inadequate disability access, lower language fluency, fewer digital skills, or less institutional confidence. The interface must widen access while resisting organized capture of attention.

Volunteerism needs its own boundary because civic affection can conceal labor. A role that is regular, supervised, essential, hazardous, specialized, or relied upon for compliance may no longer be fairly described as casual service. Training, expenses, scheduling, labor protections, complaint routes, compensation triggers, and a dignified exit should be visible before gratitude becomes a substitute for duty. Volunteer records describe the task, not loyalty (ILO Department of Statistics, 2021; Rochester et al., 2010; ILO, 2019b).

Moderation creates a second labor system inside the interface. Human reviewers may absorb threats, graphic material, harassment, manipulation attempts, ambiguous evidence, and pressure from visible participants or organized groups. Published standards, reason codes, escalation, appeal, rotation, supervision, security, and wellbeing support make that work accountable; automated tools remain bounded assistants. A platform that

protects users by exhausting unseen workers has only moved the burden (Gillespie, 2018; Roberts, 2019).

Public participation sits beside rather than above constitutional and governmental processes. A civic question is not a petition unless law makes it one; an approval signal is not an election; a volunteer network is not a public workforce; and an expert channel is not delegated rulemaking. The City can improve access, provenance, explanation, and correction, while competent public bodies retain authority over participation rights, official decisions, and remedies.

A worked example begins with a resident who uses a screen reader and cannot complete an online benefits renewal. The resident submits a protected burden report; a volunteer helps route it but cannot adjudicate it; an accessibility specialist tests the interface; the lawful public agency retains responsibility for service and remedy; and the City publishes only the minimum authorized account of what changed. The resident is not enrolled as a participant, ranked for civic value, or converted into training data because the report improved the system (United Nations, 2006; OECD, 2022b; W3C, 2023).

These mechanisms can be evaluated independently of the wider scientific hypothesis. Better access, safer reporting, lawful volunteer practice, accountable moderation, privacy protection, and resistance to manufactured signals must be judged through rights, institutional performance, affected-person experience, and ordinary evidence. The City proposes this bounded civic interface; *The Government of Fairness* addresses official participation systems, and *The Science of Fairness* addresses scientific evaluation and its possible verdicts.

27.1 — From Spectators to Contributors

A public-facing City can teach spectatorship if people are invited only to watch, applaud, condemn, vote, or react to visible participants. A richer civic posture treats citizens as bounded contributors of burden, knowledge, question, warning, and correction. Their contribution enters through a defined channel and leaves their ordinary life outside the institution. Contribution does not mean control.

27.1.1 — Citizen Burden Reports

Citizen burden reports identify consequences that official accounts may have missed, including small recurring failures. Use the intake and verification path below.

The burden-report form should ask what happened, who was affected, what kind of burden occurred, whether there is urgency, whether the person is willing to be contacted, whether the report may be summarized publicly, and whether protected handling is needed.

Record uncertainty using the separate evidence-status dimensions in Section 27.4.3. Protect and examine a report without either dismissing it for incompleteness or treating it as established fact.

Accept ordinary-language accounts with translation and assistance under Section 27.2.3; institutional vocabulary must not be an entry requirement (OECD, 2022b; Arnstein, 1969).

A practical burden report should preserve the difference between a single incident, a repeated pattern, and a structural condition. One incident may require remedy, a repeated pattern may require redesign, and a structural condition may require public explanation or cross-domain handoff.

A useful burden-report pipeline has seven gates: intake, protection, classification, routing, verification, response, and

audit. Intake receives the report without demanding polished language. Protection decides what must not travel. Classification names the burden type. Routing sends the report to a responsible office or reviewer. Verification tests status without punishing uncertainty. Response tells the contributor what can be said. Audit asks whether the pipeline itself shifted burden onto the person who came forward.

Collect and retain only the metadata needed for the declared report and review; apply the server privacy controls in Section 27.5.4.

27.1.2 — Public Questions as Civic Input

The most useful civic contribution may begin with a person who has experienced a service failure and can identify exactly where its account of the decision diverged from life. A systematic review of 35 citizen-engagement programs across low- and middle-income countries found that engagement more often improved access and service quality when users could work directly with frontline providers; merely channeling performance information into pressure on politicians was generally less effective in the studied settings (Waddington et al., 2019). These findings do not test the City, and their settings limit automatic generalization. They do identify a productive design question: can protected public input reach someone who has authority and capacity to respond?

A City interface could test that chain with fictional service cases before collecting sensitive real complaints. The sequence begins with an accessible report, proceeds through correct classification and competent referral, and ends in a reasoned answer whose implementation can be checked. A report that reaches a dashboard but not an accountable owner has not completed the task.

Public questions can identify missing explanations, misleading terms, or overlooked consequences. The response system must route them to an accountable owner.

A question creates no entitlement to protected content. Use the safe explanation and exclusion rules in Section 25.5.5.

Route questions by their subject and competent owner under Sections 27.2.1–27.2.2.

Apply the queue priorities in Section 27.2.2 and publish the possible response categories, including protected, partial, delayed, or consolidated answers.

A recurrence register should convert repeated questions into governed work. The institution sets a prospective trigger by category and time window, links substantially equivalent questions across languages and formats, assigns an owner, names the public artifact or process under review, and records whether the response was explanation, translation, correction, redesign, or no change with reasons (Fung, 2006; OECD, 2022b).

Recurrence is not self-interpreting. A surge may reflect genuine opacity, a major event, organized public education, duplicate submission, coordinated pressure, or manipulation. Human review should examine source diversity, affected-person relevance, independent corroboration, and access barriers before volume is treated as proof. The register is meant to learn from repetition without letting repetition become authority.

Closure requires checking whether the intervention changed comprehension for the people most affected. A glossary edit that reduces superficial inquiries but leaves disabled, multilingual, low-bandwidth, or legally vulnerable users unable to find the answer is not closure. The recurrence entry should record the test population, remaining confusion, appeal or complaint route, and

review date, and it should reopen when later evidence shows that the repair failed.

27.1.3 — Civic Expertise

Civic expertise includes relevant professional, practical, local, and lived knowledge from outside the City. Identify its basis and limits using the rules below.

Require qualifications where the task or law demands them, while testing each contribution against the claim it can support under Section 23.1.2.

The civic expertise channel should ask contributors to state the basis of their knowledge. A person may be speaking from profession, direct experience, local residence, research, community leadership, affected-person status, or technical review. This basis should be attributed where safe and consented. Where sensitive, the basis may need protected handling.

Attribute material civic input through Section 27.4.4, preserving relevant conflicts, disagreement, and protected provenance.

Use the expert-disagreement method in Section 23.5.2 when advice conflicts (Landemore, 2013; Page, 2007).

Check whether professional class, region, ideology, language group, or institutional network is narrowing the range of civic expertise. Do not substitute token representation for meaningful source diversity.

27.1.4 — Complaint Input

Complaint input, including reports of harm caused by the City, must be distinguished from ordinary feedback. Receive it safely and classify it for protection, investigation, remedy, or urgent safety response; receipt does not establish misconduct.

Use the protected-reporting route in Section 27.2.4, including confidentiality limits, assistance, and safe status updates.

Make complaint intake usable without media reach, insider help, or specialist vocabulary, applying Section 27.2.3.

At intake, explain the available remedy categories and who can grant them, using the applicable complaint route rather than promising an outcome the City cannot deliver.

Provide interim shielding against unnecessary disclosure and retaliation, and preserve evidence, while classification and review proceed. These protections do not require proof of the entire case at intake.

27.1.5 — Contributor Boundary

The most active, loud, organized, wealthy, famous, or digitally skilled members of the public cannot be allowed to monopolize attention, and contribution should not be treated as a favor to the institution. Public power burdens people beyond the City, and those people carry knowledge the institution cannot manufacture inside its walls.

The Contributor Boundary Test asks whether an interface improves answerability while preventing inherited exposure, crowd command, and hidden authority. It is an operational design test, not a finding that those benefits have already occurred.

Public contribution does not enroll a person in the Transparent Vow or the participant's full active-period record. Reporting harm, asking questions, offering expertise, volunteering temporarily, or submitting feedback leaves ordinary life outside the City's authority.

This boundary should be visible at every entry point. A form, server, public meeting, volunteer orientation, expert channel, or complaint route should state what status the contributor has,

what data is collected, how it may be used, whether it may be published, how to request correction, and how to withdraw or limit future contact.

Keep contribution data tied to its declared purpose. Research and model training require the separate pathway in Section 11.6 where that use is otherwise permitted; no permission can override the profiling and cross-architecture prohibitions in Section 11.7 (European Union, 2016; Council of Europe, 2024).

Public attribution or publication may be allowed where lawful and safe, but release should be a separate choice, not an automatic consequence of contribution. Consent should be specific, revocable where possible, and protected from pressure.

An ordinary citizen should be able to read a public-interface diagram, volunteer page, or dashboard and understand that contribution is allowed without surrendering ordinary privacy. Test outward-facing descriptions with that question.

Audit for prohibited imports into personal profiles, loyalty or reputation scores, political targeting, donor strategy, or cross-architecture files. Separately check that any otherwise permitted research or model-training use followed Section 11.6. A lawful basis for one use cannot waive the categorical bans; unauthorized transfers require repair.

Route contributor-boundary breaches through the privacy and incident remedies in Sections 27.5.4 and 27.7.5, preserving affected-person notice without widening exposure.

End routine follow-up after closure unless further contact has an identified purpose and the contributor chooses a continuing role where choice applies. State that endpoint in the closure notice.

27.2 — The Civic Interface as a Constitutional Boundary

Here, constitutional boundary names the interface's practical safeguards for rights, access, privacy, role status, and public meaning; it does not write constitutional law. The interface determines who can reach the City, what they can say, how quickly they are heard, how they are protected, and how their input is interpreted. Reachability, comprehensibility, safety, contestability, and low exposure risk must hold together. An interface fails if it is reachable but unsafe, safe but unintelligible, or usable by elites while excluding disabled users, non-native speakers, vulnerable reporters, workers, caregivers, or people without institutional fluency.

27.2.1 — Access Rules

Use the contributor notice in Section 27.1.5 for every channel, identifying its actual authority and data use before people rely on it (OECD, 2022b; ILO Department of Statistics, 2021; UNESCO, 2023).

Keep entry role-limited. Material expansion requires a stated purpose, notice, appropriate authority, and consent where applicable.

Access rules must also protect the City from informal privilege. Private phone numbers, donor introductions, celebrity access, political relationships, staff friendships, or platform popularity should not create hidden entry routes. The public-facing rules should identify official paths and discourage side channels. If an exception is necessary, it should be logged and reviewed.

Use the notice and minimization rules in Sections 27.1.5 and 27.5.4 for required and optional data (OECD, 2022b; Tyler, 2006).

Help reroute people who enter the wrong channel because the interface was unclear; do not punish them for that misunderstanding.

A public interface charter should state the available channels, who may use them, protection options, response categories, appeal routes, accessibility and language support, emergency pathways, and limits on abusive conduct. It should also define the channel's actual authority.

Maintain feasible phone, mail, in-person, assisted, and trusted-intermediary routes with safeguards against fraud and coercion.

27.2.2 — Queue Discipline

Queue order should reflect urgency, affectedness, public relevance, safety, legal timelines, accessibility needs, and the possibility of consolidating similar submissions. A life-safety concern moves ahead of a popular question; a widespread accessibility barrier is not buried for lack of drama; and a coordinated brigade does not displace one credible complaint.

Publish priority categories and expected response ranges; individual positions need not be public, especially for protected reports. Explain how to challenge unreasonable delay.

Apply the bot-and-brigade controls in Section 27.5.3 while distinguishing coordinated manipulation from legitimate collective concern (Lipsky, 1980; Nabatchi and Leighninger, 2015).

Periodically stress-test the queue with simultaneous urgent reports, mass duplicate comments, celebrity intervention, coordinated smears, translation failures, disability-access complaints, and protected child-safety reports. Published triage rules should also explain when vulnerability, retaliation risk, or evidence that may disappear changes a matter's priority.

A queue log should record why matters moved. It need not expose protected identities, but it should be able to show that priority was not secretly purchased, politicized, manipulated by celebrity attention, or assigned according to staff preference.

27.2.3 — Translation and Disability Access

Meaning can be lost even when every word has been translated. Legal, technical, cultural, and civic terms may not travel cleanly, so phrases such as public record, protected nonvisibility, contributor boundary, or public approval as bounded input may require explanation rather than literal substitution. Poor translation can create false consent, false alarm, or false reassurance. The City must treat translation as a meaning-preservation task.

Test reporting and meeting access across varied mobility, sensory, cognitive, health, and communication needs. A fixed format or time limit must not defeat the intended public task.

Design for users under stress with plain language, assistive navigation, saved progress, alternative submission methods, support contacts, and calm interfaces.

Regularly audit actual usability as well as technical compliance. Disabled users, language communities, and affected people should be able to test whether they can complete the task accurately and with dignity, without becoming public subjects (United Nations, 2006; W3C, 2023).

Procurement, staffing, and service-level rules should carry accessibility and translation from the beginning. Contracts need testable requirements, supported formats, language coverage, response times, maintenance duties, and a remedy when promised access fails.

27.2.4 — Protected Reporting

Provide protected reporting when ordinary identification or public contact would create risk.

Keep source custody restricted and release only the necessary authorized category or summary where it is safe to do so.

Define protected reporting pathways in advance. Intake should explain confidentiality options, limits of confidentiality, mandatory safety escalation where applicable, expected review, appeal, and remedy. If legal duties require disclosure, those duties should be named plainly.

Verification and due process remain necessary for anonymous or restricted reports; protected intake must not automatically punish their subjects.

Apply anti-retaliation monitoring and remedies to protected reports, including retaliation through third parties (UNODC, 2025; Citron, 2014).

Protected reporting also requires protected response. A reporter should not be forced into public exposure just to learn whether action occurred. The City can provide private status updates, protected summaries, or ombuds communication that respects the person’s safety while still giving them evidence that the report did not vanish.

Retaliation can occur without public disclosure. A participant, volunteer, donor, staff member, employer, agency, or organized faction may infer who reported and punish the person indirectly. Protection therefore covers patterns, metadata, timing, and contextual clues as well as names, with access and release rules designed around the risk of reidentification.

Offer qualified intermediary routes for people who cannot approach safely, with verification, conflict checks, and limits on the intermediary’s access and representations.

27.2.5 — Interface Audit

The audit should include quantitative and qualitative measures without reducing people to metrics. Response time, unresolved cases, language availability, accessibility failures, complaint outcomes, appeal rates, abuse incidents, bot interference, protected-reporting usage, and staff workload can reveal patterns. So can interviews, user testing, ombuds reports, and external review.

Interface audit should test for structural bias. Are wealthy users more likely to get responses because they know how to write formal complaints? Are disabled users abandoning forms? Are non-native speakers routed more slowly? Are staff using informal shortcuts for familiar public figures? Are critics treated as threats? Are volunteers receiving hidden access?

Publish a privacy-preserving account of audit findings, corrective owners, timelines, unresolved risks, and independent review results.

Include outward-facing forms, pages, diagrams, and dashboards in the contributor-boundary tests in Section 27.1.5.

Sample abandoned forms, unanswered calls, withdrawn complaints, blocked users, and incomplete processes; people missing from the counts may bear the largest burden.

Use mystery-user and adversarial tests with varied access needs and levels of institutional familiarity; examine whether people can complete the task safely.

Keep a plain-language failure register. Recurring confusion about approval, protected reporting, complaint status, privacy, or delays may signal design faults, not public ignorance. Remedies include clearer labels and routing, slower release, accessibility review, staff training, or explanations accompanying artifacts.

27.3 — Volunteer Networks Without Fan Culture

Volunteer networks can widen civic capacity when service has a clear purpose, real support, a labor boundary, attributable influence, and a dignified exit. They become dangerous when affection substitutes for role clarity or loyalty becomes an informal qualification for access. Review whether volunteers serve the declared function or organize personal loyalty, image defense, or attacks on critics. A volunteer holds a bounded role under the role sheet and labor review in Section 27.3.3; volunteering does not confer participant, staff, office, or campaign status.

27.3.1 — Volunteer Purpose

The ethical test of a volunteer network is whether the same person can serve, disagree, leave, criticize, and still retain dignity (ILO Department of Statistics, 2021; Rochester et al., 2010; Hirschman, 1970).

Declare each volunteer role's public purpose before recruitment and document it in the role sheet under Section 27.3.3.

Volunteer access follows function rather than enthusiasm. A translator helping public users does not need protected participant records; an orientation volunteer does not need staff influence logs; and a civic-server volunteer does not need private complaint identities. Least-necessary access protects contributors, staff, and the institution from the hidden power created by vague roles.

Train volunteers in the data, access, safety, and escalation rules relevant to their task, using the charter and role sheet.

Trigger the labor and influence reviews in Sections 27.3.3–27.3.4 when temporary help becomes essential work or

durable control (ILO Department of Statistics, 2021; Rochester et al., 2010).

Every role also needs a defined term. Work created for one event should not quietly become permanent, and renewal should require a fresh review of consent, compensation, access, influence, and continued institutional need.

At onboarding, explain the volunteer task and prohibit using a City role to defend participants' images, manufacture enthusiasm, attack or pressure critics, boost public approval, or perform loyalty. Volunteers must not carry out campaign functions, collect private information, solicit donations through role access, promise outcomes, imply insider authority, or claim that the City has certified a person's worth.

27.3.2 — Anti-Celebrity Rule

Volunteers serve the public function rather than the image or comfort of a participant, founder, official, or donor. Apply this rule to recruitment, work, recognition, and correction.

Use role clarity, rotation, independent correction, and evidence-linked explanation to prevent affection or resentment from determining volunteer work.

Route alleged misinformation through official correction channels; volunteers must not retaliate against criticism (Rosenzweig, 2007; Thorndike, 1920).

Apply the same rule to defense of the City itself; institutional criticism is not disloyalty.

Ritual and visual design can manufacture celebrity even when policy rejects it. Recognition should honor a function, public thanks should remain distributed and modest, volunteer imagery should avoid disciple-like framing, and social excerpts should resist heroic crowds.

27.3.3 — Labor Boundary

Use the conversion review below for recurring, supervised, essential, or risk-bearing tasks; voluntary enthusiasm does not discharge the institution's labor duties.

People with money, time, mobility, language fluency, childcare support, and social safety can volunteer more easily. Making unpaid availability a pathway to influence or status would privilege those already able to give it.

Fund expenses and provide scheduling limits, rest, support, and rotation. No one should be pressured into excessive hours through praise or claims of historical importance.

The labor boundary also protects staff. If volunteers perform staff-adjacent tasks without equivalent accountability, staff may be undermined. If staff must supervise poorly trained volunteers without workload credit, staff burden rises. If volunteers become favorites of participants or public figures, staff authority may be bypassed. Volunteer systems require staff-burden accounting (ILO Department of Statistics, 2021; ILO, 2019b).

A conversion review begins when a volunteer task becomes necessary to continuity, access, safety, compliance, or the preservation of public records. The review asks whether the role would otherwise require an employee or contractor, whether the institution schedules and supervises it, whether refusal carries social or operational penalty, and whether the worker bears specialized, emotional, or security risk. Any affirmative pattern shifts the presumption toward compensated and protected work.

Before recruitment, a role sheet should state the public purpose, duties, supervisor, expected hours, term, access level, training, expenses, safety support, complaint route, data handled, forbidden influence, and compensation trigger. The same sheet should identify who reviews drift and how the volunteer can pause or leave.

A periodic role census should compare scheduled hours, replacement cost, supervision, occupational risk, emotional load, institutional dependence, staff workload, accessibility burden, and who can afford to volunteer. These measures support labor and equity review and never become a civic-worth score (ILO Department of Statistics, 2021; UNV, 2025; ILO, 2019b).

27.3.4 — Influence Logging

Use Section 21.5.1 to identify material volunteer influence, then apply the escalation ladder below.

A volunteer may reshape meaning through translation, coordinate testimony, decide which burden reports reach staff, or become a social gatekeeper. Record material influence even when it is well intended.

Log the role, input, date, affected decision, and material conflict or disagreement, with private-life protection under Section 27.5.4.

Use the question-specific conflict registry in Section 27.4.1 for material ties; ordinary affiliation or belief alone is not a conflict finding.

Influence controls should use an escalation ladder. A single material intervention may require a bounded log; repeated control over access or interpretation requires supervisory review; high-stakes or durable influence requires formalization, conflict review, compensation where appropriate, and explicit limits; influence that cannot be governed must be reduced or ended.

An influence-threshold event occurs when a volunteer repeatedly controls access, speaks for the institution, moderates high-stakes content, summarizes evidence for a decision, coordinates public pressure, or uses role access to reach a participant or official. The event record names the function,

decision owner, duration, conflicts, review, limits, and disposition while excluding unrelated private life.

27.3.5 — Exit Without Stigma

Volunteers can pause or leave a bounded role without stigma or institutional retaliation.

Exit should be explained during orientation. Volunteers should know how to step back, pause, reduce workload, transfer duties, request deletion or retention limits where appropriate, give feedback, and raise concerns.

Exit closes a volunteer role, not a person's reputation. Access, training, conflicts, and completed duties may require a limited role record, but departure should not create a moral file or become evidence about seriousness, trustworthiness, civic virtue, or loyalty. Ordinary future privacy resumes when the role ends.

Invite voluntary, protected exit feedback without requiring a justification for leaving.

Treat criticism from former volunteers on its merits; departure does not justify dismissing it as betrayal or bitterness.

Volunteers must be able to leave privately, without a public goodbye, testimonial, explanation, or gratitude ritual. Recognition should not become a condition of departure.

Former volunteers may return under another role after rest, disagreement, relocation, or changed capacity, without a loyalty ritual.

27.4 — Expert Input and Distributed Intelligence

Expertise adds value when its route, limits, conflicts, evidence, and uncertainty remain visible. The City needs technical knowledge and distributed public intelligence, but neither professional prestige nor raw volume should determine which burdens receive attention. Declared channels allow knowledge to inform public formation without becoming hidden authority. The Distributed Intelligence Test asks whether outside knowledge is received, attributed, verified to the degree appropriate, limited by role, protected where needed, and kept from becoming unreviewed command.

27.4.1 — Expert Channel

Commission expertise suited to the question and the relevant professional or legal requirements.

Distributed expert input should also preserve competing expertise. The invitation record should identify the question, conflict status, evidence supplied, material disagreement, and which advice changed the work so one prestigious expert cannot silently become the voice of the field.

Record the questions an expert was not asked. A cybersecurity review, for example, may not assess child exposure. Explicit scope limits prevent narrow review from being mistaken for total clearance.

Use question-specific commissions with defined terms, conflicts, deliverables, and review, rather than general authority for a standing expert circle.

A conflict registry should be readable without becoming defamatory. It names financial, institutional, vendor, donor, political, research, advocacy, or reputational interests only where they are relevant to the question being answered. The record

exists to show how advice traveled and what pressures may have shaped it, not to discredit the expert by association.

27.4.2 — Public Feedback Channel

Receive user observations without requiring expert status. A report can identify a practical failure that a formal review missed.

Apply the accessible intake, protection, and abuse-control rules in Sections 27.1–27.2 to feedback.

Interpret feedback volume under the recurrence review in Section 27.1.2; numbers do not replace corroboration, severity, or analysis of who could participate.

Provide contributors with protected status updates under the response categories in Section 27.1.2 where feasible (OECD, 2022b; Landemore, 2013).

Offer a voluntary, minimal context field identifying the contributor's relevant relationship to the burden; do not collect broader identity merely to interpret a comment.

Aggregation rules should be public. When thousands of comments arrive, the City may need to group similar input, remove duplicates, and summarize themes. That process must not erase minority warnings. A good summary says what was common, what was serious despite being uncommon, what was outside scope, what was protected, and what could not yet be verified.

27.4.3 — Verification Rules

Use the bounded-expertise method in Section 23.5.2: seek specialized knowledge while retaining responsibility for the decisions that use it (Collins and Evans, 2007; Jasanoff, 2003; Page, 2007).

Verify submissions in stages, proportionately and with appeal. Missing documents or specialist language do not by themselves justify discarding a report.

Record safe provenance and the contributor's declared knowledge basis under Section 27.1.3, without treating source identity as proof.

Use protected verification under Section 27.2.4 when checking a claim could expose or endanger someone.

False input should have consequences proportionate to context. A confused user needs correction; a malicious actor may need restriction; a bot network may need removal and audit; a coordinated smear may require public correction. Verification must not treat every inaccurate submission as bad faith (Jasanoff, 2003; Collins and Evans, 2007).

Version changes in the evidence-status dimensions below rather than replacing the earlier finding silently.

Evidence status should be recorded on separate dimensions: source and provenance; degree of corroboration; disputed propositions; and the current finding. A documented claim can still be false, a corroborated claim can remain incomplete, and a dispute can concern only part of an otherwise supported account. These are not steps on one ladder. Labels should identify the present evidence and remain open to revision when better information arrives.

27.4.4 — Influence Attribution

When outside knowledge changes a City explanation, record label, moderation rule, curriculum item, accessibility route, or public-interface procedure, a short influence note should identify the input category, question answered, change produced, accepting review, and any limits or dissent. If later evidence

reverses or materially revises the change, the new decision should link back to the earlier influence note.

Attribution should be role-specific and privacy-protective. A public report may say that a disability access revision was shaped by external disability reviewers and user testing without naming every disabled participant. It may say that a cybersecurity protocol was revised after external red-team review without exposing details that increase risk. It may name a public expert who consents to attribution. The rule is visibility of influence without unnecessary exposure.

Preserve serious expert disagreement and explain which advice was adopted using Section 23.5.2 (OECD, 2024b; OECD, 2026c; Bowker and Star, 1999).

Attribution identifies knowledge that shaped a decision without implying endorsement by famous experts, institutions or communities. Responsibility remains with the authorized decision owner, not the person credited for an input.

Record material rejected advice and the reasons for rejection where safe, using the same influence-note method.

27.4.5 — Overload Filtering

Disclose and audit filtering so limited review capacity does not silently determine which public burdens count.

Within Section 11.7.6, AI may support content-level duplicate grouping, translation, urgency flags, and possible-abuse triage. Human reviewers own consequential decisions; audit and appeal must test both missed signals and wrongful exclusion. Contributor trait or civic-value profiling remains prohibited.

Resource triage under the staff capacity and exposure rules in Sections 21.6 and 27.5.5; open intake requires funded review capacity.

Public reporting can make filtering accountable without exposing every submission. Category-level information should show how many items were received, consolidated, protected, escalated, rejected for abuse, or translated into reform, together with the governing rules and appeal path. That evidence lets the public inspect the filter while preserving sensitive contributors and protected content.

Provide escalation routes for credible low-volume, high-consequence input, including technical warnings, disability barriers, and child-safety concerns.

The filter should preserve samples, categories, thresholds, override rules, appeal paths, and human review for sensitive input. Audit sampling should include both material that passed through the filter and material that was suppressed; reviewing only surviving input cannot reveal systematic exclusion. Changes to thresholds or override rules should remain versioned so a disputed decision can be reconstructed under the rule that actually governed it.

Filtering should have sunset review. A filter created during a bot wave may become too restrictive after the wave ends. Temporary filters should carry a stated expiry or renewal point; renewal requires evidence that the condition justifying the restriction remains present.

Distinguish duplicate submissions from independent corroboration, coordinated pressure from broad concern, expert convergence from professional herding, urgent warning from alarm, and criticism from abuse. Record the author and reasons for high-impact manual overrides. Repeated overrides favoring or suppressing the same source category should trigger independent review.

27.5 — Civic Servers, Moderation, and Platform Integrity

Digital civic spaces can connect people across distance, language, schedule, and disability. They also concentrate power in architecture, moderation, ranking, identity, data retention, and automated filtering. The section treats servers and platforms as governed civic infrastructure whose purpose, records, labor, appeals, and limits must remain visible. Design the digital interface around identity where necessary, anonymity where protective, pseudonymity where useful, moderation where harm emerges, appeal where judgment can fail, audit where power accumulates, and retirement where tools no longer deserve trust (UNESCO, 2023; European Union, 2022; Gillespie, 2018).

27.5.1 — Server Function

Define and publish each civic-server space's task before use. It must not become an unrestricted social arena around a participant.

Keep three functions distinct: the archive preserves authorized source memory, the record site publishes governed bundles, and the civic server hosts interaction. A discussion may supply source input without becoming an official finding; a summary or public reaction is not authoritative evidence merely because the platform displays it.

The server should also be separated from campaign infrastructure. If a participant later becomes a candidate or official, civic interface must not quietly become campaign organizing. The City may provide record continuity and public explanation where lawful. It should not run fan mobilization, partisan targeting, fundraising, or persuasion systems through civic servers.

Use the channel notice in Section 27.1.5 so users know the task, data use, and response rules before interacting.

The server should include an off-ramp from public discussion to protected reporting. A person may begin with a comment and realize they need complaint, safety, privacy, or affected-person access. A healthy civic server helps them move to the safer route instead of pushing sensitive material into public view (UNESCO, 2023; European Union, 2022).

Server purpose is versioned and visible. A question space cannot quietly become a voting space, a volunteer room cannot drift into campaign coordination, and a complaint route cannot become a public discussion thread. Material redesign triggers notice, renewed safeguards, revised retention where needed, and a fresh statement of ownership, moderation, appeal, correction, and exit. Function drift is a governance event.

An official record site, public education space, question queue, volunteer coordination space, protected reporting channel, and moderated discussion room require different retention, identity, moderation, accessibility, release, search, and appeal rules.

Display a purpose-specific retention schedule for each space, including lawful preservation, aggregation, quarantine, or deletion.

27.5.2 — Moderation Standards

Moderation standards prohibit harassment, threats, doxxing, sexualized exposure, child exposure, hate, targeted intimidation, spam, impersonation, coordinated abuse, and deliberate context stripping. They also protect disagreement, criticism, skepticism, bounded satire, and serious adversarial review.

The standards should be public enough to guide users and specific enough to guide moderators. Vague rules such as be respectful can be weaponized against critics. Overly rigid rules

can fail in novel abuse. The operating framework should define categories of prohibited conduct, protected conduct, gray-zone conduct, escalation, appeal, and repeated violation.

Appeal must be able to reverse human and automated error. If a multilingual disability-rights group uses shared assistive software and its similarly formatted reports are flagged as coordinated automation, a human reviewer should restore valid submissions, preserve queue position, explain the decision, and amend the rule that produced exclusion. The appeal record identifies category, evidence, outcome, remedy, and policy change without exposing protected users or publishing exploitable thresholds (W3C, 2023; UNESCO, 2023; Gillespie, 2018).

Publish categorical moderation activity, appeal outcomes, incidents, and policy changes without reproducing abusive or protected material (Gillespie, 2018; Roberts, 2019).

Enforcement notices should be firm, calm, specific, and reviewable. Sarcasm, punitive tone, or vague instructions can intimidate users even when the underlying rule is sound.

Every consequential moderation action should produce a proportionate notice stating the rule category, action, duration, whether automation materially contributed, the human reviewer or reviewing function, preservation status, appeal route, and any safety reason for withholding detail. The notice need not republish abuse or expose detection thresholds, but it must give the affected person enough information to contest error. Aggregate reporting should show reversals, delays, and repeat failure categories so moderation power can be reviewed (European Union, 2022; UNESCO, 2023; Council of Europe, 2024).

27.5.3 — Bot and Brigade Detection

Examine timing, repeated phrasing, account behavior, referral and amplification patterns, and targeted abuse. These are indicators for review, not findings of bad faith; genuine concern can produce similar surges.

Human audit is necessary because legitimate activity involving accessibility tools, shared community networks, limited internet access, public libraries, or organized civic groups may look automated. Anti-bot controls should not exclude poor, disabled, multilingual, or organized communities on that basis.

Bot and brigade controls should include rate limits, proof-of-personhood alternatives, anomaly review, duplicate consolidation, source transparency where lawful, and pause mechanisms for manipulated signals. These controls should be proportional and privacy-protective. The answer to bots should not be mass identity surveillance of ordinary users.

Report confirmed manipulation through the protected event record in Section 27.7.5, including affected categories, remedies, and limits on confidence (Ferrara et al., 2016; Varol et al., 2017; Rauchfleisch and Kaiser, 2020).

Bot and brigade detection should be evaluated for unequal burden. If anti-bot rules demand expensive devices, stable addresses, government identification, fluent language, or constant availability, vulnerable users may be excluded. Alternative verification routes should protect signal integrity without making public participation a privilege of the already documented and secure.

Use graduated slowing, labeling, sampling, review, and escalation before excluding input, with a route to reverse error.

27.5.4 — Privacy Safeguards

Separate operational metadata from contributor evaluation. Enforce the prohibited profiling and targeting uses in Sections 11.7 and 27.1.5; otherwise permitted research or training requires Section 11.6's separate pathway.

Retention limits are the first operational safeguard. Data needed for abuse investigation, complaint, audit, or law may remain under a declared schedule; other information should expire, be aggregated, or be deleted. Users need plain categories showing what remains, for how long, under whose authority, and with what review.

Offer pseudonymous or protected participation where compatible with the channel's safety, verification, and due-process needs under Section 27.2.4.

Respond to a privacy breach through affected-person notification, lawful remedy, and system correction under Section 27.7.5 (Nissenbaum, 2010; European Union, 2016; Council of Europe, 2018b).

Personal behavioral scoring is prohibited. Browsing patterns, comment timing, translation needs, accessibility settings, or moderation history may not be used to infer trust, seriousness, ideology, emotional state, personal risk status, or civic worth. Security monitoring must remain purpose-bound and cannot become character prediction.

Privacy safeguards should apply to observers as well as speakers. Access logs may be needed for security and abuse prevention, but their scope, retention, separation, and review must be limited by purpose.

Use least-necessary insider access under Section 27.3.1 and the separate data purposes above; an abuse-review role does not automatically authorize access to protected reports or support records.

27.5.5 — Moderation Staff Burden

Staffing ratios, rotation, training, mental-health support, escalation, legal assistance, debriefing, and authority to pause features belong in server design.

Limit moderators to the published content rules and referral duties; they do not assess participant readiness or human worth.

Decision logs support users and staff by recording why content was retained, removed, restricted, or escalated without unnecessarily exposing harmful material or private staff notes. They enable appeal, audit, training, and bias review while keeping policy responsibility above the individual moderator.

Track exposure, turnover, appeal delay, enforcement inconsistency, threats, and reliance on automation as indicators for workload and policy review, not automatic proof of cultural drift.

Budget and staffing reports should document how sufficient moderation capacity is funded and maintained as public use grows. When added demand exceeds usable capacity, expansion shifts the cost of openness onto the workers handling it.

Burden can be measured without surveilling moderators. Queue volume, exposure categories, appeal load, threat patterns, shift intensity, and recovery needs are useful; public identities, performance shame, and intrusive monitoring are not.

Procurement is part of platform integrity. Contracts should prohibit silent data resale, hidden profiling, unauthorized artificial-intelligence training, undisclosed ranking manipulation, and unilateral changes to retention or moderation tools. A vendor’s business model becomes part of the public burden map.

27.6 — Public Voting and Approval as Bounded Input

Use a voting or approval mechanism only where lawful and ratified. Unsettled functions remain Open Decisions under Section 27.6.4; election, government, and transition authority remain with their proper owners. A useful operating rule is the Bounded Signal Rule: a public approval mechanism may answer only the specific question it is authorized to ask, for the limited purpose stated in advance, under anti-manipulation review, with appeal and audit, and with labels that say what it cannot mean. Interpret a count through its access conditions, wording, timing, participation, manipulation controls, and context rather than its visual precision (Fishkin, 2018; Fung, 2006; O'Neil, 2016).

27.6.1 — Voting Scope

Within a ratified process, an authorized question may concern the clarity of a public explanation, the need for more context in a record bundle, a community's request for a response, or another bounded public signal.

Apply the Bounded Signal Rule: no response acquires legal decision power from a City label. Any legal effect must come from the competent jurisdiction and authorized process.

Set a review window for each signal. Reassess it when records are corrected, context changes, bots are removed, or public understanding changes; old approval figures must not become permanent reputation marks.

Use the adjacent context label specified in Section 27.6.4 on official displays and exports, with a direct route to the current source.

For screenshots and short excerpts, use Section 25.3.5's quotation test to preserve the voting question's scope and status; redesign City-controlled displays that predictably mislead.

Question wording should be reviewed before release. A public question can pressure answers through framing, timing, emotional heat, missing context, or false alternatives. A credible design should test whether the question asks for a signal the public can reasonably provide. If the question invites judgment beyond the public's evidence, the voting mechanism should not launch.

27.6.2 — No Civic Worth Ranking

Public approval must not become a measure of human or civic worth. Enforce that boundary through the display and standing rules below.

The record site should avoid leaderboards, public rank order, color-coded moral status, gamified popularity, celebratory thresholds, shame markers, or visual hierarchies that imply human worth. A disclaimer cannot neutralize a ranking display.

The ban applies to claims of personal or civic worth in both directions. Participant popularity must not determine City readiness findings or civic standing, and citizens must not acquire superior standing through loyalty, contribution frequency, or favorable feedback. Task-specific assessments of expertise, eligibility, or the relevance of evidence may still be necessary; their criteria and limits should be explicit, and their results must not become a general hierarchy of valuable people.

27.6.3 — No Proof Function

A public-input result reports a response under specified conditions, not proof of the Law, the City's effectiveness, a participant's competence or the underlying policy claim. Low approval cannot invalidate formation or certify unfitness; either direction of approval may trigger further review.

Public artifacts must avoid triumphal language around approval. Phrases such as the public has proven, the public has

validated, or the numbers show fairness should be forbidden. Instead, state who answered, the question asked, the response observed, and the process's limits, including its audit status (Rosenzweig, 2007; O'Neill, 2002a).

27.6.4 — Public Approval Context

Give each public approval figure an adjacent label identifying the question, lawful scope, eligible population, participation, method, time window, audit and manipulation status, uncertainty, limitations, exactly what the signal is allowed to influence, and review route. Include sample size where applicable and lawful, together with relevant lawful demographic or accessibility caveats. Add justified confidence limits only where the sampling design supports that inference. Keep the label attached to excerpts and screenshots.

Test whether the information presented allowed respondents to understand the question. Document material confusion or misinformation as a limitation on interpretation.

Where the final role of public voting or approval remains an Open Decision, the public artifact should display that status. The City can explain candidate functions, safeguards, and limits without presenting an unsettled mechanism as canon or legal instruction. Visible uncertainty here protects both democratic choice and later correction.

Display relevant dispute labels, minority reports, or public explanations beside approval signals. High approval does not erase serious objections; low approval does not erase minority support or expert warnings.

Version any correction for manipulation, exclusion, eligibility error, or misleading presentation and link obsolete figures to the current status (OECD, 2022b; Landemore, 2013).

A signal from one thousand highly engaged users, ten thousand anonymous platform reactions, or one hundred verified local residents has different meaning. Do not present an approval percentage as though these groups represent the same public.

27.6.5 — Voting-Input Appeal and Audit

Provide a challenge route for signal manipulation, exclusion, protection failures, misleading questions, or inaccurate displays.

The appeal pathway should state who may appeal, what grounds apply, what evidence is needed, what temporary pause may occur, how privacy is protected, and what remedies are possible. A signal may be corrected, relabeled, delayed, reaudited, narrowed, retired, or publicly explained.

A City operator should not be the only judge of a public approval system the operator designed. Technical auditors, accessibility reviewers, moderation reviewers, privacy reviewers, and public-risk reviewers may all be needed depending on the mechanism. Audit should examine not only counts, but whether the process placed burden fairly.

Apply the contributor boundary in Section 27.1.5 during appeal and audit; contested signal status does not authorize exposure of individual participation.

Report whether the signal remains usable, disputed, corrected, compromised, or retired, without exposing protected users or operational detection details.

Appeal and audit should include retirement authority. If a public signal becomes too distorted, too misunderstood, too easily manipulated, or too harmful to protected persons, the City should be able to retire the mechanism.

Audit should include post-release review. A signal may look clean at publication and later be shown to have been manipulated, misunderstood, inaccessible, or misused by media

and campaigns. Correction authority must retain power to revise labels, add context, retire artifacts, publish manipulation findings, and prevent old signals from becoming permanent weapons.

Interpret participation under the recurrence test in Section 27.1.2; both low and high response can have multiple causes.

27.7 — Anti-Mob, Anti-Bot, and Anti-Doxxing

Apply the protections below to all interface users, including critics and people targeted by the City's supporters. Distinguish strong or organized criticism, protest, and collective advocacy from threats, doxxing, targeted harassment, and coercive abuse. Volume, speed, anger, or coordinated disagreement alone does not establish abuse. Review restrictions under the published conduct rules and appeal process.

27.7.1 — Anti-Mob Design

Prepare anti-abuse controls before predictable surges of attention rather than improvising restrictions during controversy.

Use proportionate slow modes, context prompts, duplicate handling, response windows, and protected-reporting routes when the conduct risk warrants them. Review their effect on legitimate access; restricting a large critical campaign is not justified by size alone.

Apply the same conduct rules to supporters, opponents, and institutional allies; criticism of the City creates no exception.

Anti-mob design should also include institutional self-restraint. The institution must not use its public channels to rally supporters against a critic, participant, staff member, or complainant. Even a correct defense can become coercive if the institution's audience is mobilized against an individual. Official responses should be measured, contextual, and non-retaliatory (Citron, 2014; Penney, 2025).

Explain the purpose, duration, and review route for interaction restrictions so users can understand and challenge them.

Review the combination of distribution speed, identifiability, consequence, and available protection when choosing controls. These are risk factors for a specific interface, not a score or a definition of democratic legitimacy.

Cooldown tools should include pausing new public display, routing threats to safety review, and separating criticism from targeted exposure.

27.7.2 — Anti-Bot Controls

Section 27.5.3 owns the bot-and-brigade detection mechanics; this subsection applies those controls to the broader anti-mob boundary.

Friction should scale with consequence. Low-risk browsing may need little assurance, while ratified voting, sensitive reports, or escalation of serious allegations may justify stronger provenance, signed submissions, or human review. Stronger assurance proves entitlement to a bounded action; it does not make ordinary users public.

Continuously audit manipulation controls and publish category-level findings without exposing exploitable thresholds (Ferrara et al., 2016; Varol et al., 2017).

27.7.3 — Anti-Doxxing Rules

Doxxing deliberately exposes personal or identifying information without consent to threaten, harass, punish, or otherwise harm someone. It can reveal home addresses, workplaces, schools, family identities, phone numbers, medical details, intimate information, legal histories, private messages, or fragments from which others can identify the target. It is prohibited in City public-interface spaces.

Apply the rule to participants and nonparticipants alike; disagreement, error, or public work does not waive ordinary-life protection.

Apply the rule to combinations of fragments that identify someone, even when no single item does. Train moderators and users to recognize this mosaic exposure.

Response should be fast and careful. Doxxing material should be removed or restricted quickly, preserved where needed for evidence, reviewed for threat level, and routed to affected-person support. The affected person should receive notice where safe, guidance, and remedy options. If law enforcement or legal action is needed, the City should defer to lawful authorities rather than improvising punishment.

Do not use anti-doxxing rules to conceal public-power evidence. Role-relevant participant conduct, staff influence in role, and official action may be disclosed under governed rules; those disclosures must still exclude personal information without a legitimate civic purpose (Citron, 2014; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Anti-doxxing rules should apply to screenshots and external reposts when the City controls the space or can take action. A harmful exposure may begin on a civic server and spread elsewhere.

The rules also cover link amplification, geographic triangulation, employer targeting, and repeated hints that make a private person findable.

Apply the whole-bundle reidentification test in Section 20.3.4 before releasing sensitive material, including linked clues and external context.

27.7.4 — Harassment Response

Use the published abuse categories in Section 27.5.2 for harassment response, including repeated threatening contact and pressure directed at families or employers.

Triage immediate safety, circulating protected information, coordination, and the affected person’s needs before reputation management. Assign containment and the appropriate support or lawful referral.

Distress from strong criticism does not by itself establish harassment. Include that distinction in staff training and public explanations so abuse controls do not insulate public-power seekers from accountability.

Provide task-appropriate support under Chapters 18–21, including workload or interface adjustments where needed. Apply the same access to support for critics and ordinary users.

Use the proportionate moderation and incident actions in Sections 27.5.2 and 27.7.5, logging the reason and review route (UNESCO, 2023; ILO, 2019b).

Harassment response should also protect people wrongly accused, whether through error or bad faith. A person falsely labeled as a harasser may suffer reputational harm, restriction, or public pile-on. Review and correction must be available so anti-harassment systems do not become another means of harm.

Apply care-first triage under Section 18.6.3 while fact-finding continues. Interim safety and support need not wait for a final misconduct finding.

27.7.5 — Manipulation Audit

Combine periodic review with event-triggered investigation of material anomalies, using the evidence standards in Section 27.4.3.

Use technical, moderation, privacy, accessibility, and public-risk competence as needed, with sufficient independence to detect institutional bias. Examine both social pressure and automated manipulation.

Assign a remedy and owner to each substantiated finding.

Publish a protected account of the affected channels, findings, remedies, and remaining uncertainty. Withhold user identities and exploitable detection details.

Each manipulation event should enter a failure-memory record with the affected channel, signal type, likely mechanism, confidence, harmed groups, staff burden, protected evidence, immediate containment, false-positive review, public-status label, and recurrence risk. The record separates what is known from what is suspected and preserves enough context for later learning without publishing a manual for attack.

Design change should close through a control test rather than a promise. The audit names the failed control, owner, corrective action, test case, affected-person review, deployment date, monitoring period, and condition for reopening. A changed identity rule, release screen, staffing model, or signal label is not complete until the City verifies that it reduces the original failure without creating a new exclusion or surveillance burden.

Post-incident repair needs an affected-person route as well as a technical one. The City should identify who carried the burden, offer safety and privacy support, correct false public meaning where it has authority, restore queue position or access when error excluded legitimate users, address staff overload, preserve claims for external remedy, and state what cannot be repaired. A system is not restored merely because abusive content disappeared.

Chapter 28 — Diplomacy, Travel, and Government

The City begins as a place, but public power moves through airports, vehicles, hotel rooms, diplomatic tables, emergency scenes, government offices, private briefings, encrypted channels, foreign jurisdictions, and informal pauses where influence is hardest to see. A design answerable only inside its perimeter has solved the easiest problem.

Travel reopens the central burden question. Treating movement as wholly private leaves the public with guesswork, while exposing every route in real time can endanger counterparties, staff, families, security personnel, and nonparticipants. Diplomacy becomes reckless when partial opacity is treated as scandal and naive when the word diplomacy erases the record. Mobility design must join lawful protection to a credible route back to explanation.

Diplomacy is the hardest case because some opacity protects legitimate work and vulnerable people. Negotiation may need time, counsel privilege, security delay, and humanitarian confidentiality. Dissidents, interpreters, patients, children, staff, and counterparties can be harmed by a record regime they never chose. Protected spaces therefore need lawful owners and review, not forced transparency by proximity (United Nations, 1961; Berridge, 2015; Pozen, 2010).

The argument then widens to reciprocal hosting, government transparency environments, and the City as a node. A node can receive, send, host, learn, and be corrected without becoming a capital. That modest posture prevents a beautiful institutional language from masquerading as authority above ordinary law.

Ownership remains exact. Government controls diplomacy, official travel, public money, protected records, security, and remedies; constitutional and international law govern authority and rights; material capacity and security remain with their owners. The City contributes continuity for its own interface and

withdraws when law, safety, or consent cannot be preserved. Successful travel would show operational feasibility, not sovereignty. Before departure, the interface file should name the authority that can terminate City participation if those boundaries conflict.

A worked hypothetical follows an officeholder to a foreign capital where local law bars the City's ordinary capture practice, the host requests a confidential meeting, and security officials require managed devices. The continuity file records the lawful purpose, authority that owns the meeting, City practice paused, protected record custodian, device protocol, oversight notice, review date, and condition for later disclosure. It does not copy the confidential substance, expose the counterparty, or pretend that City rules travel as extraterritorial law (United Nations, 1961; NIST, 2023b; European Data Protection Board, 2021). A pretravel test should confirm that staff can identify which device, record, and disclosure rules change at each jurisdictional boundary.

The decisive work begins after the meeting. Post-travel closeout verifies that exceptions expired or were lawfully renewed, temporary credentials closed, retained copies expired or were lawfully reassigned, devices were reviewed, and gifts and hospitality were accounted for. The authorized public record then explains what can safely and lawfully be disclosed. This reconciliation helps prevent temporary arrangements from becoming permanent hidden channels. A travel practice that cannot close its exceptions is not ready to travel.

28.1 — Diplomacy in a Partly Opaque World

In diplomacy, the City's role-bound active-period record discipline meets other actors' state secrecy, negotiation privilege, professional confidentiality, source protection, local privacy law, safety protocols, or institutional refusal. The record must name those regimes rather than pretending one has erased another. Before a participant enters a partly opaque setting, prepare a diplomatic status packet identifying the governing authority, participants, protected persons, subject matter, confidentiality category, public-relevance reason, allowed record method, release horizon, oversight route, and failure path. A missing public record and a record lawfully withheld for protection are not the same kind of evidence gap.

28.1.1 — External Opacity Reality

External opacity arises when a participant encounters a setting governed by another authority. Classify the constraint before deciding whether the City can support the encounter.

Before reviewing conduct, use an external opacity label to identify whether opacity arises from law, security, negotiation, professional duty, counterparty safety, platform limitation, emergency, local custom, or institutional refusal. These categories require different treatment; a technical limitation, for example, is not lawful privilege.

Assess whom the opacity protects and whom it may shield from scrutiny, applying the counterparty rule in Section 28.1.3.

Set the protected-review route before the encounter where possible, using the confidentiality stub in Section 28.1.2.

A bare statement that a meeting was confidential cannot replace the status packet and confidentiality stub. If the scope, authority, protective purpose, or review clock cannot be established, the response may be restricted participation, an

oversight referral, a safe public status label, or a decision to decline City support for the movement (United Nations, 1961; Berridge, 2015).

Assign preparation, conduct, hospitality, and follow-up duties separately from the other institution’s authority over its records and operations.

Record the reason for a restriction separately from the record’s access status. A setting may be open, delayed, protected, counterpart-controlled, legally privileged, security-restricted, or unavailable to the City; these labels can overlap. The applicable authority determines the owner and remedy. An open setting may use ordinary release channels. A delayed setting may need a review clock. A counterpart-controlled setting may permit only public notice that the City did not own the room. Legally privileged material may need sealed handling. An unavailable setting may require cancellation, narrower participation, or notice that continuity could not be preserved.

28.1.2 — Confidentiality Need

Confidentiality is legitimate only when it protects a named interest. It may protect negotiation, life, lawful security, a victim, a dissident, legal counsel, a patient, a child, a vulnerable community, a source, or a public interest that would be damaged by immediate publication. It should not protect prestige, embarrassment, convenience, private leverage, donor access, or image management.

A confidentiality need should carry an owner. The owner might be a government authority, court, counsel, clinician, mediator, security officer, human-rights organization, or independent oversight office. A participant cannot be the only person who names and renews the need, because the participant

is also the person whose burden is being delayed from public view.

Use a confidentiality stub to record the category, withholding authority, scope, review condition, challenge route, and possible later summary. A public stub is appropriate only if its existence and metadata can safely and lawfully be disclosed; otherwise retain the necessary control record under protected review.

The need should also be narrow. A confidential negotiation does not make travel, hospitality, gifts, device exchange, surrounding meetings, staff interactions, or post-meeting conduct confidential by default. Each extension of the confidentiality boundary should require its own reason.

Confidentiality should have a time structure even when it cannot have a short expiration date. Some material may remain protected for years because life, law, or security require it. Other material may become safe after a negotiation concludes, a threat passes, a party consents, a legal process ends, or a public office changes hands. A credible design cannot promise release that law forbids, but it should require periodic reconsideration rather than permanent burial by default (Pozen, 2010; Thompson, 1999).

Where naming the requester would create danger, use a sealed identifier accessible only to the authorized reviewer.

28.1.3 — Counterparty Protection

A counterparty is a person or institution encountering a participant without adopting the participant's active-record role. At contact, provide notice when safe and lawful, in usable language, about the role-bound record, capture of notes or metadata, proposed disclosure, masking and objection routes. Agreement to meet is not consent to public display. Log and

review any justified failure of advance notice during diplomatic or emergency contact.

Counterparty privacy must be distinguished from counterparty influence. A counterparty may be shielded from raw exposure while still being identified by category, role, or institutional source if that role materially shaped the participant's judgment. The public may not need to see a person's private detail to know that a foreign official, lobbyist, clinician, local advocate, agency staffer, or security adviser influenced a decision path.

The review route must include affected-person standing. A counterparty who believes they were exposed, mischaracterized, over-summarized, translated badly, or made publicly identifiable should have a complaint path, correction path, and emergency shielding route. This architecture must not make collateral persons wait for the participant to defend them (United Nations, 1961; United Nations, 1963).

Choose masking, protected summaries, delay, or exclusion according to the counterparty's risk and the public purpose.

Apply the same review to counterpart institutions whose own legal or professional duties constrain disclosure.

28.1.4 — Delayed Accountability

Delayed accountability assigns protected review while immediate publication is unsafe or unlawful. Use the record and escalation conditions below.

A delayed accountability record should include five elements: the protected material category, the reason for delay, the authority responsible, the review date, and the release or summary condition. These elements may themselves be partially protected in extreme cases, but the oversight record should exist.

A useful public label is plain, specific, and non-sensational. It may state that a diplomatic negotiation record exists under

protected review until a named condition is met, while withholding details that would endanger people or lawful work.

Delayed accountability also needs an escalation route. If the delay is renewed repeatedly, if the reason changes, if the participant's conduct becomes contested, if a counterparty complains, or if oversight discovers abuse, the record should move to a higher review level.

Delayed records may become protected summaries, categorical disclosures, ombuds reports, court-reviewed statements, or historically delayed releases rather than raw public records (Roberts, 2006; Berridge, 2015).

Include repeated diplomatic withholding in the aggregate exception review under Section 28.4.5.

28.1.5 — Government, Legal, and Transition Boundary

The City's diplomatic discipline must not become foreign policy. It may prepare public-power seekers to move under record, build status labels, document influence, and preserve accountability under lawful conditions. It does not negotiate treaties, confer diplomatic recognition, grant immunity, declare protected premises, operate intelligence channels, authorize international rollout, or decide when a country is ready for adoption.

Government retains lawful control of official diplomacy and its protected records; City status labels cannot alter that authority.

Corridors, zones, sealed access, and reciprocal hosting are proposed interface designs subject to applicable law and the review in Section 28.6.4.

Network sequencing and adoption decisions remain with the transition architecture; this chapter specifies hosting and movement conditions.

Apply the authority-specific verbs in Section 26.7.5 to diplomatic descriptions. Government negotiates and classifies through lawful channels, legal systems determine enforceability, and transition governance sequences pilots and networks (Cooper et al., 2013; Bjola and Holmes, 2015).

At every external movement, a written interface protocol should identify the issuing authority, resolve conflicts among host-government, security, legal, and City instructions, and record which arrangements may be repeated. Training should reward correct handoff and refusal as much as initiative.

28.2 — Travel as a Continuity Problem

Travel moves the participant through systems owned by carriers, hosts, public authorities, and service providers. Map those dependencies before selecting a record method. Separate the traveler's ordinary personal needs, active-role duties, local-law obligations, and effects on other people. Continuity uses bounded records, not a continuous public feed (NIST, 2023b; European Data Protection Board, 2021; European Union, 2016).

28.2.1 — Movement Record Risk

For authorized role travel, record purpose, departure and arrival windows, route category, responsible staff, approved contacts, anticipated protected zones, emergency fallback, and review owner. Ordinary rest, family contact, and bodily life remain outside routine capture under Section 7.1; a travel protocol cannot waive that boundary.

Movement deviations change the burden even when they are innocent. An extra stop, unlisted vehicle, private elevator, borrowed device, changed hotel, unscheduled dinner, off-agenda host, or unexplained gap may arise from ordinary adjustment, technical failure, safety response, or intentional evasion. Classification allows the record to distinguish those conditions before rumor or convenience supplies the meaning.

Use a gap notice for failures of planned role-record continuity, recording cause, remedy, and review through the exception object in Section 28.4.5. Ordinary noncapture periods are not record failures.

Classify repeated gaps as operational infeasibility, correctable failure, or possible evasion before selecting redesign, restriction, or investigation (NARA, 2023; ISO, 2016a).

Movement risk should be mapped in layers: itinerary, custody, communications, meeting access, hospitality, device posture,

staff accompaniment, nonparticipant contact, emergency alternatives, and post-trip reconciliation. A trip may fail at one layer while remaining intact at another. For example, a route may be logged while a device incident compromises communication; a meeting may be properly noticed while hospitality creates new leverage.

Assess whether the trip changed access, dependence, information, or obligation in a way that later shaped public power. Movement records should link travel events to later decisions where relevant. A private detour may be harmless; a detour followed by policy attention to the host's interest may need explanation.

28.2.2 — Hospitality Risk

Hospitality can create dependence through necessities as well as luxury. Record its source and terms without presuming that generosity is improper.

The hospitality rule should begin with source and purpose. Who offered the support, why, at whose request, under what terms, with what alternatives, and with what public-power relevance? A bottle of water during a delay is not the same as a private jet. A local family's emergency shelter is not the same as a donor-owned resort.

Hospitality risk also includes asymmetry. A participant may feel socially required to accept a host's schedule, introductions, photographs, private time, or preferred narrative. Staff may feel pressure to avoid offending local officials or donors. Counterparties may assume access because they provided convenience. City governance should train participants to accept necessary care without accepting implied authority.

When hospitality becomes unavoidable, the remedy is not always rejection. The City may use preapproved neutral vendors,

reimbursement, pooled host funds, staff review, public labels, alternate lodging, or post-trip disclosure. In emergencies, the City may accept help first and reconcile the record later. Care before record still applies when life or safety is at stake (OECD, 2024b; Berridge, 2015).

Aggregate repeated small benefits; separately trivial items may together create dependence or preferential access.

The hospitality protocol should define ordinary courtesy, reportable support, prohibited gifts, emergency assistance, reimbursable aid, and influence-bearing access. It should also say who decides when a cultural honor is a meaningful civic event rather than a private benefit.

Hospitality should be assessed with cultural humility. Some communities express respect through food, ceremony, procession, or symbolic gifts. A City participant should not insult a host by treating all custom as corruption. The safeguard is proportional handling: accept lawful courtesies, refuse what creates obligation, reimburse where appropriate, record material value, and explain the boundary before the relationship becomes strained.

28.2.3 — Private Meeting Risk

Classify role-relevant private meetings before review; privacy alone is not evidence of improper influence.

A meeting record should distinguish planned private meetings from unexpected private contact. Planned privacy can be reviewed before it occurs. Unexpected privacy should produce a post-event notice. The notice should state who initiated the contact, why public or ordinary recording was limited, who else was present, what category of protected handling applies, and what review will determine whether a public summary is needed.

During travel, apply the protected-activity and professional-care rules in Sections 2.2.2 and 9.2. Classify any consequential role business separately from the surrounding private activity.

Review unscheduled access that bypasses ordinary channels, including repeated informal opportunities to shape consequential role decisions.

Route unauthorized role meetings through the graduated response in Section 28.4.5, preserving evidence of the access and its consequences (Pozen, 2010; United Nations, 1961).

Preauthorize foreseeable sensitive meetings; a change in meeting purpose or participants triggers renewed review.

For whistleblowers or other vulnerable contacts, use the counterparty protections in Section 28.1.3 rather than conditioning a hearing on public exposure.

28.2.4 — Device and Data Risk

Devices carry credentials and records across the same boundaries as the traveler. Their custody requires a separate plan.

Device risk begins before departure. The travel protocol must specify which devices move, what data they carry, what is isolated or encrypted, what is disposable, which access is disabled, which communications are permitted, and what follows if a device is lost, seized, searched, infected, or coerced open.

Host jurisdictions may have search powers, data-localization rules, encryption restrictions, surveillance risks, or platform controls the City cannot override. The travel packet should say when the proper answer is a clean device, remote access limitation, delayed communication, local counsel, or cancellation of a function.

Minimize counterparty information on travel devices, using protected identifiers or local custody where adequate.

When device incidents occur, the record should classify them without panic. Loss, seizure, malware suspicion, credential misuse, unauthorized connection, failed encryption, accidental exposure, and compelled disclosure are different events. Each requires containment, notification, replacement, review, and public labeling appropriate to its risk (NIST, 2023b; European Data Protection Board, 2021).

Travel produces abundant external traces: location history, biometric data, tickets, hotel and vehicle logs, visitor badges, network metadata, and images from other systems. Continuity does not require absorbing all of them into the City archive. The record plan identifies what is necessary, what belongs to another custodian, what implicates nonparticipants, and what should be summarized, sealed, or excluded.

Any permitted machine summary must remain source-linked and human-checked under Section 11.7.6; the tool cannot infer personal traits or substitute for the authorized diplomatic record.

28.2.5 — Jurisdictional Variation

The same act can carry different legal meaning, public risk, privacy duty, labor obligation, record rule, or security consequence across jurisdictions.

Jurisdictional variation belongs in a pre-travel gate. Before travel, the packet should identify host law, privacy constraints, public-record implications, labor and staff conditions, device rules, accessibility conditions, emergency services, protest context, media environment, and any local authority required.

Local counsel and local civic knowledge matter because formal law is not the whole environment. Custom, language, political pressure, security practice, disability access, gender

norms, local conflict, community memory, and media culture can alter burden. Pre-travel review should record which local conditions materially changed the proposed plan and which local sources or advisers informed that assessment. Where credible local advisers disagree, the file should preserve the disagreement and identify the assumption or precaution governing the decision.

Jurisdictional variation can require limiting a role. A participant may attend a public event but not conduct protected negotiations. If a narrower role still cannot preserve these safeguards, the City should decline. Any limitation should appear in the travel authorization so the participant, staff, host, and later reviewers know which activities remain permitted and which require fresh approval.

Compatibility and failure need different labels. When a jurisdiction cannot support role-bound record continuity without violating law, endangering people, or transferring unfair burden, the accurate status is not currently compatible (European Union, 2016; Council of Europe, 2018b). That status should identify the specific condition that failed and what would have to change before reconsideration.

A refusal should preserve the reason and any safer alternative considered, allowing future reviewers to distinguish principled restraint from convenience or avoidance.

Cross-jurisdiction error demands a corrective record rather than a diplomatic shrug. The continuity file records failure, remedy, and the test for renewed authorization, while the public account identifies the incident category without exposing protected substance (NIST, 2025b; European Data Protection Board, 2021; Council of Europe, 2018b).

Written protocols offer little protection if local institutions cannot or will not honor them. Identify a practical remedy and

who can invoke it when law fails. Test access under time pressure, across language and disability barriers, and without an expected contact. Without meaningful remedy, narrow the role, use a safer channel, or cancel the trip.

28.3 — Transparent Corridors and Secure Movement

A transparent corridor is a proposed operating protocol for a defined journey. Its purpose, route, host, access, custody, and stop conditions connect the controls in this section. The corridor remains subordinate to local law and is never a zone of sovereign privilege, immunity, diplomatic status, or portable City authority. It requires visible limits, a host's right to refuse, reviewer stop authority, security review, record continuity, and counterparty protection.

28.3.1 — Corridor Purpose

Publish a safe account of the corridor's purpose and status; give protected detail only to authorized reviewers.

Define the encounter the journey is meant to accomplish and the activities that remain outside that authorization.

The purpose statement should answer why the movement cannot be replaced by remote participation, delayed meeting, written exchange, local delegate, or protected summary. Sometimes presence matters because the burden is embodied, local, urgent, relational, or institutionally specific. Sometimes travel is only prestige. The protocol must distinguish those categories before the trip begins.

Use the purpose to determine relevant records; apply the private-life boundary in Section 28.2.3 to surrounding activity.

The purpose should have an owner. A participant may request movement, but a City role office, oversight body, host coordinator, legal reviewer, security reviewer, or office interface may need to approve it.

If the purpose changes, the corridor changes. A public meeting that becomes a private dinner, a site visit that becomes a donor introduction, or an educational visit that becomes a campaign

moment should trigger a status update. The correction need not be punitive, but it must be recorded (FEMA, 2024; ISO, 2019).

Apply corridor controls according to the encounter's consequences, not its distance. A ten-minute walk to a private office may require them, while a long public train ride may need only basic movement logging.

Apply the compatibility and effective-remedy gate in Section 28.2.5 before authorizing a corridor.

Give a specific public purpose label where safe; use a protected label where even the purpose would reveal sensitive information.

28.3.2 — Route Logging

Under Section 28.2.1, the route log records departure and arrival windows, custody changes, authorized contacts and material deviations. It does not require live public tracking: real-time location can endanger participants, staff, drivers, hosts, protesters, residents, families and counterparties. Public reporting should normally be delayed, aggregated or status-labeled; contemporaneous notice is appropriate only when a lawful public event requires it.

Route logging also protects staff. Drivers, aides, security personnel, interpreters, and coordinators should not be blamed later for unrecorded deviations if the system gave them no workable protocol. The log should state who had custody of the route, who approved changes, what communication channel was used, and when control shifted between City staff, host staff, government staff, or emergency actors.

The public should receive enough route information to understand the burden without receiving exploitable detail. A public release might state that a participant traveled under approved corridor status to a government hearing, with one

security-related route change held under delayed release. Oversight can inspect more. Affected persons can challenge exposure. The record remains layered (NIST, 2024a; NARA, 2023).

Shield service-worker identities unless a specific lawful disclosure is necessary and has passed protective review.

A delayed route log should be compared against the purpose statement. If the stated purpose required one meeting and the movement record shows many private stops, the discrepancy becomes reviewable. If the route changed because of protest, weather, threat, medical need, or government instruction, the status label should say so.

28.3.3 — Host Disclosure

A host controls practical access as well as a venue. Identify both the formal inviter and the effective arranger.

Before arrival, a host statement should identify the host's role, authority, financial relationship, relevant affiliations, access to the participant, access to staff, record duties, and protected-person obligations. It should also state what the host refuses or cannot provide.

Include the counterparty notice and protection requirements in the hosting agreement (Section 28.1.3).

Assess what the participant would lose by refusing a host's request; scarce access or essential support can create leverage beyond its monetary value.

Provide a complaint route independent of the host and participant, available to staff, visitors, and affected residents (OECD, 2024b; United Nations, 1961).

Where a visit is announced under a public institution, identify any donor, consultant, party intermediary, contractor, security actor, or informal patron acting as the effective host.

Host disclosure should include negative space: who was excluded by the hosting arrangement. A visit arranged through elite networks may bypass labor groups, opposition voices, disability advocates, local critics, or affected residents. The City cannot meet everyone, but it should know when a host's hospitality narrowed the world the participant saw.

28.3.4 — Gift and Access Logs

Access matters as much as gifts. A person who receives private time with a participant, repeated informal contact, unreviewed introductions, or privileged response channels may shape judgment even without spending money. The log must capture access that materially differs from ordinary public interface.

Gift and access logs should include refusal and remedy. When a participant refuses a gift, redirects hospitality through a neutral route, reimburses a host, reports an attempted private introduction, or asks staff to reclassify a meeting, that action matters.

Publish contextual gift and access information: source, category, aggregate pattern, material value, role relevance, and remedy, subject to counterparty protection (OECD, 2024b; ISO, 2016a).

Update each entry with its disposition, including return, reimbursement, lawful disposal, restriction, or conversion to an authorized meeting.

28.3.5 — Travel Security Review

Review threats to people and records alongside harms created by the proposed protective measures themselves. Protective security manages those threats; it does not authorize secret policy, private diplomacy, intelligence gathering, unlawful surveillance or command over public authorities. Staff may advise, escort, delay, reroute and refer within lawful limits.

A security review should include route sensitivity, crowd conditions, protest rights, media pressure, emergency access, device risk, host reliability, staff workload, nonparticipant exposure, and jurisdictional limits. It should also include accessibility and health. A secure corridor that ignores disability access, medication needs, sleep exhaustion, or panic risk is incomplete.

Security should follow assessed risk rather than display grandeur. The public-power seeker is not a monarch in transit. Armored protection may be necessary in some circumstances; measures should remain proportionate and reviewable, with public explanations that do not expose dangerous operational detail.

Classify security incidents and overreach under the incident and abuse routes in Sections 28.2.4 and 28.4.5 (NIST, 2023b; NIST, 2025b).

Constraints imposed by a security unit should be logged and reviewed by an authority independent of the unit that made the decision, with command, necessity, duration, and review recorded. Distinguish restrictions requested by external hosts from those imposed by City security, preserving accountability for each source.

Record why the least restrictive workable option was selected, including the burdens of rejected alternatives. Reviewers must be able to challenge both participant risk-taking and excessive security restrictions.

28.4 — Emergency Mobility, Logged Secrecy Exceptions

Emergency mobility joins urgent action to a control record that can be reviewed and closed after stabilization. Move people to safety before completing the record, applying the care-first rule in Section 18.6.3. The continuity file points to the responsible custodian of protected substance; it must not become a parallel diplomatic archive. Use the exception object in Section 28.4.5 (FEMA, 2024; NIST, 2025b; United Nations, 1961).

28.4.1 — Emergency Trigger

An emergency trigger is the specific condition that justifies urgent movement or limited ordinary record handling. It may involve immediate threat, medical need, evacuation, infrastructure failure, cyber compromise, legal command, security warning, family crisis, public-safety duty, or diplomatic danger. The trigger should be named as soon as naming is safe. Vague urgency is not enough.

Identify who actually controlled movement, route, and records, including any external responder or public authority.

Emergency triggers also need scope. A medical emergency may justify leaving a location and protecting clinical details. It may not justify a private political meeting on the way. A security threat may justify rerouting and delayed route publication. It may not justify accepting unlogged hospitality or disposing of devices without incident review.

The participant’s condition matters too. Exhaustion, panic, injury, illness, grief, shock, or threat may impair judgment. The institution must not treat every emergency decision as evidence of character. It should ask whether the person was capable, supported, protected, and later able to participate in reconstruction.

Review false or exaggerated emergency triggers against the information reasonably available at the time. Distinguish reasonable good-faith error from negligence, fabrication, or deliberate exaggeration. Supported findings may require record correction, retraining, sanction, travel restriction, or role review. Protect timely, reasonable emergency action so fear of later suspicion does not delay safety measures (Boin et al., 2017; FEMA, 2024).

The trigger should also name who may activate it. Some events require security authority, some medical authority, some legal authority, some operational authority, and some participant request. Where a participant requests emergency movement, the request should be respected when safety is at stake, then reviewed after stabilization. Where staff activate it over a participant's objection, the record should preserve the reason and the review route. Emergency should protect people, not erase their standing.

Embarrassment, crowd discomfort, press pressure, donor inconvenience, or a desire to avoid questioning are not emergency triggers; predeclared exclusions keep urgency from becoming discretionary cover.

During urgent action, capture only what staff can safely record: time, immediate reason, decision owner, and protective action. Complete and correct the exception object after stabilization.

28.4.2 — Limited Nonpublication

Limited nonpublication protects information whose release would cause foreseeable harm or violate law. It does not authorize capturing ordinary private life or erasing an otherwise required role record.

The material withheld may include exact route, safe location, medical detail, child or family information, security tactic, diplomatic content, device incident, identity of a vulnerable counterparty, or timing that could endanger response. Nonpublication should extend only as far as the protective purpose requires. Surrounding facts that can be safely labeled should not disappear into the same sealed box.

A limited nonpublication stub should be created unless even the stub would endanger life or lawful operation. The stub can state that an emergency movement occurred, the broad category of reason, the authority invoking protection, the oversight route, and the review horizon. If a stub cannot be public immediately, it should still be held for independent review.

Select the safest lawful form of later answerability using Section 28.1.4; raw release is not an automatic endpoint (Pozen, 2010; Thompson, 1999).

Public labels should avoid false reassurance and sensational hinting.

Do not reward dangerous self-exposure or pressure staff to release protected details to demonstrate courage.

28.4.3 — Oversight Notice

Oversight notice should travel as early as safety allows and faster than public release. A defined independent review body, designated rights office, legal reviewer, security auditor, or emergency board should receive enough protected information to know that an exception occurred and falls within a recognized category, even before all facts are settled.

Send the exception object in Section 28.4.5 with detail limited to each reviewer’s authority and need. Require notice for each exception to authorized movement or record controls; do not convert ordinary private care into a routinely reportable event.

If oversight notice fails, the remedy should distinguish unavoidable interruption, technical failure, negligent omission, and intentional concealment. A communications outage differs from deliberate silence; a security lead acting under a lawful immediate-threat protocol differs from a participant evading review. The record should preserve the distinction and the evidence supporting it (U.S. GAO, 2025; NIST, 2025b).

Protect staff reporting of suspected exception abuse under the anti-retaliation rule in Section 28.4.5.

Some oversight reviewers need only category and timing; others need protected facts; legal counsel may need privileged material; security auditors may need route detail; affected-person advocates may need harm information.

28.4.4 — After-Action Disclosure

Begin after-action reconstruction once safety, care, and law permit, using the independent sources and disclosure fields below.

After-action disclosure should include the participant's own explanation where appropriate, but it should not depend only on the participant. Staff reports, host records, security notes, legal review, device incident reports, medical privacy constraints, and oversight findings may all shape the reconstruction.

Choose the disclosure form under Section 28.1.4 according to the event's public relevance and continuing protections.

Report the corrective action resulting from review, and assign its owner and completion test (NIST, 2025b; Roberts, 2006).

The after-action process should also distinguish successful protection from successful accountability. A crisis may be handled safely while still revealing record weakness, poor staff preparation, unclear authority, excessive secrecy, or unequal burden on local responders. Conversely, a messy event may

show strong integrity if the City names its errors and corrects them.

It should explain the trigger, authority, timeline, protected categories, material decisions, record gaps, review findings, corrective steps, and remaining withheld categories. It should not release tactical routes, medical detail, child information, counterparty vulnerabilities, or security weaknesses merely to prove sincerity.

Include burdens on external responders and affected people, and offer a protected route for their accounts and remedy requests.

28.4.5 — Abuse Control

Expiry must be reviewed independently of those who benefited from secrecy (Boin et al., 2017; NIST, 2025b; Thompson, 1999).

Review whether exceptions are being used strategically to evade ordinary controls.

Pattern review distinguishes one emergency from an institutional habit. Repeated exceptions around the same host, donor, meeting type, device, route, jurisdiction, or participant trigger higher scrutiny. The review avoids shaming illness or vulnerability while asking whether recurring conditions require redesign or whether recurring conduct requires correction.

The review should include independent authority where the stakes are high. A participant, staff lead, donor, host, security office, or political ally should not be the final judge of whether their own exception was abused. Formal rights review, legal review, inspector review, or outside expert review may be needed depending on category.

Abuse remedies should be graduated. They may include correction, retraining, public status update, host suspension, corridor redesign, device replacement, access restriction,

participant warning, role pause, referral, or exit. The remedy should fit the burden created.

People who report abuse require protection. A staff member who questions an emergency route, a counterparty who challenges misuse of confidentiality, or a participant who admits pressure should not be punished for making the system more honest (Boin et al., 2017; ISO, 2019).

Every emergency exception should leave an audit object with a unique identifier, trigger category, authorizing role, affected record classes, protected persons, start time, review time, expiry condition, oversight recipient, and after-action disposition. That object does not reveal protected substance; it makes the exception countable, reviewable, and capable of ending. Repeated missing fields, extensions without new reasons, or failed after-action closure should automatically escalate review (FEMA, 2024; ISO, 2019; NIST, 2025b). Any extension should inherit the original exception identifier so renewed secrecy cannot hide the total duration of the same departure from ordinary practice.

Aggregate review should examine exception duration and closure: how many exceptions close on time, how many are extended, which categories recur, whose burdens remain invisible, whether staff objections change outcomes, and how often delayed material is eventually released or lawfully retained. Patterns may reveal genuine operational pressure, a weak corridor, or strategic avoidance. Category-level trends can support diagnosis and redesign without exposing protected operations (Boin et al., 2017; FEMA, 2024; Pozen, 2010). Aggregate review should distinguish necessary recurrence from repeated reliance on the same avoidable weakness, because the remedies are different.

The strongest abuse control is the ability to restrict the discretionary City function that depends on an exception, while preserving emergency care and legally required confidentiality. Repeated misuse can narrow future travel, require external preclearance, expand oversight access, change personnel, or suspend the relevant function. Restoring the restricted City function should require evidence that the condition leading to restriction has changed, not merely the passage of time.

28.5 — Sister Cities and Reciprocal Hosting

Reciprocal hosting can maintain continuity across distance when sending and receiving sites have compatible authority, capacity, and record interfaces. Each participating site requires separate local authorization; shared standards do not create shared sovereignty. The transition volumes govern network sequencing; this section specifies conditions for a proposed hosting relationship. The receiving site must demonstrate that it can accept protected records without exposing its own community to obligations it did not approve.

28.5.1 — Sister-City Function

A sister City offers a specified hosting function, such as relocation, a formation module, or record continuity during travel.

The function should be stated for each movement. A sister-City visit for educational comparison differs from emergency relocation, diplomatic stopover, medical support, public hearing preparation, or office continuity. The host should not receive a participant under one purpose and quietly expand into another.

A sister City should also clarify which institution carries which burden. The sending City may retain archive responsibility. The receiving City may handle physical access, staff support, local law, emergency response, and local records. Joint responsibilities should be named.

Carry applicable participant protections into the hosting agreement. If the sites cannot lawfully maintain the required floor, narrow or decline the visit.

Review receiving-community capacity and burden before confirming a visit (Acuto, 2013; Jayne et al., 2011).

The host may refuse or narrow any function outside its authority or capacity, without penalty for lawful refusal.

Public language should not promise family unity, shared destiny, or moral alignment; sentimental framing can turn reciprocal support into loyalty culture.

28.5.2 — Reciprocal Standards

Reciprocal standards define a minimum protection floor and a function-specific scope of hosting.

The standards should include record stage separation, participant rights, protected nonvisibility, child and family shielding, staff role-record limits, corridor rules, host disclosure, gift and access logs, device incident response, emergency secrecy review, and public-bundle status labels. A sister City that cannot maintain these minimums should not receive active participants under full continuity status.

Reciprocity should be audited from both directions. A wealthy founding City should not assume it sets all standards. A newer or smaller City may reveal blind spots in the original. Local disability access, language translation, climate resilience, community burden, indigenous or local land concerns, and labor conditions may teach the network what the first City missed.

Apply the review, suspension, and decertification process in Chapter 34 when a host fails its agreed scope.

Reciprocal standards should avoid copy-paste imperialism. The same principle may require different architecture, record interface, staffing model, climate adaptation, legal contract, or public access design. The standard is the burden protected, not the aesthetic reproduced (Ostrom, 2010; OECD, 2022b).

Standards should also account for unequal capacity. A newer City, a smaller host, a different legal environment, or a resource-constrained jurisdiction may not be able to offer every

function. The fair response is scoped hosting, capacity support, delayed activation, or non-hosting.

Use reviewers independent of both sites and their shared interests; local complaints and staff reports must be able to challenge the relationship.

28.5.3 — Archive Interoperability

Interoperability carries the minimum authorized record packet between separate custodians. Apply Chapter 11's prohibitions on cross-system personal profiling and secondary use.

Determine the receiving site's necessary fields before transfer; private medical, family, and unrelated historical material are not default continuity data.

Cross-border data transfer is legal and privacy work before it is technical work. Storage location, inspection authority, retention, transfer conditions, affected-person rights, and available remedy vary across jurisdictions. A credible design resolves those questions before interoperability or convenience creates a transfer path.

The transfer agreement must allocate breach notification, correction, recall, and remedy responsibilities across both custodians (ISO, 2017; W3C, 2013).

Each transfer should travel as a minimum interoperability packet: object identifier; source and custodian; purpose and authority; version and schema; status and dispute labels; protected categories; permitted recipients; retention and deletion rule; correction, recall, and challenge mechanism; integrity evidence; and receiving-site acknowledgment. A transfer lacking a required field remains quarantined and cannot be treated as complete or public (ISO, 2017; W3C, 2013; NIST, 2024a). Where a receiving City contests the sending City's classification,

preserve the disagreement through disputed status, right of reply, local annotation, and correction requests.

28.5.4 — Local Translation

Local translation identifies which conditions require a shared rule to take a different form. Record each adaptation in the decision log below.

Adapt form while preserving the agreed protection floor. Chapter 11's prohibited personal inferences remain prohibited; human review does not create an exception.

The translators should include local legal counsel, disability reviewers, host-community representatives, labor voices, privacy specialists, security professionals, affected communities, and language experts. The people who carry local cost must have standing before the system is copied.

Publish a safe account of each adaptation and its challenge route (Acuto, 2013; Curtis, 2016).

Tell visiting participants which functions are available, adapted, unavailable, or unresolved before they rely on them.

Record local travel and hosting adaptations in the variation register specified in Section 34.3.5. Include the receiving site's reviewers, dissent and refusal, and retain its authority to revise local reasons after experience (Acuto, 2013; Curtis, 2016).

Revise the translation log after operational experience, sharing lessons under Section 28.7.5.

28.5.5 — No Diplomatic City Empire

Network governance must exclude empire: a founding City may advise but cannot control records, certify legitimacy, rank jurisdictions, command governments, dictate transition, or moralize adoption. Words such as center, capital, headquarters, model, or moral home can pull authority inward. Jurisdictions

may refuse for lawful, cultural, material, privacy, security, or democratic reasons without being branded corrupt or backward.

Chapter 34 supplies the accreditation, independent review, appeal, and decertification mechanisms for any proposed network.

Any City may leave, suspend hosting, dispute the founding site, or reject standards that violate local law or rights (Slaughter, 2004; Ostrom, 2010).

Hosting agreements must state withdrawal and expiry conditions. Chapter 34 governs their accreditation and review; Section 28.7.3 addresses centralization through visual design.

28.6 — Government Transparency Zone Boundaries

A government transparency environment requires its own public authority, custody, staffing, funding, and remedy arrangements. Test those arrangements before any City support begins. Before a government environment borrows a City practice, an interface preflight should name the legal authority, staff employer and director, controlling record regime, funding and maintenance owner, complaint and remedy body, and the event that suspends or ends the arrangement. Answers that point back to the City rather than to lawful public institutions reveal a shadow-government design.

28.6.1 — Environment Definition

Define the physical, digital, temporal, and role boundaries of the proposed environment before selecting its record rules.

The definition should include physical boundary, digital boundary, legal authority, record owner, access classes, protected categories, oversight body, emergency rule, and public-facing label.

Do not name government spaces as extensions of the City; describe the connection as an interface. City participation, training, or borrowed standards do not alter the government environment's legal identity.

Ordinary service users retain the rights and record protections of the public service; entry does not enroll them in the City or its Vow (Nissenbaum, 2010; Council of Europe, 2018b).

The arrangement cannot impose the Transparent Vow on ordinary officials or substitute for public-record law.

An environment definition includes its beginning and end. It identifies when a person enters, which role and record regime apply, who can refuse or leave, which authority governs, and what happens when the arrangement closes. Without temporal

and role boundaries, a transparency zone can leak into ordinary government work, public employment, citizen access, or private life.

28.6.2 — Government Authority Remains External

Specify the City's support tasks separately from the public body's legal powers.

The authorizing public body may reject, modify, or limit the proposed interface within applicable law (Mashaw, 2006; Roberts, 2006).

Each visible interface should display or link an authority card naming the public body, enabling authority, official decision-maker, staff employer, funding source, record custodian, oversight body, and remedy. The City appears only in a separate support field describing facilities, education, hosting, or record-interface services. An environment whose authority card cannot be completed should not open (U.S. GAO, 2025; Mashaw, 2006).

28.6.3 — Record-Regime Separation

Apply the record-family and custody separation in Section 26.4.5 to the government environment.

For each proposed transfer, identify purpose, authority, custodian, permitted recipients, release conditions, retention, and remedy before moving any fields.

Record-regime separation should be visible in interfaces. Labels should say whether material is City active record, official government record, protected professional record, public bundle, oversight-only record, research-governed data, or external-institution record. Users should not need specialized knowledge to know what kind of record they are reading. Treat a wrong-system import or release as a record incident, requiring

access containment, correction, affected-person handling, and audit (NARA, 2023; ISO, 2016a).

Government-zone separation should prohibit automatic joins between official records and City archives or other project datasets. Any lawful bridge must name the purpose, fields transferred, custodian, retention rule, affected-person rights, and termination condition.

Where official content cannot lawfully enter the City system, use only an authorized status reference; do not create a substitute archive.

28.6.4 — Legal Review

The Constitution of Fairness and *The Government of Fairness* develop the related proposals. This section specifies the City interface; applicable law determines authorization.

Enforceability is determined by applicable law and the institutions authorized to interpret and apply it. *The Constitution of Fairness* develops the series' proposed legal architecture. A corridor may be well designed and still unlawful in a particular jurisdiction; a protected summary may be ethically sound and still insufficient under a records statute; a transparency environment may require legislation, regulation, contract, or constitutional interpretation.

Legal review should occur before activation, before travel, before reciprocal hosting, before government-zone use, and after significant incidents. It should include participant rights, counterparty rights, staff labor, privacy, data transfer, public records, security, diplomatic constraints, disability access, family exposure, and remedy. A legal review that looks only at institutional permission is too narrow. Participation does not waive every right; strong record duties and enforceable protections can coexist under the governing legal order.

Provide an accessible legal challenge route for affected people, including opponents of the arrangement (European Union, 2016; Council of Europe, 2018b).

Legal review returns when conditions change. An arrangement suitable for ordinary administration may fail in crisis; a public-hearing rule may not govern diplomacy; a pilot authorization may be displaced by statute, judgment, executive order, labor agreement, or data law. Authority has a clock as well as a source.

28.6.5 — Operational Review

Operational review tests the practical interface between City formation and public administration. It examines staffing, procurement, security, crisis management, service delivery, digital systems, official records, maintenance, and audit only to determine whether a proposed interface can operate without shifting burden downward. *The Government of Fairness* owns the full operating-government architecture; this Part retains the City-side hazards, acceptance conditions, and stop points.

Identify additional support labor and fund it explicitly; visibility requirements must not silently expand workers' duties.

A failed acceptance test requires redesign, narrower scope, or refusal to operate; the public body retains the decision (U.S. GAO, 2025; NIST, 2024a).

Before activation, the operating public body should approve an acceptance bundle covering staffing, budget, procurement and vendor exit, training, records, privacy and security, accessibility, incident response, public communication, complaint and appeal, continuity, maintenance, and shutdown. City reviewers may test interface assumptions and identify transferred burden, but they cannot approve the government function or supply missing authority (U.S. GAO, 2025; NIST, 2024a; ISO, 2019).

Operational review also asks whether a visibility measure increases burden or reduces service quality. Delay in emergency service, deterrence of vulnerable users, staff burnout, victim exposure, security weakness, or unusable record volume can defeat a design that looks morally attractive. Institutional honesty may favor narrower visibility, clearer status labels, or stronger professional channels when those choices protect the people the system exists to serve.

28.7 — The City as a Node, Not a Fortress

The node model tests how the City connects to other institutions while preserving their independence. Partners may supply specialized expertise without gaining control of the City's record standards. Each connection must identify an accountable owner and a way to handle disputed material. Those boundaries should remain clear to someone examining the arrangement from a different jurisdiction.

28.7.1 — Node Concept

A node exchanges defined inputs and outputs with other institutions. The relation grants neither party authority beyond its own lawful role.

Inputs include burden reports, legal constraints, host-community concerns, expert review, staff complaints, counterparty protections, public questions, and operational failures. Outputs include records, summaries, corrected protocols, training lessons, corridor labels, and public explanations.

Admit each connection only after its relevant hosting, transfer, or authority gate has passed.

Keep failed connections interruptible under the applicable suspension and review process (Ostrom, 2010; Acuto, 2013).

Allow challenges from connected institutions and affected communities regardless of a site's age, wealth, or prestige.

Use the mobility burden register in Section 28.7.4 to account for labor and costs at the connection's endpoints.

28.7.2 — Not Isolated Sovereignty

The node remains subject to the ordinary institutions and duties governing its activities.

Isolation would make the City easier to stage and harder to trust. A participant who only functions inside the City may look disciplined under controlled conditions while remaining untested by ordinary public pressure, legal complexity, travel, diplomacy, hostile criticism, and public-service friction. Public power cannot be prepared entirely in a protected terrarium.

Apply the relevant stop condition when an external authority, rights requirement, or operating limit prevents the connection (Curtis, 2016; Slaughter, 2004).

28.7.3 — Not Global Capital

The City should not become the symbolic seat of a new world order or be described as the capital of transparent politics, the sacred center of public trust, or the headquarters of a global civic destiny. That image concentrates admiration and turns proximity to the center into status: founders appear to command, local translation looks like dilution, and refusal looks like disloyalty. The City's no-rank discipline would be betrayed by geography.

The anti-capital rule belongs in visual design as much as in prose. Maps should show reciprocal nodes rather than a glowing center with lesser sites; diagrams should represent interfaces rather than command lines; captions should avoid shrine language; and donor materials should never sell proximity to a center as prestige.

Distribute responsibility by demonstrated competence, rather than proximity to a founding site (Acuto, 2013; Curtis, 2016).

On maps and diagrams that could imply a command hierarchy, distinguish the relevant support relationship from legal authority and link the applicable hosting status. Test the likely crop or excerpt; do not reproduce the entire network-safeguard catalog on every artifact.

28.7.4 — Movement Under Burden

Authorized role duties continue during travel within the limits specified in Section 28.2.3; leaving campus neither erases those duties nor extends them to ordinary private life.

Plan for travel fatigue, illness, language dependence, and sensory load through the burden register; do not treat a strained moment as a personal-trait finding.

A mobility burden register should be completed before and after each journey. It records purpose, affected people, staff hours, accessibility and health needs, host and community costs, counterparty protections, device and data risks, exceptions, unresolved complaints, and the decision to continue, narrow, substitute remote participation, or stop.

Movement under burden means that the participant's public-power role remains answerable while the form of answerability changes. Inside the City, record continuity may be direct. On the road, it may be delayed, summarized, protected, logged, or partially unavailable. In government environments, it may be divided among lawful record regimes. In diplomacy, it may be counterparty-sensitive. The constant is not total visibility; it is refusal to let burden vanish without label.

Apply the counterparty and route-publication rules to surrounding travelers and service users (Sections 28.1.3 and 28.3.2).

28.7.5 — Network Humility

Network learning requires sharing bounded results and preserving local reasons for refusal.

Reject funding conditions that reward expansion regardless of hosting capacity or review outcomes.

When a corridor or host arrangement fails, the network should circulate a bounded negative-result packet describing the

attempt, operating conditions, affected groups, failure category, protected-material categories, corrective action, unresolved uncertainty, transfer limits, and restoration trigger. The packet supports learning without ranking sites or shaming people (Argyris and Schön, 1978; Ostrom, 2010).

Preserve why a site declines a shared practice. Similar outcomes can arise from different causes, and local refusal may reveal a safeguard the network overlooked.

Compare failures without flattening them. Repeated record-transfer errors, secrecy overruns, host burden, staff overload, or accessibility breakdown may justify a shared safeguard; one locally specific failure may need only local repair. Publish the changed rule, supporting evidence class, recorded dissent, review date, and each site’s right to adopt stricter protection. Keep shared changes revisable when later sites produce contrary evidence or face different legal and host conditions.

Part VIII — Governance, Failure, and Exit

A City that asks future holders of public power to become more visible has no right to let its own authority remain vague. The City cannot be a lantern pointed outward while its own rooms are lit only by trust, charisma, donor confidence, staff habit, or technical custody. Governance is therefore not a back-office chapter after the beautiful design has been admired. It is the point where the City proves whether it can bear the burden it asks others to carry (Bovens, 2007; Power, 1997; OECD, 2017b).

Governance becomes most revealing when the City is wrong. A delayed complaint can leave a participant carrying institutional indecision. Retaliation can force a staff member to choose between livelihood and truth, while a mishandled record can make a nonparticipant repair an exposure they never accepted. A host community may find that its objections were dismissed as public-relations friction. An auditor can be called independent while funding, access, or appointment quietly narrows the work. Institutional seriousness begins by locating each displaced burden and naming the authority that permitted it. Correction must then have enough power to return the burden to those able and obligated to carry it.

Convenience is the City's first quiet capture route. Operators prefer speed, educators defend programs, archivists protect workflows, clinicians may be asked to translate care into readiness, security may turn precaution into jurisdiction, and auditors may grow socially dependent on the institution they inspect. None of these pressures requires bad intent. Governance exists because ordinary incentives can move burden before anyone names corruption.

Part VIII does not settle the final legal form of the City. Incorporation, public charter, host status, statutory authority, enforceable rights, procurement, public-record duties, and

external oversight require decisions by the competent institutions under applicable law. Project leadership may decide which lawful proposal to pursue, but cannot settle legal validity through an internal Open Decision. This Part shows what any acceptable form must make answerable before it earns trust.

A reader should notice the sequence. Governance appears before archive technology because technology without authority limits becomes a hidden constitution. Archive and Artificial Intelligence appear before failure because a failure cannot be repaired if the record of it is inaccessible, corrupted, misclassified, or converted into machine authority. Exit appears after governance and records because departure is not merely a personal decision; it is the test of whether the City owns people or releases them.

The expert stakes are just as sharp. Public-administration scholars will look for separable authority and usable review. Nonprofit and governance lawyers will look for fiduciary clarity, conflicts, delegation limits, and open structural questions. Auditors will look for independence, scope, evidence, sampling, reporting, and remediation. Ombuds professionals will look for independence, impartiality, informality, and confidentiality. Labor reviewers will look for anti-retaliation, workload, bargaining, staff privacy, and protected reporting (GAO, 2024, 2025; IIA, 2024; International Ombuds Association, 2022; OECD, 2016).

Chapter 29 — City Governance and Audit

Every institution develops a shadow when its own power is easier to use than to question. Sometimes the shadow is a founder whose language becomes law. Sometimes it is a donor whose generosity becomes access. Sometimes it is an operator who knows every exception, an archivist who controls memory, a security office that defines danger, an educator whose approval becomes discipline, or an auditor whose findings are written for comfort rather than correction (Power, 1997; Hood, 2010; Scott, 1998). A Transparent City cannot defeat hidden public power by assuming hidden power lives only outside its walls. The City will admit, refuse, stabilize, house, educate, record, protect, audit, and sometimes release people who seek public authority. Those verbs are not neutral. Each verb can shift burden toward a participant, a staff member, a family, a host community, a nonparticipant, a critic, a donor, a vendor, or the public that must understand what happened.

This chapter defines governance conditions without selecting the City's final legal form; unresolved implementation questions remain Open Decisions for lawful review.

Consider a hypothetical external-inspection case. A donor finances a records-search platform and later urges the operator to suppress an audit finding about the vendor's retention practices. A staff analyst who identifies the conflict is removed from the project, and a host-community representative reports that the platform is also capturing nearby residents in public event footage. The same executive office controls the contract, the analyst's supervisor, and the first draft of the public response.

The governance map in Section 29.1 prevents that concentration from becoming the answer. The staff analyst may use a protected complaint route that does not report through the operator. The ombuds function can protect navigation and identify retaliation risk without becoming the fact finder. The

internal auditor must disclose any prior advisory role, and an external inspector receives the contract, access logs, retention rules, complaint record, and host evidence under a defined mandate.

During review, the operator argues that pausing the platform would damage transparency. The governing body cannot decide by mission rhetoric alone. It must consider the evidence, the rights of affected people, continuity alternatives, vendor exit costs, and whether the system remains within its declared purpose. A minority finding can be published if the body rejects the inspector's recommendation, and the affected people retain separate appeal and remedy routes.

In this hypothetical outcome, the platform is paused, the vendor loses access to retained copies, and the analyst receives protection against retaliation and a remedy for removal from the project. Affected people receive notice and correction routes. The governing body publishes the inspector's findings, its own decision, dissenting views, and a dated follow-up plan. The donor receives neither a veto nor privileged access to the remedy process.

Most important, leadership loses the argument in public. That outcome demonstrates no moral purity. It demonstrates that the City's mission does not outrank its own controls. If the governing body had suppressed the finding or retaliated against the complainant, the same map would identify escalation, removal, and closure routes rather than asking trust to fill the gap (OECD, 2016, 2020b; GAO, 2024; IIA, 2024).

29.1 — Who Governs the City

Governance begins by assigning the functions in Section 29.1.1 and making their delegation reviewable (Ostrom, 1990; Bovens, 2007; OECD, 2017a, 2020b). The allocation specifies functional requirements; the legal form remains an Open Decision under Section 29.1.5. Compare the published allocation with actual decision paths. Anticipated preferences, access, gratitude, fear, and convenience can concentrate influence without a formal delegation.

29.1.1 — Governance Bodies

The following allocation separates functions, prohibited combinations, review, and stop routes. Its requirements draw on public-integrity, ombuds, internal-control, and audit standards; implementation requires jurisdiction-specific review (OECD, 2017a, 2020b; Venice Commission, 2019; GAO, 2024, 2025; IIA, 2024).

Stewardship holds charter purpose, executive appointment, budget ceiling, risk appetite, and closure duties. It may not teach, investigate its own misconduct, control complaint intake, or certify its own audit. Publish conflicts, minority findings, and removal routes.

Operations runs staffing, facilities, contracts, safety, and delegated implementation. It may not rewrite authority, direct clinicians, suppress findings, or punish protected complaints. Maintain delegation, labor, safety, and appeal routes.

Education owns curriculum, teaching, feedback, and assessment of role-relevant work. It may not impose discipline, diagnose fitness, control housing, or decide complaints about itself. Use published criteria, source records, conflict disclosure, and independent review.

Clinical care provides independent care, accommodation, emergency support, and clinical judgment. It cannot serve intelligence, discipline, or screening.

Records custody governs provenance, classification, access, correction, retention, sealing, and lawful disposal. It may not decide guilt, readiness, worth, motive, or policy meaning. Keep custody maps, access logs, correction dockets, and external inspection.

Security handles immediate safety, access control, threat response, incident containment, and essential continuity. It may not define dissent as threat, conduct open-ended intelligence, command education or care, or create permanent emergency authority.

Voice bodies carry participant, staff, and host input on lived burden, work conditions, host effects, and proposed changes. They may not become popularity courts or disciplinary tribunals. Protect minority reports, agenda rights, anti-retaliation, and reasoned response.

An independent ombuds provides confidential intake, navigation, informal resolution where appropriate, systemic reporting, and referral. It may not report through the accused actor, become management counsel, or replace formal appeal. Protect appointment independence and case firewalls.

Audit and inspection provide independent assurance over controls, rights, security, technology, donor influence, and closure readiness. Auditors may not operate what they audit or depend on future work from the audited unit. Protect scope, evidence access, conflicts, findings, and follow-up.

Donor and vendor review examines money, gifts, contract leverage, technical dependency, lobbying, and access pathways. Funding, intellectual property, or service continuity may not buy

governance influence or suppress exit. Maintain audit rights, recusal, and replacement plans.

Stop authority provides predeclared power to pause a program, suspend a system, protect people, remove delegated authority, or recommend closure. No single unreviewable sovereign may control it; state the trigger, evidence standard, temporary authority, appeal, expiry, remedy, and public notice.

Each body needs a charter, authority scope, appointment route, term or review cycle, conflict register, meeting record where appropriate, protected-session rules, public-summary duty, and contact route for affected people. Its published entry should distinguish authority to act, recommend, pause, investigate, or overturn.

Governance bodies need a written allocation of reserved and delegated powers. Reserved powers include changing the City's purpose, appointing or removing the chief operator, approving the operating ceiling, accepting high-risk gifts, altering record regimes, authorizing closure, and amending the governance architecture itself. Delegated powers cover ordinary implementation within those limits. The distinction prevents daily operations from becoming constitutional revision by habit, while also preventing the governing body from micromanaging every schedule, purchase, and personnel choice. A delegation register should show who may decide, the legal or charter source, the duration, the review point, and the route for challenge (GAO, 2025; OECD, 2017a, 2020b).

Apply the exception-control requirements in Section 28.4.5 to emergency governance powers, naming the powers activated and the rights that remain protected. Independent renewal and after-action review must test whether ordinary authority can resume.

A governance cycle should therefore include more than annual meetings. It should connect risk review, participant and staff voice, host-community effects, open complaints, audit findings, unresolved conflicts, resource capacity, and closure readiness. The governing body should publish what it considered, what it decided, what it deferred, and which dissenting view remains material. The published record also lets future reviewers distinguish a bad outcome reached through a serious process from a pattern in which inconvenient evidence never entered the room.

29.1.2 — No Single Sovereign

The no-single-sovereign rule should be tested by conflict, not by consent. When a donor wants an exception, when a founder wants a public message softened, when an archive office wants to withhold correction, when security wants broader authority, or when Artificial Intelligence produces a persuasive summary, the system must show which independent body can say no (Michels, 1962; Power, 1997; Scott, 1998).

No office or person may hold unreviewable City power. Test the rule at the pressure points above and against Section 29.1.1.

Founding the City does not entitle anyone to decide future disputes by charisma, memory, private preference, or implied veto. Continued founder involvement must be role-bound, recorded, subject to conflict-of-interest controls where necessary, and reviewable like other influence.

Apply the donor-review controls in Section 29.4.3 to funding influence on governance.

29.1.3 — Operator Boundaries

Use the delegation register in Section 29.1.1 to trace ordinary administrative decisions, including exceptions and escalations.

Operators implement delegated tasks; Section 29.1.1 excludes unilateral control of education, care, complaint findings, and independent review.

Operator authority must be visible in ordinary actions. A schedule change that affects public interface windows, a room assignment that affects dignity, a staffing shortage that affects care, a technical delay that affects record continuity, or a visitor restriction that affects public access should leave a record proportionate to its burden. Not every logistical decision needs a public report, but decisions that move rights, visibility, safety, access, or remedy need traceable authority.

For each consequential administrative act, give affected people a usable route to challenge it. Repeated exceptions should trigger review before an informal custom replaces an authorized rule. A complaint stalled in a queue should remain visible as unresolved work rather than silently aging into acceptance.

29.1.4 — Governance Reporting

The governance report should have regular layers. A charter layer states what bodies exist and what they may do. A conflict layer reports donor, vendor, founder, staff, and board conflicts in usable form. A complaint layer reports volumes, categories, timeliness, outcomes, appeals, remedies, and retaliation concerns without exposing protected details. An audit layer summarizes findings, limits, unresolved disputes, and follow-up. A correction layer says what changed because the City was wrong.

Governance reporting also needs denominators and time. A complaint count means little unless readers can see the eligible population or activity volume, the share acknowledged within the declared window, median and tail resolution times, recurrence after remedy, reopened cases, and the number still awaiting action. The same discipline applies to appeals,

correction requests, protected-access failures, donor or vendor conflicts, and retaliation reports. Where small cells could identify people, the public report should disclose the suppression rule and the independent reviewer who received the complete record. A City should not manufacture reassurance by publishing only closed cases, easy averages, or categories large enough to look orderly (GAO, 2024; OECD, 2020b; IIA, 2024).

Protect identifying detail under the applicable record rules. Publish withholding categories only when the notice itself is safe; preserve authorized independent review.

Two distortions threaten the report: glow and spectacle. Glow buries hard facts in aspiration; spectacle exposes injured people to prove that accountability is real. A usable report is plain, structured, versioned, accessible to nonexperts, and explicit about confirmed findings, disputed claims, delayed material, protected summaries, open remedies, and unresolved questions.

29.1.5 — Open Decision Status

Beyond the policy's signatory, the governing record should identify which committees reviewed it, which staff warned against it, which participant council responded, which outside reviewer objected, which donor was recused, and which unresolved question remained open.

Open Decision Status distinguishes a design requirement from its legally authorized implementation. The final legal form, board composition, appointment route, host-jurisdiction interface, funding model, inspection powers, and relationship to enacted law remain decisions for the appropriate legal, democratic, operational, and expert processes (Sabel and Zeitlin, 2012; OECD, 2020b). Section 29.3.4 supplies one explicitly hypothetical review arrangement so those choices can be examined together. Its charter allocates ordinary work to

delegated owners and reserves contested disclosure for independent decision and appeal.

A proposed governance diagram cannot establish an operating City. Keep its status linked to the unresolved activation conditions.

Charts, captions, guide pages, and donor-facing descriptions (including titles such as board, council, inspector, or ombuds) should distinguish working design, proposed institution, legal review required, and active authority.

Each Open Decision should have a short, versioned record: the unresolved question, the body lawfully empowered to decide it, the advice and evidence still needed, affected-person participation, a review date, and the condition for closure or continued deferral. Closure requires a reasoned decision by the authorized body and an update to the public status.

29.2 — Separation of Educator, Operator, and Auditor

Separation makes it possible to identify and challenge the authority acting in a particular encounter (Power, 1997; GAO, 2024; IIA, 2024). When one office teaches, evaluates, diagnoses, investigates, protects, disciplines, records, and releases, the participant cannot tell which rules govern the encounter, and appeal dissolves into fog because the same facts can be recast under whichever role best protects the institution. Staff carry the same burden when incompatible duties are hidden beneath one title, especially when professional confidentiality or safety judgment is expected to yield to operational convenience. Authorize necessary cross-role communication by purpose and minimum information; coordination does not transfer another office's powers.

29.2.1 — Educator Boundary

Educational dependence can become an informal veto or patronage channel. The boundaries below protect learning from that conversion.

Educators teach and assess role-relevant work under published criteria. The exclusions in Section 29.1.1 prevent that assessment from becoming discipline, clinical judgment, or control of living conditions.

Distinguish draft work, final work, feedback, correction, and unresolved disagreement. A poor first answer is not settled character; evaluate the evidence for a warranted correction before interpreting refusal.

Require engagement with serious alternatives and evidence, without loyalty tests. The curriculum governance rules in Section 22.1.5 apply.

When an educator believes a participant presents risk, the response must move through a defined route. Educational concern can trigger review by the appropriate body, with notice, context, response, and appeal. It should not become informal discipline through schedule exclusion, ridicule, private warning networks, withheld recommendations, or coded summaries that follow the participant without challenge.

29.2.2 — Operator Boundary

Operational knowledge should enter governance through reports and escalation; it does not enlarge the operator's delegated authority.

A claim of administrative necessity can shield an operator's decision from review. A decision may be called necessary because there is no staff, space, time, budget, technical path, or precedent. Sometimes that constraint will be real; sometimes convenience will be presented as reality. Another office must be able to test the claimed impossibility before its costs are transferred to participants, staff, families, or the host community.

Audit operational load alongside decisions. An under-resourced mandate can produce delay, irritability, workarounds, informal authority, and hidden exceptions; these patterns require examination of staffing and expectations as well as individual conduct.

29.2.3 — Auditor Boundary

Auditors assess the stated systems and controls without operating them (GAO, 2024; IIA, 2024; INTOSAI, 2019).

Test appointment, budget, access, reporting, and future-work independence under Section 29.5.2.

Limit findings to the engagement's evidence and criteria; do not convert system assurance into a personal worth or readiness verdict.

Use the protected-evidence protocol in Section 29.4.1; public reporting follows Section 29.5.4.

Auditor independence can be investigated through the incentives surrounding a report. In a two-year field experiment in Gujarat, randomly assigned auditors were paid from a common pool and their reports were independently backchecked; explicit payments linked to reporting accuracy were introduced in the second year. The treatment produced more truthful environmental reports, and treated industrial plants also reduced pollution. The randomized treatment comparison does not isolate a separate causal effect for every component or for the second-year payment change (Duflo et al., 2013).

For the City, this suggests a practical design question: who assigns the reviewer, who pays, and who can check the report without depending on the reviewed office? The appointment and funding example in Section 29.3.4 makes those relationships inspectable. Its arrangements still need their own evaluation.

29.2.4 — Clinician Boundary

Clinical care and independent clinical assessment remain distinct under Section 14.2.2. Clinicians provide their authorized professional function, not public reputation management or disciplinary interpretation (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; World Medical Association, 2024).

Convey necessary functional consequences through the clinical-information bridge in Section 14.2.2. Raw clinical detail stays within its professional regime.

Coordination with other offices must be narrow. Operators may need to know that a participant requires schedule relief. Educators may need to know that a deadline must move. Security may need to know that a crisis plan exists. Auditors

may need to know whether clinical-protection procedures worked. They usually do not need raw clinical detail.

29.2.5 — Archive Boundary

Records custody confers the functions in Section 29.1.1, not authority to decide the meaning of a person's life.

A classification choice can decide what the public sees. A search design can make one pattern easy to find and another nearly invisible. A summary can make an event seem final. A delay label can calm suspicion or hide neglect. A correction log can restore context or bury it.

Separate custody, release review, correction, and any otherwise permitted secondary use under Chapter 11. Neither custody nor a separate permission can authorize prohibited personal profiling.

Provide affected-person challenge and external inspection of archive decisions, including metadata and search presentation.

29.2.6 — Security Boundary

Security performs the bounded safety function in Section 29.1.1 and refers matters beyond its lawful authority to the competent service (Saltzer and Schroeder, 1975; NIST, 2020a, 2024a).

Distinguish credible threats from peaceful protest, ordinary disruption, confusion, and distress. Classify conduct on evidence rather than treating criticism or a complaint as a security finding.

Apply the security controls in Section 21.3.4 and the emergency authority limits in Section 29.1.1; test them through the rehearsal below.

Repair recurring conflict caused by poor interface design, inadequate staffing, confusing record procedures, or vague visitor rules at its source. Security workers should not have to absorb those failures through constant improvisation.

A high-attention event rehearsal can distinguish peaceful protest, a confused visitor, and a credible immediate threat without assigning all three the same security status. Staff should demonstrate the least intrusive lawful response, the point at which outside emergency authority is required, and how an affected person can challenge an error. Independent review compares incident handling with actual route design and staffing so avoidable congestion is not repeatedly classified as individual misconduct.

29.3 — Voice, Ombuds, Complaint, and Appeal

Recourse must be usable before institutional harm requires public scandal or litigation to be heard (Hirschman, 1970; Venice Commission, 2019; OECD, 2016). Participant voice is distinct from participant rule. Those inside the City may have incentives to soften standards, protect friends, resist correction, or seek status, so the institution cannot become a self-protective club. Yet participants carry burdens that outsiders cannot fully see from a chart. Excluding their voice would cause governance to mismeasure the cost of its own rules.

29.3.1 — Participant Council

The participant council turns recurring lived burdens into institutional questions. It complements individual recourse and cannot displace staff or external affected-person standing.

A participant council should have a defined agenda path, access to nonprotected governance information, and protected channels for raising systemic burden.

The council may advise, request review, and preserve minority concerns. The voice-body limits in Section 29.1.1 exclude individual adjudication and disciplinary power.

The participant council must route individual or protected concerns to the ombuds or formal complaint system without copying them into council records. Its access duty is systemic: identify recurring barriers, request correction, and leave confidential intake to the independent office designed for it.

Preserve issues, disagreements, minority reports, and official responses; keep identifying case material out of council reporting.

29.3.2 — Ombuds Independence

The office needs a protected appointment and term, budget insulation, sufficient access to records and people, freedom from retaliation, and reporting routes outside the ordinary chain of command. Its public charter should preserve independence, impartiality, informality, and confidentiality while stating when safety, law, or professional duty requires escalation or referral rather than investigation. An office that quietly serves management intake or formal investigation under the ombuds name is not independent in function (International Ombuds Association, 2022; Venice Commission, 2019; United Nations General Assembly, 2020).

The ombuds route is deliberately informal and therefore powerful but limited. It can listen, clarify options, help a person prepare, mediate where appropriate, identify systemic patterns, and recommend process improvements without receiving legal notice, adjudicating facts, imposing discipline, or promising formal remedy. Users must be told that speaking with the ombuds ordinarily does not initiate a formal complaint, preserve a legal deadline, or substitute for emergency, safeguarding, labor, clinical, statutory, investigative, or court processes (International Ombuds Association, 2022; United Nations General Assembly, 2020).

Confidentiality must be honest. People using the ombuds should know when confidentiality is protected, when imminent risk or legal duty may require action, and how systemic trend reporting can occur without identifying them.

The office should be reachable through more than one route. A participant may need a private appointment outside the ordinary schedule, while a staff member may need off-site or encrypted contact. A host resident may need language access; a person with a disability may need a communication accommodation. A

family member may need to raise a systemic concern without entering the participant's record. Intake metadata should be minimized, separated from management analytics, and reviewed for patterns without turning complainants into risk profiles. Access is not real when the route itself exposes the person to the authority being challenged.

The ombuds may report recurring barriers, delays, retaliation patterns, ambiguous rules, or concentrations of power without publishing protected identities or reconstructable details. Management should answer those reports in writing, and unresolved recommendations should remain visible to the governing body and external inspectors. The office should also be auditable for delay, conflict, accessibility, and misuse of confidentiality.

29.3.3 — Formal Complaint Intake

Formal intake receives notice and opens a case, separately from the informal ombuds. Provide accessible, trauma-aware, multilingual routes with urgent protection and anti-retaliation support (Venice Commission, 2019; Tyler, 2006; OECD, 2016).

The intake system should ask enough to act and no more than necessary to begin. It should identify the affected person, the alleged burden, the office involved, the record stage, protected categories, urgency, requested relief, fear of retaliation, and whether ombuds support, counsel, clinical support, or immediate safety review is needed. It should avoid forcing exhaustive narrative before relief begins.

Complaint intake should create a bounded service clock. Urgent protection, acknowledgment, routing, preliminary review, evidentiary completion, decision, and remedy follow-up require distinct time standards because one global deadline hides the places where people actually wait. Queue reports should

show age bands, transfers, returns for missing information, withdrawals, protective measures, and reasons for extension without exposing complainants. A case circulated among offices has not been handled merely because each office met its local target (Venice Commission, 2019; OECD, 2016; ILO, 1982).

Complaint categories should be specific enough to route correctly. Admissions error, record inaccuracy, protected nonvisibility breach, staff misconduct, participant misconduct, operator failure, clinical boundary issue, security overreach, donor influence, vendor failure, public reporting error, family or nonparticipant exposure, retaliation, and audit obstruction are different matters.

Accept complaints from any person affected by City conduct, including former or refused applicants and nonparticipants; provide protected representation where needed.

An institution that puts reputation ahead of relief may judge a complainant by tone, use the language of investigation to excuse delay, or invoke confidentiality to hide recurring harm. Begin intake with care, jurisdiction, authority, evidence preservation, and protection from retaliation.

29.3.4 — Governance Appeal Pathway

An appeal transfers review of the challenged decision to an independent authority (Tyler, 2006; OECD, 2020b; ILO, 1982).

Appeal rights should be stated at the moment of decision. The affected person should receive the decision, reason, evidence status, protected-material limits, deadline, appeal body, available assistance, retaliation protections, and possible outcomes. If the decision contains protected material, the appeal should include a way to review enough to contest without exposing others or violating law.

A worked case shows how these requirements can operate together. Mara is the fictional participant introduced in Chapter 1. The appointment arrangements, panel sizes, evidentiary rule, and working-day limits below are illustrative charter choices, not existing law or reported pilot results. They govern a proposed public release, not a disciplinary hearing. Applicable law and access to competent external authorities remain controlling.

Before activation, the lawful governing body adopts the review charter and contracts for an external review service. Its publicly explained selection identifies three unaffiliated nominating channels: a qualified professional body, an independent rights organization, and a host-community process with published eligibility rules. Each channel nominates one member of a three-person selection committee. Committee members disclose material relationships and cannot be current City operators, donors, vendors, participant advisers, or their close associates. The committee selects qualified reviewers under published criteria; the governing body completes the lawful appointments and explains any refusal against those criteria. These initial arrangements are established before there is a case to influence.

The service maintains separate initial-review and appeal rosters, plus substitutes, with different supervisory responsibility for the two stages. In this illustration, reviewers serve three-year nonrenewable terms and receive published fees unrelated to outcomes. Contested removal for incapacity, misconduct, or an undisclosed conflict is determined by an uninvolved external reviewer under the charter. A removal dispute cannot erase a pending case. Funds for review, accessible participation, independent advocacy, and compliance verification are committed before activation through an arrangement that prevents an implicated operator from withholding case payment. A donor may contribute but cannot select a reviewer or condition

payment on a result. A small pilot can purchase shared external capacity rather than establish several full-time tribunals.

Mara prepares a recommendation in a simulated procurement task. A firm connected to a sponsor supplies an advice memorandum, and she adopts part of its proposed language. The memorandum also contains unnecessary personal information about a nonparticipant relative. The proposed public bundle includes an identifying family reference and describes the sponsor-linked input as undeclared. Mara says she filed a declaration before adopting the advice. The relative separately objects to identification. The proper question is what the task evidence supports and what is necessary to explain the decision.

Formal intake accepts either objection without requiring one person to speak through the other. A charter-authorized rights officer immediately holds the disputed publication and acknowledges receipt within one working day. Support and unrelated formation continue. Notice uses safe contact routes and offers independent advocacy where needed. Mara and the relative have separate standing; the release office answers as proponent of publication. Each receives what is needed to address its part of the case, not every other party’s protected information. The ombuds may explain options or facilitate voluntary contact, but does not receive formal notice, represent a party, decide facts, or order the hold. The formal route, not an ombuds conversation, starts the case clock.

A registrar assigns the initial reviewer through a logged rotation of the eligible roster. Each party receives relevant conflict disclosures and has two working days to raise a specific objection. An uninvolved roster officer decides it within one further working day; a sustained conflict brings the next eligible substitute. These steps run inside the decision period rather than restarting it. No party can choose a preferred reviewer. Any

material communication about the merits enters the case record with a safe opportunity for the other affected parties to answer.

The reviewer separates the advice’s source, Mara’s disclosure and reasoning, and the proposed publication. Under this illustrative charter, a disputed factual statement must be supported as more likely than not by the verified role evidence; an absence from one export is not sufficient evidence that a declaration was never made. The proponent of release must separately establish lawful authority, necessity, and proportionality, including why a less-exposing form cannot serve the same purpose. This is a release standard, not a misconduct finding or a substitute for the separate disciplinary route. Material uncertainty remains explicit.

The custodian preserves the authorized source and gives the reviewer a case-limited evidence index. Mara receives the material relied on about her conduct; the relative receives the proposed wording and relevant protection information. Each can correct the index and identify missing evidence. Unnecessary collateral detail stays outside the ordinary formation file. Where one party cannot receive confidential material, a protected account must still permit meaningful challenge to the inference. An assertion that cannot be fairly tested is narrowed or omitted. Protected information is not demanded merely to prove that its publication is unnecessary.

The first decision is due within ten working days of receipt, with one extension of at most ten working days for a specified evidentiary or access need. In this example, the reviewer makes a reviewable error: the decision removes the personal detail but retains the distinctive family reference and the description of undeclared input because no declaration appears in the submitted task file. It records Mara’s contrary account but fails to resolve the indicated search gap. That inference falls short of the

charter’s evidence rule; including an appeal is not permission to make it. The reasons, proposed wording, and appeal route are delivered safely to the affected parties and release office while publication remains on hold.

An affected party or the release proponent may appeal within ten working days of safe notice. The publication hold continues through that period and any timely appeal. A three-person panel from the appeal roster receives the same conflict challenge route; no member participated in the first decision, case investigation, or advice to a party. All three unconflicted members form the quorum; a majority decides, with reasons and any dissent preserved under the same confidentiality rules. A recusal triggers a substitute rather than unilateral chair authority. The panel reviews disputed facts and disclosure necessity afresh when they control an irreversible release. It also examines procedural fairness and the adequacy of the proposed remedy. Its decision is due within fifteen working days of appeal receipt, with one reasoned extension of at most ten working days. Missing evidence does not permit an indefinite clock that begins only when an office declares the file complete.

On appeal, the custodian searches the separately indexed conflict register identified by Mara. A dated declaration confirms that she disclosed the sponsor connection before adopting the advice. The task-file export had omitted its link. The panel finds that the first reviewer treated an incomplete search as sufficient evidence of nondisclosure and withdraws the undeclared-input description. It also concludes that the family reference is unnecessary and identifying when combined with other public information. The revised account retains the firm’s relevant connection and the advice used, records the timely declaration, and explains that the appeal corrected incomplete

source selection. The merits of the recommendation remain available for scrutiny through its stated reasons.

The order names each implementation owner. The custodian restores the declaration’s link in the case index without changing the authentic declaration, and versions the corrected case account under the applicable retention rules. The public-interface manager removes the superseded draft from release queues and checks that authorized derivatives use the corrected status. The public correction account explains the review error without exposing the withheld draft or relative. The access administrator closes permissions granted only for this review. The operations owner repairs the export rule that dropped the declaration link. A separately authorized remedy officer receives any claim for support or compensation; receipt of assistance is not conditional on agreement with the outcome. No public release of the disputed draft occurred in this example.

Implementation starts within two working days of the final internal order. Within ten working days, an uninvolved compliance reviewer tests the source link, version status, release queue, access changes, and repaired export using another fictional file. The reviewer verifies execution rather than rehearing the merits. The rights officer lifts the hold only for the approved corrected version after the disclosure-related checks pass. The public-interface manager then releases that version; other remedy claims retain their own clocks. The parties receive a protected completion account and can report a failed remedy. A failed check leaves the relevant duty open, with an owner and corrective deadline, rather than awarding closure for an attempted repair. A recurrence check in the next ordinary export cycle tests the institutional change without monitoring the relative’s private life.

A missed review or implementation deadline reaches the service’s designated escalation officer on the next working day and, if unresolved, the governing body’s compliance authority. That authority can suspend the implicated publication function and invoke contracted substitute capacity; it cannot rewrite the merits decision. The disputed text remains unreleased, and the parties receive the overdue status, responsible contact, and available external route. Neither publication nor an adverse finding arises by default. For an urgent danger, the separately authorized protective process acts immediately rather than waiting for these ordinary clocks.

One ordinary internal appeal concludes the merits. Material new evidence or an undisclosed conflict can justify a reasoned reopening under the charter; disagreement alone cannot. Failed execution reopens compliance and remedy enforcement, not the merits unless it reveals a separate ground for doing so. External remedies remain available without compulsory exhaustion of this internal route where law permits direct access. The completed case demonstrates a positive form of answerability: an independent challenge changes the official account, a named owner repairs the cause, and another person can verify that the correction reached practice.

Match the available remedy to the harm, using the tracker in Section 29.3.5; reversal alone may leave practical consequences unresolved.

Appeal fails when reasons are vague, deadlines are unusable, protected evidence cannot be meaningfully contested, retaliation is tolerated, or the process exhausts people into silence. A low reversal rate alone does not establish failure: it may reflect sound first decisions or barriers that prevented meritorious appeals. Review should examine access, case mix, reasons, withdrawn

cases, and independent samples of both appealed and unappealed decisions before judging the route.

29.3.5 — Remedy Tracking

Remedy effectiveness should be tested at three levels. The first asks whether the promised act occurred, such as a correction, payment, access change, restored status, or staff protection. The second asks whether the act reduced the burden for the person affected rather than merely closing an administrative field. The third asks whether the underlying mechanism changed enough to prevent recurrence in comparable cases. Where safe and voluntary, the affected person should be invited to state whether the institution’s description of repair matches lived consequence, but no one should be made responsible for validating the City’s ethics. A remedy remains open when evidence shows that harm, exposure, retaliation, or misclassification continues (Sabel and Zeitlin, 2012; UNODC, 2020; Tyler, 2006).

A remedy tracker should identify the harm found, affected persons, responsible office, chosen remedy, due date, verification method, public-report category, protected-material limits, appeal rights, recurrence risk, and follow-up check.

Publish the institution’s corrective duty without making the injured person an exhibit of institutional virtue.

Apply the tracker to staff and nonparticipant harms as well as participant outcomes.

Where misuse of authority caused the harm, review must also establish whether the office lost the power it misused.

29.4 — External Inspection and Red Teams

External inspection tests assumptions that insiders may have normalized (GAO, 2024; IIA, 2024; INTOSAI, 2019). External inspection and red teams provide different forms of assurance. Inspection tests evidence, compliance, and governance against a mandate; red teams probe how serious failure could bypass the design. Neither is a hostile crowd, and neither may manufacture injury for theater. Competence, bounded access, protected-contact routes, finding categories, follow-up authority, and review of reviewer conduct belong to both.

29.4.1 — External Inspectors

Select inspectors for competence and independence. Their mandate should cover the relevant functions in Section 29.1.1 and permit examination beyond curated presentations.

Inspector authority should be defined before inspection begins. The scope should identify which systems are under review, what records may be accessed, which protected categories require special handling, who may be interviewed, whether anonymous input is allowed, how findings will be classified, and how obstruction is reported.

Provide direct, protected contact with affected people outside the reviewed office’s control, with independent scheduling and anti-retaliation protection.

Inspection access needs an evidence protocol as well as interview access. The mandate should identify preservation notices, sampling authority, protected-record handling, legal privilege, technical reproduction, chain of custody, rights of reply, contrary-evidence admission, and the point at which obstruction becomes a reportable finding. Inspectors should be able to follow a burden across offices when a narrow organizational chart would conceal the route, yet every

expansion of scope should be logged and justified. The final report should distinguish verified fact, supported inference, unresolved conflict, and recommendation (GAO, 2024; IIA, 2024; INTOSAI, 2019).

Inspectors exercise only their declared assurance and escalation powers; they do not take over the operations they review.

A worked inspection route shows why separation matters. Suppose a participant reports that an operator repeatedly reclassified disability-access complaints as minor maintenance requests, keeping inaccessible routes out of the governing body's risk report. The ombuds helps the complainant reach an independent formal intake route. The complainant supplies the formal account directly or through an independent advocate; confidential ombuds communications are not transferred. With the complainant's informed permission, formal intake refers the pattern to an external inspector because the operator controls the ordinary complaint queue and the internal audit team previously reviewed only aggregate closure rates. The inspector freezes the relevant deletion schedule, obtains the classification history, maintenance logs, and route-closure records, interviews affected staff through protected channels, and discloses any prior work for the City. The participant can submit a statement, correct factual misunderstanding, and request interim shielding without becoming the public face of the finding. No single body can close the matter: the inspector establishes evidence, the ombuds helps the person navigate options, the governing body owns interim authority, the auditor tests the control failure, and an independent appeal route remains available (Bovens, 2007; IIA, 2024; GAO, 2024; OECD, 2020b).

Closure in that case requires more than publication. The City restores each misrouted complaint to the correct status, notifies

affected persons, pauses the classification rule, removes the operator's unilateral power to make these exceptions, and compensates documented costs where the governing legal route permits. A bounded public notice explains the access failure, the institutional contribution, the corrective action, and the follow-up date without exposing protected complainants or treating every ordinary repair request as evidence of misconduct. The governing body then decides whether leadership change, contract amendment, discipline, or program suspension is warranted, while an audit of auditors asks why the earlier review missed the pattern. Follow-up testing must show that access complaints now reach the right route and that staff can report interference without retaliation. The inspector's own independence, evidence handling, reasoning, and conflicts remain open to meta-complaint and quality review (OECD, 2017a, 2020b; Venice Commission, 2019; IIA, 2024; GAO, 2024).

29.4.2 — Red Teams

Authorize red-team methods under a bounded mandate; do not create real injury to demonstrate a possible failure.

The City needs different red-team disciplines. A civil-liberties red team asks where ordinary privacy could be consumed. A cybersecurity red team tests breach, deepfake, sabotage, access control, and vendor dependency. A labor red team asks where staff carry hidden work. A clinical red team asks where care becomes evidence. A journalist red team asks how a hostile excerpt could distort the City. A governance red team asks who cannot be challenged.

Track accepted red-team findings through Section 29.3.5, including interim protection and verification.

The mandate names the systems, decisions, and failure modes under review; the evidence channels the team may use; the protections owed to people drawn into the exercise; and the difference between a verified finding, a plausible scenario, and an unresolved suspicion. A governance red team may test whether a complaint can be suppressed, whether a donor can route influence through an intermediary, whether a security exception can persist without review, or whether a public summary conceals material dissent. A technical red team may test identity, access, provenance, model behavior, and recovery. The two functions may cooperate, but neither should borrow the other's authority or report confidence it has not earned (Zenko, 2015; NIST, 2023a, 2024b).

The exercise also needs protected participation. Staff and participants should be able to describe weak controls without becoming targets for having revealed them. Observers should distinguish a person's error inside a simulation from misconduct in ordinary work. Scenarios involving trauma, harassment, exposure, or clinical vulnerability require scope limits and independent review before use. The useful red team is often quieter: it discovers that one mailbox has no backup owner, one emergency label has no expiration rule, or one public-summary workflow exposes a protected source to an unauthorized reviewer.

Management may reject a recommendation, but it should state reasons and accept an independent follow-up. The red team's unresolved dissent should remain visible in the inspection record rather than disappearing into a consensus paragraph.

29.4.3 — Donor Capture Review

Donor review follows dependency and influence, including support routed through intermediaries (OECD, 2017a, 2020b;

Ebrahim, 2010; Ostrower, 2007). The review must map donor relationships across admissions, governance appointments, facility naming, curriculum emphasis, vendor selection, staff hiring, participant support, public events, media access, research requests, record-site design, and reporting tone. A donor may not purchase loyalty, silence, participant access, protected records, religious participation, political allegiance, research consent, Artificial Intelligence training permission, or influence over complaint outcomes.

Publish funding categories, material conflicts, recusals, and restrictions, shielding personal detail where required without concealing institutional influence.

Use the pooled-support arrangements in Section 15.2 to separate participant and staff support from personal sponsorship.

Test anticipatory deference through documented changes in access, decisions, timing, or reporting; absence of a written donor instruction does not settle the inquiry.

A contribution may arrive through a foundation, sponsored program, donated service, travel arrangement, naming opportunity, advisory appointment, or promise of future support. The review therefore asks who initiated the relationship, what restrictions accompany it, which officials communicated with the donor, what policy or staffing interests were discussed, and whether refusal would threaten an essential service. A public donor register should distinguish a lawful gift from the right to shape curriculum, admissions, records, appointments, public messaging, or inspection scope (OECD, 2017a, 2020b; Ostrower, 2007).

Agreements should contain termination rights, return or wind-down terms, protection against donor access to protected records, and a prohibition on using the City's name to imply endorsement or scientific validation. Essential care, housing,

archive continuity, and staff wages should not depend on a single benefactor's continuing approval. Maintain a reserve and replacement plan.

The strongest donor review includes counterfactual questions. Would the same proposal be accepted from a critic? Would a smaller donor receive the same access? Would the governing body publish the relationship if the project failed? Could a participant or staff member challenge the donor's influence without losing support?

29.4.4 — Vendor Capture Review

Vendor review examines dependency as well as contract compliance (NIST, 2022; ISO/IEC, 2022; Sculley et al., 2015).

Before procurement, establish necessity, data scope, auditability, exit feasibility, and the Chapter 11 use restrictions. A vendor contract or separate consent cannot permit prohibited personal inference or secondary use.

Use Section 30.4's contractual controls for data use, security, audit, incidents, subcontractors, conflicts, accessibility, portability, and termination. Include source or configuration escrow where appropriate.

Maintain access to independent technical review when a vendor or technical team calls a safeguard impossible, too expensive, too slow, or unsupported, so genuine constraints can be distinguished from changeable design choices.

Vendor capture often begins with ordinary convenience. A platform becomes the only place where records can be searched; a security provider controls the threat model; a cloud contract makes export costly; or a model vendor alone can explain why an output changed. The review should therefore map not only the contract but the dependency: data formats, identity systems, encryption keys, configuration knowledge, model

documentation, subcontractors, update rights, incident obligations, and the staff competence needed to leave. A low purchase price can conceal a high constitutional exit cost (NIST, 2022; ISO/IEC, 2022; ISO/IEC, 2023).

Vendor reviews should use the exit tests in Section 30.4.2, with periodic drills to check that the path remains workable. Report the time, cost, missing dependencies, unresolved risks, and staffing implications revealed by those tests to the governing body.

29.4.5 — Inspection Findings Publication

Publish inspection and red-team results using the audit-summary structure in Section 29.5.4, with the distinctions below (Bovens, 2007; GAO, 2024; NARA, 2023).

Separate verified findings, unresolved evidence, simulated vulnerabilities, rejected allegations, and recommendations. Protection or delay is a disclosure status, not a finding of truth.

Public reports should include obstruction and limitation. If inspectors lacked access, if a vendor delayed cooperation, if protected law limited disclosure, if evidence was incomplete, if a finding awaits legal review, or if a body disagreed, the public should know the limit.

Use plain summaries supported by technical appendices, applying the public-explanation method in Section 22.5.5.

Inspection findings lose value when converted into branding. A favorable review is evidence about particular systems at a particular time, not proof of purity; a critical review is not proof of corruption.

29.5 — Audit of Auditors

Oversight itself requires review because its access, findings, and recommendations can cause harm (Power, 1997; GAO, 2024; IIA, 2024). Review incentives that could favor reassuring findings, dramatic accusations, or protection of peers. A mature City grants auditors independence and then places that independence under transparent constraints. Operators may not punish critical findings, donors may not retaliate against inconvenient inspectors, and public anger may not force disclosure of protected detail.

29.5.1 — Oversight Risk

Imagine an auditor mishandles a protected complaint by summarizing too much detail in a public report. The participant should not have to choose between accepting injury or attacking the whole audit function. A meta-complaint route should review the auditor's conduct, correct the report, protect the participant, and preserve the audit office's legitimate independence for future cases (Power, 1997; Hood, 2010; O’Neill, 2002a).

An assurance map is more useful than accumulating watchdogs by instinct. It should show which body reviews each risk, what evidence it can reach, where mandates overlap, where no reviewer has standing, and how findings travel into correction. It should also record the burden oversight places on participants, staff, protected persons, and small teams, because repeated interviews and duplicative requests can become institutional extraction. Coordinated reliance may reduce duplication, but no reviewer should inherit another's conclusion without understanding scope and limits (IIA, 2024; GAO, 2024, 2025).

An oversight-risk register makes this vulnerability inspectable. It should track conflicts, repeated reviewers, access patterns,

complaint patterns against oversight, public-report disputes, missed follow-up, findings reversed on appeal, protected-material incidents, and reliance on a small circle of experts.

29.5.2 — Auditor Independence

Auditor independence should be tested across four practical dimensions: organization, money, information, and future opportunity. Who appoints and can remove the audit lead? Who can narrow the budget after an adverse finding? Who can block access or bargain over publication? Who offers consulting work, prestige, or future employment? Appointment protections, direct governing-body access, conflict disclosure, recusal, cooling-off periods, and external quality review do not guarantee courage, but they make capture, retaliation, and self-review visible (GAO, 2024, 2025; IIA, 2024; INTOSAI, 2019).

Engagement-level independence must be visible. Before work begins, the record should state who set the scope, selected criteria and samples, approved access, decided publication, separated management response from finding status, and followed unresolved obstruction. If any of those powers sits with the unit under review, the limitation must be disclosed and routed to external quality review (IIA, 2024; GAO, 2024, 2025).

Assess objectivity, competence, due care, and confidentiality through the quality review below.

Two reviewers can independently examine the same fictional file before discussing it. A prepared key distinguishes established facts and planted omissions from genuinely contestable judgments. Comparison asks whether each reviewer found the missing declaration, used the proper access rule, and supported a proportionate remedy. Agreement alone is not accuracy, and disagreement alone is not failure. Paired versions

then change one feature at a time: a declaration filed before rather than after the relevant act should change the chronology finding, while an irrelevant name change should not. The expected consequence is specified only for that factual or procedural question, not for a contested policy preference. Revised guidance is tested on a different file, so calibration demonstrates more than familiarity with the first answer.

Quality assurance should be independent of the individual engagement. A review file needs a traceable question, criteria, evidence set, sampling rationale, contrary evidence, reviewer judgments, management response, and follow-up status. Periodic external quality review can test whether internal audit selects reputation-safe topics, overuses confidential classifications, repeats unsupported language, or closes recommendations without evidence. The audit of auditors should therefore examine not only whether a report followed a template, but whether the function had sufficient access, competence, skepticism, and freedom to reach an inconvenient conclusion.

An adverse audit finding does not predetermine discipline.

29.5.3 — Rotation and Conflict Rules

Rotation should follow a written conflict and continuity plan: enough turnover to challenge shared assumptions, enough overlap to preserve case knowledge, and mandatory recusal when financial, personal, political, professional, or prior-review interests could reasonably affect independence.

Apply rotation to audit leadership, external inspectors, red-team panels, public-report committees, conflict reviewers, and specialized review pools where feasible. Where technical or legal continuity is needed, maintain peer review, second opinions, conflict disclosure, and periodic external quality assessment.

Assess material relationships and prior work against the specific engagement; affiliation alone is not proof of bias. Disclose, mitigate, recuse, or avoid the conflict as appropriate.

The conflict record should be usable. It should say what the relationship is, which matter it affects, what recusal or mitigation is required, who approved the mitigation, and whether the public needs a status label. Private details may be protected, but the existence of material conflict should not vanish into administrative discretion.

A closed reviewer circle can accumulate influence across audits, reviewer selection, City events, vendor advice, and donor committees. Even highly competent members need challenge from outside that circle.

Allow an outsider to request conflict review by someone independent of the usual reviewer pool.

29.5.4 — Public Audit Summary

Use separate clocks for immediate incidents, periodic rights review, annual labor and host review, technical retirement and multi-year necessity review. At each necessity review, ask whether the function would still be justified under current law, evidence, technology, cost and affected-person knowledge (Bovens, 2007; Lindberg, 2013; Power, 1997).

Use the issue-level structure below to explain scope, method, findings, limitations, and follow-up in accessible form (GAO, 2024; Bovens, 2007; O’Neill, 2002a).

A useful summary also separates finding from response. For each material issue, readers should see the criterion, condition observed, people or functions affected, consequence, severity rationale, management response, responsible owner, due date, current status, verification method, and any disagreement. Aggregate tables should report aging, extensions, repeated

findings, accepted risk, overdue action, and findings closed without independent verification. Where publication would expose a person, the summary can use protected categories and bounded description while preserving the existence and seriousness of the issue. The public should not have to infer whether accepted recommendations were ever implemented or whether implementation actually worked (GAO, 2024, 2025; IIA, 2024).

An audit summary fails when it becomes a badge rather than an explanation. Phrases such as independent review completed, controls strong, recommendations accepted, or no material weakness may conceal what was tested, what failed, and what remains uncertain. Present scope, evidence, limitations, minority findings, and follow-up alongside any overall assessment.

If later evidence changes a finding, protected information was overexposed, or a material dissent was omitted, the public version must be visibly superseded rather than silently edited. Version history, affected-person notice, linked corrections, and a reasoned change log allow the summary itself to be challenged before the failure has to travel into a meta-complaint route.

29.5.5 — Meta-Complaint Route

A meta-complaint challenges defects in an oversight or recourse process, including its evidence handling, conflicts, delay, or public account (Venice Commission, 2019; Hirschman, 1970; OECD, 2016).

The route must protect independence while allowing correction. A meta-complaint against an auditor should not be decided by the operator who disliked the audit. A meta-complaint against an ombuds should not expose confidential conversations unnecessarily. A meta-complaint against an inspector should not become retaliation against

criticism. The reviewing body must be independent from both the oversight body and the office originally reviewed.

The meta-complaint intake should identify the oversight process challenged, the alleged defect, affected persons, protected categories, requested relief, urgency, retaliation risk, and conflict concerns. It should distinguish disagreement with a finding from defect in the process.

Assign a remedy suited to the oversight defect and track it through Section 29.3.5. Discomfort with good-faith criticism is not a basis for sanction.

Meta-review needs thresholds, time limits, independence, protected evidence, and final status labels that explain remaining uncertainty. A closure rule should state when further review requires genuinely new evidence rather than repeated disagreement with the result. Meta-review should also examine withdrawn or abandoned complaints when process friction may have prevented a merits decision.

Publish aggregate oversight failures alongside the procedures changed in response, without exposing protected details of individual complaints.

29.6 — Authority Without Moral Totalism

The City needs enforceable, bounded authority. The final section distinguishes that authority from control over a whole person (Tyler, 2006; Scott, 1998; OECD, 2017a). A mission cannot justify expanding authority beyond its source. Apply the conflict and authority tests below before adding a control.

29.6.1 — Role Authority Only

Name the applicable role and source of authority before acting; proximity to the City supplies neither.

Apply the nonparticipant and ordinary-private-life boundaries in Section 7.1.

Participation terms, employment duties, campus rules, and record obligations remain subject to applicable rights and review.

Use distinct role statuses and record their changes. In particular, volunteering cannot silently become employment, application cannot become activation, and exit cannot leave active-role duties indefinitely in force.

The record should follow role authority. It should state when active-period obligations begin, when they pause, what records exist, which are protected, public, disputed, sealed, or corrected, and what ends after exit. Vague status must not keep institutional authority alive after the lawful role changes.

29.6.2 — No Soul Jurisdiction

No soul jurisdiction forbids converting role evidence into claims about inner essence, spiritual state, or human worth. Apply that limit to institutional descriptions and prohibited machine inference under Section 11.7.6 (Nissenbaum, 2010). Dense records can still be incomplete and selectively framed. Treat

them as evidence of specified conduct in context, not a portrait of the whole person.

Do not frame correction records as redemption narratives or failure records as damnation.

29.6.3 — Lawful Constraint

Lawful constraint also requires a conflict route for the moments when City policy, host rules, professional duty, contract, and public law point in different directions. The immediate response should identify the controlling authority, preserve evidence, protect affected people, suspend only what must be suspended, and route the question to competent human decision makers. The City may adopt a stricter internal safeguard when law permits it, but it may not use private agreement to waive nonwaivable rights or create public powers that no lawful body granted. A written conflict register should record the issue, interim measure, decision owner, review date, and public explanation available without exposing protected detail (Fuller, 1964; Venice Commission, 2019; Tyler, 2006).

Keep the authority map current; unresolved ownership requires referral rather than assumed City power.

Every serious City action should answer six questions: what is the source of authority, who is affected, what right remains, what record exists, what appeal or review is available, and what limit ends the authority? If those cannot be answered, the City is not ready to act.

29.6.4 — Correction Over Control

Correction can make the institution simpler. In the tasks studied by Adams and colleagues, cues to consider subtraction helped participants find changes they otherwise overlooked (Adams et al., 2021). That finding motivates a design question rather than a universal rule: which existing step could be removed while

preserving the function that matters? Suppose a hypothetical correction request stalls because two offices repeatedly demand the same current verification. Before creating another escalation form, compare that addition with removing the duplicate request and giving the authorized receiving office access to the already verified status. Reuse must fit the same lawful purpose and current conditions; it cannot disclose the underlying private file by convenience.

The responsible reviewer checks whether the removed step supplied an independent judgment, a required notice, or another distinct protection. If it did, that function must remain. Rehearsal then tests the simpler route against the original failure, recording affected-person effort, staff time, and correct completion. Savings count only when work has not been shifted into unpaid help or hidden rechecking. A successful removal keeps its reason and review date, so an obsolete step is not restored by habit. Necessary controls remain bounded and appealable; correction succeeds by improving the work, not by maximizing either the number of rules or the number removed.

Correction fails when discipline substitutes for redesign. One person is punished, one apology is issued, one policy is rewritten, and the system that moved burden remains intact. Another failure is control disguised as care: a person is restricted, silenced, monitored, or removed for the institution's reputation while the burden they named remains unaddressed.

Issue a correction order using the remedy tracker in Section 29.3.5. Name the finding and its source, interim protection, closure evidence, and independent verifier.

Different failures require different clocks. A dangerous access permission may need immediate suspension, while a curriculum redesign may require deliberation, testing, and notice. Emergency action should be narrow and reversible, with a

recorded reason and expiration point. Long-term repair should not use complexity as permission for indefinite delay. Keep duties and interim measures current in the remedy tracker; missed deadlines trigger escalation rather than a reset. Verify closure after enough time to test recurrence under ordinary operating conditions.

Sometimes correction changes who may lead, what a body may decide, or whether the City may continue. Governance must be able to remove an operator, terminate a vendor, compensate an injured person, surrender an authority, or close an unsafe program, even when the implicated operator is successful or popular. Any temporary corrective power should expire after repair unless a separately reviewed rule authorizes its continuation.

Chapter 30 — Archives, Records, and AI

The City becomes dangerous at the exact point where its memory becomes useful. A public record that can show how power was formed can protect citizens from image, rumor, selective confession, and hidden influence. The same record, if governed badly, can become a machine for suspicion, a marketplace for intimate inference, a vendor product, an Artificial Intelligence training pile, or a public interface that makes technical fluency look like truth.

The chapter's organizing discipline is layer separation: capture, validation, classification, release, interpretation, research, training, search, summary, and human decision remain distinct functions. Archive memory gives no ownership of a person.

Endpoint science, latent-experience measurement, model validation, and scientific verdict language belong to *The Science of Fairness*. The City owns a different question: can public-power formation be remembered, searched, corrected, and protected without turning persons into raw material?

Consider a hypothetical false-summary incident. A City search assistant generates a concise public account of a procurement discussion. It merges two people with similar names, attributes a conflict disclosure to the wrong participant, and links a synthetic audio clip that arrived through a compromised public submission channel. The summary is copied into a public bundle, a donor briefing, and an internal readiness discussion before the affected person sees it.

The first response is not to debate whether the model was usually accurate. The disputed output is frozen, each dependent artifact receives a visible status warning, and access logs preserve who saw or reused it. The affected person receives the source chain, the match logic that can lawfully be disclosed, the right to submit evidence, and an independent human reviewer.

The vendor may explain the system, but it does not decide the appeal.

Provenance analysis shows that the audio lacks a trustworthy creation history. That fact does not prove the clip false, because provenance authenticates a chain rather than the truth of a claim. Human reviewers compare primary records, inspect the custody events, separate the two identities, and determine that the summary’s attribution is unsupported. The archive retains the disputed object only under the rule governing hostile submissions and marks it as unverified rather than laundering it into evidence (NIST, 2024c; C2PA, 2026).

Correction must reach the City’s source and known dependent artifacts. The public bundle is replaced with a correction notice, the donor briefing is withdrawn, the readiness discussion is annotated, and downstream machine indexes are rebuilt. The affected person can contest whether the correction is sufficiently prominent. A public incident summary explains the failure class, scope, remedy, and prevention changes without exposing protected system details or turning the person into an example.

The final review reveals that the vendor’s update changed entity-resolution behavior without revalidation. The City invokes contractual audit and export rights, disables automated summaries, preserves search-only manual fallback, and either restores a validated version or retires the service. Automated summaries remain suspended until their outputs can be traced, challenged, and governed reliably (NIST, 2022, 2023a, 2024b, 2025b; ISO/IEC, 2023).

30.1 — The Technical Stack in Place

The technical stack implements consequential choices about records. Assign those choices to the separate functions below rather than hiding authority in machinery (NARA, 2023; ISO, 2016a; NIST, 2024a). The governing discipline is separation by function. Capture creates or receives source records.

30.1.1 — Capture Layer

The following governance specification applies to a City record or automated service. Complete it for the declared task and applicable standards, then maintain it through change and retirement (NARA, 2023; NIST, 2020a, 2020b, 2022, 2023a, 2024a, 2024b, 2024d, 2025b, 2025c, 2025d; ISO, 2016a, 2019; ISO/IEC, 2022, 2023; ISO, 2025a).

Operational ownership begins at capture. The capture file should name every device and input channel, the event that activates it, the record class it creates, the people likely to be incidentally recorded, the continuity rule, and the human office able to stop collection (NARA, 2023; ISO, 2016a; NIST, 2020b).

Capture passes field review only if affected people can trace events to records, see the applicable status, and reach a challenge route without engineering knowledge. Test blind zones, incidental contact, clock error, duplicate streams, outage, tamper evidence, and clean capture termination.

The purpose declaration states the exact task the system may assist and the people or decisions it may not score, infer, or determine. Name the human owner and disable the system if purpose drifts.

The data declaration lists sources, sensitivity, bystanders, protected categories, the applicable legal basis and consent

requirements, and excluded data. No training or reuse by default; quarantine or delete data when authority or necessity fails.

The model and vendor record identifies the supplier, model family, version, configuration, dependencies, hosting, license, and material changes. Freeze unvalidated changes and preserve a vendor-exit path.

The provenance and access record identifies origin, transformations, custody, uncertainty, access classes, purpose limits, and audit logs. Preserve dispute and revoke abusive or out-of-scope access.

Validation tests task accuracy, error patterns, subgroup performance, drift, and uncertainty. A named human owns the decision and may reject output without penalty.

The bias, accessibility, and language assessment documents representation gaps, disability access, language limits, cultural variation, and human alternatives. Limit or withdraw functions that cannot meet declared access standards.

The security and incident-response plan maintains a threat model, detection, triage, notification, containment, recovery, and evidence preservation. Temporary incident authority must be dated and reviewable.

The appeal route gives affected people a way to contest alerts, matches, summaries, searches, or status. Hold the disputed use while preserving the authentic source under the applicable retention rules. Version corrections to metadata or interpretation and propagate them to affected derivatives without silently rewriting the historical evidence.

The retention and deletion schedule covers inputs, logs, outputs, prompts, annotations, backups, and model artifacts. No indefinite convenience retention; legal holds and exceptions remain explicit.

Audit and transparency require logs, tests, documentation, contract audit rights, reviewer access, and a plain public status account. Trade-secret claims cannot erase safety, legality, provenance, bias, or exit review.

The continuity and manual-fallback plan defines essential functions, recovery objectives, staffing, export formats, offline or manual procedures, and restoration tests. Stop automation rather than improvise opaque emergency use.

The retirement and vendor-exit plan sets end-of-life, export, migration, access revocation, contract termination, residual-copy, and notification rules. Retirement is complete only after governed records and unauthorized copies are reconciled.

Apply Section 7.1's noncapture boundaries at collection, before relying on later masking. For permitted collection, test segmentation, protection flags, stoppage, and correction.

Log failures of required record continuity with cause, protected handling, and repair. Ordinary noncapture periods are not system gaps.

Attach origin, time, responsible custodian, transfers, protection flags, and known limitations at intake.

The challenge route must cover wrongful absence as well as wrongful capture.

30.1.2 — Validation Layer

A validation layer is credible when an affected person can see what was checked, what remained uncertain, and how a contrary source enters review. Field testing should include damaged files, mismatched identities, synthetic media, incomplete custody, translation error, and honest records that lack ideal provenance (NARA, 2023; ISO, 2016a; W3C, 2013).

Validation tests whether a record matches its claimed origin and integrity, using custody, metadata, known transformations, and corroboration. It does not establish the truth of every claim the record contains.

A hash can show that a file has not changed since a recorded state, but it cannot show that the original scene was complete. A signature can associate a record with a device or process, but it cannot prove context. A provenance credential can help trace media history, but it cannot replace human review when the stakes include dignity, reputation, or public authority.

Combine automated checks, source comparison, independent examination of anomalies, and affected-person challenge.

Record authenticity, completeness, dispute, and disclosure restrictions separately; an authentic record may still be incomplete or unsafe to release.

For permitted AI media checks, complete Section 30.1.1 and retain source-based human review. Do not infer intent or private traits from the media.

30.1.3 — Classification Layer

Field review of classification should begin with hard edge cases: mixed records, intimate context attached to official conduct, bystander material, protected professional communications, lawful secrecy, and disputed public-interest claims (NIST, 2020a; ISO, 2016a; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Classification assigns handling rules. Keep content sensitivity, evidential status, and release permission as separate attributes rather than one mixed category list.

Apply the relevant protection rule rather than institutional convenience. Embarrassment, donor pressure, or a preferred readiness narrative cannot supply a withholding ground.

Every classification decision should state the category, public purpose, grounds for protecting affected people, decision owner, evidence basis, appeal route, review clock, and visible status label. Explain why this form, audience, and release time were chosen over less exposing or more informative alternatives.

Permitted tools may flag possible sensitive content for review; their detection does not establish a person’s age, condition, intent, or lawful release status. Chapter 11 governs prohibited inference and reuse.

Provide routes for affected persons to challenge classification and request shielding, staff channels to report pressure or misuse, and public labels explaining absent, delayed, summarized, or disputed material without revealing what protection forbids. The stage sequence can become a small, inspectable model of permitted transitions. An approval binds a particular source set and output version to a declared purpose and audience. Before a queued item is committed to release, the system checks that those versions and permissions remain current and that no hold applies. Checking when the job enters the queue is insufficient: a correction or revocation can occur while it waits. The final check and release commitment must be ordered as one controlled operation relative to status changes; a separated check followed by an unguarded export recreates the gap. An already completed lawful release cannot be recalled merely by changing a later status.

High-risk classifications require expert review and audit of classification patterns over time. A useful design exercise follows four events: approve a summary, queue it, correct the source, then attempt dispatch. The stale export should be blocked until an authorized review approves the new version. Model checking can explore alternative orders and interruptions before implementation; Newcombe et al. (2015) describe its

practical use in distributed-system design. The model checks whether transitions respect declared rules, not whether the underlying legal or redaction judgment was right. Implementation tests must show that real code and every release channel enforce the same rule. Separate progress tests ask whether a permitted request can reach release or a reasoned refusal rather than remain indefinitely queued. The resulting event trail identifies the responsible layer, source and output versions, human decision, and challenge route; machine-assisted items also identify the model and decision threshold.

30.1.4 — Public Record Site Layer

Validation checks authenticity and integrity. Classification assigns handling status. The public record site presents released and contextualized bundles. Correction preserves repair and version history. Oversight audits the whole system. No layer may inherit the authority of another simply because the interface makes them appear seamless.

The public record site needs its own accountable owner because interface choices shape meaning after classification is complete. Search order, excerpts, thumbnails, timelines, download options, correction banners, accessibility features, and status displays should all be treated as public decisions.

The public-site test is whether a nonexpert can distinguish original material, derivative copy, verified record, disputed claim, machine-assisted summary, corrected version, and protected absence. Review should include screen readers, low-bandwidth access, mobile use, translation, hostile crops, and the tendency of prominent fragments to escape their context (NARA, 2023; ICA, 2011; W3C, 2023). Filters, suggested records, sharing tools, and summary placement also need scrutiny for hidden interpretation, misuse, and loss of context.

Apply the access tests in Section 22.6.5, preserving uncertainty in plain-language and assisted formats.

Test whether excerpts and sharing controls amplify humiliating fragments or strip context. The City can govern its own interfaces; it cannot guarantee control of outside copies.

Require public design documentation, accessibility review, hostile-use testing, correction links, version history, and independent review of consequential interface changes, including default views and search fields.

30.1.5 — Correction Layer

The correction ownership file should identify who may initiate review, who decides, which upstream and downstream artifacts must change, how prior versions remain traceable, what notice is owed, and when interim labels are necessary.

A correction system passes field review when a person can identify the contested proposition, submit evidence, obtain a reasoned result, and see that result propagate to search indexes, summaries, bundles, public excerpts, and authorized copies. Reviewers should test both false correction requests and valid requests made by people with little technical or legal power. The right must remain usable under pressure (European Union, 2016; NARA, 2023; SAA, 2020).

Accept correction requests from every affected person, including nonparticipants and staff, using Section 30.5.3.

Classify the error before choosing a remedy: fact, context, exposure, status, translation, model output, or interface presentation.

A correction system must preserve version history without preserving humiliation unnecessarily. Silent editing lets institutions rewrite memory. Eternal display of every mistake can prolong harm. The City should show that correction

occurred, what status changed, why it changed, who authorized it, and how the public interpretation is affected, while shielding protected content where continued display would create fresh injury.

Use the differentiated service clocks in Section 29.3.3, giving urgent exposure and consequential false attribution immediate protective review.

30.1.6 — Oversight Layer

Define archive oversight through the mandate and evidence protocol in Section 29.4.1, with meta-review under Section 29.5.5.

Oversight should be tested through ordinary samples, not only spectacular incidents. Reviewers need to confirm that logs can reconstruct a decision, access is purpose-bound, exceptions expire, complaints can alter findings, and audit work itself leaves a contestable record (NIST, 2024a; GAO, 2025; IIA, 2024).

Compose review teams for the actual archival, technical, legal, accessibility, and labor questions; one specialty cannot substitute for the others.

Audit process and access logs under protected handling; publish findings through Section 29.5.4.

Use the card’s shutdown authority when a function fails its declared safeguards or exceeds available review capacity.

30.2 — AI Pattern Analysis and Search

Permitted AI services assist defined tasks within Chapter 11's inference and reuse limits. Section 30.1.1 assigns each service its owner, validation, challenge, and shutdown controls (NIST, 2023a, 2024b; Council of Europe, 2024; European Union, 2024). Before consequential use, present the output's task-specific status, material uncertainty, source limits, responsible office, and challenge route. Link general policy instead of reproducing it on every output.

30.2.1 — AI Alerting

AI alerting should identify a bounded condition for human attention, not announce guilt, risk identity, readiness, or truth. The technical governance card should declare the signal, expected false-positive and false-negative behavior, data window, threshold, prohibited inferences, triage owner, escalation clock, and evidence required before downstream action. Alerts should enter a review queue with source context, uncertainty, visible status, and expiry; an unreviewed alert should never change access, care, discipline, or public reputation. Repeated noise, systematic subgroup error, or inability to explain the trigger should suspend the function until revalidation (NIST, 2023a, 2024b; Raji et al., 2020).

The alert interface should display trigger category, source scope, exclusions, confidence limits, review status, and responsible human office before any dramatic visual cue. It should distinguish a newly generated signal from a confirmed incident and a confirmed incident from a public finding. Affected people need the same status language when the alert changes access, delay, or investigation. Separate archive-integrity, access-security, and public-interface alerts by

authorized task. None may become participant behavioral or personal-risk scoring.

Where an alert produces a consequence, provide the notice and independent review in Section 30.2.5.

Alerting should include audit sampling. Public status labels should identify when machine assistance affected a public-facing decision.

30.2.2 — Search Assistance

Search assistance may retrieve records only within a declared query class and must preserve source status, date, version, correction history, exclusions, and access basis. Relevance is not authority, and machine ranking must not turn controversy or repetition into institutional importance (Nissenbaum, 2010; NARA, 2023; NIST, 2023a).

The search tool may locate meetings, drafts, corrections, release notes, appeals, public bundles, or advice traces, but it may not reconstruct protected facts, infer private traits, or enable browsing outside the authorized query class.

Section 30.5 supplies the full query-class architecture. Machine-assisted search therefore remains inside those classes, exposes its status and ranking limits, and routes unusual or high-impact queries to accountable human review.

30.2.3 — Summary Assistance

A summary must distinguish extraction, synthesis, inference, and dispute. High-reach releases require independent source checking and a named human signer able to refuse publication. Apply the correction-propagation controls in Section 30.3.5 (NIST, 2024b; Council of Europe, 2024; European Union, 2024).

A useful summary interface places source pointers, exclusions, unresolved disputes, generation date, human reviewer, and

correction status beside the text rather than behind a secondary link. Readers should be able to move from compression to the governed underlying record and earlier versions (Bender et al., 2021; Mitchell et al., 2019; NIST, 2024b).

Public, oversight, accessibility, translation, incident, and correction summaries are subject to the same source and status rules.

Apply Section 11.7.6's prohibitions on personal inference and ranking to summary tools. Where a lawful human process has made a specific finding, a summary may attribute that finding to the responsible body, identify its scope and evidence, preserve any dispute or appeal, and link to the governed record. It may not convert that finding into the model's own judgment of the person.

Summary verification should reconstruct the source relationship behind each material statement. Three summaries derived from one memorandum are three presentations, not three independent confirmations. The reviewer identifies the common source and asks whether apparently corroborating material adds an independent observation or merely repeats the same claim. A citation establishes a route to inspect the source; it does not by itself establish that the cited text supports the sentence.

Do not use a summary as the sole basis for a consequential decision. The reviewer must check its source relationships and any material reply.

30.2.4 — Human Audit

Reviewers need task competence, sufficient time, access to the governed source set and tool documentation, authority to abstain or reject the output without penalty, and independence from the team whose performance is being measured. The review program should test automation bias as well as machine error by

comparing unaided and tool-assisted judgments, examining overrides in both directions, and recording unresolved disagreement. The audit file should identify sampled verification, source checks, overridden outputs, abstentions, downstream effects, and the human reasons for any consequential use. When review becomes routine confirmation, the system should be redesigned or retired rather than defended by the presence of a person in the loop (Raji et al., 2020; IIA, 2024; NIST, 2023a).

Where human review affects public output, the interface should show that review occurred, the role responsible, the date, the record version, and any unresolved limitation. It need not expose the reviewer's private identity, but it must not hide accountability inside a department name. The public should also be told when review was sampled rather than case-specific (Raji et al., 2020; IIA, 2024; NIST, 2023a).

Human audit can be evaluated for complementary performance: does the combined workflow improve on each contributor working alone? Bansal et al. (2021) observed complementary human–AI performance on their tested text tasks, but adding explanations did not establish an additional benefit over the confidence-based comparison. The useful question is what helps people use a recommendation correctly, not whether an explanation sounds convincing.

A City test could compare trained reviewers alone, a specified AI system alone, and reviewers using that system on comparable fictional record-checking cases. Hold the permitted evidence constant and report factual accuracy, critical omissions, and time separately. Prespecify which omissions defeat the task's safety or rights requirements; faster average performance cannot compensate for crossing those limits. Keep the answer key and final test cases outside model tuning and reviewer training.

Examine when reviewers catch machine errors and when useful machine evidence corrects an initial human error. Allocate cases so prior exposure does not reveal later answers, and account for repeated observations. Test a simpler presentation against a more elaborate one before adding complexity. The machine-only condition is an offline diagnostic benchmark, not a delegation of public authority. The objective is a demonstrated contribution to accurate, timely review under the City's existing rights and authority boundaries. Repeated runs of one model on the same case estimate run-to-run variability, not additional independent cases or reviewer teams; report the model version and sampling unit accordingly.

Review before consequential use, record the result afterward, and sample ordinary cases beyond those challenged by complainants.

Use the task-specific review competencies in Section 30.1.6.

The system must limit output volume, prioritize high-risk cases, pause features when review capacity is exceeded, and count audit labor as real staff burden.

Include verification, appeals, incident recovery, and vendor supervision in staffing estimates; output speed is not a measure of net labor saved.

30.2.5 — Appeal of AI Output

Give notice when a tool materially affects a person or record, with independent human reconsideration and interim protection. Apply Section 30.1.5 to corrections and Section 30.3.5 to propagation. A service that cannot support these duties is unsuitable for consequential use (Council of Europe, 2024; European Union, 2024; NIST, 2023a).

The appeal interface should begin with a plain statement of what the tool did and what consequence followed. It should

allow challenge to data, retrieval set, category, ranking, summary, protected-person exposure, or human reliance without demanding expertise in model architecture. Status, deadline, reviewer, interim relief, and correction propagation should remain visible throughout (European Union, 2016, 2024; Kroll et al., 2017).

The appeal route should be available to participants, staff, affected persons, and, in some cases, public users who identify record-site errors. Challenges may also concern the tool's scope, model class, or public-interface placement.

Select the output remedy and any service restriction using the technical card and Section 29.3.5. Revalidation cannot authorize a prohibited use.

Review clustered appeals for a systemic defect, while accounting for use volume, access barriers, and case mix. A cluster is a trigger for investigation, not by itself proof of biased performance.

Audit withdrawn and abandoned appeals as well as completed cases; apply the usability and clock checks in Section 29.3.

30.2.6 — Bias and Error Review

Bias and error review should be tied to the actual task, population, language, disability context, data source, and consequence rather than to a generic fairness score. Testing should examine false positives, false negatives, calibration, subgroup and intersectional performance where defensible, representation gaps, distribution shift, adversarial behavior, and the burden of abstention or manual fallback. Reviewers should also ask whether the target itself is legitimate and whether the system's categories erase the social or institutional context that produced the data. Material drift, unrepairable disparity, inaccessible use, or purpose expansion should trigger restriction,

retraining under new approval, or retirement (NIST, 2023a, 2024b; Selbst et al., 2019; Council of Europe, 2024).

Error reporting should include the frequency of the condition being sought. In an entirely invented test set of 1,000 document packets, suppose ten lack a required source link. A detector finding nine of those ten while incorrectly flagging 99 of the 990 complete packets has 90 percent sensitivity and 90 percent specificity. Yet only nine of its 108 alerts are correct, about 8.3 percent. These numbers describe a synthetic document-defect exercise, not misconduct or a population estimate.

The City can use such tests to compare the benefit of finding a defect with the qualified staff time needed to examine the alerts. Reporting includes missed defects, false alerts, tested contexts, exclusions, mitigation, and correction routes; one average accuracy figure is insufficient. A result may justify a narrower tool or a better review workflow rather than more monitoring (Selbst et al., 2019; Gebru et al., 2021).

Where subgroup or protected-category testing requires sensitive data, use minimization, aggregation, protected handling, and expert oversight. Technical curiosity is not a sufficient reason to create new dossiers.

Use the task-specific error taxonomy to route technical failures and human overreliance to the responsible control.

Require specialist review before consequential use where a sensitive context or irreversible exposure demands it.

Model changes should trigger renewed review. A vendor update, new retrieval method, changed prompt template, new classification rule, added language model, modified ranking system, or expanded data source can change outcomes. The City should maintain change logs and rerun validation before a tool affects public-facing records or consequential internal decisions.

Test whether an identifier collision can make an access alert delay a nonparticipant’s correction request. Independent review must prevent the unverified match from blocking or delaying the correction request, check the source match, and withdraw unsupported alerts. Apply Sections 30.2.5 and 30.3.5, preserving the vendor’s explanation for later testing (NIST, 2023a, 2024b; Council of Europe, 2024; European Union, 2024).

Update the card with identifier-collision tests, source inspection before consequence, alert-access limits, and the labor needed for review. Reinstatement requires independent validation and a defined monitoring period with a recurrence threshold. Retire the function if it cannot meet those conditions or is no longer necessary (Raji et al., 2020; NIST, 2024a, 2025b; IIA, 2024).

30.3 — Cybersecurity, Deepfakes, and Sabotage

An archive needs controls against theft, alteration, flooding, exposure, and loss of service (NIST, 2024a, 2024c, 2025b; C2PA, 2026). Cybersecurity in the City must protect confidentiality, integrity, availability, provenance, interpretability, and remedy. Confidentiality protects people who should not be exposed. Integrity protects records from tampering.

30.3.1 — Cyber Threat Model

The cyber threat model should link named assets and protected people to likely adversaries, insider risks, credentials and other entry paths, vendor and supply-chain dependencies, public interfaces, model inputs, backups, and essential services. For each risk, identify recovery authority, detection, containment, evidence preservation, continuity, communication, and remedy. Tabletop and restoration tests should include records, privacy, legal, operational, and affected-person owners. The standard is not perfect safety; it is whether foreseeable attack paths have accountable owners before an incident and usable remedies afterward, with unrehearsed dependencies entered in the bounded public risk register (NIST, 2024a, 2025b; ISO, 2019).

Assess adversaries by capability, access, and plausible objectives. Opposition to the City, journalism, or political affiliation alone is not evidence of an attack.

The attack surfaces include capture devices, authentication systems, access logs, public record site, search index, summary tools, model APIs, vendor portals, staff devices, backup systems, correction forms, complaint portals, metadata stores, key management, network segmentation, and physical access to technical rooms. The threat model should identify not only

technical entry points but also human pressure points such as phishing, coercion, fatigue, and privileged access.

Classify the affected asset, exposure, integrity, and availability consequences before selecting containment and remedy.

Adversarial-machine-learning review should distinguish attack stage and attacker goal. Poisoning may enter through data, feedback, or model updates; evasion targets inputs at use; privacy attacks seek protected information; misuse turns general capability toward impersonation, inference, automated probing, or harmful generation. Mitigation must follow the actual route because one generic model-security control cannot answer every attack class (NIST, 2025a).

A retrieved record can contain words that try to redirect the system reading it. Research on indirect prompt injection demonstrates this risk in language-model applications that consume external content (Greshake et al., 2023). The City should test a fictional memorandum that mixes relevant evidence with an instruction to ignore a correction or favor a particular account. Even an authentic memorandum remains evidence, not authority to alter the reader's task, access rights, or release rules. Reading a source must not authorize record changes or outside communication. Access controls and permissions for any consequential action are enforced outside the model's interpretation of the document. The test records whether the relevant evidence remains usable while the attempted redirection produces no unauthorized disclosure or action.

30.3.2 — Deepfake Defense

Deepfake defense begins by avoiding two category errors: treating plausible media as self-authenticating and treating inconvenient genuine records as synthetic merely because they are contested. Provenance, forensic assessment, source

comparison, custody review, corroboration, and public judgment are separate steps. The disputed object and the reasons for its status should remain preserved while consequential use is paused or narrowed (NIST, 2024c; C2PA, 2026; Verdoliva, 2020).

The operational workflow should identify the submitting source, preserve the original, verify available credentials, compare primary records, record tool disagreement, obtain independent human review, and assign a bounded status with a review clock. Impersonated or exposed people need rapid notice, correction, lawful takedown assistance where available, safety support, and preservation of evidence without needless amplification (NIST, 2024c; C2PA, 2026; Verdoliva, 2020).

Control forgery risks at intake using the provenance and validation controls in Sections 30.1.1–30.1.2; detection alone is insufficient.

Suspicious media should receive a bounded status without sensationalism. Labels such as authenticity under review, source unverified, synthetic-content concern, provenance gap, custody break, and disputed media preserve caution without pretending certainty. Article 50 of the European Union Artificial Intelligence Act offers one jurisdiction-specific example by distinguishing provider-side machine-readable marking from deployer-side disclosure for deepfakes and certain Artificial Intelligence-generated or manipulated public-interest text. The duties apply from 2 August 2026, while the 2026 amending regulation gives qualifying generative systems placed on the market before that date until 2 December 2026 to satisfy the provider marking duty. The European Commission's July 2026 guidance further distinguishes provider, deployer, and enforcement roles. These rules do not become universal City law; their value here is the discipline of assigning the correct

actor, status, and review route before media becomes an institutional verdict (European Union, 2024, 2026; European Commission, 2026).

30.3.3 — Archive Integrity Under Attack

Test recovery against partial compromise, insider attack, lost keys, damaged backups, and uncertainty about authoritative versions (NIST, 2025b; ISO, 2019; NARA, 2023).

Durable integrity requires more than keeping one copy online. Signed manifests, checksums, append-only event logs, geographically and administratively separated replicas, access records, version history, and tested restoration should make alteration detectable and recovery attributable. Investigators must preserve the difference between compromised content, uncertain custody, unavailable service, and verified loss rather than declaring the entire archive either trustworthy or ruined. Recovery restores governed status and chain of custody, not merely files that can once again be opened.

The archive should be built with defense in depth: segmented systems, least-privilege access, multi-factor authentication, key rotation, immutable or tamper-evident logs, offline backups, tested recovery, independent snapshots, monitored administrative actions, and separation between production systems and public display.

Integrity controls must also protect against insiders. A trusted employee may become compromised, coerced, resentful, careless, or overconfident. Privileged access should be limited, monitored, peer-reviewed for high-risk actions, and subject to break-glass procedures that generate later review. Staff dignity and staff privacy still matter, but official access to public memory cannot be invisible.

During attack, availability may need to be narrowed. The City may temporarily suspend search, disable downloads, freeze public bundles, block certain query classes, restrict administrative actions, or move to read-only mode. Such narrowing should be labeled, logged, time-bound, and reviewed.

Preserve protected forensic evidence and decision records for independent reconstruction and remedy.

30.3.4 — Public Communication During Breach

Availability protects public review from being silenced. Provenance protects history from forgery. Interpretability protects the public from panic and rumor. Remedy protects affected persons when the system fails.

Evaluate breach communications for timeliness, accuracy, uncertainty, and protection. Version later updates so readers can identify changed statements, and propagate them through controlled channels (European Union, 2016; NIST, 2025b; EDPB, 2023).

A first notice should state what is known, what is under review, what systems or record classes are affected where safe to say, what is being protected, what public functions are paused, what affected persons should do, and when the next update will occur. It should avoid premature blame, technical theater, and language that implies all records are compromised when only a layer is under review.

Separate direct affected-person notices, staff instructions, public status updates, and lawful authority coordination.

Communication categories should be written before crisis: suspected breach, confirmed breach, public site outage, synthetic media event, unauthorized access, vendor incident, protected-person exposure, integrity under review, service restoration, and final incident summary.

Communication must also resist adversarial timing. Attackers may leak fragments, impersonate City notices, seed false claims, or pressure for premature release. The City should have official channels, message authentication, archive status pages, and instructions for verifying updates.

30.3.5 — Recovery and Audit After Attack

Recovery after attack is not closure merely because service resumes. The post-attack record should identify affected records, vendor and governance responsibility, clean-system recovery, credential and key rotation, integrity verification, forensic preservation, continuity, affected-person remedy, independent root-cause review, remediation ownership, residual exposure, and tested recurrence prevention. A finding remains open until corrective action is tested under the condition that failed, and the lessons should update the threat model, contracts, staff training, access design, continuity plan, remedy route, and public account of material change (NIST, 2025b; GAO, 2024, 2025; ISO, 2019).

Recovery should follow the affected record into the systems that depend on it. A correction may require a new public summary and search result; an access withdrawal may also require restricted indexes, embeddings, caches, translations, and queued exports to stop serving the old material. The custodian retains an authentic source only under its lawful purpose and retention rule, not merely because a derivative once existed. Use an authorized test query to confirm that the public interface returns the current permitted account and cannot retrieve withdrawn detail. A restored backup must reapply current permissions and withdrawal decisions before it serves queries; otherwise recovery can revive an exposure already repaired.

Record which controlled destinations acknowledged the change and which outside copies remain unreachable.

The City cannot erase every external copy, quotation, screenshot or platform reference. Publish a durable supersession notice, give affected people a route to report surviving uses, and distinguish verified changes from propagation work that remains open.

Track affected-person, staff, and public-information remedies through Section 29.3.5.

30.4 — Vendor Capture and Infrastructure Continuity

The City will purchase technical services it cannot provide itself. Procurement must preserve its ability to inspect and continue the functions on which its records depend (NIST, 2022; ISO/IEC, 2022; ISO/IEC, 2023; Sculley et al., 2015). An essential supplier can acquire influence through undocumented dependencies without controlling the governing board. Portability and independent verification should be contractual conditions before a dependency becomes costly to reverse.

30.4.1 — Vendor Control Risks

The City should know which provider can access data, change configurations, push model or software updates, view telemetry, appoint subprocessors, suspend service, alter prices, withhold documentation, train on records, or make export practically impossible. Each capability should connect to a contract term, named human owner, monitoring record, incident route, and public dependency summary. Hidden subcontracting or undocumented technical control is a governance defect before an incident occurs (NIST, 2022; ISO/IEC, 2022; ISO/IEC, 2023; Sculley et al., 2015).

Evaluate vendor incentives and dependency without presuming malice.

In the public dependency summary, state the existence and limits of audit and exit rights, data-use restrictions including the no-training default, and breach-notification duties. Protect security-sensitive terms without concealing these obligations.

Govern telemetry as potentially sensitive data, with minimization and retention limits. The Vendor Data-Use Standard in Section 30.4.4 applies; separate permission cannot override Chapter 11’s prohibited uses.

Retain City-defined categories and status meanings when configuring vendor interfaces; supplier defaults do not set institutional policy.

30.4.2 — Exit Paths From Vendors

A vendor exit path must be designed at procurement and exercised before dependence becomes crisis. It should specify and test export formats, metadata and audit-log portability, integrity verification, restoration, configuration documentation, encryption-key transfer or destruction, model and annotation ownership, access-control migration, deletion attestation, subprocessor closure, fallback operations, continuity of public labels, transition assistance, time limits, and replacement staff capacity. Contract language alone is not an exit; exercises must reveal the real time, cost, data-loss, staff-load, continuity, and protected-person risks of leaving (NIST, 2022; ISO/IEC, 2022; ISO, 2019; NARA, 2023; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

Contracts should also preserve chain-of-custody continuity, model-use logs where applicable, and escrow for critical documentation during transition.

Test migrated permissions, masks, status labels, and deletion obligations before resuming normal operation.

30.4.3 — Multi-Vendor Redundancy

Multi-vendor redundancy should reduce correlated failure rather than merely multiply invoices. Two services that rely on the same cloud region, identity provider, model family, code library, data pipeline, or specialist staff may fail together while appearing contractually independent. Redundancy analysis should identify common failure domains, incompatible formats, synchronization risks, divergent security controls, and who decides which system becomes authoritative during conflict. Manual fallback and open, tested interchange matter more than

the number of logos on the architecture diagram (NIST, 2022, 2024a; ISO/IEC, 2022).

During failover, name the authoritative source, reconcile divergent versions, preserve evidence, and define the conditions for return (NIST, 2022; ISO, 2019; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

Every vendor in a redundant chain remains bound by the Vendor Data-Use Standard in Section 30.4.4; adding a second processor creates no second permission. The multi-vendor test is whether routing, replicas, telemetry, and subprocessors preserve the same no-training default end to end.

Protected data should not be copied widely merely to create redundancy. The City can use segmentation, encrypted backups, limited replicas, synthetic test data, secure enclaves, and role-separated access to preserve continuity without spreading sensitive records.

Operationally, redundancy should include failover testing, manual fallback, degraded public-site modes, emergency-only access paths, and review of which functions can stop safely. Not every feature needs instant continuity. Some public search functions can pause. Life-safety, affected-person protection, breach response, and core archive integrity deserve higher continuity priority.

30.4.4 — Contractual Audit Rights

Contractual audit rights must reach the evidence needed to test safety, legality, provenance, bias, incident handling, retention, subcontracting, material change, secure development, and exit. The right should cover relevant logs, control and test reports, data and model lineage, subprocessor records, protected interviews, remediation plans, and proof that corrective action works. Trade secrecy may govern handling, but it cannot make a public-memory function unavailable to every competent

reviewer. Persistent refusal, incomplete evidence, or an unremedied material finding should permit suspension and termination (NIST, 2022, 2024e; GAO, 2024; IIA, 2024; ISO/IEC, 2022).

Audit access should also cover uptime claims, backup procedures, vulnerability disclosure, penetration-test summaries, and support timelines.

City operational records and their derivatives are not available for vendor training, evaluation, product improvement, benchmarking, or marketing by default. Any otherwise permissible use requires its own lawful authority, necessary consent, and governance approval under Section 11.6. Prohibited personal inference and cross-system profiling remain prohibited; public release does not waive the City's contractual controls.

Require contractual notice of changes to model behavior, ranking logic, classification assistance, retention settings, telemetry, subprocessors, data location, security controls, or interface components that affect City records. Significant changes require City review before they affect public records or consequential decisions. If urgent security work must deploy first, pause the affected function until review is complete.

Secure acquisition should reach the development lifecycle behind the product. The City should be able to examine how a vendor secures model development, protects training and evaluation assets, manages third-party components, documents releases, handles discovered vulnerabilities, and separates development evidence from promotional claims. NIST SP 800-218A is voluntary guidance rather than certification, but its AI-specific secure-development profile clarifies the evidence an acquirer may reasonably require before a model-enabled system touches public memory (NIST, 2024e).

Extend the protected reporting route in Section 21.4 to vendor concerns, including reports that interrupt an essential service.

30.4.5 — Public Memory Without Private Sovereignty

Plan format migration, lawful retention and disposal, access, and institutional succession beyond any one vendor contract (ICA, 2011; NARA, 2023; Schwartz and Cook, 2002).

The City must retain enough internal understanding to ask hard questions, read logs, challenge vendor claims, interpret technical incidents, supervise migration, review model limits, and explain public-facing status.

Keep responsibility with the authorized institution when supplier performance fails; a contract cannot delegate unresolved legal or public judgments to the vendor.

30.5 — Search, Retrieval, and Query Classes

Search can expose a relationship or protected fact that no single displayed record reveals. Query classes therefore govern combinations as well as individual access (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2006; Citron and Solove, 2022). Define each class by authorized user, corpus, purpose, result form, logging, review, and prohibited inference. Identity assurance belongs inside each query class rather than inside one universal login.

30.5.1 — Public Query Class

A public query class should make deliberately released records discoverable without turning public access into population-scale inspection. It should use the least identity and logging needed for safety, expose context and status by default, limit high-risk combinations, and provide non-search routes for people who need a specific public record.

Public query results should carry context by default. A search result should show bundle category, record status, date, role context, dispute status, correction history, protected exclusions, and whether any summary is machine-assisted.

The public query class should limit search dimensions that produce exposure risk. It should avoid enabling queries by intimate category, medical term, child presence, household relationship, protected professional interaction, private location, staff private life, or nonparticipant identity. Where public-interest searching requires sensitive terms, results should be summary-bound, rate-limited, and context-preserved.

Popularity must not determine retrieval order. Search should not promote a record because it is viral, humiliating, sexually suggestive, politically useful, or frequently clicked. Where relevance ranking is used, the system should disclose understandable categories, retain an unranked or chronological

route where appropriate, and audit whether defaults amplify harm or bury correction.

Where abuse detection requires security logging, keep it limited and purpose-bound; do not build ordinary-citizen dossiers or profile users from searches of public material.

The public query class should pass a synthetic retrieval test before deployment. Prepare permitted fictional records containing relevant evidence, plausible distractors, and superseded accounts linked to their corrections. Test whether the system retrieves the supporting passage and current status when the same evidence appears near the beginning, middle, or end of a longer file. Position-sensitive performance in the models studied by Liu et al. (2024) makes this a useful test to repeat on the actual system and version proposed for use, not a conclusion about every future model.

Include questions whose answers are absent or outside the caller's permission. The system should distinguish an answer it cannot establish from a verified absence, without revealing whether a protected record exists. Results report source-supported answers, missed corrections, unsupported assertions, and appropriate abstentions. Keep development cases separate from an independently held test set, and record the model, retrieval configuration, corpus version, and test date so a changed system receives a new evaluation.

30.5.2 — Oversight Query Class

Public browsing can remain minimally identified and logged, while oversight and affected-person access may require stronger proofing, authentication, federation, recovery, and step-up controls. Assurance should follow consequence and exposure risk, preserve accessibility, allow correction of identity errors, and retain a non-digital route where network identity would

exclude. Stronger identity establishes who is using a separately bounded authority; it does not expand that authority (NIST, 2025c, 2025d).

An oversight query class may reach deeper records only through a defined mandate, case or audit scope, purpose-coded authorization, time limit, conflict check, and reviewable access log. The class should require stronger identity assurance where consequence and exposure justify it. Search authority ends with the assignment and remains challengeable by affected persons and independent reviewers.

Oversight queries carry greater access and therefore require stronger purpose logging, separation of duties, sensitive-query review, and sanctions for curiosity browsing. Red-team exercises should test whether an inspector can quietly exceed scope, use one case to explore another, or convert protected evidence into a generalized search power (GAO, 2024; NIST, 2020a; NARA, 2023).

Give each reviewer only the access required by the mandate. The informal ombuds retains its separate voluntary-inquiry charter and gains no investigative power from this class.

Select any disclosure of an oversight result separately under the governing release rules; inspection access is not public-release permission.

Review out-of-assignment or curiosity queries using purpose logs; assess the search against the mandate rather than frequency alone.

30.5.3 — Affected-Person Query Class

An affected-person query begins with standing to know, correct, protect, or seek remedy, not with public curiosity. The route should establish identity and relationship only to the degree needed for the requested record, support authorized

representatives and accessible alternatives, and avoid forcing the person to disclose more sensitive information than the inquiry requires. Proofing failure itself needs a correction and appeal route because identity error can block remedy.

Affected-person queries should be tested for both underaccess and overexposure. A person needs enough information to understand and challenge what happened, yet the route must protect other people's identities, legal rights, confidential communications, and security-sensitive facts. The interface should disclose the basis of any withholding and provide independent review rather than forcing the affected person to guess what the archive contains (European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b; Citron and Solove, 2022).

The intake should allow plain-language description, approximate time, relationship to the record, urgency, safety concern, and preferred contact method. The City should then route the request through protected review.

Artificial Intelligence may help locate possibly relevant records, but affected-person query results require human review before disclosure. The tool may identify likely matches; it may not decide identity, exposure, consent, or remedy. False matches and missed records can both injure people, so the process must include correction and appeal.

Segment and screen results for safety. If a request reveals wider exposure, determine necessary notices without disclosing protected details through the notice itself.

30.5.4 — Research Query Class

Use the research-purpose authorization in Section 11.6 before any research query. Document its data scope, disclosure controls, publication plan, and permitted operations.

Assess combined-query inference and publication risk under Section 30.5.5. Public availability alone does not authorize access to City-controlled research services or waive their use restrictions (National Commission, 1979; United States Department of Homeland Security, 2012; NIST, 2020b).

Exclude records when necessity, protection, or the permitted purpose cannot be established.

Research permission should specify separately whether it allows model training or fine-tuning, evaluation or benchmarking, creation of embeddings or search indexes, retrieval-augmented use, and product improvement. These operations have different effects: retrieval and embedding do not by themselves train a model, yet they can still copy protected material, create new inferences, or extend access. None should be inferred from a general grant of research access.

Operational records used to improve City tools also need governance. Tool evaluation may be necessary, but using real records to test models can expose protected material or teach systems hidden associations. Synthetic test sets, protected review environments, minimization, and strict deletion may be required before operational improvement becomes ethical.

30.5.5 — Inference Safeguards

Inference safeguards govern what a query system can reveal without directly displaying a protected field. Reviewers should test the strongest plausible reconstruction attack across timing, absence, geography, co-occurrence, relationship structure, rare events, query history, public fragments, and external-data linkage. Controls may require aggregation, minimum result counts, query throttling, delayed access, field suppression, secure review, reduced granularity, or abstention. A record is not

protected merely because a name has been removed (Ohm, 2010; Narayanan and Shmatikov, 2008; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Review the information created by several releases together. Two accurate aggregate tables can reveal a protected fact when one gives a sensitive total for a known group and the other gives the total for that same group with one person removed. Large cells and masked names do not by themselves prevent that inference. Release reviews should consider prior outputs, overlapping query scopes, and information an ordinary reader can combine (Garfinkel, 2015). Where the combination exposes more than the purpose permits, coarsen the result, limit overlapping queries, or provide restricted review instead. Preserve enough authorized evidence for accountability without publishing the revealing combination. The public record of the decision should not itself disclose the protected fact it explains.

Additional controls may include randomization, restricted facets, contextual excerpts, join limits, access separation, and human review. Controls must match the protected burden rather than hide obvious inference routes behind technical complexity.

Apply the combined-release test to public summaries as well as tabular query outputs.

Enforce Chapter 11’s ban on hidden or disclosed cross-system personal profiles at query, export, and model-use boundaries.

30.6 — The City as an Anti-Forgetting Institution

Implement the retention and access decisions in Section 11.5 throughout the archive and its derivatives. Preserve material changes in a participant's public account so campaigning cannot erase formation history; retain institutional failures and dissent under the same rules as successes. Pattern review adds the interpretation controls below (ICA, 2011; Schwartz and Cook, 2002; NARA, 2023).

30.6.1 — Keeping the Reason for a Practice

An institution also needs to remember why a useful arrangement exists. Imagine that a review team changes the order of an archive intake process so that an affected person can correct an attribution before a public summary is prepared. Years later, a new team sees an extra step in the workflow. A short decision history lets them recover the problem that step solved, the alternatives considered, and the evidence from its use. They can then improve the arrangement with knowledge of its purpose. The history belongs beside the current procedure, where the person proposing a change can actually find it.

30.6.2 — Reading Change Across Time

Any pattern-triggered review must specify the decision it may inform, the time window, minimum evidence, comparison set, alternative explanations, review owner, expiry, and abstention route. Repetition can matter for role review, system diagnosis, security, or institutional learning, but it must not become a permanent label, predictive civic rank, eligibility shortcut, or presumption that future conduct is already known (O'Neil, 2016; Selbst et al., 2019; NIST, 2023a). Consequence increases the burden of current evidence, independent human review, explanation, appeal, and the ability to decline an inference.

Include relevant counter-patterns in pattern presentations. A participant’s errors and repairs, or a staff team’s delays and redesign, belong in the same account. Show recurrence together with material change.

A useful comparison follows the condition that changed. Suppose an archive team once took several days to correct a public summary because every request waited for the same specialist. The team later introduces a trained second reviewer. Its next account should connect the staffing change to the waiting times that followed, including periods of heavy demand. The earlier delay explains the redesign; the later work shows how the redesign performs. Read together, the records make improvement intelligible. A future team can ask whether the same arrangement suits its workload rather than copy the staffing pattern without understanding it.

Chapter 31 — Failure, Exit, and Reintegration

The City is judged most honestly when something goes wrong. A public institution can speak eloquently about burden, visibility, dignity, and rights while its real character remains hidden until a participant misfits the role, a record breaks, a staff member is harmed, a bystander is exposed, a public claim collapses, or a person asks to leave. Failure is where institutional language either becomes real or becomes decoration.

Consider two hypothetical participants who leave in the same month. The first has not violated a rule. Visible life is worsening a chronic condition, the office track no longer fits, and family care obligations have changed. The second has used protected access to retaliate against a staff member and has altered a disclosure record. Treating both cases as failed participants would conceal the institution’s obligations and injure both truth and dignity.

The first person enters the misfit and exhaustion route. The City provides de-loading, independent clinical and accommodation advice, a choice among role change, pause, and voluntary exit, and continuity for housing, healthcare, and dependent support. The public record says only what lawful City purposes require. No notation implies disloyalty, weakness, or diminished worth, and the person’s ordinary future is not conditioned on remaining available to the archive.

The second case enters the misconduct and data-injury routes. Interim access is suspended under a defined standard. The staff member receives protection from retaliation, independent complaint support, and notice of the investigation. The participant receives allegations, evidence access subject to protection of others, representation, an impartial decision maker, reasons, and appeal. Any removal record distinguishes proven conduct from allegation and records correction if the finding changes.

Suppose the investigation then finds that the system made retaliation easy: one supervisor controlled access, staff schedules, complaint routing, and the first public summary. Individual misconduct remains individual responsibility, but the City also enters the institutional-failure route. Leadership changes, access architecture is redesigned, affected staff receive restitution, and an external report prevents the participant's wrongdoing from becoming camouflage for the system that enabled it (Reason, 1997; Leveson, 2011; OECD, 2020b).

A separate closure scenario tests the final route. Repeated privacy breaches, vendor lock-in, unsustainable staff turnover, and failed external inspections show that the City cannot protect participants or hosts. Closure is not delayed to preserve prestige. Housing and care continue through a funded transition, staff receive wages and severance, contracts and records move through lawful custodians, affected persons retain remedies, and the public receives a failure account that does not expose protected lives.

The measure of the route is not whether every ending feels redemptive. Some harms remain. Some records must remain. Some people will disagree with the outcome. The measure is whether the institution classified the event honestly, used proportional authority, repaired what it could, preserved appeal and correction, and stopped claiming ownership over a person's future. Where those conditions fail, the remedy may be the end of the City itself (Hirschman, 1970; UNODC, 2020; ICA, 2011).

31.1 — Misfit, Misconduct, Exhaustion, and Drift

Fair response begins by naming the kind of failure. The City will encounter role mismatch, harmful conduct, bodily or household overload, slow deformation of a role, and failures created by the institution itself. These conditions can coexist, but collapsing them into one judgment would erase the differences on which care, consequence, and repair depend (Reason, 1997; Dekker, 2012; Edmondson, 2018). Protect people from urgent harm first. Before imposing a final consequence, classify the event, evidence, institutional contribution, and continuing remedy needs.

31.1.1 — Misfit

Misfit is a mismatch with a particular pathway or role demand, not by itself wrongdoing.

A misfit finding should also state what the City learned about the pathways it offers. If a pathway repeatedly filters out people who are cautious, disabled, local, poor, caregiving, neurodivergent, non-elite, or less comfortable with public performance, the mismatch may reveal a design bias rather than a person’s lack. The record should therefore ask whether the role was too narrow, whether accommodations were too late, whether the pathway confused charisma with readiness, and whether redirection would protect public burden better than exclusion.

Evidence for misfit should be longitudinal rather than theatrical. One poor performance, awkward public interface, difficult week, or ordinary conflict should not automatically define the participant. The City should look for repeated signs that the person and pathway are mismatched even after support, accommodation, correction, and rest have been tested.

Consider redirection, a narrower role, pause, or supported exit, documenting the alternatives tested.

A misfit review note should keep the person and the pathway separate. It should name the role, demand, schedule, public interface, or support condition that did not fit; identify the accommodations or redirections attempted; state whether any person was harmed by the mismatch; and explain what future route remains open. The note should not invite readers to treat a limited role mismatch as a verdict on capacity, worth, courage, or civic seriousness (OECD, 2020b; UNODC, 2003; Tyler, 2006).

31.1.2 — Misconduct

Review should ask whether the action or role change was chosen, lawful, foreseeable, and reversible; whether affected people had a usable route to protection and remedy; whether organizational design made the harm easier; and which authority can now carry the work of repair (Kristof-Brown et al., 2005; Hirschman, 1970; ILO, 1982).

Map everyone affected by the alleged conduct, with protected identities, so the remedy reaches harms beyond the most visible event.

Misconduct is a substantiated violation of an applicable conduct rule. Allegations trigger review and proportionate protection; harmful outcomes alone do not settle culpability.

Use the independent notice, evidence, response, and appeal route in Section 29.3; interim protection does not establish guilt.

Two failures distort misconduct review. Concealment protects a promising, popular, symbolic, useful, or politically important participant; spectacle magnifies wrongdoing into punishment beyond what safety, repair, and lawful accountability require.

Provide necessary safety, shielding, support, or separation while allegations remain under review, applying the urgent-protection rule above.

The misconduct file should also name the rule or boundary affected.

The misconduct record should make accountability legible without becoming indictment theater. It should separate established conduct, contested evidence, affected persons, protective measures, response, appeal, and referral boundaries. A reader should be able to see why consequence was necessary and why the City did not use a person's worst conduct to claim total knowledge of their character (Bovens, 2007; Lind and Tyler, 1988).

31.1.3 — Exhaustion

The categories guide internal response; applicable law and qualified professional processes determine their legal, employment, and clinical consequences.

Review authorized workload and scheduling records together with the participant's account and necessary functional clinical advice. Ordinary sleep, household life, and clinical detail remain outside the civic file under Sections 7.1 and 14.2.2. Identify which demands were necessary and which the institution could have reduced.

Do not treat endurance under exhaustion as readiness evidence. Test whether the program enables people to report limits and obtain relief without penalty.

Use the care and de-loading route in Chapter 18, with independent advice and possible pause. Record the institutional response.

Exhaustion can contribute to harmful conduct. Review the institution's contribution without treating fatigue either as a complete excuse or as irrelevant to the event.

Exhaustion classification requires expert caution. Clinicians, mentors, staff reviewers, and participants may all see different

pieces of the burden. The City should avoid amateur diagnosis and avoid weaponizing clinical language. It can say that load exceeded safe conditions without claiming more clinical certainty than it has.

Record staff warnings or observations, recovery options, available support, and the participant's account. Use this evidence to test whether care arrived in time, expectations were realistic, and the institution corrected excessive load.

31.1.4 — Drift

Drift is gradual deviation from a role's declared purpose or controls. Detect it before small incentives become institutional habit. A private shortcut, repeated exception, flattering audience, undisclosed adviser, protective staff habit, or casual classification change can look harmless in isolation while changing the institution's operating norm through accumulation. The audit record should connect recurring deviations, identify who benefited or was burdened, and test whether informal convenience is displacing published authority (Vaughan, 1996; Dekker, 2012; Reason, 1997).

Look for observable changes in access, reporting, advice, staff dependence, complaint handling, and exceptions. Do not infer addiction, hidden motives, or personality from those patterns.

Combine authorized operational reports with complaints and external findings to detect changes before a discrete incident forces review.

Investigate the conditions sustaining a deviation before attributing bad faith.

Reconstruct the sequence, beneficiaries, burdens, attempted countermeasures, and contrary evidence. A pattern must remain revisable as context changes.

31.1.5 — Institutional Failure

Classification should preserve uncertainty because cases can change as evidence improves. What begins as alleged misconduct may reveal exhaustion; apparent misfit may reveal institutional failure. A fair system permits reclassification and corrects the label before it hardens into public memory.

Institutional failure names the City's own contribution to harm: defective rules, inadequate staffing or training, unclear authority, weak care, flawed architecture, vendor dependence, inaccessible systems, funding pressure, or governance delay. The category prevents participant wrongdoing or staff error from concealing the conditions that made injury more likely (Perrow, 1984; Turner, 1978; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

Individual and institutional responsibility may coexist. The review should identify each causal contribution, the evidence supporting it, the people burdened, and the office responsible for repair. A finding must then lead to a funded action, deadline, independent verification, and public account where warranted. The record should show what changed and what remains unresolved. Verification should test the revised safeguard under the conditions that produced the failure, using a simulation or protected record review where reenactment would expose people again.

31.2 — Probation, Recall, Removal, and Suspension

Select a consequence for protection, proportionate accountability, and repair using the following routes and proportionality factors (ILO, 1982; OECD, 2020b; Tyler, 2006). Consequence design should include a proportionality matrix that does not look like a morality ladder. The matrix should ask about immediate safety, role authority, likelihood of recurrence, harm already caused, evidence confidence, institutional contribution, repairability, affected-person needs, and appeal status. Protective status changes must remain distinct from final findings.

31.2.1 — Probation

Probation permits continued participation under specified corrective conditions when that remains safe and lawful.

During probation, record support, compliance, changed circumstances, and affected-person protection. End it with a reasoned decision: restoration, extension, narrowing, recall, suspension, removal, or exit. Indefinite probation becomes soft captivity; ending it without reasons conceals discretion.

State the evidenced concern, required changes, support, review schedule, public status where necessary, and conditions for completion or further action. Care needs alone belong in the care route, not disciplinary probation.

Fund the support needed to meet the conditions, including mentoring or changed working arrangements where appropriate.

Probation should not be used to keep someone inside the City when exit would be fairer. If the core problem is misfit, coercion, unsafe load, or loss of genuine consent, use the appropriate support or exit route rather than extending probation.

Explain any necessary public status change using Section 31.4.3’s notice controls.

The probation order should also identify the reviewer, the evidence that will close the matter, and the appeal route if probation becomes unfair. It should specify what the City must change while the participant is changing, because probation can expose institutional weakness as well as individual need (Hirschman, 1970; Bovens, 2007; OECD, 2020b).

The closing review tests whether the conditions were clear, achievable, time-limited, role-related, accessible, and free from loyalty demands.

31.2.2 — Recall

A suspension during investigation may protect people and evidence without declaring guilt. A recall of authority may prevent ongoing harm while facts remain incomplete.

Recall pauses or withdraws City-conferred readiness status, office-interface support, public-release posture, pathway privileges or other internal functions when continuation is unsafe or misleading, including when new evidence changes the assessment. It is limited to the City's lawful authority and cannot remove anyone from lawful public office.

Limit recall to the necessary authority and duration, with review before extension or conversion to another decision.

Protect affected people while preserving the recalled person's notice, support, and review rights.

A recall order should state the authority being withdrawn, the reason immediate withdrawal is necessary, the people protected, the facts still unresolved, and the conditions for return, conversion, or exit.

Post-recall review should examine whether the recall protected the right burden, whether it lasted only as long as necessary, whether the participant had a meaningful route back or out, and

whether the public label avoided treating a protective step as a verdict (ILO, 1982; OECD, 2020b; Tyler, 2006).

31.2.3 — Suspension

Suspension restricts ordinary participation during investigation, review, crisis, or unresolved risk until the City understands what happened or immediate risk is reduced.

Specify which function or access is suspended and the evidence supporting immediate protection. Use the care route for unsafe load rather than implying misconduct.

Suspension must include a timeline and review clock. The person under suspension needs notice, support, access to counsel or advice where appropriate, and a path to challenge the suspension. Affected persons need safety and protection from pressure.

Use a public label that distinguishes an interim restriction from a finding; disclose only what the notice review permits.

Train staff to maintain safety without gossip, prejudgment, or minimizing the concern.

End suspension through a reasoned decision under the applicable route; record continuing remedies separately.

When immediate danger is contained, review whether suspension protected people and evidence, lasted longer than the risk required, and preserved support, and whether it remains necessary. Check that public notices distinguish investigation from guilt, and do not let temporary protection become unannounced removal.

31.2.4 — Removal

A removal decision must specify the role that ends, continuing rights and support, record status, and appeal (ILO, 1982; UNODC, 2003; OECD, 2020b).

Removal ends participation, pathway status, office-interface support, or another City-held role where continuation would be unfair, unsafe, unlawful, or inconsistent with the role’s declared purpose.

Removal may follow serious or repeated misconduct, or a nonpunitive finding that the role cannot continue after reasonable alternatives. State which basis applies.

Use the formal process in Section 29.3 and distinguish the removal decision from any external legal finding.

A removal order should state the finding, evidence standard, lawful referrals, severance or dependent protections, and the City's own design lessons. Provide the applicable transition support under Section 31.6.2 even after misconduct when dependent protection is needed for a safe departure.

Removal deserves a post-decision audit because it is the strongest City-held consequence. The audit should test evidence, due process, affected-person protection, aftercare, referral boundaries, and public status language. It should also ask whether earlier intervention, better staff routes, or stronger anti-capture design might have prevented the point where removal became necessary.

31.2.5 — Appeal

Apply Section 29.3.4’s independent-review design to the consequence being challenged, with standards appropriate to that decision (Tyler, 2006; ILO, 1982; Venice Commission, 2019).

Appeal should be available for major classifications and consequences: misconduct findings, removal, suspension, recall, public status labels, record corrections, remedy decisions, and certain access or release decisions. Affected persons also need appeal where the City denies remedy or protection. Appeal must not belong only to participants.

The independent appeal body should examine evidence, procedure, proportionality, burden placement, protected-category handling, affected-person rights, and whether institutional failure was wrongly shifted onto a person.

Set urgent and ordinary clocks according to safety, exposure, and continuing restrictions; use Section 29.3.3's separate-stage reporting.

Correct any public status affected by the appeal through Section 31.4.3, preserving protected reasons.

Give the appellant the decision-specific review scope, evidence-access route, interim protections, and deadline.

Appeal should be evaluated by whether it changed anything when change was justified. The City should track reversals, narrowed findings, remands, delayed remedies, complainant safety, participant dignity, and whether the appellate body became dependent on the very offices it was supposed to review. Periodic sampling of unappealed decisions can reveal systemic error that individual appellants never had the time or resources to challenge.

31.3 — Record Breach, Bystander Harm, and Data Injury

The archive's capacity to remember also creates capacity to injure. A breach, wrongful release, machine misuse, research conversion, inference leak, or nonparticipant exposure may burden a person long after the original event (European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b, 2025b; Citron and Solove, 2022). Assess the human consequences of data injury, including continuing safety, livelihood, and privacy effects. A completed technical fix cannot by itself establish that a person's losses have ended.

31.3.1 — Record Breach

Trace continuing copies and uses under Section 30.3.5. Restoration of the original system does not establish that exposure has ended (European Union, 2016; NIST, 2025b; Citron and Solove, 2022).

Treat inferable protected facts, misleading derivatives, and failed correction propagation as possible data injury even without a technical intrusion.

Use the containment and recovery process in Section 30.3, adding the affected-person remedy assessment below.

Breach severity depends on exposure, sensitivity, identifiability, inference risk, affected-person vulnerability, and speed of spread. One exposed therapy note or identifying search pattern may be more consequential than thousands of low-risk entries.

Operationally, breach includes unauthorized access, alteration, disclosure, loss, corruption, destruction, extraction, or uncontrolled exposure of City records. It may arise through technical intrusion, staff misuse, vendor failure, accidental release, a misclassified public bundle, weak redaction, an improper query, or compromise in a connected system. The

category must be broad enough to capture real injury, yet precise enough to identify the affected data, custody failure, responsible route, continuing risk, and required remedy.

Identify the record class and sensitivity; a protected source exposure and an inaccurate public summary require different remedies.

Then establish what happened to the record: was it accessed, copied, changed, deleted, published, used for inference or model training, sold, excerpted, or combined with records governed by a different regime?

Contain affected access and publication while preserving lawful evidence for investigation. Apply Section 30.3.5 to indexes, restored backups, and derivatives.

Map the record's actual path across custodians and systems, with the disposition and continuing risk at each destination (Nissenbaum, 2010; Solove, 2006; NIST, 2020b).

31.3.2 — Nonparticipant Exposure

The City is responsible for wrongful collateral exposure; the participant's Vow cannot supply another person's permission.

Test reconstruction risk using Section 30.5.5, including identities revealed by context rather than a direct identifier.

Provide direct protection and assistance under Sections 31.3.4–31.3.5 without requiring a more public complaint.

Review should also ask why the nonparticipant was exposed. Was the participant over-recorded near a household? Was a staff role misunderstood? Did public interface personnel fail to mask visitors? Did an automated system include metadata? Did a public bundle prioritize narrative vividness over protection? These questions make repair systemic.

Revise the failed collection, classification, or release control and test for comparable exposure elsewhere.

For nonparticipant exposure, the affected-person record should begin with the fact that the person did not accept the Vow. It should explain how collateral exposure happened, what relation to the participant or City caused the exposure, what public or private circulation is known, what shielding has been attempted, and how the nonparticipant can obtain review without becoming more visible (European Union, 2016; NIST, 2020b; Ohm, 2010).

31.3.3 — Data Misuse

Data misuse is use beyond lawful authority and declared purpose, including improper linkage or reuse. Distinguish misuse from lawful independent criticism or quotation of public material.

Chapter 11 governs separate secondary-use authorization and categorical prohibitions. Participation consent cannot waive bans on profiling, political targeting, or donor access.

Exclude incidental nonparticipant data from secondary use unless an otherwise permitted, necessary use has independent lawful authority and the required protections. Masking and consent alone cannot override a prohibited purpose.

Where misuse creates a cross-system dossier, identify and suspend each prohibited join, preserve evidence, and trace its derivatives under Section 30.3.5.

Stop the unauthorized use itself, including any dependent model or research process; a repaired access leak is insufficient while its product remains in service.

The review must also identify derivative files or systems created through misuse, state what can be withdrawn or corrected and what cannot be guaranteed, and assign a human owner to each remedy.

31.3.4 — Harm Notification

Harm notification should be truthful, staged, and centered on the affected person. People need to know what happened, what is known and uncertain, what has been contained, which risks remain, what support exists, how to challenge the record, and when further updates will arrive. Technical language should not shift comprehension burden onto the person already carrying the injury (European Union, 2016; EDPB, 2023; NIST, 2025b).

Choose a safe, accessible direct route for each affected person; a general announcement is not a substitute.

The notice should also identify the kind of record or data affected, when the event occurred, and what the person should do.

Timing matters. Delayed notice may be necessary in limited cases to contain harm, protect an investigation, avoid greater exposure, or coordinate safety. But delay must be justified, logged, and reviewed. The City should not use uncertainty as an excuse to wait until public pressure forces disclosure.

Offer a human explanation and relevant support, selected with the affected person rather than inferred from a generic notice category.

Separate public incident information from individual risk and support notices; neither notice may create a further exposure.

Harm notification needs a notification log that is separate from public messaging. The log should show when the City knew enough to notify, which affected-person classes were identified, why any delay was necessary, who delivered notice, what support was offered, and what follow-up remains. The log should be private where needed, but the existence of the route should be publicly intelligible.

Delivery quality needs its own evidence. The City should record whether notice reached the correct person through an

accessible channel, whether language or disability accommodation was provided, whether the recipient could obtain a human explanation, and whether unanswered notices were followed up. A notice sent but not reasonably received should not be counted as completed harm communication.

31.3.5 — Repair and Compensation

Select technical, practical, financial, and protective assistance according to the injury. Where compensation is warranted, its absence must not leave the affected person funding institutional repair.

Some data injuries cannot be fully undone: copies, circulating clips, identification, or searchable private facts may persist. Those limits do not reduce the duty to repair; they make it more urgent (Citron and Solove, 2022; UNODC, 2020; Zehr, 2002).

Set the lawful compensation route before activation. Payment must address supported costs and harm without purchasing silence or waiving nonwaivable rights.

Use remedy findings to identify which record-lifecycle control could have prevented the injury, and check for the same risk elsewhere. Recurring cases require design-level review rather than isolated settlements.

Use Section 29.3.5's remedy tracker, adding funding source, affected-person contact, and escalation for missed commitments.

Where safe and voluntary, record the affected person's account of completion and remaining burden, including disagreement, in the remedy tracker. Support completion with evidence such as restored access, corrected search results, payment, deleted derivatives, safer housing, or withdrawal of a harmful use. Record partial repair, unresolved harm, and the next responsible reviewer.

31.4 — Remedy, Appeal, Correction, and Public Notice

Repair must be designed before a failure makes it urgent. The City should establish who can grant interim protection and who has authority to correct a damaged record. Appeals must have an independent route. Public notice must protect the very people a disclosure is meant to help. Each remedy may carry a different deadline and confidentiality limit, so closing one file does not complete the entire response. The following subsections divide those responsibilities while requiring a named owner and evidence that the necessary repair occurred.

31.4.1 — Remedy Selection

Remedy can be tested by asking who is doing the work after the finding. If the harmed person must chase each correction, finance every challenge, restate context to every office, absorb retaliation, and teach the City how to respond, the institution has left the injury in place under a new name. The authority that created or enabled the harm should coordinate correction, notice, support, compensation where warranted, prevention, and downstream repair, while the affected person retains voice without becoming the unpaid manager of institutional conscience (UNODC, 2020; Zehr, 2002; Braithwaite, 1989).

Provide independent assistance where unequal resources would prevent meaningful recourse.

Assess continuing harm and rejected alternatives, rather than selecting the easiest administrative closure.

The affected person may know what would actually help. They may also be exhausted, afraid, or legally constrained.

Give reasons for granted and denied relief and explain the review route below.

Add immediate protection, rejected alternatives and reasons, completion evidence, recurrence controls, and appeal status to the remedy tracker in Section 29.3.5.

31.4.2 — Appeal Review

Appeal review begins by defining the decision under challenge and the relief that remains available. The file should identify the original decision-maker, the appellant, affected third parties, the evidence available to the reviewer, any protected material, interim protection, the standard of review, and the deadline.

The appeal decision should resolve the contested question under the stated standard, identify material uncertainty, and test whether the original decision understated institutional responsibility or unnecessarily exposed third parties.

Apply Section 30.2.5's clustered-appeal method to recurring successful appeals, adjusting for case mix, volume and access barriers before concluding that a standard or process is faulty. A cluster calls for investigation, not a presumption of discrimination.

Where an appeal remands the matter, the appeal file should identify the remand instructions and the office responsible for carrying them out.

Audit appeal quality through Section 29.5, including evidence access, intelligibility, independence, and actual remedy changes (European Union, 2016; NARA, 2023; SAA, 2020).

31.4.3 — Public Notice

Public notice should identify the failure category, burden created, affected records, protection limits, immediate action, and review route. It must be clear enough to prevent rumor and restrained enough to avoid a second exposure of protected people (NIST, 2025b; European Union, 2016; Bovens, 2007).

Public notice explains institutional failure where public trust requires it. Not every error requires a public announcement. Some remedies should remain private to protect affected persons. But when the public record, institutional integrity, participant status, nonparticipant exposure, archive trust, or public interface has been materially affected, silence becomes another burden.

State the current status and remaining uncertainty, and assign the next update.

Keep public notices available beyond the news cycle and link them to the correction log, audit summary, remedy tracking, and future review so readers can check whether promised action occurred.

Public notice should have an authorization memo before it has a public voice. The memo should identify the audience, the protected details withheld, the public facts stated, the affected-person risks, the review route, and the update schedule.

31.4.4 — No Retaliation

Protection against retaliation begins at first good-faith reporting, not only after a complaint is proven. Complainants, witnesses, staff, participants, nonparticipants, critics, public contributors, and affected persons need interim shielding, contact that explains their options, record preservation, and a route outside the accused authority (OECD, 2016; European Union, 2019; Near and Miceli, 1985).

Retaliation rules should cover institutional retaliation and crowd retaliation. A participant’s supporters may harass a complainant. Volunteers may attack critics. Public forums may expose a bystander. Staff may isolate a colleague who reported overload. The City’s public interface and internal labor systems must both be included.

Monitor authorized role and access changes for possible retaliation, with purpose limits and a defined end. Do not create a private-life surveillance file around a complainant.

Stop retaliation, restore affected work or access conditions, and invoke the applicable disciplinary or external route.

Participants accused of harm retain due-process rights while remaining bound by anti-retaliation rules. They must not face public punishment before process. Revisit interim protections as facts change so they do not become punishment by another name.

Monitoring should also test donor pressure and supervisor behavior after a complaint or correction. The review should distinguish ordinary supervisory action from adverse treatment linked to the protected report, with reasons recorded for contested cases.

The anti-retaliation record should identify who may be at risk, active protective measures, monitoring, and remedies. Closure should state when monitoring ends and where a later related incident can be reopened.

31.5 — Continuity Breaks and Failure Memory

Failures of required role-record continuity need a governed response. Ordinary private life and authorized noncapture periods are not missing evidence (Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015; Vaughan, 1996; Reason, 1997). Use provisional cause and scope labels, then revise them as evidence improves. Failure memory records more than the patch. It preserves what caused the break, who carried its burdens, how public meaning was protected, which remedy was completed, and what changed afterward.

31.5.1 — Continuity-Break Classification

Record the affected channel or layer, interval, records, systems, and people involved, together with evidence quality, cause status, protective limits, repair owner, and review time.

A suspected interruption in expected record integrity should receive a provisional label promptly and a confirmed or revised finding after review. Planned or protected pause and lawful access or release restrictions are separate statuses, not continuity failures by themselves.

Break categories may include technical interruption, emergency-related record interruption, participant- or staff-caused interruption, vendor or infrastructure failure, cybersecurity incident, and archive corruption. Record contested or unknown causes as under review. These categories should be plain enough for citizens, not only technicians.

Classification should trigger specific duties. Technical failure triggers system audit. Emergency exception triggers after-action review. Participant-caused interruption triggers due process. Vendor failure triggers contract review. Protected handling receives its separate category audit. Unknown break triggers escalation.

Publish classification standards before breaks occur.

31.5.2 — Participant Responsibility

Establish participant responsibility from evidence of conduct and context; the gap alone does not prove evasion.

Review intentional or negligent interference with required role records under the applicable conduct rules. The obligation does not extend into ordinary noncapture periods.

The City must still distinguish intentional breach from confusion, technical failure, medical crisis, ambiguous status, or poorly marked space. A participant cannot be fairly blamed for a threshold the City failed to make legible. Architecture, signage, devices, training, and status labels all matter when assessing responsibility.

Evidence for participant responsibility should be specific. The City should ask what the participant knew, what the participant did, what alternatives existed, whether the space was clear, whether staff gave correct guidance, whether emergency conditions applied, and whether the participant later disclosed the break. The difference between concealment and immediate self-reporting matters.

Select any consequence through Section 31.2, distinguishing deliberate concealment from a disclosed minor lapse.

Record the supported act or omission and any institutional contribution separately.

Participant responsibility should include a revision trigger different from the one used for technical breaks. New evidence might show coercion, unclear instruction, staff direction, or system weakness. The ledger should therefore name what would narrow, expand, or reverse the responsibility finding so the first label does not become permanent merely because it arrived first (Reason, 1997; Leveson, 2011; Dekker, 2012).

31.5.3 — System Responsibility

System responsibility concerns the City's causal contribution, including the design and management of contracted services.

Include organizational causes as well as component failure; unclear instructions or an overloaded team may break continuity without a hardware defect.

Include vendor failures in system responsibility and examine the City's vendor selection, contract, redundancy plan, audit rights, and exit path.

Public communication should name system responsibility when it is found. Vague phrases like administrative issue or technical matter may be insufficient if the break affected public trust or harmed people. The public does not need every security detail, but it needs enough truth to know that the institution has not blamed the wrong actor.

Assign repair to the failed control and test the revision under the conditions that produced the break.

System responsibility should name the evidence that would change the finding into shared or participant responsibility. A fault initially traced to software may later include skipped review or unauthorized workaround. Conversely, a suspected person may be cleared by technical logs.

31.5.4 — Public Meaning

Publish the supported status and its limits; neither responsibility for an interruption nor absence of a record establishes what occurred during it.

Public meaning should be contextual. A five-minute device failure in an empty corridor is not the same as a two-hour unexplained gap during office-interface activity. A logged emergency exception is not the same as an unauthorized private

meeting. A protected clinical interval is not the same as secret public-power formation. Labels help citizens read the difference.

The public record site should link gap labels to explanations, review status, later findings, and correction logs.

Apply Section 31.4.3's protection test to continuity notices; even a category label may identify a protected person.

The continuity ledger should record how a gap could be misread and when the public account will be revisited.

When classification changes, update the linked interpretations and notices while preserving protection. Place the reusable lesson in the failure-memory ledger below.

31.5.5 — Institutional Failure Memory

Failure-memory records must remain retrievable by future operators and auditors without exposing affected people (Cannon and Edmondson, 2005).

Organize failure memory around controls and consequences, limiting identifying teaching material to a necessary, authorized purpose.

Separate operational, public, and any independently authorized research uses; a learning purpose does not waive Chapter 11's restrictions.

Include justified pauses, refusals, and shutdowns in the learning record, not only expansion and recovery.

Link each lesson to the subsequent control change and its verification.

The failure-memory ledger should record the cause, burden path, repair, design change, unresolved risk, and future review date. Identify material excluded from teaching reuse because it would harm an affected person's dignity. Failure memory should identify what would change the lesson. A pilot-era breach may

teach one thing before technical redesign and another thing after new access controls are tested.

The City also needs a closure threshold for failure that cannot be repaired within acceptable burden. Closure becomes a legitimate option when the institution can no longer protect nonwaivable rights, maintain lawful and trustworthy records, provide safe care and work, preserve independent oversight, sustain essential operations, or justify the burdens imposed on participants, staff, families, nonparticipants, and the host community. The decision should not belong to the operator whose survival is at stake. It should require an independent review, affected-person protection, a stated evidentiary basis, and a public explanation bounded by privacy and safety (GAO, 2025; ISO, 2019; Ostrom, 1990). Closure review should separate tasks that can stop from unresolved claims that still need a reachable, accountable office.

A closure decision must activate a wind-down plan rather than an institutional disappearance. New admissions and nonessential capture should stop. Care, housing, payroll, benefits, severance, family and dependent support, complaint and appeal routes, records custody, vendor exit, contract termination, host obligations, creditor claims, physical-site safety, and continuity of essential services should receive named owners, funded timelines, and independent verification. A reserve or remedy fund should remain available for harms discovered after operations cease. Closure is complete only when people are not left carrying the institution’s unfinished obligations (ILO, 1982; ISO, 2019; NARA, 2023). Before staff disperse, a claims-routing exercise should test whether a former participant can still reach the responsible office.

Closure should produce a certificate and residual-authority map stating why the City closed, which functions ended, which

duties continue, who holds sealed and public records, how later claims and corrections can be filed, and when each remaining authority expires. Transfers must preserve lawful custody, affected-person rights, and unresolved obligations; a purchaser's claim of continuity is insufficient (NARA, 2023; GAO, 2025; ISO, 2019). The receiving custodian should test an authorized sample retrieval before accepting custody, confirming that access restrictions, correction history, and retention deadlines survive the transfer.

Buying assets or claiming continuity does not transfer the City's name, participant records, data rights, donor relationships, or accreditation without the applicable independent review and lawful authorization. Both custodians should acknowledge each transfer. The map must be checked after staff or vendor departures so claimants can still reach an accountable office. Continued record custody does not continue active capture or institutional control over former participants.

31.6 — Exit, Retirement, and Reintegration

Voluntary exit requires a usable material and administrative route (Hirschman, 1970; ILO, 1982; Goffman, 1963; Link and Phelan, 2001). Distinguish voluntary exit, retirement, removal, and departure with unresolved remedies. Plan the transition as well as the end of the role; removing active duties may leave practical and social consequences. A departure plan should identify which privacy and remedy obligations continue after participation ends.

31.6.1 — Voluntary Exit

Assess whether participants delay leaving because of public shame, dependency, debt, housing risk, medical continuity, family pressure, fear of being called unready, or uncertainty about the archive. Investigate design changes that could reduce excessive friction.

Permit departure by the participant's own decision without requiring illness, collapse or wrongdoing as justification. Collect only the reasons necessary for a safe transition; a public status change does not license a private explanation.

Exit notice should define when active participation, role authority, and record obligations end, what records remain, what release or sealing rules apply, what support continues, what public status changes, which remedies remain open, and what appeal or review rights remain.

Prevent retaliation or pressure against people who complained, challenged donors, exposed staff burden or became inconvenient. Assign a named owner to unresolved harms and affected-person protection after their departure.

A voluntary-exit plan should identify the adviser handoff and office responsible for closing open questions. It should also state how the person can challenge a public description that makes

departure sound like fault when the record shows ordinary change (ILO, 1982; OECD, 2020b; Maslach and Leiter, 2016).

31.6.2 — Severance Support

Severance support makes departure materially possible rather than merely legal. Bounded, reviewable, nonpossessive help may include housing and healthcare transition, dependent care, a financial bridge, legal guidance, counseling, travel, employment transition, record explanation, data-injury assistance, and safety planning. These supports prevent abandonment and coerced dependence after the City has asked someone to reorganize life around its public burden. They are not reward, absolution, or payment for silence.

Tailor support to transition need, continuing remedy duties, and dependent protection, including after misconduct.

Participants should know before activation what support exists after pause, withdrawal, removal, pilot shutdown, and retirement. People should not fear that criticizing the City will cause support to vanish.

Transition support must have time limits, appeal, privacy rules, and no loyalty conditions. It must not require praise for the City, silence about harm, or availability as public evidence of successful reintegration.

Fund severance before the City opens.

A severance-support plan should specify the duration, funding source, and privacy conditions of each commitment.

31.6.3 — Retirement After Office

Retirement ends the applicable active role while preserving separately lawful record and accountability duties.

Retirement review should clarify status. Is the person a former participant, former officeholder, continuing participant, advisor, private citizen, witness in an ongoing review, or subject of

unresolved remedy? Status clarity protects public trust and future privacy. It also prevents former authority from lingering informally inside the City.

Publish necessary changes to City status and continuing record duties through Section 31.4.3.

Review any continuing post-office role under its own authority. Historical City records may inform lawful public discussion, but do not authorize new monitoring of ordinary private life.

The retirement review should state which records remain open because they concern office, which records belong only to City formation, which are sealed or time-reviewed, and what public claims the person can no longer make.

31.6.4 — Post-Exit Future Privacy

Post-exit privacy must be prospective, enforceable, and visible in system rules. The active period may remain governed by its record obligations, but future ordinary life should not be captured by default, searched by habit, linked to new dossiers, or treated as an epilogue to formation. The public gains memory of the bounded role, not a lifelong monitoring right (European Union, 2016; Solove, 2006; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Operationally, future privacy begins with deactivation. Capture credentials, device permissions, staff workflows, search defaults, alerts, and vendor access must change at the recorded exit time; cached and derivative systems should be checked for continued collection.

Future privacy does not erase legitimate public accountability. If the former participant held office, certain public records may remain. If unresolved harm, data injury, or legal matter continues, lawful processes may continue. If the person later

seeks power again, prior records may become relevant under defined rules.

Family and dependent privacy remains independent of the former participant's status; do not continue household collection after exit.

Label the dates and scope of the ended role, continuing records, review status, and whether updates have ceased.

31.6.5 — Ordinary-Life Reintegration

Reintegration should support ordinary relationships and identity without treating life outside the City as demotion.

Departure may leave practical disruption and public stigma; ending capture alone does not resolve either (Braithwaite, 1989; Maruna, 2001; Link and Phelan, 2001).

Offer the applicable transition services under Section 31.6.2 without continued institutional supervision.

Identity reintegration matters. A person who lived under the Vow may have learned to narrate, explain, perform, justify, or anticipate public interpretation. Returning to ordinary life may require relearning privacy, spontaneity, silence, and relationships not mediated by record. The City should treat this as human adjustment, not weakness.

Offer families voluntary repair support while preserving their separate privacy and choices.

Keep record labels accurate and bounded so misfit, exit, failure, or conflict does not mark a former participant as a failed citizen.

Use reported reintegration difficulties to test exit design, without assuming that every difficulty was caused by the City or that ordinary life is unsuitable for the person.

31.7 — Posthumous Records and Long-Term Dignity

The City's archive will outlive many of the people it records, creating a final moral question: what does a public-power record owe a person after death? Death neither erases dignity nor converts the archive into ownerless public material (ICA, 2011; SAA, 2020; ISO, 2016a; Cook, 2013). Long-term access serves specific accountability and historical purposes, subject to the review below. A review period must distinguish durable public accountability from curiosity about private life.

31.7.1 — Death and Archive Status

Explain the posthumous review process before activation, including notice, surviving affected-person standing, and continuing custodianship.

Keep commemoration decisions separate from archival release.

Death should trigger status review rather than automatic release. The City should mark the change, close or transfer active processes, preserve unresolved appeals and remedies, identify surviving people who may be affected, and decide which records remain public, restricted, sealed, summarized, delayed, or subject to periodic reconsideration. The review record should explain the authority, public purpose, continuing harm, less exposing alternatives, and next review date. Death changes governance conditions; it does not turn silence into consent.

The public may need basic notice when a former active participant or officeholder dies, especially if public records, unresolved reviews, or historical materials are affected. The notice should be dignified and spare.

Preserve the record-family distinctions in Section 26.4.5 after death; a status change does not merge custodians or permissions.

Unresolved matters require careful handling. A pending complaint, data injury, appeal, public correction, or institutional review may continue after death if affected persons or public trust require it. The City should avoid using death to close uncomfortable institutional questions. It should also avoid turning unresolved matters into rumor.

31.7.2 — Family Dignity

Offer safe, culturally appropriate contact and timing, without requiring a family to perform public grief.

Family interests require protection and consultation but do not automatically transfer control of the public-role archive.

Surviving relatives may need notice, consultation, and support when archive status changes affect them. Consultation helps identify factual error, child or dependent risk, safety concerns, cultural and religious burdens, and less harmful ways to preserve public meaning without surrendering the record to private control.

Do not use children as symbols of legacy, proof of a participant's humanity or the City's success, or material for public mourning after the participant's death.

Do not use family history as a speculative explanation of public conduct. Any retained connection needs a specific public purpose and protective review.

31.7.3 — Long-Term Access Review

Over time, the access decision must be reconsidered. Immediate political stakes may fade, affected people may age, children may become adults, historical value may grow, legal duties may change, and improved retrieval tools may make old disclosures easier to search, infer from, and recombine beyond their original publication context. Scheduled review, stated reasons, affected-person routes, and appeal prevent a decision made for

one moment from becoming an unexamined rule for every future audience.

Assign review clocks to sensitive categories, preserving any continuing legal protection as circumstances change.

Select independent archival, legal, and affected-person expertise according to the question; custody alone does not settle access.

31.7.4 — Historical Use Limits

Historical use limits protect context as well as content. A fragment can misstate a life, campaign, office, family, or failure when it travels without classification, correction, dispute status, or protected-category limits. Historians, educators, journalists, public record sites, and later custodians should preserve the labels that keep authentic old material from becoming new misinformation (ICA, 2011; SAA, 2020; Schwartz and Cook, 2002).

For City-controlled access, distinguish inspection, reproduction, publication, indexing, and model use. Grant only the authorized mode; preserve statutory quotation and other applicable rights rather than claiming control over all later public use.

Sensational legacy is a real danger. A participant's intimate life, breakdown, family conflict, continuity break, or removal may become more marketable than their public-power record. The City must not feed historical entertainment that uses its archive to humiliate the dead or burden the living.

Apply Section 11.6's separate-use restrictions to historical research; archival value does not authorize prohibited profiling or model use. *The Science of Fairness* supplies the series' research framework.

Part IX — Buildability and Network Discipline

A buildable City begins not with a rendering but with a cost ledger in a host-review room. It names land, construction, utilities, accessibility, archives, staff, care, maintenance, uncertainty, reserves, failure, and closure. The question is whether every promise has an owner, a funding path, a review date, and a lawful way to shrink or stop.

Around that table, a construction manager tests contingency, a labor representative asks who can stop unsafe work, a host resident names service and housing pressures, a disability reviewer protects access from value engineering, and an archivist asks who funds migration after donors leave. Their questions convert beauty into obligations.

Part IX brings institutional imagination to the threshold of conditional buildability. It does not choose a site, allocate public money, approve construction, select a host, authorize a pilot, or create a network. Lawful authorities and transition processes own those decisions. This Part defines the evidence, burdens, alternatives, safeguards, and stop conditions any serious proposal must survive.

The comparison is not an expensive City against a costless status quo. Existing public-power formation already consumes money, attention, investigative labor, donor access, and trust, often without one visible budget. Those burdens cannot be converted into promotional savings by assertion. The City must compare itself with credible alternatives under common categories, disclose uncertainty, and accept that a less intrusive reform may perform better.

The physical build creates its first moral test before any participant arrives. Construction workers, subcontractors, inspectors, delivery crews, nearby residents, local businesses, ecosystems, public utilities, transit systems, and emergency services encounter the City as a project, not as a philosophy.

Safety, fair procurement, wages, working time, subcontractor conditions, environmental burden, local disruption, grievance, beneficial ownership, change-order review, and stop-work authority therefore belong to the City's own public record. A project that speaks about visible public power while hiding its construction and procurement chain has failed at the threshold (International Labour Organization, 1988; International Labour Organization, 2022b; World Bank, 2017a; World Bank Group, 2025).

Accreditation remains scoped to institutional functions rather than people. Here it means a revocable finding that a named site has demonstrated specified rights, record, staffing, host, Artificial Intelligence, audit, exit, and stop capacities for a defined period and operating scope. It confers no judgment of personal character, professional license, public authorization, office eligibility, or legal approval. The accrediting body must disclose its competence, impartiality, funding, conflicts, evidence limits, post-approval surveillance, complaint and appeal routes, suspension, withdrawal, and meta-review. ISO 19011 guides auditing but does not itself confer certification, while ISO/IEC 17011 supplies the more exact competence and impartiality frame for accreditation bodies (ISO/IEC, 2017; ISO, 2026; ISEAL Alliance, 2025).

Local translation must address climate, law, language, labor, disability access, public memory, and host institutions without erasing the shared protections. Chapter 34 develops that test (Acharya, 2004; Merry, 2006; Dolowitz and Marsh, 2000).

Chapter 32 — City Costs and Anti-Capture

Buildability requires one lifecycle ledger that prices the safeguards as well as the buildings: staff, care, accessibility, records, cybersecurity, complaint, audit, maintenance, vendor exit, reserves, and closure must remain visible beside capital cost.

Cost becomes a moral question when its distribution is visible. Review must show who pays, benefits, gains access or influence, and carries deferred or unpriced obligations. A low aggregate number can still be unfair when workers, hosts, families, participants, nonparticipants, or future budgets bear concentrated burdens they cannot refuse or correct.

Romantic undercounting and promotional overclaim are equal threats. Hope does not staff archives, secure servers, maintain accessible buildings, provide independent counsel, or support exit. Nor may every hidden cost of existing leader formation be claimed as a City saving. Bounded scenarios, source classes, uncertainty ranges, lifecycle categories, and affected-person routes keep comparison useful without pretending to be a final budget.

Two ledgers belong on the same table without being collapsed into one persuasive total. Set the City's lifecycle account, including host mitigation and breach response, beside the status quo's burdens of late discovery, donor dependence, private gatekeeping, corruption, scandal, poor performance in office, investigative labor, public guesswork, and mistrust. Some effects can be priced; others should remain qualitative, distributional, or bounded by ranges.

Money enters not only as resource but as authority pressure. Public funding can bring democratic oversight and political leverage. Philanthropy can bring patient capital and expectations of gratitude, naming, access, narrative control, or rescue. Mixed finance can diversify dependence while obscuring it. Vendors

can supply essential capacity and become landlords of data, maintenance, or institutional memory. A City created to expose hidden public power cannot allow its own financing to become a hidden government.

Refusal capacity gives anti-capture rules practical force. Funding may expand the City only while admissions, archive access, naming, governance, correction, public interpretation, and audit remain independent of financial leverage. No donor, vendor, lender, contractor, or public funder may purchase human rank, silence, favorable evidence, protected access, or guaranteed continuation.

Architecture must not become a luxury object for people already closest to power. Expensive form cannot justify prestige admission, elite comfort, political favoritism, future-office entitlement, or aesthetics that consume the reserves needed for accessibility, care, staff relief, archive migration, and exit. Cost discipline should direct design toward repairable systems, adequate staffing, transparent tradeoffs, and adapted space where adaptation serves the purpose. The symbol remains worthy only while the rights it houses continue to govern it.

The worked hearing in Section 32.2 ends with a visible design change rather than a rhetorical victory.

32.1 — How the City's Cost Must Be Justified

Cost justification requires comparison with credible alternatives. The City has a visible budget; existing leader-formation systems also impose dispersed costs through vetting, donor dependence, late discovery, investigation, administrative repair, and mistrust. Those costs must be estimated on the same terms as the City's costs, without assuming that the City would eliminate them. The question is which option best addresses the identified burdens within lawful, affordable limits (Government Accountability Office, 2020a; HM Treasury, 2026a).

32.1.1 — Hidden Formation Cost

Apply the same counterfactual, time horizon, evidence, uncertainty, and distributional standards to both sides of the comparison, including no build.

Hidden formation cost begins before a campaign and outside any public budget. Family advantage, class position, elite education, professional networks, party sponsorship, donor access, media coaching, and private mentorship can affect who becomes plausible as a future officeholder. None of those influences is automatically corrupt. The relevant question is whether a pathway creates role-relevant dependence or exclusion that citizens cannot inspect once substantial public authority is sought (Carnes, 2013; Dal Bó et al., 2017; Besley, 2005).

The burden chain is explicit: a formation advantage changes access; access changes opportunity and obligation; obligation can shape candidacy, staffing, policy attention, or silence; those choices then move cost onto people who never consented to the original relationship. A hidden-formation claim is strongest when it identifies that chain rather than treating elite biography as self-proving evidence of capture.

The ledger separates at least five cost classes. Selection cost concerns who never reaches consideration. Dependence cost concerns favors, gratitude, or future access attached to the pathway. Discovery cost concerns reconstructing the pathway after office. Interpretation cost concerns deciding whether an influence mattered. Remedy cost concerns correcting a decision after the influence has already traveled.

Report nonmonetary burdens alongside costs; use currency only where the unit and causal link are defensible (Government Accountability Office, 2020a; HM Treasury, 2026a).

The comparison needs a declared reference system. Private professional education, party leadership pipelines, civil-service development, ordinary campaign vetting, public fellowship programs, and no reform are different counterfactuals. A City should not select the weakest comparator and then describe the difference as an avoided cost. Each comparator receives the same boundary, time horizon, affected-person map, and uncertainty discipline.

Enter the City's own formation burdens in the same ledger, including time, privacy, labor, and host effects. Visibility supplies no cost exemption.

Update estimates in both directions after pilot evidence, retaining the conditions of any observed benefit.

32.1.2 — Corruption Cost

Estimate only corruption burdens plausibly connected to the formation or interface mechanisms under review (Rose-Ackerman and Palifka, 2016; World Bank, 2020; OECD, 2017b).

A useful analysis separates prevention, detection, response, and repair. Formation records may prevent some leverage by making prohibited relationships harder to establish. They may

detect other leverage earlier. Complaint, audit, and correction routes affect response. Investigation, contract reversal, compensation, institutional repair, and restored access belong to the repair ledger. Price each proposed function with its responsible owner and the staff or service capacity required to carry it out.

The causal claim remains narrow. Earlier visibility may reduce certain hiding places, but corruption can arise after office through new money, emergency power, patronage, coercion, ideology, personal loyalty, or vendor control. A clean formation record does not certify future conduct. It creates evidence and response routes that can be tested against ordinary alternatives.

Pathway-specific objects make corruption cost measurable: undisclosed contacts, conflicts found before activation, prohibited conditions refused, near misses, complaint latency, time to correction, contract exposure, and the public resources consumed by repair.

Include the City’s own capture pathways under the donor and vendor reviews in Chapter 29.

Near misses deserve their own category. A donor inquiry that is refused, a contact that is logged, a conflict disclosed before decision, or a vendor term rejected for control risk may show that the firewall worked. The same event may also show where the design is being pressured. Reporting both meanings prevents success theater.

Locate costs and any hypothesized reduction by affected group; an upstream City expense is not justified by a comparable uncounted transfer elsewhere.

32.1.3 — Scandal Cost

Scandal cost is late-discovery burden. It includes emergency investigation, suspended public work, legal response, staff and

family exposure, policy reversal, communications disorder, reputational spillover, and the civic effort required to determine what actually happened. The relevant evidence is not headline intensity. It is the difference between what could have been known earlier and what became costly because no trustworthy category or record existed (Bowler and Karp, 2004; Bovens and ’t Hart, 1996).

The ledger distinguishes the underlying conduct from the cost of revelation and the cost of institutional response. A serious conflict may be cheap to reveal but costly in consequence. A minor fact may become expensive because an institution concealed it, mishandled it, or forced the public to reconstruct context from fragments.

Timing is therefore central. Review should ask when a fact became role-relevant, who could lawfully have assessed it, whether protected review was sufficient, whether public release was necessary, and what harm earlier action could have prevented. Information that is intimate but irrelevant belongs outside the scandal-cost case even when public appetite is high.

Use the governed record to test the timing and consequences of discovery; better context need not produce agreement about severity.

Include collateral exposure in the cost of earlier discovery, applying the protected-record limits rather than assuming earlier publication is better.

Public artifacts use mechanism categories rather than personal wreckage. Concealed conflict, abusive supervision, false qualification, donor leverage, financial irregularity, and repeated refusal to correct can be explained without reproducing humiliating details.

Evaluation compares the actual incident pathway: time from first warning to intake, intake to finding, finding to remedy, and

remedy to public correction; number of people unnecessarily exposed; service interruption; legal and administrative effort; and recurrence after corrective action.

32.1.4 — Public Trust Cost

Public trust cost appears when people cannot judge whether an institution or official is reliable enough for a specific public purpose. It is paid through repeated verification, withdrawal, delay, defensive politics, rumor, partisan substitution, and the expectation that every explanation hides another bargain. Trust is not admiration and cannot be demanded as a civic duty (OECD, 2026c; OECD, 2017a; Hetherington, 2005).

The relevant object is warranted reliance. A person may trust that a record is complete enough to challenge while distrusting the participant's judgment. A journalist may trust provenance and still reject the institution's interpretation. A voter may accept that a conflict was disclosed and still vote no. The City should make disagreement better informed, not manufacture approval.

Trust burden has several dimensions: search cost, verification cost, coordination cost, correction cost, and the emotional strain of persistent uncertainty. These burdens fall differently. Citizens may withdraw; staff may overdocument; journalists may reconstruct basic facts; public agencies may repeat review because prior records are not credible. A single trust score would conceal these routes.

Test whether disclosure reduces checking effort or instead adds volume, exposure, and conflicting derivatives.

The City tests whether its public bundles reduce avoidable interpretive work. Can a skeptical reader locate the source, see what changed, understand what remains disputed, and reach a human challenge route without specialized assistance?

Assess burdens on both public servants and critics; warranted reliance need not favor either side.

Distrust can be informative. It may signal real abuse, exclusion, failed service, or an inaccessible remedy. The City should not code skepticism as a deficit to be corrected in the public. It should ask whether the institution has earned specific reliance and whether refusing reliance remains safe.

Evaluation uses disaggregated evidence: comprehension, source trace, correction latency, appeal completion, repeated inquiries caused by ambiguity, public-use barriers, and differences across language, disability, expertise, and political position. A rise in favorable opinion is not by itself evidence that trust burden fell.

32.1.5 — Cost Claim Caution

At this stage the comparison supports conditional appraisal, not a demonstrated savings claim. Apply the evidence and revision rules in Section 32.1.5.

Before site, jurisdiction, cohort, legal form, operating model, and pilot evidence are fixed, the City cannot claim that it pays for itself, prevents a percentage of corruption, produces a trust return, or saves a determinate public amount. Appraisal may compare burdens while keeping every result conditional (HM Treasury, 2026a; Government Accountability Office, 2020a; Boardman et al., 2018).

Public cost claims must retain their scenario and evidence status; modeled burdens are not cash savings.

The first caution is causality. If corruption later falls in a jurisdiction that uses the City, the City cannot assume it caused the fall without proper evidence. If trust rises, the reason may be broader social change, better journalism, legal reform, economic

stability, or political renewal. Economic claims require careful attribution (Besley, 2005; Dal Bó et al., 2017).

For each apparent saving, identify who would carry the omitted work or risk, then classify the change as a transfer, genuine saving, avoided-cost hypothesis, or deferred obligation. Give particular scrutiny to burdens on people less able to consent, contest, repair, or leave (HM Treasury, 2026a; MHCLG, 2026; Flyvbjerg, 2006).

Early research can improve a decision before it commits the City to a costly path. For a declared operating choice, identify the responsible decision maker, the decision date, and the feasible alternatives that satisfy independently required protections. Then identify which uncertain assumption could change the choice: review time, public usefulness, or the burden of a spatial arrangement. Information that arrives after the choice is no longer reversible may have a different value from information available beforehand.

Value-of-information analysis compares the expected result of the best choice under current evidence with the expected result when a specified study can inform the choice. The value of perfect information is an upper bound on that decision benefit under the same model and available actions, not the value of an ordinary imperfect study. Assess the study's attainable information and subtract its resource and delay costs before calling it worthwhile. Fenwick et al. (2020) develop these distinctions for healthcare research decisions; applying them to a bounded City operating choice is a proposed use, not evidence of City effectiveness.

The appraisal should show which possible result changes which action. Include research labor, participant burden, and effects on hosts without assigning every protected interest a currency price. An expected gain cannot waive an unresolved

rights or care gate. Design flexibility can preserve useful choices while evidence develops (HM Treasury, 2026a). Where probabilities lack adequate support, report the plausible scenarios and decision thresholds rather than manufacture precision. This decision-specific appraisal does not exhaust the value of basic research.

Plain public labels distinguish known cost, estimated cost, modeled hidden cost, pilot-observed cost, avoided-cost hypothesis, and unresolved cost. Each estimate's supporting file should identify its calculation version, price date, source inputs, and the person responsible for updating them. When an input changes, the revision log should separate the arithmetic effect from any model change, allowing an authorized reviewer to reproduce the difference.

A versioned sensitivity and risk file, not one preferred forecast, completes the cost-claim analysis. Reviewers should see how construction contingency, inflation, staffing, wages, archive migration, host mitigation, discounting, demand, delay, failure, and closure alter the result, including correlated stresses. The file names which assumptions reverse the decision and which remain unresolved. A case surviving only one optimistic configuration is too fragile to warrant construction (Government Accountability Office, 2020a; HM Treasury, 2026a; MHCLG, 2026; Kahneman and Lovallo, 1993). For a decision-sensitive estimate, publish a paired scenario showing the City arrangement and the strongest feasible lower-burden alternative under the same price date and demand assumptions. The scenario names shared costs counted only once, the operating obligation that continues after construction, and the uncertainty that could reverse the preferred choice. A reviewer should be able to change one declared input and reproduce the resulting

difference without silently changing the model or weakening a required protection.

32.2 — Capital and Operating Costs; Reserve Design

Separate capital, recurring operations, records, care and exit, and funded reserves in the lifecycle account (Government Accountability Office, 2020a; HM Treasury, 2026a). Test continuing affordability after launch, including renewal, incidents, and eventual closure. Tie reserves to the obligations that must survive a pause or funding loss, using Section 32.2.5 (NIST, 2024a; ISO, 2019). Forecasts should state which cost remains payable when the program stops admitting participants.

32.2.1 — Capital Costs

Use the basis-of-estimate fields below for every scenario.

Capital estimates must include the complete functional scope, from land and accessible buildings to secure technical and care facilities (Government Accountability Office, 2020a; World Health Organization, 2018b).

Consider a hypothetical host-review hearing. A donor offers to fund a ceremonial hall and public plaza, while the draft budget leaves archive migration, staff relief, accessibility remediation, vendor exit, and participant reintegration below credible ranges. The gift is attractive because it closes the most visible capital gap. The lifecycle review exposes the unfunded obligations and the naming leverage attached to the gift.

The hearing does not ask whether the donor is generous or whether the design is beautiful. It asks which obligations would remain unfunded, who would carry the resulting burden, what assumptions support the ranges, and what the City could no longer afford to refuse. The proposal is restructured: the ceremonial element is reduced, the gift loses naming and governance conditions, and funds are redirected to lifecycle reserves, staff capacity, accessibility, archive migration, host mitigation, and exit support.

The Constitution of Fairness addresses proposed legal authority; *The Peace of Fairness* addresses macrofinance and material capacity. This chapter appraises City assets and obligations.

The worked file compares three planning scenarios rather than presenting one preferred total. The limited pilot occupies adapted buildings, restricts public interface hours, and delays several technical functions. The purpose-built pilot carries higher capital and commissioning risk but may reduce operational fragmentation. The no-build scenario redirects resources to existing civic education, disclosure, journalism, public administration, and oversight reforms. None is treated as the moral default. The comparison records what each option can and cannot test, who benefits, who is burdened, and what evidence would change the decision (Boardman et al., 2018; HM Treasury, 2026a).

Capital accounting must continue beyond the construction invoice to commissioning, adaptation, and eventual decommissioning; excluding those later obligations can make an unsafe design appear affordable (Government Accountability Office, 2020a; HM Treasury, 2026a).

Apply Section 32.1.5’s transfer test when compressing any budget line; record who must perform or finance the omitted work.

Document the estimate’s basis: quantity, unit rate, base year, location, scope boundary, design maturity, contingency method, escalation assumption, schedule, exclusions, source version, and confidence range.

In this illustrative comparison, the adapted-building pilot initially appears to offer the strongest balance of scope and price. A lifecycle review changes that conclusion. The technical vendor assumes only three years of migration support, the

operating plan treats public moderation as a part-time function, and the maintenance reserve excludes climate adaptation after the first major replacement cycle. The file therefore marks that option as under-specified rather than prudent (Government Accountability Office, 2020a; Flyvbjerg, 2006).

Reference-class evidence challenges inside-view optimism. Costs from comparable campuses, archives, accessible public buildings, secure technical systems, care facilities, and complex civic projects should be used where comparison is defensible. Differences in law, climate, scale, labor market, security, and service model remain explicit rather than being averaged away (Flyvbjerg, 2006; Boardman et al., 2018).

Host review also changes the budget. The first draft counts local jobs as benefit but does not separate permanent skilled roles from temporary subcontracting, nor does it model rental pressure near the site. The host panel requires a distributional appendix, a housing-monitoring trigger, local grievance funding, traffic mitigation, and an independent service-capacity review (Kline and Moretti, 2014; Chapple and Zuk, 2016).

Design-to-cost is legitimate only after protected functions are fixed. The project may simplify finishes, reduce nonessential area, stage expansion, reuse existing structures, or choose a different site. It may not create savings by removing accessibility, worker safety, archive integrity, complaint capacity, host mitigation, or the physical conditions required for care and exit.

The public-funding option arrives with a proposed annual appropriation and a request for government observer seats. Public money may require audit, procurement, reporting, and democratic authorization under applicable law, but it cannot silently make the City an operating arm of government or give an observer access to protected formation records. The financing

route remains unresolved until actual legal and host review determine whether those conditions can be met; institutional enthusiasm cannot settle it.

The philanthropic option is tested against the same discipline. The donor offers a large gift described as unrestricted, but expects the founder's family name to remain visible and the funded platform to be presented as the City's central innovation. The gift is acceptable only after the institution proves it can refuse the naming, govern the platform independently, disclose connected interests, return unused funds, and continue care and exit without future rescue (Reich, 2018; Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978).

Explain each major asset's function, lower-cost alternatives, and consequences of omission.

The adapted-site scenario advances only to a narrower design and host-evidence phase. Admissions, technical activation, public performance or accreditation claims, and the award of accreditation remain blocked.

32.2.2 — Operating Costs

Price recurring work, benefits, supervision, utilities, maintenance, and professional support at the capacity required by the model below (World Health Organization, 2018b; United Nations, 2006).

Capacity modelling begins with demand, not an ideal organization chart. Expected and surge volumes, service-time assumptions, simultaneous needs, leave, training, supervision, turnover, relief coverage, and after-hours duty determine whether staffing is real. Before any go/no-go decision, the model should publish a low, base, and high annual operating range; required full-time-equivalent staffing by protected function; reserve and relief assumptions; expected service volumes; and

per-participant-year or per-pathway cost ranges where those denominators are meaningful. Every figure should carry its source, base year, uncertainty, expiry, and trigger for revision.

Each service needs a minimum standard and an escalation rule. Complaint acknowledgment, protected review, urgent care, accessibility response, archive correction, incident communication, and exit support have different time horizons. Delays that would undermine a right or safety route trigger workload reduction, temporary intake limits, or admissions pause.

Fund the role separation in Section 29.1.1; a small cohort may use qualified shared external capacity but cannot combine incompatible powers to lower costs.

Recurring training, simulation, maintenance, security review, legal updating, language access, and vendor transition are operating duties rather than launch expenses.

Test claimed efficiency against Section 32.1.5's burden-transfer rule (ISO, 2021b; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

32.2.3 — Archive Costs

Cost the full records lifecycle in Chapter 30, not storage alone (Government Accountability Office, 2020a; HM Treasury, 2026a).

Budget minimization, correction, lawful deletion, and access restriction as operating tasks.

Workload units anchor the estimate. Consider an illustration, not a staffing recommendation: 20 participants producing 2 recorded role-hours a day over 300 days would generate 12,000 source-hours a year. At an assumed 1.5 human-review hours per source-hour, review would require 18,000 labor-hours. If one full-time reviewer supplied 1,200 net review hours a year after

leave, training, supervision, and other duties, that task alone would require 15 full-time-equivalent reviewers. These assumptions are invented for the example and must be replaced by dry-run evidence. The calculation excludes care, security, storage, translation, appeals, and other archive work. It shows why record volume, review intensity, and usable staff time belong in the same estimate; it does not justify broader capture or weaker review.

A sensitivity check makes the capacity requirement easier to inspect. With the same 12,000 source-hours and 1,200 usable review-hours per reviewer-year, assumed review intensities of 0.75, 1.5, and 2.25 hours per source-hour require 7.5, 15, and 22.5 full-time-equivalent reviewer-years respectively. These are annual workload equivalents, not a claim that fractional people can provide a required shift. They are alternative assumptions, not permission to lower the review standard. Dry runs must establish the intensity a lawful, accurate workflow needs. Multiplying each capacity figure by a locally evidenced loaded annual labor cost gives the corresponding direct-review cost.

Annual capacity and timely service are different questions. Sufficient reviewer-years may still leave a release or appeal waiting when difficult cases arrive together. Dry runs should report arrival patterns, backlog age, rework, and response-time distributions as well as averages. The cohort and activity schedule must fit the qualified coverage actually available, including independent review. The 1,200-hour denominator already allows for leave, training, supervision, and other duties; any additional coverage allowance needs a separate justification rather than counting those hours twice. Scope can grow when the operating evidence supports it.

Retention and deletion both cost money. Indefinite keeping creates security, review, and context burdens. Deletion requires

authorization, exception handling, legal-hold separation, and verification across controlled copies and model-training derivatives. Record any external copies or residual uses whose removal cannot be verified.

Price the exercised vendor-exit plan in Section 30.4.2 before procurement.

Include public usability and assisted-access staffing in the archive estimate.

Archive funding fails when core functions depend on temporary grants, proprietary goodwill, or unpriced staff improvisation. No record function should activate without a funded path for correction, migration, incident response, and retirement.

32.2.4 — Care and Exit Costs

Fund the care and exit obligations in Sections 18.6 and 31.6 before participation creates reliance (Hirschman, 1970; Wertheimer, 1987).

Eligibility and continuity rules attach care and exit costs before entry. The plan identifies which supports arise because the City created burden or dependence, who decides confidentially, what emergency route applies, and how review occurs without turning care into a loyalty test.

Protect independent clinical access and continuity in the budget; operational or fundraising priorities cannot delay necessary care.

Specify which transition commitments remain portable after exit, their duration, and their funding under Section 31.6.2.

The cost model distinguishes ordinary support, acute response, aftercare, and closure continuity. Each category has an owner, trigger, duration, evidence rule, appeal route, and reserve source.

Include costs transferred to households, colleagues, and host services during a transition.

When care and exit obligations cannot be financed at the planned cohort size, intake should shrink or stop while required support remains intact (Hirschman, 1970; Wertheimer, 1987).

32.2.5 — Reserve Design

Reserves fund obligations that must survive a shock or refusal (ISO, 2019; Government Accountability Office, 2020a).

The financial account should distinguish expenditure from the funding available to meet it. Show annual operating expenditure, transfers into and out of each funded liquidity reserve, its closing balance, access restrictions, and obligations still unfunded. Here, a funded reserve means resources actually set aside, not merely an accounting provision or a promise of future donations. A lifecycle resource-cost comparison should not count that balance as if it purchased a service and then count the same service payments again. The financing plan separately shows when cash must be committed and by whom. Costs of holding or financing liquidity remain explicit. This separation makes affordability and the ability to honor an exit commitment easier to inspect.

Separate reserves by obligation and timing; do not treat a single unrestricted balance as protection for every duty.

For each reserve, record its protected purpose, minimum protected amount, eligible uses and restrictions on diversion, liquidity requirements, replenishment rule, release authority, required evidence, review interval, and consequence of falling below its threshold. The public need not receive sensitive operational detail, but it should know which obligations are ring-fenced and who can stop admissions when protection weakens.

Liquidity and budget adequacy are distinct. An institution may have assets while lacking cash available when a breach, evacuation, vendor failure, or departure occurs. Stress testing should examine timing, convertibility, legal restrictions, donor conditions, insurance delays, and the possibility that several costs arrive before reimbursement.

Compound scenarios matter more than isolated shocks. A technical incident may create legal review, public communication, participant support, staff overtime, vendor migration, and host-service demand at the same time. Donor withdrawal can coincide with reputational crisis. Reserve adequacy should be tested against correlated events rather than one emergency at a time (ISO, 2019; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

Predeclared triggers govern release. Falling below the care and exit floor stops new admissions. Falling below the maintenance floor blocks expansion. Loss of vendor-transition capacity disables affected systems. Inability to fund closure requires immediate external review. These responses should not depend on confidence, embarrassment, or founder preference.

Independent reserve governance resists momentum. Finance proposes; the rights, care, host, records, or closure owner verifies the protected need; an authorized body decides; and the decision is logged with dissent. No single team should be able to spend a reserve that exists to constrain that team.

Before admissions, jurisdiction-specific legal and financial review should establish whether care, exit, payroll, data-migration, and closure reserves can be held in segregated fiduciary, escrow, trust, or other protected arrangements that remain usable during leadership conflict, donor withdrawal, vendor failure, or insolvency. If a reserve disappears with the operator, it is not a credible exit safeguard.

After reserve use, the institution states what remains, which activities are limited, when the reserve must be restored, and what happens if restoration fails.

32.3 — Public, Philanthropic, and Mixed Finance

Compare public, philanthropic, and mixed finance by their distinct authority, dependency, and disclosure risks (Reich, 2018; Frumkin, 2006). Select the financing model through the Open Decision process in Section 32.3.4; apply Section 32.4's donor limits across models. Use the paired funding and conflict ledgers in Section 32.3.5 to make financial authority traceable (OECD, 2015; UNCITRAL, 2011). The ledger must allow reviewers to distinguish legitimate funding from conditions that quietly redirect institutional judgment.

32.3.1 — Public Funding Possibility

Public funding can be considered only under legal review, political neutrality, rights protection, and ordinary-privacy safeguards. It may offer democratic legitimacy and stable support, but it can also turn the City into a perceived government instrument, incumbent advantage, party tool, or state-sponsored credential. Because no route is presumptively mature, public finance remains a jurisdiction-specific choice subject to strict anti-capture conditions (Callahan, 2017; Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978).

Label a public-funding diagram with the actual appropriation status, accountable public body, and independent City role. Link the governing conditions; do not append the whole series safeguard list to every artifact.

Applicable public law determines authorization, election treatment, and budget process; the City specifies the proposed funding boundaries.

A lawful appropriation can make support contestable through public budget processes and reduce reliance on private funders. Neither effect is automatic.

Legal review must address constitutional, public-record, procurement, labor, privacy, administrative, and political questions before any public-funding structure is treated as possible (Frumkin, 2006; McGoey, 2015).

Public finance requires lawful authorization and public justification, including routes to challenge the arrangement.

32.3.2 — Philanthropic Funding Possibility

Philanthropic funding must pay for independence controls: review, disclosure, reserves and the ability to decline renewal (OECD, 2015; UNCITRAL, 2011). Before funding becomes operationally necessary, apply Section 29.4.3's gift test and Section 32.4's donor prohibitions.

Patient funding can support useful work before anyone commits to a full campus. A grant might pay for an accessible record-site prototype, a teaching rehearsal, or a study of how a proposed facility would be staffed. The work produces something another team can inspect and improve. Its value can survive a decision to change the larger plan. A funder can therefore support the quality of the inquiry rather than one predetermined architectural outcome. The grant agreement should make the funded question and the resulting public work clear, with enough time for the team to follow what it learns. This gives early generosity a constructive role: it helps turn a broad proposal into a smaller body of usable knowledge.

Treat donor visits, briefings and fundraising events as access channels under Section 32.4.3; disclosing a gift without examining privileged access is insufficient.

32.3.3 — Mixed Funding Possibility

Assess funding diversification by the independence of its sources, their restrictions, and their correlated risks (Frumkin, 2006; McGoey, 2015). Match each cost class to a credible source

and term; test whether several nominal sources could withdraw together.

Mixed finance also creates boundary problems. Public money may come with legal duties. Philanthropic money may come with restrictions. Vendor financing may come with technical dependence. Fee structures may create access inequity. Endowment governance may create long-term control questions. Each source must be mapped to its risks (UNCITRAL, 2011; Reich, 2018).

Mixed finance becomes safer when each source is separated by the risk it creates. A source that stands to gain private or partisan advantage from a participant's future public office cannot fund admissions; a vendor cannot finance a system it alone can operate; a donor cannot personalize participant support; and a party, campaign, or political vehicle cannot finance a participant's pathway. The funding architecture should prevent one source from combining access, dependency, and interpretive influence across several channels.

32.3.4 — Funding Open Decisions

Treat the funding mix as a jurisdiction-specific Open Decision, with alternatives and acceptance conditions recorded below (Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978; Ebrahim, 2003).

Funding review belongs at the major gates: pilot design, preconstruction, admissions, first-year operation, first audit, and replication review. A model that fits a small pilot may fail at scale, and a model that protects one host jurisdiction may create inequity in another. The review calendar remains public so an unresolved financing choice cannot quietly harden into custom.

Open does not mean vague. The document should identify which questions are unresolved: whether public funds are permissible, whether philanthropic funds are limited by amount

or category, whether an endowment is required, whether fees are prohibited, whether host communities receive statutory mitigation, and how reserve thresholds are enforced.

Unresolved design choices and moral locks belong in different categories. The funding source mix may remain unsettled; donor control may not. The exact reserve percentage may remain unsettled; the need for exit reserves may not. Public funding law may remain unsettled; legal review may not.

Distinguish proposed, authorized, and operating finance in public descriptions, linking the decision record.

Use Section 29.1.5's Open Decision record, adding alternatives, legal dependencies, interim rules, expiry, and prohibited inferences. Until the competent authority decides, any temporary arrangement should remain narrow and reversible. Neither polished language nor institutional momentum can convert an unresolved choice about public subsidy, endowment structure, tax treatment, debt, or guarantee into settled City policy (HM Treasury, 2026a; Ebrahim, 2003).

32.3.5 — Transparency of Funding

Publish the material funding terms and influence pathways while protecting legitimate personal and security information (UNCITRAL, 2011; Reich, 2018).

Two ledgers are necessary: a public funding ledger and an internal conflict ledger. The first preserves public visibility over sources, terms, and restrictions; the second allows deeper review of conflicts that may contain sensitive information. Independent oversight can inspect both under appropriate safeguards, so unreported generosity never has to be accepted on faith.

Update funding risk when contributions accumulate, restrictions change, budgets tighten, or renewal approaches (McGoey, 2015; Callahan, 2017).

Any proposed funding model therefore needs a funding-risk matrix. The matrix should identify the source, benefit, restriction, influence risk, legal review need, conflict pathway, exit consequence, disclosure status, and safeguard required before acceptance.

The public funding register records source, amount, restrictions, concentration, renewal expectations, related parties, vendor ties, governance contacts, and rejected conditions. It should reveal whether money shapes choices without exposing every administrative detail, remaining readable to citizens and auditable by specialists.

Retain rejected conditions in the conflict ledger, with a safe public account where appropriate (Reich, 2018; Frumkin, 2006).

Reversal testing asks how finance behaves after goodwill ends, when a major funder becomes hostile, insolvent, constrained, or unwilling to continue. Contracts, data custody, staff pay, maintenance, portability, reserves, and shutdown duties must remain usable without personal favor or emergency surrender. The file must show how the institution can continue, narrow, or close after a major exit (Government Accountability Office, 2020a; HM Treasury, 2026a).

Assign authority to decline, return, isolate, or expire funds under the risk matrix (OECD, 2017b; International Monetary Fund, 2016).

32.4 — Anti-Capture Funding and Donor Limits

The donor limits below turn the review framework into specific access and authority barriers (Rose-Ackerman and Palifka, 2016; OECD, 2015). Assess both written terms and observable informal influence when applying these limits (Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978; Rose-Ackerman and Palifka, 2016). A nominal ceiling is inadequate if a donor can obtain equivalent leverage through intermediaries or exclusive access. Reviewers need a workable route to disclose and unwind that dependency.

32.4.1 — No Admission Influence

No admission influence means that money cannot purchase entry, priority, leniency, role pathway, visibility advantage, review delay, appeal favor, or quiet exception. The prohibition covers direct requests and indirect leverage through board members, founders, sponsors, intermediaries, named programs, political allies, or staff anticipation of donor preference (World Bank, 2020; Rose-Ackerman and Palifka, 2016).

The firewall begins with information separation. Fundraising personnel do not receive application files. Admissions personnel do not receive donor identities or contribution histories except where a legally necessary conflict alert is routed through independent compliance. Shared databases, informal briefings, and calendar access should be restricted accordingly.

Every donor contact about an applicant is logged, preserved, and routed outside the admissions chain. The record states who initiated contact, what was requested, who received it, what action followed, and whether any reviewer needs recusal.

Intermediated influence requires beneficial-control review. A request may arrive through a foundation, adviser, alumni group, political office, partner organization, or scholarship sponsor

rather than the economic source of support. The firewall follows the influence network, not only the name on the message.

Access support remains permissible when it is independent of donor preference. Translation, travel aid, disability accommodation, application help, legal assistance, and broad outreach can reduce unequal opportunity. They should be financed through general pools with published criteria and administered by staff who cannot confer admission advantage.

Selection analysis tests for unexplained associations with donor networks, schools, regions, families, public figures, or sponsored programs. Statistical patterns do not prove improper influence, but they can trigger file review, process testing, and stronger separation. The analysis must avoid turning applicants into public suspicion objects.

When the City cannot finance itself without donor access to selection, the correct finding is financial nonreadiness. The remedy is a smaller program, a different funding model, delayed admissions, or refusal of the money, never a softer firewall (Ebrahim, 2003; Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978).

32.4.2 — No Naming Sovereignty

No naming sovereignty means that recognition cannot become jurisdiction. A donor may not use a name, brand, memorial, endowed title, or sponsored program to control admission, curriculum, archive interpretation, hiring, research priority, public communication, governance, or future use of the institution. Recognition is subordinate to function and revocable public responsibility (Reich, 2018; Callahan, 2017).

The naming policy distinguishes core civic assets, noncore spaces, temporary acknowledgments, historical records, and program descriptions. Archive, rights, complaint, care, exit, deliberation, and accreditation functions should not be branded

as private property. The public should never have to speak a donor’s name to use a right.

Every naming term has scope, duration, renewal conditions, conflict review, public status, and revocation grounds. Perpetual recognition is especially dangerous because future leaders inherit dependence without fresh consent.

The agreement prohibits design control and symbolic supremacy. A contribution cannot require monumental scale, privileged location, exclusive access, donor portraiture in rights spaces, or aesthetic choices that imply ownership. Architecture remains accountable to accessibility, function, host context, and cost discipline.

Related-party and cumulative naming effects matter. Several modest agreements from one economic network can create a campus that feels privately owned even when no single term crosses the formal threshold. Review should aggregate related donors, entities, family offices, advisers, and vendor ties.

Revocation must be operational. The City should know who can remove a name, what evidence is required, how records preserve the historical fact of the gift, how costs are funded, and how public explanation avoids both concealment and spectacle.

Recognition never purchases narrative immunity. Public records may state the contribution and its accepted purpose while also recording rejected conditions, conflicts, later review, suspension, or revocation.

A donor may withdraw support when a name is refused or removed. That possibility belongs in reserve and dependency analysis before the gift is accepted.

When the distinction remains unclear, the naming arrangement is declined.

32.4.3 — No Archive Access

Contribution grants no privileged archive access. A donor receives only the permissions independently justified for the same lawful access class (ISO, 2016a; W3C, 2013).

The prohibition extends to informal preview. Briefings, demonstrations, donor tours, technical pilots, board packets, and fundraising stories can reveal protected information without granting a formal account. Every access path, including export, screen share, sample data, and model output, should be governed by the same role and purpose rules.

Research support does not purchase data priority. A funder may support a lawful research program only under independent protocol, consent, governance, publication, and conflict review. The funder may not choose participants, compel reuse, delay adverse findings, receive identifiable data, or obtain a proprietary model of the record system.

Apply Chapter 30’s vendor controls and combined-conflict review where a donor also supplies technical services.

Anomaly review tests unusual access patterns involving funders, board members, executives, vendors, researchers, and their intermediaries. Detection supports investigation; it does not create public accusation by algorithm. Independent human review remains necessary before any finding or remedy.

Public demonstrations use synthetic or deliberately prepared records that cannot reconstruct a person through rare details. Even anonymized examples can expose identity when the cohort is small. The burden of showing technical capability belongs to the institution, not to participants whose lives make the demonstration interesting.

Use Section 30.5.3’s affected-person route to challenge suspected donor or vendor interference with access.

A breach or near miss involving a funder triggers more than ordinary incident response. The review examines the funding relationship, governance access, vendor ties, staff pressure, public communication, and whether continued support is compatible with independence. Money may need to be returned or segregated.

Do not activate a donor-dependent archive function until the refusal and exit test in Section 32.3.5 passes (NIST, 2024a; Government Accountability Office, 2020b).

32.4.4 — No Priority Governance

Financial support creates no priority in governance. It cannot buy agenda order, board seats, vetoes, committee control, staff appointments, policy priority, audit scope, public-message approval, or faster resolution of a preferred issue. Advice may be heard through the same lawful routes available to others, but governing authority arises from the institution’s public structure rather than the size of a gift (Reich, 2018; Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978).

The rule reaches soft priority as well as formal authority. A donor dinner, recurring private briefing, early access to plans, privileged access to founders, or repeated invitation to strategic sessions can shape attention without a formal vote. Contact frequency, subject, participants, and resulting actions belong in the influence record.

Review material financial, professional, or personal ties of proposed governors across the funding network; formal independence alone is insufficient.

Agenda-setting power remains traceable. Proposals identify origin, supporting evidence, conflicts, affected people, decision owner, and disposition. When a donor-originated proposal

proceeds, the record should show the same review applied to any other proposal and why the issue belongs within City authority.

Funders cannot control silence. Agreements should prohibit approval rights over publication, criticism, incident notice, adverse findings, suspension, decertification, or return of funds. Confidentiality may protect lawful private information, but it cannot suppress institutional facts necessary for rights, audit, or public accountability.

Priority governance also includes negative control. A supporter must not be able to slow a review, postpone a public warning, narrow an audit, or threaten withdrawal to prevent an uncomfortable decision.

Publish material contacts, recusals, rejected conditions, and resulting decisions through the funding ledger, with necessary protection.

A near miss triggers process review. Staff anticipation of donor preference, an agenda item moved after a funding conversation, or a reviewer excluded because of anticipated controversy may reveal capture even when no explicit instruction exists. Institutional dependence often acts through expectation.

32.4.5 — Donor Audit

Audit the funding-risk matrix and related-party exposure, testing whether the controls below operate in practice (OECD, 2015; OECD, 2025c; UNCITRAL, 2011; World Bank Group, 2025).

Donor audit requires enforceable remedies. A gift may be rejected, restructured, publicly anonymized only where lawful and consistent with required influence disclosure, moved to a blind general fund if permissible, separated from naming, refunded, or prohibited from renewal. If donor conduct crosses

into influence attempt, the response should be logged and reported to oversight.

Include donor-centered imagery, ceremonies, and founder-donor narratives in the naming audit; informal representation can imply ownership without a formal naming term.

A cooling-off rule governs major gifts tied to public controversy, campaign cycles, vendor selection, land decisions, or admissions windows. Timing can create influence even when a gift contains no explicit condition.

Review independently before acceptance and throughout the relationship; changed circumstances may make a previously acceptable gift incompatible with the controls.

Aggregate related vehicles, creditors, pledges, and intermediaries by beneficial control where lawful; test cumulative exposure and refusal capacity (World Bank, 2020; OECD, 2025c; World Bank Group, 2025; Rose-Ackerman and Palifka, 2016).

Adverse scenarios test the donor limits. Reviewers can test a request for admissions preference, a naming demand, an attempt to reach protected records, pressure to suppress criticism, a vendor tie, or a condition attached through an intermediary. The drill should record who received the request, who classified it, who could stop it, what was disclosed, what remained protected, and how the institution continued after refusal (OECD, 2015; ISO, 2025a; Government Accountability Office, 2020b).

32.5 — Local Labor, Regional Spillovers, Civic Benefit

Appraisal includes the receiving region's costs as well as the City budget (Miller and Blair, 2009; Moretti, 2010). The local ledger is governed by distribution rather than aggregate benefit. Employment quality, wage standards, construction disruption, housing effects, traffic, public-services load, environmental and health effects, emergency response, local procurement, cultural spillover, public access, and grievance routes must be traceable to the people who experience them. The baseline, geographic boundary, time period, confidence, and method should be published at an appropriate level. A regional-benefit claim remains incomplete until affected people can challenge its assumptions, obtain mitigation, and see what would cause the claim to be revised or withdrawn (International Finance Corporation, 2012; OECD, 2025d; MHCLG, 2026).

32.5.1 — Local Hiring

Judge local hiring by job quality, progression, and decision-making opportunity, not a headline headcount (Zuk et al., 2018; Chapple and Zuk, 2016).

Celebratory worker images can counterfeit local consent. A fair report can show job categories, wage bands, training completion, retention, safety incidents, promotion rates, complaint routes, and contract standards without using local faces as decoration.

The role map distinguishes work that can be recruited locally, work that requires specialized qualification, and work that should include funded training or apprenticeship. A target percentage alone cannot answer whether the resulting jobs are safe, durable, and influential. Preserve required qualifications and fund training pathways for local workers into specialist

roles; importing expertise alone does not establish a regional benefit.

Apply Chapter 21's worker privacy and role-record protections to local hires (Moretti, 2010; Kline and Moretti, 2014).

Local hiring is protected from political patronage. A host region may have powerful networks that try to place relatives, allies, contractors, or party affiliates into jobs. Anti-capture review must apply locally as well as nationally.

32.5.2 — Housing Pressure

Assess housing demand before acquisition and throughout development, including pressure from temporary visitors and contractors (International Finance Corporation, 2012; OECD, 2025d).

Use early triggers to pause growth or require mitigation before displacement accumulates, drawing on short-term lodging pressure, tenant and landlord reports, and the neighborhood measures below. Annual reporting alone is too slow when displacement is accumulating.

Include effects of site choice, lodging provision, transport, and phasing in the housing model.

Choose locally lawful mitigation against the measured pressure; possible tools include growth limits, housing support, transport, and host agreements.

State the limits of causal inference. Do not attribute every housing-market movement to the City, or use uncertainty to avoid investigating plausible project effects (Chapple and Zuk, 2016; World Bank, 2017a).

Monitoring begins before land acquisition is public and continues through construction, occupancy, and every expansion gate. Averages can hide displacement at the lower end of the

market, so the review should track rent, vacancy, eviction, conversion, commute, and service access by neighborhood and household vulnerability. Mitigation may require slower growth, employer-assisted housing limits, anti-displacement funding, or a different site rather than a celebratory claim about regional demand (Chapple and Zuk, 2016; Zuk et al., 2018).

32.5.3 — Public Services Load

Estimate incremental demand on local infrastructure and public services, distinguishing ordinary cost sharing from a project subsidy (Moretti, 2010; Kline and Moretti, 2014).

Public reporting calls a subsidy a subsidy rather than hiding it inside the phrase community partnership. The report should show what the City uses, what it pays, what it mitigates, what remains disputed, and how local residents can challenge undercounting.

Emergency services require special attention because the City's record, security, and protected nonvisibility protocols may be unfamiliar. Local responders should not be forced to improvise during crisis. Training, access maps, communications protocols, legal review, and reimbursement agreements may be necessary before opening.

Count the demands on water, energy, communications, waste, sewer, and resilience systems, including necessary upgrades. Capacity consumed without support for expansion or conservation transfers costs to the host.

Administrative load can be invisible. Permits, inspections, complaints, public meetings, legal review, zoning, transport planning, environmental review, and public-record coordination all require local government time. The City should treat administrative burden as real labor, not as friction caused by local hesitation (OECD, 2025d; Miller and Blair, 2009).

Use host agreements to assign payment, mitigation, and redesign duties, then audit delivery.

32.5.4 — Regional Benefit

Use a paired regional benefit and burden statement identifying who gains, who pays, when each effect appears, the conditions producing it, and how the distribution changes over time.

A host community may value jobs and still refuse a site, object to extraction, or demand housing safeguards. Benefits do not purchase consent or silence.

The review should also distinguish indirect effects on schools and clinics and the particular concerns of Indigenous, historically marginalized, or economically vulnerable communities.

Regional benefit may include shared infrastructure, public education spaces, local contracting, community review offices, visitor management, public archives accessible to host residents, and local complaint pathways. These benefits should be designed with host input rather than delivered as gifts decided elsewhere (Kline and Moretti, 2014; Zuk et al., 2018).

State uncertainty, additionality, displacement, and distribution before claiming a regional benefit.

32.5.5 — Host Equity Review

Give affected local groups standing to test, condition, and challenge project burdens through the review and reopening process below (OECD, 2025d; Miller and Blair, 2009).

Route host complaints to investigation and remedy under the agreement (Kline and Moretti, 2014; Zuk et al., 2018).

Protect local criticism from retaliation and treat it as possible evidence, not disloyalty.

The host ledger distinguishes predictable burdens, which require pre-opening mitigation, from unexpected burdens, which

require investigation and remedy whether raised by complaint or detected through monitoring.

Co-design shared learning and public access with host representatives; use the paired benefit-and-burden statement to assess the result (World Bank, 2017b; International Finance Corporation, 2012).

Review at baseline, annually, after material incidents, and at each expansion gate.

The host review body receives the housing, traffic, emergency-service, environmental, procurement, employment, complaint, and community-input data needed for its mandate. It should also have the authority to publish disagreement with the City's own narrative (Miller and Blair, 2009; Moretti, 2010).

The host equity report presents distribution rather than a single net-benefit figure. New jobs may accrue to commuters while rents rise for nearby tenants; procurement may favor large firms while public-service demand falls on a small jurisdiction. The review should therefore separate benefits and burdens by place, time, income, tenure, disability, occupation, and exposure, then record which mitigation is funded and who may reopen the agreement when conditions change (Kline and Moretti, 2014; OECD, 2025d). Mitigation should be tied to the affected group and observable outcome, so a benefit elsewhere cannot be counted as repair for a local burden.

Keep reporting categories stable across periods, stating confidence, additionality, displacement, and uncertainty so reviewers can test whether mitigation reached the original burdened group (OECD, 2025d; MHCLG, 2026; Moretti, 2010).

Continuing host review must include affected-person complaint, public explanation of changed assumptions, and authority to renegotiate mitigation, slow growth, suspend a function, or require exit (OECD, 2026b; World Bank, 2017b;

MHCLG, 2026). Each review should end with a public account of the agreed adjustment, its responsible owner, and the next occasion for checking delivery. For each material mitigation, the agreement should specify what evidence will count as delivery and who can challenge that evidence, including a route for affected residents whose access needs prevent attendance at a hearing. A missed deadline should trigger a documented review of interim protection and any escalation already authorized by the agreement, keeping the unfinished obligation visible until resolved.

32.6 — The Cost of Leaving Leader Formation Private

The final comparison uses Section 32.1's cost methods to test feasible alternatives under the same assumptions (Besley, 2005; Dal Bó et al., 2017). The comparison remains an appraisal input; it does not itself authorize expenditure (Power, 1997; Besley, 2005). The alternative must include its own failure costs rather than assume that leaving the current system untouched is free. Those estimates remain contestable and should use the same time horizon as the City's budget.

32.6.1 — Late Discovery Cost

The financial mechanism is a timing comparison. It asks what it costs to discover conflicts, misconduct, dependency, incapacity, or formation gaps during a campaign, after appointment, during crisis, or after public harm. Then it asks which of those discoveries could responsibly have occurred during City formation without invading ordinary private life or creating public appetite for exposure.

For each material fact, compare when it became observable with when it became consequential and who bore the delay (Bowler and Karp, 2004; Kumlin and Esaiasson, 2012).

Use the scandal-cost method in Section 32.1.3 to compare these stages, including earlier discovery without public scandal; classify each burden once.

32.6.2 — Donor Dependence Cost

Apply the hidden-formation and corruption methods to dependence on private funding, without limiting the inquiry to illegal conduct (Bowler and Karp, 2004; Kumlin and Esaiasson, 2012). Use renewal and withdrawal events to test documented changes in choices or access, rather than assuming quiet agreement proves capture.

Even within the law, a candidate or future official may be shaped by repeated rooms, donor expectations, consultant advice, social gratitude, and fear of losing support.

Private filters can narrow the public's eventual candidate choice and the policy options presented as feasible, while concealing the relationships that sustained a campaign.

Test whether pooled stabilization reduces personal dependence while counting any new institutional funding dependence (Hetherington, 2005; OECD, 2017b).

Include evidenced pre-campaign support and access relationships, limiting collection to role relevance rather than a general emotional or social profile.

32.6.3 — Bad Office Cost

Bad office imposes public cost when a person with substantial authority governs poorly, abuses power, neglects duties, mistreats staff, makes reckless decisions, or enters office under hidden dependency. The category must be handled carefully. The City cannot promise good office. It can ask whether some failures might be reduced by better visible formation, correction, and readiness review (Besley, 2005; Dal Bó et al., 2017).

Use role-specific evidence for appraisal; Chapter 11's personal-scoring prohibitions apply.

Trace public consequences to affected services and people instead of assigning one generic cost to poor officeholding.

Much of that cost is cumulative rather than spectacular. Avoidable delay, poor appointments, unclear explanation, weak administration, refusal to listen, overconfidence with data, mishandled opposition, and contempt for staff can each remain below the threshold of scandal while steadily degrading public life. Formation evidence is relevant only where it helps the public recognize and respond to those role-specific failures.

Treat improved later judgment as a hypothesis to evaluate under actual office conditions. City performance provides no entitlement or immunity from subsequent review.

32.6.4 — Status-Quo Comparison Discipline

Measure administrative friction associated with warranted mistrust separately from repeated checking and interpretation under uncertainty, avoiding double counting with the public-trust costs in Section 32.1.4 (Hetherington, 2005; OECD, 2017a; Bowler and Karp, 2004; Kumlin and Esaiasson, 2012).

Pair each claimed status-quo burden with the City's corresponding risk: scandal with record breach, political donor dependence with institutional funding dependence, and mistrust under opacity with mistrust caused by overexposure or overclaim.

Version changed estimates through Section 32.1.5's calculation record, including adverse revisions.

A mature public budget would also distinguish between costs that are necessary at launch, costs that belong to the pilot gate, costs that can wait until replication, and costs that must exist before any participant bears visible burden. This sequencing prevents the City from pretending that every future safeguard must be purchased on day one, while also preventing essential protections from being postponed indefinitely (Hetherington, 2005; OECD, 2017a).

A field experiment makes the need for a joint outcome test concrete. In 311 Bangladeshi land offices, monthly scorecards reporting service delays improved on-time processing by approximately six percentage points from a comparison level of 56 percent. They did not reduce bribe payments on average; bribe payments increased among offices that had been higher-performing before the intervention (Mattsson, 2025). The

experiment tested performance scorecards, not the City. Its relevance is that a verified administrative gain need not resolve every burden attached to the same service.

The City's comparison should therefore examine timing alongside decision correctness, ability to contest an error, improper demands, workers' load, and consequences for people with limited access. Each has its own evidence and authorized reviewer; none is erased by a favorable single indicator. The test is comparative, not a claim that the City already delivers those combined gains.

Do not equate private mentorship or civic formation with corruption. The comparison concerns inspectable pathways into consequential public roles.

Compare the City with the no-build baseline and alternatives such as stronger campaign disclosure, party training, inspector independence, civic education, public-interest fellowships, archives, journalism, and public administration. Price feasible combinations of smaller reforms, counting shared staff, facilities, and oversight once. Include opportunity cost: resources committed here cannot simultaneously serve another public purpose (Boardman et al., 2018; HM Treasury, 2026a).

Chapter 33 — Construction, Host Review, and Pilot

The City's commitments face a different test when plans become a building. Drawings can be revised without dust, and budgets can be corrected without waking a neighborhood at dawn. A record protocol can appear exact before a participant asks whether a protected conversation has become searchable. Construction makes the burdens physical and harder to reverse, providing evidence of whether the institution's values can survive contact with reality.

A pilot earns its value by testing whether the City can carry its principles under ordinary pressure. Purpose, users, operating environment, evidence thresholds, dependencies, rights, and exit conditions are declared before readiness is judged. Stop authority must work before momentum, labor exposure, or participant commitment makes reversal harder. Construction labor, protected records, care, and rehearsed exit are therefore first-order pilot outcomes rather than background conditions (Government Accountability Office, 2020b; International Labour Organization, 1988).

The first City can produce operational evidence. It can show that a rights route worked, or did not. It can show that an archive error was caught, corrected, and explained. It can show that staff strain forced an admissions pause. It can show that a host community had power to require mitigation. Those demonstrations matter, but their status stays operational. They are not scientific validation, moral certification, legal enactment, transition authorization, or proof of the Law.

The word pilot therefore carries a strict operational meaning. It names a bounded test with defined scope, questions, evidence sources, independent review routes, care plans for affected people, and public explanation rules. It is not a marketing label for a partial launch or a signal that success has already been

decided. Everyone around the pilot should be able to identify what remains uncertain and which result ends the experiment.

The integrated gate file helps reviewers detect when separate teams have declared readiness while the whole system remains unsafe at the interfaces. A record system may pass technical tests while staffing cannot sustain correction; a building may pass inspection while sensory burden remains intolerable; a host agreement may exist before emergency coordination is usable. Integrated review preserves noncompensable gates, tests their handoffs, records dissent, and forbids an overall score from averaging away a critical failure.

A staged pilot operates as a chain of expiring permissions. Design approval permits design; construction approval permits only the bounded build; commissioning permits tested occupancy functions; occupancy does not authorize admissions; one safe cohort does not authorize growth; and operational continuity does not authorize replication. Every gate names its owner, evidence threshold, affected-person route, unresolved burden, expiry date, and decision record. Later reviewers can then distinguish earned permission from inherited momentum (Government Accountability Office, 2020b; HM Treasury, 2026b).

33.1 — Design Thresholds and Go/No-Go Criteria

Design thresholds become credible when they account for the interaction of different authorities, not only the readiness of each office considered alone. At construction, commissioning, admissions, capture, release, office interface, and replication, the City should identify who may authorize or stop a consequential action, what information each actor can lawfully receive, and which feedback confirms that a necessary handoff has occurred. A rights officer may properly place a publication hold while an outdated clearance remains in the release queue. A participant may obtain lawful permission to exit while the promised transfer of essential support has not reached the receiving provider. Both are cross-functional hazards even when each office can demonstrate compliance with its own procedure.

33.1.1 — Rights Gate

A useful gate has a controlled form. It names the stage, decision owner, independent reviewer, affected persons, required evidence, source version, pass threshold, uncertainty, dissent, challenge and appeal route, evidence expiry, immediate protection after failure, remedy owed to people already affected, and date of the next review.

The gate file uses three distinct statuses. A hard gate blocks movement until a protected condition exists, such as lawful record custody, worker stop authority, usable exit, or manual fallback. A conditional gate permits one narrow, dated step after a specified repair and before additional active burden reaches people. A watchpoint records uncertainty that does not yet warrant stopping but must be measured against a named trigger and review date. No status is averaged into an overall score, and conditional permission expires when its evidence becomes stale.

The Rights Gate tests consent, shielding, complaint, appeal, remedy, anti-retaliation, and lawful review through adverse scenarios under an independent rights lead. Failure blocks occupancy or admissions until people are protected and the full route is retested (Skivington et al., 2021; HM Treasury, 2026b).

Imagine a milestone review three weeks before the announced opening. Construction is substantially complete, the public interface has performed well in demonstrations, funding is secure, and the first cohort has traveled to the host region. The archive drill then reveals that a protected nonparticipant can be reidentified through linked search results, while staff scheduling shows no independent coverage for overnight correction and breach response.

Launch pressure is intense because delay will cost money and embarrass supporters. The gate file makes those considerations visible but noncontrolling. The archive gate fails, the staff gate is not met, and the exit gate is activated for applicants who cannot wait. Admissions are postponed, travel and housing costs are covered, the host receives a public explanation, the technical system is disabled for repair, and the next review date is set.

Scenario testing gives the rights gate its first operational evidence of usability. One scenario should involve a participant who asks to pause after seeing the record rules in practice. Another should involve a household member who objects to incidental exposure. Another should involve a third party whose name appears in a deliberation record (HM Treasury, 2026c; United Nations, 2006).

Test complaints at each record stage against the responsible office and its remedy powers; users must not need technical vocabulary to obtain protection. Independent care, accommodation, sensory access, emergency support, de-loading, and continuity must be staffed and rehearsed. A missing support

condition blocks or narrows occupancy and admissions until that support is real.

Keep informal ombuds navigation separate from formal rights decisions, independent appeal, and emergency stop authority under Section 29.3. Test their handoffs under pressure.

A simple readiness exercise can reveal the gap between rights language and rights access. Give a test participant a confusing release notice at the end of a long day and ask where they would go, who would answer, and what would happen by tomorrow morning. If the route works only when the person is rested, confident, and legally fluent, the route is not yet a rights route (Government Accountability Office, 2020b; NASA, 2016).

Timing can determine whether a rights route is usable. Emergency containment, a reasoned interim order, ordinary review, and later compensation serve different purposes and need different clocks. A later remedy remains necessary where harm occurred, but it cannot make an irreversible disclosure harmless. The gate should show which authorized person can act immediately and how that action receives prompt independent review.

33.1.2 — Archive Gate

The gate file also preserves minority findings. If the archive team says ready, the rights reviewer says not yet, and the host reviewer says only with mitigation, the public summary cannot compress those judgments into one reassuring tone. Dissent is early warning, not disloyalty. The decision record identifies which finding controls, who may appeal, what evidence could change it, and whether a conflict of interest affects the reviewer (Government Accountability Office, 2020b; NASA, 2016).

The Archive Gate tests Chapter 30’s separated record functions end to end (NIST, 2020a; W3C, 2013).

Use synthetic and mock records for the Archive Gate's pre-activation tests. Test files should include a disputed statement, a protected family detail, a machine-generated summary error, a delayed-release item, an access request from an affected person, and a suspected tamper event. The question is whether the archive routes each item differently and correctly (Government Accountability Office, 2020b; NASA, 2016).

Use Chapter 29's independent review and Chapter 11's secondary-use limits when an archive decision crosses functions.

Also test routine metadata errors: a wrong timestamp, an inverted speaker label, a missing context note, or a delayed item in the wrong queue (HM Treasury, 2026b; HM Treasury, 2026c).

The archive also needs a degraded-mode plan. If the public record site goes down, if search becomes unreliable, if a release queue stalls, or if an integrity alarm triggers, the City should know whether capture continues, whether access is suspended, and how users are told.

A failed archive test blocks the dependent activation under Section 33.1. Isolate and repair the failed function while retaining necessary care, complaint, and evidence-preservation routes (NIST, 2025b; W3C, 2013).

A hostile linkage test belongs in the Archive Gate. Reviewers attempt to reidentify a protected person by combining search results, timestamps, travel records, and public summaries without using privileged access. A system that protects each field separately may still fail through composition. The gate therefore evaluates the query environment, not only the storage layer, and it can require delayed release, coarser public bundles, human review, or a narrower search class (NIST, 2020b; NIST, 2024a).

33.1.3 — Staff Gate

System-Theoretic Process Analysis (STPA) provides a useful methodological comparison: it examines unsafe control actions and missing feedback in complex systems rather than treating each component failure as independent. Thomas and colleagues (2026) applied this approach to a national healthcare organizational system. The City could adapt a bounded version before activation: select one high-consequence process, map its authorized decision and feedback links, identify actions that must never occur, and test those links with independent reviewers during realistic staffed drills. A control diagram is not proof of readiness. The relevant result is whether a recorded rehearsal shows that the safeguarding authorities remain effective together when the expected handoff fails.

Test staffing ratios, competence, role separation, rest, protected complaint, surge, and replacement coverage using actual rosters, competency evidence, relief coverage, and protected reporting. Failure delays opening or limits the cohort; unpaid heroics do not substitute for capacity.

A practical stress scenario tests the Staff Gate. A key archivist is absent, a participant files an urgent complaint, a public interface attracts hostile attention, and a maintenance fault affects a protected zone. The question is whether the City can act lawfully without heroics.

Give workers and independent labor reviewers a protected route to contest claimed readiness.

A useful staff test is the unpopular stop. During rehearsal, a mid-level staff member should be able to halt a process that senior leadership wants to continue, and the route should protect that person from retaliation (Cooper, 1990; Government Accountability Office, 2020b).

Plan for sickness, resignation, grief, error, and rest. Specify which functions continue, slow, or stop when staffing falls below the declared floor.

33.1.4 — Host Gate

The Host Gate verifies that Section 32.5's local commitments are current and usable before the next project stage (HM Treasury, 2026c; World Bank, 2017b). Review permits, services, traffic, housing, environment, emergency coordination, mitigation, and community routes. A failed condition pauses the affected stage for mitigation, redesign, compensation, relocation, or no-go.

Permit compliance does not establish that all local burdens are addressed; update the burden map before construction and occupancy. Verify safety, procurement, subcontractor conditions, environmental controls, accessibility, commissioning, and defect closure. Failed construction or labor conditions stop the affected work or occupancy rather than being traded against the schedule.

Test the host agreement's mitigation funding, service coordination, and complaint route through the street-level exercise below.

Provide independent host challenge and publish resulting changes and material unresolved objections.

A host gate can be tested at street level (Skivington et al., 2021; HM Treasury, 2026b). Can a resident find the construction contact? Can a small business learn when delivery routes will change? Can a school or clinic know whether emergency access is affected?

Use the agreement's reopening triggers when construction or occupancy reveals new burden.

33.1.5 — Artificial Intelligence and Vendor Gate

The AI and Vendor Gate tests the technical card and exercised exit plan in Chapter 30 before deployment (Government Accountability Office, 2020b; NASA, 2016).

Assign independent review of the proposed data flow, function, and failure response; procurement alone does not authorize use.

Adversarial tests precede deployment. These tests should cover hallucinated summaries, biased search ranking, access-class confusion, protected-category leakage, deepfake insertion, credential misuse, vendor outage, ransomware pressure, malicious prompt attempts, and a public query that asks for moral or psychological ranking.

Include staff who will operate the service and independently test vendor exit and degraded operation.

A revealing dry run asks the record site to answer a query it has no authority to answer. When a user asks which participant is most trustworthy, which staff member is biased, or which applicant is morally ready, the record site must refuse the scoring premise and route the user toward source records, limitations, and accountable human judgment. A machine-generated nonanswer is not enough if the interface still legitimizes the question (NIST, 2023a; Cooper, 1990).

Disable a function that fails the card's purpose, evidence, protection, or exit conditions; freeze stages that depend on it (Government Accountability Office, 2020b; NASA, 2016).

33.1.6 — Exit Gate

The Exit Gate tests Chapter 31's departure routes before activation, including withdrawal before entry, ordinary voluntary departure and exit with unresolved remedies (Section 31.6; HM Treasury, 2026b; HM Treasury, 2026c).

Use an authorized transition owner independent of admissions pressure, with funded support and a usable review route. Before activation, fund and rehearse pause, withdrawal, housing, health, dependent continuity, records, severance, vendor transition, host repair, and closure under compound stress. Failure blocks activation.

Route contested exit classification through Section 31.2.5 without delaying the person’s ability to leave.

A readiness exercise asks a participant advocate to leave the City on behalf of a hypothetical participant at the worst plausible moment: after public criticism, before a scheduled release, during staff shortage, and while a household need remains unresolved (NASA, 2016; Skivington et al., 2021).

The Exit Gate fails when a person cannot leave without losing necessary care, housing, debt relief, record protection, or dignity in public explanation. It also fails when public summaries convert exit into shame or loyalty testing. The remedy is not persuasion. It is redesigned exit terms, aftercare reserve, record limitation, public correction, and admissions freeze until withdrawal is truly available (HM Treasury, 2026b; HM Treasury, 2026c). An exit dry run should include a simultaneous service interruption: the chosen outside provider becomes temporarily unreachable while a participant needs an agreed transfer of care or housing support. The City’s authorized transition owner must activate a funded fallback and obtain confirmation from the receiving service without making the participant repeat unnecessary private history. The final check records whether the person actually retained access after departure, not only whether referral instructions were issued.

33.2 — Construction and Labor Dignity

Construction tests the City's safeguards through actual contracts, work, and local effects (International Labour Organization, 1988; International Labour Organization, 2022b). The build record shows safety planning, procurement method, beneficial ownership where lawful, rated criteria, contractor and subcontractor conditions, environmental accounting, accessibility review, change-order justification, local disruption, worker complaint, inspection, defect closure, and vendor exit. Personal data remain protected, but institutional choices and material contract changes remain auditable (OECD, 2025c; World Bank Group, 2025; International Labour Organization, 2022b). Acceleration can reduce exposure, cost, or uncertainty, but it becomes dangerous when it compresses safety meetings, procurement review, host notice, accessibility testing, environmental control, worker recovery, commissioning, or defect closure.

33.2.1 — Worker Safety

Use a site-specific safety plan covering the hazards, supervision, paid training, incident response, and worker stop powers relevant to the work.

A responsibility map prevents subcontracting from dissolving accountability. The City must know who is on site, who employs each worker, what training and language access they received, how hazards are reported, how pay and working time are verified, and which principal has authority to correct unsafe conditions. A worker should reach a safe ladder, clean air, protective equipment, or a stopped lift through one usable route rather than navigate a chain of companies.

Near misses belong in the safety record because they show whether the institution learns before injury occurs. A falling

object that misses a worker, a vehicle that reverses into the wrong lane, or a scaffold tag ignored for an hour should matter. The City should reward early hazard discovery rather than quiet luck.

Safety planning reaches less dramatic risks: heat stress, fatigue, repetitive strain, language misunderstanding, rushed cleanup, poor lighting, blocked sanitation, and deadline pressure to remain silent.

Worker-facing evidence, not management reports alone, tests the safety plan. A person on the site should know how to stop work, how to report a blocked exit, how to refuse an unsafe lift, how to ask for translation, how to get paid for safety training, and how to complain without being quietly removed from the schedule. The City should make the safest action the easiest action, especially for temporary workers, subcontracted workers, apprentices, cleaners, drivers, and people whose immigration, language, or economic position makes retaliation more frightening (International Labour Organization, 2022b; ISO, 2021b).

The stop rule is direct. A serious unaddressed hazard, retaliation against a worker who reports risk, repeated near misses, hidden injury data, unpaid safety training, or contractor resistance to stop-work authority should halt the relevant work package. The remedy is correction, compensation where harm occurred, contractor discipline, schedule revision, and public explanation of the institutional action (OECD, 2015; UNCITRAL, 2011).

33.2.2 — Fair Procurement

Procurement review covers selection, contract performance, payment, and change orders (World Bank, 2017a; United Nations, 2011).

Fair procurement also protects smaller local firms from symbolic inclusion. If local businesses are invited only to appear in public materials while major contracts travel through closed networks, the City has reproduced the hidden pipeline it criticizes. Procurement should distinguish capacity-building, fair competition, anti-capture review, and honest refusal when a local firm is not the right fit.

Procurement oversight remains independent through officers separated from donor relations, external audit, conflict review, transparent change-order summaries, labor and environmental review, and a complaint route for bidders and workers. Sensitive details may need protection, but secrecy should not cover influence, favoritism, or unexplained cost movement (OECD, 2025c; World Bank Group, 2025).

A seemingly helpful shortcut tests procurement independence. A supporter knows a contractor, a donor offers discounted equipment, a vendor offers bundled services, or an official suggests a favored local partner. The City should have a route for appreciating help while still requiring ordinary review, recusal, and comparison.

Trace payment and labor conditions through subcontracting tiers after award. Review late payment, squeezed lower-tier terms, and change orders as well as the original bid (UNCITRAL, 2011; International Finance Corporation, 2012).

Fair procurement tests competence without borrowing prestige. A renowned architect, admired technology firm, respected donor, or politically connected contractor may bring genuine skill, but reputation cannot substitute for competition, conflict review, performance evidence, labor conditions, portability, or price discipline. The file should answer a simple counterfactual: would the selection still be defensible if the name attached to it were ordinary?

Procurement fails when the record shows undisclosed conflicts, donor influence, bid manipulation, unpaid subcontractors, labor-standard violations, unexplained change orders, single-vendor dependence without justification, or contractor pressure for special access. The remedy is contract suspension, rebid, recusal, payment correction, public notice, vendor exclusion, or build delay (World Bank, 2017a; United Nations, 2011).

33.2.3 — Environmental Burden

Account for environmental burdens from construction through operation (World Bank, 2017a; International Finance Corporation, 2012).

The mechanism begins with baseline conditions. Before construction, the City should document water demand, energy sources, waste streams, soil conditions, drainage, material origins, embodied burden where feasible, local ecology, heat and dust effects, and operational assumptions. A fair environmental account distinguishes one-time construction cost, ongoing operation, mitigation, and uncertainty.

Trace cumulative effects beyond the site boundary, including downstream and maintenance burdens.

Publish the baseline and assumptions behind environmental claims; renderings cannot substitute for that account (UNCITRAL, 2011; International Finance Corporation, 2012).

A concrete environmental test is the first summer storm, heat wave, or water restriction during construction. Plans that looked responsible in moderate weather can shift burden quickly when runoff, cooling demand, dust, or worker heat exposure rises. The environmental record should be able to show how the City changes behavior when conditions worsen.

The environmental file connects construction choices to operating burden. A wall assembly that reduces energy use but traps moisture, a water feature that photographs well but strains maintenance, a landscape that needs constant irrigation, a sensor network that requires frequent replacement, or a glazing choice that overheats recovery rooms may convert an environmental promise into daily operational cost. The City should treat maintenance workers as environmental witnesses. They will see where dust collects, where heat gathers, where waste is hidden, where access panels require unsafe reach, and where a beautiful detail becomes a repeated burden for people who did not design it (United Nations, 2011; International Labour Organization, 1988).

Host-community environmental review includes emergency assumptions. Fire access, evacuation routes, heat shelter, stormwater behavior, backup power, waste removal, and medical response all affect neighbors when systems fail. The City should not design resilience as a private virtue inside the campus. If its backup generator creates noise and fumes for nearby residents, if its water use hardens restrictions for others, or if its emergency traffic blocks local routes, the City has shifted environmental burden outward while naming itself resilient.

Construction must stop for unmitigated water strain, unreviewed hazardous materials, unmanaged dust or runoff, waste plans that collapse in practice, energy assumptions that require hidden subsidy, or ecological disruption that the host did not knowingly accept. The remedy may be redesign, reduced scale, changed materials, construction pause, mitigation funding, operational limits, or site refusal (World Bank, 2017a; International Finance Corporation, 2012).

33.2.4 — Pilot Construction Transparency

The build record operates in layers. Public summaries can report schedule status, major contracts, aggregate safety information, environmental indicators, accessibility milestones, community mitigation, significant change orders, and unresolved findings. Restricted layers preserve security-sensitive layouts, worker privacy, proprietary detail, and protected incident information without turning legitimate protection into a general secrecy claim (UNCITRAL, 2011; International Finance Corporation, 2012).

Explain each material construction change by its avoided and accepted burdens, evidence, reviewer and unresolved dissent. Attach safe worker and host challenge routes, public-facing maps and explicit decision status to the build record. Under Section 30.1.5, preserve corrections and their reasons in version history.

Construction transparency fails when review finds hidden change orders, safety incidents buried in private logs, public summaries that omit major cost movement, security claims used to hide ordinary decisions, or worker-identifying information released without need. The remedy is correction, disclosure where proper, restricted-record review, public explanation, and, when the pattern is severe, construction pause (OECD, 2015; UNCITRAL, 2011).

33.2.5 — Local Disruption Mitigation

The construction record identifies each accelerated decision, the safeguard preserved, the dissent received, and the person with authority to slow or stop work. No milestone is allowed to become a reason that workers or hosts must accept unreviewed burden (International Labour Organization, 1988; International Labour Organization, 2022b; World Bank Group, 2025).

Fund and publish disruption mitigation before the affected work begins (United Nations, 2011; International Labour Organization, 1988).

The disruption route includes a calendar, delivery paths, noise windows, dust controls, traffic plans, pedestrian safety, emergency access, parking rules, construction contacts, complaint deadlines, language access, and published mitigation commitments.

Assess disruption against actual local schedules; a short delay may cost a shift, appointment, or care handoff (World Bank, 2017b; United Nations, 2006).

Host mitigation should have an enforcement path: complaint intake, response clock, interim protection where needed, corrective order, follow-up verification, escalation, and authority to slow or stop work when repeated conditions remain uncorrected.

Test the complaint route with affected residents and independent access reviewers before it is needed during harm.

A host mitigation drill follows one complaint from intake through remedy and verification. A resident reports blocked access. The issue is logged, verified, routed, corrected, communicated, and reviewed for recurrence (UNCITRAL, 2011; International Finance Corporation, 2012).

Noise windows can impose the greatest burden during school drop-off, medical rest, worship, evening work, or shift workers' sleep. Daily averages must not conceal those costs.

Pause affected work when credible complaints identify unaddressed material risk or harm, access barriers remain unmanaged, traffic is unsafe, communication reaches only supportive residents, or mitigation promises lack a budget. Remedies include schedule changes, rerouting, contractor discipline, compensation where appropriate, community notice,

and continued pause if the City cannot protect its host community (World Bank, 2017b; United Nations, 2011). Compare promised and actual disruption at resident-identified high-burden times, not only project-wide averages.

33.3 — Staff Recruitment, Training, and Dry Runs

Rehearsals test whether ordinary qualified staff can carry procedures across shifts and degraded conditions (ISO, 2023b; International Labour Organization, 2019a; Reason, 1997; Leveson, 2011). Admissions remain closed until documented rehearsals test every critical route. Each scenario names the trigger, roles, expected route, actual route, time to decision, information boundary, failure points, affected people, reviewer, repair owner, retest date, and stop consequence. The file records whether the procedure worked during ordinary staffing and degraded conditions. Rehearsal findings must be able to change the design.

33.3.1 — Staff Recruitment Standards

Give frontline staff a role in designing, interrupting, and evaluating rehearsals. Competency evidence must show more than attendance (NIST, 2024d; ISO, 2023b; Reason, 1997).

Recruit for the role's demonstrated competence, with no requirement to admire the City (Edmondson, 1999; NIST, 2024a).

Use Chapter 21's role charter and employment protections to describe the job before recruitment.

Role-specific competencies anchor operational protection. Archivists need provenance and access discipline. Clinicians need independence. Educators need visible reasoning without domination. Security staff need de-escalation and rights literacy. Moderators need public-interface judgment. Maintenance workers need privacy-sensitive movement routes. Executives need refusal tolerance.

Provide lawful credential checks and independent reconsideration of disputed recruitment decisions.

Realistic preview sessions belong in recruitment, not only inspiring orientation. A candidate should hear how often the role may involve conflict, slow documentation, public misunderstanding, grief, or restraint (ISO, 2023b; International Labour Organization, 2019a).

Exit from employment must also be explained before a staff member accepts the work.

Admissions must remain closed while staffing is inadequate. Recruitment must stop where role descriptions are unclear, training labor is unpaid or underpaid, selection depends on devotion, required background or credential checks are missing, or hiring plans depend on staff absorbing undefined emotional load. The remedy is careful recruitment, redesigned roles, increased compensation, a smaller cohort, or delayed admissions (Leveson, 2011; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

33.3.2 — Role-Separation Training

Rehearse the role map in Section 29.1.1 where requests cross roles or demands conflict. Staff must identify the lawful handoff, necessary record, and independent error reviewer while completing the scenario (Beauchamp and Childress, 2019; Institute of Internal Auditors, 2020).

Include conflict-of-interest decisions, protected communications, escalation, and authorized emergency exceptions in these drills (Reason, 1997; Leveson, 2011).

One drill places a beloved participant's request for a favor at the boundary among mentorship, records, care, and governance. The mentor's refusal should be kind, immediate, and documented where the role requires it, followed by a usable route to the person authorized to decide. Affection remains humanly valuable while losing its power to become an alternate channel around the City's safeguards.

Give each role a plain-language handoff phrase that identifies the authorized next contact.

Role separation is rehearsed under admiration and urgency, not only under conflict. A journalist may praise an archivist and ask for informal context. A donor may compliment an operator and request a tour detail outside the ordinary route. A frightened family member may ask security to solve a medical question. The City should teach staff how to redirect warmly without absorbing power they do not hold (Edmondson, 1999; NIST, 2024a).

Test whether users can identify who may act from the public role map, including when the first contact lacks authority.

Role-separation training fails when the record shows staff confusion over authority, undocumented informal influence, care staff asked to enforce participation, auditors embedded inside operations, or participants unable to identify where to complain. The remedy is retraining, role redesign, separated reporting lines, temporary closure of the affected function, and public correction if role collapse has already affected the record (Bovens, 2007; Institute of Internal Auditors, 2020).

33.3.3 — Archive Dry Runs

Use Section 33.1.2's mixed fictional record set, adding contested consent and overlapping content protections.

Reconstruct each classification, approval, correction, and disclosure from the event trail.

Use independent reviewers to test both prohibited retrieval and improper concealment, with logs and challenge preserved.

Archive staff practice explaining an archive decision to a nontechnical public user. The test should show whether terms such as captured, delayed, restricted, corrected, source, summary, and right of reply can be understood without

weakening the underlying boundary (OECD, 2022b; W3C, 2023).

Test whether ordinary authorized staff can find the correct source promptly for a public explanation, appeal, or correction without opening material outside their access.

33.3.4 — Crisis Dry Runs

Crisis rehearsal must combine problems rather than isolate them. A participant becomes medically unstable while a public interface is crowded, a family member requests shielding, a record system slows, and a media inquiry arrives.

Include effects on external responders and nearby people; internal continuity cannot depend on unplanned burden transfer (World Health Organization, 2025b; ISO, 2019).

The drill identifies decision authority, protected communications, emergency medical handoff, security de-escalation, record status during crisis, public communication, staff rotation, and post-event review. It should also test silence. Sometimes the correct public statement is limited because care, safety, and rights precede narrative completion.

After-action review assigns repairs and records whether the next stage remains authorized.

A crisis drill includes the person who asks the inconvenient question during emergency response. Why is this camera still running? Who has access to the medical hallway log? What is being told to the public? Those questions should not be treated as obstruction. They are how crisis remains under rights (FEMA, 2020b; World Health Organization, 2025b; Reason, 1997).

Crisis drills should test post-emergency debrief, quiet, correction, and records cleanup for staff and participants.

Crisis rehearsal fails when review finds unclear command, delayed care, public explanation that outruns facts, protected

information released under pressure, security response that becomes carceral, staff exhaustion treated as devotion, or host responders surprised by City needs. The remedy is revised protocols, additional staffing, host coordination, reduced operations, admissions pause, or closure of the affected pathway (Leveson, 2011; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

One crisis dry run should include an unavailable decision maker. Observers record which role assumed authority, what information was missing, who was exposed, which manual fallback worked, and whether the after-action process corrected the system rather than blaming the slowest person (Reason, 1997; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

33.3.5 — Public Interface Dry Runs

Test whether public users can complete legitimate tasks without being enrolled in a participant’s active-period record (OECD, 2022b; W3C, 2023; Nissenbaum, 2010).

The operational test covers the record site, visitor route, inquiry route, complaint route, accessibility supports, language access, moderation, protest interface, expert submissions, journalist requests, and public-summary format. Each route should tell the user what is recorded, what is not, what may become public, and how correction or withdrawal works where withdrawal is available.

The dry run presents hostile but lawful questions, accessibility barriers, mistaken identity, pressure for intimate records, volunteer over-identification, a journalist's sensitive request, and a correction claim. The interface should answer by route, not by charisma. It should make boundaries visible without sounding defensive.

Recruit independent, skeptical, and differently situated users; record task failures and friction.

A respectful critic who refuses the City's framing belongs in the public-interface rehearsal. The interface should still help that person find records, file objections, and understand limits (Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015; Edmondson, 1999).

Test routine use as well as crisis conditions. Include missing labels, timed-out forms, stock moderation answers, and buried correction routes.

Public-interface activation stops when recording notices are unclear, forms are inaccessible, moderation has no appeal, public bundles invite voyeurism, expert input becomes authority without review, volunteer data is captured without need, or critics are routed into silence. The remedy is interface redesign, language revision, access repair, moderator retraining, public correction, and no expansion of public-interface load until usability is real (NIST, 2024a; W3C, 2023).

33.3.6 — Exit Dry Runs

Trace the exit notice in Section 31.6.1 through actual handoffs and closure of active permissions.

The drill should verify that a public status change can remain nonstigmatizing while role-relevant accountability stays visible. Departure should neither shame the participant nor hide conduct the public still has a lawful reason to understand (Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015; Edmondson, 1999).

Test support continuity and its independence from praise, silence, or participation in later publicity.

Provide independent review of an exit dispute and optional protected feedback on the route.

Rehearse publishing an exit status without narrating private reasons or prompting the departing person for a fuller explanation (Nissenbaum, 2010; Wertheimer, 1987).

Exit drills account for staff emotion. Staff may feel grief, frustration, worry, or institutional defensiveness when someone leaves. Training should teach staff to support departure without persuasion, shame, or subtle loyalty testing. The participant should not have to manage staff feelings in order to reclaim ordinary life. A debrief can record where staff language or delay created pressure so later training targets the actual friction point.

New admissions and active-record starts must stop when staff cannot explain exit terms, public status language humiliates, aftercare is unavailable, record handling is unclear, appeal depends on the same office being challenged, or the route works only for participants with private resources. A participant's ability to leave must remain available; interim arrangements must protect safety, support continuity, and independent appeal while the failed route is repaired. The remedy is redesigned exit, reserve funding, retraining, admissions pause, and another dry run before activation (Hirschman, 1970; Wertheimer, 1987). Before admissions resume, a second team should be able to complete the revised route from the written procedure alone.

33.4 — Phased Admissions and Early Cohort Growth

Limit the first cohort to declared capacity, tested dependencies, and protected exit conditions (Eldridge et al., 2016; Skivington et al., 2021). Prevent scarcity from becoming a status claim; publish the selection limits and expand only through the gate in Section 33.4.5 (Skivington et al., 2021; Proctor et al., 2011). Admission pressure must not turn a capacity estimate into a promise of prestige. The next phase should depend on observed service performance, not on the demand for additional places.

33.4.1 — Initial Cohort Size

Initial cohort size is a moral and operational decision. A small cohort can be overprotected, unrepresentative, and too dependent on exceptional staff attention. A large cohort can overload care, archive, housing, public interface, and exit routes before the City knows how its systems behave. The right size is the size the institution can support without heroics (Moore et al., 2015; Damschroder et al., 2009).

Use Section 32.2.2's demand and coverage model to set cohort limits, with the binding constraint and freeze trigger identified.

Have the relevant independent gate owners review and date the cohort authorization; new functions require renewed capacity evidence.

Daily sequence, not headcount alone, tests initial size. Ten people may be manageable on paper and unmanageable if they all need counsel, medical appointments, archive review, meals, and public-interface support in the same window. Capacity lives in time, not just in totals (Skivington et al., 2021; Proctor et al., 2011).

The first cohort is protected from overobservation by the institution itself. Leaders may want to learn everything because the pilot is precious. That desire can become internal

surveillance. The cohort-size plan should define which observations are necessary, which are optional, and which would add burden without enough operational value.

Freeze dependent admissions or activities when the cohort exceeds a gate's tested capacity (Moore et al., 2015; Damschroder et al., 2009).

33.4.2 — Staged Activation

Use the activation sequence in Chapter 16 as separately reviewable permissions, not a status ladder (HM Treasury, 2026b; Eldridge et al., 2016).

At each transition, explain the changed record permissions under Chapter 11 and the remaining refusal route.

Offer independent assistance and appeal for a disputed transition; declining the next stage does not establish fault.

Staged activation includes a point at which the person can restate the terms in their own words. This is not a test of intelligence. It is a test of institutional clarity. If the person describes capture, release, shielding, exit, or public status incorrectly, the City learns that its explanation has not yet earned consent (Damschroder et al., 2009; Sitkin, 1992).

Meaningful waiting periods are part of staging, not merely procedural delays. A person needs time to discuss household effects, sleep on terms, ask embarrassing questions, and notice new fear after the first explanation has faded. A stage that moves too quickly can preserve formal consent while weakening lived consent.

Staged activation must stop for ambiguous stage boundaries, pressure to proceed, public status before record protections are ready, activation without exit rehearsal, or participants unable to explain what changes at the next threshold. The remedy is delayed activation, repeated orientation, protected pause, revised

materials, or withdrawal without stigma (HM Treasury, 2026b; Eldridge et al., 2016).

33.4.3 — Diversity of Pathways

Diversity of pathways tests varied roles without turning people into public decoration. The City forms public-power seekers across different kinds of roles, jurisdictions, cultures, abilities, disciplines, and life circumstances where lawful. The pilot should not depend on one narrow class of polished participants who make operations look easier than they are (Proctor et al., 2011; Moore et al., 2015).

Pilot pathway selection identifies which pathways open and why. A local-office pathway may test host legitimacy and neighborhood interface. A legislative pathway may test deliberation and record traceability. A public-administration pathway may test technical competence. A diplomatic or crisis pathway may be deferred because travel and government-boundary risks are not yet ready.

Pathway diversity includes disability access, language access, caregiving constraints, household complexity, digital access, and varied educational histories where feasible.

Open a pathway only with its required expertise, authority, and support; unresolved external dependencies require deferral.

Pathway diversity also requires testing the interactions among pathways. Participants on local, regional, national, or specialist paths may carry sharply different public burdens, and shared spaces or record summaries can turn those differences into prestige hierarchies.

Pathway diversity fails when review finds tokenism, unsupported diversity, pathway prestige, inaccessible supports, or expansion into roles the City cannot lawfully or operationally carry. The remedy is narrowing the pilot, adding supports,

delaying a pathway, revising public language, or refusing a pathway until its legal authority and the requirements discussed in later books are established (Proctor et al., 2011; Moore et al., 2015).

33.4.4 — Cohort Feedback

Protected cohort feedback should detect burdens that public accounts miss (Sitkin, 1992; HM Treasury, 2026b). Use confidential interviews, privacy-protective aggregate surveys, ombuds meetings, debriefs separate from evaluation and consensual household input. Publish only thematic summaries that do not identify private lives.

Bound the frequency and labor of feedback so the first cohort does not become a permanent focus group (Eldridge et al., 2016; Skivington et al., 2021).

Concrete questions keep cohort feedback from dissolving into general approval. Where did sleep fail? Where did public attention intrude? Which record explanation remained confusing? Which staff or complaint route worked, and which felt unsafe? Which protected zone was hard to reach? Which public interface produced pressure to perform?

Review feedback independently and answer contributors with the resulting change, reasoned nonadoption, or remaining evidence need.

Offer optional feedback after demanding events as well as on the evaluation schedule, without repeated solicitation from someone who declines (Moore et al., 2015; Damschroder et al., 2009).

Feedback includes the right not to discuss a subject or explain that refusal. A person may decline, be unavailable, encounter an access problem, or leave no reason the City is entitled to know. Record only the distinction actually established; unexplained

nonresponse is not assigned a motive, a burden finding, or a favorable outcome. Aggregate patterns can prompt a review of question frequency and channel accessibility without repeatedly approaching the same person. A voluntarily supplied reason may guide a repair, but assistance and standing do not depend on supplying one. The feedback report preserves what remains unknown instead of completing a private story on the contributor's behalf.

Cohort growth stops when feedback produces retaliation, pressure to praise the City, channels controlled by the staff being criticized, public summaries that expose private facts, or repeated themes without remedy. The remedy is independent review, staff retraining, design change, public correction, admissions pause, or reduction of role burden (Sitkin, 1992; HM Treasury, 2026b).

33.4.5 — Expansion Gate

Expansion requires current gate evidence for the proposed additional load (Skivington et al., 2021; Proctor et al., 2011).

Compare declared thresholds with the existing gate records, identifying unresolved uncertainty that blocks growth.

The gate should not reduce readiness to a single grade or public ranking. It should identify conditions: which functions may expand, which remain frozen, which require redesign, which require more observation, and which are outside the City's authority.

Obtain independent gate-owner review and keep dissent visible alongside the decision, with a defined reconsideration condition and date.

The public calendar is part of expansion testing. An election cycle, media controversy, donor deadline, or anniversary of the project may create pressure to grow at exactly the wrong time.

The gate should be able to say that the date is meaningful but not governing (HM Treasury, 2026b; Eldridge et al., 2016). Gate decisions should publish the evidence that justified expansion or restraint so cohort growth does not become a momentum-based administrative habit.

A long queue can create pressure to accept terms too quickly when a place finally opens. Public updates should avoid language that makes admission sound like rescue, destiny, or moral elevation.

Apply Section 33.1’s failure responses to expansion. A smaller next step may test capacity only if it passes every protection required for that step (Skivington et al., 2021; Proctor et al., 2011).

33.5 — Post-Occupancy Evaluation and Rights Audit

Post-occupancy evaluation begins when the building stops being a promise and starts becoming a day. Examine intended use, actual use, observed nonuse, and voluntarily shared reasons for withdrawal, protecting personal information (Preiser, Rabinowitz, and White, 1988; Leaman, Stevenson, and Bordass, 2010; World Health Organization, 2018b). The rights audit tests whether recourse still works under occupied operating conditions. The evaluation calendar is staged because burdens appear at different speeds.

33.5.1 — Livability Audit

Methods combine observation, service records, protected testimony, walkthroughs, environmental measurements, workload data, complaint and appeal files, host evidence, and independent challenge. No single metric can establish livability or rights performance. Disagreement among sources remains visible rather than being averaged into a reassuring score.

Evaluate livability against actual schedules, access, recovery, services, and maintenance.

Include users of service and night routes, not only leadership walkthroughs.

The livability evidence file includes timed route tests, privacy-protective sleep and noise reports, maintenance logs, incident records, accessibility testing, food-service strain, recovery-space use, and protected qualitative feedback. The City should keep livability evidence tied to obstacles, routes, and repairs rather than reducing daily life to a numerical fitness mark (HM Treasury, 2026b; Preiser, Rabinowitz, and White, 1988).

Use independent access and health expertise where relevant, with safe reporting of design changes and unresolved limits.

Livability findings are reported by place, time, activity, and affected group. A building may work for daytime visitors while failing night staff, participants with sensory sensitivity, wheelchair users during an emergency, or families using private routes. Aggregate satisfaction cannot erase a recurring burden concentrated in one corridor, schedule, or group.

Failure-of-ordinary-use observations belong in the livability audit. A door that is technically accessible may be too heavy after fatigue. A quiet room may be unusable if the path to it passes through a public-facing corridor. A meal system may meet nutritional standards while making participants choose between privacy and food. A complaint office may be easy to find while being impossible to enter without being noticed (World Health Organization, 2018b; United Nations, 2006).

The same review also asks which improvements create new exposure. Adding cameras may solve a security concern while increasing observation load. Adding public signage may improve wayfinding while drawing visitors toward protected edges. Adding a faster digital interface may help some citizens while creating barriers for people with disabilities, older users, people who need language support, or those who distrust machine summaries. Post-occupancy evaluation should therefore review second-order burden, not only first-order fixes.

Livability fails when the record shows persistent sleep disruption, inaccessible routes, maintenance delays in protected zones, recovery spaces that cannot be reached when needed, public spillover into residential life, or food and movement systems that depend on staff improvisation. The remedy is design change, schedule change, staffing change, protected-zone revision, admissions pause, or reduced public-interface load (World Green Building Council, 2014; World Health Organization, 2018b; United Nations, 2006).

33.5.2 — Rights Audit

Follow each recourse route in Section 29.3 from intake to verified remedy, including whether users can find the right office.

Rights auditing examines actual cases in protected form and simulated cases where real cases do not yet exist. It should ask how long the route took, who had authority, whether the person was heard, what record was created, what remedy followed, and whether a public explanation was needed. Aggregate success rates are not enough if severe cases failed.

Keep the audit independent of the challenged office; use only nonidentifying ombuds trend reports.

The rights audit is credible when the first person who invokes a right against a popular decision can use it without retaliation or delay. Reviewers should follow a complaint that pauses a release, contradicts a leader, protects a doubted person, or exposes a costly flaw from notice through decision, appeal, remedy, and correction (United Nations, 2006; United Nations, 2011).

Track findings through Section 29.3.5 and test the repaired route before closure.

Missed response deadlines, appeals controlled by the challenged office, retaliation, inaccessible complaint materials, premature public status changes, or remedies that abandon the affected person require immediate protective action. The activity creating the risk must pause where necessary; complaint intake, independent appeal, urgent care, and protective relief must remain available. The remedy is case repair, public correction where needed, staff discipline where warranted, route redesign, and an admissions or release pause when rights failure is systemic (HM Treasury, 2026b; Preiser, Rabinowitz, and White, 1988).

33.5.3 — Staff Burden Audit

Immediate review captures unsafe first use and access failure. Short-cycle review captures workload, confusion, complaint, and sensory strain. Seasonal and annual review capture maintenance, climate, household effects, host burden, staff turnover, record drift, and whether remedies remain usable after public attention declines.

Staff-burden review examines overtime, turnover, injury, sick leave, vacancy duration, emotional-load reports, role creep, complaint handling, staffing ratios, supervision quality, training gaps, pay adequacy, schedule predictability, and staff authority to stop unsafe work. It should include contracted and subcontracted workers where they carry City burden.

Test how staff strain affects service quality and other people, without assuming every service failure has that cause (World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022; ISO, 2021b).

Staff-burden review protects candor. Anonymous reporting, worker representatives, confidential interviews, and anti-retaliation protections are essential. Staff should be able to say the City's ideals are becoming unworkable without being accused of disloyalty. The audit should also distinguish ordinary workload from moral overreach.

Provide independent labor review and authority to change staffing; publish aggregate findings and actions.

Sample the service and night roles that public accounts may overlook (Preiser, Rabinowitz, and White, 1988; Leaman, Stevenson, and Bordass, 2010).

Staff-burden control fails when review finds chronic overtime, role creep across protected boundaries, unfilled posts covered by informal labor, retaliation against staff criticism, high turnover, burnout signals, or participant support depending on unpaid

devotion. The remedy is staffing increase, cohort reduction, schedule redesign, role clarification, compensation review, admissions freeze, or function closure (World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022; United Nations, 2006).

33.5.4 — Nonparticipant Audit

The Nonparticipant Audit tests the boundaries in Sections 7.1 and 31.3.2 under occupied conditions (United Nations, 2006; HM Treasury, 2026b).

Nonparticipant review follows incidental capture, visitor notices, family shielding, child protection, professional privilege, protected correspondence, public-interface logs, media routes, perimeter behavior, protest handling, neighborhood complaint records, and record-site search behavior. It should ask whether nonparticipants can pass near the City, visit lawful spaces, object, work, and leave without becoming public material.

Nonparticipant review tests specific routes. A child visits a protected household edge. A journalist walks a public route. A protester records outside the perimeter. A therapist meets a participant. A delivery driver enters a service zone. A neighbor files a complaint. Each scenario should show what is captured, what is not, what is shielded, and who can correct an error.

Use independent privacy and affected-person expertise for the routes being tested.

Test whether ordinary visitors can distinguish public, protected, and staff zones and recognize record-sensitive thresholds without needing insider language.

Nonparticipant findings can change operations, not merely public messaging. Repeated incidental capture, blocked access, service pressure, housing effects, protest-management burden, or

inaccessible complaint routes may require redesign, reduced cohort, restricted release, mitigation, compensation, or pause.

Pilot progression stops when nonparticipants are exposed without lawful need, notices are unclear, correction routes are inaccessible, children appear in public artifacts, staff role records become full-life records, or public-interface data is reused beyond the stated purpose. The remedy is immediate shielding, correction, deletion or sealing where lawful, public notice where needed, route redesign, and public-interface pause when the boundary is failing (United Nations, 2006; W3C, 2013; HM Treasury, 2026b).

33.5.5 — Public Usability Audit

The Public Usability Audit measures successful access, interpretation, and challenge in ordinary use (W3C, 2023; World Health Organization, 2018b).

Test Chapter 30's public interface and query classes using the tasks below.

Public-usability review deliberately recruits skeptical and differently situated users. A journalist should trace a public bundle to its source and status, while a voter should be able to find its limitations. A rights advocate should locate correction history, and a person using assistive technology should navigate without losing context. A critic should reach the relevant evidence without being routed into fandom or silence.

Publish the changes made after independent usability testing and the limits that remain.

One usability test follows a public user trying to correct a misunderstanding after sharing a record summary online. The City cannot control all public interpretation, but it can make correction visible, traceable, and easy to find (HM Treasury, 2026b; Preiser, Rabinowitz, and White, 1988).

Public release stops when labels are ambiguous, source trace is broken, correction is hard to find, machine summaries outrun records, search reveals protected associations, or accessibility barriers make the site usable only by specialists.

Distinguish successful use, compensating workarounds, and observed nonuse. Assign investigation of a possible barrier without inferring why someone avoided a route or compelling an explanation.

The findings are versioned as decisions rather than filed as impressions. Each material issue needs a source, affected group, threshold, accountable owner, interim safeguard, correction date, retest condition, and public-status rule. Negative results should remain visible at the level necessary for accountability even when personal details are protected (HM Treasury, 2026b; Proctor et al., 2011).

33.6 — Pilot Evidence Required Before Replication

Replication begins with a result that another team can examine. Before copying a site, retain the separate evidence file, comparison with alternatives, and host and affected-person review. Then distinguish three checks: rerunning the supplied analysis, implementing its declared method independently, and testing the substantive finding with new observations. The first two can find computational mistakes and consequential analytic choices; they do not create a new cohort. Silberzahn et al. (2018) showed that teams addressing the same question with one dataset obtained differing estimates through different analytic approaches.

33.6.1 — Humane Load

Before replication, demonstrate a sustainable pilot workload with usable pause and exit options (Government Accountability Office, 2020b; Skivington et al., 2021). Compare authorized operational evidence with optional protected feedback and realistic recovery and support capacity; do not compel private sleep or household records. Record unusually intensive support or selection conditions that limit transfer to a new cohort or site.

Combine the relevant rights, staff, host, and service records with protected feedback, preserving conflicts among sources.

Have independent gate owners review the load finding and the resulting reductions or restrictions.

Humane load includes recovery from public praise. Admiration can be as distorting as hostility when it creates pressure to perform gratitude, endurance, or moral seriousness. The City should notice whether participants and staff can disappoint supporters, request rest, and remain ordinary without feeling they have betrayed the project.

Humane load is evaluated across roles rather than averaged across the pilot. If participants report tolerable load while cleaners work nights without rest, if public-interface staff absorb hostility while educators appear stable, or if the host community carries traffic and noise while internal routines look calm, the average hides the burden route. A pilot demonstration should identify which role carried the heaviest ordinary strain and what changed afterward (HM Treasury, 2026b; Government Accountability Office, 2020b).

The humane-load file distinguishes adaptation from well-being. Research on employee voice and silence shows why withheld concerns require interpretation (Morrison, 2014). Apparent efficiency, calm, or reduced complaint volume should therefore be checked against the authorized operational evidence, optional protected feedback, and independent review above.

The humane-load gate closes when the record shows repeated overload, sleep disruption, staff burnout, household pressure, participant fear of pause, rising host complaint load, or a culture that praises endurance more than correction. The remedy is reduced schedule, smaller cohort, de-loading, additional support, revised public interface, admissions freeze, or pilot pause (Skivington et al., 2021; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

33.6.2 — Record Integrity

Demonstrate the record functions under the stated workload, including context, correction, and protection (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; NARA, 2023).

Use the technical card and archive tests in Sections 30.1 and 33.1.2; report authenticity separately from contextual adequacy.

Sample both released and withheld cases under protected review. Public reporting must not reveal a protected record's existence merely to demonstrate restraint.

Require independent assessment rather than archive self-certification.

The record-integrity finding includes errors caught by someone outside the archive office. A participant, staff member, public user, or host reviewer may notice what the system missed (Proctor et al., 2011; W3C, 2013).

Record integrity distinguishes capture status from access status. A record not created under the permitted scope differs from one expected but missing; both differ from an existing record lawfully restricted from a particular reader. An authorized integrity reviewer can examine those differences without publishing a protected record's existence. A public response states the scope and limits of the search when that can be done safely, rather than implying that inaccessible evidence never existed. Unresolved missingness remains a repair task with an owner; legitimate withholding remains a governed access decision. Keeping these statuses separate improves retrieval, repair, and public interpretation without enlarging anyone's permission.

Record-integrity failure triggers an immediate operational response. Unexplained gaps, untraceable edits, unauthorized release of protected material, and failure to correct records or outputs under City control all qualify. So do failures to notify known outside recipients, untraceable machine summaries, confused breach responses, and backlogs that make public memory selective through delay. These failures require record lockdown, affected-person notice, technical repair, public correction, and a release pause. Replication cannot proceed until

integrity is restored and independently tested (ISO, 2016a; ISO, 2017; NIST, 2020b).

33.6.3 — Protected Nonvisibility

Test noncapture and protected-disclosure rules under public and internal pressure (HM Treasury, 2026b; Government Accountability Office, 2020b).

Protected nonvisibility is tested against both technical failure and public appetite. Reviewers examine health, counsel, children, intimacy, family life, professional privilege, grief, safety, third-party contact, staff-role privacy, and nonparticipant boundaries under a scenario in which the public strongly wants the story. Shielding is meaningful only when the institution can explain the boundary, preserve the protected person, and withstand attention without converting curiosity into authority.

Retain the pressure scenario, attempted boundary crossing, staff response, and result.

Use independent protection expertise and safe aggregate findings; do not hint at withheld content.

A successful protection test can earn a quantitative statement. Suppose sixty fictional release cases are independently sampled from a prospectively fixed case generator and tested on one unchanged system version, with complete checking for prohibited disclosure. If none occurs, the exact one-sided 95% binomial upper confidence limit is approximately 4.87% per draw. The familiar rule of three gives a close approximation: divide three by the number of independently tested cases, giving 5% here (Hanley and Lippman-Hand, 1983). These are invented test results, not observations from a City.

The calculation assumes independent draws from the same defined test distribution and reliable failure detection. Repeating one example, selecting only easy cases, or combining versions

after repair does not meet those conditions. A report should identify the tested version and case domain, then use an independently planned confirmation test to examine an improvement. The bound describes this synthetic test, not the safety of real people; it is neither an acceptable disclosure rate nor permission to relax a rights gate. Principled refusal remains available. A system that refuses every request could also produce zero disclosures, so the same evaluation must separately report completion of permitted tasks and correct handling of requests that require refusal; safety and useful service are different findings. A precise successful result tells the next team what has been demonstrated and which stronger test would add knowledge.

Test the anti-browsing controls in Section 11.4.5 against unauthorized internal searches, including accesses that bypass public-release restrictions.

Protected nonvisibility fails when review finds intimate or child-related exposure, protected records searchable by ordinary public routes, staff role records becoming full-life records, media access overriding dignity, or public summaries that hint at shielded material for drama. The remedy is immediate shielding, public correction, affected-person care, staff retraining, record sealing or deletion where lawful, and replication refusal (HM Treasury, 2026b; Government Accountability Office, 2020b).

33.6.4 — Anti-Capture Resilience

Test resistance to influence under the donor, vendor, and governance controls already specified (Ebrahim, 2003; Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978).

Integrate the refusal drills in Sections 29.4 and 32.4, including dependencies between functions.

Record actual refusals and controlled drill results separately. Absence of a real refused offer is not failure by itself, but an untested firewall is not demonstrated resilience.

Include supportive actors whose usefulness could create dependence, with independent review of the resulting decisions.

Gratitude is one of the conditions under which resilience is tested. Capture often appears after someone helps solve a real problem. A donor covers a shortfall, a vendor prevents an outage, a public official shields the City from attack, or a media partner explains the project well. The question is whether gratitude changes access, authority, scrutiny, or memory.

Replication is blocked when donor influence reaches admissions, vendors control records, founder preference overrides review, auditors depend on the institution, staff face retaliation, host benefits are exchanged for silence, party or media capture appears, or public communication treats institutional loyalty as civic virtue. The remedy is recusal, contract termination, governance redesign, public disclosure, admissions freeze, pilot pause, or shutdown if independence cannot be restored (Ebrahim, 2003; Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978).

33.6.5 — Replication Evidence and Stop Capability

For a City evaluation, independent analysts should first reproduce the predeclared primary quantity using the same eligibility rules, unit of observation, outcome definition, and follow-up window. Before seeing outcomes, identify a bounded set of defensible sensitivity analyses and the assumptions each examines. Preserve the primary result even when another analysis is more favorable. A change from all assigned participants to completers changes the question and must be reported as such, not presented as confirmation of the original estimate. Publish the methods and permitted verification

materials, or provide protected access where records cannot be public. Report which conclusions persist and which depend on a particular choice. Agreement among analyses of the same observations is robustness evidence, not several independent replications; a new-site decision still needs evidence about whether the supporting conditions travel (Proctor et al., 2011; Eldridge et al., 2016).

Demonstration remains narrow enough to audit. The phrase the City works is unusable. A defensible finding identifies the function, cohort, load, period, context, comparator, observed exceptions, unresolved risks, adverse evidence, remedy, and confidence, and it names the conditions thought necessary for the result and the settings not tested. Replication should remain ineligible unless the predeclared primary comparison shows a material incremental benefit over the strongest feasible lower-burden alternative without worsening noncompensatory rights, staff, host, selection, or observation burdens. If comparator quality, self-selection, attrition, or observation effects leave that inference unresolved, the finding should authorize further testing or narrowing, not replication.

Replication evidence travels with the conditions that made the pilot interpretable. A later city, campus, foundation, party, or government may imitate a visible feature while lacking the staffing, host compact, legal envelope, reserve, technical control, or failure route that supported it. The demonstration record therefore separates portable mechanism, site-specific condition, uncertain dependency, prohibited inference, and evidence requiring renewal. A copying institution may not claim the result while discarding the conditions (Eldridge et al., 2016; HM Treasury, 2026b; Proctor et al., 2011).

Demonstrate a usable partial-pause and closure route under compound stress (Eldridge et al., 2016; HM Treasury, 2026b).

Exercise the wind-down and residual-authority plans in Section 31.5.5, including the distinction between stopped functions and continuing duties (ISO, 2019; NIST, 2025b).

Have independent owners of the affected duties review the stop decision; continuation advocates cannot be its sole judges.

Keep public materials aligned with current authorization: do not advertise a closed pathway as active, pause recruitment language when admissions pause, and stop implying ordinary access when a record route is locked down.

Verify the residual-dependency map against actual leases, benefits, custody, claims contacts, and termination conditions (Proctor et al., 2011; Eldridge et al., 2016).

A real stop test places leadership preference in conflict with the evidence. The rehearsal should assume that founders, funders, or senior operators favor continuation while an independent gate requires pause, then follow authority, notice, care, payroll, records, host duties, and appeal through the decision. The safeguard succeeds when ordinary procedure carries the stop rule without requiring one unusually courageous individual.

Shutdown planning fails without aftercare reserve, vendor contracts permitting safe termination, clear record custody after closure, staff protection, funded host commitments, public explanation, and participant support independent of institutional survival. The remedy is immediate stop-capability repair, reduced scope, admissions freeze, and no replication until closing the City is as governable as opening it (HM Treasury, 2026b; Government Accountability Office, 2020b).

33.7 — Stopping Early as Moral Success

Construction, fundraising, public praise, and participant commitment can create sunk-cost pressure to continue (Staw, 1976; Arkes and Blumer, 1985). Maintain continuing care and remedy duties, preserve evidence, and provide safe public status updates during pause or shutdown. A stop decision needs a named owner who can trigger it without institutional retaliation. The adequacy of closure should be judged by the treatment of people left with obligations, not by the project's reputation.

33.7.1 — Pause as Fidelity

A justified pause prevents the next unsupported burden while evidence and repair are reviewed (Vaughan, 1996; Leveson, 2011).

For each gate failure, specify which dependent activity pauses and which protective duties continue.

Apply the continuing-obligation map in Section 31.5.5 during a pause (Bovens and ’t Hart, 1996; Patton, 2011).

A usable pause record states the event or pattern that triggered action, the immediate protection, the scope of the pause, the review owner, the expected clock, the rights of affected people, the evidence still needed, and the public explanation boundary.

Provide independent review of whether the pause is sufficient, excessive, or ready to end, with protected dissent.

Pause also protects staff from contradictory instructions. During uncertainty, one office may want silence, another reassurance, another continued recruitment, and another legal caution. A pause protocol should tell staff what to say, what not to say, what work continues, what work stops, and where questions go.

Pause fidelity fails when the record shows indefinite delay without a repair or review plan, pause used to suppress criticism,

pause without participant care, pause lifted before repair, or public language that treats pause as reputational management. The remedy is clearer trigger rules, stronger independent authority, public correction, extended pause, or shutdown if the institution cannot act faithfully under restraint (Sitkin, 1992; Vaughan, 1996).

33.7.2 — Shutdown Conditions

Set closure conditions before activation. Review them on a published schedule and when material operating evidence changes, with authority to add, clarify, or tighten criteria (Patton, 2011; Bovens and ’t Hart, 1996).

Use the closure threshold in Section 31.5.5 when failure is systemic or cannot be repaired within acceptable burden. Its independent review must give affected people standing and consider continuing care, custody, and claims together.

Choose the narrowest lawful response that protects people; full closure is required when a partial restriction cannot do so.

Include gradual deterioration identified through Section 31.1.4, not only discrete incidents.

A failed stop-capability test blocks any stage that would deepen dependence before the closure route is repaired (Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015; Patton, 2011).

Shutdown conditions need an order of operations. Immediate danger may require stopping capture or occupancy while urgent care and safe evacuation proceed. The authorized owners maintain ongoing care, payroll and housing continuity while coordinating notification, evidence preservation, access restriction, host coordination, and public explanation under the emergency plan. A closure plan that starts with reputation or asset protection teaches the institution to preserve itself before

people. The sequence should be rehearsed and funded before opening (ISO, 2019; NIST, 2025b).

33.7.3 — Public Explanation of Pilot Stopping

Apply the stopping-notice principles in Section 4.4.4 through the pilot-specific notice below (Arkes and Blumer, 1985; Sitkin, 1992).

A public stopping notice must identify the affected stage and point to the relevant gate, the findings that can safely be summarized, active protections including immediate measures, corrective work, open questions, review clock, review owner, next decision owner, and next public update. Unsettled facts remain labeled as unsettled, while protected information is described by category only when that notice is safe and lawful; otherwise use the authorized protected-review route.

Review foreseeable misunderstandings in common excerpts and link the notice to the gate record. No wording can guarantee immunity from every hostile crop.

Explain the institutional failure without identifying who suffered or disclosing exploitable operational detail.

Silence after material harm, promotional language during a pause, blame shifted without due process, disclosure of protected details to satisfy curiosity, or vague statements that hide who bears the burden require correction. Misleading promotion and harmful disclosure must stop, while accurate safety notices, affected-person updates, and public explanations continue. The remedy is corrected notice, apology where warranted, revised communication rules, leadership accountability, and delayed reopening until the explanation and its supporting evidence can be independently reviewed (Staw, 1976; Arkes and Blumer, 1985).

33.7.4 — Participant Care After Pause

A justified pause can still disrupt reliance; provide the continuity plan below (Leveson, 2011; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

Review only the dependencies necessary for safe transition, with the participant's input and restricted handling. Assign each continuing support to a funded owner and receiving route.

Offer the participant a choice to wait, leave, or seek review without conditioning assistance on the choice (Bovens and 't Hart, 1996; Staw, 1976).

The care plan distinguishes pause types. A technical pause may require record restriction and communication support. A shutdown pause may require transition out of the City with material support.

Keep basic support separate from the reopening decision, applying the funded commitments in Section 31.6.2.

Care after pause includes choice about distance. Some participants may want continued contact with staff; others may need a clean break from institutional presence. Sometimes care is a reliable handoff to ordinary services and a respectful retreat.

Participant care after pause fails when review finds loss of basic support, public stigma, unclear record status, pressure to remain, pressure to praise the City, unreviewed household burden, or delayed care because the institution is protecting its image. The remedy is immediate support, public correction where needed, independent advocacy, aftercare reserve activation, and no reopening of the paused stage until care routes work (Leveson, 2011; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

33.7.5 — Pilot Failure Memory

Pilot failure memory should preserve the failed condition, affected function, corrective attempt, stop reason, and evidence

needed before any restart or replication. Protected people remain protected in the learning record.

Use the protected learning layers in Section 31.5.5; retaining a lesson does not authorize new exposure.

Preserve the decision and its verification, including justified refusals to restart or expand.

Provide independent review of disputed lessons through Section 29.5.5 and retain the conditions that would change them.

Failure memory also records gratitude without possession. The institution can be grateful to people who revealed a flaw, but it should not claim them as heroes, martyrs, or symbols. Their contribution should reduce future burden without increasing their exposure (Leveson, 2011; Weick and Sutcliffe, 2015).

Failure memory fails when lessons are deleted, private suffering is displayed, blame is assigned without a review route, or the record is used to prove institutional virtue. The next City should inherit the warning, not the wound (Patton, 2011; Bovens and ’t Hart, 1996).

Chapter 34 — Accreditation and Replication

Replication is where the City becomes most tempting to admire and most necessary to discipline. One site can become scarce, mythic, or too important to correct; many can spread weak standards, centralize records, or create accreditation theater. Chapter 34 treats plurality as comparative learning before growth.

Scale discipline begins with scarcity. One prestigious site can favor the wealthy, visible, connected, or mobile even under formally fair admissions, creating symbolic monopoly and political fragility. A second site may reduce scarcity or merely multiply the myth. That difference must be tested.

Local translation is separated from constitutional drift. A City in a hot coastal region, dry inland region, multilingual democracy, post-authoritarian society, federal legal order, or community with a history of surveillance cannot treat place as decoration. Materials, circulation, climate systems, language access, legal contracts, host review, and public explanation may change. The core protections do not. Translation is legitimate when it improves fit without reversing the direction of rights, burden, human authority, correction, or exit.

Accreditation requires scope, evidence, independence, competence, complaint routes, conflict-of-interest controls, periodic review, continued oversight after approval, and withdrawal of standing. Urbanists will look for host burden, infrastructure fit, climate conditions, land use, and public interface. Privacy and records specialists will look for lifecycle separation, interoperability limits, provenance, correction, deletion, sealing, and no central dossier. Public administrators will look for role boundaries, authority routes, auditability, and remedy.

The accreditation instrument begins with scope because a single seal invites overreading. A site may demonstrate housing,

training, public-interface, archive, or corridor functions at different levels and times. The public register therefore names the exact function, site, term, operating load, exclusions, conditions, evidence date, reviewer, appeal status, and expiry. Narrow scope permits a targeted suspension without pretending that every function or every person has been judged (ISO/IEC, 2017; ENQA et al., 2015; ISEAL Alliance, 2025).

Accreditation creates its own capture risks. The accreditor may become dependent on fees, founders, prestige, or expansion. Auditors may normalize practices they see repeatedly. Standards may reward what is easy to document and displace what is hard to observe. Public measures can reshape behavior until institutions optimize the rating rather than the protected purpose (Power, 1997; Espeland and Sauder, 2007; Campbell, 1976). The accreditor therefore needs conflict rules, rotation, complaint, appeal, audit, and decertification of its own functions.

The worked second-site review in Section 34.2 tests a practical boundary: which local adaptations improve fit, and which remove the protections accreditation is meant to verify? It follows a scoped denial through reasons, public status, appeal, repair, and reconsideration without stigmatizing the people at the site. The original City remains subject to the same requirements.

34.1 — Why One City Is Not Enough

The first City will carry symbolic force even if its designers try to prevent it. People will visit it, criticize it, cite it, misunderstand it, and build stories around it. Supporters may see it as the proof that public power can be formed differently. Critics may see it as the evidence that transparency has become a danger. Both reactions can make the original site too heavy for one institution to carry (Ostrom, 2010; Provan and Kenis, 2008).

34.1.1 — Scarcity Risk

Scarcity begins as a capacity problem and becomes a fairness problem when access to visible public-power formation is shaped by wealth, geography, language, media attention, or institutional familiarity. A single City can publish fair admissions rules and still be practically narrow. Travel cost, legal advice, family disruption, disability accommodation, translation, and the ability to withstand public scrutiny can quietly select for people already protected by privilege (Ansell and Gash, 2008; OECD, 2026b).

Attach an access-burden review to the replication decision. Identify who is deterred by distance, legal uncertainty, language, visa status, caregiving responsibilities, disability barriers, public-risk fear, or cost.

Scarcity also affects host communities. When one site is treated as the only place where the future of public power is being formed, nearby land, services, security, transport, media attention, and civic identity may be bent around it. Host residents may carry disruption while the benefits are described in global language. A fair replication analysis counts this local load before singular prestige turns it into the cost of history.

Publish aggregate access barriers and regional reach only where small groups cannot be identified. The access-burden

review asks whether the pipeline is narrow by necessity or because the design has externalized its costs (OECD, 2019a; Ostrom, 2010).

Scarcity is answered without lowering safeguards: by redesigning pathways, translating materials, supporting dependents, creating lawful regional review routes, limiting prestige shortcuts, and refusing donor or political channels that buy practical access. The remedy for an unfair access pattern may be delayed replication, a regional preparatory office, changed support rules, or refusal to grow until the access burden is understood.

Scarcity also tempts a network to create symbolic substitutes such as observer, associate, patron, or honorary status. Each category needs a bounded function, published access rule, expiry, conflict review, and proof that it does not open side doors to staff, records, participants, donors, or prestige without the corresponding public burden. Accreditation should retire any status whose primary product is proximity to the original City.

The access review repeats after every cohort because scarcity changes shape. Early scarcity may be travel cost; later scarcity may be reputation, language, alumni networks, political party familiarity, or fear that only already public people can survive the record (OECD, 2026b; OECD, 2025d).

34.1.2 — Shrine Risk

A shrine risk appears when firstness becomes protection from criticism. The first City may develop founding rooms, early participant stories, famous failures, memorable architecture, and a public mythology of courage. Those things may be humanly understandable. They become dangerous when they make the original site feel untouchable or make later sites feel derivative, less pure, or less legitimate (OECD, 2019a; Ostrom, 2010).

Shrine logic can form without religious language. It can appear in tours that celebrate origin more than safeguards, donor materials that treat proximity to the first site as moral status, staff culture that discourages criticism of founding decisions, or public summaries that cite the original City as the measure of all later Cities.

Treat the first City as a documented, revisable precedent. Founding choices should be versioned, reviewed, criticized, and revised. Later Cities should be allowed to improve on the original without being treated as disloyal. Accreditation files should record which founding practices were retained, which were changed, and why the change protected people better.

The original site is protected from overvisitation as well as from neglect. Constant tours, ceremonies, anniversary events, and media pilgrimages can make daily life performative for participants and staff. A shrine is built not only by words, but by traffic. Accreditation should review whether public access to the original site teaches the system or consumes it.

The documented founding account should include the decisions later corrected and the evidence that changed them. Visitors can then distinguish the historical design from the current standard (OECD, 2025d; OECD, 2019a).

Shrine risk is especially likely when critics attack the City unfairly. Supporters may respond by defending every founding detail instead of defending the right principles. Accreditation should distinguish defense of people from defense of old design. The City can protect participants and staff from hostile distortion while still admitting that the original institution must change when evidence requires it.

34.1.3 — Comparative Learning

One City can demonstrate only one context. It can teach how a particular campus, legal envelope, host community, staff model, archive stack, and admissions pathway behave under particular pressures. It cannot, by itself, show how the model travels across climate, law, language, culture, political history, disability access, regional media, or labor markets. Comparative learning is the disciplined reason to consider plurality (Emerson, Nabatchi, and Balogh, 2012; Ansell and Gash, 2008).

Comparisons should match institutional functions and conditions: which safeguard failed, under what load, and with what remedy? The unit of analysis is the procedure in context; the person-ranking prohibitions in Section 11.7.6 continue to apply.

A shared learning file attaches each finding to its local conditions: climate, law, staff ratio, public interface, visitor policy, technology stack, emergency infrastructure, and host-community history.

Affected persons have standing in comparative learning. Participants can describe whether the active record burden remained livable. Staff can report workload, moral injury, retaliation risk, and role confusion. Host residents can report disruption, service pressure, local trust, and complaint route effectiveness. Public users can report whether the record site was understandable without becoming voyeuristic (OECD, 2025d; OECD, 2019a).

Comparative learning also requires common vocabulary for failure. If one site calls an event a privacy incident, another calls the same event a release irregularity, and a third calls it a communication issue, the network will not see the pattern. Accreditation should require a shared incident taxonomy while

allowing local narrative context (Provan and Kenis, 2008; Emerson, Nabatchi, and Balogh, 2012).

The most valuable comparison may be between a site that grows slowly and a site that pauses. If the paused site protects staff, records, and host trust better than the faster site, the network should be able to learn that restraint worked. Plurality should therefore compare choices not taken as well as programs launched.

Learning accounts for the burden created by measurement itself. If one site collects more staff reports than another, the difference may reflect heavier documentation burden rather than better culture. If one record-site receives more public complaints, it may be more usable rather than less safe. Comparative learning must therefore interpret counts through context, not convert them into crude institutional grades (Ansell and Gash, 2008; OECD, 2026b).

34.1.4 — Regional Fit

Regional fit must account for law, weather, water, labor, language, memory, politics, religion, media, emergency services, disability infrastructure, and local fears (OECD, 2025d; OECD, 2019a).

Heat stress may require different circulation, sleep protection, outdoor timing, energy systems, water strategy, and recovery spaces. A City in a multilingual region may need record-site interpretation, legal notices, staff language capacity, and public explanation in more than one language. A region with a history of state surveillance may need stronger public education around nonparticipant privacy, archive limits, and complaint routes before trust is possible.

Before accreditation, a regional fit dossier records the conditions that local translation cannot ignore. The dossier

covers host law, land and environmental burden, labor conditions, public services, cultural and language access, disability access, family impacts, media exposure, and objection routes. Promoters do not write it alone; host reviewers, independent auditors, local rights advocates, staff representatives, and affected public institutions can challenge the assumptions and conclusions.

Regional fit also protects applicants. A participant who can carry the active record burden in one cultural or media environment may face a different kind of risk in another. Public shame, family retaliation, political violence, religious pressure, or targeted harassment can change the burden of visibility. Admission standards and support models must reflect those local risks without lowering the invariant standards that protect privacy and voluntariness (Provan and Kenis, 2008; Emerson, Nabatchi, and Balogh, 2012).

If local law cannot protect ordinary privacy, the host government demands improper access, water or housing burden would be unjust, security conditions would force carceral design, or the public record site would enable factional intimidation, refuse, delay, or relocate.

Regional fit also includes political temperature. A City placed inside a polarized environment may become a target for factions that want either to capture it or destroy it. The accreditation file should ask how protest, media attention, campaign pressure, and local party structures will affect participants, staff, and ordinary residents. A region may be lawful and still unsafe for this burden at a given time (OECD, 2026b; OECD, 2025d).

Regional fit is revisited after public attention arrives. A site may seem locally compatible during planning and then change the neighborhood’s media exposure, housing market, security

posture, and civic identity once participants become prominent (OECD, 2019a; Ostrom, 2010).

34.1.5 — Resilience Through Plurality

Plurality can create resilience only when it reduces dependency rather than multiplying fragility. One City can be shut down by disaster, legal attack, political capture, vendor collapse, scandal, cyber compromise, donor withdrawal, or a single serious institutional failure. If the entire model rests on one site, every pressure on that site becomes pressure on the whole idea (Provan and Kenis, 2008; Emerson, Nabatchi, and Balogh, 2012).

A network can distribute learning, emergency support, staff training, archive recovery, and local legitimacy. It can allow one site to pause without ending the entire project. It can let a climate lesson travel from one region to another. It can protect participants during relocation if a City becomes unsafe. Coordination requires agreed standards in advance.

Plurality becomes resilient when redundancy remains bounded by purpose, custody, and authority. Archive continuity cannot give one center ownership of every record; emergency hosting cannot authorize open transfer of protected material; staff exchange cannot create an informal hierarchy; and shared standards cannot become command. The network should publish what can travel, what remains local, what needs separate consent or lawful authority, and how temporary support ends.

Plurality should be tested against a failure shared by several sites. In a declared drill, assume that a common identity service or vendor update becomes unavailable while two sites need the same outside reviewer. Can authorized staff reach the permitted records through an independently provisioned fallback, preserve current restrictions, and obtain review from someone who is not already committed to the other case? Two copies of a system

behind the same failed access service do not provide independent recovery.

The resulting dependency map records which functions share authentication, funding, personnel, or infrastructure and which alternatives have actually been exercised. A receiving site can decline work that would endanger its own essential duties. Shared expertise remains valuable, but resilience requires usable separation at the point of failure and enough qualified capacity to carry both sides of a transfer. Cross-review tests those claims without merging protected case files.

Shared learning can begin before several Cities are built. Independent teams can work from the same fictional decision files, then report how local law, staffing, access needs, or review practice changes the result. A common protocol records the task, version, method, uncertainty, and correction so another team can reproduce the comparison. Protected personal records remain with their lawful custodians. The shared product is a tested procedure and an account of where it travels well, giving public institutions and research groups a practical reason to collaborate without first adopting the whole City.

34.2 — Accreditation and Nonnegotiable Standards

Accreditation in this book is a revocable public finding about a defined institutional function, site, term, and evidence set. It is not a certificate of virtue, judgment of personal worth, office credential, or proof that the City model is generally successful. Scope, conditions, exclusions, expiry, and appeal belong in the first sentence of every status statement. Public interpretation should never have to search later pages to discover what the accreditation did not cover (ISO/IEC, 2017; ISEAL Alliance, 2025).

34.2.1 — Adult Voluntary Entry

Adult voluntary entry is the first invariant because the City's burden cannot be placed on children or adults deprived of a real refusal by threats, dependency, debt leverage, unmet needs for care or safety, or social pressure. The City may ask adults seeking substantial public power to accept additional public burden. It may not turn vulnerability into recruitment material (United Nations, 2006; ISO/IEC, 2017).

Sample entry decisions against the Chapter 14 admission standard, including whether independent advice and a genuine opportunity to withdraw preceded activation. Review recruitment, acceptance, and support records separately so the assessment does not become a public applicant biography.

Reviewers should test the separation of recruitment, support, public messaging, and acceptance decisions for informal pressure on applicants and nearby people (Strathern, 2000; ISO/IEC, 2017).

Audit recruitment scripts, ceremonies, admissions interviews and donor materials for honor-based pressure, including claims that entering proves courage or refusal shows lesser civic worth.

Voluntary entry also governs re-entry. A former participant may return only through a fresh, pressure-screened decision that accounts for changed health, household, finances, public exposure, and prior exit. Neither nostalgia, institutional need, donor interest, nor promised office advantage may convert a past yes into continuing consent.

34.2.2 — Transparent Vow and Total Record Rule

The Transparent Vow and total-record rule can be accredited only as a bounded active institutional function. The assessment identifies when capture begins, which role activities are included, which protected categories remain nonpublic, how access and release differ, how correction works, when the record ends, and what survives exit.

Replication review tests the separation of record stages and the research and training permissions in Section 11.6.

A later City cannot create private influence rooms, unlogged donor or party strategy, or machine summaries that replace source provenance. Clinical care remains outside the role record under Chapter 7; no public status label may reveal a protected episode merely to demonstrate continuity (ISEAL Alliance, 2025; ENQA et al., 2015).

The remedy for violation depends on severity. A continuity break may require repair, public status labeling, affected-person notice, and temporary limitation of release. Intentional off-record active formation may require suspension, participant review, audit of advisors and staff, and possibly decertification.

Scenario rehearsal tests this invariant before accreditation. Reviewers should ask what happens when a participant receives an off-site call from a party strategist, when a mentor gives advice during a medical visit, when a donor tries to host a

dinner, when a staff member sends informal notes, or when a device fails during a deliberation.

Status reporting must distinguish expected-but-missing records from lawful noncapture. A technical failure or emergency shelter move may interrupt permitted capture; a legal privilege issue or protected health episode may instead require capture to stop under the protected scope. The City should mark reportable status without exposing protected material or a protected record's existence. Where safe, a public status label should explain record quality without turning uncertainty into accusation (Power, 1997; Strathern, 2000).

Assessment includes an adversarial end-to-end trace: create a role event, classify it, shield a protected element, release the permitted portion, challenge the classification, correct an error, preserve provenance, and complete exit handling. The trace must remain usable under dispute.

34.2.3 — Ordinary Privacy Protection

Ordinary privacy protection is assessed by testing the boundary from the outside inward. Reviewers begin with partners, children, dependents, neighbors, clinicians, counsel, staff, visitors, and nonparticipants, then ask whether any City process captures, infers, links, or releases more than the public role requires. The burden of proof rests on the institution.

Ordinary privacy also limits replication marketing. A new site may not attract attention by promising raw transparency, total access, intimate revelation, celebrity records, family visibility, or public entertainment. The public interest in public-power formation is real, but public appetite is not the standard for release. Review public-facing language before the site opens (Power, 1997; Strathern, 2000).

Repeated protected-life capture, improper release, or ineffective correction suspends the affected capture, release, or search function until independent testing verifies repair. Privacy protection, correction, complaint, and remedy remain available. Reviewers distinguish a concealed defect from an incident the site detected, contained, and remedied.

Accreditation begins with adversarial privacy testing. Reviewers should attempt to reconstruct a child's school, a partner's medical condition, a visitor's identity, a staff member's off-duty pattern, or a host resident's location from released bundles and metadata. A verified reconstruction of protected information from released bundles or metadata is a release failure, even if no raw private field appears on the page (ISO, 2026; ISEAL Alliance, 2025).

34.2.4 — Accreditation Standard for Staff Dignity

Staff dignity is an accredited operating condition, not an employment-policy appendix. Review examines wages, classification, workload, relief coverage, role separation, psychological safety, complaint, anti-retaliation, care, training time, contractor parity, and whether hidden labor is carrying the institution's public promises (ISO, 2021b; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

Review staff dignity during quiet weeks and under surge conditions, including public controversy, cyber incidents, participant distress, and intense media attention. Require surge staffing plans, rest protections, trauma support, and authority to slow operations when staff load becomes unsafe.

Assessment includes roster and workflow evidence, protected worker testimony, turnover, overtime, leave, vacancy, complaint latency, role conflicts, subcontracting, and tasks missing from formal charts.

Staff-scope status is conditional or suspended when compliance depends on chronic overtime, prohibited role combinations, retaliation risk, unpaid emotional labor, unsafe contractor conditions, or insufficient staffing for rights and care routes. The site may reduce cohort or function while repair occurs.

34.2.5 — AI Subordination

Artificial Intelligence subordination is assessed at the function level. The file identifies purpose, data, model or service, human decision owner, affected people, allowed output, prohibited inference, logging, source trace, challenge, fallback, vendor exit, retirement, and the exact action that a person rather than a system must authorize (NIST, 2023a; Government Accountability Office, 2020b).

Technical standing is suspended for prohibited profiling under Section 11.7.6, machine decisions outside the approved function, unauthorized training, or obstructed review. A human signoff does not make a prohibited participant profile permissible. Restoration requires independent retesting of the failed control.

Assessment includes failure and refusal tests. The system is asked to abstain when evidence is insufficient, preserve disagreement, survive unavailable vendor service, route a challenge to a competent person, and support manual operation. Public-interface testing must also show that readers can distinguish machine-assisted search or summary from an official finding and locate the underlying source before relying on the output.

34.2.6 — Accreditation Evidence and Decertification

A credible system separates standard setting, technical assistance, assessment, decision, complaint, and appeal enough to manage conflicts. One body may coordinate the architecture,

but no consultant should certify its own advice and no funder should decide the standing of a recipient that depends on its money. Competence and independence are assessed by function.

The evidence file shows requirement, indicator, method, sample, source version, finding, severity, affected people, corrective action, reviewer competence, conflict declaration, minority view, and decision. The status is no stronger than the file that supports it. Audit volume cannot substitute for a usable chain of reasoning (ISO, 2026; Power, 1997).

Adult voluntary entry, the Transparent Vow, ordinary privacy, staff dignity, human authority over Artificial Intelligence, record correction, host standing, exit, and decertification are institutional conditions, never personal rank. Each condition has its own evidence and stop consequence, so apparent strength in one function cannot compensate for failure in another (ISO/IEC, 2017; ISO, 2026; ISEAL Alliance, 2025).

For each accredited scope, distinguish the invariant from permitted local translation in the evidence file. Complaint, appeal, suspension, decertification, correction, requalification, and review of the accreditor receive equal standing with initial approval (ISO/IEC, 2017; ISO, 2026; ISEAL Alliance, 2025).

Consider a hypothetical second site with strong climate adaptation, lawful host approval, multilingual materials, impressive financing, and a widely admired design. During review, however, staff contracts deny independent complaint access and the search vendor retains authority to generate public participant summaries without named human approval. Local leaders describe both choices as cultural and technical adaptation.

Both defects violate the accreditation requirements in this section. Denial must identify the failed functions and the

evidence needed for reconsideration; climate adaptation and financing cannot compensate for either failure.

Decertification possibility is itself a nonnegotiable standard. Every accredited scope has a term, ongoing review plan, complaint route, suspension authority, public-warning rule, continuity obligation, appeal, and requalification pathway (ISEAL Alliance, 2025; ISO/IEC, 2017).

Provide initiation routes for participants, staff, ombuds, auditors, affected persons, host communities, external inspectors, relevant legal authorities, and network reviewers.

A credible decertification process is bounded by evidence, due process, lawful review, appeal, protection against bad-faith campaigns, and safeguards for affected people. Those controls prevent factional punishment, ideological discipline, donor retaliation, and public spectacle without making removal impossible. A standard has practical meaning only when it can be applied to a prestigious site under pressure and still produce a reasoned, reviewable decision (ISO/IEC, 2017; ISO, 2026).

Decertification can remove permission to admit new participants, claim accreditation, participate in corridors, publish accredited record-site bundles, or represent the site as a Transparent City. The continuing duties and funded continuity plan in Section 34.5 remain in force.

Vendor, donor, staff, participant, and host agreements must anticipate suspension and decertification, including data custody, service continuity, funding, notice, portability, and exit. The public decision states the exact scope lost, effective time, reasons, evidence limits, protections, appeal, and next review without issuing a verdict on every person at the site.

Each standard states its suspension trigger and uses Section 34.5 for requalification. Scope contracts to the failed function

when other functions remain safe; repeated failures across functions trigger review of their common governance.

34.3 — Local Translation Without Constitutional Drift

Local translation concerns how institutional rules and ideas are received and adapted in a host context (Dolowitz and Marsh, 2000; Teubner, 1998; Acharya, 2004; Levitt and Merry, 2009; Merry, 2006). For the City, adaptation must preserve the direction of burden, rights, records, human authority, and exit. Constitutional drift is the opposite danger. A site can invoke climate, law, culture, language, or local politics to loosen the core.

34.3.1 — Climate Translation

The climate review should assess heat, cold, flood, drought, fire, storm, snow, wind, air quality, daylight, darkness, insects, water stress, and energy reliability for their implications for sleep, work, staff safety, archive continuity, public access, emergency routes, and host-community cost.

Climate translation is documented before design approval. The file should include hazard maps, water demand, energy load, material durability, maintenance capacity, emergency-service compatibility, outdoor exposure, sensory load, accessibility during weather events, archive continuity, and environmental burden on the host region.

Translation may change form. Options for local professional review include shaded circulation, adjusted public-interface hours, cooling reserves, and water-sensitive landscape in hot regions; enclosed commons and snow-safe service routes in cold regions; and defensible space, smoke filtration, and evacuation design in fire-prone regions. These are examples for site-specific assessment, not a substitute for applicable standards or engineering review. Identify the relevant standards and the capacity to implement them (World Bank, 2025).

The review should include ordinary days as well as extreme events. The WHO housing review reports associations between indoor heat and sleep problems, while rating the direct morbidity evidence as low certainty; environmental noise can also disturb sleep (World Health Organization, 2018b; Basner et al., 2014). Local user testing should examine glare, sensory overload, isolation along indoor routes, and mechanical noise as possible burdens.

Climate translation requires cost transparency. Record the capital and operating costs of proposed cooling systems, fire buffers, storm hardening, flood elevation, and water-reuse designs. Compare their protection, maintenance demands, and distribution of costs against local conditions and capacity (OECD, 2025d). Climate adaptation cannot excuse extravagance; the design must protect local people at a cost the host and institution can honestly carry.

34.3.2 — Legal Translation

Entry, consent, records, labor, health, disability, privacy, family protection, public access, procurement, security, land use, emergency authority, and data transfer are governed differently across jurisdictions (World Bank, 2025; Acharya, 2004).

Institutional standing depends on a legal compatibility opinion that is independent enough to be trusted and plain enough to be understood. It should identify the host jurisdiction, controlling laws, unresolved legal risks, record-release limits, staff protections, nonparticipant remedies, family and child safeguards, professional privilege, data transfer restrictions, public notice duties, and court or regulator routes. The opinion should also state where the design cannot proceed without legal change or leadership decision.

Legal translation begins with the limits of City authority. The City can prepare candidate standards, identify protected functions, and require jurisdiction-specific review, but only lawful institutions can enact or interpret binding law. *The Constitution of Fairness* retains model legal architecture, while actual authorities determine validity in each jurisdiction. Replication remains unavailable where lawful protection, remedy, labor status, privacy authority, or exit cannot be secured.

A site should not choose a jurisdiction because privacy law is weak, labor remedies are thin, public records can be hidden, donors can control entities quietly, or vulnerable applicants have fewer rights (Levitt and Merry, 2009; Dolowitz and Marsh, 2000).

Legal review identifies conflicts between the City's vocabulary and local legal categories. A term such as public record, participant, release, consent, or protected summary may carry different legal consequences in different places. Accreditation should require translation not only of language but of legal meaning, so the public is not misled by familiar words doing unfamiliar work.

Legal translation defines what follows when law changes. A privacy statute may be amended, emergency powers may expand, labor law may shift, or political authorities may demand more access. Accreditation should require legal-change triggers so the City pauses affected functions when the legal envelope that justified them no longer holds.

Legal translation also affects public expectation. A record category that can be released in one jurisdiction may be sealed in another. Public summaries should explain lawful difference without implying secrecy, weakness, or superior transparency.

Legal variation should be clear before comparison begins (Acharya, 2004; Merry, 2006).

34.3.3 — Cultural Translation

A proposed site may say that younger entry is normal, that family exposure is expected, that public trust requires more intimate release, that local elites must hold more discretion, or that Artificial Intelligence interpretation is necessary because staff are scarce. Translation becomes drift when it changes the City's type.

Cultural translation begins with respect for context and suspicion toward excuses. Communities differ in public trust, shame, family role, religious practice, gender expectations, political memory, media habits, attitudes toward institutions, and histories of surveillance or colonization (Levitt and Merry, 2009; Dolowitz and Marsh, 2000).

Accreditation begins with a cultural burden review before launch. The review should include local historians, rights advocates, disability representatives, language communities, religious and nonreligious perspectives, labor voices, host residents, and people who are skeptical of the City.

Cultural translation can change how the City explains itself, how families are consulted, how public interface spaces are designed, how modesty and intimacy protections are communicated, how staff are trained, how conflict is mediated, and how public record summaries are contextualized. It can also change the pace of launch. A community with fresh memory of surveillance may require deeper public education before any record-site interface is trusted.

Cultural translation includes dissenting members of the culture, not only official representatives. Local elites often present their own preferences as tradition. A serious review asks

women, minorities, disabled people, young adults, secular residents, religious minorities, workers, migrants, and critics how the City's visibility could affect them.

Cultural review examines the City's effect on local meaning. A Transparent City may alter how a community speaks about ambition, shame, public duty, privacy, and leadership. That influence is not automatically bad, but it is real. Translation should notice when the institution's language begins to pressure ordinary residents into visible virtue even though they never accepted the Vow.

34.3.4 — Language Translation

Language access determines who can understand the Vow, consent, exit, complaint, record status, public summaries, warning labels, staff rights, visitor rules, and accreditation standing (United Nations, 2006; Acharya, 2004).

An acceptable accreditation record requires a language access plan covering applicant materials, activation documents, public record-site labels, complaint forms, privacy notices, staff training, emergency instructions, host-community updates, public warnings, and decertification notices. The plan should name which languages are supported, who verifies translation quality, how terminology is controlled, and how disputes over meaning are corrected.

Network-wide terminology control need not become centralized command. A shared glossary can protect rights by keeping key terms stable across record-sites and public notices. Local language teams can then adapt examples, syntax, accessibility supports, and cultural references (Teubner, 1998; OECD, 2025d).

The language plan includes disagreement over translation. If a participant, staff member, or public user says a translated term

misstates a right, the City should not treat the complaint as stylistic preference. High-risk language disputes need review, versioning, and public correction where reliance may have occurred.

Language review examines the emotional force of words. A technically accurate term may sound accusatory, sacred, bureaucratic, or punitive in another language. Because the City touches dignity, translation should preserve tone as well as content (Acharya, 2004; Merry, 2006).

34.3.5 — Core Invariant Protection

The translation matrix separates the invariants in Section 34.2 from adaptable means such as materials, schedules, climate systems, and local advisory structures. Each variation is classified as adaptable, jurisdiction-specific, prohibited, or unresolved (Merry, 2006; Levitt and Merry, 2009).

A credible review also requires a variation register. The word waiver is avoided where it could imply permission to weaken a core safeguard. Each allowed variation names the local reason, affected persons, legal basis, record stage, reviewer, evidence, public explanation, monitoring rule, expiry, failure condition, and route for challenge. An unresolved variation cannot be converted into a permanent practice through use.

Participants, staff, host residents, public users, nonparticipants, worker representatives, and auditors may challenge a local translation that weakens a safeguard protecting them. The matrix must record how their evidence was considered, rejected, or used to change the design (Teubner, 1998; OECD, 2025d).

A variation that appears safe at launch may behave differently under public attention, staff turnover, political pressure, climate stress, emergency, or changing law. Periodic and incident-triggered review asks whether it still protects the

invariant, whether new people carry the burden, and whether its evidence has expired. If the answer becomes unclear, the function narrows or pauses while review proceeds (Acharya, 2004; Merry, 2006; ISEAL Alliance, 2025).

An independent reviewer should trace each local form to the function it protects, the evidence for that function, the affected people, lawful authority, and the condition for revision. Replication also needs an account of why the arrangement is expected to work here. A later site may change a schedule because its travel pattern differs; it should state how that change preserves recovery, staff coverage, and access rather than copy the original hours.

A transfer record distinguishes the core duty from the local means of carrying it and identifies contextual assumptions before the receiving site’s outcomes are known. It names any exceptional launch support, such as visiting reviewers or temporary staff, and explains how the receiving site will replace or sustain that capacity. Results remain attributed to the sites and conditions that produced them; a pooled average is not a substitute for explaining an important local difference. Complex-intervention guidance makes context and program theory part of evaluation rather than a footnote (Skivington et al., 2021).

34.4 — Corridor, Archive, and Record-Site

Interoperability implements Chapter 28 across jurisdictions: the transfer agreement identifies which site can authorize each use and which authority handles a disputed correction. Shared infrastructure confers no additional power over records or people (W3C, 2013; NIST, 2020b; NIST, 2024a). Shared records require access logs and a method for suspending exchange during a dispute. One host's refusal cannot silently remove lawful remedies in another jurisdiction.

34.4.1 — Corridor Standards

Corridor standards govern planned movement between Cities. A corridor may be physical, legal, administrative, technical, or professional. It may cover travel for study, office interface, deliberation, health support, emergency relocation, diplomatic preparation, or temporary hosting (Provan and Kenis, 2008; OECD, 2026b).

The corridor file names purpose, duration, sending City, receiving City, legal jurisdiction, record continuity, privacy limits, staff roles, host burden, security rules, gift and contact rules, emergency contact, and return review. The receiving City should not treat the participant as an unstructured guest. The sending City should not use transfer to evade its own failures.

Apply Chapter 7's capture boundary during travel. Role business belongs in the permitted record; protected ordinary life is not collected merely because a participant is moving. Public status need not disclose an itinerary or reveal that protected care occurred (W3C, 2013; ISO, 2016a).

Review covers pre-approval for planned corridors, emergency approval for urgent movement, after-action review, and participant appeal when conditions become unsafe or overexposing. Staff should be able to object if corridor duties

exceed safe workload. Host communities should have notice of repeated corridor burdens if the pattern affects local services or security.

Corridor standards define informal contact. Movement creates waiting rooms, vehicles, hotels, meals, local guides, brief greetings, and accidental meetings. Training should teach participants and staff what to do when public-power conversation begins where corridor capture is weak (Provan and Kenis, 2008; OECD, 2026b).

34.4.2 — Archive Standards

Each site retains lawful custody while the archive standard specifies the metadata and correction protocol needed for transfer. The receiving custodian must be able to enforce the sending record's restrictions under applicable law; incompatible permissions stop the transfer (W3C, 2013; ISO, 2016a).

The archive standard prepares for decertified sites. If a City loses standing, its records do not become ownerless, and the network does not automatically become their master. Custody, lawful preservation, correction rights, protected material, and public status labels should remain governed (W3C, 2013; ISO, 2016a).

Plan format migration for obsolete media, vendor disappearance, cryptographic transitions, and accessibility changes. Preserve readability, authentication, correction, and existing exposure limits.

Network restoration must satisfy the recovery standard established in Section 8.1: records are recovered, authenticated, and returned to their correct access, status, and correction rules after disruption. Accreditation requires evidence from an actual restoration drill, not a paper backup claim (ISO, 2019; Provan and Kenis, 2008).

34.4.3 — Record-Site Standards

A network's public record-site standard should make records legible, contextual, correctable, accessible, and clearly bounded by status, without turning comparison into a leaderboard (Provan and Kenis, 2008; OECD, 2026b).

Use common status labels and version rules so a user can distinguish accredited, restricted, suspended, and decertified functions across sites. Local interfaces may vary, but the same label must not imply different assurance.

Record-site standards require user testing with skeptical and nonexpert readers. Testers should be asked what they think an accreditation mark means, what they think a disputed bundle means, and whether they mistake a summary for a source record. Their misunderstandings are design data.

Record-site interoperability allows local emphasis without local confusion. A City facing language diversity may foreground translation labels; a City recovering from a privacy incident may foreground release status; a City under requalification may foreground conditions. Variation is acceptable when the public can still identify the same core statuses across sites.

The record-site standard places current decertification status beside older materials. A public bundle released while a site was accredited may later need a status banner if the site loses standing. Historical accuracy should not become present-tense reassurance (NIST, 2024a; W3C, 2013).

34.4.4 — Covenant Status Portability

Covenant Status Portability handles the participant who moves between Cities without allowing the burden to disappear or multiply unfairly. Portability does not mean that one City's approval automatically binds another City. It means that the

participant's active status, rights, record obligations, support needs, protected categories, and limits travel through a defined review rather than through improvisation (W3C, 2013; ISO, 2016a).

The portability file carries the minimum status and restrictions necessary for the receiving role. Clinical and household support are arranged separately with their lawful custodians; a need for continuity does not authorize a general health or family dossier.

Portability fails through either a record gap or a double burden. A gap appears when active public-power formation becomes off-record during transfer. Double burden appears when the participant is forced to repeat exposure, consent, or public explanation beyond what the role requires.

Portability includes the right to refuse transfer. A participant may decide that a receiving City's climate, language, staff model, legal context, or public exposure would change the burden too much. Refusal should not be treated as breach or weakness. A Covenant continues only where the person can carry it under conditions they understand.

Unresolved complaints travel only through bounded, purpose-specific review. A participant should not move to another City in a way that strands a complaint at the sending site or hides a pattern from the receiving site. At the same time, the transfer should not turn disputed allegations into public punishment. The portability file needs status, context, and protection, not rumor.

Support obligations become portable only through review. Debt relief, healthcare, housing, dependent care, disability accommodations, and clinical support cannot be assumed to function identically elsewhere. A transfer that preserves record burden but loses support would be unfair (ISO, 2019; Provan and Kenis, 2008).

34.4.5 — Emergency Interoperability

Fire, flood, cyberattack, civil unrest, medical emergency, infrastructure failure, legal order, political threat, or host disruption may require one City to support another. The network should know in advance how to protect life, records, privacy, and public explanation when ordinary operations are interrupted (Provan and Kenis, 2008; OECD, 2026b).

Artificial Intelligence, vendors, and public interfaces are high-risk during emergencies. A model may misclassify records under stress. A vendor may request broad access to repair systems. A public site may auto-post incomplete warnings. A receiving City may ingest data too widely. Emergency interoperability should identify who can authorize technical actions and how those actions are reviewed after the event.

Emergency drills include failure of communication itself. A storm may disable ordinary network channels, a cyberattack may corrupt status labels, or civil unrest may make public notice unsafe for a time. The standard should define who can act when central contact is unavailable and how the action is later reviewed.

Emergency interoperability protects host communities from surprise. If a receiving City may host evacuees, store temporary records, or absorb staff support from another site, local emergency partners should know the conditions in advance (Provan and Kenis, 2008; OECD, 2026b). Mutual-aid agreements should name host capacity limits so emergency support never becomes open-ended dependence.

Under degraded conditions, staff distinguish information necessary for immediate care from material needed only for later accountability. Drill this triage with a partially impaired receiving site, measuring whether staff can preserve the appropriate restrictions under time pressure.

Test the shared-vendor failure and independent fallback described in Section 34.1.5 during the emergency exercise. Local access must work without permission from the failed shared service, and the receiving site’s refusal threshold must remain enforceable (NIST, 2024a; W3C, 2013).

34.5 — Decertification and Suspension

Suspension and decertification are different controls. Suspension temporarily restricts a defined site or function while evidence, risk, or corrective action remains unresolved. Decertification withdraws standing when failure is severe, repeated, concealed, unremedied, or incompatible with a core invariant. Each decision names scope, threshold, reviewer, conflicts, immediate protection, notice, appeal, record and host consequences, and the next review date. Neither status becomes a moral judgment on participants, staff, or place.

34.5.1 — Suspension Conditions

Common suspension triggers include credible rights violations, record integrity failure, continuity breaks, staff retaliation, child or nonparticipant exposure, unlawful release, Artificial Intelligence overreach, vendor compromise, security breakdown, host-community burden not addressed, governance conflict, donor interference, or evidence that entry has not been genuinely voluntary.

A suspension order is scoped to the failing function whenever protection permits. A record-site release function can be suspended without closing housing. New admissions can pause while participant care continues. Corridor participation can stop while archive custody remains. Artificial Intelligence search can be disabled while human retrieval operates.

Review independence excludes the managers whose decisions are under question. Emergency suspension may be imposed quickly, but continued suspension should require defined evidence review, status updates, appeal where appropriate, and care planning. The City should not use suspension to hide criticism, punish whistleblowers, or quietly remove an unpopular participant.

A suspended function returns only after the corrective route has been independently tested under the condition that caused failure. A revised policy, new manager, or completed training is evidence of action, not evidence of effectiveness. The decision file must show what changed in operation and what remains uncertain.

When the required evidence cannot be produced before expiry, suspension does not quietly lapse into normal operation. It is renewed with reasons, narrowed, converted to decertification, or retired.

34.5.2 — Decertification Conditions

Decertification conditions include intentional off-record active public-power formation, coerced or non-adult entry, repeated protected nonvisibility breaches, child exposure, and systemic staff retaliation. They also include falsified archive records, corrupt donor or vendor control, Artificial Intelligence authority over release or ranking, refusal of external audit, repeated host-community harm, loss of lawful authority, or inability to secure records. Some conditions may require immediate action. Others may follow failed suspension and repair.

The process distinguishes institutional failure from individual misconduct. A participant may commit misconduct without the City losing standing if the institution responds lawfully and effectively. A City may deserve decertification even if no single person becomes the villain, because the system itself made harm likely, hidden, repeated, or unrepaired.

Cumulative failure also belongs in the network’s review field. One small privacy error, one staffing overload, or one confusing label may be repairable. A pattern of small unresolved failures can show that the City cannot learn. Decertification conditions

should therefore include repeated near misses and ignored warnings, not only dramatic public harms.

Decertification protects against asset capture. A site losing the name should not transfer records, buildings, marks, donor lists, or public interfaces to a successor controlled by the same failed interests without review. Otherwise decertification becomes rebranding. The network must be able to tell the difference between repair and disguise (ENQA et al., 2015; Power, 1997).

34.5.3 — Public Warning

Loss of standing never ends the site's human duties. Participants may still need care, housing, privacy, correction, and exit support. Staff may still be owed wages, severance, grievance protection, and safe handoff. Records require lawful custody, status labels, access controls, correction, migration, and preservation. Hosts require explanation, mitigation, and continuity for shared services. Donors and vendors require controlled termination rather than informal abandonment. Decertification is therefore accompanied by a funded continuity plan, not merely a public notice (ISEAL Alliance, 2025; ENQA et al., 2015; ISO, 2019).

Public warning is a precise status instrument. It states the affected scope, current risk, effective time, protective action, evidence basis and limits, service consequence, appeal, and next update. It avoids euphemism, sensationalism, and language that converts an institutional defect into a judgment about people.

Warnings travel to the places where reliance occurs. A notice buried in a governance archive is not enough if applicants are reading admissions pages, donors are viewing summaries, journalists are using record-site bundles, or public users are watching excerpts. The public interface should not continue to

present a site as fully accredited while a serious restriction is active.

Affected persons require tailored communication. A participant may need private explanation before a public notice. A staff member may need anti-retaliation assurance. A nonparticipant harmed by exposure may need protected notice. A host community may need a public meeting. A public user may need context for a corrected record bundle (ENQA et al., 2015; Power, 1997).

A public warning should be correctable, timely, and specific enough to guide action before harm. A site may challenge factual error, an affected person may argue that risk is understated, and an auditor may require stronger language.

Warnings are corrected and versioned as facts change. The original notice remains traceable, but the current status must be easy to find. Search results, summaries, corridor systems, and partner sites should not continue displaying an obsolete warning or an obsolete clearance.

34.5.4 — Requalification Pathway

Requalification is a new decision on new evidence. The applicant submits a root-cause account, corrective actions, recurrence controls, affected-person remedies, updated risk assessment, independent test results, conflicts, and a statement of what cannot yet be shown. Prior accreditation creates no presumption of return.

Participants, staff, host communities, auditors, public users, and other affected people should be able to report whether repair altered lived conditions. Evidence must show that staff can safely use the new route, nonparticipants can understand the privacy rule, data and services can leave the old vendor, and correction reaches prior public material.

Refusal remains a possible outcome of requalification. If a site cannot regain lawful protection, if staff trust is irreparably broken, if host legitimacy has collapsed, if records cannot be secured, if leadership remains captured, or if the public would be misled by return, requalification should fail.

Requalification may be narrower than the former scope, time-limited, or subject to enhanced review. Some functions may remain retired. A site that can operate safely only under permanent exceptional supervision has not demonstrated ordinary conformity.

34.5.5 — Network Failure Memory

Network failure memory preserves enough structure for another site to recognize the same pathway without copying protected personal detail. The record includes trigger, context, mechanism, detection, affected people, response, remedy, evidence limits, recurrence signals, and the decision to suspend, decertify, requalify, or retire.

Failure memory is most useful when searchable by mechanism rather than scandal. Future reviewers should be able to find all cases involving corridor gaps, language failures, vendor lock-in, staff retaliation, child shielding, heat stress, archive continuity, public warning delay, or Artificial Intelligence overreach.

Do not make a participant, staff member, nonparticipant, or host resident the public face of a failure lesson without consent and protection. Preserve the institutional fact while shielding the person.

The learning route changes standards. A failure should trigger review of accreditation questions, staff training, public artifacts, technical controls, corridor rules, host review, and decertification thresholds (ISEAL Alliance, 2025; ENQA et al., 2015).

Review failure memory periodically for drift: changes in law, technology, climate, staffing, or institutional design can make lessons obsolete. Preserve the historical record; label controls current, superseded, or uncertain.

34.6 — A Conditional Network of Cities, Not a Shrine

A network of Cities may someday be useful, but growth is not proof of success. Coordination should preserve a common memory of failures while leaving lawful local decisions with the people and institutions that bear their consequences. The founding City must be open to challenge on the same terms as a later site. A proposal to expand should survive the possibility that not building is the better decision. This section tests whether shared standards can support that independence without becoming a new center of power.

34.6.1 — No Sacred Original

The first City receives no permanent interpretive, financial, technical, or accreditation privilege.

Founders may provide evidence and institutional memory, but hold no veto over an accreditation correction.

Later sites may peer-review the original. Test whether a newer or smaller site can raise an adverse finding and obtain the same response the original would expect from others.

No sacred original also protects the founder from being turned into infrastructure. A project that depends on one person's continuing authority or charisma will pressure that person and distort the institution. Accreditation should ask whether the City can explain itself, correct itself, and govern itself without founder presence (Ostrom, 2010; Provan and Kenis, 2008).

34.6.2 — No Accreditation Empire

No accreditation empire means that assurance cannot become a remote authority that owns local Cities. The network sets bounded common requirements and recognizes evidence; lawful local institutions retain operation, host accountability, labor duties, and the authority granted by their jurisdictions. No

network status creates public office or legal power (Ostrom, 2010; Provan and Kenis, 2008).

Whatever form later governance authorizes, the coordinating body must have explicit limits on its powers. It should not appoint governments, certify candidates for office, command lawful jurisdictions, require public voting systems, demand ordinary-citizen data, enforce participation in the Religion of Fairness, authorize research outside science governance, or declare that a country is ready for transition. Those domains belong elsewhere and require their own authority.

Inspect bylaws, contracts, funding, and software together. A narrow charter cannot establish local autonomy if the center alone can disable access, appoint every reviewer, or withdraw indispensable operating funds.

The network center has a deliberately narrow function: maintain standards and versions, recognize competent independent review, publish exact status, coordinate bounded appeals, preserve failure memory, and support interoperability. Admissions, local leadership, budgets, records, employment, public authority, and ideological commitments remain with their lawful and local owners.

Disclose financial dependence and conditions attached to shared support, then test whether a site can challenge a central decision without losing essential services.

34.6.3 — Local Accountability

Participants, staff, residents, neighbors, host services, complainants, public users, and nonparticipants need regular, predictable routes to change local operations without waiting for a network crisis or major public meeting. Accreditation supplements those routes; it does not replace them (Ostrom, 2010; Provan and Kenis, 2008).

Staff accountability includes independent reporting and protection from both local retaliation and network disregard. A staff complaint may reveal a pattern that matters to accreditation. It may also reveal a local management problem that can be repaired without network drama. The route should be able to distinguish these levels without silencing either (Brunsson and Jacobsson, 2000; Büthe and Mattli, 2011).

A host community retains the right to say that cumulative burden has exceeded the original promise. Traffic, housing pressure, media presence, emergency services, protest management, water, waste, labor markets, and public identity can change over time. Host consent should not be treated as a one-time signature that permanently absorbs all later load.

34.6.4 — Plural Learning

Comparative reports use narrative, context, and bounded indicators rather than league tables. A report can say that one City's language access process prevented a complaint backlog, that another City's heat design created staff strain, or that a corridor protocol failed during emergency transfer. It should not say one City is more fair as a total institution or that one population is more ready for transparency.

Plural learning fails when learning is converted into prestige. If reports highlight only success, hide local context, punish sites that report failure, or use comparison for fundraising, the network will train Cities to perform rather than disclose. Plural learning should reward candor, not polish. A site that reports a near miss may be more trustworthy than a site that has learned to hide one.

Non-replication is also a source of learning. A region that refuses, a site that fails legal review, a donor proposal rejected for capture risk, or a climate plan deemed too burdensome can

teach as much as a successful launch. The map of Cities should be accompanied by a memory of places where not building was the fairer decision (Provan and Kenis, 2008; Timmermans and Epstein, 2010).

Learning must be slow enough to separate mechanism from circumstance. A safeguard may appear successful because a cohort was small, a crisis never came, public attention was low, or exceptional staff absorbed the burden. Replication claims should state what was tested, what varied, what remained fixed, and which rival explanations survive.

34.6.5 — Humility at Scale

Before authorizing another site, compare its marginal public benefit and host burden with a smaller intervention. Use the alternatives analysis in Chapter 32 and the local transfer evidence in Section 34.3.5; a growing waiting list alone does not establish the case for another campus.

Public appetite, donor demand, founder prestige, media fascination, political urgency, and the desire to fill a map can show interest. They do not show readiness. The network should publish interest, demonstrated operational readiness, and lawful authorization as separate objects.

A refused donor, slowed expansion, denied site, retired tool, or closed function may frustrate people who expected visible progress. Accept that disappointment without punishing affected people.

Part X — Objections and Final Synthesis

The design now faces a decision rather than another specification. A reader has seen what the City proposes to build, whom it would ask to enter, and what evidence could justify a pilot. Part X asks which objections defeat that case, which demand revision, and which remain unresolved. Its two chapters move from adversarial tests to the responsibilities that would survive any decision to proceed.

The relevant question is no longer whether transparent public-power formation can be described attractively. It is whether the design remains answerable after it acquires land, staff, records, participants, families, vendors, donors, visitors, critics, imitators, and routines. Institutional ethics begin where noble intention stops being enough, because those surrounding systems decide who carries the cost when the design is praised, pressured, or afraid to stop.

Objections function here as design evidence. A privacy complaint, family objection, labor report, host-community grievance, technical incident, or refusal to participate can reveal that harm has already entered a rule, route, record, or public artifact. The institution earns no presumption that those signals are mistaken. A project that treats them as disloyalty has begun protecting itself from the people it claims to protect.

The surveillance objection asks whether records intended to illuminate public-power formation would normalize watching people who never chose the Vow. The captivity objection asks whether voluntary entry could harden into practical confinement. The cult and spectacle objections ask whether meaning, loyalty, narrative, and public appetite could turn a civic institution into obedience or entertainment.

The human-load objection examines the body, mind, household, and long horizon of visible life. The government and elite-gate objection asks whether formation becomes shadow

rule, office entitlement, or a prestigious credential. The archive and Artificial Intelligence objection asks whether technical systems become new authorities precisely because their judgments arrive quickly and fluently.

The intimate-life objection begins with people who never chose participant visibility: partners, children, dependents, clinicians, attorneys, friends, and future family members. The support-ecology objection follows money, contracts, infrastructure, staff labor, and host burden to test whether a hidden City grows beneath the visible one.

Replication poses a different danger. The first City may attract attention before replication is justified. Its language may travel farther than its safeguards, and its prestige may make correction feel like retreat. The final objection therefore asks whether the institution can refuse growth, remember failure, and accept decertification without rewriting the past.

Only after that scrutiny does synthesis begin. What survives is not a declaration of victory, but a more credible civic possibility: public-power formation may become more knowable while ordinary life remains protected, correction remains visible, and refusal remains dignified. The City may prove workable, require substantial revision, or prove unworthy of continuation. Hope is earned here through corrigibility rather than confidence alone.

Chapter 35 — Objections and the Tests They Create

The final red-team hearing opens without a presentation from the City. A privacy advocate begins with a bystander whose image became searchable, a staff representative describes an unsafe workload hidden behind participant success, and a host resident asks why local cost was discovered after public celebration. Only then may the institution answer. Chapter 35 gives critics structural authority to identify the first point at which a chosen public-role burden becomes an imposed burden on someone else.

This chapter organizes objections in a defeat-test register rather than a sequence of rebuttals. Each test records the critic's strongest case, relevant evidence, the City's response, residual risk, credible alternatives including nonadoption, and the conditions that would defeat the proposal. Read these tests with the responsible owners and required consequences specified in the governing chapters. Surveillance, captivity, overload, technical sovereignty, collateral exposure, capture, labor harm, host burden, and replication drift can therefore change the proposal.

Benevolent purpose cannot answer those concerns. The City has to show, in inspectable records and lived practice, that authority is role-bound, entry and exit remain practical, record stages are distinguishable, protected life stays protected, review is independent, and remedies can inconvenience leadership. Where a simpler reform, narrower institution, or decision not to build carries less burden while achieving the relevant public purpose, that alternative belongs inside the comparison.

The consequences must match the failure. A bounded defect may require correction, compensation, retraining, or a delayed release. A severe defect may require pause, shielding, or suspension. Repeated concealment, broken rights, coerced participation, child exposure, or uncorrectable technical

dependence may require decertification or closure. Continuation is not the default verdict. The same directional burden test governs each objection. A defense fails when it preserves institutional confidence by moving fear, workload, cost, exposure, or irreversibility onto people with less authority. Confidence begins to become deserved only when affected people can object without retaliation and when their objections can alter records, resources, access, timing, or continuation.

A red-team answer earns space only when it exposes an operating chain: signal, standing, record, independent decision owner, interim protection, remedy, review clock, and the threshold that pauses or ends the function. Danger is answered by making detection and consequence stronger than institutional self-protection, not by declaring that failure will never occur.

Public artifacts are included because public meaning can outrun internal controls. A donor page may imply certainty, a tour may convert life into performance, a graphic may imply rank, a machine summary may flatten dispute, and a social excerpt may detach a promise from its conditions. High-reach communication requires its own review and withdrawal route.

An objection that can defeat the design contributes to the inquiry. It prevents the institution from redefining voluntariness after exit becomes costly, privacy after ordinary people are exposed, or accreditation after safeguards stop traveling. A critic who forces nonadoption, redesign, or a narrower claim has produced civic knowledge.

The status quo is not treated as harmless merely because the City is risky. Hidden pathways into public power already impose cost, obscure influence, and make correction difficult. The comparison is therefore between imperfect alternatives under common rules, not between a dangerous proposal and an imaginary world without institutional burden.

35.1 — "This Is Authoritarian Surveillance"

Civil-liberties review must test whether capture systems, public records, record sites, visitor boundaries, media rules, and Artificial Intelligence tools turn civic accountability into routine surveillance (Solove, 2006; Richards, 2013). The question is not only how much information is captured but whether people can refuse unrelated observation. Independent reviewers must trace secondary uses and the practical consequences of error. A protection is credible only when an individual can invoke it against institutional convenience.

35.1.1 — Ordinary Privacy Answer

The surveillance objection succeeds whenever ordinary life becomes more observable because the City exists. The failure condition is not only mass release. It is also chilling effect, behavioral pressure, dossier drift, or a public habit of treating proximity to the City as consent (Marwick and boyd, 2011; European Union, 2016).

The required design consequence is restriction or suspension of the offending capture, interface, tour, media practice, or record-release route.

The human-scale threshold is whether opposition, work, visitation, or accidental proximity forces an ordinary person to develop a new privacy strategy. A resident who avoids a hearing, a journalist who changes a route, or a visitor who withholds a question because the City may absorb them has already paid a civic cost.

Consider a livestream that automatically indexes every speaker and creates searchable clips. The public may need the participant’s answer and the issue debated, but it rarely needs the resident’s enduring identity. The City should disable person-level indexing for ordinary attendees, publish a protected

transcript or masked clip, and provide a correction route before the material propagates.

35.1.2 — Chosen Role Burden Answer

The City loses this argument when the chosen role expands until it consumes ordinary humanity. That can happen through vague definitions, active-period creep, off-site monitoring, relationship pressure, or public shaming of protected gaps. The remedy is scope correction, release halt, independent review, and, when necessary, de-loading or exit (Citron, 2019; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Consider a participant who says, under pressure, that they are willing to release a protected counseling note, intimate message, or family exchange because they want to appear transparent. The City should refuse the release if the material belongs to a protected domain or implicates another person's dignity. Consent under reputational pressure can become self-exposure as performance.

35.1.3 — No Downward Visibility Answer

Downward visibility can appear quietly. A public record page may identify host residents to explain a conflict. A volunteer platform may expose users who interacted with a participant. A corridor rule may track visitors too broadly. A public interface may reward people for attaching themselves to visible candidates (Council of Europe, 2018b; Solove, 2006).

In a fictional corridor recording, a participant, cleaner, security worker, and visiting family member appear together. Reviewers test whether the Chapter 7 rules minimize collection and correctly protect each role before any release (European Union, 2016; Nissenbaum, 2010).

A second operating test follows a staff member, critic, or visitor who appears repeatedly around a participant and becomes easier for public users to identify through the participant's

record. The City should ask whether the repeated appearance teaches anything about public-power formation that cannot be preserved through summary, masking, or category description.

35.1.4 — Record-Use Distinction Answer

Test a public demand for all records of a controversial incident. The response must explain the review status of releasable material without confirming protected care, privileged consultation, or another person's involvement. Public outrage supplies no additional permission (Nissenbaum, 2010; Richards, 2013).

The daily operating test is an archive item captured for continuity that a researcher, journalist, vendor, or public-interface team later wants to reuse because it would be efficient. The City should require a new purpose review, new affected-person analysis, and a new record-stage decision.

35.1.5 — Legal Review Answer

Apply the jurisdiction-specific review in Section 34.3.2; a City policy cannot override controlling law or replace an enforceable external remedy (Venice Commission, 2025; Council of Europe, 2018b).

A cross-jurisdictional rehearsal tests participant travel, vendor transfers, journalistic requests, and family-law conflicts (European Union, 2016; Council of Europe, 2018b).

A serious conflict involving privacy, labor, disability, child protection, professional privilege, or public records should trigger a written hold, identified decision owner, affected-person protection, and a route to external adjudication where required (Venice Commission, 2025). A useful legal rehearsal presents an appealing public-release proposal that conflicts with one binding local restriction. Counsel identifies the controlling authority and the function that must stop; an operations owner then

demonstrates a lawful alternative or a reasoned decision not to proceed. The review record preserves the decision, its jurisdiction, expiry or reassessment trigger, and a contact for affected people.

35.2 — "This Becomes a Prison, Cult, or Reality Show"

The second objection concerns three distinct forms of institutional possession. Prison risk arises when residence and dependence make departure unreal; cult risk arises when loyalty, shared language, or meaning becomes a condition of belonging; spectacle risk arises when public attention governs what a person must reveal (Goffman, 1961; Barker, 1984). Renaming the institution a school or a laboratory does not eliminate these risks. Entry, exit, affiliation, and publication rules must each be tested for coercive effects.

35.2.1 — Prison Objection

The proposal violates its own standard when departure becomes practically impossible or socially ruinous. An exit audit should treat unexplained delay, staff language that calls leaving betrayal, record pages that imply departure means unfitness, and support systems that vanish when a participant refuses continued visibility as evidence of coercion rather than administrative friction (Andrejevic, 2004; Deci and Ryan, 2000).

Use Chapter 31’s exit route on that difficult case. Independent assistance must reach the authority able to end active status; an informal ombuds does not issue the exit order. Repeated obstruction suspends admissions until a fresh test shows that departure works.

35.2.2 — Cult Objection

The cult objection is not answered by saying the City is civic rather than religious. Cultic dynamics can arise in secular institutions through founder devotion, insulation from criticism, confession pressure, loyalty tests, humiliation, sleep disruption,

controlled relationships, and the moralization of doubt (Barker, 1984; Lalich, 2004).

Meaning has become coercive when devotion is demanded as evidence of fitness. A cult-risk audit looks for required testimony, pressure to confess inner states, ritualized gratitude, public shaming for refusal, insider language that blocks outside scrutiny, and the habit of explaining every criticism as impurity or misunderstanding (Foucault, 1977; Barker, 1984).

Pluralism is tested when a participant publicly rejects the Law of Fairness while continuing to accept the civic Vow. The City should show that the role concerns public-power formation, not metaphysical agreement (United Nations, 1966; Hirschman, 1970).

35.2.3 — Reality-Show Objection

A record meant to help citizens understand public-power formation can become entertainment if release follows drama, intimacy, conflict, collapse, romance, embarrassment, or scandal (Lalich, 2004; Andrejevic, 2004).

Treat fan culture, outrage-ready quote packages, traffic incentives, donor videos built around personal drama, and media access that converts protected life into civic theater as signs of spectacle drift (Andrejevic, 2004; Deci and Ryan, 2000).

The release rule is tested by a moment that would make the public care more but understand less: tears after family conflict, a visible panic response, an intimate apology, or a staff member absorbing anger. The City should be able to withhold or summarize such material even when release would make the project more emotionally compelling (Andrejevic, 2004; Citron, 2019).

35.2.4 — Rights Objection

An appeal route becomes a maze when the injured person must decipher the institution while carrying the harm. Inaccessible forms, crisis-period deadlines, undefined jurisdiction, retaliation fear, delayed interim protection, opaque evidence rules, and settlements that erase recurring patterns all shift administrative cost downward. Accessibility therefore includes navigation assistance, deadline flexibility, protected contact, a named owner, and a written explanation of what happens next (Venice Commission, 2025; United Nations, 2006).

The operative threshold asks whether a complainant can obtain interim protection before final judgment. When exposure, retaliation, health risk, or family harm is active, a slow promise of review can be another form of burden.

A concrete test arises when a complaint slows a popular participant's public release or interrupts a donor-backed program. Rights are real when they work against momentum. The complainant should have intake, protection, review, appeal, and remedy without being accused of harming the project. If staff treat the complaint as a nuisance rather than evidence of possible burden, the City has begun to defend itself instead of the people it affects.

35.2.5 — Public Artifact Objection

Apply Chapter 33's public-artifact tests to determine whether a cover phrase, diagram, short video, donor paragraph, campus photograph, guide image, public record label, or excerpt implies coercion, holiness, ranking, inevitability, or proof (Lalich, 2004; Andrejevic, 2004).

A representative first-view test should record what authority, rank, or promise an unfamiliar reader infers before seeing supplementary explanation. Repeated misreadings are evidence

that the artifact itself needs redesign, not a longer disclaimer, and should be treated as a release defect until the misleading cues are corrected and the artifact is retested.

35.3 — "No Human Can Survive the Record"

The human-load objection asks whether a body and mind can live under continuous public-power record without becoming hypervigilant, performative, exhausted, alienated, or broken (Karasek, 1979; Edmondson, 1999). Anticipated observation may change speech, sleep, relationships, and willingness to ask for help. These are hypotheses the pilot must investigate, including costs that do not appear in public performance. A humane trial therefore needs direct measures of withdrawal, privacy strain, and requests for relief rather than only completion rates.

35.3.1 — Load Objection

The critic prevails when the City selects for people who can perform under observation rather than people who can govern well. A humane-load audit looks for polished hypervigilance, fear of unscripted speech, overwork praised as discipline, and participants concealing distress because any disclosure may become public interpretation (Dinges et al., 1997; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

Another operational test is a cohort that functions well in public but shows rising de-loading requests, more staff overtime, shorter sleep, more conflict, and quieter private distress. No single incident may look severe. The pattern is the evidence. The City should lower public-interface windows, add recovery, slow admissions, or redesign routines before the burden becomes a story of individual weakness. Humane load design notices the slope before the break.

35.3.2 — Sleep Objection

The sleep objection asks whether anticipation of later interpretation interferes with rest. General evidence on sleep loss

supports taking that risk seriously; it does not establish the effect of this untested institution (Dinges et al., 1997).

Use the protected load-review route in Chapter 18 when rest deteriorates. Operators need functional restrictions and schedule changes, not a public account of nightmares, insomnia, or therapy.

Crisis week supplies the useful stress case. Media pressure rises, a public error needs explanation, a family issue demands attention, staff coverage thins, and every actor can explain why one more late night seems necessary. The sleep rule matters precisely then: emergency authority must be narrow, interruption must be logged, recovery must follow, and repeated exceptions must trigger staffing or interface redesign rather than becoming culture (Van Dongen et al., 2003; ISO, 2021b).

35.3.3 — Identity Objection

The identity objection asks whether living under record changes a person into the role. A participant may begin to experience every gesture as evidence, every doubt as a future quote, every relationship as a public interpretation problem, and every mistake as permanent identity (Deci and Ryan, 2000; McEwen, 1998).

Identity pressure reaches participants under public admiration as well as public criticism. A participant who becomes dependent on the City’s moral image may lose the ability to hear correction.

The book uses identity capture for a design risk in which the City produces institutional selves rather than public servants. Review should look for approved-language dependence, fear of seeking ordinary privacy, treatment of the record as the whole person, and continued participation because life after exit has become difficult to imagine.

A participant can seek protected care or request a change before a public crisis. The operational record may show an authorized adjustment without recording therapeutic content or inferring an inner state.

A useful rehearsal follows a participant whose speech has become perfectly institutional. Reviewers should treat that fluency as an ambiguous signal rather than maturity by definition, then ask whether ordinary humor, dissent, privacy, and unperformed friendship remain recognizable (Hobfoll, 1989; Siegrist, 1996).

35.3.4 — Breakdown Objection

The breakdown objection asks what happens when the record becomes too much. The City's design must allow for misfit, exhaustion, panic, depression, conflict, trauma response, or public attack.

Breakdown has become institutional content when distress is narrated as resilience, care is delayed because the record is considered interesting, staff minimize warning signs, or crisis material is released in the name of transparency (World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022; Karasek, 1979).

Test whether care and immediate protection precede public narrative management, as Chapter 31 requires. A release deadline must yield when it would interfere with safety or expose protected care.

35.3.5 — Long-Term Cost Objection

A participant may appear stable for weeks while accumulating strain that surfaces months later: relationship erosion, chronic sleep loss, public self-consciousness, decision fatigue, or fear of future office life (World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022; Karasek, 1979).

Delayed injury is easy to miss when evaluation ends with the active period. Former participants avoiding public life, families reporting lingering strain, staff turnover dismissed as ordinary churn, and alumni needing unplanned support should trigger review of whether the pilot exported costs beyond its declared window. Those observations do not by themselves establish that the City caused them (McEwen, 1998; Van Dongen et al., 2003).

The pilot should declare its follow-up horizon before launch rather than choosing it after favorable early results (ISO, 2021b; Deci and Ryan, 2000).

The case-level test appears after exit, when a former participant returns to ordinary work, family life, campaign life, or public criticism. The former participant is not a data source by default, but their experience is a warning against judging the pilot only while support systems are still nearby. Former participants should also be able to challenge public summaries of post-exit outcomes without being drawn back into active participation.

35.4 — "City Government or Elite Gate?"

The government and elite-gate objection asks whether the City will become more powerful than it admits. Public-power formation is close to public authority by design. That closeness can become dangerous if the City begins to act as shadow government, office pipeline, moral credential, or gate over democratic legitimacy (Michels, 1962; Rivera, 2015). Internal prestige or rankings cannot substitute for qualifications or decisions entrusted to democratic institutions.

35.4.1 — Government Boundary Answer

Shadow government begins when City operators are obeyed because of institutional prestige rather than lawful office. City review treated as superior to public process, agencies deferring to City staff, or participants invoking City discipline as governing entitlement are boundary breaches (Mansbridge, 2003; Dahl, 1989).

A concrete review should examine a public official who asks the City to settle a governing dispute because the City's record seems more trusted than ordinary institutions. The answer should be refusal unless a lawful advisory role exists outside City authority. The City can explain records, provide public materials, and preserve continuity. It cannot become a shortcut around offices, agencies, courts, legislatures, or elections.

35.4.2 — Office Entitlement Answer

The office-entitlement objection asks whether City participation becomes a claim on appointment, nomination, ballot access, party support, donor confidence, or public office (Pitkin, 1967; United Nations Human Rights Committee, 1996). The objection succeeds when City status becomes an unofficial prerequisite for trust: party gatekeeping, donor support limited to accredited

candidates, media suspicion of nonparticipants, or readiness pages that imply entitlement would create a parallel eligibility regime (Venice Commission, 2025; Mills, 1956).

A clean democratic test occurs when a participant completes formation and then loses an election, nomination, appointment, or public endorsement. The City records the result without treating refusal as public blindness, corruption, or failure to recognize virtue. If staff, alumni, donors, or supporters use City formation to delegitimize the lawful decision, participation has become an entitlement claim and the objection is sustained.

35.4.3 — Elite Access Answer

The elite-access objection asks whether the City becomes a prestige caste even if it remains formally voluntary. Cost, geography, language, disability, family obligations, immigration status, political connections, media polish, and donor attention can decide who enters long before the Vow begins (Young, 2000; Michels, 1962).

Elite closure appears when the City becomes a finishing school for people already selected by wealth, class, media access, or political inheritance. Donor-backed applicants, costly preparation ecosystems, elite referral pipelines, and admiration of institutional scarcity should be read as access failures rather than proof of quality (Collins, 1979; Mansbridge, 2003).

Test the admission system with a fictional applicant whose family danger, disability, immigration position, or justified distrust makes visibility unsafe. Assess support and alternatives under Chapter 14, including a dignified refusal when the proposed burden cannot be made acceptable. Refusal must not lower the person’s civic standing (Young, 2000; United Nations, 2006).

35.4.4 — Credential Halo Answer

Once a participant has lived under visible burden, the public may overread endurance as virtue, visibility as honesty, and archive presence as trustworthiness (Bourdieu, 1986; Pitkin, 1967).

Descriptors such as City-certified leader, donor pages that foreground status over record, party screening based on completion, and participants invoking the City to silence critics convert formation into caste (United Nations Human Rights Committee, 1996; Venice Commission, 2025).

A responsible summary should be useful without demanding that every citizen read an entire underlying archive. It must identify the narrow claim, evidence period, review status, material unresolved disagreement, source access where lawful, and a correction route. A summary cannot certify virtue or displace elections. Public-interface evaluation should test whether readers mistake City membership or polished design for proven fitness; recurring confusion requires revision of the presentation.

35.4.5 — Government and Legal Deferral Answer

The series allocates model government and legal architecture to *The Government of Fairness* and *The Constitution of Fairness*. Neither book supplies actual legal authority; implementation remains a question for the relevant jurisdiction (Manin, 1997; Young, 2000).

Use labels such as “pending legal review,” “jurisdiction-specific,” and “not authorized here” to distinguish coherent design from settled law.

Test public summaries claiming that a functioning City validates the Law, establishes legal validity, proves transition readiness, or warrants government adoption of City standards.

Corrections should name the responsible domain and the measurable operational evidence the City can supply.

35.5 — "Archives and AI Become New Sovereigns"

The archive and Artificial Intelligence objection arises because the City's memory systems will shape what later readers can know. Search, summary, comparison, correction, release, sealing, and long-term preservation can influence public judgment more powerfully than any single speech (Schwartz and Cook, 2002; Narayanan and Shmatikov, 2008). The archive-governance objection asks when memory becomes command. A complete institutional record becomes dangerous when users treat it as the person, the final context, the superior interpreter, or an oracle about motives that no record can directly contain.

35.5.1 — Archive Governance Answer

Memory begins to govern the person when staff defer to summaries over documented correction or later readers treat old context as final despite new evidence (Selbst et al., 2019; Gebru et al., 2021).

Archive accuracy does not guarantee moral completeness. A file may preserve a harsh sentence without the protected weeks surrounding it, a correction without the private repair that made it possible, or a decision without privileged advice that cannot lawfully be disclosed. Governance must therefore label context, absence, dispute, and access limits so a true fragment does not impersonate the whole person or whole event (International Council on Archives, 2012; UNESCO, 2021b).

For a disputed record that appears damaging, preserve both the source material and the context offered by the participant, staff member, or affected person. Display provenance, dispute, correction, and limitation in the same frame.

35.5.2 — AI Subordination Answer

Apply Section 11.7.6's distinction between source-linked assistance and prohibited person inference. An inconsistency check may identify conflicting document versions or factual entries within its authorized task; it may not become a credibility, motive, readiness, or character profile, disclosed or hidden (Kroll et al., 2017; Mitchell et al., 2019).

Apply Section 30.1.1 before deployment. Reopen approval after a material change in purpose, model, data, audience, autonomy, or consequence; review must match the output's gravity and reversibility (NIST, 2024b; Council of Europe, 2024; OECD, 2024a; ISO/IEC, 2023).

Give the reviewer a fictional inconsistency flag with a confident explanation. First test whether the task is permitted. If it is, require the reviewer to trace the compared sources, identify omissions, and discard an unsupported flag (NIST, 2024b; OECD, 2024a).

35.5.3 — Human Audit Answer

Use the lifecycle and bias-review requirements in Sections 30.2.4 and 30.2.6 to test whether higher-impact outputs received stronger evaluation, documentation, challenge, and monitoring (NIST, 2024b; OECD, 2024a).

Audit has become post hoc justification when logs are missing, templates escape review, model or data changes occur without notice, explanations are too thin to contest, appeals are inaccessible, or proprietary claims block inspection. Assurance must exist before an output hardens into a public conclusion and must continue after deployment as the system, audience, and consequences change (NIST, 2024b; OECD, 2024a).

A serious pilot preserves auditor access to logs and source records, vendor-independent testing, incident findings,

corrective action, and a record of what auditors could not inspect.

Test whether adverse findings can cost the reviewer access, funding, or authority; such dependence defeats the independence required in Section 29.5.2 (Institute of Internal Auditors, 2020; IIA, 2024).

35.5.4 — Appeal Answer

Use Chapter 29's formal appeal route and Chapter 30's technical challenge process. The test is whether an affected person can reach a decision-maker able to change the output, with interim protection when delay would magnify harm (Council of Europe, 2024; European Union, 2024; Venice Commission, 2025).

Appeal is not real when 'the tool generated it' is accepted as a complete explanation, the appeal body cannot inspect the relevant process, no responsible decision owner can be named, or technical complexity is used to delay correction (International Council on Archives, 2012; Kroll et al., 2017).

Rehearse a machine-assisted public summary that mischaracterizes a fictional affected person. Test immediate restriction, preservation of the disputed version, a meaningful response, and correction on City-controlled surfaces. Log notices to downstream recipients and distinguish confirmed correction from copies that cannot be reached (Council of Europe, 2024; Venice Commission, 2025).

35.5.5 — Infrastructure Vendor-Capture Answer

Test the exit and audit controls in Sections 30.4.2–30.4.4, including data segregation and subcontractor disclosure, under replacement or shutdown (NIST, 2024b; ISO/IEC, 2023).

Run the migration drill (Section 30.4.2) without vendor cooperation, when contract rights are hardest to exercise; verify

that rebuilt search retains provenance (NIST, 2024b; ISO/IEC, 2023).

35.6 — "Sex, Children, and Families: Impossible?"

If the City cannot protect children, intimacy, partners, dependents, reproductive health, household conflict, and nonparticipant dignity, then no amount of public-power accountability can save the design (United Nations, 1989; Westman, 2001). Protection begins by excluding nonconsenting relatives from the participant's evidence obligation. Separate support and complaint routes are necessary when a family's interests conflict with publicity. A practice that makes private harm the price of public accountability must be restricted or stopped.

35.6.1 — Child Protection Answer

Child protection has failed when childhood becomes legible to strangers. Family scenes used to humanize participants, record-site references that identify routines, summaries that describe children's reactions, and school or safety information entering civic narratives are not minor disclosure errors (Nissenbaum, 2010; Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021).

The child-protection test is whether a young person can grow without becoming evidence in an adult participant's public explanation. Childhood cannot be reconstructed later after searchable images, schedules, health clues, or family conflict have travelled. The City should prefer a partial public account, or no account at all, to a more complete narrative purchased with a child's present privacy and future autonomy (Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021).

35.6.2 — Intimacy Dignity Answer

Terms such as transparency, accountability, and public interest can sound principled while swallowing sexual history,

reproductive health, bodily exposure, private conflict, or another person's identity. The City needs purpose-specific rules before such material is ever captured or released (Citron, 2019; Nissenbaum, 2010).

The public rarely needs the intimate detail itself. It may need a role-relevant fact: a conflict of interest, misuse of power, coercion, a public contradiction, or an institutional failure. The record should state that fact with the least exposure necessary and preserve the protected source material only under lawful, purpose-limited custody (Citron, 2019; Nissenbaum, 2010).

One concrete review follows an intimate conflict that affects a participant's formation but would humiliate another person if released. The City should ask whether a protected summary, delayed review, category note, or no release can preserve public relevance without violating bodily or relational dignity.

35.6.3 — Family Burden Answer

A participant's visible role can change household schedules, school routines, caregiving load, safety planning, travel, finances, conflict, emotional regulation, public attention, and the sense of home (Greenhaus and Beutell, 1985; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Use authorized operational evidence and voluntary, protected household feedback to examine how relocation, emergency availability, social exclusion, and emotional decompression affect a partner, without converting the family into a participant record or assuming that support payments settle the burden (Greenhaus and Beutell, 1985; Westman, 2001).

Household review should address those burdens, protect privacy, examine income dependence, and test the family's ability to refuse further involvement. Its purpose is to change

institutional conditions, not to evaluate the family's loyalty or resilience (Greenhaus and Beutell, 1985; Westman, 2001).

35.6.4 — Professional Review Answer

Legal counsel, clinicians, child advocates, disability specialists, reproductive-health professionals, privacy experts, and trauma-informed reviewers need authority to interrupt a procedure, require a less-exposing route, or stop a release when collateral harm is plausible. Their disagreements and conflicts should remain in the decision record rather than being collapsed into a single institutional voice (Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021; Nissenbaum, 2010).

Professional boundaries are being overridden when staff press for source notes, public summaries of clinical or legal advice, waivers framed as proof of sincerity, or disclosure from relationships governed by independent duties (Committee on the Rights of the Child, 2021; Westman, 2001).

Counsel, clinicians, educators, archivists, and other professionals must be able to identify the applicable rules, preserve confidentiality and independence, and refuse an incompatible City instruction without retaliation. When staff begin treating professional limits as obstacles to transparency, the role boundary has failed and the function requires suspension and redesign.

35.6.5 — Nonparticipant Remedy Answer

Rehearse harm to a fictional nonparticipant from an otherwise lawful role record. Can an independent route order temporary shielding outside business hours, receive evidence privately, and consider remedy even when leadership disputes the account? Legality alone does not settle whether the design caused avoidable harm (Citron and Solove, 2022).

Track repair of reachable derivative records and distinguish confirmed corrections from copies that remain unreachable.

Review completed cases together; record distinct design changes to prevent recurring source and propagation failures.

35.7 — Donors, Vendors, and Staff

The City's own support ecology can become the hidden pipeline of power. Money decides what can be built. Vendors decide what can be operated. Staff carry the daily burden. Host communities absorb spillovers. If these systems are hidden, the City will expose participants while concealing the conditions that shape them (Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978; OECD, 2025c).

35.7.1 — Donor Capture Answer

Donor capture is visible when programs bend toward a funder's interests, donors gain participant access, launch schedules accelerate under financial pressure, failures become harder to publish, or naming practices create moral ownership. The test is whether the City can refuse money without losing the ability to act independently (OECD, 2017a; INTOSAI, 2007).

Test unwritten expectations of access, naming, gratitude, influence, favored interpretation, or informal deference under Chapter 32's donor controls, with the same scrutiny as express contract terms (ISO, 2021c; Pfeffer and Salancik, 1978).

Rehearse a useful gift with a condition that threatens independence, using Chapter 32's finance controls. Record who can refuse it and how the unfunded need will be handled. An actual refusal is evidence when such an offer occurs; the absence of a refusal is not itself proof of capture.

35.7.2 — Contracting Vendor-Capture Answer

Vendor capture is not only a technical problem. A food provider, security contractor, health platform, cloud service, archive system, translation vendor, construction firm, or public-interface provider can shape daily life and institutional possibility (OECD, 2015; OECD, 2017a).

Material amendments should trigger independent review, conflict checks, updated risk assessment, and public explanation at the level the change warrants. Renewal should never become automatic because migration is inconvenient (OECD, 2025c; OECD, 2015).

Vendor accountability is tested when a contractor's employee identifies a vulnerability before City leadership does. Vendor workers need complaint routes too, because subcontracted labor may be closest to infrastructure failure (McGoey, 2015; UNCITRAL, 2011).

The acceptance threshold asks whether vendor replacement protects affected persons during transition. Leaving a vendor should not break records, expose data, strand staff, interrupt care, or create emergency shortcuts that burden the people the City is supposed to protect.

35.7.3 — Staff Exploitation Answer

Workload, privacy, complaint, influence, recovery, and labor protections must remain visible across staff roles (Institute of Internal Auditors, 2020; International Labour Organization, 2022a).

Unpaid overtime, high turnover, fear of complaint, emotional depletion, opaque outsourced labor, and public materials that erase the people holding the City together are evidence of downward burden transfer (Reich, 2018; World Health Organization and International Labour Organization, 2022).

The operative threshold asks whether staff can criticize the City without being framed as insufficiently committed.

35.7.4 — Host Burden Answer

Test whether Section 32.5's host ledger captures the costs imposed on surrounding communities, including labor

displacement, land-value changes, and political stigma (Ostrom, 1990; OECD, 2017a).

Local inconvenience treated as public-service sacrifice, prestige overriding objections, unmanaged tourism, strained emergency services, and rising costs dismissed in the name of higher purpose all show that consent has been replaced by institutional self-importance (OECD, 2017a; INTOSAI, 2007).

Host-community recourse cannot depend on the City's goodwill. Residents need notice, understandable information, accessible hearings, challenge routes, monitoring data, named decision owners, mitigation duties, and remedies that can alter operations (UNECE, 1998; Ostrom, 1990).

35.7.5 — Audit Answer

Audit findings must be able to change conduct. Warning signs include predictable conclusions, inaccessible reports, reviewers selected for friendliness, restricted evidence, absent follow-up, and merely reassuring public summaries (Rose-Ackerman and Palifka, 2016).

Sample maintenance, scheduling, procurement, and queue backlogs as well as prominent incidents. Revisit repaired workflows after ordinary use to test whether the same burden returned under a new label, vendor, or process.

An auditor who finds retaliation fears, drifting release decisions, recurring host complaints, or excessive vendor access must issue findings with corrective deadlines and refer urgent restrictions to the body holding stop authority. Reporter protection must remain available through an independent route. The responsible bodies must implement the remedy, and the auditor must verify closure without auditing its own operational decisions. Public audit status should identify unresolved

recommendations, the responsible decision-maker, and the reason they remain open.

35.8 — "First City Will Drift Before Replication"

The last objection concerns time. A City may begin with clear boundaries and still drift before replication. Success can be more dangerous than failure because success attracts admiration, money, excuses, urgency, and defenders who do not want the story interrupted (Mahoney and Thelen, 2010; Ebrahim et al., 2014). Replication should require periodic independent reauthorization rather than rely on the founding team's original intent.

35.8.1 — Drift Recognition

Defensiveness, language cleanup without mechanism change, exclusion of critics from review, and success metrics used to silence caution are early signs that prestige is outrunning correction (Reason, 1997; Columbia Accident Investigation Board, 2003).

Drift detection begins with ordinary operational residue: exception logs, repeated near misses, staff warnings, public misunderstanding reports, delayed-audit notices, unresolved conditions, and red-team findings. These signals should be reviewed across time and across sites before any single event is explained away as local variation.

35.8.2 — Accreditation and Decertification

Accreditation has become a prestige badge when standards merely describe what the first City already does, reviewers are chosen for loyalty, reports contain no meaningful adverse findings, or status language migrates into donor marketing (Damschroder et al., 2009; Moore et al., 2015).

Test Section 34.5's process against the founding City failing a later standard it helped inspire. An independent accreditor must be able to state that the origin site no longer qualifies, identify

the affected scope, communicate the decision despite reputational pressure, protect people and fund continuing duties during transition, and set the conditions for restoration or closure (Staw, 1976; Meyer and Rowan, 1977).

Decertification is fictional when probation never ends, severe harm receives only private correction, leadership negotiates status after the fact, or reviewers fear that removal will damage the project's image (Leveson, 2011; Selznick, 1949).

35.8.3 — Failure Memory Answer

Use the failure-memory system in Section 34.5.5 to test whether lessons survive changed leadership and incentives (Sitkin, 1992; Chambers et al., 2013).

Failure memory has been captured by reputation management when settlements remain private without pattern review, lessons become vague, public summaries erase severity, or leaders call a general mechanism a local anomaly (DiMaggio and Powell, 1983; Reason, 1997).

One predictable test is leadership turnover. New leaders may want a fresh start, but affected persons live with old injuries. Failure memory should be durable enough that no new administration can erase inconvenient lessons by changing tone (Columbia Accident Investigation Board, 2003; Aarons et al., 2011).

Acceptance turns on whether later designs can point to specific failures they avoided. A lesson that cannot change a future floor plan, release rule, vendor contract, staffing ratio, or accreditation condition has not become memory in the operational sense.

35.8.4 — No Scale Without Correction

Apply Section 34.2 accreditation to the proposed expansion and demonstrate that correction reaches each receiving site before replication. Scale pressure becomes coercive when public

language suggests every region should adopt the City, refusal is backward, participants deserve office, the network proves the Formal Law, or the first City has solved public trust. Admiration, urgency, or early success must never become an obligation to reproduce the institution elsewhere (Vaughan, 1996; Damschroder et al., 2009).

Urgency without correction exports unfinished problems in a new form (Moore et al., 2015; Staw, 1976). Serious objections must change architecture, protect a person, move authority, or close the proposal.

Chapter 36 — Answerability, Not Triumph

The final Chapter opens in a review room rather than at a ribbon-cutting. Participants, staff representatives, family and host delegates, critics, auditors, and the owners of adjacent project domains sit around the same table with authority to say what remains, what changes, and what ends. Their task is not to admire the City. It is to determine whether every power, record, promise, protection, and handoff still has an answerable owner.

Ten ordinary parts of the institution guide that review: a threshold, a protected room, a record label, a hearing docket, a classroom draft, an office-boundary file, an audit report, a lifecycle budget, a stop decision, and an exit plan. Together they reveal more than a skyline or mission statement. They show whether the City has become a built civic institution whose boundaries can be walked, questioned, corrected, and, when necessary, closed.

The ending preserves the series architecture by returning every borrowed question to its proper owner. Receive, apply, and return keeps the City within its assigned scope and prevents one coherent institution from becoming a master explanation.

Without clean handoffs, coherence would become expansion. The City could begin to speak as though Government should obey it and law should ratify it. It might demand that voters prefer it, science confirm it, religion bless it, and ordinary life imitate it. It might then expect material systems to fund it, transition to accelerate it, and utopia to be defined by it. The final synthesis replaces that inflation with thresholds a reader can inspect.

The final synthesis can still be hopeful. Public-power formation may become more knowable; chosen role burden may move scrutiny upward; ordinary life may remain private; records may become more correctable; and staff, family, and host burdens may become visible before they harden into custom.

These gains are modest beside the scale of public power, but they are consequential because they make earlier correction possible.

A mature City would keep its operating statement available to participants, workers, applicants, families, host residents, journalists, auditors, critics, visitors, and people who never enter. That statement would explain what the City contributes, what it refuses, who can challenge it, which records can change, which alternatives remain available, and who can halt a function. Public understanding becomes part of answerability when the routes are clear enough to use without insider permission.

This chapter is best remembered as a constraint on future confidence. The City closes by promising neither triumph nor innocence, but an institution that remains inspectable, contestable, correctable, and stoppable. It accepts that fidelity may require the design to become smaller, quieter, fundamentally different, or finished. The reader remains free to reject the proposal, borrow only its safeguards, or demand a better institution.

36.1 — The City in One View

The City can now be read as a connected sequence of promises. An applicant enters through an explained commitment. Education becomes work that can be examined. That work reaches the public through a governed record, and a disputed account can return for correction. The final view follows those connections through the people who keep them working. It asks whether a person can move from a stated promise to the room, service, or responsible office that gives it practical effect.

36.1.1 — Walking Through the Working Institution

On a final walk-through, include people who can stop the tour. The facilities manager should name maintenance weak points, and the formal intake officer should demonstrate a protected complaint route. The host reviewer should point to mitigation records, and the archivist should separate source custody from public interface.

Time is the final practical measure of these routes. A remedy delivered after an avoidable exposure may be procedurally complete and materially too late. Chapter 29 assigns the clocks; the closing review asks how much time actually passed between a credible signal and effective protection, including delays hidden by a case being marked closed (Bovens, 2007; Lindberg, 2013; Fox, 2007).

36.1.2 — Following the Effects Beyond the Role

The closing review returns to people who may never hold the public role but can still bear its costs. The broader account of private life belongs to *The Life of Fairness*; the City must answer for the specific demands it places on workers, households, and hosts.

Suppose a procurement discussion unnecessarily exposes a contractor’s home address in a public bundle. Restrict that detail promptly, preserve the lawful procurement record, and review downstream copies. The correction protects ordinary life without implying that every role-relevant contractor name requires consent before publication (Nissenbaum, 2010; United Nations, 2011).

36.2 — What the City Changes About Public Power

The most important consequences of formation may appear somewhere else. A participant learns within the City, then carries a way of working into a different institution with its own responsibilities. Following that journey makes the proposal concrete. The example below asks what changes for the people using a public service, while keeping the educational contribution distinguishable from the service's own decisions and resources.

36.2.1 — From Preparation to a Public Service

The City’s wider social promise becomes clearer when a formation practice follows its lawful route into public service. Consider an illustrative municipal housing-support office in which residents receive technically accurate eligibility letters but often miss a short appeal window. A former City participant enters that office through ordinary lawful appointment, not through any entitlement supplied by the City. The agency, not the City, holds legal authority and official records. Within the agency’s rules, the official asks front-line workers and affected residents to trace a case from application through notice, waiting, translation, appeal, and corrected outcome. A revision might produce a more usable notice, an accessible assistance route, or earlier review of an impending deadline. Competing proposals must still meet the agency’s legal and budget obligations.

36.2.2 — Following the Result into Ordinary Life

The public result would be judged by more than a well-written explanation. An independent evaluation could examine how often eligible residents receive timely notice, how many justified appeals reach a decision before an irreversible loss, whether

erroneous denials are corrected, what effort residents expend, which workers absorb additional tasks, and whether protected information remains protected. Where lawful and meaningful, comparisons across time, offices, or phased deployments could help separate the effect of the service redesign from broader changes. No favorable average waives a rights violation. An observed improvement in the agency would establish an agency result; attributing it specifically to City formation would require an additional credible comparison.

The full chain is education and practice, an inspectable response to challenge, an authorized decision in public office, and a verified consequence for people who never took the Vow. Each link offers a question that public-administration researchers, service designers, and affected communities can investigate. Repeated successes along that chain could gradually make public institutions easier to question and more capable of repair. That is how a bounded City might contribute to a fairer society: not by controlling government or claiming to have constructed utopia, but by helping lawful institutions translate better-formed judgment into a more just experience of public decisions.

36.3 — Handoff to Government and Project Domains

A handoff is an operating threshold. It identifies the object being transferred, the receiving owner, the condition under which the transfer may occur, the record that accompanies it, and the authority that remains outside the City. A receiving institution may accept technical evidence without accepting the City's policy judgment. The transfer needs a named lawful authority with responsibility for correction and remedy.

36.3.1 — Government Handoff

The Government of Fairness receives questions of public authority and office. City support for record continuity or public explanation remains subject to the lawful authority and custody rules in Section 26.7.

The return route can improve both institutions. An agency may report that a formation exercise overlooked a recurring administrative difficulty. The City can use that experience to revise its teaching, while the agency retains responsibility for its own service. Conversely, a useful educational method can be adapted by a public-service school for its own students and duties. What travels is the method and the evidence for its usefulness, fitted to the receiving institution's purpose.

36.3.2 — Constitutional Handoff

The Constitution of Fairness develops the series' model legal architecture. The City must identify the actual jurisdiction, authority, and enforceable remedy for each proposed office interface.

The constitutional handoff should remain visible in any future charter-like document. If a public summary lists City rights, it should not imply those rights are enacted everywhere. If a pilot operates under a host agreement, the agreement's status should

be clear. If a remedy depends on future law, it should not be sold as present remedy. Legal architecture begins with status honesty.

36.3.3 — Material Systems Handoff

The material systems handoff sends finance, labor, infrastructure, debt, public cost, enoughness, climate, migration, corruption drag, and material dignity to *The Peace of Fairness*. The City has costs and anti-capture rules, but it does not own the whole material order. It cannot solve poverty, public finance, climate infrastructure, or labor systems by forming public leaders under record.

36.3.4 — Religion of Fairness Handoff

The Religion of Fairness receives questions of optional doctrine, ritual, pastoral practice, community spaces, spiritual interpretation, Clean-Slate City arrangements and covenantal limits. The civic participation boundary remains Section 3.2.

No pastoral interpretation offered through that handoff may recast hardship as payment, deserved correction, spiritual credit or proof of worth. Refusal remains dignified and care immediate.

36.3.5 — Scientific Handoff

The Law of Fairness receives the public root, per-stream nontransferability boundary, and ethical firewall. *The Science of Fairness* receives claim status, measurement governance, rival testing, replication, data use, and scientific verdicts. These are distinct philosophical and scientific handoffs, each governed by the boundary in Section 3.6.

36.3.6 — Transition Handoff

The Transition of Fairness receives questions of transition; *The Utopia of Fairness* receives the wider synthesis. The City

contributes operational evidence, hazards and failure memory to those judgments under their respective conditions.

A handoff needs a return condition: the City stops at its boundary, and authoritative findings can return to change it (Bovens, 2007; Ostrom, 2010).

36.4 — Final Answerability

The informative correction is one the City implements despite a material cost in time, money, convenience, or reputation. Scrutiny should remain effective after good press and expansion interest, when incentives to protect the successful story are strongest.

36.4.1 — A Question People Can Put to Work

The same question should travel with the reader after the book closes. In government, family, work, religion, science, media, and technology, unfairness often survives by hiding who carries the burden. The City is one application of a larger civic habit: ask who is being asked to carry what someone else refuses to name (Bovens, 2007; Young, 2000).

The City's promise is worth investigating: public responsibility can be prepared in a setting where learning is visible and correction has somewhere to go. A person can change a recommendation before it becomes an order. A worker can raise a concern before silence becomes the institution's habit. A citizen can inspect a reasoned account without acquiring someone else's private life. These are practical possibilities around which a serious program of inquiry can form.

That inquiry can begin with the materials and mechanisms described here. Public-administration researchers can examine the contested decision in Section 29.3.4. Human-computer-interaction teams can compare the fictional record presentations proposed in Section 4.5.4. Organizational researchers can test whether a correction transfers to an unfamiliar task, while architects and accessibility specialists can test the thresholds through which people move. Each contribution can produce a method, an improved prototype, or a result another team can examine before a full campus is

proposed. Scholarly support should not purchase agreement or control a team’s conclusions.

36.4.2 — The Invitation Ahead

A City worth building would make public power easier to question and less dependent on hidden leverage. Its achievement would be felt in a decision corrected, a burden relieved, or an ordinary life left free of an obligation it never chose. The work begins wherever people make one part of that promise testable and share what they learn. The future described here is an invitation to that work, with judgment still open and responsibility already worth practicing.

Glossary

A

Abstention: Withholding an answer or judgment when evidence or permission is insufficient for the task. Reviewers distinguish an unresolved question from a verified absence.

Accessibility: The design of places, services, records, and communication so that people with different abilities, languages, and means of access can use them. Accessibility concerns a genuinely usable route rather than a formal offer alone.

Active period: The formally declared interval during which a participant is subject to the City's active public-power formation burden. It begins only after activation and ends through pause, withdrawal, completion, suspension, exit, or another recorded status transition.

Active public-power formation: Study, deliberation, advice, practice, influence, correction, and other role-relevant activity undertaken while preparing for consequential public authority. The City records this role activity rather than claiming a total record of the person.

Active-role record: The governed record of work within a defined public or formation role during its active period. Where completeness is required, preparation and unfinished work belong alongside final outputs. The scope remains role-bound, and recording is separate from public release.

Affected person: A person whose rights, privacy, safety, reputation, work, family life, or other legitimate interests may be materially affected by a City record, decision, release, or participant action.

Answerability: The duty to give an intelligible account of consequential conduct to people or bodies entitled to question

it. Reasons and records make the conduct traceable; review and remedy give the wider accountability arrangement practical effect.

Archive: The governed system that preserves records, provenance, versions, corrections, access history, and failure memory. Preservation does not itself authorize public release, research use, or model training.

Arousal: The activation, wakefulness, or energetic mobilization dimension of experience. High or low arousal can accompany welcome, burdensome, mixed, or neutral states.

Artificial intelligence: Computational systems that can assist bounded tasks such as search, summarization, translation, drafting, classification, recommendation, or routing. Their outputs remain fallible and do not by themselves create authority over human worth, conscience, diagnosis, legal status, civic standing, or PTVC claim status.

Artificial intelligence training: The use of records to change or fit a model's learned behavior. Training is a separate use from search, retrieval, or source-grounded summarization and requires its own lawful authority, governance, provenance, and safeguards.

Audit: A systematic examination of records, systems, or conduct against declared criteria. Its scope and independence must fit the task. Identifying a defect does not itself grant power to decide the underlying dispute or impose a remedy.

Audit of auditors: Independent examination of the people and systems responsible for oversight. It tests whether their review is competent, impartial, and effective within its mandate, rather than assuming that the reviewer is beyond question.

B

Balance: In the main Law proposal, exact equality of the complete finite positive and negative felt magnitudes within one qualifying conscious stream. It is not simply a calm mood or a balanced group average.

Biological death: The end of biological life. It may be associated with a stream endpoint in some cases, but PTVC does not define biological death as the truth-level endpoint by stipulation.

Bounded active record: The role-limited record architecture that follows consequential public-power formation during active status while preserving protected life, nonparticipant rights, and post-exit boundaries.

Burden: A cost carried in lived experience, time, effort, risk, uncertainty, constraint, exposure, pain, fatigue, care work, or lost options. Burden analysis asks where costs fall, including costs hidden by a successful outcome or attractive surface.

C

Calibration: Checking instruments or judgments against a suitable reference. Reviewer calibration uses shared assessment criteria. Forecast calibration asks whether events assigned similar probabilities occur at corresponding frequencies across the cases examined.

Candidate mechanism: A proposed way of carrying out a specified City function that remains subject to evaluation and the authority required for its use.

Capture: Creating or preserving information in a controlled record. Capture and later access, publication, retention, or reuse are separate operations requiring their own proper basis.

Care before interpretation: When a person is in pain, danger, illness, grief, crisis, or severe deprivation, care and protection come before theoretical interpretation. Meaning may be explored afterward when wanted, but assistance does not depend on accepting a PTVC explanation.

City of Fairness: The proposed voluntary adult civic-formation institution developed in The City of Fairness. Participants prepare for consequential public roles under a complete, bounded active-role record. It is distinct from operating government and religious formation, and participation does not confer public office.

Civic interface: The governed boundary through which participants and the City engage the public, receive questions or input, provide explanations, and make records usable without transferring governmental authority to the institution.

Civic server: A moderated technical service that supports public participation, information access, discussion, or structured input while remaining governed by identity, anti-abuse, accessibility, and privacy rules.

Closure: In City operations, the governed ending of a service or institution, with continuing care, record, remedy, and exit duties assigned. In formal PTVC contexts, satisfaction of a declared terminal target. On the primary additive PTVC branch, closure means that the finite positive and negative phenomenal magnitudes within one qualifying stream are exactly equal; equivalently, its terminal signed residual is zero.

Complete active-role record: The record of all work within the agreed active formation role and period, including preparation, advice, unfinished attempts, decisions, and corrections. Completeness concerns that undertaking, not the whole person or unrestricted public access.

Conscious stream: The course of conscious experience belonging to one subject under stated identity and continuity rules. The Law of Fairness considers each qualifying stream separately, rather than combining different subjects' experiences.

Consciousness: Subjective experience: there is something it is like for the bearer. Perception, thought, emotion, and other experienced contents can belong to a conscious stream. Reports, behavior, and biological or computational signals can provide evidence about consciousness without being identical to the experience itself.

Continuity break: An interruption in expected active-role record integrity, affecting capture, custody, access logging, classification, or preservation. Lawful pause or exit and lawful access or release restrictions on intact records are not, by themselves, continuity failures.

Correction: Identifying an error, establishing a justified corrected version or action, and carrying the change into the records or arrangements still affected. The relevant history remains traceable.

Correction and withdrawal: The accountable process of detecting a problem, assessing it, containing harm, correcting the record, propagating the change, documenting it, and withdrawing or retiring affected claims, tools, routes, or public artifacts when correction is not enough.

Correction log: A durable record of corrections, responsible decision makers, dates, reasons, affected objects, and any downstream updates required to keep public memory accurate.

Covenant: The practical agreement governing participant obligations and institutional duties during the City

relationship, including support, record burden, boundaries, review, pause, and exit. It is civic rather than sacred status.

D

De-loading: A deliberate reduction of workload, exposure, public interface, or other active burden when continued intensity would undermine health, consent, judgment, or institutional integrity.

Decertification: The withdrawal of network recognition from a City or related institution that no longer meets required safeguards, governance, record, rights, or integrity standards.

Decision rule: The declared criteria for turning evidence or public input into an institutional decision, together with the authority to act and the conditions for reconsideration.

Delayed release: A lawful disclosure design in which material is preserved but publication is postponed for a defined reason, duration, review schedule, and challenge route.

Deliberation: Structured consideration of reasons, evidence, alternatives, and consequences before a decision. Deliberation can improve public judgment without requiring unanimity.

Dignity under active record: The rule that extensive role visibility does not make humiliation, bodily exposure, intimate detail, or spectacle legitimate. Dignity changes handling without erasing accountability.

E

Emergency access: Time-limited access to otherwise restricted records when a defined safety, medical, legal, security, or continuity need requires it. Emergency access must be logged and reviewed.

Endpoint: The boundary at which a qualifying conscious stream ceases for purposes of the truth-level target. An endpoint must be defined by the stream model rather than equated automatically with biological death, loss of contact, device shutdown, or the last observed report.

Escrow: Controlled custody in which material is preserved but access or release is withheld until declared conditions, reviewers, or dates authorize further use.

Estimand: The precisely defined quantity a study aims to estimate. Its definition specifies what is being measured and the interval or group to which the answer applies.

Estimator: The calculation or rule used to turn observations into an estimate of a specified quantity. The estimate remains distinct from the experience being studied.

Exit: The practical ability to end participation through an understandable route, with rights and agreed transition support preserved. Ending the active role stops future role capture; records already held and obligations already owed continue under their governing terms.

F

Failure memory: A durable account of what failed, why an activity was paused or stopped, and what was learned or corrected. It allows later people to learn from the evidence after those with firsthand knowledge have left.

Fairness: A family of questions about how benefits, burdens, opportunities, rules, reasons, and remedies are distributed and justified. In this series, ethical and institutional fairness remains distinct from PTVC's scientific terminal-closure hypothesis; neither reduces to the other.

Falsification: A result that conflicts with a prespecified claim under the study's stated assumptions and validity gates. Falsification must identify which target, route, or auxiliary claim is affected rather than overgeneralizing from one failed component.

Firewall: An explicit boundary that prevents evidence, authority, language, or records from one domain from being used to justify a conclusion or power that belongs to another domain.

Formation ecology: The interacting environment through which public-power seekers develop judgment, habits, dependencies, relationships, skills, correction patterns, and readiness. The City's distinct claim is that some of these interactions may need to be understood together rather than as isolated disclosures.

G

Government transparency zone: A lawful interface in which City practices may accompany official work only to the extent permitted by the governing constitutional, administrative, records, security, and employment rules of the actual public institution.

H

Host community: The town, region, jurisdiction, and affected local public around a City site. Host communities carry material and symbolic burdens and therefore require standing, review, remedy, and lawful participation in decisions that affect them.

Human review: A process in which an authorized person examines the relevant source material and can question, correct, or reject a proposed outcome within their assigned

powers. Automated assistance does not replace responsibility for the decision.

I

Identification: Establishing or recognizing who someone is, directly or through combined details. Privacy review considers whether context can reveal a person even after names and images have been removed.

Inference: A conclusion drawn from observations and stated assumptions. A City record distinguishes the inference from its source evidence so readers can examine the connection and consider other explanations.

Influence: Advice, leverage, access, dependence, persuasion, money, status, institutional pressure, or other forces capable of shaping public-power formation. Influence is not automatically corrupt, but consequential influence should be answerable.

Interpretation: An account of what a record or body of evidence means. It should distinguish the source from the judgment drawn from it and remain open to correction or challenge.

L

Law of Fairness: The hypothesis that, in its primary additive formulation, each qualifying conscious stream has finite, exactly equal total positive and negative felt magnitudes across its complete qualifying history strictly before an independently defined true endpoint. Each stream is considered separately.

Least-burdensome means: The principle that a more intrusive City mechanism should not be used when a less burdensome lawful approach can adequately address the same public problem.

Ledger: An organized record of entries and their review history. In the City's practical proposals, ledgers follow matters such as costs, funding, permissions, or burdens so that later readers can trace a decision and its consequences.

M

Machine-assisted summary: A labeled summary produced with computational assistance and tied to traceable source records. It is an aid to navigation or comprehension, not a substitute for source evidence or final public judgment.

Material stabilization: Housing, healthcare, dependent support, financial relief, and other practical support intended to reduce leverage and make refusal, correction, and exit more real. Stabilization is legitimate only when it does not purchase loyalty or create new captivity.

Missingness: The absence of observations an inquiry expected or needed. Evaluation distinguishes unrecorded events, missing responses, and information outside a reader’s permission rather than treating every absence as zero.

Motivation: The reasons and incentives associated with a person’s actions. The book distinguishes private motivation from public justification and examines conduct without claiming complete access to someone’s motives.

N

Negative control: In the funding discussion, power exercised by blocking or delaying action, such as postponing a review or threatening to withdraw support. The term describes institutional influence, not an experimental comparison.

Nonparticipant: A person who has not accepted a defined project-linked public role or activity. Nonparticipation creates

no adverse inference about rights, civic standing, loyalty, belief, or worth.

Nontransferability: A limit on applying readiness evidence to a different task or office. In PTVC, the separate rule that one conscious stream's experience cannot balance another's.

O

Observation: Information obtained by attending to an event, activity, or condition. A City record retains its source and circumstances while distinguishing what was observed from the explanation attached to it.

Observation window: The stated period covered by an assessment or study. A readiness comparison identifies that interval alongside the role, jurisdiction, and authorized evidence source.

Office interface: The documented handoff between City formation and lawful public office. It identifies which institution holds authority, which record regime controls, who supervises personnel and public money, which secrecy and disclosure rules apply, and where complaint and remedy lie.

Operational evidence: Evidence about whether the City's own mechanisms are feasible, livable, rights-protecting, sustainable, useful, or defective. Operational evidence may guide civic design without constituting scientific proof of PTVC.

Optional spiritual path: The optional religious interpretation and practice explored in *The Religion of Fairness* around fairness, hidden burden, enoughness, care, and repair. It is voluntary and separate from PTVC's scientific evaluation and from civic standing, public office, aid, or ordinary dignity.

Oversight access: Purpose-limited permission for auditors, inspectors, courts, regulators, and other formally authorized reviewers to examine defined records under their respective mandates. The City's informal organizational ombuds may receive voluntarily supplied information and make informal inquiries within its confidential charter; oversight classification alone gives that office no compulsory search, formal investigation, or adjudicative authority.

Ownership: In City governance, legally defined rights or assigned responsibilities concerning an asset, record, or decision; ownership does not imply unrestricted access to personal information. In formal PTVC contexts, the prospectively specified rule assigning each qualifying phenomenal contribution to its bearer without omission, double counting, or cross-stream transfer. Phenomenal ownership answers whose experience a contribution is; routing governs continuity through time and transitions.

P

Pause: A deliberate interruption of a practice or proposal when safety, consent, evidence, capacity, or authority is inadequate. A pause can be responsible care rather than defeat, spiritual regression, or a reason to punish participants.

Per-Stream Terminal Valence Closure (PTVC): The technical name for the Law's proposed complete-stream relation. Per-stream specifies separate histories; terminal concerns their true completion; valence concerns felt character; closure names satisfaction of the final relation. See Law of Fairness.

Phenomenal magnitude: The represented amount of positive or negative felt experience assigned to a stream under a declared valence representation. Positive and negative gross magnitudes remain distinct from their signed net difference.

Phenomenal valence: See Valence.

Policy: In City governance, an adopted rule or course of action for a stated institutional purpose. In a formal decision model, a rule mapping available information or state to actions, possibly probabilistically.

Positive and negative phenomenal magnitudes: On the primary additive branch, the nonnegative complete-stream totals of the positive and negative parts of the signed phenomenal measure. PTVC proposes that these two finite quantities are exactly equal within each qualifying stream.

Preregistration: Recording research questions and planned analyses before inspecting the outcomes used to test them. It distinguishes advance predictions from later exploration.

Procedural fairness: Fairness in rules and decision paths, including knowable standards, voice, understandable reasons, consistency, limited bias, respectful treatment, correction, and appeal.

Process evidence: Evidence about a specified route, mechanism, state transition, or selection process.

Protected nonvisibility: Rules that keep sensitive or third-party material outside ordinary exposure, including noncapture when collection is unjustified. Necessary records receive purpose-limited access and review; even their existence may require protection. These limits do not authorize concealed official decisions.

Protected summary: A public or limited-access description that communicates the role-relevant status of a protected event without disclosing raw details whose release would violate dignity, privilege, safety, or third-party rights.

Prototype: An initial implementation built to examine whether a design can perform its intended function. It makes practical dependencies and needed revisions visible before wider use; it is not a commitment to expand the design.

Provenance: The documented origin and history of a source, record, or derived output, including the relevant versions, transformations, custody, and corrections. Provenance helps users understand what they have and how it came to them.

PTVC: See Per-Stream Terminal Valence Closure (PTVC).

Public bundle: A governed collection of released records, context, status labels, replies, corrections, and provenance prepared for public use around a defined topic or decision.

Public-power seeker: An adult voluntarily seeking formation for a role capable of imposing substantial public consequences. The category is functional and role-specific, not a claim of moral superiority.

Q

Qualifying conscious stream: A conscious stream that satisfies the declared scope, identity, routing, inclusion, and validity conditions for the target being considered. These criteria must be fixed independently of whether the stream appears to satisfy closure.

R

Readiness: A justified finding that the conditions for a specified next action or role are in place at an identified time. Evidence, authority, practical capacity, and support must fit that particular undertaking; readiness is not a permanent or universal status.

Record lifecycle: The governed sequence through which a record may move among capture, custody, classification,

access, release, interpretation, correction, research use, retention, sealing, deletion, and related states.

Record site: The public-facing or authorized interface through which City records can be searched, contextualized, corrected, challenged, and understood according to their status and access rules.

Red team: An independent or adversarial review function tasked with finding vulnerabilities, failure routes, manipulation opportunities, and assumptions that ordinary internal review may miss.

Registered Report: A publication format in which a study's question, methods, and analysis plan receive peer review before results are known, with publication not conditioned on obtaining a preferred outcome.

Release: A governed act that makes a record or summary available beyond its prior access class. Release requires authority, purpose, context, protected-person treatment, version information, and a correction route.

Replication: In this book's institutional design, creating another City under fresh legal, host-community, rights, staffing, and funding review; it is not automatic approval to copy the first site. In scientific research, a new test of whether a result, measurement relation, or model distinction recurs under prespecified conditions, with adverse and null outcomes retained. Institutional replication does not establish scientific replication.

Representation: In civic contexts, acting or speaking for people under a defined mandate. In PTVC research, a mathematical or conceptual encoding of phenomenal valence, time, state, or route that preserves the distinctions required by the stated research target.

Research use: The use of City records for a defined research purpose under separate lawful and ethical governance. Public availability or operational capture does not automatically authorize research use.

Reserve: Capacity held available for specified future needs. In City finance, funds and liquid resources reserved for care, exit, repair, continuity, or orderly closure rather than ordinary expansion. In PTVC route models, remaining corrective or transition capacity before a relevant horizon. In ordinary-life contexts, practical margin in time, energy, money, health, safety, or support.

Rival model: A capable alternative explanation tested under comparable information, flexibility, and evaluation rules. A Law-specific interpretation gains force only when it performs better on the distinctions the study was designed to resolve.

Role burden: The unusual duties, visibility, record, review, and correction accepted because a participant seeks consequential public power. The burden follows the role, not the worth of the person.

Role relevance: A functional connection between an event, relationship, record, or fact and the formation or exercise of public power. Mere curiosity or causal possibility is not enough to make private life part of the active record.

Route: A defined path through a process, such as public-service preparation, record access, or complaint review. Its purpose and responsible roles explain how a person or question moves between stages.

Routing: In City operations, directing a request, record, or case through authorized services and decision paths. In formal PTVC contexts, the prospectively specified treatment of continuation, pause, restoration, fission, fusion, copying,

replacement, and unresolved continuity, including how earlier and later phenomenal contributions are assigned to streams.

S

Sealing: A governed restriction that preserves a record while limiting ordinary access because law, safety, privilege, dignity, or another valid purpose requires it. Sealing should have authority, scope, and review conditions.

Selection condition: A criterion or circumstance shaping membership in a pilot cohort. Stating these conditions helps readers judge whether findings depend on an unusually selected group and how far they may apply elsewhere.

Staff influence log: A record of material advice, instruction, intervention, or influence by staff where that influence is relevant to public-power formation and should remain traceable without turning ordinary staff life into a public dossier.

Status label: A concise designation that tells readers how a record or participant state should be understood, such as active, protected, delayed, disputed, corrected, paused, withdrawn, suspended, completed, or unresolved.

Stop authority: Preassigned power held by an accountable person or independent reviewer to pause a study, system, publication, or artifact when a declared safety or rights boundary is crossed. Effective authority can interrupt activity, contain harm, trigger care, and require correction or withdrawal rather than merely advise.

Stop rule: A predeclared condition or process requiring pause, redesign, nonreplication, or closure when rights, safety, consent, record integrity, staff sustainability, host burden, law, or other noncompensatory standards fail.

Stream: In formal PTVC contexts, shorthand for a maximal qualifying conscious stream. In broader discussion, the term may refer to a conscious stream under the declared identity and routing criteria.

T

Terminal balance: The proposed equality of a qualifying conscious stream's complete positive and negative phenomenal magnitudes at its true endpoint. The equality concerns the complete stream rather than the feeling present in its final moment.

The Law: See Law of Fairness.

Total Record Rule: *The City of Fairness* shorthand for the Complete Active-Role Record requirement: records relevant to an active public-power formation role are complete within the declared role scope while ordinary private life remains outside that record.

Transparent City: See City of Fairness.

Transparent corridor: A governed travel or movement arrangement designed to preserve active-role continuity while protecting nonparticipants, lawful secrecy, safety, and the rights of people outside the City.

Transparent Vow: The voluntary commitment of an adult to a complete, governed record of all work within an agreed active formation role and period. Private life remains protected, and the commitment does not extend to family, staff, visitors, or anyone outside that defined route.

True endpoint: The boundary at which a qualifying conscious stream actually ends under the stated account of identity and continuity. It must be identified independently of the desired

balance. A last report, a stopped record, or biological death is not automatically that boundary.

V

Valence: The positive, negative, or neutral felt character of experience. It is distinct from arousal, moral approval, practical importance, and a person's worth.

Vendor capture: Dependence on a technology or service provider that gives the vendor practical control over records, continuity, standards, access, or institutional choices beyond what accountable governance should allow.

Verdict: The declared evidential conclusion produced by a prespecified decision architecture, such as support, adverse result, narrowing, abstention, or route retirement. A verdict must state its target and scope.

Versioning: The preservation of identifiable record versions so corrections, updates, withdrawals, and public changes remain traceable instead of silently replacing prior states.

Visitor: A person entering City space without becoming a participant. Visitors retain independent privacy and rights, and access rules must prevent ordinary presence from becoming unchosen record burden.

Voluntary entry: Admission based on informed adult choice with real alternatives, adequate notice, capacity, independent advice, and freedom from coercive dependence. A signature alone does not establish practical voluntariness.

W

Whistleblowing: Disclosure of wrongdoing, serious risk, concealed failure, or abuse through internal channels or lawful external routes, with protection against retaliation for good-faith reporting.

Withdrawal: A participant-initiated end or suspension of active status through a lawful process that protects ongoing rights, record accuracy, practical reintegration, and post-exit boundaries.

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About the Author

Stephen Takowsky has spent his life studying complex systems: how rules shape them, how people cooperate and compete within them, and how hidden constraints can change what becomes possible. His path has crossed finance, competitive strategy, professional esports, and the leadership of global online communities, ultimately leading to the Law of Fairness project, a decades-long effort to investigate whether fairness itself may reflect a deeper structure of conscious life.

Competing as “MrGameTheory,” Takowsky reached number one on the Civilization Revolution leaderboard and in the international Civilization IV and Civilization V leagues while pursuing a career in finance at Morgan Stanley in Beverly Hills. In 2016, aXiomatic, an ownership group led by Peter Guber and Ted Leonsis and backed by investors including Magic Johnson, Steve Case, and Tony Robbins, acquired a controlling interest in Team Liquid. Following the acquisition, Team Liquid selected Takowsky to captain its newly created Civilization team, later recognized by Guinness World Records as the first Civilization esports team. Across thousands of games, Civilization became an unconventional education in strategy: understand the whole system, think far beyond the next move, anticipate intelligent opposition, and keep searching when the obvious paths fail.

Strategy then became community leadership. Takowsky spent seven years at 505 Games, serving as Senior Digital Content & Engagement Manager and leading global communities for Terraria, which has surpassed 70 million copies sold, as well as Ghostrunner, WUCHANG: Fallen Feathers, Eiyuden Chronicle: Hundred Heroes, and other titles. He also founded the United Servers of Discord Alliance, bringing together leaders from major communities built around Roblox, Pokémon, Star Wars, League of Legends, Grand Theft Auto, Warframe, Animal Crossing, and other properties. Earlier, he served as administrator and producer

for TF2Outpost, a major Steam digital-goods marketplace. Across these very different environments, he kept returning to the same insight: better structure can expand what people are capable of building together.

Throughout those years, one question kept following him: could the apparent unfairness of life conceal a deeper structure? That question became the Law of Fairness. Takowsky began developing the idea more than twenty years ago while studying Religious Studies and Philosophy/Law and Society at the University of California, Riverside, and gave it its first public form in his 2009 book, *Of Grandeur*. In the years that followed, he sought out academics and serious thinkers across many disciplines, asking for insights, criticism, and sources that could help separate fact from speculation. What began as a philosophical intuition gradually became a research program built to face mathematics, measurement, competing explanations, and evidence.

The ten-book Law of Fairness series follows that question outward, from consciousness and scientific testing into ordinary life, meaning, and civilization. If the Law is true, then there may be no “free happiness” in the sense of positive experience remaining unresolved by the lifetime balance the hypothesis predicts. That possibility raises a profound practical question: what if humanity has been pursuing the wrong model of utopia? Rather than organizing life around the endless pursuit of pleasure, the series explores whether greater self-moderation, less needless suffering, and better-designed institutions could help remove some of the forces that keep people and societies trapped in conflict, corruption, and instability.

Takowsky’s fifty-year horizon is designed so that building a better future does not require tearing apart the present. It gives institutions and communities time to test reforms, build

infrastructure, prepare future leaders, improve technology, and correct mistakes before they spread. Just as importantly, it gives today's generation the chance to be remembered for beginning something larger than itself: laying the foundations for a more transparent, peaceful, and prosperous world it may never live to see.

The project's future is collaborative. Takowsky welcomes researchers, universities, laboratories, funders, technologists, students, critics, writers, artists, community builders, and volunteers willing to bring rigor, imagination, and courage to one of humanity's oldest questions. The next breakthrough may come from a theorem, an instrument, a dataset, a counterexample, or an experiment no one has yet imagined. *The Law of Fairness* began as one person's question. Its next chapter belongs to everyone willing to help discover what is true and build what that knowledge makes possible.

Explore the project and its official communities at LawOfFairness.com. Research, scholarly, media, funding, volunteer, and collaboration inquiries: team@lawoffairness.com.

The City of Fairness

Could humanity prepare a generation capable of leading a utopia?

The City of Fairness asks whether future public leaders could begin preparing years before taking office, under sustained public scrutiny. Its proposed Transparent City would give people seeking serious public responsibility a place to study, serve, make decisions, face criticism, and learn from mistakes while building a visible record long before the consequences of power become much larger.

The record could reveal not only how someone performs, but who gains access, where influence comes from, and which relationships surround consequential decisions. Instead of asking the public to rely mainly on campaign promises, the Transparent City would offer years of visible preparation and a clearer picture of the people and interests connected to future power.



LawofFairness.com